French, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they are written.

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Preface

This book teaches French one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart — traced back to its root (usually Latin), then forward to the English cousins you already own, so nothing here is a fresh thing to memorize. It is written for someone starting from zero, whose only shared language is English. *jour* ("day") arrives next to *journal* and *journey*; *salut* ("hi") turns out to wish you *health*, like *salute* and *salubrious*.

French has a close sibling in Spanish — both are worn-down Latin — so where a French word and its Spanish cousin descend from one Latin root, the book shows both and dwells on the *difference* between them (why the same *dies* became French *jour* but Spanish *día*; why French keeps *bonjour* singular where Spanish pluralizes *buenos días*). Every such comparison is supplied in full by the text — no prior Spanish is assumed; it is offered as enrichment, and a reader who happens to know Spanish simply nods along.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the French out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind pronunciation. Each lesson names the one or two sounds its own word needs, exactly where they are needed. The whole system is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

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107.1 le supermarché 785
107.2 le cinéma 786
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108.1 le bureau 791
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109.2 le nord 798
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131 Busy, Free, Open, Closed, Calm 933
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132.1 bruyant 939
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133.2 méchant . . . 946
133.3 la chaleur . . . 947
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134 Grass, Ear, Lip, Number (on a door, Address **951**
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134.4 le numéro . . . 953
134.5 l'adresse . . . 954

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135.2 la monnaie . . . 958
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136 Zero, Sixty, Seventy, Ninety, Thousand **963**
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136.2 soixante . . . 964
136.3 soixante-dix . . . 965
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137 To begin, To visit (a place), To answer, To put, To believe **969**
137.1 commencer . . . 969
137.2 visiter . . . 970
137.3 répondre . . . 971
137.4 mettre . . . 971
137.5 croire . . . 972

138 To know (a person, a place), To prefer, To hope, To drive, To get dressed **975**
138.1 connaître . . . 975
138.2 préférer . . . 976

138.3 espérer 977
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138.5 s'habiller 978
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139 Nothing, None, Neither, Which One, Anything at All 983
139.1 rien 983
139.2 aucun / aucune 984
139.3 non plus 985
139.4 lequel / laquelle 986
139.5 n'importe quoi 987

140 Already, Recently, the Day before Yesterday, Formerly, To Happen 989
140.1 déjà 989
140.2 récemment 990
140.3 avant-hier 991
140.4 autrefois 992
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141 The Future, This Evening, a Plan, To Foresee, To Organise 995
141.1 l'avenir 995
141.2 ce soir 996
141.3 le projet 997
141.4 prévoir 998
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142 Opening Hours, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Bill 1001
142.1 l'horaire 1001
142.2 l'avis 1002
142.3 le loyer 1003
142.4 l'annonce 1004
142.5 la facture 1005
142.6 (dialogue) 1005
142.7 (dialogue) 1006

143 To switch on, To switch off, To jump, To smile, To shout 1007
143.1 allumer 1007
143.2 éteindre 1008
143.3 sauter 1009
143.4 sourire 1009
143.5 crier 1010

144 To explain, To translate, To decide, To try, To continue 1013
144.1 expliquer 1013
144.2 traduire 1014
144.3 décider 1015
144.4 essayer 1015
144.5 continuer 1016

145 To sign, To fill in a form, To phone, To discuss, To quarrel 1019
145.1 signer 1019
145.2 remplir un formulaire 1020
145.3 téléphoner 1021
145.4 discuter 1021
145.5 se disputer 1022

146 To be bored, To have fun, To get angry, To worry, To smoke 1025
146.1 s'ennuyer 1025
146.2 s'amuser 1026
146.3 se fâcher 1027
146.4 s'inquiéter 1027
146.5 fumer 1028

147 To compare, To advise, To convince, To criticise, To prove 1031
147.1 comparer 1031
147.2 conseiller 1032
147.3 convaincre 1033
147.4 critiquer 1033
147.5 démontrer 1034

148 To observe, To take part, To go for a walk, To fold, To own 1037
148.1 observer . . . 1037
148.2 participer . . . 1038
148.3 se promener . . . 1039
148.4 plier . . . 1039
148.5 posséder . . . 1040

149 To discover, To seem, To serve, To suffer, To dream 1043
149.1 découvrir . . . 1043
149.2 sembler . . . 1044
149.3 servir . . . 1045
149.4 souffrir . . . 1045
149.5 rêver . . . 1046

150 To move away, To come near, To chat, To plug in, To deliver 1049
150.1 s'éloigner . . . 1049
150.2 s'approcher . . . 1050
150.3 bavarder . . . 1051
150.4 brancher . . . 1051
150.5 livrer . . . 1052

151 To put up, To pray, To recommend, To slow down, To breathe 1055
151.1 héberger . . . 1055
151.2 prier . . . 1056
151.3 recommander . . . 1057
151.4 ralentir . . . 1058
151.5 respirer . . . 1058
151.6 (dialogue) . . . 1059
151.7 (dialogue) . . . 1060

152 To admire, To act, To move forward, To move back, To lower 1063
152.1 admirer . . . 1063
152.2 agir . . . 1064
152.3 avancer . . . 1065
152.4 reculer . . . 1065
152.5 baisser . . . 1066

153 To notice, To replace, To meet, To blush, To bleed 1069
153.1 remarquer . . . 1069
153.2 remplacer . . . 1070
153.3 rencontrer . . . 1071
153.4 rougir . . . 1071
153.5 saigner . . . 1072

154 Health, Brain, Lung, Liver, Kidney 1075
154.1 la santé . . . 1075
154.2 le cerveau . . . 1076
154.3 le poumon . . . 1077
154.4 le foie . . . 1077
154.5 le rein . . . 1078

155 Rest, Sleep, Dream, Anxiety, Love 1081
155.1 le repos . . . 1081
155.2 le sommeil . . . 1082
155.3 le rêve . . . 1083
155.4 l'angoisse . . . 1083
155.5 l'amour . . . 1084

156 Rarely, Afterwards, Finally, From now on, Still 1087
156.1 rarement . . . 1087
156.2 ensuite . . . 1088
156.3 enfin . . . 1089
156.4 désormais . . . 1089
156.5 encore . . . 1090

157 Above, Below, In front, Behind, Beside 1093
157.1 au-dessus . . . 1093
157.2 au-dessous . . . 1094
157.3 devant . . . 1095
157.4 derrière . . . 1095
157.5 à côté . . . 1096

158 So, However, Anyway, On the contrary, Although 1099
158.1 donc . . . 1099
158.2 pourtant . . . 1100
158.3 de toute façon . . . 1101
158.4 au contraire . . . 1101

158.5 bien que 1102

159 Comfortable, Uncomfortable, Polite, Rude, Unpleasant 1105
159.1 confortable 1105
159.2 inconfortable 1106
159.3 poli / polie 1107
159.4 impoli / impolie 1108
159.5 désagréable 1108

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160.1 profond / profonde 1111
160.2 bas / basse 1112
160.3 inconnu / inconnue 1113
160.4 dangereux / dangereuse 1114
160.5 sûr / sûre 1114
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160.7 (dialogue) 1116

161 Modern, Former, Fresh, Spicy, Raw 1119
161.1 moderne 1119
161.2 ancien / ancienne 1120
161.3 frais / fraîche 1121
161.4 épicé / épicée 1121
161.5 cru / crue 1122

162 Worried, With a cold, Single, Married, Divorced 1125
162.1 inquiet / inquiète 1125
162.2 enrhumé / enrhumée 1126
162.3 célibataire 1127
162.4 marié / mariée 1127
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163 Flat, Dining room, Balcony, Lock, Doorbell 1131
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163.2 la salle à manger 1132
163.3 le balcon 1133
163.4 la serrure 1133
163.5 la sonnette 1134

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164.1 le passeport 1137
164.2 la douane 1138
164.3 la réservation 1139
164.4 la boucherie 1139
164.5 le fleuve 1140

165 War, Peace, Army, Soldier, Tradition 1143
165.1 la guerre 1143
165.2 la paix 1144
165.3 l'armée 1145
165.4 le soldat 1145
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166 Photographer, Journalist, Architect, Dentist, Pharmacist 1149
166.1 le photographe 1149
166.2 le journaliste 1150
166.3 l'architecte 1151
166.4 le dentiste 1151
166.5 le pharmacien 1152

167 Mother-in-law, Son-in-law, Daughter-in-law, Fiancé, Fiancée 1155
167.1 la belle-mère 1155
167.2 le gendre 1156
167.3 la belle-fille 1157
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168 Rule, Permission, Ban, Safety, Advice 1161
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168.2 la permission 1162
168.3 l'interdiction 1163
168.4 la sécurité 1163
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169.1 la carte postale 1167
169.2 le dossier 1168

169.3 la fiche de paie 1169
169.4 l'étiquette 1169
169.5 le guide 1170
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169.7 (dialogue) 1172

170 Castle, Tower, Monument, Statue, Fountain 1173
170.1 le château 1173
170.2 la tour 1174
170.3 le monument 1175
170.4 la statue 1175
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171 Volcano, Plain, Waterfall, Rock, Pebble 1179
171.1 le volcan 1179
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172 Plastic, Cotton, Wool, Silk, Leather 1185
172.1 le plastique 1185
172.2 le coton 1186
172.3 la laine 1187
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173 Ball, Racket, Gym, Swimming, Victory 1191
173.1 le ballon 1191
173.2 la raquette 1192
173.3 la salle de sport 1193
173.4 la natation 1193
173.5 la victoire 1194

174 Company, Colleague, Salary, Meeting, Contract 1197
174.1 l'entreprise 1197
174.2 le collègue 1198
174.3 le salaire 1199
174.4 la réunion 1199
174.5 le contrat 1200

174.6 (dialogue) 1201
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175 To kiss, To greet, To thank, To invite, To park 1203
175.1 embrasser 1203
175.2 saluer 1204
175.3 remercier 1205
175.4 inviter 1205
175.5 garer 1206

176 To stop, To change, To move, To take off, To hold 1209
176.1 arrêter 1209
176.2 changer 1210
176.3 déplacer 1211
176.4 enlever 1211
176.5 tenir 1212

177 To promise, To allow, To forbid, To protect, To rescue 1215
177.1 promettre 1215
177.2 permettre 1216
177.3 interdire 1217
177.4 protéger 1217
177.5 sauver 1218

178 To snow, To go with, To add, To announce, To appear 1221
178.1 neiger 1221
178.2 accompagner 1222
178.3 ajouter 1223
178.4 annoncer 1223
178.5 apparaître 1224

179 To depend, To share, To avoid, To throw, To turn 1227
179.1 dépendre 1227
179.2 partager 1228
179.3 éviter 1229
179.4 lancer 1229
179.5 tourner 1230

180 To prepare, To introduce, To lend, To propose, To pick up 1233
180.1 préparer . . . 1233
180.2 présenter . . . 1234
180.3 prêter . . . 1235
180.4 proposer . . . 1235
180.5 ramasser . . . 1236

181 To look like, To push, To pull, To waste, To overtake 1239
181.1 ressembler . . . 1239
181.2 pousser . . . 1240
181.3 tirer . . . 1241
181.4 gaspiller . . . 1241
181.5 dépasser . . . 1242

182 To correct, To direct, To destroy, To exaggerate, To celebrate 1245
182.1 corriger . . . 1245
182.2 diriger . . . 1246
182.3 détruire . . . 1247
182.4 exagérer . . . 1247
182.5 fêter . . . 1248

183 To give up, To exchange, To download, To ski, To slip 1251
183.1 renoncer . . . 1251
183.2 échanger . . . 1252
183.3 télécharger . . . 1253
183.4 skier . . . 1253
183.5 glisser . . . 1254
183.6 (dialogue) . . . 1255
183.7 (dialogue) . . . 1256

184 To stir, To pick, To defend, To disappear, To borrow 1257
184.1 bouger . . . 1257
184.2 cueillir . . . 1258
184.3 défendre . . . 1259
184.4 disparaître . . . 1259
184.5 emprunter . . . 1260

185 Muscle, Thumb, Wound, Scar, Cold 1263
185.1 le muscle . . . 1263
185.2 le pouce . . . 1264
185.3 la blessure . . . 1265
185.4 la cicatrice . . . 1265
185.5 le rhume . . . 1266

186 Friendship, Hope, Trust, Courage, Shame 1269
186.1 l'amitié . . . 1269
186.2 l'espoir . . . 1270
186.3 la confiance . . . 1271
186.4 le courage . . . 1271
186.5 la honte . . . 1272

187 In that case, Late, Suddenly, Until, Since 1275
187.1 alors . . . 1275
187.2 tard . . . 1276
187.3 soudain . . . 1277
187.4 jusqu'à . . . 1277
187.5 depuis . . . 1278

188 Near to, Far from, At the bottom, On the right, On the left 1281
188.1 près de . . . 1281
188.2 loin de . . . 1282
188.3 au fond . . . 1283
188.4 à droite . . . 1283
188.5 à gauche . . . 1284

189 Despite, Unfortunately, Luckily, Certainly, Really 1287
189.1 malgré . . . 1287
189.2 malheureusement . . . 1288
189.3 heureusement . . . 1289
189.4 certainement . . . 1290
189.5 vraiment . . . 1290

190 Cheerful, Serious, Shy, Brave, Fearful 1293
190.1 joyeux / joyeuse . . . 1293
190.2 sérieux / sérieuse . . . 1294
190.3 timide . . . 1295

190.4 courageux / courageuse 1295
190.5 peureux / peureuse 1296

191 Simple, Complicated, Necessary, Useful, Useless 1299
191.1 simple 1299
191.2 compliqué / compliquée 1300
191.3 nécessaire 1301
191.4 utile 1301
191.5 inutile 1302

192 Cooked, Ripe, Dark, Clear, Distant 1305
192.1 cuit / cuite 1305
192.2 mûr / mûre 1306
192.3 sombre 1307
192.4 clair / claire 1307
192.5 lointain / lointaine 1308
192.6 (dialogue) 1309
192.7 (dialogue) 1310

193 Sheet, Drawer, Armchair, Saucepan, Frying pan 1311
193.1 le drap 1311
193.2 le tiroir 1312
193.3 le fauteuil 1313
193.4 la casserole 1313
193.5 la poêle 1314

194 Valley, Temperature, Butterfly, Fly, Mosquito 1317
194.1 la vallée 1317
194.2 la température 1318
194.3 le papillon 1319
194.4 la mouche 1320
194.5 le moustique 1320

195 Dialect, Piece of news, Advertising, Screen, Keyboard 1323
195.1 le dialecte 1323
195.2 la nouvelle 1324
195.3 la publicité 1325
195.4 l'écran 1325
195.5 le clavier 1326

196 Butcher, Mechanic, Electrician, Plumber, Worker 1329
196.1 le boucher . . . 1329
196.2 le mécanicien . . . 1330
196.3 l'électricien . . . 1331
196.4 le plombier . . . 1331
196.5 l'ouvrier . . . 1332

197 Bridegroom, Bride, Widower, Success, Failure 1335
197.1 le marié . . . 1335
197.2 la mariée . . . 1336
197.3 le veuf . . . 1337
197.4 le succès . . . 1337
197.5 l'échec . . . 1338

198 Promise, Discount, Sales, Coin, Banknote 1341
198.1 la promesse . . . 1341
198.2 la réduction . . . 1342
198.3 les soldes . . . 1343
198.4 la pièce . . . 1343
198.5 le billet de banque . . . 1344
198.6 (dialogue) . . . 1345
198.7 (dialogue) . . . 1346

199 Entrance, Exit, Luggage, Seat, Steering wheel 1347
199.1 l'entrée . . . 1347
199.2 la sortie . . . 1348
199.3 les bagages . . . 1349
199.4 le siège . . . 1349
199.5 le volant . . . 1350

200 Gate, Fence, Cellar, Attic, Vegetable garden 1353
200.1 le portail . . . 1353
200.2 la clôture . . . 1354
200.3 la cave . . . 1355
200.4 le grenier . . . 1355
200.5 le potager . . . 1356

201 Earth, Mud, Dust, Smoke, Flame 1359
201.1 la terre . . . 1359
201.2 la boue . . . 1360

201.3 la poussière 1361
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202 Natural rubber, Metal, Brick, Small bag, Rope 1365
202.1 le caoutchouc 1365
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203 Defeat, Championship, Player, Coach, Connection 1371
203.1 la défaite 1371
203.2 le championnat 1372
203.3 le joueur 1373
203.4 l'entraîneur 1373
203.5 la correspondance 1374

204 Interview, Career, Printer, Mobile phone, Sheet of paper 1377
204.1 l'entretien 1377
204.2 la carrière 1378
204.3 l'imprimante 1379
204.4 le téléphone portable 1379
204.5 la feuille de papier 1380
204.6 (dialogue) 1381
204.7 (dialogue) 1382

205 To book, To spend, To save, To order, To dry 1383
205.1 réserver 1383
205.2 dépenser 1384
205.3 économiser 1385
205.4 commander 1386
205.5 sécher 1386

206 To break, To touch, To taste, To heat, To cool down 1389
206.1 casser 1389
206.2 toucher 1390
206.3 goûter 1391
206.4 chauffer 1391

206.5 refroidir 1392

207 To be born, To die, To grow old, To marry, To divorce 1395
207.1 naître 1395
207.2 mourir 1396
207.3 vieillir 1397
207.4 épouser 1397
207.5 divorcer 1398

208 To applaud, To cross, To increase, To decrease, To warn 1401
208.1 applaudir 1401
208.2 traverser 1402
208.3 augmenter 1403
208.4 diminuer 1403
208.5 prévenir 1404

209 To enjoy, To imagine, To point out, To inform, To complain 1407
209.1 profiter 1407
209.2 imaginer 1408
209.3 indiquer 1409
209.4 informer 1409
209.5 se plaindre 1410

210 To reach, To achieve, To give a present, To give back, To recognise 1413
210.1 atteindre 1413
210.2 réaliser 1414
210.3 offrir un cadeau 1415
210.4 rendre 1415
210.5 reconnaître 1416

211 To be silent, To fear, To attempt, To transport, To kill 1419
211.1 se taire 1419
211.2 craindre 1420
211.3 tenter 1421
211.4 transporter 1421
211.5 tuer 1422

212 To fix, To brake, To function, To float, To chase 1425
212.1 fixer 1425
212.2 freiner 1426
212.3 fonctionner 1427
212.4 flotter 1427
212.5 poursuivre 1428

213 To lift, To surprise, To suspect, To squeeze, To suggest 1431
213.1 soulever 1431
213.2 surprendre 1432
213.3 soupçonner 1433
213.4 serrer 1433
213.5 suggérer 1434
213.6 (dialogue) 1435
213.7 (dialogue) 1436

214 To record, To maintain, To exist, To express, To put on weight 1437
214.1 enregistrer 1437
214.2 entretenir 1438
214.3 exister 1439
214.4 exprimer 1439
214.5 grossir 1440

215 Flu, Prescription, Tablet, Syrup, Ointment 1443
215.1 la grippe 1443
215.2 l'ordonnance 1444
215.3 le comprimé 1445
215.4 le sirop 1446
215.5 la pommade 1446

216 Around, Everywhere, Elsewhere, Up there, Suburbs 1449
216.1 autour 1449
216.2 partout 1450
216.3 ailleurs 1451
216.4 là-haut 1451
216.5 la banlieue 1452

217 Almost, About, Only, Together, Nevertheless 1455
217.1 presque . . . 1455
217.2 environ . . . 1456
217.3 seulement . . . 1457
217.4 ensemble . . . 1457
217.5 cependant . . . 1458

218 Curious, Jealous, Proud, Nervous, Quiet 1461
218.1 curieux / curieuse . . . 1461
218.2 jaloux / jalouse . . . 1462
218.3 fier / fière . . . 1463
218.4 nerveux / nerveuse . . . 1463
218.5 tranquille . . . 1464

219 Boring, Fun, Strange, Different, Same 1467
219.1 ennuyeux / ennuyeuse . . . 1467
219.2 amusant / amusante . . . 1468
219.3 étrange . . . 1469
219.4 différent / différente . . . 1470
219.5 pareil / pareille . . . 1470

220 Punctual, Foreign, Friendly, Honest, Patient 1473
220.1 ponctuel / ponctuelle . . . 1473
220.2 étranger / étrangère . . . 1474
220.3 aimable . . . 1475
220.4 honnête . . . 1475
220.5 patient / patiente . . . 1476

221 Scissors, Watch, Pyjamas, Button, Peach 1479
221.1 les ciseaux . . . 1479
221.2 la montre . . . 1480
221.3 le pyjama . . . 1481
221.4 le bouton . . . 1481
221.5 la pêche . . . 1482

222 Society, Government, Law, Court, Judge 1485
222.1 la société . . . 1485
222.2 le gouvernement . . . 1486
222.3 la loi . . . 1487
222.4 le tribunal . . . 1487

222.5 le juge 1488
222.6 (dialogue) 1489
222.7 (dialogue) 1490

223 Battery, Charger, Singer, Concert, Show 1491
223.1 la batterie 1491
223.2 le chargeur 1492
223.3 le chanteur 1493
223.4 le concert 1494
223.5 le spectacle 1494

224 Employee, Pilot, Accountant, Scientist, Researcher 1497
224.1 l'employé 1497
224.2 le pilote 1498
224.3 le comptable 1499
224.4 le scientifique 1499
224.5 le chercheur 1500

225 Experience, Choice, Decision, Possibility, Reason 1503
225.1 l'expérience 1503
225.2 le choix 1504
225.3 la décision 1505
225.4 la possibilité 1505
225.5 la raison 1506

226 Bank card, Cash machine, Bank account, Loan, Debt 1509
226.1 la carte bancaire 1509
226.2 le distributeur 1510
226.3 le compte bancaire 1511
226.4 le prêt 1512
226.5 la dette 1512

227 Wheel, Engine, Toll, Motorway, Fine 1515
227.1 la roue 1515
227.2 le moteur 1516
227.3 le péage 1517
227.4 l'autoroute 1517
227.5 l'amende 1518
227.6 (dialogue) 1519
227.7 (dialogue) 1520

228 Vase, Plant, Seed, Root, Branch 1521
228.1 le vase . . . 1521
228.2 la plante . . . 1522
228.3 la graine . . . 1523
228.4 la racine . . . 1523
228.5 la branche . . . 1524

229 Lightning, Thunder, Climate, Environment, Pollution 1527
229.1 l'éclair . . . 1527
229.2 le tonnerre . . . 1528
229.3 le climat . . . 1529
229.4 l'environnement . . . 1529
229.5 la pollution . . . 1530

230 Thread, Needle, Nail for hammering, Hammer, Ladder 1533
230.1 le fil . . . 1533
230.2 l'aiguille . . . 1534
230.3 le clou . . . 1535
230.4 le marteau . . . 1535
230.5 l'échelle . . . 1536

231 Return, Arrival, Departure, Destination, Landscape 1539
231.1 le retour . . . 1539
231.2 l'arrivée . . . 1540
231.3 le départ . . . 1541
231.4 la destination . . . 1541
231.5 le paysage . . . 1542

232 Magazine, Dictionary, University, Mistake, History 1545
232.1 le magazine . . . 1545
232.2 le dictionnaire . . . 1546
232.3 l'université . . . 1547
232.4 l'erreur . . . 1547
232.5 l'histoire . . . 1548
232.6 (dialogue) . . . 1549
232.7 (dialogue) . . . 1549

233 To iron, To repair, To build, To photograph, To repeat 1551
233.1 repasser . . . 1551
233.2 réparer . . . 1552

233.3 construire 1553
233.4 photographier 1553
233.5 répéter 1554

234 To fill, To empty, To measure, To weigh, To check 1557
234.1 remplir 1557
234.2 vider 1558
234.3 mesurer 1559
234.4 peser 1559
234.5 vérifier 1560

235 To move house, To rent, To rest, To wake up, To do one's hair 1563
235.1 déménager 1563
235.2 louer 1564
235.3 se reposer 1565
235.4 se réveiller 1565
235.5 se coiffer 1566

236 To be enough, To burn, To throw away, To calculate, To hit 1569
236.1 suffire 1569
236.2 brûler 1570
236.3 jeter 1571
236.4 calculer 1571
236.5 frapper 1572

237 To miss, To deserve, To improve, To get worse, To offer 1575
237.1 manquer 1575
237.2 mériter 1576
237.3 améliorer 1577
237.4 empirer 1577
237.5 offrir 1578

238 To reduce, To refuse, To risk, To solve, To fly 1581
238.1 réduire 1581
238.2 refuser 1582
238.3 risquer 1583
238.4 résoudre 1583
238.5 voler 1584

239 To unite, To be worth, To get used to, To realise, To hurry 1587
239.1 unir . . . 1587
239.2 valoir . . . 1588
239.3 s'habituer . . . 1589
239.4 se rendre compte . . . 1589
239.5 se dépêcher . . . 1590

240 To insist, To interrupt, To tie, To mix, To obey 1593
240.1 insister . . . 1593
240.2 interrompre . . . 1594
240.3 attacher . . . 1595
240.4 mélanger . . . 1595
240.5 obéir . . . 1596

241 To cough, To tremble, To scream, To vote, To welcome 1599
241.1 tousser . . . 1599
241.2 trembler . . . 1600
241.3 hurler . . . 1601
241.4 voter . . . 1601
241.5 accueillir . . . 1602
241.6 (dialogue) . . . 1603
241.7 (dialogue) . . . 1604

242 To lose weight, To feed, To go on holiday, To joke, To tidy up 1605
242.1 maigrir . . . 1605
242.2 nourrir . . . 1606
242.3 partir en vacances . . . 1607
242.4 plaisanter . . . 1608
242.5 ranger . . . 1608

243 Plaster, Emergency department, Emergency, Medical appointment, Diet 1611
243.1 le pansement . . . 1611
243.2 les urgences . . . 1612
243.3 l'urgence . . . 1613
243.4 la consultation . . . 1614
243.5 le régime . . . 1614

244 Silent, Clean, Hard, Smooth, Rough 1617
244.1 silencieux / silencieuse 1617
244.2 propre 1618
244.3 dur / dure 1619
244.4 lisse 1619
244.5 rugueux / rugueuse 1620

245 Similar, Fair, False, Ready, Free of charge 1623
245.1 semblable 1623
245.2 juste 1624
245.3 faux / fausse 1625
245.4 prêt / prête 1625
245.5 gratuit / gratuite 1626

246 Generous, Lazy, Hard-working, Talkative, Angry 1629
246.1 généreux / généreuse 1629
246.2 paresseux / paresseuse 1630
246.3 travailleur / travailleuse 1631
246.4 bavard / bavarde 1632
246.5 fâché / fâchée 1632

247 Bill, Tip, Stop, Motorbike, Platform 1635
247.1 l'addition 1635
247.2 le pourboire 1636
247.3 l'arrêt 1637
247.4 la moto 1637
247.5 le quai 1638

248 Mayor, Elections, Vote, Politics, Economy 1641
248.1 le maire 1641
248.2 les élections 1642
248.3 le vote 1643
248.4 la politique 1643
248.5 l'économie 1644

249 Actor, Actress, Poem, Writer, Painter 1647
249.1 l'acteur 1647
249.2 l'actrice 1648
249.3 le poème 1649
249.4 l'écrivain 1649

249.5 le peintre 1650

250 Foreigner, Tourist, Adult, Elderly person, Twin 1653
250.1 l'étranger 1653
250.2 le touriste 1654
250.3 l'adulte 1655
250.4 la personne âgée 1655
250.5 le jumeau 1656
250.6 (dialogue) 1657
250.7 (dialogue) 1658

251 Result, Difference, Example, Truth, Lie 1659
251.1 le résultat 1659
251.2 la différence 1660
251.3 l'exemple 1661
251.4 la vérité 1661
251.5 le mensonge 1662

252 Tax, Form, Envelope, Stamp, Parcel 1665
252.1 l'impôt 1665
252.2 le formulaire 1666
252.3 l'enveloppe 1667
252.4 le timbre 1667
252.5 le colis 1668

253 Driving licence, Helmet, Tunnel, Building site, Block of flats 1671
253.1 le permis de conduire 1671
253.2 le casque 1672
253.3 le tunnel 1673
253.4 le chantier 1673
253.5 l'immeuble 1674

254 Trunk, Thorn, Lawn, Path, Cave 1677
254.1 le tronc 1677
254.2 l'épine 1678
254.3 la pelouse 1679
254.4 le sentier 1679
254.5 la grotte 1680

255 Rubbish, Recycling, Energy, Electricity, Gas 1683
255.1 les déchets . . . 1683
255.2 le recyclage . . . 1684
255.3 l'énergie . . . 1685
255.4 l'électricité . . . 1685
255.5 le gaz . . . 1686

256 Tool, Guitar, Piano, Violin, Drum 1689
256.1 l'outil . . . 1689
256.2 la guitare . . . 1690
256.3 le piano . . . 1691
256.4 le violon . . . 1691
256.5 le tambour . . . 1692

257 Geography, Mathematics, Art, Team, Birthday 1695
257.1 la géographie . . . 1695
257.2 les mathématiques . . . 1696
257.3 l'art . . . 1697
257.4 l'équipe . . . 1697
257.5 l'anniversaire . . . 1698
257.6 (dialogue) . . . 1699
257.7 (dialogue) . . . 1700

258 The Scene — c'était, il y avait, il faisait froid 1701
258.1 je parlais, il parlait . . . 1701
258.2 c'était, il y avait . . . 1703
258.3 il faisait froid, il faisait chaud . . . 1704
258.4 je dormais / j'ai dormi . . . 1706
258.5 quand, pendant que . . . 1708
258.6 (review) . . . 1709

259 D'abord, Ensuite, Enfin — A Story Told in Order 1711
259.1 d'abord . . . 1711
259.2 raconter . . . 1713
259.3 (reading) . . . 1714
259.4 (review) . . . 1716

260 What I Think, and So — je pense que, donc 1719
260.1 je pense que, à mon avis . . . 1719
260.2 donc, alors . . . 1721

260.3 (review) 1722

261 Should, and Why — je devrais, expliquer 1725
261.1 je devrais 1725
261.2 expliquer pourquoi 1727
261.3 (review) 1728

262 Finding the Way — excusez-moi, tout droit 1731
262.1 excusez-moi, pour aller à… ? 1731
262.2 tout droit 1733
262.3 (review) 1734

263 At the Station — un aller-retour, j'ai raté le train 1737
263.1 un aller-retour, un aller simple 1737
263.2 j'ai raté le train 1739
263.3 (review) 1740

264 How It Felt — j'étais content, j'espère 1743
264.1 j'étais content, j'étais inquiet 1743
264.2 j'espère revenir 1745
264.3 (review) 1746

265 More Than, and for How Long — plus … que, depuis, pendant 1749
265.1 plus … que, moins … que 1749
265.2 depuis, pendant 1751
265.3 (review) 1752

266 If — si, s'il pleut, ça dépend 1755
266.1 si, s'il 1755
266.2 s'il pleut, je reste 1757
266.3 ça dépend 1758
266.4 (review) 1760

267 Would — the conditionnel, and Six Lines 1763
267.1 je pourrais, j'aimerais, je devrais 1763
267.2 ce serait 1765
267.3 (review) 1766
267.4 (six lignes) 1767

268 Tout d'abord **1771**
268.1 tout d'abord 1771
268.2 en premier lieu 1772
268.3 par la suite 1773
268.4 en dernier lieu 1774
268.5 pour finir 1775

269 Au moment où **1777**
269.1 lorsque 1777
269.2 dès que 1778
269.3 au moment où 1779
269.4 aussitôt 1780
269.5 tandis que 1781

270 Tout à coup **1783**
270.1 tout à coup 1783
270.2 subitement 1784
270.3 brusquement 1785
270.4 sur le coup 1786
270.5 dans la foulée 1787

271 Peu à peu **1789**
271.1 peu à peu 1789
271.2 progressivement 1790
271.3 au fur et à mesure 1791
271.4 à la longue 1792
271.5 tôt ou tard 1793

272 Jadis et naguère **1795**
272.1 jadis 1795
272.2 naguère 1796
272.3 auparavant 1797
272.4 jusqu'alors 1798
272.5 depuis lors 1799

273 La veille et le lendemain **1801**
273.1 la veille 1801
273.2 le lendemain 1802
273.3 le surlendemain 1803
273.4 dernièrement 1804

273.5 prochainement 1805

274 Ce qui est arrivé 1807
274.1 survenir 1807
274.2 dérouler 1808
274.3 avoir lieu 1809
274.4 précéder 1810
274.5 durer 1811

275 Le temps passe 1813
275.1 écouler 1813
275.2 ajourner 1814
275.3 aboutir 1815
275.4 le contretemps 1816
275.5 l'échéance 1817
275.6 (dialogue) 1818

276 Les époques 1821
276.1 l'époque 1821
276.2 la décennie 1822
276.3 le millénaire 1823
276.4 l'ère 1824
276.5 la durée 1825

277 Étape par étape 1827
277.1 l'étape 1827
277.2 la phase 1828
277.3 la chronologie 1829
277.4 l'instant 1830
277.5 à l'issue de 1831

278 La presse 1833
278.1 l'actualité 1833
278.2 la presse 1834
278.3 le quotidien 1835
278.4 l'hebdomadaire 1836
278.5 l'abonné 1837

279 Écrire pour le journal 1839
279.1 rédiger . . . 1839
279.2 la rédaction . . . 1840
279.3 imprimer . . . 1841
279.4 paraître . . . 1842
279.5 la parution . . . 1843

280 Le journal télévisé 1845
280.1 le journal télévisé . . . 1845
280.2 le présentateur . . . 1846
280.3 le téléspectateur . . . 1847
280.4 l'auditeur . . . 1848
280.5 le micro . . . 1849

281 Le reportage 1851
281.1 le reportage . . . 1851
281.2 l'envoyé spécial . . . 1852
281.3 le correspondant . . . 1853
281.4 la dépêche . . . 1854
281.5 l'agence de presse . . . 1855

282 Les gros titres 1857
282.1 le gros titre . . . 1857
282.2 la manchette . . . 1858
282.3 la rubrique . . . 1859
282.4 l'éditorial . . . 1860
282.5 les faits divers . . . 1861

283 À l'antenne 1863
283.1 diffuser . . . 1863
283.2 la diffusion . . . 1864
283.3 filmer . . . 1865
283.4 interviewer . . . 1866
283.5 l'antenne . . . 1867
283.6 (dialogue) . . . 1868

284 Ce que disent les journaux 1871
284.1 révéler . . . 1871
284.2 rapporter . . . 1872
284.3 démentir . . . 1873

284.4 relater 1874
284.5 commenter 1875

285 On dit que... 1877
285.1 la rumeur 1877
285.2 le scoop 1878
285.3 la désinformation 1879
285.4 la censure 1880
285.5 la polémique 1881

286 Les chiffres 1883
286.1 le sondage 1883
286.2 le bilan 1884
286.3 la hausse 1885
286.4 la baisse 1886
286.5 la statistique 1887

287 Le cambriolage 1889
287.1 cambrioler 1889
287.2 le cambrioleur 1890
287.3 le cambriolage 1891
287.4 l'effraction 1892
287.5 le butin 1893

288 Attention aux escrocs 1895
288.1 le pickpocket 1895
288.2 l'arnaque 1896
288.3 l'escroc 1897
288.4 escroquer 1898
288.5 l'escroquerie 1899

289 Une agression 1901
289.1 l'agression 1901
289.2 agresser 1902
289.3 l'agresseur 1903
289.4 menacer 1904
289.5 la menace 1905

290 Le crime **1907**
290.1 le crime 1907
290.2 le criminel 1908
290.3 le meurtre 1909
290.4 le délinquant 1910
290.5 la délinquance 1911

291 Les gendarmes **1913**
291.1 le gendarme 1913
291.2 la gendarmerie 1914
291.3 patrouiller 1915
291.4 la patrouille 1916
291.5 la brigade 1917
291.6 (dialogue) 1918

292 Les enquêteurs **1921**
292.1 l'enquêteur 1921
292.2 l'inspecteur 1922
292.3 le détective 1923
292.4 l'indice 1924
292.5 l'empreinte 1925

293 Un mystère **1927**
293.1 le mystère 1927
293.2 élucider 1928
293.3 prouver 1929
293.4 l'alibi 1930
293.5 le soupçon 1931

294 L'arrestation **1933**
294.1 interpeller 1933
294.2 l'arrestation 1934
294.3 les menottes 1935
294.4 la garde à vue 1936
294.5 interroger 1937

295 Les aveux **1939**
295.1 avouer 1939
295.2 l'aveu 1940
295.3 le complice 1941

295.4 acquitter 1942
295.5 relâcher 1943

296 Le braquage 1945
296.1 le braquage 1945
296.2 le braqueur 1946
296.3 l'otage 1947
296.4 la rançon 1948
296.5 échapper 1949

297 Accident de la route 1951
297.1 le carambolage 1951
297.2 le chauffard 1952
297.3 l'excès de vitesse 1953
297.4 le constat 1954
297.5 le dérapage 1955

298 Le choc 1957
298.1 renverser 1957
298.2 le blessé 1958
298.3 le choc 1959
298.4 l'airbag 1960
298.5 cabosser 1961

299 Une mauvaise chute 1963
299.1 la chute 1963
299.2 fouler 1964
299.3 la contusion 1965
299.4 l'hématome 1966
299.5 la plaie 1967
299.6 (dialogue) 1968

300 Les secours 1971
300.1 les secours 1971
300.2 secourir 1972
300.3 réanimer 1973
300.4 le garrot 1974
300.5 la civière 1975

301 L'alerte 1977
301.1 l'alerte . . . 1977
301.2 alerter . . . 1978
301.3 le défibrillateur . . . 1979
301.4 la sortie de secours . . . 1980
301.5 évacuer . . . 1981

302 Au feu ! 1983
302.1 l'incendie . . . 1983
302.2 l'extincteur . . . 1984
302.3 l'explosion . . . 1985
302.4 exploser . . . 1986
302.5 l'étincelle . . . 1987

303 Quand la terre tremble 1989
303.1 le tremblement de terre . . . 1989
303.2 l'avalanche . . . 1990
303.3 l'éboulement . . . 1991
303.4 effondrer . . . 1992
303.5 les décombres . . . 1993

304 Au bord de l'eau 1995
304.1 la noyade . . . 1995
304.2 noyer . . . 1996
304.3 le sauveteur . . . 1997
304.4 la bouée . . . 1998
304.5 le maître-nageur . . . 1999

305 Les rescapés 2001
305.1 le naufrage . . . 2001
305.2 écraser . . . 2002
305.3 le rescapé . . . 2003
305.4 survivre . . . 2004
305.5 la catastrophe . . . 2005

306 Petits accidents 2007
306.1 étouffer . . . 2007
306.2 l'intoxication . . . 2008
306.3 piquer . . . 2009
306.4 mordre . . . 2010

306.5 la morsure 2011

307 Les dégâts 2013
307.1 le dégât 2013
307.2 endommager 2014
307.3 l'assurance 2015
307.4 le sinistré 2016
307.5 la rayure 2017
307.6 (dialogue) 2018

308 Une naissance 2021
308.1 la naissance 2021
308.2 enceinte 2022
308.3 l'accouchement 2023
308.4 allaiter 2024
308.5 le berceau 2025

309 Les premières années 2027
309.1 la maternité 2027
309.2 le baptême 2028
309.3 baptiser 2029
309.4 la poussette 2030
309.5 l'enfance 2031

310 La jeunesse 2033
310.1 l'adolescence 2033
310.2 l'adolescent 2034
310.3 la jeunesse 2035
310.4 la rentrée 2036
310.5 majeur 2037

311 Un grand jour 2039
311.1 fiancer 2039
311.2 la demande en mariage 2040
311.3 marier 2041
311.4 la pièce montée 2042
311.5 la dragée 2043

312 Une nouvelle maison **2045**
312.1 le déménagement . . . 2045
312.2 emménager . . . 2046
312.3 la crémaillère . . . 2047
312.4 le locataire . . . 2048
312.5 le bail . . . 2049

313 La retraite **2051**
313.1 la retraite . . . 2051
313.2 le retraité . . . 2052
313.3 la vieillesse . . . 2053
313.4 hospitaliser . . . 2054
313.5 le décès . . . 2055

314 Les funérailles **2057**
314.1 décéder . . . 2057
314.2 enterrer . . . 2058
314.3 l'enterrement . . . 2059
314.4 les funérailles . . . 2060
314.5 le cimetière . . . 2061

315 Le deuil **2063**
315.1 la tombe . . . 2063
315.2 le deuil . . . 2064
315.3 le testament . . . 2065
315.4 hériter . . . 2066
315.5 l'héritage . . . 2067
315.6 (dialogue) . . . 2068

316 Célébrer **2071**
316.1 célébrer . . . 2071
316.2 la célébration . . . 2072
316.3 le cortège . . . 2073
316.4 la fanfare . . . 2074
316.5 le jour férié . . . 2075

317 Le carnaval **2077**
317.1 le défilé . . . 2077
317.2 défiler . . . 2078
317.3 le carnaval . . . 2079

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Chapter 1

Greetings

Modes: **voice** (9) **pen** (6) **Hands-free start:** the first of 15 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone in French, recognize the reply, and choose an appropriate response.
>
> *The French greetings, built from their pieces — a word for "good," words for "day," "evening" and "night," and the gender machine that decides their endings. French and Spanish are both daughters of Latin; where a French word and its Spanish cousin split from one Latin root, both appear here, because the difference between them is often the lesson — and the text supplies the Spanish word whether or not you have met it before.*

1.1 salut — "hi," and a wish for your health

Your first French word, and a warmer one than it looks. *Salut* is the casual "hi" — but taken apart, it literally wishes you good health.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-final` — the final **t is silent**: *salut* is *sa-LU*, not *sa-LUT*. Most French final consonants go silent. → reference
- `vowel-u` — the **u** is the French front-rounded *ee* (say *ee* with pursed lips), not *oo*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salut — informal "hi" (and "bye"). Root: Latin **salus, salutem** ("health, safety, well-being"). So *salut* is, at root, a wish of *health* — the same instinct as English "cheers" or old "hail" (be healthy). The family you already own in English:

- **salut**e, **salut**ation — a greeting (a wishing-of-health).
- **salut**ary, **salu**brious — health-giving.
- and, from the close cousin *salvus* ("safe"), *save*, *salvation*, *safe*.

Spanish note: its casual "hi" is *hola* — an uncertain, rootless interjection. French *salut* is the opposite: a transparent Latin word meaning "health." Two Romance languages, two totally different casual "hi"s.

Why it's said this way

Salut is strictly **informal** — friends, family, peers — and it doubles as "bye." For anyone you'd show respect to, or a first meeting, you reach past it for the formal greeting (a few lessons on), exactly as Spanish reaches past *hola* for *buenos días*.

Writing — trace the silent t

Keep **salut** visible. Trace only its final **t**, once, then say *sa-LU*: you stop on the **u**, but the page keeps the **t**.

Do not copy the word yet; the next lesson traces all of it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "salut" — *sa-LU*, silent *t*
- "salut" then English "salute", "salutary" — the health root

Before you move on

What does *salut* literally wish someone? (Health — from Latin *salus*.) What happens to its final *t*? (Silent.)

1.2 *salut* — let your eye and hand meet one known word

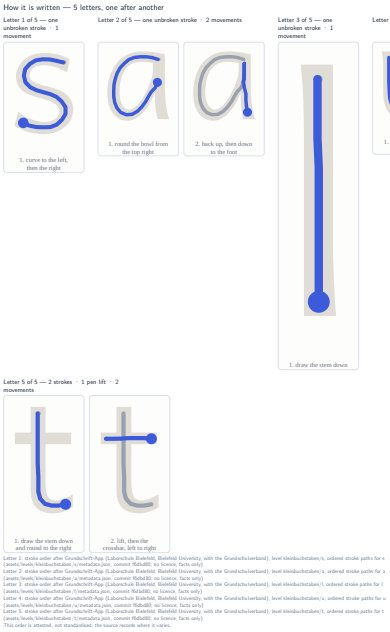
Say the casual greeting you just learned: *salut*, *sa-LU*. Today adds no new French. You will only notice how that familiar word sits on a page.

What you've built — one spelling

s a l u t → salut

The word has five written letters. Your voice finishes on **u**; the final **t** stays visible and silent. Point to each letter from left to right once.

Writing — trace with the model visible



How salut is written, letter by letter, stroke by stroke

Keep **salut** visible. Slowly finger-trace the five letters once, left to right. Then trace the word once in the air. Say *sa-LU* only after your finger reaches the silent **t**.

This is noticing, not a handwriting test. Use the letter forms you normally write; there is no new alphabet and no demand for perfect penmanship.

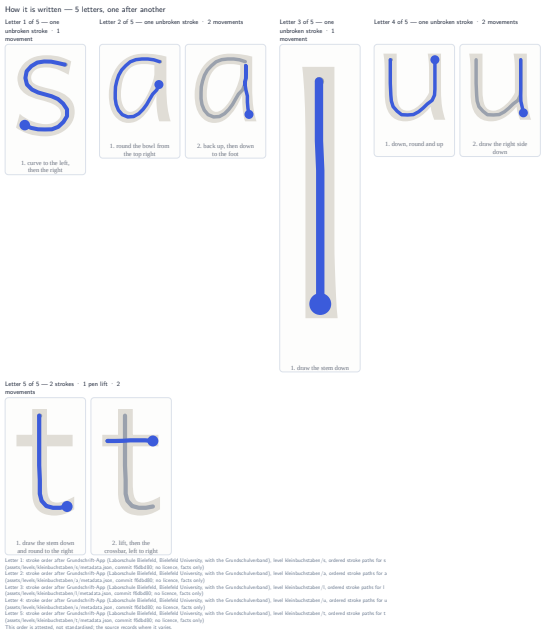
Before you move on

Point to the silent letter. Stop here; copying comes in the next tiny lesson.

1.3 *salut* — one supported copy

Point to the last letter in **salut**. It is written **t** and said as silence. Keep the model on the page for the whole lesson.

Writing — guided copy



How salut is written, letter by letter, stroke by stroke

Copy **salut** once. You may look back after every letter.

When you finish, touch **s-a-l-u-t** in your copy and say *sa-LU*. The eye checks five letters; the voice does not add a final *t* sound.

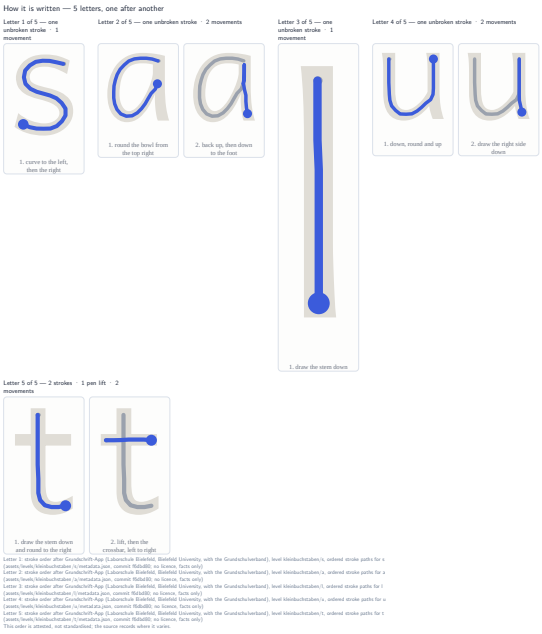
Before you move on

Compare only the order and presence of the five letters. Repair one letter if needed, then stop. The model stays visible today.

1.4 *salut* — look, hide, write, compare

Look at **salut** for five seconds. Touch the final silent **t**. Do not copy it yet.

Writing — delayed copy



How salut is written, letter by letter, stroke by stroke

1. cover the model;
2. wait five seconds;
3. write the word once from memory;
4. uncover **salut**, compare, and repair only the place that differs.

If one letter differs, circle that place and repair only that letter. A repair is part of the exercise, not a failure.

Before you move on

Read your repaired word as *sa-LU*. Stop after one memory attempt.

1.5 One heard greeting — write what you know

Cover the answer line lower on this page. You will hear one familiar casual greeting. No new vocabulary is hiding in this lesson.

Writing — short dictation

Hear: sa-LU

Write the French greeting from the sound alone. Remember that your pen records one final letter that your voice does not pronounce.

Now uncover and compare: **salut**. Check only the five letters and the silent final **t**. Repair one place if needed.

Before you move on

Writing from sound is the endpoint of this four-step runway. It is not yet a DILF mock; later lessons will grow from one known word to contact details, numbers, forms, and short practical messages.

1.6 bien — "well," a whole answer

A tiny, essential word: **bien**, "well." It carries a good chunk of everyday conversation, and its root reaches straight into English.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — **ien** is a **nasal** *byan*: air through the nose, and the *n* itself is silent. Not "bee-en." → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bien — "well." Root: Latin **bene** ("well"). The English *bene-* family is yours already:

- **bene**fit ("do well"), **bene**volent ("wish well"), **bene**diction ("speak well"), be**nign**.

  A cross-language aside: Spanish, another daughter of Latin, has the very same word — *bien*, also from *bene*, also "well." French and Spanish each inherited the Latin adverb independently and it barely changed in either; when two Romance languages agree this exactly, you're looking straight at the shared Latin parent.

Using it alone: asked "how's it going?", you can answer with one word: "**Bien.**" ("Well / good.")

Grammar Lens: the "good" it pairs with

bien is the **adverb** ("well" — *how* something is done). The **adjective** "good" (describing a thing) is a different word — the next lesson. This is the same *well* vs. *good* split as English, and the same *bien* vs. *bueno* split as Spanish; French's adjective comes from Latin *bonus*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bien" — nasal *byan*
- "bien" then English "benefit", "benevolent"

Before you move on

French *bien* and Spanish *bien* come from the same Latin word — which one? (*bene*, "well.") Adverb or adjective? (Adverb — "good" the adjective is a different word, next.)

1.7 bon / bonne — "good," the block you build greetings from

This is the word that starts French's "good day" and "good evening." Learn it alone first — including the trick that its two forms *sound* completely different even though they look nearly the same.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-on` — **bon** is a **nasal** *bõ*: the *n* is silent, the vowel goes through the nose. → reference
- `silent-final` — but **bonne** (feminine) is *bun* — the doubled *nn* **cancels the nasal** and you actually pronounce an *n*. So *bon* (*bõ*) and *bonne* (*bun*) sound different despite looking alike.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bon — "good" (adjective, masculine). **bonne** — "good" (feminine). Root: Latin **bonus / bona** ("good"). Your English cousins:

- **bon**us (borrowed straight from Latin *bonus*), **bon**anza, and — via Old French *bonté* — **boun**ty. Even *bonbon* ("good-good," a candy).

  Spanish cousin: from the same *bonus / bona*, Spanish made *bueno / buena*. Notice French kept it shorter (*bon*) while Spanish broke the *o* into a diphthong (*bue-*). Same Latin word, two accents of wear.

Grammar Lens: adjectives agree with their noun

Like every Romance adjective, *bon* **agrees** with its noun's gender and number — *bon* (masc.), *bonne* (fem.), *bons* (masc. pl.), *bonnes* (fem. pl.). This is Latin's legacy: adjectives change their ending to match the noun (Spanish runs the same machine on *bueno / buena*). You'll watch it in the next few lessons: the day greeting takes *bon*, the night one *bonne*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bon" (nasal *bõ*) then "bonne" (*bun*) — hear the difference
- the four shapes — bon, bonne, bons, bonnes

Before you move on

Why do *bon* and *bonne* sound different? (The double *nn* in *bonne* cancels the nasal — *bõ* vs *bun*.) Which Spanish adjective shares *bon*'s Latin root? (*bueno*, from the same *bonus*.)

1.8 le, la, les — "the," and the gender it carries

Before your first noun: the words for "the." French splits "the" by gender — masculine *le*, feminine *la* — a habit it inherited from Latin (its sibling Spanish did the same, from the same source).

Sounds you'll need

- **le** = *luh*, **la** = *lah*, **les** = *lay* (the *s* is silent — `silent-final`). → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le — "the" (masculine). **la** — "the" (feminine). **les** — "the" (plural, both genders). Roots: Latin demonstratives **ille / illa / illos** ("that one / those"):

- **le** ← *ille*, **la** ← *illa*, **les** ← *illos* — the pointing force ("that") faded into a plain "the," and the initial *il-* wore off.

  Spanish cousin, exactly: from the *same ille / illa / illos*, Spanish made *el / la / los*. French kept *le* where Spanish kept *el* — same parent. And those same Latin demonstratives also gave French **il** ("he") and **elle** ("she") (Spanish *él / ella*): article and pronoun, one Latin root. (English "the" is Germanic — unrelated.)

Grammar Lens: French gender, also from Latin

Every French noun is **masculine or feminine** — a grammatical gender baked into the noun, inherited from Latin: its three genders (masculine, feminine, neuter) collapsed to two, the neuters folding into the masculine. (Spanish, the other Latin daughter, did the very same.) You learn each noun **with its article** (*le* or *la*), because the gender can't be guessed. French has one convenience here: in the plural, both genders share a single article, *les*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le", "la", "les"
- "le" (masc.), "la" (fem.), "les" (plural) — the nouns that wear them are coming

Before you move on

le and *la* come from which Latin words? (*ille* / *illa*, "that one" — same as Spanish *el/la*.) What's the single plural "the"? (*les*.)

1.9 jour — "day," and a detour through Latin that explains English *journey*

Your first French noun. In Spanish "day" is *día*; in French it's *jour* — they look nothing alike, yet they're cousins. The gap between them is the whole lesson, and it cracks open a shelf of English words.

What to know first

- le / la / les — gender and the articles; *jour* is masculine, *le jour*.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-zh` — **j** is the soft *zh* of *measure*: *jour* starts *zh-*.
- `vowel-ou` — the letters **o-u** say *oo*. So *jour* = *zhoor*. → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le jour — "the day" (masculine). Root: Latin **diurnum** ("daytime, daily") — itself from **dies** ("day"). That extra step through *diurnum* is why *jour* looks so unlike Spanish *día*:

- Spanish took *dies* → *día* (short path).
- French took the derivative *diurnum* → *jorn* → *jour* (the *di-* crushed down to *j-*).

Same ultimate root, two different Latin words, two very different results. And *diurnum* is a goldmine of English cousins — most of them arrived through French:

- **jour**nal (a *daily* record), **jour**ney (originally a *day's* travel or work — French *journée*, "a day's worth"), **jour**nalist.
- so**journ** ("to stay [for days]"), ad**journ** (*à jour*, "to [another] day").
- and straight from *dies*: **di**urnal, **di**ary — cousins of *jour* through the grandparent root.

  So English *journey* and Spanish *día* are cousins, meeting back at Latin *dies* — one through French *jour*, one direct. That's the kind of hidden family this whole book is built to show.

Grammar Lens

jour is **masculine** — *le jour* — a gender it inherited from its Latin source. As always, learn it with the article. Plural: French adds a (silent) **-s** — *les jours* — sounds identical to the singular; only *les* tells your ear it's plural.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le jour" — *luh zhoor*
- "jour" then "journal", "journey" — the daily root

- "les jours" — plural, heard only in the *les*

Before you move on

jour and Spanish *día* share which grandparent root? (Latin *dies*.) What English travel-word is literally "a day's worth"? (*Journey*, from *journée*.)

1.10 bonjour — assembled, and *not* plural (unlike Spanish)

Snap two words together — *bon* + *jour* — and you have the single most important word in French politeness. And there's a sharp contrast with Spanish hiding in it.

What to know first

- bon / bonne · jour

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bonjour = **bon** ("good") + **jour** ("day") = "good day." One written word, said *bõ- zhoor*. *bon* is masculine because *jour* is masculine — the agreement from the *bon* lesson, quietly at work. Both are inherited: *bon* ← Latin *bonus*, *jour* ← Latin *diurnum*, "daytime" (EtymDB 2.1).

Why it's said this way

Here's the contrast worth banking. Spanish says *buenos días* — **plural**, "good days," the fossil of a blessing ("may God give you good days"). French says *bonjour* — **singular**, just "good day." French didn't fossilize the plural; it kept the plain, single wish. Same two building blocks (*good* + *day*), same Latin roots, but Spanish pluralized the blessing and French didn't. Two neighbours, two instincts. Culturally, *bonjour* carries weight far beyond "hello": in France, opening almost any interaction — a shop, a bus, a desk — *without* a *bonjour* reads as rude. It's the formal, all-purpose daytime greeting (the evening has its own, two lessons on), and the polite default where *salut* would be too casual.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- build it — "bon" … "jour" … "bonjour"
- "salut" (casual) then "bonjour" (polite) — feel the register gap
- bonjour vs Spanish buenos días — one singular, one plural

Before you move on

bonjour is singular; the Spanish equivalent is plural — what is it, and why plural? (*Buenos días*, fossil of "may God give you good days.")

1.11 soir — "evening," and the same "late" idea Spanish used

The evening counterpart of *jour*. And there's a lovely parallel with Spanish waiting: both languages built their "later in the day" word out of the Latin word for *late*.

What to know first

- jour — the day word; *soir* is its evening partner.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-oi` — **oi** = *wa*: *soir* is *swahr*. → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le soir — "the evening" (masculine). Root: Latin **sērum** (*tempus*), "the **late** [hour]," from **sērus** ("late"). English cousins are few but real: *soirée* (an evening party — borrowed straight from French *soir*), and the rare *serotine* (a bat that flies in the *late* evening).

Spanish parallel — this is the good part. Spanish *tarde* ("afternoon") comes from Latin *tardus*, "**late**." French *soir* ("evening") comes from *sērus*, "**late**." Two different Latin "late" words, two languages, the same idea: name the later

part of the day after its *lateness*.

Grammar Lens

soir is **masculine** — *le soir* — so, like *jour*, it will take *bon* (not *bonne*) in the greeting. Plural *les soirs*, the *s* silent.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le soir" — *luh swahr*
- "soir" then English "soirée"
- Spanish *tarde* ← "late", French *soir* ← "late" — same idea

Before you move on

What did *soir*'s Latin root *sērus* mean? ("Late.") What Spanish time-word did the exact same thing from a different "late" word? (*Tarde*, ← *tardus*.)

1.12 bonsoir — good evening

Same assembly as *bonjour*, one word swapped. If you have that one, this is nearly free.

What to know first

- bon / bonne · soir · bonjour

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bonsoir = **bon** ("good") + **soir** ("evening") = "good evening." *bon* stays masculine because *soir* is masculine — same as *bonjour*, no new agreement to learn. Said *bõ- swahr*. *Soir* ← Latin *sērō*, "late", from *sērus* (EtymDB 2.1).

Why it's said this way

bonsoir is the evening swap for *bonjour*: as the day turns to evening (roughly late afternoon on), French speakers switch from *bonjour* to *bonsoir*. Both are the polite, all-purpose greeting for their time of day. And like Spanish *buenas noches*, *bonsoir* works both **arriving** and **leaving** in the evening — "good evening" on the way in, "goodnight-ish" on the way out. (For actually sending someone to bed, French has a separate phrase — the next two lessons.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bonsoir" — *bõ- swahr*
- "bonjour" (daytime) then "bonsoir" (evening) — the pair

Before you move on

What two words build *bonsoir*, and why does *bon* stay masculine? (*bon* + *soir*; *soir* is masculine.)

1.13 nuit — "night," and a sound-change that mirrors Spanish

"Night." In Spanish it's *noche*; in French, *nuit*. They came from the *same* Latin word and drifted apart by two different rules — and once you know the rules, you can predict a dozen more words.

What to know first

- le / la / les — *nuit* is feminine, *la nuit*.

Sounds you'll need

- **nuit** = *nwee* — the **u** is the front-rounded French *u* gliding into *ee*; the final **t** is silent (`silent-final`). → reference

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la nuit — "the night" (feminine). Root: Latin **noctem** (*nox*, stem *noct-*). English cousins through the *noct-* root: **noct**urnal, **noct**urne, equi**nox** ("equal night").
The sound-change, side by side with Spanish. Latin *noctem* went two ways:

- Spanish softened *-ct-* → **-ch-**: *noctem* → *noche*.
- French turned *-ct-* → **-it-**: *noctem* → *nuit*.

And it's a *rule*, not a one-off — watch it repeat:

Latin	Spanish / French	English
noctem	noche / nuit	night
lactem	leche / lait	(lact-, "milk")
factum	hecho / fait	fact

So a Spanish *-ch-* word and a French *-it-* word are often the *same* Latin word — and the English cousin usually kept the *-ct-*.

Grammar Lens

nuit is **feminine** — *la nuit* — inherited from Latin, where *nox* was feminine (exactly as Spanish *la noche* is). Its gender matters next lesson: it's why "good night" is *bon**ne** nuit*, not *bon nuit*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la nuit" — *lah nwee*
- "nuit" then Spanish "noche" — same Latin *noctem*, two rules
- the row — "noche, nuit, night"

Before you move on

Latin *noctem* → Spanish *noche* by *-ct-→-ch-*; → French *nuit* by which change? (*-ct-→-it-*.) Is *nuit* masculine or feminine? (Feminine — *la nuit*.)

1.14 bonne nuit — good night, and the feminine side of *bon*

The last greeting of the day — and the one that finally shows *bon* in its feminine coat.

What to know first

- bon / bonne · nuit

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bonne nuit = **bonne** ("good," feminine) + **nuit** ("night," feminine) = "good night." Here it is at last: because *nuit* is **feminine**, *bon* becomes **bonne** — and, from the *bon* lesson, remember they even *sound* different: *bon* is nasal *bõ*, but *bonne nuit* is *bun nwee*, with a real *n*.
So the three evening-ish greetings line up and show the whole agreement rule in one breath:

- *bon**jour*** — *jour* masculine → *bon*
- *bon**soir*** — *soir* masculine → *bon*
- *bon**ne** nuit* — *nuit* feminine → *bonne*

Why it's said this way

Unlike *bonsoir* (an evening *greeting*), *bonne nuit* is a **farewell for bed** — "goodnight," said when parting for sleep. It maps onto the Spanish split you may feel forming: Spanish overloads *buenas noches* for both, while French keeps *bonsoir* (evening hello/bye) separate from *bonne nuit* (off-to-sleep).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bonne nuit" — *bun nwee*
- the trio — bonjour, bonsoir, bonne nuit — and for each, is *bon* masculine or feminine, and why?

Before you move on

Why is it *bonne* nuit but *bon* jour? (*nuit* is feminine, *jour* masculine — agreement.) *bonsoir* vs *bonne nuit* — which is "off to bed"? (*Bonne nuit.*)

1.15 Practice — the French greetings

No new words — just the ones you built, until the register and the agreement are automatic.

What you've built

- **salut** — casual "hi/bye" (← *salus*, "health").
- **bien** — "well," a one-word answer (← *bene*; Spanish kept the same word).
- **bon / bonne** — "good," the adjective (← *bonus*), and its agreement.
- **le / la / les** — "the," carrying gender (← *ille/illa/illos*).
- **bonjour** = bon + jour (masc.) — polite daytime "hello," *singular* where Spanish is plural.
- **bonsoir** = bon + soir (masc.) — evening greeting.
- **bonne nuit** = bonne + nuit (fem.) — off-to-bed "goodnight."

Two threads run through it all: **register** (*salut* vs *bonjour*) and **agreement** (*bon jour / bon soir / bonne nuit*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- greet a friend casually, then a shopkeeper politely — *salut / bonjour*
- pick the right greeting for right now (day → *bonjour*, evening → *bonsoir*)
- bonjour, bonsoir, bonne nuit — and say why each takes *bon* or *bonne*

- answer "how are you" in one word — *bien*

Twice through: Run bonjour → bonsoir → bonne nuit without hesitating on *bon/bonne*.

Writing — close the first runway

Cover the word **salut** elsewhere in this chapter. Write the casual greeting once from memory, then uncover it and check the silent final **t**. This is a chapter-level retrieval of the tiny trace-to-dictation runway, not a new word.

Before you move on

French *bonjour* is singular; the Spanish morning greeting is plural — name it. (*Buenos días.*) Next chapter: introducing yourself — "my name is…" — and French's own two words for "you," one familiar and one formal.

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (9) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can introduce myself in French, give my name, and understand the other person's name.
>
> *Now a first real exchange — "Je m'appelle Mira." / "Comment vous appelez-vous?" / "Je m'appelle Arun." / "Enchanté." — giving your name, asking for someone else's, and saying you are glad to meet them. We build it the same way as the greetings: each piece taken apart first, then assembled.*

2.1 je — "I," the smallest word you own

To introduce yourself you need "I." French's is tiny — but it comes from a word you already own whole in English.

Sounds you'll need

- **je** = *zhuh* — a soft *j* (as in *measure*) plus a light *uh*.
- Before a vowel it **elides**: the *e* drops and an apostrophe takes its place, **j'**. You'll meet the same squeeze in *je m'appelle*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

je — "I." Root: Latin **ego**. That Latin form survives *raw* in English:

- **ego**, **ego**ist, **ego**tism, **ego**centric — the "I" at the center of the self.

So the word for "I" and the psychologist's *ego* are the **same** ancient word — one worn down to a whisper (*je*), one kept whole (*ego*). (Spanish wore *ego* down to *yo*; French wore it further, to *je*.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je" (*zhuh*)
- "je", then the bare *zh* of **j'** — all that is left when the *e* drops
- the English cousin that kept the Latin whole — *ego*

Before you move on

What Latin word is **je** worn down from, and what English word kept it whole? (*ego* — English *ego*.) What happens to *je* before a vowel? (It elides to *j'*.)

2.2 me — "myself," the same word as English *me*

The middle piece of *je m'appelle*. It's a real word with a real history — not just a bit of glue — and you've owned it in English all your life.

Sounds you'll need

- **me** = *muh* — a light *uh*, like *je*.
- Before a vowel it **elides**: *me appelle* → **m'appelle** (the *e* drops, the words fuse).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

me — "me / myself." Root: Latin **mē** (the accusative "me") — literally the **same** word as English **me**. The whole family grows from one Proto-Indo-European root ***me-**:

- English **me**, **my**, **mine**;
- Latin **mē** and **meus** ("my"), which became French *mon / ma /*

mes.

So the tiny *m'* in *je m'appelle* is a first-person marker you've carried in English since childhood — *me*, *my*, *mine* are its cousins.

Grammar Lens: the reflexive set (me / te / se)

me is one of three little pronouns that **bounce a verb back onto its doer** — *me* ("myself"), *te* ("yourself"), *se* ("himself, herself"). Their roots run in parallel with the one you just met, and two of them you already own in English:

- *te* ← Latin **tē**, the cousin of archaic English **thee**.
- *se* ← Latin **sē**, the "self" root behind **se**parate and, at a distance, **su**icide (*suī*, "of oneself").

Only **me** does any work here: it is what gives your own name, *je m'appelle*. *te* turns up once, in the informal "what's your name?" at the end of this chapter, and *se* waits for a lesson that needs it. The set is named so its shape is familiar, not laid out as a grid to memorize — you meet each one where it earns its place.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "me" (*muh*), then its elision — "m'appelle"
- the English cousins from the same root — *me*, *my*, *mine*
- the set — *me* (myself), *te* (yourself), *se* (oneself)

Before you move on

What Latin word is **me** from, and what three English words share its root? (*mē* — *me*, *my*, *mine*.) What are its two siblings, and what does *me* do to a verb? (*te*, *se*; it bounces the action back onto the doer — reflexive.)

2.3 (s')appeler — "to call," and "to call *oneself*"

French says "my name is" by saying "I call myself." Here's the verb that does it — and a fat English family riding on it.

Sounds you'll need

- **appeler** = *a-play* — the *-er* infinitive ending is a plain "ay."
- In **m'appelle** the doubled *ll* keeps a crisp "l": *ma-PELL*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

appeler — "to call." Root: Latin **appellāre** ("to address, call by name"). The English cousins are everywhere in formal language:

- **appeal** — to *call* to a higher authority.
- **appell**ation — a name or title (an *appellation* of wine is its official name).
- **appell**ate, **appell**ant — the court that hears appeals, and the one who brings it.

To **name** someone is, at root, to **call** them.

Grammar Lens: reflexive verbs — doing something to yourself

French builds "to be called" from "to call" plus a little word that bounces the action back onto the doer: **s'appeler**, "to call *oneself*." That bounce-back word changes for each person:

- **me** = myself · **te** = yourself · **se** = himself/herself.

So "I call myself" needs **me**: *je* ***me*** *appelle* → (elided) *je m'appelle*. English hides the same move in "I call **myself**" — French just uses it as the normal way to give a name.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "appeler" (*a-play*)

- the English cousins — *appeal*, *appellation*
- "call oneself" with *me* — *je me appelle*

Before you move on

What Latin verb is **appeler** from, and two English cousins? (*appellāre* — *appeal*, *appellation*.) What does a *reflexive* verb do, and which little word means "myself"? (Bounces the action back on the doer; *me*.)

2.4 je m'appelle... — "my name is...," literally "I call myself"

Assemble the two pieces you just met — *je* and *(s')appeler* — into the single most useful sentence for meeting anyone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Three atoms, each already taken apart on its own — je (I, ← *ego*), me (myself, ← *mē*), appelle (call, ← *appellāre*):

- **je** (I) + **me** (myself) + **appelle** (call).
- *me* elides before the vowel of *appelle* → **m'**.

  je m'appelle... = word for word "I call myself..." = **"my name is..."**

Je m'appelle Arun. → "My name is Arun." *Je m'appelle Mira.* → "My name is Mira."

Why it's said this way

French *prefers* this verb-based "I call myself" to a literal "my name is." The literal form does exist:

- **mon nom est...** ("my name is..."), with **nom** ("name") ← Latin **nōmen** → English **noun**, **nom**inate, **nom**inal, **nom**enclature.

But *mon nom est* sounds stiff and official — a passport-desk phrase. For a real introduction, reach for **je m'appelle**. (You now also see

why “noun” is literally “a naming word.”)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “je m’appelle…” then your own name
- what it *literally* says (“I call myself”)
- the stiff literal alternative — “mon nom est…”

Before you move on

What does **je m’appelle** literally mean, and why does *me* become *m’*? (“I call myself”; elision before the vowel of *appelle*.) What’s the more literal but stiffer “my name is,” and what English word is *nom* cousin to? (*mon nom est*; *noun*.)

2.5 tu / vous — “you,” familiar and formal

To *ask* someone their name, you need “you.” French has two, and choosing between them is a small act of social judgment.

Sounds you’ll need

- **tu** = *too*, but with the front-rounded French *u* (lips rounded, tongue forward). **vous** = *voo* (silent *s*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **tu** (familiar “you”) ← Latin **tū**.
- **vous** (formal / plural “you”) ← Latin **vōs**, “you all.”

English once had the same split — old **thou** was the *tu* — but *thou* died out, leaving one flat **you** for everyone.

Grammar Lens: two "you"s, chosen by register

- **tu** — for friends, family, children, peers. Intimate, equal.
- **vous** — for strangers, elders, anyone you'd show respect — **and** it's the plural "you all."

The trick: French makes politeness by using the **plural** on a single person. Addressing one respected person as "you all" is the polite move (French even has a verb for it, *vouvoyer*). This is the same politeness Spanish builds with *usted*, but by a different route: Spanish coined a whole new pronoun (from "your grace"); French just borrows its plural. Using *tu* too early can feel over-familiar — **when in doubt, *vous***.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "tu" (front-rounded *u*), "vous" (*voo*)
- who gets *tu* (friends), who gets *vous* (strangers, elders)
- the rule of thumb — "when in doubt, *vous*"

Before you move on

What decides *tu* vs *vous* — and what does French do to be polite to one person? (Register — familiar vs respect; it uses the *plural* (*vous*) on one person.) What old English word was the lost *tu*? (*thou*.)

2.6 comment — "how," from the same *quomodo* as Spanish *cómo*

French asks "what's your name?" as "**how** are you called?" — so first, the word for "how."

Sounds you'll need

- **comment** = *ko-MAHN* — the final *-ent* is a **nasal** vowel; the *t* is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comment — "how." Root: Latin **quo modo**, "in what manner" — two words fused and worn into one.

- That same **quomodo** also became Spanish **cómo** — two Romance languages, one Latin "in-what-way," reshaped differently.
- The piece **modo** ("manner, measure") is alive in English **mode**, **mod**el, **mod**erate, **mod**ify — all about the *way* a thing is done.

Grammar Lens: French counts names as a matter of "how"

Where English asks "**what** is your name?", French asks "**how** are you called?" — *comment* (how), not *what*. The question is about the *manner* of your calling, not a thing to be named. Don't translate word for word; learn the French logic: the name-question runs on **comment**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "comment" (*ko-MAHN*, nasal ending)
- the Latin *quo modo* → French *comment*, Spanish *cómo*
- English *mode/model* share the *modo* piece

Before you move on

What two Latin words fused into **comment**, and what Spanish word shares them? (*quo modo* — Spanish *cómo*.) English asks "what is your name?" — what does French literally ask? ("*How* are you called?")

2.7 comment vous appelez-vous? — "what's your name?"

Assemble it: "how" + "do you call yourself" = the polite question that gets the introduction going.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **comment** (how) + **vous appelez-vous** ("do you call yourself").

  comment vous appelez-vous? = literally "**how do you call yourself?**" = the polite **"what's your name?"**

Comment ← Latin *quōmodo*, "in what manner", *vous* ← Latin *vōs*, and *appeler* ← Latin *appellāre*, "to call" (EtymDB 2.1).

Grammar Lens: asking by inversion

A statement — *vous vous appelez* ("you call yourself") — becomes a **question** by flipping the verb and the pronoun, joined with a hyphen:

> *vous appelez-**vous**?*

That flip is French's formal way to ask anything. The **informal** version simply swaps in *tu*:

> *comment **tu t'appelles**?* — note *te* elides to **t'**, exactly as *me* became *m'* in *je m'appelle*.

So the same verb, *s'appeler*, runs the whole exchange: *je m'appelle* to give your name, *comment vous appelez-vous?* to ask for theirs.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "comment vous appelez-vous?" (formal)
- the informal — "comment tu t'appelles?"
- the pair — ask, then answer: "…vous appelez-vous?" / "je m'appelle…"

Before you move on

What does **comment vous appelez-vous?** literally say? ("How do you call yourself?") How do you turn the statement into a question, and what's the *tu* version? (Invert verb + pronoun with a

hyphen; *comment tu t'appelles?*)

2.8 enchanté(e) — "delighted," i.e. "pleased to meet you"

The graceful close to an introduction — and it literally says you've been put under a spell.

Sounds you'll need

- **enchanté** = *ahn-shahn-TAY* — two **nasal** vowels (*en*, *an*), then a clean "tay." **ch** = English *sh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enchanté — "delighted." Root: Latin **in-** ("upon") + **cantāre** ("to sing, chant"). To *enchant* was literally to **sing a spell upon** someone. The magic survives in the English family:

- **enchant**, **incant**ation, and the plain **chant**.

So saying *enchanté* on meeting someone means, gallantly, "I'm **enchanted** [to meet you]."

Grammar Lens: it agrees with *you*

enchanté follows the gender-agreement rule you met in *bon/bonne*: it reports the **speaker's own gender**.

- A man says **enchanté**.
- A woman says **enchantée** — an extra *-e* (same sound, silent).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "enchanté" (*ahn-shahn-TAY*)
- the English cousins — *enchant*, *incantation*, *chant*

- both forms — *enchanté* (m.) / *enchantée* (f.)

Before you move on

What does **enchanté** literally mean, and from what Latin pieces? ("Enchanted" — *in-* + *cantāre*, "to sing upon.") How does a woman say it, and why? (*enchantée* — it agrees with the speaker's gender.)

2.9 Chapter 2 — the introduction, whole

Every piece is built. Here's the exchange it was all for.

The exchange

French	English
Je m'appelle Mira.	My name is Mira.
Comment vous appelez-vous?	What's your name?
Je m'appelle Arun.	My name is Arun.
Enchanté.	Pleased to meet you.

Every piece traced to a root:

- **je** ← *ego* (English *ego*)
- **me** ← *mē* (English *me*, *my*, *mine*)
- **(s')appeler** ← *appellāre* (English *appeal*, *appellation*)
- **comment** ← *quo modo* (Spanish *cómo*, English *mode*)
- **enchanté** ← *in-cantāre* (English *enchant*, *incantation*, *chant*)

And two habits of French to keep: it gives a name with a **reflexive verb** ("I call *myself*") and asks for one with **"how"** ("*how* are you called?"), and it makes politeness by using the **plural** *vous* on one person.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices

- your own introduction — “je m’appelle …, enchanté(e)”
- ask it back — “comment vous appelez-vous?”

Before you move on

Give your name in French, ask someone else’s, and say you’re pleased to meet them. (*Je m’appelle… / Comment vous appelez-vous? / Enchanté(e).*) Which two French habits does this exchange show? (Naming with a reflexive verb; asking with “how,” not “what.”)
Next chapter: *Comment ça va?* (“how’s it going?”) and answering with *bien* again — the responding cycle.

Chapter 3

How Are You?

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how someone is in French, answer naturally, and return the question.
>
> *Now the small talk that follows a name: thanking, answering a thank-you, and asking how someone is doing. French asks that last question with a verb of motion — not "how are you?" but "how does it go?"*

3.1 merci — "thank you," and it means *mercy*

You can introduce yourself in French. Next you'll ask *how are you?* — and every polite answer needs **merci** first. It hides a word you already know: *mercy*.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-uvular` — **merci** = *mehr-SEE*, with the soft guttural French *r* at the back of the throat (never the Spanish tap). Stress the end: *mehr-**SEE***.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

merci — "thank you." Root: Latin **mercēs**, *"wages, reward, price, that which is earned."* Saying *merci* originally invoked a **reward** owed for a kindness — and, in old religious use, a plea for divine **mercy** (a reward you haven't earned).
That one root **merc-** ("pay, trade, reward") pays out a huge English

family:

- **mercy**, **merciful** — the reward/pity sense.
- **mercenary** — a soldier who fights for *wages*.
- **merchant**, **commerce**, **market**, **mercantile** — buying and selling, the *price* sense (Latin *mercārī*, "to trade").
- Even **Mercury** — the Roman god of merchants.

Why it's said this way

Here's a lovely contrast to lock in:

language	"thank you"	literal root
French	*merci*	*mercēs* — **reward / mercy**
Spanish	*gracias*	*grātia* — **grace / favour**
Portuguese	*obrigado*	*obligātus* — "I am **obliged**"

Three Romance sisters, three different pictures of gratitude: French hands you a **reward**, Spanish hands you **grace**, Portuguese declares itself **obliged**. Same feeling, three metaphors — this is exactly the kind of thing worth *noticing*, not just memorizing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "merci" — *mehr-SEE*, guttural *r*
- "merci" then English "mercy, merchant, commerce" — one family
- French *merci* (reward) vs Spanish *gracias* (grace) — feel the difference

Before you move on

What everyday English word is *merci* a cousin of? (*Mercy.*) And its "trade" cousins? (Merchant, commerce, market, mercenary.) How

does its metaphor differ from Spanish *gracias*? (*merci* = reward/ mercy; *gracias* = grace.) Next: the reply to a thank-you.

3.2 de rien — "you're welcome," or "it was nothing"

Someone says **merci**. The easy reply: **de rien** — literally *"of nothing."* You wave the favour off as no trouble — and Spanish pulls *this exact trick* too.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — **rien** is a nasal ending: the air goes out through the nose and there is no hard *n* to stop it. *duh RYAN*, with that final vowel humming rather than closing.
- `r-uvular` — that guttural French *r* again, at the back of the throat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **de** = "of / from" (Latin **dē**).
- **rien** = "nothing." And here is the beautiful part.

rien comes from Latin **rem** — the accusative of **rēs**, *"a thing."* In Latin *rem* meant a **thing**, something real. But French kept using it inside negations — *ne … rien*, "not … a thing" — until the *thing* word absorbed the "nothing" and **rien came to mean 'nothing' all by itself.**
Latin *rēs* also gives English **real**, **re**public (*rēs pūblica*, "the public thing"), and **rebus**. So *rien* is, at the root, a **real thing** that learned to mean nothing at all.

Why it's said this way

If that sounds familiar, it should: **Spanish did the identical thing with nada** (← Latin *nāta*, "a born thing" → "nothing"). Two sister languages, the same move — the word for **thing** collapses into the word for **nothing**:

language	"you're welcome"	the "nothing" word, from Latin
French	*de rien*	*rien* ← *rem*, "a thing"
Spanish	*de nada*	*nada* ← *nāta*, "a born thing"

Two sister languages, one instinct: wave the favour off as no *thing* at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "merci" … "de rien" — the full exchange, both voices
- French *de rien* and Spanish *de nada* back to back — same idea, two "thing → nothing" words

Before you move on

What did *rien* ("nothing") originally mean in Latin? (*rem* — a *thing*.) What Spanish word pulled the same trick, and from what? (*nada* ← *nāta*, "a born thing.") Next: the verb French uses for "how are you?" — and it's not "to stand" like Spanish, but **to go**.

3.3 aller — "to go," the verb behind "how are you?"

Spanish asks *how are you* with **estar**, "to *stand*." French asks it with **aller**, "to **go**" — *how does it go?* Same question, a different picture of a life: one language stands, the other walks. Meet **aller**.

Sounds you'll need

- `er-ending` — the infinitive **-er** is a clean *ay*: **aller** = *ah-LAY* (the double *l* is just one *l* sound; the *r* is silent here).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aller means "to go." Its origin is one of the great messes of French — it is **suppletive**, meaning it was stitched together from **three** different Latin verbs, and you can still see the seams in its everyday forms:

- **je vais** ("I go") ← Latin **vādere**, "to go, to rush" → English **invade**, **evade**, **wade** (all "going" words).
- **nous allons** ("we go"), and the infinitive **aller** ← Latin **ambulāre**, "to walk" → English **amble**, **ambulance** (a walking hospital), **preamble**, **perambulate**.
- **j'irai** ("I will go") ← Latin **īre**, "to go" → English **exit** (*ex-it*, "he goes out"), **transit**, **initial**.

So a single French verb carries **three** Latin roots for motion. You don't need to conjugate it yet — just recognize one form for the next lesson:

- **ça va** = "it goes" (the *va* is from *vādere*) — the beating heart of French small talk.

Grammar Lens: "going" as "being"

Lots of languages borrow a motion verb to talk about *state*: English says "how are you **getting on**? / how's it **going**?" French made that the standard: *Comment ça va?* = "How does it **go**?" Hold the metaphor — it makes the next lesson obvious.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "aller" — *ah-LAY*
- "ça va" — *sa VA*, "it goes"
- English "amble, ambulance" (walk) and "invade, evade" (go) — aller's two big families

Before you move on

What does *aller* literally mean, and how many Latin verbs is it stitched from? (To *go*; three — *ambulāre, vādere, īre.*) Which everyday form means "it goes"? (*ça va.*) So *Comment ça va?* literally asks — what? ("How does it *go*?") Next: ask it for real.

3.4 Comment ça va ? — "how are you?"

You know **comment**, "how," and **ça va**, "it goes." Assemble the most useful neutral check-in in spoken French.

Comment ça va ? — "How are you?" literally: "How does this go?"

The even shorter **Ça va ?** is extremely common. Answer with the same words:

Ça va ? — Ça va. "How's it going? — It's going / I'm fine."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **comment** comes from Latin *quōmodo*, "in what manner";
- **ça** comes from *ecce hoc*, "behold this";
- **va** is the third-person form of **aller**, "to go."

French pictures wellbeing as **going**. Spanish uses a "standing" verb instead; the comparison is a memory hook, not a prerequisite. Pronounce *comment* roughly *ko-mahn*: the ending is nasal and the written *t* is silent in this neutral phrase.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Comment ça va ?"
- the shorter question — "Ça va ?"

- the pair — "Ça va ? — Ça va."

Twice through: "Ça va ? — Ça va."

Before you move on

What does *Comment ça va ?* literally ask? ("How does it go?") Which verb owns **va**? (**Aller**.) What is the shortest version? (**Ça va ?**) How can you answer it? (**Ça va.**) Next: choose *tu* or *vous* explicitly.

3.5 Comment vas-tu ? / Comment allez-vous ?

Comment ça va ? avoids naming the listener. Now use the *tu* / *vous* choice you learned when you gave your name.

Grammar Lens: a ladder of three registers

French offers a neat climb from casual to formal. *tu* is the familiar "you" (a friend, a peer); *vous* is the formal or plural "you" (a stranger, an elder, a group).

register	question	literally
casual, universal	**Comment ça va ?** (or **Ça va ?**)	"How does *it* go?"
informal, one friend	**Comment vas-tu ?**	"How go *you*?"
formal or plural	**Comment allez-vous ?**	"How go *you* (vous)?"

Vas and **allez** are simply the *tu* and *vous* forms of *aller*, "to go." Formal writing and careful speech invert verb and pronoun: **allez-vous**, literally "go-you." For a stranger or a boss, reach for **Comment allez-vous ?**

Sounds you'll need

The final *t* of **comment** is normally silent. Before vowel-initial **allez**, liaison can carry it across:

Comment allez-vous ? — roughly *ko-mahn-ta-lay-voo*

That linking sound is not an extra word; it is a normally silent consonant surfacing between two words.

Use **Ça va ?** as the easy neutral default, **vas-tu** for a friend when you want explicit informality, and **allez-vous** for formal or plural address.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to a friend — "Comment vas-tu ?"
- to a stranger — "Comment allez-vous ?"
- the neutral default — "Ça va ?"

Twice through: "Vas-tu — friend. Allez-vous — formal or plural."

Before you move on

Which form addresses one friend? (**Comment vas-tu ?**) Which is formal or plural? (**Comment allez-vous ?**) What sound appears in the liaison? (The normally silent ***t*** of *comment.*) Next: the "so-so" answer.

3.6 comme ci, comme ça — the classic French shrug

Someone asks *Ça va?* You're not great, not bad. The perfect, gloriously French answer — a phrase English borrowed whole — is **comme ci, comme ça**: "like this, like that." A verbal shrug of the shoulders.

First, twenty seconds of review. From your first greetings: **bien** — "well" (← Latin *bene*). So *Ça va bien* = "It's going well." Now the answer for when it's only *going.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comme ci, comme ça — literally **"like this, like that."** Every piece is an old friend:

- **comme** = "like, as" — from Latin **quōmodo**, "in what manner." That's the **same root as *comment*** ("how") from last lesson! *comment* = "in what manner (as a question)"; *comme* =

"in the manner of, like." One Latin word, two French children.

- **ci** = "here / this" ← Latin **ecce hic**, "behold here."
- **ça** = "there / that" ← Latin **ecce hoc**, "behold this" — the same *ça* from *Ça va?*.

So you're literally waving a hand: *a bit like this way, a bit like that way* — neither up nor down.

Grammar Lens: your answer set for *Ça va?*

answer	sense
Bien, merci	well, thank you
Ça va	fine / okay ("it goes")
Comme ci, comme ça	so-so
Pas mal	not bad

Why it's said this way

Every language has its shrug, and each paints it differently: Spanish says **más o menos** ("more or less") or **regular**, Italian says **così così** ("so so"), French says **comme ci, comme ça** ("like this, like that"). Same gesture, three pictures.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "comme ci, comme ça" — with a little hand-wobble in the voice
- answer "Ça va?" three ways — "Bien" / "Ça va" / "Comme ci, comme ça"
- notice *comme* and *comment* share a root — *quōmodo*

Before you move on

What does *comme ci, comme ça* literally mean? ("Like this, like that.") What "how"-word shares *comme*'s root? (*comment* — both from *quōmodo*.) What's the Spanish equivalent shrug? (*más o*

menos / regular.) Next: put the whole exchange together.

3.7 Practice — "comment ça va ?", start to finish

No new words. This chapter's atoms — *merci, de rien, aller, ça va, comme ci comme ça* — assemble into a real exchange, run formally and informally. It picks up right where the introduction exchange left off.

The exchange

Formal (a stranger, an elder):

— Bonjour. **Comment allez-vous ?** — **Bien, merci.** Et vous ? — **Comme ci, comme ça.** — [later, after a small favour] — Merci ! — **De rien.**

Informal (a friend):

— Salut ! **Ça va ?** — **Ça va, et toi ?** — Comme ci, comme ça.

The glue word is **et vous ? / et toi ?** — "and you?" (*et* = "and," Latin *et*; *toi* is the stressed "you"). It bounces the question back — exactly like Spanish *¿y usted? / ¿y tú?*

What you've built this chapter

- **merci** — thank you (← *mercēs*, "reward / mercy").
- **de rien** — you're welcome (← *rem*, "a thing" → "nothing"; twin of Spanish *de nada*).
- **aller / ça va** — "to go," the verb French uses for *how are you* (vs Spanish *estar*, "to stand").
- **Comment ça va ? / allez-vous ? / vas-tu ?** — the casual, formal, and informal question.
- **bien / ça va / comme ci comme ça / pas mal** — the answer ladder.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the full *formal* exchange, both voices
- the same *informally* — *allez-vous* → *ça va*, *vous* → *toi*
- chain the introduction onto this one — "Je m'appelle … Comment allez-vous ?"

Twice through: "Ça va ? — Ça va, et toi ?" until it's reflex.

Before you move on

Which verb carries French "how are you?", and how does its metaphor differ from Spanish's? (*aller*, "to go" — *how does it go?* — vs *estar*, "to stand.") What does *de rien* literally say, and its Spanish twin? ("Of nothing"; *de nada*.) Next chapter: **farewells**.

Chapter 4

Farewells

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 10 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can end a French conversation politely and choose a farewell that fits the situation.
>
> *You can open a French conversation; now close it. French has one plain goodbye and a small family of soft ones, all built the same way — the preposition à ("to") followed by a time word — and this chapter also teaches the accents, the cedilla and the trema you have been reading all along.*

4.1 au revoir — "goodbye," i.e. "until we see each other again"

You can open a French conversation; now close it. The standard goodbye is **au revoir** — and where Spanish *adiós* commends you *to God*, French makes a promise to **see you again**.

Sounds you'll need

- `r-uvular` — two guttural French *r*'s: *oh ruh-VWAHR*.
- `vowel-oi` — **-voir** = *vwahr* (the *oi* = *wa*, as in *soir*, the evening).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au revoir is **au** + **revoir** = "at the **re-seeing**":

- **au** = "at/to the" (a fusion of *à* + *le*).
- **revoir** = "to see again" = **re-** ("again") + **voir** ("to see").

So *au revoir* literally means **"until the seeing-again"** — a small promise that this isn't the end. It's built on **voir**, from Latin **vidēre**, "to see" — one of the richest roots in English:

- **vis**ion, **vis**ible, **vis**it, **vis**a, **view**, **video** ("I see").
- **re-vise** ("look again"), **e-vid**ent ("seen out"), **pro-vide**, **super-vise**, **sur-vey**.

Why it's said this way

Here's a satisfying cross-language pair: **German says the exact same thing.** *Auf Wiedersehen* = *auf* ("on") + *wieder* ("again") + *sehen* ("to see") = "on the seeing-again." French and German, side by side, both promise a **re-seeing**; Spanish *adiós* instead commends you *to God*. Same moment, two different pictures.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "au revoir" — *oh ruh-VWAHR*
- "au revoir" then English "vision, revise, video" — the *vidēre* family
- French *au revoir* and German *auf Wiedersehen* — both "see you again"

Before you move on

What does *au revoir* literally mean? ("Until the seeing-again.") What Latin verb is *voir* from, and two English cousins? (*vidēre* — vision, video, revise.) Which other language builds its goodbye the same "see again" way? (German *auf Wiedersehen*.) Next: "see you later."

4.2 à plus tard — the casual "see you later"

The everyday, friendly "see you later" is **à plus tard** — and among friends it shrinks to just **à plus** (*ah PLUSS*, and here you *do* sound the final *s*). It's the French twin of Spanish *hasta luego*.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-final` — in the full phrase, *plus* is *ploo* (silent *s*): *ah ploo TAR*. But in the clipped **à plus**, the *s* is pronounced: *ah PLUSS*.
- **tard** = *tar* (silent *d*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à plus tard = literally "to more late" → "see you later."

- **à** = "to / at" (Latin *ad*) — French's all-purpose farewell preposition, the way Spanish leans on *hasta*: *à* + a time = a soft goodbye.
- **plus** = "more," from Latin **plūs** — the *plus* you already write in English (and the *plu-* of *plural*, *surplus*).
- **tard** = "late," from Latin **tarde**, "slowly, late." English keeps it in **tardy** and **retard** ("hold back, make late").

So *à plus tard* is "until more-late" — see you at some later point.

Why it's said this way

Spanish inherited that identical Latin *tarde* — the word you met giving your name — but the two languages grew it in different directions. French kept it meaning **late** (*tard*); Spanish grew it into **afternoon** (*tarde*). One Latin word, two everyday meanings. And where French leans on **à** for its soft goodbyes, Spanish leans on **hasta** ("until"): *hasta luego* is the twin of *à plus tard*.

Grammar Lens: the "à ..." farewells

French's soft goodbyes are all **à** + a time word — mirror this against Spanish *hasta*:

French	Spanish	"until / to …"
à plus tard / à plus	hasta luego	later
à + "soon" (next lesson)	hasta pronto	soon
à + "tomorrow" (the lesson after)	hasta mañana	tomorrow

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "à plus tard" (*ah ploo TAR*), then clipped "à plus" (*ah PLUSS*)
- "tard" then Spanish "tarde" — the same Latin *tarde*, "late"
- English "tardy, retard" — held back, late

Before you move on

What does *à plus tard* literally mean? ("To more late.") What Spanish word is *tard* identical to at the root, and what does each mean now? (*tarde* — French "late", Spanish "afternoon".) What preposition carries French's soft goodbyes, like Spanish *hasta*? (*à*.) Next: "see you soon."

4.3 à bientôt — "see you soon"

For when you'll genuinely meet again shortly: **à bientôt**, "see you soon" — the French twin of Spanish *hasta pronto*. It hides a word you already know from your first greetings: **bien**.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — **bien** = *byan*, nasal (the sound you met in your first greetings).
- **bientôt** = *byan-TOH*; the circumflex on *ô* just marks a long *o*, and the final *t* is silent. Whole phrase: *ah byan-TOH*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à bientôt = "to soon" → "see you soon."

- **à** = "to" (the farewell preposition again).
- **bientôt** = "soon," and it's a compound you can pull apart: - **bien** = "well" (from Latin *bene*, the *bene* of *benefit*). - **tôt** = "early / soon." - Together, *bien + tôt* = "**well-soon**" → *quite soon*. (French loves gluing *bien* onto words for emphasis — *bientôt* "soon", *bienvenue* "welcome" = "well-come".)

The circumflex **ô** is itself a little history lesson: a circumflex usually marks an **s that dropped out** (*hôtel* was *hostel*, *forêt* was *forest*). *tôt* came from an older *tost* — so the hat on *ô* is the ghost of a lost *s*.

Grammar Lens: bien, the intensifier

You met *bien* as "well" (an answer to *ça va?*). Here it's doing a second job: **gluing onto another word to strengthen it** — *bien + tôt* = "soon indeed." Same word, new trick.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "à bientôt" — *ah byan-TOH*
- pull it apart — "bien" (well) + "tôt" (early) = bientôt (soon)
- "à bientôt" = Spanish "hasta pronto" — see you soon

Before you move on

What two words hide inside *bientôt*? (*bien* "well" + *tôt* "early" → soon.) What does the circumflex on *ô* usually mark? (A dropped *s* — *tost* → *tôt*.) What's the Spanish equivalent of *à bientôt*? (*hasta pronto*.) Next: "until tomorrow."

4.4 à demain — "see you tomorrow"

Parting for the day: **à demain**, "until tomorrow" — the twin of Spanish *hasta mañana*. And *demain* shares a hidden root with *mañana* that's worth seeing.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — **demain** = *duh-MAN*: the *-ain* is the nasal you heard in *bien*; the final consonant is silent. *ah duh-MAN*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à demain = "to tomorrow" → "see you tomorrow."

- **à** = "to" (the farewell preposition, one last time).
- **demain** = "tomorrow," from Latin **dē māne**, "**from the morning**": - **dē** = "from" · **māne** = "in the morning." - The next "morning" is *tomorrow* → *de mane* fused into **demain**.

English keeps *māne* too, in the poetic **matins** (morning prayers) and **matinée** (a *morning*/daytime show).

Why it's said this way

Spanish *mañana* ("tomorrow / morning") comes from Latin *(hōra) maneana* — built on the **same** *māne*, "morning." So French **demain** and Spanish **mañana** are cousins through one Latin word: both turn "morning" into "tomorrow," just assembled differently — French says *from-morning*, Spanish says *morning-ish hour*.

Grammar Lens: the "à ..." farewells, complete

Your French soft-goodbye set, mapped to Spanish:

French	Spanish	when
à plus tard / à plus	hasta luego	later (default)
à bientôt	hasta pronto	soon
à demain	hasta mañana	tomorrow

…and **au revoir** for the plain goodbye.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "à demain" — *ah duh-MAN*
- "demain" ← *dē māne* "from morning"; Spanish "mañana" ← *maneana* — same *māne*
- the three "à …" goodbyes — à plus tard / à bientôt / à demain

Before you move on

What does *demain* literally come from? (*dē māne* — "from the morning.") What Spanish word shares that *māne* root? (*mañana.*) Which French goodbye for parting until tomorrow? (*à demain.*) Next: put the farewells together.

4.5 Practice — saying goodbye in French

No new words. The farewells — *au revoir* and the three *à …* goodbyes — now close a real conversation and fold back into everything since *salut.*

Your turn: choosing the right goodbye

you're...	**say**
parting plainly / politely	**au revoir**
expecting to meet again shortly	**à bientôt**
casual "see you"	**à plus (tard)**
leaving for the day	**à demain**

The exchange, start to finish

Everything from the French Chapters 1–4:

> — Salut ! Je m'appelle Chloé. Comment tu t'appelles ? — Je m'appelle Marc. Enchanté. — Ça va ? — Ça va bien, merci, et toi ? — Bien. Bon… **à demain**, Marc. — Oui, **à demain**, Chloé. **Au revoir !**

What you've built this chapter

- **au revoir** — the plain goodbye ("until the seeing-again"; the *voir* / *vidēre* family; twin of German *auf Wiedersehen*).
- **à plus tard / à bientôt / à demain** — later / soon / tomorrow, all **à** + a time, mirroring Spanish's **hasta**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the full conversation, both voices — *salut* to *au revoir*
- pick the goodbye — a friend you'll see tomorrow? (à demain); a polite plain goodbye? (au revoir)

Twice through: Run the exchange, greeting to goodbye, without stopping.

Before you move on

What does *au revoir* literally promise? (A *re-seeing* — "until we see again.") Which preposition carries French's soft goodbyes? (*à* — like Spanish *hasta*.) You can now hold a whole short French exchange, hello to goodbye. Next chapter: your first verbs — to speak, to live somewhere, to work.

4.6 é è ê — the three hats on *e*, and the one that hides an *s*

French sprinkles little marks over its vowels, and they are **not** decoration — each does a specific job. You've read one since *enchanté*, and another on the *à* of your goodbyes. Three of them ride on *e*, and one of the three hides a word you already know in English.

You'll want to know: the three accents, and what they do

- **é** — *accent aigu* (rising stroke, like Spanish's). It fixes the sound: **é = a crisp "ay"** (no glide). *enchanté*, *été* ("summer").

- **è** — *accent grave* (falling stroke). **è = an open "eh"** as in *bed*. *première* ("first" — English borrowed it as *premiere*), *Genève* ("Geneva"). The grave also just **separates look-alikes**: *a* ("has") vs **à** ("to") — same job as Spanish *tu/tú*.
- **ê** — *accent circonflexe* (a little hat). This one is a **fossil**.

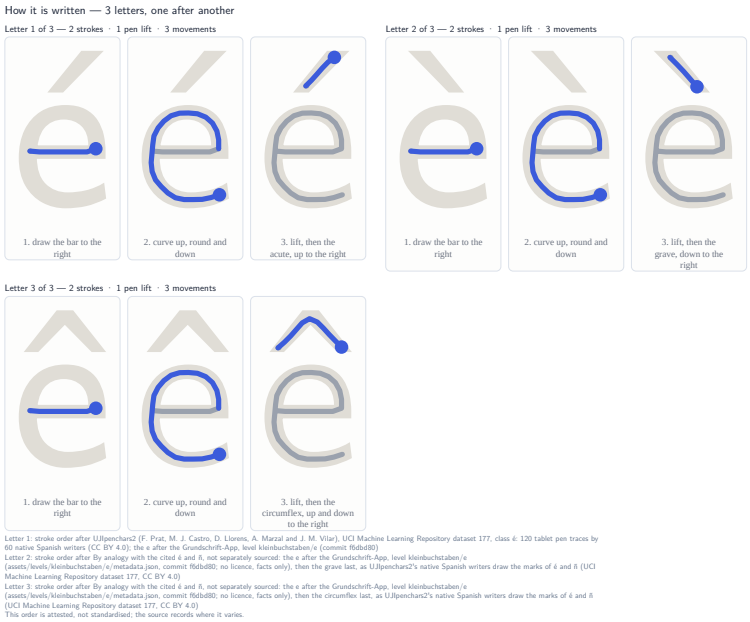
Why it's said this way

Centuries ago French dropped an *s* before certain consonants, and left a **hat** where it used to stand. English, having borrowed the older form, usually **still has that s** — so the circumflex is a decoder ring between the two languages:

French (hat)	**the lost *s***	**English kept it**
forêt	forest	**forest**
hôpital	hospital	**hospital**
île	isle	**isle / island**
bête	beste	**beast**
fête	feste	**feast**
pâte	paste	**paste / pasta**
goût	gust	(Latin *gustus*, cf. *gusto*)

So when you meet a circumflex, **mentally slot an *s* back in** and an English cousin often appears. *Hôpital* → *hospital*. It's the single most useful reading trick in French spelling.

Writing: the three accents



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: é, è, ê

All three are small strokes **above** the vowel: **é** leans right (up-stroke), **è** leans left (down-stroke), **ê** is a little peak (^). Get the *lean* right — *é* and *è* are different sounds, so the direction matters.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "é" = *ay* (*enchanté*), "è" = *eh* (*première*) — hear the two sounds
- forêt → forest, hôpital → hospital, île → isle — put the *s* back
- "à" vs "a" — the grave that only separates

Before you move on

Which accent makes *e* say "ay," and which "eh"? (*é* aigu = ay; *è* grave = eh.) What does the circumflex **ê** usually mark, and how do you use it? (A lost *s* — slot it back to find the English cousin: *forêt*

→ forest.) Next writing lesson: the little hook under *c* — the **cédille**.

4.7 ç — the little tail that softens *c*

You've seen it in **français** and **garçon**. The **cédille** is the tiny hook under a *c* — **ç** — and it exists to solve one specific spelling problem.

You'll want to know: the problem the cedilla solves

In French (as in Latin, Italian, Spanish), **c is soft (an *s* sound) before *e* and *i***, but **hard (a *k*) before *a*, *o*, *u***:

- *ce*, *ci* → soft: *ceci* = *suh-SEE*.
- *ca*, *co*, *cu* → hard: *car*, *comme*, *cure* = *k*.

So "franc-ais" would read *frank-ay* — wrong. To force the **soft** *s* before *a/o/u*, French adds the hook: **ç**.

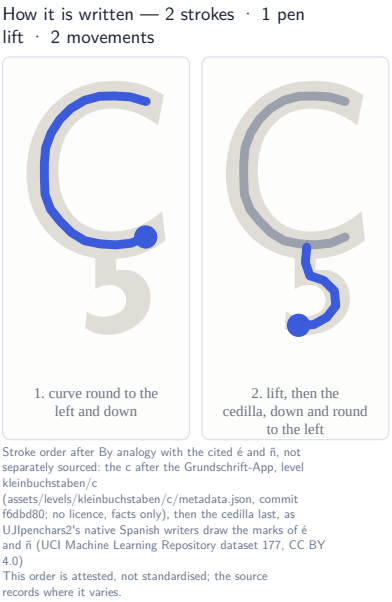
- **français** = *frahn-**SEH*** (not "frank-").
- **garçon** = *gar-**SOHN*** ("boy").
- **ça** = *sa* ("that" — the *ça* of *ça va?*).
- **reçu** = *ruh-**SU*** ("received").

The rule is tidy: **ç only ever appears before a, o, u** — never before *e/i*, where *c* is already soft and the hook would be pointless.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The *cédille* is literally **"a little *z*."** Its name is Spanish **zedilla** ("little zeta") — medieval scribes wrote a small subscript **z** under the *c* to say "pronounce this like *z/s*, not *k*." Over time the little *z* shrank into the hook you write today. So **ç = c + a ghost z.** (Spanish later dropped it; French and Portuguese kept it — *ç* is alive in *português* itself.)

Writing: the cedilla



How ç is written, stroke by stroke

Write a normal **c**, then add a small **hook curling left off the bottom**, like a tiny *5*'s tail. Only ever under *c*, only before *a/o/u*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "français", "garçon", "ça" — the ç forcing a soft *s*
- imagine no cédille — "franc-ais" as *frank-ay* — that's what it prevents

Before you move on

What does the cédille do, and before which letters does it appear? (Keeps *c* soft (*s*) — only before *a, o, u*.) What is the hook, historically? (A shrunken subscript *z* — Spanish *zedilla*, "little z".) Next writing lesson: the two dots — the **tréma**.

4.8 ï ë ü — the two dots that say "say me on my own"

The last French mark: two little dots over a vowel — the **tréma** (English calls it a *diaeresis*). It answers one question the reader would otherwise get wrong: **do these two vowels blend, or not?**

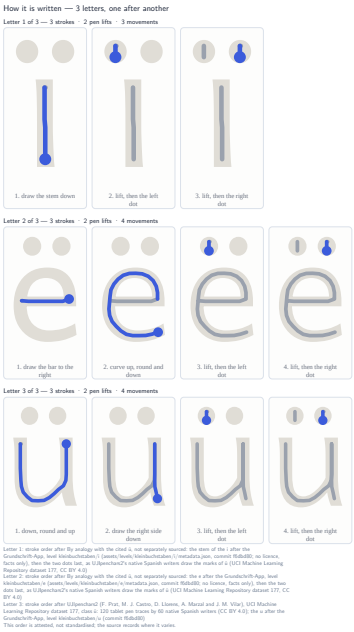
You'll want to know: the problem the trema solves

French loves to fuse vowel pairs into one sound: *a-i* says *eh*, *a-u oh*, *o-u oo*, *o-i wa*. Usually that's what you want. But sometimes two vowels really should be sounded **separately** — and the tréma is how the spelling says so: **"break these apart; pronounce the marked vowel on its own."**

- **naïve** = *na-**EEV*** (na-i, two syllables) — not "nave." (English kept the dots: *naïve*.)
- **Noël** = *no-**EL*** ("Christmas") — *o* and *e* separately, not "nurl."
- **maïs** = *ma-**EES*** ("corn"). Without the dots the same letters blend to *meh*, a different word: the dots flip the meaning.
- **Citroën**, **Israël**, **égoïste** — same rule: split the vowels.

So the tréma is the **opposite** of a blend instruction: where *a-i* says "merge," *aï* says "don't."

Writing: the trema



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: ï, ë, ü

Two dots, side by side, **above** the vowel that starts its **own** sound — the *second* vowel of the pair (na-**ï**-ve). (It looks like a German umlaut, but the job is different: German ä/ö/ü *change* the vowel; the French tréma *separates* it. Same two dots, opposite purpose — that's the next lesson.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "naïve" = na-EEV, "Noël" = no-EL — two syllables each
- "maïs" (ma-EES, corn), then the blended *meh* the dots forbid

Before you move on

What does the tréma tell you to do? (Pronounce the two vowels **separately**, not blended.) How is it different from a German umlaut? (Tréma *separates* vowels; umlaut *changes* a vowel's sound.) That's the French writing kit: **é è ê**, **ç**, and **ï ë**.

4.9 à — one word, three goodbyes

Three soft goodbyes, from memory. Say all three, then say the one word every one of them begins with.

You'll want to know: the soft goodbyes are all à plus a time

à plus tard	to more late — later, the default
à bientôt	to well-soon — soon
à demain	to tomorrow

One preposition and a word for *when*. Choosing between them is choosing a distance in time, and nothing else about the sentence moves.

bonne nuit is not in that family and is worth keeping apart: it is for someone going to **bed**, not for someone leaving a room. Said on the way out of an afternoon meeting it lands oddly.

Grammar Lens: tu and vous, and where the choice actually shows

tu is the familiar you, for a friend or a peer; *vous* is the formal or plural one, for a stranger, an elder, a group. The climb is visible in the question: **Comment vas-tu ?** against **Comment allez-vous ?** The verb changes with the pronoun, so the choice is not a single word you can swap late — it is decided before the sentence starts.

What you've built — thanks, and the shrug

merci and its reply **de rien**, "of nothing" — the same modesty Spanish reaches for with *de nada*.
And the shrug: **comme ci, comme ça**, "like this, like that". Every language paints that gesture differently — Spanish weighs it (*más o menos*, more or less), Italian doubles a word (*così così*), French points twice. One gesture, three pictures.

Before you move on

What do the three soft goodbyes share? (**à**, plus a word for when.) Who is **bonne nuit** for? (**Someone going to bed.**) Where does the tu-vous choice show itself? (**In the verb** — *vas-tu* against

allez-vous.) And what does **de rien** say literally? (**Of nothing.**)

4.10 ê ç ï — three marks, three different jobs

forêt, **hôpital**, **île**. One letter is missing from each, and English still has it. Say which letter, before reading on.

Script: what each mark is actually for

The three arrived a page apart and do three unrelated jobs. Sorted by what they change, they stop looking like a single topic called *accents*:

mark	what it changes
ê the circumflex	**nothing you say** — it records an *s* that fell out
ç the cédille	**the sound** — it keeps **c** soft before a, o, u
ï the tréma	**the grouping** — read this vowel on its own

The circumflex is the odd one and the useful one. French dropped an *s* before certain consonants and left a hat where it stood; English borrowed the older spelling and kept the *s*. So **forêt** is forest, **hôpital** is hospital, **île** is isle. **A hat is a decoder ring**, not a pronunciation instruction.

The other two are instructions. **ç** exists because **c** would otherwise go hard before those three vowels; **ï** exists because two vowels side by side would otherwise be read as one sound.

Your turn

- *Look:* at a word with a hat and say the English word that kept the *s*
- *Say it:* a **c** before **a** with the hook and without it
- *Say it:* two vowels with the tréma and without, and hear them split
- *Trace it:* each of the three marks once

Before you move on

Which of the three changes nothing you say? (**The circumflex**.)
What does it record? (**A lost *s***, which English usually still has.)
What does the cédille stop happening? (**A hard c** before a, o, u.)
And what does the tréma ask you to do? (**Read the vowel separately**.)

Chapter 5

The First Verbs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build short present-tense French sentences with the chapter's first verbs.
>
> *Until now you have assembled fixed phrases. This chapter hands you a pattern instead: the regular -er verbs, the largest verb family in French by a wide margin. Learn the one template and thousands of verbs come with it — and with it you build your first sentence that nobody handed you pre-made.*

5.1 parler — "to speak," and the great regular French verb

Until now you've assembled fixed phrases. **parler** ("to speak") is your first real **verb** — and it's the model for the **biggest** French verb family by far: the **-er** verbs. Learn this one pattern and you can drive thousands.

Sounds you'll need

- `er-ending` — the infinitive **-er** is a clean *ay*: **parler** = *par-LAY* (the *r* is silent in the ending). The stem is *parl-*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parler comes from Late Latin **parabolāre**, *"to tell parables, to discourse"* — from **parabola**, "a comparison, a speech" (itself from

Greek *parabolē*, "a throwing-beside"). So to *speak*, in French, is at root to *tell parables*. That root fans into English:

- **parable** — the story-comparison itself.
- **parole** — a spoken word of honour (a prisoner's *parole*).
- **palaver** — a long talk; **parley** — to talk terms; even **parliament** — a *talking*-place.

Grammar Lens: the -er present tense (and its silent trap)

Drop **-er**, add the ending for the person:

person	**ending, on *parler***	**sounds like**
je	**-e**: **je parle**	*parl*
tu	**-es**: **tu parles**	*parl*
il / elle	**-e**: **il parle**	*parl*
nous	-ons: **nous parlons**	par-LON
vous	-ez: **vous parlez**	par-LAY
ils / elles	**-ent**: **ils parlent**	*parl*

Here is the great French surprise: **-e, -es, and -ent are all SILENT** — *je parle*, *tu parles*, *ils parlent* **all sound identical**, just *parl*. Only *nous* (*-ons*) and *vous* (*-ez*) are audible.

Grammar Lens: why French keeps its pronouns

That silence has a consequence which shapes the whole language. In Spanish the ending alone tells you who is speaking — *hablo* ("I speak") against *hablas* ("you speak") — so the pronoun can be dropped. In French your ear cannot hear any difference between *parle*, *parles* and *parlent*, so the **pronoun must stay** to carry the person. *Je* and *tu* are not optional decoration in French; they are the only thing telling you who is doing the speaking.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "parler" — *par-LAY*
- "je parle, tu parles, il parle" — all *parl*, identical

- "parler" then English "parable, parole, palaver" — the *parabola* root

Before you move on

What Latin word is *parler* from, and its English cousins? (*parabolāre* ← *parabola* — parable, parole.) Which three present-tense endings are silent? (*-e, -es, -ent* — je/tu/ils all sound *parl.*) Why does French keep *je/tu* when Spanish drops *yo/tú*? (The endings are silent, so the pronoun carries the person.) Next: the verb "to live."

5.2 habiter — "to live," and it's about *having a place*

A second **-er** verb — snap it into the exact template you just learned. **habiter** ("to live, to dwell") lets you say *where* you live, the answer to a "where?" question.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-final` — the **h is silent** (French *h* never sounds): **habiter** = *a-bee-TAY*. Same *-er* = *ay* ending as *parler*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

habiter comes from Latin **habitāre**, *"to dwell, to keep on having [a place]"* — the **frequentative** of **habēre**, "to have." To *dwell* somewhere is to *keep having* it as your place. That root is thoroughly English:

- **habitat** — the place a creature dwells.
- **inhabit**, **inhabitant**, **habitation** — to dwell in / one who dwells.
- and (via *habēre*, "have") **habit** — what you "keep having," and **able**, **ability** (what you "have" it in you to do).

Grammar Lens: same -er template

Drop **-er**, add the endings — identical to *parler*, silent trap and all: | j'habite · tu habites · il habite | (all *a-BEET*) |

| nous habitons · vous habitez | (a-bee-TON · a-bee-TAY) |
Note **j'habite** — *je* elides to **j'** before the vowel of *habite* (the *h* is silent, so it counts as a vowel). Now you can say where you live:

J'habite à Paris. — "I live in Paris."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "habiter" — *a-bee-TAY*, silent *h*
- "j'habite, tu habites, il habite" — all *a-BEET*
- "habiter" then English "habitat, inhabit" — the *habitāre* root

Before you move on

What Latin verb is *habiter* from, and what does it literally involve? (*habitāre*, "keep having a place" — from *habēre*, "to have.") English cousins? (Habitat, inhabit, habitation.) Say "I live in Paris." (*J'habite à Paris.*) Next: the verb "to work."

5.3 travailler — "to work," and the torture behind "travel"

A third **-er** verb, and it shares its dark, delightful origin with a Spanish word you may already know: **travailler** ("to work") began as a word for **torture**, and it's the secret ancestor of English **travel**.

Sounds you'll need

- `ai-y` — the **-ill-** is a *y* glide: **travailler** = *tra-va-YAY*. Same *-er* = *ay* ending.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

travailler comes from Vulgar Latin **tripaliāre**, *"to torture"* — from **tripalium**, a Roman instrument of torture made of **three stakes** (*tri-* "three" + *pālus* "stake" → English *pale*, *impale*).

The slide of meaning is grim and logical: *torture* → *painful toil* → **work**. And two English words came down the same road:

- **travail** — painful, laborious effort.
- **travel** — journeying was once such an **ordeal** that *travail* (toil) became *travel* (to make a journey). You are, etymologically, *tortured* every time you travel.

Why it's said this way

Spanish **trabajar** ("to work") comes from the very same *tripaliāre* — a perfect cross-language twin, torture and all. The middle of the word went one way in each language: the *-al-* stayed in French (*travail*, *travailler*) and softened to *-aj-* in Spanish (*trabajo*, *trabajar*).

Grammar Lens: same -er template

| je travaille · tu travailles · il travaille | (all *tra-VYE*) |
| nous travaillons · vous travaillez | |

Je travaille à Paris. — "I work in Paris."

Nothing new to learn — that's the point. **One template, every -er verb.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "travailler" — *tra-va-YAY*
- "je travaille" — *je tra-VYE*, "I work"
- travailler → travail → travel — torture became a journey; twin of Spanish *trabajar*

Before you move on

What did *travailler* originally mean, and from what device? ("To torture," ← *tripalium*, three stakes.) What two English words share the root? (*Travail* and *travel*.) Its Spanish twin? (*Trabajar* — same

tripaliāre.) Next: build your first full sentence — "I speak French."

5.4 Je parle français — your first real sentence

The moment it all pays off: you take a **verb** you conjugated and a **noun**, and build a sentence **no one handed you pre-made** — *Je parle français*, "I speak French."

Sounds you'll need

- `soft-c-s` — **français** = *frahn-SEH*. The cedilla under the **ç** forces a soft *s* where a plain *c* would have been hard.
- The opening *fran-* is nasal, and the final *-ais* is a plain *eh*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

français = "French" — both the language and a French person — from **Francia**, "land of the **Franks**": the Germanic people who settled Roman Gaul and gave France its name. And here is the twist: the Franks' own name meant **"free."** That is why English **frank** and **frankly** mean open and unguarded, and why the old French coin was called a *franc*.

Grammar Lens: two rules hiding in four words

Snap together two things you own:

> **Je** (I, ← *ego*) + **parle** (speak, from *parler*) = **Je parle français.**

A complete, grammatical French sentence. Two rules are hiding in it:

- **You keep the *je*.** Spanish drops its pronoun — *hablo español* says "I speak Spanish" with no word for "I," because the ending *-o* carries the person. French cannot do that: *parle*, *parles* and *parlent* all sound alike, so **the pronoun must stay**. This is the single biggest structural difference between French and its Iberian cousins.
- **No article on the language** here: *je parle français*, not *je parle le français*.

Swap the pieces and it generates:

- **J'habite à Paris.** — "I live in Paris."
- **Tu parles français ?** — "Do you speak French?" (just raise the tone).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Je parle français" — *zhuh parl frahn-SEH*
- keep the *je* — French can't drop it (unlike Spanish *hablo*)
- swap — "Tu parles français ?", "J'habite à Paris"

Before you move on

Where does *français* come from, and what did the Franks' name mean? (*Francia*, "land of the Franks"; the name meant "free" — English *frank*.) Why must French keep *je* where Spanish drops *yo*? (French endings are silent, so the pronoun carries the person.) Next: practice.

5.5 Practice — making sentences with -er verbs

For the first time you're not reciting phrases — you're **building** sentences from a pattern. Drill the three verbs, and burn in the French rule the whole language turns on: **keep the pronoun** (the endings are silent).

Your turn: conjugate on command

Run each through *je / tu / il*:

- **parler**: je parle · tu parles · il parle — all **parl**
- **habiter**: j'habite · tu habites · il habite — all **a-beet**
- **travailler**: je travaille · tu travailles · il travaille — all **tra-vye**

Every singular form (and the *ils* form) **sounds the same** — the *-e/-es/-ent* are silent. That's why *je, tu, il* stay put: they carry the person your ear can't hear.

Your turn: say something real

— **Tu parles** français ? — Oui, je **parle** français. (Do you speak French? — Yes, I speak French.) — **Tu habites** à Lyon ? — Oui, **j'habite** à Lyon. Je **travaille** à Paris. — Merci ! — De rien.

What you've built this chapter

- **the regular -er present tense** — drop *-er*, add *-e/-es/-e/-ons/-ez/-ent*; the singular + *ils* endings are **silent**, so the pronoun is mandatory (the big contrast with Spanish/Italian pro-drop).
- **parler** (← *parabolāre* → parable/parole), **habiter** (← *habitāre* → habitat/inhabit), **travailler** (← *tripalium* → travail/travel; twin of Spanish *trabajar*).
- **Je parle français** — your first self-assembled sentence (*français* ← *Francia*, the Franks = "free").

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- conjugate all three verbs, je/tu/il — hear that they don't change
- answer about yourself — where you live, where you work, what you speak
- chain it — "Bonjour ! Je parle français. Tu parles français ? … Au revoir !"

Twice through: "Tu parles français ? — Oui, je parle français."

Before you move on

Which -er endings are silent, and what follows from that? (*-e, -es, -ent* — so French keeps its subject pronouns.) Give "I" forms of the three verbs. (*Je parle, j'habite, je travaille.*) Say "I live in Paris. I

work in Lyon." (*J'habite à Paris. Je travaille à Lyon.*) French now moves in real sentences.

Chapter 6

Numbers One to Ten

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (12) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 12 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from one to ten in French and use the numbers in a short exchange.
>
> *The ten most-reused words in the language, taken one at a time. Each is a Latin numeral that barely moved on its way into French, so English has already handed you half of them — and four of them left a copy of themselves in the calendar, still counting two months out of place.*

6.1 un — one

Numbers are the most-reused words in any language, and French inherited them from Latin almost unchanged. You already half-know them through English. We take them **one at a time**, starting with the first.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-un` — **un** is a **nasal vowel**, close to "uh" hummed through the nose. No *n* is ever pronounced. The letters *u*-*n* are a single sound, not two.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

un (1) comes from Latin **ūnus**, and that root is everywhere in English:

- **unit** — one thing counted

- **union** — many made one
- **unique** — one of its kind
- **universe** — everything turned into one

English **one** and **a/an** descend from the same ancient word, worn down at home rather than borrowed. Spanish keeps the Latin shape more plainly: *uno*.

Grammar Lens: one word for "one" and "a"

French draws no line between "one" and "a/an." **un** does both jobs, and it takes the gender of the noun it stands in front of:

- **un** before a masculine noun — *un jour*, "a day" **or** "one day"
- **une** before a feminine noun — *une nuit*, "a night" **or** "one night"

You met that same masculine/feminine split in *le* and *la*. It is the same split, on a different word. Spanish does exactly this too (*un* / *una*). The counting words that follow never change shape; this first one is the only one that does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "un" — hum it through the nose, no *n* at the end
- "un jour" then "une nuit" — same word, two genders
- "un" then English "unit, union, unique" — hear the ūnus

Before you move on

How do you say one in French? (**un**, nasal, with no *n* sounded.) What two things does it mean? (**One**, and **a/an**.) What is its feminine form, and when do you use it? (**une**, before a feminine noun — *une nuit*.) Next: the number two.

6.2 deux — two

One down. The second number brings a vowel your mouth has to be taught, and a final letter you must **not** say.

Travailler and Spanish *trabajar* are twins from one Latin word: French kept the *-al-*, Spanish softened it to *-aj-*.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-eu` — say "eh," then round your lips as if for "oo" without moving your tongue. That rounded *eu* is the whole word: **deux** = *deuh*.
- `silent-final` — the **x** is silent. French writes letters at the end of a word that it has stopped pronouncing, and this is your first one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

deux (2) comes from Latin **duo**, which English borrowed several times over:

- **duo** — two performers
- **dual**, **duel** — of two
- **duet** — a piece for two
- **double** — Latin *duplus*, "two-fold"

Spanish went the other way with the same word and wore it down to *dos*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "deux" — round the lips, stop before the *x*
- "un, deux" — count what you have so far
- "deux jours" — two days

Before you move on

How do you say two? (**deux**, *deuh.*) What happens to the **x**? (Nothing — it is silent.) Which English words carry the same Latin *duo*? (*Duo, dual, duet, double.*) Count what you have. (*Un, deux.*) Next: the number three.

6.3 trois — three

The third number shows you the most French vowel spelling there is: **oi**, which sounds nothing like either letter in it.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-oi` — the pair **oi** is always *wa*. So **trois** = *trwa*.
- `silent-final` — the **s** is silent here, exactly as the *x* was in *deux*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trois (3) comes from Latin **trēs**. Look at what happened next: French turned it into *trois* and Spanish into *tres*. **Same Roman word, worn two different ways** — the clearest picture yet of how one language becomes two.
English took the Latin form whole, over and over:

- **trio** — three players
- **triple** — three-fold
- **trident** — three teeth
- **triangle** — three corners

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "trois" — *trwa*, one syllable
- "un, deux, trois" — the count so far
- "trois" then Spanish "tres" — one Latin word, two shapes

Before you move on

How do you say three? (**trois**, *trwa.*) What sound does **oi** always make? (*Wa.*) Which Latin word gave both *trois* and Spanish *tres*? (**trēs**.) Count to three. (*Un, deux, trois.*) Next: the number four.

6.4 quatre — four

The fourth number is the first that runs to two syllables, and it ends in a letter French writes but barely breathes.

Sounds you'll need

- **quatre** = *KA-truh.* The **qu-** is a plain *k*; no *w* sound survives.
- `silent-final-e` — the closing **-e** is a whisper, not a vowel you lean on.
- `r-uvular` — the French **r** is made at the back of the throat, near where you would gargle, and never rolled at the tip of the tongue.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quatre (4) comes from Latin **quattuor**. English borrowed the Latin stem and kept the *qua-* visible in every one:

- **quart** — a fourth of a gallon
- **quarter** — a fourth of anything
- **quatrain** — a four-line verse
- **quadrant** — a quarter of a circle

Spanish stayed nearer the Latin with *cuatro*; French compressed the middle of the word away.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "quatre" — *KA-truh*, the *r* at the back of the throat

- "un, deux, trois, quatre"
- "quatre" then English "quarter, quadrant" — the same *quattuor*

Before you move on

How do you say four? (**quatre**, *KA-truh.*) Where in your mouth is the French **r** made? (At the **back of the throat**.) Which English words come from *quattuor*? (*Quart, quarter, quatrain, quadrant.*) Next: the number five, which closes the first hand.

6.5 cinq — five

Five closes the first hand — and this one came into English so completely that you have handled it on a pair of dice.

Sounds you'll need

- `soft-c-s` — a **c** before *i* or *e* is an *s*. So **cinq** opens with *s*, not *k*.
- `nasal-in` — the **in** is nasal, like the *un* you met in **un**, but with the tongue further forward. The **q** at the end **is** sounded: *sank*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cinq (5) comes from Latin **quīnque**. English took the Latin stem for counting words:

- **quintet** — five players
- **quintessence** — the *fifth* essence, the one the ancients set above earth, water, air and fire

And English took the **French** word whole for one job: **cinque**, the five on a die or a playing card. Spanish, again, kept the Latin *q*: *cinco*.

Grammar Lens: what the first five have in common

Set the five beside their Latin parents and one fact stands out: **the numbers barely moved.** *ūnus, duo, trēs, quattuor, quīnque* went into French as the five words you have learned, and into Spanish as *uno, dos, tres, cuatro, cinco.* Words used every day by every speaker

are the words a language changes least.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "cinq" — *sank*, the *q* sounded
- "un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq" — count the whole hand
- "cinq jours" — five days

Twice through: "un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq"

Before you move on

How do you say five? (**cinq**, *sank.*) Why does the **c** sound like *s*? (It stands before **i**.) Which English word for the 5 on a die is French? (**cinque**.) Count to five. (*Un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq.*) Next: the number six, and a rule about final letters that turn on and off.

6.6 six — six

Six is spelled like the English word and means the same thing. The new thing here is not the word. It is that its last sound **switches on and off** depending on what follows.

Sounds you'll need

- Counting on its own, **six** ends in an *s* sound: *sees.*
- The **i** is the short, tight vowel of English *machine*, not of *sit.*

Grammar Lens: a final letter that comes and goes

French final consonants are not a fixed yes or no. **six** has three settings, and which one you hear is decided by the next word:

- **counting, or standing alone** — the *s* is sounded: *sees*
- **before a consonant** — the *s* falls silent: *six livres* = *see livres*
- **before a vowel** — it comes back voiced, as a *z*: *six ans* =

*see-**z**-ans*

That third case is called **liaison**: a silent ending waking up to bridge into a vowel. French does this constantly, and you will meet it in every chapter from here on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

six (6) comes from Latin **sex**, which is where English got:

- **sextet** — six players
- **sextant** — an instrument marking a sixth of a circle
- **semester** — Latin *sex mensis*, "six months"

Spanish made *seis* from the same *sex*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "six" alone — *sees*, the *s* sounded
- "six livres" — *see livres*, the *s* gone
- the count so far, one through six
- "six ans" — *see-z-ans*, the *s* back as a *z*

Before you move on

How do you say six when counting? (*Sees*, with the *s*.) What happens to that *s* before a consonant? (It **goes silent** — *six livres*.) And before a vowel? (It returns as a **z** — *six ans*. That is **liaison**.) Next: the number seven, and a secret hidden in the calendar.

6.7 sept — seven

Seven is the first of four numbers that left a copy of themselves in the calendar. Learn the number and you have been handed a month.

Sounds you'll need

- **sept** = *set*. The **p** is written and never spoken.
- The final **t**, unusually, **is** spoken. French keeps a handful of final consonants alive, and this is one of them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sept (7) comes from Latin **septem**. The same *septem* stands, undisguised, at the front of a month you already know:

- **septembre** — French for September
- **septet** — seven players

The month is worth staring at. *Septembre* announces itself as the **seventh**, and everybody uses it as the ninth. That gap has an explanation, and it is waiting at the end of this chapter. Spanish made *siete* from the same *septem*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sept" — *set*, no *p*
- the count so far, one through seven
- "sept" then English "September" — the seven inside the month

Before you move on

How do you say seven? (**sept**, *set*.) Which written letter is silent? (The **p**.) Which month carries the same Latin *septem*? (**September**, in French as in English — the ninth month, for a reason we come to.) Next: the number eight.

6.8 huit — eight

Every number so far has looked like its Latin parent. This one looks like nothing at all — and that is the lesson.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-h` — French never pronounces a written **h**. Not here, not anywhere.
- **huit** = *weet*, with the final **t** sounded.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

huit (8) comes from Latin **octō**, and the road it travelled is worth following step by step:

octō → *oit* → **huit**

The *c* dropped out, the vowels softened, and a written *h* grew on the front as a prop. The number came out unrecognisable. English, which borrowed the Latin form directly, kept it whole in **octave**, **octagon** and **octopus** — the eight-armed one.
Here is the consolation: French kept the old shape in the **month**. **Octobre** still carries *oct-* in plain sight. The eight vanished from the number and survived in the calendar. Spanish made *ocho*, which sits about halfway along the same road.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "huit" — *weet*, no *h*, with the *t*
- the count so far, one through eight
- the road — "octō, oit, huit" — then the month, where the *oct-* held (English "October" kept it too)

Before you move on

How do you say eight? (**huit**, *weet*.) What does French do with a written **h**? (Never pronounces it.) Which Latin word is *huit* worn down from, and where can you still see it? (**octō** — kept intact in the month: French's, and English **October**.) Next: the number nine.

6.9 neuf — nine

You met a final letter that goes silent before a consonant. Nine shows you the other move: a final letter that **changes shape** to reach a vowel.

Sounds you'll need

- **neuf** = *nuhf*. The vowel is the rounded *eu* you learned in **deux**, and the **f** is sounded.

Grammar Lens: the f that turns into a v

Standing before a vowel, the **f** of *neuf* softens into a **v**:

- **neuf ans** ("nine years") = *neu-**v**-ans*
- **neuf heures** ("nine o'clock") = *neu-**v**-eures*

This is the same instinct you saw in *six ans*: French will not let a consonant sit awkwardly against a following vowel, so it bends the sound to bridge them. With *six* the ending woke up as a *z*; with *neuf* it softens to a *v*. Both are liaison, doing the one job of keeping the line smooth.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neuf (9) comes from Latin **novem**. Once again the month kept the number visible: **novembre** wears its *nov-* on the outside, and English has **novena**, a devotion of nine days. Spanish made *nueve*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "neuf" — *nuhf*, with the *f*
- "neuf ans" — *neu-v-ans*, the *f* softened
- "six ans, neuf ans" — a *z* and a *v*, the same bridging move

Before you move on

How do you say nine? (**neuf**, *nuhf.*) What happens to the **f** before a vowel? (It becomes a **v** — *neuf ans.*) Which month keeps the same Latin *novem*? (**November**, in French as in English.) Next: the number ten, and the count is complete.

6.10 dix — ten

The last number of the count, and the one you have been carrying in your pocket in English without knowing it.

Sounds you'll need

- Counting on its own, **dix** ends in an *s* sound: *dees.*
- It behaves exactly like **six**: silent before a consonant (*dix livres* = *dee livres*), and back as a *z* before a vowel (*dix ans* = *dee-**z**-ans*).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dix (10) comes from Latin **decem**, and it has left tracks in three places you already walk:

- **décembre** — the month that says "ten"
- **decimal** — counting by tens
- **dime** — a tenth of a dollar. That one came through Old French **disme**, from Latin *decima*, "a tenth." The coin in an American pocket is a French word for a tenth part.

Spanish made *diez* from the same *decem.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dix" alone — *dees*
- "dix livres", then "dix ans" — silent, then *z*
- "dix" then English "decimal, dime" — the *decem* in both

Before you move on

How do you say ten on its own? (**dix**, *dees.*) Which other number shares its on-and-off ending? (**six**.) Which American coin is a worn-down French word for a tenth? (The **dime**, from *disme* ← *decima.*) Next: why those four months are counting wrong.

6.11 The months that are off by two

Four times in this chapter a number turned up at the front of a month, and four times the arithmetic was wrong by two. Here is why.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Line up what the four months **say** against where they **sit**:

month	**says**	**sits at**
septembre	seven (*septem*)	9th
octobre	eight (*octō*)	10th
novembre	nine (*novem*)	11th
décembre	ten (*decem*)	12th

Every one is two places late, and all four are late by the **same** two places. A single event moved them.

The old Roman year began in **March**, not January. Counting from March, *September* genuinely was the seventh month and *December* the tenth — the names were accurate. Later, two months named for **Julius Caesar** and the emperor **Augustus** were fixed into the middle of the year, and the start of the year was moved back to January. The counting months were shoved two places along. Their Latin names never caught up.

So every December, in French and in English alike, you are saying the Roman word for **ten**. Spanish carries the identical fault: *diciembre* is *decem* too.

Before you move on

What does *septembre* mean, and which month is it? (**Seven** — and it is the ninth.) In which month did the old Roman year begin? (**March**.) Which two months were pushed in, and for whom? (The

two named for **Julius Caesar** and **Augustus**.) What number are you saying when you say *décembre*? (**Ten**, Latin *decem*.)

6.12 Practice — counting to ten, out loud and in use

Ten words, taken one at a time. Now run them together until the chain is one motion, then put it to work.

Your turn: the whole count

Up, then down:

un, deux, trois, quatre, cinq, six, sept, huit, neuf, dix

Twice through: the count from one to ten

Then backwards, which is where a memorised chant stops helping and the words have to be individually yours: *dix, neuf, huit, sept, six, cinq, quatre, trois, deux, un.*

Your turn: the endings that move

Three numbers change sound depending on what comes next. Say each pair and listen for the difference:

- *six livres* / *six ans* — silent, then **z**
- *dix livres* / *dix ans* — silent, then **z**
- *neuf livres* / *neuf ans* — **f**, then **v**

Your turn: say something real

— Bonjour ! **Un** jour ? — Non, **deux** jours.

— **Trois** ? — Non, **deux**. Merci !

— De rien. Bonne nuit — **une** nuit, **deux** nuits.

Say how many, then correct yourself. The exchange is short on purpose: every word in it is already yours, from this chapter or from the first.

What you've built this chapter

- **un** to **dix** — the ten most-reused words in the language, each of them a Latin numeral that barely moved on the way in.
- **un / une** — the number one doubling as "a/an," and taking gender.
- **liaison** — *six*, *dix* and *neuf* changing their final sound to reach a following vowel.
- **the four months at the end of the year** — still counting seven to ten, two places out of place ever since the Roman year stopped starting in March.

Before you move on

Count from one to ten without stopping. Now backwards. Which three numbers change their ending before a vowel, and how? (*Six* and *dix* to a **z**, *neuf* to a **v**.) What is the difference between *un jour* and *une nuit*? (Gender — the same word for "one" and "a," agreeing with the noun.) Why does the twelfth month say **ten**? (The Roman year began in **March**, and two months were later inserted.)

Chapter 7

The Days of the Week

Modes: **voice** (7) **eyes** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 7 of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the days of the week in French and use them in simple plans.
>
> *Seven day-names that are a map of the sky. Five carry a Roman planet-god and all of them carry Latin dies, "day" – so half of every weekday comes free, and English names the same gods on the same days under Germanic names. Then two days where a later faith wrote over the planets entirely.*

7.1 la lune — the Moon

The seven-day week is one of the oldest things any language carries, and the French day-names are a **map of the sky**. Before we read the map, one of the objects on it.

Sounds you'll need

- `front-rounded-u` — the French **u** has no English equivalent. Say "ee," and then, without moving your tongue, round your lips as though for "oo." That is **u**. So **lune** is *lün*, never *loon*.
- `silent-final-e` — the closing **-e** is a whisper, not a syllable of its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la lune is feminine, so it takes **la**, the article you already know. It comes from Latin **lūna**, which English kept in a small family:

- **lunar** — of the Moon
- **lunation** — one full cycle of it
- **lunatic** — someone the Moon was believed to have unsettled, back when moonlight was thought to disturb the mind

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "lune" — *lün*, lips rounded and tongue forward
- "la lune" — feminine, so *la*
- "lune" then English "lunar, lunatic" — the same *lūna*

Before you move on

How do you say the Moon? (**la lune**, *la lün.*) Which article does it take, and why? (**la** — the word is feminine.) How do you make the French **u**? (Say "ee," then round the lips without moving the tongue.) Next: the day named after it.

7.2 lundi — Monday

You have the Moon. Add one ending and you have the first day of the week — and, with it, the second half of five more words.

Sounds you'll need

- **lundi** = *luh(n)-DEE*, opening with the nasal *un* you met in the number **un**.
- The weight falls on the **second** syllable. French leans on the end of a word where English leans near the front: *MON-day* against *lun-DI.*

Grammar Lens: every weekday ends in "day"

Every French weekday ends in **-di**, always said *DEE*. That **-di** is Latin **diēs**, "day" — the same word English puts at the *end* of *Monday*, and French puts at the end too.
So a French weekday reads as **"[god]'s day,"** the god in front and the day behind:

> **lundi** = *lūnae* ("of the Moon") + *diēs* ("day") = **the Moon's day**

The Romans named each day for a planet-god, and the planets were the gods. Learn to hear that **-di** and half of five more words is already yours.

Why it's said this way

English *Monday* says the identical thing — *Moon* plus *day* — but out of Germanic parts rather than Latin ones. The two languages did not copy each other. They inherited the **same Roman week** and each translated it into its own words. That is why the days will keep lining up as we go, and why they will line up through their *meanings* rather than their sounds.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "lundi" — *luh(n)-DEE*, weight on the end
- it split — "lune" plus "-di": the Moon's day
- "lundi, Monday" — the same sentence in two languages

Before you move on

How do you say Monday? (**lundi**, *luh(n)-DEE*.) What does the **-di** mean, and from which Latin word? ("Day," from **diēs**.) What does *lundi* mean once you take it apart, and what does *Monday* mean? (Both: **the Moon's day**.) Next: the day of the war-god.

7.3 mardi — Tuesday

The second day carries the best story in the week: *mardi* and *Tuesday* look nothing alike and are, underneath, exactly the same word.

Sounds you'll need

- **mardi** = *mar-DEE*, with the **r** made at the back of the throat, as in **quatre**.
- The familiar **-di** closes it, so only the first syllable is new.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mardi is Latin **Martis diēs**, "the day of **Mars**" — the god of war, and the red planet named for him.

Why it's said this way

English *Tuesday* is named for **Tiw**, the Germanic war-god. French *mardi* is named for **Mars**, the Roman one. Different gods, different sounds — and the **same day**, because it is the same slot in the same week.

Here is how that happened. The Romans mapped their gods onto the planets and named the days for them. When the week reached the Germanic-speaking peoples, they did not borrow the Roman names; they **swapped in their own gods**, matching them role for role. Scholars call that *interpretatio germanica*: translating a pantheon rather than a word.

So the two languages will keep agreeing about **which** god each day belongs to while disagreeing about that god's name. Once you know that, every remaining weekday has an English key.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mardi" — *mar-DEE*, the *r* at the back of the throat
- "lundi, mardi" — the first two, both ending *DEE*
- the bridge — "mardi is Mars, Tuesday is Tiw, both the war-god"

Before you move on

How do you say Tuesday? (**mardi**, *mar-DEE.*) Which god is it named for? (**Mars**, the war-god.) Why do *mardi* and *Tuesday* line up despite sharing no sound? (Same day, same role — Latin used *Mars*, the Germanic peoples put in their own war-god **Tiw**.) Next: the messenger's day.

7.4 mercredi — Wednesday

The longest day-name of the week, and the first place to try the key you were handed: find the god, and English will tell you the day.

Sounds you'll need

- **mercredi** = *mair-kruh-DEE*, three syllables with the weight at the end.
- Two throat-**r** sounds in one word, one in each of the first two syllables. Take it slowly; this word is worth drilling on its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mercredi is Latin **Mercuriī diēs**, "the day of **Mercury**" — the messenger of the gods, and the swiftest planet. English kept the god's name in **mercurial**, "quick-changing," and gave it to the metal that runs like water.

Why it's said this way

Apply the key from *mardi*. English *Wednesday* is **Woden's day** — and Woden is the god the Romans matched to Mercury, both of them travellers, guides and carriers of the dead. Same day, same role, two names. English still spells the *d* it stopped pronouncing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mercredi" — *mair-kruh-DEE*, slowly, both *r* sounds at the back

- "lundi, mardi, mercredi" — three down
- the key again — "Mercury for the Romans, Woden for the Germanic peoples, one day"

Before you move on

How do you say Wednesday? (**mercredi**, *mair-kruh-DEE*.) Which god is it named for? (**Mercury**, the messenger.) Which god does English name the same day for? (**Woden** — the god Rome matched to Mercury.) Next: the day of the king of the gods.

7.5 jeudi — Thursday

The fourth day belongs to the king of the gods, and it introduces the sound most people get wrong on their first attempt at French.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-zh` — the French **j** is the soft buzz in the middle of English *mea**s**ure* or *vi**si**on*. It is never the hard *j* of *jam*.
- `vowel-eu` — the rounded *eu* you learned in **deux**.
- Together: **jeudi** = *zheu-DEE*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeudi is Latin **Jovis diēs**, "the day of **Jove**" — Jove being the other name of **Jupiter**, king of the gods and the largest planet. English keeps *Jove* in the phrase *by Jove*, and keeps the god's temperament in **jovial**: cheerful, the way people born under Jupiter were said to be.

Why it's said this way

The key once more. English *Thursday* is **Thor's day** — Thor, the thunder-god, matched to Jupiter, who also threw the lightning. Two pantheons, one sky-king, one day. Every weekday so far has agreed on the god's *job* and disagreed on the god's *name*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "jeudi" — *zheu-DEE*, the soft *j* of "measure"
- "mercredi, jeudi" — the pair
- the bridge — "Jupiter and Thor, both the thunder-king, one day"

Before you move on

How do you say Thursday? (**jeudi**, *zheu-DEE*.) What English sound is the French **j**? (The buzz in *measure*, never the *j* of *jam*.) Which god is *jeudi* named for, and which god does *Thursday* name? (**Jupiter**, or Jove — and **Thor**.) Next: the day of the morning star.

7.6 vendredi — Friday

The fifth day closes the planet-week, and it is the only one named for a goddess.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-en` — the opening **en** is nasal, sent through the nose like the *un* of **lundi** but with the mouth more open. So **vendredi** = *van-druh-DEE*.
- The **r** is the throat-**r** again, and the ending is the familiar *DEE*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vendredi is Latin **Veneris diēs**, "the day of **Venus**" — goddess of love and the brightest thing in the sky after the Sun and Moon. Her name is still in English **venerate**, "to hold in reverence."

Why it's said this way

The last application of the key, and the cleanest. English *Friday* is **Frigg's day** — Frigg, the Germanic goddess of love and marriage, matched to Venus. Five days, five gods, and every single pairing made by role.
That is the whole planet-week: **lundi** the Moon, **mardi** Mars,

mercredi Mercury, **jeudi** Jupiter, **vendredi** Venus. Two days are left, and neither of them is a planet — which is the next surprise.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vendredi" — *van-druh-DEE*, the *en* through the nose
- the work week — "lundi, mardi, mercredi, jeudi, vendredi"
- each as a god — "Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus"

Twice through: the five weekdays, in order

Before you move on

How do you say Friday? (**vendredi**, *van-druh-DEE.*) Which goddess is it named for, and who does English name it for? (**Venus** — and **Frigg**.) Give the five planet-days in order. (*Lundi, mardi, mercredi, jeudi, vendredi.*) Next: the two days where the planets stop.

7.7 samedi — Saturday

Five days named for planets — and then two that are not. The weekend is where **religion overwrote astronomy**, and French shows both layers.

Sounds you'll need

- **samedi** = *sam-DEE*. The **a** is open, and the middle **e** is so light it nearly disappears: two syllables in practice, not three.
- `nasal-none` — the **am** here is **not** nasal, because the *m* is followed by a vowel that pulls it into the next syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

samedi still carries the **-di** of *diēs*, so the shape of the week holds. What changed is the first half. It is **sambatī diēs**, from Latin **Sabbatum**, which is Hebrew **shabbāt** — "to cease, to rest."

Not a god. An instruction.

Why it's said this way

By the Roman pattern this should have been **Saturn's day** — and in English it still is. *Saturday* is the one weekday English kept a Roman god for, while replacing the other four with Germanic ones.
French did the reverse. It kept the Roman gods on the weekdays and let this one go: Latin-speaking Christians took the Jewish **Sabbath** and put it here, so the planet was written over by the rest-day.
So *Saturday* and *samedi* are the same day under two ideas — **the planet against the Sabbath** — and the two languages swapped exactly which half of the week they preserved.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "samedi" — *sam-DEE*, the middle *e* almost gone
- "vendredi, samedi" — the pair
- the contrast — "samedi is the Sabbath, Saturday is Saturn"

Before you move on

How do you say Saturday? (**samedi**, *sam-DEE*.) Where does the first half come from? (The **Sabbath** — Latin *Sabbatum*, Hebrew *shabbāt*, "to rest.") Which planet-god does English keep on this day that French dropped? (**Saturn**.) Next: the last day, where even the **-di** moves.

7.8 dimanche — Sunday

Six days have ended in **-di**. The seventh breaks the pattern in public — and once you see how, it is not a break at all.

Sounds you'll need

- `ch-sh` — the French **ch** is *sh*, as in English *machine*. Never *ch* as in *church*.

- `nasal-an` — the **an** is nasal, the same open nasal as the **en** of **vendredi**: French spells that one sound two ways.
- Together: **dimanche** = *dee-MAHNSH*.

Grammar Lens: the ending that moved to the front

Look at the first two letters. **Di**manche. That is the **same *diēs*** every other day of the week ends with, sitting at the front instead.

diēs Dominica → *di-manche* → **dimanche**

Latin let the two words come in either order, and for this one day the order that survived is "day of the Lord" rather than "the Lord's day." So the pattern did not break; it flipped. All seven days still carry *diēs*, and *dimanche* is the only one that wears it where you can see it first.

Why it's said this way

Dominica comes from **Dominus**, "lord, master" — which English holds in **dominion**, **dominate**, and, worn much smoother, **dame**. English kept **Sun**day, the star. French dropped it entirely for "the Lord's day." Put beside *samedi*, that makes the weekend two different rewrites of the same Roman week:

- **samedi** — the planet replaced by the **Sabbath**, a day of rest
- **dimanche** — the Sun replaced by the **Lord**, a day of worship

Five days of Roman sky, then two days where a later faith wrote over it. The French week is a record of both.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dimanche ← Old French *diemenche* ← Latin *dies Dominica*, "the Lord's day" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dimanche" — *dee-MAHNSH*, the *ch* as *sh*

- "samedi, dimanche" — the weekend
- the whole week — "lundi, mardi, mercredi, jeudi, vendredi, samedi, dimanche"

Before you move on

How do you say Sunday? (**dimanche**, *dee-MAHNSH.*) Where did its *diēs* go? (**To the front** — *diēs Dominica.*) What does it mean literally? ("The **Lord's** day.") What does English keep on this day that French dropped? (The **Sun**.) Next: the whole week, run together.

7.9 Practice — the whole week

Seven days, taken one at a time. Now put them in a row and make the row automatic — a week you have to assemble is a week you cannot use.

Your turn: the seven, in order

Read down the column, then cover the right-hand side and read down the left:

French	English
lundi	Monday
mardi	Tuesday
mercredi	Wednesday
jeudi	Thursday
vendredi	Friday
samedi	Saturday
dimanche	Sunday

Twice through: the seven days, in order

Then start from **jeudi** and go round to *mercredi.* A list you can only say from the top is a list you have memorised rather than learned.

Your turn: name the god

Five of the seven still name a planet. Say each day, then what is inside it:

- **lundi** — *la lune*, the Moon

- **mardi** — Mars
- **mercredi** — Mercury
- **jeudi** — Jupiter
- **vendredi** — Venus

Every one of those ends in **-di**, Latin *diēs*, "day."

What you've built this chapter

- **the -di rule** — every weekday ends in Latin *diēs*, "day," so half of five words came free.
- **the planet week** — Moon, Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus, named by Rome.
- **the key to English** — *Tuesday*, *Wednesday*, *Thursday* and *Friday* name the **same** gods by their Germanic names, matched role for role. The days agree about the god's job and disagree about the god's name.
- **the weekend rewrite** — *samedi* is the **Sabbath** where English keeps Saturn; *dimanche* is the **Lord's day** where English keeps the Sun. And in *dimanche* the *diēs* moved to the front.

Before you move on

Give the seven days without stopping. Now start from **jeudi**. What does the **-di** mean? ("Day," Latin *diēs*.) Which two days are not named for a planet, and what replaced them? (**samedi**, the Sabbath; **dimanche**, the Lord's day.) Why do *mardi* and *Tuesday* mean the same thing? (Same day, same role — the war-god, called **Mars** in Latin and **Tiw** in Germanic.)

Chapter 8

Telling the Time

Modes: **voice** (8) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 8 of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for and tell the time in French.
>
> *One noun, one frame and three small additions. heure is the same word as English hour, both from Latin hora and both keeping an h neither language ever said; il est … heures counts the hours where English says o'clock; and midi and minuit are one idea used twice, the middle of the day and the middle of the night.*

8.1 heure — the hour

With your numbers in hand you are one word away from telling the time. This is that word — and it turns out you have been saying it in English your whole life.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-h` — the **h** of **heure** is silent, exactly as in English *hour*. Say *eur*.
- `liaison-z` — because the word **begins with a vowel sound**, the number in front links straight onto it. That is the liaison you met counting: **deux heures** = *deu-**z**-eur*, **trois heures** = *troi-**z**-eur*.

The silent *h* is why the liaison happens at all. A written *h* that is never pronounced is not a consonant in the way; the number hears a vowel

and reaches for it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heure comes from Latin **hōra**, which came from Greek **hōrā**. The Greek word did not mean "hour." It meant *a period, a season, the right time* — the goddesses of the seasons were the **Horae**. Latin narrowed it to a fixed slice of the day, and French wore *hōra* down to **heure**. English took the **same** Latin *hōra* and made **hour**. So *heure* and *hour* are one word spelt two ways — and the silent *h* in both is a fossil of the Latin spelling that neither language ever said aloud.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "heure" — *eur*, no *h* at all
- "deux heures" — *deu-z-eur*, the number linking on
- "trois heures, six heures, dix heures" — hear the *z* each time

Before you move on

How do you say hour? (**heure**, *eur*.) Why does a number link onto it with a *z*? (The **h** is silent, so the word starts with a vowel sound.) What did the Greek *hōrā* originally mean? (**A season, the right time** — the *Horae* were the season-goddesses.) Next: the frame that puts a number in front of it.

8.2 il est ... heures — telling the clock

One word for the hour, one small frame to hang it in, and the clock is yours. Take the frame whole for now — it never changes.

Grammar Lens: French counts the hours

To say the time, French uses a fixed opening — **il est** — then the number, then **heures**:

il est + *number* + **heures**

Il est deux heures. Read it literally and it says *"it is two **hours**."* French **counts the hours**. English does something stranger and then hides it: *two o'clock* is a worn-down *two of the clock*, which counted the hours too before it shrank.
Learn **il est** as one unbreakable piece for now. It is the same *it is* that English uses for weather and time — a subject that stands for nothing in particular — and you will meet the verb inside it properly later.

Sounds you'll need

- **il est** = *eel-**eh***. The final **t** of *est* is silent on its own.
- But before **heures**, with its silent *h*, that **t** wakes up and links: **il est une heure** = *eel eh-**t**-ün-eur*. Another liaison, the same instinct as *deux heures*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

il est ... heures — *il* ← Latin *ille*, "that"; *est* is Latin *est*, "is"; *heure* ← Latin *hora*, "hour". All three are inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "il est" — *eel-eh*, no *t* sounded
- "Il est deux heures." — *eel eh deu-z-eur*
- "Il est six heures. Il est dix heures."

Twice through: "Il est deux heures."

Before you move on

What frame tells the time in French? (**il est** + number + **heures**.)
What does *Il est deux heures* say literally? ("It is two **hours**.")
What is English *o'clock* worn down from? (*Of the clock* — which counted hours too.) Next: the one hour that takes a different ending.

8.3 une heure — one o'clock

Eleven of the twelve hours behave identically. One does not, and the reason is a rule you already met on a different word.

Grammar Lens: one hour, two hours

heure is a **feminine** noun, so "one" in front of it is **une**, not *un* — the same gendered "one" you learned counting. And because the noun counts, it takes a plural **-s** from two upwards:

- **Il est une heure.** — one o'clock. One hour, so no *-s*.
- **Il est deux heures.** — two o'clock. Two hours, so *-s*.

Now listen rather than read. That **-s** is **silent**, like every plural *-s* in French. *Une heure* and *deux heures* end in the identical sound. The plural is visible on the page and inaudible in the air — what your ear actually uses to tell them apart is the **number in front**, which is why French never drops it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Il est une heure." — *eel eh-t-ün-eur*
- "Il est deux heures." — *eel eh deu-z-eur*
- both again and notice the ending never changes — only the number does

Before you move on

How do you say one o'clock? (**Il est une heure** — *une*, because *heure* is feminine.) When does *heure* take an **-s**? (From **two** upwards.) Can you hear that *-s*? (**No** — it is silent, so the number carries the count.) Next: the two hours that refuse a number altogether.

8.4 midi — noon

Two hours in the day do not get a number. They get a name, because they are the pivots the rest of the day turns on. Here is the first.

Sounds you'll need

- **midi** = *mee-DEE*, two clean syllables with the weight at the end.
- Both vowels are the tight French **i** of *machine*, never the *i* of *sit*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

midi is Latin **medius diēs**, "the middle day," and both halves are still visible:

> **mi-** ("middle," from *medius*) + **-di** (*diēs*, "day") = **the day's middle**

You already own the second half. That **-di** is the same *diēs* that ends *lundi* and *mardi* — here it has come round to the front of a different word. And *medius* is the English **medium**, **median**, **mid** and **middle**, all one family.

Grammar Lens: a name instead of a number

Because **midi** *is* the hour, it does not take **heures**. Drop the number and drop the noun:

> **Il est midi.** — "It is noon."

Not "it is twelve hours" with a number in the slot. The frame stays; what goes into it is a name.

Why it's said this way

English **noon** is Latin **nōna hōra**, "the **ninth** hour" — which in Roman reckoning was the middle of the afternoon. Over centuries the meal it named crept earlier, and the word came with it until it landed on midday and stopped. So English says *noon* and means "the ninth hour"; French says *midi* and means what it says.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "midi" — *mee-DEE*
- "Il est midi." — no number, no *heures*
- it split — "mi- plus -di: the day's middle"

Before you move on

How do you say noon? (**midi**, *mee-DEE*.) What are its two halves? (**mi-**, "middle," and **-di**, *diēs*, "day.") Where have you met that *-di* before? (Ending **lundi** and **mardi**.) Why is there no *heures* after it? (*Midi* **is** the hour.) Next: its opposite number.

8.5 minuit — midnight

The second pivot, and it is built from a word you have had since the very first chapter.

Sounds you'll need

- **minuit** = *mee-NWEE*. The **ui** is a single gliding sound, *wee*, not two vowels taken in turn.
- The final **t** is silent, as it is in **nuit** itself.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

minuit is Latin **media nox**, "the middle night," and the two halves are as plain as they were in *midi*:

> **mi-** ("middle," *medius* again) + **-nuit** (*nox*, "night") = **the night's middle**

The second half is the **nuit** you learned in your first week. Latin *nox* has the stem *noct-*, which English carries in **nocturnal** and, straight through its Germanic side, in **night** itself.
So the two pivots of the French day are one idea applied twice: the **middle** of the day, and the **middle** of the night. English builds *midday* and *midnight* out of exactly the same two pieces.

Grammar Lens: the same rule as midi

minuit is the hour, so no number and no **heures**:

Il est minuit. — "It is midnight."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "minuit" — *mee-NWEE*, the *ui* as one glide
- "Il est midi. Il est minuit." — the two pivots
- both split — "the day's middle, the night's middle"

Before you move on

How do you say midnight? (**minuit**, *mee-NWEE.*) What are its two halves? (**mi-**, "middle," and **nuit**, "night," from Latin *nox.*) Which English word carries the *noct-* stem? (**Nocturnal**.) Say both pivots. (*Il est midi. Il est minuit.*) Next: the quarter hour.

8.6 et quart — quarter past

Whole hours are not enough to make an appointment. Three small additions finish the clock, and the first is already half-known to you from counting.

Sounds you'll need

- **quart** = *kar.* The **qu-** is a plain *k*, and the final **t** is silent.
- The **r** is the throat-**r**, as in **quatre**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quart is "a fourth part," and it comes from the same Latin **quattuor** that gave you **quatre**. English took the identical word and made **quarter** — a fourth of an hour, a fourth of a gallon, a fourth of a town. Once you see *quatre* inside *quart*, it stops being a new word and becomes a number you already have, doing a different job.

Grammar Lens: adding to the hour

French adds the quarter with **et** ("and"), after the hour:

> **Il est deux heures et quart.** — "It is a quarter past two."

Read literally: *"it is two hours **and a quarter**."* French does not say "past"; it adds.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "quart" — *kar*, no *t*
- "Il est deux heures et quart."
- "quatre, quart" — the number and the fourth part, one root

Before you move on

How do you say a quarter? (**quart**, *kar.*) Which number is it built on? (**quatre** — Latin *quattuor.*) How do you say quarter past two? (*Il est deux heures **et quart**.*) Next: the half hour.

8.7 et demie — half past

Same move as the quarter, a different fraction — and a spelling that tells you something about the word it leans on.

Sounds you'll need

- **demie** = *duh-MEE*. The first **e** is the light, almost-swallowed vowel you met in the middle of *samedi*.
- The final **-e** is silent, so *demie* and *demi* sound identical.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

demie comes from Latin **dimidius**, "halved" — literally *di-* ("apart") plus *medius*, the "middle" you have now met twice, in **midi** and

minuit. To halve a thing is to cut it at its middle.
English borrowed the French form as the prefix **demi-**: a **demigod** is half a god, a **demitasse** is half a cup.

Grammar Lens: why it is demie and not demi

The **-e** on the end is agreement. It follows **heure**, which is feminine, so the half agrees with it and takes a feminine **-e**:

> **Il est deux heures et demie.** — "It is half past two."

After **midi** and **minuit**, which are masculine, it drops the *-e*:

> **Il est midi et demi.** — "It is half past twelve."

Your ear cannot tell them apart; the page can. That is the same silent-agreement pattern as the plural *-s* on *heures*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "demie" — *duh-MEE*
- "Il est deux heures et demie."
- "Il est midi et demi." — masculine, so no *-e* on the page

Before you move on

How do you say half past two? (*Il est deux heures* ***et demie***.) Why does *demie* carry an **-e**? (It agrees with **heure**, which is feminine.) What is inside Latin *dimidius*? (*Medius* — the same "middle" as in *midi*.) Next: the one that subtracts.

8.8 moins le quart — quarter to

Twice now you have **added** to the hour. The last piece of the clock does the opposite, and it does it with a word you can read on a calculator.

Sounds you'll need

- **moins** = *mwa(n)*. The **oi** is *wa*, as in **trois**, and the **in** is nasal, as in **cinq**.
- The final **s** is silent. Two familiar sounds and one silent letter — nothing in this word is new.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moins is Latin **minus**, and it means exactly what *minus* means: **less**, taken away. English uses the Latin form untouched for subtraction, and keeps the same root in **minor**, **minimum** and **diminish**.

Grammar Lens: French subtracts from the next hour

To say "quarter to," French does not look back at the hour that has passed. It names the hour **coming**, and takes the quarter off it:

> **Il est trois heures moins le quart.** — "It is a quarter to three."

Literally: *"it is three hours **minus** the quarter."* English does the same arithmetic and hides it behind the word *to*; French shows its working. So the three additions to the hour are one small system:

- **et quart** — the hour, plus a quarter
- **et demie** — the hour, plus a half
- **moins le quart** — the *next* hour, minus a quarter

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "moins" — *mwa(n)*, no *s*
- "Il est trois heures moins le quart."
- the three in a row — "deux heures et quart, deux heures et demie, trois heures moins le quart"

Before you move on

How do you say quarter to three? (*Il est trois heures* ***moins le quart***.) Which hour does French name in that sentence, the one gone or the one coming? (**The one coming** — it subtracts from it.) What Latin word is *moins*? (**Minus**.) Next: the whole clock, put to use.

8.9 Practice — reading the clock

One frame, one noun and three small additions. Put them together and you can say any time on a clock face.

Your turn: whole hours

Put each of these into the frame — *Il est …* — then cover the right column and read back from the left:

French	English
une heure	one o'clock
deux heures	two o'clock
six heures	six o'clock
dix heures	ten o'clock

Twice through: the four whole hours, each inside *Il est …*

Listen for the liaison each time: *ün-eur*, *deu-z-eur*, *see-z-eur*, *dee-z-eur*.

Your turn: the two that take a name

- **Il est midi.** — noon, "the day's middle"
- **Il est minuit.** — midnight, "the night's middle"

No number and no *heures*: each of them **is** the hour.

Your turn: the parts of the hour

French	English
deux heures et quart	quarter past two
deux heures et demie	half past two
trois heures moins le quart	quarter to three
midi et demi	half past twelve

Say all four inside the frame and hear the clock move. The third names the hour **ahead** and subtracts from it.

What you've built this chapter

- **heure** — the same word as English *hour*, both Latin *hōra*, both keeping a silent *h* neither language ever pronounced.
- **il est ... heures** — French counts the hours; English says *o'clock*.
- **agreement you cannot hear** — *une heure* against *deux heures*, *et demie* against *et demi*. The page shows it; the ear uses the number in front.
- **midi** and **minuit** — one idea twice: the *middle* of the day and of the night, with the *-di* of *lundi* and the *nuit* of your first chapter.
- **adding and subtracting** — *et quart*, *et demie*, *moins le quart*.

Before you move on

Say one o'clock, then two. (*Il est une heure. Il est deux heures.*) Say noon and midnight, and what each means literally. (*Midi*, the day's middle; *minuit*, the night's middle.) Say quarter past two, half past two, quarter to three. Which of those names an hour that has not arrived? (**Quarter to** — *moins le quart* subtracts.) Why do *heure* and *hour* both carry a silent *h*? (Both are Latin *hōra*, where it was already silent.)

Chapter 9

The Months: Gods and Beginnings

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the first six months in French and say which Roman figure each one carries.

Six months, and not one of them is a number. The calendar is a procession of Roman gods and festivals carried almost unchanged out of Latin – Janus in the doorway of the year, the Februa that cleaned the city before it turned, and the war-god who already owns a weekday.

9.1 janvier — January

The week was a map of the sky. The calendar is a **procession of Roman gods and emperors**, carried almost unchanged out of Latin — and it opens with the one god who faces both ways at once.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-zh` — the soft **j** of *measure*, the one you met in **jeudi**.
- `nasal-an` — the **an** is nasal.
- Together: **janvier** = *zhan-vee-AY*, three syllables, weight at the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

janvier is Latin **Januarius**, "the month of **Janus**."
Janus is the god of **doorways** — of gates, of thresholds, of any moment where one thing stops and another starts. He is carved with **two faces**, one looking back and one looking forward, because that is what a doorway is.
Put the first month of the year in his care and the name explains itself: the month that stands in the door, looking back at the year that closed and forward into the one opening. English **January** is the identical word; a **janitor** was once a doorkeeper, from the same *janua*, "door."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "janvier" — *zhan-vee-AY*, the soft *j* of **jeudi**
- the god — "Janus, two faces, the doorway of the year"
- "janvier" then English "January, janitor" — one door-god in all three

Before you move on

How do you say January? (**janvier**, *zhan-vee-AY*.) Which god is it named for, and what is he god of? (**Janus** — **doorways**, beginnings.) Why does he have two faces? (One looks **back**, one looks **forward** — the year's threshold.) Next: the month named for a washing.

9.2 février — February

Eleven of the twelve months are named for a god, an emperor or a number. This one is named for a **festival** — and specifically for a cleaning.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-e-acute` — the **é** is a tight, bright *ay*, said with the mouth narrow. It is the accent that tells you the vowel is that one and no other.

- **février** = *fay-vree-AY*. The **r** is the throat-**r**, and the ending is the same *-AY* as **janvier**.

Why it's said this way

février is Latin **Februarius**, from the **Februa** — a Roman festival of **purification** held in this month.
That placement is the interesting part. The old Roman year began in **March**, so February was the **last** month, and the city cleaned itself before the year turned. The month is named for the scrubbing that came before the fresh start.
English **February** is the same word, and English speakers have been quietly dropping its first **r** for centuries.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "février" — *fay-vree-AY*, the *é* bright and narrow
- "janvier, février" — the first two, both ending *-AY*
- the reason — "the Februa, the cleaning before the year turned"

Before you move on

How do you say February? (**février**, *fay-vree-AY*.) What is it named after? (The **Februa**, a festival of **purification**.) Why did a cleaning-festival fall at the end of the year? (The Roman year began in **March**, so February closed it.) Next: a month you already know as a day.

9.3 mars — March

This one you have already half-learned, in a different part of the calendar. The war-god who owns Tuesday also owns a month.

Sounds you'll need

- **mars** = *marss*. The final **s** **is** sounded here — one of the small set of French words that keeps it.

- Do not read it as English *Mars*, which has a different vowel; the French **a** is open and flat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mars is Latin **Martius**, the month of **Mars**, the war-god.
Now put it beside the weekday:

- **mars** — *Martius*, **his month**
- **mardi** — *Martis diēs*, **his day**

The same god, twice in the calendar. Spot one and you already know the other, which is the first time a French word has paid you back in two different systems at once. English keeps the god's name in **martial**, "of war," and in the planet **Mars**.

Why it's said this way

March was the **first month** of the old Roman year. That single fact has now explained three separate things you have met: why *février*'s cleaning festival came at the end, why the counting months land two places late, and why the war-god gets the opening of the year — campaigning season began when the weather turned.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mars" — *marss*, the *s* sounded
- the pair — "mars, mardi": his month and his day
- "janvier, février, mars" — the first three

Before you move on

How do you say March? (**mars**, *marss*, with the *s*.) Which god is it named for? (**Mars**, the war-god.) Which weekday is named for the same god, and what is the difference between the two words? (**mardi** — *Martis diēs*, his **day**; *mars* is *Martius*, his **month**.) Which month opened the old Roman year? (**March**.) Next: the

month the buds open.

9.4 avril — April

Every month so far has had a firm answer behind it. This one has a guess — and the guess is old enough that the Romans were already making it.

Sounds you'll need

- **avril** = *a-VREEL*. Two syllables; the **r** sits at the back of the throat, and the **i** is the tight vowel of *machine*.
- The final **l** is sounded.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avril is Latin **Aprilis**, and where *Aprilis* came from is genuinely uncertain. The oldest guess, and still the best one, is Latin **aperīre**, "to **open**" — the month the buds open.
It is worth noticing that this is a **guess**, and saying so. A book that hands you a confident story for every word is inventing some of them. English **aperture**, an opening, comes from that same *aperīre*, so if the guess is right, an aperture and April are the same idea: something unclosing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "avril" — *a-VREEL*, the *l* sounded
- "mars, avril" — the pair
- the guess — "aperīre, to open; the buds open"

Before you move on

How do you say April? (**avril**, *a-VREEL*.) What is the best guess at its root, and what does it mean? (**aperīre**, "to **open**.") How certain is that? (Not very — it is a **guess**, and an ancient one.) Next: the

goddess of growing.

9.5 mai — May

The shortest month-name in French, and one of the shortest words you have met: three letters, one syllable.

Sounds you'll need

- `ai-y` — the pair **ai** is a single sound, close to the *e* of English *bed*. So **mai** = *may*, in one beat. Neither letter is heard on its own.
- This is the same **ai** you will meet again and again; it is one of the most common vowel pairs in French, and it never splits.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mai is Latin **Maius**, the month of **Maia** — an old Italic goddess of **growth** and increase, worshipped long before the Romans wrote much down about her.
Her name is thought to sit on the same root as Latin **maior**, "greater," which English carries in **major**, **majority** and **mayor**. If that is right, then *mai* is the **growing** month in the plainest sense: the one where things get bigger.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mai" — *may*, one beat, the *ai* never split
- "avril, mai" — the pair
- the goddess — "Maia, growth; and maior, greater"

Before you move on

How do you say May? (**mai**, *may*.) What sound does the pair **ai** make? (One sound, close to the *e* of *bed* — never two.) Which goddess is the month named for, and what is she goddess of? (**Maia** — **growth**.) Next: the queen of the gods.

9.6 juin — June

The sixth month closes the half-year, and it belongs to the one figure in the calendar who outranks everybody else in it.

Sounds you'll need

- `j-zh` — the soft **j** again, as in **jeudi** and **janvier**.
- `nasal-in` — the **in** is nasal, as in **cinq**.
- Together: **juin** = *zhwa(n)*, one syllable. It is shorter than it looks.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juin is Latin **Junius**, the month of **Juno** — queen of the gods, wife of Jupiter, and the goddess of marriage.
That last detail still shows. June is the traditional wedding month across Europe because it was **her** month, and couples wanted her on their side.
You have already met her husband: **jeudi**, *Jovis diēs*, is Jupiter's day. So the calendar now holds both halves of the divine marriage — his **day** and her **month**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "juin" — *zhwa(n)*, one syllable
- "mai, juin" — the pair
- the couple — "juin is Juno's month, jeudi is Jupiter's day"

Before you move on

How do you say June? (**juin**, *zhwa(n)*, one syllable.) Which goddess is it named for? (**Juno**, queen of the gods.) Why are weddings held in June? (She is the goddess of **marriage**, and it is her month.) Which day belongs to her husband? (**jeudi** — Jupiter's.) Next: the first six, run together.

9.7 Practice — the first half of the year

Six months, taken one at a time. Run them together now, then say what is inside each one.

Your turn: the six, in order

Read it: down the left, then cover the right and read back

French	English
janvier	January
février	February
mars	March
avril	April
mai	May
juin	June

Twice through: the six months, in order

Four of them end in that same unstressed *-AY*; **mars** and **mai** are the two short ones, and they are the two easiest to lose.

Your turn: name what is inside

Say each month, then the figure or thing behind it:

- **janvier** — **Janus**, the two-faced god of doorways
- **février** — the **Februa**, a festival of purification
- **mars** — **Mars**, the war-god (and *mardi* is his day)
- **avril** — perhaps *aperīre*, "to open," though nobody is certain
- **mai** — **Maia**, goddess of growth
- **juin** — **Juno**, queen of the gods

What you've built this chapter

- **six month names**, each of which is a Roman figure rather than a number.
- **one word paying twice** — *mars* and *mardi* are the same god's month and day, which is the first time a French word has cashed out in two systems.

- **the old Roman year began in March**, which has now explained three separate oddities: why a cleaning-festival names February, why the war-god opens the year, and why four months you have seen are counting two places out.

Before you move on

Give the six months without stopping. Now start from **avril**. Which month shares its god with a weekday, and which weekday? (**mars** — with **mardi**, both Mars.) Which month is named for a festival rather than a person? (**février**, the Februa.) Which one is a guess? (**avril** — perhaps *aperīre*, "to open.")

Chapter 10

The Months: Caesars and Counting

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the last six months in French and explain why four of them are counting wrong.

Two men put their names on a calendar of gods, and the four months after them have been miscounting since long before either was born. juillet is Julius Caesar and août is the emperor Augustus — but neither added a month: Quintilis and Sextilis were renamed. What pushed septembre to décembre two places out was janvier and février, added at the front of a year that used to begin in March.

10.1 juillet — July

Six months named for gods and a festival. The next two are named for **men** — the only two months in the year that carry a person who actually lived.

Sounds you'll need

- `ill-mouille` — the **ill** in the middle is not an *l* sound at all. It is a *y*, as in English *yes*. This spelling is everywhere in French and it catches every beginner once.
- With the soft **j** of **juin**: **juillet** = *zhwee-YAY*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juillet is Latin **Julius**, and the Julius in question is **Julius Caesar**. He **reformed the entire calendar** — the Julian calendar is his, and it ran Europe for sixteen centuries. He did not add a month while doing it. The month was already there, and it was called **Quintilis**, "the 5th." After his death it was **renamed** in his honour, and *Quintilis* has not been heard since.
English **July** is the same name, worn down a different way from the same *Julius*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "juillet" — *zhwee-YAY*; the *ill* is a **y**, never an *l*
- "juin, juillet" — both open with the soft *j*, and they are easy to confuse; say them back to back until they separate
- the man — "Julius Caesar: Quintilis, the 5th, renamed for him"

Before you move on

How do you say July? (**juillet**, *zhwee-YAY*.) What sound does the **ill** make? (A **y**, as in *yes* — never an *l*.) Who is it named for, and what did he do to the calendar? (**Julius Caesar** — he **reformed** it.) Did he add this month to the year? (**No** — it already existed as **Quintilis**, "the 5th," and was **renamed** for him.) Next: the emperor who copied him.

10.2 août — August

The most violently worn-down word in the French calendar. Four letters on the page, and barely two sounds in the mouth.

Sounds you'll need

- **août** = *oot*, and in much of France simply *oo*. The **a** is not sounded, and the final **t** is optional.
- `circumflex` — the little hat on the **û** is a **gravestone**. It marks

a letter that used to be there and is gone: older French wrote *aoust*, and when the **s** fell silent the hat took its place.

You have met that hat before, on **hôpital** and **forêt** in English's *hospital* and *forest*. Wherever you see a circumflex, try putting an **s** after the vowel and see whether an English word appears.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

août is Latin **Augustus**, the first Roman emperor.
Julius Caesar had a month renamed for him. His heir Augustus, not to be outdone, had **the next one** renamed for himself: **Sextilis**, "the 6th," became *Augustus*.
Note what neither man did. **Neither one added a month.** *Quintilis* and *Sextilis* were already sitting in the year; the two most powerful men in Rome simply took the two of them and wrote their own names over the top. The calendar did not get longer. Two of its months just stopped being numbers and started being people.

Why it's said this way

Ten of the twelve months are a god, a festival or a number. **Two are people.**
Julius and Augustus put themselves among the gods, in the most public place available — the calendar everybody has to say out loud. They did not need to build anything to do it; they only had to rename what was there. Two thousand years later, France still says both their names every summer, and nobody thinks of either man while doing it. That is what winning looks like at scale.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "août" — *oot*, and hear how little of the spelling survives
- "juillet, août" — the two men, back to back
- the hat — "aoust lost its *s*, and the circumflex marks the grave"

Before you move on

How do you say August? (**août** — *oot*, or simply *oo*.) What does the circumflex mark? (A **lost letter** — here an *s*, from older *aoust*.) Who are the two months named for people? (**Julius Caesar** and the emperor **Augustus**.) Did either of them add a month to the year? (**No** — they **renamed** two that already existed, *Quintilis* and *Sextilis*, "the 5th" and "the 6th.") Next: the four that are still counting.

10.3 septembre — September

You met this word while counting, as the proof that *sept* means seven. Now take it as a month in its own right.

Sounds you'll need

- **septembre** = *sep-TAHM-bruh*. The **em** in the middle is **nasal**, and the closing **-re** is barely a syllable.
- All four of the counting months end this same way, so learning it once buys you four.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

septembre is Latin **september**, "the **seventh**" — from **septem**, the seven you can already count with.
You know why it sits ninth: the old Roman year began in **March**, so counting from there, *september* really was the seventh. Then **janvier and février were added at the front** of the year — centuries before either Caesar was born — and every month behind them slid two places without being renamed. The name never caught up.
That is worth being exact about, because the story is usually told wrong. It was not Julius and Augustus. They renamed two months in the middle and added nothing; the damage was done long before them, at the **front** of the year.
What is new here is the **word**: *septembre* is now yours as a month, not only as evidence about a number.
English **September** is the identical Latin word, carrying the identical mistake.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "septembre" — *sep-TAHM-bruh*, the *em* through the nose
- "sept, septembre" — the number and the month it hides in
- "août, septembre" — the emperor, then the month that miscounts for an older reason

Before you move on

How do you say September? (**septembre**, *sep-TAHM-bruh.*) What number is inside it? (**sept**, seven — Latin *septem.*) Which month is it actually? (The **ninth**.) What put it two places out — the emperors, or something older? (**Older**: *janvier* and *février* were added at the **front** of a year that used to begin in March.) Next: the eighth month, which is the tenth.

10.4 octobre — October

Of the four counting months, this is the one that rescues a number you could no longer see.

Sounds you'll need

- **octobre** = *ok-TOH-bruh.* The **o** sounds are both closer to English *taught* than to *toe.*
- Same *-bruh* ending as **septembre**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

octobre is Latin **october**, "the **eighth**," from **octō**.
Here is why this word matters more than the other three. When you learned to count, *octō* had been battered past recognition on its way to **huit** — the *c* gone, the vowels softened, a written *h* propped on the front. The number kept none of its ancestry.
The month kept all of it. *Oct-* stands there in plain sight, exactly as Latin left it, and English **octave**, **octagon** and **octopus** stand beside it. The eight vanished from the number and survived in the calendar.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "octobre" — *ok-TOH-bruh*
- the contrast — "huit, octobre": the same eight, unrecognisable and intact
- "septembre, octobre" — the pair

Before you move on

How do you say October? (**octobre**, *ok-TOH-bruh.*) What number is inside it? (**octō**, eight.) Why is the eight easier to see here than in the number **huit**? (*Huit* wore its Latin away; the **month kept it**.) Next: the ninth, which is the eleventh.

10.5 novembre — November

The third of the four, and by now you can predict both the shape and the arithmetic.

Sounds you'll need

- **novembre** = *no-VAHM-bruh*, the **em** nasal and the ending the same *-bruh* as the last two.
- Three months in a row have now ended identically. That is the pattern paying out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

novembre is Latin **november**, "the **ninth**," from **novem** — the nine you count with as **neuf**.
Unlike *huit*, **neuf** still shows its Latin: *novem* to *neuf* is a short walk, and the *nov-* is right there in both. English keeps the same root in **novena**, a devotion of nine days.
Be careful of one false friend: Latin **novus** means "new," and English **novel** and **novelty** come from *that*, not from *novem*. Two similar roots, two different ideas. **November is a count, not a newness.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "novembre" — *no-VAHM-bruh*
- "neuf, novembre" — the nine in both
- "septembre, octobre, novembre" — three in a row, one ending

Before you move on

How do you say November? (**novembre**, *no-VAHM-bruh.*) What number is inside it? (**novem**, nine — the *neuf* you count with.) Does it have anything to do with "new"? (**No** — that is Latin *novus*, a different root.) Next: the last of them, and the biggest number.

10.6 décembre — December

The twelfth month, and it says **ten**. This is the last and largest of the four miscounts, and after it the year closes.

Sounds you'll need

- **décembre** = *day-SAHM-bruh.* The **é** is the bright *ay* of **février**, the **c** before *e* is an *s*, and the **em** is nasal.
- The familiar *-bruh* closes it for the fourth and final time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décembre is Latin **december**, "the **tenth**," from **decem**.
That root is one of the most productive you have met. It gave you the number **dix**; it gives English **decimal**, **decade** and **decimate**; and it reached an American pocket as the **dime**, through Old French *disme* from Latin *decima*, "a tenth part."
So every December, in French and English alike, you say the Roman word for ten and mean the twelfth month. Spanish carries the identical fault: *diciembre* is *decem* too.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "décembre" — *day-SAHM-bruh*
- "dix, décembre, dime" — one Latin *decem* in three places
- all four — "septembre, octobre, novembre, décembre"

Before you move on

How do you say December? (**décembre**, *day-SAHM-bruh.*) What number is inside it? (**decem**, ten — the *dix* you count with.) Name two English words from the same root. (*Decimal*, *decade*, *decimate* — or the **dime**.) Next: all twelve, together.

10.7 Practice — the whole year

Twelve months, six at a time. Run the whole year now, and hear where it breaks.

Your turn: the twelve, in order

Read it: down the left, then cover the right and read back

French	English
janvier	January
février	February
mars	March
avril	April
mai	May
juin	June
juillet	July
août	August
septembre	September
octobre	October
novembre	November
décembre	December

Twice through: the twelve months, in order
Then start from **juillet** and go round to *juin*.

Your turn: the two hard pairs

Two pairs cause almost all the trouble. Drill them alone:

- **juin** / **juillet** — *zhwa(n)* against *zhwee-YAY*. Both open with the soft *j* and neither is long.
- **mars** / **mai** — *marss* against *may*. The two short ones, and the two most easily swallowed.

What you've built this chapter

- **twelve month names**, and the year runs end to end.
- **two men in a calendar of gods** — *juillet* for Julius Caesar, *août* for the emperor Augustus. Neither added a month: *Quintilis* and *Sextilis*, "the 5th" and "the 6th," were already there and were **renamed**.
- **why the last four miscount** — the Roman year began in **March**, and *janvier* and *février* were later added at the **front**, sliding *septembre* through *décembre* two places along. Their Latin names never caught up. The emperors get blamed for this and had nothing to do with it.
- **a number rescued** — *octō* is unrecognisable inside **huit** and perfectly legible inside **octobre**. When a word wears down, look for a longer relative that did not.

Before you move on

Give the twelve months without stopping. Now start from **septembre**. Which two are named for people, and who? (**juillet**, Julius Caesar; **août**, the emperor Augustus.) Did either add a month? (**No** — both were **renamings**.) So what pushed the counting months two places out? (**janvier** and **février**, added at the **front** of a year that began in March.) Which month shows a number that its own French numeral has lost? (**octobre** — the *octō* that vanished from *huit*.)

Chapter 11

The Four Seasons

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the four seasons in French and say that something happens in one of them.

Four small Latin poems about heat, sleep and first things. printemps is prīmum tempus, "the first time"; été is aestās, "heat"; hiver is hībernum, the wintry season that gave English hibernate. And three seasons take en while spring takes au, for a reason that is not about seasons at all.

11.1 le printemps — spring

Twelve months name gods, emperors and numbers. The four seasons are something else entirely: four small Latin poems about **heat, sleep and first things**. Here is the first thing.

Sounds you'll need

- **le printemps** = *luh pran-TAHN*. **Two nasal vowels in one word**: the **in** of *prin-* and the **em** of *-temps*.
- Everything after that second nasal is silent. The **-ps** on the end is not said at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

printemps is two Latin words fused: **prīmum tempus**, "the **first time**."

> **prin-** = *prīmum*, "first" — English **prime**, **primary**, **premier**
> **-temps** = *tempus*, "time, season" — English **temporal**, **tempo**
>
> So spring is the year's **prime time**, and the French say so every time they name it. Older French used **primevère**, from the same *prima vera*, "first spring" — which Italian keeps to this day as **primavera**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le printemps" — *luh pran-TAHN*, both vowels through the nose
- it split — "prīmum tempus: the first time"
- "décembre, printemps" — the year ending, then the year beginning
- "printemps" then Italian "primavera" — two names for one idea

Before you move on

How do you say spring? (**le printemps**, *luh pran-TAHN*.) What are its two halves? (*prīmum*, "**first**," and *tempus*, "**time**.") How many nasal vowels does it hold? (**Two**.) What does Italian call the same season? (**Primavera** — the same "first spring.") Next: the hot one.

11.2 l'été — summer

Spring was named for its **place** in the year. Summer is named for what it **feels like**.

Sounds you'll need

- **été** = *ay-TAY*. Both **é** are the bright, narrow *ay* you met in **février**.
- `elision` — the article does not stay *le*. Before a vowel sound it drops its own vowel and clamps on: *le été* is impossible, so it becomes **l'été**, said as one word, *lay-TAY*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

été is Latin **aestās**, and *aestās* means "**heat**."
Not "the third season" or "the warm months" — just *heat*. Summer, in Latin and so in French, is named for the thing itself. English keeps the same root in **estival**, "of summer," and in **aestivate**, which is what an animal does when it sleeps through the hot season rather than the cold one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'été" — *lay-TAY*, one word, the article clamped on
- "le printemps, l'été" — hear the article change shape
- the meaning — "aestās: heat"

Before you move on

How do you say summer? (**l'été**, *lay-TAY*.) Why is it *l'* and not *le*? (The word starts with a **vowel**, so the article elides.) What does the Latin *aestās* mean? (**Heat**.) Next: the one English borrowed whole.

11.3 l'automne — autumn

Three of the four seasons are a Latin idea reshaped by French. This one is a Latin word that French barely touched, and then handed to English intact.

Sounds you'll need

- `diphthong-au` — the letter pair **a-u** is a single *o* sound, closer to English *taught* than to *cow*. It never sounds like *ow*.
- **automne** = *o-TON*. Here is the oddity worth knowing: the **m** is written and the **n** is not sounded — the spelling keeps a letter the mouth dropped.
- With elision: **l'automne** = *lo-TON*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

automne is Latin **autumnus**, and unlike the other three seasons nobody is sure what *autumnus* originally meant. It may not even be Latin in origin.
What is certain is where it went. English took **autumn** from French, spelling and silent letter and all — which is why English writes an *n* it does not say in exactly the same place. Two languages carrying the identical silent letter, because one copied the other's spelling.
American English mostly prefers **fall**, a Germanic word for the leaves coming down; **autumn** is the French one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'automne" — *lo-TON*, the *a-u* a single *o*
- "l'été, l'automne" — both elide
- French "automne" then English "autumn" — the same silent letter twice

Before you move on

How do you say autumn? (**l'automne**, *lo-TON*.) What sound does **a-u** make? (A single **o**.) Which written letter is not pronounced, and does English do the same? (The **n** — and **yes**, English *autumn* copied the spelling from French.) Next: the cold one, and a bear.

11.4 l'hiver — winter

The last season, and it shares a root with the deepest sleep in the animal world.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-h` — the **h** is silent, exactly as in **heure**. And because a silent *h* is no obstacle, the article elides straight through it: **l'hiver**, *lee-VAIR*.
- The **r** at the end is the throat-**r**, and it **is** sounded.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hiver is Latin **hībernum**, short for *hībernum tempus* — "the **wintry** season." Like *printemps*, it is a *tempus* phrase with the *tempus* worn off.
Now follow that root sideways. English **hibernate** is *hībernāre*, and it means, with no metaphor at all, "**to spend the winter**." A bear hibernating is a bear *wintering*.
So the same Latin word gave French a season and English a kind of sleep — one naming the time, the other naming what you do in it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'hiver" — *lee-VAIR*, the *h* silent and the article through it
- "heure, hiver" — two silent *h*, two elisions
- the pair — "hiver and hibernate: the season and the sleeping"

Before you move on

How do you say winter? (**l'hiver**, *lee-VAIR*.) Why does the article elide in front of an **h**? (The **h** is silent, so the word begins with a vowel sound.) What does English **hibernate** literally mean? ("**To spend the winter**.") Next: how to say you are *in* a season.

11.5 au printemps, en été — saying you are *in* a season

You have the four seasons. Now put something *in* one — and meet a rule with exactly one exception, which turns out not to be an exception at all.

Grammar Lens: three take en, one takes au

Three of the four use **en**:

en été · **en automne** · **en hiver**

And spring does not:

au printemps

Learn it as a list and it is an oddity to memorise. Look at the words and it stops being odd. **Été**, **automne** and **hiver** all begin with a **vowel sound** — that is why each of them elides its article to *l'*. **Printemps** begins with a consonant, and it is the only one that does. So the split is not about seasons at all. It is the **same vowel-or-consonant question** that decided *le* against *l'*, asked one more time about a different little word. French keeps asking it, and once you hear it you stop needing the list.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "en été, en automne, en hiver"
- the one — "au printemps"
- the reason aloud — "three start with a vowel, one starts with a consonant"

Twice through: "au printemps, en été, en automne, en hiver"

Before you move on

How do you say "in summer"? (**en été**.) In winter? (**en hiver**.) In spring? (**au printemps** — not *en*.) And **why** is spring different? (It is the only season starting with a **consonant**; the other three begin with a vowel sound, which is also why they elide to *l'*.)

11.6 Practice — the turning year

Four seasons, four small Latin poems. Run them, then put a month inside each one.

Your turn: the four, in order

Read it: down the left, then cover the right and read back

French	English
le printemps	spring
l'été	summer
l'automne	autumn
l'hiver	winter

Twice through: the four seasons, in order

Notice which article each one carries. **Three elide to *l'*** and one does not, and that single fact is about to do a second job.

Your turn: in a season

- **au printemps** — the consonant one
- **en été** · **en automne** · **en hiver** — the three vowel ones

Now join what you learned last chapter to what you learned this one. Say each month inside its season:

> **en hiver** — *janvier, février* · **au printemps** — *mars, avril, mai* **en été** — *juin, juillet, août* · **en automne** — *septembre, octobre*

What you've built this chapter

- **four season names**, each one a Latin sentence worn down to a word: *printemps* is "the **first time**," *été* is "**heat**," *hiver* is "the **wintry** season," and *automne* is a word so old nobody is sure of it.
- **two of them still pay out in English** — *estival* from *aestās*, and **hibernate**, which means, with no metaphor, "to spend the winter."
- **au against en**, and the reason behind it: **printemps** is the only season beginning with a consonant. It is the same vowel-or-consonant question that decided *le* against *l'*, asked about a different word.

Before you move on

Give the four seasons. Which three take **en**, and which takes **au**? (*En été, en automne, en hiver*; **au printemps**.) Why? (Spring is the only one starting with a **consonant**.) What does *printemps* literally mean? ("The **first time**.") Which English word means "to spend the winter"? (**Hibernate** — from the same *hībernum* as *hiver*.)

Chapter 12

Family, and the Oldest Words We Have

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the four closest family members in French, each with its article, and use one sound-law to recognise their English cousins.

Four words — père, mère, frère, sœur — and every one of them is older than Latin. Each also hands you an English word you already knew: paternal, maternal, fraternal, sorority. One sound-law, Grimm's p→f and t→th, turns père into father and frāter into brother in a single move, and the fused letter œ arrives here, in sœur and cœur.

12.1 le père — father

The calendar took you back two thousand years, to Rome. This word goes back further than Rome — further than Latin, further than any written language at all.

Sounds you'll need

- `e-grave` — the **è** is open, the mouth wider than for **é**. Think of the *e* in English *bed*, held a moment longer.
- `r-uvular` — the **r** is the French one, made at the back of the throat.

- Together: **le père** = *luh PEHR*, one syllable after the article.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

père is Latin **pater**, worn down by French mouths for fifteen centuries until only four letters were left.
pater itself is inherited, not invented. Behind it stands Proto-Indo-European ***ph₂tḗr** — a word nobody ever wrote down, reconstructed from the shapes its descendants kept. Sanskrit *pitṛ́*, Greek *patḗr*, Latin *pater*: the same word, spoken across a continent, for longer than anyone can document.
English never borrowed *père*, but it borrowed *pater* itself, over and over, and left it visible every time:

- **pat**ernal, **pat**ernity — "of a father"
- **pat**ron — a man who stands to you as a father would
- **pat**riarch, ex**pat**riate, **pat**rimony

So the French word is short and the English cousins are long, and they are the same word. When *père* looks like nothing you know, say *paternal* and the *p* and the *t* are still there.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le père" — *luh PEHR*, the **è** open and the **r** in the throat
- the ladder — "*ph$_2$tḗr, pater, père"
- "père → paternal, patron" — the *p* and *t* still standing

Before you move on

How do you say "the father"? (**le père**, *luh PEHR*.) Which article does it take, and what does that tell you? (**le** — it is masculine.) What Latin word is it? (**pater**.) Name two English words with that *pater* still inside them. (**paternal**, **patron** — also *paternity*, *patriarch*.) Next: the other half of the pair.

12.2 la mère — mother

The same word, one letter different, one article different — and a much stranger set of English cousins waiting at the end of it.

Sounds you'll need

- **la mère** = *lah MEHR*. The vowel is the identical open **è** you just met in **père**; only the first consonant changes.
- Say them back to back — *père, mère* — and hear that the rhyme is exact. That rhyme is not a coincidence; it is two inherited words worn down by the same mouths in the same way.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mère is Latin **māter**, from Proto-Indo-European ***méh₂tēr**.
The obvious English cousins are the ones you would guess:

- **mat**ernal, **mat**ernity — "of a mother"
- **mat**ron, **mat**riarch, alma **mat**er

And then there is one nobody guesses. Latin took *māter* and built **materia** from it — originally the **usable wood of a tree**, the growing part, the stuff a mother-trunk yields. Roman writers then stretched *materia* to mean the stuff anything is made of, and English inherited it twice over:

- **material** — what a thing is made of
- **matter** — stuff itself, the physical world

So when a physicist says *matter*, the word underneath is *mother*. That is the kind of thing etymology is for: not a party trick, but a reminder that abstract vocabulary is almost always a concrete word that travelled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la mère" — *lah MEHR*

- the pair — "le père, la mère"; the rhyme is exact, the articles are not
- the surprising one — "māter → materia → matter"

Before you move on

How do you say "the mother"? (**la mère**, *lah MEHR.*) Which article, and why is it not the same as *père*'s? (**la** — *mère* is feminine.) Give both parents together. (**le père, la mère**.) Which everyday English word for physical stuff comes from *māter*? (**matter** — through *materia*, the wood a tree yields.) Next: why English says *father* where French says *père*.

12.3 père / father — one sound-law

You have met two words that mean what English *father* and *mother* mean, and look almost nothing like them. That is about to stop being true.

Grammar Lens: the same word went down two roads

French took *pater* and *māter* straight from Latin. English did **not** borrow them from anybody. It inherited the very same Proto-Indo-European words down a different branch of the family — and on that branch, one systematic change hit every word at once. It is called **Grimm's law**, and the part that matters here is short: **p became f, and t became th.**

Apply it and watch the disguise fall off. Each row is one inherited word, shown first as it is reconstructed, then down each of the two roads:

Proto-Indo-European	**Latin → French**	**English**
*ph$_2$tḗr	*pater* → **père**	**f**a**th**er
*méh$_2$tēr	*māter* → **mère**	**m**o**th**er

père keeps the **p**; *father* shifts it to **f**. The *t* of *pater* is still a *t* in French and has become *th* in English. Nothing else moved.

This is why the resemblance between *maternal* and *mother* feels different from the resemblance between *paternal* and *father*: **maternal** came into English late, borrowed whole from Latin with its *t* intact, while **mother** came down the long way and took the sound-change

with it. Two arrivals of one word, centuries apart.
The point is not the pair. It is that sound-change is **regular** — it applies to a language wholesale, not word by word — which is exactly what makes a word you have never seen guessable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the law — "p becomes f, t becomes th"
- "père, father" — then "mère, mother"; hear the same word twice
- the two arrivals — "maternal came by boat, mother came on foot"

Before you move on

Which two sounds does Grimm's law change, in the version you need here? (**p** → **f** and **t** → **th**.) Are *père* and *father* borrowed from each other? (**No** — they are the **same inherited word**, arriving by two different roads.) Why does *maternal* keep its *t* while *mother* does not? (*maternal* was **borrowed late from Latin**; *mother* came down the Germanic road and took the sound-change.) Next: the brother.

12.4 le frère — brother

Parents done. The next word rhymes with both of them, and it lets you use the sound-law you just learned instead of only hearing about it.

Sounds you'll need

- **le frère** = *luh FREHR*. The same open **è**, the same throat **r** — and now an **r** on each side of the vowel, which is the only hard part.
- Say **père**, then **frère**. One consonant has been added at the front; everything else is identical.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frère is Latin **frāter**, from Proto-Indo-European ***b^{h}réh$_2$tēr**.
Now use what you have. English **brother** is that same PIE word down the Germanic road: the *t* became *th*, exactly as it did in *father* and *mother*. The law you just met explains a third pair without being told to.
By the Latin road, English got the formal set:

- **frat**ernal, **frat**ernity, **frat**ernize
- and, softened through Old French *frere*, **friar** — a monk who is literally a *brother* of his order

Fraternity and *friar* are the same word twice, once in a lecture hall and once in a monastery, and the difference between them is only how long each spent in a French mouth on the way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le frère" — *luh FREHR*, an *r* on both sides of the vowel
- the three so far — "le père, la mère, le frère"
- the law again — "frāter, brother: the *t* went to *th*"
- "frère → fraternal, friar"

Before you move on

How do you say "the brother"? (**le frère**, *luh FREHR*.) What Latin word is behind it? (**frāter**.) Which sound-change turns *frāter* into English *brother*? (The same one: **t** → **th**.) What is a **friar**, underneath the word? (A **brother** — the same *frère*, worn down through Old French.) Next: the sister, and a letter you have not met.

12.5 la sœur — sister

Three words that rhyme, and then this one. *Père, mère, frère* — and **sœur**, which refuses the pattern and brings a letter with

it.

Sounds you'll need

- **la sœur** = *lah SUR*, but not the *sur* of English *sure*. Round your lips as if to say *oo*, then say *eh* without moving them. That rounded front vowel is what **œu** spells.
- The **r** is the throat **r**, as in the other three.
- The strange letter is **œ**, an *o* and an *e* fused into one. It gets a lesson of its own next; for now, read it as the single vowel you just made.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sœur is Latin **soror** — and you can watch it collapse:
soror → *seror* → *suer* → **sœur**
Two syllables ground down into one, which is why it stopped rhyming with its three relatives. They were worn evenly; this one was worn out of shape.
English kept *soror* whole in the borrowed words:

- **soror**ity, **soror**al
- and a nun is still addressed as **Sister** in English and **ma sœur** in French, the same word in both mouths

English **sister** is not from *soror* by borrowing — it comes down the Germanic road from the same PIE ***swésōr**. So *soror* and *sister* are cousins who have not spoken since before either language existed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la sœur" — lips rounded, then *eh* without moving them
- the pair — "le frère, la sœur"
- the collapse — "soror, seror, sœur"
- all four — "le père, la mère, le frère, la sœur"

Before you move on

How do you say "the sister"? (**la sœur**, *lah SUR* with rounded lips.) What Latin word is behind it? (**soror**.) Why does it not rhyme with the other three? (It was worn down from **two syllables to one** — *soror* → *sœur*.) An English word that kept *soror* whole? (**sorority**.) Next: that fused letter, on its own.

12.6 œ — one letter, not two

You have just read a word containing a character English does not own. It is worth two minutes on its own, because it is not decoration and it is not rare.

Script: œ, one letter and not two

œ is an *o* and an *e* pushed together into a **single letter**. French calls it *e dans l'o* — "e in the o" — which is exactly what it looks like.

Three things follow, and they are the whole lesson:

- It counts as **one** letter when you spell aloud. **sœur** is spelled *s-œ-u-r*: four letters, not five.
- Writing it as two separate letters — *soeur* — is a **substitution**, the way writing *ae* for *æ* is. French readers accept it and French typography does not; a printed book, a newspaper and a road sign all use **œ**.
- It is not a separate sound of its own. In **sœur** the vowel is spelled **œu**, the rounded vowel you made in the last lesson.

Its capital exists too, and looks like what you would expect: **Œ**.

Writing: œ, and the everyday words that need it

The list of everyday **œ** words is short enough to hold in your head, and you already have one of them:

- **la sœur** — the sister, which you have
- **le cœur** — the heart

The words for "egg" and "eye" need it too, and both come later in this book as words in their own right, so learning the letter now means that when they arrive, only the meaning is new. **le cœur** is here because you will meet it everywhere else — it is one of the most common nouns in the language.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the name of the letter — "e dans l'o"
- *Say it:* spell it — "s-œ-u-r", four letters
- *Say it:* the two words — "sœur, cœur"
- *Write it:* **œ** three times: draw the *o*, then start the *e* inside its right edge

Before you move on

How many letters is **œ**? (**One.**) What does French call it? (*e dans l'o* — "e in the o".) How many letters in **sœur**? (**Four** — *s-œ-u-r.*) Name another word that uses it. (**cœur**, the heart.) Next: putting the family together.

12.7 Practice — four words, one law

Four words, learned one at a time. Run them as a set now, and then cash in what each one buys you in English.

Your turn: the set, with articles

The article is half the word, and a family word said bare is a word half learned.

Say these aloud:

- "le père, la mère" — the parents, masculine then feminine
- "le frère, la sœur" — the siblings, same order
- all four straight through, then in reverse

Twice through: "le père, la mère, le frère, la sœur"

Your turn: the three that rhyme, and the one that does not

Say these aloud:

- "père, mère, frère" — one vowel, three times: the open **è**
- "sœur" after them, and hear the break
- why it broke — "soror ground down two syllables into one"

Your turn: cash in the English

Each French word hands you an English one you already knew and never thought about, and the French is the key rather than the lock.

Say these aloud:

- "père → paternal, patron"
- "mère → maternal, matter"
- "frère → fraternal, friar"
- "sœur → sorority"

What you've built this chapter

- **four family words**, each with its article.
- **one sound-law** — Grimm's law, $p \to f$ and $t \to th$. It is why *père* is *father*, *mère* is *mother* and *frāter* is *brother*, and it turned three separate memorisations into one fact.
- **a letter** — **œ**, one character, waiting in *cœur*.
- **a habit worth more than any of them**: when a French word looks like nothing, reach for the long formal English word rather than the short common one. *Père* is opaque next to *father* and obvious next to *paternal*.

Before you move on

Give all four family words with their articles. (**le père, la mère, le frère, la sœur**.) Which two are feminine? (**la mère, la sœur**.) State Grimm's law in the form you need. (**p → f**, **t → th**.) Use it:

what English word is *frāter*? (**brother**.) How many letters is **œ**, and name a word besides *sœur* that has it. (**One**; *cœur*.) Which English word for physical stuff traces back to *mère*? (**matter**.)

Chapter 13

Bread, Water, Wine

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name bread, water and wine in French, and ask for some of any of them.
>
> *Three things on a table, and two opposite fates for one kind of word: aqua dissolved into eau, a single vowel spelled with three letters, while vīnum stayed legible in wine, vine and vinegar. pānis gave French its bread and English its companions. Then one rule that English simply leaves out — de plus the article, contracting to du — turns each noun from the thing into some of it.*

13.1 le pain — bread

Food at last. This one word sits at the centre of the French table, and it hides what may be the loveliest word-story English has.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — the **-ain** is a **nasal vowel**: the air goes through the nose and the **n** is never said as a consonant of its own.
- `silent-final` — nothing after that vowel is pronounced.
- Together: **le pain** = *luh PA(N)*, where the *(n)* is the nose and not a letter you hear. It is masculine: **le** pain.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pain is Latin **pānis**, "bread." That much is unremarkable. What the root did in English is not.
Take *com-*, "with," and put *pānis* after it. **com + pānis** — "one you break bread with." That is a **companion**, and the word means nothing else:

- **companion**, **company** — a *company* was first a group who ate together, and only later a body of soldiers or a business
- **pantry** — the room the bread is kept in
- **pannier** — a bread-basket, now the bag slung over a bicycle or a donkey

So *le pain* and *companion* are the same root wearing two different jobs. French kept the bread; English kept the friendship built on it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le pain" — *luh PA(N)*, the vowel through the nose
- the sum — "com + pānis: one you break bread with"
- "pain → companion, company, pantry"

Before you move on

How do you say "the bread"? (**le pain**, *luh PA(N).*) Is the **n** a consonant here? (**No** — it marks the vowel as **nasal**.) What Latin word is it? (**pānis**.) What does *companion* literally mean? ("One you **break bread with**" — *com-* + *pānis*.) Next: the drink that wore away to a single vowel.

13.2 l'eau — water

Every word so far has been worn down a little. This one was worn down almost completely — and you can still hear what it used to be, in English.

Sounds you'll need

- `o-eau` — **eau** is pronounced **"oh."** That is the entire word. Three written letters, *e-a-u*, spelling **one** vowel sound and nothing else.
- `elision` — it begins with a vowel sound, so the article elides: **l'eau**, not *le eau*. The same elision you met on **l'été**.
- Together: **l'eau** = *loh*. Two letters heard, four written.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

eau is Latin **aqua**. Say those two aloud, one after the other, and the distance is almost comic.
Watch the erosion happen, though, and each step is small:
aqua → *ewe* → *eaue* → **eau**
The **q** goes, then the **w**-sound goes, then the final vowel goes, and what is left is a held "oh" with a spelling that remembers the rest.
French, quite literally, **drank the consonants out of** *aqua*.
Meanwhile the loud original survived — in **English**, which borrowed the Latin word whole and never wore it at all: **aqua**tic, **aqua**rium, **aque**duct, **aqua**lung. Italian barely touched it either: *acqua*.
So **l'eau** and **aquarium** are the two far ends of one word, and English is holding the end that still looks like Latin.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'eau" — *loh*, one vowel and no more
- the erosion — "aqua, ewe, eaue, eau"
- the two ends — "l'eau, aquarium"
- "le pain, l'eau" — and notice why one elides and the other does not

Before you move on

How do you say "the water"? (**l'eau**, *loh*.) How many sounds are in **eau**? (**One.**) Why is the article **l'** and not *le*? (**eau** begins with a **vowel sound**.) What Latin word is underneath it? (**aqua**.) Where

can you still hear *aqua* loud and whole? (**English** — *aquatic*, *aquarium*, *aqueduct*; and Italian *acqua*.) Next: the drink that refused to wear down.

13.3 le vin — wine

Eau dissolved down to one vowel. This word, sitting on the same table, did the opposite — and the reason is not linguistic.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — the same nasal you met in **pain**, spelled **-in** this time rather than **-ain**. Two spellings, one vowel.
- `silent-final` — again, the **n** is the nose and not a consonant.
- Together: **le vin** = *luh VA(N)*. Say **pain** and **vin** back to back and hear that only the first consonant differs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vin is Latin **vīnum** — and unlike *aqua*, it is still recognisable everywhere it went.
English has it several times over, by several routes:

- **wine** — *vīnum* borrowed into early Germanic, long before French existed
- **vine**, **vine**yard — the plant it comes from
- **vin**egar — French *vin* + *aigre*, "**sour wine**," which is exactly what vinegar is
- **vint**age, **vin**yl — the harvest year, and a plastic named from wine spirit

Why did *aqua* dissolve while *vīnum* held? Because words wear down with use and hold their shape when they are **traded**. Water is what you have; wine is what you buy, ship, tax and write down. A word that keeps appearing on a bill of lading in three countries stays legible in all three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le vin" — *luh VA(N)*, the nose again
- the near-pair — "le pain, le vin"; one consonant apart
- "vin → wine, vine, vinegar"
- the contrast — "l'eau wore away, le vin did not"

Before you move on

How do you say "the wine"? (**le vin**, *luh VA(N).*) Which other word this chapter has the same vowel? (**le pain**.) What Latin word is behind it? (**vīnum**.) What does *vinegar* literally say? (**Sour wine** — *vin* + *aigre*.) Next: how to ask for **some** of any of them.

13.4 du pain, de l'eau — asking for *some*

You have three things on the table and no way to ask for any of them yet. **le pain** is *the* bread — a particular loaf. What you actually want at a table is **some** bread, and French makes you say so.

Grammar Lens: French says "of the", where English says nothing

English can drop the word entirely. *"I'd like bread"* is perfectly good English. French cannot: it marks **an unmeasured amount of a thing** with **de** plus the article the noun already takes.

de + le pain → du pain — *some bread*

de + le vin → du vin — *some wine*

de + l'eau → de l'eau — *some water*

That is one rule, not three. **de + le** always contracts to **du**; **de + l'** has nothing to contract, so it simply stays apart. You are not learning a new list here — you are putting *de* in front of the article you already know, and letting the vowel rule you already met decide the shape.

And the contrast is worth hearing directly:

- **le pain** — *the* bread, that loaf, the one on the table
- **un pain** — *a* loaf, one whole item you could pick up
- **du pain** — *some* bread, an amount with no edges

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "du pain, du vin, de l'eau"
- the reason — "de plus the article; du where it contracts"
- the ladder on one noun — "le pain, un pain, du pain"

Twice through: "du pain, du vin, de l'eau"

Before you move on

How do you say "some bread"? (**du pain**.) Some wine? (**du vin**.) Some water? (**de l'eau** — *eau* takes **l'**, so there is nothing to contract.) What are the two words hiding inside **du**? (**de** + **le**.) What is the difference between *un pain* and *du pain*? (**un pain** is **a loaf**, one whole item; **du pain** is **some bread**, an amount with no edges.) Next: all three together.

13.5 Practice — the table, and asking for some of it

Three nouns and one rule. Run the nouns first, then put the rule on each of them in turn.

Your turn: the three, with their articles

Say these aloud:

- "le pain, l'eau, le vin"
- the odd one — "l'eau elides, because it opens with a vowel"

- the near-pair — "le pain, le vin"; the same nasal, one consonant apart

Twice through: "le pain, l'eau, le vin"

Your turn: now ask for some

Say these aloud:

- "du pain, du vin, de l'eau"
- each noun three ways — "le pain, un pain, du pain"
- the same three ways for wine — "le vin, un vin, du vin"

Your turn: two words that wore differently

Say these aloud:

- the erosion — "aqua, ewe, eaue, eau"
- the survival — "vīnum: wine, vine, vinegar"
- the sum — "com plus pānis: companion"

What you've built this chapter

- **three nouns** you can put on a table, each with the right article.
- **one rule for "some"** — *de* plus the article, contracting to **du** where it can. It is the first time French has asked you to say something English simply leaves out.
- **two opposite fates for one kind of word.** *aqua* dissolved into *eau*; *vīnum* is still legible in four English words. Everyday things wear down, traded things stay legible — which is a rule you can use on words you have not met yet.
- **a root that paid twice** — *pānis* gave French its bread and English its **companions**.

Before you move on

Give all three with their articles. (**le pain, l'eau, le vin**.) Why does only one of them elide? (**eau** begins with a **vowel sound**.) Ask

for some of each. (**du pain, du vin, de l'eau**.) What two words are inside **du**? (**de** + **le**.) Which Latin word wore down to a single vowel, and which one barely moved? (**aqua** → *eau*; **vīnum** → *vin*.)

Chapter 14

The Welded Teens

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (9) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from eleven to sixteen in French, and say which half of each word is the digit and which is the ten.
>
> *Six numbers French did not build. It inherited them from Latin already welded shut — ūndecim, duodecim, trēdecim — and wore them down to one syllable each. The -ze they all share is decem, the same ten already hiding in dix and in décembre, and the front of every one of them is its own digit: deux in douze, six in seize. The digit comes first and the ten comes second, which is a choice, and French is about to make the other one.*

14.1 onze — eleven

You can count to ten. The eleventh number is where you find out that French did not build its teens at all — it inherited them, already welded shut.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-on` — the **on** is a **nasal vowel**, the same one you have in **bonjour**.
- `z-voiced` — the **z** is buzzed, not hissed: your throat should vibrate.
- Together: **onze** = *ONZ*, one syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

onze is Latin **ūndecim** — *ūnus* ("one") plus *decem* ("ten"), fused into one word before French existed.
Notice what French did **not** do. English says *eleven*, which is its own strange word; German says *elf*. French could have said **dix-un**, "ten-one," and it does not. It took the Latin compound whole and wore it down: *ūndecim* → *onze*, four syllables into one.
That is worth flagging now, because it will not last. French keeps this inherited style for exactly six numbers, and then abandons it in front of you.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "onze" — *ONZ*, the vowel through the nose, the *z* buzzed
- the count so far — "huit, neuf, dix, onze"
- what is inside it — "ūnus plus decem: one-ten"

Before you move on

How do you say eleven? (**onze**, *ONZ*.) What two Latin words are fused inside it? (***ūnus*** and ***decem*** — "one" and "ten".) Did French build this word out of *dix* and *un*? (**No** — it inherited *ūndecim* already joined.) Next: twelve, the same way.

14.2 douze — twelve

One welded number could be an accident. Two of them is a pattern, and this one lets you hear the join.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-ou` — the letters **o-u** make a single pure **oo**, as in English *food*. Never two sounds.
- `z-voiced` — the same buzzed **z** as **onze**.
- Together: **douze** = *DOOZ*, one syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douze is Latin **duodecim** — *duo* ("two") plus *decem* ("ten").
And this time you can see both halves survive into the French. Say **deux**, then say **douze**, and listen to the front of each: *deu-*, *dou-*. That is the same digit, and it did not disappear — it was only worn down. The back half is doing the same thing. **onze** and **douze** both end in **-ze**, and both come from a Latin word ending in *-decim*. Two words, one shared ending, and a strong hint about where that ending came from.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "douze" — *DOOZ*, the *o-u* a single pure vowel
- the digit surfacing — "deux, douze"
- the pair — "onze, douze"; hear the shared ending

Before you move on

How do you say twelve? (**douze**, *DOOZ*.) Which small number can you hear at the front of it? (***deux***.) What Latin word is it from? (***duodecim***.) What ending do *onze* and *douze* share? (**-ze**.) Next: what that **-ze** actually is.

14.3 -ze — the ten you keep meeting

Onze and *douze* share an ending. Before you learn four more words that also share it, it is worth two minutes to find out what it **is** — because you have already met it twice, wearing other clothes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The **-ze** on the end of *onze* and *douze* is Latin **decem**, "ten."
That is all it is. *ūn-decim* → *on-ze*. *duo-decim* → *dou-ze*. The Latin *-decim* has been ground down to a single buzzed consonant and a silent vowel, but it is still the word **ten**, still sitting in the back half of the

number, still telling you what the number is built on.
Now put it beside the other two places you have already met that same *decem*:

- **dix** — ten itself, worn down from *decem* at the front instead of the back
- **décembre** — the old **tenth** month, which kept *decem* almost intact
- **-ze** — the same ten, welded onto a digit and nearly erased

One Latin root, three disguises, and you now hold all three. This is the single most useful habit this book can give you: when a scrap of a word looks familiar, it usually is, and the long word is the one that tells you what the short one was.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three disguises — "dix, décembre, onze"
- the claim — "the -ze is decem; it means ten"
- the two you have — "onze, douze"; and hear the ten on the end of both

Before you move on

What is the **-ze** of *onze* and *douze*? (Latin **decem**, "ten".) Name two other French words where you have already met that same *decem*. (**dix** and **décembre**.) Which of the three kept it most intact? (**décembre**.) Next: thirteen, with the ten now visible on the end.

14.4 treize — thirteen

With the **-ze** identified, the rest of the welded teens stop being words to memorise and start being sums you can read.

Sounds you'll need

- The **ei** is the open **è** you met in *père* and *frère* — *treh*, not *tray*.
- `z-voiced` — the buzzed **z** again.
- Together: **treize** = *TREHZ*, one syllable, with the throat **r** at the front.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

treize is Latin **trēdecim** — *trēs* ("three") plus *decem* ("ten").
Read it as a sum now rather than a word:
trei- is *trois*, worn down · **-ze** is *decem*, worn down
Say **trois**, then **treize**, and the front half answers for itself. You are not learning a thirteenth arbitrary noise; you are reading *three* and *ten* stuck together and then rubbed smooth.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "treize" — *TREHZ*, the open *è*
- the digit surfacing — "trois, treize"
- the three you have — "onze, douze, treize"

Before you move on

How do you say thirteen? (**treize**, *TREHZ*.) What are its two halves? (***trois*** and the **-ze** that is **decem**.) Count from eleven. (*Onze, douze, treize.*) Next: fourteen, the longest of them.

14.5 quatorze — fourteen

Every teen so far has been one syllable. This one is two, and the reason is that it started out longer than any of them.

Sounds you'll need

- **quatorze** = *ka-TORZ*. Two syllables, weight on the second.
- The **qu** is a plain **k**, exactly as in **quatre** — never a *kw*.
- `z-voiced` — the buzzed **z** closes it, like all the others.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quatorze is Latin **quattuordecim** — *quattuor* ("four") plus *decem*. *Quattuordecim* is five syllables. *Quatorze* is two. French has thrown away more than half the word and still kept both ideas: **quator-** is the four, **-ze** is the ten.
Set it beside its own digit — **quatre**, *KATR* — and the family resemblance is obvious once you stop expecting the spelling to match. Both begin *quat-*; the number simply grew a syllable to carry the ten.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "quatorze" — *ka-TORZ*, the *qu* a plain *k*
- the digit surfacing — "quatre, quatorze"
- the four you have — "onze, douze, treize, quatorze"

Before you move on

How do you say fourteen? (**quatorze**, *ka-TORZ*.) How is the **qu** pronounced? (A plain **k**.) What Latin word is behind it? (***quattuordecim***.) Count from eleven. (*Onze, douze, treize, quatorze*.) Next: fifteen.

14.6 quinze — fifteen

Back to one syllable — and this is the teen whose Latin half you are most likely to already know from English.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-in` — the **in** is the nasal vowel you have in **pain** and **vin**.
- The **qu** is a plain **k** again.
- Together: **quinze** = *KANZ*, one syllable, the vowel through the nose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quinze is Latin **quīndecim** — *quīnque* ("five") plus *decem*.
The French digit **cinq** has travelled a long way from *quīnque*, so *quinze* does not obviously look like *cinq*. But the Latin **quīn-** is loud in English, and that is the way in:

- **quin**tet — a group of five
- **quin**tuplet — one of five
- **quin**tessence — the *fifth* essence, the one the ancients added to earth, water, air and fire

So when *cinq* and *quinze* refuse to look related, go through English: *quintet* is the bridge between them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "quinze" — *KANZ*, the vowel through the nose
- the bridge — "cinq, quintet, quinze"
- the five you have — "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze"

Before you move on

How do you say fifteen? (**quinze**, *KANZ*.) Which English words carry the same *quīn-*? (**quintet**, **quintuplet**, **quintessence**.) Why is that useful here? (*cinq* and *quinze* **do not look alike**; the English word is the **bridge** between them.) Next: sixteen, the last of the welded ones.

14.7 seize — sixteen

The sixth and last of them. After this word the pattern you have spent five lessons learning simply stops — which is the next chapter's whole subject.

Sounds you'll need

- The **ei** is the open **è**, the same vowel as **treize**.
- `z-voiced` — the buzzed **z** one last time.
- Together: **seize** = *SEHZ*. Say **treize** and **seize** back to back: one consonant apart, and they rhyme exactly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

seize is Latin **sēdecim** — *sex* ("six") plus *decem*.
That is the sixth and final inherited compound. Latin had them beyond this point too, but French did not keep them, and you are about to see what it did instead.
Note also what **seize** is not. It is **not** *dix-six*. Nothing in the first six teens is built out of *dix* plus a digit — every one of them arrived from Latin already joined, and French merely wore them down. That distinction is the thing to hold on to going into the next chapter.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "seize" — *SEHZ*
- the rhyme — "treize, seize"
- all six — "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"

Before you move on

How do you say sixteen? (**seize**, *SEHZ*.) Which other teen rhymes with it? (**treize**.) Is it built from *dix* and *six*? (**No** — it came from Latin *sēdecim* already **fused**.) Count all six. (*Onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize*.) Next: which end of each word is the digit.

14.8 trei-ze — which half is which

You have six words and you know their ending is *ten*. One question is left, and it is the one that makes the next chapter make sense: **which end of the word is the digit?**

Grammar Lens: digit in front, ten behind

In all six, the **digit comes first** and the **ten comes second**.
Trēdecim is "three-ten," **not** "ten-three."
Each word is its own small number worn down, with the ten stuck on the back:

number	the digit in front	the ten behind
onze	**on-** ← *un*	**-ze**
douze	**dou-** ← *deux*	**-ze**
treize	**trei-** ← *trois*	**-ze**
quatorze	**quator-** ← *quatre*	**-ze**
quinze	**quin-** ← *cinq*	**-ze**
seize	**sei-** ← *six*	**-ze**

Say each pair slowly — *deux, douze*; *six, seize* — and the small number surfaces every time.
Hold on to the **order**, not just the halves. Digit-first is a choice, and a language can make the other one. French is about to.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the rule — "digit first, ten second"
- the six pairs — "un/onze, deux/douze, trois/treize, quatre/quatorze, cinq/quinze, six/seize"
- the shape of one — "trei- is three, -ze is ten"

Twice through: "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"

Before you move on

In *treize*, which half is the three and which is the ten? (**trei-** is the three; **-ze** is the ten.) So is 13 built as "three-ten" or "ten-three"?

(**Three-ten** — the **digit comes first**.) Which digit is hiding in *quatorze*? (***quatre***.) Next chapter: the number where French reverses that order and stops fusing altogether.

14.9 Practice — eleven to sixteen

Six words, learned one at a time. Run them as a block, then take each one apart again from memory.

Your turn: the run

Say these aloud:

- "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"
- from ten — "dix, onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"
- backwards — "seize, quinze, quatorze, treize, douze, onze"

Twice through: "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize"

Your turn: surface the digit

Say these aloud:

- each pair — "un/onze, deux/douze, trois/treize"
- the harder three — "quatre/quatorze, cinq/quinze, six/seize"
- the one that needs English — "cinq, quintet, quinze"

Your turn: the ten on the end

Say these aloud:

- the three disguises — "dix, décembre, -ze"
- one sum aloud — "trei- is three, -ze is ten, treize is thirteen"

What you've built this chapter

- **six numbers**, eleven to sixteen.
- **one ending explained** — the **-ze** is *decem*, the same ten you already had in **dix** and **décembre**. Three disguises, one root.
- **the order** — digit in front, ten behind. *Treize* is "three-ten."
- **a way in when a word refuses** — *cinq* and *quinze* do not look alike, and English **quintet** stands between them. Reach for the long formal English word whenever the short French one has worn past recognition.

Before you move on

Count eleven to sixteen without stopping. (*Onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize.*) What is the **-ze**? (Latin **decem**, "ten".) Which comes first in these words, the digit or the ten? (The **digit**.) Which digit is in *quatorze*? (***quatre***.) Were any of these built out of *dix* plus a digit? (**No** — all six arrived from Latin already **fused**.)

Chapter 15

Where French Changes Its Mind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from seventeen to twenty in French, and name the two things that change at seventeen.
>
> *At exactly seventeen, French stops inheriting numbers and starts building them — and swaps the order of the parts while doing it. seize is six-ten, fused; dix-sept is ten-seven, built out of two words you already own. Most language change is too slow to point at; this seam sits between two consecutive numbers and you can say both sides of it aloud. Then vingt arrives as a single inherited word again, and it is the number French will later count in: quatre-vingts, four twenties.*

15.1 dix-sept — seventeen

Six words in a row arrived from Latin already welded. Here is the seventh, and you can read it at sight — which is exactly the surprise.

Sounds you'll need

- **dix-sept** = *dees-SET*. The **x** of *dix* becomes an **s** sound here, and the **p** of *sept* is silent as always.
- `final-consonant` — the **t** of *sept* **is** pronounced. That is unusual for a final consonant in French, and *sept* keeps it in every position.
- Two words, one hyphen, one number.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

There is no Latin ancestor to trace here, and that is the point. **dix-sept** is **dix** and **sept**, the two words you have had since the counting chapter, put side by side with a hyphen. Nothing has been worn down, nothing is hiding, nothing needs an etymology. It says **ten-seven** and it means seventeen.

Latin *did* have a fused word for this — *septendecim* — and French threw it away. After six inherited compounds the language simply stopped, and started building numbers out of parts the speaker already had.

You have just watched a language change its mind mid-count. The next lesson is about what exactly changed, because it is **two** things and not one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dix-sept" — *dees-SET*, and the final *t* is heard
- the seam — "seize, dix-sept"; one is welded, one is built
- the parts — "dix, sept, dix-sept"

Before you move on

How do you say seventeen? (**dix-sept**, *dees-SET*.) What two words is it made of? (***dix*** and ***sept***.) Did French inherit this one from Latin the way it inherited *seize*? (**No** — Latin had *septendecim* and French **abandoned** it, building the number out of parts instead.) Next: the two things that changed at this exact number.

15.2 seize / dix-sept — the seam

Put the two words side by side — **seize**, then **dix-sept** — and something changed between them. Two things did, and most people only notice one.

Grammar Lens: strategy and direction, both at once

The obvious change is **strategy**. Up to sixteen the numbers are **fused** — single words inherited whole and worn down. From seventeen they are **transparent** — built in the open out of words you already have. The change nobody notices is **direction**, and it is a question of which half comes first:

number	**shape**	**what comes first**
seize	*sē-decim*, fused	the **digit**: six-ten
dix-sept	*dix* + *sept*, built	the **ten**: ten-seven

Seize is **six-ten**. *Dix-sept* is **ten-seven**. The two halves have swapped places. So at exactly one number, French changed **how** it makes the word and **which way round** the parts go — and it never went back. That is worth seeing because it is a rare thing to catch. Languages usually change too slowly to point at. Here the join is visible between two consecutive numbers, and you can say both sides of it out loud.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- across the seam — "seize, dix-sept"
- the first change — "fused, then built"
- the second change — "six-ten, then ten-seven"
- the summary — "at seventeen, both the method and the order flipped"

Before you move on

Name the **two** things that change between *seize* and *dix-sept*. (The **strategy** — fused becomes built; and the **direction** — digit-first becomes ten-first.) Which half comes first in *seize*? (The **digit**: six-ten.) And in *dix-sept*? (The **ten**: ten-seven.) Next: eighteen, which now costs you nothing.

15.3 dix-huit — eighteen

This is the first number in the book that costs you nothing. You already know the rule; this is just applying it.

Sounds you'll need

- **dix-huit** = *dee-ZWEET*. The **x** of *dix* buzzes into a **z** here, because *huit* begins with a vowel sound.
- `silent-h` — the **h** of *huit* is not said, which is why the *z* can carry straight across into it.
- The final **t** of *huit* **is** pronounced.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dix + huit, ten and eight. Nothing more.
What is worth a moment is what Latin did here instead, because it is stranger than anything French does. For 18 and 19 Latin did not add — it **subtracted**. Eighteen was **duodēvīgintī**: "**two from twenty**." Nineteen was *ūndēvīgintī*, "one from twenty."
Every language descended from Latin dropped that. French, Spanish and Italian all count **up** to twenty rather than down from it. So the plain *ten-eight* in front of you is not a lazy simplification — it is the survivor of a competition, and the elegant subtraction trick is the thing that lost.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dix-huit" — *dee-ZWEET*, the *x* buzzing into the vowel
- the pair — "dix-sept, dix-huit"; hear *dees-* then *dee-z-*
- what Latin said — "two from twenty"

Before you move on

How do you say eighteen? (**dix-huit**, *dee-ZWEET*.) Why does the *x* buzz here but hiss in *dix-sept*? (***huit*** begins with a **vowel sound**; *sept* does not.) How did Latin build eighteen? (By **subtracting** —

duodē- vīgintī, "**two from twenty**".) Did French keep that? (**No.**) Next: nineteen.

15.4 dix-neuf — nineteen

The last of the built teens — and a word that quietly means two different things.

Sounds you'll need

- **dix-neuf** = *dees-NUF*. The **x** hisses as an **s** here, the way it does in *dix-sept*, because *neuf* begins with a consonant.
- The **eu** is the rounded vowel you made in **sœur**: lips rounded, tongue forward.
- The final **f** is pronounced.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dix + neuf, ten and nine.
The interesting part is **neuf** itself, which is two words wearing one coat:

- **neuf** = **nine**, from Latin *novem*
- **neuf** = **new**, from Latin *novus*

Those were distinct in Latin and French wore them into the same four letters. So *un livre neuf* is "a new book," and *neuf livres* is "nine books," and only the position tells you which.
They are not unrelated, either. The same *nov-* is behind English **novel**, **novice**, **innovate** and **November** — the old **ninth** month, which is the counting month you already met. *Novem* and *novus* are cousins from far enough back that nobody is quite sure which sense came first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dix-neuf" — *dees-NUF*, the *f* heard

- all three built teens — "dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf"
- the double word — "neuf is nine, and neuf is new"

Before you move on

How do you say nineteen? (**dix-neuf**, *dees-NUF*.) What are its two parts? (***dix*** and ***neuf***.) What else does **neuf** mean besides nine? (**New** — from *novus*, where the number is from *novem*.) Which month carries the same *nov*-? (**novembre**.) Next: twenty, and a different system again.

15.5 vingt — twenty

Three built numbers in a row, and then this — which is not built out of anything at all.

Sounds you'll need

- **vingt** = *VA(N)*. The **in** is the nasal vowel you have in **vin** and **pain**.
- `silent-final` — the **g** and the **t** are both silent. Four written letters after the vowel, none of them heard.
- Say **vin** and **vingt** aloud: standing alone they are **identical**. Only the spelling and the sentence tell them apart.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vingt is Latin **vīgintī**, and that is the whole story: an old, single, inherited word, like *dix* and unlike *dix-sept*.
So the count you have just walked through has **three** systems in it, not two:

- 11–16 — inherited, **fused**, digit first
- 17–19 — **built**, transparent, ten first
- 20 — inherited again, a **single word** built from nothing

Twenty is not the end of a pattern. It is the start of a different one, because *vingt* is the number French will later count **in**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vingt" — *VA(N)*, everything after the vowel silent
- the homophones — "vin, vingt"; identical on their own
- the last four — "dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt"

Before you move on

How do you say twenty? (**vingt**, *VA(N)*.) How many of its letters after the vowel are pronounced? (**None.**) Which word from the table chapter sounds exactly the same? (***vin***, wine.) Is *vingt* built out of smaller numbers? (**No** — it is a single inherited word, from *vīgintī*.) Next: what that *vīgintī* went on to do.

15.6 vīgintī — the number French counts in

Vingt looks like an ending. It is a beginning, and this lesson is here so that a famous French oddity is already explained before you meet it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin **vīgintī** did not only give French *vingt*. It gave English a word for an idea:
vigesimal — counting in **twenties**, the way *decimal* is counting in tens.
Most of Europe counts in tens. But a way of counting in **twenties** survived underneath French, and it surfaces in the higher numbers. Eighty in French is not "eight-ten." It is:

quatre-vingts — literally **four twenties**

Four twenties is eighty. And ninety-nine, famously, is *quatre-vingt-dix-neuf* — "four twenties, ten, nine."
You are not learning those numbers here. You are learning **why** they will look the way they do, so that when they arrive they are a consequence rather than a shock. English keeps one fossil of the same habit: a **score** is twenty, and "four score and seven years ago" is

quatre-vingt-sept in a different language.
So *vingt* is the base of a second counting system hiding inside a decimal one — which is a much better thing to know at twenty than at eighty.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the English word — "vigesimal: counting by twenties"
- the preview — "quatre-vingts, four twenties, eighty"
- the English fossil — "four score and seven"

Before you move on

What does **vigesimal** mean? (**Counting by twenties.**) What does *quatre-vingts* literally say, and what number is it? ("**Four twenties**" — **eighty**.) Which English word for twenty preserves the same habit? (A **score**.) Next: all ten numbers together.

15.7 Practice — across the seam, and up to twenty

You can now count to twenty. Run the whole thing, and listen for the place where the machine changes.

Your turn: the full count

Say these aloud:

- eleven to twenty — "onze, douze, treize, quatorze, quinze, seize, dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt"
- from one, the whole way
- the four new ones alone — "dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt"

Twice through: "dix-sept, dix-huit, dix-neuf, vingt"

Your turn: hear the seam

Say these aloud:

- the two words either side — "seize, dix-sept"
- what changed first — "fused, then built"
- what changed second — "six-ten, then ten-seven"

Your turn: the x that cannot decide

Say these aloud:

- hissing — "dix-sept, dix-neuf"; both follow a consonant
- buzzing — "dix-huit"; it follows a vowel sound
- the reason aloud — "the x buzzes into a vowel and hisses before a consonant"

What you've built this chapter

- **four numbers**, seventeen to twenty, and with them the whole count to 20.
- **a seam you can point at** — at seventeen French changed both its **strategy** and its **direction**, and never went back. Most language change is too slow to witness; this one sits between two consecutive numbers.
- **three systems in ten numbers** — inherited and fused, built and transparent, then a single inherited word again at *vingt*.
- **an oddity explained before you meet it** — *vīgintī* is why eighty will be **quatre-vingts**, four twenties.

Before you move on

Count from eleven to twenty without stopping. Which number is the seam, and what two things change there? (**Seventeen** — **fused becomes built**, and **digit-first becomes ten-first**.) Why does the *x* of *dix* buzz in *dix-huit* but hiss in *dix-neuf*? (***huit*** begins with a **vowel sound**.) What will *quatre-vingts* mean, and why? ("**Four**

twenties” — eighty; from *vīgintī*, the **vigesimal** habit.)

Chapter 16

Colours

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (8) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name four basic colours in French, put a colour after the noun it describes, and say which of them are not Latin.
>
> *Four colours with two different homelands. noir walked down from Latin niger and rouge from a root older than Latin — the same one behind English red, rust and German rot. But blanc and bleu are Frankish, Germanic words that displaced Latin ones inside a Romance language, which is the opposite of the usual traffic. albus did not die when blanc took its job; it stopped being a colour and became l'aube, the dawn. And the colour goes after its noun — le vin rouge — with bonjour as the exception the reader already says every day.*

16.1 noir — black

Four colours in this chapter, and they do not have four similar stories. Start with the one that behaves exactly as you would expect, so the surprises stand out later.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-oi` — the **oi** is *wa*, one gliding vowel. It is the same **oi** you have in **trois** and **soir**.
- `r-uvular` — the final **r** is sounded here, made in the throat.
- Together: **noir** = *NWAR*, one syllable.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

noir is Latin **niger**, "black." Nothing was borrowed and nothing is hiding: the word walked straight down from Rome into French, and did the same into its sisters — Spanish *negro*, Italian *nero*.
English took *niger* too, but only as a metaphor. To **denigrate** someone is, literally, to **blacken** them — to darken a name rather than a thing. The colour stayed in the Romance languages; the insult is what crossed into English.
So *noir* is the plain case. Hold on to that, because the next colour is not plain at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "noir" — *NWAR*, the *oi* a single gliding vowel
- the family — "niger, noir, negro, nero"
- the English one — "denigrate: to blacken a name"

Before you move on

How do you say black? (**noir**, *NWAR*.) What Latin word is it from? (***niger***.) What does **denigrate** literally mean? (To **blacken** — to darken someone's name.) Next: white, which did not come from Latin at all.

16.2 blanc — white

Every word in this book so far has come down from Latin. This one did not, and the direction it came from is the opposite of what usually happens.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-an` — the **an** is the nasal vowel you have in **janvier**.
- `silent-final` — the **c** at the end is **not** pronounced.
- Together: **blanc** = *BLA(N)*, one syllable, nothing after the nose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin had a perfectly good word for white: **albus**. French does not use it.
blanc is **Frankish** — a **Germanic** word, from **blank*, meaning not "white" exactly but "**shining, gleaming, flashing**." The Franks are the people who gave France its name, and they gave it its word for white as well.
That direction is the surprising part. Latin words pour into Germanic languages constantly; English is more than half built of them. Traffic the other way, a Germanic word displacing a Latin one **inside** a Romance language, is much rarer.
Why did *albus* lose? Most likely because *blank* was more **vivid**. *Albus* is a flat, plain white; *blank* is a white that **shines**. Colour words are replaced by the more dramatic option surprisingly often — the exciting word wins and then calms down into the ordinary one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "blanc" — *BLA(N)*, the *c* silent
- the pair — "noir, blanc"
- the origin — "Frankish blank: shining"
- the two stories — "noir walked down from Rome, blanc walked in from the north"

Before you move on

How do you say white? (**blanc**, *BLA(N).*) Is the final **c** sounded? (**No.**) Which language did it come from? (**Frankish** — Germanic, not Latin.) What did **blank* actually mean? ("**Shining**, gleaming.") What was the Latin word it displaced? (***albus***.) Next: where *albus* went instead.

16.3 l'aube — the white that stopped being a colour

Blanc took the job. That does not mean *albus* was thrown away — words that lose an argument usually go and do something else.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin **albus** is still all around you. It simply stopped being the word for the colour, and survives inside words for **things that are white**:

- **l'aube** — the **dawn**: the sky going white. French, and pronounced *lohb*
- **l'aubépine** — the **hawthorn**, literally the "**white thorn**"
- **album** — English, from a *blank white tablet* you wrote on
- **albino** — English, someone white-skinned

That is a pattern worth naming, because it will keep happening. When a newer word takes over a plain everyday meaning, the older one does not vanish. It gets pushed into the **specific** — a time of day, a particular tree, a technical term — and stays there for centuries, unnoticed.
So French has two whites after all. One you say when you mean the colour, and one you say without knowing you are saying it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'aube" — *lohb*, the dawn
- the white inside it — "albus: the sky going white"
- the English survivors — "album, albino"
- the two whites — "blanc for the colour, aube for the hour"

Before you move on

What does **l'aube** mean, and what is white about it? (The **dawn** — the sky going white.) Which Latin word is inside it? (***albus***.) Name two English words that kept the same *albus*. (**album**, **albino**.) What happens to a word when a newer one takes its everyday job? (It survives in the **specific** — a time, a tree, a technical term.) Next: red, which is older than Latin.

16.4 rouge — red

Noir came from Latin and *blanc* from the Franks. This one goes back further than either — further than Latin itself.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-ou` — the letters **o-u** make the pure **oo** you have in **douze**.
- `soft-j` — the **g** here is the soft *zh* of *measure*, the same sound as the **j** in **janvier**.
- Together: **rouge** = *ROOZH*, one syllable. English borrowed the word whole for makeup and kept the French sound with it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rouge is Latin **rubeus**, "reddish." But *rubeus* is itself inherited, from a Proto-Indo-European root ***h₁rewd^{h}-** so old that its children are scattered across the whole family:

- Latin *ruber*, *rubeus* → French **rouge**, and English **ruby**, **rubric**
- English **red**, **rust**, **ruddy**
- German **rot**

So *rouge* and **red** are not lookalikes that happen to mean the same thing. They are **actual cousins**, separated for something like five thousand years and still saying the same colour.
That is not an accident of this one word. **Red** is one of the oldest colours any language names — after black and white, it is almost

always the third colour a language gets a word for, and often the only other one for a long time. A word that old survives everywhere because it was never not needed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "rouge" — *ROOZH*, the soft *g*
- the cousins in a row — "rouge, red, rot"
- the Latin ones — "ruber, ruby, rubric"
- the three you have — "noir, blanc, rouge"

Before you move on

How do you say red? (**rouge**, *ROOZH*.) How is the **g** pronounced? (Soft — the *zh* of *measure*.) Are *rouge* and English *red* borrowed from each other? (**No** — they are **cousins** from the same Proto-Indo-European root.) Name two more of that root's children. (**rust**, **ruddy**, **ruby**, **rubric**, German **rot** — any two.) Next: blue, which went abroad and came home.

16.5 bleu — blue

The fourth colour, and the second one that is not Latin. Once is a curiosity; twice is a pattern about who was actually living in France.

Sounds you'll need

- `vowel-eu` — the **eu** is the rounded front vowel you made in **sœur**: lips rounded, tongue forward.
- `silent-final` — there is no consonant after it to say.
- Together: **bleu** = *BLUH*, one syllable, and shorter than English speakers expect.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bleu is **Frankish *blāo** — Germanic again, borrowed exactly the way *blanc* was.
Then something neat happened. **English took *bleu* from French.** So English **blue** is a Germanic word that walked into France, spent centuries there changing its shape, and was then borrowed back into a Germanic language. It went abroad and came home wearing different clothes.
Meanwhile German never sent its copy anywhere: it still says **blau**, which is what **blāo* sounded like all along. Say **blau**, **bleu**, **blue** in a row and you are hearing one word at three stages of one journey.
*(French has a second, more poetic blue as well — **azur**, ultimately from Arabic* lāzaward*, "lapis lazuli." You have almost certainly seen it already, on the map: the **Côte d'Azur**.)*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "bleu" — *BLUH*, lips rounded, and keep it short
- the round trip — "blau, bleu, blue"
- the two Frankish ones — "blanc, bleu"
- all four — "noir, blanc, rouge, bleu"

Before you move on

How do you say blue? (**bleu**, *BLUH.*) Which language did it come from? (**Frankish** — Germanic, like *blanc.*) What is odd about English **blue**? (It is a **Germanic** word that English borrowed **from French** — it went abroad and came back.) What did German keep? (**blau**.) Next: where the colour goes in the sentence.

16.6 le vin rouge — where the colour goes

You have four colours and a table full of nouns. Putting them together takes one rule, and English gets it the other way round.

Grammar Lens: the colour comes second

English puts the colour **in front** of the noun: *red wine*, *white bread*. French puts it **behind**:

le vin rouge — the wine red

le pain blanc — the bread white

The order feels backwards for about a week and then stops feeling like anything. What makes it stick faster is noticing that you **already say the exception**.
bonjour is *bon* + *jour* — a good day, with the adjective in **front**. So French does both, and the split is not random: a small handful of very common, very short adjectives go before the noun — *bon*, *bonne*, and a few others you will meet — while nearly everything else, **colours included**, goes after.
That is the useful form of the rule. Not "French adjectives follow the noun," which the word *bonjour* would immediately contradict, but: **the short common ones lead, and everything else follows.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two wines — "le vin rouge, le vin blanc"
- with bread — "le pain blanc"
- the exception you already own — "bonjour: bon comes first"
- the rule as one line — "short and common in front, everything else behind"

Twice through: "le vin rouge, le vin blanc"

Before you move on

How do you say "red wine"? (**le vin rouge** — the colour **second**.) White bread? (**le pain blanc**.) Which everyday word puts its adjective **first**? (**bonjour** — *bon* + *jour*.) State the rule in one line. (**Short, common adjectives go in front; everything else,**

colours included, goes after.) Next: the three colours on the flag.

16.7 bleu, blanc, rouge — the flag

Three of your four colours are the flag, and saying them in its order is the easiest way to keep them. There is also a joke buried in them.

Why it's said this way

The French flag is named by its colours, left to right:

bleu, blanc, rouge

Say it in that order and it comes as one unit rather than three words. French speakers say it that way constantly — *le drapeau bleu-blanc-rouge* — and it is by far the most common context in which all three appear together.
Now count where they came from:

- **bleu** — Frankish, Germanic
- **blanc** — Frankish, Germanic
- **rouge** — Latin, from a root older than Latin

So the **tricolour is two-thirds Germanic**. The flag of the most self-consciously Latin nation in Europe names itself with two borrowed Germanic words and one inherited one, and no one notices, because a word stops being foreign the moment everybody uses it.
That is the honest summary of this chapter: of four basic colours, **half** came from the north. Half of French's most everyday vocabulary is not doing what the label "Romance language" would lead you to expect.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the flag — "bleu, blanc, rouge"
- all four colours — "noir, blanc, rouge, bleu"

- the sources — “Latin, Frankish, Latin, Frankish”
- the finding — “the tricolour is two-thirds Germanic”

Twice through: “bleu, blanc, rouge”

Before you move on

Name the flag’s colours in order. (**bleu, blanc, rouge**.) Which two of them are Germanic borrowings? (***bleu*** and ***blanc***.) So what fraction of the tricolour is Germanic? (**Two-thirds.**) And of the chapter’s four colours? (**Half.**) Next: all four, put to work.

16.8 Practice — four colours and where they came from

Four words, and then the thing that makes them worth more than four words: each one has a passport.

Your turn: the four

Say these aloud:

- “noir, blanc, rouge, bleu”
- the flag order — “bleu, blanc, rouge”
- the two nasal ones — “blanc”; and the two that end in a vowel sound — “bleu”

Twice through: “noir, blanc, rouge, bleu”

Your turn: put them on nouns

Say these aloud:

- “le vin rouge, le vin blanc”
- “le pain blanc”
- the order out loud — “the noun, then the colour”
- the exception — “bonjour”

Your turn: where each one came from

Say these aloud:

- "noir — Latin niger; denigrate"
- "blanc — Frankish blank, shining"
- "rouge — Latin rubeus; red, rot, ruby"
- "bleu — Frankish blao; blau, bleu, blue"
- the one that changed jobs — "albus became l'aube, the dawn"

What you've built this chapter

- **four colours**, and the flag as a set.
- **word order** — the colour goes **after** the noun, and *bonjour* is the exception you already said before you knew it was one.
- **half of them are not Latin.** *blanc* and *bleu* are Frankish, which runs against the usual direction of traffic: Latin words flood into Germanic languages, not the reverse.
- **a word that lost and survived anyway** — *albus* gave up the colour and kept the dawn. That is what usually happens to a displaced word, and it is worth looking for.

Before you move on

Give the four colours. (**noir, blanc, rouge, bleu**.) Which two are Germanic? (***blanc*** and ***bleu***.) Say "red wine." (**le vin rouge** — the colour second.) Which Latin word for white did French drop, and where did it end up? (***albus*** — in **l'aube**, the dawn, and in English *album* and *albino*.) Are *rouge* and *red* borrowed from each other? (**No** — **cousins**, from one Proto-Indo-European root.)

Chapter 17

To Have, and How Old You Are

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (14) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 14 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use all six forms of avoir, and ask and answer how old someone is the way French does it — by having years rather than being them.
>
> *The verb French leans on hardest, taken one person at a time. Its three singular forms are written ai, as and a and sound the same, which is why French keeps the subject pronouns Spanish drops; its plural endings -ons and -ez survived and are unmistakable. Then the sentence the verb exists for: J'ai vingt ans, "I have twenty years". Never "to be", and ans cannot be dropped — and every Romance language on the continent agrees while every Germanic one does not.*

17.1 j'ai — I have

The verb French leans on hardest starts here, with the form you will say most — and it is one sound long.

Sounds you'll need

- `elision` — it is **j'ai**, never *je ai*. Before a vowel **je** drops its **e**, the same move that turns *le eau* into **l'eau**.
- The **ai** is a single vowel, close to English *eh*.
- Together: **j'ai** = *zhay*. One syllable, and the whole of "I have."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

j'ai is Latin **habeō**, "I have."
Say those two aloud: *ha-be-o*, then *zhay*. Three syllables become one, and not one consonant of the Latin survives into the vowel.
French does this harder than any of its sisters. Italian kept **ho**, Spanish kept **he** — both still a whole syllable with a consonant. French kept a vowel. It is the same appetite that ground *aqua* down to **eau**, and you will see it again every time a very common word looks like nothing.
The rule of thumb is worth having now: **the more often a word is said, the more of it wears away.** That is why the most useful words in a language are usually its least recognisable ones.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "j'ai" — *zhay*, one syllable
- the erosion — "habeō, ho, he, j'ai"
- a whole sentence — "J'ai un frère"

Before you move on

How do you say "I have"? (**j'ai**, *zhay*.) Why is it not *je ai*? (**Elision** — *je* drops its **e** before a vowel.) What Latin word is it from? (***habeō***.) What do Italian and Spanish still keep that French does not? (A whole **syllable** — *ho*, *he*.) Next: the same verb, said to one person.

17.2 tu as — you have

The second form of the verb, and the first sign that this paradigm is easier to say than it looks to read.

Sounds you'll need

- `silent-final` — the **s** of **as** is **not pronounced**.
- **tu as** = *tü ah*. The **u** of *tu* is the tight front-rounded vowel; the **as** is a bare open *ah*.

- Say **j'ai** and **tu as** back to back and notice how little work the verb is doing in either.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

as is the **tu** form — the one you use with a friend, a child, or anyone you would call by their first name. It is the same *tu* you met when you learned which "you" to pick.
The written **s** is a signal to the eye and nothing to the ear. That is the normal state of affairs in French verbs: the endings are alive on the page and almost dead in the mouth. It is why the pronoun is not optional — *as* on its own would tell a listener nothing about who has something.
Keep that in mind as the paradigm fills in. You are learning six written forms and rather fewer sounds. *Avoir* itself is inherited from Latin *habēre*, "to have" (EtymDB 2.1).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "tu as" — *tü ah*, the *s* silent
- the pair — "j'ai, tu as"
- with a noun — "Tu as un frère"

Before you move on

How do you say "you have" to a friend? (**tu as**, *tü ah*.) Is the **s** pronounced? (**No.**) Why can you not drop the pronoun? (The verb form alone **does not say who** — the pronoun carries it.) Next: he and she.

17.3 il a, elle a — he has, she has

The third form, and the shortest verb you will ever meet: one letter.

Sounds you'll need

- **a** is a bare open *ah* — the same sound as **tu as**, with nothing written after it.
- **il a** = *eel ah*. **elle a** = *el ah*.
- All three singular forms are now in your mouth, and the next lesson is about what they have in common.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

a is the form for **il** (he) and **elle** (she), and it is a single letter carrying an entire verb. It goes back to Latin *habet*, "has", worn down to one letter; *avoir* is inherited from *habēre* (EtymDB 2.1).
You already know the two pronouns from the articles: **le** and **la** split the world into masculine and feminine, and **il** and **elle** do the same for people. French has no separate word for *it* — a table is *elle*, a book is *il*, because the noun's gender decides.
One thing to notice for later. When French turns this into a question by putting the verb first, two vowels would collide — *a il ?* — so a **t** is pushed in between them: **a-t-il ?**, "has he?" That **t** means nothing at all. It is there purely so the mouth has something to land on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "il a, elle a" — *eel ah*, *el ah*
- the three singulars — "j'ai, tu as, il a"
- the question shape — "a-t-il ?"; the *t* is only there for the mouth

Before you move on

How do you say "he has"? (**il a**.) And "she has"? (**elle a**.) How many letters is the verb? (**One.**) What is the **t** doing in *a-t-il ?* (**Nothing** — it keeps two vowels from colliding.) Next: why those three forms are harder to hear than to read.

17.4 ai · as · a — three spellings, one ear

You have the three singular forms. Say them one after another and listen to how much difference there actually is.

Grammar Lens: the endings are for the eye

Written, the three singular forms are **ai**, **as**, **a** — three different words. Spoken, **as** and **a** are the same bare *ah*, and **ai** is a single vowel too. The written endings differ; your ear has almost nothing to work with. This is not a quirk of *avoir*. It is the central fact about French verbs, and it has one large consequence: **the pronoun is compulsory.** Spanish can say *tengo* and drop the *yo*, because *-o* means "I" out loud. French cannot drop the *je*, because the ending that would have carried it went silent centuries ago. So French kept the pronoun and Spanish did not, and the two languages ended up in different places for the same reason: **what the ear can still hear decides what the sentence must carry.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three verb forms bare — "ai, as, a"; hear how close they are
- them with their pronouns — "j'ai, tu as, il a"
- the consequence — "the pronoun does the work the ending stopped doing"

Twice through: "j'ai, tu as, il a"

Before you move on

Write it: the three singular forms (**ai**, **as**, **a**.) How many distinct sounds are there? (Effectively **one** — a bare vowel.) Why can French not drop its subject pronouns the way Spanish can? (Because the **endings are silent** — the pronoun is the only thing left that says **who**.) Next: the plural, where the endings come back to life.

17.5 nous avons — we have

Three forms that sound alike, and then this: an ending you can actually hear.

Sounds you'll need

- **nous avons** = *noo-za-VO(N)*. The **s** of *nous* wakes up and buzzes into the vowel — that is the liaison you already know.
- `nasal-on` — the **-ons** ending is a nasal vowel; the **n** is the nose, not a consonant.
- Weight on the last syllable, as almost always in French.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avons is Latin **habēmus**, "we have."
Here the paradigm turns around. The three singular endings wore away to nothing; **-ons** did not. It is a full syllable, it is unmistakable, and it belongs to **nous** and nothing else.
That pattern holds across French verbs: **-ons** for *nous*, **-ez** for *vous*. Once you have those two you can hear the plural coming in any verb in the language, regular or not. *avoir* is one of the most irregular verbs French has, and it still obeys this.
So the difficulty is not spread evenly. The singular is a listening problem and the plural is not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nous avons" — *noo-za-VO(N)*, the *s* buzzing across
- the contrast — "il a" then "nous avons"; one is a vowel, one is a syllable
- the ending alone — "-ons is always nous"

Before you move on

How do you say "we have"? (**nous avons**, *noo-za-VO(N).*) Which ending marks *nous*? (**-ons**.) Why is this form easier to hear than *il a*? (The **plural endings survived** where the singular ones went silent.) Next: the other you.

17.6 vous avez — you have

The second plural ending, and a form you will use with strangers far more often than with crowds.

Sounds you'll need

- **vous avez** = *voo-za-VAY*. The same buzzing liaison as *nous avons*.
- `vowel-e-acute` — the **-ez** is the bright, narrow *ay* of **février**. The **z** is silent.
- Say **nous avons, vous avez** together: *-ons*, *-ez*, the two plural endings of nearly every French verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avez is Latin **habētis**, and it goes with **vous**.
vous is two things at once. It is the plural "you" — several people. And it is the polite "you" for **one** person, which is the use you will need first and most: a shopkeeper, a stranger, anyone you have not been invited to call *tu*.
So *vous avez* is what you say to one person you are being careful with. Getting this wrong is one of the few grammar mistakes in French that a listener hears as a mistake about **them** rather than about the language, which is why *tu* and *vous* is worth more attention than most endings.
The verb form does not change between the two meanings. Only who you are looking at does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vous avez" — *voo-za-VAY*
- the two plural endings — "nous avons, vous avez"
- the two jobs — "vous to a group, vous to one stranger"

Before you move on

How do you say "you have" politely? (**vous avez**, *voo-za-VAY*.) What are the two jobs *vous* does? (**Plural you**, and **polite you** to one person.) Which ending marks *vous*? (**-ez**.) Next: the last form, and the odd one.

17.7 ils ont, elles ont — they have

The sixth and last form, and the one that does not resemble the other five.

Sounds you'll need

- **ils ont** = *eel-ZO(N)*. The **s** of *ils* buzzes across into the vowel.
- `nasal-on` — **ont** is one nasal vowel; the **n** and **t** are both silent.
- **elles ont** = *el-ZO(N)*, identical but for the first vowel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ont is Latin **habent**, and it is the odd one out: every other form of *avoir* has an **a** in it, and this one does not.

There is a trap here worth meeting before you fall into it. **ils ont** is "they have." In two chapters you will meet "they **are**," one consonant away from it and just as common. The way to keep them apart is the liaison: *ils* ***ont*** buzzes — *eel-**z**-o(n)* — and the "are" form hisses. The buzz means *have*.

That is the whole paradigm. Six forms, and you now have all of them: **j'ai · tu as · il a · nous avons · vous avez · ils ont**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ils ont" — *eel-ZO(N)*, the buzz

- "elles ont" — *el-ZO(N)*, the same buzz; the buzz means have
- all six in order

Before you move on

How do you say "they have"? (**ils ont**, *eel-ZO(N)*.) What tells your ear that it means *have*? (The **buzz** — *ils ont* links with a **z**; the "they are" form you meet later hisses.) What is unusual about *ont* among the six forms? (It is the only one with **no a** in it.) Next: where the whole verb came from.

17.8 habēre — the root you already met

You have all six forms of *avoir*. You have also, without being told, already learned its root — in a different verb, several chapters ago.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avoir is Latin **habēre**, "to have."
Now recall **habiter**, "to live somewhere." That is Latin **habitāre** — and *habitāre* is just *habēre* run through a pattern that means "keep doing it." To *habitāre* a place is to **keep having** it.
So *avoir* and *habiter* are the same verb twice: one wore down to a vowel, the other kept the *h*, the *b* and the *t* because it was said far less often. The two French verbs sitting at opposite ends of the same root are a compact demonstration of the rule you met with *j'ai*: frequency is what erodes a word.
English borrowed the Latin whole and shows the root undisguised every time:

- **habit** — what you *have* regularly
- **inhabit** — to *have* a place; the exact twin of *habiter*
- **exhibit** — to *hold* out
- **prohibit** — to *hold* back

Four English words, one French verb you use constantly, and one French verb you met learning to say where you live — all the same handful of Latin letters.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the root — "habēre"
- the two French verbs — "avoir, habiter"
- the English four — "habit, inhabit, exhibit, prohibit"
- the twins — "habiter, inhabit"

Before you move on

What Latin verb is *avoir* from? (***habēre***.) Which other French verb you already know comes from it? (***habiter*** — from *habitāre*, "to keep having a place".) Which English word is *habiter*'s exact twin? (**inhabit**.) Why did *avoir* wear down so much further than *habiter*? (It is said **far more often** — frequency erodes a word.) Next: all six forms, together.

17.9 Practice — the whole of avoir

Six forms, learned one at a time. This is the first time they stand together — and a paradigm you have already built is a recap, not a wall.

Your turn: the six in order

Say these aloud:

- "j'ai, tu as, il a, nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"
- the singulars alone — "j'ai, tu as, il a"
- the plurals alone — "nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"

Twice through: "j'ai, tu as, il a, nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"

Your turn: the two halves sound different

Say these aloud:

- the three that blur — "ai, as, a"
- the two that do not — "-ons, -ez"
- "ils ont" with its liaison — *eel-z-o(n)*; the buzz means have

Your turn: use it

Say these aloud:

- "J'ai un frère"
- "Tu as une sœur"
- "Nous avons du pain"
- the root — "avoir, habiter, inhabit"

What you've built so far

- **six forms** of the verb French leans on hardest, one lesson each.
- **a listening fact** — the singular endings are silent, so French keeps its subject pronouns where Spanish drops them.
- **a root that pays twice** — *habēre* gave French *avoir* and *habiter*, and English *habit*, *inhabit*, *exhibit*, *prohibit*.

Before you move on

Give all six forms without stopping. Which three sound effectively the same? (**ai, as, a**.) Which two endings can you always hear? (**-ons** and **-ez**.) What do you hear in *ils ont* that marks it as *have*? (The **buzz** — *ont* takes a liaison **z**.) What Latin verb is behind all of it? (***habēre***.)

17.10 un an — a year

One small word, and it unlocks the single most common question anyone will ask you in a new language.

Sounds you'll need

- `nasal-an` — **an** is a **nasal vowel**, the same one in **blanc** and **janvier**. The **n** is the nose, not a consonant.
- `silent-final` — the plural **ans** adds a written **s** and no sound at all.
- **un an** = *a(n)-NA(N)*: the **n** of *un* links across into the vowel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

an is Latin **annus**, "year," and English kept it whole in a whole shelf of words:

- **annual** — happening each year
- **anniversary** — literally the year **turning** (*annus* + *vertere*, "to turn")
- **annals** — a record kept year by year
- ***per annum*** — English never even translated this one

You have met *annus*'s neighbours already: the months came out of the same Roman calendar, and *janvier* stands at the door of exactly this word.
French also has a second word for year, **année**, and the difference is real but small: *an* counts years, *année* describes them as a stretch of time. For counting — which is what the next lesson does — you want **an**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "un an" — *a(n)-NA(N)*, both vowels through the nose
- the plural — "deux ans, dix ans"; the *s* is silent
- the English family — "annual, anniversary, annals"

Before you move on

How do you say "a year"? (**un an**.) What Latin word is it? (***annus***.) Does the plural **ans** sound different from **an**? (**No** — the **s** is silent.) What does *anniversary* literally say? (The **year turning**.) Next: what French does with *avoir* and *ans* together.

17.11 j'ai vingt ans — having your years

Here is the first thing French lets you say that English cannot say the same way at all.

Grammar Lens: age is something you have

English **is** its age: you *are* twenty. French **has** it:

J'ai vingt ans. — literally, "I *have* twenty years."

Two things follow, and both are absolute.
The verb is *avoir*, never "to be." Building it with French's "to be" is not a stylistic choice; it is simply wrong, and it is the single most common thing an English speaker gets wrong in their first month.
And *ans* cannot be dropped. English says "I'm twenty" with no noun at all. French must name the years: *J'ai vingt* on its own means nothing.
One sound to get right. **vingt** normally ends in silence — you learned it as *VA(N)*, with the **g** and **t** both dead. Put **ans** after it and the **t wakes up**: *vin-**t**-a(n)*. That is liaison, doing what it always does — reviving a buried consonant when a vowel follows it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "J'ai vingt ans" — with the liaison, *vin-t-a(n)*
- the rule — "avoir, never 'to be'"
- the buried t waking — "vingt" alone, then "vingt ans"
- your own age, with the numbers you have

Twice through: "J'ai vingt ans"

Before you move on

How does French say "I'm twenty"? (**J'ai vingt ans** — "I *have* twenty years".) Which verb, and which is wrong? (***avoir***; "to be" is wrong.) Can you drop *ans* the way English drops "years"? (**No.**) What happens to the **t** of *vingt* before *ans*? (It **wakes up** — *vin-t-a(n)*, a liaison.) Next: how to ask.

17.12 Quel âge as-tu ? — asking someone's age

You can answer the question. Now you can ask it — and this is a phrase worth taking whole rather than building.

Sounds you'll need

- **Quel âge as-tu ?** = *kel AHZH ah-tü.*
- `circumflex` — the hat on **â** is the gravestone you met on **août**: it marks a lost **s**. Older French wrote *aage*, and before that Latin had *aetāticum.*
- The **g** of *âge* is the soft *zh* of **rouge**.
- The polite form is **Quel âge avez-vous ?** — *kel AHZH ah-vay-VOO.*

The exchange

Take it as one unit, the way you took *Comment vous appelez-vous ?*

— **Quel âge as-tu ?** — "What age do you *have*?"

— **J'ai vingt ans.** — "I *have* twenty years."

Notice the question uses **avoir** as well. The whole exchange is built on having, on both sides — which is what makes it a pair worth memorising together rather than two separate facts.

And **âge** is a word you already own in English. *Age* came into English from French, hat and all, having lost its *s* on the way: Latin *aetāticum* → *aage* → **âge** → English **age**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Quel âge as-tu ?" — *kel AHZH ah-tü*
- the polite one — "Quel âge avez-vous ?"
- both halves — "Quel âge as-tu ? J'ai vingt ans."
- the hat's meaning — "â marks a lost s, like août"

Twice through: "Quel âge as-tu ? J'ai vingt ans."

Before you move on

How do you ask a friend their age? (**Quel âge as-tu ?**) And a stranger? (**Quel âge avez-vous ?**) Which verb does the **question** use? (***avoir*** — the same as the answer.) What does the circumflex on **â** mark? (A **lost s**.) Next: who else in Europe does it this way.

17.13 "having" your years — who else does it

French is not being strange here. It is on one side of a line that runs straight across Europe, and the line is exactly where you would draw it.

Why it's said this way

Ask the same question in six languages and count the verbs.

language	**"I am 20"**	**verb**
French	*j'ai vingt ans*	have
Spanish	*tengo veinte años*	have
Italian	*ho venti anni*	have
Portuguese	*tenho vinte anos*	have
German	*ich bin zwanzig Jahre alt*	be
English	*I am twenty*	be

A clean split, and not a coincidental one: every **Romance** language on that list *has* its years, and every **Germanic** one *is* them.
French treats age as something you **carry**: a count of years in your

possession, which grows. English treats it as something you **are**, a property like tall or tired.
Neither is more logical. What matters is that the choice is inherited rather than reasoned: French did not decide this, it received it, along with the rest of what Latin left behind. And it means the mistake you are most likely to make — *je suis vingt ans* — is you importing your own family's habit into another one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

j'ai vingt ans — *ai* ← Latin *habeo*, "I have"; *vingt* ← Latin *viginti*; *an* ← Latin *annus*, "year". All three are inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four that have — "j'ai, tengo, ho, tenho"
- the two that are — "ich bin, I am"
- the line — "Romance has its years; Germanic is its years"
- the French one again, correctly — "J'ai vingt ans"

Before you move on

Which language family uses **have** for age? (**Romance** — French, Spanish, Italian, Portuguese.) Which uses **be**? (**Germanic** — German, English.) Is either one more logical? (**No** — the choice is **inherited**, not reasoned.) Which error does that make an English speaker likely to commit? (***Je suis vingt ans*** — importing English's *be*.) Next: all of it together.

17.14 Practice — to have, and how old you are

A verb and a sentence. Run the verb first, then use it for the thing it will earn its keep on.

Your turn: the paradigm, cold

Say these aloud:

- all six — "j'ai, tu as, il a, nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"
- backwards — "ils ont, vous avez, nous avons, il a, tu as, j'ai"
- "ils ont" — the liaison buzz that means *have*

Twice through: "j'ai, tu as, il a, nous avons, vous avez, ils ont"

Your turn: the exchange

Say these aloud:

- "Quel âge as-tu ?"
- "J'ai vingt ans" — with the liaison, *vin-t-a(n)*
- the polite pair — "Quel âge avez-vous ?"
- your own age

Your turn: use the verb on what you own

Say these aloud:

- "J'ai un frère, j'ai une sœur"
- "Nous avons du pain et du vin"
- the root pair — "avoir, habiter"

What you've built this chapter

- **the whole of *avoir***, six forms, one lesson each, and a paradigm you built rather than one you were handed.
- **why French keeps its pronouns** — the singular endings went silent, so *je*, *tu* and *il* carry what the verb stopped saying.
- **age is something you have** — *J'ai vingt ans*, never "I am," and *ans* is compulsory. Every Romance language on the continent agrees with French, and every Germanic one disagrees.

- **one root, two verbs, four English words** — *habēre* gave *avoir* and *habiter*, plus *habit*, *inhabit*, *exhibit*, *prohibit*.

Before you move on

Give the six forms of *avoir*. Ask a friend their age. (**Quel âge as-tu ?**) Answer with your own. Which verb must you never use for age? (The verb **"to be"**.) Can *ans* be left out? (**No.**) Which other French verb shares *avoir*'s root? (***habiter***.) What marks *ils ont* as *have*? (The **buzz** of its liaison.)

Chapter 18

The Compound Past

Modes: **voice** (12) **Hands-free start:** all 12 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build and use French's everyday past tense, and recognise the second past tense that only appears in writing.
>
> *French's everyday past is avoir plus a participle that never moves, so it costs one new form rather than six. It exists because habeō litterās scriptās once meant plain possession — 'I have letters, written ones' — and hardened into a tense, which is also why a participle still agrees when its object comes first. Then the other past: il parla, which you read in every novel and never hear. It is the same inherited tense Spanish says every day as habló, and it retreated into writing across a connected block of France, southern Germany and northern Italy while the languages at the western edge kept theirs.*

18.1 parlé — the past participle

Before French can talk about the past it needs one new form of the verb, and for the verbs you already have it is the smallest change imaginable.

Grammar Lens: -er becomes -é

Take an **-er** verb and put an accent where the **r** was:

> **parler** → **parlé** · **habiter** → **habité** · **travailler** → **travaillé**

That form is the **past participle**. On its own it is not a tense and not

even really a verb — it is closer to an adjective, and *parlé* means something like "spoken," the way *written* or *broken* work in English. That is worth holding on to, because it explains everything this chapter does next. You are not learning a past tense yet. You are learning a **part**, and the tense gets built out of it in the next lesson. All three of your **-er** verbs behave identically. There is no list to learn and no exception in this class at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the swap — "parler, parlé"
- the other two — "habiter, habité; travailler, travaillé"
- what it is — "spoken, lived, worked: adjectives, not tenses"

Before you move on

What is the past participle of *parler*? (**parlé**.) What changes? (The **-er** becomes **-é**.) Is *parlé* a past tense on its own? (**No** — it is closer to an **adjective**, "spoken.") Give the participles of *habiter* and *travailler*. (**habité**, **travaillé**.) Next: what to build with it.

18.2 j'ai parlé — the past built from "have"

You have both halves of French's everyday past tense already. This lesson only puts them next to each other.

Grammar Lens: avoir, then the participle

The recipe is two words:

avoir (conjugated) + **past participle**

So, with *parlé*:

- **j'ai parlé** — I spoke, I have spoken
- **tu as parlé** — you spoke

- **il a parlé** — he spoke
- **nous avons parlé** — we spoke
- **ils ont parlé** — they spoke

Only *avoir* changes. The participle sits there, identical in every line. So this is not six new forms — it is the verb you spent last chapter on, with one unchanging word after it.
Notice too that French makes no distinction English insists on. *J'ai parlé* is both "I spoke" and "I have spoken"; there is no separate form for the two. Where English has two past tenses to choose between, French conversation mostly has this one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the recipe — "avoir, then the participle"
- the run — "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé, nous avons parlé, ils ont parlé"
- another verb — "j'ai travaillé, j'ai habité"
- the two English meanings — "I spoke, I have spoken; French has one form"

Twice through: "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé"

Before you move on

What are the two parts of the compound past? (***avoir* conjugated**, then the **past participle**.) Which part changes with the person? (**Only *avoir*.**) Say "we worked." (**Nous avons travaillé**.) How many English tenses does *j'ai parlé* cover? (**Two** — "I spoke" and "I have spoken".) Next: a spelling trap you cannot hear.

18.3 parler · parlé · parlez — one sound, three jobs

Say the infinitive, the participle and the *vous* form out loud, one after the other. Now try to hear a difference.

Grammar Lens: your ear gets no help at all

parler, **parlé** and **parlez** are pronounced **exactly the same**: *par-LAY*.
Three different jobs, three different spellings, one sound:

- **parler** — to speak (the infinitive)
- **parlé** — spoken (the participle)
- **parlez** — you speak (the *vous* form)

This is the same phenomenon you met with *ai*, *as* and *a*, and it has the same cause: French endings survive on the page and die in the mouth. But it lands harder here, because these three are **different parts of speech**, and only the sentence around them says which one you heard. The good news is that the sentence always does. *Vous parlez* has a pronoun in front of it. *J'ai parlé* has *avoir* in front of it. **Parler** has nothing in front of it, or another verb, the way English *speak* follows *want to*. In practice you never have to decide — which is why French speakers are untroubled by a distinction that looks impossible written down.
For **writing**, though, you do have to choose, and choosing wrongly is the single most common spelling mistake native French speakers make.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "parler, parlé, parlez"; one sound
- each in its frame — "vous parlez", "j'ai parlé"
- the rule of thumb — "what comes before it tells you which"

Before you move on

How many of *parler*, *parlé* and *parlez* sound different? (**None** — all three are *par-LAY*.) What tells you which one you are hearing? (**What comes before it** — a pronoun, *avoir*, or nothing.) Which is the participle? (**parlé**.) Next: the verbs that do not end in *-er*.

18.4 fini · vendu — the other two classes

Every verb you have met so far ends in **-er**. That is by far the biggest group, and it is not the only one.

Grammar Lens: three classes, three vowels

French verbs are sorted by how the infinitive ends, and each group makes its participle with its own vowel:

infinitive ends in	participle ends in	example
-er	**-é**	*parler* → *parlé*
-ir	**-i**	*fini*, "finished"
-re	**-u**	*vendu*, "sold"

fini and *vendu* are the standard examples, and they are here as **examples of the pattern** rather than words to add to your vocabulary — neither verb has had a lesson of its own in this book yet. What you want from this lesson is the shape: when you meet a verb, its infinitive ending already tells you what its participle will look like. That is three facts, not three hundred. And **-er** is the group that matters most in practice: it holds the overwhelming majority of French verbs, and it is the only group still taking new members — every verb French invents or borrows becomes an *-er* verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three endings — "é, i, u"
- the three participles — "parlé, fini, vendu"
- the useful half — "-er is the big one, and the only one still growing"

Before you move on

What vowel ends the participle of an **-ir** verb? (**-i**.) And an **-re** verb? (**-u**.) And **-er**? (**-é**.) Which class is by far the largest? (**-er** — and it is the only one that still takes new verbs.) Next: where those three endings came from.

18.5 -ātum · -ītum · -ūtum — where the endings came from

Three participle vowels, and two of them are inherited. The third is French tidying up after itself, which is a different kind of fact.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin marked its participles with a **-t-** and a vowel in front of it:

- **parlé** ← *-ātum*
- **fini** ← *-ītum*
- **vendu** ← *-ūtum*

French wore away the **-t-** and the ending, and kept the vowel. English, which borrowed from Latin rather than inheriting it, kept the **-t-** instead — you can see it whole in **fini*te***, **acu*te***, **statu*te***. Same suffix, two salvage strategies: French saved the vowel, English saved the consonant.

Now the third one, which is the interesting one. ***-ūtus* was rare in Latin.** It turns up in a handful of words — *minūtus* (small, hence *minute*), *tribūtus* (assigned, hence *tribute*) — and nothing like a whole class.

French and Italian took that small, scrappy group and **spread it across an entire conjugation**. So *-é* and *-i* are straight inheritance, and *-u* is largely the language **tidying up by analogy**: a pattern noticed in a few words and then applied on purpose to many.

That is worth separating from ordinary etymology. Most of what this book shows you is erosion — words wearing down. This is the opposite force: speakers **regularising**, making a language tidier than they received it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three Latin endings — "-ātum, -ītum, -ūtum"
- what English kept — "finite, acute, statute"; the *t* survived
- the odd one — "-ūtus was rare, and French spread it"
- the two forces — "erosion wears words down; analogy tidies them up"

Before you move on

What did French keep from the Latin participle ending, and what did English keep? (French kept the **vowel**; English kept the **-t-**, as in *finite*, *acute*, *statute*.) Which of the three French endings is **not** straight inheritance? (**-u** — *-ūtus* was **rare** in Latin and French spread it over a whole class.) What is that process called? (**Analogy** — speakers regularising.) Next: why this tense exists at all.

18.6 habeō litterās scriptās — the buried possessive

There is an obvious question about this tense that is worth asking: why *have*? What does owning something have to do with the past?

Grammar Lens: it was never a tense to begin with

Latin could say:

habeō litterās scriptās — "I *have* letters, written ones."

Read that as Latin, not as French. It is **not** a past tense. It is *habēre* in its plain, ordinary sense — **I possess some letters** — with *scriptās* as an **adjective** describing them, agreeing with *litterās* in gender and number the way any Latin adjective would.
The sentence says nothing about who did the writing, and nothing about when. It says: I own letters, and their condition is *written*. Then centuries pass. The phrase gets said constantly, the possession fades out of it, and what is left is the doing: *I wrote*. A construction

about **owning** an object hardened into a construction about **having done** an action.
This happens to be one of the best-documented examples of the whole process, and you can watch it happen in the surviving texts. It is also why English "I have written" exists — English built the same thing, from the same starting point, independently.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the Latin — "habeō litterās scriptās"
- what it meant — "I have letters, written ones"
- what it became — "I wrote"
- the shift in one line — "possession hardened into a tense"

Before you move on

What did *habeō litterās scriptās* originally mean? ("**I have letters, written ones**" — plain possession.) What part of speech was *scriptās*? (An **adjective**, describing the letters.) What did the phrase turn into? (A **past tense** — "I wrote".) Why does French build its past out of *have*? (Because the construction **began** as one about **having**.) Next: the fossil that construction left behind.

18.7 les lettres que j'ai écrites — the fossil

The possessive is gone from the meaning. It is not gone from the spelling, and the place it survives is one of the strangest rules in French.

Grammar Lens: the participle still agrees, when the object goes first

Normally the participle never changes:

J'ai écrit les lettres. — "I wrote the letters." *écrit*, plain.

Move the object in front of the verb, though, and the participle **agrees**

with it — feminine, plural, exactly as an adjective would:

> **Les lettres que j'ai écrites.** — "The letters that I wrote." *écrit**es**.*

That **-es** is the two-thousand-year-old adjective ending from *habeō litterās scriptās*, still doing the job it was doing in Latin. The meaning moved on; the agreement stayed behind.
Two things make this bearable. First, you can almost never **hear** it — *écrit* and *écrites* sound the same, so it is a writing rule far more than a speaking one. Second, it now has an explanation instead of being arbitrary: the participle agrees when the thing it describes comes **before** it, which is where an adjective could still see it.
French schoolchildren spend years on this rule and are taught it as a list of conditions. It is really one fact with a very long memory.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the plain order — "J'ai écrit les lettres"
- the object first — "Les lettres que j'ai écrites"
- what the *-es* is — "an adjective ending, two thousand years old"
- the consolation — "you cannot hear it"

Before you move on

When does the past participle agree with the object? (When the object comes **before** the verb.) Why does it agree at all? (Because it was an **adjective** first, describing the thing that was possessed.) Can you hear the agreement in *écrites*? (**No** — it is a writing rule.) Next: all of it, together.

18.8 Practice — the past you actually say

> One tense, built from two things you already had. Run it, then take it apart again.

Your turn: build it

Say these aloud:

- "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé, nous avons parlé, vous avez parlé, ils ont parlé"
- with your other verbs — "j'ai travaillé, nous avons habité"
- what moves and what does not — "avoir changes; the participle never does"

Twice through: "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé"

Your turn: the three endings

Say these aloud:

- "é, i, u"
- the participles — "parlé, fini, vendu"
- the Latin — "-ātum, -ītum, -ūtum"; and English "finite, acute, statute"

Your turn: the sound trap and the fossil

Say these aloud:

- the three that sound alike — "parler, parlé, parlez"
- the old meaning — "I have letters, written ones"
- the fossil — "Les lettres que j'ai écrites"

What you've built so far

- **a past tense**, made of a verb you already knew and one unchanging word.
- **three participle endings**, one per verb class, two inherited and one spread by analogy.
- **an explanation for the *have***: the construction began as plain possession — *I have letters, written ones* — and hardened into a

tense.

- **a fossil you can point at**: the agreement in *écrites* is an adjective ending that has outlived the grammar that required it.

Before you move on

Say "we spoke." (**Nous avons parlé**.) Which half changes with the person? (***avoir***.) Give the three participle vowels. (**-é, -i, -u**.) Which three forms of *parler* sound identical? (***parler, parlé, parlez***.) When does the participle agree? (When the **object comes first**.) Next: the other past tense — the one you will read and never say.

18.9 il parla — the past you read but never say

French has a **second** past tense. You will meet it on the first page of almost any novel and never once hear it in a conversation.

Grammar Lens: recognise it, do not produce it

It is called the **passé simple**, and it is one word where the compound past is two:

meaning	**passé simple**	**passé composé**
he spoke	*il parla*	*il a parlé*
they spoke	*ils parlèrent*	*ils ont parlé*
he had	*il eut*	*il a eu*

You do **not** need to produce these, and you should not try. Nobody says them. Using one out loud sounds roughly like announcing "thus spake he" in an English pub.

What you need is to **recognise** them, because they carry the past tense of essentially all French literature. A reader who stalls at *il parla* stalls on page one of everything.

So this is the first thing in this book that is deliberately **half**-learned, and that is a real distinction worth making: some things you learn to say, and some you learn only to understand. Treating those as the same job is what makes beginners feel they must master everything before reading anything.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "il parla … il a parlé"; same meaning, two registers
- the plural pair — "ils parlèrent … ils ont parlé"
- where you meet it — "in a novel, not a conversation"

Before you move on

What is *il parla*? (The **passé simple** — "he spoke".) Where will you meet it? (In **writing**, especially novels — never in speech.) Do you need to produce it? (**No** — recognition only.) What is the everyday equivalent? (***il a parlé***.) Next: who else kept this tense alive.

18.10 il parla · habló · falou — the same tense, four fates

The tense French retired to its libraries is a tense other people use to order coffee.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

il parla comes from the plain Latin perfect, handed straight down with no rebuilding at all. Which means it is the **same tense** as these:

language	"he spoke"	status
French	*il parla*	books only
Spanish	*habló*	everyday speech
Portuguese	*falou*	everyday speech
Italian	*parlò*	regional

One Latin ancestor, four different fates. A Spaniard saying *habló* and a French novelist writing *il parla* are using the **same inherited form**, and only one of them sounds archaic doing it.

That is worth sitting with, because it undoes an assumption. A tense is not formal or informal, literary or everyday, by its nature. **Register is not a property of a form; it is a property of what a particular community of speakers happens to have kept.**

French did not decide *il parla* was fancy. It just stopped saying it, and the books did not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the sisters — "il parla, habló, falou, parlò"
- the split — "one of them is literary; the others are lunch"
- the finding — "register is not in the form, it is in the speakers"

Before you move on

What Latin tense is *il parla*? (The plain **perfect**, inherited directly.) Which languages still say it every day? (**Spanish** — *habló* — and **Portuguese** — *falou*.) So what makes a tense "literary"? (**Not the form** — what its speakers kept using.) Next: what pushed it out, and where else that happened.

18.11 the same retreat, three times over

French pushed its old past tense into books and replaced it with a compound built on *have*. It is not the only language that did.

Why it's said this way

language	the simple past	what replaced it in speech
French	*passé simple*	*passé composé* — *j'ai parlé*
German	*Präteritum*	*Perfekt* — *ich habe gesagt*
Italian	*passato remoto*	*passato prossimo* — *ho parlato*

Three languages, two Romance and one **Germanic**, each built a compound past out of "have," and each let that compound push the inherited simple past out of conversation and into writing.
The obvious reading is that this is a natural drift any language might

undergo. The better reading is geographical. **France, southern Germany and northern Italy form one connected block**, and the change spread through it by **contact**, over the same few centuries — carried by people who lived near each other, across language boundaries that were never barriers to anything.
Linguists call that an **areal** change: one that travels by neighbourhood rather than by descent. And the evidence is at the edges. **Spanish and Portuguese**, out at the western rim, largely **did not get it** — they kept their simple past in everyday speech, which is why *habló* is still ordinary. Though Spain's Spanish has begun drifting the same way, with *he hablado* taking ground: the change reaching the edge, late.
So the map explains what the family tree cannot. Italian and Spanish are close relatives that behave differently here, and French and German are distant relatives that behave the same — because what mattered was who was standing next to whom.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

passé simple — *passé*, "passed", goes back to Latin *passus*, "a step"; *simple* ← Latin *simplex*. (EtymDB 2.1)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three retreats — "passé simple, Präteritum, passato remoto"
- the three replacements — "j'ai parlé, ich habe gesagt, ho parlato"
- the shape — "a connected block: France, southern Germany, northern Italy"
- the edge — "Spanish and Portuguese kept theirs"

Before you move on

Which three languages made the same swap? (**French**, **German**, **Italian**.) Was it three separate inventions? (**No** — one change spreading by **contact** across a connected block.) What is that kind of change called? (**Areal**.) Which languages at the edge kept their simple past? (**Spanish** and **Portuguese**.) Next: everything

together.

18.12 Practice — two pasts, and why

One tense to say and one to recognise. Run both, and keep the jobs separate.

Your turn: the one you say

Say these aloud:

- "j'ai parlé, tu as parlé, il a parlé, nous avons parlé, vous avez parlé, ils ont parlé"
- "j'ai travaillé, nous avons habité"
- the three endings — "é, i, u"

Twice through: "j'ai parlé, nous avons travaillé"

Your turn: the one you read

Say these aloud:

- the pairs — "il parla … il a parlé"; "ils parlèrent … ils ont parlé"
- the sisters — "il parla, habló, falou, parlò"
- the job — "recognise it; do not say it"

Your turn: the two histories

Say these aloud:

- where the tense came from — "I have letters, written ones"
- the fossil — "Les lettres que j'ai écrites"
- the three retreats — "passé simple, Präteritum, passato remoto"

What you've built this chapter

- **the past tense you will actually use**, built from *avoir* and a participle that never moves.
- **three participle endings**, and the fact that one of them was spread by analogy rather than inherited.
- **an origin**: the tense began as plain possession and hardened, which is why it uses *have* at all — and why a participle still agrees when its object comes first.
- **a second past you only read**, and the reason it is only read: not because the form is fancy, but because a block of neighbouring languages stopped saying theirs at roughly the same time, and the ones at the edge did not.

Before you move on

Say "they worked." (**Ils ont travaillé**.) Which part of the compound past changes? (***avoir***.) Which three forms of *parler* are homophones? (***parler, parlé, parlez***.) What is *il parla*, and what do you do with it? (The **passé simple** — **recognise** it, never say it.) Why does the participle agree in *les lettres que j'ai écrites*? (It was an **adjective** first, and the object comes **before** it.)

Chapter 19

To Be, and the Three Verbs Inside It

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (12) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 12 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use all six forms of être, and explain why it has no pattern to find.
>
> *The most irregular verb in French, and the irregularity turns out to have a shape. There is no pattern in être because être is THREE verbs: es- from esse for the present and infinitive, fu- from fuī for the passé simple — the same root as English be — and ét- from stāre, 'to stand', which supplied a whole limb of participles and the imperfect. The patching is called suppletion, and English does it too, with go and went. Spanish inherited the same two Latin verbs and made the opposite choice: it kept ser and estar apart and made you pick.*

19.1 je suis — I am

The partner of *avoir*, and the most irregular verb in French. That irregularity is not carelessness; it is age.

Sounds you'll need

- **je suis** = *zhuh SWEE*. The **s** at the end is silent.
- The **ui** is a single glide: start at the tight **u** of *tu* and slide straight into *ee*.
- Do not hear an English *swiss*; there is no *s* at the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

suis is Latin **sum**, "I am."
Before you go looking for a pattern in this verb: **there is not one.** *être* is the most irregular verb in French, and it is irregular for the same reason English *be / am / is / was* is. These are among the **oldest word-shapes in Europe**, said millions of times a day for three thousand years, and constant use does not regularise a word — it protects it. Rare verbs get tidied up by analogy; the commonest ones are said too often for anyone to forget them, so they keep whatever shape history left them with.
So the six forms are six things to learn, and that is the honest situation. What this chapter can give you instead of a pattern is an **explanation** — because the irregularity turns out to have a shape once you know where the pieces came from.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je suis" — *zhuh SWEE*, the final *s* silent
- a whole sentence — "Je suis fatigué"
- the Latin — "sum, suis"

Before you move on

How do you say "I am"? (**je suis**, *zhuh SWEE*.) Is the final **s** pronounced? (**No.**) What Latin word is it? (***sum***.) Why is this verb so irregular? (It is **very old and very common** — constant use protects a shape rather than tidying it.) Next: the same verb, to a friend.

19.2 tu es — you are

After *suis*, the shortest form in the verb — and one that is easy to swallow entirely.

Sounds you'll need

- **tu es** = *tü ay*. Two letters, one vowel sound.
- The **s** is silent, as it was in **tu as**.
- Careful: **tu es** and **tu as** differ only in that vowel — *ay* against *ah*. Say them back to back until the difference is deliberate.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

es is Latin **es**, unchanged. Latin said *es* for "you are" and French still does, which for a form this heavily used is unusual — most such words are ground down past recognition.
The pair to watch is not Latin, though. It is **tu es** against **tu as**: "you are" and "you have," one vowel apart, both extremely common, both with a silent **s**. English keeps them far apart; French does not.
That is the practical difficulty of this verb. Not the etymology — the fact that its forms are short, unstressed, and easily confused with *avoir*'s.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "tu es" — *tü ay*
- the pair to keep apart — "tu es, tu as"
- both verbs together — "je suis, j'ai"

Before you move on

How do you say "you are" to a friend? (**tu es**, *tü ay*.) Which other very common form does it nearly collide with? (***tu as***, "you have".) What is the difference? (Only the **vowel** — *ay* against *ah*.) What Latin word is *es*? (***es*** — unchanged.) Next: he and she.

19.3 il est, elle est — he is, she is

You have said this one already, many times, without knowing it was part of a verb.

Sounds you'll need

- **il est** = *ee-LAY*. The **s** and **t** are both silent, and the **l** of *il* runs into the vowel.
- Before a vowel the buried **t** wakes: **est-il ?** = *eh-TEEL*.
- **elle est** = *el-AY*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

est is Latin **est**, also unchanged — and it is very probably the single most frequently said word-form in French.
You already own it. **il est trois heures**, "it is three o'clock," is this exact form; so is every time you have said what time it was. The clock chapter handed you a piece of *être* several chapters before the verb arrived, which is the ordinary way a language teaches itself: the commonest forms turn up inside fixed phrases long before anybody explains them.
Note also that **il** here is not "he." In *il est trois heures* it refers to nothing at all — French requires a subject even when there is nobody to be one. That is the same reason the pronoun cannot be dropped: the sentence needs the slot filled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "il est, elle est"
- what you already knew — "il est trois heures"
- the three singulars — "je suis, tu es, il est"

Before you move on

How do you say "he is"? (**il est**, *ee-LAY*.) Where have you said this form before? (**Telling the time** — *il est trois heures*.) Who is *il* in that sentence? (**Nobody** — French needs the subject slot filled even when there is no subject.) Next: the plural, and a form with no French shape at all.

19.4 nous sommes — we are

Every verb you have met marks *nous* with **-ons**. Watch what this one does.

Sounds you'll need

- **nous sommes** = *noo SOM*. The **s** of *nous* buzzes across into the vowel.
- The final **-es** is silent; the word ends on the **m**.
- Compare **nous avons**, which ends in a nasal. This one does not.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sommes is Latin **sumus**.
And notice what is missing. Every other verb you have met marks *nous* with **-ons**: *nous avons*, *nous parlons*. This verb does not. There is no *-ons* here at all, and no way to derive *sommes* from anything.
That is the shape of this verb's irregularity: it does not bend the rules, it predates them. The **-ons** ending is a regularity French built up over centuries, and *être* was already too well-worn and too heavily used to be dragged into it.
So *sommes* is not an exception to a rule. It is a survival from before the rule existed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nous sommes" — *noo SOM*
- the missing ending — "nous avons, nous parlons, nous sommes"
- the reason — "it predates the rule, it does not break it"

Before you move on

How do you say "we are"? (**nous sommes**, *noo SOM*.) Which usual ending is missing? (**-ons**.) Why? (*être* is **older than that regularity** and was too common to be pulled into it.) What Latin word is it? (***sumus***.) Next: the form that keeps a hat.

19.5 vous êtes — you are

The politeness form, and the one that wears its history on the page.

Sounds you'll need

- **vous êtes** = *voo-ZET*. The **s** of *vous* buzzes into the vowel.
- `circumflex` — the hat on **ê** marks a **lost s**, the same gravestone you met on **août** and **âge**.
- The final **-es** is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

êtes is Latin **estis**, "you are" — and you can read the erosion straight off the page.
estis → *estes* → **êtes**. The **s** after the first vowel fell silent and then fell out of the spelling, and the circumflex was put there to mark where it had been. This is the third time you have met that hat doing exactly this job, and by now it should be a reflex: **see a circumflex, try putting an *s* back.**
Do it here and *êtes* becomes *estes*, which is visibly Latin *estis*. Do it on **août** and you get *aoust*. Do it on **âge** and you get *aage*, from *aetāticum*.
The infinitive works the same way: **être** was *estre*, from Vulgar Latin **essere*. The hat is not decoration on any of them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vous êtes" — *voo-ZET*
- put the *s* back — "êtes, estes, estis"
- the same trick on the infinitive — "être, estre"
- the two plurals — "nous sommes, vous êtes"

Before you move on

How do you say "you are" politely? (**vous êtes**, *voo-ZET*.) What does the circumflex mark? (A **lost s**.) Put it back — what do you get? (***estes***, from Latin *estis*.) And on the infinitive *être*? (***estre***.) Next: the last form, and the one you must not confuse with *avoir*.

19.6 ils sont, elles sont — they are

The sixth form, and the one you were warned about two chapters ago.

Sounds you'll need

- **ils sont** = *eel SO(N)*. The **on** is nasal; the **t** is silent.
- Here is the pair to drill: **ils sont** *hisses*, **ils ont** *buzzes*. *eel-**s**o(n)* against *eel-**z**o(n)*.
- That single consonant is the whole difference between **they are** and **they have**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sont is Latin **sunt**.
You now have both of the verbs French is built on, and their *ils* forms are one sound apart. That is worth two minutes of drilling on its own, because the two sentences it distinguishes are both things you will say constantly.
The full set, and you built every piece of it:
je suis · tu es · il est · nous sommes · vous êtes · ils sont
Six forms and no pattern — which is what the next three lessons are about, because the *reason* there is no pattern turns out to be more interesting than a pattern would have been.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ils sont" — *eel SO(N)*, hissing
- the pair — "ils sont, ils ont"; hiss for are, buzz for have

- all six — "je suis, tu es, il est, nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont"

Before you move on

How do you say "they are"? (**ils sont**, *eel SO(N).*) How do you hear it against *ils ont*? (**A hiss** against a **buzz**.) Give all six forms of *être*. Is there a pattern in them? (**No** — and the next lessons explain why.) Next: where these forms actually came from.

19.7 esse — the first stem

Six forms with no pattern between them. Put them beside their Latin and something appears — not a pattern, but a **seam**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Every present form of *être* comes from Latin **esse**, "to be":

- **je suis** ← *sum* · **nous sommes** ← *sumus* · **ils sont** ← *sunt*
- and the two short ones, **tu es** ← *es*, **il est** ← *est*, arrived practically untouched

Say each pair aloud and the irregularity stops looking random. The **s-** is there every time, and the forms are **as scattered in Latin as they are in French** — *sum, es, est, sumus, estis, sunt* is not a tidy paradigm either. French did not break this verb. It **received** it broken, and Latin had received it broken too.
The infinitive comes from the same place, by a detour. Classical Latin's infinitive was *esse*, which is short and odd; Vulgar Latin rebuilt it on the ordinary pattern as ***essere**, and **essere* → *estre* → **être**.
So one stem, **es-**, accounts for the present tense and the infinitive. That is most of what you have learned so far. The rest of the verb comes from somewhere else entirely.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pairs — "sum suis, sumus sommes, sunt sont"

- the stem — "es-, for the present and the infinitive"
- the rebuild — "esse, essere, estre, être"

Before you move on

Which Latin verb are all the present forms from? (***esse***.) Was Latin's version regular? (**No** — *sum, es, est, sumus, estis, sunt* is already scattered; French inherited the mess.) Where does the infinitive *être* come from? (Vulgar Latin ***essere**, a rebuild of *esse*.) Next: a part of the verb that is not from *esse* at all.

19.8 je fus — the second stem

The past of this verb does not begin with an **s**. That is not a sound change. It is a different verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The *passé simple* of *être* — the literary past you learned to recognise — is **je fus**, **il fut**.
There is no way to get *fus* from *suis*, and nobody has ever tried. It comes from Latin **fuī**, and *fuī* comes from Proto-Indo-European ***b^{h}uH-**, "to grow, to become."
That root went somewhere you will recognise. ***b^{h}uH-** is also the source of English **be**. So English's *be* and French's *fus* are the same ancient word, and neither of them is related to French *suis* — which is the cousin of English *is* and *am*.
English has exactly the same patchwork, and nobody notices because it is their own: **am** and **is** from one root, **be** from another, **was** and **were** from a third. French is doing what English does. It is only visible here because it is somebody else's language.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the form — "je fus, il fut"
- the root — "fuī, from *b^{h}uH-: to grow, to become"

- the surprise — "that root is English *be*"
- the English patchwork — "am, is, be, was: three roots"

Before you move on

What is *je fus*? (The **passé simple** of *être* — "I was".) Is it related to *suis*? (**No** — different root entirely.) Which Latin word is it from? (***fuī***.) Which English word comes from the same root? (**be**.) Does English do the same thing? (**Yes** — *am*/*is*, *be*, and *was* come from **three** different roots.) Next: the third stem, and it is a verb about standing.

19.9 été — the third stem

Two stems so far. The third is the largest, and it is not a form of "to be" in any language — it is a verb about **standing**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The past participle of *être* is **été**. It has nothing to do with *suis* and nothing to do with *fus*. It comes from Latin **stāre**, "**to stand**."
And it is not one stray form. **Every** *être* form beginning **ét-** comes from the standing verb:

- **été** — the past participle ← *stātum*
- **étant** — the present participle ← *stantem*
- **j'étais**, **il était** — the imperfect ← *stābam*

That is a whole limb of the verb, borrowed wholesale from a different one.
The idea is not far-fetched. "How are you?" is *how do you stand?* in more languages than not — English still says *how do you stand on this*, and *standing* means status. A verb for standing drifting into a verb for being is one of the best-worn paths in language.
Stāre left French other things too, outside *être*: **rester** ← *re-stāre*, "to stay," and **coûter** ← *constāre*, "to cost." What it did **not** do in French is survive as a separate verb meaning "to be."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the participle — "été"
- the limb — "été, étant, j'étais": all from *stāre*
- the meaning — "to stand"
- its other children — "rester, coûter"

Before you move on

What is the past participle of *être*? (**été**.) Which Latin verb is it from? (***stāre***, "to **stand**".) Which other *être* forms come from the same place? (Every one beginning **ét-** — *étant*, *j'étais*, *il était*.) Name two French verbs outside *être* from *stāre*. (**rester**, **coûter**.) Next: the name for what this verb is doing.

19.10 suppletion — three verbs in a trench coat

You have three stems and three different origins. There is a name for this, and having the name makes it stop being strange.

Grammar Lens: a paradigm filled in from elsewhere

Lay out what *être* is made of:

- **es-** — the present tense and the infinitive, from *esse*
- **fu-** — the *passé simple*, from *fuī*
- **ét-** — the participles and the imperfect, from *stāre*

One verb, three ancestors, and the joins are invisible unless somebody points at them.
The name for this is **suppletion**: one verb's paradigm filled in with pieces of another. It is not a French disease and not a sign of decay. It happens to the **most used verbs in every language**, and only to them — a verb has to be extremely common for speakers to tolerate a completely unpredictable form, and extremely common verbs are also the ones people reach for when another verb is missing a form.

English does it constantly and you have never thought about it:

- **go / went** — *went* was stolen outright from *wend*
- **am / is / be / was** — the same three-way patchwork as *être*
- **good / better** — *better* is not from *good* at all

So the answer to "why is *être* so irregular?" is now complete. It is irregular because it is old, common, and **assembled from three verbs**. There was never a pattern to find, and the time you might have spent hunting for one is better spent on the six forms themselves.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three stems — "es-, fu-, ét-"
- the word — "suppletion"
- the English case — "go, went; and went was taken from wend"
- the conclusion — "no pattern, because it is three verbs"

Before you move on

Name *être*'s three stems and what each covers. (**es-** present and infinitive, **fu-** the *passé simple*, **ét-** participles and imperfect.) What is the name for a paradigm filled in from another verb? (**Suppletion**.) Give an English example. (***go/went***, or *am/be/was*, or *good/better*.) Which verbs does it happen to? (The **most used ones** — only they are common enough to survive it.) Next: what Spanish did with the same two verbs.

19.11 être / ser · estar — the same two verbs, twice

Stāre should have rung a bell. If you have ever looked at Spanish, you have met it wearing its own name.

Why it's said this way

Spanish has **two** verbs for "to be," and choosing between them is famously the hardest thing about beginner Spanish:

- **ser** ← *esse*
- **estar** ← *stāre*

Those are the **same two Latin verbs** French has. French did not get a different inheritance; it made a different decision with the same one.

- **Spanish** kept them **apart** as two verbs, and made every speaker choose between them for the rest of their life.
- **French** kept **one** verb, *être* ← *esse*, and quietly **swallowed** a large limb of *stāre* — the *ét-* forms — into it.

Neither language invented anything. They took the same two words and resolved the overlap in opposite directions, and the result is that a French speaker never thinks about *stāre* while a Spanish speaker thinks about it every day.
This is worth carrying beyond this chapter, because it is the general shape of how related languages differ. They rarely differ because one has something the other lacks. They differ because both inherited the same crowded set of options and **tidied it up differently**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the Spanish pair — "ser, estar"
- their sources — "ser from esse, estar from stāre"
- the French answer — "one verb, être, which absorbed the ét- limb"
- the finding — "same two words, opposite solutions"

Before you move on

Which two Latin verbs lie behind Spanish *ser* and *estar*? (***esse*** and ***stāre***.) Are they the same two behind French *être*? (**Yes** — the identical inheritance.) What did each language do? (**Spanish kept them apart** as two verbs; **French kept one** and absorbed *stāre*'s *ét-* forms.) Why do related languages usually differ? (They inherited the **same options** and tidied them differently.) Next: all six forms, together.

19.12 Practice — the whole of être

Six forms and three ancestors. Run the forms first; the history is what makes them stay.

Your turn: the six

Say these aloud:

- "je suis, tu es, il est, nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont"
- backwards — "ils sont, vous êtes, nous sommes, il est, tu es, je suis"
- two sentences — "Je suis français", "Je suis fatigué"

Twice through: "je suis, tu es, il est, nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont"

Your turn: the two verbs side by side

Say these aloud:

- the buzz and the hiss — "ils ont, ils sont"
- the vowel pair — "tu as, tu es"
- both verbs from the top — "j'ai … je suis"

Your turn: the three stems

Say these aloud:

- "es- from esse: the present and the infinitive"

- "fu- from fuī: the passé simple, and English *be*"
- "ét- from stāre: to stand"
- the name — "suppletion"; and "go, went"

What you've built this chapter

- **the second verb the language rests on**, six forms, one lesson each.
- **an explanation instead of a pattern.** There is no pattern in *être* because it is **three verbs**: *esse*, *fuī* and *stāre*, patched into one paradigm.
- **a word for that** — **suppletion** — and the knowledge that English does exactly the same with *go/went* and *am/be/was*.
- **a comparison that generalises.** Spanish kept *ser* and *estar* apart; French kept one verb and absorbed the other's limb. Related languages usually differ not by what they inherited but by **how they tidied it**.

Before you move on

Give all six forms of *être*. How do you hear *ils sont* against *ils ont*? (**Hiss** against **buzz**.) Name the three stems and their sources. (**es-** ← *esse*, **fu-** ← *fuī*, **ét-** ← *stāre*.) What is the process called? (**Suppletion**.) Which Spanish verb is *stāre*? (***estar***.)

Chapter 20

The Past That Takes être

Modes: **voice** (10) **Hands-free start:** all 10 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can choose between avoir and être in the past, and say what the participle agrees with and why.
>
> *A short closed list of verbs refuses avoir and takes être, and it is easier as a shape than a list: arriving and leaving, in space or in life. Two corrections come with it — motion verbs like running take avoir, because motion is not transition, and five verbs switch to avoir the moment they take an object, which shows the rule is about the sentence rather than the verb. Then the agreement, which is audible for once: elle est morte. And underneath avoir's rule, être's rule and the pronominal rule sits one fact — the participle was an adjective, and it agrees with whatever it described.*

20.1 je suis allé — the past built from "be"

You built a past tense out of *avoir*. Now meet the verbs that will not have it.

Grammar Lens: some verbs take être instead

The recipe is the same shape as before, with the other verb in front:

être (conjugated) + **past participle**

aller, "to go," is the headline case. Its past is **not** *j'ai allé*. It is:

- **je suis allé** — I went
- **tu es allé** — you went

- **il est allé** — he went
- **nous sommes allés** — we went
- **ils sont allés** — they went

Say *j'ai allé* to a French speaker and it will land as clearly wrong, the way *I have went* lands in English.
So you now have two past tenses that are really one tense with two auxiliaries, and the only question a verb ever raises is: **which one?** For the vast majority it is *avoir*, and this chapter is about the short list that says otherwise — what is on it, what is deceptively not on it, and the visible thing that happens to the participle when *être* is used.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je suis allé, tu es allé, il est allé"
- the contrast — "j'ai parlé … je suis allé"
- the error, so you can hear it — "j'ai allé is wrong, like *I have went*"

Twice through: "j'ai parlé … je suis allé"

Before you move on

How do you say "I went"? (**Je suis allé**.) Which auxiliary does *aller* take? (***être***.) What is wrong with *j'ai allé*? (**The wrong auxiliary** — it sounds like *I have went*.) Which auxiliary do most French verbs take? (***avoir***.) Next: which verbs are on the short list.

20.2 aller · venir · naître · mourir — the shape of the list

Textbooks give this as a list to memorise, usually a dozen verbs long. It is much easier to hold as a shape.

Grammar Lens: arriving and leaving

The verbs that take *être* are these: *aller* (go), *venir* (come), *partir* (leave), *arriver* (arrive), *entrer*, *sortir*, *monter*, *descendre*, *naître* (be born), *mourir* (die), *rester* (stay), *tomber* (fall).
Read them as a **shape** and the list stops needing memorising:

> **going, coming, being born, dying** — arriving and leaving, in space or in life.

Every one of them is about **crossing a threshold**. Entering or leaving a place; entering or leaving the world; going up, going down, falling, staying put at the end of a movement. They are not verbs about **doing** something. They are verbs about **ending up somewhere**. Hold on to that phrasing, because it is what makes the next two lessons make sense. It is also why the participle behaves the way it does: if the verb describes where you **ended up**, the participle is describing **you** — and you will see it agree with you accordingly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four corners — "going, coming, born, dying"
- the shape — "arriving and leaving, in space or in life"
- the test — "not doing something; ending up somewhere"
- "je suis allé, je suis venu, je suis resté"

Before you move on

Give the shape of the *être* list in one line. (**Arriving and leaving, in space or in life** — going, coming, being born, dying.) What do all these verbs have in common? (They cross a **threshold** — they are about **ending up somewhere**, not about doing something.) Name three. (*aller*, *venir*, *partir*, *naître*, *mourir*, *rester*, *tomber* — any three.) Next: the verbs that look like they belong and do not.

20.3 j'ai couru — not every motion verb qualifies

"Verbs of motion take *être*" is the rule most learners are given, and it will mislead you within a week.

Grammar Lens: moving is not arriving

These are all motion verbs, and every one of them takes **avoir**:

- *j'ai marché* — I walked
- *j'ai couru* — I ran
- *j'ai nagé*, *j'ai dansé*, *j'ai voyagé* — I swam, danced, travelled

You can run for an hour and arrive nowhere. That is the whole distinction. The *être* verbs are not about **movement**; they are about **arriving, leaving and changing state** — crossing a threshold, as the last lesson put it.
J'ai couru describes what your legs did. *Je suis parti* describes that you are no longer here. The first is an activity; the second is a change in where you are, and it is the change that takes *être*.
So correct the rule in your head now, before it costs you anything: **not motion — transition.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the avoir ones — "j'ai marché, j'ai couru, j'ai dansé"
- against the être ones — "je suis parti, je suis arrivé"
- the corrected rule — "not motion, transition"
- the test — "you can run for an hour and arrive nowhere"

Before you move on

Which auxiliary does "to run" take? (***avoir*** — *j'ai couru*.) But is it not a motion verb? (**Yes** — which is why "motion verbs take *être*" is the **wrong rule**.) State the right one. (**Transition, not motion** — arriving, leaving, changing state.) Next: the verbs that use both.

20.4 je suis monté / j'ai monté les valises

A handful of verbs sit on both sides of the line, and which side they are on depends on the sentence rather than the verb.

Grammar Lens: an object flips the auxiliary

monter, **descendre**, **sortir**, **rentrer** and **passer** take *être* when they stand alone, and *avoir* the moment they take a **direct object**:

> **Je suis monté.** — "I went up." No object; *être*.
>
> **J'ai monté les valises.** — "I took the suitcases up." An object; *avoir*.

This looks like an extra rule to memorise. It is the opposite: it is the rule you already have, doing exactly what it said it would.
Je suis monté describes **where I ended up** — a transition, so *être*.
J'ai monté les valises describes **something I did to the suitcases** — an action on an object, so *avoir*. The verb has not changed its meaning much; what has changed is whether the sentence is about a transition or about an action, and that is the only thing the auxiliary has ever cared about.
So these verbs are not exceptions. They are the clearest demonstration that the rule is about the **sentence**, not the verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "Je suis monté … J'ai monté les valises"
- the same for going out — "Je suis sorti … J'ai sorti le vin"
- the reason — "transition takes être; an action on an object takes avoir"
- the conclusion — "what decides it is the sentence, not the verb"

Before you move on

Which auxiliary in *je suis monté*? (***être*** — no object, a transition.) And in *j'ai monté les valises*? (***avoir*** — a **direct object**.) Is this a new rule? (**No** — it is the same rule: transition takes *être*, an action on an object takes *avoir*.) Next: what happens to the participle.

20.5 elle est allée — the participle agrees

With *avoir*, the participle almost never moved. With *être* it moves every time, and this is the one agreement in French you can actually hear.

Grammar Lens: it agrees with the subject

French	English
Il est **allé**.	He went.
Elle est **allée**.	She went.
Ils sont **allés**.	They went.
Elles sont **allées**.	They (f.) went.

The participle takes the **subject's** gender and number — exactly like an adjective.

And the reason is the same fossil you already met. *Elle est allée* began as a plain description: "**she is gone**," with *gone* describing **her**, in the same way *elle est fatiguée* describes her. It was never an action she performed on something. It was a **state she was in** — which is precisely the shape of every verb on this list. So the participle agreed with her, and it still does.

One practical note. With *aller* you cannot hear the difference: *allé* and *allée* are identical aloud. But some of these verbs end in a consonant, and then you can — *il est mort* against *elle est morte*, where the **t** wakes up. That makes this the rare French agreement rule that is not purely a spelling problem.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four — "il est allé, elle est allée, ils sont allés, elles sont allées"

- one you can hear — "il est mort, elle est morte"
- the reason — "she is gone: gone describes her"
- the parallel — "elle est fatiguée, elle est allée"

Before you move on

With *être*, what does the participle agree with? (The **subject**.) Say "she went." (**Elle est allée**.) Why does it agree? (It began as a **description of her** — "she is gone" — so it behaved like an **adjective**.) Which example lets you **hear** the agreement? (***il est mort*** against ***elle est morte***.) Next: the one rule under both auxiliaries.

20.6 une seule règle — both halves are the same fact

You now have two agreement rules that look unrelated. They are one rule, and seeing that is worth more than either of them.

Grammar Lens: the participle agrees with whatever it described

auxiliary	**the participle agrees with**	**because it was...**
avoir	a **preceding object** — *les lettres que j'ai écrites*	"I have letters, **written**"
être	the **subject** — *elle est allée*	"she is **gone**"

Two rules, two different targets — and one explanation covering both. The participle **was an adjective**, and an adjective agrees with the thing it describes. That is all either rule says.

- With *avoir*, the thing described was the **object you possessed**: the letters are the written ones. So the participle agrees with the object — and only when the object comes first, because that is where an adjective could still reach it.
- With *être*, the thing described was the **subject**: she is the gone

one. So the participle agrees with her.

Both are the same sentence-shape from Latin, one built on *habēre* and one built on *esse*, and in both the participle is doing an adjective's job. French textbooks teach these as two chapters and a long list of exceptions. They are one idea with a two-thousand-year memory, and once you have the idea most of those exceptions write themselves.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the avoir case — "les lettres que j'ai écrites"
- the être case — "elle est allée"
- the single rule — "the participle agrees with whatever it described"
- the two old sentences — "I have letters written … she is gone"

Before you move on

With *avoir*, what does the participle agree with? (A **preceding object**.) With *être*? (The **subject**.) State the one rule underneath both. (The participle **was an adjective** and agrees with **whatever it described**.) Why does the *avoir* rule need the object to come first? (Because that is where an **adjective could still reach it**.) Next: the verbs that take *être* and ignore its rule.

20.7 je me suis levé — the pronominal family

The *être* list was short and closed. Here is one more family that takes *être*, and it has no end to it.

Grammar Lens: all of them, without exception

A **pronominal** verb is one carrying the little reflexive pronoun you met when you learned to give your name — the *me* of *je m'appelle*, the *se* of *s'appeler*.
Every one of them takes *être* in the past. No list, no shape to memorise, no exceptions:

je me suis levé — I got up

elle s'est lavée — she washed

Notice the word order: the reflexive pronoun comes **before** the auxiliary, not after it. *Je **me** suis levé*, not *je suis me levé*.
That gives you two ways into *être*, and they work differently. The verbs from the earlier list are a **closed set** you can hold as a shape. The pronominals are an **open class** identified by their form — if it has a *me*, *te* or *se*, it takes *être*, and you never have to ask.
But be careful with what comes next. They take *être*, and they do **not** follow *être*'s agreement rule.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je me suis levé"
- "elle s'est lavée"
- the word order — "je *me* suis levé"; the pronoun comes first
- the rule — "if it has me, te or se, it takes être"

Before you move on

Which auxiliary do pronominal verbs take? (***être*** — **all** of them.) How do you recognise one? (It carries **me, te** or **se**.) Where does that pronoun sit? (**Before the auxiliary** — *je me suis levé*.) Is this a closed list like the earlier one? (**No** — it is an **open class**.) Next: the trap in their agreement.

20.8 elle s'est lavée — the auxiliary lies about the rule

Pronominal verbs take *être*. Now watch them ignore *être*'s agreement rule completely.

Grammar Lens: être on the outside, avoir underneath

They agree with a **preceding direct object** — which is *avoir*'s rule, not *être*'s. Usually that object **is** the reflexive pronoun, and sometimes it is not:

> **Elle s'est lavée.** — She washed **herself**. *se* is the direct object, and it comes first, so the participle agrees.
>
> **Elle s'est lavé les mains.** — She washed **her hands**. The object is *les mains*, and it **follows**, so there is no agreement.
>
> **Elles se sont parlé.** — They spoke **to each other**. *se* is **indirect** — you speak *to* someone — so there is no agreement.

Which is, satisfyingly, the rule you already had. Nothing new has been introduced: the participle agrees with a preceding **direct** object, exactly as it did in *les lettres que j'ai écrites*.
The lesson to take is about **appearances**. The auxiliary looks like *être* and the agreement behaves like *avoir*, and if you let the first tell you about the second you will get it wrong every time. The auxiliary is not what decides agreement; it never was. What decides it is what the participle is describing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- agreement — "Elle s'est lavée"
- no agreement, object after — "Elle s'est lavé les mains"
- no agreement, indirect — "Elles se sont parlé"
- the warning — "the auxiliary looks like être; the agreement is avoir's"

Before you move on

Which agreement rule do pronominal verbs follow? (***avoir*'s** — a **preceding direct object**.) Why does *elle s'est lavée* agree? (*se* is

the **direct object** and comes **first**.) Why does *elle s'est lavé les mains* not? (The object is *les mains* and it **follows**.) Why does *elles se sont parlé* not? (*se* is **indirect** — you speak *to* someone.) Next: the group that escapes even this.

20.9 elles se sont souvenues — the verbs with no other form

One small group escapes even the rule you just learned, and it escapes for a reason you can work out rather than memorise.

Grammar Lens: no object to be an object of

A few verbs exist **only** in pronominal form. There is no plain version of them at all:

- **se souvenir** — to remember
- **s'enfuir** — to flee
- **s'évanouir** — to faint

There is no *souvenir quelqu'un*, no *enfuir quelque chose*. The *se* is not doing a job you could describe as direct or indirect, because there is no non-reflexive verb for it to be the object **of**. It is simply part of the word.
So the previous lesson's test cannot be run on them, and they fall back to agreeing with the **subject**:

> **Elles se sont souvenues.** — They remembered.

Which is where this chapter's whole argument lands. The agreement is not decided by the auxiliary, and not by a list of verb types. It is decided by **what the participle is describing** — and when there is no object in the picture at all, the only thing left for it to describe is the subject.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three — "se souvenir, s'enfuir, s'évanouir"
- the example — "Elles se sont souvenues"
- the reason — "no plain verb, so the *se* is not an object of anything"
- the landing — "what is left for the participle to describe is the subject"

Before you move on

What is special about *se souvenir*? (It exists **only** in pronominal form — there is no plain *souvenir* verb.) So what does its participle agree with? (The **subject** — *elles se sont souvenues.*) Why can the direct-object test not be applied? (There is **no non-reflexive verb** for *se* to be the object of.) Next: all of it together.

20.10 Practice — which auxiliary, and what agrees

Two questions cover this whole chapter: which auxiliary, and what does the participle describe. Run both.

Your turn: which auxiliary

Say these aloud:

- the contrast — "j'ai parlé … je suis allé"
- the shape of the list — "arriving and leaving, in space or in life"
- the trap — "j'ai couru, j'ai marché"; motion is not transition
- the switch — "je suis monté … j'ai monté les valises"

Twice through: "je suis allé, je suis venu, je suis resté"

Your turn: what the participle agrees with

Say these aloud:

- the four — "il est allé, elle est allée, ils sont allés, elles sont allées"

- the audible one — “il est mort, elle est morte”
- the avoir side — “les lettres que j’ai écrites”
- the single rule — “it agrees with whatever it described”

Your turn: the pronominals

Say these aloud:

- “je me suis levé”
- the three cases — “elle s’est lavée; elle s’est lavé les mains; elles se sont parlé”
- the group with no plain form — “elles se sont souvenues”

What you’ve built this chapter

- **a second auxiliary**, and a short closed list that is easier as a shape than a list: **arriving and leaving, in space or in life**.
- **two corrections to the rule you would have been given.** *Motion* verbs do not take *être* — **transition** verbs do; and five verbs switch the moment they take an object, which shows that what decides the auxiliary is the **sentence**, not the verb.
- **an agreement you can hear** — *il est mort*, *elle est morte*.
- **one rule under everything**: the participle was an adjective, and it agrees with whatever it described. *Avoir*’s rule, *être*’s rule and the pronominal rule are that one fact seen from three angles.

Before you move on

Say “she went.” (**Elle est allée**.) Which auxiliary does “to run” take, and why? (***avoir*** — it is **motion**, not **transition**.) What flips *monter* to *avoir*? (A **direct object**.) Which agreement rule do pronominal verbs follow? (***avoir*’s** — a preceding **direct** object.) State the one rule under all of it. (The participle **agrees with whatever it described**.)

Chapter 21

Head and Hand

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the head and the hand in French with the right article, and point out the Latin manus hiding inside English manual, manufacture and maintain.
>
> *Say la main with its nasal -ain, then run the manus family out loud — manual, manuscript, maintenir — and land on manufacture, 'made by hand', now the name for the opposite.*

21.1 la tête — "the head"

The first body part, and one of the best etymologies in French. The word for *head* is not the Latin word for head.

You'll want to know: The word

la tête — the head. Feminine, so **la**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin's word for "head" was ***caput***. You can see it surviving all over Europe:

Portuguese	*cabeça*
Spanish	*cabeza*
Italian	*capo* (now "chief, boss")
English	**cap**tain, **cap**ital, de**cap**itate

French has *caput* too, and in two layers. **Inherited**, worn down by use: **chef** ("chief," originally "head"), **chapitre**, **cap** (a headland), **achever** ("to finish" — to bring to a head). **Re-borrowed** later, straight from written Latin: **capital**, **capitaine**, **décapiter**.
What French does *not* use it for is the thing on your shoulders. **Tête** comes from Latin ***testa***: an **earthenware pot**, a shell, a potsherd.

Why it's said this way

Soldiers' slang. Roman troops called the skull a *testa* the way English speakers say someone got hit on the **noggin** — a noggin being a small mug. It was a joke, it spread, and eventually the joke *replaced the real word* in Gaul and Italy.
So a French speaker saying *j'ai mal à la tête* is, historically, saying "my pot hurts."
Testa is still visible in English **test** — which began as the shallow pot an alchemist used to assay metals.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la tête"
- "j'ai mal à la tête" — "my head hurts"
- the joke — "*testa* = a **pot**"
- the receipt — "te**s**te → tê-te"

Before you move on

Say "the head." (*La tête* — feminine.) Does it come from Latin *caput*? (**No** — from ***testa***, an **earthenware pot**.) Why a pot?

(Roman soldiers' **slang** for the skull, which replaced the proper word.) Where did *caput* survive in French? (**Inherited** in *chef*, *chapitre*, *cap*, *achever*; **re-borrowed** in *capital*, *capitaine*, *décapiter* — just never for the head itself.) What does the circumflex on *tête* record? (**A lost *s*** — *teste*, still visible in English **test**.) Next: the hand.

21.2 (la tête, continued) — The circumflex is a receipt

Before going on: say **la tête** again, and what it means.

Sounds you'll need

Look at the accent: **tê**te. Chapter W01 taught what a circumflex records — a letter that used to be there, almost always an **s**.

testa → Old French **teste** → modern **tête**

The *s* stopped being pronounced, and the accent was put in to mark the grave. That is why English, which borrowed from Old French *before* the *s* fell, still has it in **test**.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **la tête**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **la tête**? Say it once more, without looking.

21.3 la main — "the hand"

Where *tête* abandoned its Latin ancestor, this one kept it — and then lent it to English several dozen times over.

Je suis monté, but *j'ai monté les valises*: a direct object flips the helper to *avoir*.

You'll want to know: The word

> **la main** — the hand. **Feminine**, and worth flagging: it ends in a consonant and still takes *la*. French gender is not predictable from the ending, which is why this book always gives you the article.

The *-ain* is the nasal vowel of *pain*, the bread — say them together: *pain*, *main*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Main comes from Latin ***manus***, "hand." That word is inside an enormous number of English words, and once you see it you cannot unsee it:

English	**literally**
manual	done by hand
manufacture	made by hand (*manus* + *facere* "to make")
manuscript	written by hand (*manus* + *scrībere*)
maintain	hold in the hand (*manū tenēre*)
manage	to handle — via Italian *maneggiare*, of horses
manoeuvre	work by hand (*manū operārī*)

Manufacture is the one worth pausing on. It means "made by hand" — and it now names precisely the thing that *isn't*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la main" — and hear *pain*, *main*
- "j'ai mal à la main"
- the family — "manual, manuscript, maintain — all a **hand**"
- the irony — "**manufacture** = made by hand"

Before you move on

Say "the hand." (*La main* — **feminine**, despite the consonant ending.) What Latin word is it from? (***Manus***.) Give three English words built on it. (*Manual*, *manufacture*, *manuscript*, *maintain*, *manage*, *manoeuvre*.) What does *manufacture* literally mean? ("**Made by hand**" — now the name for the opposite.) And *maintenir*? (*Manū tenēre*, "**hold in the hand**".) Next: the rest of the body.

21.4 (la main, continued) — French kept it too

Before going on: say **la main** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Maintenir / English **maintain** is Latin *manū tenēre*, "to hold in the hand" — a hand, plus the verb *tenēre*, "to hold."
So *maintenance* — the least romantic word in any office — is literally **keeping something in hand**.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **la main**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **la main**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 22

Yes and No

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer yes or no in French, send non through my nose as a nasal vowel, and recognise the ne … pas pair that carries negation inside a sentence.
>
> *The oui / non pair said back to back, non's -on nasal placed against bon and bonjour, and the ne … pas frame named as the sentence-level negation to come.*

22.1 oui — yes

Where Spanish kept Latin's word for yes, French built a brand-new one — and named half a country after it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oui = **yes**. Just two sounds, *wee*.
Its Romance cousins (Spanish *sí*, Italian *sì*) come from Latin *sīc* "thus." **French took a different road entirely.** *oui* comes from Old French **oïl**, and *oïl* is a squeezed-down Latin phrase:

hoc ille ("this [is] it") → *o-il* → **oui**

You answered "yes" by saying, in effect, "*that's the one.*"

Why it's said this way

This mattered so much it became a map. In the Middle Ages France was divided by how people said *yes*:

- the **north** said *oïl* → the **langue d'oïl** (which became modern French)
- the **south** said *oc* → the **langue d'oc** — still visible in the region name **Languedoc**, and in the language **Occitan**

One little answer-word, drawn as a border.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "oui" — *wee*
- the origin — "hoc ille → oïl → oui": *that's the one*
- the contradiction — "Tu ne viens pas ? — Si !"

Before you move on

How do you say yes in French? (**oui**.) What Latin phrase is it worn down from? (**hoc ille**, "this is it," via *oïl*.) What were the *langue d'oïl* and *langue d'oc* named after? (The two medieval words for **yes**.) When do you answer **si** instead of *oui*? (To **contradict a negative** — *Tu ne viens pas? — Si!*)

22.2 (oui, continued) — The other "yes," si

Before going on: say **oui** again, and what it means.

Grammar Lens: The other "yes," si

French keeps a **second** yes — **si** — for one special job: contradicting a **negative**. When someone says something *isn't* so and you insist it *is*, you answer **si**, not *oui*:

Tu ne viens pas ? ("You're not coming?") — ***Si !*** ("Yes I

am!")

(That *si* is the Latin *sīc* the Spanish *sí* also comes from — French kept it only for this contradicting move.)

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **oui**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **oui**? Say it once more, without looking.

22.3 non — no / not

After French's home-grown *oui*, its **no** is the family word, shared straight with Spanish — but said the French way, through the nose.

Every pronominal verb takes *être* in the past: *je me suis levé*, *elle s'est lavée*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

non = **no**. It comes from Latin **nōn**, the same source as Spanish *no* and Italian *no*:

Latin *nōn*	→
Spanish	no
Italian	no
French	**non**

Spanish dropped the *n* and left a clean *no*. French **kept** the *n* — but turned it into a **nasal vowel**: you don't quite touch your tongue to say the final *n*, you send the vowel through your nose. That's the sound written **-on** in *non*, *bon*, *bonjour* — you've met it before.

Grammar Lens: The seed of French negation

The word that actually carries negation inside a French sentence isn't *non* but its **unstressed twin, ne** — both worn down from the same Latin *nōn*. Modern French usually reinforces *ne* with a second word,

giving the pair *ne … pas*:

> *Je* ***ne*** *parle* ***pas*** *français* = "I do **not** speak French."

For now, **non** on its own is your answer-word. In *ne … pas*, the **ne** is *non*'s cousin from *nōn*; the **pas** was added later — it originally meant "a step" (Latin *passus*), as in "not walk a *step*" — and simply stuck. That fuller sentence negation is something you'll build later.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "non" — nasal, through the nose, like the *-on* in *bon*
- the pair with yes — "oui / non"
- the family — Latin *nōn* → Spanish *no*, French *non*

Before you move on

How do you say no in French? (**non**.) What Latin word is it from, and which Spanish word is its twin? (**nōn**; Spanish **no**.) What did French do to the *n* that Spanish dropped? (Kept it as a **nasal vowel** — the *-on* sound.) What pair does full French negation usually wrap around the verb? (***ne … pas***.)

Chapter 23

Please

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say please in French and choose between s'il vous plaît and s'il te plaît depending on who I am speaking to.
>
> *Say s'il vous plaît with its silent final -t, take it apart into 'if it pleases you', then switch to s'il te plaît for a friend. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

23.1 s'il vous plaît — please

French doesn't order you to do things — it asks, very politely, *if it would please you.*

Some verbs exist only with *se*: *se souvenir*, to remember. *Elles se sont souvenues.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'il vous plaît = please — but taken apart it's a tiny sentence:

> **s'** (*si*, "if") + **il** ("it") + **vous** ("you") + **plaît** ("pleases")
> → "**if it pleases you.**"

You're not demanding; you're checking whether the favour would please them. It's the polite indirectness Spanish also uses in *por favor* ("for a favour") — same courtesy, built a different way.
The verb **plaît** is from Latin **placēre**, "to please" — which English borrowed wholesale: **please**, **pleasure**, **pleasant**, and (via "calm,

pleasing") even **placid**.

Grammar Lens: Formal and familiar

French chooses the word for "you" by who you're talking to — and *please* comes in both:

- **s'il vous plaît** — *vous*, the **formal / plural** you (a stranger, an elder, a room). Often written **SVP**.
- **s'il te plaît** — *te*, the **familiar** you (a friend, a child).

Two sounds to respect: the final **-t** of *plaît* is **silent** (*pleh*), and *plaît* itself carries the *ai* = *eh* you've met.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "s'il vous plaît" — final t silent, *see voo pleh*
- taken apart — "if it pleases you"
- familiar — "s'il te plaît" to a friend

Before you move on

How do you say please in French? (**s'il vous plaît**.) What does it literally mean? ("**If it pleases you.**") Which Latin verb is *plaît* from, and what English words come from it? (**placēre** — *please, pleasure, placid.*) When do you say **s'il te plaît** instead? (To someone you address as **tu** — a friend or child.)

Chapter 24

Sorry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apologise in French and pick between je suis désolé(e), pardon and excusez-moi for the situation I am actually in.
>
> *Say je suis désolé(e) knowing it literally means 'I am desolate', then place pardon as the quick reflex and excusez-moi as the attention-getter. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

24.1 je suis désolé(e) — "I'm sorry" (literally "I am desolate")

You already know **s'il vous plaît**, "please" — "if it pleases you." French's "sorry" is, secretly, a much bigger word than it sounds: **désolé** is the same word as English **desolate**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- **je suis** = "**I am**."
- **désolé** (feminine **désolée**) = "**sorry**," but literally "**made utterly alone / devastated.**" It comes from Latin **dēsōlāre**, "to make solitary" — **dē-** ("thoroughly, completely") + **sōlus** ("alone"), the very root of English **sole**, **solo**, **solitary**, and **desolate** itself.

So **je suis désolé(e)** literally says "**I am desolate**" — French reaches

for a word of real devastation to say a plain "sorry," the way English keeps "terribly sorry" as an option rather than a requirement.

Why it's said this way

French keeps two more courtesy words for different jobs:

- **pardon** — a quick, all-purpose "sorry / pardon me" (bumping someone, a small slip). It comes from **pardonner**, Latin **per-** ("thoroughly") + **dōnāre** ("to give") — "to give completely," i.e. to forgive. The neat part isn't that French and Spanish coined this separately — it's that they **didn't have to**: **perdōnāre** was already one word in Late Latin, so French *pardonner* and Spanish *perdón/perdonar* are simply two children of the *same* inherited word, not two languages independently landing on the same idea.
- **excusez-moi** — "**excuse me**," from **excuser** < Latin **ex-** ("out of, free from") + **causa** ("cause, charge") — literally "to free from a charge." Reach for this to get someone's **attention**, not to apologize for a real fault.

Je suis désolé(e) carries the most **regret**; **pardon** is the quick, light reflex; **excusez-moi** is for getting attention. Native speakers slide between all three by feel.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "désolé" — sorry / desolate — then "je suis désolé," I am sorry
- the quick one — "pardon"
- the attention one — "excusez-moi"

Before you move on

What does **désolé** literally mean, and what English word is it identical to? (**"Made utterly alone"** — the same word as English **desolate**.) What is **pardon** built from, and why does **Spanish perdón** look just like it? (**Per- "thoroughly" + dōnāre "to give"** — both simply inherited the *same* already-formed Latin

word, **perdōnāre**.) What's **excusez-moi** for? (**Getting someone's attention**, not apologizing for a real fault.)

Chapter 25

Weather

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the weather in French — quel temps fait-il, il fait chaud, il fait froid, il pleut.
>
> *Use le temps in both its senses, build the weather with faire (il fait chaud / il fait froid), and say il pleut with the Latin pl- cluster French kept intact. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

25.1 le temps, il pleut — the same Latin word, a different fate for "rain"

> You've seen Spanish's *tiempo* mean both "time" and "weather" at once, from Latin *tempus*. French has the exact same word, the exact same double meaning — because this widening happened within Latin itself, before French and Spanish went their separate ways.

The two words: le temps — time and weather

le temps = both "**time**" and "**weather**" — from Latin **tempus**, same as Spanish's *tiempo* (English kept only the "time" half: **temporal, tempo**). So **quel temps fait-il ?** ("what's the weather like?") is literally "**what time does it make**?" — the identical construction inside Spanish's *¿qué tiempo hace?*.

Grammar Lens: il fait chaud / il fait froid

Il fait chaud. — "It's hot." — literally "it **makes** hot." **Il fait froid.** — "It's cold." — literally "it **makes** cold."

Same *hacer*-style periphrasis as Spanish, just with French's own **faire** ("to make/do").

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le temps" — time, or weather, depending on context
- "il fait chaud. il fait froid." — it's hot/cold
- "il pleut" — it's raining, pl- kept intact from Latin

Before you move on

What two things does **le temps** mean, and where does this polysemy come from? (**"Time"** and **"weather"** — from Latin *tempus*, already double-sensed before French/Spanish split apart.) Does French's *il pleut* show the same *pl-* → *ll-* shift as Spanish's *llueve*? (**No** — French kept the *pl-* cluster intact; only Spanish underwent that shift.)

25.2 (le temps, il pleut, continued) — il pleut

Before going on: say **le temps, il pleut** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Il pleut. — "It's raining." — from **pleuvoir** ← Latin **pluere**, "to rain" — the **same** Latin verb behind Spanish's *llueve*. But here's the honest difference: Spanish underwent the **pl-** → **ll-** shift (*pluere* → *llover*), while French kept the **pl-** cluster fully intact — *pleuvoir* still visibly starts with *pl-*, just like the Latin original. So the same Latin verb took two different sound-change paths in its two daughters:

one eroded the cluster, one preserved it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **le temps, il pleut**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **le temps, il pleut**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 26

Dog and Cat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a dog and a cat in French and say why chien is the regular descendant of canis while chat is a word that travelled out of Egypt.
>
> *Say chien and check its ca- → cha- shift against champ and chanter, then say chat and place it beside Spanish gato and Italian gatto as one inherited cattus. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

26.1 chien, chat — the regular one, and the well-traveled one

You've met Spanish's *perro*, a genuine unsolved mystery, and Latin's own *canis*/*fēlēs*→*cattus* history. French's two animal words tell a cleaner story: one is perfectly regular, the other is the same well- documented word you already know.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chien ("**dog**") comes straight from Latin **canis** (accusative *canem*) — and unlike Spanish, French kept it. Two separate, regular changes are stacked here: the initial **c→ch** is the same **ca- → cha-** palatalization you can check against other Latin words — **campus → champ** ("field"), **cantāre → chanter** ("to sing"); the **a→ie** in the middle is a different, later shift specific to words like *canem* (known as Bartsch's Law — the outcome is completely regular and undisputed, even though

the precise phonetic trigger is still debated). Put together, *chien* is a fully **regular** sound change, following French's own rules predictably — a genuinely different story from Spanish, where the expected descendant (*can*) got pushed aside by the still-unexplained *perro*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "chien" — dog, the regular descendant of canis
- "champ, chanter" — the same ca- → cha- shift, in field and to sing
- "chat" — cat, the same word as Spanish's gato, from Egypt via Rome

Before you move on

Is *chien* a regular or irregular descendant of Latin *canis*? (**Regular** — the same *ca-* → *cha-* shift as *champ* and *chanter*.) Does French show the same *perro*-style mystery Spanish does for "dog"? (**No** — French kept the expected Latin word.) What word does *chat* continue, and where did that word most likely originate? (**Cattus**, most likely **Afro-Asiatic**, traveling with the cat out of **Egypt**.)

26.2 (chien, chat, continued) — chat

Before going on: say **chien, chat** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chat ("**cat**") continues **cattus**, the same Late Latin word — most likely ultimately **Afro-Asiatic** (compare Nubian *kadis*) — that spread along Roman trade routes as domestic cats themselves spread out of **Egypt**. This is the identical word behind Spanish's *gato* and Italian's *gatto* — French, Spanish, and Italian all independently inherited the exact same Late Latin replacement for Classical *fēlēs*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **chien, chat**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **chien, chat**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 27

Green and Yellow

Modes: **voice** (2) **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name green and yellow in French, and say how solid the claimed link between jaune and German gelb actually is.
>
> *Say vert as the ordinary Romance inheritance from viridis, say jaune as galbinus 'yellow-green', and state the jaune / gelb cousinhood as probable rather than certain. The chapter's only lesson, so the payoff covers everything it introduces.*

27.1 vert, jaune — the expected inheritance, and a hidden PIE-level cousin

French's green word is exactly what you'd expect. Its yellow word hides something you won't expect at all — a secret cousin sitting inside German.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vert ("**green**") ← Latin **viridis** — and this is genuinely the **standard** source of "green" across nearly every Romance language: Spanish *verde*, Italian *verde*, Portuguese *verde*, Catalan *verd*. No surprise here — a clean, shared inheritance.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vert" — green, the standard Romance word
- "jaune" — yellow, literally "yellow-green"
- the probable cousin — "jaune, gelb" — likely the same ancient PIE root, two completely different paths, though the link isn't airtight

Before you move on

Is **vert** a typical or unusual Romance word for "green"? (**Typical** — the standard source across nearly all Romance languages.) What did Latin **galbinus**, the source of *jaune*, literally mean? ("**Yellow-green**.") What German word is usually called *jaune*'s deep PIE cousin, and how solid is that link? (**Gelb** — both usually traced to PIE **ghel-*, "to shine," though modern Latin scholarship treats *galbus*'s origin as genuinely unknown, so the connection is probable, not certain.)

27.2 (vert, jaune, continued) — jaune

Before going on: say **vert, jaune** again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jaune ("**yellow**") ← Latin **galbinus**, which literally meant "**yellow-green**" — an extended form of **galbus**, from **Proto-Indo-European **ghel-***, "**to shine**" (with derivatives covering green, yellow, and gold alike — the same root gives Greek *khlōros*, "greenish-yellow"). Here's the genuinely surprising part: this **same PIE root**, ****ghel-***, is also usually cited as the source of **German**'s **gelb** and English's **yellow** — by a completely separate, Germanic path (Proto-Germanic ****gelwaz***). Honesty check, though: the *galbus*→**ghel-* link itself is **less secure** than it looks — some modern Latin scholarship treats *galbus*'s origin as unknown rather than confirming the connection. So *jaune* and *gelb* are **probably** cousins at the Proto-Indo-European level, despite one reaching French through Latin and the other reaching German directly through Germanic — just don't treat that link as airtight.

Your turn

- *Say it:* what this lesson added to **vert, jaune**, in one sentence

Before you move on

What did this lesson add to **vert, jaune**? Say it once more, without looking.

Chapter 28

Taking, Asking, Helping, Loving

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that I take, ask, help and like or love in French, break prendre's stem the way its plural requires, and know that je t'aime bien is weaker than je t'aime rather than stronger.
>
> *Run the chapter's four verbs together with je — je prends, je demande, j'aide, j'aime — then turn aimer over: one verb covers like and love, the thing named decides which, and adding bien downgrades it. Reaches back past the chapter to re-say le chien and le chat from Chapter 22, le vert from Chapter 23, and the s'il vous plaît request from Chapter 19.*

28.1 prendre — "to take," the verb your hand does

You already have **la main**, the hand. Here is the verb that hand performs — and it turns out to be hiding inside a surprising number of English words you use without thinking.

You'll want to know: the word

prendre — to take. Said *PRAHN-druh*: the *-en-* is the **nasal** vowel of *an*, sent through the nose, not a clean *en*.

Je prends le pain. — I take the bread.

The *-ds* of *je prends* is **silent**. You say *prahn*, and stop.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prendre ← Latin **prehendere**, "to grasp, to seize," which Romans themselves shortened to **prendere**. That short form is the one French inherited — and English borrowed the family repeatedly:

- **prehensile** — a tail that grasps.
- **apprehend** — to seize (*ad-* "toward" + grasp); **reprehensible**, something to be seized back on.
- **prison** ← Latin *prehensiō*, "**a seizing**" — a jail is, literally, a taking-hold.
- **surprise** — French *sur-* "over" + *prendre*: an **over-taking**.
- **enterprise**, something undertaken; **apprentice**, one who takes on.
- **impregnable** — from Old French *imprenable*, "**not takeable**." Nothing to do with pregnancy.

Manus gave you a hand that **holds** — *manual*, *maintain*. *Prendere* gives you the hand that **closes**.

Grammar Lens: the stem that doubles

Prendre is irregular, and its irregularity is one clean rule: the stem **loses** its *d*, and in the *ils* form it **doubles its n**. Say the six:

- **je prends** — *prahn*
- **tu prends** — *prahn*
- **il prend** — *prahn* (all three identical to the ear)
- **nous prenons** — *pruh-NOHN*, and the nasal is **gone**
- **vous prenez** — *pruh-NAY*, nasal gone again
- **ils prennent** — *PREN*, a doubled *n* and a flat *e*

So the nasal survives in the singular and dies in the plural. That is the whole verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "prendre" — *PRAHN-druh*, nasal in the middle
- "je prends le pain" then "nous prenons le pain" — nasal, then no nasal
- "je prends la main" — I take the hand, the *manus* you already have
- the family — "prehensile, apprehend, prison, surprise" — all a **grasp**

Before you move on

Say "I take the bread." (*Je prends le pain* — and the *-ds* is silent.) What happens to the nasal in *nous prenons*? (It **disappears**; the stem flattens to *pruh-*.) What did Latin *prehendere* mean, and what is a *prison* literally? (**To grasp**; a prison is "**a seizing**".) And the hand that does the taking? (*La main.*)

28.2 demander — "to ask," and the trap it sets in English

Prendre was taking. This one is the opposite move: putting a question out. And it is the word most likely to make you sound furious when you meant to sound polite.

You'll want to know: the word

demander — to ask. Said *duh-mahn-DAY*: the *-an-* is that same nasal from *prendre*, and the *-er* ending is a clean *ay*.

Je demande l'heure. — I ask the time.

It is an ordinary **-er** verb, so nothing in it breaks: *je demande, tu demandes, il demande, nous demandons, vous demandez, ils demandent.* Only *nous* and *vous* are audible; the other four all sound *duh-MAHND.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

demander ← Latin **dēmandāre**, "to hand over, to entrust" — *dē-* plus **mandāre**. And *mandāre* is itself two words: ***manus***, "**hand**," plus ***dare***, "**to give**." Giving into the hand.
So the *manus* you met in *la main* is sitting inside this verb too:

- **mandate** — what was placed in someone's hands to carry out.
- **command** — *com-* + *mandāre*: to entrust an order; and **commandment**, ten of them.
- **mandatory** — handed over as an obligation; **remand**, handed back.

One family, two very different jobs: *manual* is work done **by** the hand, *mandate* is a charge given **into** it.

Why it's said this way

> **Careful.** French **demander** means simply "**to ask**." It is neutral, everyday and perfectly polite. English **demand** is forceful — a thing you insist on.

Je demande l'heure is "I'm asking the time," not "I demand the time." The English word drifted toward force; the French one never did. Translate *demander* as **ask**, every time, and you will never be rude by accident.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "demander" — *duh-mahn-DAY*, nasal in the middle
- "je demande l'heure" — I **ask** the time, not demand it
- "je prends, je demande" — take, then ask
- the family — "mandate, command, mandatory" — a **hand** and a **giving**

Before you move on

Say "I ask the time." (*Je demande l'heure.*) Does *demander* carry the force of English *demand*? (**No** — it is the ordinary, polite word for asking.) What two Latin words are inside *mandāre*, and which one do you already know? (***Manus*** "hand" — the source of *la main* — plus ***dare***, "to give.")

28.3 aider — "to help," and the English word that is really the same word

You can ask for something now. This is the verb for what you hope the other person then does — and it is one of the rare cases where the English cousin is not a distant relative but the very same word, spelled shorter.

You'll want to know: the word

aider — to help. Said *ay-DAY*: the *ai-* is a plain *ay*, the *-er* ending is another *ay*. Two of them in a row.

Vous m'aidez. — You are helping me.

Another ordinary **-er** verb: *j'aide, tu aides, il aide, nous aidons, vous aidez, ils aident*. The *j'* is the elision you already make in *j'ai*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aider ← Latin **adiūtāre**, a repeated-action form of **adiuvāre** — *ad-* "toward" plus **iuvāre**, "**to help**." English took the same verb through French and clipped it:

- **aid** — the noun and verb; **aide**, a person who is your help.
- **aide-de-camp** — literally a "camp helper," an officer's assistant.
- **adjutant**, the officer who assists; **adjuvant**, a substance in medicine that helps another one work.

Two honesty notes. English **help** is **Germanic** and has no connection to *aider* whatsoever. And **juvenile** is *not* in this family: that is Latin *iuvenis*, "young," a different word that merely resembles *iuvāre*.

Grammar Lens: asking for it politely

Put the verb together with the courtesy you already have:

> **Vous m'aidez, s'il vous plaît.** — Help me, please. **Tu m'aides, s'il te plaît.** — the same request, to a friend.

The register has to match on **both** halves. *Vous* takes *s'il vous plaît*; *tu* takes *s'il te plaît*. Mixing them — *tu m'aides, s'il vous plaît* — is the mistake a beginner makes most, and a French ear catches it instantly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "aider" — *ay-DAY*, two *ay* sounds
- "j'aide" then "vous aidez"
- "vous m'aidez, s'il vous plaît" — both halves formal
- "tu m'aides, s'il te plaît" — both halves familiar
- "je demande, vous aidez" — I ask, you help

Before you move on

Ask a stranger for help, politely. (*Vous m'aidez, s'il vous plaît.*) And a friend? (*Tu m'aides, s'il te plaît* — both halves change together.) What Latin verb is *aider* from, and which English word is the same word? (**Adiūtāre**; English **aid**.) Is English *help* related? (**No** — it is Germanic, unrelated.)

28.4 aimer — one verb for "like" and "love," and the word that weakens it

Three verbs so far: *je prends*, *je demande*, *j'aide*. The fourth does a job English needs **two** words for — and the way you soften it is the opposite of what you would guess.

You'll want to know: the word

aimer — to like **and** to love. Said *ay-MAY*: the *ai-* is *ay*, the *-mer* is *may*.

J'aime le chien. — I like the dog. **J'aime le chat.** — I like the cat.

An ordinary **-er** verb: *j'aime, tu aimes, il aime, nous aimons, vous aimez, ils aiment*. French does not choose between "like" and "love" — the **thing you name** does. A dog, a colour, a food: that reads as *like*. A person: *love*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aimer ← Latin **amāre**, "to love," and English is full of it:

- **amateur** — one who does a thing **for love**, not for money.
- **amorous**, full of love; **enamoured**, in it; **paramour**, beside it.
- **amiable** and **amicable** — from *amīcus*, "friend"; **amity** between nations.

An honest stop, though: unlike *viridis* behind **vert**, *amāre* has **no agreed ancestor** beyond Latin. It is often guessed to be a nursery word, a baby's *amma*, but that is a guess. The trail genuinely ends at Latin.

Why it's said this way

Je t'aime. — I love you. Full strength. **Je t'aime bien.** — I like you. **Much** weaker.

Every English speaker gets this backwards. *Bien* means "well," so *je t'aime bien* looks like it ought to be **more**. It is **less**. Adding *bien* downgrades love to friendly liking, which is exactly why *je t'aime bien* is the polite way to turn someone down.
With a thing, no such danger: *j'aime bien le chat* is simply "I quite like the cat." The trap only bites when the object is a **person**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "j'aime le chien" then "j'aime le chat" — liking, because they are animals
- "j'aime le vert" — I like green
- "je t'aime" then "je t'aime bien" — love, then only liking
- the four verbs — "je prends, je demande, j'aide, j'aime"
- "vous m'aidez, s'il vous plaît" — the request, once more
- "aimer, amateur, amiable" — the *amāre* family, which stops at Latin

Before you move on

Which is stronger, *je t'aime* or *je t'aime bien*? (***Je t'aime*** — *bien* makes it **weaker**.) Say "I like the dog" and "I like green." (*J'aime le chien. J'aime le vert.*) What does *amateur* literally mean, and how far back does *amāre* go? (One who does it **for love**; the trail **stops at Latin**.) Say the chapter's four verbs with *je*. (*Je prends, je demande, j'aide, j'aime.*)

Chapter 29

Verbs of the Mind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I understand, think, read and write in French, and take comprendre apart into com- plus prendre — so understanding, in French, is grasping.
>
> *Say the chapter's four with je — je comprends, je pense, je lis, j'écris — and take écrire apart into scrībere 'to scratch' plus the propped-up é- that also made école and étoile. Reaches back past the chapter to la main and manus from Chapter 17, which meet écrire inside the single word manuscript, and to prendre and aimer from Chapter 24.*

29.1 comprendre — "to understand," which is just taking, together

This is the cheapest verb you will ever learn, because you already own all of it. *Prendre* was "to take." Put *com-* in front, and French tells you what it thinks understanding actually is.

You'll want to know: the word

comprendre — to understand. Said *kohn-PRAHN-druh*: two nasals in a row, *kohn* then *prahn*.

Je comprends. — I understand. **Vous comprenez ?** — Do you understand?

The *-ds* of *je comprends* is silent, exactly as in *je prends*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comprendre is **com-** ("together, with") + **prendre** ("to take"), and Latin had already built it: **comprehendere**, "to grasp several things at once." Nothing has been added since. To understand, in French, is to **get your hand around the whole of it**.
English took the long Latin form and the short French one both:

- **comprehend** — the full Latin spelling, straight through.
- **comprehensive** — having taken everything in; **comprehension**.
- **comprise** — from French *compris*, "taken together": what a thing takes in.

And you can hear the metaphor still alive in English: we say we **grasp** an idea, or that a point is **over our heads** — out of reach of the hand.

Grammar Lens: the same verb, so the same forms

Because *comprendre* **is** *prendre* with a prefix, it breaks in exactly the same places. Nothing new to memorise — say the six and hear the nasal die in the plural, just as before:

- **je comprends** — *kohn-PRAHN*
- **tu comprends** — *kohn-PRAHN*
- **il comprend** — *kohn-PRAHN* (three identical to the ear)
- **nous comprenons** — *kohn-pruh-NOHN*, nasal gone from the stem
- **vous comprenez** — *kohn-pruh-NAY*
- **ils comprennent** — *kohn-PREN*, the doubled *n* again

This is worth more than one verb. Every French verb built on *prendre* behaves this way, so the pattern you drilled once now pays out repeatedly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "je prends" then "je comprends" — the second is the first, plus *com-*
- "nous prenons, nous comprenons" — both lose the nasal
- "vous comprenez ?" then answer "oui" and then "non"
- "comprendre, comprehend, comprise" — one family, two spellings

Before you move on

What two pieces is *comprendre* made of, and what does the whole literally mean? (*Com-* "together" + *prendre* "to take" — **to take together**.) Say "we understand." (*Nous comprenons* — nasal gone, like *nous prenons*.) Someone asks *vous comprenez ?* — give both possible answers. (***Oui*** or ***non***.)

29.2 penser — "to think," which began as weighing

Understanding, you saw with *comprendre*, is grasping. This verb says thinking is **weighing** — and once you know that, half a dozen English words you use in money and medicine suddenly line up behind it.

You'll want to know: the word

penser — to think. Said *pahn-SAY*: the *-en-* is the nasal you have been making since *prendre*, and *-er* is a clean *ay*.

Je pense. — I think. **Vous pensez ?** — Do you think so?

A completely regular **-er** verb after the strain of *comprendre*: *je pense, tu penses, il pense, nous pensons, vous pensez, ils pensent*. Four of the six sound identical — *pahns* — and only *nous* and *vous* stand out.

Sounds you'll need

Two nasals sit close together in French and beginners flatten them into one. Hold them apart by saying them back to back:

- **non** — the **-on** nasal, rounded, lips pushed forward.
- **pense** — the **-en** nasal, unrounded, mouth wider and flatter.

Same trick every time: your **lips** tell the two apart, not your tongue.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

penser ← Latin **pēnsāre**, "to weigh carefully," a repeated-action form of **pendere**, "to weigh, to hang." Roman weighing was done by hanging things from a balance, which is why one root covers both. English inherited the whole scale:

- **pensive** — weighing something in your mind.
- **compensate** — to weigh one thing **against** another until they balance; **expense** and **expend**, money **weighed out**; **dispense**, weighed apart.
- **pension** — originally a weighing-out, a payment; **poise**, a balance held.
- **suspend** and **pendant** — the hanging half of the same root.

The prettiest cousin is a flower. French **pensée** means "**a thought**" — and English borrowed it, sound and all, as **pansy**.
One honest note: English **think** is **Germanic** and is not related to any of this. The two words mean the same thing and share no history.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "penser" — *pahn-SAY*
- "non, pense" — the round nasal, then the flat one
- "je pense" then "je comprends" — I think, I understand

- "penser, pensive, compensate, pansy" — all a **weighing**

Before you move on

Say "I think" and "do you think so." (*Je pense. Vous pensez ?*) What did Latin *pēnsāre* mean, and name three English cousins. (**To weigh** — *pensive, compensate, expense, pension, poise.*) What flower is French for "a thought"? (The **pansy**, from *pensée.*) Which of *non* and *pense* has the rounded lips? (***Non*** — *pense* is flat and wide.)

29.3 lire — "to read," which used to mean "to pick up"

A short word with an enormous family behind it. Before *lire* meant reading, its Latin ancestor meant **gathering** — and that older sense is why a dozen English words that seem unrelated turn out to be relatives.

You'll want to know: the word

lire — to read. Said *leer*, with the throaty French **r** at the end.

Je lis le français. — I read French.

Lire is irregular, and its stem grows an **s** in the plural. Say the six:

- **je lis** — *lee*, the *-s* silent
- **tu lis** — *lee*
- **il lit** — *lee* (three identical again)
- **nous lisons** — *lee-ZOHN*, and there is the *s*
- **vous lisez** — *lee-ZAY*
- **ils lisent** — *LEEZ*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lire ← Latin **legere**, whose first meaning was "**to gather, to pick out**." Reading was a later use of it: your eye picks the letters up off the page one after another. Both senses left English words behind. The reading half:

- **legible**, able to be picked out; **lecture**, "a reading"; **lesson**, from *lectiō*, the passage read aloud.
- **legend** — literally "**things which must be read**."

The gathering half, which is the surprise:

- **collect** — gather together; **select**, gather apart; **elect**, pick out; **neglect**, fail to pick up at all.
- **elegant** — originally "choosy," someone who picks well; **diligent**; **intellect**, what picks between things.

One honest limit. Greek's **legein** — the *-logy* in every science name — is a **cousin**, not a parent: it descends from the same ancient root alongside Latin *legere*, rather than from it. And French **le livre**, "book," is not in this family at all; that is Latin *liber*, a separate word.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "lire" — *leer*, throaty *r*
- *Say it:* "je lis" then "nous lisons" — the *s* appears
- *Read aloud, gathering the words one by one:* "le chien, le chat"
- *Say it:* "je lis le français" then "je pense"
- *Say it:* "legible, lecture, collect, elect, elegant" — all a **picking out**

Before you move on

Say "I read French" and "we read." (*Je lis le français. Nous lisons* — the *s* only appears in the plural.) What did Latin *legere* mean first? (**To gather, to pick out** — reading came second.) Which of *collect*, *elegant* and *book* is **not** in this family? (**Book** — French

livre is from *liber*, a different word.) Now say these two aloud. (*Le chien, le chat.*)

29.4 écrire — "to write," born from a scratch

You can think, understand and read. The last of the four is the one that puts something back out — and its French spelling still carries a repair job the language did more than a thousand years ago.

You'll want to know: the word

écrire — to write. Said *ay-KREER*: the *é* is a sharp *ay*, then the throaty **r** at the end, as in *lire*.

J'écris le français. — I write French.

Irregular, and the stem grows a **v** in the plural:

- **j'écris** — *ay-KREE*
- **tu écris** — *ay-KREE*
- **il écrit** — *ay-KREE*
- **nous écrivons** — *ay-kree-VOHN*, and there is the *v*
- **vous écrivez** — *ay-kree-VAY*
- **ils écrivent** — *ay-KREEV*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écrire ← Latin **scrībere**, "**to scratch, to incise**." A Roman wrote by scratching a stylus across wax, and the verb never forgot it. English took the Latin form whole:

- **scribe**, **script**, **scripture**, **scribble**.
- **describe** — scratch it down; **prescribe**, **subscribe**, **inscribe**.

Now the *é*. Latin *scrībere* began with **sc-**, and a French-speaking mouth could not start a word that way, so it propped one up with a

vowel in front: *scrībere* → *escrire* → **écrire**. The same repair ran through the whole language — *schola* became *école*, *spatha* became *épée*, *stella* became *étoile*. That accent is not decoration: it is standing where an *s* used to be.
And the best cousin belongs to both halves of this chapter. **Manuscript** is *manus* + *scrībere* — "**scratched by hand**." **La main** and *écrire* meet inside one English word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "écrire" — *ay-KREER*
- "j'écris" then "nous écrivons" — the *v* appears in the plural
- the four of this chapter — "je comprends, je pense, je lis, j'écris"
- "j'écris à la main" — I write by hand; that is *manuscript*, taken apart
- "j'aime lire" then "j'aime écrire" — I like reading, I like writing
- "je prends le pain, et j'écris" — the taking verb, still there
- "lire, écrire" — gathering off the page, scratching onto it

Before you move on

Say "I write" and "we write." (*J'écris. Nous écrivons* — the *v* arrives in the plural.) What did *scrībere* literally mean, and why does *écrire* start with an *é*? (**To scratch**; French propped a vowel in front of Latin's *sc-*, the same repair that made *école* and *étoile*.) Pull *manuscript* apart. (*Manus* "**hand**" — your *la main* — plus *scrībere*, "scratched": **written by hand**.) Now say the four verbs of this chapter with *je*. (*Je comprends, je pense, je lis, j'écris*.)

Chapter 30

Hearing, Sleeping, Walking, Running

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that I hear, sleep, walk and run in French, use ça marche for "that works," and say why entendre carries English's intend inside it while the Latin verb for hearing ended up in English instead.
>
> *Run the chapter's four verbs together with je — j'entends, je dors, je marche, je cours — then use courir's spelling to settle why canis became chien while currere stayed hard at the front: the ca- shift only ever struck c before a. Reaches back past the chapter to le chien and its palatalization from Chapter 22, le chat from the same chapter, il fait chaud and il pleut from Chapter 21, and the ne … pas negation from Chapter 18.*

30.1 entendre — "to hear," and the stretching inside it

You can think and understand. Now the ear — and French's word for it is English's *intend*.

You'll want to know: the word

entendre — to hear. Two nasal *an* sounds in a row, then the *-dre* of *prendre*: say it *ahn-TAHN-druh*.

J'entends le chien. — I hear the dog.

The *-ds* of *j'entends* is silent, as in *je prends*.

Grammar Lens: the nasal that stays put

Prendre's nasal dies in the plural. *Entendre* looks like its twin and does the opposite — the stem never moves:

- **j'entends** — *jahn-TAHN*
- **tu entends** — *ahn-TAHN*
- **il entend** — *ahn-TAHN* (three identical to the ear)
- **nous entendons** — *ahn-tahn-DOHN*, nasal still there
- **vous entendez** — *ahn-tahn-DAY*
- **ils entendent** — *ahn-TAHND*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entendre ← Latin **intendere** — **in-** "toward" plus **tendere**, "**to stretch**." To *intendere* was to stretch a thing out and aim it: a bowstring, a journey, your attention. English kept the family — **intend**, plainest of them, plus **intent**, **intense**, **tension**, a **tent** (a stretched skin), **extend** and **pretend**.
Set your three mind-verbs together: French pictures each as a different thing the body does.

- **comprendre** — to **grasp together**, built on *prendre*.
- **penser** — to **weigh**, from *pēnsāre*.
- **entendre** — to **stretch toward**.

Why it's said this way

From its oldest French records *entendre* already covers a span at once: to hear, to attend, to understand, to intend. Nothing arrived late. What happened since is that the other senses fell away and hearing took the word outright — because Latin's verb for hearing, **audīre**, wore down in French to *ouïr* and stopped being usable. English kept that family instead: **audio**, **audience**, **audible**, **audition**.
The abandoned senses survive in phrases French never rebuilt:

- **entendu** — "understood," "agreed."
- **s'entendre** — to hear one another, and so to **get along**.
- **l'entente** — an understanding between parties, borrowed into English whole in *Entente Cordiale*.

So the two languages split one Latin pair: French hears with the verb English uses for intending, and English hears with the verb French let go.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "entendre" — *ahn-TAHN-druh*, two nasals
- "j'entends le chien"
- "nous prenons" then "nous entendons" — one flattens, one holds
- "j'écris, je comprends, j'entends"
- the three pictures — stretching, grasping, weighing
- "intend, tension, tent" — all a stretching

Before you move on

Say "I hear the dog" and "we hear." (*J'entends le chien. Nous entendons* — and unlike *nous prenons*, nothing flattens.) What did *intendere* mean, and which English verb is its plainest survival? (**To stretch toward**; **intend**.) Why did French hand hearing to this verb? (Latin's *audīre* wore down to *ouïr* and fell out of use — English kept the *audīre* words instead.) What does *s'entendre* mean? (**To get along**.)

30.2 dormir — "to sleep," and the room named after it

After a verb that changed jobs, here is one that never changed. *Dormir* is Latin's word for sleeping, handed on almost untouched — and it hides one trap.

You'll want to know: the word

dormir — to sleep. Said *dor-MEER*, with the throaty French **r** in the middle and at the end.

Le chat dort. — The cat is sleeping.

French has no separate "is sleeping" form. *Il dort* covers both "he sleeps" and "he is sleeping"; the plain present does all the work.

Grammar Lens: the m that goes missing

The stem is *dorm-*, and in the singular French throws the **m** away. Listen for where it comes back:

- **je dors** — *dor*
- **tu dors** — *dor*
- **il dort** — *dor* (three identical, the *m* gone)
- **nous dormons** — *dor-MOHN*, and there it is
- **vous dormez** — *dor-MAY*
- **ils dorment** — *DORM*

One rule, and you have the whole verb: singular loses the last stem consonant, plural gets it back. A small family of *-ir* verbs shares the shape, so learning it once is worth more than one verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dormir ← Latin **dormīre**, "to sleep." Spanish kept *dormir*, Italian *dormire*, Portuguese *dormir* — the verb crossed into its daughter languages untouched, which is rarer than it sounds. English has no inherited descendant; it borrowed the family later, through French:

- **dormitory** ← *dormītōrium*, a sleeping place; French wore the identical word down to **dortoir**.
- **dormant** — Old French *dormant*, "sleeping"; a dormant volcano is asleep.
- **dormer** — a roof window, from Old French *dormeor*, because

the room behind it was where you slept.

And an honest stop. The **dormouse** looks like the best cousin of the lot and is not one. The story needs an Anglo-Norman word for "sleeper" that nobody has found in a text, and *dormouse*'s real origin is unknown. A guess in circulation, not an etymology.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dormir" — *dor-MEER*, throaty *r*
- "je dors" then "nous dormons" — the *m* vanishes, then returns
- "le chat dort" — the cat, the travelling word out of Egypt
- "j'entends le chat" then "le chat dort"
- "dormir, dormitory, dormant" — one Latin verb, borrowed back
- "je comprends" then "je dors"

Before you move on

Say "the cat is sleeping" and "we sleep." (*Le chat dort. Nous dormons* — the *m* is silent in the singular and audible in the plural.) Where does *dormitory* come from? (Latin *dormītōrium*, "a **sleeping place**" — and French wore the same word down to *dortoir*.) Is the **dormouse** in this family? (**No** — that is folk etymology; the word's real origin is unknown.) And *chat* — an inherited Latin word, or a traveller? (**A traveller**, from *cattus*, moving with the cat itself out of Egypt.)

30.3 marcher — "to walk," and the step hiding inside French negation

You can hear and you can sleep. Now move. This verb does a second job too, used dozens of times a day.

You'll want to know: the word

marcher — to walk. Said *mar-SHAY*: the *-er* is a clean *ay*, and the *ch* is *sh*, never *k*.

Je marche. — I walk.

After *dormir*'s vanishing *m*, this one asks nothing: an ordinary **-er** verb. *Je marche, tu marches, il marche, nous marchons, vous marchez, ils marchent* — four of the six sound identical, just *marsh*.

Why it's said this way

Marcher is also the everyday verb for a thing **working**. A machine, a plan, an arrangement: if it functions, it walks.

Ça marche. — "That works." Also "Fine," "Deal," "Sounds good." **Ça ne marche pas.** — "That doesn't work."

There is your *ne … pas* from the answer-word *non*, round a real verb at last. And *ça marche* alone is an agreement, two words long. *Entendre* once held several jobs and shed all but hearing. *Marcher* holds two right now.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Here the honest answer is that nobody is certain. Old French *marchier* first meant "**to trample, to tread on**," and two accounts compete:

- Frankish **markōn**, "to mark, to press a step in" — preferred by most reference works.
- Late Latin *marcāre*, from **marcus**, "**a hammer**" — a blow and a tread being one motion.

Three consequences, in falling order of certainty:

- English **march**, the verb, is borrowed straight **from** *marcher*. Secure whichever origin is right.
- English **mark** is Germanic, from Old English *mearc*. A relative **only if** the Frankish account holds — conditional, not a fact.

- French **la marche**, a borderland, with **marquis** and German **margrave**, comes from the Germanic **noun** *marka*, "boundary" — a separate arrival.

And one cousin you own already. The **pas** in *ne … pas* began as Latin *passus*, "**a step**." *Je ne marche pas* is, underneath, "I do not walk a step."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "marcher" — *mar-SHAY*, *sh* not *k*
- "je marche" then "nous marchons"
- "ça marche" — that works, that's fine
- "non", then "je ne marche pas" — and *pas* is a **step**
- "j'entends, je dors, je marche"
- "nous dormons, nous marchons" — one stem shifts, one never does

Before you move on

Say "I walk" and "that works." (*Je marche. Ça marche.*) What are the two competing origins? (Frankish **markōn**, ***"to press a step in," or Latin*** **marcus**, ***"a hammer." Genuinely unsettled.) Which English word is certainly related, and which only might be? (March, borrowed straight from*** **marcher**; ***mark only if the Frankish account is right.) What did*** **pas** ***mean before it meant "not"? (A step.)***

30.4 courir — "to run," and why it is not *chourir*

Hearing, sleeping, walking — and now the fastest of the four. Its Latin root is one of the busiest in English, and its spelling settles a question the dog raised.

You'll want to know: the word

courir — to run. Said *koo-REER*, throaty at both *r*s.

Le chien court. — The dog runs.

Grammar Lens: the same endings, a different stem

Courir takes *dormir*'s singular endings — **-s, -s, -t**, all silent:

- **je cours** — *koor*
- **tu cours** — *koor*
- **il court** — *koor*
- **nous courons** — *koo-ROHN*
- **vous courez** — *koo-RAY*
- **ils courent** — *KOOR*

But the resemblance stops there. *Dormir* **sheds** a consonant in the singular: *dorm-* becomes *dor-*. *Courir* sheds nothing — its stem *cour-* has nothing spare to lose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Marcher left a choice between a Frankish verb and a Latin hammer. This one leaves none. **courir** ← Latin **currere**, "to run," which English mined harder than almost any other verb:

- **current** and **currency** both run; a **cursor** runs across a screen; a **course** is a run, a **corridor** a running-place.
- **courier**, one who runs; **curriculum**, literally "**a running**."
- **concur**, run together; **occur**, run up against; **excursion**.

Now the spelling question. *Chien* came from *canis*, and its **c** turned into **ch** — the shift that made *champ* and *chanter*. So why is this verb not *chourir*? Because that shift only struck **c** before **a**. *Currere* had **c** before **u**, untouched, so the *k* survived. One rule, two regular outcomes. One honest limit. Latin **carrus**, "wagon," gave English **car** and **cargo**, and descends from the same very old root. But Latin borrowed

carrus from Gaulish: a cousin by another road, not a word built out of *currere*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the chapter's four with *je* — "j'entends, je dors, je marche, je cours"
- "le chien court" then "le chat dort"
- "il fait chaud, je cours"
- "il pleut, je ne cours pas"
- "je dors, nous dormons" then "je cours, nous courons" — one sheds
- "chien" then "courir" — *ch* before *a*, *k* before *u*
- "current, course, courier, curriculum" — every one a running
- "ça marche" — the agreement, two words

Before you move on

Say the chapter's four verbs with *je*. (*J'entends, je dors, je marche, je cours.*) What does **curriculum** literally mean? (**A running** — from *currere*.) Why did *canis* become *chien* while *currere* stayed hard? (The shift only hit **c** before **a**.) Which of the four began as a **stretching**? (***Entendre*** — *intendere*, to stretch toward.) Now: "the dog runs" and "it is hot." (*Le chien court. Il fait chaud.*)

Chapter 31

Sitting, Standing, Opening, Closing

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can sit down, get up, open and close in French, hold both accepted paradigms of s'asseoir apart, say why French needs two pieces — se lever and debout — where English has one verb "to stand," and know that ouvrir takes marcher's endings despite its -ir spelling.

Say the chapter's four with je — je m'assieds, je me lève, j'ouvre, je ferme — drill ouvrir and fermer as one pair now that both carry the same endings, and take fermer apart into firmāre, 'to make firm', the verb that gave Italian fermare 'to stop' and Spanish firmar 'to sign'. Reaches back past the chapter to open and close la main from Chapter 17, to close because il pleut from Chapter 21, and to ask in both registers and then apologise, from Chapters 19 and 20.

31.1 s'asseoir — "to sit down," a verb you do to yourself

You have walked and you have run. Now stop. French does not say "I sit" — it says "**I seat myself**," and that extra word is one you own.

You'll want to know: the word

s'asseoir — to sit down. Said *sah-SWAHR*.

Je m'assieds. — I sit down. Said *juh mah-SYAY.*

The **m'** is the *me* inside *je m'appelle*: French treats sitting as something you do **to yourself**, so the pronoun is not optional.

Keep two ideas apart. *S'asseoir* is the **movement**, lowering yourself into a chair. **Je suis assis** is the **state** after it, "I am seated." English lets *sit* cover both; French makes you choose.

Grammar Lens: one verb, two accepted sets

The only verb in this book with **two** correct answers, both in dictionaries. Learn this series whole:

- **je m'assieds** — *mah-SYAY*
- **tu t'assieds** — *tah-SYAY*
- **il s'assied** — *sah-SYAY* (three identical to the ear)
- **nous nous asseyons** — *noo-zah-say-YOHN*
- **vous vous asseyez** — *voo-zah-say-YAY*
- **ils s'asseyent** — *sah-SAY*

Then recognise the rival singulars **je m'assois, tu t'assois, il s'assoit** — ordinary spoken French. Their plurals (*assoyons, assoyez*) are much rarer in France, so the series above is the safer one to own. Since 1990 the infinitive may also be spelled **s'assoir**. Nothing here is wrong; the language never chose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'asseoir ← Vulgar Latin **adsedēre**, a remaking of Classical **adsidēre** — **ad-** "at" plus **sedēre**, "**to sit**." Latin had built the compound; French only wore it down. And *sedēre* is everywhere in English:

- **sedentary**, sitting work; a **session**, "a sitting"; **sediment**, what sits at the bottom.
- **reside**, sit back; **preside** and **president**, sitting in front; **assiduous**, sitting at a task.
- **siege** — an army sitting down before a city; **possess**, **obsess**,

subsidy.

- A bishop's **see** is his *sedēs*, his **seat**.

Dormir English only borrowed. This root it owns from birth too: **sit**, **seat** and **settle** come down the Germanic road from the same source.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "s'asseoir" — *sah-SWAHR*
- "je m'assieds" then "nous nous asseyons"
- "je m'appelle" then "je m'assieds" — the same little *m'*
- "je m'assieds" then "je suis assis" — movement, then state
- "je marche, je cours, je m'assieds, je dors"
- "j'entends" — the ear needs no chair
- "sedentary, session, siege" — every one a sitting

Before you move on

Say "I sit down" and "we sit down." (*Je m'assieds. Nous nous asseyons.*) Why is the pronoun there? (French sits you **yourself** down — the same *m'* as in *je m'appelle.*) What is a **siege**, literally? (**A sitting** — an army sitting down before a city.) Which English words are cousins of *sedēre* by birth rather than borrowing? (**Sit**, **seat**, **settle**.) Now the pair: "je cours" and "je dors."

31.2 se lever, debout — standing, which French says in two pieces

You sat down. Getting up is harder, because French has **no single verb** for "to stand." It splits the idea in two.

You'll want to know: the movement

se lever — to get up, to rise. Said *suh luh-VAY*.

Je me lève. — I get up. Said *juh muh LEV*.

Reflexive, as *s'asseoir* is: you raise **yourself**. After that verb's two paradigms this is a relief — an ordinary **-er** verb with one habit. Silent ending, and the *e* takes a **grave accent**; spoken ending, and it flattens:

- **je me lève** — *LEV*
- **tu te lèves** — *LEV*
- **il se lève** — *LEV*
- **nous nous levons** — *luh-VOHN*, flat
- **vous vous levez** — *luh-VAY*, flat
- **ils se lèvent** — *LEV*

You'll want to know: the state

debout — standing, upright. Said *duh-BOO*.

Je suis debout. — I am standing.

Se lever is the **movement**, *debout* the **state** — the split between sitting down and being seated. *Debout* is no verb: attach it to *être*.

Opened, it is transparent:

de + bout → debout

"**On end**": a *bout* is a tip or end, so standing is being set on your end. French did once have a plain verb for standing, *ester*; it survives only in a courtroom phrase, which is why the language builds this from pieces.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lever ← Latin **levāre**, "to raise" — built on **levis**, "**light in weight**." To raise a thing is to lighten it. Hence **elevate**, **elevator**, **levitate**, **levity**; a **lever**, which lightens a load; **alleviate**, **relieve**, **relief**; **leaven**.

So two of this book's verbs come from one corner of Roman thought. *Penser* is *pēnsāre*, "**to weigh**"; *lever* is *levāre*, "to make **light**."

Thinking weighs, rising un-weighs, and *sedēre* just sits there. One correction. **Bout** comes from *bouter*, "to strike," taken from Frankish — and its English relative by **descent** is **beat**. *Butt* looks closer but is a later **borrowing** back out of French.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "se lever" — *suh luh-VAY*
- "je me lève" then "nous nous levons" — sharp, then flat
- "je m'assieds" then "je me lève" — down, then up
- "je suis debout" — the state, on *être*
- "je me lève et je cours"
- "je pense" then "je me lève" — weighing, then lightening
- "elevate, lever, relief" — all a raising

Before you move on

Say "I get up" and "we get up." (*Je me lève. Nous nous levons* — the accent appears only when the ending is silent.) How does French say "I am standing"? (***Je suis debout*** — a state pinned to *être*, not a verb; *debout* is "**on end**.") *Penser* came from weighing; what does *lever* come from? (***Levis***, "**light in weight**".) And the opposite movement? (*Je m'assieds.*)

31.3 ouvrir — "to open," an -ir verb wearing -er endings

You can sit and rise. Now something for the hand. This verb is French conjugation's small trap: spelled like one family, behaving like another.

You'll want to know: the word

ouvrir — to open. Said *oo-VREER*.

J'ouvre la main. — I open my hand.

French says *la main* where English says "my hand"; with your own body the article does the work. And listen to that nasal — *pain*, *main* — the same *-ain* you have been making since the bread.

Grammar Lens: the endings it should not have

Ouvrir ends in **-ir**, so you would expect it to run like *dormir*. It does not. It takes the endings of **marcher**, an *-er* verb, exactly:

- **j'ouvre** — *JOOVR*
- **tu ouvres** — *OOVR*
- **il ouvre** — *OOVR*
- **nous ouvrons** — *oo-VROHN*
- **vous ouvrez** — *oo-VRAY*
- **ils ouvrent** — *OOVR*

Four identical to the ear, *nous* and *vous* audible: the shape of *je marche, nous marchons*. A small group of *-ir* verbs does this, and *ouvrir* is the one you meet most. The spelling promises one thing; listen to what the verb does.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin's verb for opening was **aperīre**, which *ouvrir* does not look much like — because the word was remodelled on the way into popular Latin **operīre**. The likeliest cause is the pull of its own opposite, *cooperīre*, "to cover," which became French **couvrir**. Opening and covering ended up rhyming and have stayed matched since. The meaning stayed *aperīre*'s; only the shape moved.
English collected both ends:

- from *aperīre* — an **aperture**; an **aperitif**, the drink that **opens** a meal.

- from Old French *ovrir* — **overt**, its past participle "opened," and **overture**, *ouverture*.
- from the covering half — **curfew**, Old French *cuevrefeu*, "**cover-fire**," the bell that said to bank the hearth.

Set that beside the hand. *Maintenir* is *manū tenēre*, "**to hold in the hand**" — and *ouvrir la main* releases that grip.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ouvrir" — *oo-VREER*
- "j'ouvre la main" — and hear *pain*, *main*
- "je marche, nous marchons" then "j'ouvre, nous ouvrons" — one shape
- "je m'assieds, je me lève, j'ouvre la main"
- "je suis debout et j'ouvre la main"
- "maintenir" then "ouvrir" — holding in the hand, then letting go
- "aperture, aperitif, overt, overture" — every one an opening

Before you move on

Say "I open my hand" and "we open." (*J'ouvre la main. Nous ouvrons.*) Which endings does *ouvrir* borrow, despite its spelling? (The **-er** set — *marcher*'s.) What is an **aperitif**, literally? (**The opener** — the drink that opens a meal.) Why does *ouvrir* not look like Latin *aperīre*? (It was **reshaped** to match its own opposite, the verb for covering.)

31.4 fermer — "to close," which in French means "to make firm"

The last of the four, and the opposite of the one before it. French chose an unexpected picture: to close a thing is to make it **firm**.

You'll want to know: the word

fermer — to close. Said *fer-MAY.*

Je ferme la main. — I close my hand. **Il pleut. Je ferme.** — It's raining. I'm closing up.

A regular **-er** verb: *je ferme, tu fermes, il ferme, nous fermons, vous fermez, ils ferment.*

Grammar Lens: two opposites, one set of endings

Ouvrir borrowed the *-er* endings against its own spelling. *Fermer* owns them outright. So the two opposites conjugate in step, and drill as one pair:

- **j'ouvre / je ferme**
- **nous ouvrons / nous fermons**
- **ils ouvrent / ils ferment**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fermer ← Latin **firmāre**, "to make firm," from **firmus**, "**firm**." A Roman door was not closed, it was **secured**. English took the adjective and left the verb: **firm**, **affirm**, **confirm**, **infirm** and the **infirmary**, the **firmament** — the sky as a solid vault.
Probably also **farm**. Old French *ferme* meant a **fixed rent**, from Medieval Latin *firma*, "a fixed payment," so a farm began as a lease and not a field. Etymologists call this history a confused one, because Old English *feorm*, "food-rent," sat nearby and may have pulled on it. Likely, not clean.
The best part is the split. One Latin verb, three languages, three jobs:

- French **fermer** — to **close**.
- Italian **fermare** — to **stop**.
- Spanish **firmar** — to **sign**, because a signature makes a paper firm.

And Spanish and Portuguese do not close with this verb at all. Their words come from Latin's **bolt**. So French shuts a door by making it solid while its neighbours slide a bar across.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "fermer" — *fer-MAY*
- "j'ouvre la main" then "je ferme la main"
- the chapter's four — "je m'assieds, je me lève, j'ouvre, je ferme"
- "je suis debout et je ferme"
- "il pleut, je ferme"
- "vous fermez, s'il vous plaît" then "tu fermes, s'il te plaît" — formal, then familiar
- "je suis désolé, je ferme" — the apology before the refusal
- "fermer, firm, affirm, confirm" — all a making-firm

Before you move on

Say the chapter's four with *je*. (*Je m'assieds, je me lève, j'ouvre, je ferme.*) What did *firmāre* mean, and what is a French door doing when it closes? (**Making firm** — being **secured**, not barred.) One Latin verb, three languages: Italian and Spanish? (*Fermare*, "to **stop**"; *firmar*, "to **sign**".) Now close politely in both registers, then apologise. (*Vous fermez, s'il vous plaît. Tu fermes, s'il te plaît. Je suis désolé.*) And the hand? (*J'ouvre la main, je ferme la main.*)

Chapter 32

Coffee, Tea, Milk, Sugar

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for coffee, tea, milk or sugar in French, and trace each word to the road it travelled to get there — one unbroken, one forked, one never borrowed, one from Sanskrit.
>
> *Ask for sugar, trace sucre to Sanskrit śárkarā through Arabic sukkar, and set the chapter's four masculine drink-words beside l'eau's lone feminine exception. Reaches back past the chapter to Chapter 18's si, the answer that contradicts a negative, and to the langue d'oïl / langue d'oc split behind oui itself.*

32.1 le café — coffee, one word the whole road agrees on

First, two words from the last chapter, taken apart. *Se lever* is built on a Latin word for what? (***Levis***, **light** — rising unweighs you, as in *elevate*.) And a Roman door was not closed, it was made what? (**Firm** — *firmāre*, the root of *confirm*.)

You already know how to ask nicely — **s'il vous plaît**. Now something worth asking for: the first of four everyday words for what's on the table.

You'll want to know: the word

le café — coffee. **Masculine**.

> **Un café, s'il vous plaît.** — "A coffee, please."

Café also names the **place** you drink it, exactly the way English *cafe* does — one word, two jobs, in both languages at once.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

café comes from Ottoman Turkish **kahve**, which comes from Arabic **qahwa**. Arabic lexicographers record *qahwa* as an older word for **wine** — it only attached to the coffee bean once the drink spread out of Yemen, in the fifteenth century.
From Ottoman *kahve*, the word crossed into Europe through Italian **caffè** — and stopped there. French **café**, English **coffee**, German **Kaffee**, Italian **caffè** itself: every one of these is the *same* borrowing, taken at a different stop on a *single* road out of the Ottoman Empire. Nobody translated it; everybody just repeated it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le café" — masculine
- "un café, s'il vous plaît"
- the road — "qahwa, kahve, caffè, café" — one word, four stops
- the surprise — "qahwa once meant **wine**"

Before you move on

Say "coffee, please." (***Un café, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) What Arabic word is *café* from, and what did it mean before coffee existed? (***Qahwa*** — "**wine**.") Name the road it travelled. (**Arabic qahwa → Ottoman kahve → Italian caffè → French café**, with English *coffee* and German *Kaffee* the same borrowing at other stops.) Is *s'il vous plaît* the right register here? (**Yes** — spoken, to someone you don't know well.)

32.2 le thé — tea, the word that took the other road

You just saw *café* travel Europe as one word, unchanged at every stop. Tea took the opposite kind of trip — it **split**.

You'll want to know: the word

le thé — tea. **Masculine**.

Un thé, s'il vous plaît. — "A tea, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

China writes "tea" with one character everywhere, but doesn't say it the same way everywhere. In Mandarin it's **chá**. In the **Hokkien** of the south-eastern coast — the Amoy dialect — it's **tê**.
Traders who bought the leaf overland or through Mandarin-speaking ports carried home **chá**: it travelled into Persian, into Arabic, into Hindi. Dutch traders bought their tea specifically at **Amoy**, in Hokkien territory, and carried home **tê** instead — which became Dutch **thee**, then French **thé**, English **tea**, German **Tee**. French borrowed **thé** from Dutch.
So *café* and *thé* make a matched pair with opposite stories: *café* is one word repeated unchanged at every stop; *thé* is the *same original word*, worn into two different shapes depending which Chinese port a trader happened to deal with.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le thé" — masculine
- "un café, un thé" — both masculine, both borrowed
- the fork — "chá overland, tê by Dutch ship"
- the pair — "café: one road. thé: two."

Before you move on

Say "tea, please." (***Un thé, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) What Chinese dialect gave French *thé* its shape, and by what route? (**Hokkien tê**, carried by **Dutch** ships from the port of **Amoy**.) What's the overland word that *chá*-family languages use instead? (**Chá**, into **Persian, Arabic, Hindi**.) How is *thé*'s story different from *café*'s? (*Café* stayed **one word** everywhere; *thé* **split in two**

depending on the port.)

32.3 le lait — milk, the word French never had to borrow

Café and *thé* both crossed an ocean to reach French. This word never left home.

Je m'assieds, tu t'assieds, il s'assied: three forms, one sound.

You'll want to know: the word

le lait — milk. **Masculine**, like *café* and *thé*.

Du lait, s'il vous plaît. — "Some milk, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lait comes from Latin ***lac*** (stem ***lact-***) — a word Latin-speakers in Gaul simply kept saying, generation after generation, until it wore down into *lait*. No port, no trade route: this one was **inherited**, not borrowed, unlike *café*'s single road or *thé*'s forked one.
English shows the same split *tête* showed for "head": the **inherited**, everyday English word for this drink is **milk** — and it has **nothing to do with** *lac*. *Milk* descends from a completely different Proto-Indo-European root, one meaning "to milk a cow." English only meets *lac*'s stem *lact-* in **learned** words borrowed straight from written Latin much later: **lactic**, **lactose**, **lactate**. So French *lait* and English *lactic* are close cousins; French *lait* and English *milk* are not related at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le lait" — masculine
- "un café, un thé, du lait" — three drinks, one gender
- the cousins — "lait, lactic, lactose"
- the non-cousins — "lait and milk share no root at all"

Before you move on

Say "milk, please." (***Du lait, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) Is *lait* borrowed, like *café* and *thé*, or inherited straight from Latin? (**Inherited** — from *lac*, stem *lact-*.) Which English words are close cousins of *lait*? (**Lactic, lactose, lactate** — learned borrowings of the same stem.) Is English *milk* one of those cousins? (**No** — a completely different, unrelated root.)

32.4 le sucre — sugar, the longest road of the four

Coffee took one road, tea forked into two, milk never left home. Sugar's road is the longest of all — and it ends the chapter with a whole table's worth of masculine drink-words.

You'll want to know: the word

le sucre — sugar. **Masculine.**

Du sucre, s'il vous plaît. — "Some sugar, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sucre ← Old French **çucre** ← Arabic **sukkar** ← Persian **shakar** ← Sanskrit **śárkarā**, which first meant "**grit, gravel**" — crystallized sugar looked like gravel to whoever named it first.
Sucre passed through Arabic just like *café* did, but through a **different** Arabic word (*sukkar*, not *qahwa*): a shared **language of transmission**, not a shared root. Where *lait* is inherited straight from Latin, *sucre* is borrowed — from **further back** than *café* or *thé*, all the way to Sanskrit.

Grammar Lens: a lean, and its one loud exception

Four drink-words, four **masculine** articles: *le café, le thé, le lait, le sucre*. Not a rule to trust — a lean: French tends to make plain substances masculine. This lean has a loud exception: **l'eau**, "water," is **feminine**. You still learn each word with its article, the promise this book has kept since *la main*.

Why it's said this way

The **si** you learned — the "yes" for contradicting a negative — fits this table exactly:

> **Vous n'avez pas le sucre ?** — ***Si !*** ("You don't have the sugar? — Yes, I do!")

Plain **oui** here would agree you *don't* have it; *si* is what pushes back. That same *oui* once mattered enough to **split a country** — *langue d'oïl* in the north, *langue d'oc* in the south.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le sucre" — masculine
- all four — "le café, le thé, le lait, le sucre"
- the exception — "l'eau" — feminine, against the lean
- the contradiction — "Vous n'avez pas le sucre ? — Si !"

Before you move on

Say "sugar, please." (***Du sucre, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) Trace *sucre* back to Sanskrit. (**Sukkar** ← **shakar** ← **śárkarā**, "**grit, gravel**.") Do *café* and *sucre* share a root? (**No** — a language of transmission, Arabic, not a root; *qahwa* and *sukkar* are different words.) What is the lean about French drink-words, and what breaks it? (**Masculine by default** — broken by **l'eau**, feminine.) When do you answer **si** instead of **oui**? (**Contradicting a negative** — the same word-pair that once **split France** into *langue d'oïl* and *langue d'oc*.)

Chapter 33

The People You Introduce

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can introduce a friend, name my family, name a child and name any person, using French's four different relationships between grammatical gender and the person meant, and elide le or la to l' before a vowel.
>
> *Say la personne, always feminine even naming a man, then line the chapter's four words up by how each one handles gender: l'ami changes, la famille is fixed, l'enfant is one spelling with two articles, la personne is fixed regardless of sex. Reaches back to Chapter 18's non for a sound contrast (personne's double -nn- blocks the nasal non has) and to its ne … pas negation, which personne itself joins as "nobody."*

33.1 l'ami, l'amie — the friend, and why the article gives way

> The café chapter handed you *le lait* and *le sucre*, and three more things to ask for. Now the people you'd ask them with — starting with the one whose name teaches French's most useful spelling rule.

You'll want to know: the word

un ami — a (male) friend. **un**e **amie** — a (female) friend. Same sound, *ah-MEE*; the feminine just adds a silent **-e**. A regular swap: the article and ending follow **who the friend is**.

Grammar Lens: why it's l'ami, not le ami

Say **le ami** out loud: two vowels collide, *euh* then *ah*, and French won't stand for it. So **le** and **la** both drop their vowel before a word that starts with one, and glue on with an apostrophe: **l'ami**, **l'amie** — one form for both genders once the article elides. This is the *exact* same move as *l'eau* — French never tolerates *le* or *la* sitting next to another vowel sound. It also happens to a pronoun you already use daily: *je ai* became **j'ai** by the identical rule.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ami ← Latin **amicus**, "**friend**" — built on the verb **amāre**, "to love." English kept the adjective whole in **amicable**, **amiable**, and **amity** ("friendship" between nations). A French *ami* is, at the root, someone you **love**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "un ami, une amie" — the regular swap
- "l'ami, l'amie" — never *le ami*
- the family — "l'eau, j'ai, l'ami" — one rule, three words
- "amicable, amiable, amity" — all built on **amāre**, to love

Before you move on

Give "a friend" for a man and for a woman. (**un ami, une amie**.) Why do you say *l'ami* instead of *le ami*? (**Two vowels can't sit together** — the article **elides**, the same rule behind *l'eau* and *j'ai*.) What Latin verb is *ami* built on, and what does it mean? (**Amāre**, "**to love**.")

33.2 la famille — the family, feminine no matter who's in it

L'ami changes shape with who it names. This word never does — whoever is in the family, the word itself stays exactly as it

is. (And before you had *l'ami*, you already had *le sucre* — every one of this book's nouns keeps its article.)

You'll want to know: the word

la famille — the family. **Feminine**, fixed — no elision here, since *famille* starts with a consonant: **la famille**, never *l'famille*.

The double **-ll-** after **i** is not said like an English L: **famille** is *fah-MEE-yuh*, the *-ille* landing as a **y**-sound, the *l* itself silent. You'll meet this **-ille** spelling again.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

famille ← Latin **familia**, "**the household**" — built on **famulus**, "servant, slave." Roman *familia* named **everyone under one roof**: parents, children, and the servants who worked there, all together. It broadened to mean "blood relatives" only because relatives usually *were* the people sharing that roof. Where *ami* is built on **loving** someone, *famille* is built on **living with** them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la famille" — feminine, no elision
- the sound — "fa-MI-yuh," not "fa-MILL"
- the contrast — "un ami: loving. la famille: living together."

Before you move on

Say "the family." (***La famille*** — feminine.) Why doesn't it elide to *l'famille*? (**It starts with a consonant** — elision only happens before a vowel.) What did Latin *familia* originally include besides relatives? (**The household's servants**, from *famulus*.)

33.3 l'enfant — the child, one word for both

La famille stays fixed no matter who's in it. This member of it does something different again: **one spelling**, for a boy or a girl alike.

You'll want to know: the word

l'enfant — the child. Starts with a vowel, so the article **elides** again, exactly like *l'ami*: **un enfant** (a boy), **une enfant** (a girl) — but the *word itself* never changes. Only **un/une** tells you which.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enfant ← Latin **īnfāns**, "**not speaking**" — **in-** "not" + **fāns**, "speaking" (from **fārī**, "to speak"). Literally, a baby too young to talk. But Romans already stretched *īnfāns* to cover children well past babyhood long before French existed, and French *enfant* simply inherited that wider sense — it didn't narrow English **infant** into something broader. The two words split apart in a different way: English kept the narrow, original "not-yet-speaking" sense for its borrowing, while French's everyday word carried the older, already-widened Latin meaning forward.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "un enfant, une enfant" — one spelling, two articles
- the elision — "l'enfant," never *le enfant*
- "in- + fari" — not speaking
- the family so far — "l'ami, la famille, l'enfant"

Before you move on

How do you tell a boy child from a girl child in French, if the word itself never changes? (**The article** — *un enfant / une enfant.*) What does *enfant* literally mean, and where does that meaning come from? (**"Not speaking"** — *in-* + *fārī*, "to speak.") Does French narrow Latin's meaning or keep it wide? (**Keeps it wide** — Latin had already stretched *infans* past babyhood.)

33.4 la personne — the person, and the mask behind the word

> *L'ami* changes with its friend; *l'enfant* doesn't, but its article does. This last one is the strangest of the four: it never changes at all — **not even for a man**.

You'll want to know: the word

la personne — the person. **Always feminine** — grammatically, whether you mean a man, a woman, or anyone at all:

> **Cet homme est une bonne personne.** — "That man is a good person."

Homme is masculine; *personne* describing him stays **feminine** regardless. Grammatical gender here has come loose from the person's actual sex entirely — further even than *ami*, which at least tracks who's meant.

Sounds you'll need

Personne looks like it should rhyme with **non**'s nasal *-on* — it doesn't. Double **-nn-** blocks the nasal: **non** is nasal, said through the nose, but **personne** ends oral, *pehr-SUN*, the vowel staying in the mouth. One consonant, doubled, is the difference between a nasal ending and a plain one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

personne ← Latin **persona**, a **theatrical mask** — from Etruscan **phersu**, most likely from Greek **prósōpon**, "face." A tidy but doubted story derives it from *per-* + *sonāre*, "sound through" (the mask an actor's voice rang through); linguists reject it on the vowel length, so treat it as folk etymology, not fact.
Pair *personne* with **ne** and it flips to "**nobody**" — ***je ne vois personne*** = "I see **nobody**." Behind an empty mask, no one at all.

Grammar Lens: four people, four kinds of gender

The chapter's four words, side by side:

- **l'ami / l'amie** — **changes** with who's meant; elides either way.

- **la famille** — **fixed** feminine, whoever's in it; no elision.
- **l'enfant** — **one** spelling; only **un/une** shows which; elides.
- **la personne** — **fixed** feminine, even naming a man.

Four different relationships between gender and the person named — none of them the "normal" case. Each is its own rule, learned with the word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la personne" — always feminine
- "cet homme est une bonne personne"
- the contrast — "non" nasal, "personne" not
- the flip — "je ne vois personne" — nobody

Before you move on

Is *personne* ever masculine, even describing a man? (**No — always feminine**, grammatically.) Why doesn't *personne* nasalize like *non*? (**Double -nn-** blocks it.) What does *ne … personne* mean, and what does that use share with *ne … pas*? (**"Nobody"** — the same negation frame built around *ne*.) Is *persona* really built on "sounding through"? (**Probably not** — a folk etymology; the real root is likely Etruscan *phersu*, "**mask**.")

Chapter 34

Cheese, Butter, Salt, Egg

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for cheese, butter, salt or an egg in French, and say why un œuf keeps its final f while les œufs drops it.
>
> *Ask for an egg, hold un œuf's pronounced f against les œufs' silent one, and place œuf beside English egg as genuine cousins rather than a borrowing. Reaches back past the chapter to le sel, le beurre and le fromage, and to Chapter 29's elision rule, which l'œuf needs exactly as l'ami did.*

34.1 le fromage — cheese, named for its mould

> You can name *la personne* and *l'enfant* now. The café chapter asked politely for a drink; this chapter asks for what goes with it — starting with a word every other Romance language names completely differently.
>
> What did *personne* first name in Latin, and what does it become beside *ne*? (A theatre **mask**; *ne … personne* is **nobody**.)

You'll want to know: the word

le fromage — cheese. **Masculine.**

> **Du fromage, s'il vous plaît.** — "Some cheese, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fromage ← Medieval Latin **formāticum**, "**a thing made in a mould**" — built on **forma**, "shape, mould." Cheesemakers press curds into a mould to set their shape, and French named the finished cheese for **that step**.
Classical Latin's actual word for cheese was **caseus** — and that word is what survives in Spanish **queso** and Portuguese **queijo**, as well as English **casein** and Old English **cyse**, the ancestor of **cheese** itself. So French *fromage* and English *cheese* are **not** cousins: French walked away from *caseus* entirely and named the cheese for its mould instead, while Spanish, Portuguese and English all kept the old word for the curd.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le fromage" — masculine
- "du fromage, s'il vous plaît"
- the mould — "forma → fromage"
- the split — "fromage and cheese are not cousins; queso, queijo and cheese all come from caseus"

Before you move on

Say "cheese, please." (***Du fromage, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) What Latin word is *fromage* built on, and what did it mean? (**Forma**, "**shape, mould**.") Which Romance languages kept the older word for cheese instead, and what is it? (**Spanish queso, Portuguese queijo** — from Latin **caseus**, also behind English **casein** and **cheese**.)

34.2 le beurre — butter, one loanword twice

Fromage took a French road all its own. This word, French and English took **together** — the exact same borrowing, not two.

You'll want to know: the word

le beurre — butter. **Masculine.**

> **Du beurre, s'il vous plaît.** — "Some butter, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beurre ← Latin **būtyrum** ← Greek **boútūron**, usually broken down as **boûs** "cow" + **tyrós** "cheese" — "cow-cheese." But butter wasn't a Greek or Roman product; both cultures were oil cultures, and most likely imported both the substance and the word from further east, possibly from Scythian traders. Treat "cow-cheese" as a **folk reshaping** of a foreign word into familiar Greek pieces, not a certain compound.
Either way, English **butter** borrows the *identical* Latin word French **beurre** does. This isn't two languages separately naming the same thing — it's **one loanword, arriving twice**.

Why it's said this way

The courtesy words you already have fit right here:

> **Désolé, je n'ai pas le beurre.** — "Sorry, I don't have the butter."

Désolé — real regret, for letting someone down. If you'd only bumped the butter dish, **pardon** would do instead; to get someone's attention before asking for it at all, **excusez-moi**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le beurre" — masculine
- "du beurre, s'il vous plaît"
- "beurre, butter" — one word, borrowed twice
- "désolé, je n'ai pas le beurre"

Before you move on

Say "butter, please." (***Du beurre, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) Is "cow-cheese" a safe etymology for *boútūron*? (**Not certain** — likely a Greek reshaping of a foreign word, since butter wasn't native to Greece or Rome.) Is French *beurre* related to English *butter* by common descent or by borrowing? (**Borrowing** — the same Latin word, taken by both languages.) When would you reach for *pardon* instead of *désolé*? (**A small, quick slip** — not real regret.)

34.3 le sel — salt, a real cousin and a fake legend

Beurre was one word borrowed twice. This one is different again — a genuine family relative of its English counterpart, plus a famous story about it that isn't actually true.

You'll want to know: the word

le sel — salt. **Masculine.**

Du sel, s'il vous plaît. — "Some salt, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sel ← Latin **sal**, stem **sal-** — **inherited**, like *lait*, not borrowed like *café* or *sucre*. English **salt** is a genuine **cousin**: both words descend from the same Proto-Indo-European root, ***sal-**, inherited separately down the Latin and Germanic branches. Unlike *lait* and *milk*, which share no root at all, *sel* and *salt* really are family.
Latin **salārium** — English **salary** — is built on this same *sal*. You may have heard that Roman soldiers were literally paid in salt, which is where "salary" supposedly comes from. That claim appears in **no ancient source**; no Roman writer says it. *Salārium* genuinely is built on *sal* — that part is real — but the vivid soldiers-and-salt story attached to it later, and belongs with folk etymology, not fact.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le sel" — masculine

- "du sel, s'il vous plaît"
- the real cousins — "sel, salt — one PIE root, two branches"
- "beurre, fromage, sel" — three foods, all masculine

Before you move on

Say "salt, please." (***Du sel, s'il vous plaît.*** — masculine.) Is *sel* related to English *salt* by common descent or by borrowing? (**Common descent** — both from PIE **sal-*, **a genuine cousin pair.) Is the "soldiers paid in salt" story behind *salary* true?** (No — **it appears in no ancient source; *salārium* really is built on *sal*, but the legend is later.)**

34.4 l'œuf — the egg, that loses its consonant only in the plural

Fromage, beurre, sel — three foods, three masculine articles. The fourth starts with a vowel, so this chapter closes the way it began: with the elision rule from *l'ami*.

You'll want to know: the word

l'œuf — the egg. **Masculine**, and it elides — never *le œuf*.

Un œuf, s'il vous plaît. — "An egg, please." Said with a clear final **f**: *un-EUF*.

Now the plural: **les œufs**. Spelled with the same *-fs*, but the **f disappears entirely** — *lay-ZEU*, not *lay-ZEUFS*. One noun, and its final consonant survives in the singular only to vanish in the plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

œuf ← Latin **ovum**, from a Proto-Indo-European word for "egg," ***h₂ōwyóm**. English **egg** descends from the *same* root, by the Germanic road (Old Norse *egg*, from Proto-Germanic **ajja-*) — a real cousin pair, exactly like *sel* and *salt*, not a borrowing in either direction. The Latin-only learned family — **oval**, **ovary**, **ovum** itself — are the ones English took straight from written Latin, sitting beside

its own native *egg*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'œuf" — masculine, elided
- "un œuf" — f pronounced
- "les œufs" — f silent
- the cousins — "œuf, egg — same PIE root, two branches"

Before you move on

Say "an egg, please," then "the eggs." (***Un œuf, s'il vous plaît*** — f pronounced; ***les œufs*** — f silent.) Why does *l'œuf* elide? (**Vowel-initial** — same rule as *l'ami*.) Is *œuf* borrowed from Latin *ovum*, or a genuine cousin of it? (**A cousin** — both from PIE **h₂ōwyóm*, like English *egg*.) Name the chapter's four foods with their articles. (***Le fromage, le beurre, le sel, l'œuf*** — all masculine.)

Chapter 35

Eyes, Nose, Mouth, Stomach

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the eye and its irregular-looking plural yeux, the nose, the mouth and the stomach in French, extending Chapter 17's head and hand.
>
> *Say j'ai mal au ventre, take ventriloquist apart as "belly-speaker," and close the chapter's own four words (l'œil/les yeux, le nez, la bouche, le ventre) beside Chapter 17's head and hand. Reaches back past the chapter to la main's nasal -ain, contrasted with ventre's own different nasal vowel, and further back to le café, l'ami and l'œuf, one word from each of this book's four newest chapters.*

35.1 l'œil, les yeux — the eye, and a plural that only looks broken

> You have the head and the hand. This chapter fills in the rest of the body it left for later — starting above the mouth.

You'll want to know: the word

l'œil — the eye. **Masculine**, and it elides — never *le œil*. Its plural is completely different in **shape**: **les yeux**.

Tête, remember, is feminine even though it never looks like a body part should tell you its gender; *œil* is masculine, on the same body, right above it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

œil ← Vulgar Latin **oclus** (from **oculus**, "eye") — a heavily worn singular. **Yeux** ← Latin's plural **oculōs**, and *that* development is completely **regular** sound change, the ordinary path oculōs was always going to take.
So *les yeux* doesn't break the rules — *œil* does. The singular eroded further and faster than the plural did, and the two paths simply arrived looking unrelated. French has a small family of nouns built this way — *le ciel / les cieux* ("sky/skies"), *le travail / les travaux* ("work/works") — an odd-looking plural is often the **regular** one, standing next to a singular that took the shortcut.

Why it's said this way

You may remember *tête* itself came from **testa**, a soldier's joke for "pot" that replaced the real Latin word for head. *Œil* never had that kind of accident — it's simply the ordinary, expected descendant of *oculus*, sitting on the very pot the joke was about.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "l'œil" — one eye, masculine
- "les yeux" — both eyes, different shape
- "la tête, l'œil" — feminine pot, masculine eye
- the family — "le ciel/les cieux, œil/yeux" — same pattern

Before you move on

Say "the eye" and "the eyes." (***L'œil, les yeux.***) Which form is the *regular* sound outcome of Latin — *œil* or *yeux*? (***Yeux*** — from *oculōs*; *œil* is the one that eroded further.) What other French noun changes shape the same way between singular and plural? (**Le ciel / les cieux**, or **le travail / les travaux**.) What was *tête* originally a soldier's joke for? (**A pot.**)

35.2 le nez — the nose, another real cousin

Below the eye, the nose — and a third pair of true cousins, joining *sel/salt* and *œuf/egg*.

Comprendre is *prendre* with a prefix, so it breaks in the same places: *je comprends*, *nous comprenons*.

You'll want to know: the word

le nez — the nose. **Masculine**, final **z silent**: *NAY*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nez ← Latin **nāsus**, from PIE ***nas-**. English **nose** descends from the *same* root, down the Germanic branch — a genuine cousin, exactly the pattern *sel/salt* and *œuf/egg* already showed you.
English **nasal** is a *different* kind of relative: a **learned** borrowing of the Latin word itself, sitting beside native *nose* the same way *lactic* sits beside native *milk*. One root, French *nez* and English *nose* both inherited; one root, English separately borrowed as *nasal*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le nez" — silent z
- "l'œil, le nez" — eye, nose
- the cousins — "nez, nose — same PIE root"
- the borrowing — "nasal," taken later, straight from Latin

Before you move on

Say "the nose." (***Le nez*** — masculine, silent z.) Is *nez* related to English *nose* by inheritance or by borrowing? (**Inheritance** — both from PIE **nas-*, a genuine cousin pair.) Where does English *nasal* fit? (A **learned borrowing** of the Latin word, alongside native *nose* — the same relationship as *lactic* beside *milk*.)

35.3 la bouche — the mouth, which used to mean "cheek"

Tête wasn't Latin's word for head. This one wasn't Latin's word for mouth, either.

You'll want to know: the word

la bouche — the mouth. **Feminine.**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Classical Latin's real word for "mouth" was **ōs**. But Latin's vowel lengths eventually stopped being pronounced, and short **os** "**bone**" and long **ōs** "**mouth**" **collapsed into the same sound**. Faced with that collision, speakers reached for a slangy stand-in instead: **bucca**, which had meant "**cheek**" — much the way an English speaker might call a mouth a "cheek" in passing. The slang stuck, and **bucca** became French's ordinary word for mouth: **bouche**.
English kept *bucca*'s **original** sense in one narrow technical word, **buccal** ("of the cheek," used mostly by dentists) — never demoted to "mouth" the way French's everyday word was.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "la bouche" — feminine
- "le nez, la bouche" — nose, mouth
- the collision — "os 'bone', ōs 'mouth' — same sound"
- "bucca" — cheek, the slang that took over

Before you move on

Say "the mouth." (***La bouche*** — feminine.) What did Latin *bucca* originally mean? (**"Cheek."**) Why did *bucca* replace the real Latin word for mouth, *ōs*? (**It collided in sound with *os*, "bone,"** once vowel length stopped being pronounced.) Which English word still keeps *bucca*'s original "cheek" sense? (**Buccal.**)

35.4 le ventre — the stomach, closing four chapters of everyday words

Eye, nose, mouth — three words down. One more, and this book's body vocabulary reaches all the way from the head and the hand to here.

You'll want to know: the word

le ventre — the stomach, the belly. **Masculine.**

J'ai mal au ventre. — "My stomach hurts."

Say the nasal: **ven-**. It's a different vowel from *la main*'s *-ain*, even though both endings are written with a nasal consonant after the vowel — French has several distinct nasal vowels, and *main* and *ventre* use two of them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ventre ← Latin **venter**, stem **ventr-**, "belly." English kept two learned words on this stem: **ventral** ("of the belly," the opposite of *dorsal*), and **ventriloquist** — *venter* + *loquī*, "to speak" — literally a "**belly-speaker**," someone whose voice seems to come from the stomach rather than the mouth.

Grammar Lens: five chapters, tied off

Before you close the book on this run, three threads from earlier chapters, tied off here:

- **la tête** is **feminine**, was Roman soldiers' slang for a **pot**, and wears a circumflex that marks a **lost *s***.
- **oui** once **split a country** into *langue d'oïl* and *langue d'oc*; its cousin **si** is the one you use to contradict a negative.
- and among this run's own new words — **le sel**, **la personne** — every one still carries the article that names its gender, exactly the promise this book made back at *la main*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "le ventre" — masculine
- "j'ai mal au ventre"
- "main, ventre" — two different nasal vowels
- "ventriloquist" — the belly-speaker
- the whole run — "le café, l'ami, l'œuf, le ventre" — four chapters, one thread

Before you move on

Say "my stomach hurts." (***J'ai mal au ventre.***) What English word literally means "belly-speaker"? (**Ventriloquist** — *venter* + *loquī*.) Is *ventre*'s nasal the same vowel as *la main*'s? (**No** — a different nasal vowel, despite both being spelled with a nasal consonant.) Name the four body words this chapter added to the head and the hand. (***L'œil* (les yeux), *le nez*, *la bouche*, *le ventre***.)

35.5 The three marks, from cold

The word that closed four chapters of everyday nouns — the stomach. Say it with its article.

You'll want to know: le ventre, and the nasal it shares

le ventre — masculine, and nasal like **la main**, but reaching that nasal through a different vowel. Two body words, two routes to the same kind of sound, and the gender is not predictable from either.

Script: the three marks, thirty chapters later

ê ç ï

Cover the page and say what each one does before checking. They were taught three pages apart and have not been asked for since, which makes this the first real test of them:

- **ê** records a letter that is gone. English usually still has it.
- **ç** keeps a **c** soft where it would otherwise harden.
- **ï** splits two vowels that would otherwise be read as one.

One is history, one is sound, one is grouping. Sorting them that way is what stops them blurring into a single topic called *accents*.

Before you move on

Which mark is a piece of history rather than an instruction? (**The circumflex**.) Which one changes a consonant? (**The cédille**.) Which one changes how two letters group? (**The tréma**.) And what gender is **ventre**? (**Masculine** — and nothing about the word says so.)

Chapter 36

Asking a Question — Three Ways, and Which One to Use

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (9) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask a question in French three ways — by raising my voice, with est-ce que, and by inversion — choose between them by how formal the moment is, and ask where, when, how, how much and why.
>
> *The one question word that agrees with its noun, closing a chapter that began with the question costing no new words at all.*

36.1 une question — the question you make with your voice alone

You can say a great deal in French and cannot yet ask anything. This chapter fixes that, and the first way costs you no new words at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

French has three ways to ask a question. This is the first, the cheapest, and by far the commonest in speech — and it costs you **nothing new at all**.

> **Tu parles français.** — You speak French. **Tu parles français ?** — You speak French?

The words are identical. The order is identical. The only

difference is that the second one rises at the end, and in writing, a question mark.
That is a real question, correct and unremarkable, and it is what a French speaker uses with friends, family, in a shop, all day. Note the space before the question mark — French puts a thin space before `?`, `!`, `:` and `;`, which English does not.
Why start here. Textbooks usually open with the formal inversion, which is the rarest of the three and the hardest to build. You can ask about anything you can already say, right now, by lifting your voice. Everything after this lesson is about *register* and *precision*, not about being understood.

Your turn

- *Say it: une question*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

How do you turn a French statement into a question with no new words? (**Raise your voice** at the end.) Is that correct French, or a shortcut? (**Correct**, and the commonest form in speech.) And what does French put before a question mark? (A **space**.)

36.2 est-ce que — the phrase that announces a question before it starts

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

Vous m'aidez. An ordinary *-er* verb: *j'aide*, *nous aidons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The second way. Put **est-ce que** in front of a statement and it becomes a question:

Est-ce que tu parles français ?

Nothing else moves. The statement stays exactly as it was; the phrase sits in front of it like a flag.

It is worth taking apart, because it looks like three words and behaves like one. Literally it is *est-ce que* = "is it that…" — French built a question marker out of a tiny sentence, then wore it down until nobody hears the parts any more. A speaker says it as one word, roughly *ESS-kuh*.

When you would choose it. It is more neutral than the voice-only question and less formal than the inversion coming next — the safe middle. In writing, where your voice cannot rise, it is the ordinary way to ask.

English has no equivalent and does not need one, because English inverts instead: *do you speak…*. That English **do** is doing the same job — a meaningless word inserted to mark a question — so the device is familiar even though the word is not.

Your turn

- *Say it: est-ce que*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **est-ce que** do to a statement? (Turns it into a **question**, with nothing else moving.) What is it literally? (*Is it that…*) And which English word does the same job? (**Do**, as in *do you speak*.)

36.3 où — where

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

où — where

Où est la gare ? — Where is the station? **Tu vas où ?** — Where are you going?

Both are correct. The question word can open the sentence or sit at the end where the answer would go, and the second is what you will hear far more in speech.

Now the accent, which is not decoration. French has two words spelled *o-u*:

- **ou** — *or*
- **où** — *where*

The grave accent is the **only** difference in writing, and in speech there is no difference at all: both are *oo*. This is the one place in French where an accent does nothing to the sound and everything to the meaning, which is why it is never optional. The two were different words in Latin: *où* ← *ubi*, "where", and *ou* ← *aut*, "or" (EtymDB 2.1). You now hold the first question word, and with it a question you can actually use on the first day in a French city.

Your turn

- *Say it: où*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **où** mean? (**Where**.) What is the same word without the accent? (**Or**.) And do they sound different? (**No** — the accent is meaning only.)

36.4 quand — when

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

Entendre once covered hearing, attending, understanding and intending. Hearing took the word when *ouïr* wore out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quand — when

Quand est-ce que tu arrives ? — When do you arrive?

The **d** is silent. *Quand* is *kahn*, nasal, with nothing on the end — until the next word begins with a vowel, and then it comes back **as a t**:

Quand est-ce que... — *kahn-TESS-kuh*

That is **liaison**, and it is one of the things that makes fast French hard to cut into words: the consonants at the ends of words are silent alone and audible in company. Nobody writes it down; every speaker does it. Latin **quando** is the ancestor, and it is worth spending: Spanish *cuándo*, Italian *quando*, Portuguese *quando* — and the *qu-* on all of them is the same Latin question-word opening you see in English **query**, **question** and **quest**.

Your turn

- *Say it: quand*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **quand** mean? (**When**.) Is the *d* pronounced? (**Not alone** — but it returns as a *t* before a vowel.) What is that called? (**Liaison**.)

36.5 comment — how

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comment — how

You already say it. **Comment allez-vous ?** is *how are you*, and you learned it before you knew it contained a question word.

Comment tu dis ça ? — How do you say that?
Comment ? — on its own: *Sorry? / Pardon?*

That last one is worth having. Used alone it is how a French speaker asks you to repeat — politer than *quoi ?*, which is the blunt *what?* The origin is Latin **quomodo**, "in what manner", and English took the same idea by a different road: **mode**, **modal** and **manner** are all from *modus*, the "how" half of it.

Your turn

- *Say it: comment*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **comment** mean? (**How**.) Which phrase you already knew contains it? (*Comment allez-vous* — how are you.) And what does **Comment ?** alone mean? (**Sorry? / Pardon?**)

36.6 combien — how much and how many

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

combien — how much, how many

C'est combien ? — How much is it? **Combien de personnes ?** — How many people?

English splits this and French does not. *Much* for things you measure, *many* for things you count — French uses **combien** for both and lets the noun sort it out. One word fewer to choose between, and one of the rare places French is simpler than English. *Combien* is Old French *com* + *bien*, "how well", with *bien* ← Latin *bene* (EtymDB 2.1). Note **combien de** before a noun. The *de* is not optional and does not change for number: *combien de personnes*, *combien d'argent*.
C'est combien ? is the single most useful question in this chapter for a traveller, and it is three words long.

Your turn

- *Say it: combien*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What does **combien** cover that English splits in two? (**How much** and **how many**.) What must follow it before a noun? (**de**.) And how do you ask a price? (*C'est combien ?*)

36.7 pourquoi — why

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pourquoi — why

Take it apart:
pour ("for") + **quoi** ("what") → **pourquoi**
For what? French built its *why* out of two words you can still see inside it, and English does the same thing in *what for?* Both halves are Latin underneath: *pour* ← Vulgar Latin *por*, *quoi* ← *quid*, "what" (EtymDB 2.1).

Pourquoi ? — Why?

The answer, "because," is built to match — *by this that* against *for what* — and it gets a lesson of its own a few chapters on, where it joins two clauses into one sentence.
That gives you the last of the five question words.

Your turn

- *Say it: pourquoi*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What is **pourquoi** made of? (Two words, "for" and "what" — *for what?*) What does English build the same way? (*What for?*)

36.8 parlez-vous — the third way to ask

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The third and last way. Swap the verb and the subject, and join them with a hyphen:

> **Tu parles français. → Parles-tu français ? Vous parlez français. → Parlez-vous français ?**

This is **inversion**, and it is the form English used to have — *speak you French?* — and lost, keeping it only in *are you*, *have you*, *can you*.
Where the three ways differ is register, not meaning:

- **Tu parles français ?** — friends, family, shops. Commonest by far.
- **Est-ce que tu parles français ?** — neutral, and the default in writing.
- **Parlez-vous français ?** — formal, written, or deliberately polite.

A beginner is often taught inversion first and then sounds like a textbook in every conversation. It is the one you need to **recognise** immediately and can afford to **produce** last.
One sound rule: if the verb ends in a vowel and the subject begins with one, French inserts a **-t-** to keep them apart — *parle-t-il*, *a-t-elle*. It exists purely so two vowels do not collide.

Your turn

- *Say it: parlez-vous*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

What are the three ways to ask a question? (**Voice**, **est-ce que**, **inversion**.) Which is commonest in speech? (**Voice**.) Which should

you learn to recognise first and produce last? (**Inversion**.) And why the *-t-* in *parle-t-il*? (To keep **two vowels apart**.)

36.9 quel, quelle — which

Recall the previous piece before adding another.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quel — which, what

Every question word so far has been invariable. This one is not: **quel is an adjective**, and like every French adjective it agrees with the noun it asks about.

Quel jour ? — Which day? *(masculine)* **Quelle heure ?** — What time? *(feminine)* **Quels livres ?** — Which books? *(masculine plural)* **Quelles questions ?** — Which questions? *(feminine plural)*

All four sound identical. *Kell*, every time. The agreement is entirely written — which makes it a spelling problem rather than a speaking one, and it is one of the commonest places a French exam takes marks off.
You already use one of these without thinking: **Quelle heure est-il ?** — what time is it. *Heure* is feminine, so *quelle* takes two *l*s and an *e*. That is the fifth and last way this chapter teaches you to ask. Three structures, five question words, and one adjective that agrees.

Your turn

- *Say it: quel, quelle*
- *Ask:* the same question all three ways you know so far

Before you move on

Why does **quel** change and *où* does not? (**Quel is an adjective** and agrees with its noun.) Do the four forms sound different? (**No** — all *kell*.) So what kind of problem is it? (A **spelling** one.)

Chapter 37

Want, Can, Must

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I want, what I can do and what I must do, put any verb I already know behind vouloir, pouvoir or devoir without changing it, and choose je voudrais over je veux when I am asking rather than stating.
>
> *Three verbs that between them open a sentence for every verb the reader already owns – and the point at which correct French used at the wrong moment is named as a harder mistake to hear than a grammatical one.*

37.1 vouloir — to want

Put **est-ce que** in front of a statement and it becomes a question. Hold that; you will need it in a moment.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vouloir — **to want**. It comes from Latin *velle*, through Vulgar Latin **volēre* (EtymDB 2.1). The singular forms first:
Say it as a chant, three beats:

je veux — tu veux — il veut

I want, you want, he wants. And notice what your ear reports: **all three sound identical**. *veux*, *veux*, *veut* — the spelling distinguishes them and the mouth does not. That is why French keeps the subject pronoun in front: without *je* or *tu*, nothing tells a listener who wants what.

A *want* needs something wanted:

- **Je veux un café.** — I want a coffee.
- **Tu veux le pain ?** — Do you want the bread?

Why it's said this way

Now the part a phrasebook will not tell you, and the reason this word needs a warning where *parler* did not.
Je veux is blunt in a request. Said to a waiter or a shopkeeper it lands close to English *I want*, which is to say it lands badly. It is perfectly ordinary elsewhere — *je veux dire* is "I mean", and *je veux bien* is a cheerful "gladly" — so the problem is not the word, it is the counter. French has a softened form built for exactly this, and it is the one you should reach for by default:

je voudrais — *I would like*

Same verb, different shape. **Je voudrais un café** is what a French speaker actually says across a counter, and it is no harder to say than *je veux*.
So learn both, and learn when each belongs. *Je veux* is for a want you are simply stating — to a friend, to a child, about yourself. **Je voudrais is for asking anyone for anything.** If you are unsure which you are doing, you are asking, and you want *voudrais*.

Your turn

- *Say it: je veux, tu veux, il veut* — and hear that all three are the same sound
- *Say it: je voudrais un café*, as though to a stranger behind a counter
- *Ask: est-ce que tu veux un café ?*

Before you move on

Give the three singular forms. (***Veux, veux, veut*** — all said the same.) You are ordering coffee from someone you have never met: which form do you use? (***Je voudrais***, never *je veux*.)

37.2 pouvoir — can

Say *je voudrais un café*. That was a want, softened.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pouvoir — **to be able**, and in practice **can**. It comes from Old French *povoir* (EtymDB 2.1), from Vulgar Latin **potēre*. The singular: Same chant, three beats:

je peux — tu peux — il peut

I can, you can, he can. The same pattern you just met: **all three sound alike**, and the pronoun carries the person.
That final *t* is silent — until you invert. **Peut-il ?** wakes it, and needs no added *-t-* the way *parle-t-il* did, because this verb already has one.
What follows *pouvoir* is a **plain, unchanged verb**:

- **Je peux parler français.** — I can speak French.
- **Tu peux aider ?** — Can you help?

Nothing happens to *parler* or *aider*. They arrive in the dictionary form and stay there, which makes this one of the cheapest structures in French: every **plain** verb you know can be put behind *peux* with no change at all.
One group does change, and you already own two of them. A verb that carries *se* keeps it, and the *se* matches the person: **je peux m'asseoir**, **tu peux te lever**. The verb itself is still untouched; only its little pronoun follows you.

Why it's said this way

The reason *pouvoir* matters early has little to do with ability.
Asking someone to do something by telling them to do it is abrupt in French, as it is in English. What French reaches for instead is a **question about ability** — the same move English makes with *can you*:

Tu peux fermer la porte ? — Can you close the door?

Nobody is really asking whether the other person is capable. The

question is the politeness, and it is why *pouvoir* buys you more than a translation would suggest.
For a stranger, soften it the same way *vouloir* softened into *voudrais* — the identical shift, on this verb:

Pourriez-vous fermer la porte ?

Your turn

- *Say it: je peux, tu peux, il peut* — again, one sound between them
- *Say it: je peux parler français*
- *Ask: tu peux aider ?*

Before you move on

What happens to the verb that follows *peux*? (**Nothing** — it stays in its dictionary form.) Why does a beginner need *pouvoir* early? (Because **asking whether someone can** is how French makes a polite request.)

37.3 devoir — must

Say *je peux parler français*. The second verb did not change.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

devoir — to have to, must. The singular, and by now you can predict the shape of the problem:

je dois — tu dois — il doit

I must, you must, he must. **All three sound alike again.** Three verbs in a row have done this, which is the point worth carrying away: in the French present singular, the three persons are routinely one sound, and the pronoun is what tells them apart. This is not a quirk of these three words.
The exceptions are the three verbs you learned earliest, and they are exceptions because they are used constantly: *suis / es / est*, *ai / as / a*, *vais / vas / va*. Everywhere else, expect one sound.

A plain verb follows, exactly as after *peux*:

- **Je dois partir.** — I must leave.
- **Tu dois entendre.** — You must hear.

Why it's said this way

devoir comes from Latin ***dēbēre***, **to owe** — and it never stopped meaning that. The same French verb still does both jobs:

- **Je dois partir.** — I must leave.
- **Je te dois dix euros.** — I owe you ten euros.

One word, two obligations — and the order matters. The owing came first: the Latin verb meant *to owe*, and the sense of *must* grew out of it, exactly as English *ought* grew out of *owed*.
That Latin *dēbēre* is also where English gets **debt**, **debit** and **due** — so a word you have never seen has been sitting in your own vocabulary all along, spelled differently and meaning the half of *devoir* that involves money.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *je dois, tu dois, il doit*
- *je dois partir*
- *je te dois dix euros* — the same verb, the other meaning

Before you move on

What two things does *devoir* mean? (**Must**, and **to owe**.) Which English words share its Latin root? (**Debt**, **debit**, **due**.)

37.4 Practice — want, can, must

Say *je dois partir*.

What you've built

Three verbs, one shape between them. Say each chant in turn:

je veux — tu veux — il veut

je peux — tu peux — il peut

je dois — tu dois — il doit

Every chant is three forms that sound identical, and between the three chants you have wanting, being able, and having to.
And all three do the same structural thing: **a plain verb follows, unchanged.**

- **Je veux partir.** — I want to leave.
- **Je peux partir.** — I can leave.
- **Je dois partir.** — I must leave.

That is the payoff, and it is larger than three words. Every verb you have learned in this book — *parler*, *aider*, *fermer*, *ouvrir*, *écrire*, *lire*, *dormir* — can be dropped in behind any of these three with **no change of any kind**. You have not learned three expressions. You have learned three openings, and you already own everything that goes after them.

Why it's said this way

One caution carried forward, because it is the difference between sounding capable and sounding rude.

- Stating a want to a friend: **je veux**.
- Asking anyone for anything: **je voudrais**.
- Asking someone else to act: **tu peux…?** or **vous pouvez…?**

The blunt form is not wrong French. It is correct French used at the wrong moment, which is a harder mistake to hear and an easier one to make.

Your turn

- *Say it: je veux partir, je peux partir, je dois partir*
- *Say it:* the same three with *parler français* instead of *partir*
- *Ask: vous pouvez fermer la porte ?*

Before you move on

What happens to a verb placed after *veux*, *peux* or *dois*? (**Nothing** — it stays in its dictionary form.) You want to ask a stranger to close a window: which of the three do you start with? (***Vous pouvez…***)

Chapter 38

Five Ways to Point

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that something exists, say what it is, hand somebody over, point at a noun, and answer the question where.
>
> *Everything the book owns is pointed at five ways: it exists, it is a thing, it is handed over, it is pointed at in front of its noun, and it is somewhere. One Latin word runs under four of the five – ecce, 'behold', which fused into ce, ici, voici and voila and then vanished inside all of them.*

38.1 il y a — "there is," built out of "it has there"

Say **il a** and **il est**. You have both verbs whole, and you still cannot say that something exists.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the three ways to ask a question — voice, *est-ce que*, inversion

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

il y a — there is, there are.

Said *eel-ya*, three words run into two syllables.

Il y a du pain. — There is some bread.

Il y a un café. — There is a café.

Word for word it says **it has there**. The **il** stands for nobody — the same empty *il* as in *il est trois heures* — the **a** is *avoir*, and the **y** is the piece worth stopping on.
That **y** is Latin **ibi**, "there," and it survives in French almost nowhere else. Spanish welded the same *ibi* onto its own *ha* and got **hay**; French kept the two apart and writes them still. Two languages, one Latin adverb, one idea — and only French leaves the seam visible.
One shape covers both numbers. **Il y a un café** and **il y a deux cafés** use the identical phrase, so there is no *there are* to learn separately.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *il y a* — *eel-ya*
- with the partitive you already own — "Il y a du pain, du vin, de l'eau."
- with a count — "Il y a un café" and "Il y a deux cafés", the same phrase twice
- the three pieces, slowly — *il … y … a*
- with the chain from the last chapter, the second verb unchanged — "Je veux du pain" and "Il va y avoir du pain"

Before you move on

What does *il y a* say word for word? (**It has there.**) What is the **y**? (**Latin *ibi*, "there"** — the same word inside Spanish *hay*.) Does it change for plural? (**No.**) Say "there is some bread."

38.2 c'est — "this is," and the pointing phrase inside it

Il y a says a thing exists. It cannot say **what** the thing is. Say **il est** and **l'eau**, and watch the apostrophe do its usual work.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

c'est — this is, that is. · **ce sont** — these are, those are.

ce is the pointing word, **est** is *être*, and the **e** of *ce* falls out in front of a vowel exactly as *le* becomes *l'*:

C'est du café. — That's coffee. · **C'est mon frère.** — That's my brother.

For a plural French switches the verb and stops eliding, because *sont* opens with a consonant:

Ce sont des cafés. — Those are cafés.

ce is Latin **ecce hoc** — *behold this* — a whole phrase worn down to two letters over fifteen centuries. The *ecce* half is still doing work elsewhere in this language, and the next two lessons will show where.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *c'est* — one syllable, *say*
- the table — "C'est du pain. C'est du fromage. C'est du café."
- people — "C'est mon frère. C'est ma sœur."
- the plural — "Ce sont des cafés."
- the pair — "Il y a un café" against "C'est un café"

Before you move on

What two words are inside *c'est*? (***Ce*** and ***est***.) What happens for a plural? (***Ce sont***, with no elision.) What Latin phrase is *ce*? (***Ecce hoc*** — "behold this".) What does *il y a* do that *c'est* does not? (**Say a thing exists without saying what it is.**)

38.3 ici, là, là-bas — three distances

You can ask **où ?**. You have had no way at all to answer it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ici — here. · **là** — there. · **là-bas** — over there, further off.

Où est le café ? — Ici.

ici is Latin **ecce hic**, "behold here" — the same **ecce**, "behold," that is buried inside **c'est**. French said its pointing word so often that it fused into several separate everyday words and then disappeared inside each of them; two more of them arrive in the next lesson.
là-bas is **là** plus **bas**, "low" — *there below.* The picture is of something further down a road, and it marks the far end of a three-step scale English can only manage with two words and a gesture.
The accent on **là** is doing real work: it separates the adverb from **la**, the article. Same letter, same sound, and the grave mark is the only difference on the page.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three, near to far — "ici, là, là-bas"
- the question and its answer — "Où est le café ? — Ici."
- "Le pain est là."
- "Il y a un café là-bas."
- the pair the accent separates — "la" the article, "là" the place
- with what it is — "C'est le café. Il est là."

Before you move on

Say the three distances. (***Ici, là, là-bas.***) What is *là-bas* made of? (***Là*** plus ***bas***, "low" — *there below.*) What does the accent on *là* separate it from? (**The article *la*.**) Answer *où est le pain ?* three

ways.

38.4 voici — "here is," and introducing somebody else

You can give your own name, ask for somebody else's, and shake hands afterwards. Say all three. Then notice that you have never been able to introduce a third person.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voici — here is, here are. · **voilà** — there is, there are.

Voici ma mère. — This is my mother.

Voilà mon père. — That's my father.

Both are frozen commands. **voici** is **vois** + **ci**, "see here"; **voilà** is **vois** + **là**, "see there". Nobody hears an order in them any more, and the verb inside has not been conjugated for centuries.
The **ci** and the **là** are the two words you took last lesson, and the *vois* in front of them carries the same Latin **ecce**, "behold," that is buried inside *ce* and *ici*. So French points four ways off one ancient root — *ce*, *ici*, *voici*, *voilà* — and each of the four froze at a different moment. Between them and *c'est*, you can now hand somebody over:

Voici ma sœur. — Enchanté.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *voici* and *voilà*
- the household — "Voici ma mère. Voici mon père."
- "Voici mon frère. Voici ma sœur."
- "Voici mon ami." then the reply, "Enchanté."
- the four pointing words in one breath — "ce, ici, voici, voilà"

- your own name, then somebody else's — "Je m'appelle…", "Voici…"

Before you move on

What two words are frozen inside *voici*? (***Vois*** and ***ci*** — "see here".) And inside *voilà*? (***Vois*** and ***là***.) Introduce your mother, and answer yourself. (**Voici ma mère. — Enchanté.**)

38.5 ce, cet, cette, ces — pointing at a noun

Say **le**, **la**, **les**. Those say *the*. Nothing you own says *this* in front of a noun — *c'est* and *voici* both need a whole sentence.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ce, **cet**, **cette**, **ces** — this, that, these, those, standing in front of a noun.

The choice follows the article you already know, one for one:

the noun takes	you say
le	**ce** pain
le, before a vowel	**cet** ami
la	**cette** mère
les	**ces** cafés

Only the second line is new machinery, and it is machinery you have already met from the other side. *Le ami* is impossible, so French writes **l'ami**. *Ce ami* is impossible for the identical reason — and here French borrows a **t** instead of eliding, giving **cet ami**.
The result is a small trap for the ear: **cet ami** and **cette amie** are pronounced exactly alike, and only the sentence around them says which was meant.
All four are Latin **ecce iste**, "behold that one" — the same **ecce** inside *ce*, *voici* and *voilà*, welded this time to a different second half.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the article first, then the pointer — "le pain, ce pain"

- "la mère, cette mère"
- "les cafés, ces cafés"
- the borrowed *t* — "l'ami, cet ami"
- the animals — "ce chien, ce chat"
- the two that sound alike — "cet ami", "cette amie"

Before you move on

Which shape goes in front of a *le*-word? (***Ce***.) A *la*-word? (***Cette***.) A plural? (***Ces***.) Why does *cet* exist? (**To keep two vowels apart**, the same job the apostrophe does in *l'ami*.) Which two of the four sound identical? (***Cet*** and ***cette***.)

38.6 Voici tout — the chapter, run cold

One Latin word is inside four things you learned this chapter. Name it, then name the four.

Your turn: the table, pointed at five ways

Everything the book has put on a table, pointed at five different ways. Say each line before you read the next.

Say these aloud:

- it exists — "Il y a du pain, du vin, de l'eau."
- what it is — "C'est du fromage. C'est du café. C'est du lait."
- handed over — "Voici le thé. Voici le sel. Voici le sucre."
- pointed at — "ce beurre, cet œuf, cette eau, ces cafés"
- the loan and the inheritance side by side — *café* and *thé* came from far away; *pain*, *vin* and *lait* never left

Your turn: the distant band — people, animals, the body

Now reach back. Every person, every animal and every part of the body this book has taught, introduced or pointed at.

Say these aloud:

- the household, handed over — "Voici ma mère, mon père, mon frère, ma sœur"
- the four Latin cousins those keep — *mater, pater, frater, soror*
- "Voici mon ami. Voici l'enfant. Voici la famille." then "Enchanté."
- the two animals, pointed at — "ce chien, ce chat"
- the body — "cette tête, cette main, ce nez, cet œil, cette bouche, ce ventre"
- the one that needed a borrowed *t*, and why — "cet œil"

Your turn: where

- *Say it:* "Où est le café ?" then all three answers — "Ici. Là. Là-bas."
- *Say it:* "Il y a un café là-bas."
- *Ask:* the same question the other two ways you know

Before you move on

Which phrase says a thing exists without saying what it is? (***Il y a.***) Which says what it is? (***C'est.***) Which hands it to somebody? (***Voici.***) Which points at it in front of its noun? (***Ce, cet, cette, ces.***) And what single Latin word is buried in *ce*, *ici*, *voici* and *voilà*? (***Ecce*** — "behold".)

Chapter 39

Where Two Words Melt Into One

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to, at, of and from, and I know which four combinations of preposition and article melt into a single word.

Every noun the book owns is put in somebody's hands and put somewhere. Two prepositions and four articles make eight combinations, four of which melt – and the rule that decides which is the one du already showed: le and les contract, la and l' do not. The u inside au was an l, which is the same eight-century-old change that made chevaux out of cheval.

39.1 à — one letter, and the accent that saves it

Say **il a** and **il y a**. The **a** in both is the verb. This lesson takes the other one.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the three question words you took last — *comment*, *combien*, *pourquoi*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à — to, at.

à Paris — to Paris, in Paris. · **à trois heures** — at three o'clock.

Latin **ad** gave it, and the **d** wore off, leaving a single letter. English

kept the same *ad* in a hundred borrowed words — *advance*, *admit*, *adhere* — where it still means *toward*.
The grave accent has one job and no other: it separates this word from **a**, the verb. Same letter, same sound, and only the mark on the page says which is meant. French does this three times over — *a*/*à*, *ou*/*où*, *la*/*là* — and you have already met the third.
You have owned the clock since it was taught and had no way to say **at** a time. Now you have one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two *a*s — the verb "il a", the preposition "à Paris"
- the clock, at last — "à trois heures", "à midi", "à minuit"
- the three pairs the accent separates — "a/à", "ou/où", "la/là"
- ask for a time, then answer — "Quelle heure est-il ? — À midi."
- the three modals, each pointed at a time — "Je veux partir à midi. Je peux partir à midi. Je dois partir à midi." — and the second verb never moving

Before you move on

What Latin word is **à**? (***Ad.***) What is the accent for? (**To separate it from *a*, the verb** — nothing else.) Say "at midday" and "at three o'clock."

39.2 de — "of," and the word already hiding in *du*

Say **du pain**. You were told two words are inside it. Name them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

de — of, from.

le café de Paris — the café of Paris. · **le frère de**

Marie — Marie's brother.

That second line is worth a moment. French owns nothing with an apostrophe: it says **the brother of Marie**, and it has said so since Latin. English is the odd one here — the possessive **'s** is a Germanic survival that Latin's daughters never had, so *Marie's brother* is the outlier and *le frère de Marie* is the ordinary European shape.
Before a vowel it elides, exactly as *le* does:

le livre d'Anne — Anne's book.

And you have been saying **de** since the food chapter without meeting it alone: *du pain* is **de** + **le**, and *de l'eau* is **de** with nothing to contract.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- possession, the French way — "le frère de Marie", "la mère de Anne"
- elided — "le café d'Anne"
- the two you already had — "du pain", "de l'eau"
- the pair — "à Paris" and "de Paris"

Before you move on

How does French say "Marie's brother"? (**Le frère de Marie** — of Marie.) Which language invented the apostrophe possessive? (**English**, and none of Latin's daughters has one.) What two words are inside *du*? (***De*** and ***le***.)

39.3 au, aux — where *à* and *le* melt together

De plus *le* gave you **du**. Predict what *à* plus *le* gives before you read on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au = **à** + **le**. · **aux** = **à** + **les**.

au café — to the café. · **aux cafés** — to the cafés.

à la maison — no contraction, because *la* is not *le*.

Two of the four combinations melt and two do not, and the split is the same one *du* already showed you: **le** and **les** contract, **la** and **l'** stay apart.
The *u* in **au** was an *l*. French turned **al** into **au** across the whole language, and once you have seen it you find it everywhere:

older shape	**modern**
bel	**beau**
cheval	**chevaux**
journal	**journaux**

So the **x** on *aux* and the *x* on *chevaux* are the same story, and a plural that looks irregular is an *l* that turned into a *u* eight centuries ago.
The **x** of *aux* is silent alone and comes back as a **z** before a vowel — *aux amis* is *oh-ZAH-mee*, the liaison you have had since the numbers.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four — "au café", "aux cafés", "à la maison", "à l'eau"
- the pair that melt the same way — "du café", "au café"
- the liaison — "aux amis", *oh-ZAH-mee*
- the *l* that became a *u* — "bel, beau; cheval, chevaux"

Before you move on

What is *au* made of? (***À*** plus ***le***.) And *aux*? (***À*** plus ***les***.) Which two never contract? (***La*** and ***l'***.) What was the *u* of *au* before it was a *u*? (**An *l***, the same one inside *chevaux*.)

39.4 de la — the half of the partitive that was missing

Say "some bread" and "some water". Both are yours. Now try "some milk" — *le lait* is a *le*-word, but **la viande**, meat, is not.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

de la — some, in front of a *la*-word.

du lait — some milk. · **de la viande** — some meat. · **de l'eau** — some water.

Three shapes, one rule, and it is a rule you already own from two other places: **de** plus the article, contracting only where *le* and *les* contract. That is worth stating plainly, because it looks like three separate things to memorise and is one:

the noun takes	**some...**
le	**du**
la	**de la**
l'	**de l'**

The food chapter taught the first and third and stopped, because every noun on its table happened to be a *le*-word or a vowel-word. The middle line was never missing from the language, only from the table.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three shapes — "du lait, de la viande, de l'eau"
- the table you already had — "du pain, du vin, du fromage"
- the two drinks — "du café, du thé"
- article first, then the partitive — "le lait → du lait"
- pointed at, then measured — "ce lait", then "du lait"; "cette eau", then "de l'eau"

Before you move on

Which shape goes with a *la*-word? (***De la***.) With a *le*-word? (***Du***.) Why does *de la* not contract? (**Only *le* and *les* ever contract** — the same rule behind *du* and *au*.)

39.5 des — the plural of *un*, and the last shape of *some*

un café is *a café*. Say the plural. English drops the word entirely — *cafés* — and French cannot.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

des — some; and the plural of **un** and **une**.

un café → des cafés · une amie → des amies

Il y a des cafés. — There are cafés.

des is **de** + **les**, contracted exactly as *du* is *de* + *le*. So it completes two systems at once and adds no new machinery to either.
Here English is the language with the hole. English has *a* and no plural of it, so it says *books*, *cafés*, *friends* with nothing in front. French will not leave the slot empty, and a sentence with a bare plural noun in it sounds unfinished to a French ear. That is the single commonest mistake an English speaker makes in French, and it is a missing word rather than a wrong one.
The **s** is silent, and it comes back as a **z** before a vowel: *des amies* is *day-ZAH-mee*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- singular then plural — "un café, des cafés"
- "un chien, des chiens; un chat, des chats"
- the liaison — "des amies", *day-ZAH-mee*

- existence and identity, in the plural — "Il y a des cafés." "Ce sont des amis."
- all four shapes of *some* — "du, de la, de l', des"

Before you move on

What two words are inside *des*? (***De*** and ***les***.) What is the plural of *un café*? (***Des cafés***.) What does English put in that slot? (**Nothing** — it has no plural of *a*.) Say all four shapes of *some*.

39.6 Au café — the chapter, run cold

Two prepositions and four articles make eight combinations. Four melt into one word and four do not. Say which four melt, and say the one rule that decides it.

Your turn: the four that melt

Say these aloud:

- *à* melting — "au café", "aux cafés"
- *de* melting — "du pain", "des amis"
- the four that stay apart — "à la maison", "à l'eau", "de la viande", "de l'eau"
- the two liaisons — "aux amis", "des amis"

Your turn: the distant band — everything, placed and possessed

Every noun the book owns, put in somebody's hands and put somewhere. Say these aloud:

- the table, possessed — "le pain de Marie, le vin de Paris, le café d'Anne"
- the table, in the plural — "des œufs, des cafés, du sel, du sucre, du beurre"

- the household, possessed — “la mère de Marie, le frère d’Anne, la sœur de Paul”
- the animals — “le chien de l’enfant, le chat de l’ami”
- the clock, at last with a preposition — “à midi”, “à minuit”, “à trois heures”
- put it all together — “Il y a des cafés là-bas. C’est le café de Marie. Je suis au café.”

Before you move on

Which two articles contract, and which two never do? (***Le*** and ***les*** contract; ***la*** and ***l’*** do not.) Name the four melted words. (***Au, aux, du, des***.) How does French say “Marie’s bread”? (**Le pain de Marie**.) And what does English have that French does not need? (**An apostrophe.**)

Chapter 40

Two Ideas, One Sentence

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the order a French sentence holds to, and join two thoughts with and, or, but and because.
>
> *Every verb the book owns is given a reason. The chapter also names the sentence shape the reader has been building for thirty-odd chapters without being told what it was, and says why French is stricter about word order than Latin ever was: Latin's endings said who did what, French wore them off, and position had to take the job.*

40.1 sujet, verbe, objet — the order that carries the meaning

You have been building French sentences for thirty-odd chapters and nobody has said what shape they are. Say **je parle français** and **parlez-vous français ?** and notice that only one of the two moves anything.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the phrase that says a thing exists — *il y a*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The doer comes first, the verb second, and what is done to comes third.

Marie mange le pain. — Marie eats the bread.

Turn those three around and you change who eats whom. French depends on the order, and the dependence has a cause.
Latin did not depend on it. *Maria panem edit* and *panem Maria edit* mean the same thing, because **panem** carries an ending that says *this is the thing being eaten* wherever it stands. French wore those endings off — *panem* became *pain*, and the *-em* that did the work went with it. Once the endings were gone, something had to say who did what, and position took the job. So French is **stricter** about word order than its own parent was, and the strictness is the price of the simpler nouns.
Two places already break the order, and you own both: a question by inversion puts the verb first, and *voici* and *voilà* have no subject at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the plain order — "Marie mange le pain."
- turn it round and hear the meaning turn — "Le pain mange Marie."
- "Je parle français."
- the doer named by a possessive phrase — "Le frère de Marie mange le pain."
- the two shapes that break the order — "Parlez-vous français ?" and "Voici le café."

Before you move on

What order does a French sentence hold to? (**Doer, verb, done-to.**) Why is French stricter about it than Latin? (**Latin's endings said who did what; French wore them off**, so position had to take over.) Name the two shapes you own that break the order.

40.2 et — "and," and the one *t* that never wakes

You have said **et vous ?** and **et toi ?** many times as glue in a conversation. It has never been a word of its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

et — and.

du pain et du vin — bread and wine.

Latin **et**, unchanged in two thousand years, and the same word inside English **etcetera**.
It hides one genuine oddity. Every other final **t** in French comes back to life before a vowel — *quand est-ce que* is *kahn-TESS-kuh*, and you met that liaison with the numbers. The **t** of **et** never does:

du pain et un café — *pan … ay … uh café*, with a clean break.

Nobody can say why this one word refuses. It is old enough that grammarians record the exception and do not explain it, and it is worth knowing because the liaison you would naturally make there is the one liaison a French ear will notice as wrong.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *et*, and the break after it — "du pain et un café"
- the table joined — "du pain et du vin", "du café et du lait"
- the household joined — "mon frère et ma sœur"
- with the plural — "des cafés et des amis"

Before you move on

What Latin word is *et*? (***Et***, unchanged.) What does its **t** do before a vowel? (**Nothing** — it is the one final *t* in French that never comes back.) Say "bread and a coffee" with the break in the right place.

40.3 ou — "or," and the accent that is the only difference

You own **où**, "where." Say it. This lesson takes the word that is spelled the same and means something else entirely.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ou — or. · **où** — where.

du café ou du thé ? — coffee or tea?

The two have nothing to do with each other. **ou** is Latin **aut**, "or"; **où** is Latin **ubi**, "where." Two unrelated words wore down until they landed on the same three letters, and French put a grave accent on one of them to keep the page readable.
That is now the third such pair you have seen, and they work the same way every time: **a/à**, **la/là**, **ou/où**. The accent carries no sound at all in any of the three — it is punctuation for the eye.
Spoken French makes no distinction whatever. *Où est le café ?* and *ou est le café* are the same noise, and only the sentence settles it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the choice — "du café ou du thé ?"
- "du pain ou du vin ?", "un chien ou un chat ?"
- the two joiners together — "du pain et du vin", "du pain ou du vin"
- all three accent pairs — "a/à, la/là, ou/où"

Before you move on

Which Latin word is *ou*? (***Aut.***) And *où*? (***Ubi.***) Do they sound different? (**No** — the accent is for the eye.) Name the other two pairs the accent keeps apart. (***A/à*** and ***la/là.***)

40.4 mais — "but," and the Latin word for *more*

Et adds. *Ou* offers a choice. Neither can say that the second half disagrees with the first.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mais — but.

Ça va bien, mais je suis fatigué. — I'm well, but I'm tired.

Said *may*: the **ai** is the *e* sound you met in *lait*, and the **s** is silent.
mais is Latin **magis**, which meant **more** — and that is worth a moment, because the same word is still doing the older job next door. Spanish inherited *magis* as **más** and it still means *more*; French inherited it and drifted it into *but*.
The road between the two is short. *"He is clever, more he is lazy"* is not far from *"he is clever, but he is lazy"* — a *more* used to add a second, competing fact turns into a contrast if you use it that way for long enough. One Latin adverb, two daughters, two different parts of speech.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mais* — *may*, the *s* silent
- "Ça va bien, mais je suis fatigué."
- "Il y a du café, mais il n'y a pas de thé."
- the three joiners in a row — "et, ou, mais"

Before you move on

What did *mais* mean in Latin? (***More*** — *magis*.) Which language still uses that word for *more*? (**Spanish**, as *más*.) Say the three joiners.

40.5 parce que — "because," and the three words inside it

You can ask **pourquoi ?**. Nothing you own can answer it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parce que — because.

Pourquoi ? — Parce que je suis fatigué.

Three words are welded in there: **par** ("by"), **ce** ("this") and **que** ("that"). *By this that…* — a phrase that pointed forward at the reason about to be given, said so often that the first two fused and the third stayed loose. All three are inherited from Latin: *par* ← *per*, *ce* ← *ecce hoc*, "look, this", and *que* ← *quid*, *quem* or *quia* (EtymDB 2.1 lists all three).
English built its own the same way. **Because** is **by** + **cause**, and the seam is still faintly visible if you look. Two languages, two prepositions, two pointing words, one job.
Before a vowel the **que** elides, exactly as *le* and *de* do:

parce qu'il est midi — because it's noon.

And the **ce** inside it is the same *ce* you took two chapters ago — the fourth place that one small pointing word has turned up.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the question and its answer — "Pourquoi ? — Parce que je suis fatigué."
- elided — "parce qu'il est midi"
- the three pieces, slowly — *par … ce … que*
- all four joiners — "et, ou, mais, parce que"

Before you move on

What three words are inside *parce que*? (***Par***, ***ce***, ***que*** — "by this that".) How did English build *because*? (**By** plus **cause** — the same trick.) What happens to *que* before a vowel? (**It elides** — *parce qu'il*.)

40.6 Deux idées — the chapter, run cold

Say the four joiners. Then say what French lost that made its word order compulsory.

Your turn: joined, chosen, contrasted, explained

Say these aloud:

- joined — "du pain et du vin", "du café et du lait"
- chosen — "du café ou du thé ?", "de l'eau ou du vin ?"
- contrasted — "Ça va bien, mais je suis fatigué."
- explained — "Pourquoi ? — Parce que je suis fatigué."
- all four in one breath — "et, ou, mais, parce que"

Your turn: the distant band — every verb, given a reason

Every verb this book owns can now carry a reason. Say the sentence, then say why.

Say these aloud:

- "Je parle français, parce que j'habite à Paris."
- "Je travaille, mais je suis fatigué."
- the verbs of the page — "Je lis et j'écris."
- the verbs of the body — "Je marche ou je cours."
- "J'entends, mais je ne comprends pas."
- with the three modals — "Je veux dormir, parce que je suis fatigué." "Je peux prendre le café." "Je dois travailler."

- “J’aime le café, mais je demande du thé.”

Before you move on

Which joiner was Latin for *more*? (***Mais***, from *magis*.) Which one has three words inside it? (***Parce que***.) Which one’s *t* never makes a liaison? (***Et***.) And which two are kept apart only by an accent? (***Ou*** and ***où***.)

Chapter 41

Three More Ways to Use a Verb

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give a command, say what is about to happen, run the second regular verb family, drop the ne the way speakers do, and use on.
>
> *Every verb the book owns is commanded, put in the near future and refused. The imperative costs almost nothing because voici and voila have been frozen commands since the pointing chapter, and the near future costs nothing at all because it walks into the modal chain the reader already owns – a fourth verb in a slot built for three.*

41.1 Parle ! — the command, and the pronoun that goes missing

French insists on a subject pronoun in every sentence — you were told why: the endings are silent, so *je*, *tu* and *ils* carry the person alone. There is one place it lets the pronoun go.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the four melted words — *au, aux, du, des*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

To tell somebody to do something, take the **tu** form and drop the **tu** — and, for an *-er* verb, drop the **-s** as well.

tu parles → Parle ! · **tu écoutes → Écoute !**

vous parlez → Parlez ! — the polite one, unchanged.

The lost **-s** is a spelling rule and nothing more: it was silent anyway, so the command sounds identical to the form it came from. Only the page changes.
And you have been doing this since the pointing chapter without being told. **voici** and **voilà** are **vois** — the command form of *voir*, "see" — welded to *ci* and *là*. The shape was in your mouth before it had a name.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the form, then the command — "tu parles → Parle !"
- "Écoute !" and the polite "Écoutez !"
- the *-er* verbs you own — "Travaille ! Habite ! Aime ! Demande ! Marche !"
- the command you have said all along — "Voici", and the *vois* inside it

Before you move on

How do you build a command? (**Take the *tu* form, drop the pronoun** — and the *-s* on an *-er* verb.) Does it sound different from *tu parles*? (**No** — the *s* was silent.) Which word you have said for two chapters is a frozen command? (***Voici***.)

41.2 je vais partir — the future made out of "go"

Aller is yours, and so is the rule that a second verb after *vouloir*, *pouvoir* or *devoir* never changes. Put those two together before you read on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aller + an unchanged second verb says the thing is about to happen.

Je vais partir. — I'm going to leave.

Je vais travailler. — I'm going to work.

The second verb sits in its dictionary form and stays there, exactly as it does after *je veux*, *je peux* and *je dois*. So this is not a new construction; it is a fourth verb walking into a chain you already own. What makes it worth a lesson is that English does the identical thing and nobody notices. *I am* ***going to*** *leave* has no walking in it at all — the verb of motion has been emptied out and pointed at time. French emptied its own verb of motion the same way, separately, and the two languages arrived at the same idiom by the same road.
Spoken French uses this far more than the one-word future that grammars teach first. It is the ordinary way to talk about tomorrow.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Je vais partir." and "Je vais travailler."
- with the verbs of the page — "Je vais lire. Je vais écrire."
- "Je vais dormir. Je vais marcher."
- the chain, four verbs deep — "je veux dormir, je peux dormir, je dois dormir, je vais dormir"

Before you move on

What two pieces make the near future? (***Aller* plus a verb in its dictionary form**.) What does English use for the same job? (***Going to*** — its own emptied verb of motion.) Say "I'm going to read."

41.3 finir — the second regular family

parler gave you the biggest verb family in French. **dormir** was irregular and had to be learned as itself. There is a second **regular** family between them, and it also ends in *-ir*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

finir — to finish.

Latin **finire**, from **finis**, "end" — the same root inside English **final**, **finish**, **finite** and **define**.
Said *fee-NEER*, with the *r* sounded, which is where it differs from an *-er* infinitive: *parler* ends in a clean *ay* and *finir* ends in a real *r*.

Grammar Lens: the plural grows a syllable

In the singular the stem is **fini-**; in the plural an extra **-iss-** appears before the ending.

Singular: **je finis**, **tu finis**, **il finit** — all three the same noise, which is the ordinary French silence you have met on *parle*, *parles* and *parlent*.
Plural: **nous finissons**, **vous finissez**, **ils finissent** — an extra syllable in every one, and that syllable is what tells the ear a plural is happening.
The **-iss-** is a fossil. Latin had a suffix **-isc-** that meant *begin to*, and **finire** picked it up as **finiscere**, "to begin to end." The starting sense wore away completely; the syllable stayed. So *nous finissons* is carrying a meaning the verb has not had for fifteen hundred years. Dozens of everyday verbs run this pattern — *choisir*, *grandir*, *réussir* — and every one of them adds the same syllable in the same three places.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the infinitive, with its *r* sounded — "finir"
- the three singular forms, all one noise — "je finis, tu finis, il finit"
- the plural, hearing the extra syllable — "nous finissons, vous finissez, ils finissent"
- the three infinitive endings side by side — "parler, finir, dormir"
- with the near future — "Je vais finir."

Before you move on

What appears in the plural of *finir*? (**An extra *-iss-***.) What did that syllable once mean? (***Begin to*** — Latin's *-isc-*.) Name the three infinitive endings you now own. (***-er***, ***-ir***, and the irregular *-ir* of *dormir*.)

41.4 je sais pas — the *ne* that speech leaves out

Say **je ne comprends pas**. Two words wrap the verb. In ordinary speech one of them is usually gone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

In speech the **ne** drops and the **pas** carries the negative alone.

written: **Je ne sais pas.** · said: **Je sais pas.**

This is not slang and it is not careless. It is what most French speakers do most of the time, and a learner who says every *ne* sounds like a written page read aloud.

The reason it can happen at all is in the history of **pas**. That word was the noun for a **step**: *je ne marche pas* first meant *I do not walk a step*, with the step there for emphasis, exactly as English says *not a bit* or *not a jot*. French did the same with *point* (a dot) and *mie* (a crumb). Then the emphasiser took over. **Pas** spread to every verb, lost its meaning entirely, and ended up carrying the negation by itself — after which the original **ne** became the optional half. The word that was decoration is now the load bearer, and the word that did the work is the one that falls off.

Written, both. Spoken, one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- written, then spoken — "Je ne sais pas." / "Je sais pas."
- "Je ne comprends pas." / "Je comprends pas."

- with this chapter's verb — "Je ne finis pas." / "Je finis pas."
- the step that is no longer a step — *pas*, the noun
- the answer-words you keep — "non" and the one that contradicts a negative, "si"

Before you move on

Which half of the negative does speech drop? (**The *ne***.) What was *pas* before it was a negative? (**A step** — a noun, put in for emphasis.) Which two other nouns did French use the same way? (***Point*** and ***mie***.)

41.5 on — the pronoun that was a word for *man*

You own six subject pronouns and none of them can say *people in general*. Say **personne**, then take the pronoun built out of a word like it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

on — one, people, they — and in everyday speech, **we**.

On parle français ici. — French is spoken here. / People speak French here.

On y va. — Let's go. (Literally: *one goes there*.)

It takes the same ending as *il* and *elle*, so nothing new has to be learned to use it: **on parle**, **on finit**, **on va**.
on is Latin **homo**, "man," worn down to two letters. Two neighbours did the identical thing with their own words: German turned *Mann* into the pronoun **man**, and English turned *one* into the pronoun **one** — *one does not do such things*. Three languages, three words for a person, all promoted to mean *anybody at all*.
What French then did that the others did not is let it take over **nous**. *On y va* is what people actually say for *let's go*, and *nous* survives mostly in writing. So the pronoun for nobody in particular has quietly become the pronoun for **us**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *on* — one syllable, nasal
- "On parle français ici."
- the one everybody says — "On y va."
- with this chapter's verbs — "On finit." "On va travailler."
- with the dropped *ne* — "On sait pas."
- the three cousins — French *on*, German *man*, English *one*

Before you move on

What Latin word is *on*? (***Homo***, "man".) Which ending does it take? (**The same as *il*** — *on parle*.) What does it stand in for in everyday speech? (***Nous*** — "we".) Say "let's go."

41.6 On y va ! — the chapter, run cold

Three of the five things in this chapter are shapes a verb can take and two are words. Sort them, then say which shape leaves the pronoun out and which word replaces one.

Your turn: every verb, three ways

Every verb the book owns, commanded, put in the near future, and refused. Say these aloud:

- commanded — "Parle ! Travaille ! Écoute ! Marche ! Demande !"
- about to happen — "Je vais lire. Je vais écrire. Je vais dormir. Je vais courir."
- refused, in speech — "Je comprends pas. J'entends pas. Je finis pas."
- the false friend, still false — *demander* asks, it does not demand
- the one that means both walk and work — *marcher*

Your turn: the distant band — on, and the whole table

The whole table, with *on* in front of it and the joiners between.

Say these aloud:

- "On va au café. On prend du pain et du fromage."
- "Il y a du café et du thé, mais il n'y a pas de lait."
- "On finit le pain, parce qu'on a faim."
- the whole table in the plural — "des œufs, du sel, du sucre, du beurre, de l'eau"
- "On parle français ici, mais on parle anglais là-bas."
- the three cousins of *on* — French *on*, German *man*, English *one*

Before you move on

How do you build a command? (**The *tu* form without its pronoun** — and without its *-s* on an *-er* verb.) What two pieces make the near future? (***Aller* plus a plain verb**.) What grows in the plural of *finir*? (**An extra *-iss-***.) Which half of the negative does speech drop? (**The *ne***.) And what was *on* in Latin? (***Homo***, "man".)

Chapter 42

What the Ear Cannot Hear

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I know why a written consonant at the end of a French word is silent, what the plural and the feminine do about it, and what happens to some after a negative.
>
> *One sound rule and the four spellings that hang off it. The chapter names the thing the reader has been working around since the numbers – a final consonant is silent – and then shows the plural, the feminine, the -x plural and the negative partitive as four consequences of it rather than four separate facts.*

42.1 la consonne finale — the rule under half this book

Say **quand**, **et**, **parlez**, **des**. Four words, four written consonants at the end, and not one of them sounded. Nobody has yet said why.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the joiner Latin used for *more* — *mais*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

> A consonant written at the end of a French word is normally **not pronounced**.

Salut is *sa-LU*. *Deux* is *deu*. *Trois* is *trwah*. *Nuit* is *nwee*. The letter is on the page and not in the mouth.

Those letters were once sounded. Old French said the *t* of *salut* and the *s* of *trois*, and over centuries the mouth dropped them while the spelling stayed where it was. Every silent consonant in French is a fossil of a sound the language used to make.
Two things bring them back to life, and you own both:

- **Liaison.** Before a vowel the consonant wakes up — *des amis* is *day-ZAH-mee*, *quand est-ce que* is *kahn-TESS-kuh*. You met this on the numbers.
- **A following -e.** Add an *-e* and the consonant is no longer final, so it is no longer silent. That is the next lesson.

There are exceptions worth naming, and the shortest way to hold them is the word **CaReFuL** — *c*, *r*, *f*, *l* are the four consonants that usually **do** sound at the end: *avec*, *bonjour*, *neuf*, *il*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- silent — "salut, deux, trois, nuit"
- woken by a vowel — "des amis", "quand est-ce que"
- the four that usually sound — "avec, bonjour, neuf, il"
- the one *t* that never wakes — "et un café"
- a silent letter you have been pointing with — "ces cafés", where the *s* is heard only before a vowel
- the accent that is not a sound either — "là", "là-bas"

Before you move on

What happens to a consonant written at the end of a French word? (**It is normally silent.**) What wakes it? (**A following vowel** — liaison.) Which four usually sound anyway? (***C, r, f, l*** — *careful.*) And which word refuses to make its liaison at all? (***Et.***)

42.2 le pluriel en -s — written, and never heard

A final consonant is silent. A plural is written with a final **s**. Put the two facts together before you read on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

A French noun takes **-s** in the plural, and that **-s** is silent.

le café → **les cafés** — *luh ka-FAY* → *lay ka-FAY*

Say those two aloud and listen. The noun did not change at all. Only the article in front of it did.
That is the whole reason the article system matters so much here. **le**, **la**, **les**, **un**, **une**, **des** are not ornament — they are the **only** place a French listener can hear that more than one thing is meant. Drop the article, as English does with a bare plural, and a French sentence becomes genuinely ambiguous.
The **-s** does come back before a vowel, as a **z**: *les amis* is *lay-ZAH-mee*. So the plural is audible exactly when the next word begins with a vowel and inaudible otherwise, which is one more reason liaison is not optional politeness.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair, listening for no difference — "le café, les cafés"
- "le chien, les chiens; le chat, les chats"
- the plural that IS audible — "les amis", *lay-ZAH-mee*
- with *des* — "des cafés, des chiens, des œufs"
- the article carrying the whole load — "le" against "les"

Before you move on

Is the plural *-s* pronounced? (**No** — it is a final consonant.) Then what tells a listener a plural is meant? (**The article** — *les*, *des*.) When does the *-s* come back? (**Before a vowel**, as a *z*.)

42.3 petit, petite — the ending that wakes the letter before it

Say **bon** and **bonne**. You have had both since page one, and the difference between them has never been named.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The feminine of an adjective adds **-e**. That **-e** is itself silent — and it makes the consonant in front of it audible.

petit — *puh-TEE.* · **petite** — *puh-TEET.* ("small")

vert — *vair.* · **verte** — *vairt.* ("green")

Nothing is added to the sound at the end. What changes is that the *t* stops being final, so the rule from two lessons ago no longer silences it. This is worth holding on to, because it makes the feminine **easier to hear than to see**. A French listener knows *petite* from *petit* instantly — one ends in a consonant and one does not — while a reader has to notice a letter that is never said.
The other colours you own behave the same way: *blanc* and *blanche*; *noir* and *noire*, where the *r* was already sounding and nothing changes at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair, hearing the *t* arrive — "petit, petite"
- "vert, verte" — the *t* arrives again
- "blanc, blanche"
- the one that does not change — "noir, noire"
- with a noun behind it — "le vin blanc", "la maison blanche"
- the pair you have had since page one — "bon, bonne"

Before you move on

Is the feminine *-e* pronounced? (**No.**) Then what does it do? (**It stops the consonant before it being final**, so that consonant sounds.) Is the feminine easier to hear or to see? (**To hear** — the difference is a whole consonant.)

42.4 les bateaux — the plural that is not irregular

You were told that the *u* in **au** was once an *l*. That fact has been waiting two chapters to pay for itself.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Nouns ending in **-eau** and **-eu** take **-x** in the plural instead of **-s**, and nouns already ending in **-s**, **-x** or **-z** take nothing.

le bateau → les bateaux · le cheveu → les cheveux · le nez → les nez

The **x** is silent, exactly as the **s** is, so once again the article carries the whole plural.
Two of the three lines are the same story you already have. **Cheval** became **chevaux** because *-als* turned into *-aus*, and French wrote that *-aus* as *-aux*. That is the change that made **au** out of *à + le* — an *l* softening into a *u* somewhere around the twelfth century, right across the language.
So *chevaux* is not an irregular plural at all. It is a perfectly regular plural of a word whose *l* melted, and the strange-looking *x* is a spelling convention for a *u-s* that got there honestly.
The third line is simpler still: a word that already ends in *s*, *x* or *z* has nowhere to put another one, so it does not try. **Le nez** and **les nez** share the same three-letter noun.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — “le bateau, les bateaux”

- "le cheveu, les cheveux"
- the invariable — "le nez, les nez"
- the *l* that melted — "cheval, chevaux" and "à le, au"
- with the indefinite — "des bateaux, des cheveux"

Before you move on

Which endings take *-x*? (***-eau*** and ***-eu***.) Which take nothing at all? (**Words already ending in *s*, *x* or *z***.) Why is *chevaux* not really irregular? (**Its *l* melted into a *u***, the same change that made *au*.)

42.5 pas de pain — where the partitive collapses

Say the four shapes of *some*: **du**, **de la**, **de l'**, **des**. Now negate one of them and watch all four become the same word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

After a negative, **du**, **de la**, **de l'** and **des** all become a bare **de**.

J'ai du pain. → Je n'ai pas de pain.

Il y a des cafés. → Il n'y a pas de cafés.

Je bois de l'eau. → Je ne bois pas d'eau.

Four shapes, one replacement, and it elides before a vowel like everything else.

The reason is in what the partitive was doing. **Du pain** means *an amount of bread* — the article was measuring. A negative says the amount is **zero**, and there is nothing left to measure, so the measuring article drops out and only the bare *de* remains.

This does **not** happen to *le*, *la* and *les*. **Je n'aime pas le café** keeps its article, because that sentence is about coffee in general rather than a quantity of it. So the collapse is a test: if the article was measuring an amount, it goes.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — "J'ai du pain." / "Je n'ai pas de pain."
- "Il y a du lait." / "Il n'y a pas de lait."
- elided — "Je ne bois pas d'eau."
- the one that keeps its article — "Je n'aime pas le café."
- with the *ne* dropped, as speech does — "Y a pas de pain."
- where you are going, and what is not there — "Je vais au café, mais il n'y a pas de café."
- about to happen, and refused — "Je vais prendre du pain." / "Je ne vais pas prendre de pain."

Before you move on

What do *du*, *de la*, *de l'* and *des* become after a negative? (**A bare *de*.**) Why? (**The article was measuring an amount, and the negative makes the amount zero.**) Which articles do **not** collapse? (***Le***, ***la***, ***les***.)

42.6 Ce qu'on n'entend pas — the chapter, run cold

One rule about sound runs under this whole chapter. State it. Then name the two things that bring a silent consonant back.

Your turn: silent, and woken

Say these aloud:

- silent — "salut, deux, trois, nuit"
- woken by a vowel — "des amis", "quand est-ce que", "six ans", "dix ans", "neuf ans"
- the four that sound anyway — "avec, bonjour, neuf, il"
- the one *t* that refuses — "et un café"

Your turn: the distant band — everything, in the plural and the feminine

Every noun the book owns, made plural — and listen for how little changes.

Say these aloud:

- the table — "les cafés, les pains, les œufs"
- the household and the animals — "les frères, les sœurs, les enfants, les chiens, les chats, les amis"
- the body — "les mains, les têtes, les nez, les bouches" — and the one that goes its own way, "l'œil, les yeux"
- the colours, masculine then feminine — "vert, verte; blanc, blanche; noir, noire; bon, bonne"
- the ones that never change in the feminine — "rouge, bleu, jaune"
- the article doing all the work — "le café" against "les cafés"

Your turn: and none of it

Say these aloud:

- the four shapes, then their one negative — "du, de la, de l', des" → "pas de"
- "Il n'y a pas de pain. Il n'y a pas de lait. Il n'y a pas d'eau."
- as speech says it — "Y a pas de café."

Before you move on

Why is the plural *-s* silent? (**Because every final consonant is.**) Why is the feminine *-e* audible even though it is silent? (**It stops the consonant before it being final.**) Why is *chevaux* not irregular? (**Its *l* became a *u*.**) And what do all four partitives become after a negative? (**A bare *de*.**)

Chapter 43

Standing Alone

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask who and what, and use the pronouns that stand on their own instead of leaning on a verb.
>
> *Every person and every thing the book owns is asked about and answered. One accident runs under three of the chapter's four pairs: a pronoun that lived unstressed in front of a verb wore down, and the one that stood alone kept its weight – which is why French has que and quoi, je and moi, tu and toi, and only one elle.*

43.1 qui — "who," the word Latin barely changed

Five question words are yours — *où, quand, comment, combien, pourquoi*. Every one of them asks about a circumstance. None of them can ask about a **person**.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the pronoun that was Latin for *man* — *on*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

qui — who.

Qui est-ce ? — Who is it? · **Qui est là ?** — Who's there?

Latin **quis**, and almost nothing has happened to it. That is unusual:

most French words are half the length of their Latin parents — *aqua* to *eau*, *calidus* to *chaud* — and this one lost a single consonant in two thousand years.
The **qu-** is the same opening that starts *quand*, *quel* and *combien*'s cousins, and English carries it in the borrowed words **query**, **question** and **quest**.
One thing to watch: **qui** never elides. *Qui est* stays two clean words where *que* would have become *qu'*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *qui* — one syllable, *kee*
- "Qui est-ce ?" and "Qui est là ?"
- ask, then answer with what you own — "Qui est-ce ? — C'est ma mère."
- "Qui est ici ? — Voici mon ami."
- asked about several people, with the plural you cannot hear — "Qui sont les amis ?"
- the six question words together — "qui, où, quand, comment, combien, pourquoi"

Before you move on

What Latin word is *qui*? (***Quis***, one letter shorter.) Does it elide before a vowel? (**No** — *qui est*, two clean words.) Ask who somebody is and answer with your mother.

43.2 que — "what," and the word that always elides

You have said **que** twice already without meeting it: inside **est-ce que** and inside **parce que**. Say both.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

que — what.

Qu'est-ce que c'est ? — What is it?

qui and **que** are Latin **quis** and **quid** — the *who* and the *what* of one pronoun, kept as a pair. French has both halves where English rebuilt its own from a different root.
Unlike *qui*, **que** always elides before a vowel, and that is why the commonest question in French looks so alarming on the page.
Qu'est-ce que c'est is four ordinary words: *que* + *est-ce* + *que* + *c'est* — "what is it that this is." Said aloud it is three syllables, *kess-kuh-SAY*, and it is the first thing a learner should be able to say without thinking.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the big one, slowly, then fast — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ?" → *kess-kuh-SAY*
- the four pieces — *que, est-ce, que, c'est*
- ask and answer — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ? — C'est du pain."
- the pair — "Qui est-ce ?" against "Qu'est-ce que c'est ?"
- ask about an action — "Qu'est-ce que tu finis ?" and the plural that grows a syllable, "Qu'est-ce que vous finissez ?"

Before you move on

Which of the pair elides? (***Que.***) What four words are inside *qu'est-ce que c'est*? (***Que, est-ce, que, c'est.***) Which asks about a person and which about a thing?

43.3 quoi — "what," standing on its own two feet

Say **que**. Now try to say it alone, as a one-word question. It cannot be done — the word is too light to stand up.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quoi — what, when it has to carry weight.

Quoi ? — What? · **De quoi ?** — Of what? · **À quoi ?** — To what?

que and **quoi** are the same Latin **quid**, twice. One of them spent centuries unstressed in front of a verb and wore down to a single silent-*e* syllable; the other spent those centuries alone or after a preposition, where it had to be heard, and kept its weight.
So the split is not a rule somebody invented. It is one word that lived two different lives in two different positions.
The practical test is short: **que** leans on something and **quoi** does not. After a preposition — *de*, *à* — only *quoi* will do.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- alone — "Quoi ?"
- after a preposition — "De quoi ?", "À quoi ?"
- the pair — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ?" against "C'est quoi ?"
- all three pronouns — "qui, que, quoi"

Before you move on

Which of the two can stand alone? (***Quoi.***) Which one follows a preposition? (***Quoi.***) What single Latin word are both? (***Quid*** — worn two ways by two positions.) Say all three pronouns.

43.4 moi et toi — the pronouns that can stand alone

Je and **tu** cannot stand alone either — they must lean on a verb. You have seen that happen to *que* in the last lesson, and the same accident produced the same result here.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moi — me. · **toi** — you, informally.

Moi ? — Me? · **Et toi ?** — And you? · **C'est moi.** — It's me.

You have said **et toi ?** and **et vous ?** for a long time as a fixed piece of conversation. This is the word inside it.
je and **moi** are one Latin pronoun, **tu** and **toi** are another, and each split for the reason *que* and *quoi* split: the form that lived unstressed in front of a verb wore down, and the form that stood alone or after a preposition kept its weight. Three pairs, one accident.
The polite twin of *toi* is **vous**, which does both jobs and does not split — *et vous ?* is the same word as the *vous* in *vous parlez*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- alone — "Moi ?" "Toi ?"
- the phrase you already had — "Ça va bien, et toi ?"
- politely — "Et vous ?"
- "C'est moi." "C'est toi."
- the three pairs the same accident made — "je/moi, tu/toi, que/quoi"
- in the order a sentence holds to, doer first — "Moi, je parle français."

Before you move on

Which form of *je* stands alone? (***Moi.***) And of *tu*? (***Toi.***) Which earlier pair split the same way? (***Que*** and ***quoi.***) What is the polite word that does not split? (***Vous.***)

43.5 lui et elle — the third pair, and the one that did not split

Je became *moi*, *tu* became *toi*. Predict what *il* becomes, then predict what *elle* becomes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lui — him, standing alone. · **elle** — her, and also *she*.

C'est lui. — It's him. · **C'est elle.** — It's her.

Only half the prediction comes true. **il** does split, into **lui** — and **elle** does not split at all. The same four letters do both jobs: *elle parle* and *c'est elle*.
Nothing decided that except which syllables happened to carry stress in Latin. Latin *illī* gave *lui*, *ille* gave *il*, and *illa* gave one *elle* that was heavy enough already. The masculine split and the feminine did not, and the language has lived with the asymmetry ever since.
That same *ille* family is where **le**, **la** and **les** came from, so the article and the pronoun in front of you are cousins several times over.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "C'est lui." "C'est elle."
- the four that stand alone — "moi, toi, lui, elle"
- the feminine doing both jobs — "elle parle" and "c'est elle"
- ask and answer — "Qui est-ce ? — C'est lui."
- the cousins — "il, elle, le, la", all from one Latin family
- offer a choice between them — "C'est lui ou c'est elle ?"
- the plural that takes an *x* — "les cheveux de lui", and "les bateaux"

Before you move on

What does *il* become when it stands alone? (***Lui.***) And *elle*? (***Elle*** — it does not change.) Which Latin family gave *il*, *elle*, *le* and *la*? (***Ille, illa, illi*** — one family.) Say the four standing pronouns.

43.6 Qui est-ce ? — the chapter, run cold

One accident made three of this chapter's pairs. Name the accident, then name the three pairs.

Your turn: asking about people and things

Every person and every thing the book owns, asked about and answered.

Say these aloud:

- about people — "Qui est-ce ? — C'est ma mère. C'est mon père. C'est mon frère. C'est ma sœur."
- "Qui est-ce ? — C'est mon ami. C'est l'enfant."
- about things — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ? — C'est du pain. C'est du café. C'est du fromage."
- the short spoken version — "C'est quoi ?"
- the three ways to ask, all still yours — voice, *est-ce que*, inversion

Your turn: the distant band — standing alone

The leaning pronouns and the standing ones, side by side.

Say these aloud:

- leaning — "je suis, tu es, il est, nous sommes, vous êtes, ils sont"
- standing — "moi, toi, lui, elle"
- the pairs — "je/moi, tu/toi, il/lui" — and the one that did not split, "elle"
- the same accident on a question word — "que/quoi"
- the phrase you have had all along — "Ça va bien, et toi ?" and politely, "Et vous ?"
- the pronoun that took over from *nous* — "On y va."
- contrasted — "Moi, oui, mais toi, non."

Before you move on

Which question pronoun never elides? (***Qui.***) Which one always does? (***Que.***) Which one stands alone and follows a preposition? (***Quoi.***) And which of the four standing pronouns is the same word as its leaning twin? (***Elle.***)

Chapter 44

How Much, and What to Call People

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lot, a little, very and enough, and address somebody the way French expects.
>
> *Combien ? has had no possible answer since it was taught, and now it has four. The chapter also finishes the bare-de rule: a quantity word is already measuring, so the measuring article drops – which is the same reason the partitive collapses after a negative, one chapter earlier.*

44.1 beaucoup — "a beautiful blow"

You can say *some* four ways and *none* one way. You have no way at all to say **a lot**.

- *Recall:* two chapters back, the four partitives collapsing after a negative — *pas de*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beaucoup — a lot, much, many.

beaucoup de café — a lot of coffee. · **beaucoup d'amis** — a lot of friends.

Note what follows it: a bare **de**, exactly as after a negative. Any word of quantity in French takes *de* and never *du* or *des*, for the same reason

— the quantity word is already doing the measuring, so the measuring article drops out.
beaucoup is **beau** + **coup**, "a **beautiful blow**." *Coup* is Latin **colaphus**, a punch on the ear, and English borrowed it far more politely as *coup d'état* and *a coup*. A word from a fistfight became the ordinary French for *a lot* — the promotion any word earns by carrying emphasis often enough.
The **p** is silent, as final consonants are: *boh-KOO*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *beaucoup* — *boh-KOO*, the *p* silent
- "beaucoup de café", "beaucoup de pain", "beaucoup d'amis"
- the three shapes of the same *de* — "du café", "pas de café", "beaucoup de café"
- the two words inside it — *beau* and *coup*
- asked and explained — "Qu'est-ce que c'est ? — Beaucoup de café, parce que j'ai beaucoup d'amis."

Before you move on

What follows *beaucoup*? (**A bare *de*** — never *du* or *des*.) Why? (**The quantity word is already measuring**, so the article drops.) What two words are inside it? (***Beau*** and ***coup*** — a beautiful blow.)

44.2 un peu — the other end of the scale

Beaucoup de café. Say it, and say what has to follow any word of quantity.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

un peu — a little.

un peu de café — a little coffee. · **un peu d'eau** — a

little water.

The same bare **de** follows it, because the same reasoning applies: the quantity is already stated.
peu is Latin **paucus**, "few," and English has it twice — in **paucity**, borrowed from the Latin directly, and buried in **poor**, which came through French from *pauper*. So the everyday French word for *a little* and the English word for *scarcity* are one Latin adjective that travelled by two roads.
un peu is also the standard modest answer to a question about what you can do:

Vous parlez français ? — Un peu.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair, both ends of the scale — "beaucoup de café", "un peu de café"
- "un peu de pain", "un peu d'eau"
- the modest answer — "Vous parlez français ? — Un peu."
- asked short — "C'est quoi ? — Un peu de pain."

Before you move on

What follows *un peu*? (**A bare *de***, as after *beaucoup*.) What Latin word is *peu*? (***Paucus***, "few" — English *paucity*.) Answer *vous parlez français ?* modestly.

44.3 très — "very," and the line it crosses

Beaucoup and *un peu* measure a **thing** and both take *de*. This one measures a **quality**, and it takes nothing at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

très — very, in front of an adjective or an adverb.

très bien — very well. · **très bon** — very good.

No *de*, ever. That is the whole difference: *beaucoup* and *un peu* stand in front of a **noun** and need the bare *de*; *très* stands in front of an **adjective** and needs nothing.
très is Latin **trans**, "across, beyond" — the *trans* of *transport* and *translate*. To say a thing is *très bon* is to say it has gone **across a line** into another category, which is what every intensifier in every language is trying to do.
The **s** is silent and comes back as a **z** before a vowel: *très intéressant* is *tray-zan-tay-ress-AHN*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "très bien", "très bon"
- the feminine — "très bonne"
- the contrast — "beaucoup de café" against "très bon"
- the liaison — "très intéressant"
- the answer everybody gives — "Ça va ? — Très bien, merci."
- as a command — "Parle très bien !" and "Écoute !"
- standing alone — "Moi, très bien. Et toi ?"
- the weather, measured — "Il fait très chaud." "Il pleut", and *le temps*, which is both the time and the weather
- the colours, measured — "très vert", "très jaune", and the German cousin *gelb* that *jaune* is not

Before you move on

What does *très* stand in front of? (**An adjective or an adverb** — never a noun.) Does it take *de*? (**No.**) What Latin word is it? (***Trans***, "across".)

44.4 assez — "enough," and "rather"

Three quantity words are yours. Two take *de* and one does not. Say which is which before you read on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

assez — enough; and also *rather*, *fairly*.

assez de café — enough coffee. · **assez bon** — rather good.

It does both jobs, and which one it is doing depends on what follows it: before a **noun** it takes *de* and means *enough*; before an **adjective** it takes nothing and means *rather*.
So *assez* behaves like *beaucoup* in one position and like *très* in the other, which makes it the word that ties the chapter together.
assez is Latin **ad satis**, "to enough." That *satis* is the root inside English **satisfy**, **saturate** and **satiate** — so to be *satisfied* is literally to have been given **enough**.
The **z** is silent, like every final consonant, and unlike *très* it does not usually come back before a vowel.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- with a noun — "assez de café", "assez de pain"
- with an adjective — "assez bon", "assez bien"
- all four, in order of size — "un peu, assez, beaucoup" and, for a quality, "très"
- the Latin inside it — *ad satis*, and English *satisfy*

- about to happen — “Je vais prendre assez de pain.”
- about him — “Lui ? Assez bien.”

Before you move on

When does *assez* take *de*? (**Before a noun**, where it means *enough*.) And when does it take nothing? (**Before an adjective**, where it means *rather*.) What Latin phrase is it? (***Ad satis*** — “to enough”.) Which English words share that root?

44.5 Monsieur, Madame — “my lord” and “my lady”

You have said **bonjour** since page one and **vous** since the second chapter. A bare *bonjour* to a stranger in France is slightly abrupt, and the word that fixes it is one you have never met.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Monsieur — sir. · **Madame** — madam. · **Mademoiselle** — miss.

Bonjour, Monsieur. · **Bonjour, Madame.**

Two possessives fused into titles. **Monsieur** is **mon sieur**, “my lord,” and **Madame** is **ma dame**, “my lady” — the same *dame* inside English *dame* and *damsel*, and the *sieur* is a worn-down *seigneur*, from Latin **senior**, “the elder.”
The spelling records a word the mouth stopped saying centuries ago. **Monsieur** is pronounced *muh-SYUH*: the *n* has gone nasal-free, the *s* is silent, and the ending is the *eu* vowel. Nothing about the sound follows from the letters, which is why it is worth learning as a noise first and a spelling second.
Where English attaches a surname — *good morning, Mr Dubois* — French attaches the bare title far more often. **Bonjour, Madame** to a shopkeeper is ordinary and expected; the surname is not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the noise, not the spelling — "Monsieur", *muh-SYUH*
- the greeting, completed — "Bonjour, Monsieur." "Bonjour, Madame."
- at night — "Bonsoir, Madame."
- thanking and leaving — "Merci, Monsieur." "Au revoir, Madame."
- introducing — "Voici Madame Dubois."
- the two possessives inside them — *mon sieur*, *ma dame*
- closing a conversation — "Je finis, Monsieur." and "Nous finissons, Madame."
- the courtesy words, each with a title — "S'il vous plaît, Monsieur." "Je suis désolé, Madame." "Oui, Monsieur."
- admitting it politely — "Je ne comprends pas, Monsieur." and the stem it borrows from *prendre*

Before you move on

What two words are inside *Monsieur*? (***Mon*** and ***sieur*** — "my lord".) And inside *Madame*? (***Ma*** and ***dame***.) How is *Monsieur* said? (*Muh-SYUH* — the *s* silent.) Greet a shopkeeper properly.

44.6 Combien ? — the chapter, run cold

Four measures. Three take a bare *de* in at least one position and one never does. Sort them, then say the one rule that decides it.

Your turn: the answers combien was waiting for

Combien ? has had no answer since it was taught. Now it has four. Say these aloud:

- the whole table, measured — "beaucoup de café, un peu de lait, assez de pain, pas de vin"
- "beaucoup de fromage, un peu de sucre, assez de sel, pas de beurre"
- with the plural — "beaucoup d'œufs", "pas d'œufs"
- the four shapes of *de* in one breath — "du café, pas de café, beaucoup de café, un peu de café"

Your turn: the distant band — qualities, measured

Every adjective the book owns, intensified — and no *de* anywhere.
Say these aloud:

- "très bon, très bien, assez bon"
- the feminine — "très bonne", and the consonant it wakes
- the colours — "très rouge, très blanc, assez noir, très vert"
- with the noun behind — "un vin très rouge", "un pain très blanc"
- the everyday exchange — "Ça va ? — Très bien, merci."

Your turn: and the person you are talking to

Say these aloud:

- the greeting completed — "Bonjour, Monsieur." "Bonsoir, Madame."
- "Merci, Madame." "Au revoir, Monsieur."
- "Qui est-ce ? — C'est Madame Dubois." then "Voici Madame Dubois."
- written, then as speech says it — "Je ne sais pas, Monsieur." / "Je sais pas."

Before you move on

Which of the four measures refuses *de*? (***Très***.) Which one takes it before a noun and not before an adjective? (***Assez***.) Why do quantity words take a bare *de* at all? (**They are already measuring**, so the measuring article drops.) And what two words are inside *Monsieur*?

Chapter 45

Reading — Instructions, a Form, and a First Paragraph

Modes: **eyes** (3) **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can read a French instruction, a line off a form, and a whole paragraph, without translating word by word.

Sixty-three words of French in a row with no new word in them, including the sentence that admits it did not follow everything and carries on anyway.

45.1 (reading) — six things you would be told

Every line below you have heard and said. Not one is new.

What is new is that nobody says them first.

Read this

Parle ! Écoute ! On y va ! Un peu Beaucoup Merci

Read it: down the list once, without stopping
Read it: the list again, and notice that three of them end in an exclamation mark and three do not
French puts a space before it, which English does not.

Why it's said this way

Parle ! and **Écoute !** are the same verbs you conjugate, with the ending taken off and nothing put in its place. That is the whole imperative.
An instruction you can only recognise by ear is one somebody has to say to you. On a page it waits, which is why a classroom is the first place a beginner reads rather than listens.
Six lines, and half of them are one word.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
What does French put before an exclamation mark? (**A space.**)

45.2 (reading) — six lines off a form

The last lesson gave you things somebody says. These are things somebody writes down.

Nothing here is new.

Read this

Nom : Marie Âge : vingt ans Lundi : le travail Mardi : un livre Une heure Dix minutes

Read it: the six lines down once, without stopping
Read it: the six lines again, and notice the colon
French puts a space before that too, and the space is the clearest signal on the page that a label has ended.

Why it's said this way

A form is the first thing a beginner can read end to end. It puts the label before the value every time, and it never asks for a verb.

That is why the last two lines are the hardest, not the first four. **Une heure** and **Dix minutes** have no label in front of them, so nothing tells you what they are for until you have read them.
Six lines, and four of them do half your work.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, in order, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

Which two lines have no label? (**Une heure** and **Dix minutes**.)
What does French put before a colon? (**A space.**)

45.3 (reading) — the first paragraph

Six instructions, then six lines off a form. Now a whole paragraph.

Sixty-three words, and not one of them is new.

Read this

Bonjour ! Je m'appelle Marie. J'habite à Paris. J'ai un frère et une sœur. Je bois du café et je mange du pain. Le jour, je vais au travail. Je travaille beaucoup, mais j'aime ça. Le soir, je lis un livre. Le livre est très bon. Je ne comprends pas tout, mais ça va. Demain, je vais parler français. Merci et au revoir.

Read it: the passage once without stopping; do not translate as you go — let the sentences arrive
Read it: the passage again, and notice how little work it took

Why it's said this way

Look at what is holding it together, because it is not vocabulary. **Et** adds. **Mais** holds two true things apart, and it does it twice here — once about work and once about understanding. Each of those was

a chapter, and none of them is longer than four letters.
Notice the tenth line especially. **Je ne comprends pas tout, mais ça va.** Somebody has admitted they did not follow everything, and the paragraph carries on. That is the most useful sentence on this page. This is the first whole paragraph the book has asked you to hold at once, and it works because everything in it was paid for.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the paragraph aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many words in that paragraph were new? (**None.**)
Which word appears twice and turns the sentence both times? (**Mais.**)

Chapter 46

Writing — My Own Line

Modes: ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write one line about myself from a closed supply of known words, with nothing to copy, and put every accent on.
>
> *Complete FR-W02-ma-propre-ligne: subject, verb and the rest, chosen rather than copied, with the accents checked before anything else.*

46.1 Your own line — the first writing with no model

> Everything you have written so far had something to reach for — a shape, a word, a sound.
>
> This does not. You choose the words, from a supply that is closed: only what this book has taught you.

Writing — controlled composition

Write **one line** about yourself. Subject, verb, then the rest — the order you already know.

One thing to decide deliberately rather than by accident before you start: **the accents are letters, not decoration.**

An acute on an **e** is not a flourish on the same letter; it makes a different sound and, often enough, a different word. A hand that writes French without accents has not written French untidily — it has written something else and hoped the reader would guess.

Write the line. Then read it back and check the accents **before** you check anything else.

Before you move on

Are French accents decoration? (**No** — they are part of the letter.) And what did you choose here that the earlier lessons chose for you? (**The words.**)

Chapter 47

Writing — With A Clock

Modes: ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can complete the DELF A1 writing paper's two parts inside its published thirty minutes, and write past the forty-word floor rather than up to it.
>
> *Complete FR-W03-avec-la-montre: ten minutes for the form and twenty for the message, then count the words against a floor that has no ceiling.*

47.1 The same writing, with a clock

You wrote your own line with as long as you liked.

A task you can only do untimed is not yet a task you can do.

Writing — timed production

What France Éducation international publishes. The DELF A1 writing paper runs **30 minutes** and holds **two** parts: a form to complete, and a personal message of **at least forty words**.

Those numbers are read out of `task-shapes/a1.json`, which transcribes the published materials. Note what is *not* there: the paper publishes a **minimum** for the message and no maximum. Forty is a floor, not a target.

Ten minutes for the form, starting now. Fill every field.

Now **twenty minutes** for the message. Forty words is the floor; write past it rather than up to it.

Stop when the time is up, even mid-word.

Before you move on

Count your words. **Under forty and the task has not been done** — this is the one number on the paper that is a hard floor rather than guidance.

Now the rule worth carrying out of this lesson, because it changes how you should study rather than how you should write today. DELF A1 passes on **50 out of 100 overall** — and **any single skill below 5 out of 25 is eliminatory.** A candidate with 45 across three papers and 4 in the fourth does not pass, whatever the total says.

So the paper that decides your result is **the one you are worst at**, not the average of four. If that is writing, no amount of reading practice repairs it.

Chapter 48

Writing — Four Lines, And The Joiner That Moves Nothing

Modes: ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write four connected lines to a named reader, joining with et and mais and giving a reason with parce que, keeping ordinary word order after it.
>
> *Complete FR-W04-quatre-lignes: four lines to one reader, at least one joined with et or mais and one with parce que, then check the words after parce que are in ordinary order.*

48.1 Four lines, and the joiner that moves nothing

> The last lesson asked for writing **finished on time**. This one asks for writing that **holds together**.
>
> Pick one person who will read it.

What to know first

Connected writing is not **longer** writing. Four short lines can be connected; one long line can fail to be. What makes it connected is that a sentence stops standing on its own.

You hold three joiners. **et** adds. **mais** sets against. **parce que** gives the reason.

And here is the thing to notice, which is easiest to see by contrast. In German, the word for *because* drags the verb to the end of its clause: the join is visible in the word order. **French does nothing of the kind.**

After **parce que**, the words stand in exactly the order they would have stood in on their own — subject, verb, the rest. Nothing moves.

That makes French easier to *write* and harder to *hear*. Nothing in the shape of the second clause tells you a reason has started; only the two little words do. Which is why **parce que** has to be written in full, and why it is two words rather than one.

Writing — connected composition

Write **four lines** to the person you picked.

At least one must use **et** or **mais**. At least one must use **parce que** — both words, spelled out.

Use only words you already write. This lesson adds no vocabulary; the whole exercise is the joining.

Before you move on

Cover your first line and read the second alone. Does it still make sense without the first? If it does, you wrote a **list** — which is where you were one lesson ago.
Then find your **parce que** line and read the words after it. They should be in ordinary order. If you moved something, you were remembering a different language's rule.

Chapter 49

Arm, Leg, Foot, Finger, Tooth

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name an arm, a leg, a foot, a finger, a tooth.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 49: I can name an arm, a leg, a foot, a finger, a tooth.*

49.1 le bras — an arm

Before the new one: say the French for enough, then the French for sir.

You'll want to know: le bras

le bras — "an arm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bras ← Old French *bras* ← Latin *bracchium*, "arm" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bras*
- *Say it: le bras*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bras*
- *Recall:* say the French for enough, then the French for sir, then say *le bras* again

Before you move on

What does le bras mean? (“An arm”.) Say it once more.

49.2 la jambe — a leg

Before the new one: say the French for sir, then the French for an arm.

You’ll want to know: la jambe

la jambe — “a leg”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jambe ← Late Latin *gamba*, “a hoof, a leg” (Lewis & Short) — inherited: Latin *g* before *a* softened to the French *j*. EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *gamba* to the same Late Latin word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la jambe*
- *Say it: la jambe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la jambe*
- *Recall:* say the French for sir, then the French for an arm, then say *la jambe* again

Before you move on

What does la jambe mean? (“A leg”.) Say it once more.

49.3 le pied — a foot

Before the new one: say the French for an arm, then the French for a leg.

You’ll want to know: le pied

le pied — “a foot”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pied ← Old French *pié* ← Latin *pes*, *pedis*, “foot” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pied*
- *Say it: le pied*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pied*
- *Recall:* say the French for an arm, then the French for a leg, then say *le pied* again

Before you move on

What does le pied mean? (“A foot”.) Say it once more.

49.4 le doigt — a finger

Before the new one: say the French for a leg, then the French for a foot.

You'll want to know: le doigt

le doigt — "a finger".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

doigt ← Old French *doit* ← Latin *digitus*, "finger" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The silent *g* was put back into the spelling later, to recall the Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le doigt*
- *Say it: le doigt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le doigt*
- *Recall:* say the French for a leg, then the French for a foot, then say *le doigt* again

Before you move on

What does le doigt mean? ("A finger".) Say it once more.

49.5 la dent — a tooth

Before the new one: say the French for a foot, then the French for a finger.

You'll want to know: la dent

la dent — "a tooth". English *dentist* shares the root.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dent ← Latin *dens*, *dentis*, "tooth" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dent*
- *Say it: la dent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la dent*
- *Recall:* say the French for a foot, then the French for a finger, then say *la dent* again

Before you move on

What does la dent mean? ("A tooth".) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

Neck, Shoulder, Knee, Face, Blood

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the neck, a shoulder, a knee, the face, blood.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 50: I can name the neck, a shoulder, a knee, the face, blood.*

50.1 le cou — the neck

Before the new one: say the French for a finger, then the French for a tooth.

You'll want to know: le cou

le cou — "the neck".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cou ← Latin *collum*, "neck" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Old French said *col*; the *l* later melted into a vowel.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cou*
- *Say it: le cou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cou*
- *Recall:* say the French for a finger, then the French for a tooth, then say *le cou* again

Before you move on

What does le cou mean? (“The neck”.) Say it once more.

50.2 l’épaule — a shoulder

Before the new one: say the French for a tooth, then the French for the neck.

You’ll want to know: l’épaule

l’épaule — “a shoulder”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épaule ← Old French *espalle* ← Late Latin *spatula*, “a flat piece, a shoulder blade” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *é-* stands where an *s* once was: *espaule*, then *épaule*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’épaule*
- *Say it: l’épaule*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’épaule*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tooth, then the French for the neck, then say *l’épaule* again

Before you move on

What does l'épaule mean? ("A shoulder".) Say it once more.

50.3 le genou — a knee

Before the new one: say the French for the neck, then the French for a shoulder.

You'll want to know: le genou

le genou — "a knee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

genou ← Vulgar Latin **genuculum*, "a little knee", from Latin *genu*, "knee" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1 records both Latin words.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le genou*
- *Say it: le genou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le genou*
- *Recall:* say the French for the neck, then the French for a shoulder, then say *le genou* again

Before you move on

What does le genou mean? ("A knee".) Say it once more.

50.4 le visage — the face

Before the new one: say the French for a shoulder, then the French for a knee.

You'll want to know: le visage

le visage — "the face".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

visage — built in Old French from *vis*, "face", with the ending *-age*. *vis* ← Latin *visus*, "a look, an appearance", from *videre*, "to see". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le visage*
- *Say it: le visage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le visage*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shoulder, then the French for a knee, then say *le visage* again

Before you move on

What does le visage mean? ("The face".) Say it once more.

50.5 le sang — blood

Before the new one: say the French for a knee, then the French for the face.

You'll want to know: le sang

le sang — "blood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sang ← Old French *sanc* ← Latin *sanguis*, "blood", through a Vulgar Latin form **sanguem* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sang*
- *Say it: le sang*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sang*
- *Recall:* say the French for a knee, then the French for the face, then say *le sang* again

Before you move on

What does le sang mean? ("Blood".) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

Skin, Nail, Chin, Throat, Cheek

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name skin, a nail (finger or toe), the chin, the throat, a cheek.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 51: I can name skin, a nail (finger or toe), the chin, the throat, a cheek.*

51.1 la peau — skin

Before the new one: say the French for the face, then the French for blood.

You'll want to know: la peau

la peau — "skin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peau ← Old French *pel* ← Latin *pellis*, "skin, hide" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la peau*
- *Say it: la peau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la peau*
- *Recall:* say the French for the face, then the French for blood, then say *la peau* again

Before you move on

What does la peau mean? ("Skin".) Say it once more.

51.2 l'ongle — a nail (finger or toe)

Before the new one: say the French for blood, then the French for skin.

You'll want to know: l'ongle

l'ongle — "a nail (finger or toe)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ongle ← Latin *ungula*, "a claw, a hoof", from *unguis*, "nail" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *unghia* to the same *ungula*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ongle*
- *Say it: l'ongle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ongle*
- *Recall:* say the French for blood, then the French for skin, then say *l'ongle* again

Before you move on

What does l'ongle mean? ("A nail (finger or toe)".) Say it once more.

51.3 le menton — the chin

Before the new one: say the French for skin, then the French for a nail.

You'll want to know: le menton

le menton — "the chin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

menton ← Vulgar Latin **mento*, from Latin *mentum*, "chin" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le menton*
- *Say it: le menton*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le menton*
- *Recall:* say the French for skin, then the French for a nail, then say *le menton* again

Before you move on

What does le menton mean? ("The chin".) Say it once more.

51.4 la gorge — the throat

Before the new one: say the French for a nail, then the French for the chin.

You'll want to know: la gorge

la gorge — "the throat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gorge ← Late Latin **gurga*, from Latin *gurges*, "a whirlpool, an abyss" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gorge*
- *Say it: la gorge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la gorge*
- *Recall:* say the French for a nail, then the French for the chin, then say *la gorge* again

Before you move on

What does la gorge mean? ("The throat".) Say it once more.

51.5 la joue — a cheek

Before the new one: say the French for the chin, then the French for the throat.

You'll want to know: la joue

la joue — "a cheek".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joue ← Old French *jode* ← Vulgar Latin **gauta*, "cheek" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1). Where **gauta* came from is uncertain; Gaulish is the usual guess.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la joue*
- *Say it: la joue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la joue*
- *Recall:* say the French for the chin, then the French for the throat, then say *la joue* again

Before you move on

What does la joue mean? ("A cheek".) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

Chest, Stomach, Ankle, Elbow, Wrist

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the chest, the stomach, an ankle, an elbow, a wrist.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 52: I can name the chest, the stomach, an ankle, an elbow, a wrist.

52.1 la poitrine — the chest

Before the new one: say the French for the throat, then the French for a cheek.

You'll want to know: la poitrine

la poitrine — "the chest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poitrine ← Old French *peitrine* ← Late Latin **pectorina*, from Latin *pectus*, *pectoris*, "chest" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poitrine*
- *Say it: la poitrine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poitrine*
- *Recall:* say the French for the throat, then the French for a cheek, then say *la poitrine* again

Before you move on

What does la poitrine mean? (“The chest”.) Say it once more.

52.2 l’estomac — the stomach

Before the new one: say the French for a cheek, then the French for the chest.

You’ll want to know: l’estomac

l’estomac — “the stomach”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

estomac ← Old French *estomac* ← Latin *stomachus*, from Greek *stomachos*, built on *stoma*, “mouth” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’estomac*
- *Say it: l’estomac*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’estomac*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cheek, then the French for the chest, then say *l’estomac* again

Before you move on

What does l'estomac mean? ("The stomach".) Say it once more.

52.3 la cheville — an ankle

Before the new one: say the French for the chest, then the French for the stomach.

You'll want to know: la cheville

la cheville — "an ankle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cheville ← Vulgar Latin **cavicula*, from Latin *clavicula*, "a little key, a peg" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1): the ankle bone was seen as the peg of the leg.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cheville*
- *Say it: la cheville*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cheville*
- *Recall:* say the French for the chest, then the French for the stomach, then say *la cheville* again

Before you move on

What does la cheville mean? ("An ankle".) Say it once more.

52.4 le coude — an elbow

Before the new one: say the French for the stomach, then the French for an ankle.

You'll want to know: le coude

le coude — "an elbow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coude ← Latin *cubitus*, "elbow" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited: once the *i* dropped out, *cubitu* became **cobdo*, the *b* was lost, and Old French had *code*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coude*
- *Say it: le coude*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le coude*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stomach, then the French for an ankle, then say *le coude* again

Before you move on

What does le coude mean? ("An elbow".) Say it once more.

52.5 le poignet — a wrist

Before the new one: say the French for an ankle, then the French for an elbow.

You'll want to know: le poignet

le poignet — "a wrist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poignet — built from the French word for "fist", which goes back to Latin *pugnus*, with the small-thing ending *-et*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poignet*
- *Say it: le poignet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poignet*
- *Recall:* say the French for an ankle, then the French for an elbow, then say *le poignet* again

Before you move on

What does le poignet mean? ("A wrist".) Say it once more.

Chapter 53

Pain, Fever, Cough, Medicine, Doctor

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name pain, a fever, a cough, a medicine, a doctor.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 53: I can name pain, a fever, a cough, a medicine, a doctor.

53.1 la douleur — pain

Before the new one: say the French for an elbow, then the French for a wrist.

You'll want to know: la douleur

la douleur — "pain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douleur ← Old French *dolor* ← Latin *dolor*, "pain, grief" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la douleur*
- *Say it: la douleur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la douleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for an elbow, then the French for a wrist, then say *la douleur* again

Before you move on

What does la douleur mean? (“Pain”.) Say it once more.

53.2 la fièvre — a fever

Before the new one: say the French for a wrist, then the French for pain.

You’ll want to know: la fièvre

la fièvre — “a fever”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fièvre ← Latin *febris*, “fever” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the stressed *e* broke into *ie*, and *b* became *v*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fièvre*
- *Say it: la fièvre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fièvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wrist, then the French for pain, then say *la fièvre* again

Before you move on

What does la fièvre mean? ("A fever".) Say it once more.

53.3 la toux — a cough

Before the new one: say the French for pain, then the French for a fever.

You'll want to know: la toux

la toux — "a cough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toux ← Old French *tous* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *tussis*, "a cough" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la toux*
- *Say it: la toux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la toux*
- *Recall:* say the French for pain, then the French for a fever, then say *la toux* again

Before you move on

What does la toux mean? ("A cough".) Say it once more.

53.4 le médicament — a medicine

Before the new one: say the French for a fever, then the French for a cough.

You'll want to know: le médicament

le médicament — "a medicine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

médicament ← Latin *medicamentum*, "a remedy", from *medicari*, "to heal" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le médicament*
- *Say it: le médicament*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le médicament*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fever, then the French for a cough, then say *le médicament* again

Before you move on

What does le médicament mean? ("A medicine".) Say it once more.

53.5 le médecin — a doctor

Before the new one: say the French for a cough, then the French for a medicine.

You'll want to know: le médecin

le médecin — "a doctor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

médecin — formed in French from the word for "medicine", which ← Latin *medicina*, "the art of healing", from *medicus*, "doctor" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le médecin*
- *Say it: le médecin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le médecin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cough, then the French for a medicine, then say *le médecin* again

Before you move on

What does le médecin mean? ("A doctor".) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

Hospital, Illness, Thirst, Tiredness, Ill

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a hospital, an illness, thirst, tiredness, ill.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 54: I can name a hospital, an illness, thirst, tiredness, ill.

54.1 l'hôpital — a hospital

Before the new one: say the French for a medicine, then the French for a doctor.

You'll want to know: l'hôpital

l'hôpital — "a hospital".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hôpital ← Old French *hospital* ← Medieval Latin *hospitale*, "a guest house", from Latin *hospes*, "guest" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the *s* that French later stopped writing. The same Latin word, worn down in everyday speech, also gave French its word for "hotel".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'hôpital*
- *Say it: l'hôpital*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'hôpital*
- *Recall:* say the French for a medicine, then the French for a doctor, then say *l'hôpital* again

Before you move on

What does l'hôpital mean? ("A hospital".) Say it once more.

54.2 la maladie — an illness

Before the new one: say the French for a doctor, then the French for a hospital.

You'll want to know: la maladie

la maladie — "an illness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maladie — built in Old French from the adjective for "sick", with the ending *-ie*. That adjective goes back to Latin *male habitus*, "in poor condition". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la maladie*
- *Say it: la maladie*, once more

- *Say it:* say *la maladie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a doctor, then the French for a hospital, then say *la maladie* again

Before you move on

What does la maladie mean? ("An illness".) Say it once more.

54.3 la soif — thirst

Before the new one: say the French for a hospital, then the French for an illness.

You'll want to know: la soif

la soif — "thirst". **j'ai soif**: I am thirsty, with **avoir**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soif ← Old French *soif* ← Latin *sitis*, "thirst" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la soif*
- *Say it: la soif*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la soif*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hospital, then the French for an illness, then say *la soif* again

Before you move on

What does la soif mean? ("Thirst".) Say it once more.

54.4 la fatigue — tiredness

Before the new one: say the French for an illness, then the French for thirst.

You'll want to know: la fatigue

la fatigue — "tiredness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fatigue — formed from the verb for "to tire", a learned borrowing of Latin *fatigare*, "to weary". (EtymDB 2.1) The kept *g* shows the book word: in everyday speech it would have dropped out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fatigue*
- *Say it: la fatigue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fatigue*
- *Recall:* say the French for an illness, then the French for thirst, then say *la fatigue* again

Before you move on

What does la fatigue mean? ("Tiredness".) Say it once more.

54.5 malade — ill, sick

Before the new one: say the French for thirst, then the French for tiredness.

You'll want to know: malade

malade — "ill, sick".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

malade ← Old French *malade* ← Latin *male habitus*, "in poor condition" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *malade*
- *Say it:* *malade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malade*
- *Recall:* say the French for thirst, then the French for tiredness, then say *malade* again

Before you move on

What does malade mean? ("Ill, sick".) Say it once more.

Chapter 55

Joy, Fear, Anger, Sadness, Happy

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name joy, fear, anger, sadness, happy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 55: I can name joy, fear, anger, sadness, happy.*

55.1 la joie — joy

Before the new one: say the French for tiredness, then the French for ill.

You'll want to know: la joie

la joie — "joy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joie ← Latin *gaudia*, "joys", the plural of *gaudium* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the *g* became *j*, as in *jambe*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la joie*
- *Say it: la joie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la joie*
- *Recall:* say the French for tiredness, then the French for ill, then say *la joie* again

Before you move on

What does la joie mean? ("Joy".) Say it once more.

55.2 la peur — fear

Before the new one: say the French for ill, then the French for joy.

You'll want to know: la peur

la peur — "fear". **j'ai peur**: I am afraid.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peur ← Old French *peor* ← Latin *pavor*, "fear, fright" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; the *v* between vowels dropped out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la peur*
- *Say it: la peur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la peur*
- *Recall:* say the French for ill, then the French for joy, then say *la peur* again

Before you move on

What does la peur mean? ("Fear".) Say it once more.

55.3 la colère — anger

Before the new one: say the French for joy, then the French for fear.

You'll want to know: la colère

la colère — "anger".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

colère ← Latin *cholera*, "a bilious illness", from Greek *kholera*, built on *khole*, "bile" — a learned borrowing: anger was blamed on bile. (EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *collera* to the same Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la colère*
- *Say it: la colère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la colère*
- *Recall:* say the French for joy, then the French for fear, then say *la colère* again

Before you move on

What does la colère mean? ("Anger".) Say it once more.

55.4 la tristesse — sadness

Before the new one: say the French for fear, then the French for anger.

You'll want to know: la tristesse

la tristesse — "sadness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tristesse ← Latin *tristitia*, "sadness", from *tristis*, "sad" — inherited; Latin *-itia* became French *-esse*. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tristesse*
- *Say it: la tristesse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tristesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for fear, then the French for anger, then say *la tristesse* again

Before you move on

What does la tristesse mean? ("Sadness".) Say it once more.

55.5 heureux — happy

Before the new one: say the French for anger, then the French for sadness.

You'll want to know: heureux

heureux — "happy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heureux — built from Old French *eur*, "luck", with *-eux*, "full of": lucky, then happy. *eur* ← Latin *augurium*, "an omen". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: heureux*
- *Say it: heureux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *heureux*
- *Recall:* say the French for anger, then the French for sadness, then say *heureux* again

Before you move on

What does heureux mean? ("Happy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

Sad, Pleased, Daughter, Grandfather, Grandmother

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name sad, pleased, a daughter, a grandfather, a grandmother.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 56: I can name sad, pleased, a daughter, a grandfather, a grandmother.*

56.1 triste — sad

Before the new one: say the French for sadness, then the French for happy.

You'll want to know: triste

triste — "sad". The adjective beside **la tristesse**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

triste ← Latin *tristis*, "sad, gloomy" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: triste*
- *Say it: triste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *triste*
- *Recall:* say the French for sadness, then the French for happy, then say *triste* again

Before you move on

What does triste mean? ("Sad".) Say it once more.

56.2 content — pleased, glad

Before the new one: say the French for happy, then the French for sad.

You'll want to know: content

content — "pleased, glad".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

content ← Latin *contentus*, "satisfied", the past participle of *continere*, "to hold together" (Lewis & Short) — taken from written Latin; Old French already had it (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: content*
- *Say it: content*, once more
- *Say it:* say *content*
- *Recall:* say the French for happy, then the French for sad, then say *content* again

Before you move on

What does content mean? ("Pleased, glad".) Say it once more.

56.3 la fille — a daughter; a girl

Before the new one: say the French for sad, then the French for pleased.

You'll want to know: la fille

la fille — "a daughter; a girl".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fille ← Latin *filia*, "daughter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *figlia* to the same word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fille*
- *Say it: la fille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fille*
- *Recall:* say the French for sad, then the French for pleased, then say *la fille* again

Before you move on

What does la fille mean? ("A daughter; a girl".) Say it once more.

56.4 le grand-père — a grandfather

Before the new one: say the French for pleased, then the French for a daughter; a girl.

You'll want to know: le grand-père

le grand-père — "a grandfather".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grand-père — built from the French word for "big, great", from Latin *grandis* (EtymDB 2.1), and *père*, "father". English *grandfather* copied the French pattern.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le grand-père*
- *Say it: le grand-père*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le grand-père*
- *Recall:* say the French for pleased, then the French for a daughter; a girl, then say *le grand-père* again

Before you move on

What does le grand-père mean? ("A grandfather".) Say it once more.

56.5 la grand-mère — a grandmother

Before the new one: say the French for a daughter; a girl, then the French for a grandfather.

You'll want to know: la grand-mère

la grand-mère — "a grandmother".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grand-mère — built from the French word for "big, great", from Latin *grandis* (EtymDB 2.1), and *mère*, "mother". English

grandmother copied the French pattern.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grand-mère*
- *Say it: la grand-mère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la grand-mère*
- *Recall:* say the French for a daughter; a girl, then the French for a grandfather, then say *la grand-mère* again

Before you move on

What does la grand-mère mean? ("A grandmother".) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

Husband, Woman, Uncle, Aunt, Cousin

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a husband, a woman, an uncle, an aunt, a cousin (female).

Complete the last lesson of chapter 57: I can name a husband, a woman, an uncle, an aunt, a cousin (female).

57.1 le mari — a husband

Before the new one: say the French for a grandfather, then the French for a grandmother.

You'll want to know: le mari

le mari — "a husband".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mari ← Latin *maritus*, "husband" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mari*
- *Say it: le mari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mari*
- *Recall:* say the French for a grandfather, then the French for a grandmother, then say *le mari* again

Before you move on

What does le mari mean? ("A husband".) Say it once more.

57.2 la femme — a woman; a wife

Before the new one: say the French for a grandmother, then the French for a husband.

You'll want to know: la femme

la femme — "a woman; a wife".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

femme ← Latin *femina*, "woman" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la femme*
- *Say it: la femme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la femme*
- *Recall:* say the French for a grandmother, then the French for a husband, then say *la femme* again

Before you move on

What does la femme mean? (“A woman; a wife”.) Say it once more.

57.3 l’oncle — an uncle

Before the new one: say the French for a husband, then the French for a woman; a wife.

You’ll want to know: l’oncle

l’oncle — “an uncle”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oncle ← Vulgar Latin **aunculus* ← Latin *avunculus*, “mother’s brother” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’oncle*
- *Say it: l’oncle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’oncle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a husband, then the French for a woman; a wife, then say *l’oncle* again

Before you move on

What does l’oncle mean? (“An uncle”.) Say it once more.

57.4 la tante — an aunt

Before the new one: say the French for a woman; a wife, then the French for an uncle.

You'll want to know: la tante

la tante — "an aunt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tante ← Old French *ante* ← Latin *amita*, "father's sister" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *t-* at the front is usually explained as a child's way of saying "your aunt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tante*
- *Say it: la tante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tante*
- *Recall:* say the French for a woman; a wife, then the French for an uncle, then say *la tante* again

Before you move on

What does la tante mean? ("An aunt".) Say it once more.

57.5 la cousine — a cousin (female)

Before the new one: say the French for an uncle, then the French for an aunt.

You'll want to know: la cousine

la cousine — "a cousin (female)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cousine ← Latin *consobrina*, "a cousin on the mother's side" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cousine*
- *Say it: la cousine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cousine*
- *Recall:* say the French for an uncle, then the French for an aunt, then say *la cousine* again

Before you move on

What does la cousine mean? ("A cousin (female)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

Neighbour, Guest, Baby, Grandson, Granddaughter

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a neighbour, a guest, a baby, a grandson, a granddaughter.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 58: I can name a neighbour, a guest, a baby, a grandson, a granddaughter.

58.1 le voisin — a neighbour

Before the new one: say the French for an aunt, then the French for a cousin.

You'll want to know: le voisin

le voisin — "a neighbour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voisin ← Latin *vicinus*, "neighbour", from *vicus*, "a village" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le voisin*
- *Say it: le voisin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le voisin*
- *Recall:* say the French for an aunt, then the French for a cousin, then say *le voisin* again

Before you move on

What does le voisin mean? ("A neighbour".) Say it once more.

58.2 l'invité — a guest

Before the new one: say the French for a cousin, then the French for a neighbour.

You'll want to know: l'invité

l'invité — "a guest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

invité is the past participle of the French verb for "to invite", used as a noun: one who is invited. The verb ← Latin *invitare* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'invité*
- *Say it: l'invité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'invité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cousin, then the French for a neighbour, then say *l'invité* again

Before you move on

What does l'invité mean? ("A guest".) Say it once more.

58.3 le bébé — a baby

Before the new one: say the French for a neighbour, then the French for a guest.

You'll want to know: le bébé

le bébé — "a baby".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bébé ← English *baby* — borrowed in the 19th century.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bébé*
- *Say it: le bébé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bébé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a neighbour, then the French for a guest, then say *le bébé* again

Before you move on

What does le bébé mean? ("A baby".) Say it once more.

58.4 le petit-fils — a grandson

Before the new one: say the French for a guest, then the French for a baby.

You'll want to know: le petit-fils

le petit-fils — "a grandson".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

petit-fils — built from the French words for "little" and "son": a grandson. The "little" word ← Vulgar Latin **pittitus*, and the "son" word ← Latin *filius*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le petit-fils*
- *Say it: le petit-fils*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le petit-fils*
- *Recall:* say the French for a guest, then the French for a baby, then say *le petit-fils* again

Before you move on

What does le petit-fils mean? ("A grandson".) Say it once more.

58.5 la petite-fille — a granddaughter

Before the new one: say the French for a baby, then the French for a grandson.

You'll want to know: la petite-fille

la petite-fille — "a granddaughter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

petite-fille — built from the French for "little", in its feminine form, and *fille*, "daughter": a granddaughter. The "little" word ← Vulgar Latin **pittitus*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la petite-fille*
- *Say it: la petite-fille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la petite-fille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a baby, then the French for a grandson, then say *la petite-fille* again

Before you move on

What does la petite-fille mean? ("A granddaughter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

Nephew, Niece, Pupil, Teacher, Laugh

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a nephew, a niece, a pupil, a teacher, to laugh.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 59: I can name a nephew, a niece, a pupil, a teacher, to laugh.

59.1 le neveu — a nephew

Before the new one: say the French for a grandson, then the French for a granddaughter.

You'll want to know: le neveu

le neveu — "a nephew".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neveu ← Latin *nepos*, *nepotis*, "grandson, nephew" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le neveu*
- *Say it: le neveu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le neveu*
- *Recall:* say the French for a grandson, then the French for a granddaughter, then say *le neveu* again

Before you move on

What does le neveu mean? ("A nephew".) Say it once more.

59.2 la nièce — a niece

Before the new one: say the French for a granddaughter, then the French for a nephew.

You'll want to know: la nièce

la nièce — "a niece".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nièce ← Vulgar Latin **neptia*, from Latin *neptis*, "granddaughter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nièce*
- *Say it: la nièce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la nièce*
- *Recall:* say the French for a granddaughter, then the French for a nephew, then say *la nièce* again

Before you move on

What does la nièce mean? (“A niece”.) Say it once more.

59.3 l’élève — a pupil

Before the new one: say the French for a nephew, then the French for a niece.

You’ll want to know: l’élève

l’élève — “a pupil”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

élève — formed from the verb for “to raise, to bring up” (EtymDB 2.1), on the model of Italian *allievo*, “pupil”. The verb is built on Latin *levare*, “to lift”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’élève*
- *Say it: l’élève*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’élève*
- *Recall:* say the French for a nephew, then the French for a niece, then say *l’élève* again

Before you move on

What does l’élève mean? (“A pupil”.) Say it once more.

59.4 le professeur — a teacher

Before the new one: say the French for a niece, then the French for a pupil.

You'll want to know: le professeur

le professeur — "a teacher".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

professeur ← Latin *professor*, "a public teacher", from *profiteri*, "to declare in public" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le professeur*
- *Say it: le professeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le professeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a niece, then the French for a pupil, then say *le professeur* again

Before you move on

What does le professeur mean? ("A teacher".) Say it once more.

59.5 rire — to laugh

Before the new one: say the French for a pupil, then the French for a teacher.

You'll want to know: rire

rire — "to laugh".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rire ← Latin *ridere*, "to laugh" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rire*
- *Say it: rire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pupil, then the French for a teacher, then say *rire* again

Before you move on

What does rire mean? (“To laugh”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Cry, Wash, Cook, Play, Learn

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to cry, to wash, to cook, to play, to learn.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 60: I can say to cry, to wash, to cook, to play, to learn.*

60.1 pleurer — to cry

Before the new one: say the French for a teacher, then the French for to laugh.

You'll want to know: pleurer

pleurer — "to cry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pleurer ← Old French *plorer* ← Latin *plorare*, "to wail, to weep aloud" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pleurer*
- *Say it: pleurer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pleurer*
- *Recall:* say the French for a teacher, then the French for to laugh, then say *pleurer* again

Before you move on

What does pleurer mean? ("To cry".) Say it once more.

60.2 laver — to wash

Before the new one: say the French for to laugh, then the French for to cry.

You'll want to know: laver

laver — "to wash".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

laver ← Latin *lavare*, "to wash" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laver*
- *Say it: laver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to laugh, then the French for to cry, then say *laver* again

Before you move on

What does laver mean? ("To wash".) Say it once more.

60.3 cuisiner — to cook

Before the new one: say the French for to cry, then the French for to wash.

You'll want to know: cuisiner

cuisiner — "to cook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuisiner — built from the French word for "kitchen, cooking", which ← Vulgar Latin **cocina* ← Latin *coquina*, "kitchen", from *coquere*, "to cook". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuisiner*
- *Say it: cuisiner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuisiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cry, then the French for to wash, then say *cuisiner* again

Before you move on

What does cuisiner mean? ("To cook".) Say it once more.

60.4 jouer — to play

Before the new one: say the French for to wash, then the French for to cook.

You'll want to know: jouer

jouer — "to play".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jouer ← Old French *joer* ← Latin *iocari*, "to jest, to joke" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jouer*
- *Say it: jouer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jouer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wash, then the French for to cook, then say *jouer* again

Before you move on

What does jouer mean? ("To play".) Say it once more.

60.5 apprendre — to learn

Before the new one: say the French for to cook, then the French for to play.

You'll want to know: apprendre

apprendre — "to learn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

apprendre ← Old French *aprendre* ← Latin *apprehendere*, "to seize, to grasp" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: to learn is to grasp. It is *prendre*, "to take", with *a-* in front.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *apprendre*
- *Say it:* *apprendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *apprendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cook, then the French for to play, then say *apprendre* again

Before you move on

What does apprendre mean? ("To learn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

Teach, Drink, Eat, Give, Live

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to teach, to drink, to eat, to give, to live.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 61: I can say to teach, to drink, to eat, to give, to live.*

61.1 enseigner — to teach

Before the new one: say the French for to play, then the French for to learn.

You'll want to know: enseigner

enseigner — "to teach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enseigner ← Old French *enseignier* ← Vulgar Latin **insignare*, "to mark, to point out", from Latin *signum*, "a mark, a sign" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *enseigner*
- *Say it:* *enseigner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enseigner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to play, then the French for to learn, then say *enseigner* again

Before you move on

What does enseigner mean? (“To teach”.) Say it once more.

61.2 boire — to drink

Before the new one: say the French for to learn, then the French for to teach.

You’ll want to know: boire

boire — “to drink”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boire ← Old French *boivre* ← Latin *bibere*, “to drink” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *boire*
- *Say it:* *boire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *boire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to learn, then the French for to teach, then say *boire* again

Before you move on

What does boire mean? (“To drink”.) Say it once more.

61.3 manger — to eat

Before the new one: say the French for to teach, then the French for to drink.

You’ll want to know: manger

manger — “to eat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manger ← Old French *mengier* ← Latin *manducare*, “to chew” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) It replaced the older Latin verb for “to eat” in everyday speech.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: manger*
- *Say it: manger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to teach, then the French for to drink, then say *manger* again

Before you move on

What does manger mean? (“To eat”.) Say it once more.

61.4 donner — to give

Before the new one: say the French for to drink, then the French for to eat.

You'll want to know: donner

donner — "to give".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

donner ← Latin *donare*, "to give as a gift", from *donum*, "a gift" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: donner*
- *Say it: donner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *donner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drink, then the French for to eat, then say *donner* again

Before you move on

What does donner mean? ("To give".) Say it once more.

61.5 vivre — to live

Before the new one: say the French for to eat, then the French for to give.

You'll want to know: vivre

vivre — "to live".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vivre ← Latin *vivere*, "to live" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vivre*
- *Say it: vivre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vivre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to eat, then the French for to give, then say *vivre* again

Before you move on

What does vivre mean? (“To live”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Come back, Study, Pay, Use, Show

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to come back, to study, to pay, to use, to show.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 62: I can say to come back, to study, to pay, to use, to show.*

62.1 revenir — to come back

Before the new one: say the French for to give, then the French for to live.

You'll want to know: revenir

revenir — "to come back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

revenir ← Latin *revenire*, "to come back", from *re-*, "back", and *venire*, "to come" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: revenir*
- *Say it: revenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *revenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give, then the French for to live, then say *revenir* again

Before you move on

What does revenir mean? ("To come back".) Say it once more.

62.2 étudier — to study

Before the new one: say the French for to live, then the French for to come back.

You'll want to know: étudier

étudier — "to study".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étudier ← Old French *estudier*, a medieval scholars' word built on Latin *studium*, "eagerness, study", from *studere*, "to be eager" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin verb.) The *é-* stands where an *s* once was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: étudier*
- *Say it: étudier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étudier*

- *Recall:* say the French for to live, then the French for to come back, then say *étudier* again

Before you move on

What does étudier mean? (“To study”.) Say it once more.

62.3 payer — to pay

Before the new one: say the French for to come back, then the French for to study.

You’ll want to know: payer

payer — “to pay”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

payer ← Old French *paiier* ← Latin *pacare*, “to calm, to satisfy”, from *pax*, “peace” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: to pay was to settle with someone.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: payer*
- *Say it: payer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *payer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to come back, then the French for to study, then say *payer* again

Before you move on

What does payer mean? (“To pay”.) Say it once more.

62.4 utiliser — to use

Before the new one: say the French for to study, then the French for to pay.

You'll want to know: utiliser

utiliser — "to use".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

utiliser — formed in French in the 18th century from the word for "useful", a borrowing of Latin *utilis*, "useful", from *uti*, "to use" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: utiliser*
- *Say it: utiliser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utiliser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to study, then the French for to pay, then say *utiliser* again

Before you move on

What does utiliser mean? ("To use".) Say it once more.

62.5 montrer — to show

Before the new one: say the French for to pay, then the French for to use.

You'll want to know: montrer

montrer — "to show".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

montrer ← Old French *monstrer* ← Latin *monstrare*, "to show", from *monere*, "to warn, to remind" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *montrer*
- *Say it:* *montrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *montrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pay, then the French for to use, then say *montrer* again

Before you move on

What does montrer mean? ("To show".) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

Clean, Cut, Forget, Look for, Lose

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to clean, to cut, to forget, to look for, to lose.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 63: I can say to clean, to cut, to forget, to look for, to lose.*

63.1 nettoyer — to clean

Before the new one: say the French for to use, then the French for to show.

You'll want to know: nettoyer

nettoyer — "to clean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nettoyer ← Old French *nettoier*, built on the adjective for "clean, neat", which goes back to Latin *nitidus*, "shining". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nettoyer*
- *Say it: nettoyer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nettoyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to use, then the French for to show, then say *nettoyer* again

Before you move on

What does nettoyer mean? (“To clean”.) Say it once more.

63.2 couper — to cut

Before the new one: say the French for to show, then the French for to clean.

You’ll want to know: couper

couper — “to cut”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couper — built on the French word for “a blow”, which ← Late Latin *colpus*, from Latin *colaphus*, “a punch”, from Greek *kolaphos*: to cut was first to strike. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: couper*
- *Say it: couper*, once more
- *Say it:* say *couper*
- *Recall:* say the French for to show, then the French for to clean, then say *couper* again

Before you move on

What does couper mean? (“To cut”.) Say it once more.

63.3 oublier — to forget

Before the new one: say the French for to clean, then the French for to cut.

You’ll want to know: oublier

oublier — “to forget”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oublier ← Old French *oblier* ← Vulgar Latin **oblitare*, from Latin *oblitus*, “forgotten”, the past participle of *oblivisci*, “to forget” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oublier*
- *Say it: oublier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oublier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clean, then the French for to cut, then say *oublier* again

Before you move on

What does oublier mean? (“To forget”.) Say it once more.

63.4 chercher — to look for

Before the new one: say the French for to cut, then the French for to forget.

You'll want to know: chercher

chercher — "to look for".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chercher ← Old French *cerchier* ← Late Latin *circare*, "to go around", from *circus*, "a ring" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. English *search* came from the same Old French verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *chercher*
- *Say it:* *chercher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chercher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cut, then the French for to forget, then say *chercher* again

Before you move on

What does chercher mean? ("To look for".) Say it once more.

63.5 perdre — to lose

Before the new one: say the French for to forget, then the French for to look for.

You'll want to know: perdre

perdre — "to lose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

perdre ← Latin *perdere*, "to destroy, to lose" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: perdre*
- *Say it: perdre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perdre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to forget, then the French for to look for, then say *perdre* again

Before you move on

What does perdre mean? ("To lose".) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

Look at, Listen to, Wait for, Buy, Know

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to look at, to listen to, to wait for, to buy, to know (a fact).
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 64: I can say to look at, to listen to, to wait for, to buy, to know (a fact).*

64.1 regarder — "to look at, to watch"

> Before the new one: say the French for to look for, then the French for to lose.

You'll want to know: regarder

regarder — "to look at, to watch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

regarder — built from *re-* and the French verb for "to keep, to watch over", which ← Frankish **wardon*, "to watch". EtymDB 2.1 traces Italian *guardare* to the same Frankish verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: regarder*
- *Say it: regarder*, once more
- *Say it:* say *regarder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to look for, then the French for to lose, then say *regarder* again

Before you move on

What does regarder mean? ("To look at, to watch".) Say it once more.

64.2 écouter — to listen to

Before the new one: say the French for to lose, then the French for to look at.

You'll want to know: écouter

écouter — "to listen to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écouter ← Old French *escouter* ← Latin *auscultare*, "to listen" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: écouter*
- *Say it: écouter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *écouter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lose, then the French for to look at, then say *écouter* again

Before you move on

What does écouter mean? (“To listen to”.) Say it once more.

64.3 attendre — to wait for

Before the new one: say the French for to look at, then the French for to listen to.

You’ll want to know: attendre

attendre — “to wait for”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

attendre ← Latin *attendere*, “to stretch toward, to pay heed” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: attendre*
- *Say it: attendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *attendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to look at, then the French for to listen to, then say *attendre* again

Before you move on

What does attendre mean? (“To wait for”.) Say it once more.

64.4 acheter — to buy

Before the new one: say the French for to listen to, then the French for to wait for.

You'll want to know: acheter

acheter — "to buy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

acheter ← Old French *acheter* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **accaptare*, from Latin *captare*, "to try to catch" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: Latin *ca-* became French *che-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: acheter*
- *Say it: acheter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *acheter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to listen to, then the French for to wait for, then say *acheter* again

Before you move on

What does acheter mean? ("To buy".) Say it once more.

64.5 savoir — to know (a fact)

Before the new one: say the French for to wait for, then the French for to buy.

You'll want to know: savoir

savoir — "to know (a fact)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

savoir ← Latin *sapere*, "to taste, to be wise" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, through a Vulgar Latin **sapere* stressed on its middle syllable.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: savoir*
- *Say it: savoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *savoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wait for, then the French for to buy, then say *savoir* again

Before you move on

What does savoir mean? ("To know (a fact)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

Leave, Carry, Send, Receive, Feel

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to leave (something), to carry, to send, to receive, to feel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 65: I can say to leave (something), to carry, to send, to receive, to feel.*

65.1 laisser — to leave (something); to let

Before the new one: say the French for to buy, then the French for to know.

You'll want to know: laisser

laisser — "to leave (something); to let".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

laisser ← Old French *laissier* ← Latin *laxare*, "to loosen", from *laxus*, "slack" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laisser*
- *Say it: laisser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laisser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to buy, then the French for to know, then say *laisser* again

Before you move on

What does laisser mean? ("To leave (something); to let".) Say it once more.

65.2 porter — to carry; to wear

Before the new one: say the French for to know, then the French for to leave.

You'll want to know: porter

porter — "to carry; to wear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

porter ← Latin *portare*, "to carry" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: porter*
- *Say it: porter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *porter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to know, then the French for to leave, then say *porter* again

Before you move on

What does porter mean? (“To carry; to wear”.) Say it once more.

65.3 envoyer — to send

Before the new one: say the French for to leave, then the French for to carry; to wear.

You’ll want to know: envoyer

envoyer — “to send”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

envoyer ← Old French *envoier* ← Late Latin *inviare*, “to put on the way”, from *via*, “a road” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *envoyer*
- *Say it:* *envoyer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *envoyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to leave, then the French for to carry; to wear, then say *envoyer* again

Before you move on

What does envoyer mean? (“To send”.) Say it once more.

65.4 recevoir — to receive

Before the new one: say the French for to carry; to wear, then the French for to send.

You'll want to know: recevoir

recevoir — "to receive".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recevoir ← Latin *recipere*, "to take back, to receive" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, through a Vulgar Latin form **recipere* stressed on its middle syllable.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: recevoir*
- *Say it: recevoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *recevoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to carry; to wear, then the French for to send, then say *recevoir* again

Before you move on

What does recevoir mean? ("To receive".) Say it once more.

65.5 sentir — to feel; to smell

Before the new one: say the French for to send, then the French for to receive.

You'll want to know: sentir

sentir — "to feel; to smell".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sentir ← Latin *sentire*, "to feel, to perceive" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sentir*
- *Say it: sentir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sentir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to send, then the French for to receive, then say *sentir* again

Before you move on

What does sentir mean? ("To feel; to smell".) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

Draw, Paint, Count, Win, Hide

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to draw, to paint, to count, to win, to hide.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 66: I can say to draw, to paint, to count, to win, to hide.*

66.1 dessiner — to draw

Before the new one: say the French for to receive, then the French for to feel; to smell.

You'll want to know: dessiner

dessiner — "to draw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessiner ← Middle French *desseigner*, from Italian *disegnare*, "to draw", ← Latin *designare*, "to mark out" — borrowed from Italian. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Middle French and Latin forms.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dessiner*
- *Say it: dessiner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dessiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to receive, then the French for to feel; to smell, then say *dessiner* again

Before you move on

What does dessiner mean? (“To draw”.) Say it once more.

66.2 peindre — to paint

Before the new one: say the French for to feel; to smell, then the French for to draw.

You’ll want to know: peindre

peindre — “to paint”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peindre ← Old French *peindre* ← Latin *pingere*, “to paint” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peindre*
- *Say it: peindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to feel; to smell, then the French for to draw, then say *peindre* again

Before you move on

What does peindre mean? (“To paint”.) Say it once more.

66.3 compter — to count

Before the new one: say the French for to draw, then the French for to paint.

You’ll want to know: compter

compter — “to count”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compter ← Latin *computare*, “to reckon” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Old French wrote it *conter*; the *mp* was put back later to recall the Latin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: compter*
- *Say it: compter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *compter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to draw, then the French for to paint, then say *compter* again

Before you move on

What does compter mean? (“To count”.) Say it once more.

66.4 gagner — to win; to earn

Before the new one: say the French for to paint, then the French for to count.

You'll want to know: gagner

gagner — "to win; to earn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gagner ← Old French *gaaignier* ← Frankish **waidanjan*, "to hunt for food, to graze" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gagner*
- *Say it:* *gagner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gagner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to paint, then the French for to count, then say *gagner* again

Before you move on

What does gagner mean? ("To win; to earn".) Say it once more.

66.5 cacher — to hide

Before the new one: say the French for to count, then the French for to win; to earn.

You'll want to know: cacher

cacher — "to hide".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cacher ← Old French *cachier* ← Vulgar Latin **coacticare*, "to press together" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cacher*
- *Say it:* *cacher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cacher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to count, then the French for to win; to earn, then say *cacher* again

Before you move on

What does cacher mean? ("To hide".) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

Find, Fish, Chicken, Fruit, Apple

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name to find, fish, chicken, a fruit, an apple.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 67: I can name to find, fish, chicken, a fruit, an apple.*

67.1 trouver — to find

Before the new one: say the French for to win; to earn, then the French for to hide.

You'll want to know: trouver

trouver — "to find".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trouver ← Old French *trover*, probably from Vulgar Latin **tropare*, "to compose a poem", from Latin *tropus*, "a figure of speech", from Greek *tropos*, "a turn" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1). This is the usual account; it is not certain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trouver*
- *Say it: trouver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trouver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to win; to earn, then the French for to hide, then say *trouver* again

Before you move on

What does trouver mean? ("To find".) Say it once more.

67.2 le poisson — fish

Before the new one: say the French for to hide, then the French for to find.

You'll want to know: le poisson

le poisson — "fish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poisson ← Latin *piscis*, "fish", through a Vulgar Latin form **piscio* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poisson*
- *Say it: le poisson*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poisson*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hide, then the French for to find, then say *le poisson* again

Before you move on

What does le poisson mean? ("Fish".) Say it once more.

67.3 le poulet — chicken

Before the new one: say the French for to find, then the French for fish.

You'll want to know: le poulet

le poulet — "chicken".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poulet — built from the French word for "hen", with *-et*, "little". The hen word ← Latin *pulla*, the feminine of *pullus*, "a young animal" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poulet*
- *Say it: le poulet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poulet*
- *Recall:* say the French for to find, then the French for fish, then say *le poulet* again

Before you move on

What does le poulet mean? ("Chicken".) Say it once more.

67.4 le fruit — a fruit

Before the new one: say the French for fish, then the French for chicken.

You'll want to know: le fruit

le fruit — "a fruit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fruit ← Old French *fruit* ← Latin *fructus*, "enjoyment, produce" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fruit*
- *Say it: le fruit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fruit*
- *Recall:* say the French for fish, then the French for chicken, then say *le fruit* again

Before you move on

What does le fruit mean? ("A fruit".) Say it once more.

67.5 la pomme — an apple

Before the new one: say the French for chicken, then the French for a fruit.

You'll want to know: la pomme

la pomme — "an apple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pomme ← Latin *poma*, "fruits", the plural of *pomum* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) In Latin *pomum* was any fruit; French narrowed it to the apple.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pomme*
- *Say it: la pomme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pomme*
- *Recall:* say the French for chicken, then the French for a fruit, then say *la pomme* again

Before you move on

What does la pomme mean? ("An apple".) Say it once more.

Chapter 68

Banana, Orange, Potato, Tomato, Onion

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a banana, an orange, a potato, a tomato, an onion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 68: I can name a banana, an orange, a potato, a tomato, an onion.*

68.1 la banane — a banana

> Before the new one: say the French for a fruit, then the French for an apple.

You'll want to know: la banane

la banane — "a banana".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banane ← Portuguese *banana* (EtymDB 2.1), from a West African language, perhaps Wolof — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la banane*
- *Say it: la banane*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la banane*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fruit, then the French for an apple, then say *la banane* again

Before you move on

What does la banane mean? ("A banana".) Say it once more.

68.2 l'orange — an orange

Before the new one: say the French for an apple, then the French for a banana.

You'll want to know: l'orange

l'orange — "an orange".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

orange ← Old French *pome orenge*, "orange apple" (EtymDB 2.1), which came through Italian from Arabic *naranj* and Persian *narang* — borrowed. The *n-* fell away on the journey.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'orange*
- *Say it: l'orange*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'orange*
- *Recall:* say the French for an apple, then the French for a banana, then say *l'orange* again

Before you move on

What does l'orange mean? ("An orange".) Say it once more.

68.3 la pomme de terre — a potato

Before the new one: say the French for a banana, then the French for an orange.

You'll want to know: la pomme de terre

la pomme de terre — "a potato". Literally "apple of the earth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pomme de terre — "apple of the earth": *pomme*, "apple", *de*, "of", and *terre*, "earth", ← Latin *terra*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pomme de terre*
- *Say it: la pomme de terre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pomme de terre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a banana, then the French for an orange, then say *la pomme de terre* again

Before you move on

What does la pomme de terre mean? ("A potato".) Say it once more.

68.4 la tomate — a tomato

Before the new one: say the French for an orange, then the French for a potato.

You'll want to know: la tomate

la tomate — "a tomato".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tomate ← Spanish *tomate* ← Nahuatl *tomatl* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tomate*
- *Say it: la tomate*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tomate*
- *Recall:* say the French for an orange, then the French for a potato, then say *la tomate* again

Before you move on

What does la tomate mean? ("A tomato".) Say it once more.

68.5 l'oignon — an onion

Before the new one: say the French for a potato, then the French for a tomato.

You'll want to know: l'oignon

l'oignon — "an onion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oignon ← Old French *oingnon* ← Latin *unio*, *unionis*, a kind of onion that grows as a single bulb — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) *unio* is built on *unus*, "one" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'oignon*
- *Say it: l'oignon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'oignon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a potato, then the French for a tomato, then say *l'oignon* again

Before you move on

What does l'oignon mean? ("An onion".) Say it once more.

Chapter 69

Carrot, Cake, Soup, Honey, Oil

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a carrot, a cake, a soup, honey, oil.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 69: I can name a carrot, a cake, a soup, honey, oil.*

69.1 la carotte — a carrot

Before the new one: say the French for a tomato, then the French for an onion.

You'll want to know: la carotte

la carotte — "a carrot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carotte ← Latin *carota* ← Greek *karoton* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carotte*
- *Say it: la carotte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carotte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tomato, then the French for an onion, then say *la carotte* again

Before you move on

What does la carotte mean? ("A carrot".) Say it once more.

69.2 le gâteau — a cake

Before the new one: say the French for an onion, then the French for a carrot.

You'll want to know: le gâteau

le gâteau — "a cake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gâteau ← Old French *gastel* ← Frankish **wastil*, "food" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gâteau*
- *Say it: le gâteau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le gâteau*
- *Recall:* say the French for an onion, then the French for a carrot, then say *le gâteau* again

Before you move on

What does le gâteau mean? ("A cake".) Say it once more.

69.3 la soupe — a soup

Before the new one: say the French for a carrot, then the French for a cake.

You'll want to know: la soupe

la soupe — "a soup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soupe ← Old French *sope* ← Late Latin *suppa*, "bread soaked in broth" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1); Late Latin had taken *suppa* from a Germanic language.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la soupe*
- *Say it: la soupe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la soupe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a carrot, then the French for a cake, then say *la soupe* again

Before you move on

What does la soupe mean? ("A soup".) Say it once more.

69.4 le miel — honey

Before the new one: say the French for a cake, then the French for a soup.

You'll want to know: le miel

le miel — "honey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

miel ← Latin *mel*, "honey" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the stressed *e* broke into *ie*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le miel*
- *Say it: le miel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le miel*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cake, then the French for a soup, then say *le miel* again

Before you move on

What does le miel mean? ("Honey".) Say it once more.

69.5 l'huile — oil

Before the new one: say the French for a soup, then the French for honey.

You'll want to know: l'huile

l'huile — "oil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

huile ← Old French *oile* ← Latin *oleum*, "olive oil", from Greek *elaion* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *h* was added to the spelling only.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'huile*
- *Say it: l'huile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'huile*
- *Recall:* say the French for a soup, then the French for honey, then say *l'huile* again

Before you move on

What does l'huile mean? ("Oil".) Say it once more.

Chapter 70

Lunch, Dinner, Breakfast, Rice, Pear

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name lunch, dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 70: I can name lunch, dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear.

70.1 le déjeuner — lunch

Before the new one: say the French for honey, then the French for oil.

You'll want to know: le déjeuner

le déjeuner — "lunch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déjeuner ← Vulgar Latin **disieiunare*, "to break the fast" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin verb.) The French word for "dinner" comes from the same verb by another path.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le déjeuner*
- *Say it: le déjeuner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le déjeuner*
- *Recall:* say the French for honey, then the French for oil, then say *le déjeuner* again

Before you move on

What does le déjeuner mean? (“Lunch”.) Say it once more.

70.2 le dîner — dinner

Before the new one: say the French for oil, then the French for lunch.

You’ll want to know: le dîner

le dîner — “dinner”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dîner ← Old French *disner* ← Vulgar Latin **disiunare*, from *disieiunare*, “to break the fast” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) It is the same verb as *déjeuner*, worn down differently.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dîner*
- *Say it: le dîner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dîner*
- *Recall:* say the French for oil, then the French for lunch, then say *le dîner* again

Before you move on

What does le dîner mean? ("Dinner".) Say it once more.

70.3 le petit-déjeuner — breakfast

Before the new one: say the French for lunch, then the French for dinner.

You'll want to know: le petit-déjeuner

le petit-déjeuner — "breakfast". Literally "little lunch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

petit-déjeuner — built from the French word for "little" and *déjeuner*: the small first breaking of the fast, as English *breakfast* is.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le petit-déjeuner*
- *Say it: le petit-déjeuner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le petit-déjeuner*
- *Recall:* say the French for lunch, then the French for dinner, then say *le petit-déjeuner* again

Before you move on

What does le petit-déjeuner mean? ("Breakfast".) Say it once more.

70.4 le riz — rice

Before the new one: say the French for dinner, then the French for breakfast.

You'll want to know: le riz

le riz — "rice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

riz ← Old French *ris* ← Italian *riso* ← Latin *oryza*, from Greek *oryza* — borrowed from Italian. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le riz*
- *Say it: le riz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le riz*
- *Recall:* say the French for dinner, then the French for breakfast, then say *le riz* again

Before you move on

What does le riz mean? ("Rice".) Say it once more.

70.5 la poire — a pear

Before the new one: say the French for breakfast, then the French for rice.

You'll want to know: la poire

la poire — "a pear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poire ← Old French *peire* ← Vulgar Latin **pira*, from Latin *pirum*, "pear" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poire*
- *Say it: la poire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poire*
- *Recall:* say the French for breakfast, then the French for rice, then say *la poire* again

Before you move on

What does la poire mean? ("A pear".) Say it once more.

Chapter 71

Lemon, Grapes, Jam, Yoghurt, Ham

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a lemon, grapes, jam, a yoghurt, ham.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 71: I can name a lemon, grapes, jam, a yoghurt, ham.*

71.1 le citron — a lemon

Before the new one: say the French for rice, then the French for a pear.

You'll want to know: le citron

le citron — "a lemon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

citron — formed from Latin *citrus*, "the citron tree" (EtymDB 2.1), with the ending *-on*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le citron*
- *Say it: le citron*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le citron*
- *Recall:* say the French for rice, then the French for a pear, then say *le citron* again

Before you move on

What does le citron mean? (“A lemon”.) Say it once more.

71.2 le raisin — grapes

Before the new one: say the French for a pear, then the French for a lemon.

You’ll want to know: le raisin

le raisin — “grapes”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raisin ← Vulgar Latin **racimus* ← Latin *racemus*, “a cluster of grapes” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le raisin*
- *Say it: le raisin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le raisin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pear, then the French for a lemon, then say *le raisin* again

Before you move on

What does le raisin mean? (“Grapes”.) Say it once more.

71.3 la confiture — jam

Before the new one: say the French for a lemon, then the French for grapes.

You’ll want to know: la confiture

la confiture — “jam”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

confiture — built on Old French *confire*, “to preserve”, ← Latin *conficere*, “to prepare”. (EtymDB 2.1 links it to Latin *confectura*, “a preparing”.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la confiture*
- *Say it: la confiture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la confiture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lemon, then the French for grapes, then say *la confiture* again

Before you move on

What does la confiture mean? (“Jam”.) Say it once more.

71.4 le yaourt — a yoghurt

Before the new one: say the French for grapes, then the French for jam.

You'll want to know: le yaourt

le yaourt — "a yoghurt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

yaourt ← Turkish *yogurt* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le yaourt*
- *Say it: le yaourt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le yaourt*
- *Recall:* say the French for grapes, then the French for jam, then say *le yaourt* again

Before you move on

What does le yaourt mean? ("A yoghurt".) Say it once more.

71.5 le jambon — ham

Before the new one: say the French for jam, then the French for a yoghurt.

You'll want to know: le jambon

le jambon — "ham".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jambon — built from *jambe*, "leg", with *-on*: the leg of the pig. *jambe* ← Late Latin *gamba*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jambon*
- *Say it: le jambon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jambon*
- *Recall:* say the French for jam, then the French for a yoghurt, then say *le jambon* again

Before you move on

What does le jambon mean? (“Ham”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 72

Salad, Pasta, Cream, Pepper, Walnut

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a salad, pasta, cream, pepper, a walnut.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 72: I can name a salad, pasta, cream, pepper, a walnut.*

72.1 la salade — a salad; lettuce

> Before the new one: say the French for a yoghurt, then the French for ham.

You'll want to know: la salade

la salade — "a salad; lettuce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salade ← Italian *salata*, "salted", that is, salted greens (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; behind it is Latin *sal*, "salt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salade*
- *Say it: la salade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la salade*
- *Recall:* say the French for a yoghurt, then the French for ham, then say *la salade* again

Before you move on

What does la salade mean? ("A salad; lettuce".) Say it once more.

72.2 les pâtes — pasta

Before the new one: say the French for ham, then the French for a salad; lettuce.

You'll want to know: les pâtes

les pâtes — "pasta".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pâtes is the plural of the French word for "dough, paste", which ← Old French *paste* ← Late Latin *pasta*, "dough", from Greek *pasta*, "barley porridge" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les pâtes*
- *Say it: les pâtes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les pâtes*
- *Recall:* say the French for ham, then the French for a salad; lettuce, then say *les pâtes* again

Before you move on

What does les pâtes mean? (“Pasta”.) Say it once more.

72.3 la crème — cream

Before the new one: say the French for a salad; lettuce, then the French for pasta.

You’ll want to know: la crème

la crème — “cream”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crème ← Old French *cresme* ← Late Latin *crama*, “cream”, probably a Gaulish word (EtymDB 2.1); its spelling was later pulled toward Church Latin *chrisma*, “anointing oil”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la crème*
- *Say it: la crème*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la crème*
- *Recall:* say the French for a salad; lettuce, then the French for pasta, then say *la crème* again

Before you move on

What does la crème mean? (“Cream”.) Say it once more.

72.4 le poivre — pepper

Before the new one: say the French for pasta, then the French for cream.

You'll want to know: le poivre

le poivre — "pepper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poivre ← Old French *peivre* ← Latin *piper*, from Greek *peperi* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The word travelled with the spice from India: Sanskrit has *pippali*, "long pepper".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poivre*
- *Say it: le poivre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poivre*
- *Recall:* say the French for pasta, then the French for cream, then say *le poivre* again

Before you move on

What does le poivre mean? ("Pepper".) Say it once more.

72.5 la noix — a walnut, a nut

Before the new one: say the French for cream, then the French for pepper.

You'll want to know: la noix

la noix — "a walnut, a nut".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

noix ← Old French *nois* ← Latin *nux*, *nucis*, "nut" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la noix*
- *Say it: la noix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la noix*
- *Recall:* say the French for cream, then the French for pepper, then say *la noix* again

Before you move on

What does la noix mean? ("A walnut, a nut".) Say it once more.

Chapter 73

Kitchen, Window, Chair, Key, Wall

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a kitchen, a window, a chair, a key, a wall.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 73: I can name a kitchen, a window, a chair, a key, a wall.

73.1 la cuisine — a kitchen; cooking

Before the new one: say the French for pepper, then the French for a walnut.

You'll want to know: la cuisine

la cuisine — "a kitchen; cooking". The noun behind **cuisiner**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuisine ← Vulgar Latin **cocina* ← Latin *coquina*, "kitchen", from *coquere*, "to cook" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cuisine*
- *Say it: la cuisine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cuisine*
- *Recall:* say the French for pepper, then the French for a walnut, then say *la cuisine* again

Before you move on

What does la cuisine mean? ("A kitchen; cooking".) Say it once more.

73.2 la fenêtre — a window

Before the new one: say the French for a walnut, then the French for a kitchen; cooking.

You'll want to know: la fenêtre

la fenêtre — "a window".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fenêtre ← Old French *fenestre* ← Latin *fenestra*, "window" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fenêtre*
- *Say it: la fenêtre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fenêtre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a walnut, then the French for a kitchen; cooking, then say *la fenêtre* again

Before you move on

What does la fenêtre mean? (“A window”.) Say it once more.

73.3 la chaise — a chair

Before the new one: say the French for a kitchen; cooking, then the French for a window.

You’ll want to know: la chaise

la chaise — “a chair”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaise ← Latin *cathedra*, “a seat”, from Greek *kathedra* (Lewis & Short) — inherited. Old French said *chaiere*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to *cathedra*; Paris speech turned its *r* into a *z*. The older form lives on in the French word for a pulpit.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chaise*
- *Say it: la chaise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chaise*
- *Recall:* say the French for a kitchen; cooking, then the French for a window, then say *la chaise* again

Before you move on

What does la chaise mean? (“A chair”.) Say it once more.

73.4 la clé — a key

Before the new one: say the French for a window, then the French for a chair.

You'll want to know: la clé

la clé — "a key".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clé ← Old French *clef* ← Latin *clavis*, "key" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la clé*
- *Say it: la clé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la clé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a window, then the French for a chair, then say *la clé* again

Before you move on

What does la clé mean? ("A key".) Say it once more.

73.5 le mur — a wall

Before the new one: say the French for a chair, then the French for a key.

You'll want to know: le mur

le mur — "a wall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mur ← Latin *murus*, "wall" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mur*
- *Say it: le mur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a chair, then the French for a key, then say *le mur* again

Before you move on

What does le mur mean? ("A wall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 74

Roof, Garden, Lamp, Bathroom, Bedroom

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a roof, a garden, a lamp, a bathroom, a bedroom.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 74: I can name a roof, a garden, a lamp, a bathroom, a bedroom.

74.1 le toit — a roof

Before the new one: say the French for a key, then the French for a wall.

You'll want to know: le toit

le toit — "a roof".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toit ← Latin *tectum*, "roof", from *tegere*, "to cover" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited: Latin *-ct-* became French *-it*, as in *lait* from Latin *lac*, *lactis*, through Vulgar Latin **lacte*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le toit*
- *Say it: le toit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le toit*
- *Recall:* say the French for a key, then the French for a wall, then say *le toit* again

Before you move on

What does le toit mean? ("A roof".) Say it once more.

74.2 le jardin — a garden

Before the new one: say the French for a wall, then the French for a roof.

You'll want to know: le jardin

le jardin — "a garden".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jardin ← Old French *jardin* (EtymDB 2.1), from Frankish **gardo*, "an enclosure" — borrowed from the Franks.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jardin*
- *Say it: le jardin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jardin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wall, then the French for a roof, then say *le jardin* again

Before you move on

What does le jardin mean? (“A garden”.) Say it once more.

74.3 la lampe — a lamp

Before the new one: say the French for a roof, then the French for a garden.

You’ll want to know: la lampe

la lampe — “a lamp”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lampe ← Late Latin *lampada* ← Latin *lampas*, “a torch”, from Greek *lampas* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lampe*
- *Say it: la lampe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la lampe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a roof, then the French for a garden, then say *la lampe* again

Before you move on

What does la lampe mean? (“A lamp”.) Say it once more.

74.4 la salle de bain — a bathroom

Before the new one: say the French for a garden, then the French for a lamp.

You'll want to know: la salle de bain

la salle de bain — "a bathroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salle de bain — "room of bath": *salle*, "a room", ← Frankish **sal*, "a hall" (EtymDB 2.1); *de*, "of"; *bain*, "bath", ← Latin *balneum* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salle de bain*
- *Say it: la salle de bain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la salle de bain*
- *Recall:* say the French for a garden, then the French for a lamp, then say *la salle de bain* again

Before you move on

What does la salle de bain mean? ("A bathroom".) Say it once more.

74.5 la chambre — a bedroom

Before the new one: say the French for a lamp, then the French for a bathroom.

You'll want to know: la chambre

la chambre — "a bedroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chambre ← Latin *camera*, "a vaulted room", from Greek *kamara* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: Latin *ca-* became French *cha-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chambre*
- *Say it: la chambre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chambre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lamp, then the French for a bathroom, then say *la chambre* again

Before you move on

What does la chambre mean? ("A bedroom".) Say it once more.

Chapter 75

Floor, Stairs, Mirror, Living room, Sofa

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the floor, the stairs, a mirror, a living room, a sofa.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 75: I can name the floor, the stairs, a mirror, a living room, a sofa.

75.1 le sol — the floor, the ground

Before the new one: say the French for a bathroom, then the French for a bedroom.

You'll want to know: le sol

le sol — "the floor, the ground".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sol ← Latin *solum*, "ground, floor" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sol*
- *Say it: le sol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sol*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bathroom, then the French for a bedroom, then say *le sol* again

Before you move on

What does le sol mean? ("The floor, the ground".) Say it once more.

75.2 l'escalier — the stairs

Before the new one: say the French for a bedroom, then the French for the floor.

You'll want to know: l'escalier

l'escalier — "the stairs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

escalier ← Occitan *escalier* ← Latin *scalaria*, "steps", from *scala*, "a ladder" — borrowed from the south in the 1500s. (EtymDB 2.1 has the Middle French form.) The word French inherited from *scala* is the one for "ladder".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'escalier*
- *Say it: l'escalier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'escalier*

- *Recall:* say the French for a bedroom, then the French for the floor, then say *l'escalier* again

Before you move on

What does l'escalier mean? ("The stairs".) Say it once more.

75.3 le miroir — a mirror

Before the new one: say the French for the floor, then the French for the stairs.

You'll want to know: le miroir

le miroir — "a mirror".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

miroir — built in Old French from the verb *mirer*, "to look at", ← Latin *mirari*, "to wonder at". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le miroir*
- *Say it: le miroir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le miroir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the floor, then the French for the stairs, then say *le miroir* again

Before you move on

What does le miroir mean? ("A mirror".) Say it once more.

75.4 le salon — a living room

Before the new one: say the French for the stairs, then the French for a mirror.

You'll want to know: le salon

le salon — "a living room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salon ← Italian *salone*, "a large hall", from *sala*, "a hall", a Germanic word — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le salon*
- *Say it: le salon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le salon*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stairs, then the French for a mirror, then say *le salon* again

Before you move on

What does le salon mean? ("A living room".) Say it once more.

75.5 le canapé — a sofa

Before the new one: say the French for a mirror, then the French for a living room.

You'll want to know: le canapé

le canapé — "a sofa".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

canapé ← Medieval Latin *canapeum* ← Latin *conopeum*, "a bed with a mosquito net", from Greek *konopeion*, built on *konops*, "mosquito" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le canapé*
- *Say it: le canapé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le canapé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mirror, then the French for a living room, then say *le canapé* again

Before you move on

What does le canapé mean? ("A sofa".) Say it once more.

Chapter 76

Cupboard, Ceiling, Corridor, Glass, Plate

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a cupboard, a ceiling, a corridor, a glass, a plate.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 76: I can name a cupboard, a ceiling, a corridor, a glass, a plate.

76.1 le placard — a cupboard

Before the new one: say the French for a living room, then the French for a sofa.

You'll want to know: le placard

le placard — "a cupboard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

placard — built from the verb for "to stick on, to plate", with *-ard*; the verb comes from Middle Dutch *placken*, "to patch". A placard was first a notice stuck on a wall, then a cupboard set into one.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le placard*
- *Say it: le placard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le placard*
- *Recall:* say the French for a living room, then the French for a sofa, then say *le placard* again

Before you move on

What does le placard mean? ("A cupboard".) Say it once more.

76.2 le plafond — a ceiling

Before the new one: say the French for a sofa, then the French for a cupboard.

You'll want to know: le plafond

le plafond — "a ceiling".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plafond — built from the French words for "flat" and "bottom": the flat underside of the floor above. The second ← Latin *fundus*, "bottom". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plafond*
- *Say it: le plafond*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le plafond*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sofa, then the French for a cupboard, then say *le plafond* again

Before you move on

What does le plafond mean? ("A ceiling".) Say it once more.

76.3 le couloir — a corridor

Before the new one: say the French for a cupboard, then the French for a ceiling.

You'll want to know: le couloir

le couloir — "a corridor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couloir — built from the verb for "to flow", with *-oir*, "a place for": a passage things flow along. The verb ← Latin *colare*, "to strain, to filter" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le couloir*
- *Say it: le couloir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le couloir*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cupboard, then the French for a ceiling, then say *le couloir* again

Before you move on

What does le couloir mean? ("A corridor".) Say it once more.

76.4 le verre — a glass

Before the new one: say the French for a ceiling, then the French for a corridor.

You'll want to know: le verre

le verre — "a glass".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verre ← Latin *vitrum*, "glass" — inherited; the *t* between vowels dropped out. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le verre*
- *Say it: le verre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le verre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ceiling, then the French for a corridor, then say *le verre* again

Before you move on

What does le verre mean? ("A glass".) Say it once more.

76.5 l'assiette — a plate

Before the new one: say the French for a corridor, then the French for a glass.

You'll want to know: l'assiette

l'assiette — "a plate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

assiette ← Vulgar Latin **assedita*, "a seating", from Latin *assidere*, "to sit beside" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: first a place at table, then the plate set there.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'assiette*
- *Say it: l'assiette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'assiette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a corridor, then the French for a glass, then say *l'assiette* again

Before you move on

What does l'assiette mean? ("A plate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 77

Spoon, Knife, Fork, Bottle, Cup

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 6 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a spoon, a knife, a fork, a bottle, a cup.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 77: I can name a spoon, a knife, a fork, a bottle, a cup.*

77.1 la cuillère — a spoon

Before the new one: say the French for a glass, then the French for a plate.

You'll want to know: la cuillère

la cuillère — "a spoon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuillère ← Latin *cochlearium*, "a spoon", from *cochlear*, a pointed spoon for getting snails out of their shells, and *cochlea*, "a snail", from Greek *kokhlias* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cuillère*
- *Say it: la cuillère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cuillère*
- *Recall:* say the French for a glass, then the French for a plate, then say *la cuillère* again

Before you move on

What does la cuillère mean? ("A spoon".) Say it once more.

77.2 le couteau — a knife

Before the new one: say the French for a plate, then the French for a spoon.

You'll want to know: le couteau

le couteau — "a knife".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couteau ← Old French *coutel* ← Latin *cultellus*, "a little knife", from *culter*, "knife" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le couteau*
- *Say it: le couteau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le couteau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plate, then the French for a spoon, then say *le couteau* again

Before you move on

What does le couteau mean? (“A knife”.) Say it once more.

77.3 la fourchette — a fork

Before the new one: say the French for a spoon, then the French for a knife.

You’ll want to know: la fourchette

la fourchette — “a fork”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fourchette — built from the French word for “pitchfork”, with *-ette*, “little”. The pitchfork word ← Old French *furche* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *furca*, “a two-pronged fork” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fourchette*
- *Say it: la fourchette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fourchette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a spoon, then the French for a knife, then say *la fourchette* again

Before you move on

What does la fourchette mean? (“A fork”.) Say it once more.

77.4 la bouteille — a bottle

Before the new one: say the French for a knife, then the French for a fork.

You'll want to know: la bouteille

la bouteille — "a bottle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouteille ← Medieval Latin *butticula*, from Late Latin *buttis*, "a cask" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bouteille*
- *Say it: la bouteille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la bouteille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a knife, then the French for a fork, then say *la bouteille* again

Before you move on

What does la bouteille mean? ("A bottle".) Say it once more.

77.5 la tasse — a cup

Before the new one: say the French for a fork, then the French for a bottle.

You'll want to know: la tasse

la tasse — "a cup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tasse ← Arabic *tas*, "a bowl, a cup", itself from Persian — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tasse*
- *Say it: la tasse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tasse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fork, then the French for a bottle, then say *la tasse* again

Before you move on

What does la tasse mean? ("A cup".) Say it once more.

77.6 The body, family, doing and food — a first pass

Say the words for a bottle and a cup.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an arm, a leg, a foot, a finger, a tooth
- the neck, a shoulder, a knee, the face, blood
- skin, a nail, the chin, the throat, a cheek
- the chest, the stomach, an ankle, an elbow, a wrist
- pain, a fever, a cough, a medicine, a doctor
- a hospital, an illness, thirst, tiredness, ill
- joy, fear, anger, sadness, happy
- sad, pleased, a daughter; a girl, a grandfather, a grandmother

- a husband, a woman; a wife, an uncle, an aunt, a cousin
- a neighbour, a guest, a baby, a grandson, a granddaughter
- a nephew, a niece, a pupil, a teacher, to laugh
- to cry, to wash, to cook, to play, to learn
- to teach, to drink, to eat, to give, to live
- to come back, to study, to pay, to use, to show

Before you move on

An arm? (**le bras**.) A leg? (**la jambe**.) A foot? (**le pied**.) A finger? (**le doigt**.) A tooth? (**la dent**.) The neck? (**le cou**.) A shoulder? (**l'épaule**.) A knee? (**le genou**.) The face? (**le visage**.) Blood? (**le sang**.) Skin? (**la peau**.) A nail? (**l'ongle**.) The chin? (**le menton**.) The throat? (**la gorge**.) A cheek? (**la joue**.) The chest? (**la poitrine**.) The stomach? (**l'estomac**.) An ankle? (**la cheville**.) An elbow? (**le coude**.) A wrist? (**le poignet**.) Pain? (**la douleur**.) A fever? (**la fièvre**.) A cough? (**la toux**.) A medicine? (**le médicament**.) A doctor? (**le médecin**.) A hospital? (**l'hôpital**.) An illness? (**la maladie**.) Thirst? (**la soif**.) Tiredness? (**la fatigue**.) Ill? (**malade**.) Joy? (**la joie**.) Fear? (**la peur**.) Anger? (**la colère**.) Sadness? (**la tristesse**.) Happy? (**heureux**.) Sad? (**triste**.) Pleased? (**content**.) A daughter; a girl? (**la fille**.) A grandfather? (**le grand-père**.) A grandmother? (**la grand-mère**.) A husband? (**le mari**.) A woman; a wife? (**la femme**.) An uncle? (**l'oncle**.) An aunt? (**la tante**.) A cousin? (**la cousine**.) A neighbour? (**le voisin**.) A guest? (**l'invité**.) A baby? (**le bébé**.) A grandson? (**le petit-fils**.) A granddaughter? (**la petite-fille**.) A nephew? (**le neveu**.) A niece? (**la nièce**.) A pupil? (**l'élève**.) A teacher? (**le professeur**.) To laugh? (**rire**.) To cry? (**pleurer**.) To wash? (**laver**.) To cook? (**cuisiner**.) To play? (**jouer**.) To learn? (**apprendre**.) To teach? (**enseigner**.) To drink? (**boire**.) To eat? (**manger**.) To give? (**donner**.) To live? (**vivre**.) To come back? (**revenir**.) To study? (**étudier**.) To pay? (**payer**.) To use? (**utiliser**.) To show? (**montrer**.)

77.7 The house, the table and things — a second pass

Say the words for to clean and to cut.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to clean, to cut, to forget, to look for, to lose
- to look at, to listen to, to wait for, to buy, to know
- to leave, to carry; to wear, to send, to receive, to feel; to smell
- to draw, to paint, to count, to win; to earn, to hide
- to find, fish, chicken, a fruit, an apple
- a banana, an orange, a potato, a tomato, an onion
- a carrot, a cake, a soup, honey, oil
- lunch, dinner, breakfast, rice, a pear
- a lemon, grapes, jam, a yoghurt, ham
- a salad; lettuce, pasta, cream, pepper, a walnut
- a kitchen; cooking, a window, a chair, a key, a wall
- a roof, a garden, a lamp, a bathroom, a bedroom
- the floor, the stairs, a mirror, a living room, a sofa
- a cupboard, a ceiling, a corridor, a glass, a plate
- a spoon, a knife, a fork, a bottle, a cup

Before you move on

To clean? (**nettoyer**.) To cut? (**couper**.) To forget? (**oublier**.) To look for? (**chercher**.) To lose? (**perdre**.) To look at? (**regarder**.) To listen to? (**écouter**.) To wait for? (**attendre**.) To buy? (**acheter**.) To know? (**savoir**.) To leave? (**laisser**.) To carry; to

wear? (**porter**.) To send? (**envoyer**.) To receive? (**recevoir**.) To feel; to smell? (**sentir**.) To draw? (**dessiner**.) To paint? (**peindre**.) To count? (**compter**.) To win; to earn? (**gagner**.) To hide? (**cacher**.) To find? (**trouver**.) Fish? (**le poisson**.) Chicken? (**le poulet**.) A fruit? (**le fruit**.) An apple? (**la pomme**.) A banana? (**la banane**.) An orange? (**l'orange**.) A potato? (**la pomme de terre**.) A tomato? (**la tomate**.) An onion? (**l'oignon**.) A carrot? (**la carotte**.) A cake? (**le gâteau**.) A soup? (**la soupe**.) Honey? (**le miel**.) Oil? (**l'huile**.) Lunch? (**le déjeuner**.) Dinner? (**le dîner**.) Breakfast? (**le petit-déjeuner**.) Rice? (**le riz**.) A pear? (**la poire**.) A lemon? (**le citron**.) Grapes? (**le raisin**.) Jam? (**la confiture**.) A yoghurt? (**le yaourt**.) Ham? (**le jambon**.) A salad; lettuce? (**la salade**.) Pasta? (**les pâtes**.) Cream? (**la crème**.) Pepper? (**le poivre**.) A walnut? (**la noix**.) A kitchen; cooking? (**la cuisine**.) A window? (**la fenêtre**.) A chair? (**la chaise**.) A key? (**la clé**.) A wall? (**le mur**.) A roof? (**le toit**.) A garden? (**le jardin**.) A lamp? (**la lampe**.) A bathroom? (**la salle de bain**.) A bedroom? (**la chambre**.) The floor? (**le sol**.) The stairs? (**l'escalier**.) A mirror? (**le miroir**.) A living room? (**le salon**.) A sofa? (**le canapé**.) A cupboard? (**le placard**.) A ceiling? (**le plafond**.) A corridor? (**le couloir**.) A glass? (**le verre**.) A plate? (**l'assiette**.) A spoon? (**la cuillère**.) A knife? (**le couteau**.) A fork? (**la fourchette**.) A bottle? (**la bouteille**.) A cup? (**la tasse**.)

Chapter 78

Pen, Paper, Notebook, Pencil, Bag

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a pen, paper, a notebook, a pencil, a bag.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 78: I can name a pen, paper, a notebook, a pencil, a bag.*

78.1 le stylo — a pen

Before the new one: say the French for a bottle, then the French for a cup.

You'll want to know: le stylo

le stylo — "a pen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stylo — short for *stylographe*, a 19th-century name for a fountain pen, built from Latin *stilus*, "a writing stick" (EtymDB 2.1), and Greek *graphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le stylo*
- *Say it: le stylo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le stylo*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bottle, then the French for a cup, then say *le stylo* again

Before you move on

What does le stylo mean? (“A pen”.) Say it once more.

78.2 le papier — paper

Before the new one: say the French for a cup, then the French for a pen.

You’ll want to know: le papier

le papier — “paper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

papier ← Latin *papyrus*, from Greek *papyros*, “papyrus” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le papier*
- *Say it: le papier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le papier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cup, then the French for a pen, then say *le papier* again

Before you move on

What does le papier mean? (“Paper”.) Say it once more.

78.3 le cahier — a notebook

Before the new one: say the French for a pen, then the French for paper.

You’ll want to know: le cahier

le cahier — “a notebook”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cahier ← Old French *quaer* ← Vulgar Latin **quaternum*, from Latin *quaterni*, “four at a time” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: a booklet made of four folded sheets.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cahier*
- *Say it: le cahier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cahier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pen, then the French for paper, then say *le cahier* again

Before you move on

What does le cahier mean? (“A notebook”.) Say it once more.

78.4 le crayon — a pencil

Before the new one: say the French for paper, then the French for a notebook.

You'll want to know: le crayon

le crayon — "a pencil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crayon — built from the French word for "chalk", with *-on*. The chalk word ← Latin *creta*, "chalk, clay". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le crayon*
- *Say it: le crayon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le crayon*
- *Recall:* say the French for paper, then the French for a notebook, then say *le crayon* again

Before you move on

What does le crayon mean? ("A pencil".) Say it once more.

78.5 le sac — a bag

Before the new one: say the French for a notebook, then the French for a pencil.

You'll want to know: le sac

le sac — "a bag".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sac ← Latin *saccus*, from Greek *sakkos*, "a coarse bag" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sac*
- *Say it: le sac*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sac*
- *Recall:* say the French for a notebook, then the French for a pencil, then say *le sac* again

Before you move on

What does le sac mean? ("A bag".) Say it once more.

Chapter 79

Phone, Umbrella, Money, Present, Glasses

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a phone, an umbrella, money, a present, glasses.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 79: I can name a phone, an umbrella, money, a present, glasses.

79.1 le téléphone — a phone

Before the new one: say the French for a pencil, then the French for a bag.

You'll want to know: le téléphone

le téléphone — "a phone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

téléphone — a 19th-century coinage from Greek *tele*, "far off", and *phone*, "voice, sound" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le téléphone*
- *Say it: le téléphone*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le téléphone*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pencil, then the French for a bag, then say *le téléphone* again

Before you move on

What does le téléphone mean? ("A phone".) Say it once more.

79.2 le parapluie — an umbrella

Before the new one: say the French for a bag, then the French for a phone.

You'll want to know: le parapluie

le parapluie — "an umbrella". Literally "guard-rain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parapluie — built from *para-*, "guarding against", and the French word for "rain". *para-* came from Italian *parare*, "to shield", ← Latin *parare*, "to prepare". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parapluie*
- *Say it: le parapluie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le parapluie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bag, then the French for a phone, then say *le parapluie* again

Before you move on

What does le parapluie mean? (“An umbrella”.) Say it once more.

79.3 l’argent — money; silver

Before the new one: say the French for a phone, then the French for an umbrella.

You’ll want to know: l’argent

l’argent — “money; silver”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

argent ← Latin *argentum*, “silver” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) Coins were silver, so the word came to mean money.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’argent*
- *Say it: l’argent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’argent*
- *Recall:* say the French for a phone, then the French for an umbrella, then say *l’argent* again

Before you move on

What does l’argent mean? (“Money; silver”.) Say it once more.

79.4 le cadeau — a present, a gift

Before the new one: say the French for an umbrella, then the French for money; silver.

You'll want to know: le cadeau

le cadeau — "a present, a gift".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cadeau ← Old Provençal *capdel*, "a chief; a capital letter", ← Latin *capitellum*, "a little head" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1) It meant a flourished capital letter, then a flourish, a treat, and finally a gift.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cadeau*
- *Say it: le cadeau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cadeau*
- *Recall:* say the French for an umbrella, then the French for money; silver, then say *le cadeau* again

Before you move on

What does le cadeau mean? ("A present, a gift".) Say it once more.

79.5 les lunettes — glasses

Before the new one: say the French for money; silver, then the French for a present.

You'll want to know: les lunettes

les lunettes — "glasses".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lunettes — built from *lune*, "moon", with *-ette*, "little": the round lenses were little moons. *lune* ← Latin *luna*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les lunettes*
- *Say it: les lunettes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les lunettes*
- *Recall:* say the French for money; silver, then the French for a present, then say *les lunettes* again

Before you move on

What does les lunettes mean? ("Glasses".) Say it once more.

Chapter 80

Box, Suitcase, Ticket, Map, Photo

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a box, a suitcase, a ticket, a map, a photo.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 80: I can name a box, a suitcase, a ticket, a map, a photo.*

80.1 la boîte — a box

Before the new one: say the French for a present, then the French for glasses.

You'll want to know: la boîte

la boîte — "a box".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boîte ← Old French *boiste* ← Vulgar Latin **buxita*, from Late Latin *buxis*, "a box" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boîte*
- *Say it: la boîte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boîte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a present, then the French for glasses, then say *la boîte* again

Before you move on

What does la boîte mean? ("A box".) Say it once more.

80.2 la valise — a suitcase

Before the new one: say the French for glasses, then the French for a box.

You'll want to know: la valise

la valise — "a suitcase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

valise ← Italian *valigia* — borrowed in the 1500s. Where the Italian word came from is uncertain. (EtymDB 2.1 records Medieval Latin *valisia*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la valise*
- *Say it: la valise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la valise*
- *Recall:* say the French for glasses, then the French for a box, then say *la valise* again

Before you move on

What does la valise mean? (“A suitcase”.) Say it once more.

80.3 le billet — a ticket; a banknote

Before the new one: say the French for a box, then the French for a suitcase.

You’ll want to know: le billet

le billet — “a ticket; a banknote”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

billet ← Old French *billette*, a little form of *bille*, “a written note”, from Medieval Latin *bulla*, “a seal, a sealed document”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le billet*
- *Say it: le billet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le billet*
- *Recall:* say the French for a box, then the French for a suitcase, then say *le billet* again

Before you move on

What does le billet mean? (“A ticket; a banknote”.) Say it once more.

80.4 la carte — a map; a card

Before the new one: say the French for a suitcase, then the French for a ticket; a banknote.

You'll want to know: la carte

la carte — "a map; a card".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carte ← Latin *charta*, "a sheet of paper", from Greek *chartes* (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: an inherited form would begin with *ch-*. The worn-down form gave French its word for a charter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carte*
- *Say it: la carte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a suitcase, then the French for a ticket; a banknote, then say *la carte* again

Before you move on

What does la carte mean? ("A map; a card".) Say it once more.

80.5 la photo — a photo

Before the new one: say the French for a ticket; a banknote, then the French for a map; a card.

You'll want to know: la photo

la photo — "a photo".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

photo — short for *photographie* (EtymDB 2.1), a 19th-century coinage from Greek *phos*, *photos*, "light", and *graphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la photo*
- *Say it: la photo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la photo*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ticket; a banknote, then the French for a map; a card, then say *la photo* again

Before you move on

What does la photo mean? ("A photo".) Say it once more.

Chapter 81

Tree, Flower, Leaf, Mountain, River

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a tree, a flower, a leaf, a mountain, a river.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 81: I can name a tree, a flower, a leaf, a mountain, a river.*

81.1 l'arbre — a tree

Before the new one: say the French for a map; a card, then the French for a photo.

You'll want to know: l'arbre

l'arbre — "a tree".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arbre ← Latin *arbor*, "tree" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arbre*
- *Say it: l'arbre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'arbre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a map; a card, then the French for a photo, then say *l'arbre* again

Before you move on

What does l'arbre mean? ("A tree".) Say it once more.

81.2 la fleur — a flower

Before the new one: say the French for a photo, then the French for a tree.

You'll want to know: la fleur

la fleur — "a flower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fleur ← Old French *flur* ← Latin *flos*, *floris*, "flower" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fleur*
- *Say it: la fleur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a photo, then the French for a tree, then say *la fleur* again

Before you move on

What does la fleur mean? (“A flower”.) Say it once more.

81.3 la feuille — a leaf; a sheet of paper

Before the new one: say the French for a tree, then the French for a flower.

You’ll want to know: la feuille

la feuille — “a leaf; a sheet of paper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feuille ← Late Latin *folia*, “leaves”, the plural of *folium*, used as a singular — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la feuille*
- *Say it: la feuille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la feuille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tree, then the French for a flower, then say *la feuille* again

Before you move on

What does la feuille mean? (“A leaf; a sheet of paper”.) Say it once more.

81.4 la montagne — a mountain

Before the new one: say the French for a flower, then the French for a leaf; a sheet of paper.

You'll want to know: la montagne

la montagne — "a mountain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

montagne ← Vulgar Latin **montanea*, from Latin *mons*, *montis*, "mountain" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la montagne*
- *Say it: la montagne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la montagne*
- *Recall:* say the French for a flower, then the French for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then say *la montagne* again

Before you move on

What does la montagne mean? ("A mountain".) Say it once more.

81.5 la rivière — a river

Before the new one: say the French for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then the French for a mountain.

You'll want to know: la rivière

la rivière — "a river".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rivière ← Vulgar Latin **riparia*, "a riverbank", from Latin *ripa*, "bank" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rivière*
- *Say it: la rivière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la rivière*
- *Recall:* say the French for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then the French for a mountain, then say *la rivière* again

Before you move on

What does la rivière mean? ("A river".) Say it once more.

Chapter 82

Sea, Stone, Sand, Beach, Island

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the sea, a stone, sand, a beach, an island.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 82: I can name the sea, a stone, sand, a beach, an island.*

82.1 la mer — the sea

> Before the new one: say the French for a mountain, then the French for a river.

You'll want to know: la mer

la mer — "the sea".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mer ← Latin *mare*, "sea" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: Latin's stressed *a* became *e*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mer*

- *Say it:* *la mer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la mer*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mountain, then the French for a river, then say *la mer* again

Before you move on

What does la mer mean? ("The sea".) Say it once more.

82.2 la pierre — a stone

Before the new one: say the French for a river, then the French for the sea.

You'll want to know: la pierre

la pierre — "a stone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pierre ← Latin *petra*, "rock", from Greek *petra* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la pierre*
- *Say it:* *la pierre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pierre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a river, then the French for the sea, then say *la pierre* again

Before you move on

What does la pierre mean? ("A stone".) Say it once more.

82.3 le sable — sand

Before the new one: say the French for the sea, then the French for a stone.

You'll want to know: le sable

le sable — "sand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sable ← Latin *sabulum*, "coarse sand" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sable*
- *Say it: le sable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sable*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sea, then the French for a stone, then say *le sable* again

Before you move on

What does le sable mean? ("Sand".) Say it once more.

82.4 la plage — a beach

Before the new one: say the French for a stone, then the French for sand.

You'll want to know: la plage

la plage — "a beach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plage ← Italian *piaggia*, "a sloping shore" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plage*
- *Say it: la plage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la plage*
- *Recall:* say the French for a stone, then the French for sand, then say *la plage* again

Before you move on

What does la plage mean? ("A beach".) Say it once more.

82.5 l'île — an island

Before the new one: say the French for sand, then the French for a beach.

You'll want to know: l'île

l'île — "an island".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

île ← Old French *isle* ← Latin *insula*, "island" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited. The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'île*
- *Say it: l'île*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'île*
- *Recall:* say the French for sand, then the French for a beach, then say *l'île* again

Before you move on

What does l'île mean? ("An island".) Say it once more.

Chapter 83

Sun, Star, Cloud, Rain, Snow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the sun, a star, a cloud, rain, snow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 83: I can name the sun, a star, a cloud, rain, snow.*

83.1 le soleil — the sun

Before the new one: say the French for a beach, then the French for an island.

You'll want to know: le soleil

le soleil — "the sun".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soleil ← Vulgar Latin **soliculus*, "a little sun", from Latin *sol*, "sun" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le soleil*
- *Say it: le soleil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le soleil*
- *Recall:* say the French for a beach, then the French for an island, then say *le soleil* again

Before you move on

What does le soleil mean? ("The sun".) Say it once more.

83.2 l'étoile — a star

Before the new one: say the French for an island, then the French for the sun.

You'll want to know: l'étoile

l'étoile — "a star".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étoile ← Old French *estoile* ← Latin *stella*, "star" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *é-* stands where an *s* once was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étoile*
- *Say it: l'étoile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étoile*
- *Recall:* say the French for an island, then the French for the sun, then say *l'étoile* again

Before you move on

What does l'étoile mean? ("A star".) Say it once more.

83.3 le nuage — a cloud

Before the new one: say the French for the sun, then the French for a star.

You'll want to know: le nuage

le nuage — "a cloud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nuage — built from Old French *nue*, "a cloud", with *-age*; *nue* ← Vulgar Latin **nuba* ← Latin *nubes*, "cloud". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le nuage*
- *Say it: le nuage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le nuage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sun, then the French for a star, then say *le nuage* again

Before you move on

What does le nuage mean? ("A cloud".) Say it once more.

83.4 la pluie — rain

Before the new one: say the French for a star, then the French for a cloud.

You'll want to know: la pluie

la pluie — "rain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pluie ← Vulgar Latin **ploia* ← Latin *pluvia*, "rain" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the same root as *il pleut*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pluie*
- *Say it: la pluie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pluie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a star, then the French for a cloud, then say *la pluie* again

Before you move on

What does la pluie mean? ("Rain".) Say it once more.

83.5 la neige — snow

Before the new one: say the French for a cloud, then the French for rain.

You'll want to know: la neige

la neige — "snow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neige — formed from the verb for "to snow", which ← Vulgar Latin **nivicare*, from Latin *nix*, *nivis*, "snow" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la neige*
- *Say it: la neige*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la neige*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cloud, then the French for rain, then say *la neige* again

Before you move on

What does la neige mean? ("Snow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 84

Wind, Fire, Hill, Desert, Wave

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the wind, fire, a hill, a desert, a wave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 84: I can name the wind, fire, a hill, a desert, a wave.*

84.1 le vent — the wind

Before the new one: say the French for rain, then the French for snow.

You'll want to know: le vent

le vent — "the wind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vent ← Latin *ventus*, "wind" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vent*

- *Say it:* *le vent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vent*
- *Recall:* say the French for rain, then the French for snow, then say *le vent* again

Before you move on

What does le vent mean? (“The wind”.) Say it once more.

84.2 le feu — fire

Before the new one: say the French for snow, then the French for the wind.

You’ll want to know: le feu

le feu — “fire”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feu ← Old French *fu* ← Latin *focus*, “a hearth” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le feu*
- *Say it:* *le feu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le feu*
- *Recall:* say the French for snow, then the French for the wind, then say *le feu* again

Before you move on

What does le feu mean? (“Fire”.) Say it once more.

84.3 la colline — a hill

Before the new one: say the French for the wind, then the French for fire.

You'll want to know: la colline

la colline — "a hill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

colline ← Italian *collina*, from Latin *collis*, "hill" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la colline*
- *Say it: la colline*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la colline*
- *Recall:* say the French for the wind, then the French for fire, then say *la colline* again

Before you move on

What does la colline mean? ("A hill".) Say it once more.

84.4 le désert — a desert

Before the new one: say the French for fire, then the French for a hill.

You'll want to know: le désert

le désert — "a desert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désert ← Latin *desertum*, "a wasteland", from *desertus*, "abandoned" — taken from Church Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le désert*
- *Say it: le désert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le désert*
- *Recall:* say the French for fire, then the French for a hill, then say *le désert* again

Before you move on

What does le désert mean? ("A desert".) Say it once more.

84.5 la vague — a wave

Before the new one: say the French for a hill, then the French for a desert.

You'll want to know: la vague

la vague — "a wave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vague ← Old French *wague*, from Old Norse *vagr*, "sea, wave" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed from the Norse settlers.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vague*
- *Say it: la vague*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vague*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hill, then the French for a desert, then say *la vague* again

Before you move on

What does la vague mean? (“A wave”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 85

Cow, Pig, Bird, Mouse, Wolf

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a cow, a pig, a bird, a mouse, a wolf.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 85: I can name a cow, a pig, a bird, a mouse, a wolf.*

85.1 la vache — a cow

Before the new one: say the French for a desert, then the French for a wave.

You'll want to know: la vache

la vache — "a cow". It gives **le lait**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vache ← Latin *vacca*, "cow" — inherited: Latin *ca* became French *che*. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vache*
- *Say it: la vache*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vache*
- *Recall:* say the French for a desert, then the French for a wave, then say *la vache* again

Before you move on

What does la vache mean? ("A cow".) Say it once more.

85.2 le cochon — a pig

Before the new one: say the French for a wave, then the French for a cow.

You'll want to know: le cochon

le cochon — "a pig".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cochon — its origin is uncertain; the usual account is that it grew from a call used to summon pigs.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cochon*
- *Say it: le cochon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cochon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wave, then the French for a cow, then say *le cochon* again

Before you move on

What does le cochon mean? (“A pig”.) Say it once more.

85.3 l’oiseau — a bird

Before the new one: say the French for a cow, then the French for a pig.

You’ll want to know: l’oiseau

l’oiseau — “a bird”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oiseau ← Old French *oisel* ← Vulgar Latin **aucellus*, “a little bird”, from Latin *avis*, “bird” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin words.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’oiseau*
- *Say it: l’oiseau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’oiseau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cow, then the French for a pig, then say *l’oiseau* again

Before you move on

What does l’oiseau mean? (“A bird”.) Say it once more.

85.4 la souris — a mouse

Before the new one: say the French for a pig, then the French for a bird.

You'll want to know: la souris

la souris — "a mouse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souris ← Latin *sorex*, *soricis*, "a shrew", through Vulgar Latin *soricem* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la souris*
- *Say it: la souris*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la souris*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pig, then the French for a bird, then say *la souris* again

Before you move on

What does la souris mean? ("A mouse".) Say it once more.

85.5 le loup — a wolf

Before the new one: say the French for a bird, then the French for a mouse.

You'll want to know: le loup

le loup — "a wolf".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loup ← Latin *lupus*, "wolf" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le loup*
- *Say it: le loup*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le loup*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bird, then the French for a mouse, then say *le loup* again

Before you move on

What does le loup mean? (“A wolf”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 86

Bear, Fox, Snake, Hen, Duck

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a bear, a fox, a snake, a hen, a duck.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 86: I can name a bear, a fox, a snake, a hen, a duck.*

86.1 l'ours — a bear

Before the new one: say the French for a mouse, then the French for a wolf.

You'll want to know: l'ours

l'ours — "a bear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ours ← Old French *urs* ← Latin *ursus*, "bear" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ours*
- *Say it: l'ours*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ours*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mouse, then the French for a wolf, then say *l'ours* again

Before you move on

What does l'ours mean? ("A bear".) Say it once more.

86.2 le renard — a fox

Before the new one: say the French for a wolf, then the French for a bear.

You'll want to know: le renard

le renard — "a fox".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

renard — named after *Renart*, the cunning fox of the medieval *Roman de Renart*; his name is the Germanic personal name *Reginhard*. It replaced the Old French word *goupil*, from Latin *vulpecula*, "little fox".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le renard*
- *Say it: le renard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le renard*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wolf, then the French for a bear, then say *le renard* again

Before you move on

What does le renard mean? (“A fox”.) Say it once more.

86.3 le serpent — a snake

Before the new one: say the French for a bear, then the French for a fox.

You’ll want to know: le serpent

le serpent — “a snake”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serpent ← Latin *serpens*, *serpentis*, “snake”, from *serpere*, “to creep” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le serpent*
- *Say it: le serpent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le serpent*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bear, then the French for a fox, then say *le serpent* again

Before you move on

What does le serpent mean? (“A snake”.) Say it once more.

86.4 la poule — a hen

Before the new one: say the French for a fox, then the French for a snake.

You'll want to know: la poule

la poule — "a hen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poule ← Latin *pulla*, the feminine of *pullus*, "a young animal" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poule*
- *Say it: la poule*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poule*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fox, then the French for a snake, then say *la poule* again

Before you move on

What does la poule mean? ("A hen".) Say it once more.

86.5 le canard — a duck

Before the new one: say the French for a snake, then the French for a hen.

You'll want to know: le canard

le canard — "a duck".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

canard — built from Old French *cane*, "a duck", with *-ard* (EtymDB 2.1). Where *cane* itself came from is uncertain; it is usually taken to imitate the bird's cackle.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le canard*
- *Say it: le canard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le canard*
- *Recall:* say the French for a snake, then the French for a hen, then say *le canard* again

Before you move on

What does le canard mean? ("A duck".) Say it once more.

Chapter 87

Sheep, Goat, Lion, Monkey, Bee

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a sheep, a goat, a lion, a monkey, a bee.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 87: I can name a sheep, a goat, a lion, a monkey, a bee.*

87.1 le mouton — a sheep

> Before the new one: say the French for a hen, then the French for a duck.

You'll want to know: le mouton

le mouton — "a sheep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mouton ← Old French *mouton* ← Medieval Latin **multo*, from Gaulish **multon-*, "sheep" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, a Celtic word that came into French through Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mouton*
- *Say it: le mouton*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mouton*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hen, then the French for a duck, then say *le mouton* again

Before you move on

What does le mouton mean? (“A sheep”.) Say it once more.

87.2 la chèvre — a goat

Before the new one: say the French for a duck, then the French for a sheep.

You’ll want to know: la chèvre

la chèvre — “a goat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chèvre ← Old French *chievre* ← Latin *capra*, “she-goat” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *che-*, and *p* became *v*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chèvre*
- *Say it: la chèvre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chèvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a duck, then the French for a sheep, then say *la chèvre* again

Before you move on

What does la chèvre mean? (“A goat”.) Say it once more.

87.3 le lion — a lion

Before the new one: say the French for a sheep, then the French for a goat.

You’ll want to know: le lion

le lion — “a lion”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lion ← Latin *leo*, *leonis*, from Greek *leon* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lion*
- *Say it: le lion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le lion*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sheep, then the French for a goat, then say *le lion* again

Before you move on

What does le lion mean? (“A lion”.) Say it once more.

87.4 le singe — a monkey

Before the new one: say the French for a goat, then the French for a lion.

You'll want to know: le singe

le singe — "a monkey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

singe ← Latin *simius*, "an ape", a form of *simia*, built on *simus*, "snub-nosed" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le singe*
- *Say it: le singe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le singe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a goat, then the French for a lion, then say *le singe* again

Before you move on

What does le singe mean? ("A monkey".) Say it once more.

87.5 l'abeille — a bee

Before the new one: say the French for a lion, then the French for a monkey.

You'll want to know: l'abeille

l'abeille — "a bee". It makes **le miel**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

abeille ← Old Provençal *abelha* ← Latin *apicula*, "a little bee", from *apis*, "bee" — borrowed from the south. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'abeille*
- *Say it: l'abeille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'abeille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lion, then the French for a monkey, then say *l'abeille* again

Before you move on

What does l'abeille mean? ("A bee".) Say it once more.

Chapter 88

Ant, Elephant, Rabbit, Frog, Tiger

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name an ant, an elephant, a rabbit, a frog, a tiger.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 88: I can name an ant, an elephant, a rabbit, a frog, a tiger.*

88.1 la fourmi — an ant

Before the new one: say the French for a monkey, then the French for a bee.

You'll want to know: la fourmi

la fourmi — "an ant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fourmi ← Old French *furmi* ← Vulgar Latin **formicus* ← Latin *formica*, "ant" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fourmi*
- *Say it: la fourmi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fourmi*
- *Recall:* say the French for a monkey, then the French for a bee, then say *la fourmi* again

Before you move on

What does la fourmi mean? ("An ant".) Say it once more.

88.2 l'éléphant — an elephant

Before the new one: say the French for a bee, then the French for an ant.

You'll want to know: l'éléphant

l'éléphant — "an elephant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éléphant ← Latin *elephantus*, from Greek *elephas*, "elephant, ivory" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éléphant*
- *Say it: l'éléphant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'éléphant*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bee, then the French for an ant, then say *l'éléphant* again

Before you move on

What does l'éléphant mean? ("An elephant".) Say it once more.

88.3 le lapin — a rabbit

Before the new one: say the French for an ant, then the French for an elephant.

You'll want to know: le lapin

le lapin — "a rabbit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lapin — its origin is uncertain. The usual account ties it to Middle French *laperiau*, "a young rabbit" (EtymDB 2.1), from a pre-Latin root of Spain and southern France.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lapin*
- *Say it: le lapin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le lapin*
- *Recall:* say the French for an ant, then the French for an elephant, then say *le lapin* again

Before you move on

What does le lapin mean? ("A rabbit".) Say it once more.

88.4 la grenouille — a frog

Before the new one: say the French for an elephant, then the French for a rabbit.

You'll want to know: la grenouille

la grenouille — "a frog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grenouille ← Old French *grenoille* (EtymDB 2.1), from Vulgar Latin **ranucula*, "a little frog", from Latin *rana*, "frog" (Lewis & Short) — inherited; the *g-* in front is usually put down to imitation of the croak.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grenouille*
- *Say it: la grenouille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la grenouille*
- *Recall:* say the French for an elephant, then the French for a rabbit, then say *la grenouille* again

Before you move on

What does la grenouille mean? ("A frog".) Say it once more.

88.5 le tigre — a tiger

Before the new one: say the French for a rabbit, then the French for a frog.

You'll want to know: le tigre

le tigre — "a tiger".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tigre ← Latin *tigris*, from Greek *tigris* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tigre*
- *Say it: le tigre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tigre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rabbit, then the French for a frog, then say *le tigre* again

Before you move on

What does le tigre mean? ("A tiger".) Say it once more.

Chapter 89

Tortoise, New, Old, Fast, Easy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a tortoise, new, old, fast, easy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 89: I can name a tortoise, new, old, fast, easy.*

89.1 la tortue — a tortoise

Before the new one: say the French for a frog, then the French for a tiger.

You'll want to know: la tortue

la tortue — "a tortoise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tortue ← Old Provençal *tortuga* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1) The usual account takes it to Late Latin *tartaruchus*, "of the underworld", a name for a creature thought demonic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tortue*
- *Say it: la tortue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tortue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a frog, then the French for a tiger, then say *la tortue* again

Before you move on

What does la tortue mean? (“A tortoise”.) Say it once more.

89.2 nouveau — new

Before the new one: say the French for a tiger, then the French for a tortoise.

You’ll want to know: nouveau

nouveau — “new”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nouveau ← Old French *novel* ← Latin *novellus*, “new, young”, from *novus*, “new” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nouveau*
- *Say it: nouveau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nouveau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tiger, then the French for a tortoise, then say *nouveau* again

Before you move on

What does nouveau mean? (“New”.) Say it once more.

89.3 vieux — old

Before the new one: say the French for a tortoise, then the French for new.

You’ll want to know: vieux

vieux — “old”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vieux ← Old French *viel* ← Vulgar Latin **veclus* ← Latin *vetulus*, “oldish”, from *vetus*, “old” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vieux*
- *Say it: vieux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vieux*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tortoise, then the French for new, then say *vieux* again

Before you move on

What does vieux mean? (“Old”.) Say it once more.

89.4 rapide — fast

Before the new one: say the French for new, then the French for old.

You'll want to know: rapide

rapide — "fast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rapide ← Latin *rapidus*, "swift, snatching", from *rapere*, "to seize" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rapide*
- *Say it: rapide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rapide*
- *Recall:* say the French for new, then the French for old, then say *rapide* again

Before you move on

What does rapide mean? ("Fast".) Say it once more.

89.5 facile — easy

Before the new one: say the French for old, then the French for fast.

You'll want to know: facile

facile — "easy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

facile ← Latin *facilis*, "easy to do", from *facere*, "to do, to make" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: facile*
- *Say it: facile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *facile*
- *Recall:* say the French for old, then the French for fast, then say *facile* again

Before you move on

What does facile mean? ("Easy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 90

Difficult, Dear, High, Full, Empty

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name difficult, dear, high, full, empty.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 90: I can name difficult, dear, high, full, empty.*

90.1 difficile — difficult

Before the new one: say the French for fast, then the French for easy.

You'll want to know: difficile

difficile — "difficult".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

difficile ← Latin *difficilis*, "hard to do": *facile* with *dis-*, "not", in front — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: difficile*
- *Say it: difficile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *difficile*
- *Recall:* say the French for fast, then the French for easy, then say *difficile* again

Before you move on

What does difficile mean? ("Difficult".) Say it once more.

90.2 cher — dear; expensive

Before the new one: say the French for easy, then the French for difficult.

You'll want to know: cher

cher — "dear; expensive".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cher ← Latin *carus*, "dear, beloved, costly" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: Latin *ca-* became *che-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cher*
- *Say it: cher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cher*
- *Recall:* say the French for easy, then the French for difficult, then say *cher* again

Before you move on

What does cher mean? (“Dear; expensive”.) Say it once more.

90.3 haut — high, tall

Before the new one: say the French for difficult, then the French for dear; expensive.

You’ll want to know: haut

haut — “high, tall”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

haut ← Latin *altus*, “high”, blended with Frankish **hauh*, “high”, which gave it its *h* (EtymDB 2.1 gives the Frankish side) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: haut*
- *Say it: haut*, once more
- *Say it:* say *haut*
- *Recall:* say the French for difficult, then the French for dear; expensive, then say *haut* again

Before you move on

What does haut mean? (“High, tall”.) Say it once more.

90.4 plein — full

Before the new one: say the French for dear; expensive, then the French for high.

You'll want to know: plein

plein — "full".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plein ← Latin *plenus*, "full" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plein*
- *Say it: plein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plein*
- *Recall:* say the French for dear; expensive, then the French for high, then say *plein* again

Before you move on

What does plein mean? ("Full".) Say it once more.

90.5 vide — empty

Before the new one: say the French for high, then the French for full.

You'll want to know: vide

vide — "empty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vide ← Old French *vuit* ← Vulgar Latin **vocitus*, "empty" (EtymDB 2.1), related to Latin *vacuus*, "empty" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vide*
- *Say it: vide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vide*
- *Recall:* say the French for high, then the French for full, then say *vide* again

Before you move on

What does vide mean? (“Empty”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 91

Strong, Weak, Rich, Poor, Grey

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name strong, weak, rich, poor, grey.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 91: I can name strong, weak, rich, poor, grey.*

91.1 fort — strong

Before the new one: say the French for full, then the French for empty.

You'll want to know: fort

fort — "strong".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fort ← Latin *fortis*, "strong" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fort*

- *Say it: fort*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fort*
- *Recall:* say the French for full, then the French for empty, then say *fort* again

Before you move on

What does fort mean? (“Strong”.) Say it once more.

91.2 faible — weak

Before the new one: say the French for empty, then the French for strong.

You’ll want to know: faible

faible — “weak”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faible ← Old French *feble* ← Latin *flebilis*, “to be wept over, pitiable” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: faible*
- *Say it: faible*, once more
- *Say it:* say *faible*
- *Recall:* say the French for empty, then the French for strong, then say *faible* again

Before you move on

What does faible mean? (“Weak”.) Say it once more.

91.3 riche — rich

Before the new one: say the French for strong, then the French for weak.

You'll want to know: riche

riche — "rich".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

riche ← Frankish **riki*, "powerful" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: riche*
- *Say it: riche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *riche*
- *Recall:* say the French for strong, then the French for weak, then say *riche* again

Before you move on

What does riche mean? ("Rich".) Say it once more.

91.4 pauvre — poor

Before the new one: say the French for weak, then the French for rich.

You'll want to know: pauvre

pauvre — "poor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pauvre ← Old French *povre* ← Latin *pauper*, "poor" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pauvre*
- *Say it: pauvre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pauvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for weak, then the French for rich, then say *pauvre* again

Before you move on

What does pauvre mean? ("Poor".) Say it once more.

91.5 gris — grey

Before the new one: say the French for rich, then the French for poor.

You'll want to know: gris

gris — "grey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gris ← Old French *gris*, which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Vulgar Latin **grisus*; behind it is Frankish **gris*, "grey" — borrowed from the Franks.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gris*
- *Say it: gris*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gris*
- *Recall:* say the French for rich, then the French for poor, then say *gris* again

Before you move on

What does gris mean? (“Grey”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 92

Soft, Dirty, Young, Kind, Narrow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name soft, dirty, young, kind, narrow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 92: I can name soft, dirty, young, kind, narrow.*

92.1 doux — soft; mild; sweet

Before the new one: say the French for poor, then the French for grey.

You'll want to know: doux

doux — "soft; mild; sweet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

doux ← Old French *dous* ← Latin *dulcis*, "sweet" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: doux*
- *Say it: doux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *doux*
- *Recall:* say the French for poor, then the French for grey, then say *doux* again

Before you move on

What does doux mean? ("Soft; mild; sweet".) Say it once more.

92.2 sale — dirty

Before the new one: say the French for grey, then the French for soft; mild; sweet.

You'll want to know: sale

sale — "dirty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sale ← Frankish **salo*, "dull, dirty grey" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sale*
- *Say it: sale*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sale*
- *Recall:* say the French for grey, then the French for soft; mild; sweet, then say *sale* again

Before you move on

What does sale mean? (“Dirty”.) Say it once more.

92.3 jeune — young

Before the new one: say the French for soft; mild; sweet, then the French for dirty.

You’ll want to know: jeune

jeune — “young”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeune ← Latin *iuvenis*, “young” (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jeune*
- *Say it: jeune*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jeune*
- *Recall:* say the French for soft; mild; sweet, then the French for dirty, then say *jeune* again

Before you move on

What does jeune mean? (“Young”.) Say it once more.

92.4 gentil — kind, nice

Before the new one: say the French for dirty, then the French for young.

You'll want to know: gentil

gentil — "kind, nice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gentil ← Latin *gentilis*, "of the same clan", from *gens*, "a clan" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) In Old French it meant "high-born, noble".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gentil*
- *Say it: gentil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gentil*
- *Recall:* say the French for dirty, then the French for young, then say *gentil* again

Before you move on

What does gentil mean? ("Kind, nice".) Say it once more.

92.5 étroit — narrow

Before the new one: say the French for young, then the French for kind.

You'll want to know: étroit

étroit — "narrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étroit ← Old French *estroit* ← Latin *strictus*, "drawn tight" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-ct-* became *-it*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: étroit*
- *Say it: étroit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étroit*
- *Recall:* say the French for young, then the French for kind, then say *étroit* again

Before you move on

What does étroit mean? ("Narrow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 93

Thin, Big, Heavy, Light, Sweet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name thin, big, heavy, light (not heavy), sweet (with sugar).
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 93: I can name thin, big, heavy, light (not heavy), sweet (with sugar).*

93.1 mince — thin, slim

Before the new one: say the French for kind, then the French for narrow.

You'll want to know: mince

mince — "thin, slim".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mince — formed from the Old French verb *mincier*, "to cut fine", from Vulgar Latin **minutiare*, built on Latin *minutus*, "small" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mince*
- *Say it: mince*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mince*
- *Recall:* say the French for kind, then the French for narrow, then say *mince* again

Before you move on

What does mince mean? ("Thin, slim".) Say it once more.

93.2 gros — big, fat

Before the new one: say the French for narrow, then the French for thin.

You'll want to know: gros

gros — "big, fat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gros ← Late Latin *grossus*, "thick, coarse" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gros*
- *Say it: gros*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gros*
- *Recall:* say the French for narrow, then the French for thin, then say *gros* again

Before you move on

What does gros mean? (“Big, fat”.) Say it once more.

93.3 lourd — heavy

Before the new one: say the French for thin, then the French for big.

You’ll want to know: lourd

lourd — “heavy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lourd ← Old French *lourt*, “dull, stupid”, usually traced to Latin *luridus*, “sallow, ghastly” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The sense moved from dull to heavy.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lourd*
- *Say it: lourd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lourd*
- *Recall:* say the French for thin, then the French for big, then say *lourd* again

Before you move on

What does lourd mean? (“Heavy”.) Say it once more.

93.4 léger — light (not heavy)

Before the new one: say the French for big, then the French for heavy.

You'll want to know: léger

léger — "light (not heavy)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

léger ← Vulgar Latin **leviarius*, from Latin *levis*, "light" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: léger*
- *Say it: léger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *léger*
- *Recall:* say the French for big, then the French for heavy, then say *léger* again

Before you move on

What does léger mean? ("Light (not heavy)".) Say it once more.

93.5 sucré — sweet (with sugar)

Before the new one: say the French for heavy, then the French for light.

You'll want to know: sucré

sucré — "sweet (with sugar)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sucré is the past participle of the verb for "to sugar", made from *sucre*, "sugar": sugared.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sucré*
- *Say it: sucré*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sucré*
- *Recall:* say the French for heavy, then the French for light, then say *sucré* again

Before you move on

What does sucré mean? ("Sweet (with sugar)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 94

Salty, Bitter, Round, Square, Dry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name salty, bitter, round, square, dry.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 94: I can name salty, bitter, round, square, dry.

94.1 salé — salty

Before the new one: say the French for light, then the French for sweet.

You'll want to know: salé

salé — "salty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salé is the past participle of the verb for "to salt", made from *sel*, "salt", ← Latin *sal*: salted.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: salé*
- *Say it: salé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *salé*
- *Recall:* say the French for light, then the French for sweet, then say *salé* again

Before you move on

What does salé mean? ("Salty".) Say it once more.

94.2 amer — bitter

Before the new one: say the French for sweet, then the French for salty.

You'll want to know: amer

amer — "bitter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amer ← Latin *amarus*, "bitter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: amer*
- *Say it: amer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *amer*
- *Recall:* say the French for sweet, then the French for salty, then say *amer* again

Before you move on

What does amer mean? (“Bitter”.) Say it once more.

94.3 rond — round

Before the new one: say the French for salty, then the French for bitter.

You’ll want to know: rond

rond — “round”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rond ← Old French *reont* ← Vulgar Latin **retundus* ← Latin *rotundus*, “round”, from *rota*, “a wheel” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rond*
- *Say it: rond*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rond*
- *Recall:* say the French for salty, then the French for bitter, then say *rond* again

Before you move on

What does rond mean? (“Round”.) Say it once more.

94.4 carré — square

Before the new one: say the French for bitter, then the French for round.

You'll want to know: carré

carré — "square".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carré ← Old French *quarré* ← Latin *quadratus*, "squared" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: carré*
- *Say it: carré*, once more
- *Say it:* say *carré*
- *Recall:* say the French for bitter, then the French for round, then say *carré* again

Before you move on

What does carré mean? ("Square".) Say it once more.

94.5 sec — dry

Before the new one: say the French for round, then the French for square.

You'll want to know: sec

sec — "dry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sec ← Latin *siccus*, "dry" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sec*
- *Say it: sec*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sec*
- *Recall:* say the French for round, then the French for square, then say *sec* again

Before you move on

What does sec mean? (“Dry”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 95

Wet, Week, Month, Morning, Always

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name wet, a week, a month, the morning, always.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 95: I can name wet, a week, a month, the morning, always.*

95.1 mouillé — wet

> Before the new one: say the French for square, then the French for dry.

You'll want to know: mouillé

mouillé — "wet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mouillé is the past participle of the verb for "to wet", from Vulgar Latin **molliare*, "to soften", built on Latin *mollis*, "soft" (Lewis & Short): bread was softened by soaking.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mouillé*
- *Say it: mouillé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mouillé*
- *Recall:* say the French for square, then the French for dry, then say *mouillé* again

Before you move on

What does mouillé mean? ("Wet".) Say it once more.

95.2 la semaine — a week

Before the new one: say the French for dry, then the French for wet.

You'll want to know: la semaine

la semaine — "a week".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

semaine ← Latin *septimana*, "a set of seven", from *septimus*, "seventh", and *septem*, "seven" — inherited. *sept* is the same Latin number. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la semaine*
- *Say it: la semaine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la semaine*
- *Recall:* say the French for dry, then the French for wet, then say *la semaine* again

Before you move on

What does la semaine mean? (“A week”.) Say it once more.

95.3 le mois — a month

Before the new one: say the French for wet, then the French for a week.

You’ll want to know: le mois

le mois — “a month”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mois ← Old French *mois* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *mensis*, “month” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mois*
- *Say it: le mois*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mois*
- *Recall:* say the French for wet, then the French for a week, then say *le mois* again

Before you move on

What does le mois mean? (“A month”.) Say it once more.

95.4 le matin — the morning

Before the new one: say the French for a week, then the French for a month.

You'll want to know: le matin

le matin — "the morning".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

matin ← Latin *matutinum*, "the early part of the day", from *matutinus*, "of the morning" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le matin*
- *Say it: le matin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le matin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a week, then the French for a month, then say *le matin* again

Before you move on

What does le matin mean? ("The morning".) Say it once more.

95.5 toujours — always; still

Before the new one: say the French for a month, then the French for the morning.

You'll want to know: toujours

toujours — "always; still".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toujours ← Old French *toz jorz*, "all days": the word for "all" with *jours*, "days". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toujours*
- *Say it: toujours*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toujours*
- *Recall:* say the French for a month, then the French for the morning, then say *toujours* again

Before you move on

What does toujours mean? ("Always; still".) Say it once more.

Chapter 96

Never, Now, Then, Far, Near

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name never, now, then, far, near.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 96: I can name never, now, then, far, near.*

96.1 jamais — never; ever

Before the new one: say the French for the morning, then the French for always; still.

You'll want to know: jamais

jamais — "never; ever".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jamais ← Old French *ja mais*, "ever more" (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *iam*, "already", and *magis*, "more" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jamais*
- *Say it: jamais*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jamais*
- *Recall:* say the French for the morning, then the French for always; still, then say *jamais* again

Before you move on

What does jamais mean? (“Never; ever”.) Say it once more.

96.2 maintenant — now

Before the new one: say the French for always; still, then the French for never; ever.

You’ll want to know: maintenant

maintenant — “now”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maintenant is the present participle of the verb “to maintain”, from Latin *manu tenere*, “to hold in the hand”: the moment at hand. The *main-* is *main*, “hand”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maintenant*
- *Say it: maintenant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maintenant*
- *Recall:* say the French for always; still, then the French for never; ever, then say *maintenant* again

Before you move on

What does maintenant mean? (“Now”.) Say it once more.

96.3 puis — then

Before the new one: say the French for never; ever, then the French for now.

You’ll want to know: puis

puis — “then”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

puis ← Vulgar Latin **postius*, from Latin *post*, “after” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puis*
- *Say it: puis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puis*
- *Recall:* say the French for never; ever, then the French for now, then say *puis* again

Before you move on

What does puis mean? (“Then”.) Say it once more.

96.4 loin — far

Before the new one: say the French for now, then the French for then.

You'll want to know: loin

loin — "far".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loin ← Latin *longe*, "far off", from *longus*, "long" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: loin*
- *Say it: loin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *loin*
- *Recall:* say the French for now, then the French for then, then say *loin* again

Before you move on

What does loin mean? ("Far".) Say it once more.

96.5 près — near

Before the new one: say the French for then, then the French for far.

You'll want to know: près

près — "near".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

près ← Old French *pres* ← Latin *presse*, "closely", from *pressus*, "pressed" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: près*
- *Say it: près*, once more
- *Say it:* say *près*
- *Recall:* say the French for then, then the French for far, then say *près* again

Before you move on

What does près mean? ("Near".) Say it once more.

Chapter 97

On top, Underneath, Inside, Outside, Today

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name on top, underneath, inside, outside, today.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 97: I can name on top, underneath, inside, outside, today.

97.1 dessus — on top

Before the new one: say the French for far, then the French for near.

You'll want to know: dessus

dessus — "on top".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessus — built from *de*, "of, from", and Old French *sus*, "up, above", ← Latin *sursum*, "upward". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dessus*
- *Say it: dessus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dessus*
- *Recall:* say the French for far, then the French for near, then say *dessus* again

Before you move on

What does dessus mean? ("On top".) Say it once more.

97.2 dessous — underneath

Before the new one: say the French for near, then the French for on top.

You'll want to know: dessous

dessous — "underneath".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessous — built from *de*, "of, from", and the word for "under", from Latin *de* and *subtus*, "below". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dessous*
- *Say it: dessous*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dessous*
- *Recall:* say the French for near, then the French for on top, then say *dessous* again

Before you move on

What does dessous mean? (“Underneath”.) Say it once more.

97.3 dedans — inside

Before the new one: say the French for on top, then the French for underneath.

You’ll want to know: dedans

dedans — “inside”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dedans — built from *de*, “of, from”, and Old French *denz*, “within”, ← Latin *de intus*, “from inside” (Lewis & Short for *intus*).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dedans*
- *Say it:* *dedans*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dedans*
- *Recall:* say the French for on top, then the French for underneath, then say *dedans* again

Before you move on

What does dedans mean? (“Inside”.) Say it once more.

97.4 dehors — outside

Before the new one: say the French for underneath, then the French for inside.

You'll want to know: dehors

dehors — "outside".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dehors ← Old French *defors* ← Late Latin *deforis*, "from outside", from *foris*, "outside" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dehors*
- *Say it: dehors*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dehors*
- *Recall:* say the French for underneath, then the French for inside, then say *dehors* again

Before you move on

What does dehors mean? ("Outside".) Say it once more.

97.5 aujourd'hui — today

Before the new one: say the French for inside, then the French for outside.

You'll want to know: aujourd'hui

aujourd'hui — "today".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aujourd'hui — "on the day of today": *au*, *jour*, and Old French *hui*, "today", ← Latin *hodie*, "today" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word). The word holds "today" two times over.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aujourd'hui*
- *Say it: aujourd'hui*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aujourd'hui*
- *Recall:* say the French for inside, then the French for outside, then say *aujourd'hui* again

Before you move on

What does aujourd'hui mean? ("Today".) Say it once more.

Chapter 98

Yesterday, Often, Sometimes, Town, Street

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name yesterday, often, sometimes, a town, a street.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 98: I can name yesterday, often, sometimes, a town, a street.

98.1 hier — yesterday

Before the new one: say the French for outside, then the French for today.

You'll want to know: hier

hier — "yesterday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hier ← Old French *ier* ← Latin *heri*, "yesterday" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hier*
- *Say it: hier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hier*
- *Recall:* say the French for outside, then the French for today, then say *hier* again

Before you move on

What does hier mean? ("Yesterday".) Say it once more.

98.2 souvent — often

Before the new one: say the French for today, then the French for yesterday.

You'll want to know: souvent

souvent — "often".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souvent ← Old French *suvent* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *subinde*, "soon after, time after time" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: souvent*
- *Say it: souvent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *souvent*
- *Recall:* say the French for today, then the French for yesterday, then say *souvent* again

Before you move on

What does souvent mean? (“Often”.) Say it once more.

98.3 parfois — sometimes

Before the new one: say the French for yesterday, then the French for often.

You’ll want to know: parfois

parfois — “sometimes”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parfois — built from the word for “by” and the word for “a time, an occasion”, ← Latin *vices*, “turns” (Lewis & Short): by times.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parfois*
- *Say it: parfois*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parfois*
- *Recall:* say the French for yesterday, then the French for often, then say *parfois* again

Before you move on

What does parfois mean? (“Sometimes”.) Say it once more.

98.4 la ville — a town, a city

Before the new one: say the French for often, then the French for sometimes.

You'll want to know: la ville

la ville — "a town, a city".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ville ← Latin *villa*, "a country house, a farm" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la ville*
- *Say it: la ville*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la ville*
- *Recall:* say the French for often, then the French for sometimes, then say *la ville* again

Before you move on

What does la ville mean? ("A town, a city".) Say it once more.

98.5 la rue — a street

Before the new one: say the French for sometimes, then the French for a town.

You'll want to know: la rue

la rue — "a street".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rue ← Latin *ruga*, "a wrinkle, a furrow" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: a street was a furrow between houses.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rue*
- *Say it: la rue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la rue*
- *Recall:* say the French for sometimes, then the French for a town, then say *la rue* again

Before you move on

What does la rue mean? ("A street".) Say it once more.

Chapter 99

Shop, School, Bank, Train, Aeroplane

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a shop, a school, a bank, a train, an aeroplane.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 99: I can name a shop, a school, a bank, a train, an aeroplane.

99.1 le magasin — a shop

Before the new one: say the French for a town, then the French for a street.

You'll want to know: le magasin

le magasin — "a shop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

magasin ← Italian *magazzino*, "a storehouse", from Arabic *makhazin*, "storehouses" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le magasin*
- *Say it: le magasin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le magasin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a town, then the French for a street, then say *le magasin* again

Before you move on

What does le magasin mean? ("A shop".) Say it once more.

99.2 l'école — a school

Before the new one: say the French for a street, then the French for a shop.

You'll want to know: l'école

l'école — "a school".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

école ← Old French *escole* ← Latin *schola*, from Greek *schole*, "leisure, a place for talk" (EtymDB 2.1) — semi-learned: a fully inherited form would have broken the *o* into *ue*. The *é-* stands where an *s* once was.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'école*
- *Say it: l'école*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'école*
- *Recall:* say the French for a street, then the French for a shop, then say *l'école* again

Before you move on

What does l'école mean? ("A school".) Say it once more.

99.3 la banque — a bank

Before the new one: say the French for a shop, then the French for a school.

You'll want to know: la banque

la banque — "a bank".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banque ← Italian *banca*, "a bench", the money-changer's table — borrowed. The Italian word is Germanic, from Lombardic **bank*, "bench". (EtymDB 2.1 records the Lombardic step, through Italian *banco*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la banque*
- *Say it: la banque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la banque*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shop, then the French for a school, then say *la banque* again

Before you move on

What does la banque mean? ("A bank".) Say it once more.

99.4 le train — a train

Before the new one: say the French for a school, then the French for a bank.

You'll want to know: le train

le train — "a train".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

train — formed from the verb for "to drag, to pull along", which ← Vulgar Latin **traginare*, from Latin *trahere*, "to draw" (Lewis & Short): a train is a line of things pulled along.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le train*
- *Say it: le train*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le train*
- *Recall:* say the French for a school, then the French for a bank, then say *le train* again

Before you move on

What does le train mean? ("A train".) Say it once more.

99.5 l'avion — an aeroplane

Before the new one: say the French for a bank, then the French for a train.

You'll want to know: l'avion

l'avion — "an aeroplane".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avion — coined in the 1890s by the engineer Clément Ader from Latin *avis*, "bird" (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avion*
- *Say it: l'avion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'avion*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bank, then the French for a train, then say *l'avion* again

Before you move on

What does l'avion mean? ("An aeroplane".) Say it once more.

Chapter 100

Car, Bridge, Park, Church, Museum

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a car, a bridge, a park, a church, a museum.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 100: I can name a car, a bridge, a park, a church, a museum.

100.1 la voiture — a car

Before the new one: say the French for a train, then the French for an aeroplane.

You'll want to know: la voiture

la voiture — "a car".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voiture ← Old French *veiture* ← Latin *vectura*, "a carrying, transport", from *vehere*, "to carry" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-ct-* became *-it-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la voiture*
- *Say it: la voiture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la voiture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a train, then the French for an aeroplane, then say *la voiture* again

Before you move on

What does la voiture mean? ("A car".) Say it once more.

100.2 le pont — a bridge

Before the new one: say the French for an aeroplane, then the French for a car.

You'll want to know: le pont

le pont — "a bridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pont ← Latin *pons*, *pontis*, "bridge" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pont*
- *Say it: le pont*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pont*
- *Recall:* say the French for an aeroplane, then the French for a car, then say *le pont* again

Before you move on

What does le pont mean? (“A bridge”.) Say it once more.

100.3 le parc — a park

Before the new one: say the French for a car, then the French for a bridge.

You’ll want to know: le parc

le parc — “a park”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parc ← Old French *parc*, “a pen for animals” ← Medieval Latin *parricus*, “an enclosure”, probably from Frankish **parrik* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parc*
- *Say it: le parc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le parc*
- *Recall:* say the French for a car, then the French for a bridge, then say *le parc* again

Before you move on

What does le parc mean? (“A park”.) Say it once more.

100.4 l’église — a church

Before the new one: say the French for a bridge, then the French for a park.

You'll want to know: l'église

l'église — "a church".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

église ← Latin *ecclesia*, from Greek *ekklesia*, "an assembly" (EtymDB 2.1) — semi-learned, a Church word: a fully inherited form would show *-oi-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'église*
- *Say it: l'église*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'église*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bridge, then the French for a park, then say *l'église* again

Before you move on

What does l'église mean? ("A church".) Say it once more.

100.5 le musée — a museum

Before the new one: say the French for a park, then the French for a church.

You'll want to know: le musée

le musée — "a museum".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

musée ← Latin *museum*, from Greek *mouseion*, "a shrine of the Muses" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le musée*
- *Say it: le musée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le musée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a park, then the French for a church, then say *le musée* again

Before you move on

What does le musée mean? ("A museum".) Say it once more.

Chapter 101

Restaurant, Hotel, Pharmacy, Village, Post office

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a restaurant, a hotel, a pharmacy, a village, the post office.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 101: I can name a restaurant, a hotel, a pharmacy, a village, the post office.

101.1 le restaurant — a restaurant

Before the new one: say the French for a church, then the French for a museum.

You'll want to know: le restaurant

le restaurant — "a restaurant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

restaurant is the present participle of the verb for "to restore", a learned borrowing of Latin *restaurare* (EtymDB 2.1): first a restoring broth, then the place that served it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le restaurant*
- *Say it: le restaurant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le restaurant*
- *Recall:* say the French for a church, then the French for a museum, then say *le restaurant* again

Before you move on

What does le restaurant mean? (“A restaurant”.) Say it once more.

101.2 l’hôtel — a hotel

Before the new one: say the French for a museum, then the French for a restaurant.

You’ll want to know: l’hôtel

l’hôtel — “a hotel”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hôtel ← Old French *hostel* ← Late Latin *hospitale*, “a guest house”, from *hospes*, “guest” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) *hôpital* is the same Latin word taken in by scholars; *hôtel* is the one worn down in speech.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’hôtel*
- *Say it: l’hôtel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’hôtel*
- *Recall:* say the French for a museum, then the French for a restaurant, then say *l’hôtel* again

Before you move on

What does l'hôtel mean? ("A hotel".) Say it once more.

101.3 la pharmacie — a pharmacy

Before the new one: say the French for a restaurant, then the French for a hotel.

You'll want to know: la pharmacie

la pharmacie — "a pharmacy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pharmacie ← Medieval Latin *pharmacia*, from Greek *pharmakeia*, "the use of drugs", built on *pharmakon*, "a drug" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pharmacie*
- *Say it: la pharmacie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pharmacie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a restaurant, then the French for a hotel, then say *la pharmacie* again

Before you move on

What does la pharmacie mean? ("A pharmacy".) Say it once more.

101.4 le village — a village

Before the new one: say the French for a hotel, then the French for a pharmacy.

You'll want to know: le village

le village — "a village".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

village — built from *ville*, which then meant "a farm, an estate", with *-age*: the cluster of houses around it. (EtymDB 2.1 traces it to Latin *villa*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le village*
- *Say it: le village*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le village*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hotel, then the French for a pharmacy, then say *le village* again

Before you move on

What does le village mean? ("A village".) Say it once more.

101.5 la poste — the post office

Before the new one: say the French for a pharmacy, then the French for a village.

You'll want to know: la poste

la poste — "the post office".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poste ← Italian *posta*, "a relay station", from Latin *posita*, "placed", the past participle of *ponere*, "to put" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poste*
- *Say it: la poste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poste*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pharmacy, then the French for a village, then say *la poste* again

Before you move on

What does la poste mean? ("The post office".) Say it once more.

Chapter 102

Police, Theatre, Library, Bakery, Town hall

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the police, a theatre, a library, a bakery, the town hall.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 102: I can name the police, a theatre, a library, a bakery, the town hall.*

102.1 la police — the police

> Before the new one: say the French for a village, then the French for the post office.

You'll want to know: la police

la police — "the police".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

police ← Latin *politia*, "government, citizenship", from Greek *politeia*, built on *polis*, "a city" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la police*
- *Say it: la police*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la police*
- *Recall:* say the French for a village, then the French for the post office, then say *la police* again

Before you move on

What does la police mean? ("The police".) Say it once more.

102.2 le théâtre — a theatre

Before the new one: say the French for the post office, then the French for the police.

You'll want to know: le théâtre

le théâtre — "a theatre".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

théâtre ← Latin *theatrum*, from Greek *theatron*, "a place for viewing" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le théâtre*
- *Say it: le théâtre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le théâtre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the post office, then the French for the police, then say *le théâtre* again

Before you move on

What does le théâtre mean? (“A theatre”.) Say it once more.

102.3 la bibliothèque — a library

Before the new one: say the French for the police, then the French for a theatre.

You’ll want to know: la bibliothèque

la bibliothèque — “a library”. A false friend: a bookshop is **la librairie**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bibliothèque ← Latin *bibliotheca*, from Greek *bibliotheke*, “a case for books”, built on *biblion*, “a book” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bibliothèque*
- *Say it: la bibliothèque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la bibliothèque*
- *Recall:* say the French for the police, then the French for a theatre, then say *la bibliothèque* again

Before you move on

What does la bibliothèque mean? (“A library”.) Say it once more.

102.4 la boulangerie — a bakery

Before the new one: say the French for a theatre, then the French for a library.

You'll want to know: la boulangerie

la boulangerie — "a bakery".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boulangerie — built from the word for "baker", with *-erie*, "a place for". The baker word came from Picard *boulenc*, probably from Middle Dutch *bolle*, "a round loaf".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boulangerie*
- *Say it: la boulangerie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boulangerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a theatre, then the French for a library, then say *la boulangerie* again

Before you move on

What does la boulangerie mean? ("A bakery".) Say it once more.

102.5 la mairie — the town hall

Before the new one: say the French for a library, then the French for a bakery.

You'll want to know: la mairie

la mairie — "the town hall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mairie — built from the word for "mayor", with *-ie*: the mayor's house. The mayor word ← Latin *maior*, "greater" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mairie*
- *Say it: la mairie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la mairie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a library, then the French for a bakery, then say *la mairie* again

Before you move on

What does la mairie mean? ("The town hall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 103

District, Airport, Clothes, Shirt, Dress

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a district, an airport, clothes, a shirt, a dress.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 103: I can name a district, an airport, clothes, a shirt, a dress.*

103.1 le quartier — a district, a neighbourhood

Before the new one: say the French for a bakery, then the French for the town hall.

You'll want to know: le quartier

le quartier — "a district, a neighbourhood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quartier ← Latin *quartarius*, "a fourth part", from *quartus*, "fourth" — first a quarter of something, then a part of a town. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le quartier*
- *Say it: le quartier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le quartier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bakery, then the French for the town hall, then say *le quartier* again

Before you move on

What does le quartier mean? ("A district, a neighbourhood".) Say it once more.

103.2 l'aéroport — an airport

Before the new one: say the French for the town hall, then the French for a district.

You'll want to know: l'aéroport

l'aéroport — "an airport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aéroport — a 20th-century coinage from *aéro-*, "air", from Greek *aer*, and Old French *port*, "harbour", ← Latin *portus* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aéroport*
- *Say it: l'aéroport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'aéroport*
- *Recall:* say the French for the town hall, then the French for a district, then say *l'aéroport* again

Before you move on

What does l'aéroport mean? ("An airport".) Say it once more.

103.3 les vêtements — clothes

Before the new one: say the French for a district, then the French for an airport.

You'll want to know: les vêtements

les vêtements — "clothes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vêtements is the plural of the word for "a garment" ← Old French *vestement* ← Latin *vestimentum*, "clothing", from *vestire*, "to clothe" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. The circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les vêtements*
- *Say it: les vêtements*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les vêtements*
- *Recall:* say the French for a district, then the French for an airport, then say *les vêtements* again

Before you move on

What does les vêtements mean? ("Clothes".) Say it once more.

103.4 la chemise — a shirt

Before the new one: say the French for an airport, then the French for clothes.

You'll want to know: la chemise

la chemise — "a shirt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chemise ← Late Latin *camisia*, "a shirt", probably a Gaulish word (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *che-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chemise*
- *Say it: la chemise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chemise*
- *Recall:* say the French for an airport, then the French for clothes, then say *la chemise* again

Before you move on

What does la chemise mean? ("A shirt".) Say it once more.

103.5 la robe — a dress

Before the new one: say the French for clothes, then the French for a shirt.

You'll want to know: la robe

la robe — "a dress".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

robe ← Old French *robe*, "booty, a garment", from Frankish **rauba*, "plunder" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: clothes were the first spoils of a raid.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la robe*
- *Say it: la robe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la robe*
- *Recall:* say the French for clothes, then the French for a shirt, then say *la robe* again

Before you move on

What does la robe mean? ("A dress".) Say it once more.

Chapter 104

Trousers, Shoes, Hat, Coat, Skirt

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name trousers, shoes, a hat, a coat, a skirt.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 104: I can name trousers, shoes, a hat, a coat, a skirt.*

104.1 le pantalon — trousers

Before the new one: say the French for a shirt, then the French for a dress.

You'll want to know: le pantalon

le pantalon — "trousers".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pantalon — named after *Pantalone* (EtymDB 2.1), the old Venetian of Italian comedy, who wore long trousers.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pantalon*
- *Say it: le pantalon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pantalon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shirt, then the French for a dress, then say *le pantalon* again

Before you move on

What does le pantalon mean? (“Trousers”.) Say it once more.

104.2 les chaussures — shoes

Before the new one: say the French for a dress, then the French for trousers.

You’ll want to know: les chaussures

les chaussures — “shoes”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaussures is the plural of the word for “footwear”, built from the verb for “to put on shoes”, which ← Latin *calceare*, from *calceus*, “a shoe” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les chaussures*
- *Say it: les chaussures*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les chaussures*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dress, then the French for trousers, then say *les chaussures* again

Before you move on

What does les chaussures mean? (“Shoes”.) Say it once more.

104.3 le chapeau — a hat

Before the new one: say the French for trousers, then the French for shoes.

You’ll want to know: le chapeau

le chapeau — “a hat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chapeau ← Old French *chapel* ← Vulgar Latin **cappellus*, from Late Latin *cappa*, “a hooded cloak” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chapeau*
- *Say it: le chapeau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chapeau*
- *Recall:* say the French for trousers, then the French for shoes, then say *le chapeau* again

Before you move on

What does le chapeau mean? (“A hat”.) Say it once more.

104.4 le manteau — a coat

Before the new one: say the French for shoes, then the French for a hat.

You'll want to know: le manteau

le manteau — "a coat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manteau ← Old French *mantel* ← Latin *mantellum*, "a cloak" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le manteau*
- *Say it: le manteau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le manteau*
- *Recall:* say the French for shoes, then the French for a hat, then say *le manteau* again

Before you move on

What does le manteau mean? ("A coat".) Say it once more.

104.5 la jupe — a skirt

Before the new one: say the French for a hat, then the French for a coat.

You'll want to know: la jupe

la jupe — "a skirt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jupe ← Italian *giubba*, from Arabic *jubba*, "a long garment" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la jupe*
- *Say it: la jupe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la jupe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hat, then the French for a coat, then say *la jupe* again

Before you move on

What does la jupe mean? ("A skirt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 105

Socks, Thirty, Forty, Fifty, Hundred

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name socks, thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 105: I can name socks, thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred.*

105.1 les chaussettes — socks

Before the new one: say the French for a coat, then the French for a skirt.

You'll want to know: les chaussettes

les chaussettes — "socks".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaussettes is the plural of a little form of Old French *chauce*, "hose", ← Latin *calceus*, "a shoe" (Lewis & Short), with *-ette*, "little".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les chaussettes*
- *Say it: les chaussettes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les chaussettes*
- *Recall:* say the French for a coat, then the French for a skirt, then say *les chaussettes* again

Before you move on

What does les chaussettes mean? (“Socks”.) Say it once more.

105.2 trente — thirty

Before the new one: say the French for a skirt, then the French for socks.

You’ll want to know: trente

trente — “thirty”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trente ← Latin *triginta*, “thirty” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trente*
- *Say it: trente*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trente*
- *Recall:* say the French for a skirt, then the French for socks, then say *trente* again

Before you move on

What does trente mean? (“Thirty”.) Say it once more.

105.3 quarante — forty

Before the new one: say the French for socks, then the French for thirty.

You’ll want to know: quarante

quarante — “forty”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quarante ← Latin *quadraginta*, “forty” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: quarante*
- *Say it: quarante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *quarante*
- *Recall:* say the French for socks, then the French for thirty, then say *quarante* again

Before you move on

What does quarante mean? (“Forty”.) Say it once more.

105.4 cinquante — fifty

Before the new one: say the French for thirty, then the French for forty.

You'll want to know: cinquante

cinquante — "fifty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cinquante ← Vulgar Latin **cinquaginta* ← Latin *quinquaginta*, "fifty" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cinquante*
- *Say it: cinquante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cinquante*
- *Recall:* say the French for thirty, then the French for forty, then say *cinquante* again

Before you move on

What does cinquante mean? ("Fifty".) Say it once more.

105.5 cent — a hundred

Before the new one: say the French for forty, then the French for fifty.

You'll want to know: cent

cent — "a hundred".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cent ← Latin *centum*, "a hundred" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cent*
- *Say it: cent*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cent*
- *Recall:* say the French for forty, then the French for fifty, then say *cent* again

Before you move on

What does cent mean? ("A hundred".) Say it once more.

105.6 Nature, animals and describing words — a first pass

Say the words for fifty and a hundred.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a pen, paper, a notebook, a pencil, a bag
- a phone, an umbrella, money; silver, a present, glasses
- a box, a suitcase, a ticket; a banknote, a map; a card, a photo
- a tree, a flower, a leaf; a sheet of paper, a mountain, a river
- the sea, a stone, sand, a beach, an island
- the sun, a star, a cloud, rain, snow
- the wind, fire, a hill, a desert, a wave
- a cow, a pig, a bird, a mouse, a wolf
- a bear, a fox, a snake, a hen, a duck
- a sheep, a goat, a lion, a monkey, a bee
- an ant, an elephant, a rabbit, a frog, a tiger

- a tortoise, new, old, fast, easy
- difficult, dear; expensive, high, full, empty
- strong, weak, rich, poor, grey

Before you move on

A pen? (**le stylo**.) Paper? (**le papier**.) A notebook? (**le cahier**.) A pencil? (**le crayon**.) A bag? (**le sac**.) A phone? (**le téléphone**.) An umbrella? (**le parapluie**.) Money; silver? (**l'argent**.) A present? (**le cadeau**.) Glasses? (**les lunettes**.) A box? (**la boîte**.) A suitcase? (**la valise**.) A ticket; a banknote? (**le billet**.) A map; a card? (**la carte**.) A photo? (**la photo**.) A tree? (**l'arbre**.) A flower? (**la fleur**.) A leaf; a sheet of paper? (**la feuille**.) A mountain? (**la montagne**.) A river? (**la rivière**.) The sea? (**la mer**.) A stone? (**la pierre**.) Sand? (**le sable**.) A beach? (**la plage**.) An island? (**l'île**.) The sun? (**le soleil**.) A star? (**l'étoile**.) A cloud? (**le nuage**.) Rain? (**la pluie**.) Snow? (**la neige**.) The wind? (**le vent**.) Fire? (**le feu**.) A hill? (**la colline**.) A desert? (**le désert**.) A wave? (**la vague**.) A cow? (**la vache**.) A pig? (**le cochon**.) A bird? (**l'oiseau**.) A mouse? (**la souris**.) A wolf? (**le loup**.) A bear? (**l'ours**.) A fox? (**le renard**.) A snake? (**le serpent**.) A hen? (**la poule**.) A duck? (**le canard**.) A sheep? (**le mouton**.) A goat? (**la chèvre**.) A lion? (**le lion**.) A monkey? (**le singe**.) A bee? (**l'abeille**.) An ant? (**la fourmi**.) An elephant? (**l'éléphant**.) A rabbit? (**le lapin**.) A frog? (**la grenouille**.) A tiger? (**le tigre**.) A tortoise? (**la tortue**.) New? (**nouveau**.) Old? (**vieux**.) Fast? (**rapide**.) Easy? (**facile**.) Difficult? (**difficile**.) Dear; expensive? (**cher**.) High? (**haut**.) Full? (**plein**.) Empty? (**vide**.) Strong? (**fort**.) Weak? (**faible**.) Rich? (**riche**.) Poor? (**pauvre**.) Grey? (**gris**.)

105.7 Time, the town, clothes and numbers — a second pass

Say the words for soft; mild; sweet and dirty.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- soft; mild; sweet, dirty, young, kind, narrow
- thin, big, heavy, light, sweet
- salty, bitter, round, square, dry
- wet, a week, a month, the morning, always; still
- never; ever, now, then, far, near
- on top, underneath, inside, outside, today
- yesterday, often, sometimes, a town, a street
- a shop, a school, a bank, a train, an aeroplane
- a car, a bridge, a park, a church, a museum
- a restaurant, a hotel, a pharmacy, a village, the post office
- the police, a theatre, a library, a bakery, the town hall
- a district, an airport, clothes, a shirt, a dress
- trousers, shoes, a hat, a coat, a skirt
- socks, thirty, forty, fifty, a hundred

Before you move on

Soft; mild; sweet? (**doux**.) Dirty? (**sale**.) Young? (**jeune**.) Kind? (**gentil**.) Narrow? (**étroit**.) Thin? (**mince**.) Big? (**gros**.) Heavy? (**lourd**.) Light? (**léger**.) Sweet? (**sucré**.) Salty? (**salé**.) Bitter? (**amer**.) Round? (**rond**.) Square? (**carré**.) Dry? (**sec**.) Wet? (**mouillé**.) A week? (**la semaine**.) A month? (**le mois**.) The morning? (**le matin**.) Always; still? (**toujours**.) Never; ever? (**jamais**.) Now? (**maintenant**.) Then? (**puis**.) Far? (**loin**.) Near? (**près**.) On top? (**dessus**.) Underneath? (**dessous**.) Inside? (**dedans**.) Outside? (**dehors**.) Today? (**aujourd'hui**.) Yesterday? (**hier**.) Often? (**souvent**.) Sometimes? (**parfois**.) A town? (**la ville**.) A street? (**la rue**.) A shop? (**le magasin**.) A school?

(**l'école**.) A bank? (**la banque**.) A train? (**le train**.) An aeroplane? (**l'avion**.) A car? (**la voiture**.) A bridge? (**le pont**.) A park? (**le parc**.) A church? (**l'église**.) A museum? (**le musée**.) A restaurant? (**le restaurant**.) A hotel? (**l'hôtel**.) A pharmacy? (**la pharmacie**.) A village? (**le village**.) The post office? (**la poste**.) The police? (**la police**.) A theatre? (**le théâtre**.) A library? (**la bibliothèque**.) A bakery? (**la boulangerie**.) The town hall? (**la mairie**.) A district? (**le quartier**.) An airport? (**l'aéroport**.) Clothes? (**les vêtements**.) A shirt? (**la chemise**.) A dress? (**la robe**.) Trousers? (**le pantalon**.) Shoes? (**les chaussures**.) A hat? (**le chapeau**.) A coat? (**le manteau**.) A skirt? (**la jupe**.) Socks? (**les chaussettes**.) Thirty? (**trente**.) Forty? (**quarante**.) Fifty? (**cinquante**.) A hundred? (**cent**.)

Chapter 106

Bicycle, Underground, Taxi, Car park, Lift

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a bicycle, the underground, a taxi, a car park, a lift.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 106: I can name a bicycle, the underground, a taxi, a car park, a lift.

106.1 le vélo — a bicycle

Before the new one: say the French for fifty, then the French for a hundred.

You'll want to know: le vélo

le vélo — "a bicycle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vélo — short for *vélocipède*, a 19th-century coinage from Latin *velox*, "swift", and *pes*, *pedis*, "foot" (EtymDB 2.1 gives the two Latin parts).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vélo*
- *Say it: le vélo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vélo*
- *Recall:* say the French for fifty, then the French for a hundred, then say *le vélo* again

Before you move on

What does le vélo mean? ("A bicycle".) Say it once more.

106.2 le métro — the underground, the metro

Before the new one: say the French for a hundred, then the French for a bicycle.

You'll want to know: le métro

le métro — "the underground, the metro".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

métro — short for *métropolitain*, the city railway, from Greek *metropolis*, "a mother city", built from *meter*, "mother", and *polis*, "city". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le métro*
- *Say it: le métro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le métro*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hundred, then the French for a bicycle, then say *le métro* again

Before you move on

What does le métro mean? (“The underground, the metro”.) Say it once more.

106.3 le taxi — a taxi

Before the new one: say the French for a bicycle, then the French for the underground.

Ask for a taxi: *je demande un taxi*. **Demander** is to ask, never to demand.

You’ll want to know: le taxi

le taxi — “a taxi”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

taxi — short for *taximètre*, the fare meter, built from Medieval Latin *taxa*, “a charge”, and Greek *metron*, “measure”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le taxi*
- *Say it: le taxi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le taxi*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bicycle, then the French for the underground, then say *le taxi* again

Before you move on

What does le taxi mean? (“A taxi”.) Say it once more.

106.4 le parking — a car park

Before the new one: say the French for the underground, then the French for a taxi.

You'll want to know: le parking

le parking — "a car park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parking ← English *parking* — borrowed in the 20th century; English itself says *car park*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parking*
- *Say it: le parking*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le parking*
- *Recall:* say the French for the underground, then the French for a taxi, then say *le parking* again

Before you move on

What does le parking mean? ("A car park".) Say it once more.

106.5 l'ascenseur — a lift, an elevator

Before the new one: say the French for a taxi, then the French for a car park.

You'll want to know: l'ascenseur

l'ascenseur — "a lift, an elevator".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ascenseur ← Latin *ascensor*, "one who climbs", from *ascendere*, "to climb up" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ascenseur*
- *Say it: l'ascenseur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ascenseur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a taxi, then the French for a car park, then say *l'ascenseur* again

Before you move on

What does l'ascenseur mean? ("A lift, an elevator".) Say it once more.

Chapter 107

Supermarket, Cinema, Stadium, Swimming pool, Grocer's shop

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a supermarket, a cinema, a stadium, a swimming pool, a grocer's shop.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 107: I can name a supermarket, a cinema, a stadium, a swimming pool, a grocer's shop.

107.1 le supermarché — a supermarket

Before the new one: say the French for a car park, then the French for a lift.

You'll want to know: le supermarché

le supermarché — "a supermarket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

supermarché — built from *super-*, Latin for "above", and the French word for "market", which ← Latin *mercatus*, "trade" (Lewis & Short); modelled on English *supermarket*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le supermarché*
- *Say it: le supermarché*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le supermarché*
- *Recall:* say the French for a car park, then the French for a lift, then say *le supermarché* again

Before you move on

What does le supermarché mean? ("A supermarket".) Say it once more.

107.2 le cinéma — a cinema

Before the new one: say the French for a lift, then the French for a supermarket.

You'll want to know: le cinéma

le cinéma — "a cinema".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cinéma — short for *cinématographe*, a coinage of the 1890s from Greek *kinema*, "movement" (EtymDB 2.1), and *graphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cinéma*
- *Say it: le cinéma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cinéma*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lift, then the French for a supermarket, then say *le cinéma* again

Before you move on

What does le cinéma mean? (“A cinema”.) Say it once more.

107.3 le stade — a stadium

Before the new one: say the French for a supermarket, then the French for a cinema.

You’ll want to know: le stade

le stade — “a stadium”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stade ← Latin *stadium*, from Greek *stadion*, a measure of length and the racecourse of that length — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le stade*
- *Say it: le stade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le stade*
- *Recall:* say the French for a supermarket, then the French for a cinema, then say *le stade* again

Before you move on

What does le stade mean? (“A stadium”.) Say it once more.

107.4 la piscine — a swimming pool

Before the new one: say the French for a cinema, then the French for a stadium.

You'll want to know: la piscine

la piscine — "a swimming pool".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

piscine ← Latin *piscina*, "a fishpond", from *piscis*, "fish" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: the same Latin fish as *poisson*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la piscine*
- *Say it: la piscine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la piscine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cinema, then the French for a stadium, then say *la piscine* again

Before you move on

What does la piscine mean? ("A swimming pool".) Say it once more.

107.5 l'épicerie — a grocer's shop

Before the new one: say the French for a stadium, then the French for a swimming pool.

You'll want to know: l'épicerie

l'épicerie — "a grocer's shop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épicerie — built from the French word for "spice", with *-erie*, "a shop for". The spice word ← Latin *species*, "a kind; wares" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'épicerie*
- *Say it: l'épicerie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'épicerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a stadium, then the French for a swimming pool, then say *l'épicerie* again

Before you move on

What does l'épicerie mean? ("A grocer's shop".) Say it once more.

Chapter 108

Office, Factory, Pavement, Crossroads, Red light

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name an office, a factory, a pavement, a crossroads, a red light.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 108: I can name an office, a factory, a pavement, a crossroads, a red light.

108.1 le bureau — an office; a desk

Before the new one: say the French for a swimming pool, then the French for a grocer's shop.

You'll want to know: le bureau

le bureau — "an office; a desk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bureau ← Old French *burel*, "coarse woollen cloth", from Old French *bure*, ← Latin *burra*, "shaggy cloth" (EtymDB 2.1): the cloth on a desk, then the desk, then the room.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bureau*
- *Say it: le bureau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bureau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a swimming pool, then the French for a grocer's shop, then say *le bureau* again

Before you move on

What does le bureau mean? ("An office; a desk".) Say it once more.

108.2 l'usine — a factory

Before the new one: say the French for a grocer's shop, then the French for an office; a desk.

You'll want to know: l'usine

l'usine — "a factory".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

usine ← northern dialect *wisine*, from Latin *officina*, "a workshop" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'usine*
- *Say it: l'usine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'usine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a grocer's shop, then the French for an office; a desk, then say *l'usine* again

Before you move on

What does l'usine mean? ("A factory".) Say it once more.

108.3 le trottoir — a pavement

Before the new one: say the French for an office; a desk, then the French for a factory.

You'll want to know: le trottoir

le trottoir — "a pavement".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trottoir — built from the verb for "to trot", from Frankish **trotton*, "to run" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-oir*, "a place for": a place to walk.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le trottoir*
- *Say it: le trottoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le trottoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for an office; a desk, then the French for a factory, then say *le trottoir* again

Before you move on

What does le trottoir mean? ("A pavement".) Say it once more.

108.4 le carrefour — a crossroads

Before the new one: say the French for a factory, then the French for a pavement.

You'll want to know: le carrefour

le carrefour — "a crossroads".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carrefour ← Old French *quarrefourc* ← Late Latin *quadrifurcum*, "a place with four forks", from *quattuor*, "four", and *furca*, "a fork" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le carrefour*
- *Say it: le carrefour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le carrefour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a factory, then the French for a pavement, then say *le carrefour* again

Before you move on

What does le carrefour mean? ("A crossroads".) Say it once more.

108.5 le feu rouge — a red light

Before the new one: say the French for a pavement, then the French for a crossroads.

You'll want to know: le feu rouge

le feu rouge — "a red light". **le feu** is a fire; at a crossing it is the traffic light.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feu rouge — "red fire": *feu*, "fire", ← Latin *focus*, and *rouge*, "red", ← Latin *rubeus*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le feu rouge*
- *Say it: le feu rouge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le feu rouge*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pavement, then the French for a crossroads, then say *le feu rouge* again

Before you move on

What does le feu rouge mean? ("A red light".) Say it once more.

Chapter 109

Border, North, South, West, Letterbox

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a border, the north, the south, the west, a letterbox.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 109: I can name a border, the north, the south, the west, a letterbox.

109.1 la frontière — a border

Before the new one: say the French for a crossroads, then the French for a red light.

You'll want to know: la frontière

la frontière — "a border".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frontière — built from Old French *front*, "forehead, the front line", ← Latin *frons*, *frontis* (Lewis & Short), with *-ière*: the line an army faced.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la frontière*
- *Say it: la frontière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la frontière*
- *Recall:* say the French for a crossroads, then the French for a red light, then say *la frontière* again

Before you move on

What does la frontière mean? (“A border”.) Say it once more.

109.2 le nord — the north

Before the new one: say the French for a red light, then the French for a border.

You’ll want to know: le nord

le nord — “the north”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nord ← Old English *north* — borrowed in the Middle Ages, like the other compass points. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le nord*
- *Say it: le nord*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le nord*
- *Recall:* say the French for a red light, then the French for a border, then say *le nord* again

Before you move on

What does le nord mean? ("The north".) Say it once more.

109.3 le sud — the south

Before the new one: say the French for a border, then the French for the north.

You'll want to know: le sud

le sud — "the south".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sud ← Old French *su* ← Old English *suth*, "south" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sud*
- *Say it: le sud*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sud*
- *Recall:* say the French for a border, then the French for the north, then say *le sud* again

Before you move on

What does le sud mean? ("The south".) Say it once more.

109.4 l'ouest — the west

Before the new one: say the French for the north, then the French for the south.

You'll want to know: l'ouest

l'ouest — "the west".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ouest ← Old French *west* ← Old English *west* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ouest*
- *Say it: l'ouest*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ouest*
- *Recall:* say the French for the north, then the French for the south, then say *l'ouest* again

Before you move on

What does l'ouest mean? ("The west".) Say it once more.

109.5 la boîte aux lettres — a letterbox, a postbox

Before the new one: say the French for the south, then the French for the west.

You'll want to know: la boîte aux lettres

la boîte aux lettres — "a letterbox, a postbox".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boîte aux lettres — "box for the letters": *boîte*, "box", with *aux*, "to the", and the word for "letters", ← Latin *littera*, "a letter of the alphabet" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boîte aux lettres*
- *Say it: la boîte aux lettres*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boîte aux lettres*
- *Recall:* say the French for the south, then the French for the west, then say *la boîte aux lettres* again

Before you move on

What does la boîte aux lettres mean? ("A letterbox, a postbox".) Say it once more.

Chapter 110

Right, Left, World, Journey, Holidays

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the right, the left, the world, a journey, holidays.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 110: I can name the right, the left, the world, a journey, holidays.

110.1 la droite — the right

Before the new one: say the French for the west, then the French for a letterbox.

You'll want to know: la droite

la droite — "the right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

droite is the feminine of the word for "right, straight", ← Latin *directus*, "straight" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: *-ct-* became *-it*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la droite*
- *Say it: la droite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la droite*
- *Recall:* say the French for the west, then the French for a letterbox, then say *la droite* again

Before you move on

What does la droite mean? ("The right".) Say it once more.

110.2 la gauche — the left

Before the new one: say the French for a letterbox, then the French for the right.

You'll want to know: la gauche

la gauche — "the left".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gauche — formed from the Old French verb *gauchir*, "to veer, to warp" (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Frankish **walkan*, "to trample". The left was the clumsy hand.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gauche*
- *Say it: la gauche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la gauche*
- *Recall:* say the French for a letterbox, then the French for the right, then say *la gauche* again

Before you move on

What does la gauche mean? (“The left”.) Say it once more.

110.3 le monde — the world

Before the new one: say the French for the right, then the French for the left.

You’ll want to know: le monde

le monde — “the world”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

monde ← Latin *mundus*, “the world” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le monde*
- *Say it: le monde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le monde*
- *Recall:* say the French for the right, then the French for the left, then say *le monde* again

Before you move on

What does le monde mean? (“The world”.) Say it once more.

110.4 le voyage — a journey, a trip

Before the new one: say the French for the left, then the French for the world.

You'll want to know: le voyage

le voyage — "a journey, a trip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voyage ← Old French *voiage* ← Latin *viaticum*, "money and food for a journey", from *via*, "a road" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le voyage*
- *Say it: le voyage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le voyage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the left, then the French for the world, then say *le voyage* again

Before you move on

What does le voyage mean? ("A journey, a trip".) Say it once more.

110.5 les vacances — holidays

Before the new one: say the French for the world, then the French for a journey.

The holiday month: say *en août*.

You'll want to know: les vacances

les vacances — "holidays". Always plural in this sense.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vacances ← Latin *vacantia*, "empty, free times", from *vacare*, "to be empty, to be free" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les vacances*
- *Say it: les vacances*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les vacances*
- *Recall:* say the French for the world, then the French for a journey, then say *les vacances* again

Before you move on

What does les vacances mean? ("Holidays".) Say it once more.

Chapter 111

Rug, Television, Computer, Fridge, Radio

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge, a radio.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 111: I can name a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge, a radio.*

111.1 le tapis — a rug, a carpet

Before the new one: say the French for a journey, then the French for holidays.

You'll want to know: le tapis

le tapis — "a rug, a carpet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tapis ← Old French *tapiz* ← Byzantine Greek *tapetion*, from Greek *tapes*, "a carpet" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tapis*
- *Say it: le tapis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tapis*
- *Recall:* say the French for a journey, then the French for holidays, then say *le tapis* again

Before you move on

What does le tapis mean? ("A rug, a carpet".) Say it once more.

111.2 la télévision — a television

Before the new one: say the French for holidays, then the French for a rug.

You'll want to know: la télévision

la télévision — "a television".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

télévision — a 20th-century coinage from Greek *tele*, "far off", and *vision*, ← Latin *visio*, "seeing" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la télévision*
- *Say it: la télévision*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la télévision*
- *Recall:* say the French for holidays, then the French for a rug, then say *la télévision* again

Before you move on

What does la télévision mean? ("A television".) Say it once more.

111.3 l'ordinateur — a computer

Before the new one: say the French for a rug, then the French for a television.

You'll want to know: l'ordinateur

l'ordinateur — "a computer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ordinateur ← Latin *ordinator*, "one who sets in order" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing, chosen in 1955 as the French name for the computer.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ordinateur*
- *Say it: l'ordinateur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ordinateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rug, then the French for a television, then say *l'ordinateur* again

Before you move on

What does l'ordinateur mean? ("A computer".) Say it once more.

111.4 le réfrigérateur — a fridge

Before the new one: say the French for a television, then the French for a computer.

You'll want to know: le réfrigérateur

le réfrigérateur — "a fridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réfrigérateur — formed from the verb for "to chill", a learned borrowing of Latin *refrigerare*, "to make cool", from *frigus*, "cold" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le réfrigérateur*
- *Say it: le réfrigérateur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le réfrigérateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a television, then the French for a computer, then say *le réfrigérateur* again

Before you move on

What does le réfrigérateur mean? ("A fridge".) Say it once more.

111.5 la radio — a radio

Before the new one: say the French for a computer, then the French for a fridge.

You'll want to know: la radio

la radio — "a radio".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

radio — short for *radiotélégraphie*, built on Latin *radius*, "a rod, a ray" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la radio*
- *Say it: la radio*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la radio*
- *Recall:* say the French for a computer, then the French for a fridge, then say *la radio* again

Before you move on

What does la radio mean? ("A radio".) Say it once more.

Chapter 112

Shower, Bathtub, Wardrobe, Shelf, Curtain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a shower, a bathtub, a wardrobe, a shelf, a curtain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 112: I can name a shower, a bathtub, a wardrobe, a shelf, a curtain.

112.1 la douche — a shower

Before the new one: say the French for a fridge, then the French for a radio.

You'll want to know: la douche

la douche — "a shower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douche ← Italian *doccia*, "a water pipe", from Latin *ductus*, "a leading, a conduit", from *ducere*, "to lead" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la douche*
- *Say it: la douche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la douche*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fridge, then the French for a radio, then say *la douche* again

Before you move on

What does la douche mean? ("A shower".) Say it once more.

112.2 la baignoire — a bathtub

Before the new one: say the French for a radio, then the French for a shower.

You'll want to know: la baignoire

la baignoire — "a bathtub".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

baignoire — built from the verb for "to bathe", with *-oire*, "a thing for". The verb ← Latin *balneare*, from *balneum*, "a bath" (EtymDB 2.1 records *balneum*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la baignoire*
- *Say it: la baignoire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la baignoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a radio, then the French for a shower, then say *la baignoire* again

Before you move on

What does la baignoire mean? (“A bathtub”.) Say it once more.

112.3 l’armoire — a wardrobe

Before the new one: say the French for a shower, then the French for a bathtub.

You’ll want to know: l’armoire

l’armoire — “a wardrobe”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

armoire ← Old French *armaire* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *armarium*, “a cupboard, a chest”, from *arma*, “tools, arms” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’armoire*
- *Say it: l’armoire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’armoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shower, then the French for a bathtub, then say *l’armoire* again

Before you move on

What does l’armoire mean? (“A wardrobe”.) Say it once more.

112.4 l’étagère — a shelf

Before the new one: say the French for a bathtub, then the French for a wardrobe.

You'll want to know: l'étagère

l'étagère — "a shelf".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étagère — built from the word for "a level, a storey", with *-ère* (EtymDB 2.1). That word goes back to Latin *stare*, "to stand".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étagère*
- *Say it: l'étagère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étagère*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bathtub, then the French for a wardrobe, then say *l'étagère* again

Before you move on

What does l'étagère mean? ("A shelf".) Say it once more.

112.5 le rideau — a curtain

Before the new one: say the French for a wardrobe, then the French for a shelf.

You'll want to know: le rideau

le rideau — "a curtain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rideau ← Old French *ridel*, "a pleated cloth", from *rider*, "to pleat, to wrinkle". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rideau*
- *Say it: le rideau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rideau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wardrobe, then the French for a shelf, then say *le rideau* again

Before you move on

What does le rideau mean? ("A curtain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 113

Pillow, Blanket, Towel, Soap, Toothbrush

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a pillow, a blanket, a towel, soap, a toothbrush.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 113: I can name a pillow, a blanket, a towel, soap, a toothbrush.

113.1 l'oreiller — a pillow

Before the new one: say the French for a shelf, then the French for a curtain.

You'll want to know: l'oreiller

l'oreiller — "a pillow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oreiller ← Old French *orillier* (EtymDB 2.1), built from the word for "ear", ← Latin *auricula*, "a little ear", with *-ier*: the thing for the ear.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'oreiller*
- *Say it: l'oreiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'oreiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shelf, then the French for a curtain, then say *l'oreiller* again

Before you move on

What does l'oreiller mean? ("A pillow".) Say it once more.

113.2 la couverture — a blanket

Before the new one: say the French for a curtain, then the French for a pillow.

You'll want to know: la couverture

la couverture — "a blanket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couverture ← Late Latin *coopertura*, "a covering", from *coopertus*, "covered", the past participle of *cooperire* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la couverture*
- *Say it: la couverture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la couverture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a curtain, then the French for a pillow, then say *la couverture* again

Before you move on

What does la couverture mean? (“A blanket”.) Say it once more.

113.3 la serviette — a towel; a napkin

Before the new one: say the French for a pillow, then the French for a blanket.

You’ll want to know: la serviette

la serviette — “a towel; a napkin”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serviette — built from the verb for “to serve”, with *-ette*: a little thing for serving. The verb ← Latin *servire*, “to be a servant”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la serviette*
- *Say it: la serviette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la serviette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pillow, then the French for a blanket, then say *la serviette* again

Before you move on

What does la serviette mean? (“A towel; a napkin”.) Say it once more.

113.4 le savon — soap

Before the new one: say the French for a blanket, then the French for a towel; a napkin.

You'll want to know: le savon

le savon — "soap".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

savon ← Old French *savon* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *sapo*, *saponis*, "soap", a Germanic word in Latin (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le savon*
- *Say it: le savon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le savon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a blanket, then the French for a towel; a napkin, then say *le savon* again

Before you move on

What does le savon mean? ("Soap".) Say it once more.

113.5 la brosse à dents — a toothbrush

Before the new one: say the French for a towel; a napkin, then the French for soap.

You'll want to know: la brosse à dents

la brosse à dents — "a toothbrush".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brosse à dents — "brush for teeth": *brosse*, "brush", first "brushwood" in Old French (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; *à*, "for"; and *dents*, "teeth", ← Latin *dens*, *dentis*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la brosse à dents*
- *Say it: la brosse à dents*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la brosse à dents*
- *Recall:* say the French for a towel; a napkin, then the French for soap, then say *la brosse à dents* again

Before you move on

What does la brosse à dents mean? ("A toothbrush".) Say it once more.

Chapter 114

Toothpaste, Shampoo, Comb, Bin, Broom

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name toothpaste, shampoo, a comb, a bin, a broom.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 114: I can name toothpaste, shampoo, a comb, a bin, a broom.

114.1 le dentifrice — toothpaste

Before the new one: say the French for soap, then the French for a toothbrush.

You'll want to know: le dentifrice

le dentifrice — "toothpaste".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dentifrice ← Latin *dentifricium*, "tooth powder", from *dens*, "tooth", and *fricare*, "to rub" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dentifrice*
- *Say it: le dentifrice*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dentifrice*
- *Recall:* say the French for soap, then the French for a toothbrush, then say *le dentifrice* again

Before you move on

What does le dentifrice mean? ("Toothpaste".) Say it once more.

114.2 le shampooing — shampoo

Before the new one: say the French for a toothbrush, then the French for toothpaste.

You'll want to know: le shampooing

le shampooing — "shampoo".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

shampooing ← English *shampooing*, from Hindi *champo*, "press! knead!" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le shampooing*
- *Say it: le shampooing*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le shampooing*
- *Recall:* say the French for a toothbrush, then the French for toothpaste, then say *le shampooing* again

Before you move on

What does le shampooing mean? ("Shampoo".) Say it once more.

114.3 le peigne — a comb

Before the new one: say the French for toothpaste, then the French for shampoo.

You'll want to know: le peigne

le peigne — "a comb".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peigne ← Old French *peigne* ← Latin *pecten*, *pectinis*, "a comb" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le peigne*
- *Say it: le peigne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le peigne*
- *Recall:* say the French for toothpaste, then the French for shampoo, then say *le peigne* again

Before you move on

What does le peigne mean? ("A comb".) Say it once more.

114.4 la poubelle — a bin

Before the new one: say the French for shampoo, then the French for a comb.

You'll want to know: la poubelle

la poubelle — "a bin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poubelle comes from the name of Eugène Poubelle, the prefect of Paris who made lidded bins compulsory in 1884.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poubelle*
- *Say it: la poubelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poubelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for shampoo, then the French for a comb, then say *la poubelle* again

Before you move on

What does la poubelle mean? ("A bin".) Say it once more.

114.5 le balai — a broom

Before the new one: say the French for a comb, then the French for a bin.

You'll want to know: le balai

le balai — "a broom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

balai ← Old French *balain*, from Breton *balan*, "broom", the shrub that brooms were made of — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le balai*
- *Say it: le balai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le balai*
- *Recall:* say the French for a comb, then the French for a bin, then say *le balai* again

Before you move on

What does le balai mean? ("A broom".) Say it once more.

Chapter 115

Vacuum, Laundry, Washing powder, Iron, Pocket

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a vacuum cleaner, laundry, washing powder, iron, a pocket.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 115: I can name a vacuum cleaner, laundry, washing powder, iron, a pocket.

115.1 l'aspirateur — a vacuum cleaner

Before the new one: say the French for a bin, then the French for a broom.

You'll want to know: l'aspirateur

l'aspirateur — "a vacuum cleaner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aspirateur — built from the verb for "to breathe in, to suck in", with *-ateur*, "a thing that does". The verb ← Latin *aspirare*, "to breathe upon", from *spirare*, "to breathe" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aspirateur*
- *Say it: l'aspirateur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'aspirateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bin, then the French for a broom, then say *l'aspirateur* again

Before you move on

What does l'aspirateur mean? ("A vacuum cleaner".) Say it once more.

115.2 le linge — laundry, linen

Before the new one: say the French for a broom, then the French for a vacuum cleaner.

You'll want to know: le linge

le linge — "laundry, linen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

linge ← Latin *lineus*, "made of flax", from *linum*, "flax" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le linge*
- *Say it: le linge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le linge*
- *Recall:* say the French for a broom, then the French for a vacuum cleaner, then say *le linge* again

Before you move on

What does le linge mean? ("Laundry, linen".) Say it once more.

115.3 la lessive — washing powder; the washing

Before the new one: say the French for a vacuum cleaner, then the French for laundry.

You'll want to know: la lessive

la lessive — "washing powder; the washing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lessive ← Old French *lissive* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *lixivus*, "made into lye", from *lix*, "ashes, lye" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: clothes were washed in lye.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lessive*
- *Say it: la lessive*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la lessive*
- *Recall:* say the French for a vacuum cleaner, then the French for laundry, then say *la lessive* again

Before you move on

What does la lessive mean? ("Washing powder; the washing".) Say it once more.

115.4 le fer — iron; an iron (for clothes)

Before the new one: say the French for laundry, then the French for washing powder; the washing.

You'll want to know: le fer

le fer — "iron; an iron (for clothes)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fer ← Latin *ferrum*, "iron" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fer*
- *Say it: le fer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fer*
- *Recall:* say the French for laundry, then the French for washing powder; the washing, then say *le fer* again

Before you move on

What does le fer mean? ("Iron; an iron (for clothes)".) Say it once more.

115.5 la poche — a pocket

Before the new one: say the French for washing powder; the washing, then the French for iron; an iron.

You'll want to know: la poche

la poche — "a pocket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poche ← Frankish **pokka*, "a bag" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1 has Old French *poche*, "a bag".)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poche*
- *Say it: la poche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poche*
- *Recall:* say the French for washing powder; the washing, then the French for iron; an iron, then say *la poche* again

Before you move on

What does la poche mean? ("A pocket".) Say it once more.

Chapter 116

Jacket, Tie, Belt, Gloves, Scarf

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a jacket, a tie, a belt, gloves, a scarf.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 116: I can name a jacket, a tie, a belt, gloves, a scarf.*

116.1 la veste — a jacket

Before the new one: say the French for iron; an iron, then the French for a pocket.

You'll want to know: la veste

la veste — "a jacket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

veste ← Italian *veste*, "a garment", from Latin *vestis*, "clothing" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la veste*
- *Say it: la veste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la veste*
- *Recall:* say the French for iron; an iron, then the French for a pocket, then say *la veste* again

Before you move on

What does la veste mean? ("A jacket".) Say it once more.

116.2 la cravate — a tie

Before the new one: say the French for a pocket, then the French for a jacket.

You'll want to know: la cravate

la cravate — "a tie".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cravate — an old French form of the word for "a Croat" (EtymDB 2.1): Croatian soldiers in 17th-century France wore knotted neck scarves, and the fashion took their name.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cravate*
- *Say it: la cravate*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cravate*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pocket, then the French for a jacket, then say *la cravate* again

Before you move on

What does la cravate mean? (“A tie”.) Say it once more.

116.3 la ceinture — a belt

Before the new one: say the French for a jacket, then the French for a tie.

You’ll want to know: la ceinture

la ceinture — “a belt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ceinture ← Latin *cinctura*, “a girdle”, from *cingere*, “to gird” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-nct-* became *-int-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la ceinture*
- *Say it: la ceinture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la ceinture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a jacket, then the French for a tie, then say *la ceinture* again

Before you move on

What does la ceinture mean? (“A belt”.) Say it once more.

116.4 les gants — gloves

Before the new one: say the French for a tie, then the French for a belt.

You'll want to know: les gants

les gants — "gloves".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gants is the plural of the word for "glove" ← Old French *guant* ← Frankish **want*, "glove" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les gants*
- *Say it: les gants*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les gants*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tie, then the French for a belt, then say *les gants* again

Before you move on

What does les gants mean? ("Gloves".) Say it once more.

116.5 l'écharpe — a scarf

Before the new one: say the French for a belt, then the French for gloves.

You'll want to know: l'écharpe

l'écharpe — "a scarf".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écharpe ← Old French *escharpe*, a pilgrim's bag on a strap, from Frankish **skirpja*, "a bag of rushes" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'écharpe*
- *Say it: l'écharpe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'écharpe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a belt, then the French for gloves, then say *l'écharpe* again

Before you move on

What does l'écharpe mean? ("A scarf".) Say it once more.

116.6 Getting around and the town — a first pass

Say the words for gloves and a scarf.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a bicycle, the underground, a taxi, a car park, a lift
- a supermarket, a cinema, a stadium, a swimming pool, a grocer's shop
- an office; a desk, a factory, a pavement, a crossroads, a red light
- a border, the north, the south, the west, a letterbox
- the right, the left, the world, a journey, holidays

Before you move on

A bicycle? (**le vélo**.) The underground? (**le métro**.) A taxi? (**le taxi**.) A car park? (**le parking**.) A lift? (**l'ascenseur**.) A supermarket? (**le supermarché**.) A cinema? (**le cinéma**.) A

stadium? (**le stade**.) A swimming pool? (**la piscine**.) A grocer's shop? (**l'épicerie**.) An office; a desk? (**le bureau**.) A factory? (**l'usine**.) A pavement? (**le trottoir**.) A crossroads? (**le carrefour**.) A red light? (**le feu rouge**.) A border? (**la frontière**.) The north? (**le nord**.) The south? (**le sud**.) The west? (**l'ouest**.) A letterbox? (**la boîte aux lettres**.) The right? (**la droite**.) The left? (**la gauche**.) The world? (**le monde**.) A journey? (**le voyage**.) Holidays? (**les vacances**.)

116.7 The house — a second pass

Say the words for a rug and a television.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a rug, a television, a computer, a fridge, a radio
- a shower, a bathtub, a wardrobe, a shelf, a curtain
- a pillow, a blanket, a towel; a napkin, soap, a toothbrush
- toothpaste, shampoo, a comb, a bin, a broom
- a vacuum cleaner, laundry, washing powder; the washing, iron; an iron, a pocket
- a jacket, a tie, a belt, gloves, a scarf

Before you move on

A rug? (**le tapis**.) A television? (**la télévision**.) A computer? (**l'ordinateur**.) A fridge? (**le réfrigérateur**.) A radio? (**la radio**.) A shower? (**la douche**.) A bathtub? (**la baignoire**.) A wardrobe? (**l'armoire**.) A shelf? (**l'étagère**.) A curtain? (**le rideau**.) A pillow? (**l'oreiller**.) A blanket? (**la couverture**.) A towel; a napkin? (**la serviette**.) Soap? (**le savon**.) A toothbrush? (**la brosse à dents**.) Toothpaste? (**le dentifrice**.) Shampoo? (**le shampooing**.) A comb? (**le peigne**.) A bin? (**la poubelle**.) A broom? (**le balai**.) A vacuum cleaner? (**l'aspirateur**.) Laundry?

(**le linge**.) Washing powder; the washing? (**la lessive**.) Iron; an iron? (**le fer**.) A pocket? (**la poche**.) A jacket? (**la veste**.) A tie? (**la cravate**.) A belt? (**la ceinture**.) Gloves? (**les gants**.) A scarf? (**l'écharpe**.)

Chapter 117

Boots, Cap, Swimsuit, Size, Wallet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name boots, a cap, a swimsuit, size, a wallet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 117: I can name boots, a cap, a swimsuit, size, a wallet.*

117.1 les bottes — boots

Before the new one: say the French for gloves, then the French for a scarf.

You'll want to know: les bottes

les bottes — "boots".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bottes is the plural of the word for "boot", whose origin is uncertain. EtymDB 2.1 records Old French *bote*, "a high, thick shoe", and offers a Frankish source that is not secure.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les bottes*
- *Say it: les bottes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les bottes*
- *Recall:* say the French for gloves, then the French for a scarf, then say *les bottes* again

Before you move on

What does les bottes mean? ("Boots".) Say it once more.

117.2 la casquette — a cap

Before the new one: say the French for a scarf, then the French for boots.

You'll want to know: la casquette

la casquette — "a cap".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

casquette — a little form of the French word for "helmet", with *-ette*. That word came from Spanish *casco*, "skull, helmet" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la casquette*
- *Say it: la casquette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la casquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a scarf, then the French for boots, then say *la casquette* again

Before you move on

What does la casquette mean? (“A cap”.) Say it once more.

117.3 le maillot — a swimsuit; a sports shirt

Before the new one: say the French for boots, then the French for a cap.

You’ll want to know: le maillot

le maillot — “a swimsuit; a sports shirt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maillot ← Old French *mailloel*, a swaddling band, from *maille*, “a stitch, a mesh”, ← Latin *macula*, “a spot, a mesh”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le maillot*
- *Say it: le maillot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le maillot*
- *Recall:* say the French for boots, then the French for a cap, then say *le maillot* again

Before you move on

What does le maillot mean? (“A swimsuit; a sports shirt”.) Say it once more.

117.4 la taille — size; the waist

Before the new one: say the French for a cap, then the French for a swimsuit; a sports shirt.

You'll want to know: la taille

la taille — "size; the waist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

taille — formed from the verb for "to cut", ← Late Latin *taliare*, from *talea*, "a cutting, a twig" (EtymDB 2.1): the cut of a garment, then its size.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la taille*
- *Say it: la taille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la taille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cap, then the French for a swimsuit; a sports shirt, then say *la taille* again

Before you move on

What does la taille mean? ("Size; the waist".) Say it once more.

117.5 le portefeuille — a wallet

Before the new one: say the French for a swimsuit; a sports shirt, then the French for size; the waist.

You'll want to know: le portefeuille

le portefeuille — "a wallet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

portefeuille — "carry-leaves": *porte*, from *porter*, "to carry", and *feuille*, "a leaf, a sheet": a case for carrying papers.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le portefeuille*
- *Say it: le portefeuille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le portefeuille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a swimsuit; a sports shirt, then the French for size; the waist, then say *le portefeuille* again

Before you move on

What does le portefeuille mean? ("A wallet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 118

Jewel, Ring, Necklace, Perfume, Letter

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a jewel, a ring, a necklace, perfume, a letter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 118: I can name a jewel, a ring, a necklace, perfume, a letter.*

118.1 le bijou — a jewel, a piece of jewellery

> Before the new one: say the French for size; the waist, then the French for a wallet.

You'll want to know: le bijou

le bijou — "a jewel, a piece of jewellery". Plural **les bijoux**, with an x.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bijou ← Breton *bizou*, "a ring", from *biz*, "finger" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bijou*
- *Say it: le bijou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bijou*
- *Recall:* say the French for size; the waist, then the French for a wallet, then say *le bijou* again

Before you move on

What does le bijou mean? (“A jewel, a piece of jewellery”.) Say it once more.

118.2 la bague — a ring

Before the new one: say the French for a wallet, then the French for a jewel.

You’ll want to know: la bague

la bague — “a ring”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bague — its origin is uncertain; Middle Dutch *bagge*, “a ring”, is the usual guess. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Middle French form.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bague*
- *Say it: la bague*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la bague*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wallet, then the French for a jewel, then say *la bague* again

Before you move on

What does la bague mean? (“A ring”.) Say it once more.

118.3 le collier — a necklace

Before the new one: say the French for a jewel, then the French for a ring.

You’ll want to know: le collier

le collier — “a necklace”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

collier ← Late Latin *collare*, “a band for the neck”, from *collum*, “neck” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the same *collum* as *cou*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le collier*
- *Say it: le collier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le collier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a jewel, then the French for a ring, then say *le collier* again

Before you move on

What does le collier mean? (“A necklace”.) Say it once more.

118.4 le parfum — perfume

Before the new one: say the French for a ring, then the French for a necklace.

You'll want to know: le parfum

le parfum — "perfume".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parfum — formed from the verb for "to scent", which came from Italian *perfumare*, "to smoke through", from Latin *per*, "through", and *fumare*, "to smoke". (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin parts.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parfum*
- *Say it: le parfum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le parfum*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ring, then the French for a necklace, then say *le parfum* again

Before you move on

What does le parfum mean? ("Perfume".) Say it once more.

118.5 la lettre — a letter

Before the new one: say the French for a necklace, then the French for perfume.

You'll want to know: la lettre

la lettre — "a letter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lettre ← Old French *letre* ← Latin *littera*, "a letter of the alphabet" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lettre*
- *Say it: la lettre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la lettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a necklace, then the French for perfume, then say *la lettre* again

Before you move on

What does la lettre mean? ("A letter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 119

Beef, Vegetables, Mushroom, Beans, Cucumber

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name beef, vegetables, a mushroom, beans, a cucumber.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 119: I can name beef, vegetables, a mushroom, beans, a cucumber.*

119.1 le bœuf — beef; an ox

Before the new one: say the French for perfume, then the French for a letter.

Le bœuf is written with **œ**, the joined o and e. *Write it: bœuf* once

You'll want to know: le bœuf

le bœuf — "beef; an ox".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bœuf ← Latin *bos*, *bovis*, "ox" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the stressed *o* became *œu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bœuf*
- *Say it: le bœuf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bœuf*
- *Recall:* say the French for perfume, then the French for a letter, then say *le bœuf* again

Before you move on

What does le bœuf mean? ("Beef; an ox".) Say it once more.

119.2 les légumes — vegetables

Before the new one: say the French for a letter, then the French for beef; an ox.

You'll want to know: les légumes

les légumes — "vegetables".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

légumes is the plural of the word for "a vegetable", ← Latin *legumen*, "a pulse, a bean" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les légumes*
- *Say it: les légumes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les légumes*
- *Recall:* say the French for a letter, then the French for beef; an ox, then say *les légumes* again

Before you move on

What does les légumes mean? ("Vegetables".) Say it once more.

119.3 le champignon — a mushroom

Before the new one: say the French for beef; an ox, then the French for vegetables.

You'll want to know: le champignon

le champignon — "a mushroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

champignon ← Vulgar Latin **campaniolus*, "growing in the fields", from Latin *campania*, "level country", and *campus*, "a field" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le champignon*
- *Say it: le champignon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le champignon*
- *Recall:* say the French for beef; an ox, then the French for vegetables, then say *le champignon* again

Before you move on

What does le champignon mean? ("A mushroom".) Say it once more.

119.4 les haricots — beans

Before the new one: say the French for vegetables, then the French for a mushroom.

You'll want to know: les haricots

les haricots — "beans".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

haricots is the plural of the word for "bean", whose origin is uncertain. It first named a meat stew, from an Old French verb meaning "to chop up"; the bean sense may owe something to Nahuatl *ayacotli*, "bean".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les haricots*
- *Say it: les haricots*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les haricots*
- *Recall:* say the French for vegetables, then the French for a mushroom, then say *les haricots* again

Before you move on

What does les haricots mean? ("Beans".) Say it once more.

119.5 le concombre — a cucumber

Before the new one: say the French for a mushroom, then the French for beans.

You'll want to know: le concombre

le concombre — "a cucumber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

concombre ← Old Provençal *cocombre* ← Latin *cucumis*, *cucumeris*, "cucumber" — borrowed from the south. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le concombre*
- *Say it: le concombre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le concombre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mushroom, then the French for beans, then say *le concombre* again

Before you move on

What does le concombre mean? ("A cucumber".) Say it once more.

Chapter 120

Strawberry, Cherry, Melon, Garlic, Flour

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a strawberry, a cherry, a melon, garlic, flour.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 120: I can name a strawberry, a cherry, a melon, garlic, flour.

120.1 la fraise — a strawberry

Before the new one: say the French for beans, then the French for a cucumber.

You'll want to know: la fraise

la fraise — "a strawberry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fraise ← Latin *fraga*, "strawberries" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. The *-s-* is unexplained; it may come from the French word for "raspberry".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fraise*
- *Say it: la fraise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fraise*
- *Recall:* say the French for beans, then the French for a cucumber, then say *la fraise* again

Before you move on

What does la fraise mean? ("A strawberry".) Say it once more.

120.2 la cerise — a cherry

Before the new one: say the French for a cucumber, then the French for a strawberry.

You'll want to know: la cerise

la cerise — "a cherry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cerise ← Vulgar Latin **ceresia* ← Latin *cerasium*, from Greek *kerasion*, "cherry" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cerise*
- *Say it: la cerise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cerise*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cucumber, then the French for a strawberry, then say *la cerise* again

Before you move on

What does la cerise mean? ("A cherry".) Say it once more.

120.3 le melon — a melon

Before the new one: say the French for a strawberry, then the French for a cherry.

You'll want to know: le melon

le melon — "a melon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

melon ← Late Latin *melo*, *melonis*, short for *melopepo*, from Greek *melopepon*, "apple-gourd" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le melon*
- *Say it: le melon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le melon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a strawberry, then the French for a cherry, then say *le melon* again

Before you move on

What does le melon mean? ("A melon".) Say it once more.

120.4 l'ail — garlic

Before the new one: say the French for a cherry, then the French for a melon.

You'll want to know: l'ail

l'ail — "garlic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ail ← Latin *allium*, "garlic" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ail*
- *Say it: l'ail*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ail*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cherry, then the French for a melon, then say *l'ail* again

Before you move on

What does l'ail mean? ("Garlic".) Say it once more.

120.5 la farine — flour

Before the new one: say the French for a melon, then the French for garlic.

You'll want to know: la farine

la farine — "flour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

farine ← Latin *farina*, "flour, meal", from *far*, "spelt" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la farine*
- *Say it: la farine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la farine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a melon, then the French for garlic, then say *la farine* again

Before you move on

What does la farine mean? (“Flour”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 121

Beer, Juice, Ice cream, Chocolate, Biscuit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name beer, juice, ice cream, chocolate, a biscuit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 121: I can name beer, juice, ice cream, chocolate, a biscuit.*

121.1 la bière — beer

> Before the new one: say the French for garlic, then the French for flour.

You'll want to know: la bière

la bière — "beer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bière ← Middle Dutch *bier* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed in the 1400s, with hopped beer.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bière*
- *Say it: la bière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la bière*
- *Recall:* say the French for garlic, then the French for flour, then say *la bière* again

Before you move on

What does la bière mean? (“Beer”.) Say it once more.

121.2 le jus — juice

Before the new one: say the French for flour, then the French for beer.

You’ll want to know: le jus

le jus — “juice”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jus ← Latin *ius*, “broth, sauce” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: Latin *i-* before a vowel regularly became French *j-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jus*
- *Say it: le jus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jus*
- *Recall:* say the French for flour, then the French for beer, then say *le jus* again

Before you move on

What does le jus mean? (“Juice”.) Say it once more.

121.3 la glace — ice cream; ice; a mirror

Before the new one: say the French for beer, then the French for juice.

You’ll want to know: la glace

la glace — “ice cream; ice; a mirror”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

glace ← Vulgar Latin **glacia* ← Latin *glacies*, “ice” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la glace*
- *Say it: la glace*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la glace*
- *Recall:* say the French for beer, then the French for juice, then say *la glace* again

Before you move on

What does la glace mean? (“Ice cream; ice; a mirror”.) Say it once more.

121.4 le chocolat — chocolate

Before the new one: say the French for juice, then the French for ice cream; ice; a mirror.

You'll want to know: le chocolat

le chocolat — "chocolate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chocolat ← Spanish *chocolate*, from Nahuatl, often given as *xocolatl* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; the Nahuatl form is debated.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chocolat*
- *Say it: le chocolat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chocolat*
- *Recall:* say the French for juice, then the French for ice cream; ice; a mirror, then say *le chocolat* again

Before you move on

What does le chocolat mean? ("Chocolate".) Say it once more.

121.5 le biscuit — a biscuit

Before the new one: say the French for ice cream; ice; a mirror, then the French for chocolate.

You'll want to know: le biscuit

le biscuit — "a biscuit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

biscuit ← Old French *bescuit*, "cooked two times": *bes-*, "two times", ← Latin *bis*, and the word for "cooked", ← Latin *coctus*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le biscuit*
- *Say it: le biscuit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le biscuit*
- *Recall:* say the French for ice cream; ice; a mirror, then the French for chocolate, then say *le biscuit* again

Before you move on

What does le biscuit mean? ("A biscuit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 122

Sandwich, Sauce, Vinegar, Dessert, Meal

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a sandwich, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert, a meal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 122: I can name a sandwich, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert, a meal.*

122.1 le sandwich — a sandwich

> Before the new one: say the French for chocolate, then the French for a biscuit.

You'll want to know: le sandwich

le sandwich — "a sandwich".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sandwich ← English *sandwich*, named after the Earl of Sandwich — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sandwich*
- *Say it: le sandwich*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sandwich*
- *Recall:* say the French for chocolate, then the French for a biscuit, then say *le sandwich* again

Before you move on

What does le sandwich mean? ("A sandwich".) Say it once more.

122.2 la sauce — a sauce

Before the new one: say the French for a biscuit, then the French for a sandwich.

You'll want to know: la sauce

la sauce — "a sauce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauce ← Vulgar Latin **salsa*, "salted", from Latin *salsus*, from *sal*, "salt" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sauce*
- *Say it: la sauce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la sauce*
- *Recall:* say the French for a biscuit, then the French for a sandwich, then say *la sauce* again

Before you move on

What does la sauce mean? ("A sauce".) Say it once more.

122.3 le vinaigre — vinegar

Before the new one: say the French for a sandwich, then the French for a sauce.

You'll want to know: le vinaigre

le vinaigre — "vinegar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vinaigre — "sour wine": *vin*, "wine", and Old French *aigre*, "sour", ← Latin *acer*, "sharp". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vinaigre*
- *Say it: le vinaigre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vinaigre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sandwich, then the French for a sauce, then say *le vinaigre* again

Before you move on

What does le vinaigre mean? ("Vinegar".) Say it once more.

122.4 le dessert — a dessert

Before the new one: say the French for a sauce, then the French for vinegar.

You'll want to know: le dessert

le dessert — "a dessert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessert — formed from the verb for "to clear the table", built from *des-* and the verb for "to serve" (EtymDB 2.1): what comes once the table is cleared.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dessert*
- *Say it: le dessert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dessert*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sauce, then the French for vinegar, then say *le dessert* again

Before you move on

What does le dessert mean? ("A dessert".) Say it once more.

122.5 le repas — a meal

Before the new one: say the French for vinegar, then the French for a dessert.

You'll want to know: le repas

le repas — "a meal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

repas ← Old French *repast*, from Late Latin *repascere*, "to feed", built on Latin *pascere*, "to feed, to graze" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le repas*
- *Say it: le repas*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le repas*
- *Recall:* say the French for vinegar, then the French for a dessert, then say *le repas* again

Before you move on

What does le repas mean? ("A meal".) Say it once more.

Chapter 123

Nurse, Cook, Police officer, Shop assistant, Farmer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a nurse, a cook, a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 123: I can name a nurse, a cook, a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer.

123.1 l'infirmière — a nurse

Before the new one: say the French for a dessert, then the French for a meal.

You'll want to know: l'infirmière

l'infirmière — "a nurse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

infirmière — built from the old word for "a sick ward", with *-ière*; behind it is Latin *infirmus*, "weak, sick", from *firmus*, "strong" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'infirmière*
- *Say it: l'infirmière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'infirmière*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dessert, then the French for a meal, then say *l'infirmière* again

Before you move on

What does l'infirmière mean? ("A nurse".) Say it once more.

123.2 le cuisinier — a cook

Before the new one: say the French for a meal, then the French for a nurse.

You'll want to know: le cuisinier

le cuisinier — "a cook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuisinier — built from *cuisine*, "kitchen", with *-ier*, "one who works at".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cuisinier*
- *Say it: le cuisinier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cuisinier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a meal, then the French for a nurse, then say *le cuisinier* again

Before you move on

What does le cuisinier mean? (“A cook”.) Say it once more.

123.3 le policier — a police officer

Before the new one: say the French for a nurse, then the French for a cook.

You’ll want to know: le policier

le policier — “a police officer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

policier — built from *police* with *-ier*, “one who works at”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le policier*
- *Say it: le policier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le policier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a nurse, then the French for a cook, then say *le policier* again

Before you move on

What does le policier mean? (“A police officer”.) Say it once more.

123.4 le vendeur — a shop assistant

Before the new one: say the French for a cook, then the French for a police officer.

You'll want to know: le vendeur

le vendeur — "a shop assistant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vendeur — built from the verb for "to sell", with *-eur*, "one who". The verb ← Latin *vendere*, "to sell" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vendeur*
- *Say it: le vendeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vendeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cook, then the French for a police officer, then say *le vendeur* again

Before you move on

What does le vendeur mean? ("A shop assistant".) Say it once more.

123.5 l'agriculteur — a farmer

Before the new one: say the French for a police officer, then the French for a shop assistant.

You'll want to know: l'agriculteur

l'agriculteur — "a farmer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agriculteur ← Latin *agricultor*, "a farmer", from *ager*, "a field", and *cultor*, "a tiller" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'agriculteur*
- *Say it: l'agriculteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'agriculteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a police officer, then the French for a shop assistant, then say *l'agriculteur* again

Before you move on

What does l'agriculteur mean? ("A farmer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 124

Baker, Student, Driver, Lawyer, Engineer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a baker, a student, a driver, a lawyer, an engineer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 124: I can name a baker, a student, a driver, a lawyer, an engineer.

124.1 le boulanger — a baker

Before the new one: say the French for a shop assistant, then the French for a farmer.

You'll want to know: le boulanger

le boulanger — "a baker". The person behind **la boulangerie**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boulanger ← Picard *boulenc*, probably from Middle Dutch *bolle*, "a round loaf": a maker of round loaves. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Old French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le boulanger*
- *Say it: le boulanger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le boulanger*
- *Recall:* say the French for a shop assistant, then the French for a farmer, then say *le boulanger* again

Before you move on

What does le boulanger mean? (“A baker”.) Say it once more.

124.2 l’étudiant — a student

Before the new one: say the French for a farmer, then the French for a baker.

You’ll want to know: l’étudiant

l’étudiant — “a student”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étudiant is the present participle of *étudier*, “to study”, used as a noun: one who is studying. *Étudier* ← Old French *estudier*, from the Latin family of *studium*, “eagerness, study” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’étudiant*
- *Say it: l’étudiant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’étudiant*
- *Recall:* say the French for a farmer, then the French for a baker, then say *l’étudiant* again

Before you move on

What does l'étudiant mean? ("A student".) Say it once more.

124.3 le chauffeur — a driver

Before the new one: say the French for a baker, then the French for a student.

You'll want to know: le chauffeur

le chauffeur — "a driver".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chauffeur — built from the verb for "to heat", with *-eur*: first the stoker of a steam engine, then the driver. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chauffeur*
- *Say it: le chauffeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chauffeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a baker, then the French for a student, then say *le chauffeur* again

Before you move on

What does le chauffeur mean? ("A driver".) Say it once more.

124.4 l'avocat — a lawyer; an avocado

Before the new one: say the French for a student, then the French for a driver.

You'll want to know: l'avocat

l'avocat — "a lawyer; an avocado".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avocat — two words in one. The lawyer ← Latin *advocatus*, "one called in to help" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing. The fruit ← Spanish *aguacate*, from Nahuatl *ahuacatl* (EtymDB 2.1), reshaped to look like the lawyer word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avocat*
- *Say it: l'avocat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'avocat*
- *Recall:* say the French for a student, then the French for a driver, then say *l'avocat* again

Before you move on

What does l'avocat mean? ("A lawyer; an avocado".) Say it once more.

124.5 l'ingénieur — an engineer

Before the new one: say the French for a driver, then the French for a lawyer; an avocado.

You'll want to know: l'ingénieur

l'ingénieur — "an engineer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ingénieur — built from Old French *engin*, "a clever device, a war machine", ← Latin *ingenium*, "talent" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-eur*, later respelt after the Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ingénieur*
- *Say it: l'ingénieur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ingénieur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a driver, then the French for a lawyer; an avocado, then say *l'ingénieur* again

Before you move on

What does l'ingénieur mean? ("An engineer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 125

Firefighter, Postman, Waiter, Customer, Till

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a firefighter, a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 125: I can name a firefighter, a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till.*

125.1 le pompier — a firefighter

> Before the new one: say the French for a lawyer; an avocado, then the French for an engineer.

You'll want to know: le pompier

le pompier — "a firefighter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pompier — built from the word for "a pump", with *-ier*: the one who works the pump.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pompier*
- *Say it: le pompier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pompier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lawyer; an avocado, then the French for an engineer, then say *le pompier* again

Before you move on

What does le pompier mean? ("A firefighter".) Say it once more.

125.2 le facteur — a postman, a postwoman

Before the new one: say the French for an engineer, then the French for a firefighter.

You'll want to know: le facteur

le facteur — "a postman, a postwoman".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

facteur ← Latin *factor*, "a maker, a doer", from *facere*, "to make, to do" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing; the agent who delivers became the postman.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le facteur*
- *Say it: le facteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le facteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for an engineer, then the French for a firefighter, then say *le facteur* again

Before you move on

What does le facteur mean? (“A postman, a postwoman”.) Say it once more.

125.3 le serveur — a waiter

Before the new one: say the French for a firefighter, then the French for a postman.

You’ll want to know: le serveur

le serveur — “a waiter”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serveur — built from the verb for “to serve”, ← Latin *servire*, with *-eur*, “one who”. (EtymDB 2.1 records the verb.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le serveur*
- *Say it: le serveur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le serveur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a firefighter, then the French for a postman, then say *le serveur* again

Before you move on

What does le serveur mean? (“A waiter”.) Say it once more.

125.4 le client — a customer

Before the new one: say the French for a postman, then the French for a waiter.

You'll want to know: le client

le client — "a customer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

client ← Latin *cliens*, *clientis*, "a dependant, a follower" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le client*
- *Say it: le client*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le client*
- *Recall:* say the French for a postman, then the French for a waiter, then say *le client* again

Before you move on

What does le client mean? ("A customer".) Say it once more.

125.5 la caisse — a till, a checkout

Before the new one: say the French for a waiter, then the French for a customer.

You'll want to know: la caisse

la caisse — "a till, a checkout".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caisse ← Old Provençal *caissa* ← Latin *capsa*, "a box" — borrowed from the south: an inherited form would begin with *ch-*. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin word.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la caisse*
- *Say it: la caisse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la caisse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a waiter, then the French for a customer, then say *la caisse* again

Before you move on

What does la caisse mean? ("A till, a checkout".) Say it once more.

Chapter 126

Class, Lesson, Exam, Word, Board

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a class, a lesson, an exam, a word, a board.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 126: I can name a class, a lesson, an exam, a word, a board.*

126.1 la classe — a class; a classroom

Before the new one: say the French for a customer, then the French for a till.

You'll want to know: la classe

la classe — "a class; a classroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

classe ← Latin *classis*, "a division of the people, a class" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la classe*
- *Say it: la classe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la classe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a customer, then the French for a till, then say *la classe* again

Before you move on

What does la classe mean? (“A class; a classroom”.) Say it once more.

126.2 la leçon — a lesson

Before the new one: say the French for a till, then the French for a class; a classroom.

Read it: the instruction and do it — *Dites « la classe ».*

Read it: le stylo, le cahier, le crayon aloud as one line, without stopping between the words

You’ll want to know: la leçon

la leçon — “a lesson”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

leçon ← Latin *lectio*, “a reading”, from *legere*, “to read” (EtymDB 2.1) — semi-learned: the *-ct-* did not become *-it-*, as it did in the word for “bed” from *lectum*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la leçon*
- *Say it: la leçon*, once more

- *Say it:* say *la leçon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a till, then the French for a class; a classroom, then say *la leçon* again

Before you move on

What does la leçon mean? ("A lesson".) Say it once more.

126.3 l'examen — an exam

Before the new one: say the French for a class; a classroom, then the French for a lesson.

You'll want to know: l'examen

l'examen — "an exam".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

examen ← Latin *examen*, "the tongue of a balance, a weighing" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'examen*
- *Say it: l'examen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'examen*
- *Recall:* say the French for a class; a classroom, then the French for a lesson, then say *l'examen* again

Before you move on

What does l'examen mean? ("An exam".) Say it once more.

126.4 le mot — a word

Before the new one: say the French for a lesson, then the French for an exam.

You'll want to know: le mot

le mot — "a word".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mot ← Late Latin *muttum*, "a grunt, a sound", from *muttire*, "to mutter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mot*
- *Say it: le mot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mot*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lesson, then the French for an exam, then say *le mot* again

Before you move on

What does le mot mean? ("A word".) Say it once more.

126.5 le tableau — a board; a painting

Before the new one: say the French for an exam, then the French for a word.

You'll want to know: le tableau

le tableau — "a board; a painting".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tableau ← Old French *tablel*, a little form of the word for "table", ← Latin *tabula*, "a board, a plank". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tableau*
- *Say it: le tableau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tableau*
- *Recall:* say the French for an exam, then the French for a word, then say *le tableau* again

Before you move on

What does le tableau mean? ("A board; a painting".) Say it once more.

Chapter 127

Rubber, Homework, Answer, Idea, Problem

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a rubber, homework, an answer, an idea, a problem.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 127: I can name a rubber, homework, an answer, an idea, a problem.

127.1 la gomme — a rubber, an eraser

Before the new one: say the French for a word, then the French for a board; a painting.

You'll want to know: la gomme

la gomme — "a rubber, an eraser".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gomme ← Late Latin *gumma* ← Latin *gummi*, from Greek *kommi*, a word from Egyptian — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gomme*
- *Say it: la gomme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la gomme*
- *Recall:* say the French for a word, then the French for a board; a painting, then say *la gomme* again

Before you move on

What does la gomme mean? ("A rubber, an eraser".) Say it once more.

127.2 les devoirs — homework

Before the new one: say the French for a board; a painting, then the French for a rubber.

You'll want to know: les devoirs

les devoirs — "homework".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

devoirs is the plural of *devoir*, "to have to", used as a noun: duties, the work one owes. The verb ← Latin *debere*, "to owe" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les devoirs*
- *Say it: les devoirs*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les devoirs*

- *Recall:* say the French for a board; a painting, then the French for a rubber, then say *les devoirs* again

Before you move on

What does les devoirs mean? ("Homework".) Say it once more.

127.3 la réponse — an answer

Before the new one: say the French for a rubber, then the French for homework.

Read it: La leçon est à neuf heures, dans la classe douze aloud as one line

Then answer from it: at what time is the lesson? (**À neuf heures.**)

You'll want to know: la réponse

la réponse — "an answer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réponse ← Old French *response*, from Latin *responsa*, "answers", from *respondere*, "to answer" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réponse*
- *Say it: la réponse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la réponse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rubber, then the French for homework, then say *la réponse* again

Before you move on

What does la réponse mean? ("An answer".) Say it once more.

127.4 l'idée — an idea

Before the new one: say the French for homework, then the French for an answer.

You'll want to know: l'idée

l'idée — "an idea".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

idée ← Latin *idea*, from Greek *idea*, "a form, a pattern", from *idein*, "to see" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'idée*
- *Say it: l'idée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'idée*
- *Recall:* say the French for homework, then the French for an answer, then say *l'idée* again

Before you move on

What does l'idée mean? ("An idea".) Say it once more.

127.5 le problème — a problem

Before the new one: say the French for an answer, then the French for an idea.

You'll want to know: le problème

le problème — "a problem".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

problème ← Latin *problema*, from Greek *problema*, "a thing put forward", from *proballein*, "to throw forward" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le problème*
- *Say it: le problème*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le problème*
- *Recall:* say the French for an answer, then the French for an idea, then say *le problème* again

Before you move on

What does le problème mean? ("A problem".) Say it once more.

127.6 Clothes and things you carry — a first pass

Say the words for an idea and a problem.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- boots, a cap, a swimsuit; a sports shirt, size; the waist, a wallet
- a jewel, a ring, a necklace, perfume, a letter
- beef; an ox, vegetables, a mushroom, beans, a cucumber
- a strawberry, a cherry, a melon, garlic, flour

- beer, juice, ice cream; ice; a mirror, chocolate, a biscuit

Before you move on

Boots? (**les bottes**.) A cap? (**la casquette**.) A swimsuit; a sports shirt? (**le maillot**.) Size; the waist? (**la taille**.) A wallet? (**le portefeuille**.) A jewel? (**le bijou**.) A ring? (**la bague**.) A necklace? (**le collier**.) Perfume? (**le parfum**.) A letter? (**la lettre**.) Beef; an ox? (**le bœuf**.) Vegetables? (**les légumes**.) A mushroom? (**le champignon**.) Beans? (**les haricots**.) A cucumber? (**le concombre**.) A strawberry? (**la fraise**.) A cherry? (**la cerise**.) A melon? (**le melon**.) Garlic? (**l'ail**.) Flour? (**la farine**.) Beer? (**la bière**.) Juice? (**le jus**.) Ice cream; ice; a mirror? (**la glace**.) Chocolate? (**le chocolat**.) A biscuit? (**le biscuit**.)

127.7 Food and work — a second pass

Say the words for a sandwich and a sauce.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a sandwich, a sauce, vinegar, a dessert, a meal
- a nurse, a cook, a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer
- a baker, a student, a driver, a lawyer; an avocado, an engineer
- a firefighter, a postman, a waiter, a customer, a till
- a class; a classroom, a lesson, an exam, a word, a board; a painting
- a rubber, homework, an answer, an idea, a problem

Before you move on

A sandwich? (**le sandwich**.) A sauce? (**la sauce**.) Vinegar? (**le vinaigre**.) A dessert? (**le dessert**.) A meal? (**le repas**.) A nurse? (**l'infirmière**.) A cook? (**le cuisinier**.) A police officer? (**le policier**.) A shop assistant? (**le vendeur**.) A farmer?

(**l'agriculteur**.) A baker? (**le boulanger**.) A student? (**l'étudiant**.) A driver? (**le chauffeur**.) A lawyer; an avocado? (**l'avocat**.) An engineer? (**l'ingénieur**.) A firefighter? (**le pompier**.) A postman? (**le facteur**.) A waiter? (**le serveur**.) A customer? (**le client**.) A till? (**la caisse**.) A class; a classroom? (**la classe**.) A lesson? (**la leçon**.) An exam? (**l'examen**.) A word? (**le mot**.) A board; a painting? (**le tableau**.) A rubber? (**la gomme**.) Homework? (**les devoirs**.) An answer? (**la réponse**.) An idea? (**l'idée**.) A problem? (**le problème**.)

Chapter 128

Music, Sport, Game, Film, Song

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name music, sport, a game, a film, a song.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 128: I can name music, sport, a game, a film, a song.*

128.1 la musique — music

Before the new one: say the French for an idea, then the French for a problem.

Say *j'aime bien la musique*. **Aimer bien** is to like, softer than **aimer**.

You'll want to know: la musique

la musique — "music".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

musique ← Latin *musica*, from Greek *mousike*, "the art of the Muses" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la musique*
- *Say it: la musique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la musique*
- *Recall:* say the French for an idea, then the French for a problem, then say *la musique* again

Before you move on

What does la musique mean? ("Music".) Say it once more.

128.2 le sport — sport

Before the new one: say the French for a problem, then the French for music.

Sport on a Sunday: say *dimanche*.

You'll want to know: le sport

le sport — "sport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sport ← English *sport* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed in the 19th century. English had shortened it from Old French *desport*, "a pastime".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sport*
- *Say it: le sport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sport*
- *Recall:* say the French for a problem, then the French for music, then say *le sport* again

Before you move on

What does le sport mean? ("Sport".) Say it once more.

128.3 le jeu — a game

Before the new one: say the French for music, then the French for sport.

You'll want to know: le jeu

le jeu — "a game". Plural **les jeux**, with an x.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeu ← Old French *geu* ← Latin *iocus*, "a joke, a jest" — inherited. It is the noun beside *jouer*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jeu*
- *Say it: le jeu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jeu*
- *Recall:* say the French for music, then the French for sport, then say *le jeu* again

Before you move on

What does le jeu mean? ("A game".) Say it once more.

128.4 le film — a film

Before the new one: say the French for sport, then the French for a game.

You'll want to know: le film

le film — "a film".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

film ← English *film*, "a thin skin, a membrane", then the coated strip a camera uses — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le film*
- *Say it: le film*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le film*
- *Recall:* say the French for sport, then the French for a game, then say *le film* again

Before you move on

What does le film mean? ("A film".) Say it once more.

128.5 la chanson — a song

Before the new one: say the French for a game, then the French for a film.

You'll want to know: la chanson

la chanson — "a song".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chanson ← Old French *chançon* ← Latin *cantio*, *cantionis*, "a song", from *canere*, "to sing" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chanson*
- *Say it: la chanson*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chanson*
- *Recall:* say the French for a game, then the French for a film, then say *la chanson* again

Before you move on

What does la chanson mean? ("A song".) Say it once more.

Chapter 129

Drawing, Life, Time, Colour, Price

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a drawing, life, a time, a colour, a price.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 129: I can name a drawing, life, a time, a colour, a price.*

129.1 le dessin — a drawing

Before the new one: say the French for a film, then the French for a song.

You'll want to know: le dessin

le dessin — "a drawing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dessin — formed from *dessiner*, "to draw": a drawing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dessin*

- *Say it:* *le dessin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dessin*
- *Recall:* say the French for a film, then the French for a song, then say *le dessin* again

Before you move on

What does le dessin mean? ("A drawing".) Say it once more.

129.2 la vie — life

Before the new one: say the French for a song, then the French for a drawing.

You'll want to know: la vie

la vie — "life".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vie ← Latin *vita*, "life" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the *t* between vowels dropped out. It shares its root with *vivre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la vie*
- *Say it:* *la vie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a song, then the French for a drawing, then say *la vie* again

Before you move on

What does la vie mean? ("Life".) Say it once more.

129.3 la fois — a time, an occasion

Before the new one: say the French for a drawing, then the French for life.

You'll want to know: la fois

la fois — "a time, an occasion". **une fois**: once; **deux fois**: twice.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fois ← Old French *foiz* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *vices*, "turns, changes" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fois*
- *Say it: la fois*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fois*
- *Recall:* say the French for a drawing, then the French for life, then say *la fois* again

Before you move on

What does la fois mean? ("A time, an occasion".) Say it once more.

129.4 la couleur — a colour

Before the new one: say the French for life, then the French for a time.

Ask for the colour: *Quelle couleur ?* **Quel** takes an -le before a feminine noun.

You'll want to know: la couleur

la couleur — "a colour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couleur ← Latin *color*, *coloris*, "colour" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la couleur*
- *Say it: la couleur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la couleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for life, then the French for a time, then say *la couleur* again

Before you move on

What does la couleur mean? ("A colour".) Say it once more.

129.5 le prix — a price; a prize

Before the new one: say the French for a time, then the French for a colour.

You'll want to know: le prix

le prix — "a price; a prize".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prix ← Old French *pris* ← Latin *pretium*, "worth, price, reward" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le prix*
- *Say it: le prix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le prix*
- *Recall:* say the French for a time, then the French for a colour, then say *le prix* again

Before you move on

What does le prix mean? (“A price; a prize”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 130

Pink, Purple, Brown (chestnut), Brown (of hair, Pretty

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name pink, purple, brown (chestnut), brown (of hair, pretty.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 130: I can name pink, purple, brown (chestnut), brown (of hair, pretty.

130.1 rose — pink

Before the new one: say the French for a colour, then the French for a price; a prize.

Before the new colours, one from before: **jaune**, which sits beside German *gelb*. Say *jaune*.

You'll want to know: rose

rose — "pink".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rose — the colour named after the flower, *rose*, ← Latin *rosa*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rose*
- *Say it: rose*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rose*
- *Recall:* say the French for a colour, then the French for a price; a prize, then say *rose* again

Before you move on

What does rose mean? ("Pink".) Say it once more.

130.2 violet — purple

Before the new one: say the French for a price; a prize, then the French for pink.

You'll want to know: violet

violet — "purple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

violet — the colour named after the flower, the violet, a little form of Old French *viole*, ← Latin *viola*, "a violet" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: violet*
- *Say it: violet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *violet*
- *Recall:* say the French for a price; a prize, then the French for pink, then say *violet* again

Before you move on

What does violet mean? ("Purple".) Say it once more.

130.3 marron — brown (chestnut)

Before the new one: say the French for pink, then the French for purple.

You'll want to know: marron

marron — "brown (chestnut)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marron ← Italian *marrone*, "a large chestnut" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; the colour is named after the nut. The Italian word's own origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: marron*
- *Say it: marron*, once more
- *Say it:* say *marron*
- *Recall:* say the French for pink, then the French for purple, then say *marron* again

Before you move on

What does marron mean? ("Brown (chestnut)".) Say it once more.

130.4 brun — brown (of hair, skin)

Before the new one: say the French for purple, then the French for brown.

You'll want to know: brun

brun — "brown (of hair, skin)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brun ← Old French *brun*, "brown, shiny" ← Frankish **brun*, "brown" — borrowed from the Franks. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *brun*
- *Say it:* *brun*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brun*
- *Recall:* say the French for purple, then the French for brown, then say *brun* again

Before you move on

What does brun mean? ("Brown (of hair, skin)".) Say it once more.

130.5 joli — pretty

Before the new one: say the French for brown, then the French for brown.

You'll want to know: joli

joli — "pretty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joli ← Old French *jolif*, "merry, festive" (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; the usual guess is Old Norse *jol*, the midwinter feast.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: joli*
- *Say it: joli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *joli*
- *Recall:* say the French for brown, then the French for brown, then say *joli* again

Before you move on

What does joli mean? ("Pretty".) Say it once more.

Chapter 131

Busy, Free, Open, Closed, Calm

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name busy, free, open, closed, calm.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 131: I can name busy, free, open, closed, calm.*

131.1 occupé — busy

Before the new one: say the French for brown, then the French for pretty.

You'll want to know: occupé

occupé — "busy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

occupé is the past participle of the verb for "to occupy", a learned borrowing of Latin *occupare*, "to seize", from *ob* and *capere*, "to take" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: occupé*
- *Say it: occupé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *occupé*
- *Recall:* say the French for brown, then the French for pretty, then say *occupé* again

Before you move on

What does occupé mean? (“Busy”.) Say it once more.

131.2 libre — free

Before the new one: say the French for pretty, then the French for busy.

You’ll want to know: libre

libre — “free”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

libre ← Latin *liber*, “free” (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: libre*
- *Say it: libre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *libre*
- *Recall:* say the French for pretty, then the French for busy, then say *libre* again

Before you move on

What does libre mean? (“Free”.) Say it once more.

131.3 ouvert — open

Before the new one: say the French for busy, then the French for free.

Ouvert belongs to **ouvrir**, to open, which takes the endings of a verb in -er: *j’ouvre*. Say *j’ouvre*, then its opposite, *je ferme*.

You’ll want to know: ouvert

ouvert — “open”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ouvert is the past participle of *ouvrir*, “to open”: opened. It goes back to Vulgar Latin **opertus*, from Latin *apertus*, “open”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ouvert*
- *Say it: ouvert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ouvert*
- *Recall:* say the French for busy, then the French for free, then say *ouvert* again

Before you move on

What does ouvert mean? (“Open”.) Say it once more.

131.4 fermé — closed

Before the new one: say the French for free, then the French for open.

Fermé is the closed form of **fermer**, to close. Say *fermer*, then *fermé*.

You'll want to know: fermé

fermé — "closed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fermé is the past participle of *fermer*, "to close": closed. The verb ← Latin *firmare*, "to make firm, to fasten" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fermé*
- *Say it: fermé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fermé*
- *Recall:* say the French for free, then the French for open, then say *fermé* again

Before you move on

What does fermé mean? ("Closed".) Say it once more.

131.5 calme — calm, quiet

Before the new one: say the French for open, then the French for closed.

You'll want to know: calme

calme — "calm, quiet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

calme ← Italian *calma* ← Late Latin *cauma*, "the heat of midday", from Greek *kauma*, "burning heat" (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the still hour when the sun was hottest.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *calme*
- *Say it:* *calme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *calme*
- *Recall:* say the French for open, then the French for closed, then say *calme* again

Before you move on

What does calme mean? ("Calm, quiet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 132

Noisy, Last, Next, Famous, Funny

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name noisy, last, next, famous, funny.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 132: I can name noisy, last, next, famous, funny.*

132.1 bruyant — noisy

> Before the new one: say the French for closed, then the French for calm.

You'll want to know: bruyant

bruyant — "noisy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bruyant is the present participle of the Old French verb *bruire*, "to roar, to rustle", usually traced to Latin *rugire*, "to roar" (Lewis & Short), with a changed start.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bruyant*
- *Say it: bruyant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bruyant*
- *Recall:* say the French for closed, then the French for calm, then say *bruyant* again

Before you move on

What does bruyant mean? ("Noisy".) Say it once more.

132.2 dernier — last

Before the new one: say the French for calm, then the French for noisy.

You'll want to know: dernier

dernier — "last".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dernier — built in Old French on *derrain*, "last", from Vulgar Latin **deretranus*, built on Latin *retro*, "behind" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dernier*
- *Say it: dernier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dernier*
- *Recall:* say the French for calm, then the French for noisy, then say *dernier* again

Before you move on

What does dernier mean? (“Last”.) Say it once more.

132.3 prochain — next

Before the new one: say the French for noisy, then the French for last.

You’ll want to know: prochain

prochain — “next”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prochain ← Vulgar Latin **propeanus*, from Latin *prope*, “near” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prochain*
- *Say it: prochain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prochain*
- *Recall:* say the French for noisy, then the French for last, then say *prochain* again

Before you move on

What does prochain mean? (“Next”.) Say it once more.

132.4 célèbre — famous

Before the new one: say the French for last, then the French for next.

You'll want to know: célèbre

célèbre — "famous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

célèbre ← Latin *celeber*, "crowded, much spoken of" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: célèbre*
- *Say it: célèbre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *célèbre*
- *Recall:* say the French for last, then the French for next, then say *célèbre* again

Before you move on

What does célèbre mean? ("Famous".) Say it once more.

132.5 drôle — funny

Before the new one: say the French for next, then the French for famous.

You'll want to know: drôle

drôle — "funny".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

drôle ← Middle Dutch *drol*, "a little fellow, a goblin" — borrowed; it first meant "a rascal", then "a comic".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *drôle*
- *Say it:* *drôle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *drôle*
- *Recall:* say the French for next, then the French for famous, then say *drôle* again

Before you move on

What does drôle mean? ("Funny".) Say it once more.

Chapter 133

Nice, Nasty, Heat, Storm, Fog

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name nice, nasty, heat, a storm, fog.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 133: I can name nice, nasty, heat, a storm, fog.*

133.1 sympathique — nice, friendly

Before the new one: say the French for famous, then the French for funny.

You'll want to know: sympathique

sympathique — "nice, friendly". Often shortened to **sympa**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sympathique — built from the word for "sympathy", ← Latin *sympathia*, from Greek *sympatheia*, "fellow feeling". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sympathique*
- *Say it: sympathique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sympathique*
- *Recall:* say the French for famous, then the French for funny, then say *sympathique* again

Before you move on

What does sympathique mean? ("Nice, friendly".) Say it once more.

133.2 méchant — nasty, mean

Before the new one: say the French for funny, then the French for nice.

You'll want to know: méchant

méchant — "nasty, mean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

méchant is the present participle of Old French *mescheoir*, "to turn out badly": *mes-*, "badly", and *cheoir*, "to fall", ← Latin *cadere* (Lewis & Short). Ill-fated, then wicked.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: méchant*
- *Say it: méchant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *méchant*
- *Recall:* say the French for funny, then the French for nice, then say *méchant* again

Before you move on

What does méchant mean? (“Nasty, mean”.) Say it once more.

133.3 la chaleur — heat

Before the new one: say the French for nice, then the French for nasty.

Heat belongs to a season: say *en été*, then *au printemps*.

You’ll want to know: la chaleur

la chaleur — “heat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaleur ← Old French *chalor* ← Latin *calor*, “heat” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chaleur*
- *Say it: la chaleur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la chaleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for nice, then the French for nasty, then say *la chaleur* again

Before you move on

What does la chaleur mean? (“Heat”.) Say it once more.

133.4 l’orage — a storm

Before the new one: say the French for nasty, then the French for heat.

You'll want to know: l'orage

l'orage — "a storm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

orage — built from Old French *ore*, "a wind", ← Latin *aura*, "a breeze", from Greek *aura*, with *-age*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'orage*
- *Say it: l'orage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'orage*
- *Recall:* say the French for nasty, then the French for heat, then say *l'orage* again

Before you move on

What does l'orage mean? ("A storm".) Say it once more.

133.5 le brouillard — fog

Before the new one: say the French for heat, then the French for a storm.

You'll want to know: le brouillard

le brouillard — "fog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brouillard — built from Old French *broillas*, "fog", from the verb for "to blur, to mix up", ← Vulgar Latin **brodiculare*, "to jumble together" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-ard*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le brouillard*
- *Say it: le brouillard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le brouillard*
- *Recall:* say the French for heat, then the French for a storm, then say *le brouillard* again

Before you move on

What does le brouillard mean? ("Fog".) Say it once more.

Chapter 134

Grass, Ear, Lip, Number (on a door, Address

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name grass, an ear, a lip, a number (on a door, an address.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 134: I can name grass, an ear, a lip, a number (on a door, an address.*

134.1 l'herbe — grass

Before the new one: say the French for a storm, then the French for fog.

You'll want to know: l'herbe

l'herbe — "grass".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

herbe ← Old French *erbe* ← Latin *herba*, "grass, a plant" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The *h* was put back later, from Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'herbe*
- *Say it: l'herbe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'herbe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a storm, then the French for fog, then say *l'herbe* again

Before you move on

What does l'herbe mean? ("Grass".) Say it once more.

134.2 l'oreille — an ear

Before the new one: say the French for fog, then the French for grass.

You'll want to know: l'oreille

l'oreille — "an ear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

oreille ← Vulgar Latin **oricla* ← Latin *auricula*, "a little ear", from *auris*, "ear" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'oreille*
- *Say it: l'oreille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'oreille*
- *Recall:* say the French for fog, then the French for grass, then say *l'oreille* again

Before you move on

What does l'oreille mean? ("An ear".) Say it once more.

134.3 la lèvre — a lip

Before the new one: say the French for grass, then the French for an ear.

You'll want to know: la lèvre

la lèvre — "a lip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lèvre ← Latin *labra*, "lips", the plural of *labrum* (Lewis & Short) — inherited: stressed *a* became *e*, and *b* became *v*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lèvre*
- *Say it: la lèvre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la lèvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for grass, then the French for an ear, then say *la lèvre* again

Before you move on

What does la lèvre mean? ("A lip".) Say it once more.

134.4 le numéro — a number (on a door, a phone)

Before the new one: say the French for an ear, then the French for a lip.

You'll want to know: le numéro

le numéro — "a number (on a door, a phone)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

numéro ← Italian *numero* ← Latin *numerus*, "a number" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le numéro*
- *Say it: le numéro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le numéro*
- *Recall:* say the French for an ear, then the French for a lip, then say *le numéro* again

Before you move on

What does le numéro mean? ("A number (on a door, a phone)".) Say it once more.

134.5 l'adresse — an address

Before the new one: say the French for a lip, then the French for a number.

You'll want to know: l'adresse

l'adresse — "an address".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adresse — formed from the verb for "to direct, to send", ← Vulgar Latin **addirectiare*, built on Latin *directus*, "straight" (Lewis & Short): where a letter is sent.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'adresse*
- *Say it: l'adresse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'adresse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lip, then the French for a number, then say *l'adresse* again

Before you move on

What does l'adresse mean? ("An address".) Say it once more.

Chapter 135

Second, Change (coins), Date, Century, Email

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a second, change (coins), a date, a century, an email.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 135: I can name a second, change (coins), a date, a century, an email.

135.1 la seconde — a second

Before the new one: say the French for a number, then the French for an address.

A time from before: say *deux heures moins le quart*.

You'll want to know: la seconde

la seconde — "a second".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

seconde ← Medieval Latin *secunda*, short for *secunda minuta*, "the second small part" of an hour — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la seconde*
- *Say it: la seconde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la seconde*
- *Recall:* say the French for a number, then the French for an address, then say *la seconde* again

Before you move on

What does la seconde mean? ("A second".) Say it once more.

135.2 la monnaie — change (coins); currency

Before the new one: say the French for an address, then the French for a second.

You'll want to know: la monnaie

la monnaie — "change (coins); currency".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

monnaie ← Old French *moneie* ← Latin *moneta*, "a mint, coin", from Juno *Moneta*, in whose temple Rome struck its coins — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la monnaie*
- *Say it: la monnaie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la monnaie*
- *Recall:* say the French for an address, then the French for a second, then say *la monnaie* again

Before you move on

What does la monnaie mean? (“Change (coins); currency”.) Say it once more.

135.3 la date — a date

Before the new one: say the French for a second, then the French for change.

You’ll want to know: la date

la date — “a date”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

date ← Late Latin *data*, “given”, the first word of a dated letter: “given at Rome on…” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la date*
- *Say it: la date*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la date*
- *Recall:* say the French for a second, then the French for change, then say *la date* again

Before you move on

What does la date mean? (“A date”.) Say it once more.

135.4 le siècle — a century

Before the new one: say the French for change, then the French for a date.

You'll want to know: le siècle

le siècle — "a century".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

siècle ← Church Latin *saeculum*, "a generation, an age" (Lewis & Short) — taken from Latin in a half-learned form.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le siècle*
- *Say it: le siècle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le siècle*
- *Recall:* say the French for change, then the French for a date, then say *le siècle* again

Before you move on

What does le siècle mean? ("A century".) Say it once more.

135.5 le courriel — an email

Before the new one: say the French for a date, then the French for a century.

You'll want to know: le courriel

le courriel — "an email".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

courriel — coined from *courrier électronique*, "electronic mail", in Quebec in the 1990s.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le courriel*
- *Say it: le courriel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le courriel*
- *Recall:* say the French for a date, then the French for a century, then say *le courriel* again

Before you move on

What does le courriel mean? ("An email".) Say it once more.

Chapter 136

Zero, Sixty, Seventy, Ninety, Thousand

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name zero, sixty, seventy, ninety, a thousand.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 136: I can name zero, sixty, seventy, ninety, a thousand.

136.1 zéro — zero

Before the new one: say the French for a century, then the French for an email.

You'll want to know: zéro

zéro — "zero".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zéro ← Italian *zero* ← Medieval Latin *zephirum*, from Arabic *sifr*, "empty" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zéro*
- *Say it:* *zéro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zéro*
- *Recall:* say the French for a century, then the French for an email, then say *zéro* again

Before you move on

What does zéro mean? ("Zero".) Say it once more.

136.2 soixante — sixty

Before the new one: say the French for an email, then the French for zero.

You'll want to know: soixante

soixante — "sixty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soixante ← Old French *soissante* ← Latin *sexaginta*, "sixty" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *soixante*
- *Say it:* *soixante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soixante*
- *Recall:* say the French for an email, then the French for zero, then say *soixante* again

Before you move on

What does soixante mean? (“Sixty”.) Say it once more.

136.3 soixante-dix — seventy

Before the new one: say the French for zero, then the French for sixty.

You’ll want to know: soixante-dix

soixante-dix — “seventy”. Literally “sixty-ten”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soixante-dix — “sixty-ten”: *soixante*, “sixty”, and *dix*, “ten”. France counts the seventies on from sixty. *Soixante* ← Latin *sexāgintā* and *dix* ← *decem*, both inherited (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soixante-dix*
- *Say it: soixante-dix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soixante-dix*
- *Recall:* say the French for zero, then the French for sixty, then say *soixante-dix* again

Before you move on

What does soixante-dix mean? (“Seventy”.) Say it once more.

136.4 quatre-vingt-dix — ninety

Before the new one: say the French for sixty, then the French for seventy.

You'll want to know: quatre-vingt-dix

quatre-vingt-dix — "ninety". Literally "four-twenties-ten".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quatre-vingt-dix — "four-twenties-ten": *quatre*, *vingt* and *dix*. Old French often counted in twenties. *Quatre* ← Latin *quattuor*, *vingt* ← *vīgintī*, *dix* ← *decem*, all inherited (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: quatre-vingt-dix*
- *Say it: quatre-vingt-dix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *quatre-vingt-dix*
- *Recall:* say the French for sixty, then the French for seventy, then say *quatre-vingt-dix* again

Before you move on

What does quatre-vingt-dix mean? ("Ninety".) Say it once more.

136.5 mille — a thousand

Before the new one: say the French for seventy, then the French for ninety.

You'll want to know: mille

mille — "a thousand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mille ← Latin *mille*, "a thousand" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mille*
- *Say it: mille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mille*
- *Recall:* say the French for seventy, then the French for ninety, then say *mille* again

Before you move on

What does mille mean? ("A thousand".) Say it once more.

Chapter 137

To begin, To visit (a place), To answer, To put, To believe

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to begin, to visit (a place), to answer, to put, to believe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 137: I can say to begin, to visit (a place), to answer, to put, to believe.*

137.1 commencer — to begin

> Before the new one: say the French for ninety, then the French for a thousand.

You'll want to know: commencer

commencer — "to begin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

commencer ← Old French *comencier* ← Vulgar Latin **cominitiare*, from *com-* and Latin *initiare*, "to begin" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: commencer*
- *Say it: commencer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *commencer*
- *Recall:* say the French for ninety, then the French for a thousand, then say *commencer* again

Before you move on

What does commencer mean? ("To begin".) Say it once more.

137.2 visiter — to visit (a place)

Before the new one: say the French for a thousand, then the French for to begin.

You'll want to know: visiter

visiter — "to visit (a place)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

visiter ← Latin *visitare*, "to go to see", from *videre*, "to see" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: visiter*
- *Say it: visiter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *visiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for a thousand, then the French for to begin, then say *visiter* again

Before you move on

What does visiter mean? (“To visit (a place)”.) Say it once more.

137.3 répondre — to answer

Before the new one: say the French for to begin, then the French for to visit.

You’ll want to know: répondre

répondre — “to answer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

répondre ← Old French *respondre* ← Latin *respondere*, “to answer, to pledge back” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: répondre*
- *Say it: répondre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *répondre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to begin, then the French for to visit, then say *répondre* again

Before you move on

What does répondre mean? (“To answer”.) Say it once more.

137.4 mettre — to put; to put on

Before the new one: say the French for to visit, then the French for to answer.

You'll want to know: mettre

mettre — "to put; to put on".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mettre ← Old French *metre* ← Latin *mittere*, "to send, to let go" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mettre*
- *Say it: mettre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to visit, then the French for to answer, then say *mettre* again

Before you move on

What does mettre mean? ("To put; to put on".) Say it once more.

137.5 croire — to believe

Before the new one: say the French for to answer, then the French for to put; to put on.

You'll want to know: croire

croire — "to believe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

croire ← Old French *creire* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *credere*, "to believe" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *croire*
- *Say it:* *croire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *croire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to answer, then the French for to put; to put on, then say *croire* again

Before you move on

What does croire mean? ("To believe".) Say it once more.

Chapter 138

To know (a person, a place), To prefer, To hope, To drive, To get dressed

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to know (a person, to prefer, to hope, to drive, to get dressed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 138: I can say to know (a person, to prefer, to hope, to drive, to get dressed.*

138.1 connaître — to know (a person, a place)

> Before the new one: say the French for to put; to put on, then the French for to believe.

You'll want to know: connaître

connaître — "to know (a person, a place)". **savoir** knows a fact; **connaître** knows a person or a place.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

connaître ← Old French *conoistre* ← Latin *cognoscere*, "to get to know" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) The circumflex marks a lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: connaître*
- *Say it: connaître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *connaître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put; to put on, then the French for to believe, then say *connaître* again

Before you move on

What does connaître mean? ("To know (a person, a place)".) Say it once more.

138.2 préférer — to prefer

Before the new one: say the French for to believe, then the French for to know.

You'll want to know: préférer

préférer — "to prefer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préférer ← Latin *praeferre*, "to carry before, to put first" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: préférer*
- *Say it: préférer*, once more

- *Say it:* say *préférer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to believe, then the French for to know, then say *préférer* again

Before you move on

What does préférer mean? (“To prefer”.) Say it once more.

138.3 espérer — to hope

Before the new one: say the French for to know, then the French for to prefer.

You’ll want to know: espérer

espérer — “to hope”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

espérer ← Latin *sperare*, “to hope” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, with an *e-* added in front of *sp-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: espérer*
- *Say it: espérer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *espérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to know, then the French for to prefer, then say *espérer* again

Before you move on

What does espérer mean? (“To hope”.) Say it once more.

138.4 conduire — to drive

Before the new one: say the French for to prefer, then the French for to hope.

You'll want to know: conduire

conduire — "to drive".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conduire ← Old French *conduire* ← Latin *conducere*, "to lead together" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: conduire*
- *Say it: conduire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *conduire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to prefer, then the French for to hope, then say *conduire* again

Before you move on

What does conduire mean? ("To drive".) Say it once more.

138.5 s'habiller — to get dressed

Before the new one: say the French for to hope, then the French for to drive.

You'll want to know: s'habiller

s'habiller — "to get dressed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'habiller ← Old French *abiller*, "to prepare, to trim" (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to the word for "a log"; its *h* and its sense of dressing came from the word for a garment, ← Latin *habitus*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'habiller*
- *Say it: s'habiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'habiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hope, then the French for to drive, then say *s'habiller* again

Before you move on

What does s'habiller mean? ("To get dressed".) Say it once more.

138.6 School and free time — a first pass

Say the words for to drive and to get dressed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- music, sport, a game, a film, a song
- a drawing, life, a time, a colour, a price; a prize
- pink, purple, brown, brown, pretty
- busy, free, open, closed, calm
- noisy, last, next, famous, funny

Before you move on

Music? (**la musique**.) Sport? (**le sport**.) A game? (**le jeu**.) A film? (**le film**.) A song? (**la chanson**.) A drawing? (**le dessin**.) Life? (**la vie**.) A time? (**la fois**.) A colour? (**la couleur**.) A price; a prize? (**le prix**.) Pink? (**rose**.) Purple? (**violet**.) Brown? (**marron**.) Brown? (**brun**.) Pretty? (**joli**.) Busy? (**occupé**.) Free? (**libre**.) Open? (**ouvert**.) Closed? (**fermé**.) Calm? (**calme**.) Noisy? (**bruyant**.) Last? (**dernier**.) Next? (**prochain**.) Famous? (**célèbre**.) Funny? (**drôle**.)

138.7 Describing words, time, numbers and verbs — a second pass

Say the words for nice and nasty.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nice, nasty, heat, a storm, fog
- grass, an ear, a lip, a number, an address
- a second, change, a date, a century, an email
- zero, sixty, seventy, ninety, a thousand
- to begin, to visit, to answer, to put; to put on, to believe
- to know, to prefer, to hope, to drive, to get dressed

Before you move on

Nice? (**sympathique**.) Nasty? (**méchant**.) Heat? (**la chaleur**.) A storm? (**l'orage**.) Fog? (**le brouillard**.) Grass? (**l'herbe**.) An ear? (**l'oreille**.) A lip? (**la lèvre**.) A number? (**le numéro**.) An address? (**l'adresse**.) A second? (**la seconde**.) Change? (**la monnaie**.) A date? (**la date**.) A century? (**le siècle**.) An email? (**le courriel**.) Zero? (**zéro**.) Sixty? (**soixante**.) Seventy? (**soixante-dix**.) Ninety? (**quatre-vingt-dix**.) A thousand?

(**mille**.) To begin? (**commencer**.) To visit? (**visiter**.) To answer? (**répondre**.) To put; to put on? (**mettre**.) To believe? (**croire**.) To know? (**connaître**.) To prefer? (**préférer**.) To hope? (**espérer**.) To drive? (**conduire**.) To get dressed? (**s'habiller**.)

Chapter 139

Nothing, None, Neither, Which One, Anything at All

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that there is nothing and none, ask which one, and answer "me neither".
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 139: I can say that there is nothing and none, ask which one, and answer "me neither".*

139.1 rien — nothing

Before the new one: say the French for to drive, then the French for to get dressed.

You'll want to know: rien

rien — "nothing". With a verb it takes **ne** in front: **Je ne comprends rien.** — "I understand nothing." On its own it answers a question: **Rien.**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rien ← Latin *rem*, "a thing", the accusative of *res* (Lewis & Short) — inherited: "a thing" became "anything", then, in negative sentences, "nothing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rien*
- *Say it: rien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rien*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drive, then the French for to get dressed, then say *rien* again

Before you move on

What does rien mean? ("Nothing".) Say it once more.

139.2 aucun / aucune — none, not a single

Before the new one: say the French for to get dressed, then the French for nothing.

You'll want to know: aucun / aucune

aucun / aucune — "none, not a single". It agrees with its noun and also takes **ne**: **Il n'y a aucun train lundi.** — "There is no train at all on Monday."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aucun ← Old French *alcun* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **alicunus*, from Latin *aliquis*, "someone", and *unus*, "one" — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aucun / aucune*
- *Say it: aucun / aucune*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aucun / aucune*

- *Recall:* say the French for to get dressed, then the French for nothing, then say *aucun / aucune* again

Before you move on

What does aucun / aucune mean? (“None, not a single”.) Say it once more.

139.3 non plus — neither, not either

Before the new one: say the French for nothing, then the French for none.

You’ll want to know: non plus

non plus — “neither, not either”. The answer to a negative: **Je ne travaille pas samedi.** — **Moi non plus.** — “Me neither.” After a yes, French says **moi aussi** instead.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

non plus — *non*, “no, not”, and *plus*, “more”, ← Latin *plus* (EtymDB 2.1): “not more”, that is, not either.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: non plus*
- *Say it: non plus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *non plus*
- *Recall:* say the French for nothing, then the French for none, then say *non plus* again

Before you move on

What does non plus mean? ("Neither, not either".) Say it once more.

139.4 lequel / laquelle — which one

Before the new one: say the French for none, then the French for neither.

You'll want to know: lequel / laquelle

lequel / laquelle — "which one". A question that picks from a set, and it agrees with what is picked: **Lequel ?** for a train, **Laquelle ?** for a chambre.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lequel — *le* and *quel*, "which", ← Latin *qualis*, "of what kind" (Lewis & Short): "the which".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lequel / laquelle*
- *Say it: lequel / laquelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lequel / laquelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for none, then the French for neither, then say *lequel / laquelle* again

Before you move on

What does lequel / laquelle mean? ("Which one".) Say it once more.

139.5 n'importe quoi — anything at all

Before the new one: say the French for neither, then the French for which one.

You'll want to know: n'importe quoi

n'importe quoi — "anything at all". **Je lis n'importe quoi.** — "I read anything at all." Said of what someone claims, it means "nonsense".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

n'importe quoi — "it does not matter what": *n'*, "not", the verb for "to matter", ← Italian *importare*, and *quoi*, "what".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: n'importe quoi*
- *Say it: n'importe quoi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *n'importe quoi*
- *Recall:* say the French for neither, then the French for which one, then say *n'importe quoi* again

Before you move on

What does n'importe quoi mean? ("Anything at all".) Say it once more.

Chapter 140

Already, Recently, the Day before Yesterday, Formerly, To Happen

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what happened, and when: already, recently, the day before yesterday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 140: I can say what happened, and when: already, recently, the day before yesterday.*

140.1 déjà — already

> Before the new one: say the French for which one, then the French for anything at all.

You'll want to know: déjà

déjà — "already". It sits between **avoir** and the participle: **J'ai déjà parlé.** — "I have already spoken."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déjà ← Middle French *desja*, from *des*, "from", and Old French *ja*, "now, already", ← Latin *iam* — the *ja* of *jamais*. (EtymDB 2.1 has the Middle French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: déjà*
- *Say it: déjà*, once more
- *Say it:* say *déjà*
- *Recall:* say the French for which one, then the French for anything at all, then say *déjà* again

Before you move on

What does déjà mean? ("Already".) Say it once more.

140.2 récemment — recently

Before the new one: say the French for anything at all, then the French for already.

You'll want to know: récemment

récemment — "recently". **Récemment, j'ai beaucoup lu.** — "Recently I have read a lot." The ending **-ment** makes an adverb, the way English uses -ly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

récemment — built from the word for "recent", ← Latin *recens*, *recentis* (Lewis & Short), with the adverb ending *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: récemment*
- *Say it: récemment*, once more
- *Say it:* say *récemment*

- *Recall:* say the French for anything at all, then the French for already, then say *récemment* again

Before you move on

What does récemment mean? ("Recently".) Say it once more.

140.3 avant-hier — the day before yesterday

Before the new one: say the French for already, then the French for recently.

You'll want to know: avant-hier

avant-hier — "the day before yesterday". One day further back than **hier**: **Avant-hier, j'ai écrit une lettre.** — "The day before yesterday I wrote a letter."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avant-hier — *avant*, "before", ← Late Latin *abante*, and *hier*, "yesterday". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: avant-hier*
- *Say it: avant-hier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avant-hier*
- *Recall:* say the French for already, then the French for recently, then say *avant-hier* again

Before you move on

What does avant-hier mean? ("The day before yesterday".) Say it once more.

140.4 autrefois — formerly, in the old days

Before the new one: say the French for recently, then the French for the day before yesterday.

You'll want to know: autrefois

autrefois — "formerly, in the old days". It points to a time long past rather than a single day: **Autrefois, le magasin était ici.** — "In the old days the shop was here."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

autrefois — "another time": the word for "other", ← Latin *alter*, and *fois*, "a time". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: autrefois*
- *Say it: autrefois*, once more
- *Say it:* say *autrefois*
- *Recall:* say the French for recently, then the French for the day before yesterday, then say *autrefois* again

Before you move on

What does autrefois mean? ("Formerly, in the old days".) Say it once more.

140.5 se produire — to happen, to occur

Before the new one: say the French for the day before yesterday, then the French for formerly.

You'll want to know: se produire

se produire — "to happen, to occur". Its past takes **être**, like **aller**: **Qu'est-ce qui s'est produit ?** — "What happened?"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se produire — "to produce itself": *produire* ← Latin *producere*, "to lead forward" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se produire*
- *Say it: se produire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se produire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the day before yesterday, then the French for formerly, then say *se produire* again

Before you move on

What does se produire mean? ("To happen, to occur".) Say it once more.

Chapter 141

The Future, This Evening, a Plan, To Foresee, To Organise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what will happen, and when: this evening, next week, in a year.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 141: I can say what will happen, and when: this evening, next week, in a year.

141.1 l'avenir — the future

Before the new one: say the French for formerly, then the French for to happen.

You'll want to know: l'avenir

l'avenir — "the future". French builds the future on the infinitive: **parler** becomes **je parlerai** — "I will speak" — then **tu parleras**, **il parlera**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avenir is the old verb *avenir*, "to come about", used as a noun: what is to come. It ← Latin *advenire*, "to come to", from *venire*, "to come". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avenir*
- *Say it: l'avenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'avenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for formerly, then the French for to happen, then say *l'avenir* again

Before you move on

What does l'avenir mean? ("The future".) Say it once more.

141.2 ce soir — this evening

Before the new one: say the French for to happen, then the French for the future.

You'll want to know: ce soir

ce soir — "this evening". The time word can stand first: **Ce soir, je travaillerai.** — "This evening I will work." **Dans** a length of time gives "in": **dans deux jours** — "in two days".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ce soir — *ce*, "this", ← Latin *ecce hoc*, "look, this" (Lewis & Short for *ecce*), and *soir*, "evening".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ce soir*
- *Say it: ce soir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ce soir*

- *Recall:* say the French for to happen, then the French for the future, then say *ce soir* again

Before you move on

What does ce soir mean? ("This evening".) Say it once more.

141.3 le projet — a plan, a project

Before the new one: say the French for the future, then the French for this evening.

You'll want to know: le projet

le projet — "a plan, a project". **Quels sont tes projets pour le week-end ?** — "What are your plans for the weekend?"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

projet — formed from the verb for "to throw forward", reshaped after Latin *proiectus*, "thrown forward" (EtymDB 2.1): a plan cast ahead.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le projet*
- *Say it: le projet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le projet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the future, then the French for this evening, then say *le projet* again

Before you move on

What does le projet mean? ("A plan, a project".) Say it once more.

141.4 prévoir — to foresee, to plan for

Before the new one: say the French for this evening, then the French for a plan.

You'll want to know: prévoir

prévoir — "to foresee, to plan for". **voir** with **pré-**, "before": seeing a thing before it comes. The future of **être** is irregular: **je serai**, **tu seras**, **il sera**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prévoir ← Old French *preveoir*, modelled on Latin *praevidere*, "to see beforehand", from *videre*, "to see". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prévoir*
- *Say it: prévoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prévoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for this evening, then the French for a plan, then say *prévoir* again

Before you move on

What does prévoir mean? ("To foresee, to plan for".) Say it once more.

141.5 organiser — to organise

Before the new one: say the French for a plan, then the French for to foresee.

You'll want to know: organiser

organiser — "to organise". A regular **-er** verb, so the future follows **parler**: **J'organiserai tout.** — "I will organise everything."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

organiser ← Medieval Latin *organizare*, from *organum*, "an instrument", from Greek *organon*, "a tool" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: organiser*
- *Say it: organiser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *organiser*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plan, then the French for to foresee, then say *organiser* again

Before you move on

What does organiser mean? ("To organise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 142

Opening Hours, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Bill

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read opening hours, a notice, an advert and a bill, and act on what they say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 142: I can read opening hours, a notice, an advert and a bill, and act on what they say.*

142.1 l'horaire — opening hours, a timetable

> Before the new one: say the French for to foresee, then the French for to organise.

You'll want to know: l'horaire

l'horaire — "opening hours, a timetable".

Read it: the door

The door says **Horaire : lundi – vendredi, 9 h – 18 h.** Open on weekdays from nine to six: not on **samedi**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

horaire ← Latin *horarius*, "of the hours", from *hora*, "hour", the Latin of *heure* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1 records *hora*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'horaire*
- *Say it: l'horaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'horaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to foresee, then the French for to organise, then say *l'horaire* again

Before you move on

What does l'horaire mean? ("Opening hours, a timetable".) Say it once more.

142.2 l'avis — a notice, an opinion

Before the new one: say the French for to organise, then the French for opening hours.

You'll want to know: l'avis

l'avis — "a notice, an opinion".

Read it: the notice

The notice says **Avis : le magasin est fermé aujourd'hui.** The shop is closed today, so come back another day.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avis ← Old French *avis*, built on *vis*, "a view", ← Latin *visus*, "a look" (EtymDB 2.1): how a matter looks to you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avis*
- *Say it: l'avis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'avis*
- *Recall:* say the French for to organise, then the French for opening hours, then say *l'avis* again

Before you move on

What does l'avis mean? ("A notice, an opinion".) Say it once more.

142.3 le loyer — the rent

Before the new one: say the French for opening hours, then the French for a notice.

You'll want to know: le loyer

le loyer — "the rent". The money for a **chambre**, paid every **mois**: **Le loyer est de 400 euros par mois.**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loyer ← Old French *loier* ← Latin *locarium*, "rent for a place", from *locus*, "a place" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le loyer*
- *Say it: le loyer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le loyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for opening hours, then the French for a notice, then say *le loyer* again

Before you move on

What does le loyer mean? ("The rent".) Say it once more.

142.4 l'annonce — an advert, an announcement

Before the new one: say the French for a notice, then the French for the rent.

You'll want to know: l'annonce

l'annonce — "an advert, an announcement".

Read it: the advert

The advert says **Chambre libre. Loyer : 400 euros.** A room is free, at 400 a month.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

annonce — formed from the verb for "to announce", ← Latin *annuntiare*, "to make known", from *nuntius*, "a messenger" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'annonce*
- *Say it: l'annonce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'annonce*
- *Recall:* say the French for a notice, then the French for the rent, then say *l'annonce* again

Before you move on

What does l'annonce mean? ("An advert, an announcement".) Say it once more.

142.5 la facture — a bill, an invoice

Before the new one: say the French for the rent, then the French for an advert.

You'll want to know: la facture

la facture — "a bill, an invoice".

Read it: the bill

The bill says **Facture : loyer, 400 euros. À payer avant lundi.** Pay it before Monday.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

facture ← Latin *factura*, "a making" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing; the bill is the account of work made.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la facture*
- *Say it: la facture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la facture*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rent, then the French for an advert, then say *la facture* again

Before you move on

What does la facture mean? ("A bill, an invoice".) Say it once more.

142.6 Saying no and looking back — a first pass

Say the words for an advert and a bill.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nothing, none, neither, which one, anything at all
- already, recently, the day before yesterday, formerly, to happen

Before you move on

Nothing? (**rien**.) None? (**aucun / aucune**.) Neither? (**non plus**.) Which one? (**lequel / laquelle**.) Anything at all? (**n'importe quoi**.) Already? (**déjà**.) Recently? (**récemment**.) The day before yesterday? (**avant-hier**.) Formerly? (**autrefois**.) To happen? (**se produire**.)

142.7 Looking ahead and reading notices — a second pass

Say the words for the future and this evening.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the future, this evening, a plan, to foresee, to organise
- opening hours, a notice, the rent, an advert, a bill

Before you move on

The future? (**l'avenir**.) This evening? (**ce soir**.) A plan? (**le projet**.) To foresee? (**prévoir**.) To organise? (**organiser**.) Opening hours? (**l'horaire**.) A notice? (**l'avis**.) The rent? (**le loyer**.) An advert? (**l'annonce**.) A bill? (**la facture**.)

Chapter 143

To switch on, To switch off, To jump, To smile, To shout

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to switch on, to switch off, to jump, to smile and to shout.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 143: I can say to switch on, to switch off, to jump, to smile and to shout.*

143.1 allumer — to switch on, to light

Before the new one: say the French for an advert, an announcement, then the French for a bill, an invoice.

You'll want to know: allumer

allumer — "to switch on, to light".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

allumer ← Old French *allumer* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **alluminare*, from Latin *lumen*, "light" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: allumer*
- *Say it: allumer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *allumer*
- *Recall:* say the French for an advert, an announcement, then the French for a bill, an invoice, then say *allumer* again

Before you move on

What does allumer mean? ("To switch on, to light".) Say it once more.

143.2 éteindre — to switch off, to put out

Before the new one: say the French for a bill, an invoice, then the French for to switch on.

You'll want to know: éteindre

éteindre — "to switch off, to put out".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éteindre ← Old French *esteindre* ← Latin *exstinguere*, "to put out" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: éteindre*
- *Say it: éteindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *éteindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bill, an invoice, then the French for to switch on, then say *éteindre* again

Before you move on

What does éteindre mean? ("To switch off, to put out".) Say it once more.

143.3 sauter — to jump

Before the new one: say the French for to switch on, then the French for to switch off.

You'll want to know: sauter

sauter — "to jump".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauter ← Latin *saltare*, "to dance, to leap" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: the *l* melted into a vowel.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sauter*
- *Say it: sauter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sauter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to switch on, then the French for to switch off, then say *sauter* again

Before you move on

What does sauter mean? ("To jump".) Say it once more.

143.4 sourire — to smile

Before the new one: say the French for to switch off, then the French for to jump.

You'll want to know: sourire

sourire — "to smile".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sourire ← Latin *subridere*, "to smile": *rire* with *sou-*, "under", in front (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sourire*
- *Say it: sourire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sourire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to switch off, then the French for to jump, then say *sourire* again

Before you move on

What does sourire mean? ("To smile".) Say it once more.

143.5 crier — to shout

Before the new one: say the French for to jump, then the French for to smile.

You'll want to know: crier

crier — "to shout".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crier ← Old French *crier* (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Latin *quiritare*, "to call for help" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *crier*
- *Say it:* *crier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *crier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to jump, then the French for to smile, then say *crier* again

Before you move on

What does crier mean? ("To shout".) Say it once more.

Chapter 144

To explain, To translate, To decide, To try, To continue

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to explain, to translate, to decide, to try and to continue.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 144: I can say to explain, to translate, to decide, to try and to continue.*

144.1 expliquer — to explain

> Before the new one: say the French for to smile, then the French for to shout.

You'll want to know: expliquer

expliquer — "to explain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

expliquer ← Latin *explicare*, "to unfold" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *expliquer*
- *Say it:* *expliquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *expliquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to smile, then the French for to shout, then say *expliquer* again

Before you move on

What does expliquer mean? (“To explain”.) Say it once more.

144.2 traduire — to translate

Before the new one: say the French for to shout, then the French for to explain.

You’ll want to know: traduire

traduire — “to translate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

traduire ← Latin *traducere*, “to lead across” (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing of the 1500s.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *traduire*
- *Say it:* *traduire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *traduire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to shout, then the French for to explain, then say *traduire* again

Before you move on

What does traduire mean? ("To translate".) Say it once more.

144.3 décider — to decide

Before the new one: say the French for to explain, then the French for to translate.

You'll want to know: décider

décider — "to decide".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décider ← Latin *decidere*, "to cut off, to settle" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: décider*
- *Say it: décider*, once more
- *Say it:* say *décider*
- *Recall:* say the French for to explain, then the French for to translate, then say *décider* again

Before you move on

What does décider mean? ("To decide".) Say it once more.

144.4 essayer — to try

Before the new one: say the French for to translate, then the French for to decide.

You'll want to know: essayer

essayer — "to try".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

essayer ← Vulgar Latin **exagiare*, from Late Latin *exagium*, "a weighing" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: to try was to weigh up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *essayer*
- *Say it:* *essayer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *essayer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to translate, then the French for to decide, then say *essayer* again

Before you move on

What does essayer mean? ("To try".) Say it once more.

144.5 continuer — to continue

Before the new one: say the French for to decide, then the French for to try.

You'll want to know: continuer

continuer — "to continue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

continuer ← Latin *continuare*, "to join together" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: continuer*
- *Say it: continuer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *continuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to decide, then the French for to try, then say *continuer* again

Before you move on

What does continuer mean? ("To continue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 145

To sign, To fill in a form, To phone, To discuss, To quarrel

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sign, to fill in a form, to phone, to discuss and to quarrel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 145: I can say to sign, to fill in a form, to phone, to discuss and to quarrel.*

145.1 signer — to sign

> Before the new one: say the French for to try, then the French for to continue.

You'll want to know: signer

signer — "to sign".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

signer ← Latin *signare*, "to mark", from *signum*, "a sign" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: signer*
- *Say it: signer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *signer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to try, then the French for to continue, then say *signer* again

Before you move on

What does signer mean? ("To sign".) Say it once more.

145.2 remplir un formulaire — to fill in a form

Before the new one: say the French for to continue, then the French for to sign.

You'll want to know: remplir un formulaire

remplir un formulaire — "to fill in a form".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remplir un formulaire — *remplir*, "to fill", is *re-* and Old French *emplir*, ← Latin *implere* (EtymDB 2.1); *un*, "a"; *formulaire*, "a form", ← Latin *formularium* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remplir un formulaire*
- *Say it: remplir un formulaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remplir un formulaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to continue, then the French for to sign, then say *remplir un formulaire* again

Before you move on

What does remplir un formulaire mean? ("To fill in a form".) Say it once more.

145.3 téléphoner — to phone

Before the new one: say the French for to sign, then the French for to fill in a form.

You'll want to know: téléphoner

téléphoner — "to phone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

téléphoner — formed from *téléphone* with the verb ending *-er*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: téléphoner*
- *Say it: téléphoner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *téléphoner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sign, then the French for to fill in a form, then say *téléphoner* again

Before you move on

What does téléphoner mean? ("To phone".) Say it once more.

145.4 discuter — to discuss

Before the new one: say the French for to fill in a form, then the French for to phone.

You'll want to know: discuter

discuter — "to discuss".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

discuter ← Latin *discutere*, "to shake apart" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing: to examine by taking apart.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *discuter*
- *Say it:* *discuter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *discuter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fill in a form, then the French for to phone, then say *discuter* again

Before you move on

What does discuter mean? ("To discuss".) Say it once more.

145.5 se disputer — to quarrel

Before the new one: say the French for to phone, then the French for to discuss.

You'll want to know: se disputer

se disputer — "to quarrel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se disputer ← Latin *disputare*, "to weigh up, to argue" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se disputer*
- *Say it: se disputer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se disputer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to phone, then the French for to discuss, then say *se disputer* again

Before you move on

What does se disputer mean? ("To quarrel".) Say it once more.

Chapter 146

To be bored, To have fun, To get angry, To worry, To smoke

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to be bored, to have fun, to get angry, to worry and to smoke.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 146: I can say to be bored, to have fun, to get angry, to worry and to smoke.*

146.1 s'ennuyer — to be bored

> Before the new one: say the French for to discuss, then the French for to quarrel.

You'll want to know: s'ennuyer

s'ennuyer — "to be bored".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'ennuyer ← Vulgar Latin **inodiare*, from Latin *in odio*, "in hatred" (Lewis & Short for *odium*) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'ennuyer*
- *Say it: s'ennuyer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'ennuyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to discuss, then the French for to quarrel, then say *s'ennuyer* again

Before you move on

What does s'ennuyer mean? ("To be bored".) Say it once more.

146.2 s'amuser — to have fun

Before the new one: say the French for to quarrel, then the French for to be bored.

You'll want to know: s'amuser

s'amuser — "to have fun".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'amuser ← Old French *amuser*, "to keep idle", built from *a-* and *muser*, "to gape, to dawdle". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'amuser*
- *Say it: s'amuser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'amuser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to quarrel, then the French for to be bored, then say *s'amuser* again

Before you move on

What does s'amuser mean? ("To have fun".) Say it once more.

146.3 se fâcher — to get angry

Before the new one: say the French for to be bored, then the French for to have fun.

You'll want to know: se fâcher

se fâcher — "to get angry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se fâcher — its origin is uncertain; the usual account derives it from Vulgar Latin **fasticare*, built on Latin *fastidium*, "disgust".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se fâcher*
- *Say it: se fâcher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se fâcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be bored, then the French for to have fun, then say *se fâcher* again

Before you move on

What does se fâcher mean? ("To get angry".) Say it once more.

146.4 s'inquiéter — to worry

Before the new one: say the French for to have fun, then the French for to get angry.

You'll want to know: s'inquiéter

s'inquiéter — "to worry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'inquiéter ← Latin *inquietare*, "to disturb", from *inquietus*, "restless" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'inquiéter*
- *Say it: s'inquiéter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'inquiéter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to have fun, then the French for to get angry, then say *s'inquiéter* again

Before you move on

What does s'inquiéter mean? ("To worry".) Say it once more.

146.5 fumer — to smoke

Before the new one: say the French for to get angry, then the French for to worry.

You'll want to know: fumer

fumer — "to smoke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fumer ← Latin *fumare*, "to smoke" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fumer*
- *Say it: fumer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fumer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get angry, then the French for to worry, then say *fumer* again

Before you move on

What does fumer mean? (“To smoke”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 147

To compare, To advise, To convince, To criticise, To prove

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to compare, to advise, to convince, to criticise and to prove.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 147: I can say to compare, to advise, to convince, to criticise and to prove.*

147.1 comparer — to compare

> Before the new one: say the French for to worry, then the French for to smoke.

You'll want to know: comparer

comparer — "to compare".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comparer ← Latin *comparare*, "to pair together", from *par*, "equal" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: comparer*
- *Say it: comparer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *comparer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to worry, then the French for to smoke, then say *comparer* again

Before you move on

What does comparer mean? ("To compare".) Say it once more.

147.2 conseiller — to advise

Before the new one: say the French for to smoke, then the French for to compare.

You'll want to know: conseiller

conseiller — "to advise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conseiller ← Old French *consellier* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *consiliari*, "to take counsel", from *consilium*, "advice" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: conseiller*
- *Say it: conseiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *conseiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to smoke, then the French for to compare, then say *conseiller* again

Before you move on

What does conseiller mean? ("To advise".) Say it once more.

147.3 convaincre — to convince

Before the new one: say the French for to compare, then the French for to advise.

You'll want to know: convaincre

convaincre — "to convince".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

convaincre ← Latin *convincere*, "to overcome, to prove wrong", from *vincere*, "to conquer" (Lewis & Short) — taken from Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: convaincre*
- *Say it: convaincre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *convaincre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to compare, then the French for to advise, then say *convaincre* again

Before you move on

What does convaincre mean? ("To convince".) Say it once more.

147.4 critiquer — to criticise

Before the new one: say the French for to advise, then the French for to convince.

You'll want to know: critiquer

critiquer — "to criticise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

critiquer — formed from the word for "criticism", ← Latin *criticus*, from Greek *kritikos*, "able to judge". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *critiquer*
- *Say it:* *critiquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *critiquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to advise, then the French for to convince, then say *critiquer* again

Before you move on

What does critiquer mean? ("To criticise".) Say it once more.

147.5 démontrer — to prove

Before the new one: say the French for to convince, then the French for to criticise.

You'll want to know: démontrer

démontrer — "to prove".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

démontrer ← Old French *demonstrer* ← Latin *demonstrare*, "to point out" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *montrer* with *dé-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: démontrer*
- *Say it: démontrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *démontrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to convince, then the French for to criticise, then say *démontrer* again

Before you move on

What does démontrer mean? ("To prove".) Say it once more.

Chapter 148

To observe, To take part, To go for a walk, To fold, To own

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to observe, to take part, to go for a walk, to fold and to own.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 148: I can say to observe, to take part, to go for a walk, to fold and to own.*

148.1 observer — to observe

> Before the new one: say the French for to criticise, then the French for to prove.

You'll want to know: observer

observer — "to observe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

observer ← Latin *observare*, "to watch, to heed" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: observer*
- *Say it: observer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *observer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to criticise, then the French for to prove, then say *observer* again

Before you move on

What does observer mean? ("To observe".) Say it once more.

148.2 participer — to take part

Before the new one: say the French for to prove, then the French for to observe.

You'll want to know: participer

participer — "to take part".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

participer ← Latin *participare*, "to share in", from *pars*, "a part", and *capere*, "to take" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: participer*
- *Say it: participer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *participer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to prove, then the French for to observe, then say *participer* again

Before you move on

What does participer mean? ("To take part".) Say it once more.

148.3 se promener — to go for a walk

Before the new one: say the French for to observe, then the French for to take part.

You'll want to know: se promener

se promener — "to go for a walk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se promener ← Old French *pormener*, "to lead around", built on *mener*, "to lead", ← Latin *minare*, "to drive cattle" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se promener*
- *Say it: se promener*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se promener*
- *Recall:* say the French for to observe, then the French for to take part, then say *se promener* again

Before you move on

What does se promener mean? ("To go for a walk".) Say it once more.

148.4 plier — to fold

Before the new one: say the French for to take part, then the French for to go for a walk.

You'll want to know: plier

plier — "to fold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plier ← Latin *plicare*, "to fold" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plier*
- *Say it: plier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to take part, then the French for to go for a walk, then say *plier* again

Before you move on

What does plier mean? ("To fold".) Say it once more.

148.5 posséder — to own

Before the new one: say the French for to go for a walk, then the French for to fold.

You'll want to know: posséder

posséder — "to own".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

posséder ← Latin *possidere*, "to hold, to own" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: posséder*
- *Say it: posséder*, once more
- *Say it:* say *posséder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go for a walk, then the French for to fold, then say *posséder* again

Before you move on

What does posséder mean? (“To own”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 149

To discover, To seem, To serve, To suffer, To dream

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to discover, to seem, to serve, to suffer and to dream.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 149: I can say to discover, to seem, to serve, to suffer and to dream.

149.1 découvrir — to discover

Before the new one: say the French for to fold, then the French for to own.

You'll want to know: découvrir

découvrir — "to discover".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

découvrir ← Old French *descovrir*, "to uncover", from *des-* and the verb for "to cover", ← Latin *cooperire*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: découvrir*
- *Say it: découvrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *découvrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fold, then the French for to own, then say *découvrir* again

Before you move on

What does découvrir mean? (“To discover”.) Say it once more.

149.2 sembler — to seem

Before the new one: say the French for to own, then the French for to discover.

You’ll want to know: sembler

sembler — “to seem”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sembler ← Late Latin *similare*, “to be like”, from *similis*, “like” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sembler*
- *Say it: sembler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sembler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to own, then the French for to discover, then say *sembler* again

Before you move on

What does sembler mean? (“To seem”.) Say it once more.

149.3 servir — to serve

Before the new one: say the French for to discover, then the French for to seem.

You’ll want to know: servir

servir — “to serve”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

servir ← Latin *servire*, “to be a servant”, from *servus*, “a slave” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: servir*
- *Say it: servir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *servir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to discover, then the French for to seem, then say *servir* again

Before you move on

What does servir mean? (“To serve”.) Say it once more.

149.4 souffrir — to suffer

Before the new one: say the French for to seem, then the French for to serve.

You'll want to know: souffrir

souffrir — "to suffer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souffrir ← Vulgar Latin **sufferire* ← Latin *sufferre*, "to bear up under" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: souffrir*
- *Say it: souffrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *souffrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to seem, then the French for to serve, then say *souffrir* again

Before you move on

What does souffrir mean? ("To suffer".) Say it once more.

149.5 rêver — to dream

Before the new one: say the French for to serve, then the French for to suffer.

You'll want to know: rêver

rêver — "to dream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rêver ← Old French *resver*, "to wander, to be delirious" (EtymDB 2.1), whose origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rêver*
- *Say it: rêver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rêver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to serve, then the French for to suffer, then say *rêver* again

Before you move on

What does rêver mean? ("To dream".) Say it once more.

Chapter 150

To move away, To come near, To chat, To plug in, To deliver

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to move away, to come near, to chat, to plug in and to deliver.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 150: I can say to move away, to come near, to chat, to plug in and to deliver.*

150.1 s'éloigner — to move away

> Before the new one: say the French for to suffer, then the French for to dream.

You'll want to know: s'éloigner

s'éloigner — "to move away".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'éloigner ← Old French *esloignier*, built on *loing*, "far", the old spelling of *loin* (EtymDB 2.1): to put far off.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'éloigner*
- *Say it: s'éloigner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'éloigner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to suffer, then the French for to dream, then say *s'éloigner* again

Before you move on

What does s'éloigner mean? ("To move away".) Say it once more.

150.2 s'approcher — to come near

Before the new one: say the French for to dream, then the French for to move away.

You'll want to know: s'approcher

s'approcher — "to come near".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'approcher ← Late Latin *appropiare*, "to draw near", from *prope*, "near", the Latin of *prochain* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'approcher*
- *Say it: s'approcher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'approcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dream, then the French for to move away, then say *s'approcher* again

Before you move on

What does s'approcher mean? ("To come near".) Say it once more.

150.3 bavarder — to chat

Before the new one: say the French for to move away, then the French for to come near.

You'll want to know: bavarder

bavarder — "to chat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bavarder — built from the word for "chatty", which comes from the word for "drool", probably imitative: to chatter is to slobber words.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bavarder*
- *Say it: bavarder*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bavarder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move away, then the French for to come near, then say *bavarder* again

Before you move on

What does bavarder mean? ("To chat".) Say it once more.

150.4 brancher — to plug in

Before the new one: say the French for to come near, then the French for to chat.

You'll want to know: brancher

brancher — "to plug in".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brancher — built from the word for "a branch", ← Late Latin *branca*, "a paw" (EtymDB 2.1): to join on like a branch.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: brancher*
- *Say it: brancher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brancher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to come near, then the French for to chat, then say *brancher* again

Before you move on

What does brancher mean? ("To plug in".) Say it once more.

150.5 livrer — to deliver

Before the new one: say the French for to chat, then the French for to plug in.

You'll want to know: livrer

livrer — "to deliver".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

livrer ← Latin *liberare*, "to set free", the Latin of *libre* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: to hand over was to release.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: livrer*
- *Say it: livrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *livrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to chat, then the French for to plug in, then say *livrer* again

Before you move on

What does livrer mean? ("To deliver".) Say it once more.

Chapter 151

To put up, To pray, To recommend, To slow down, To breathe

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to put up, to pray, to recommend, to slow down and to breathe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 151: I can say to put up, to pray, to recommend, to slow down and to breathe.*

151.1 héberger — to put up (a guest)

> Before the new one: say the French for to plug in, then the French for to deliver.

You'll want to know: héberger

héberger — "to put up (a guest)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

héberger ← Old French *herbergier*, "to shelter", a Germanic word: Old High German has *heribergan*, from *heri*, "army", and *bergan*, "to shelter" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: héberger*
- *Say it: héberger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *héberger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to plug in, then the French for to deliver, then say *héberger* again

Before you move on

What does héberger mean? ("To put up (a guest)".) Say it once more.

151.2 prier — to pray

Before the new one: say the French for to deliver, then the French for to put up.

You'll want to know: prier

prier — "to pray".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prier ← Old French *preier* ← Latin *precari*, "to pray, to beg" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prier*
- *Say it: prier*, once more

- *Say it:* say *prier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deliver, then the French for to put up, then say *prier* again

Before you move on

What does prier mean? (“To pray”.) Say it once more.

151.3 recommander — to recommend

Before the new one: say the French for to put up, then the French for to pray.

You’ll want to know: recommander

recommander — “to recommend”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recommander — built from *re-* and the verb for “to order, to entrust”, ← Vulgar Latin **commandare* ← Latin *commendare*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: recommander*
- *Say it: recommander*, once more
- *Say it:* say *recommander*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put up, then the French for to pray, then say *recommander* again

Before you move on

What does recommander mean? (“To recommend”.) Say it once more.

151.4 ralentir — to slow down

Before the new one: say the French for to pray, then the French for to recommend.

You'll want to know: ralentir

ralentir — "to slow down".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ralentir — built from *re-*, *a-* and the word for "slow", ← Latin *lentus*, "pliant, slow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ralentir*
- *Say it: ralentir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ralentir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pray, then the French for to recommend, then say *ralentir* again

Before you move on

What does ralentir mean? ("To slow down".) Say it once more.

151.5 respirer — to breathe

Before the new one: say the French for to recommend, then the French for to slow down.

You'll want to know: respirer

respirer — "to breathe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

respirer ← Latin *respirare*, "to breathe back, to breathe" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: respirer*
- *Say it: respirer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *respirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to recommend, then the French for to slow down, then say *respirer* again

Before you move on

What does respirer mean? ("To breathe".) Say it once more.

151.6 Words from chapters 143-146 — a first pass

Say the words for to slow down and to breathe.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to switch on, to switch off, to jump, to smile, to shout
- to explain, to translate, to decide, to try, to continue
- to sign, to fill in a form, to phone, to discuss, to quarrel
- to be bored, to have fun, to get angry, to worry, to smoke

Before you move on

To switch on? (**allumer**.) To switch off? (**éteindre**.) To jump? (**sauter**.) To smile? (**sourire**.) To shout? (**crier**.) To explain? (**expliquer**.) To translate? (**traduire**.) To decide? (**décider**.) To try? (**essayer**.) To continue? (**continuer**.) To sign? (**signer**.) To fill in a form? (**remplir un formulaire**.) To phone? (**téléphoner**.) To discuss? (**discuter**.) To quarrel? (**se disputer**.) To be bored? (**s'ennuyer**.) To have fun? (**s'amuser**.) To get angry? (**se fâcher**.) To worry? (**s'inquiéter**.) To smoke? (**fumer**.)

151.7 Words from chapters 147-151 — a second pass

Say the words for to compare and to advise.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to compare, to advise, to convince, to criticise, to prove
- to observe, to take part, to go for a walk, to fold, to own
- to discover, to seem, to serve, to suffer, to dream
- to move away, to come near, to chat, to plug in, to deliver
- to put up, to pray, to recommend, to slow down, to breathe

Before you move on

To compare? (**comparer**.) To advise? (**conseiller**.) To convince? (**convaincre**.) To criticise? (**critiquer**.) To prove? (**démontrer**.) To observe? (**observer**.) To take part? (**participer**.) To go for a walk? (**se promener**.) To fold? (**plier**.) To own? (**posséder**.) To discover? (**découvrir**.) To seem? (**sembler**.) To serve? (**servir**.) To suffer? (**souffrir**.) To dream? (**rêver**.) To move away? (**s'éloigner**.) To come near? (**s'approcher**.) To chat? (**bavarder**.) To plug in? (**brancher**.) To deliver? (**livrer**.) To put up? (**héberger**.) To pray? (**prier**.) To recommend? (**recommander**.)

To slow down? (**ralentir**.) To breathe? (**respirer**.)

Chapter 152

To admire, To act, To move forward, To move back, To lower

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to admire, to act, to move forward, to move back and to lower.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 152: I can say to admire, to act, to move forward, to move back and to lower.*

152.1 admirer — to admire

> Before the new one: say the French for to slow down, then the French for to breathe.

You'll want to know: admirer

admirer — "to admire".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

admirer ← Latin *admirari*, "to wonder at" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: admirer*
- *Say it: admirer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *admirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to slow down, then the French for to breathe, then say *admirer* again

Before you move on

What does admirer mean? ("To admire".) Say it once more.

152.2 agir — to act

Before the new one: say the French for to breathe, then the French for to admire.

You'll want to know: agir

agir — "to act".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agir ← Latin *agere*, "to do, to drive" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: agir*
- *Say it: agir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *agir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to breathe, then the French for to admire, then say *agir* again

Before you move on

What does agir mean? ("To act".) Say it once more.

152.3 avancer — to move forward

Before the new one: say the French for to admire, then the French for to act.

You'll want to know: avancer

avancer — "to move forward".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avancer ← Old French *avancer* ← Late Latin *abante*, "in front", from *ab* and *ante*, "before" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: avancer*
- *Say it: avancer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avancer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to admire, then the French for to act, then say *avancer* again

Before you move on

What does avancer mean? ("To move forward".) Say it once more.

152.4 reculer — to move back

Before the new one: say the French for to act, then the French for to move forward.

You'll want to know: reculer

reculer — "to move back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reculer — built from *re-*, "back", and the word for "backside", ← Latin *culus* (Lewis & Short): to go back rear first.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reculer*
- *Say it: reculer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reculer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to act, then the French for to move forward, then say *reculer* again

Before you move on

What does reculer mean? ("To move back".) Say it once more.

152.5 baisser — to lower

Before the new one: say the French for to move forward, then the French for to move back.

You'll want to know: baisser

baisser — "to lower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

baisser ← Vulgar Latin **bassiare*, from Late Latin *bassus*, "low" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baisser*
- *Say it: baisser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baisser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move forward, then the French for to move back, then say *baisser* again

Before you move on

What does baisser mean? ("To lower".) Say it once more.

Chapter 153

To notice, To replace, To meet, To blush, To bleed

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to notice, to replace, to meet, to blush and to bleed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 153: I can say to notice, to replace, to meet, to blush and to bleed.*

153.1 remarquer — to notice

Before the new one: say the French for to move back, then the French for to lower.

You'll want to know: remarquer

remarquer — "to notice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remarquer — built from *re-* and the verb for "to mark", whose noun came from a Germanic word for "a sign".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remarquer*
- *Say it: remarquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remarquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move back, then the French for to lower, then say *remarquer* again

Before you move on

What does remarquer mean? (“To notice”.) Say it once more.

153.2 remplacer — to replace

Before the new one: say the French for to lower, then the French for to notice.

You’ll want to know: remplacer

remplacer — “to replace”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remplacer — built from *re-*, *en-* and the word for “a place”, ← Latin *platea*, “a broad street” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remplacer*
- *Say it: remplacer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remplacer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lower, then the French for to notice, then say *remplacer* again

Before you move on

What does remplacer mean? ("To replace".) Say it once more.

153.3 rencontrer — to meet

Before the new one: say the French for to notice, then the French for to replace.

You'll want to know: rencontrer

rencontrer — "to meet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rencontrer — built from *re-* and Old French *encontrer*, "to meet", from *encontre*, "against", ← Latin *in contra* (Lewis & Short for *contra*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rencontrer*
- *Say it: rencontrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rencontrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to notice, then the French for to replace, then say *rencontrer* again

Before you move on

What does rencontrer mean? ("To meet".) Say it once more.

153.4 rougir — to blush

Before the new one: say the French for to replace, then the French for to meet.

You'll want to know: rougir

rougir — "to blush".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rougir — built from *rouge*, "red", with the verb ending *-ir*: to go red. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rougir*
- *Say it: rougir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rougir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to replace, then the French for to meet, then say *rougir* again

Before you move on

What does rougir mean? ("To blush".) Say it once more.

153.5 saigner — to bleed

Before the new one: say the French for to meet, then the French for to blush.

You'll want to know: saigner

saigner — "to bleed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

saigner ← Latin *sanguinare*, "to bleed", from *sanguis*, the Latin of *sang* (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: saigner*
- *Say it: saigner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *saigner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to meet, then the French for to blush, then say *saigner* again

Before you move on

What does saigner mean? ("To bleed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 154

Health, Brain, Lung, Liver, Kidney

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say health, the brain, a lung, the liver and a kidney.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 154: I can say health, the brain, a lung, the liver and a kidney.*

154.1 la santé — health

Before the new one: say the French for to blush, then the French for to bleed.

You'll want to know: la santé

la santé — "health".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

santé ← Old French *santé* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *sanitas*, *sanitatis*, "soundness of body", from *sanus*, "healthy" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la santé*
- *Say it: la santé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la santé*
- *Recall:* say the French for to blush, then the French for to bleed, then say *la santé* again

Before you move on

What does la santé mean? (“Health”.) Say it once more.

154.2 le cerveau — the brain

Before the new one: say the French for to bleed, then the French for health.

You’ll want to know: le cerveau

le cerveau — “the brain”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cerveau ← Old French *cervel* ← Latin *cerebellum*, “a little brain”, from *cerebrum*, “brain” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cerveau*
- *Say it: le cerveau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cerveau*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bleed, then the French for health, then say *le cerveau* again

Before you move on

What does le cerveau mean? ("The brain".) Say it once more.

154.3 le poumon — a lung

Before the new one: say the French for health, then the French for the brain.

You'll want to know: le poumon

le poumon — "a lung".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poumon ← Latin *pulmo*, *pulmonis*, "lung" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poumon*
- *Say it: le poumon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poumon*
- *Recall:* say the French for health, then the French for the brain, then say *le poumon* again

Before you move on

What does le poumon mean? ("A lung".) Say it once more.

154.4 le foie — the liver

Before the new one: say the French for the brain, then the French for a lung.

You'll want to know: le foie

le foie — "the liver".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

foie ← Late Latin *ficatum*, short for *iecur ficatum*, "liver fattened on figs", from *ficus*, "fig" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le foie*
- *Say it: le foie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le foie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the brain, then the French for a lung, then say *le foie* again

Before you move on

What does le foie mean? ("The liver".) Say it once more.

154.5 le rein — a kidney

Before the new one: say the French for a lung, then the French for the liver.

You'll want to know: le rein

le rein — "a kidney".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rein ← Old French *rein* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *renes*, "the kidneys" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rein*
- *Say it: le rein*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rein*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lung, then the French for the liver, then say *le rein* again

Before you move on

What does le rein mean? ("A kidney".) Say it once more.

Chapter 155

Rest, Sleep, Dream, Anxiety, Love

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rest, sleep, a dream, anxiety and love.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 155: I can say rest, sleep, a dream, anxiety and love.*

155.1 le repos — rest

> Before the new one: say the French for the liver, then the French for a kidney.

You'll want to know: le repos

le repos — "rest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

repos — formed from the verb for "to rest", ← Late Latin *repausare*, "to rest", from *pausare*, "to pause". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le repos*
- *Say it: le repos*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le repos*
- *Recall:* say the French for the liver, then the French for a kidney, then say *le repos* again

Before you move on

What does le repos mean? (“Rest”.) Say it once more.

155.2 le sommeil — sleep

Before the new one: say the French for a kidney, then the French for rest.

You’ll want to know: le sommeil

le sommeil — “sleep”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sommeil ← Vulgar Latin **somniculus*, “a little sleep”, from Latin *somnus*, “sleep” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sommeil*
- *Say it: le sommeil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sommeil*
- *Recall:* say the French for a kidney, then the French for rest, then say *le sommeil* again

Before you move on

What does le sommeil mean? (“Sleep”.) Say it once more.

155.3 le rêve — a dream

Before the new one: say the French for rest, then the French for sleep.

You’ll want to know: le rêve

le rêve — “a dream”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rêve — formed from *rêver*, “to dream”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rêve*
- *Say it: le rêve*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rêve*
- *Recall:* say the French for rest, then the French for sleep, then say *le rêve* again

Before you move on

What does le rêve mean? (“A dream”.) Say it once more.

155.4 l’angoisse — anxiety

Before the new one: say the French for sleep, then the French for a dream.

You'll want to know: l'angoisse

l'angoisse — "anxiety".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

angoisse ← Latin *angustia*, "narrowness, distress", from *angustus*, "narrow" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'angoisse*
- *Say it: l'angoisse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'angoisse*
- *Recall:* say the French for sleep, then the French for a dream, then say *l'angoisse* again

Before you move on

What does l'angoisse mean? ("Anxiety".) Say it once more.

155.5 l'amour — love

Before the new one: say the French for a dream, then the French for anxiety.

You'll want to know: l'amour

l'amour — "love".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amour ← Old French *amor* ← Latin *amor*, "love" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1). Its *-our*, where French usually has *-eur* as in *douleur*, is often put down to the love poetry of the south.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'amour*
- *Say it: l'amour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'amour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dream, then the French for anxiety, then say *l'amour* again

Before you move on

What does l'amour mean? ("Love".) Say it once more.

Chapter 156

Rarely, Afterwards, Finally, From now on, Still

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rarely, afterwards, finally, from now on and still.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 156: I can say rarely, afterwards, finally, from now on and still.*

156.1 rarement — rarely

Before the new one: say the French for anxiety, then the French for love.

You'll want to know: rarement

rarement — "rarely".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rarement — built from the word for "rare", ← Latin *rarus*, "thin, scattered" (Lewis & Short), with *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rarement*
- *Say it: rarement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rarement*
- *Recall:* say the French for anxiety, then the French for love, then say *rarement* again

Before you move on

What does rarement mean? ("Rarely".) Say it once more.

156.2 ensuite — afterwards, next

Before the new one: say the French for love, then the French for rarely.

You'll want to know: ensuite

ensuite — "afterwards, next".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ensuite — *en*, "in", and the word for "what follows", ← Vulgar Latin **sequita*, from Latin *sequi*, "to follow" (Lewis & Short): in what follows.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ensuite*
- *Say it: ensuite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ensuite*
- *Recall:* say the French for love, then the French for rarely, then say *ensuite* again

Before you move on

What does ensuite mean? ("Afterwards, next".) Say it once more.

156.3 enfin — finally

Before the new one: say the French for rarely, then the French for afterwards.

You'll want to know: enfin

enfin — "finally".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enfin — *en*, "in", and the word for "end", ← Latin *finis*, the *fin* of *finir*: in the end.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *enfin*
- *Say it:* *enfin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enfin*
- *Recall:* say the French for rarely, then the French for afterwards, then say *enfin* again

Before you move on

What does enfin mean? ("Finally".) Say it once more.

156.4 désormais — from now on

Before the new one: say the French for afterwards, then the French for finally.

You'll want to know: désormais

désormais — "from now on".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désormais — "from now on more": Old French *des*, "from", *ore*, "now", ← Latin *hora*, "hour", and *mais*, "more", ← Latin *magis* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: désormais*
- *Say it: désormais*, once more
- *Say it:* say *désormais*
- *Recall:* say the French for afterwards, then the French for finally, then say *désormais* again

Before you move on

What does désormais mean? ("From now on".) Say it once more.

156.5 encore — still, again

Before the new one: say the French for finally, then the French for from now on.

You'll want to know: encore

encore — "still, again".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

encore — its origin is not settled: the usual account takes it to Latin *hinc ad horam*, "from here to the hour", or *hanc horam*, "this hour".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *encore*
- *Say it:* *encore*, once more
- *Say it:* say *encore*
- *Recall:* say the French for finally, then the French for from now on, then say *encore* again

Before you move on

What does encore mean? ("Still, again".) Say it once more.

Chapter 157

Above, Below, In front, Behind, Beside

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say above, below, in front, behind and beside.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 157: I can say above, below, in front, behind and beside.*

157.1 au-dessus — above

Before the new one: say the French for from now on, then the French for still.

You'll want to know: au-dessus

au-dessus — "above".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au-dessus — *au*, "at the", and *dessus*, "on top". *Dessus* is *de* with Old French *sus*, "above", from Latin *sursum*, "upward".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: au-dessus*
- *Say it: au-dessus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *au-dessus*
- *Recall:* say the French for from now on, then the French for still, then say *au-dessus* again

Before you move on

What does au-dessus mean? ("Above".) Say it once more.

157.2 au-dessous — below

Before the new one: say the French for still, then the French for above.

You'll want to know: au-dessous

au-dessous — "below".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au-dessous — *au*, "at the", and *dessous*, "underneath". *Dessous* ← Latin *dē* + *subtus*, "below" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: au-dessous*
- *Say it: au-dessous*, once more
- *Say it:* say *au-dessous*
- *Recall:* say the French for still, then the French for above, then say *au-dessous* again

Before you move on

What does au-dessous mean? (“Below”.) Say it once more.

157.3 devant — in front

Before the new one: say the French for above, then the French for below.

You’ll want to know: devant

devant — “in front”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

devant — *de* and the word for “before”, ← Late Latin *abante*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: devant*
- *Say it: devant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *devant*
- *Recall:* say the French for above, then the French for below, then say *devant* again

Before you move on

What does devant mean? (“In front”.) Say it once more.

157.4 derrière — behind

Before the new one: say the French for below, then the French for in front.

You'll want to know: derrière

derrière — "behind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

derrière ← Late Latin *de retro*, "from behind" (Lewis & Short for *retro*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: derrière*
- *Say it: derrière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *derrière*
- *Recall:* say the French for below, then the French for in front, then say *derrière* again

Before you move on

What does derrière mean? ("Behind".) Say it once more.

157.5 à côté — beside

Before the new one: say the French for in front, then the French for behind.

You'll want to know: à côté

à côté — "beside".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à côté — *à*, "at", and *côté*, "side", ← Latin *costatum*, from *costa*, "a rib" (EtymDB 2.1): at the side, by the ribs.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: à côté*
- *Say it: à côté*, once more
- *Say it:* say *à côté*
- *Recall:* say the French for in front, then the French for behind, then say *à côté* again

Before you move on

What does à côté mean? ("Beside".) Say it once more.

Chapter 158

So, However, Anyway, On the contrary, Although

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say so, however, anyway, on the contrary and although.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 158: I can say so, however, anyway, on the contrary and although.

158.1 donc — so, therefore

Before the new one: say the French for behind, then the French for beside.

You'll want to know: donc

donc — "so, therefore".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

donc ← Late Latin *dunc*, "then, so" — inherited. How *dunc* was formed is debated; the usual account blends *tunc*, "then", with *dum*, "while". (EtymDB 2.1 has its Middle French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: donc*
- *Say it: donc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *donc*
- *Recall:* say the French for behind, then the French for beside, then say *donc* again

Before you move on

What does donc mean? ("So, therefore".) Say it once more.

158.2 pourtant — however, yet

Before the new one: say the French for beside, then the French for so.

You'll want to know: pourtant

pourtant — "however, yet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pourtant — the words for "for" and "so much", the second ← Latin *tantum* (Lewis & Short): "for all that".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pourtant*
- *Say it: pourtant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pourtant*
- *Recall:* say the French for beside, then the French for so, then say *pourtant* again

Before you move on

What does pourtant mean? (“However, yet”.) Say it once more.

158.3 de toute façon — anyway

Before the new one: say the French for so, then the French for however.

You’ll want to know: de toute façon

de toute façon — “anyway”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

de toute façon — *de*, “in, of”, *toute*, “every”, ← Latin *totus*, and *façon*, “a way”, ← Latin *factio*, *factionis*, “a making” (EtymDB 2.1): in every way.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: de toute façon*
- *Say it: de toute façon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *de toute façon*
- *Recall:* say the French for so, then the French for however, then say *de toute façon* again

Before you move on

What does de toute façon mean? (“Anyway”.) Say it once more.

158.4 au contraire — on the contrary

Before the new one: say the French for however, then the French for anyway.

You'll want to know: au contraire

au contraire — "on the contrary".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au contraire — *au*, "to the", and *contraire*, "opposite", ← Latin *contrarius*, "lying opposite" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: au contraire*
- *Say it: au contraire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *au contraire*
- *Recall:* say the French for however, then the French for anyway, then say *au contraire* again

Before you move on

What does au contraire mean? ("On the contrary".) Say it once more.

158.5 bien que — although

Before the new one: say the French for anyway, then the French for on the contrary.

You'll want to know: bien que

bien que — "although".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bien que — *bien*, "well", ← Latin *bene*, and *que*, "that" (EtymDB 2.1): "well that", granted that.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bien que*
- *Say it: bien que*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bien que*
- *Recall:* say the French for anyway, then the French for on the contrary, then say *bien que* again

Before you move on

What does bien que mean? ("Although".) Say it once more.

Chapter 159

Comfortable, Uncomfortable, Polite, Rude, Unpleasant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say comfortable, uncomfortable, polite, rude and unpleasant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 159: I can say comfortable, uncomfortable, polite, rude and unpleasant.*

159.1 confortable — comfortable

> Before the new one: say the French for on the contrary, then the French for although.

You'll want to know: confortable

confortable — "comfortable".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

confortable ← English *comfortable* — borrowed in the 1700s. English had built it on Old French *conforter*, "to strengthen", from Latin *fortis*, "strong" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: confortable*
- *Say it: confortable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *confortable*
- *Recall:* say the French for on the contrary, then the French for although, then say *confortable* again

Before you move on

What does confortable mean? ("Comfortable".) Say it once more.

159.2 inconfortable — uncomfortable

Before the new one: say the French for although, then the French for comfortable.

You'll want to know: inconfortable

inconfortable — "uncomfortable".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inconfortable — *in-*, "not", and *confortable*. *Confortable* is borrowed from English *comfortable*, built on Old French *conforter*, "to strengthen" (EtymDB 2.1); *in-* is Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inconfortable*
- *Say it: inconfortable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inconfortable*
- *Recall:* say the French for although, then the French for comfortable, then say *inconfortable* again

Before you move on

What does inconfortable mean? (“Uncomfortable”.) Say it once more.

159.3 poli / polie — polite

Before the new one: say the French for comfortable, then the French for uncomfortable.

You’ll want to know: poli / polie

poli / polie — “polite”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poli is the past participle of the verb for “to polish”, ← Latin *polire*, “to smooth” (EtymDB 2.1 gives *politus*, “polished”): good manners are polish.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poli / polie*
- *Say it: poli / polie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poli / polie*
- *Recall:* say the French for comfortable, then the French for uncomfortable, then say *poli / polie* again

Before you move on

What does poli / polie mean? (“Polite”.) Say it once more.

159.4 impoli / impolie — rude

Before the new one: say the French for uncomfortable, then the French for polite.

You'll want to know: impoli / impolie

impoli / impolie — "rude".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

impoli — *im-*, "not", and *poli*, "polite". *Poli* ← Latin *polītus*, "polished" (EtymDB 2.1), and *im-* is Latin *in-*, "not", before *p*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: impoli / impolie*
- *Say it: impoli / impolie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *impoli / impolie*
- *Recall:* say the French for uncomfortable, then the French for polite, then say *impoli / impolie* again

Before you move on

What does impoli / impolie mean? ("Rude".) Say it once more.

159.5 désagréable — unpleasant

Before the new one: say the French for polite, then the French for rude.

You'll want to know: désagréable

désagréable — "unpleasant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désagréable — *dés-*, "not", and the word for "pleasant", built on Old French *gré*, "liking", ← Latin *gratum*, "pleasing" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: désagréable*
- *Say it: désagréable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *désagréable*
- *Recall:* say the French for polite, then the French for rude, then say *désagréable* again

Before you move on

What does désagréable mean? ("Unpleasant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 160

Deep, Low, Unknown, Dangerous, Safe

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say deep, low, unknown, dangerous and safe.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 160: I can say deep, low, unknown, dangerous and safe.

160.1 profond / profonde — deep

Before the new one: say the French for rude, then the French for unpleasant.

You'll want to know: profond / profonde

profond / profonde — "deep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

profond ← Old French *profont* ← Latin *profundus*, "deep", from *pro* and *fundus*, "bottom" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: profond / profonde*
- *Say it: profond / profonde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *profond / profonde*
- *Recall:* say the French for rude, then the French for unpleasant, then say *profond / profonde* again

Before you move on

What does profond / profonde mean? (“Deep”.) Say it once more.

160.2 bas / basse — low

Before the new one: say the French for unpleasant, then the French for deep.

You’ll want to know: bas / basse

bas / basse — “low”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bas ← Late Latin *bassus*, “low, stout” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the adjective behind *baisser*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bas / basse*
- *Say it: bas / basse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bas / basse*
- *Recall:* say the French for unpleasant, then the French for deep, then say *bas / basse* again

Before you move on

What does bas / basse mean? (“Low”.) Say it once more.

160.3 inconnu / inconnue — unknown

Before the new one: say the French for deep, then the French for low.

You’ll want to know: inconnu / inconnue

inconnu / inconnue — “unknown”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inconnu — *in-*, “not”, and *connu*, the past participle of *connaître*: not known. *Connaître* ← Latin *cognōscere*, “to get to know” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inconnu / inconnue*
- *Say it: inconnu / inconnue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inconnu / inconnue*
- *Recall:* say the French for deep, then the French for low, then say *inconnu / inconnue* again

Before you move on

What does inconnu / inconnue mean? (“Unknown”.) Say it once more.

160.4 dangereux / dangereuse — dangerous

Before the new one: say the French for low, then the French for unknown.

You'll want to know: dangereux / dangereuse

dangereux / dangereuse — "dangerous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dangereux — built from the word for "danger", with *-eux* (EtymDB 2.1). That word was Old French *dangier*, "the power to harm", from Vulgar Latin **dominiarium*, built on *dominus*, "lord".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dangereux / dangereuse*
- *Say it: dangereux / dangereuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dangereux / dangereuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for low, then the French for unknown, then say *dangereux / dangereuse* again

Before you move on

What does dangereux / dangereuse mean? ("Dangerous".) Say it once more.

160.5 sûr / sûre — safe, sure

Before the new one: say the French for unknown, then the French for dangerous.

You'll want to know: sûr / sûre

sûr / sûre — "safe, sure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sûr ← Old French *seür* ← Latin *securus*, "free from care", from *se-*, "without", and *cura*, "care" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sûr / sûre*
- *Say it: sûr / sûre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sûr / sûre*
- *Recall:* say the French for unknown, then the French for dangerous, then say *sûr / sûre* again

Before you move on

What does sûr / sûre mean? ("Safe, sure".) Say it once more.

160.6 Words from chapters 152-155 — a first pass

Say the words for dangerous and safe.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to admire, to act, to move forward, to move back, to lower
- to notice, to replace, to meet, to blush, to bleed
- health, the brain, a lung, the liver, a kidney
- rest, sleep, a dream, anxiety, love

Before you move on

To admire? (**admirer**.) To act? (**agir**.) To move forward? (**avancer**.) To move back? (**reculer**.) To lower? (**baisser**.) To notice? (**remarquer**.) To replace? (**remplacer**.) To meet? (**rencontrer**.) To blush? (**rougir**.) To bleed? (**saigner**.) Health? (**la santé**.) The brain? (**le cerveau**.) A lung? (**le poumon**.) The liver? (**le foie**.) A kidney? (**le rein**.) Rest? (**le repos**.) Sleep? (**le sommeil**.) A dream? (**le rêve**.) Anxiety? (**l'angoisse**.) Love? (**l'amour**.)

160.7 Words from chapters 156-160 — a second pass

Say the words for rarely and afterwards.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- rarely, afterwards, finally, from now on, still
- above, below, in front, behind, beside
- so, however, anyway, on the contrary, although
- comfortable, uncomfortable, polite, rude, unpleasant
- deep, low, unknown, dangerous, safe

Before you move on

Rarely? (**rarement**.) Afterwards? (**ensuite**.) Finally? (**enfin**.) From now on? (**désormais**.) Still? (**encore**.) Above? (**au-dessus**.) Below? (**au-dessous**.) In front? (**devant**.) Behind? (**derrière**.) Beside? (**à côté**.) So? (**donc**.) However? (**pourtant**.) Anyway? (**de toute façon**.) On the contrary? (**au contraire**.) Although? (**bien que**.) Comfortable? (**confortable**.) Uncomfortable? (**inconfortable**.) Polite? (**poli / polie**.) Rude? (**impoli / impolie**.) Unpleasant? (**désagréable**.) Deep? (**profond / profonde**.) Low? (**bas / basse**.) Unknown? (**inconnu /**

inconnue.) Dangerous? (**dangereux / dangereuse**.) Safe? (**sûr / sûre**.)

Chapter 161

Modern, Former, Fresh, Spicy, Raw

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say modern, former, fresh, spicy and raw.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 161: I can say modern, former, fresh, spicy and raw.*

161.1 moderne — modern

> Before the new one: say the French for dangerous, then the French for safe, sure.

You'll want to know: moderne

moderne — "modern".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moderne ← Late Latin *modernus*, "of now", from *modo*, "lately" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: moderne*
- *Say it: moderne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *moderne*
- *Recall:* say the French for dangerous, then the French for safe, sure, then say *moderne* again

Before you move on

What does moderne mean? ("Modern".) Say it once more.

161.2 ancien / ancienne — former, ancient

Before the new one: say the French for safe, sure, then the French for modern.

You'll want to know: ancien / ancienne

ancien / ancienne — "former, ancient".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ancien ← Old French *ancien* ← Vulgar Latin **anteanus*, from Latin *ante*, "before" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ancien / ancienne*
- *Say it: ancien / ancienne*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ancien / ancienne*
- *Recall:* say the French for safe, sure, then the French for modern, then say *ancien / ancienne* again

Before you move on

What does ancien / ancienne mean? (“Former, ancient”.) Say it once more.

161.3 frais / fraîche — fresh, cool

Before the new one: say the French for modern, then the French for former.

You’ll want to know: frais / fraîche

frais / fraîche — “fresh, cool”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frais ← Old French *fres* ← Frankish **frisk*, “fresh” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: frais / fraîche*
- *Say it: frais / fraîche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *frais / fraîche*
- *Recall:* say the French for modern, then the French for former, then say *frais / fraîche* again

Before you move on

What does frais / fraîche mean? (“Fresh, cool”.) Say it once more.

161.4 épicé / épicée — spicy

Before the new one: say the French for former, then the French for fresh.

You'll want to know: épicé / épicée

épicé / épicée — "spicy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épicé is the past participle of the verb for "to spice", from the word for "spice", ← Latin *species*, "wares, spices" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: épicé / épicée*
- *Say it: épicé / épicée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *épicé / épicée*
- *Recall:* say the French for former, then the French for fresh, then say *épicé / épicée* again

Before you move on

What does épicé / épicée mean? ("Spicy".) Say it once more.

161.5 cru / crue — raw

Before the new one: say the French for fresh, then the French for spicy.

You'll want to know: cru / crue

cru / crue — "raw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cru ← Latin *crudus*, "raw, bloody" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cru / crue*
- *Say it: cru / crue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cru / crue*
- *Recall:* say the French for fresh, then the French for spicy, then say *cru / crue* again

Before you move on

What does cru / crue mean? (“Raw”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 162

Worried, With a cold, Single, Married, Divorced

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say worried, with a cold, single, married and divorced.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 162: I can say worried, with a cold, single, married and divorced.

162.1 inquiet / inquiète — worried

Before the new one: say the French for spicy, then the French for raw.

You'll want to know: inquiet / inquiète

inquiet / inquiète — "worried".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inquiet ← Latin *inquietus*, "restless", from *in-*, "not", and *quietus*, "calm" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inquiet / inquiète*
- *Say it: inquiet / inquiète*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inquiet / inquiète*
- *Recall:* say the French for spicy, then the French for raw, then say *inquiet / inquiète* again

Before you move on

What does inquiet / inquiète mean? ("Worried".) Say it once more.

162.2 enrhumé / enrhumée — with a cold

Before the new one: say the French for raw, then the French for worried.

You'll want to know: enrhumé / enrhumée

enrhumé / enrhumée — "with a cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enrhumé is the past participle of the verb for "to give a cold", built on the word for "a cold", ← Latin *rheuma*, from Greek *rheuma*, "a flow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: enrhumé / enrhumée*
- *Say it: enrhumé / enrhumée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enrhumé / enrhumée*
- *Recall:* say the French for raw, then the French for worried, then say *enrhumé / enrhumée* again

Before you move on

What does enrhumé / enrhumée mean? (“With a cold”.) Say it once more.

162.3 célibataire — single

Before the new one: say the French for worried, then the French for with a cold.

You’ll want to know: célibataire

célibataire — “single”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

célibataire — built from the word for “celibacy”, ← Latin *caelibatus*, from *caelebs*, “unmarried”, with *-aire*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: célibataire*
- *Say it: célibataire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *célibataire*
- *Recall:* say the French for worried, then the French for with a cold, then say *célibataire* again

Before you move on

What does célibataire mean? (“Single”.) Say it once more.

162.4 marié / mariée — married

Before the new one: say the French for with a cold, then the French for single.

You'll want to know: marié / mariée

marié / mariée — "married".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marié is the past participle of the verb for "to marry", ← Latin *maritare*, from *maritus*, the Latin of *mari* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: marié / mariée*
- *Say it: marié / mariée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *marié / mariée*
- *Recall:* say the French for with a cold, then the French for single, then say *marié / mariée* again

Before you move on

What does marié / mariée mean? ("Married".) Say it once more.

162.5 divorcé / divorcée — divorced

Before the new one: say the French for single, then the French for married.

You'll want to know: divorcé / divorcée

divorcé / divorcée — "divorced".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

divorcé is the past participle of the verb for "to divorce", from the noun, ← Latin *divortium*, "a separation" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: divorcé / divorcée*
- *Say it: divorcé / divorcée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *divorcé / divorcée*
- *Recall:* say the French for single, then the French for married, then say *divorcé / divorcée* again

Before you move on

What does divorcé / divorcée mean? ("Divorced".) Say it once more.

Chapter 163

Flat, Dining room, Balcony, Lock, Doorbell

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a flat, a dining room, a balcony, a lock and a doorbell.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 163: I can say a flat, a dining room, a balcony, a lock and a doorbell.

163.1 l'appartement — a flat

Before the new one: say the French for married, then the French for divorced.

You'll want to know: l'appartement

l'appartement — "a flat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

appartement ← Italian *appartamento* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed; built on Latin *ad* and *pars*, "a part": a set of rooms apart.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'appartement*
- *Say it: l'appartement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'appartement*
- *Recall:* say the French for married, then the French for divorced, then say *l'appartement* again

Before you move on

What does l'appartement mean? ("A flat".) Say it once more.

163.2 la salle à manger — a dining room

Before the new one: say the French for divorced, then the French for a flat.

You'll want to know: la salle à manger

la salle à manger — "a dining room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salle à manger — "room for eating": *salle*, "a room", *à*, "for", and *manger*, "to eat". *Salle* ← Frankish *sal*, "hall", *à* ← Latin *ad*, and *manger* ← Latin *manducāre*, "to chew" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salle à manger*
- *Say it: la salle à manger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la salle à manger*
- *Recall:* say the French for divorced, then the French for a flat, then say *la salle à manger* again

Before you move on

What does la salle à manger mean? (“A dining room”.) Say it once more.

163.3 le balcon — a balcony

Before the new one: say the French for a flat, then the French for a dining room.

You’ll want to know: le balcon

le balcon — “a balcony”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

balcon ← Italian *balcone*, from Lombardic **balko*, “a beam” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le balcon*
- *Say it: le balcon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le balcon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a flat, then the French for a dining room, then say *le balcon* again

Before you move on

What does le balcon mean? (“A balcony”.) Say it once more.

163.4 la serrure — a lock

Before the new one: say the French for a dining room, then the French for a balcony.

You'll want to know: la serrure

la serrure — "a lock".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serrure — built from the verb for "to squeeze, to shut", ← Late Latin *serare*, "to bolt", from *sera*, "a door bar" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la serrure*
- *Say it: la serrure*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la serrure*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dining room, then the French for a balcony, then say *la serrure* again

Before you move on

What does la serrure mean? ("A lock".) Say it once more.

163.5 la sonnette — a doorbell

Before the new one: say the French for a balcony, then the French for a lock.

You'll want to know: la sonnette

la sonnette — "a doorbell".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sonnette — built from the verb for "to ring", ← Latin *sonare*, "to sound", with *-ette*, "little". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sonnette*
- *Say it: la sonnette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la sonnette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a balcony, then the French for a lock, then say *la sonnette* again

Before you move on

What does la sonnette mean? ("A doorbell".) Say it once more.

Chapter 164

Passport, Customs, Booking, Butcher's, Large river

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a passport, customs, a booking, a butcher's and a large river.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 164: I can say a passport, customs, a booking, a butcher's and a large river.*

164.1 le passeport — a passport

> Before the new one: say the French for a lock, then the French for a doorbell.

You'll want to know: le passeport

le passeport — "a passport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

passeport — the verb for "to pass" and Old French *port*, "a harbour", ← Latin *portus*: leave to pass through a port. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le passeport*
- *Say it: le passeport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le passeport*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lock, then the French for a doorbell, then say *le passeport* again

Before you move on

What does le passeport mean? (“A passport”.) Say it once more.

164.2 la douane — customs

Before the new one: say the French for a doorbell, then the French for a passport.

You’ll want to know: la douane

la douane — “customs”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douane ← Old Italian *doana* ← Arabic *diwan*, “a register, an office”, from Persian — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la douane*
- *Say it: la douane*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la douane*
- *Recall:* say the French for a doorbell, then the French for a passport, then say *la douane* again

Before you move on

What does la douane mean? (“Customs”.) Say it once more.

164.3 la réservation — a booking

Before the new one: say the French for a passport, then the French for customs.

You’ll want to know: la réservation

la réservation — “a booking”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réservation — built from the verb for “to book”, ← Latin *reservare*, “to keep back” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réservation*
- *Say it: la réservation*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la réservation*
- *Recall:* say the French for a passport, then the French for customs, then say *la réservation* again

Before you move on

What does la réservation mean? (“A booking”.) Say it once more.

164.4 la boucherie — a butcher’s

Before the new one: say the French for customs, then the French for a booking.

You'll want to know: la boucherie

la boucherie — "a butcher's".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boucherie — built from the word for "butcher", with *-ie*. The butcher was first a seller of goat's meat, from the word for "he-goat". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boucherie*
- *Say it: la boucherie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boucherie*
- *Recall:* say the French for customs, then the French for a booking, then say *la boucherie* again

Before you move on

What does la boucherie mean? ("A butcher's".) Say it once more.

164.5 le fleuve — a large river

Before the new one: say the French for a booking, then the French for a butcher's.

You'll want to know: le fleuve

le fleuve — "a large river".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fleuve ← Middle French *fleuve* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *fluvius*, "a river" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fleuve*
- *Say it: le fleuve*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fleuve*
- *Recall:* say the French for a booking, then the French for a butcher's, then say *le fleuve* again

Before you move on

What does le fleuve mean? ("A large river".) Say it once more.

Chapter 165

War, Peace, Army, Soldier, Tradition

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say war, peace, an army, a soldier and a tradition.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 165: I can say war, peace, an army, a soldier and a tradition.*

165.1 la guerre — war

Before the new one: say the French for a butcher's, then the French for a large river.

You'll want to know: la guerre

la guerre — "war".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guerre ← Old French *guerre* ← Medieval Latin *werra* (EtymDB 2.1), from Frankish **werra*, "strife" — borrowed from the Franks; Germanic *w-* became French *gu-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la guerre*
- *Say it: la guerre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la guerre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a butcher's, then the French for a large river, then say *la guerre* again

Before you move on

What does la guerre mean? ("War".) Say it once more.

165.2 la paix — peace

Before the new one: say the French for a large river, then the French for war.

You'll want to know: la paix

la paix — "peace".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

paix ← Old French *pais* ← Latin *pax*, *pacis*, "peace" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the *pax* behind *payer*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la paix*
- *Say it: la paix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la paix*
- *Recall:* say the French for a large river, then the French for war, then say *la paix* again

Before you move on

What does la paix mean? (“Peace”.) Say it once more.

165.3 l’armée — an army

Before the new one: say the French for war, then the French for peace.

You’ll want to know: l’armée

l’armée — “an army”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

armée is the past participle of the verb for “to arm”, used as a noun: a force that is armed. (EtymDB 2.1 links it to Medieval Latin *armata*, “an armed force”.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’armée*
- *Say it: l’armée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’armée*
- *Recall:* say the French for war, then the French for peace, then say *l’armée* again

Before you move on

What does l’armée mean? (“An army”.) Say it once more.

165.4 le soldat — a soldier

Before the new one: say the French for peace, then the French for an army.

You'll want to know: le soldat

le soldat — "a soldier".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soldat ← Italian *soldato*, "one who is paid", from *soldo*, "pay", ← Late Latin *solidus*, a gold coin — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le soldat*
- *Say it: le soldat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le soldat*
- *Recall:* say the French for peace, then the French for an army, then say *le soldat* again

Before you move on

What does le soldat mean? ("A soldier".) Say it once more.

165.5 la tradition — a tradition

Before the new one: say the French for an army, then the French for a soldier.

You'll want to know: la tradition

la tradition — "a tradition".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tradition ← Old French *tradicion* ← Latin *traditio*, "a handing over" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tradition*
- *Say it: la tradition*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tradition*
- *Recall:* say the French for an army, then the French for a soldier, then say *la tradition* again

Before you move on

What does la tradition mean? ("A tradition".) Say it once more.

Chapter 166

Photographer, Journalist, Architect, Dentist, Pharmacist

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a photographer, a journalist, an architect, a dentist and a pharmacist.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 166: I can say a photographer, a journalist, an architect, a dentist and a pharmacist.

166.1 le photographe — a photographer

Before the new one: say the French for a soldier, then the French for a tradition.

You'll want to know: le photographe

le photographe — "a photographer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

photographe — built like *photo*, from Greek *phos*, *photos*, "light", and *graphein*, "to write": one who writes with light.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le photographe*
- *Say it: le photographe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le photographe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a soldier, then the French for a tradition, then say *le photographe* again

Before you move on

What does le photographe mean? (“A photographer”.) Say it once more.

166.2 le journaliste — a journalist

Before the new one: say the French for a tradition, then the French for a photographer.

You’ll want to know: le journaliste

le journaliste — “a journalist”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

journaliste — built from the word for “a newspaper”, itself built on *jour*, “day”: a daily record.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le journaliste*
- *Say it: le journaliste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le journaliste*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tradition, then the French for a photographer, then say *le journaliste* again

Before you move on

What does le journaliste mean? ("A journalist".) Say it once more.

166.3 l'architecte — an architect

Before the new one: say the French for a photographer, then the French for a journalist.

You'll want to know: l'architecte

l'architecte — "an architect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

architecte ← Latin *architectus*, from Greek *architekton*, "chief builder" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'architecte*
- *Say it: l'architecte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'architecte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a photographer, then the French for a journalist, then say *l'architecte* again

Before you move on

What does l'architecte mean? ("An architect".) Say it once more.

166.4 le dentiste — a dentist

Before the new one: say the French for a journalist, then the French for an architect.

You'll want to know: le dentiste

le dentiste — "a dentist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dentiste — *dent*, "tooth", with *-iste*, "one who works with". *Dent* ← Latin *dentem*, "tooth" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dentiste*
- *Say it: le dentiste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dentiste*
- *Recall:* say the French for a journalist, then the French for an architect, then say *le dentiste* again

Before you move on

What does le dentiste mean? ("A dentist".) Say it once more.

166.5 le pharmacien — a pharmacist

Before the new one: say the French for an architect, then the French for a dentist.

You'll want to know: le pharmacien

le pharmacien — "a pharmacist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pharmacien — *pharmacie* with *-ien*, "one who works in". *Pharmacie* ← Medieval Latin *pharmacia*, from Greek (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pharmacien*
- *Say it: le pharmacien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pharmacien*
- *Recall:* say the French for an architect, then the French for a dentist, then say *le pharmacien* again

Before you move on

What does le pharmacien mean? ("A pharmacist".) Say it once more.

Chapter 167

Mother-in-law, Son-in-law, Daughter-in-law, Fiancé, Fiancée

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a mother-in-law, a son-in-law, a daughter-in-law, a fiancé and a fiancée.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 167: I can say a mother-in-law, a son-in-law, a daughter-in-law, a fiancé and a fiancée.*

167.1 la belle-mère — a mother-in-law

> Before the new one: say the French for a dentist, then the French for a pharmacist.

You'll want to know: la belle-mère

la belle-mère — "a mother-in-law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

belle-mère — the feminine of the word for "beautiful", ← Latin *bella*, used as a courtesy, and *mère*, "mother".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la belle-mère*
- *Say it: la belle-mère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la belle-mère*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dentist, then the French for a pharmacist, then say *la belle-mère* again

Before you move on

What does la belle-mère mean? ("A mother-in-law".) Say it once more.

167.2 le gendre — a son-in-law

Before the new one: say the French for a pharmacist, then the French for a mother-in-law.

You'll want to know: le gendre

le gendre — "a son-in-law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gendre ← Latin *gener*, "son-in-law" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; French slipped a *d* between *n* and *r*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gendre*
- *Say it: le gendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le gendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pharmacist, then the French for a mother-in-law, then say *le gendre* again

Before you move on

What does le gendre mean? ("A son-in-law".) Say it once more.

167.3 la belle-fille — a daughter-in-law

Before the new one: say the French for a mother-in-law, then the French for a son-in-law.

You'll want to know: la belle-fille

la belle-fille — "a daughter-in-law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

belle-fille — the feminine of the word for "beautiful", ← Latin *bella*, used as a courtesy, and *fille*, "daughter".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la belle-fille*
- *Say it: la belle-fille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la belle-fille*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mother-in-law, then the French for a son-in-law, then say *la belle-fille* again

Before you move on

What does la belle-fille mean? ("A daughter-in-law".) Say it once more.

167.4 le fiancé — a fiancé

Before the new one: say the French for a son-in-law, then the French for a daughter-in-law.

You'll want to know: le fiancé

le fiancé — "a fiancé".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fiancé is the past participle of the verb for "to betroth", built on Old French *fiance*, "a promise", from Vulgar Latin **fidare*, "to trust", from Latin *fides*, "faith" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fiancé*
- *Say it: le fiancé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fiancé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a son-in-law, then the French for a daughter-in-law, then say *le fiancé* again

Before you move on

What does le fiancé mean? ("A fiancé".) Say it once more.

167.5 la fiancée — a fiancée

Before the new one: say the French for a daughter-in-law, then the French for a fiancé.

You'll want to know: la fiancée

la fiancée — "a fiancée".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fiancée is the feminine of *fiancé*: the woman promised in marriage. *Fiancé* comes from Old French *fiance*, "a promise", from the Latin family of *fidēs*, "faith".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fiancée*
- *Say it: la fiancée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fiancée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a daughter-in-law, then the French for a fiancé, then say *la fiancée* again

Before you move on

What does la fiancée mean? ("A fiancée".) Say it once more.

Chapter 168

Rule, Permission, Ban, Safety, Advice

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a rule, permission, a ban, safety and advice.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 168: I can say a rule, permission, a ban, safety and advice.

168.1 la règle — a rule

Before the new one: say the French for a fiancé, then the French for a fiancée.

You'll want to know: la règle

la règle — "a rule".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

règle ← Latin *regula*, "a straight stick, a rule", from *regere*, "to guide" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la règle*
- *Say it: la règle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la règle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fiancé, then the French for a fiancée, then say *la règle* again

Before you move on

What does la règle mean? ("A rule".) Say it once more.

168.2 la permission — permission

Before the new one: say the French for a fiancée, then the French for a rule.

You'll want to know: la permission

la permission — "permission".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

permission ← Latin *permissio*, "a letting go, leave", from *permittere* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la permission*
- *Say it: la permission*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la permission*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fiancée, then the French for a rule, then say *la permission* again

Before you move on

What does la permission mean? ("Permission".) Say it once more.

168.3 l'interdiction — a ban

Before the new one: say the French for a rule, then the French for permission.

You'll want to know: l'interdiction

l'interdiction — "a ban".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interdiction ← Latin *interdictio*, "a forbidding", from *interdicere* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'interdiction*
- *Say it: l'interdiction*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'interdiction*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rule, then the French for permission, then say *l'interdiction* again

Before you move on

What does l'interdiction mean? ("A ban".) Say it once more.

168.4 la sécurité — safety

Before the new one: say the French for permission, then the French for a ban.

You'll want to know: la sécurité

la sécurité — "safety".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sécurité ← Latin *securitas*, "freedom from care", from *securus* (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing; the same *securus* wore down into *sûr*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sécurité*
- *Say it: la sécurité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la sécurité*
- *Recall:* say the French for permission, then the French for a ban, then say *la sécurité* again

Before you move on

What does la sécurité mean? ("Safety".) Say it once more.

168.5 le conseil — advice

Before the new one: say the French for a ban, then the French for safety.

You'll want to know: le conseil

le conseil — "advice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conseil ← Old French *conseil* ← Latin *consilium*, "advice, a plan, a council" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le conseil*
- *Say it: le conseil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le conseil*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ban, then the French for safety, then say *le conseil* again

Before you move on

What does le conseil mean? ("Advice".) Say it once more.

Chapter 169

Postcard, Folder, Pay slip, Label, Guide

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a postcard, a folder, a pay slip, a label and a guide.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 169: I can say a postcard, a folder, a pay slip, a label and a guide.*

169.1 la carte postale — a postcard

Before the new one: say the French for safety, then the French for advice.

You'll want to know: la carte postale

la carte postale — "a postcard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carte postale — "postal card": *carte*, "card", and the adjective made from *poste*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carte postale*
- *Say it: la carte postale*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carte postale*
- *Recall:* say the French for safety, then the French for advice, then say *la carte postale* again

Before you move on

What does la carte postale mean? ("A postcard".) Say it once more.

169.2 le dossier — a folder, a file

Before the new one: say the French for advice, then the French for a postcard.

You'll want to know: le dossier

le dossier — "a folder, a file".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dossier — built from the word for "back", ← Latin *dorsum* (Lewis & Short), with *-ier*: a bundle labelled on its back.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dossier*
- *Say it: le dossier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dossier*
- *Recall:* say the French for advice, then the French for a postcard, then say *le dossier* again

Before you move on

What does le dossier mean? (“A folder, a file”.) Say it once more.

169.3 la fiche de paie — a pay slip

Before the new one: say the French for a postcard, then the French for a folder.

You’ll want to know: la fiche de paie

la fiche de paie — “a pay slip”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fiche de paie — “slip of pay”: *fiche*, “a slip, a peg”, from the verb for “to fix” (EtymDB 2.1); *de*, “of”; and *paie*, “pay”, from *payer*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fiche de paie*
- *Say it: la fiche de paie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fiche de paie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a postcard, then the French for a folder, then say *la fiche de paie* again

Before you move on

What does la fiche de paie mean? (“A pay slip”.) Say it once more.

169.4 l’étiquette — a label

Before the new one: say the French for a folder, then the French for a pay slip.

You'll want to know: l'étiquette

l'étiquette — "a label".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étiquette ← Old French *estiquette*, "a note stuck on", from *estechier*, "to stick, to attach", a Germanic word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étiquette*
- *Say it: l'étiquette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étiquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a folder, then the French for a pay slip, then say *l'étiquette* again

Before you move on

What does l'étiquette mean? ("A label".) Say it once more.

169.5 le guide — a guide, a guidebook

Before the new one: say the French for a pay slip, then the French for a label.

You'll want to know: le guide

le guide — "a guide, a guidebook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guide ← Old Provençal *guida*, from *guidar*, "to guide", from Frankish **witan*, "to show the way" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le guide*
- *Say it: le guide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le guide*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pay slip, then the French for a label, then say *le guide* again

Before you move on

What does le guide mean? ("A guide, a guidebook".) Say it once more.

169.6 Words from chapters 161-164 — a first pass

Say the words for a label and a guide.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- modern, former, fresh, spicy, raw
- worried, with a cold, single, married, divorced
- a flat, a dining room, a balcony, a lock, a doorbell
- a passport, customs, a booking, a butcher's, a large river

Before you move on

Modern? (**moderne**.) Former? (**ancien / ancienne**.) Fresh? (**frais / fraîche**.) Spicy? (**épicé / épicée**.) Raw? (**cru / crue**.) Worried? (**inquiet / inquiète**.) With a cold? (**enrhumé / enrhumée**.) Single? (**célibataire**.) Married? (**marié / mariée**.)

Divorced? (**divorcé / divorcée**.) A flat? (**l'appartement**.) A dining room? (**la salle à manger**.) A balcony? (**le balcon**.) A lock? (**la serrure**.) A doorbell? (**la sonnette**.) A passport? (**le passeport**.) Customs? (**la douane**.) A booking? (**la réservation**.) A butcher's? (**la boucherie**.) A large river? (**le fleuve**.)

169.7 Words from chapters 165-169 — a second pass

Say the words for war and peace.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- war, peace, an army, a soldier, a tradition
- a photographer, a journalist, an architect, a dentist, a pharmacist
- a mother-in-law, a son-in-law, a daughter-in-law, a fiancé, a fiancée
- a rule, permission, a ban, safety, advice
- a postcard, a folder, a pay slip, a label, a guide

Before you move on

War? (**la guerre**.) Peace? (**la paix**.) An army? (**l'armée**.) A soldier? (**le soldat**.) A tradition? (**la tradition**.) A photographer? (**le photographe**.) A journalist? (**le journaliste**.) An architect? (**l'architecte**.) A dentist? (**le dentiste**.) A pharmacist? (**le pharmacien**.) A mother-in-law? (**la belle-mère**.) A son-in-law? (**le gendre**.) A daughter-in-law? (**la belle-fille**.) A fiancé? (**le fiancé**.) A fiancée? (**la fiancée**.) A rule? (**la règle**.) Permission? (**la permission**.) A ban? (**l'interdiction**.) Safety? (**la sécurité**.) Advice? (**le conseil**.) A postcard? (**la carte postale**.) A folder? (**le dossier**.) A pay slip? (**la fiche de paie**.) A label? (**l'étiquette**.) A guide? (**le guide**.)

Chapter 170

Castle, Tower, Monument, Statue, Fountain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a castle, a tower, a monument, a statue and a fountain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 170: I can say a castle, a tower, a monument, a statue and a fountain.*

170.1 le château — a castle

Before the new one: say the French for a label, then the French for a guide, a guidebook.

You'll want to know: le château

le château — "a castle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

château ← Old French *chastel* ← Latin *castellum*, "a fort" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *ca-* became *cha-*, and the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le château*
- *Say it: le château*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le château*
- *Recall:* say the French for a label, then the French for a guide, a guidebook, then say *le château* again

Before you move on

What does le château mean? (“A castle”.) Say it once more.

170.2 la tour — a tower

Before the new one: say the French for a guide, a guidebook, then the French for a castle.

You’ll want to know: la tour

la tour — “a tower”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tour ← Old French *tor* ← Latin *turris*, “a tower”, from Greek — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tour*
- *Say it: la tour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la tour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a guide, a guidebook, then the French for a castle, then say *la tour* again

Before you move on

What does la tour mean? (“A tower”.) Say it once more.

170.3 le monument — a monument

Before the new one: say the French for a castle, then the French for a tower.

You’ll want to know: le monument

le monument — “a monument”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

monument ← Latin *monumentum*, “a memorial”, from *monere*, “to remind” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le monument*
- *Say it: le monument*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le monument*
- *Recall:* say the French for a castle, then the French for a tower, then say *le monument* again

Before you move on

What does le monument mean? (“A monument”.) Say it once more.

170.4 la statue — a statue

Before the new one: say the French for a tower, then the French for a monument.

You'll want to know: la statue

la statue — "a statue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

statue ← Latin *statua*, "a standing image", from *stare*, "to stand" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la statue*
- *Say it: la statue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la statue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tower, then the French for a monument, then say *la statue* again

Before you move on

What does la statue mean? ("A statue".) Say it once more.

170.5 la fontaine — a fountain

Before the new one: say the French for a monument, then the French for a statue.

You'll want to know: la fontaine

la fontaine — "a fountain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fontaine ← Late Latin *fontana*, from *fons*, *fontis*, "a spring" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fontaine*
- *Say it: la fontaine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fontaine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a monument, then the French for a statue, then say *la fontaine* again

Before you move on

What does la fontaine mean? ("A fountain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 171

Volcano, Plain, Waterfall, Rock, Pebble

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a volcano, a plain, a waterfall, a rock and a pebble.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 171: I can say a volcano, a plain, a waterfall, a rock and a pebble.*

171.1 le volcan — a volcano

> Before the new one: say the French for a statue, then the French for a fountain.

You'll want to know: le volcan

le volcan — "a volcano".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

volcan ← Italian *vulcano*, from Latin *Vulcanus*, the god of fire — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1 records the Latin name.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le volcan*
- *Say it: le volcan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le volcan*
- *Recall:* say the French for a statue, then the French for a fountain, then say *le volcan* again

Before you move on

What does le volcan mean? (“A volcano”.) Say it once more.

171.2 la plaine — a plain

Before the new one: say the French for a fountain, then the French for a volcano.

You’ll want to know: la plaine

la plaine — “a plain”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plaine ← Latin *plana*, “flat”, the feminine of *planus* (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plaine*
- *Say it: la plaine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la plaine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fountain, then the French for a volcano, then say *la plaine* again

Before you move on

What does la plaine mean? ("A plain".) Say it once more.

171.3 la cascade — a waterfall

Before the new one: say the French for a volcano, then the French for a plain.

You'll want to know: la cascade

la cascade — "a waterfall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cascade ← Italian *cascata*, from *cascare*, "to fall" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cascade*
- *Say it: la cascade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cascade*
- *Recall:* say the French for a volcano, then the French for a plain, then say *la cascade* again

Before you move on

What does la cascade mean? ("A waterfall".) Say it once more.

171.4 le rocher — a rock

Before the new one: say the French for a plain, then the French for a waterfall.

You'll want to know: le rocher

le rocher — "a rock".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rocher ← Old French *rochier*, built from the word for "rock", ← Medieval Latin *rocca*, whose origin is unknown. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rocher*
- *Say it: le rocher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rocher*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plain, then the French for a waterfall, then say *le rocher* again

Before you move on

What does le rocher mean? ("A rock".) Say it once more.

171.5 le caillou — a pebble

Before the new one: say the French for a waterfall, then the French for a rock.

You'll want to know: le caillou

le caillou — "a pebble".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caillou ← Norman French *caillou* (EtymDB 2.1), from a Gaulish word for "stone" — borrowed from the dialects.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le caillou*
- *Say it: le caillou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le caillou*
- *Recall:* say the French for a waterfall, then the French for a rock, then say *le caillou* again

Before you move on

What does le caillou mean? ("A pebble".) Say it once more.

Chapter 172

Plastic, Cotton, Wool, Silk, Leather

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say plastic, cotton, wool, silk and leather.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 172: I can say plastic, cotton, wool, silk and leather.

172.1 le plastique — plastic

Before the new one: say the French for a rock, then the French for a pebble.

You'll want to know: le plastique

le plastique — "plastic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plastique ← Latin *plasticus*, "of moulding", from Greek *plastikos* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plastique*
- *Say it: le plastique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le plastique*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rock, then the French for a pebble, then say *le plastique* again

Before you move on

What does le plastique mean? ("Plastic".) Say it once more.

172.2 le coton — cotton

Before the new one: say the French for a pebble, then the French for plastic.

You'll want to know: le coton

le coton — "cotton".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coton ← Italian *cotone* ← Arabic *qutn* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coton*
- *Say it: le coton*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le coton*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pebble, then the French for plastic, then say *le coton* again

Before you move on

What does le coton mean? (“Cotton”.) Say it once more.

172.3 la laine — wool

Before the new one: say the French for plastic, then the French for cotton.

You’ll want to know: la laine

la laine — “wool”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

laine ← Old French *lainne* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *lana*, “wool” (Lewis & Short) — inherited: the stressed *a* became *ai*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la laine*
- *Say it: la laine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la laine*
- *Recall:* say the French for plastic, then the French for cotton, then say *la laine* again

Before you move on

What does la laine mean? (“Wool”.) Say it once more.

172.4 la soie — silk

Before the new one: say the French for cotton, then the French for wool.

You'll want to know: la soie

la soie — "silk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soie ← Latin *saeta*, "a bristle, a stiff hair", later a silk thread — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la soie*
- *Say it: la soie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la soie*
- *Recall:* say the French for cotton, then the French for wool, then say *la soie* again

Before you move on

What does la soie mean? ("Silk".) Say it once more.

172.5 le cuir — leather

Before the new one: say the French for wool, then the French for silk.

You'll want to know: le cuir

le cuir — "leather".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuir ← Latin *corium*, "hide, leather" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cuir*
- *Say it: le cuir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le cuir*
- *Recall:* say the French for wool, then the French for silk, then say *le cuir* again

Before you move on

What does le cuir mean? (“Leather”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 173

Ball, Racket, Gym, Swimming, Victory

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a ball, a racket, a gym, swimming and a victory.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 173: I can say a ball, a racket, a gym, swimming and a victory.*

173.1 le ballon — a ball

> Before the new one: say the French for silk, then the French for leather.

You'll want to know: le ballon

le ballon — "a ball".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ballon ← Italian *pallone*, "a big ball", reshaped after the French word for "ball" — borrowed in the 1500s. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Middle French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le ballon*
- *Say it: le ballon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le ballon*
- *Recall:* say the French for silk, then the French for leather, then say *le ballon* again

Before you move on

What does le ballon mean? (“A ball”.) Say it once more.

173.2 la raquette — a racket

Before the new one: say the French for leather, then the French for a ball.

You’ll want to know: la raquette

la raquette — “a racket”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raquette ← Medieval Latin *rasceta*, from Arabic *raha*, “the palm of the hand” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la raquette*
- *Say it: la raquette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la raquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for leather, then the French for a ball, then say *la raquette* again

Before you move on

What does la raquette mean? (“A racket”.) Say it once more.

173.3 la salle de sport — a gym

Before the new one: say the French for a ball, then the French for a racket.

You’ll want to know: la salle de sport

la salle de sport — “a gym”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salle de sport — “room of sport”: *salle*, *de* and *sport*. *Salle* ← Frankish *sal*, “hall”; *sport* is borrowed from English (EtymDB 2.1), which took it from Old French *desport*, “a pastime”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salle de sport*
- *Say it: la salle de sport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la salle de sport*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ball, then the French for a racket, then say *la salle de sport* again

Before you move on

What does la salle de sport mean? (“A gym”.) Say it once more.

173.4 la natation — swimming

Before the new one: say the French for a racket, then the French for a gym.

You'll want to know: la natation

la natation — "swimming".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

natation ← Latin *natatio*, "swimming", from *natare*, "to swim" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la natation*
- *Say it: la natation*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la natation*
- *Recall:* say the French for a racket, then the French for a gym, then say *la natation* again

Before you move on

What does la natation mean? ("Swimming".) Say it once more.

173.5 la victoire — a victory

Before the new one: say the French for a gym, then the French for swimming.

You'll want to know: la victoire

la victoire — "a victory".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

victoire ← Latin *victoria*, "victory", from *vincere*, "to conquer" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la victoire*
- *Say it: la victoire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la victoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a gym, then the French for swimming, then say *la victoire* again

Before you move on

What does la victoire mean? ("A victory".) Say it once more.

Chapter 174

Company, Colleague, Salary, Meeting, Contract

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a company, a colleague, a salary, a meeting and a contract.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 174: I can say a company, a colleague, a salary, a meeting and a contract.

174.1 l'entreprise — a company

Before the new one: say the French for swimming, then the French for a victory.

You'll want to know: l'entreprise

l'entreprise — "a company".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entreprise is the past participle of the verb for "to undertake", built from *entre-* and *prendre*, "to take": a thing taken in hand.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entreprise*
- *Say it: l'entreprise*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'entreprise*
- *Recall:* say the French for swimming, then the French for a victory, then say *l'entreprise* again

Before you move on

What does l'entreprise mean? ("A company".) Say it once more.

174.2 le collègue — a colleague

Before the new one: say the French for a victory, then the French for a company.

You'll want to know: le collègue

le collègue — "a colleague".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

collègue ← Latin *collega*, "a partner in office" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le collègue*
- *Say it: le collègue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le collègue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a victory, then the French for a company, then say *le collègue* again

Before you move on

What does le collègue mean? (“A colleague”.) Say it once more.

174.3 le salaire — a salary

Before the new one: say the French for a company, then the French for a colleague.

You’ll want to know: le salaire

le salaire — “a salary”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salaire ← Latin *salarium*, “wages”, first “salt money”, from *sal*, “salt” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le salaire*
- *Say it: le salaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le salaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a company, then the French for a colleague, then say *le salaire* again

Before you move on

What does le salaire mean? (“A salary”.) Say it once more.

174.4 la réunion — a meeting

Before the new one: say the French for a colleague, then the French for a salary.

You'll want to know: la réunion

la réunion — "a meeting".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réunion — formed from the verb for "to reunite", built on the verb for "to unite", ← Latin *unire*, from *unus*, "one". (EtymDB 2.1 links it to the verb.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réunion*
- *Say it: la réunion*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la réunion*
- *Recall:* say the French for a colleague, then the French for a salary, then say *la réunion* again

Before you move on

What does la réunion mean? ("A meeting".) Say it once more.

174.5 le contrat — a contract

Before the new one: say the French for a salary, then the French for a meeting.

You'll want to know: le contrat

le contrat — "a contract".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contrat ← Old French *contract* ← Latin *contractum*, "a thing drawn together, an agreement" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le contrat*
- *Say it: le contrat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le contrat*
- *Recall:* say the French for a salary, then the French for a meeting, then say *le contrat* again

Before you move on

What does le contrat mean? ("A contract".) Say it once more.

174.6 Words from chapters 170-171 — a first pass

Say the words for a meeting and a contract.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a castle, a tower, a monument, a statue, a fountain
- a volcano, a plain, a waterfall, a rock, a pebble

Before you move on

A castle? (**le château**.) A tower? (**la tour**.) A monument? (**le monument**.) A statue? (**la statue**.) A fountain? (**la fontaine**.) A volcano? (**le volcan**.) A plain? (**la plaine**.) A waterfall? (**la cascade**.) A rock? (**le rocher**.) A pebble? (**le caillou**.)

174.7 Words from chapters 172-174 — a second pass

Say the words for plastic and cotton.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- plastic, cotton, wool, silk, leather
- a ball, a racket, a gym, swimming, a victory
- a company, a colleague, a salary, a meeting, a contract

Before you move on

Plastic? (**le plastique**.) Cotton? (**le coton**.) Wool? (**la laine**.) Silk? (**la soie**.) Leather? (**le cuir**.) A ball? (**le ballon**.) A racket? (**la raquette**.) A gym? (**la salle de sport**.) Swimming? (**la natation**.) A victory? (**la victoire**.) A company? (**l'entreprise**.) A colleague? (**le collègue**.) A salary? (**le salaire**.) A meeting? (**la réunion**.) A contract? (**le contrat**.)

Chapter 175

To kiss, To greet, To thank, To invite, To park

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to kiss, to greet, to thank, to invite and to park.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 175: I can say to kiss, to greet, to thank, to invite and to park.*

175.1 embrasser — to kiss

> Before the new one: say the French for a meeting, then the French for a contract.

You'll want to know: embrasser

embrasser — "to kiss".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

embrasser — built from *em-*, "into", and *bras*, "arm": to take into the arms, now to kiss.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *embrasser*
- *Say it:* *embrasser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *embrasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for a meeting, then the French for a contract, then say *embrasser* again

Before you move on

What does embrasser mean? ("To kiss".) Say it once more.

175.2 saluer — to greet

Before the new one: say the French for a contract, then the French for to kiss.

You'll want to know: saluer

saluer — "to greet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

saluer ← Latin *salutare*, "to greet, to wish health", from *salus*, "health" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *saluer*
- *Say it:* *saluer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *saluer*
- *Recall:* say the French for a contract, then the French for to kiss, then say *saluer* again

Before you move on

What does saluer mean? (“To greet”.) Say it once more.

175.3 remercier — to thank

Before the new one: say the French for to kiss, then the French for to greet.

You’ll want to know: remercier

remercier — “to thank”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remercier — built from *re-* and the old verb for “to thank”, made from *merci*, “thank you”. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Middle French form.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remercier*
- *Say it: remercier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remercier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to kiss, then the French for to greet, then say *remercier* again

Before you move on

What does remercier mean? (“To thank”.) Say it once more.

175.4 inviter — to invite

Before the new one: say the French for to greet, then the French for to thank.

You'll want to know: inviter

inviter — "to invite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inviter ← Latin *invitare*, "to invite" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inviter*
- *Say it: inviter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inviter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to greet, then the French for to thank, then say *inviter* again

Before you move on

What does inviter mean? ("To invite".) Say it once more.

175.5 garer — to park

Before the new one: say the French for to thank, then the French for to invite.

You'll want to know: garer

garer — "to park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

garer ← Old French *garer*, *warer*, "to shelter, to guard" (EtymDB 2.1), from a Germanic verb meaning "to watch over" — borrowed: to park is to put in shelter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: garer*
- *Say it: garer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *garer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to thank, then the French for to invite, then say *garer* again

Before you move on

What does garer mean? ("To park".) Say it once more.

Chapter 176

To stop, To change, To move, To take off, To hold

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to stop, to change, to move, to take off and to hold.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 176: I can say to stop, to change, to move, to take off and to hold.*

176.1 arrêter — to stop

> Before the new one: say the French for to invite, then the French for to park.

You'll want to know: arrêter

arrêter — "to stop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrêter ← Old French *arester* ← Vulgar Latin **arrestare*, from *ad* and *restare*, "to stay back" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arrêter*
- *Say it: arrêter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arrêter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to invite, then the French for to park, then say *arrêter* again

Before you move on

What does arrêter mean? ("To stop".) Say it once more.

176.2 changer — to change

Before the new one: say the French for to park, then the French for to stop.

You'll want to know: changer

changer — "to change".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

changer ← Old French *changier* ← Late Latin *cambiare*, "to exchange", a word Latin took from Gaulish — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: changer*
- *Say it: changer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *changer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to park, then the French for to stop, then say *changer* again

Before you move on

What does changer mean? ("To change".) Say it once more.

176.3 déplacer — to move (something)

Before the new one: say the French for to stop, then the French for to change.

You'll want to know: déplacer

déplacer — "to move (something)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déplacer — built from *dé-* and the word for "a place", ← Latin *platea*, "a broad street" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: déplacer*
- *Say it: déplacer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *déplacer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stop, then the French for to change, then say *déplacer* again

Before you move on

What does déplacer mean? ("To move (something)".) Say it once more.

176.4 enlever — to take off, to remove

Before the new one: say the French for to change, then the French for to move.

You'll want to know: enlever

enlever — "to take off, to remove".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enlever — built from *en*, "away", and *lever*, "to lift", ← Latin *levare*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: enlever*
- *Say it: enlever*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enlever*
- *Recall:* say the French for to change, then the French for to move, then say *enlever* again

Before you move on

What does enlever mean? ("To take off, to remove".) Say it once more.

176.5 tenir — to hold

Before the new one: say the French for to move, then the French for to take off.

You'll want to know: tenir

tenir — "to hold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tenir ← Vulgar Latin **tenire* ← Latin *tenere*, "to hold" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tenir*
- *Say it: tenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move, then the French for to take off, then say *tenir* again

Before you move on

What does tenir mean? ("To hold".) Say it once more.

Chapter 177

To promise, To allow, To forbid, To protect, To rescue

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to promise, to allow, to forbid, to protect and to rescue.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 177: I can say to promise, to allow, to forbid, to protect and to rescue.*

177.1 promettre — to promise

Before the new one: say the French for to take off, then the French for to hold.

You'll want to know: promettre

promettre — "to promise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

promettre ← Old French *prometre* ← Latin *promittere*, "to send forward, to promise" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *mettre* with *pro-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: promettre*
- *Say it: promettre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *promettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to take off, then the French for to hold, then say *promettre* again

Before you move on

What does promettre mean? ("To promise".) Say it once more.

177.2 permettre — to allow

Before the new one: say the French for to hold, then the French for to promise.

You'll want to know: permettre

permettre — "to allow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

permettre ← Latin *permittere*, "to let through, to allow" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, reshaped on *mettre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: permettre*
- *Say it: permettre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *permettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hold, then the French for to promise, then say *permettre* again

Before you move on

What does permettre mean? ("To allow".) Say it once more.

177.3 interdire — to forbid

Before the new one: say the French for to promise, then the French for to allow.

You'll want to know: interdire

interdire — "to forbid".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interdire ← Latin *interdicere*, "to forbid", from *inter*, "between", and *dicere*, "to say" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: interdire*
- *Say it: interdire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *interdire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to promise, then the French for to allow, then say *interdire* again

Before you move on

What does interdire mean? ("To forbid".) Say it once more.

177.4 protéger — to protect

Before the new one: say the French for to allow, then the French for to forbid.

You'll want to know: protéger

protéger — "to protect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

protéger ← Latin *protegere*, "to cover in front" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: protéger*
- *Say it: protéger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *protéger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to allow, then the French for to forbid, then say *protéger* again

Before you move on

What does protéger mean? ("To protect".) Say it once more.

177.5 sauver — to rescue

Before the new one: say the French for to forbid, then the French for to protect.

You'll want to know: sauver

sauver — "to rescue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauver ← Late Latin *salvare*, "to save", from *salvus*, "safe" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sauver*
- *Say it: sauver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sauver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to forbid, then the French for to protect, then say *sauver* again

Before you move on

What does sauver mean? ("To rescue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 178

To snow, To go with, To add, To announce, To appear

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to snow, to go with, to add, to announce and to appear.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 178: I can say to snow, to go with, to add, to announce and to appear.*

178.1 neiger — to snow

Before the new one: say the French for to protect, then the French for to rescue.

You'll want to know: neiger

neiger — "to snow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

neiger ← Vulgar Latin **nivicare*, from Latin *nix*, *nivis*, "snow" — inherited; *neige* was made from it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: neiger*
- *Say it: neiger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *neiger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to protect, then the French for to rescue, then say *neiger* again

Before you move on

What does neiger mean? (“To snow”.) Say it once more.

178.2 accompagner — to go with

Before the new one: say the French for to rescue, then the French for to snow.

You’ll want to know: accompagner

accompagner — “to go with”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accompagner ← Old French *acompagner*, built on *compaing*, “a companion” (EtymDB 2.1), from Late Latin *companio*, “one who shares bread”, from *panis*, the Latin of *pain*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: accompagner*
- *Say it: accompagner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *accompagner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rescue, then the French for to snow, then say *accompagner* again

Before you move on

What does accompagner mean? ("To go with".) Say it once more.

178.3 ajouter — to add

Before the new one: say the French for to snow, then the French for to go with.

You'll want to know: ajouter

ajouter — "to add".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ajouter ← Old French *ajouster* ← Vulgar Latin **adiuxtare*, "to put beside", from Latin *iuxta*, "next to" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ajouter*
- *Say it: ajouter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ajouter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to snow, then the French for to go with, then say *ajouter* again

Before you move on

What does ajouter mean? ("To add".) Say it once more.

178.4 annoncer — to announce

Before the new one: say the French for to go with, then the French for to add.

You'll want to know: annoncer

annoncer — "to announce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

annoncer ← Old French *anoncier* ← Latin *annuntiare*, "to make known", from *nuntius*, "a messenger" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: annoncer*
- *Say it: annoncer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *annoncer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go with, then the French for to add, then say *annoncer* again

Before you move on

What does annoncer mean? ("To announce".) Say it once more.

178.5 apparaître — to appear

Before the new one: say the French for to add, then the French for to announce.

You'll want to know: apparaître

apparaître — "to appear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

apparaître ← Old French *aparoistre* ← Late Latin *apparescere*, from Latin *apparere*, "to appear" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *apparaître*
- *Say it:* *apparaître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *apparaître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to add, then the French for to announce, then say *apparaître* again

Before you move on

What does apparaître mean? ("To appear".) Say it once more.

Chapter 179

To depend, To share, To avoid, To throw, To turn

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to depend, to share, to avoid, to throw and to turn.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 179: I can say to depend, to share, to avoid, to throw and to turn.*

179.1 dépendre — to depend

Before the new one: say the French for to announce, then the French for to appear.

You'll want to know: dépendre

dépendre — "to depend".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépendre ← Latin *dependere*, "to hang from" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dépendre*
- *Say it:* *dépendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dépendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to announce, then the French for to appear, then say *dépendre* again

Before you move on

What does dépendre mean? (“To depend”.) Say it once more.

179.2 partager — to share

Before the new one: say the French for to appear, then the French for to depend.

You’ll want to know: partager

partager — “to share”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

partager — built from the word for “a share”, from the word for “a part”, ← Latin *pars*, *partis* (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *partager*
- *Say it:* *partager*, once more
- *Say it:* say *partager*
- *Recall:* say the French for to appear, then the French for to depend, then say *partager* again

Before you move on

What does partager mean? ("To share".) Say it once more.

179.3 éviter — to avoid

Before the new one: say the French for to depend, then the French for to share.

You'll want to know: éviter

éviter — "to avoid".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éviter ← Latin *evitare*, "to shun" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: éviter*
- *Say it: éviter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *éviter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to depend, then the French for to share, then say *éviter* again

Before you move on

What does éviter mean? ("To avoid".) Say it once more.

179.4 lancer — to throw

Before the new one: say the French for to share, then the French for to avoid.

You'll want to know: lancer

lancer — "to throw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lancer ← Old French *lancier* ← Late Latin *lanceare*, "to wield a lance", from *lancea*, "a lance" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lancer*
- *Say it: lancer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lancer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to share, then the French for to avoid, then say *lancer* again

Before you move on

What does lancer mean? ("To throw".) Say it once more.

179.5 tourner — to turn

Before the new one: say the French for to avoid, then the French for to throw.

You'll want to know: tourner

tourner — "to turn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tourner ← Old French *torner* ← Latin *tornare*, "to turn on a lathe", from *tornus*, "a lathe" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tourner*
- *Say it: tourner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tourner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to avoid, then the French for to throw, then say *tourner* again

Before you move on

What does tourner mean? ("To turn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 180

To prepare, To introduce, To lend, To propose, To pick up

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to prepare, to introduce, to lend, to propose and to pick up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 180: I can say to prepare, to introduce, to lend, to propose and to pick up.*

180.1 préparer — to prepare

Before the new one: say the French for to throw, then the French for to turn.

You'll want to know: préparer

préparer — "to prepare".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préparer ← Latin *praeparare*, "to make ready beforehand" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: préparer*
- *Say it: préparer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *préparer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to throw, then the French for to turn, then say *préparer* again

Before you move on

What does préparer mean? ("To prepare".) Say it once more.

180.2 présenter — to introduce

Before the new one: say the French for to turn, then the French for to prepare.

You'll want to know: présenter

présenter — "to introduce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

présenter ← Latin *praesentare*, "to show, to place before" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: présenter*
- *Say it: présenter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *présenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to turn, then the French for to prepare, then say *présenter* again

Before you move on

What does présenter mean? (“To introduce”.) Say it once more.

180.3 prêter — to lend

Before the new one: say the French for to prepare, then the French for to introduce.

You’ll want to know: prêter

prêter — “to lend”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prêter ← Middle French *prester* ← Latin *praestare*, “to provide, to vouch for” (Lewis & Short) — inherited; the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prêter*
- *Say it: prêter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prêter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to prepare, then the French for to introduce, then say *prêter* again

Before you move on

What does prêter mean? (“To lend”.) Say it once more.

180.4 proposer — to propose

Before the new one: say the French for to introduce, then the French for to lend.

You'll want to know: proposer

proposer — "to propose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

proposer ← Old French *proposer*, after Latin *proponere*, "to put forward" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: proposer*
- *Say it: proposer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *proposer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to introduce, then the French for to lend, then say *proposer* again

Before you move on

What does proposer mean? ("To propose".) Say it once more.

180.5 ramasser — to pick up

Before the new one: say the French for to lend, then the French for to propose.

You'll want to know: ramasser

ramasser — "to pick up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ramasser — built from *re-* and the verb for "to heap up", from the word for "a mass", ← Latin *massa*, "a lump" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ramasser*
- *Say it: ramasser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ramasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lend, then the French for to propose, then say *ramasser* again

Before you move on

What does ramasser mean? ("To pick up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 181

To look like, To push, To pull, To waste, To overtake

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to look like, to push, to pull, to waste and to overtake.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 181: I can say to look like, to push, to pull, to waste and to overtake.*

181.1 ressembler — to look like

Before the new one: say the French for to propose, then the French for to pick up.

You'll want to know: ressembler

ressembler — "to look like".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ressembler — built from *re-* and *sembler*, "to seem": to seem like.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ressembler*
- *Say it: ressembler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ressembler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to propose, then the French for to pick up, then say *ressembler* again

Before you move on

What does ressembler mean? ("To look like".) Say it once more.

181.2 pousser — to push

Before the new one: say the French for to pick up, then the French for to look like.

You'll want to know: pousser

pousser — "to push".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pousser ← Latin *pulsare*, "to push, to beat" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pousser*
- *Say it: pousser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pousser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pick up, then the French for to look like, then say *pousser* again

Before you move on

What does pousser mean? ("To push".) Say it once more.

181.3 tirer — to pull

Before the new one: say the French for to look like, then the French for to push.

You'll want to know: tirer

tirer — "to pull".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tirer ← Old French *tirer*, "to draw out" (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; EtymDB links it to Gothic *tairan*, "to tear", one of several proposals.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tirer*
- *Say it: tirer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to look like, then the French for to push, then say *tirer* again

Before you move on

What does tirer mean? ("To pull".) Say it once more.

181.4 gaspiller — to waste

Before the new one: say the French for to push, then the French for to pull.

You'll want to know: gaspiller

gaspiller — "to waste".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gaspiller — from a dialect word for scattering chaff (EtymDB 2.1 has Old French *gaspail*, "chaff of wheat"); its deeper origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaspiller*
- *Say it: gaspiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gaspiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to push, then the French for to pull, then say *gaspiller* again

Before you move on

What does gaspiller mean? ("To waste".) Say it once more.

181.5 dépasser — to overtake

Before the new one: say the French for to pull, then the French for to waste.

You'll want to know: dépasser

dépasser — "to overtake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépasser — built from *dé-*, "beyond", and the verb for "to pass", ← Vulgar Latin **passare*, from Latin *passus*, "a step" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dépasser*
- *Say it: dépasser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dépasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pull, then the French for to waste, then say *dépasser* again

Before you move on

What does dépasser mean? ("To overtake".) Say it once more.

Chapter 182

To correct, To direct, To destroy, To exaggerate, To celebrate

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to correct, to direct, to destroy, to exaggerate and to celebrate.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 182: I can say to correct, to direct, to destroy, to exaggerate and to celebrate.

182.1 corriger — to correct

Before the new one: say the French for to waste, then the French for to overtake.

You'll want to know: corriger

corriger — "to correct".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

corriger ← Latin *corrigere*, "to set straight" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: corriger*
- *Say it: corriger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *corriger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to waste, then the French for to overtake, then say *corriger* again

Before you move on

What does corriger mean? ("To correct".) Say it once more.

182.2 diriger — to direct

Before the new one: say the French for to overtake, then the French for to correct.

You'll want to know: diriger

diriger — "to direct".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

diriger ← Latin *dirigere*, "to set straight, to direct" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diriger*
- *Say it: diriger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *diriger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to overtake, then the French for to correct, then say *diriger* again

Before you move on

What does diriger mean? ("To direct".) Say it once more.

182.3 détruire — to destroy

Before the new one: say the French for to correct, then the French for to direct.

You'll want to know: détruire

détruire — "to destroy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

détruire ← Old French *destruire* ← Vulgar Latin **destrugere* ← Latin *destruere*, "to pull down" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: détruire*
- *Say it: détruire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *détruire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to correct, then the French for to direct, then say *détruire* again

Before you move on

What does détruire mean? ("To destroy".) Say it once more.

182.4 exagérer — to exaggerate

Before the new one: say the French for to direct, then the French for to destroy.

You'll want to know: exagérer

exagérer — "to exaggerate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exagérer ← Latin *exaggerare*, "to heap up" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: exagérer*
- *Say it: exagérer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *exagérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to direct, then the French for to destroy, then say *exagérer* again

Before you move on

What does exagérer mean? ("To exaggerate".) Say it once more.

182.5 fêter — to celebrate

Before the new one: say the French for to destroy, then the French for to exaggerate.

You'll want to know: fêter

fêter — "to celebrate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fêter ← Old French *fester* (EtymDB 2.1), from the word for "a feast", ← Latin *festa*, "festivals" (Lewis & Short); the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fêter*
- *Say it: fêter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fêter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to destroy, then the French for to exaggerate, then say *fêter* again

Before you move on

What does fêter mean? ("To celebrate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 183

To give up, To exchange, To download, To ski, To slip

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to give up, to exchange, to download, to ski and to slip.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 183: I can say to give up, to exchange, to download, to ski and to slip.*

183.1 renoncer — to give up

Before the new one: say the French for to exaggerate, then the French for to celebrate.

You'll want to know: renoncer

renoncer — "to give up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

renoncer ← Latin *renuntiare*, "to send back word, to give up" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: renoncer*
- *Say it: renoncer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *renoncer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to exaggerate, then the French for to celebrate, then say *renoncer* again

Before you move on

What does renoncer mean? ("To give up".) Say it once more.

183.2 échanger — to exchange

Before the new one: say the French for to celebrate, then the French for to give up.

You'll want to know: échanger

échanger — "to exchange".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échanger ← Old French *eschangier* ← Vulgar Latin **excambiare* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *changer* with *é-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: échanger*
- *Say it: échanger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *échanger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to celebrate, then the French for to give up, then say *échanger* again

Before you move on

What does échanger mean? ("To exchange".) Say it once more.

183.3 télécharger — to download

Before the new one: say the French for to give up, then the French for to exchange.

You'll want to know: télécharger

télécharger — "to download".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

télécharger — *télé-*, "far off", from Greek *tele*, and the verb for "to load", ← Late Latin *carricare* (EtymDB 2.1), from *carrus*, "a wagon".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: télécharger*
- *Say it: télécharger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *télécharger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give up, then the French for to exchange, then say *télécharger* again

Before you move on

What does télécharger mean? ("To download".) Say it once more.

183.4 skier — to ski

Before the new one: say the French for to exchange, then the French for to download.

You'll want to know: skier

skier — "to ski".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

skier — formed from the word for "ski", ← Norwegian *ski*, from Old Norse *skid*, "a stick of wood, a snowshoe". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skier*
- *Say it: skier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to exchange, then the French for to download, then say *skier* again

Before you move on

What does skier mean? ("To ski".) Say it once more.

183.5 glisser — to slip

Before the new one: say the French for to download, then the French for to ski.

You'll want to know: glisser

glisser — "to slip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

glisser ← Old French *glicier*, "to slip, to glide" (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Frankish **glidan*, "to glide".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: glisser*
- *Say it: glisser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *glisser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to download, then the French for to ski, then say *glisser* again

Before you move on

What does glisser mean? ("To slip".) Say it once more.

183.6 Words from chapters 175-178 — a first pass

Say the words for to ski and to slip.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to kiss, to greet, to thank, to invite, to park
- to stop, to change, to move, to take off, to hold
- to promise, to allow, to forbid, to protect, to rescue
- to snow, to go with, to add, to announce, to appear

Before you move on

To kiss? (**embrasser**.) To greet? (**saluer**.) To thank? (**remercier**.) To invite? (**inviter**.) To park? (**garer**.) To stop? (**arrêter**.) To change? (**changer**.) To move? (**déplacer**.) To take off? (**enlever**.) To hold? (**tenir**.) To promise? (**promettre**.) To allow? (**permettre**.) To forbid? (**interdire**.) To protect?

(**protéger**.) To rescue? (**sauver**.) To snow? (**neiger**.) To go with? (**accompagner**.) To add? (**ajouter**.) To announce? (**annoncer**.) To appear? (**apparaître**.)

183.7 Words from chapters 179-183 — a second pass

Say the words for to depend and to share.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to depend, to share, to avoid, to throw, to turn
- to prepare, to introduce, to lend, to propose, to pick up
- to look like, to push, to pull, to waste, to overtake
- to correct, to direct, to destroy, to exaggerate, to celebrate
- to give up, to exchange, to download, to ski, to slip

Before you move on

To depend? (**dépendre**.) To share? (**partager**.) To avoid? (**éviter**.) To throw? (**lancer**.) To turn? (**tourner**.) To prepare? (**préparer**.) To introduce? (**présenter**.) To lend? (**prêter**.) To propose? (**proposer**.) To pick up? (**ramasser**.) To look like? (**ressembler**.) To push? (**pousser**.) To pull? (**tirer**.) To waste? (**gaspiller**.) To overtake? (**dépasser**.) To correct? (**corriger**.) To direct? (**diriger**.) To destroy? (**détruire**.) To exaggerate? (**exagérer**.) To celebrate? (**fêter**.) To give up? (**renoncer**.) To exchange? (**échanger**.) To download? (**télécharger**.) To ski? (**skier**.) To slip? (**glisser**.)

Chapter 184

To stir, To pick, To defend, To disappear, To borrow

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to stir, to pick, to defend, to disappear and to borrow.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 184: I can say to stir, to pick, to defend, to disappear and to borrow.

184.1 bouger — to stir, to move

Before the new one: say the French for to ski, then the French for to slip.

You'll want to know: bouger

bouger — "to stir, to move".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouger ← Vulgar Latin **bullicare*, "to bubble, to stir", from Latin *bullire*, "to boil" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bouger*
- *Say it: bouger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bouger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to ski, then the French for to slip, then say *bouger* again

Before you move on

What does bouger mean? ("To stir, to move".) Say it once more.

184.2 cueillir — to pick (flowers, fruit)

Before the new one: say the French for to slip, then the French for to stir.

You'll want to know: cueillir

cueillir — "to pick (flowers, fruit)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cueillir ← Old French *coillir* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *colligere*, "to gather together" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cueillir*
- *Say it: cueillir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cueillir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to slip, then the French for to stir, then say *cueillir* again

Before you move on

What does cueillir mean? (“To pick (flowers, fruit)”.) Say it once more.

184.3 défendre — to defend

Before the new one: say the French for to stir, then the French for to pick.

You’ll want to know: défendre

défendre — “to defend”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défendre ← Latin *defendere*, “to ward off” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: défendre*
- *Say it: défendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *défendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stir, then the French for to pick, then say *défendre* again

Before you move on

What does défendre mean? (“To defend”.) Say it once more.

184.4 disparaître — to disappear

Before the new one: say the French for to pick, then the French for to defend.

You'll want to know: disparaître

disparaître — "to disappear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

disparaître — built from *dis-*, "apart", and the verb for "to appear": the opposite of *apparaître*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *disparaître*
- *Say it:* *disparaître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *disparaître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pick, then the French for to defend, then say *disparaître* again

Before you move on

What does disparaître mean? ("To disappear".) Say it once more.

184.5 emprunter — to borrow

Before the new one: say the French for to defend, then the French for to disappear.

You'll want to know: emprunter

emprunter — "to borrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

emprunter ← Middle French *emprunter* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **imprumutare*, from Latin *promutuum*, "a loan paid in advance" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *emprunter*
- *Say it:* *emprunter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *emprunter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to defend, then the French for to disappear, then say *emprunter* again

Before you move on

What does emprunter mean? ("To borrow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 185

Muscle, Thumb, Wound, Scar, Cold

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a muscle, a thumb, a wound, a scar and a cold.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 185: I can say a muscle, a thumb, a wound, a scar and a cold.*

185.1 le muscle — a muscle

> Before the new one: say the French for to disappear, then the French for to borrow.

You'll want to know: le muscle

le muscle — "a muscle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

muscle ← Latin *musculus*, "a little mouse", from *mus*, "mouse" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: a flexing muscle looked like a mouse under the skin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le muscle*
- *Say it: le muscle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le muscle*
- *Recall:* say the French for to disappear, then the French for to borrow, then say *le muscle* again

Before you move on

What does le muscle mean? (“A muscle”.) Say it once more.

185.2 le pouce — a thumb

Before the new one: say the French for to borrow, then the French for a muscle.

You’ll want to know: le pouce

le pouce — “a thumb”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pouce ← Old French *pouce* ← Latin *pollex*, *pollicis*, “thumb” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pouce*
- *Say it: le pouce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pouce*
- *Recall:* say the French for to borrow, then the French for a muscle, then say *le pouce* again

Before you move on

What does le pouce mean? (“A thumb”.) Say it once more.

185.3 la blessure — a wound

Before the new one: say the French for a muscle, then the French for a thumb.

You’ll want to know: la blessure

la blessure — “a wound”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

blessure — built from the verb for “to wound”, ← Old French *blecier*, from Frankish **blettjan*, “to bruise”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la blessure*
- *Say it: la blessure*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la blessure*
- *Recall:* say the French for a muscle, then the French for a thumb, then say *la blessure* again

Before you move on

What does la blessure mean? (“A wound”.) Say it once more.

185.4 la cicatrice — a scar

Before the new one: say the French for a thumb, then the French for a wound.

You'll want to know: la cicatrice

la cicatrice — "a scar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cicatrice ← Latin *cicatrix*, "a scar" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cicatrice*
- *Say it: la cicatrice*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cicatrice*
- *Recall:* say the French for a thumb, then the French for a wound, then say *la cicatrice* again

Before you move on

What does la cicatrice mean? ("A scar".) Say it once more.

185.5 le rhume — a cold

Before the new one: say the French for a wound, then the French for a scar.

You'll want to know: le rhume

le rhume — "a cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rhume ← Latin *rheuma*, "a flow", from Greek *rheuma* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rhume*
- *Say it: le rhume*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le rhume*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wound, then the French for a scar, then say *le rhume* again

Before you move on

What does le rhume mean? ("A cold".) Say it once more.

Chapter 186

Friendship, Hope, Trust, Courage, Shame

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say friendship, hope, trust, courage and shame.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 186: I can say friendship, hope, trust, courage and shame.

186.1 l'amitié — friendship

Before the new one: say the French for a scar, then the French for a cold.

You'll want to know: l'amitié

l'amitié — "friendship".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amitié ← Old French *amistié* ← Vulgar Latin **amicitas*, from *amicus*, the Latin of *ami* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'amitié*
- *Say it: l'amitié*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'amitié*
- *Recall:* say the French for a scar, then the French for a cold, then say *l'amitié* again

Before you move on

What does l'amitié mean? ("Friendship".) Say it once more.

186.2 l'espoir — hope

Before the new one: say the French for a cold, then the French for friendship.

You'll want to know: l'espoir

l'espoir — "hope".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

espoir — formed from *espérer*, "to hope".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'espoir*
- *Say it: l'espoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'espoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cold, then the French for friendship, then say *l'espoir* again

Before you move on

What does l'espoir mean? ("Hope".) Say it once more.

186.3 la confiance — trust

Before the new one: say the French for friendship, then the French for hope.

You'll want to know: la confiance

la confiance — "trust".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

confiance — built on the verb for "to entrust", with *-ance*; behind it is Latin *confidere*, "to trust fully". (EtymDB 2.1 links it to Latin *confidentia*.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la confiance*
- *Say it: la confiance*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la confiance*
- *Recall:* say the French for friendship, then the French for hope, then say *la confiance* again

Before you move on

What does la confiance mean? ("Trust".) Say it once more.

186.4 le courage — courage

Before the new one: say the French for hope, then the French for trust.

You'll want to know: le courage

le courage — "courage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

courage — built in Old French from *cuer*, "heart", ← Latin *cor* (EtymDB 2.1), with *-age*: heart in action.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le courage*
- *Say it: le courage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le courage*
- *Recall:* say the French for hope, then the French for trust, then say *le courage* again

Before you move on

What does le courage mean? ("Courage".) Say it once more.

186.5 la honte — shame

Before the new one: say the French for trust, then the French for courage.

You'll want to know: la honte

la honte — "shame".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

honte ← Frankish **haunitha*, "scorn" — borrowed from the Franks.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la honte*
- *Say it: la honte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la honte*
- *Recall:* say the French for trust, then the French for courage, then say *la honte* again

Before you move on

What does la honte mean? (“Shame”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 187

In that case, Late, Suddenly, Until, Since

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say in that case, late, suddenly, until and since.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 187: I can say in that case, late, suddenly, until and since.

187.1 alors — in that case, so

Before the new one: say the French for courage, then the French for shame.

You'll want to know: alors

alors — "in that case, so".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

alors — *à* and Old French *lors*, "then", ← Latin *illa hora*, "at that hour". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *alors*
- *Say it:* *alors*, once more
- *Say it:* say *alors*
- *Recall:* say the French for courage, then the French for shame, then say *alors* again

Before you move on

What does alors mean? (“In that case, so”.) Say it once more.

187.2 tard — late

Before the new one: say the French for shame, then the French for in that case.

You’ll want to know: tard

tard — “late”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tard ← Latin *tarde*, “slowly”, from *tardus*, “slow” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tard*
- *Say it:* *tard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tard*
- *Recall:* say the French for shame, then the French for in that case, then say *tard* again

Before you move on

What does tard mean? ("Late".) Say it once more.

187.3 soudain — suddenly

Before the new one: say the French for in that case, then the French for late.

You'll want to know: soudain

soudain — "suddenly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soudain ← Old French *sodain* ← Vulgar Latin **subitanus* ← Latin *subitaneus*, "sudden", from *subitus* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soudain*
- *Say it: soudain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soudain*
- *Recall:* say the French for in that case, then the French for late, then say *soudain* again

Before you move on

What does soudain mean? ("Suddenly".) Say it once more.

187.4 jusqu'à — until

Before the new one: say the French for late, then the French for suddenly.

You'll want to know: jusqu'à

jusqu'à — "until".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jusqu'à — Old French *josque*, from Latin *de usque*, "right up to" (Lewis & Short for *usque*), and *à*, "to".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jusqu'à*
- *Say it: jusqu'à*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jusqu'à*
- *Recall:* say the French for late, then the French for suddenly, then say *jusqu'à* again

Before you move on

What does jusqu'à mean? ("Until".) Say it once more.

187.5 depuis — since, for

Before the new one: say the French for suddenly, then the French for until.

You'll want to know: depuis

depuis — "since, for".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

depuis — *de*, "from", and *puis*, "then": from then on. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: depuis*
- *Say it: depuis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *depuis*
- *Recall:* say the French for suddenly, then the French for until, then say *depuis* again

Before you move on

What does depuis mean? (“Since, for”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 188

Near to, Far from, At the bottom, On the right, On the left

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say near to, far from, at the bottom, on the right and on the left.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 188: I can say near to, far from, at the bottom, on the right and on the left.*

188.1 près de — near to

Before the new one: say the French for until, then the French for since.

You'll want to know: près de

près de — "near to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

près de — *près*, "near", and *de*, "of". *Près* ← Latin *presse*, "closely" (EtymDB 2.1), and *de* ← Latin *dē*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: près de*
- *Say it: près de*, once more
- *Say it:* say *près de*
- *Recall:* say the French for until, then the French for since, then say *près de* again

Before you move on

What does près de mean? (“Near to”.) Say it once more.

188.2 loin de — far from

Before the new one: say the French for since, then the French for near to.

You’ll want to know: loin de

loin de — “far from”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loin de — *loin*, “far”, and *de*, “from”. *Loin* comes from Latin *longē*, “far off”, and *de* from *dē*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: loin de*
- *Say it: loin de*, once more
- *Say it:* say *loin de*
- *Recall:* say the French for since, then the French for near to, then say *loin de* again

Before you move on

What does loin de mean? (“Far from”.) Say it once more.

188.3 au fond — at the bottom, at the back

Before the new one: say the French for near to, then the French for far from.

You’ll want to know: au fond

au fond — “at the bottom, at the back”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

au fond — *au*, “at the”, and *fond*, “bottom”, ← Latin *fundus*, “bottom”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: au fond*
- *Say it: au fond*, once more
- *Say it:* say *au fond*
- *Recall:* say the French for near to, then the French for far from, then say *au fond* again

Before you move on

What does au fond mean? (“At the bottom, at the back”.) Say it once more.

188.4 à droite — on the right

Before the new one: say the French for far from, then the French for at the bottom.

You'll want to know: à droite

à droite — "on the right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à droite — *à*, "on", and *droite*, "the right". *Droite* ← Latin *dīrēctus*, "straight" (Lewis & Short), through Old French *dreit*; *à* ← Latin *ad*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *à droite*
- *Say it:* *à droite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *à droite*
- *Recall:* say the French for far from, then the French for at the bottom, then say *à droite* again

Before you move on

What does à droite mean? ("On the right".) Say it once more.

188.5 à gauche — on the left

Before the new one: say the French for at the bottom, then the French for on the right.

You'll want to know: à gauche

à gauche — "on the left".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à gauche — *à*, "on", and *gauche*, "the left". *Gauche* comes from Old French *gauchir*, "to warp" (EtymDB 2.1), probably Frankish further back; *à* ← Latin *ad*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: à gauche*
- *Say it: à gauche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *à gauche*
- *Recall:* say the French for at the bottom, then the French for on the right, then say *à gauche* again

Before you move on

What does à gauche mean? ("On the left".) Say it once more.

Chapter 189

Despite, Unfortunately, Luckily, Certainly, Really

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say despite, unfortunately, luckily, certainly and really.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 189: I can say despite, unfortunately, luckily, certainly and really.

189.1 malgré — despite

Before the new one: say the French for on the right, then the French for on the left.

You'll want to know: malgré

malgré — "despite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

malgré ← Middle French *maugré*, from Old French *mal*, "bad", and *gré*, "liking", ← Latin *gratum*, "pleasing" (EtymDB 2.1): against one's liking.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: malgré*
- *Say it: malgré*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malgré*
- *Recall:* say the French for on the right, then the French for on the left, then say *malgré* again

Before you move on

What does malgré mean? (“Despite”.) Say it once more.

189.2 malheureusement — unfortunately

Before the new one: say the French for on the left, then the French for despite.

You’ll want to know: malheureusement

malheureusement — “unfortunately”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

malheureusement — *heureux*, “lucky”, with *mal-*, “badly”, in front and the adverb ending *-ment*: unluckily. *Heureux* is built on Old French *eur*, “luck”, from Latin *augurium*, “an omen”, and *mal-* ← Latin *male*, “badly” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: malheureusement*
- *Say it: malheureusement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malheureusement*

- *Recall:* say the French for on the left, then the French for despite, then say *malheureusement* again

Before you move on

What does malheureusement mean? (“Unfortunately”.) Say it once more.

189.3 heureusement — luckily

Before the new one: say the French for despite, then the French for unfortunately.

You’ll want to know: heureusement

heureusement — “luckily”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heureusement — *heureux*, “lucky”, with the adverb ending *-ment*. *Heureux* is built on Old French *eur*, “luck”, from Latin *augurium*, “an omen” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: heureusement*
- *Say it: heureusement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *heureusement*
- *Recall:* say the French for despite, then the French for unfortunately, then say *heureusement* again

Before you move on

What does heureusement mean? (“Luckily”.) Say it once more.

189.4 certainement — certainly

Before the new one: say the French for unfortunately, then the French for luckily.

You'll want to know: certainement

certainement — "certainly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

certainement — the word for "certain", ← Vulgar Latin **certanus*, from Latin *certus*, "sure" (Lewis & Short), with *-ment*; Old French already had it (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: certainement*
- *Say it: certainement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *certainement*
- *Recall:* say the French for unfortunately, then the French for luckily, then say *certainement* again

Before you move on

What does certainement mean? ("Certainly".) Say it once more.

189.5 vraiment — really

Before the new one: say the French for luckily, then the French for certainly.

You'll want to know: vraiment

vraiment — "really".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vraiment ← Old French *veraiement* (EtymDB 2.1), from the word for "true", ← Vulgar Latin **veracus*, from Latin *verus*, "true", with *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vraiment*
- *Say it: vraiment*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vraiment*
- *Recall:* say the French for luckily, then the French for certainly, then say *vraiment* again

Before you move on

What does vraiment mean? ("Really".) Say it once more.

Chapter 190

Cheerful, Serious, Shy, Brave, Fearful

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say cheerful, serious, shy, brave and fearful.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 190: I can say cheerful, serious, shy, brave and fearful.

190.1 joyeux / joyeuse — cheerful

Before the new one: say the French for certainly, then the French for really.

You'll want to know: joyeux / joyeuse

joyeux / joyeuse — "cheerful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joyeux — *joie*, "joy", with *-eux*, "full of". *Joie* ← Latin *gaudia*, "joys", and *-eux* ← Latin *-ōsus* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: joyeux / joyeuse*
- *Say it: joyeux / joyeuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *joyeux / joyeuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for certainly, then the French for really, then say *joyeux / joyeuse* again

Before you move on

What does joyeux / joyeuse mean? (“Cheerful”.) Say it once more.

190.2 sérieux / sérieuse — serious

Before the new one: say the French for really, then the French for cheerful.

You’ll want to know: sérieux / sérieuse

sérieux / sérieuse — “serious”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sérieux ← Medieval Latin *seriosus*, from *serius*, “earnest” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sérieux / sérieuse*
- *Say it: sérieux / sérieuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sérieux / sérieuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for really, then the French for cheerful, then say *sérieux / sérieuse* again

Before you move on

What does sérieux / sérieuse mean? (“Serious”.) Say it once more.

190.3 timide — shy

Before the new one: say the French for cheerful, then the French for serious.

You’ll want to know: timide

timide — “shy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

timide ← Latin *timidus*, “fearful”, from *timere*, “to fear” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: timide*
- *Say it: timide*, once more
- *Say it:* say *timide*
- *Recall:* say the French for cheerful, then the French for serious, then say *timide* again

Before you move on

What does timide mean? (“Shy”.) Say it once more.

190.4 courageux / courageuse — brave

Before the new one: say the French for serious, then the French for shy.

You'll want to know: courageux / courageuse

courageux / courageuse — "brave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

courageux — *courage* with *-eux*, "full of". *Courage* is built on Latin *cor*, "heart" (EtymDB 2.1), and *-eux* ← Latin *-ōsus*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *courageux / courageuse*
- *Say it:* *courageux / courageuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *courageux / courageuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for serious, then the French for shy, then say *courageux / courageuse* again

Before you move on

What does courageux / courageuse mean? ("Brave".) Say it once more.

190.5 peureux / peureuse — fearful

Before the new one: say the French for shy, then the French for brave.

You'll want to know: peureux / peureuse

peureux / peureuse — "fearful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peureux — *peur*, "fear", with *-eux*, "full of". *Peur* ← Latin *pavor*, "fear" (EtymDB 2.1), and *-eux* ← Latin *-ōsus*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *peureux / peureuse*
- *Say it:* *peureux / peureuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peureux / peureuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for shy, then the French for brave, then say *peureux / peureuse* again

Before you move on

What does peureux / peureuse mean? ("Fearful".) Say it once more.

Chapter 191

Simple, Complicated, Necessary, Useful, Useless

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say simple, complicated, necessary, useful and useless.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 191: I can say simple, complicated, necessary, useful and useless.

191.1 simple — simple

Before the new one: say the French for brave, then the French for fearful.

You'll want to know: simple

simple — "simple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

simple ← Latin *simplex*, "single, plain" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: simple*
- *Say it: simple*, once more
- *Say it:* say *simple*
- *Recall:* say the French for brave, then the French for fearful, then say *simple* again

Before you move on

What does simple mean? ("Simple".) Say it once more.

191.2 compliqué / compliquée — complicated

Before the new one: say the French for fearful, then the French for simple.

You'll want to know: compliqué / compliquée

compliqué / compliquée — "complicated".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compliqué is the past participle of the verb for "to complicate", ← Latin *complicare*, "to fold together" (Lewis & Short): folded in on itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: compliqué / compliquée*
- *Say it: compliqué / compliquée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *compliqué / compliquée*
- *Recall:* say the French for fearful, then the French for simple, then say *compliqué / compliquée* again

Before you move on

What does compliqué / compliquée mean? (“Complicated”.) Say it once more.

191.3 nécessaire — necessary

Before the new one: say the French for simple, then the French for complicated.

You’ll want to know: nécessaire

nécessaire — “necessary”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nécessaire ← Latin *necessarius*, “unavoidable”, from *necesse*, “needful” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nécessaire*
- *Say it: nécessaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nécessaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for simple, then the French for complicated, then say *nécessaire* again

Before you move on

What does nécessaire mean? (“Necessary”.) Say it once more.

191.4 utile — useful

Before the new one: say the French for complicated, then the French for necessary.

You'll want to know: utile

utile — "useful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

utile ← Latin *utilis*, "useful", from *uti*, "to use" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *utile*
- *Say it:* *utile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utile*
- *Recall:* say the French for complicated, then the French for necessary, then say *utile* again

Before you move on

What does utile mean? ("Useful".) Say it once more.

191.5 inutile — useless

Before the new one: say the French for necessary, then the French for useful.

You'll want to know: inutile

inutile — "useless".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inutile ← Latin *inutilis*, "useless": *utile* with *in-*, "not" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inutile*
- *Say it: inutile*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inutile*
- *Recall:* say the French for necessary, then the French for useful, then say *inutile* again

Before you move on

What does inutile mean? ("Useless".) Say it once more.

Chapter 192

Cooked, Ripe, Dark, Clear, Distant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say cooked, ripe, dark, clear and distant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 192: I can say cooked, ripe, dark, clear and distant.*

192.1 cuit / cuite — cooked

Before the new one: say the French for useful, then the French for useless.

You'll want to know: cuit / cuite

cuit / cuite — "cooked".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuit ← Old French *cuit* ← Latin *coctus*, "cooked", the past participle of *coquere* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-ct-* became *-it*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuit / cuite*
- *Say it: cuit / cuite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuit / cuite*
- *Recall:* say the French for useful, then the French for useless, then say *cuit / cuite* again

Before you move on

What does cuit / cuite mean? (“Cooked”.) Say it once more.

192.2 mûr / mûre — ripe

Before the new one: say the French for useless, then the French for cooked.

You’ll want to know: mûr / mûre

mûr / mûre — “ripe”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mûr ← Old French *meür* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *maturus*, “ripe” (Lewis & Short) — inherited; the *t* between vowels dropped out.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mûr / mûre*
- *Say it: mûr / mûre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mûr / mûre*
- *Recall:* say the French for useless, then the French for cooked, then say *mûr / mûre* again

Before you move on

What does mûr / mûre mean? (“Ripe”.) Say it once more.

192.3 sombre — dark

Before the new one: say the French for cooked, then the French for ripe.

You’ll want to know: sombre

sombre — “dark”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sombre ← Old French *sombre*, “dark” (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; it is usually linked to Late Latin *subumbrare*, “to shade”, from *umbra*, “shadow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sombre*
- *Say it: sombre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sombre*
- *Recall:* say the French for cooked, then the French for ripe, then say *sombre* again

Before you move on

What does sombre mean? (“Dark”.) Say it once more.

192.4 clair / claire — clear, light (of a colour)

Before the new one: say the French for ripe, then the French for dark.

You'll want to know: clair / claire

clair / claire — "clear, light (of a colour)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clair ← Old French *cler* ← Latin *clarus*, "bright, clear" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the stressed *a* became *e*; the *ai* spelling was put back later to look more like the Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *clair / claire*
- *Say it:* *clair / claire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *clair / claire*
- *Recall:* say the French for ripe, then the French for dark, then say *clair / claire* again

Before you move on

What does clair / claire mean? ("Clear, light (of a colour)".) Say it once more.

192.5 lointain / lointaine — distant

Before the new one: say the French for dark, then the French for clear.

You'll want to know: lointain / lointaine

lointain / lointaine — "distant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lointain ← Old French *loingtien* ← Vulgar Latin **longitanus*, from Latin *longe*, "far off", the Latin of *loin* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lointain / lointaine*
- *Say it: lointain / lointaine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lointain / lointaine*
- *Recall:* say the French for dark, then the French for clear, then say *lointain / lointaine* again

Before you move on

What does lointain / lointaine mean? ("Distant".) Say it once more.

192.6 Words from chapters 184-187 — a first pass

Say the words for clear and distant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to stir, to pick, to defend, to disappear, to borrow
- a muscle, a thumb, a wound, a scar, a cold
- friendship, hope, trust, courage, shame
- in that case, late, suddenly, until, since

Before you move on

To stir? (**bouger**.) To pick? (**cueillir**.) To defend? (**défendre**.) To disappear? (**disparaître**.) To borrow? (**emprunter**.) A muscle? (**le muscle**.) A thumb? (**le pouce**.) A wound? (**la blessure**.) A scar? (**la cicatrice**.) A cold? (**le rhume**.) Friendship? (**l'amitié**.) Hope? (**l'espoir**.) Trust? (**la confiance**.) Courage? (**le courage**.)

Shame? (**la honte**.) In that case? (**alors**.) Late? (**tard**.) Suddenly? (**soudain**.) Until? (**jusqu'à**.) Since? (**depuis**.)

192.7 Words from chapters 188-192 — a second pass

Say the words for near to and far from.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- near to, far from, at the bottom, on the right, on the left
- despite, unfortunately, luckily, certainly, really
- cheerful, serious, shy, brave, fearful
- simple, complicated, necessary, useful, useless
- cooked, ripe, dark, clear, distant

Before you move on

Near to? (**près de**.) Far from? (**loin de**.) At the bottom? (**au fond**.) On the right? (**à droite**.) On the left? (**à gauche**.) Despite? (**malgré**.) Unfortunately? (**malheureusement**.) Luckily? (**heureusement**.) Certainly? (**certainement**.) Really? (**vraiment**.) Cheerful? (**joyeux / joyeuse**.) Serious? (**sérieux / sérieuse**.) Shy? (**timide**.) Brave? (**courageux / courageuse**.) Fearful? (**peureux / peureuse**.) Simple? (**simple**.) Complicated? (**compliqué / compliquée**.) Necessary? (**nécessaire**.) Useful? (**utile**.) Useless? (**inutile**.) Cooked? (**cuit / cuite**.) Ripe? (**mûr / mûre**.) Dark? (**sombre**.) Clear? (**clair / claire**.) Distant? (**lointain / lointaine**.)

Chapter 193

Sheet, Drawer, Armchair, Saucepan, Frying pan

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a sheet, a drawer, an armchair, a saucepan and a frying pan.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 193: I can say a sheet, a drawer, an armchair, a saucepan and a frying pan.*

193.1 le drap — a sheet

> Before the new one: say the French for clear, light (of a colour), then the French for distant.

You'll want to know: le drap

le drap — "a sheet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

drap ← Late Latin *drappus*, "cloth", probably a Gaulish word — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le drap*
- *Say it: le drap*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le drap*
- *Recall:* say the French for clear, light (of a colour), then the French for distant, then say *le drap* again

Before you move on

What does le drap mean? (“A sheet”.) Say it once more.

193.2 le tiroir — a drawer

Before the new one: say the French for distant, then the French for a sheet.

You’ll want to know: le tiroir

le tiroir — “a drawer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tiroir — *tirer*, “to pull”, with *-oir*, “a thing for”: the thing you pull out. *Tirer* is of uncertain origin; EtymDB 2.1 points to a Gothic verb, “to tear away”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tiroir*
- *Say it: le tiroir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tiroir*
- *Recall:* say the French for distant, then the French for a sheet, then say *le tiroir* again

Before you move on

What does le tiroir mean? (“A drawer”.) Say it once more.

193.3 le fauteuil — an armchair

Before the new one: say the French for a sheet, then the French for a drawer.

You’ll want to know: le fauteuil

le fauteuil — “an armchair”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fauteuil ← Old French *faudestuel* ← Frankish **faldistol*, “a folding stool” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fauteuil*
- *Say it: le fauteuil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fauteuil*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sheet, then the French for a drawer, then say *le fauteuil* again

Before you move on

What does le fauteuil mean? (“An armchair”.) Say it once more.

193.4 la casserole — a saucepan

Before the new one: say the French for a drawer, then the French for an armchair.

You'll want to know: la casserole

la casserole — "a saucepan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

casserole — built from an older word for "a pan", from Old Provençal *cassa*, with a little-thing ending. *cassa* goes back to Medieval Latin *cattia*, "a ladle, a pan".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la casserole*
- *Say it: la casserole*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la casserole*
- *Recall:* say the French for a drawer, then the French for an armchair, then say *la casserole* again

Before you move on

What does la casserole mean? ("A saucepan".) Say it once more.

193.5 la poêle — a frying pan

Before the new one: say the French for an armchair, then the French for a saucepan.

You'll want to know: la poêle

la poêle — "a frying pan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poêle ← Old French *paelle* ← Latin *patella*, "a small pan" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poêle*
- *Say it: la poêle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poêle*
- *Recall:* say the French for an armchair, then the French for a saucepan, then say *la poêle* again

Before you move on

What does la poêle mean? ("A frying pan".) Say it once more.

Chapter 194

Valley, Temperature, Butterfly, Fly, Mosquito

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a valley, temperature, a butterfly, a fly and a mosquito.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 194: I can say a valley, temperature, a butterfly, a fly and a mosquito.

194.1 la vallée — a valley

Before the new one: say the French for a saucepan, then the French for a frying pan.

You'll want to know: la vallée

la vallée — "a valley".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vallée — built in Old French from *val*, "a valley", ← Latin *vallis*, with *-ée*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vallée*
- *Say it: la vallée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vallée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a saucepan, then the French for a frying pan, then say *la vallée* again

Before you move on

What does la vallée mean? (“A valley”.) Say it once more.

194.2 la température — temperature

Before the new one: say the French for a frying pan, then the French for a valley.

You’ll want to know: la température

la température — “temperature”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

température ← Latin *temperatura*, “due measure, a mixing”, from *temperare*, “to mix in proportion” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la température*
- *Say it: la température*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la température*
- *Recall:* say the French for a frying pan, then the French for a valley, then say *la température* again

Before you move on

What does la température mean? ("Temperature".) Say it once more.

194.3 le papillon — a butterfly

Before the new one: say the French for a valley, then the French for temperature.

You'll want to know: le papillon

le papillon — "a butterfly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

papillon ← Latin *papilio*, *papilionis*, "a butterfly" (EtymDB 2.1) — semi-learned: it kept its middle *p*. The fully inherited twin, with *v*, became the word for a tent, English *pavilion*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le papillon*
- *Say it: le papillon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le papillon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a valley, then the French for temperature, then say *le papillon* again

Before you move on

What does le papillon mean? ("A butterfly".) Say it once more.

194.4 la mouche — a fly

Before the new one: say the French for temperature, then the French for a butterfly.

You'll want to know: la mouche

la mouche — "a fly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mouche ← Old French *mousche* ← Latin *musca*, "a fly" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mouche*
- *Say it: la mouche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la mouche*
- *Recall:* say the French for temperature, then the French for a butterfly, then say *la mouche* again

Before you move on

What does la mouche mean? ("A fly".) Say it once more.

194.5 le moustique — a mosquito

Before the new one: say the French for a butterfly, then the French for a fly.

You'll want to know: le moustique

le moustique — "a mosquito".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moustique ← Spanish *mosquito*, "a little fly", from *mosca*, ← Latin *musca* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le moustique*
- *Say it: le moustique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le moustique*
- *Recall:* say the French for a butterfly, then the French for a fly, then say *le moustique* again

Before you move on

What does le moustique mean? ("A mosquito".) Say it once more.

Chapter 195

Dialect, Piece of news, Advertising, Screen, Keyboard

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a dialect, a piece of news, advertising, a screen and a keyboard.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 195: I can say a dialect, a piece of news, advertising, a screen and a keyboard.*

195.1 le dialecte — a dialect

> Before the new one: say the French for a fly, then the French for a mosquito.

You'll want to know: le dialecte

le dialecte — "a dialect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dialecte ← Latin *dialectos*, from Greek *dialektos*, "a way of speaking" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dialecte*
- *Say it: le dialecte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dialecte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fly, then the French for a mosquito, then say *le dialecte* again

Before you move on

What does le dialecte mean? (“A dialect”.) Say it once more.

195.2 la nouvelle — a piece of news

Before the new one: say the French for a mosquito, then the French for a dialect.

You’ll want to know: la nouvelle

la nouvelle — “a piece of news”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nouvelle ← Old French *novele* ← Vulgar Latin *novella*, “new things” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the feminine of the word behind *nouveau*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nouvelle*
- *Say it: la nouvelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la nouvelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mosquito, then the French for a dialect, then say *la nouvelle* again

Before you move on

What does la nouvelle mean? ("A piece of news".) Say it once more.

195.3 la publicité — advertising

Before the new one: say the French for a dialect, then the French for a piece of news.

You'll want to know: la publicité

la publicité — "advertising".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

publicité ← Medieval Latin *publicitas*, from *publicus*, "of the people" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la publicité*
- *Say it: la publicité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la publicité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dialect, then the French for a piece of news, then say *la publicité* again

Before you move on

What does la publicité mean? ("Advertising".) Say it once more.

195.4 l'écran — a screen

Before the new one: say the French for a piece of news, then the French for advertising.

You'll want to know: l'écran

l'écran — "a screen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écran ← Old French *escran*, from Middle Dutch *scherm*, "a shield, a screen" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'écran*
- *Say it: l'écran*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'écran*
- *Recall:* say the French for a piece of news, then the French for advertising, then say *l'écran* again

Before you move on

What does l'écran mean? ("A screen".) Say it once more.

195.5 le clavier — a keyboard

Before the new one: say the French for advertising, then the French for a screen.

You'll want to know: le clavier

le clavier — "a keyboard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clavier — built from Latin *clavis*, "key", the Latin of *clé*, with *-ier*: a row of keys. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le clavier*
- *Say it: le clavier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le clavier*
- *Recall:* say the French for advertising, then the French for a screen, then say *le clavier* again

Before you move on

What does le clavier mean? ("A keyboard".) Say it once more.

Chapter 196

Butcher, Mechanic, Electrician, Plumber, Worker

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a butcher, a mechanic, an electrician, a plumber and a worker.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 196: I can say a butcher, a mechanic, an electrician, a plumber and a worker.*

196.1 le boucher — a butcher

> Before the new one: say the French for a screen, then the French for a keyboard.

You'll want to know: le boucher

le boucher — "a butcher".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boucher ← Old French *bouchier*, built from *bouc*, "a he-goat" (EtymDB 2.1): first a seller of goat's meat.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le boucher*
- *Say it: le boucher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le boucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for a screen, then the French for a keyboard, then say *le boucher* again

Before you move on

What does le boucher mean? (“A butcher”.) Say it once more.

196.2 le mécanicien — a mechanic

Before the new one: say the French for a keyboard, then the French for a butcher.

You’ll want to know: le mécanicien

le mécanicien — “a mechanic”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mécanicien — built from the word for “mechanics”, ← Latin *mechanicus*, from Greek *mekhanikos*, “of machines” (Lewis & Short), with *-ien*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mécanicien*
- *Say it: le mécanicien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mécanicien*
- *Recall:* say the French for a keyboard, then the French for a butcher, then say *le mécanicien* again

Before you move on

What does le mécanicien mean? ("A mechanic".) Say it once more.

196.3 l'électricien — an electrician

Before the new one: say the French for a butcher, then the French for a mechanic.

You'll want to know: l'électricien

l'électricien — "an electrician".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

électricien — built from the word for "electric", from Latin *electrum*, "amber", from Greek *elektron* (Lewis & Short): rubbed amber draws things to it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'électricien*
- *Say it: l'électricien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'électricien*
- *Recall:* say the French for a butcher, then the French for a mechanic, then say *l'électricien* again

Before you move on

What does l'électricien mean? ("An electrician".) Say it once more.

196.4 le plombier — a plumber

Before the new one: say the French for a mechanic, then the French for an electrician.

You'll want to know: le plombier

le plombier — "a plumber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plombier — built from the word for "lead", ← Latin *plumbum* (Lewis & Short), with *-ier*: pipes were once lead.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plombier*
- *Say it: le plombier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le plombier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mechanic, then the French for an electrician, then say *le plombier* again

Before you move on

What does le plombier mean? ("A plumber".) Say it once more.

196.5 l'ouvrier — a worker

Before the new one: say the French for an electrician, then the French for a plumber.

You'll want to know: l'ouvrier

l'ouvrier — "a worker".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ouvrier ← Old French *ovrier* ← Latin *operarius*, "a labourer", from *opus*, *operis*, "work" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ouvrier*
- *Say it: l'ouvrier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ouvrier*
- *Recall:* say the French for an electrician, then the French for a plumber, then say *l'ouvrier* again

Before you move on

What does l'ouvrier mean? ("A worker".) Say it once more.

Chapter 197

Bridegroom, Bride, Widower, Success, Failure

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a bridegroom, a bride, a widower, success and failure.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 197: I can say a bridegroom, a bride, a widower, success and failure.*

197.1 le marié — a bridegroom

> Before the new one: say the French for a plumber, then the French for a worker.

You'll want to know: le marié

le marié — "a bridegroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marié — the adjective *marié*, "married", used as a noun: the man being married. *Marier* ← Latin *marītāre*, "to wed" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le marié*
- *Say it: le marié*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le marié*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plumber, then the French for a worker, then say *le marié* again

Before you move on

What does le marié mean? (“A bridegroom”.) Say it once more.

197.2 la mariée — a bride

Before the new one: say the French for a worker, then the French for a bridegroom.

You’ll want to know: la mariée

la mariée — “a bride”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mariée — the feminine of *marié*, used as a noun: the bride. *Marier* ← Latin *marītāre*, “to wed” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mariée*
- *Say it: la mariée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la mariée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a worker, then the French for a bridegroom, then say *la mariée* again

Before you move on

What does la mariée mean? (“A bride”.) Say it once more.

197.3 le veuf — a widower

Before the new one: say the French for a bridegroom, then the French for a bride.

You’ll want to know: le veuf

le veuf — “a widower”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

veuf ← Latin *viduus*, “bereaved” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le veuf*
- *Say it: le veuf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le veuf*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bridegroom, then the French for a bride, then say *le veuf* again

Before you move on

What does le veuf mean? (“A widower”.) Say it once more.

197.4 le succès — success

Before the new one: say the French for a bride, then the French for a widower.

You'll want to know: le succès

le succès — "success".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

succès ← Latin *successus*, "an outcome", from *succedere*, "to come after" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le succès*
- *Say it: le succès*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le succès*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bride, then the French for a widower, then say *le succès* again

Before you move on

What does le succès mean? ("Success".) Say it once more.

197.5 l'échec — failure

Before the new one: say the French for a widower, then the French for success.

You'll want to know: l'échec

l'échec — "failure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échec ← Old French *eschec*, "check" in chess, from Arabic, from Persian *shah*, "king" — borrowed: a check is a setback.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'échec*
- *Say it: l'échec*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'échec*
- *Recall:* say the French for a widower, then the French for success, then say *l'échec* again

Before you move on

What does l'échec mean? ("Failure".) Say it once more.

Chapter 198

Promise, Discount, Sales, Coin, Banknote

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a promise, a discount, the sales, a coin and a banknote.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 198: I can say a promise, a discount, the sales, a coin and a banknote.*

198.1 la promesse — a promise

> Before the new one: say the French for success, then the French for failure.

You'll want to know: la promesse

la promesse — "a promise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

promesse ← Latin *promissa*, "things promised" — inherited: the noun beside *promettre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la promesse*
- *Say it: la promesse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la promesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for success, then the French for failure, then say *la promesse* again

Before you move on

What does la promesse mean? ("A promise".) Say it once more.

198.2 la réduction — a discount

Before the new one: say the French for failure, then the French for a promise.

You'll want to know: la réduction

la réduction — "a discount".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réduction ← Latin *reductio*, "a leading back", from *reducere* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réduction*
- *Say it: la réduction*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la réduction*
- *Recall:* say the French for failure, then the French for a promise, then say *la réduction* again

Before you move on

What does la réduction mean? ("A discount".) Say it once more.

198.3 les soldes — the sales

Before the new one: say the French for a promise, then the French for a discount.

You'll want to know: les soldes

les soldes — "the sales".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soldes — from the verb for "to settle an account", ← Italian *saldare*, from *saldo*, "solid", ← Latin *solidus* — borrowed: goods sold off to settle up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les soldes*
- *Say it: les soldes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les soldes*
- *Recall:* say the French for a promise, then the French for a discount, then say *les soldes* again

Before you move on

What does les soldes mean? ("The sales".) Say it once more.

198.4 la pièce — a coin, a room

Before the new one: say the French for a discount, then the French for the sales.

You'll want to know: la pièce

la pièce — "a coin, a room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pièce ← Old French *piece* ← Late Latin *pettia*, "a piece", from Gaulish — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pièce*
- *Say it: la pièce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pièce*
- *Recall:* say the French for a discount, then the French for the sales, then say *la pièce* again

Before you move on

What does la pièce mean? ("A coin, a room".) Say it once more.

198.5 le billet de banque — a banknote

Before the new one: say the French for the sales, then the French for a coin.

You'll want to know: le billet de banque

le billet de banque — "a banknote".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

billet de banque — *billet*, "a note", *de*, "of", and *banque*, "bank". *Billet* ← Old French *billette*, from Latin *bulla* (EtymDB 2.1); *banque* is borrowed from Italian *banca*, "a bench", the money-changer's table.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le billet de banque*
- *Say it: le billet de banque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le billet de banque*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sales, then the French for a coin, then say *le billet de banque* again

Before you move on

What does le billet de banque mean? ("A banknote".) Say it once more.

198.6 Words from chapters 193-195 — a first pass

Say the words for a coin and a banknote.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a sheet, a drawer, an armchair, a saucepan, a frying pan
- a valley, temperature, a butterfly, a fly, a mosquito
- a dialect, a piece of news, advertising, a screen, a keyboard

Before you move on

A sheet? (**le drap**.) A drawer? (**le tiroir**.) An armchair? (**le fauteuil**.) A saucepan? (**la casserole**.) A frying pan? (**la poêle**.) A valley? (**la vallée**.) Temperature? (**la température**.) A butterfly? (**le papillon**.) A fly? (**la mouche**.) A mosquito? (**le moustique**.) A dialect? (**le dialecte**.) A piece of news? (**la nouvelle**.) Advertising? (**la publicité**.) A screen? (**l'écran**.) A

keyboard? (**le clavier**.)

198.7 Words from chapters 196-198 — a second pass

Say the words for a butcher and a mechanic.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a butcher, a mechanic, an electrician, a plumber, a worker
- a bridegroom, a bride, a widower, success, failure
- a promise, a discount, the sales, a coin, a banknote

Before you move on

A butcher? (**le boucher**.) A mechanic? (**le mécanicien**.) An electrician? (**l'électricien**.) A plumber? (**le plombier**.) A worker? (**l'ouvrier**.) A bridegroom? (**le marié**.) A bride? (**la mariée**.) A widower? (**le veuf**.) Success? (**le succès**.) Failure? (**l'échec**.) A promise? (**la promesse**.) A discount? (**la réduction**.) The sales? (**les soldes**.) A coin? (**la pièce**.) A banknote? (**le billet de banque**.)

Chapter 199

Entrance, Exit, Luggage, Seat, Steering wheel

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an entrance, an exit, luggage, a seat and a steering wheel.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 199: I can say an entrance, an exit, luggage, a seat and a steering wheel.

199.1 l'entrée — an entrance

Before the new one: say the French for a coin, a room, then the French for a banknote.

You'll want to know: l'entrée

l'entrée — "an entrance".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entrée is the past participle of the verb for "to enter", used as a noun, ← Latin *intrare* (Lewis & Short): the way in.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entrée*
- *Say it: l'entrée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'entrée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a coin, a room, then the French for a banknote, then say *l'entrée* again

Before you move on

What does l'entrée mean? ("An entrance".) Say it once more.

199.2 la sortie — an exit

Before the new one: say the French for a banknote, then the French for an entrance.

You'll want to know: la sortie

la sortie — "an exit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sortie is the past participle of the verb for "to go out", used as a noun: the way out. The verb's origin is uncertain; the usual guess is Latin *sortiri*, "to draw lots".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sortie*
- *Say it: la sortie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la sortie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a banknote, then the French for an entrance, then say *la sortie* again

Before you move on

What does la sortie mean? (“An exit”.) Say it once more.

199.3 les bagages — luggage

Before the new one: say the French for an entrance, then the French for an exit.

You’ll want to know: les bagages

les bagages — “luggage”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bagages — built from Old French *bague*, “a bundle” (EtymDB 2.1), with *-age*; *bague*’s own origin is uncertain.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les bagages*
- *Say it: les bagages*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les bagages*
- *Recall:* say the French for an entrance, then the French for an exit, then say *les bagages* again

Before you move on

What does les bagages mean? (“Luggage”.) Say it once more.

199.4 le siège — a seat

Before the new one: say the French for an exit, then the French for luggage.

You'll want to know: le siège

le siège — "a seat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

siège ← Old French *siege* ← Vulgar Latin **sedicum*, from Latin *sedes*, "a seat" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le siège*
- *Say it: le siège*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le siège*
- *Recall:* say the French for an exit, then the French for luggage, then say *le siège* again

Before you move on

What does le siège mean? ("A seat".) Say it once more.

199.5 le volant — a steering wheel

Before the new one: say the French for luggage, then the French for a seat.

You'll want to know: le volant

le volant — "a steering wheel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

volant is the present participle of the verb for "to fly", ← Latin *volare* (Lewis & Short), used as a noun: a thing that spins freely.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le volant*
- *Say it: le volant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le volant*
- *Recall:* say the French for luggage, then the French for a seat, then say *le volant* again

Before you move on

What does le volant mean? ("A steering wheel".) Say it once more.

Chapter 200

Gate, Fence, Cellar, Attic, Vegetable garden

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a gate, a fence, a cellar, an attic and a vegetable garden.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 200: I can say a gate, a fence, a cellar, an attic and a vegetable garden.

200.1 le portail — a gate

Before the new one: say the French for a seat, then the French for a steering wheel.

You'll want to know: le portail

le portail — "a gate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

portail — built from the word for "door", ← Latin *porta*, "a gate" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-ail*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le portail*
- *Say it: le portail*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le portail*
- *Recall:* say the French for a seat, then the French for a steering wheel, then say *le portail* again

Before you move on

What does le portail mean? (“A gate”.) Say it once more.

200.2 la clôture — a fence

Before the new one: say the French for a steering wheel, then the French for a gate.

You’ll want to know: la clôture

la clôture — “a fence”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clôture ← Old French *closture* ← Late Latin *clausura*, “a bar, a lock”, from *clausus*, “closed” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la clôture*
- *Say it: la clôture*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la clôture*
- *Recall:* say the French for a steering wheel, then the French for a gate, then say *la clôture* again

Before you move on

What does la clôture mean? (“A fence”.) Say it once more.

200.3 la cave — a cellar

Before the new one: say the French for a gate, then the French for a fence.

You’ll want to know: la cave

la cave — “a cellar”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cave ← Latin *cava*, “hollow places”, from *cavus*, “hollow” — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cave*
- *Say it: la cave*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la cave*
- *Recall:* say the French for a gate, then the French for a fence, then say *la cave* again

Before you move on

What does la cave mean? (“A cellar”.) Say it once more.

200.4 le grenier — an attic

Before the new one: say the French for a fence, then the French for a cellar.

You'll want to know: le grenier

le grenier — "an attic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grenier ← Old French *grenier* ← Latin *granarium*, "a granary", from *granum*, "grain" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le grenier*
- *Say it: le grenier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le grenier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fence, then the French for a cellar, then say *le grenier* again

Before you move on

What does le grenier mean? ("An attic".) Say it once more.

200.5 le potager — a vegetable garden

Before the new one: say the French for a cellar, then the French for an attic.

You'll want to know: le potager

le potager — "a vegetable garden".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

potager — built from the word for "soup", Old French *potage*, "what goes in the pot", from *pot*, ← Vulgar Latin **pottum* (EtymDB 2.1), with *-er*: the garden that fills the pot.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le potager*
- *Say it: le potager*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le potager*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cellar, then the French for an attic, then say *le potager* again

Before you move on

What does le potager mean? ("A vegetable garden".) Say it once more.

Chapter 201

Earth, Mud, Dust, Smoke, Flame

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say earth, mud, dust, smoke and a flame.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 201: I can say earth, mud, dust, smoke and a flame.*

201.1 la terre — earth, land

Before the new one: say the French for an attic, then the French for a vegetable garden.

You'll want to know: la terre

la terre — "earth, land".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

terre ← Old French *terre* ← Latin *terra*, "earth, land" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la terre*
- *Say it: la terre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la terre*
- *Recall:* say the French for an attic, then the French for a vegetable garden, then say *la terre* again

Before you move on

What does la terre mean? ("Earth, land".) Say it once more.

201.2 la boue — mud

Before the new one: say the French for a vegetable garden, then the French for earth.

You'll want to know: la boue

la boue — "mud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boue ← Gaulish **bawa*, "dirt" — a Celtic word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boue*
- *Say it: la boue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la boue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a vegetable garden, then the French for earth, then say *la boue* again

Before you move on

What does la boue mean? (“Mud”.) Say it once more.

201.3 la poussière — dust

Before the new one: say the French for earth, then the French for mud.

You’ll want to know: la poussière

la poussière — “dust”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poussière — built from Old French *pous*, “dust”, ← Vulgar Latin **pulvus*, from Latin *pulvis*, “dust” (Lewis & Short), with *-ière*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poussière*
- *Say it: la poussière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la poussière*
- *Recall:* say the French for earth, then the French for mud, then say *la poussière* again

Before you move on

What does la poussière mean? (“Dust”.) Say it once more.

201.4 la fumée — smoke

Before the new one: say the French for mud, then the French for dust.

You'll want to know: la fumée

la fumée — "smoke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fumée is the past participle of *fumer*, "to smoke", used as a noun: what is smoked out. *Fumer* ← Latin *fūmāre*, "to smoke" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fumée*
- *Say it: la fumée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la fumée*
- *Recall:* say the French for mud, then the French for dust, then say *la fumée* again

Before you move on

What does la fumée mean? ("Smoke".) Say it once more.

201.5 la flamme — a flame

Before the new one: say the French for dust, then the French for smoke.

You'll want to know: la flamme

la flamme — "a flame".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flamme ← Old French *flame* ← Latin *flamma*, "a flame" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la flamme*
- *Say it: la flamme*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la flamme*
- *Recall:* say the French for dust, then the French for smoke, then say *la flamme* again

Before you move on

What does la flamme mean? ("A flame".) Say it once more.

Chapter 202

Natural rubber, Metal, Brick, Small bag, Rope

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say natural rubber, metal, a brick, a small bag and a rope.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 202: I can say natural rubber, metal, a brick, a small bag and a rope.

202.1 le caoutchouc — natural rubber

Before the new one: say the French for smoke, then the French for a flame.

You'll want to know: le caoutchouc

le caoutchouc — "natural rubber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caoutchouc ← Spanish *caucho* ← Quechua *kawchu* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le caoutchouc*
- *Say it: le caoutchouc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le caoutchouc*
- *Recall:* say the French for smoke, then the French for a flame, then say *le caoutchouc* again

Before you move on

What does le caoutchouc mean? ("Natural rubber".) Say it once more.

202.2 le métal — metal

Before the new one: say the French for a flame, then the French for natural rubber.

You'll want to know: le métal

le métal — "metal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

métal ← Latin *metallum*, "a mine, a metal", from Greek *metallon* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le métal*
- *Say it: le métal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le métal*
- *Recall:* say the French for a flame, then the French for natural rubber, then say *le métal* again

Before you move on

What does le métal mean? (“Metal”.) Say it once more.

202.3 la brique — a brick

Before the new one: say the French for natural rubber, then the French for metal.

You’ll want to know: la brique

la brique — “a brick”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brique ← Middle Dutch *bricke* — borrowed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la brique*
- *Say it: la brique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la brique*
- *Recall:* say the French for natural rubber, then the French for metal, then say *la brique* again

Before you move on

What does la brique mean? (“A brick”.) Say it once more.

202.4 le sachet — a small bag

Before the new one: say the French for metal, then the French for a brick.

You'll want to know: le sachet

le sachet — "a small bag".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sachet — *sac*, "bag", with *-et*, "little". *Sac* ← Latin *saccus*, from Greek *sakkos* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sachet*
- *Say it: le sachet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sachet*
- *Recall:* say the French for metal, then the French for a brick, then say *le sachet* again

Before you move on

What does le sachet mean? ("A small bag".) Say it once more.

202.5 la corde — a rope

Before the new one: say the French for a brick, then the French for a small bag.

You'll want to know: la corde

la corde — "a rope".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

corde ← Old French *corde* ← Latin *chorda*, "a string of gut", from Greek *chorde* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la corde*
- *Say it: la corde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la corde*
- *Recall:* say the French for a brick, then the French for a small bag, then say *la corde* again

Before you move on

What does la corde mean? ("A rope".) Say it once more.

Chapter 203

Defeat, Championship, Player, Coach, Connection

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a defeat, a championship, a player, a coach and a connection.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 203: I can say a defeat, a championship, a player, a coach and a connection.

203.1 la défaite — a defeat

Before the new one: say the French for a small bag, then the French for a rope.

You'll want to know: la défaite

la défaite — "a defeat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défaite is the past participle of the verb for "to undo", used as a noun: an undoing. Old French had *desfait*, "undone" (EtymDB 2.1); the verb is built on Latin *facere*, "to do".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la défaite*
- *Say it: la défaite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la défaite*
- *Recall:* say the French for a small bag, then the French for a rope, then say *la défaite* again

Before you move on

What does la défaite mean? ("A defeat".) Say it once more.

203.2 le championnat — a championship

Before the new one: say the French for a rope, then the French for a defeat.

You'll want to know: le championnat

le championnat — "a championship".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

championnat — built from the word for "champion", ← Medieval Latin *campio*, "a fighter in a duel", which EtymDB 2.1 takes from Frankish **kampjo*, "a fighter", with *-at*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le championnat*
- *Say it: le championnat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le championnat*
- *Recall:* say the French for a rope, then the French for a defeat, then say *le championnat* again

Before you move on

What does le championnat mean? (“A championship”.) Say it once more.

203.3 le joueur — a player

Before the new one: say the French for a defeat, then the French for a championship.

You’ll want to know: le joueur

le joueur — “a player”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

joueur — *jouer*, “to play”, with *-eur*, “one who”. *Jouer* ← Vulgar Latin *iocāre*, “to joke” (EtymDB 2.1), and *-eur* ← Latin *-or*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le joueur*
- *Say it: le joueur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le joueur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a defeat, then the French for a championship, then say *le joueur* again

Before you move on

What does le joueur mean? (“A player”.) Say it once more.

203.4 l’entraîneur — a coach

Before the new one: say the French for a championship, then the French for a player.

You'll want to know: l'entraîneur

l'entraîneur — "a coach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entraîneur — built from the verb for "to train, to draw along", from *en-* and the verb for "to drag", ← Vulgar Latin **traginare*, from Latin *trahere*, "to draw" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entraîneur*
- *Say it: l'entraîneur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'entraîneur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a championship, then the French for a player, then say *l'entraîneur* again

Before you move on

What does l'entraîneur mean? ("A coach".) Say it once more.

203.5 la correspondance — a connection

Before the new one: say the French for a player, then the French for a coach.

You'll want to know: la correspondance

la correspondance — "a connection".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

correspondance — built from the verb for "to correspond", ← Medieval Latin *correspondere*, from *com-* and *respondere*, "to answer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la correspondance*
- *Say it: la correspondance*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la correspondance*
- *Recall:* say the French for a player, then the French for a coach, then say *la correspondance* again

Before you move on

What does la correspondance mean? ("A connection".) Say it once more.

Chapter 204

Interview, Career, Printer, Mobile phone, Sheet of paper

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an interview, a career, a printer, a mobile phone and a sheet of paper.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 204: I can say an interview, a career, a printer, a mobile phone and a sheet of paper.

204.1 l'entretien — an interview

Before the new one: say the French for a coach, then the French for a connection.

You'll want to know: l'entretien

l'entretien — "an interview".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entretien — built from *entre-*, "between", and *tenir*, "to hold": a talk held between two.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entretien*
- *Say it: l'entretien*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'entretien*
- *Recall:* say the French for a coach, then the French for a connection, then say *l'entretien* again

Before you move on

What does l'entretien mean? ("An interview".) Say it once more.

204.2 la carrière — a career

Before the new one: say the French for a connection, then the French for an interview.

You'll want to know: la carrière

la carrière — "a career".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carrière — the "career" sense ← Old Provençal *carreira*, "a road, a racecourse", from Late Latin *carraria*, "a cart road", from *carrus*, "a wagon" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carrière*
- *Say it: la carrière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carrière*
- *Recall:* say the French for a connection, then the French for an interview, then say *la carrière* again

Before you move on

What does la carrière mean? (“A career”.) Say it once more.

204.3 l’imprimante — a printer

Before the new one: say the French for an interview, then the French for a career.

You’ll want to know: l’imprimante

l’imprimante — “a printer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

imprimante — the feminine present participle of the verb for “to print”, ← Latin *imprimere*, “to press into” (Lewis & Short): the printing machine.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’imprimante*
- *Say it: l’imprimante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’imprimante*
- *Recall:* say the French for an interview, then the French for a career, then say *l’imprimante* again

Before you move on

What does l’imprimante mean? (“A printer”.) Say it once more.

204.4 le téléphone portable — a mobile phone

Before the new one: say the French for a career, then the French for a printer.

You'll want to know: le téléphone portable

le téléphone portable — "a mobile phone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

téléphone portable — *téléphone* and *portable*, "that can be carried", ← Latin *portabilis*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le téléphone portable*
- *Say it: le téléphone portable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le téléphone portable*
- *Recall:* say the French for a career, then the French for a printer, then say *le téléphone portable* again

Before you move on

What does le téléphone portable mean? ("A mobile phone".) Say it once more.

204.5 la feuille de papier — a sheet of paper

Before the new one: say the French for a printer, then the French for a mobile phone.

You'll want to know: la feuille de papier

la feuille de papier — "a sheet of paper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feuille de papier — *feuille*, "a leaf, a sheet", *de*, "of", and *papier*, "paper". *Feuille* ← Latin *folia*, "leaves", and *papier* ← Latin *papyrus* (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la feuille de papier*
- *Say it: la feuille de papier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la feuille de papier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a printer, then the French for a mobile phone, then say *la feuille de papier* again

Before you move on

What does la feuille de papier mean? ("A sheet of paper".) Say it once more.

204.6 Words from chapters 199-201 — a first pass

Say the words for a mobile phone and a sheet of paper.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an entrance, an exit, luggage, a seat, a steering wheel
- a gate, a fence, a cellar, an attic, a vegetable garden
- earth, mud, dust, smoke, a flame

Before you move on

An entrance? (**l'entrée**.) An exit? (**la sortie**.) Luggage? (**les bagages**.) A seat? (**le siège**.) A steering wheel? (**le volant**.) A gate? (**le portail**.) A fence? (**la clôture**.) A cellar? (**la cave**.) An attic? (**le grenier**.) A vegetable garden? (**le potager**.) Earth? (**la terre**.) Mud? (**la boue**.) Dust? (**la poussière**.) Smoke? (**la fumée**.) A flame? (**la flamme**.)

204.7 Words from chapters 202-204 — a second pass

Say the words for natural rubber and metal.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- natural rubber, metal, a brick, a small bag, a rope
- a defeat, a championship, a player, a coach, a connection
- an interview, a career, a printer, a mobile phone, a sheet of paper

Before you move on

Natural rubber? (**le caoutchouc**.) Metal? (**le métal**.) A brick? (**la brique**.) A small bag? (**le sachet**.) A rope? (**la corde**.) A defeat? (**la défaite**.) A championship? (**le championnat**.) A player? (**le joueur**.) A coach? (**l'entraîneur**.) A connection? (**la correspondance**.) An interview? (**l'entretien**.) A career? (**la carrière**.) A printer? (**l'imprimante**.) A mobile phone? (**le téléphone portable**.) A sheet of paper? (**la feuille de papier**.)

Chapter 205

To book, To spend, To save, To order, To dry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to book, to spend, to save, to order and to dry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 205: I can say to book, to spend, to save, to order and to dry.*

205.1 réserver — to book

Before the new one: say the French for a mobile phone, then the French for a sheet of paper.

You'll want to know: réserver

réserver — "to book".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réserver ← Latin *reservare*, "to keep back" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: réserver*
- *Say it: réserver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *réserver*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mobile phone, then the French for a sheet of paper, then say *réserver* again

Before you move on

What does réserver mean? ("To book".) Say it once more.

205.2 dépenser — to spend (money)

Before the new one: say the French for a sheet of paper, then the French for to book.

You'll want to know: dépenser

dépenser — "to spend (money)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépenser ← Old French *despenser* ← Latin *dispensare*, "to weigh out, to pay out" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dépenser*
- *Say it: dépenser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dépenser*
- *Recall:* say the French for a sheet of paper, then the French for to book, then say *dépenser* again

Before you move on

What does dépenser mean? ("To spend (money)".) Say it once more.

205.3 économiser — to save (money)

Before the new one: say the French for to book, then the French for to spend.

You'll want to know: économiser

économiser — "to save (money)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

économiser — built from the word for "economy", ← Latin *oeconomia*, from Greek *oikonomia*, "running a household" (EtymDB 2.1), with *-iser*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *économiser*
- *Say it:* *économiser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *économiser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to book, then the French for to spend, then say *économiser* again

Before you move on

What does économiser mean? ("To save (money)".) Say it once more.

205.4 commander — to order

Before the new one: say the French for to spend, then the French for to save.

You'll want to know: commander

commander — "to order".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

commander ← Old French *comander* ← Vulgar Latin **commandare*, from Latin *commendare*, "to entrust" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *commander*
- *Say it:* *commander*, once more
- *Say it:* say *commander*
- *Recall:* say the French for to spend, then the French for to save, then say *commander* again

Before you move on

What does commander mean? ("To order".) Say it once more.

205.5 sécher — to dry

Before the new one: say the French for to save, then the French for to order.

You'll want to know: sécher

sécher — "to dry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sécher ← Old French *secher* ← Latin *siccare*, "to dry", from *siccus*, the Latin of *sec* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sécher*
- *Say it: sécher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sécher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to save, then the French for to order, then say *sécher* again

Before you move on

What does sécher mean? ("To dry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 206

To break, To touch, To taste, To heat, To cool down

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to break, to touch, to taste, to heat and to cool down.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 206: I can say to break, to touch, to taste, to heat and to cool down.

206.1 casser — to break

Before the new one: say the French for to order, then the French for to dry.

You'll want to know: casser

casser — "to break".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

casser ← Old French *quasser* ← Latin *quassare*, "to shake hard, to shatter" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: casser*
- *Say it: casser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *casser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to order, then the French for to dry, then say *casser* again

Before you move on

What does casser mean? ("To break".) Say it once more.

206.2 toucher — to touch

Before the new one: say the French for to dry, then the French for to break.

You'll want to know: toucher

toucher — "to touch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toucher ← Vulgar Latin **toccare*, "to knock", imitating the sound of a tap — inherited; the account is the usual one, not certain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toucher*
- *Say it: toucher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dry, then the French for to break, then say *toucher* again

Before you move on

What does toucher mean? (“To touch”.) Say it once more.

206.3 goûter — to taste

Before the new one: say the French for to break, then the French for to touch.

You’ll want to know: goûter

goûter — “to taste”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

goûter ← Old French *goster* ← Latin *gustare*, “to taste” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: goûter*
- *Say it: goûter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *goûter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to break, then the French for to touch, then say *goûter* again

Before you move on

What does goûter mean? (“To taste”.) Say it once more.

206.4 chauffer — to heat

Before the new one: say the French for to touch, then the French for to taste.

You'll want to know: chauffer

chauffer — "to heat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chauffer ← Old French *chauffer* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **calefare*, from Latin *calefacere*, "to make warm" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chauffer*
- *Say it: chauffer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chauffer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to touch, then the French for to taste, then say *chauffer* again

Before you move on

What does chauffer mean? ("To heat".) Say it once more.

206.5 refroidir — to cool down

Before the new one: say the French for to taste, then the French for to heat.

You'll want to know: refroidir

refroidir — "to cool down".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

refroidir — built from *re-* and the word for "cold", ← Latin *frigidus* (EtymDB 2.1), with the verb ending *-ir*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: refroidir*
- *Say it: refroidir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *refroidir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to taste, then the French for to heat, then say *refroidir* again

Before you move on

What does refroidir mean? ("To cool down".) Say it once more.

Chapter 207

To be born, To die, To grow old, To marry, To divorce

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to be born, to die, to grow old, to marry and to divorce.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 207: I can say to be born, to die, to grow old, to marry and to divorce.*

207.1 naître — to be born

> Before the new one: say the French for to heat, then the French for to cool down.

You'll want to know: naître

naître — "to be born".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

naître ← Old French *naistre* ← Vulgar Latin **nascere* ← Latin *nasci*, "to be born" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naître*
- *Say it: naître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to heat, then the French for to cool down, then say *naître* again

Before you move on

What does naître mean? (“To be born”.) Say it once more.

207.2 mourir — to die

Before the new one: say the French for to cool down, then the French for to be born.

You’ll want to know: mourir

mourir — “to die”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mourir ← Old French *morir* ← Vulgar Latin **morire* ← Latin *mori*, “to die” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mourir*
- *Say it: mourir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mourir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cool down, then the French for to be born, then say *mourir* again

Before you move on

What does mourir mean? (“To die”.) Say it once more.

207.3 vieillir — to grow old

Before the new one: say the French for to be born, then the French for to die.

You’ll want to know: vieillir

vieillir — “to grow old”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vieillir — built from *vieux*, “old”, with the verb ending *-ir*: to grow old. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vieillir*
- *Say it: vieillir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vieillir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be born, then the French for to die, then say *vieillir* again

Before you move on

What does vieillir mean? (“To grow old”.) Say it once more.

207.4 épouser — to marry

Before the new one: say the French for to die, then the French for to grow old.

You'll want to know: épouser

épouser — "to marry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épouser ← Old French *espouser* ← Latin *sponsare*, "to betroth" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: épouser*
- *Say it: épouser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *épouser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to die, then the French for to grow old, then say *épouser* again

Before you move on

What does épouser mean? ("To marry".) Say it once more.

207.5 divorcer — to divorce

Before the new one: say the French for to grow old, then the French for to marry.

You'll want to know: divorcer

divorcer — "to divorce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

divorcer — formed from the noun for "a divorce", the noun behind *divorcé*. *Divorce* comes from Latin *dīvortium*, "a separation".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: divorcer*
- *Say it: divorcer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *divorcer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to grow old, then the French for to marry, then say *divorcer* again

Before you move on

What does divorcer mean? ("To divorce".) Say it once more.

Chapter 208

To applaud, To cross, To increase, To decrease, To warn

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to applaud, to cross, to increase, to decrease and to warn.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 208: I can say to applaud, to cross, to increase, to decrease and to warn.

208.1 applaudir — to applaud

Before the new one: say the French for to marry, then the French for to divorce.

You'll want to know: applaudir

applaudir — "to applaud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

applaudir ← Latin *applaudere*, "to clap the hands" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: applaudir*
- *Say it: applaudir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *applaudir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to marry, then the French for to divorce, then say *applaudir* again

Before you move on

What does applaudir mean? ("To applaud".) Say it once more.

208.2 traverser — to cross

Before the new one: say the French for to divorce, then the French for to applaud.

You'll want to know: traverser

traverser — "to cross".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

traverser ← Vulgar Latin **transversare*, from Latin *transversus*, "turned across" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: traverser*
- *Say it: traverser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *traverser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to divorce, then the French for to applaud, then say *traverser* again

Before you move on

What does traverser mean? (“To cross”.) Say it once more.

208.3 augmenter — to increase

Before the new one: say the French for to applaud, then the French for to cross.

You’ll want to know: augmenter

augmenter — “to increase”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

augmenter ← Late Latin *augmentare*, from *augere*, “to increase” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: augmenter*
- *Say it: augmenter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *augmenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to applaud, then the French for to cross, then say *augmenter* again

Before you move on

What does augmenter mean? (“To increase”.) Say it once more.

208.4 diminuer — to decrease

Before the new one: say the French for to cross, then the French for to increase.

You'll want to know: diminuer

diminuer — "to decrease".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

diminuer ← Latin *diminuere*, "to break into small pieces" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diminuer*
- *Say it: diminuer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *diminuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cross, then the French for to increase, then say *diminuer* again

Before you move on

What does diminuer mean? ("To decrease".) Say it once more.

208.5 prévenir — to warn

Before the new one: say the French for to increase, then the French for to decrease.

You'll want to know: prévenir

prévenir — "to warn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prévenir ← Latin *praevenire*, "to come before" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: to warn is to get there first.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prévenir*
- *Say it: prévenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prévenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to increase, then the French for to decrease, then say *prévenir* again

Before you move on

What does prévenir mean? ("To warn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 209

To enjoy, To imagine, To point out, To inform, To complain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to enjoy, to imagine, to point out, to inform and to complain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 209: I can say to enjoy, to imagine, to point out, to inform and to complain.*

209.1 profiter — to enjoy, to make the most of

> Before the new one: say the French for to decrease, then the French for to warn.

You'll want to know: profiter

profiter — "to enjoy, to make the most of".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

profiter — formed from the word for "profit", ← Latin *profectus*, "progress, gain" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: profiter*
- *Say it: profiter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *profiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to decrease, then the French for to warn, then say *profiter* again

Before you move on

What does profiter mean? (“To enjoy, to make the most of”.) Say it once more.

209.2 imaginer — to imagine

Before the new one: say the French for to warn, then the French for to enjoy.

You’ll want to know: imaginer

imaginer — “to imagine”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

imaginer ← Latin *imaginari*, “to picture”, from *imago*, “an image” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: imaginer*
- *Say it: imaginer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *imaginer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to warn, then the French for to enjoy, then say *imaginer* again

Before you move on

What does imaginer mean? ("To imagine".) Say it once more.

209.3 indiquer — to point out

Before the new one: say the French for to enjoy, then the French for to imagine.

You'll want to know: indiquer

indiquer — "to point out".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

indiquer ← Latin *indicare*, "to point out" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: indiquer*
- *Say it: indiquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *indiquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to enjoy, then the French for to imagine, then say *indiquer* again

Before you move on

What does indiquer mean? ("To point out".) Say it once more.

209.4 informer — to inform

Before the new one: say the French for to imagine, then the French for to point out.

You'll want to know: informer

informer — "to inform".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

informer ← Latin *informare*, "to give shape to, to describe" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: informer*
- *Say it: informer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *informer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to imagine, then the French for to point out, then say *informer* again

Before you move on

What does informer mean? ("To inform".) Say it once more.

209.5 se plaindre — to complain

Before the new one: say the French for to point out, then the French for to inform.

You'll want to know: se plaindre

se plaindre — "to complain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se plaindre ← Latin *plangere*, "to beat the breast, to lament" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se plaindre*
- *Say it: se plaindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se plaindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to point out, then the French for to inform, then say *se plaindre* again

Before you move on

What does se plaindre mean? ("To complain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 210

To reach, To achieve, To give a present, To give back, To recognise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to reach, to achieve, to give a present, to give back and to recognise.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 210: I can say to reach, to achieve, to give a present, to give back and to recognise.

210.1 atteindre — to reach

Before the new one: say the French for to inform, then the French for to complain.

You'll want to know: atteindre

atteindre — "to reach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

atteindre ← Old French *ateindre* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *attingere*, "to touch upon, to reach" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: atteindre*
- *Say it: atteindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atteindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to inform, then the French for to complain, then say *atteindre* again

Before you move on

What does atteindre mean? ("To reach".) Say it once more.

210.2 réaliser — to achieve

Before the new one: say the French for to complain, then the French for to reach.

You'll want to know: réaliser

réaliser — "to achieve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réaliser — built from the word for "real", ← Late Latin *realis*, from *res*, "a thing", with *-iser*: to make real. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: réaliser*
- *Say it: réaliser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *réaliser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to complain, then the French for to reach, then say *réaliser* again

Before you move on

What does réaliser mean? (“To achieve”.) Say it once more.

210.3 offrir un cadeau — to give a present

Before the new one: say the French for to reach, then the French for to achieve.

You’ll want to know: offrir un cadeau

offrir un cadeau — “to give a present”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

offrir un cadeau — *offrir*, “to offer”, ← Latin *offerre* (EtymDB 2.1), *un*, “a”, and *cadeau*, “a present”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: offrir un cadeau*
- *Say it: offrir un cadeau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *offrir un cadeau*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reach, then the French for to achieve, then say *offrir un cadeau* again

Before you move on

What does offrir un cadeau mean? (“To give a present”.) Say it once more.

210.4 rendre — to give back

Before the new one: say the French for to achieve, then the French for to give a present.

You'll want to know: rendre

rendre — "to give back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rendre ← Vulgar Latin **rendere* ← Latin *reddere*, "to give back" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited, its *-n-* taken from the Latin verb for "to take".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rendre*
- *Say it: rendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to achieve, then the French for to give a present, then say *rendre* again

Before you move on

What does rendre mean? ("To give back".) Say it once more.

210.5 reconnaître — to recognise

Before the new one: say the French for to give a present, then the French for to give back.

You'll want to know: reconnaître

reconnaître — "to recognise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reconnaître ← Old French *reconoistre* ← Latin *recognoscere*, "to know anew" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *connaître* with *re-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reconnaître*
- *Say it: reconnaître*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reconnaître*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give a present, then the French for to give back, then say *reconnaître* again

Before you move on

What does reconnaître mean? ("To recognise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 211

To be silent, To fear, To attempt, To transport, To kill

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to be silent, to fear, to attempt, to transport and to kill.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 211: I can say to be silent, to fear, to attempt, to transport and to kill.

211.1 se taire — to be silent

Before the new one: say the French for to give back, then the French for to recognise.

You'll want to know: se taire

se taire — "to be silent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se taire ← Old French *taire* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *tacere*, "to be silent" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *se taire*
- *Say it:* *se taire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se taire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give back, then the French for to recognise, then say *se taire* again

Before you move on

What does se taire mean? ("To be silent".) Say it once more.

211.2 craindre — to fear

Before the new one: say the French for to recognise, then the French for to be silent.

You'll want to know: craindre

craindre — "to fear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

craindre — usually traced to Latin *tremere*, "to tremble" (Lewis & Short), whose *t-* became *c-*, perhaps under a Gaulish word — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *craindre*
- *Say it:* *craindre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *craindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to recognise, then the French for to be silent, then say *craindre* again

Before you move on

What does craindre mean? (“To fear”.) Say it once more.

211.3 tenter — to attempt

Before the new one: say the French for to be silent, then the French for to fear.

You’ll want to know: tenter

tenter — “to attempt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tenter ← Latin *temptare*, “to test, to try” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *-mpt-* regularly became *-nt-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tenter*
- *Say it: tenter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be silent, then the French for to fear, then say *tenter* again

Before you move on

What does tenter mean? (“To attempt”.) Say it once more.

211.4 transporter — to transport

Before the new one: say the French for to fear, then the French for to attempt.

You'll want to know: transporter

transporter — "to transport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

transporter ← Latin *transportare*, "to carry across" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: transporter*
- *Say it: transporter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *transporter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fear, then the French for to attempt, then say *transporter* again

Before you move on

What does transporter mean? ("To transport".) Say it once more.

211.5 tuer — to kill

Before the new one: say the French for to attempt, then the French for to transport.

You'll want to know: tuer

tuer — "to kill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tuer ← Old French *tuer* ← Vulgar Latin **tutare*, "to put out (a fire)", from Latin *tutari*, "to guard" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuer*
- *Say it: tuer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to attempt, then the French for to transport, then say *tuer* again

Before you move on

What does tuer mean? ("To kill".) Say it once more.

Chapter 212

To fix, To brake, To function, To float, To chase

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to fix, to brake, to function, to float and to chase.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 212: I can say to fix, to brake, to function, to float and to chase.*

212.1 fixer — to fix, to stare at

> Before the new one: say the French for to transport, then the French for to kill.

You'll want to know: fixer

fixer — "to fix, to stare at".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fixer — built from the word for "fixed", ← Latin *fixus*, from *figere*, "to fasten". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fixer*
- *Say it: fixer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fixer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to transport, then the French for to kill, then say *fixer* again

Before you move on

What does fixer mean? ("To fix, to stare at".) Say it once more.

212.2 freiner — to brake

Before the new one: say the French for to kill, then the French for to fix.

You'll want to know: freiner

freiner — "to brake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

freiner — built from the word for "a bit, a brake", ← Latin *frenum*, "a bridle" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: freiner*
- *Say it: freiner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *freiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to kill, then the French for to fix, then say *freiner* again

Before you move on

What does freiner mean? ("To brake".) Say it once more.

212.3 fonctionner — to function, to work

Before the new one: say the French for to fix, then the French for to brake.

You'll want to know: fonctionner

fonctionner — "to function, to work".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fonctionner — built from the word for "function", ← Latin *functio*, "a performing", with *-er*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fonctionner*
- *Say it: fonctionner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fonctionner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fix, then the French for to brake, then say *fonctionner* again

Before you move on

What does fonctionner mean? ("To function, to work".) Say it once more.

212.4 flotter — to float

Before the new one: say the French for to brake, then the French for to function.

You'll want to know: flotter

flotter — "to float".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flotter ← Old French *floter* ← Frankish **flotan*, "to float" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: flotter*
- *Say it: flotter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *flotter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to brake, then the French for to function, then say *flotter* again

Before you move on

What does flotter mean? ("To float".) Say it once more.

212.5 poursuivre — to chase

Before the new one: say the French for to function, then the French for to float.

You'll want to know: poursuivre

poursuivre — "to chase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poursuivre ← Old French *porsivre* (EtymDB 2.1), from *pour-*, "forward", and the verb for "to follow", ← Latin *sequi* — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poursuivre*
- *Say it: poursuivre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poursuivre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to function, then the French for to float, then say *poursuivre* again

Before you move on

What does poursuivre mean? ("To chase".) Say it once more.

Chapter 213

To lift, To surprise, To suspect, To squeeze, To suggest

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to lift, to surprise, to suspect, to squeeze and to suggest.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 213: I can say to lift, to surprise, to suspect, to squeeze and to suggest.

213.1 soulever — to lift

Before the new one: say the French for to float, then the French for to chase.

You'll want to know: soulever

soulever — "to lift".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soulever — *sou-*, "under", and *lever*, "to lift": to lift from beneath. *Lever* ← Latin *levāre*, "to raise" (EtymDB 2.1), and *sou-* ← Latin *sub*, "under".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soulever*
- *Say it: soulever*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soulever*
- *Recall:* say the French for to float, then the French for to chase, then say *soulever* again

Before you move on

What does soulever mean? ("To lift".) Say it once more.

213.2 surprendre — to surprise

Before the new one: say the French for to chase, then the French for to lift.

You'll want to know: surprendre

surprendre — "to surprise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

surprendre ← Old French *sorprendre*, "to overtake": *sur-*, "over", and *prendre*, "to take". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: surprendre*
- *Say it: surprendre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *surprendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to chase, then the French for to lift, then say *surprendre* again

Before you move on

What does surprendre mean? ("To surprise".) Say it once more.

213.3 soupçonner — to suspect

Before the new one: say the French for to lift, then the French for to surprise.

You'll want to know: soupçonner

soupçonner — "to suspect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soupçonner — built from the word for "suspicion", ← Late Latin *suspectio*, from *suspicere*, "to look up at, to suspect" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soupçonner*
- *Say it: soupçonner*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soupçonner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lift, then the French for to surprise, then say *soupçonner* again

Before you move on

What does soupçonner mean? ("To suspect".) Say it once more.

213.4 serrer — to squeeze

Before the new one: say the French for to surprise, then the French for to suspect.

You'll want to know: serrer

serrer — "to squeeze".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serrer ← Old French *serrer* ← Vulgar Latin **serrare* ← Late Latin *serare*, "to bolt", from *sera*, "a bar" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the verb behind *serrure*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: serrer*
- *Say it: serrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *serrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to surprise, then the French for to suspect, then say *serrer* again

Before you move on

What does serrer mean? ("To squeeze".) Say it once more.

213.5 suggérer — to suggest

Before the new one: say the French for to suspect, then the French for to squeeze.

You'll want to know: suggérer

suggérer — "to suggest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

suggérer ← Latin *suggerere*, "to bring up, to supply" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suggérer*
- *Say it: suggérer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *suggérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to suspect, then the French for to squeeze, then say *suggérer* again

Before you move on

What does suggérer mean? ("To suggest".) Say it once more.

213.6 Words from chapters 205-208 — a first pass

Say the words for to squeeze and to suggest.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to book, to spend, to save, to order, to dry
- to break, to touch, to taste, to heat, to cool down
- to be born, to die, to grow old, to marry, to divorce
- to applaud, to cross, to increase, to decrease, to warn

Before you move on

To book? (**réserver**.) To spend? (**dépenser**.) To save? (**économiser**.) To order? (**commander**.) To dry? (**sécher**.) To break? (**casser**.) To touch? (**toucher**.) To taste? (**goûter**.) To heat? (**chauffer**.) To cool down? (**refroidir**.) To be born? (**naître**.) To die? (**mourir**.) To grow old? (**vieillir**.) To marry?

(**épouser**.) To divorce? (**divorcer**.) To applaud? (**applaudir**.) To cross? (**traverser**.) To increase? (**augmenter**.) To decrease? (**diminuer**.) To warn? (**prévenir**.)

213.7 Words from chapters 209-213 — a second pass

Say the words for to enjoy and to imagine.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to enjoy, to imagine, to point out, to inform, to complain
- to reach, to achieve, to give a present, to give back, to recognise
- to be silent, to fear, to attempt, to transport, to kill
- to fix, to brake, to function, to float, to chase
- to lift, to surprise, to suspect, to squeeze, to suggest

Before you move on

To enjoy? (**profiter**.) To imagine? (**imaginer**.) To point out? (**indiquer**.) To inform? (**informer**.) To complain? (**se plaindre**.) To reach? (**atteindre**.) To achieve? (**réaliser**.) To give a present? (**offrir un cadeau**.) To give back? (**rendre**.) To recognise? (**reconnaître**.) To be silent? (**se taire**.) To fear? (**craindre**.) To attempt? (**tenter**.) To transport? (**transporter**.) To kill? (**tuer**.) To fix? (**fixer**.) To brake? (**freiner**.) To function? (**fonctionner**.) To float? (**flotter**.) To chase? (**poursuivre**.) To lift? (**soulever**.) To surprise? (**surprendre**.) To suspect? (**soupçonner**.) To squeeze? (**serrer**.) To suggest? (**suggérer**.)

Chapter 214

To record, To maintain, To exist, To express, To put on weight

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to record, to maintain, to exist, to express and to put on weight.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 214: I can say to record, to maintain, to exist, to express and to put on weight.*

214.1 enregistrer — to record

> Before the new one: say the French for to squeeze, then the French for to suggest.

You'll want to know: enregistrer

enregistrer — "to record".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enregistrer — built from *en-*, the word for "a register", ← Medieval Latin *registrum* (EtymDB 2.1), and *-er*: to put in the register.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *enregistrer*
- *Say it:* *enregistrer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *enregistrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to squeeze, then the French for to suggest, then say *enregistrer* again

Before you move on

What does enregistrer mean? ("To record".) Say it once more.

214.2 entretenir — to maintain

Before the new one: say the French for to suggest, then the French for to record.

You'll want to know: entretenir

entretenir — "to maintain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entretenir ← Old French *entretenir*: *entre-*, "between", and *tenir*, "to hold". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *entretenir*
- *Say it:* *entretenir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *entretenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to suggest, then the French for to record, then say *entretenir* again

Before you move on

What does entretenir mean? (“To maintain”.) Say it once more.

214.3 exister — to exist

Before the new one: say the French for to record, then the French for to maintain.

You’ll want to know: exister

exister — “to exist”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exister ← Latin *existere*, “to stand out, to arise” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: exister*
- *Say it: exister*, once more
- *Say it:* say *exister*
- *Recall:* say the French for to record, then the French for to maintain, then say *exister* again

Before you move on

What does exister mean? (“To exist”.) Say it once more.

214.4 exprimer — to express

Before the new one: say the French for to maintain, then the French for to exist.

You'll want to know: exprimer

exprimer — "to express".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exprimer ← Latin *exprimere*, "to press out" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: exprimer*
- *Say it: exprimer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *exprimer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to maintain, then the French for to exist, then say *exprimer* again

Before you move on

What does exprimer mean? ("To express".) Say it once more.

214.5 grossir — to put on weight

Before the new one: say the French for to exist, then the French for to express.

You'll want to know: grossir

grossir — "to put on weight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grossir — *gros*, "fat", with the verb ending *-ir*: to grow fat. *Gros* ← Late Latin *grossus*, "thick" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grossir*
- *Say it: grossir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grossir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to exist, then the French for to express, then say *grossir* again

Before you move on

What does grossir mean? ("To put on weight".) Say it once more.

Chapter 215

Flu, Prescription, Tablet, Syrup, Ointment

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say flu, a prescription, a tablet, a syrup and an ointment.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 215: I can say flu, a prescription, a tablet, a syrup and an ointment.*

215.1 la grippe — flu

> Before the new one: say the French for to express, then the French for to put on weight.

You'll want to know: la grippe

la grippe — "flu".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grippe — formed from the verb for "to seize", from Frankish **gripan*, "to grab" (EtymDB 2.1): the illness that grabs you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grippe*
- *Say it: la grippe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la grippe*
- *Recall:* say the French for to express, then the French for to put on weight, then say *la grippe* again

Before you move on

What does la grippe mean? ("Flu".) Say it once more.

215.2 l'ordonnance — a prescription

Before the new one: say the French for to put on weight, then the French for flu.

You'll want to know: l'ordonnance

l'ordonnance — "a prescription".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ordonnance — built from the verb for "to arrange, to order", ← Latin *ordinare*, from *ordo*, "order" (Lewis & Short), with *-ance*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ordonnance*
- *Say it: l'ordonnance*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'ordonnance*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put on weight, then the French for flu, then say *l'ordonnance* again

Before you move on

What does l'ordonnance mean? ("A prescription".) Say it once more.

215.3 le comprimé — a tablet (medicine)

Before the new one: say the French for flu, then the French for a prescription.

You'll want to know: le comprimé

le comprimé — "a tablet (medicine)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comprimé is the past participle of the verb for "to compress", ← Latin *comprimere*, "to press together" (Lewis & Short): a pressed tablet.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le comprimé*
- *Say it: le comprimé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le comprimé*
- *Recall:* say the French for flu, then the French for a prescription, then say *le comprimé* again

Before you move on

What does le comprimé mean? ("A tablet (medicine)".) Say it once more.

215.4 le sirop — a syrup

Before the new one: say the French for a prescription, then the French for a tablet.

You'll want to know: le sirop

le sirop — "a syrup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sirop ← Medieval Latin *siruppus*, from Arabic *sharab*, "a drink" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sirop*
- *Say it: le sirop*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sirop*
- *Recall:* say the French for a prescription, then the French for a tablet, then say *le sirop* again

Before you move on

What does le sirop mean? ("A syrup".) Say it once more.

215.5 la pommade — an ointment

Before the new one: say the French for a tablet, then the French for a syrup.

You'll want to know: la pommade

la pommade — "an ointment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pommade ← Italian *pomata*, from *pomo*, "apple", ← Latin *pomum* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed: the first ointments were made with apples.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pommade*
- *Say it: la pommade*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pommade*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tablet, then the French for a syrup, then say *la pommade* again

Before you move on

What does la pommade mean? ("An ointment".) Say it once more.

Chapter 216

Around, Everywhere, Elsewhere, Up there, Suburbs

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say around, everywhere, elsewhere, up there and the suburbs.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 216: I can say around, everywhere, elsewhere, up there and the suburbs.*

216.1 autour — around

Before the new one: say the French for a syrup, then the French for an ointment.

You'll want to know: autour

autour — "around".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

autour — *au* and the word for "a turn", ← Latin *tornus*, "a lathe": round about. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: autour*
- *Say it: autour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *autour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a syrup, then the French for an ointment, then say *autour* again

Before you move on

What does autour mean? ("Around".) Say it once more.

216.2 partout — everywhere

Before the new one: say the French for an ointment, then the French for around.

You'll want to know: partout

partout — "everywhere".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

partout — the words for "through" and "all", the second ← Latin *totus* (EtymDB 2.1): through all places.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: partout*
- *Say it: partout*, once more
- *Say it:* say *partout*
- *Recall:* say the French for an ointment, then the French for around, then say *partout* again

Before you move on

What does partout mean? ("Everywhere".) Say it once more.

216.3 ailleurs — elsewhere

Before the new one: say the French for around, then the French for everywhere.

You'll want to know: ailleurs

ailleurs — "elsewhere".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ailleurs ← Old French *aillors* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *aliorsum*, "toward another place" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ailleurs*
- *Say it: ailleurs*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ailleurs*
- *Recall:* say the French for around, then the French for everywhere, then say *ailleurs* again

Before you move on

What does ailleurs mean? ("Elsewhere".) Say it once more.

216.4 là-haut — up there

Before the new one: say the French for everywhere, then the French for elsewhere.

You'll want to know: là-haut

là-haut — "up there".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

là-haut — *là*, "there", and *haut*, "high". *Haut* ← Latin *altus*, "high", with an *h* from Frankish (EtymDB 2.1 records the Frankish *hauh*); *là* ← Latin *illāc*, "there".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: là-haut*
- *Say it: là-haut*, once more
- *Say it:* say *là-haut*
- *Recall:* say the French for everywhere, then the French for elsewhere, then say *là-haut* again

Before you move on

What does là-haut mean? ("Up there".) Say it once more.

216.5 la banlieue — the suburbs

Before the new one: say the French for elsewhere, then the French for up there.

You'll want to know: la banlieue

la banlieue — "the suburbs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banlieue ← Medieval Latin *banleuca*: *ban*, "a lord's rule", a Frankish word, and *leuca*, "a league", a Gaulish one — the land within a league of a town. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la banlieue*
- *Say it: la banlieue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la banlieue*
- *Recall:* say the French for elsewhere, then the French for up there, then say *la banlieue* again

Before you move on

What does la banlieue mean? ("The suburbs".) Say it once more.

Chapter 217

Almost, About, Only, Together, Nevertheless

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say almost, about, only, together and nevertheless.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 217: I can say almost, about, only, together and nevertheless.

217.1 presque — almost

Before the new one: say the French for up there, then the French for the suburbs.

You'll want to know: presque

presque — "almost".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

presque — *près*, "near", and *que*, "that": nearly. *Près* ← Latin *presse*, "closely" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: presque*
- *Say it: presque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *presque*
- *Recall:* say the French for up there, then the French for the suburbs, then say *presque* again

Before you move on

What does presque mean? ("Almost".) Say it once more.

217.2 environ — about, approximately

Before the new one: say the French for the suburbs, then the French for almost.

You'll want to know: environ

environ — "about, approximately".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

environ — *en*, "in", and Old French *viron*, "a circuit", from the verb for "to turn": in the round of. *En* ← Latin *in*; the verb behind *viron* is of uncertain origin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: environ*
- *Say it: environ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *environ*
- *Recall:* say the French for the suburbs, then the French for almost, then say *environ* again

Before you move on

What does environ mean? (“About, approximately”.) Say it once more.

217.3 seulement — only

Before the new one: say the French for almost, then the French for about.

You’ll want to know: seulement

seulement — “only”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

seulement — the word for “alone”, ← Latin *solus* (Lewis & Short), with *-ment*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: seulement*
- *Say it: seulement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *seulement*
- *Recall:* say the French for almost, then the French for about, then say *seulement* again

Before you move on

What does seulement mean? (“Only”.) Say it once more.

217.4 ensemble — together

Before the new one: say the French for about, then the French for only.

You'll want to know: ensemble

ensemble — "together".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ensemble ← Late Latin *insimul*, "at the same time", from *simul*, "together" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ensemble*
- *Say it:* *ensemble*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ensemble*
- *Recall:* say the French for about, then the French for only, then say *ensemble* again

Before you move on

What does ensemble mean? ("Together".) Say it once more.

217.5 cependant — nevertheless, however

Before the new one: say the French for only, then the French for together.

You'll want to know: cependant

cependant — "nevertheless, however".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cependant — *ce*, "this", and the word for "during", from the verb for "to hang", ← Latin *pendere* (EtymDB 2.1): "during this".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cependant*
- *Say it:* *cependant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cependant*
- *Recall:* say the French for only, then the French for together, then say *cependant* again

Before you move on

What does cependant mean? ("Nevertheless, however".) Say it once more.

Chapter 218

Curious, Jealous, Proud, Nervous, Quiet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say curious, jealous, proud, nervous and quiet.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 218: I can say curious, jealous, proud, nervous and quiet.

218.1 curieux / curieuse — curious

Before the new one: say the French for together, then the French for nevertheless.

You'll want to know: curieux / curieuse

curieux / curieuse — "curious".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

curieux ← Latin *curiosus*, "careful, inquisitive", from *cura*, "care" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: curieux / curieuse*
- *Say it: curieux / curieuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *curieux / curieuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for together, then the French for nevertheless, then say *curieux / curieuse* again

Before you move on

What does curieux / curieuse mean? ("Curious".) Say it once more.

218.2 jaloux / jalouse — jealous

Before the new one: say the French for nevertheless, then the French for curious.

You'll want to know: jaloux / jalouse

jaloux / jalouse — "jealous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jaloux ← Old French *jalous* ← Late Latin *zelosus*, from *zelus*, "zeal", from Greek *zelos* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jaloux / jalouse*
- *Say it: jaloux / jalouse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jaloux / jalouse*
- *Recall:* say the French for nevertheless, then the French for curious, then say *jaloux / jalouse* again

Before you move on

What does jaloux / jalouse mean? (“Jealous”.) Say it once more.

218.3 fier / fière — proud

Before the new one: say the French for curious, then the French for jealous.

You’ll want to know: fier / fière

fier / fière — “proud”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fier ← Latin *ferus*, “wild, untamed” (Lewis & Short) — inherited: fierce first, then proud.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fier / fière*
- *Say it: fier / fière*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fier / fière*
- *Recall:* say the French for curious, then the French for jealous, then say *fier / fière* again

Before you move on

What does fier / fière mean? (“Proud”.) Say it once more.

218.4 nerveux / nerveuse — nervous

Before the new one: say the French for jealous, then the French for proud.

You'll want to know: nerveux / nerveuse

nerveux / nerveuse — "nervous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nerveux ← Old French *nerveus* ← Latin *nervosus*, "sinewy", from *nervus*, "a sinew" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nerveux / nerveuse*
- *Say it: nerveux / nerveuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nerveux / nerveuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for jealous, then the French for proud, then say *nerveux / nerveuse* again

Before you move on

What does nerveux / nerveuse mean? ("Nervous".) Say it once more.

218.5 tranquille — quiet, peaceful

Before the new one: say the French for proud, then the French for nervous.

You'll want to know: tranquille

tranquille — "quiet, peaceful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tranquille ← Latin *tranquillus*, "calm" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tranquille*
- *Say it: tranquille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tranquille*
- *Recall:* say the French for proud, then the French for nervous, then say *tranquille* again

Before you move on

What does tranquille mean? ("Quiet, peaceful".) Say it once more.

Chapter 219

Boring, Fun, Strange, Different, Same

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say boring, fun, strange, different and the same.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 219: I can say boring, fun, strange, different and the same.

219.1 ennuyeux / ennuyeuse — boring

Before the new one: say the French for nervous, then the French for quiet.

You'll want to know: ennuyeux / ennuyeuse

ennuyeux / ennuyeuse — "boring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ennuyeux — built from the noun beside *s'ennuyer*, with *-eux*, "full of": full of boredom.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ennuyeux / ennuyeuse*
- *Say it: ennuyeux / ennuyeuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ennuyeux / ennuyeuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for nervous, then the French for quiet, then say *ennuyeux / ennuyeuse* again

Before you move on

What does ennuyeux / ennuyeuse mean? ("Boring".) Say it once more.

219.2 amusant / amusante — fun, amusing

Before the new one: say the French for quiet, then the French for boring.

You'll want to know: amusant / amusante

amusant / amusante — "fun, amusing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amusant is the present participle of the verb in *s'amuser*, "to amuse": amusing. *Amuser* ← Old French *amuser*, "to keep idle", from *muser*, "to gape" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: amusant / amusante*
- *Say it: amusant / amusante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *amusant / amusante*

- *Recall:* say the French for quiet, then the French for boring, then say *amusant / amusante* again

Before you move on

What does amusant / amusante mean? ("Fun, amusing".) Say it once more.

219.3 étrange — strange

Before the new one: say the French for boring, then the French for fun.

You'll want to know: étrange

étrange — "strange".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étrange ← Old French *estrange* ← Latin *extraneus*, "from outside, foreign" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: étrange*
- *Say it: étrange*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étrange*
- *Recall:* say the French for boring, then the French for fun, then say *étrange* again

Before you move on

What does étrange mean? ("Strange".) Say it once more.

219.4 différent / différente — different

Before the new one: say the French for fun, then the French for strange.

You'll want to know: différent / différente

différent / différente — "different".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

différent ← Latin *differens*, "carrying apart", from *differre* (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: différent / différente*
- *Say it: différent / différente*, once more
- *Say it:* say *différent / différente*
- *Recall:* say the French for fun, then the French for strange, then say *différent / différente* again

Before you move on

What does différent / différente mean? ("Different".) Say it once more.

219.5 pareil / pareille — the same

Before the new one: say the French for strange, then the French for different.

You'll want to know: pareil / pareille

pareil / pareille — "the same".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pareil ← Middle French *pareil* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **pariculus*, from Latin *par*, "equal" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pareil / pareille*
- *Say it: pareil / pareille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pareil / pareille*
- *Recall:* say the French for strange, then the French for different, then say *pareil / pareille* again

Before you move on

What does pareil / pareille mean? ("The same".) Say it once more.

Chapter 220

Punctual, Foreign, Friendly, Honest, Patient

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say punctual, foreign, friendly, honest and patient.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 220: I can say punctual, foreign, friendly, honest and patient.*

220.1 ponctuel / ponctuelle — punctual

> Before the new one: say the French for different, then the French for the same.

You'll want to know: ponctuel / ponctuelle

ponctuel / ponctuelle — "punctual".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ponctuel ← Medieval Latin *punctualis*, from *punctus*, "a point" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ponctuel / ponctuelle*
- *Say it: ponctuel / ponctuelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ponctuel / ponctuelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for different, then the French for the same, then say *ponctuel / ponctuelle* again

Before you move on

What does ponctuel / ponctuelle mean? ("Punctual".) Say it once more.

220.2 étranger / étrangère — foreign

Before the new one: say the French for the same, then the French for punctual.

You'll want to know: étranger / étrangère

étranger / étrangère — "foreign".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étranger — built from *étrange*, then meaning "foreign", with *-ier*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: étranger / étrangère*
- *Say it: étranger / étrangère*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étranger / étrangère*
- *Recall:* say the French for the same, then the French for punctual, then say *étranger / étrangère* again

Before you move on

What does étranger / étrangère mean? (“Foreign”.) Say it once more.

220.3 aimable — friendly

Before the new one: say the French for punctual, then the French for foreign.

You’ll want to know: aimable

aimable — “friendly”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aimable ← Latin *amabilis*, “lovable” (Lewis & Short) — inherited, reshaped on *aimer*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aimable*
- *Say it: aimable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aimable*
- *Recall:* say the French for punctual, then the French for foreign, then say *aimable* again

Before you move on

What does aimable mean? (“Friendly”.) Say it once more.

220.4 honnête — honest

Before the new one: say the French for foreign, then the French for friendly.

You'll want to know: honnête

honnête — "honest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

honnête ← Old French *honeste* ← Latin *honestus*, "honourable", from *honor* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; the circumflex marks the lost *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: honnête*
- *Say it: honnête*, once more
- *Say it:* say *honnête*
- *Recall:* say the French for foreign, then the French for friendly, then say *honnête* again

Before you move on

What does honnête mean? ("Honest".) Say it once more.

220.5 patient / patiente — patient

Before the new one: say the French for friendly, then the French for honest.

You'll want to know: patient / patiente

patient / patiente — "patient".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

patient ← Latin *patiens*, *patientis*, "enduring", from *pati*, "to suffer" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: patient / paciente*
- *Say it: patient / paciente*, once more
- *Say it:* say *patient / paciente*
- *Recall:* say the French for friendly, then the French for honest, then say *patient / paciente* again

Before you move on

What does patient / paciente mean? ("Patient".) Say it once more.

Chapter 221

Scissors, Watch, Pyjamas, Button, Peach

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say scissors, a watch, pyjamas, a button and a peach.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 221: I can say scissors, a watch, pyjamas, a button and a peach.

221.1 les ciseaux — scissors

Before the new one: say the French for honest, then the French for patient.

You'll want to know: les ciseaux

les ciseaux — "scissors".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ciseaux is the plural of the word for "a chisel", usually traced to Late Latin *cisorium*, "a cutting tool", from *caedere*, "to cut" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les ciseaux*
- *Say it: les ciseaux*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les ciseaux*
- *Recall:* say the French for honest, then the French for patient, then say *les ciseaux* again

Before you move on

What does les ciseaux mean? ("Scissors".) Say it once more.

221.2 la montre — a watch

Before the new one: say the French for patient, then the French for scissors.

You'll want to know: la montre

la montre — "a watch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

montre — formed from *montrer*, "to show": the thing that shows the time.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la montre*
- *Say it: la montre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la montre*
- *Recall:* say the French for patient, then the French for scissors, then say *la montre* again

Before you move on

What does la montre mean? (“A watch”.) Say it once more.

221.3 le pyjama — pyjamas

Before the new one: say the French for scissors, then the French for a watch.

You’ll want to know: le pyjama

le pyjama — “pyjamas”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pyjama ← English *pyjamas*, from Hindi *pajama*, from Persian, “a leg garment” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pyjama*
- *Say it: le pyjama*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pyjama*
- *Recall:* say the French for scissors, then the French for a watch, then say *le pyjama* again

Before you move on

What does le pyjama mean? (“Pyjamas”.) Say it once more.

221.4 le bouton — a button

Before the new one: say the French for a watch, then the French for pyjamas.

You'll want to know: le bouton

le bouton — "a button".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouton ← Old French *boton*, built from *boter*, "to push, to sprout" (EtymDB 2.1): a bud, then a button.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bouton*
- *Say it: le bouton*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le bouton*
- *Recall:* say the French for a watch, then the French for pyjamas, then say *le bouton* again

Before you move on

What does le bouton mean? ("A button".) Say it once more.

221.5 la pêche — a peach

Before the new one: say the French for pyjamas, then the French for a button.

You'll want to know: la pêche

la pêche — "a peach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pêche ← Old French *pesche* ← Vulgar Latin **pessica*, from Latin *persica*, "the Persian (apple)" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pêche*
- *Say it: la pêche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pêche*
- *Recall:* say the French for pyjamas, then the French for a button, then say *la pêche* again

Before you move on

What does la pêche mean? ("A peach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 222

Society, Government, Law, Court, Judge

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say society, the government, a law, a court and a judge.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 222: I can say society, the government, a law, a court and a judge.

222.1 la société — society

Before the new one: say the French for a button, then the French for a peach.

You'll want to know: la société

la société — "society".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

société ← Latin *societas*, "fellowship", from *socius*, "a companion" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la société*
- *Say it: la société*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la société*
- *Recall:* say the French for a button, then the French for a peach, then say *la société* again

Before you move on

What does la société mean? ("Society".) Say it once more.

222.2 le gouvernement — the government

Before the new one: say the French for a peach, then the French for society.

You'll want to know: le gouvernement

le gouvernement — "the government".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gouvernement — built from the verb for "to govern", ← Latin *gubernare*, "to steer a ship" (Lewis & Short), with *-ment*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gouvernement*
- *Say it: le gouvernement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le gouvernement*
- *Recall:* say the French for a peach, then the French for society, then say *le gouvernement* again

Before you move on

What does le gouvernement mean? ("The government".) Say it once more.

222.3 la loi — a law

Before the new one: say the French for society, then the French for the government.

You'll want to know: la loi

la loi — "a law".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loi ← Old French *loi* ← Latin *lex*, *legis*, "law" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la loi*
- *Say it: la loi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la loi*
- *Recall:* say the French for society, then the French for the government, then say *la loi* again

Before you move on

What does la loi mean? ("A law".) Say it once more.

222.4 le tribunal — a court

Before the new one: say the French for the government, then the French for a law.

You'll want to know: le tribunal

le tribunal — "a court".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tribunal ← Latin *tribunal*, "the raised seat of the tribunes" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tribunal*
- *Say it: le tribunal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tribunal*
- *Recall:* say the French for the government, then the French for a law, then say *le tribunal* again

Before you move on

What does le tribunal mean? ("A court".) Say it once more.

222.5 le juge — a judge

Before the new one: say the French for a law, then the French for a court.

You'll want to know: le juge

le juge — "a judge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juge ← Old French *juge* ← Latin *iudex*, *iudicis*, "a judge", from *ius*, "law", and *dicere*, "to say" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le juge*
- *Say it: le juge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le juge*
- *Recall:* say the French for a law, then the French for a court, then say *le juge* again

Before you move on

What does le juge mean? ("A judge".) Say it once more.

222.6 Words from chapters 214-217 — a first pass

Say the words for a court and a judge.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to record, to maintain, to exist, to express, to put on weight
- flu, a prescription, a tablet, a syrup, an ointment
- around, everywhere, elsewhere, up there, the suburbs
- almost, about, only, together, nevertheless

Before you move on

To record? (**enregistrer**.) To maintain? (**entretenir**.) To exist? (**exister**.) To express? (**exprimer**.) To put on weight? (**grossir**.) Flu? (**la grippe**.) A prescription? (**l'ordonnance**.) A tablet? (**le comprimé**.) A syrup? (**le sirop**.) An ointment? (**la pommade**.) Around? (**autour**.) Everywhere? (**partout**.) Elsewhere?

(**ailleurs**.) Up there? (**là-haut**.) The suburbs? (**la banlieue**.) Almost? (**presque**.) About? (**environ**.) Only? (**seulement**.) Together? (**ensemble**.) Nevertheless? (**cependant**.)

222.7 Words from chapters 218-222 — a second pass

Say the words for curious and jealous.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- curious, jealous, proud, nervous, quiet
- boring, fun, strange, different, the same
- punctual, foreign, friendly, honest, patient
- scissors, a watch, pyjamas, a button, a peach
- society, the government, a law, a court, a judge

Before you move on

Curious? (**curieux / curieuse**.) Jealous? (**jaloux / jalouse**.) Proud? (**fier / fière**.) Nervous? (**nerveux / nerveuse**.) Quiet? (**tranquille**.) Boring? (**ennuyeux / ennuyeuse**.) Fun? (**amusant / amusante**.) Strange? (**étrange**.) Different? (**différent / différente**.) The same? (**pareil / pareille**.) Punctual? (**ponctuel / ponctuelle**.) Foreign? (**étranger / étrangère**.) Friendly? (**aimable**.) Honest? (**honnête**.) Patient? (**patient / patiente**.) Scissors? (**les ciseaux**.) A watch? (**la montre**.) Pyjamas? (**le pyjama**.) A button? (**le bouton**.) A peach? (**la pêche**.) Society? (**la société**.) The government? (**le gouvernement**.) A law? (**la loi**.) A court? (**le tribunal**.) A judge? (**le juge**.)

Chapter 223

Battery, Charger, Singer, Concert, Show

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a battery, a charger, a singer, a concert and a show.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 223: I can say a battery, a charger, a singer, a concert and a show.*

223.1 la batterie — a battery

> Before the new one: say the French for a court, then the French for a judge.

You'll want to know: la batterie

la batterie — "a battery".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

batterie — built from the verb for "to beat", ← Latin *battuere*, with *-erie* (EtymDB 2.1): guns firing together, then cells working together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la batterie*
- *Say it: la batterie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la batterie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a court, then the French for a judge, then say *la batterie* again

Before you move on

What does la batterie mean? (“A battery”.) Say it once more.

223.2 le chargeur — a charger

Before the new one: say the French for a judge, then the French for a battery.

You’ll want to know: le chargeur

le chargeur — “a charger”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chargeur — built from the verb for “to load”, ← Late Latin *carricare* (EtymDB 2.1), from *carrus*, “a wagon”, with *-eur*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chargeur*
- *Say it: le chargeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chargeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a judge, then the French for a battery, then say *le chargeur* again

Before you move on

What does le chargeur mean? (“A charger”.) Say it once more.

223.3 le chanteur — a singer

Before the new one: say the French for a battery, then the French for a charger.

You’ll want to know: le chanteur

le chanteur — “a singer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chanteur ← Old French *chanteor* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *cantator*, *cantatoris*, “a singer”, from *cantare*, “to sing” (Lewis & Short) — inherited: the same root as *chanson*. Latin *cantor* gave a different word, the one for a church precentor.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chanteur*
- *Say it: le chanteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chanteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a battery, then the French for a charger, then say *le chanteur* again

Before you move on

What does le chanteur mean? (“A singer”.) Say it once more.

223.4 le concert — a concert

Before the new one: say the French for a charger, then the French for a singer.

You'll want to know: le concert

le concert — "a concert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

concert ← Italian *concerto*, "an agreement, a concert" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le concert*
- *Say it: le concert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le concert*
- *Recall:* say the French for a charger, then the French for a singer, then say *le concert* again

Before you move on

What does le concert mean? ("A concert".) Say it once more.

223.5 le spectacle — a show

Before the new one: say the French for a singer, then the French for a concert.

You'll want to know: le spectacle

le spectacle — "a show".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

spectacle ← Latin *spectaculum*, "a show", from *spectare*, "to watch" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le spectacle*
- *Say it: le spectacle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le spectacle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a singer, then the French for a concert, then say *le spectacle* again

Before you move on

What does le spectacle mean? ("A show".) Say it once more.

Chapter 224

Employee, Pilot, Accountant, Scientist, Researcher

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an employee, a pilot, an accountant, a scientist and a researcher.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 224: I can say an employee, a pilot, an accountant, a scientist and a researcher.*

224.1 l'employé — an employee

> Before the new one: say the French for a concert, then the French for a show.

You'll want to know: l'employé

l'employé — "an employee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

employé is the past participle of the verb for "to employ", ← Latin *implicare*, "to involve" (Lewis & Short), used as a noun: one employed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'employé*
- *Say it: l'employé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'employé*
- *Recall:* say the French for a concert, then the French for a show, then say *l'employé* again

Before you move on

What does l'employé mean? ("An employee".) Say it once more.

224.2 le pilote — a pilot

Before the new one: say the French for a show, then the French for an employee.

You'll want to know: le pilote

le pilote — "a pilot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pilote ← Italian *pilota*, from a Medieval Greek word for "steersman", built on *pedon*, "an oar" — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pilote*
- *Say it: le pilote*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pilote*
- *Recall:* say the French for a show, then the French for an employee, then say *le pilote* again

Before you move on

What does le pilote mean? ("A pilot".) Say it once more.

224.3 le comptable — an accountant

Before the new one: say the French for an employee, then the French for a pilot.

You'll want to know: le comptable

le comptable — "an accountant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

comptable — *compter*, "to count", with *-able*: one who keeps the counts. *Compter* ← Latin *computāre*, "to reckon" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le comptable*
- *Say it: le comptable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le comptable*
- *Recall:* say the French for an employee, then the French for a pilot, then say *le comptable* again

Before you move on

What does le comptable mean? ("An accountant".) Say it once more.

224.4 le scientifique — a scientist

Before the new one: say the French for a pilot, then the French for an accountant.

You'll want to know: le scientifique

le scientifique — "a scientist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

scientifique ← Latin *scientificus*, "making knowledge", from *scientia*, "knowledge" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le scientifique*
- *Say it: le scientifique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le scientifique*
- *Recall:* say the French for a pilot, then the French for an accountant, then say *le scientifique* again

Before you move on

What does le scientifique mean? ("A scientist".) Say it once more.

224.5 le chercheur — a researcher

Before the new one: say the French for an accountant, then the French for a scientist.

You'll want to know: le chercheur

le chercheur — "a researcher".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chercheur — *chercher*, "to look for", with *-eur*: one who searches. *Chercher* ← Old French *cerchier*, from Late Latin *circāre*, "to go around" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chercheur*
- *Say it: le chercheur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chercheur*
- *Recall:* say the French for an accountant, then the French for a scientist, then say *le chercheur* again

Before you move on

What does le chercheur mean? ("A researcher".) Say it once more.

Chapter 225

Experience, Choice, Decision, Possibility, Reason

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say experience, a choice, a decision, a possibility and a reason.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 225: I can say experience, a choice, a decision, a possibility and a reason.*

225.1 l'expérience — experience

> Before the new one: say the French for a scientist, then the French for a researcher.

You'll want to know: l'expérience

l'expérience — "experience".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

expérience ← Latin *experientia*, "a trial, a test", from *experiri*, "to try" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'expérience*
- *Say it: l'expérience*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'expérience*
- *Recall:* say the French for a scientist, then the French for a researcher, then say *l'expérience* again

Before you move on

What does l'expérience mean? ("Experience".) Say it once more.

225.2 le choix — a choice

Before the new one: say the French for a researcher, then the French for experience.

You'll want to know: le choix

le choix — "a choice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

choix ← Old French *chois*, formed from the verb for "to choose" (EtymDB 2.1), which came from a Germanic verb meaning "to test, to taste".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le choix*
- *Say it: le choix*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le choix*
- *Recall:* say the French for a researcher, then the French for experience, then say *le choix* again

Before you move on

What does le choix mean? ("A choice".) Say it once more.

225.3 la décision — a decision

Before the new one: say the French for experience, then the French for a choice.

You'll want to know: la décision

la décision — "a decision".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décision ← Latin *decisio*, "a settling", the noun beside *décider* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la décision*
- *Say it: la décision*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la décision*
- *Recall:* say the French for experience, then the French for a choice, then say *la décision* again

Before you move on

What does la décision mean? ("A decision".) Say it once more.

225.4 la possibilité — a possibility

Before the new one: say the French for a choice, then the French for a decision.

You'll want to know: la possibilité

la possibilité — "a possibility".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

possibilité ← Latin *possibilitas*, from *possibilis*, "possible", from *posse*, "to be able" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la possibilité*
- *Say it: la possibilité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la possibilité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a choice, then the French for a decision, then say *la possibilité* again

Before you move on

What does la possibilité mean? ("A possibility".) Say it once more.

225.5 la raison — a reason

Before the new one: say the French for a decision, then the French for a possibility.

You'll want to know: la raison

la raison — "a reason".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raison ← Latin *ratio*, *rationis*, "reckoning, reason" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la raison*
- *Say it: la raison*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la raison*
- *Recall:* say the French for a decision, then the French for a possibility, then say *la raison* again

Before you move on

What does la raison mean? ("A reason".) Say it once more.

Chapter 226

Bank card, Cash machine, Bank account, Loan, Debt

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bank card, a cash machine, a bank account, a loan and a debt.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 226: I can say a bank card, a cash machine, a bank account, a loan and a debt.

226.1 la carte bancaire — a bank card

Before the new one: say the French for a possibility, then the French for a reason.

You'll want to know: la carte bancaire

la carte bancaire — "a bank card".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carte bancaire — *carte*, "card", and the adjective made from *banque*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carte bancaire*
- *Say it: la carte bancaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la carte bancaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a possibility, then the French for a reason, then say *la carte bancaire* again

Before you move on

What does la carte bancaire mean? ("A bank card".) Say it once more.

226.2 le distributeur — a cash machine

Before the new one: say the French for a reason, then the French for a bank card.

You'll want to know: le distributeur

le distributeur — "a cash machine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

distributeur ← Late Latin *distributor*, "one who hands out" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le distributeur*
- *Say it: le distributeur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le distributeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a reason, then the French for a bank card, then say *le distributeur* again

Before you move on

What does le distributeur mean? ("A cash machine".) Say it once more.

226.3 le compte bancaire — a bank account

Before the new one: say the French for a bank card, then the French for a cash machine.

You'll want to know: le compte bancaire

le compte bancaire — "a bank account".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compte bancaire — *compte*, "an account", from *compter*, and the adjective made from *banque*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le compte bancaire*
- *Say it: le compte bancaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le compte bancaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bank card, then the French for a cash machine, then say *le compte bancaire* again

Before you move on

What does le compte bancaire mean? ("A bank account".) Say it once more.

226.4 le prêt — a loan

Before the new one: say the French for a cash machine, then the French for a bank account.

You'll want to know: le prêt

le prêt — "a loan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prêt — formed from *prêter*, "to lend": a thing lent.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le prêt*
- *Say it: le prêt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le prêt*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cash machine, then the French for a bank account, then say *le prêt* again

Before you move on

What does le prêt mean? ("A loan".) Say it once more.

226.5 la dette — a debt

Before the new one: say the French for a bank account, then the French for a loan.

You'll want to know: la dette

la dette — "a debt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dette ← Latin *debita*, "things owed", from *debere*, the Latin of *devoir* (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dette*
- *Say it: la dette*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la dette*
- *Recall:* say the French for a bank account, then the French for a loan, then say *la dette* again

Before you move on

What does la dette mean? ("A debt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 227

Wheel, Engine, Toll, Motorway, Fine

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a wheel, an engine, a toll, a motorway and a fine.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 227: I can say a wheel, an engine, a toll, a motorway and a fine.*

227.1 la roue — a wheel

> Before the new one: say the French for a loan, then the French for a debt.

You'll want to know: la roue

la roue — "a wheel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

roue ← Old French *ruee* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *rota*, "a wheel" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la roue*
- *Say it: la roue*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la roue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a loan, then the French for a debt, then say *la roue* again

Before you move on

What does la roue mean? (“A wheel”.) Say it once more.

227.2 le moteur — an engine

Before the new one: say the French for a debt, then the French for a wheel.

You’ll want to know: le moteur

le moteur — “an engine”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moteur ← Latin *motor*, “a mover”, from *movere*, “to move” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le moteur*
- *Say it: le moteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le moteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a debt, then the French for a wheel, then say *le moteur* again

Before you move on

What does le moteur mean? (“An engine”.) Say it once more.

227.3 le péage — a toll

Before the new one: say the French for a wheel, then the French for an engine.

You’ll want to know: le péage

le péage — “a toll”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

péage ← Medieval Latin *pedaticum*, “the right to set foot”, from *pes*, *pedis*, the Latin of *pied* — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le péage*
- *Say it: le péage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le péage*
- *Recall:* say the French for a wheel, then the French for an engine, then say *le péage* again

Before you move on

What does le péage mean? (“A toll”.) Say it once more.

227.4 l’autoroute — a motorway

Before the new one: say the French for an engine, then the French for a toll.

You'll want to know: l'autoroute

l'autoroute — "a motorway".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

autoroute — *auto-*, from the word for "motor car", and the word for "a road", ← Latin *via rupta*, "a road broken through" (Lewis & Short for *rumpere*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'autoroute*
- *Say it: l'autoroute*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'autoroute*
- *Recall:* say the French for an engine, then the French for a toll, then say *l'autoroute* again

Before you move on

What does l'autoroute mean? ("A motorway".) Say it once more.

227.5 l'amende — a fine

Before the new one: say the French for a toll, then the French for a motorway.

You'll want to know: l'amende

l'amende — "a fine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amende — formed from the verb for "to make amends", ← Latin *emendare*, "to correct" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'amende*
- *Say it: l'amende*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'amende*
- *Recall:* say the French for a toll, then the French for a motorway, then say *l'amende* again

Before you move on

What does l'amende mean? ("A fine".) Say it once more.

227.6 Words from chapters 223-224 — a first pass

Say the words for a motorway and a fine.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a battery, a charger, a singer, a concert, a show
- an employee, a pilot, an accountant, a scientist, a researcher

Before you move on

A battery? (**la batterie**.) A charger? (**le chargeur**.) A singer? (**le chanteur**.) A concert? (**le concert**.) A show? (**le spectacle**.) An employee? (**l'employé**.) A pilot? (**le pilote**.) An accountant? (**le comptable**.) A scientist? (**le scientifique**.) A researcher? (**le chercheur**.)

227.7 Words from chapters 225-227 — a second pass

Say the words for experience and a choice.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- experience, a choice, a decision, a possibility, a reason
- a bank card, a cash machine, a bank account, a loan, a debt
- a wheel, an engine, a toll, a motorway, a fine

Before you move on

Experience? (**l'expérience**.) A choice? (**le choix**.) A decision? (**la décision**.) A possibility? (**la possibilité**.) A reason? (**la raison**.) A bank card? (**la carte bancaire**.) A cash machine? (**le distributeur**.) A bank account? (**le compte bancaire**.) A loan? (**le prêt**.) A debt? (**la dette**.) A wheel? (**la roue**.) An engine? (**le moteur**.) A toll? (**le péage**.) A motorway? (**l'autoroute**.) A fine? (**l'amende**.)

Chapter 228

Vase, Plant, Seed, Root, Branch

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a vase, a plant, a seed, a root and a branch.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 228: I can say a vase, a plant, a seed, a root and a branch.*

228.1 le vase — a vase

Before the new one: say the French for a motorway, then the French for a fine.

You'll want to know: le vase

le vase — "a vase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vase ← Latin *vas*, *vasis*, "a vessel" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vase*
- *Say it: le vase*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vase*
- *Recall:* say the French for a motorway, then the French for a fine, then say *le vase* again

Before you move on

What does le vase mean? (“A vase”.) Say it once more.

228.2 la plante — a plant

Before the new one: say the French for a fine, then the French for a vase.

You’ll want to know: la plante

la plante — “a plant”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plante ← Latin *planta*, “a sprout, a cutting” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plante*
- *Say it: la plante*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la plante*
- *Recall:* say the French for a fine, then the French for a vase, then say *la plante* again

Before you move on

What does la plante mean? (“A plant”.) Say it once more.

228.3 la graine — a seed

Before the new one: say the French for a vase, then the French for a plant.

You’ll want to know: la graine

la graine — “a seed”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

graine ← Vulgar Latin *grana*, “grains”, the plural of *granum* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la graine*
- *Say it: la graine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la graine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a vase, then the French for a plant, then say *la graine* again

Before you move on

What does la graine mean? (“A seed”.) Say it once more.

228.4 la racine — a root

Before the new one: say the French for a plant, then the French for a seed.

You'll want to know: la racine

la racine — "a root".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

racine ← Late Latin **radicina*, from *radix*, *radicis*, "a root" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la racine*
- *Say it: la racine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la racine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plant, then the French for a seed, then say *la racine* again

Before you move on

What does la racine mean? ("A root".) Say it once more.

228.5 la branche — a branch

Before the new one: say the French for a seed, then the French for a root.

You'll want to know: la branche

la branche — "a branch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

branche ← Late Latin *branca*, "a paw" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the noun behind *brancher*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la branche*
- *Say it: la branche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la branche*
- *Recall:* say the French for a seed, then the French for a root, then say *la branche* again

Before you move on

What does la branche mean? ("A branch".) Say it once more.

Chapter 229

Lightning, Thunder, Climate, Environment, Pollution

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say lightning, thunder, the climate, the environment and pollution.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 229: I can say lightning, thunder, the climate, the environment and pollution.

229.1 l'éclair — lightning

Before the new one: say the French for a root, then the French for a branch.

You'll want to know: l'éclair

l'éclair — "lightning".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éclair — formed from the verb for "to light up", built on *clair*, "bright".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éclair*
- *Say it: l'éclair*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'éclair*
- *Recall:* say the French for a root, then the French for a branch, then say *l'éclair* again

Before you move on

What does l'éclair mean? ("Lightning".) Say it once more.

229.2 le tonnerre — thunder

Before the new one: say the French for a branch, then the French for lightning.

You'll want to know: le tonnerre

le tonnerre — "thunder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tonnerre ← Old French *tuneire* ← Latin *tonitrus*, "thunder" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tonnerre*
- *Say it: le tonnerre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tonnerre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a branch, then the French for lightning, then say *le tonnerre* again

Before you move on

What does le tonnerre mean? (“Thunder”.) Say it once more.

229.3 le climat — the climate

Before the new one: say the French for lightning, then the French for thunder.

You’ll want to know: le climat

le climat — “the climate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

climat ← Latin *clima*, from Greek *klima*, “a slope, a zone of latitude” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le climat*
- *Say it: le climat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le climat*
- *Recall:* say the French for lightning, then the French for thunder, then say *le climat* again

Before you move on

What does le climat mean? (“The climate”.) Say it once more.

229.4 l’environnement — the environment

Before the new one: say the French for thunder, then the French for the climate.

You'll want to know: l'environnement

l'environnement — "the environment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

environnement — built from *environ*, "round about", with *-ment*: what lies around.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'environnement*
- *Say it: l'environnement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'environnement*
- *Recall:* say the French for thunder, then the French for the climate, then say *l'environnement* again

Before you move on

What does l'environnement mean? ("The environment".) Say it once more.

229.5 la pollution — pollution

Before the new one: say the French for the climate, then the French for the environment.

You'll want to know: la pollution

la pollution — "pollution".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pollution ← Latin *pollutio*, "a defiling" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pollution*
- *Say it: la pollution*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pollution*
- *Recall:* say the French for the climate, then the French for the environment, then say *la pollution* again

Before you move on

What does la pollution mean? ("Pollution".) Say it once more.

Chapter 230

Thread, Needle, Nail for hammering, Hammer, Ladder

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a thread, a needle, a nail for hammering, a hammer and a ladder.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 230: I can say a thread, a needle, a nail for hammering, a hammer and a ladder.*

230.1 le fil — a thread, a wire

Before the new one: say the French for the environment, then the French for pollution.

You'll want to know: le fil

le fil — "a thread, a wire".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fil ← Old French *fil* ← Latin *filum*, "a thread" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fil*
- *Say it: le fil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le fil*
- *Recall:* say the French for the environment, then the French for pollution, then say *le fil* again

Before you move on

What does le fil mean? (“A thread, a wire”.) Say it once more.

230.2 l’aiguille — a needle

Before the new one: say the French for pollution, then the French for a thread.

You’ll want to know: l’aiguille

l’aiguille — “a needle”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aiguille ← Old French *aguille* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **acucula*, “a little needle”, from Latin *acus*, “a needle” — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’aiguille*
- *Say it: l’aiguille*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’aiguille*
- *Recall:* say the French for pollution, then the French for a thread, then say *l’aiguille* again

Before you move on

What does l'aiguille mean? ("A needle".) Say it once more.

230.3 le clou — a nail for hammering

Before the new one: say the French for a thread, then the French for a needle.

You'll want to know: le clou

le clou — "a nail for hammering".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clou ← Old French *clou* ← Latin *clavus*, "a nail" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le clou*
- *Say it: le clou*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le clou*
- *Recall:* say the French for a thread, then the French for a needle, then say *le clou* again

Before you move on

What does le clou mean? ("A nail for hammering".) Say it once more.

230.4 le marteau — a hammer

Before the new one: say the French for a needle, then the French for a nail for hammering.

You'll want to know: le marteau

le marteau — "a hammer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marteau ← Vulgar Latin **martellus* ← Latin *martulus*, "a hammer" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le marteau*
- *Say it: le marteau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le marteau*
- *Recall:* say the French for a needle, then the French for a nail for hammering, then say *le marteau* again

Before you move on

What does le marteau mean? ("A hammer".) Say it once more.

230.5 l'échelle — a ladder

Before the new one: say the French for a nail for hammering, then the French for a hammer.

You'll want to know: l'échelle

l'échelle — "a ladder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échelle ← Old French *eschele*, *eschiele* ← Latin *scala*, "a ladder" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited; *escalier* came later from a word built on the same *scala*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'échelle*
- *Say it: l'échelle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'échelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for a nail for hammering, then the French for a hammer, then say *l'échelle* again

Before you move on

What does l'échelle mean? ("A ladder".) Say it once more.

Chapter 231

Return, Arrival, Departure, Destination, Landscape

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the return, arrival, departure, a destination and a landscape.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 231: I can say the return, arrival, departure, a destination and a landscape.

231.1 le retour — the return

Before the new one: say the French for a hammer, then the French for a ladder.

You'll want to know: le retour

le retour — "the return".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retour — formed from the verb for "to return", *re-* with *tourner*, "to turn". *Tourner* ← Latin *tornāre*, "to turn" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le retour*
- *Say it: le retour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le retour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a hammer, then the French for a ladder, then say *le retour* again

Before you move on

What does le retour mean? ("The return".) Say it once more.

231.2 l'arrivée — arrival

Before the new one: say the French for a ladder, then the French for the return.

You'll want to know: l'arrivée

l'arrivée — "arrival".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrivée is the past participle of the verb for "to arrive", ← Vulgar Latin **arripare*, "to reach the shore", from *ripa*, "a bank", the Latin of *rivière*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arrivée*
- *Say it: l'arrivée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'arrivée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a ladder, then the French for the return, then say *l'arrivée* again

Before you move on

What does l'arrivée mean? ("Arrival".) Say it once more.

231.3 le départ — departure

Before the new one: say the French for the return, then the French for arrival.

You'll want to know: le départ

le départ — "departure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

départ — formed from Old French *departir*, "to divide, to go away", from *de-* and Old French *partir*, "to share out", ← Latin *partire*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le départ*
- *Say it: le départ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le départ*
- *Recall:* say the French for the return, then the French for arrival, then say *le départ* again

Before you move on

What does le départ mean? ("Departure".) Say it once more.

231.4 la destination — a destination

Before the new one: say the French for arrival, then the French for departure.

You'll want to know: la destination

la destination — "a destination".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

destination ← Latin *destinatio*, "a fixing, a purpose", from *destinare*, "to make fast" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la destination*
- *Say it: la destination*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la destination*
- *Recall:* say the French for arrival, then the French for departure, then say *la destination* again

Before you move on

What does la destination mean? ("A destination".) Say it once more.

231.5 le paysage — a landscape

Before the new one: say the French for departure, then the French for a destination.

You'll want to know: le paysage

le paysage — "a landscape".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

paysage — built from the word for "country", ← Late Latin *pagensis*, from *pagus*, "a district" (Lewis & Short), with *-age*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le paysage*
- *Say it: le paysage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le paysage*
- *Recall:* say the French for departure, then the French for a destination, then say *le paysage* again

Before you move on

What does le paysage mean? ("A landscape".) Say it once more.

Chapter 232

Magazine, Dictionary, University, Mistake, History

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a magazine, a dictionary, a university, a mistake and history.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 232: I can say a magazine, a dictionary, a university, a mistake and history.*

232.1 le magazine — a magazine

Before the new one: say the French for a destination, then the French for a landscape.

You'll want to know: le magazine

le magazine — "a magazine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

magazine ← English *magazine*, a storehouse of writings (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed back: English had taken it from *magasin*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le magazine*
- *Say it: le magazine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le magazine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a destination, then the French for a landscape, then say *le magazine* again

Before you move on

What does le magazine mean? ("A magazine".) Say it once more.

232.2 le dictionnaire — a dictionary

Before the new one: say the French for a landscape, then the French for a magazine.

You'll want to know: le dictionnaire

le dictionnaire — "a dictionary".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dictionnaire ← Medieval Latin *dictionarium*, from *dictio*, "a saying, a word" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dictionnaire*
- *Say it: le dictionnaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le dictionnaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a landscape, then the French for a magazine, then say *le dictionnaire* again

Before you move on

What does le dictionnaire mean? (“A dictionary”.) Say it once more.

232.3 l’université — a university

Before the new one: say the French for a magazine, then the French for a dictionary.

You’ll want to know: l’université

l’université — “a university”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

université ← Latin *universitas*, “the whole, a corporation”, from *universus*, “all together” (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’université*
- *Say it: l’université*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’université*
- *Recall:* say the French for a magazine, then the French for a dictionary, then say *l’université* again

Before you move on

What does l’université mean? (“A university”.) Say it once more.

232.4 l’erreur — a mistake

Before the new one: say the French for a dictionary, then the French for a university.

You'll want to know: l'erreur

l'erreur — "a mistake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

erreur ← Latin *error*, "a wandering", from *errare*, "to wander" (Lewis & Short) — taken from Latin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'erreur*
- *Say it: l'erreur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'erreur*
- *Recall:* say the French for a dictionary, then the French for a university, then say *l'erreur* again

Before you move on

What does l'erreur mean? ("A mistake".) Say it once more.

232.5 l'histoire — history, a story

Before the new one: say the French for a university, then the French for a mistake.

You'll want to know: l'histoire

l'histoire — "history, a story".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

histoire ← Latin *historia*, from Greek *historia*, "inquiry, a narrative" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'histoire*
- *Say it: l'histoire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'histoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a university, then the French for a mistake, then say *l'histoire* again

Before you move on

What does l'histoire mean? ("History, a story".) Say it once more.

232.6 Words from chapters 228-229 — a first pass

Say the words for a mistake and history.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a vase, a plant, a seed, a root, a branch
- lightning, thunder, the climate, the environment, pollution

Before you move on

A vase? (**le vase**.) A plant? (**la plante**.) A seed? (**la graine**.) A root? (**la racine**.) A branch? (**la branche**.) Lightning? (**l'éclair**.) Thunder? (**le tonnerre**.) The climate? (**le climat**.) The environment? (**l'environnement**.) Pollution? (**la pollution**.)

232.7 Words from chapters 230-232 — a second pass

Say the words for a thread and a needle.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a thread, a needle, a nail for hammering, a hammer, a ladder
- the return, arrival, departure, a destination, a landscape
- a magazine, a dictionary, a university, a mistake, history

Before you move on

A thread? (**le fil**.) A needle? (**l'aiguille**.) A nail for hammering? (**le clou**.) A hammer? (**le marteau**.) A ladder? (**l'échelle**.) The return? (**le retour**.) Arrival? (**l'arrivée**.) Departure? (**le départ**.) A destination? (**la destination**.) A landscape? (**le paysage**.) A magazine? (**le magazine**.) A dictionary? (**le dictionnaire**.) A university? (**l'université**.) A mistake? (**l'erreur**.) History? (**l'histoire**.)

Chapter 233

To iron, To repair, To build, To photograph, To repeat

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to iron, to repair, to build, to photograph and to repeat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 233: I can say to iron, to repair, to build, to photograph and to repeat.*

233.1 repasser — to iron

Before the new one: say the French for a mistake, then the French for history, a story.

You'll want to know: repasser

repasser — "to iron".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

repasser — built from *re-* and the verb for "to pass", ← Vulgar Latin **passare* (EtymDB 2.1): to pass the hot iron over the cloth.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: repasser*
- *Say it: repasser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *repasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mistake, then the French for history, a story, then say *repasser* again

Before you move on

What does repasser mean? (“To iron”.) Say it once more.

233.2 réparer — to repair

Before the new one: say the French for history, a story, then the French for to iron.

You’ll want to know: réparer

réparer — “to repair”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réparer ← Latin *reparare*, “to restore” — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: réparer*
- *Say it: réparer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *réparer*
- *Recall:* say the French for history, a story, then the French for to iron, then say *réparer* again

Before you move on

What does réparer mean? (“To repair”.) Say it once more.

233.3 construire — to build

Before the new one: say the French for to iron, then the French for to repair.

You’ll want to know: construire

construire — “to build”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

construire ← Latin *construere*, “to heap together, to build” — taken from Latin and shaped like *détruire*. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Old French form.)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: construire*
- *Say it: construire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *construire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to iron, then the French for to repair, then say *construire* again

Before you move on

What does construire mean? (“To build”.) Say it once more.

233.4 photographier — to photograph

Before the new one: say the French for to repair, then the French for to build.

You'll want to know: photographier

photographier — "to photograph".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

photographier — formed from the word for "photography", built like *photo* from Greek *phos*, "light", and *graphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: photographier*
- *Say it: photographier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *photographier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to repair, then the French for to build, then say *photographier* again

Before you move on

What does photographier mean? ("To photograph".) Say it once more.

233.5 répéter — to repeat

Before the new one: say the French for to build, then the French for to photograph.

You'll want to know: répéter

répéter — "to repeat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

répéter ← Latin *repetere*, "to go back to, to seek once more" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: répéter*
- *Say it: répéter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *répéter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to build, then the French for to photograph, then say *répéter* again

Before you move on

What does répéter mean? ("To repeat".) Say it once more.

Chapter 234

To fill, To empty, To measure, To weigh, To check

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to fill, to empty, to measure, to weigh and to check.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 234: I can say to fill, to empty, to measure, to weigh and to check.*

234.1 remplir — to fill

Before the new one: say the French for to photograph, then the French for to repeat.

You'll want to know: remplir

remplir — "to fill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remplir ← Old French *remplir*: *re-* and *emplir*, "to fill", ← Latin *implere*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remplir*
- *Say it: remplir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remplir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to photograph, then the French for to repeat, then say *remplir* again

Before you move on

What does remplir mean? ("To fill".) Say it once more.

234.2 vider — to empty

Before the new one: say the French for to repeat, then the French for to fill.

You'll want to know: vider

vider — "to empty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vider ← Old French *vuidier* ← Vulgar Latin **vocitare*, "to empty" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the verb beside *vide*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vider*
- *Say it: vider*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vider*
- *Recall:* say the French for to repeat, then the French for to fill, then say *vider* again

Before you move on

What does vider mean? ("To empty".) Say it once more.

234.3 mesurer — to measure

Before the new one: say the French for to fill, then the French for to empty.

You'll want to know: mesurer

mesurer — "to measure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mesurer ← Late Latin *mensurare*, from *mensura*, "a measure" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mesurer*
- *Say it: mesurer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mesurer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fill, then the French for to empty, then say *mesurer* again

Before you move on

What does mesurer mean? ("To measure".) Say it once more.

234.4 peser — to weigh

Before the new one: say the French for to empty, then the French for to measure.

You'll want to know: peser

peser — "to weigh".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peser ← Vulgar Latin **pesare* ← Latin *pensare*, "to weigh, to ponder" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peser*
- *Say it: peser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to empty, then the French for to measure, then say *peser* again

Before you move on

What does peser mean? ("To weigh".) Say it once more.

234.5 vérifier — to check

Before the new one: say the French for to measure, then the French for to weigh.

You'll want to know: vérifier

vérifier — "to check".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vérifier ← Medieval Latin *verificare*, "to make true", from *verus*, "true" — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vérifier*
- *Say it: vérifier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vérifier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to measure, then the French for to weigh, then say *vérifier* again

Before you move on

What does vérifier mean? ("To check".) Say it once more.

Chapter 235

To move house, To rent, To rest, To wake up, To do one's hair

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to move house, to rent, to rest, to wake up and to do one's hair.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 235: I can say to move house, to rent, to rest, to wake up and to do one's hair.*

235.1 déménager — to move house

Before the new one: say the French for to weigh, then the French for to check.

You'll want to know: déménager

déménager — "to move house".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déménager — built from *dé-*, "out", and the word for "a household", from Old French *maisnie*, "a household", ← Vulgar Latin **mansionata*, from *mansio*, "a dwelling": to take the household out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: déménager*
- *Say it: déménager*, once more
- *Say it:* say *déménager*
- *Recall:* say the French for to weigh, then the French for to check, then say *déménager* again

Before you move on

What does déménager mean? ("To move house".) Say it once more.

235.2 louer — to rent

Before the new one: say the French for to check, then the French for to move house.

You'll want to know: louer

louer — "to rent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

louer ← Latin *locare*, "to place, to hire out" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1) A second *louer*, "to praise", comes from Latin *laudare*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: louer*
- *Say it: louer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *louer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to check, then the French for to move house, then say *louer* again

Before you move on

What does louer mean? (“To rent”.) Say it once more.

235.3 se reposer — to rest

Before the new one: say the French for to move house, then the French for to rent.

You’ll want to know: se reposer

se reposer — “to rest”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se reposer ← Late Latin *repausare*, “to rest” (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the verb beside *repos*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se reposer*
- *Say it: se reposer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se reposer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move house, then the French for to rent, then say *se reposer* again

Before you move on

What does se reposer mean? (“To rest”.) Say it once more.

235.4 se réveiller — to wake up

Before the new one: say the French for to rent, then the French for to rest.

You'll want to know: se réveiller

se réveiller — "to wake up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se réveiller — *re-* and the verb for "to wake", ← Vulgar Latin **exvigilare*, from Latin *vigilare*, "to keep watch" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se réveiller*
- *Say it: se réveiller*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se réveiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rent, then the French for to rest, then say *se réveiller* again

Before you move on

What does se réveiller mean? ("To wake up".) Say it once more.

235.5 se coiffer — to do one's hair

Before the new one: say the French for to rest, then the French for to wake up.

You'll want to know: se coiffer

se coiffer — "to do one's hair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se coiffer — formed from the word for "a cap", ← Late Latin *cofia*, a Germanic word. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se coiffer*
- *Say it: se coiffer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se coiffer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rest, then the French for to wake up, then say *se coiffer* again

Before you move on

What does se coiffer mean? ("To do one's hair".) Say it once more.

Chapter 236

To be enough, To burn, To throw away, To calculate, To hit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to be enough, to burn, to throw away, to calculate and to hit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 236: I can say to be enough, to burn, to throw away, to calculate and to hit.*

236.1 suffire — to be enough

Before the new one: say the French for to wake up, then the French for to do one's hair.

You'll want to know: suffire

suffire — "to be enough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

suffire ← Latin *sufficere*, "to be enough" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suffire*
- *Say it: suffire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *suffire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wake up, then the French for to do one's hair, then say *suffire* again

Before you move on

What does suffire mean? ("To be enough".) Say it once more.

236.2 brûler — to burn

Before the new one: say the French for to do one's hair, then the French for to be enough.

You'll want to know: brûler

brûler — "to burn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brûler — its origin is uncertain. The usual account mixes Latin *ustulare*, "to scorch", with a Germanic verb for "to burn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: brûler*
- *Say it: brûler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brûler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to do one's hair, then the French for to be enough, then say *brûler* again

Before you move on

What does brûler mean? (“To burn”.) Say it once more.

236.3 jeter — to throw away

Before the new one: say the French for to be enough, then the French for to burn.

You’ll want to know: jeter

jeter — “to throw away”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeter ← Old French *jeter* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **iectare* ← Latin *iactare*, “to throw about” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jeter*
- *Say it: jeter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jeter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be enough, then the French for to burn, then say *jeter* again

Before you move on

What does jeter mean? (“To throw away”.) Say it once more.

236.4 calculer — to calculate

Before the new one: say the French for to burn, then the French for to throw away.

You'll want to know: calculer

calculer — "to calculate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

calculer ← Late Latin *calculare*, from *calculus*, "a pebble" (Lewis & Short): sums were done with counting stones — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *calculer*
- *Say it:* *calculer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *calculer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to burn, then the French for to throw away, then say *calculer* again

Before you move on

What does calculer mean? ("To calculate".) Say it once more.

236.5 frapper — to hit, to knock

Before the new one: say the French for to throw away, then the French for to calculate.

You'll want to know: frapper

frapper — "to hit, to knock".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frapper ← Old French *fraper*, "to strike" (EtymDB 2.1), of uncertain origin; it may imitate the sound of a blow.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: frapper*
- *Say it: frapper*, once more
- *Say it:* say *frapper*
- *Recall:* say the French for to throw away, then the French for to calculate, then say *frapper* again

Before you move on

What does frapper mean? ("To hit, to knock".) Say it once more.

Chapter 237

To miss, To deserve, To improve, To get worse, To offer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to miss, to deserve, to improve, to get worse and to offer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 237: I can say to miss, to deserve, to improve, to get worse and to offer.

237.1 manquer — to miss, to be missing

Before the new one: say the French for to calculate, then the French for to hit.

You'll want to know: manquer

manquer — "to miss, to be missing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manquer ← Italian *mancare*, "to be lacking", from *manco*, "maimed", ← Latin *mancus* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: manquer*
- *Say it: manquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to calculate, then the French for to hit, then say *manquer* again

Before you move on

What does manquer mean? ("To miss, to be missing".) Say it once more.

237.2 mériter — to deserve

Before the new one: say the French for to hit, then the French for to miss.

You'll want to know: mériter

mériter — "to deserve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mériter — formed from the word for "merit", ← Latin *meritum*, "what one has earned". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mériter*
- *Say it: mériter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mériter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hit, then the French for to miss, then say *mériter* again

Before you move on

What does mériter mean? ("To deserve".) Say it once more.

237.3 améliorer — to improve

Before the new one: say the French for to miss, then the French for to deserve.

You'll want to know: améliorer

améliorer — "to improve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

améliorer — built on the word for "better", ← Latin *melior*, "better". (EtymDB 2.1 records the Old French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: améliorer*
- *Say it: améliorer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *améliorer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to miss, then the French for to deserve, then say *améliorer* again

Before you move on

What does améliorer mean? ("To improve".) Say it once more.

237.4 empirer — to get worse

Before the new one: say the French for to deserve, then the French for to improve.

You'll want to know: empirer

empirer — "to get worse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

empirer — built from *em-* and the word for "worse", ← Latin *peior*, "worse" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *empirer*
- *Say it:* *empirer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *empirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deserve, then the French for to improve, then say *empirer* again

Before you move on

What does empirer mean? ("To get worse".) Say it once more.

237.5 offrir — to offer

Before the new one: say the French for to improve, then the French for to get worse.

You'll want to know: offrir

offrir — "to offer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

offrir ← Old French *ofrir* ← Vulgar Latin **offerire* ← Latin *offerre*, "to bring before" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: offrir*
- *Say it: offrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *offrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to improve, then the French for to get worse, then say *offrir* again

Before you move on

What does offrir mean? ("To offer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 238

To reduce, To refuse, To risk, To solve, To fly

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to reduce, to refuse, to risk, to solve and to fly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 238: I can say to reduce, to refuse, to risk, to solve and to fly.*

238.1 réduire — to reduce

Before the new one: say the French for to get worse, then the French for to offer.

You'll want to know: réduire

réduire — "to reduce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réduire ← Old French *reduire* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *reducere*, "to lead back" (Lewis & Short) — inherited, like *conduire*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: réduire*
- *Say it: réduire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *réduire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get worse, then the French for to offer, then say *réduire* again

Before you move on

What does réduire mean? (“To reduce”.) Say it once more.

238.2 refuser — to refuse

Before the new one: say the French for to offer, then the French for to reduce.

You’ll want to know: refuser

refuser — “to refuse”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

refuser — usually traced to Vulgar Latin **refusare*, a blend of Latin *refutare*, “to rebut”, and *recusare*, “to decline” — the account is not certain.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: refuser*
- *Say it: refuser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *refuser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to offer, then the French for to reduce, then say *refuser* again

Before you move on

What does refuser mean? (“To refuse”.) Say it once more.

238.3 risquer — to risk

Before the new one: say the French for to reduce, then the French for to refuse.

You’ll want to know: risquer

risquer — “to risk”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

risquer — formed from the word for “risk”, ← Old Italian *risco* (EtymDB 2.1), whose own origin is uncertain.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: risquer*
- *Say it: risquer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *risquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reduce, then the French for to refuse, then say *risquer* again

Before you move on

What does risquer mean? (“To risk”.) Say it once more.

238.4 résoudre — to solve

Before the new one: say the French for to refuse, then the French for to risk.

You'll want to know: résoudre

résoudre — "to solve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

résoudre ← Latin *resolvere*, "to loosen, to untie" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: résoudre*
- *Say it: résoudre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *résoudre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to refuse, then the French for to risk, then say *résoudre* again

Before you move on

What does résoudre mean? ("To solve".) Say it once more.

238.5 voler — to fly, to steal

Before the new one: say the French for to risk, then the French for to solve.

You'll want to know: voler

voler — "to fly, to steal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voler ← Latin *volare*, "to fly" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. "To steal" grew out of falconry: a hawk flew at its prey.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: voler*
- *Say it: voler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *voler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to risk, then the French for to solve, then say *voler* again

Before you move on

What does voler mean? ("To fly, to steal".) Say it once more.

Chapter 239

To unite, To be worth, To get used to, To realise, To hurry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to unite, to be worth, to get used to, to realise and to hurry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 239: I can say to unite, to be worth, to get used to, to realise and to hurry.*

239.1 unir — to unite

> Before the new one: say the French for to solve, then the French for to fly.

You'll want to know: unir

unir — "to unite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

unir ← Latin *unire*, "to make one", from *unus*, "one" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1 has its Old French form.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: unir*
- *Say it: unir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *unir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to solve, then the French for to fly, then say *unir* again

Before you move on

What does unir mean? (“To unite”.) Say it once more.

239.2 valoir — to be worth

Before the new one: say the French for to fly, then the French for to unite.

You’ll want to know: valoir

valoir — “to be worth”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

valoir ← Old French *valoir* ← Latin *valere*, “to be strong, to be worth” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: valoir*
- *Say it: valoir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *valoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fly, then the French for to unite, then say *valoir* again

Before you move on

What does valoir mean? ("To be worth".) Say it once more.

239.3 s'habituer — to get used to

Before the new one: say the French for to unite, then the French for to be worth.

You'll want to know: s'habituer

s'habituer — "to get used to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

s'habituer ← Late Latin *habituare*, "to bring into a condition", from *habitus*, "a state, a habit" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: s'habituer*
- *Say it: s'habituer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *s'habituer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to unite, then the French for to be worth, then say *s'habituer* again

Before you move on

What does s'habituer mean? ("To get used to".) Say it once more.

239.4 se rendre compte — to realise

Before the new one: say the French for to be worth, then the French for to get used to.

You'll want to know: se rendre compte

se rendre compte — "to realise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se rendre compte — "to render oneself an account": *rendre*, "to give back", and *compte*, "an account". *Rendre* ← Latin *reddere*, "to give back", and *compte* ← Latin *computus*, "a reckoning" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se rendre compte*
- *Say it: se rendre compte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se rendre compte*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be worth, then the French for to get used to, then say *se rendre compte* again

Before you move on

What does se rendre compte mean? ("To realise".) Say it once more.

239.5 se dépêcher — to hurry

Before the new one: say the French for to get used to, then the French for to realise.

You'll want to know: se dépêcher

se dépêcher — "to hurry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se dépêcher — built in Old French as the opposite of the verb for "to hinder", ← Late Latin *impedicare*, "to catch, to entangle" (Lewis & Short): to get free and go.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: se dépêcher*
- *Say it: se dépêcher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *se dépêcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get used to, then the French for to realise, then say *se dépêcher* again

Before you move on

What does se dépêcher mean? ("To hurry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 240

To insist, To interrupt, To tie, To mix, To obey

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to insist, to interrupt, to tie, to mix and to obey.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 240: I can say to insist, to interrupt, to tie, to mix and to obey.*

240.1 insister — to insist

> Before the new one: say the French for to realise, then the French for to hurry.

You'll want to know: insister

insister — "to insist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

insister ← Latin *insistere*, "to stand on, to press on" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: insister*
- *Say it: insister*, once more
- *Say it:* say *insister*
- *Recall:* say the French for to realise, then the French for to hurry, then say *insister* again

Before you move on

What does insister mean? ("To insist".) Say it once more.

240.2 interrompre — to interrupt

Before the new one: say the French for to hurry, then the French for to insist.

You'll want to know: interrompre

interrompre — "to interrupt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interrompre ← Latin *interrumpere*, "to break apart" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: interrompre*
- *Say it: interrompre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *interrompre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hurry, then the French for to insist, then say *interrompre* again

Before you move on

What does interrompre mean? ("To interrupt".) Say it once more.

240.3 attacher — to tie, to fasten

Before the new one: say the French for to insist, then the French for to interrupt.

You'll want to know: attacher

attacher — "to tie, to fasten".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

attacher ← Old French *atachier*, built on the word for "a nail, a fastener", which came from a Germanic word for "a stake". (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: attacher*
- *Say it: attacher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *attacher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to insist, then the French for to interrupt, then say *attacher* again

Before you move on

What does attacher mean? ("To tie, to fasten".) Say it once more.

240.4 mélanger — to mix

Before the new one: say the French for to interrupt, then the French for to tie.

You'll want to know: mélanger

mélanger — "to mix".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mélanger — built from the verb for "to mix", ← Vulgar Latin **misculare*, from Latin *miscere*, "to mix" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mélanger*
- *Say it: mélanger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mélanger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to interrupt, then the French for to tie, then say *mélanger* again

Before you move on

What does mélanger mean? ("To mix".) Say it once more.

240.5 obéir — to obey

Before the new one: say the French for to tie, then the French for to mix.

You'll want to know: obéir

obéir — "to obey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

obéir ← Old French *obeir* ← Latin *oboedire*, "to obey" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: obéir*
- *Say it: obéir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obéir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tie, then the French for to mix, then say *obéir* again

Before you move on

What does obéir mean? ("To obey".) Say it once more.

Chapter 241

To cough, To tremble, To scream, To vote, To welcome

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to cough, to tremble, to scream, to vote and to welcome.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 241: I can say to cough, to tremble, to scream, to vote and to welcome.

241.1 tousser — to cough

Before the new one: say the French for to mix, then the French for to obey.

You'll want to know: tousser

tousser — "to cough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tousser ← Latin *tussire*, "to cough" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the verb beside *toux*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tousser*
- *Say it: tousser*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tousser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to mix, then the French for to obey, then say *tousser* again

Before you move on

What does tousser mean? ("To cough".) Say it once more.

241.2 trembler — to tremble

Before the new one: say the French for to obey, then the French for to cough.

You'll want to know: trembler

trembler — "to tremble".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trembler ← Old French *trembler* ← Vulgar Latin **tremulare*, from Latin *tremulus*, "trembling" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trembler*
- *Say it: trembler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trembler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to obey, then the French for to cough, then say *trembler* again

Before you move on

What does trembler mean? ("To tremble".) Say it once more.

241.3 hurler — to scream

Before the new one: say the French for to cough, then the French for to tremble.

You'll want to know: hurler

hurler — "to scream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hurler ← Latin *ululare*, "to howl" (Lewis & Short) — inherited, with its first *l* turned to *r*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hurler*
- *Say it: hurler*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hurler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cough, then the French for to tremble, then say *hurler* again

Before you move on

What does hurler mean? ("To scream".) Say it once more.

241.4 voter — to vote

Before the new one: say the French for to tremble, then the French for to scream.

You'll want to know: voter

voter — "to vote".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voter — formed from the word for "a vote", ← English *vote*, from Latin *votum*, "a vow, a wish" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: voter*
- *Say it: voter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *voter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tremble, then the French for to scream, then say *voter* again

Before you move on

What does voter mean? ("To vote".) Say it once more.

241.5 accueillir — to welcome

Before the new one: say the French for to scream, then the French for to vote.

You'll want to know: accueillir

accueillir — "to welcome".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accueillir ← Old French *acoillir* ← Vulgar Latin **accolligere* (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: *cueillir* with *ac-*, "to".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: accueillir*
- *Say it: accueillir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *accueillir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to scream, then the French for to vote, then say *accueillir* again

Before you move on

What does accueillir mean? ("To welcome".) Say it once more.

241.6 Words from chapters 233-236 — a first pass

Say the words for to vote and to welcome.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to iron, to repair, to build, to photograph, to repeat
- to fill, to empty, to measure, to weigh, to check
- to move house, to rent, to rest, to wake up, to do one's hair
- to be enough, to burn, to throw away, to calculate, to hit

Before you move on

To iron? (**repasser**.) To repair? (**réparer**.) To build? (**construire**.) To photograph? (**photographier**.) To repeat? (**répéter**.) To fill? (**remplir**.) To empty? (**vider**.) To measure? (**mesurer**.) To weigh? (**peser**.) To check? (**vérifier**.) To move house? (**déménager**.) To rent? (**louer**.) To rest? (**se reposer**.)

To wake up? (**se réveiller**.) To do one's hair? (**se coiffer**.) To be enough? (**suffire**.) To burn? (**brûler**.) To throw away? (**jeter**.) To calculate? (**calculer**.) To hit? (**frapper**.)

241.7 Words from chapters 237-241 — a second pass

Say the words for to miss and to deserve.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to miss, to deserve, to improve, to get worse, to offer
- to reduce, to refuse, to risk, to solve, to fly
- to unite, to be worth, to get used to, to realise, to hurry
- to insist, to interrupt, to tie, to mix, to obey
- to cough, to tremble, to scream, to vote, to welcome

Before you move on

To miss? (**manquer**.) To deserve? (**mériter**.) To improve? (**améliorer**.) To get worse? (**empirer**.) To offer? (**offrir**.) To reduce? (**réduire**.) To refuse? (**refuser**.) To risk? (**risquer**.) To solve? (**résoudre**.) To fly? (**voler**.) To unite? (**unir**.) To be worth? (**valoir**.) To get used to? (**s'habituer**.) To realise? (**se rendre compte**.) To hurry? (**se dépêcher**.) To insist? (**insister**.) To interrupt? (**interrompre**.) To tie? (**attacher**.) To mix? (**mélanger**.) To obey? (**obéir**.) To cough? (**tousser**.) To tremble? (**trembler**.) To scream? (**hurler**.) To vote? (**voter**.) To welcome? (**accueillir**.)

Chapter 242

To lose weight, To feed, To go on holiday, To joke, To tidy up

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to lose weight, to feed, to go on holiday, to joke and to tidy up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 242: I can say to lose weight, to feed, to go on holiday, to joke and to tidy up.*

242.1 maigrir — to lose weight

> Before the new one: say the French for to vote, then the French for to welcome.

You'll want to know: maigrir

maigrir — "to lose weight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maigrir — built from the word for "thin", ← Latin *macer*, "lean" (Lewis & Short), with the verb ending *-ir*. (EtymDB 2.1 has the Old French form of the adjective.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maigrir*
- *Say it: maigrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maigrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to vote, then the French for to welcome, then say *maigrir* again

Before you move on

What does maigrir mean? ("To lose weight".) Say it once more.

242.2 nourrir — to feed

Before the new one: say the French for to welcome, then the French for to lose weight.

You'll want to know: nourrir

nourrir — "to feed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nourrir ← Old French *norrir* ← Latin *nutrire*, "to suckle, to feed" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nourrir*
- *Say it: nourrir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nourrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to welcome, then the French for to lose weight, then say *nourrir* again

Before you move on

What does nourrir mean? (“To feed”.) Say it once more.

242.3 partir en vacances — to go on holiday

Before the new one: say the French for to lose weight, then the French for to feed.

You’ll want to know: partir en vacances

partir en vacances — “to go on holiday”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

partir en vacances — *partir*, “to leave”, first “to divide”, ← Latin *partire*, “to share out” (EtymDB 2.1); *en*, “on”; and *vacances*, “holidays”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: partir en vacances*
- *Say it: partir en vacances*, once more
- *Say it:* say *partir en vacances*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lose weight, then the French for to feed, then say *partir en vacances* again

Before you move on

What does partir en vacances mean? (“To go on holiday”.) Say it once more.

242.4 plaisanter — to joke

Before the new one: say the French for to feed, then the French for to go on holiday.

You'll want to know: plaisanter

plaisanter — "to joke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plaisanter — built from the word for "pleasing", from the verb for "to please", ← Latin *placere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plaisanter*
- *Say it: plaisanter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plaisanter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to feed, then the French for to go on holiday, then say *plaisanter* again

Before you move on

What does plaisanter mean? ("To joke".) Say it once more.

242.5 ranger — to tidy up

Before the new one: say the French for to go on holiday, then the French for to joke.

You'll want to know: ranger

ranger — "to tidy up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ranger — built from the word for “a row, a rank”, ← Frankish **hring*, “a ring”. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ranger*
- *Say it:* *ranger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ranger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go on holiday, then the French for to joke, then say *ranger* again

Before you move on

What does ranger mean? (“To tidy up”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 243

Plaster, Emergency department, Emergency, Medical appointment, Diet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a plaster, the emergency department, an emergency, a medical appointment and a diet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 243: I can say a plaster, the emergency department, an emergency, a medical appointment and a diet.*

243.1 le pansement — a plaster, a dressing

> Before the new one: say the French for to joke, then the French for to tidy up.

You'll want to know: le pansement

le pansement — "a plaster, a dressing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pansement — built from the verb for "to dress a wound", once the same verb as *penser*, "to think": to tend is to think of. (EtymDB 2.1 links it to the verb.)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pansement*
- *Say it: le pansement*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pansement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to joke, then the French for to tidy up, then say *le pansement* again

Before you move on

What does le pansement mean? ("A plaster, a dressing".) Say it once more.

243.2 les urgences — the emergency department

Before the new one: say the French for to tidy up, then the French for a plaster.

You'll want to know: les urgences

les urgences — "the emergency department".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

urgences is the plural of the word for "an emergency", ← Latin *urgens*, "pressing", from *urgere*, "to press" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les urgences*
- *Say it: les urgences*, once more

- *Say it:* say *les urgences*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tidy up, then the French for a plaster, then say *les urgences* again

Before you move on

What does les urgences mean? ("The emergency department".) Say it once more.

243.3 l'urgence — an emergency

Before the new one: say the French for a plaster, then the French for the emergency department.

You'll want to know: l'urgence

l'urgence — "an emergency".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

urgence — built from the word for "urgent", ← Latin *urgens*, "pressing", from *urgere*, "to press" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'urgence*
- *Say it: l'urgence*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'urgence*
- *Recall:* say the French for a plaster, then the French for the emergency department, then say *l'urgence* again

Before you move on

What does l'urgence mean? ("An emergency".) Say it once more.

243.4 la consultation — a medical appointment

Before the new one: say the French for the emergency department, then the French for an emergency.

You'll want to know: la consultation

la consultation — "a medical appointment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

consultation ← Latin *consultatio*, "a deliberation" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la consultation*
- *Say it: la consultation*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la consultation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the emergency department, then the French for an emergency, then say *la consultation* again

Before you move on

What does la consultation mean? ("A medical appointment".) Say it once more.

243.5 le régime — a diet

Before the new one: say the French for an emergency, then the French for a medical appointment.

You'll want to know: le régime

le régime — "a diet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

régime ← Latin *regimen*, "guidance, rule", from *regere*, "to rule" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le régime*
- *Say it:* *le régime*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le régime*
- *Recall:* say the French for an emergency, then the French for a medical appointment, then say *le régime* again

Before you move on

What does le régime mean? ("A diet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 244

Silent, Clean, Hard, Smooth, Rough

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say silent, clean, hard, smooth and rough.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 244: I can say silent, clean, hard, smooth and rough.*

244.1 silencieux / silencieuse — silent

> Before the new one: say the French for a medical appointment, then the French for a diet.

You'll want to know: silencieux / silencieuse

silencieux / silencieuse — "silent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

silencieux — built from the word for "silence", ← Latin *silentium* (Lewis & Short), with *-eux*, "full of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: silencieux / silencieuse*
- *Say it: silencieux / silencieuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *silencieux / silencieuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a medical appointment, then the French for a diet, then say *silencieux / silencieuse* again

Before you move on

What does silencieux / silencieuse mean? ("Silent".) Say it once more.

244.2 propre — clean

Before the new one: say the French for a diet, then the French for silent.

You'll want to know: propre

propre — "clean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

propre ← Latin *proprius*, "one's own" (EtymDB 2.1) — taken from Latin; "clean" grew out of "proper".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: propre*
- *Say it: propre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *propre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a diet, then the French for silent, then say *propre* again

Before you move on

What does propre mean? (“Clean”.) Say it once more.

244.3 dur / dure — hard

Before the new one: say the French for silent, then the French for clean.

You’ll want to know: dur / dure

dur / dure — “hard”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dur ← Latin *durus*, “hard” (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dur / dure*
- *Say it: dur / dure*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dur / dure*
- *Recall:* say the French for silent, then the French for clean, then say *dur / dure* again

Before you move on

What does dur / dure mean? (“Hard”.) Say it once more.

244.4 lisse — smooth

Before the new one: say the French for clean, then the French for hard.

You'll want to know: lisse

lisse — "smooth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lisse — formed from the verb for "to smooth", whose origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lisse*
- *Say it: lisse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lisse*
- *Recall:* say the French for clean, then the French for hard, then say *lisse* again

Before you move on

What does lisse mean? ("Smooth".) Say it once more.

244.5 rugueux / rugueuse — rough

Before the new one: say the French for hard, then the French for smooth.

You'll want to know: rugueux / rugueuse

rugueux / rugueuse — "rough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rugueux ← Latin *rugosus*, "wrinkled", from *ruga*, the Latin of *rue* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rugueux / rugueuse*
- *Say it: rugueux / rugueuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rugueux / rugueuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for hard, then the French for smooth, then say *rugueux / rugueuse* again

Before you move on

What does rugueux / rugueuse mean? ("Rough".) Say it once more.

Chapter 245

Similar, Fair, False, Ready, Free of charge

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say similar, fair, false, ready and free of charge.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 245: I can say similar, fair, false, ready and free of charge.

245.1 semblable — similar

Before the new one: say the French for smooth, then the French for rough.

You'll want to know: semblable

semblable — "similar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

semblable — *sembler* with *-able*: seeming alike. *Sembler* ← Late Latin *similāre*, from *similis*, "like" (EtymDB 2.1).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: semblable*
- *Say it: semblable*, once more
- *Say it:* say *semblable*
- *Recall:* say the French for smooth, then the French for rough, then say *semblable* again

Before you move on

What does semblable mean? ("Similar".) Say it once more.

245.2 juste — fair, right

Before the new one: say the French for rough, then the French for similar.

You'll want to know: juste

juste — "fair, right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juste ← Latin *iustus*, "lawful, right", from *ius*, "law" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: juste*
- *Say it: juste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *juste*
- *Recall:* say the French for rough, then the French for similar, then say *juste* again

Before you move on

What does juste mean? (“Fair, right”.) Say it once more.

245.3 faux / fausse — false, wrong

Before the new one: say the French for similar, then the French for fair.

You’ll want to know: faux / fausse

faux / fausse — “false, wrong”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faux ← Old French *faus* ← Latin *falsus*, “deceived, false”, from *fallere*, “to deceive” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: faux / fausse*
- *Say it: faux / fausse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *faux / fausse*
- *Recall:* say the French for similar, then the French for fair, then say *faux / fausse* again

Before you move on

What does faux / fausse mean? (“False, wrong”.) Say it once more.

245.4 prêt / prête — ready

Before the new one: say the French for fair, then the French for false.

You'll want to know: prêt / prête

prêt / prête — "ready".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prêt ← Late Latin *praestus*, "at hand", from *praesto*, "ready" (Lewis & Short) — inherited. It is a different word from *prêt*, "a loan".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *prêt / prête*
- *Say it:* *prêt / prête*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prêt / prête*
- *Recall:* say the French for fair, then the French for false, then say *prêt / prête* again

Before you move on

What does prêt / prête mean? ("Ready".) Say it once more.

245.5 gratuit / gratuite — free of charge

Before the new one: say the French for false, then the French for ready.

You'll want to know: gratuit / gratuite

gratuit / gratuite — "free of charge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gratuit ← Latin *gratuitus*, "freely given", from *gratia*, "favour" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gratuit / gratuite*
- *Say it: gratuit / gratuite*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gratuit / gratuite*
- *Recall:* say the French for false, then the French for ready, then say *gratuit / gratuite* again

Before you move on

What does gratuit / gratuite mean? ("Free of charge".) Say it once more.

Chapter 246

Generous, Lazy, Hard-working, Talkative, Angry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say generous, lazy, hard-working, talkative and angry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 246: I can say generous, lazy, hard-working, talkative and angry.*

246.1 généreux / généreuse — generous

Before the new one: say the French for ready, then the French for free of charge.

You'll want to know: généreux / généreuse

généreux / généreuse — "generous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

généreux ← Latin *generosus*, "of noble birth", from *genus*, "birth, kind" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: généreux / généreuse*
- *Say it: généreux / généreuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *généreux / généreuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for ready, then the French for free of charge, then say *généreux / généreuse* again

Before you move on

What does généreux / généreuse mean? ("Generous".) Say it once more.

246.2 paresseux / paresseuse — lazy

Before the new one: say the French for free of charge, then the French for generous.

You'll want to know: paresseux / paresseuse

paresseux / paresseuse — "lazy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

paresseux — built from the word for "laziness", ← Latin *pigritia*, "sloth" (Lewis & Short), with *-eux*, "full of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paresseux / paresseuse*
- *Say it: paresseux / paresseuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paresseux / paresseuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for free of charge, then the French for generous, then say *paresseux / paresseuse* again

Before you move on

What does paresseux / paresseuse mean? (“Lazy”.) Say it once more.

246.3 travailleur / travailleuse — hard-working

Before the new one: say the French for generous, then the French for lazy.

You’ll want to know: travailleur / travailleuse

travailleur / travailleuse — “hard-working”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

travailleur — *travailler*, “to work”, with *-eur*, “one who”. *Travailler* ← Vulgar Latin **tripaliāre*, “to torture” (EtymDB 2.1).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: travailleur / travailleuse*
- *Say it: travailleur / travailleuse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *travailleur / travailleuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for generous, then the French for lazy, then say *travailleur / travailleuse* again

Before you move on

What does travailleur / travailleuse mean? (“Hard-working”.) Say it once more.

246.4 bavard / bavarde — talkative

Before the new one: say the French for lazy, then the French for hard-working.

You'll want to know: bavard / bavarde

bavard / bavarde — "talkative".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bavard — built from the word for "drool", with *-ard*: the adjective behind *bavarder*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bavard / bavarde*
- *Say it: bavard / bavarde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bavard / bavarde*
- *Recall:* say the French for lazy, then the French for hard-working, then say *bavard / bavarde* again

Before you move on

What does bavard / bavarde mean? ("Talkative".) Say it once more.

246.5 fâché / fâchée — angry

Before the new one: say the French for hard-working, then the French for talkative.

You'll want to know: fâché / fâchée

fâché / fâchée — "angry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fâché is the past participle of the verb in *se fâcher*, "to get angry": angered. *Fâcher* is of uncertain origin, usually traced to Latin *fastīdium*, "disgust".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fâché / fâchée*
- *Say it: fâché / fâchée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fâché / fâchée*
- *Recall:* say the French for hard-working, then the French for talkative, then say *fâché / fâchée* again

Before you move on

What does fâché / fâchée mean? ("Angry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 247

Bill, Tip, Stop, Motorbike, Platform

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the bill, a tip, a stop, a motorbike and a platform.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 247: I can say the bill, a tip, a stop, a motorbike and a platform.*

247.1 l'addition — the bill

Before the new one: say the French for talkative, then the French for angry.

You'll want to know: l'addition

l'addition — "the bill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

addition ← Latin *additio*, "an adding", from *addere*, "to add" (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing: the bill adds it all up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'addition*
- *Say it: l'addition*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'addition*
- *Recall:* say the French for talkative, then the French for angry, then say *l'addition* again

Before you move on

What does l'addition mean? ("The bill".) Say it once more.

247.2 le pourboire — a tip

Before the new one: say the French for angry, then the French for the bill.

You'll want to know: le pourboire

le pourboire — "a tip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pourboire — the word for "for" and *boire*, "to drink": money for a drink. *Boire* ← Latin *bibere*, "to drink" (EtymDB 2.1), and *pour* ← Vulgar Latin *por*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pourboire*
- *Say it: le pourboire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le pourboire*
- *Recall:* say the French for angry, then the French for the bill, then say *le pourboire* again

Before you move on

What does le pourboire mean? ("A tip".) Say it once more.

247.3 l'arrêt — a stop

Before the new one: say the French for the bill, then the French for a tip.

You'll want to know: l'arrêt

l'arrêt — "a stop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrêt — formed from *arrêter*, "to stop": a stop. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arrêt*
- *Say it: l'arrêt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'arrêt*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bill, then the French for a tip, then say *l'arrêt* again

Before you move on

What does l'arrêt mean? ("A stop".) Say it once more.

247.4 la moto — a motorbike

Before the new one: say the French for a tip, then the French for a stop.

You'll want to know: la moto

la moto — "a motorbike".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moto — short for *motocyclette*, built from the word for "motor", as in *moteur*, and the word for "cycle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la moto*
- *Say it: la moto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la moto*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tip, then the French for a stop, then say *la moto* again

Before you move on

What does la moto mean? ("A motorbike".) Say it once more.

247.5 le quai — a platform

Before the new one: say the French for a stop, then the French for a motorbike.

You'll want to know: le quai

le quai — "a platform".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quai ← Old French *cai* ← Gaulish **caio-*, "an enclosure" — a Celtic word that came into French through the northern dialects. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le quai*
- *Say it: le quai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le quai*
- *Recall:* say the French for a stop, then the French for a motorbike, then say *le quai* again

Before you move on

What does le quai mean? ("A platform".) Say it once more.

Chapter 248

Mayor, Elections, Vote, Politics, Economy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a mayor, elections, a vote, politics and the economy.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 248: I can say a mayor, elections, a vote, politics and the economy.

248.1 le maire — a mayor

Before the new one: say the French for a motorbike, then the French for a platform.

You'll want to know: le maire

le maire — "a mayor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maire ← Old French *maire* ← Latin *maior*, "greater" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: the noun behind *mairie*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le maire*
- *Say it: le maire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le maire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a motorbike, then the French for a platform, then say *le maire* again

Before you move on

What does le maire mean? ("A mayor".) Say it once more.

248.2 les élections — elections

Before the new one: say the French for a platform, then the French for a mayor.

You'll want to know: les élections

les élections — "elections".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

élections is the plural of the word for "an election", ← Latin *electio*, "a choosing", from *eligere*, "to pick out" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les élections*
- *Say it: les élections*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les élections*
- *Recall:* say the French for a platform, then the French for a mayor, then say *les élections* again

Before you move on

What does les élections mean? (“Elections”.) Say it once more.

248.3 le vote — a vote

Before the new one: say the French for a mayor, then the French for elections.

You’ll want to know: le vote

le vote — “a vote”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vote ← English *vote* ← Latin *votum*, “a vow, a wish” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vote*
- *Say it: le vote*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le vote*
- *Recall:* say the French for a mayor, then the French for elections, then say *le vote* again

Before you move on

What does le vote mean? (“A vote”.) Say it once more.

248.4 la politique — politics

Before the new one: say the French for elections, then the French for a vote.

You'll want to know: la politique

la politique — "politics".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

politique ← Latin *politicus*, from Greek *politikos*, "of citizens", from the same *polis*, "city", as *police* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la politique*
- *Say it: la politique*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la politique*
- *Recall:* say the French for elections, then the French for a vote, then say *la politique* again

Before you move on

What does la politique mean? ("Politics".) Say it once more.

248.5 l'économie — the economy

Before the new one: say the French for a vote, then the French for politics.

You'll want to know: l'économie

l'économie — "the economy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

économie ← Latin *oeconomia*, from Greek *oikonomia*, "running a household", from *oikos*, "house" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'économie*
- *Say it: l'économie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'économie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a vote, then the French for politics, then say *l'économie* again

Before you move on

What does l'économie mean? ("The economy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 249

Actor, Actress, Poem, Writer, Painter

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an actor, an actress, a poem, a writer and a painter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 249: I can say an actor, an actress, a poem, a writer and a painter.*

249.1 l'acteur — an actor

> Before the new one: say the French for politics, then the French for the economy.

You'll want to know: l'acteur

l'acteur — "an actor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

acteur ← Latin *actor*, "a doer, a performer", from *agere*, the Latin of *agir* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'acteur*
- *Say it: l'acteur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'acteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for politics, then the French for the economy, then say *l'acteur* again

Before you move on

What does l'acteur mean? ("An actor".) Say it once more.

249.2 l'actrice — an actress

Before the new one: say the French for the economy, then the French for an actor.

You'll want to know: l'actrice

l'actrice — "an actress".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

actrice ← Latin *actrix*, the feminine of *actor*: the feminine of *acteur* — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'actrice*
- *Say it: l'actrice*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'actrice*
- *Recall:* say the French for the economy, then the French for an actor, then say *l'actrice* again

Before you move on

What does l'actrice mean? ("An actress".) Say it once more.

249.3 le poème — a poem

Before the new one: say the French for an actor, then the French for an actress.

You'll want to know: le poème

le poème — "a poem".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poème ← Latin *poema*, from Greek *poiema*, "a thing made", from *poiein*, "to make" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le poème*
- *Say it: le poème*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le poème*
- *Recall:* say the French for an actor, then the French for an actress, then say *le poème* again

Before you move on

What does le poème mean? ("A poem".) Say it once more.

249.4 l'écrivain — a writer

Before the new one: say the French for an actress, then the French for a poem.

You'll want to know: l'écrivain

l'écrivain — "a writer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écrivain ← Old French *escrivain* ← Vulgar Latin **scribanem*, from Latin *scriba*, "a clerk", from *scribere*, the Latin of *écrire* — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'écrivain*
- *Say it: l'écrivain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'écrivain*
- *Recall:* say the French for an actress, then the French for a poem, then say *l'écrivain* again

Before you move on

What does l'écrivain mean? ("A writer".) Say it once more.

249.5 le peintre — a painter

Before the new one: say the French for a poem, then the French for a writer.

You'll want to know: le peintre

le peintre — "a painter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peintre ← Old French *peintre* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Vulgar Latin **pinctor* ← Latin *pictor*, "a painter" (Lewis & Short) — inherited: the noun beside *peindre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le peintre*
- *Say it: le peintre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le peintre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a poem, then the French for a writer, then say *le peintre* again

Before you move on

What does le peintre mean? ("A painter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 250

Foreigner, Tourist, Adult, Elderly person, Twin

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a foreigner, a tourist, an adult, an elderly person and a twin.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 250: I can say a foreigner, a tourist, an adult, an elderly person and a twin.

250.1 l'étranger — a foreigner

Before the new one: say the French for a writer, then the French for a painter.

You'll want to know: l'étranger

l'étranger — "a foreigner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étranger — the adjective *étranger*, "foreign", used as a noun: a foreigner. It is built on Old French *estrange*, "foreign" (EtymDB 2.1), from Latin *extrāneus*, "from outside".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étranger*
- *Say it: l'étranger*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'étranger*
- *Recall:* say the French for a writer, then the French for a painter, then say *l'étranger* again

Before you move on

What does l'étranger mean? ("A foreigner".) Say it once more.

250.2 le touriste — a tourist

Before the new one: say the French for a painter, then the French for a foreigner.

You'll want to know: le touriste

le touriste — "a tourist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

touriste ← English *tourist*, built on English *tour*, "a circuit", which English had taken from French — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le touriste*
- *Say it: le touriste*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le touriste*
- *Recall:* say the French for a painter, then the French for a foreigner, then say *le touriste* again

Before you move on

What does le touriste mean? ("A tourist".) Say it once more.

250.3 l'adulte — an adult

Before the new one: say the French for a foreigner, then the French for a tourist.

You'll want to know: l'adulte

l'adulte — "an adult".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adulte ← Latin *adultus*, "grown up", from *adolescere*, "to grow up" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'adulte*
- *Say it: l'adulte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'adulte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a foreigner, then the French for a tourist, then say *l'adulte* again

Before you move on

What does l'adulte mean? ("An adult".) Say it once more.

250.4 la personne âgée — an elderly person

Before the new one: say the French for a tourist, then the French for an adult.

You'll want to know: la personne âgée

la personne âgée — "an elderly person".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

personne âgée — *personne*, "a person", and *âgée*, "aged", from *âge*, "age", ← Vulgar Latin **aetaticum*, from Latin *aetas*, "age" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la personne âgée*
- *Say it: la personne âgée*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la personne âgée*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tourist, then the French for an adult, then say *la personne âgée* again

Before you move on

What does la personne âgée mean? ("An elderly person".) Say it once more.

250.5 le jumeau — a twin

Before the new one: say the French for an adult, then the French for an elderly person.

You'll want to know: le jumeau

le jumeau — "a twin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jumeau ← Old French *jumel* (EtymDB 2.1) ← Latin *gemellus*, "twin-born", a little form of *geminus*, "a twin" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jumeau*
- *Say it: le jumeau*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le jumeau*
- *Recall:* say the French for an adult, then the French for an elderly person, then say *le jumeau* again

Before you move on

What does le jumeau mean? ("A twin".) Say it once more.

250.6 Words from chapters 242-245 — a first pass

Say the words for an elderly person and a twin.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to lose weight, to feed, to go on holiday, to joke, to tidy up
- a plaster, the emergency department, an emergency, a medical appointment, a diet
- silent, clean, hard, smooth, rough
- similar, fair, false, ready, free of charge

Before you move on

To lose weight? (**maigrir**.) To feed? (**nourrir**.) To go on holiday? (**partir en vacances**.) To joke? (**plaisanter**.) To tidy up? (**ranger**.) A plaster? (**le pansement**.) The emergency department? (**les urgences**.) An emergency? (**l'urgence**.) A

medical appointment? (**la consultation**.) A diet? (**le régime**.) Silent? (**silencieux / silencieuse**.) Clean? (**propre**.) Hard? (**dur / dure**.) Smooth? (**lisse**.) Rough? (**rugueux / rugueuse**.) Similar? (**semblable**.) Fair? (**juste**.) False? (**faux / fausse**.) Ready? (**prêt / prête**.) Free of charge? (**gratuit / gratuite**.)

250.7 Words from chapters 246-250 — a second pass

Say the words for generous and lazy.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- generous, lazy, hard-working, talkative, angry
- the bill, a tip, a stop, a motorbike, a platform
- a mayor, elections, a vote, politics, the economy
- an actor, an actress, a poem, a writer, a painter
- a foreigner, a tourist, an adult, an elderly person, a twin

Before you move on

Generous? (**généreux / généreuse**.) Lazy? (**paresseux / paresseuse**.) Hard-working? (**travailleur / travailleuse**.) Talkative? (**bavard / bavarde**.) Angry? (**fâché / fâchée**.) The bill? (**l'addition**.) A tip? (**le pourboire**.) A stop? (**l'arrêt**.) A motorbike? (**la moto**.) A platform? (**le quai**.) A mayor? (**le maire**.) Elections? (**les élections**.) A vote? (**le vote**.) Politics? (**la politique**.) The economy? (**l'économie**.) An actor? (**l'acteur**.) An actress? (**l'actrice**.) A poem? (**le poème**.) A writer? (**l'écrivain**.) A painter? (**le peintre**.) A foreigner? (**l'étranger**.) A tourist? (**le touriste**.) An adult? (**l'adulte**.) An elderly person? (**la personne âgée**.) A twin? (**le jumeau**.)

Chapter 251

Result, Difference, Example, Truth, Lie

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a result, a difference, an example, the truth and a lie.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 251: I can say a result, a difference, an example, the truth and a lie.

251.1 le résultat — a result

Before the new one: say the French for an elderly person, then the French for a twin.

You'll want to know: le résultat

le résultat — "a result".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

résultat ← Medieval Latin *resultatum*, from *resultare*, "to spring back" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le résultat*
- *Say it: le résultat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le résultat*
- *Recall:* say the French for an elderly person, then the French for a twin, then say *le résultat* again

Before you move on

What does le résultat mean? ("A result".) Say it once more.

251.2 la différence — a difference

Before the new one: say the French for a twin, then the French for a result.

You'll want to know: la différence

la différence — "a difference".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

différence ← Latin *differentia*, "a difference" — the noun beside *différent*. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la différence*
- *Say it: la différence*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la différence*
- *Recall:* say the French for a twin, then the French for a result, then say *la différence* again

Before you move on

What does la différence mean? ("A difference".) Say it once more.

251.3 l'exemple — an example

Before the new one: say the French for a result, then the French for a difference.

You'll want to know: l'exemple

l'exemple — "an example".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exemple ← Latin *exemplum*, "a sample, a pattern" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'exemple*
- *Say it: l'exemple*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'exemple*
- *Recall:* say the French for a result, then the French for a difference, then say *l'exemple* again

Before you move on

What does l'exemple mean? ("An example".) Say it once more.

251.4 la vérité — the truth

Before the new one: say the French for a difference, then the French for an example.

You'll want to know: la vérité

la vérité — "the truth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vérité ← Old French *verité* ← Latin *veritas*, "truth", from *verus*, "true" — taken from Latin. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vérité*
- *Say it: la vérité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la vérité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a difference, then the French for an example, then say *la vérité* again

Before you move on

What does la vérité mean? ("The truth".) Say it once more.

251.5 le mensonge — a lie

Before the new one: say the French for an example, then the French for the truth.

You'll want to know: le mensonge

le mensonge — "a lie".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mensonge ← Old French *mençonge* (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Vulgar Latin **mentionica*, built on Latin *mentiri*, "to lie" (Lewis & Short) — inherited.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mensonge*
- *Say it: le mensonge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le mensonge*
- *Recall:* say the French for an example, then the French for the truth, then say *le mensonge* again

Before you move on

What does le mensonge mean? ("A lie".) Say it once more.

Chapter 252

Tax, Form, Envelope, Stamp, Parcel

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tax, a form, an envelope, a stamp and a parcel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 252: I can say a tax, a form, an envelope, a stamp and a parcel.*

252.1 l'impôt — a tax

> Before the new one: say the French for the truth, then the French for a lie.

You'll want to know: l'impôt

l'impôt — "a tax".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

impôt ← Middle French *impost* ← Medieval Latin *impositum*, "a thing laid on", from *imponere* (EtymDB 2.1) — a learned borrowing; the circumflex marks the *s* French later stopped writing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'impôt*
- *Say it: l'impôt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'impôt*
- *Recall:* say the French for the truth, then the French for a lie, then say *l'impôt* again

Before you move on

What does l'impôt mean? ("A tax".) Say it once more.

252.2 le formulaire — a form

Before the new one: say the French for a lie, then the French for a tax.

You'll want to know: le formulaire

le formulaire — "a form".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

formulaire ← Latin *formularium*, "a book of forms", from *formula*, "a little form" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le formulaire*
- *Say it: le formulaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le formulaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lie, then the French for a tax, then say *le formulaire* again

Before you move on

What does le formulaire mean? (“A form”.) Say it once more.

252.3 l’enveloppe — an envelope

Before the new one: say the French for a tax, then the French for a form.

You’ll want to know: l’enveloppe

l’enveloppe — “an envelope”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enveloppe — formed from the verb for “to wrap up” (EtymDB 2.1), built from *en-* and an Old French verb for “to wrap” of uncertain origin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’enveloppe*
- *Say it: l’enveloppe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’enveloppe*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tax, then the French for a form, then say *l’enveloppe* again

Before you move on

What does l’enveloppe mean? (“An envelope”.) Say it once more.

252.4 le timbre — a stamp

Before the new one: say the French for a form, then the French for an envelope.

You'll want to know: le timbre

le timbre — "a stamp".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

timbre ← Old French *timbre*, "a drum, a bell" ← Latin *tympanum*, from Greek *tympanon*, "a drum" — inherited (EtymDB 2.1): then the mark struck on a letter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le timbre*
- *Say it: le timbre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le timbre*
- *Recall:* say the French for a form, then the French for an envelope, then say *le timbre* again

Before you move on

What does le timbre mean? ("A stamp".) Say it once more.

252.5 le colis — a parcel

Before the new one: say the French for an envelope, then the French for a stamp.

You'll want to know: le colis

le colis — "a parcel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

colis ← Italian *colli*, "loads", the plural of *collo*, "a neck, a load carried on it", ← Latin *collum*, the Latin of *cou* — borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le colis*
- *Say it: le colis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le colis*
- *Recall:* say the French for an envelope, then the French for a stamp, then say *le colis* again

Before you move on

What does le colis mean? ("A parcel".) Say it once more.

Chapter 253

Driving licence, Helmet, Tunnel, Building site, Block of flats

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a driving licence, a helmet, a tunnel, a building site and a block of flats.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 253: I can say a driving licence, a helmet, a tunnel, a building site and a block of flats.

253.1 le permis de conduire — a driving licence

Before the new one: say the French for a stamp, then the French for a parcel.

You'll want to know: le permis de conduire

le permis de conduire — "a driving licence".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

permis de conduire — *permis*, "permitted", from *permettre*, *de*, "of", and *conduire*, "to drive": leave to drive.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le permis de conduire*
- *Say it: le permis de conduire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le permis de conduire*
- *Recall:* say the French for a stamp, then the French for a parcel, then say *le permis de conduire* again

Before you move on

What does le permis de conduire mean? ("A driving licence".) Say it once more.

253.2 le casque — a helmet

Before the new one: say the French for a parcel, then the French for a driving licence.

You'll want to know: le casque

le casque — "a helmet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

casque ← Spanish *casco*, "a skull, a helmet", from *cascar*, "to break", ← Latin *quassare*, "to shatter" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le casque*
- *Say it: le casque*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le casque*
- *Recall:* say the French for a parcel, then the French for a driving licence, then say *le casque* again

Before you move on

What does le casque mean? ("A helmet".) Say it once more.

253.3 le tunnel — a tunnel

Before the new one: say the French for a driving licence, then the French for a helmet.

You'll want to know: le tunnel

le tunnel — "a tunnel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tunnel ← English *tunnel* (EtymDB 2.1) — borrowed back: English had taken it from Old French *tonel*, "a cask".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tunnel*
- *Say it: le tunnel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tunnel*
- *Recall:* say the French for a driving licence, then the French for a helmet, then say *le tunnel* again

Before you move on

What does le tunnel mean? ("A tunnel".) Say it once more.

253.4 le chantier — a building site

Before the new one: say the French for a helmet, then the French for a tunnel.

You'll want to know: le chantier

le chantier — "a building site".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chantier ← Latin *cantherius*, "a gelding; a rafter, a trestle" (EtymDB 2.1) — inherited: first a timber support, then a work yard.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chantier*
- *Say it: le chantier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le chantier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a helmet, then the French for a tunnel, then say *le chantier* again

Before you move on

What does le chantier mean? ("A building site".) Say it once more.

253.5 l'immeuble — a block of flats

Before the new one: say the French for a tunnel, then the French for a building site.

You'll want to know: l'immeuble

l'immeuble — "a block of flats".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

immeuble ← Latin *immobilis*, "that cannot be moved" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing: first property in land and buildings.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'immeuble*
- *Say it: l'immeuble*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'immeuble*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tunnel, then the French for a building site, then say *l'immeuble* again

Before you move on

What does l'immeuble mean? ("A block of flats".) Say it once more.

Chapter 254

Trunk, Thorn, Lawn, Path, Cave

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a trunk, a thorn, a lawn, a path and a cave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 254: I can say a trunk, a thorn, a lawn, a path and a cave.*

254.1 le tronc — a trunk

> Before the new one: say the French for a building site, then the French for a block of flats.

You'll want to know: le tronc

le tronc — "a trunk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tronc ← Latin *truncus*, "a trunk, a stem" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tronc*

- *Say it:* *le tronc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tronc*
- *Recall:* say the French for a building site, then the French for a block of flats, then say *le tronc* again

Before you move on

What does le tronc mean? (“A trunk”.) Say it once more.

254.2 l’épine — a thorn

Before the new one: say the French for a block of flats, then the French for a trunk.

You’ll want to know: l’épine

l’épine — “a thorn”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épine ← Old French *espine* ← Latin *spina*, “a thorn” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *l’épine*
- *Say it:* *l’épine*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’épine*
- *Recall:* say the French for a block of flats, then the French for a trunk, then say *l’épine* again

Before you move on

What does l’épine mean? (“A thorn”.) Say it once more.

254.3 la pelouse — a lawn

Before the new one: say the French for a trunk, then the French for a thorn.

You'll want to know: la pelouse

la pelouse — "a lawn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pelouse — from a southern word for "hairy", ← Latin *pilosus*, "hairy", from *pilus*, "a hair" (Lewis & Short): short grass like hair.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pelouse*
- *Say it: la pelouse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la pelouse*
- *Recall:* say the French for a trunk, then the French for a thorn, then say *la pelouse* again

Before you move on

What does la pelouse mean? ("A lawn".) Say it once more.

254.4 le sentier — a path

Before the new one: say the French for a thorn, then the French for a lawn.

You'll want to know: le sentier

le sentier — "a path".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sentier ← Old French *sentier* ← Vulgar Latin **semitarius*, from Latin *semita*, "a path" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sentier*
- *Say it: le sentier*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le sentier*
- *Recall:* say the French for a thorn, then the French for a lawn, then say *le sentier* again

Before you move on

What does le sentier mean? ("A path".) Say it once more.

254.5 la grotte — a cave

Before the new one: say the French for a lawn, then the French for a path.

You'll want to know: la grotte

la grotte — "a cave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grotte ← Italian *grotta* ← Latin *crypta*, from Greek *krypte*, "a hidden place" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grotte*
- *Say it: la grotte*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la grotte*
- *Recall:* say the French for a lawn, then the French for a path, then say *la grotte* again

Before you move on

What does la grotte mean? (“A cave”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 255

Rubbish, Recycling, Energy, Electricity, Gas

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say rubbish, recycling, energy, electricity and gas.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 255: I can say rubbish, recycling, energy, electricity and gas.

255.1 les déchets — rubbish

Before the new one: say the French for a path, then the French for a cave.

You'll want to know: les déchets

les déchets — "rubbish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déchets is the plural of a word formed from the verb for "to fall away", built on Latin *cadere*, "to fall" (Lewis & Short): what falls away.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les déchets*
- *Say it: les déchets*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les déchets*
- *Recall:* say the French for a path, then the French for a cave, then say *les déchets* again

Before you move on

What does les déchets mean? ("Rubbish".) Say it once more.

255.2 le recyclage — recycling

Before the new one: say the French for a cave, then the French for rubbish.

You'll want to know: le recyclage

le recyclage — "recycling".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recyclage — built from *re-*, the word for "cycle", ← Latin *cyclus*, from Greek *kyklos*, "a circle" (Lewis & Short), and *-age*; modelled on English *recycling*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le recyclage*
- *Say it: le recyclage*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le recyclage*
- *Recall:* say the French for a cave, then the French for rubbish, then say *le recyclage* again

Before you move on

What does le recyclage mean? ("Recycling".) Say it once more.

255.3 l'énergie — energy

Before the new one: say the French for rubbish, then the French for recycling.

You'll want to know: l'énergie

l'énergie — "energy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

énergie ← Late Latin *energia*, from Greek *energeia*, "activity", built on *ergon*, "work" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'énergie*
- *Say it: l'énergie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'énergie*
- *Recall:* say the French for rubbish, then the French for recycling, then say *l'énergie* again

Before you move on

What does l'énergie mean? ("Energy".) Say it once more.

255.4 l'électricité — electricity

Before the new one: say the French for recycling, then the French for energy.

You'll want to know: l'électricité

l'électricité — "electricity".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

électricité ← English *electricity* (EtymDB 2.1), built on Latin *electrum*, "amber" — borrowed in the 1700s.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'électricité*
- *Say it: l'électricité*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'électricité*
- *Recall:* say the French for recycling, then the French for energy, then say *l'électricité* again

Before you move on

What does l'électricité mean? ("Electricity".) Say it once more.

255.5 le gaz — gas

Before the new one: say the French for energy, then the French for electricity.

You'll want to know: le gaz

le gaz — "gas".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gaz — coined in the 1600s by the Flemish chemist Jan Baptist van Helmont from Greek *khaos*, "empty space" (EtymDB 2.1 links Dutch *gas* to *khaos*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gaz*
- *Say it: le gaz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le gaz*
- *Recall:* say the French for energy, then the French for electricity, then say *le gaz* again

Before you move on

What does le gaz mean? ("Gas".) Say it once more.

Chapter 256

Tool, Guitar, Piano, Violin, Drum

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tool, a guitar, a piano, a violin and a drum.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 256: I can say a tool, a guitar, a piano, a violin and a drum.*

256.1 l'outil — a tool

> Before the new one: say the French for electricity, then the French for gas.

You'll want to know: l'outil

l'outil — "a tool".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

outil ← Old French *ustil* ← Late Latin **usitilium*, "a tool", from *uti*, "to use" — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'outil*
- *Say it: l'outil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'outil*
- *Recall:* say the French for electricity, then the French for gas, then say *l'outil* again

Before you move on

What does l'outil mean? ("A tool".) Say it once more.

256.2 la guitare — a guitar

Before the new one: say the French for gas, then the French for a tool.

You'll want to know: la guitare

la guitare — "a guitar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guitare ← Spanish *guitarra* ← Arabic *qitara*, from Greek *kithara*, "a lyre" — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la guitare*
- *Say it: la guitare*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la guitare*
- *Recall:* say the French for gas, then the French for a tool, then say *la guitare* again

Before you move on

What does la guitare mean? (“A guitar”.) Say it once more.

256.3 le piano — a piano

Before the new one: say the French for a tool, then the French for a guitar.

You’ll want to know: le piano

le piano — “a piano”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

piano ← Italian *piano*, short for *pianoforte*, “soft-loud”; *piano*, “soft”, ← Latin *planus*, “flat, smooth” — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le piano*
- *Say it: le piano*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le piano*
- *Recall:* say the French for a tool, then the French for a guitar, then say *le piano* again

Before you move on

What does le piano mean? (“A piano”.) Say it once more.

256.4 le violon — a violin

Before the new one: say the French for a guitar, then the French for a piano.

You'll want to know: le violon

le violon — "a violin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

violon — built from Old French *viole*, a stringed instrument, with *-on*, under the influence of Italian *violino*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le violon*
- *Say it: le violon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le violon*
- *Recall:* say the French for a guitar, then the French for a piano, then say *le violon* again

Before you move on

What does le violon mean? ("A violin".) Say it once more.

256.5 le tambour — a drum

Before the new one: say the French for a piano, then the French for a violin.

You'll want to know: le tambour

le tambour — "a drum".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tambour ← Old French *tabour*, from Arabic *tunbur* — borrowed. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tambour*
- *Say it: le tambour*, once more
- *Say it:* say *le tambour*
- *Recall:* say the French for a piano, then the French for a violin, then say *le tambour* again

Before you move on

What does le tambour mean? ("A drum".) Say it once more.

Chapter 257

Geography, Mathematics, Art, Team, Birthday

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say geography, mathematics, art, a team and a birthday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 257: I can say geography, mathematics, art, a team and a birthday.*

257.1 la géographie — geography

> Before the new one: say the French for a violin, then the French for a drum.

You'll want to know: la géographie

la géographie — "geography".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

géographie ← Latin *geographia*, from Greek *geographia*, "a description of the earth" — a learned borrowing. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: la géographie*
- *Say it: la géographie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *la géographie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a violin, then the French for a drum, then say *la géographie* again

Before you move on

What does la géographie mean? ("Geography".) Say it once more.

257.2 les mathématiques — mathematics

Before the new one: say the French for a drum, then the French for geography.

You'll want to know: les mathématiques

les mathématiques — "mathematics".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mathématiques ← Latin *mathematicus*, "of mathematics" (Lewis & Short), from Greek *mathematikos*, built on *mathema*, "a thing learned" — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: les mathématiques*
- *Say it: les mathématiques*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les mathématiques*
- *Recall:* say the French for a drum, then the French for geography, then say *les mathématiques* again

Before you move on

What does les mathématiques mean? (“Mathematics”.) Say it once more.

257.3 l’art — art

Before the new one: say the French for geography, then the French for mathematics.

You’ll want to know: l’art

l’art — “art”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

art ← Latin *ars*, *artis*, “skill, craft” — inherited. (EtymDB 2.1)

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’art*
- *Say it: l’art*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l’art*
- *Recall:* say the French for geography, then the French for mathematics, then say *l’art* again

Before you move on

What does l’art mean? (“Art”.) Say it once more.

257.4 l’équipe — a team

Before the new one: say the French for mathematics, then the French for art.

You'll want to know: l'équipe

l'équipe — "a team".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

équipe — formed from the verb for "to fit out", first "to fit out a ship" (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Old Norse *skipa*, from *skip*, "a ship".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'équipe*
- *Say it: l'équipe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'équipe*
- *Recall:* say the French for mathematics, then the French for art, then say *l'équipe* again

Before you move on

What does l'équipe mean? ("A team".) Say it once more.

257.5 l'anniversaire — a birthday

Before the new one: say the French for art, then the French for a team.

You'll want to know: l'anniversaire

l'anniversaire — "a birthday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anniversaire ← Latin *anniversarius*, "coming round each year", from *annus*, the Latin of *an*, and *vertere*, "to turn" (Lewis & Short) — a learned borrowing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'anniversaire*
- *Say it: l'anniversaire*, once more
- *Say it:* say *l'anniversaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for art, then the French for a team, then say *l'anniversaire* again

Before you move on

What does l'anniversaire mean? ("A birthday".) Say it once more.

257.6 Words from chapters 251-253 — a first pass

Say the words for a team and a birthday.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a result, a difference, an example, the truth, a lie
- a tax, a form, an envelope, a stamp, a parcel
- a driving licence, a helmet, a tunnel, a building site, a block of flats

Before you move on

A result? (**le résultat**.) A difference? (**la différence**.) An example? (**l'exemple**.) The truth? (**la vérité**.) A lie? (**le mensonge**.) A tax? (**l'impôt**.) A form? (**le formulaire**.) An envelope? (**l'enveloppe**.) A stamp? (**le timbre**.) A parcel? (**le colis**.) A driving licence? (**le permis de conduire**.) A helmet? (**le casque**.) A tunnel? (**le tunnel**.) A building site? (**le chantier**.) A block of flats? (**l'immeuble**.)

257.7 Words from chapters 254-257 — a second pass

Say the words for a trunk and a thorn.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a trunk, a thorn, a lawn, a path, a cave
- rubbish, recycling, energy, electricity, gas
- a tool, a guitar, a piano, a violin, a drum
- geography, mathematics, art, a team, a birthday

Before you move on

A trunk? (**le tronc**.) A thorn? (**l'épine**.) A lawn? (**la pelouse**.) A path? (**le sentier**.) A cave? (**la grotte**.) Rubbish? (**les déchets**.) Recycling? (**le recyclage**.) Energy? (**l'énergie**.) Electricity? (**l'électricité**.) Gas? (**le gaz**.) A tool? (**l'outil**.) A guitar? (**la guitare**.) A piano? (**le piano**.) A violin? (**le violon**.) A drum? (**le tambour**.) Geography? (**la géographie**.) Mathematics? (**les mathématiques**.) Art? (**l'art**.) A team? (**l'équipe**.) A birthday? (**l'anniversaire**.)

Chapter 258

The Scene — c'était, il y avait, il faisait froid

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can paint the scene of a past story with the imparfait, and drop the events into it with the passé composé.
>
> *Complete FR-C258-revision-quand: a scene in the imparfait and an event that cuts into it, joined with quand or pendant que.*

258.1 je parlais — the past that is still running

Say "I spoke", with *avoir* and the participle. (*J'ai parlé.*)

That past has an edge: it happened, and it finished. French has a second past with no edge at all, and every story you tell from here on needs both of them.

Grammar Lens: one stem, one set of endings

Start from the *nous* form of the present and take off its **-ons**. What is left is the stem. Then add **-ais** for "I":

nous parl-ons, **je parlais** — I was speaking, I used to speak
nous finiss-ons, **je finissais** — I was finishing nous pren-ons, **je prenais** — I was taking

The other persons keep that stem and change only the ending: **je parlais**, **tu parlais**, **il parlait**, **nous parlions**, **vous parliez**, **ils**

parlaient.
Two things to hear. Four of those six are one sound: *parlais*, *parlais*, *parlait* and *parlaient* all end in the same open *è*, so the pronoun in front is what tells a listener who was speaking. And *nous parlions* is one small *i* away from the present *nous parlons*. Listen for that *i*.
This past is the **imparfait**, and almost every verb follows this recipe. The one that refuses it comes next.
What it means is "was -ing", or "used to": *j'habitais à Paris*, I lived in Paris, back then, with no start and no finish in view.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin already had this past, and it marked it with a **b**: *habēbat*, "he was having", from *habēre*, the Latin verb that gave **avoir** (EtymDB 2.1). In French the *b* wore away entirely. You met one of its forms in the chapter on *être*: **j'étais** goes back to *stābam*, "I was standing". Older French spelled the ending **-oit**, *il parloit*, and the spelling **-ais** settled only in the nineteenth century, long after the sound had changed. Neither EtymDB nor Lewis & Short records endings this late, so that history is the usual account in histories of French, given here as one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nous parlons*, then *je parlais*
- *je parlais, tu parlais, il parlait* — one sound
- *nous parlions, vous parliez* — and hear the *i*
- *j'habitais à Paris* — *habiter*, still running in the past
- the edge, then no edge — *j'ai parlé*, then *je parlais*

Before you move on

Which present form do you build the stem on? (The ***nous*** form, without its *-ons*.) Build "I was taking". (***Je prenais.***) Which Latin letter wore away from the ending? (The ***b*** of *habēbat*.) Which past has an edge, and which has none? (***J'ai parlé*** has one; ***je parlais***

has none.)

258.2 c'était, il y avait — the words a scene is made of

Build "I was speaking". (*Je parlais.*) Say "it's good". (*C'est bon.*) Then "there is bread". (*Il y a du pain.*)

Hold on to all three. This lesson moves the last two into the past.

You'll want to know: c'était

One verb refuses last lesson's recipe: **être**. Its *nous* form, *nous sommes*, gives nothing to build on, so it has a stem of its own, **ét-**, with the same endings: *j'étais*, *tu étais*, *il était*, *nous étions*, *vous étiez*, *ils étaient*.

The form you will use most is the one inside *c'est*:

C'était bon. — It was good. **C'était** samedi. — It was Saturday.

C'est is now; **c'était** is how things were, all through some stretch of the past.

avoir does follow the recipe: *nous avons* gives **j'avais**. Age is the clearest case. *J'ai vingt ans* is now; *j'avais vingt ans* is the age you were, back then.

You'll want to know: il y avait

You have **il y a**, "there is" and "there are". Its past is **il y avait**:

Il y avait beaucoup de monde. — There were a lot of people.
Il n'y avait pas de pain. — There was no bread.

Like *il y a*, it does not change for a plural: one *avait* for one thing or for a hundred. And after the negative, *pas de* stays exactly as it was in the present.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

était goes back to Latin *stābat*, "he was standing", the standing verb that lent *être* every form beginning *ét-*. **avait** goes back to *habēbat*, "he was having", the past of *habēre*, the Latin verb that gave **avoir** (EtymDB 2.1). In both, the Latin *b* wore away.
The little **y** of *il y a* is inherited from Latin *ibī*, "there" (EtymDB 2.1; Lewis & Short, under *ibi*). So *il y avait* is, word for word, "it had there".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *c'était, il y avait*
- *C'était samedi.* — then *C'était bon.*
- *J'avais vingt ans.*
- *Il y avait beaucoup de monde.* — then *Il n'y avait pas de pain.*
- from now to then — *c'est* becomes *c'était*, *il y a* becomes *il y avait*

Before you move on

What stem does *être* use in the imparfait? (***Ét-.***) Say "there were a lot of people". (***Il y avait beaucoup de monde.***) Does *il y avait* change for a plural? (**No.**) Which Latin verb is behind *était*? (***Stāre***, "to stand".)

258.3 il faisait froid — the weather, made in the past

Say "there were a lot of people", the way last lesson built it. (*Il y avait beaucoup de monde.*) Then "it's cold", today. (*Il fait froid.*)

You'll want to know: il faisait froid, il faisait chaud

English says the weather **was** cold. French says it **made** cold, and you have that already: *il fait froid*. Move it into the past with the recipe. *Nous faisons* gives the stem *fais-*:

> **Il faisait froid.** — It was cold. **Il faisait chaud.** — It was hot.

Listen to the first syllable. The *ai* of *faisait* is said like the short *e* of *le*: "fe-zè". It is the sound of *nous faisons* too, and the recipe carries it over.

Rain has a verb of its own. You have **il pleut**, "it's raining", and its past is **il pleuvait**, "it was raining".

Keep **c'était** and **était** for things. *Le café était froid* — the coffee was cold — is about the coffee. *Il faisait froid* is about the whole day. Put three of these together and you have a morning before anything has happened in it:

> *Il faisait froid et il pleuvait. Il n'y avait pas de soleil.*

In Québec, relaxed speech has its own word for a biting cold: *il faisait frette*. In a letter, *froid* is the word to write.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faire is inherited from Latin *facere*, "to make, to do" (EtymDB 2.1), and **faisait** goes back to its past *faciēbat*, "he was making" (Lewis & Short, under *facio*). English **fact** and **factory** share it.
froid is inherited, through Old French *froit*, from Latin *frīgidus*, "cold" (EtymDB 2.1), which English borrowed whole as **frigid**. **chaud** goes back to Old French *chaut* (EtymDB 2.1), usually traced to Latin *calidus*, "warm, hot" (Lewis & Short).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Il faisait froid.* — then *Il faisait chaud.*
- *il pleut*, then *il pleuvait*
- a thing, then a day — *Le café était froid.* then *Il faisait froid.*
- a whole morning — *Il faisait froid et il pleuvait. Il n'y avait pas de soleil.*

Before you move on

Say "it was hot". (***Il faisait chaud.***) For the coffee, is it *était* or *faisait*? (***Était*** — it is about a thing.) How is the *ai* of *faisait* said? (Like the ***e*** of *le*.) Which Latin verb is inside *faisait*? (***Facere***, "to make".)

258.4 je dormais / j'ai dormi — the same sleep, told two ways

Paint a cold morning in two short sentences. (*Il faisait froid. Il n'y avait pas de soleil.*)

Nothing has happened in it yet. This lesson is about what happens.

Grammar Lens: the scene and the events

Take one fact, that you slept, and let the tense decide what kind of fact it is:

> **Je dormais.** — I was sleeping. *(no edge: what was going on)* **J'ai dormi.** — I slept. *(an edge: a thing that happened and ended)*

Neither is more correct. A told story needs both, in a division of labour:

> The **imparfait** paints the **scene**: what was going on, what things were like. The **passé composé** drops the **events** into it: what happened.

Il faisait froid. Je dormais. Ma mère a téléphoné. — It was cold. I was asleep. My mother phoned.
English has no separate ending for this. It leans on *was -ing* and *used to* and lets the context carry the rest. French settles it in the verb.

Grammar Lens: what used to happen

A habit is scene too. It went on, again and again, with no single edge:

> *Autrefois, je dormais beaucoup.* — In the old days, I used to sleep a lot.

So the imparfait answers two questions: what was going on at that moment, and what used to happen. The passé composé answers a third: what happened, once, and was done.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

imparfait is inherited from Latin *imperfectus*, "unfinished, incomplete" (EtymDB 2.1; Lewis & Short): *in-*, "not", plus *perfectus*, "carried all the way through", which is itself *per-*, "through", plus *facere*, "to make". That *facere* is the one inside last lesson's *faisait*. So the name describes the job. The imparfait is the **not-carried-through** past: unfinished in time, with no edge on it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair — *je dormais*, then *j'ai dormi*
- a scene, then an event — *Il pleuvait. Ma mère a téléphoné.*
- a habit — *Autrefois, je dormais beaucoup.*
- *C'était samedi, et j'ai dormi.*

Before you move on

In a story, which past paints and which drops the events in? (The ***imparfait*** paints; the ***passé composé*** drops them in.) Is a habit scene or event? (**Scene**, in the imparfait.) What does *imperfectus* say? (**Not carried through.**)

258.5 quand, pendant que — the scene, and what cut into it

Say "I was sleeping", then "I slept". (*Je dormais*, then *j'ai dormi.*)

This lesson joins a scene and an event into one sentence.

Grammar Lens: quand, where the event comes in

You have **quand**, "when". It puts a scene and an event into one sentence:

> *Je lisais* ***quand*** *ma mère a téléphoné.* — I was reading when my mother phoned. *J'attendais le train* ***quand*** *il a commencé à pleuvoir.* — I was waiting for the train when it started to rain.

The first half is the scene, still running, in the imparfait. The *quand* half is the event that cut into it, in the passé composé. Turn the sentence round and the tenses keep their jobs: *Quand ma mère a téléphoné, je lisais.*
A *quand* can hold a scene too: *Quand j'avais vingt ans, j'habitais à Paris.* A stretch of life is not an event, so both halves are scene.

Grammar Lens: pendant que, two things at once

pendant que means "while". It holds a scene open so that something else can happen inside it:

> ***Pendant que*** *je lisais, mon frère dormait.* — While I was reading, my brother was asleep. ***Pendant que*** *j'attendais le train, j'ai téléphoné à ma mère.* — While I was waiting for the train, I phoned my mother.

Two scenes side by side, then one event inside a scene.
French has one more way to hold a moment still: ***être en train de***, "to be in the middle of". *J'étais en train de lire quand ma mère a téléphoné.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pendant comes from **pendre**, "to hang", which is inherited from Latin *pendēre*, "to hang, to be suspended" (EtymDB 2.1; Lewis & Short, under *pendeo*). *Pendant que je lisais* is, at root, "while my reading was still hanging": open, not yet settled. English **pending** has the same picture.
quand is inherited from Latin *quandō*, "when" (EtymDB 2.1), and the *d* it kept in spelling is the Latin one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Je lisais quand ma mère a téléphoné.*
- the same, turned round — *Quand ma mère a téléphoné, je lisais.*
- *Pendant que je lisais, mon frère dormait.*
- a scene of your own — *Il faisait froid et j'attendais …* — then one thing that happened, with *quand*

Before you move on

In *je lisais quand ma mère a téléphoné*, which half is the scene? (***Je lisais.***) Which past does the *quand* half take here? (The **passé composé** — the event.) What does *pendant que* mean? (**While.**)

258.6 Review — the scene, and what cut into it

Build "I was reading" from *lire*. (*Je lisais.*) Then say "I had a dog". (*J'avais un chien.*)

What you've built

Five lessons, and every piece of a scene is in your hands. The recipe, the *nous* stem plus **-ais**, on almost any verb: *je parlais*, *je finissais*, *je prenais*. The one verb that refuses it, *être*, with *c'était*. The scene-setter *il y avait*. The weather, made rather than being: *il faisait froid*. And the division of labour: the imparfait paints, the passé

composé drops the events in.
The joints between the two are **quand** and **pendant que**.

> *Je lisais quand ma mère a téléphoné. J'attendais le train quand il a commencé à pleuvoir.*

The second one is worth hearing twice. The rain is an event here, because it **began**: *il a commencé*. Once it is falling, it is scene again: *il pleuvait*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a scene in three — *Il faisait froid. Il y avait beaucoup de monde. C'était samedi.*
- *Je lisais quand ma mère a téléphoné.*
- the rain as an event — *il a commencé à pleuvoir* — then as a scene — *il pleuvait*
- *Pendant que j'attendais le train, j'ai téléphoné à ma mère.*
- one of your own — a scene with *je …-ais*, and one thing that happened, with *quand*

Before you move on

After *quand*, in these sentences, which past? (The **passé composé** — the event.) Why is *il a commencé à pleuvoir* in the passé composé? (The rain **began**: that is an event.) What does *imparfait* mean, taken apart? (**Not carried through.**) And which stem does *c'était* use? (***Ét-***, from the standing verb.)

Chapter 259

D'abord, Ensuite, Enfin — A Story Told in Order

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell a short connected story in order with d'abord, ensuite and enfin, and read one of about a hundred words.
>
> *Complete FR-C259-revision-histoire: retell the reading's journey aloud, choosing scene or event for every verb.*

259.1 d'abord — the events, in order

> Say "then". (*Puis.*) Then "afterwards". (*Ensuite.*) Then "finally". (*Enfin.*)
>
> Three words for the middle and the end of a story. The order still needs a first word.

You'll want to know: d'abord

d'abord — "first", "at first".

> **D'abord**, j'ai acheté le billet. — First I bought the ticket. **Ensuite**, j'ai attendu le train. — Next I waited for the train. **Puis** le train est arrivé. — Then the train came. **Enfin**, je suis rentré à la maison. — Finally I went back home.

Say it as one word: "da-BOR". The *d* is *de* with its vowel dropped, and the final *d* of *abord* is silent.

Grammar Lens: four places in a story

Ensuite and **puis** both mean "then, next", and a story can use them as many times as it has events. *Puis* is the lighter of the two, and speech often doubles it up as *et puis*.
Enfin closes the story, and it often carries relief: something you were waiting for has come at last. In speech it has a second life as a hesitation, *enfin…*, "well, I mean…", which you will hear constantly.
D'abord can also mean "at first", setting up a change:

> *D'abord, j'avais peur, mais ensuite, c'était bien.* — At first I was scared, but then it was fine.

Notice what these words do **not** touch: the scene. *Il faisait froid* needs no *d'abord*. Order belongs to the events.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

d'abord is *de* plus **abord**, "the approach, the first coming alongside". *Abord* is built on **bord**, "the edge, the side of a ship", a Germanic word: EtymDB 2.1 sets it beside Old English *bord*, "side of a ship", and Old Norse *borð*. The usual account runs through the verb *aborder*, to bring a ship alongside: *d'abord* is "from the very first approach".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *D'abord, j'ai acheté le billet. Ensuite, j'ai attendu le train.*
- *Puis le train est arrivé. Enfin, je suis rentré à la maison.*
- at first, then a change — *D'abord, j'avais peur, mais ensuite, c'était bien.*
- a scene, then events — *Il pleuvait. D'abord, j'ai attendu. Ensuite, quand le train est arrivé, je suis monté.*

Before you move on

Which word opens a story told in order? (***D'abord.***) Which two words mean "then"? (***Ensuite*** and ***puis***.) Does the weather need a

d'abord? (**No** — order belongs to the events.) And what was *abord*, at root? (A ship's **first coming alongside**.)

259.2 raconter — to tell a story, which is to count it

You can hold a scene still and put events in order with *d'abord*. This lesson gives the act a name, then puts it all together.

You'll want to know: raconter

raconter — "to tell", for a story or for what happened. It is a regular *-er* verb: *je raconte*, *j'ai raconté*, *je racontais*.

Je raconte une histoire à mon frère. — I tell my brother a story.
Raconte ! — Go on, tell me!

You have **l'histoire**, which is both "history" and "a story", so **raconter une histoire** is the whole act in three words. The person who hears it comes after **à**.

Grammar Lens: the backbone of a told story

Here is what a story tells, with both pasts to work with:

> **C'était** samedi. **Il faisait** beau. **D'abord, je suis allé** au marché. **Ensuite, j'ai rencontré** un ami, et nous **avons parlé**. **Mais il a commencé** à pleuvoir, et **enfin je suis rentré** à la maison.
>
> *It was Saturday. The weather was fine. First I went to the market. Then I met a friend, and we talked. But it started to rain, and in the end I went back home.*

Il fait beau is fine weather, with the *beau* you met inside *beaucoup*. *C'était*, *il faisait*: the scene, held still. *Je suis allé*, *j'ai rencontré*, *nous avons parlé*, *il a commencé*, *je suis rentré*: the events, put in order by *d'abord*, *ensuite* and *enfin*. **Mais** marks the turn, the point where the story stops going the way it was going. *Et* adds; *mais* turns.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raconter goes back to Old French *raconter* (EtymDB 2.1). It is built on **conter**, "to tell", which EtymDB 2.1 traces to Latin *computāre*, "to reckon up, to compute" (Lewis & Short, under *computo*), with *re-* and *a-* in front. To tell a story was to count it out, one piece after another. English kept both senses in one word: you **count** a sum, and you **recount** what happened.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the scene — *C'était samedi. Il faisait beau.*
- the events — *D'abord, je suis allé au marché. Ensuite, j'ai rencontré un ami.*
- the turn and the end — *Mais il a commencé à pleuvoir, et enfin je suis rentré à la maison.*
- *Je raconte une histoire à mon frère.*

Before you move on

In your story, which past held the weather and which one took you to the market? (***Il faisait*** — imparfait; ***je suis allé*** — passé composé.) Which word marked the turn? (***Mais.***) Which Latin verb is behind *conter*? (***Computāre***, "to reckon up".)

259.3 (reading) — a journey, told in both pasts

Chapter forty-five gave you sixty-three words in a row, all in the present. This passage is longer, and it happened last Saturday.

Every word in it has come up before this lesson.

Read this

Samedi dernier, c'était l'anniversaire de mon ami. Il faisait froid et il pleuvait. D'abord, j'ai attendu le train sur le quai. Il y avait beaucoup de monde, mais le train n'arrivait

pas, et j'étais inquiet. Ensuite, le train est arrivé, et je suis monté.

Dans le train, je lisais, et un enfant dormait à côté de moi. Quand je suis arrivé, mon ami m'attendait devant la maison. Puis nous avons mangé du gâteau, et nous avons beaucoup parlé. Enfin, le soir, je suis rentré à la maison. Il faisait beau, et il y avait des étoiles. J'étais content.

Read it once without stopping. Do not translate as you go.
Then read it a second time and sort every verb into one of two piles: the scene, or what happened.

Why it's said this way

The events pile is short: *j'ai attendu*, *est arrivé*, *je suis monté*, *je suis arrivé*, *nous avons mangé*, *nous avons parlé*, *je suis rentré*. Seven things happened, and *d'abord*, *ensuite*, *puis* and *enfin* put them in order.
Everything else is scene: the birthday, the cold, the rain, the crowd, the worry, the stars. A story is mostly background.
Le train n'arrivait pas is scene: the not-arriving went on. *Le train est arrivé* is the event that ended it. And *mon ami m'attendait* is scene too. He was already waiting, and the narrator's arrival cut into it, with *quand*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the passage aloud, once, without stopping

Before you move on

How many words in that passage were new? (**None.**)
Why is *m'attendait* in the imparfait? (The waiting **was already going on** when the narrator arrived: it is scene.)
Which word opened the line where a scene met an event? (***Quand.***)

259.4 Review — the journey, retold

Say "first". (*D'abord.*) Say "I tell a story". (*Je raconte une histoire.*)

What you've built

Two chapters, and a whole story. A scene in the imparfait: *il faisait froid*, *il y avait beaucoup de monde*, *j'étais inquiet.* Events in the passé composé, held in line by *d'abord*, *ensuite*, *puis* and *enfin.* A turn with *mais.* And the joint where a scene meets an event: *quand.*
Now the journey from the reading, told by you. Here is its skeleton, scene first, then the events:

> *C'était samedi. Il faisait froid et il pleuvait. D'abord, j'ai attendu le train. Ensuite, je suis monté. Quand je suis arrivé, mon ami m'attendait. Enfin, je suis rentré à la maison. J'étais content.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the scene — *C'était samedi. Il faisait froid et il pleuvait. Il y avait beaucoup de monde.*
- the first two events — *D'abord, j'ai attendu le train. Ensuite, je suis monté.*
- a scene inside the journey — *Pendant que je lisais, un enfant dormait.*
- the event that met the waiting friend — *Quand je suis arrivé, mon ami m'attendait.*
- the end — *Enfin, je suis rentré à la maison. J'étais content.*

Before you move on

Which word puts the first event in place? (***D'abord.***) Is *j'étais content* scene or event? (**Scene** — a feeling has no edge.) Which word marks the turn in a story? (***Mais.***) And which Latin verb is

inside *raconter*? (***Computāre***, to count it out.)

Chapter 260

What I Think, and So — je pense que, donc

Modes: **voice** (3) **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give an opinion with je pense que and à mon avis, and point a reason forward with donc or alors.
>
> *Complete FR-C260-revision-opinion: an opinion with its reason, said both ways round, with parce que and with donc.*

260.1 je pense que — giving a view

> Say "to think". (*Penser.*) Then "I think". (*Je pense.*)
>
> A story says what happened. Giving reasons starts somewhere else: with what you think about it.

You'll want to know: je pense que

je pense que — "I think that". It is the everyday opinion opener.

> **Je pense que** le train est cher. — I think the train is expensive.
> **Je pense que oui.** — I think so. · **Je pense que non.** — I don't think so.

The *que* cannot be dropped, as English drops its *that*. After it, the verb stays plain: *je pense que c'est cher*. A denial, *je ne pense pas que…*, can make careful French bend the verb that follows into a form a later chapter builds.

Two near neighbours do the same job. **Je crois que**, from *croire*, sounds a shade less sure. **Je trouve que**, from *trouver*, is "I find that", for a judgement you have made yourself: *je trouve que le film est ennuyeux.*

To hand the opinion back to a friend: ***Et toi, qu'est-ce que tu en penses ?*** — "And you, what do you think of it?" The little *en* means "of it"; keep the whole question as one piece for now.

Grammar Lens: à mon avis

You have **l'avis**, "a notice, an opinion". **À mon avis** is "in my opinion", and it puts your standpoint first:

> **À mon avis**, le train est cher, mais le petit musée est sympathique.

Relaxed speech says **pour moi** for the same thing. *Je pense que* puts the opinion first; *à mon avis* says whose it is before you give it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

penser is inherited, through Old French *penser*, from Latin *pēnsāre*, "to weigh carefully" (EtymDB 2.1), so a thought is a thing weighed. **avis** goes back to Old French *avis*, built on *vis*, "a view", which is inherited from Latin *vīsus*, "a look, an appearance" (EtymDB 2.1). *À mon avis* is "at my view": how the matter looks from where I stand.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Je pense que le train est cher.*
- both short answers — *Je pense que oui.* then *Je pense que non.*
- hand it back — *Et toi, qu'est-ce que tu en penses ?*
- *À mon avis, le film est ennuyeux.*

Before you move on

Say "I don't think so". (***Je pense que non.***) Can the *que* be dropped? (**No.**) Which opener says whose view it is first? (***À mon avis.***) And what did Latin *pēnsāre* mean? (**To weigh.**)

260.2 donc, alors — the arrow that points forward

Give an opinion with a reason: "I think it's going to rain, because there's no sun." (*Je pense qu'il va pleuvoir, parce qu'il n'y a pas de soleil.*)

Parce que runs from the claim back to its reason. This lesson runs the other way.

Grammar Lens: the two arrows

The same two facts, in opposite orders:

> J'ai pris le métro **parce qu'**il pleuvait. — I took the metro **because** it was raining. Il pleuvait, **donc** j'ai pris le métro. — It was raining, **so** I took the metro.

Parce que points **back**, from what happened to its cause. **Donc** points **forward**, from the cause to what followed, which is why the cause has to come first. Which one you reach for depends on which fact you want to say first: a choice about emphasis, not about grammar. The tenses keep their jobs. *Il pleuvait* is the scene, the reason; *j'ai pris* is the event, the consequence.

Grammar Lens: alors, the chatty one

alors can stand in the same place: *Il pleuvait,* ***alors*** *j'ai pris le métro.* It is lighter and more conversational, the "so" of a friend telling you about their day. **Donc** is the neutral one, as at home in a letter as in speech.

> chatty: *alors* · neutral: *donc*

Both point forward. *Alors* also keeps its first meaning, "then, at that time", so in a story it can do both jobs at once. And when *donc* opens a clause, its *c* is usually said: *Donc, je reste.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

alors is *à* plus Old French *lors*, "then", which goes back to Latin *illā hōrā*, "at that hour" (EtymDB 2.1): a word about time that became a

word about consequence, as English "then" did. **donc** is usually traced to Late Latin *dunc*, "then, so", whose own making is debated; EtymDB 2.1 follows it only as far as Middle French *donc*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- back — *J'ai pris le métro parce qu'il pleuvait.*
- forward — *Il pleuvait, donc j'ai pris le métro.*
- the same, to a friend — *Il pleuvait, alors j'ai pris le métro.*
- *Il faisait froid, alors je suis rentré.*
- *À mon avis, le train est cher, donc je prends le métro.*

Before you move on

Which way does *parce que* point, and which way *donc*? (*Parce que* **back** to the cause; *donc* **forward** to the consequence.) Which of the two forward words is the chatty one? (***Alors.***) What did Latin *illā hōrā* mean? (**At that hour.**)

260.3 Review — a view, and the arrows behind it

Say "I think so". (*Je pense que oui.*) Then "in my opinion". (*À mon avis.*)

What you've built

Two lessons, and the start of every argument you will make in French. An opinion, with *je pense que*, *je crois que* or *à mon avis*. A reason pointing back, with *parce que*. A consequence pointing forward, with *donc* or *alors*.
Here is one view, built both ways:

> *Je prends le métro, parce que je pense que le train est cher.*
> *Je pense que le train est cher, donc je prends le métro.*

Same facts, same view. The first starts from the decision; the second

starts from the opinion that caused it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Je pense que le train est cher.*
- the reason, back — *Je prends le métro parce que le train est cher.*
- the same, forward — *Le train est cher, donc je prends le métro.*
- in the past — *Il pleuvait, alors j'ai pris le métro.*
- a view of your own, with *à mon avis* and one reason

Before you move on

Which word points back to a cause? (***Parce que.***) Which two point forward? (***Donc*** and ***alors***.) In *il pleuvait, alors j'ai pris le métro*, which verb is the scene? (***Il pleuvait.***)

Chapter 261

Should, and Why — je devrais, expliquer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give advice with je devrais and tu devrais, and explain a decision in four moves.
>
> *Complete FR-C261-revision-explication: a whole explanation aloud: a view, a cause, a consequence and a piece of advice.*

261.1 je devrais — what you ought to do about it

> Say "I must leave". (*Je dois partir.*) Then ask a stranger for a coffee. (*Je voudrais un café.*)
>
> An explanation often ends on a third move: what somebody ought to do. That move has its own form, and you already own its ending.

You'll want to know: je devrais

je devrais — "I should".

It is *devoir* with the soft ending of *je voudrais*: **je devrais**, **tu devrais**, **il devrait**, **vous devriez**. A bare infinitive follows, with nothing in between, exactly as after *je dois*:

> **Je devrais** travailler. — I should work. **Tu devrais** dormir. — You should sleep. *(to a friend)* **Vous devriez** vous reposer. — You should rest. *(to anyone you call vous)*

Je dois travailler has no way out. *Je devrais travailler* says I know I ought to, and have not promised. That softness is the register advice usually wants. The ending is the one in *voudrais*, and chapter two hundred and sixty-seven gives the whole form its name and its recipe.

Grammar Lens: advice, with its reason

Advice sits naturally at the end of an arrow:

> *Tu es fatigué,* ***donc tu devrais*** *dormir.* — You're tired, so you should sleep. ***Je pense que tu devrais*** *te reposer.* — I think you should rest.

With **on**, it becomes "we ought to": ***On devrait*** *partir.* — We ought to leave. Said late in an evening, it is a polite way to end it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

devoir is inherited from Latin *dēbēre*, "to owe" (EtymDB 2.1), and *dēbēre* is a compound: *dē*, "from", plus *habēre*, "to have" (Lewis & Short, under *debeo*). To owe is to **have something from someone**: you are holding what is theirs. So *je devrais* is, at root, "I would owe it": the debt is there, and nobody is collecting yet.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *je devrais, tu devrais, il devrait*
- the hard one, then the soft one — *Je dois travailler.* then *Je devrais travailler.*
- advice to a tired friend — *Tu es fatigué, alors tu devrais dormir.*
- *On devrait partir.*

Before you move on

What is the difference between *je dois* and *je devrais*? (***Je dois*** is "I must"; ***je devrais*** is "I should", softer.) Which form you know has the same ending? (***Je voudrais.***) What are the two Latin pieces of *dēbēre*? (***Dē*** and ***habēre*** — to have from someone.)

261.2 expliquer pourquoi — to unfold

Four pieces are in your hands: *je pense que* for a view, *parce que* and *donc* for the two arrows, *je devrais* for advice. This lesson puts them in a row, under the verb that names the act.

Grammar Lens: explaining something to someone

You have **expliquer**, "to explain", a regular *-er* verb. The thing explained comes straight after it; the person who hears it takes **à**, or stands in front as a small pronoun:

> *J'explique le problème* ***à*** *ma mère.* — I explain the problem to my mother. *Je* ***t'****explique.* — Let me explain. *(to a friend) Vous pouvez* ***m'****expliquer ?* — Could you explain it to me?

And the explanation itself often opens with **la raison**, "the reason": *La raison, c'est que…* — "The reason is that…"

Grammar Lens: the shape of an explanation

Here is a whole explanation, every word of it met before:

> — Pourquoi tu ne sors pas ? — **Je pense qu'**il va pleuvoir. Et je suis malade, **parce qu'**hier il faisait froid. **Donc** je reste à la maison. **Je devrais** dormir.

Four moves, and a word for each: a **view** (*je pense que*), a **cause** pointing back (*parce que*), a **consequence** pointing forward (*donc*), and **advice** (*je devrais*). With both arrows you can build it cause first or claim first, and the listener can follow either.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

expliquer is a learned borrowing from Latin *explicāre*, "to unfold, to open out flat" (EtymDB 2.1; Lewis & Short, under *explico*), which is *ex-*, "out", plus *plicāre*, "to fold". **To explain is to unfold**: something was folded shut, and you open it out.
The same *plicāre* came down into French the slow way, by mouth, and gave **plier**, "to fold", which you have (EtymDB 2.1). English kept the Latin in **explicit**, and **complicated** is the opposite: folded together.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Je t'explique.* — then *Vous pouvez m'expliquer ?*
- the four moves — *Je pense qu'il va pleuvoir. Je suis malade. Donc je reste à la maison. Je devrais dormir.*
- the same, cause last — *Je reste à la maison parce que je suis malade.*
- *La raison, c'est que je suis malade.*

Before you move on

Name the four moves of an explanation and a word for each. (View ***je pense que***, cause ***parce que***, consequence ***donc***, advice ***je devrais***.) Who takes *à* after *expliquer*? (The **person** who hears it.) What is *expliquer*, taken apart? (***Ex-*** and ***plicāre***: **to unfold**.)

261.3 Review — unfolding a decision

Say "I should work". (*Je devrais travailler.*) Then "let me explain", to a friend. (*Je t'explique.*)

What you've built

Two chapters, and a whole explanation. A view: *je pense que*, *à mon avis*. A cause, pointing back: *parce que*. A consequence, pointing forward: *donc*, *alors*. And advice, softened: *je devrais*, *tu devrais*, *on devrait*.
Here is a friend's question, and an answer in four moves:

> *— Pourquoi tu ne viens pas au cinéma ? — À mon avis, le film est ennuyeux. Et je suis fatigué, parce que j'ai beaucoup travaillé. Donc je reste à la maison. Mais toi, tu devrais y aller !*

Tu ne viens pas is from **venir**, "to come", one of the verbs that take *être* in the passé composé.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the view — *À mon avis, le film est ennuyeux.*
- the cause — *Je suis fatigué, parce que j'ai beaucoup travaillé.*
- the consequence — *Donc je reste à la maison.*
- the advice — *Mais toi, tu devrais y aller !*
- an explanation of your own, in four moves, for something you are not doing tonight

Before you move on

Which move does *je devrais* make? (**Advice.**) Say "could you explain it to me?" (***Vous pouvez m'expliquer ?***) What does *expliquer* do, at root? (It **unfolds**.)

Chapter 262

Finding the Way — excusez-moi, tout droit

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can stop a stranger politely, ask the way, and follow and give simple directions.
>
> *Complete FR-C262-revision-chemin: ask the way to a place and give the directions back, straight on, left and right.*

262.1 excusez-moi — the question that finds the way

Say "to go". (*Aller.*) Say "the museum". (*Le musée.*)

You are in a town you do not know, and the museum is somewhere.

You'll want to know: excusez-moi

excusez-moi — "excuse me", to someone you do not know.

It is the *vous* command of **excuser**, "to excuse", with *moi* after it: word for word, "excuse me". A stranger in the street is owed *vous*; to a friend it is **excuse-moi**. The same words apologise: bump into someone and you say *excusez-moi !* The short **pardon** does both jobs too, and is as polite.

Grammar Lens: pour aller à...

Excusez-moi, pour aller au musée, s'il vous plaît ?
— Excuse me, how do I get to the museum?

Word for word, "to go to the museum, please". The rest of the question is left unsaid, and every French speaker hears it anyway. The place takes **à**, which welds onto *le*:

au musée · **à la** plage · **à l'**hôtel

A second way asks for the **place** rather than the **way**, with *où est*, "where is". Either can be followed by a short question that saves a walk, *c'est loin*, "is it far", or *c'est près d'ici*, "is it near here":

Où est le musée ? C'est loin ? C'est près d'ici ?

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

excuser is inherited from Latin *excūsāre* (EtymDB 2.1), built on *ex-*, "out of", and *causa*, "a cause, a charge in court" (Lewis & Short, under *excuso*): to clear someone of an accusation, to let them off. So *excusez-moi* asks, at root, to be let off. English **excuse** is the same word, and **cause** is its second half.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Excusez-moi, pour aller au musée, s'il vous plaît ?* — and let the voice rise
- the same, to the beach, then to the hotel
- ask for the place, and how far — *Excusez-moi, où est le musée ? C'est loin ?*
- to a friend — *Excuse-moi !*

Before you move on

Who gets *excusez-moi*, and who gets *excuse-moi*? (A **stranger**; a **friend**.) Ask the way to the hotel. (***Excusez-moi, pour aller à l'hôtel ?***) What does *à* plus *le* become? (***Au.***) And which Latin word is inside *excuser*? (***Causa***, a charge.)

262.2 tout droit — straight on, and then the turns

Say "on the right". (*À droite.*) Then "on the left". (*À gauche.*)

You asked the way, and a stranger is answering. This lesson is what you will hear.

You'll want to know: tout droit

tout droit — "straight on".

Allez ***tout droit.*** — Go straight on.

Listen hard to the end of it. In **droit** the final *t* is silent: "drwa". In **droite** it is said: "drwat". *Tout droit* is straight ahead; *à droite* is a turn to the right. The two sound almost alike, and they send you in different directions, so a careful listener waits for that *t*.

Grammar Lens: directions, as commands

A stranger gives directions in the *vous* command: the *vous* form of the present, without the *vous*.

Allez tout droit, puis ***tournez*** *à gauche.* — Go straight on, then turn left. ***Continuez*** *jusqu'au musée.* — Keep going as far as the museum. ***Traversez*** *la rue.* — Cross the street. ***Prenez*** *la rue à droite.* — Take the street on the right.

Five verbs carry almost every set of directions: *aller*, *tourner*, *continuer*, *traverser* and *prendre*. The order words come back too: *d'abord*, *puis*, *ensuite*. And a kind stranger may end with a distance: *C'est à deux minutes.* — It's two minutes away.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tout is inherited from Latin *tōtus*, "all, whole" (EtymDB 2.1), so *tout droit* is "all straight", the whole way. **droit** has no parent in EtymDB 2.1; it is usually traced to Latin *dīrēctus*, "set straight" (Lewis & Short, under *dirigo*), which English kept as **direct**. **Droite**, the right hand, is the same word in the feminine. That the right hand was named as the "straight" or proper one is the usual account, offered here as that.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *tout droit*, then *à droite* — and hear the *t*
- *Allez tout droit, puis tournez à gauche.*
- *Continuez jusqu'au musée. Traversez la rue.*
- the whole exchange — *Excusez-moi, pour aller à l'hôtel ? — Allez tout droit, puis prenez la rue à droite.*

Before you move on

How do you hear *tout droit* apart from *à droite*? (The final ***t*** is said only in ***droite***.) Say "turn left". (***Tournez à gauche.***) Which form do the directions take? (The ***vous*** command.) And what did Latin *tōtus* mean? (**Whole.**)

262.3 Review — finding the way

Stop a stranger politely. (*Excusez-moi.*) Then say "straight on". (*Tout droit.*)

What you've built

Two lessons, and a whole exchange in the street. The opener, *excusez-moi*. The question, *pour aller à… ?*, or *où est… ?* And the answer, in the *vous* command: *allez tout droit*, *tournez à gauche*, *continuez*, *traversez*, *prenez la rue à droite*.

— Excusez-moi, pour aller au musée, s'il vous plaît ? —

> *D'abord, allez tout droit. Ensuite, tournez à droite, et traversez la rue. Le musée est là, à côté de l'hôtel. — C'est loin ? — Non, c'est à deux minutes.*

The order words from the story chapters are back at work: a set of directions is a little story about the future, told in commands.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the question — *Excusez-moi, pour aller au musée, s'il vous plaît ?*
- the answer — *D'abord, allez tout droit. Ensuite, tournez à droite.*
- *Traversez la rue. Le musée est à côté de l'hôtel.*
- when you did not catch it — *Excusez-moi, vous pouvez m'expliquer encore une fois ?*
- directions from your door to the nearest shop, with *d'abord* and *ensuite*

Before you move on

What do you listen for to tell *tout droit* from *à droite*? (The final ***t*** of *droite*.) Say "cross the street". (***Traversez la rue.***) And what do you say to a friend instead of *excusez-moi*? (***Excuse-moi.***)

Chapter 263

At the Station — un aller-retour, j'ai raté le train

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can buy a return or a one-way ticket, ask when and where the train leaves, and report a problem.
>
> *Complete FR-C263-revision-voyage: buy a ticket, then report a missed train and ask for the next one.*

263.1 un aller-retour — there and back

> Say "a ticket". (*Un billet.*) Say "the return". (*Le retour.*) Then ask a stranger for a coffee. (*Je voudrais un café.*)
>
> You are at the ticket window, and you know the polite opener already.

You'll want to know: un aller-retour, un aller simple

un aller-retour — "a return ticket". **un aller simple** — "a one-way ticket".

Here *aller* is a noun: **l'aller** is the outward journey, and **le retour** is the way back. So an *aller-retour* is "a going and a coming back", and an *aller simple* is the going on its own. Both are masculine, *un*, and the word *billet* is usually left out.

Grammar Lens: at the window

The place you are going to takes **pour**, "for":

> ***Je voudrais un aller-retour pour Paris**, s'il vous plaît.*
> *— Un aller simple pour Lyon, s'il vous plaît.*

Then the three questions that get you onto the right train, said in one breath: *À quelle heure part le train ? De quel quai ? C'est combien ?* — "What time does the train leave? From which platform? How much is it?"
And the answer you will hear back puts the hour and the platform side by side: *Le train part à dix heures, quai trois.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aller has three Latin parents, and its infinitive is the one usually traced to Latin *ambulāre*, "to walk". **retour** is formed from the verb for "to return", *re-* plus **tourner**, "to turn", which is inherited from Latin *tornāre* (EtymDB 2.1). **simple** is inherited from Latin *simplex*, "single, plain" (EtymDB 2.1). So *un aller simple* is, at root, "a single walk out", and the ticket home is a turning back.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Je voudrais un aller-retour pour Paris, s'il vous plaît.*
- *Un aller simple pour Lyon.*
- the three questions — *À quelle heure part le train ? De quel quai ? C'est combien ?*
- a question for the timetable — *Excusez-moi, où est l'horaire des trains ?*

Before you move on

Which ticket brings you home again? (***Un aller-retour.***) Which word comes before the city? (***Pour.***) What is *l'aller*, as a noun? (**The outward journey**, the going.)

263.2 j'ai raté le train — when it goes wrong

Ask for a one-way ticket to Paris. (*Un aller simple pour Paris, s'il vous plaît.*)

Now the train has gone without you.

You'll want to know: j'ai raté le train

j'ai raté le train — "I've missed the train".

rater is a regular *-er* verb, the everyday one for anything that leaves without you:

> **J'ai raté le train.** — I've missed the train. **J'ai raté le métro.** — I've missed the metro.

You also have **manquer**, which says the same thing a little more carefully: *j'ai manqué le train.* In Québec, *manquer* is the more usual verb for it. And for a thing that is gone, not a train that has left, the verb is *perdre*: *j'ai perdu ma valise*, I've lost my suitcase.

English hesitates between "I missed" and "I've missed". French uses the passé composé for both: one finished event.

Grammar Lens: reporting a problem

A complaint to a stranger has three parts, and the first is a courtesy:

> **Excusez-moi, j'ai un problème.** — a courtesy. **J'ai raté le train.** — what went wrong. **Le prochain train part à quelle heure ?** — what you need.

Or the fault is not yours: *le train est en retard*, "the train is late". Say what happened, then ask the question that gets you moving again.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rater has no parent in EtymDB 2.1, which lists among its senses a gun that misfires. Where the word itself comes from is not settled by either source, so it is left open here. **manquer** was borrowed from Italian *mancare*, "to be lacking", which goes back to Latin *mancus*, "maimed, powerless" (EtymDB 2.1). **retard** comes from the verb *retarder*, which goes back to Latin *retardāre*, "to keep back, to delay" (Lewis & Short, under *retardo*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *J'ai raté le train.* — then *J'ai raté le métro.*
- the three parts — *Excusez-moi, j'ai un problème. J'ai raté le train. Le prochain train part à quelle heure ?*
- the fault that is not yours — *Le train est en retard.*
- what you need, with this ticket — *Je peux prendre le prochain train avec ce billet ?*

Before you move on

Say "I've missed the train". (***J'ai raté le train.***) Which verb says it more carefully, and is the more usual one in Québec? (***Manquer.***) Name the three parts of a complaint. (A **courtesy**, **what went wrong**, **what you need**.)

263.3 Review — a journey that goes wrong, and is put right

Say "a return ticket". (*Un aller-retour.*) Then "I've missed the train". (*J'ai raté le train.*)

What you've built

Two chapters, and a whole journey you can handle alone. Find the way: *excusez-moi, pour aller à… ?* Buy the ticket: *un aller-retour pour….* And when it goes wrong, say so in three parts: a courtesy, what happened, what you need.
Here is the whole of it, told afterwards as a story:

> *J'avais un aller-retour pour Paris. Quand je suis arrivé sur le quai, le train est parti. Donc j'ai demandé : « Excusez-moi, le prochain train part à quelle heure ? »*

The scene in the imparfait, the events in the passé composé, and the question quoted whole. *Est parti* is *partir* in the passé composé, with *être*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- at the window — *Je voudrais un aller-retour pour Paris, s'il vous plaît.*
- on the platform — *Excusez-moi, j'ai un problème. J'ai raté le train.*
- the story, afterwards — *Quand je suis arrivé sur le quai, le train est parti.*
- directions to the platform — *Allez tout droit, puis tournez à gauche.*

Before you move on

What are the three parts of a complaint? (A **courtesy**, **what went wrong**, **what you need**.) Which ticket is one-way? (***Un aller simple.***) In the story, why is *j'avais* in the imparfait? (The ticket in your pocket is **scene**.)

Chapter 264

How It Felt — j'étais content, j'espère

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how an experience felt, with the feeling as scene, and say what I hope and dream of doing next.
>
> *Complete FR-C264-revision-sentiments: how a journey felt, and what you hope to do next.*

264.1 j'étais content — how it felt

Say the last line of the journey you read: "I was pleased". (*J'étais content.*)

That sentence chose its past for a reason. This lesson is about why.

Grammar Lens: a feeling is scene

You already own the feelings: **content**, **heureux**, **triste**, **inquiet**, **nerveux**, **fier**. A feeling has no edge. It was going on, like the weather, so in a story it is scene, and it takes the imparfait of *être*:

> *D'abord, j'étais nerveux. Ensuite, j'étais content.* — At first I was nervous. Then I was pleased.

The adjective agrees with whoever felt it, and the ear hears some of that. *Content* ends in a silent *t*; **contente** sounds it. *Inquiet* becomes

inquiète, *nerveux* becomes **nerveuse**, *heureux* becomes **heureuse**. *Triste* has one form for a man or a woman.

> *Ma mère était inquiète.* — My mother was worried. *Nous étions contents.* — We were pleased.

The passé composé is possible too, and it changes the picture: it makes the feeling a reaction, an event at one moment. *Quand j'ai vu mon ami, j'ai été content.* — When I saw my friend, I was glad.

Grammar Lens: content de

To say **what** you were pleased with, add **de**:

> *J'étais content **du** voyage.* — I was pleased with the trip.
> *Je suis content **de** partir.* — I'm glad to be leaving.

De and *le* weld into **du**, and an infinitive can follow *de* directly. **Fier** works the same way: *je suis fier de toi*, I'm proud of you.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

content is usually traced to Latin *contentus*, "satisfied", the participle of *continēre*, "to hold together" (Lewis & Short, under *contentus* and *contineo*), itself *con-* plus *tenēre*, "to hold". EtymDB 2.1 follows it back through Old French *content*. To be content is to hold yourself in, wanting nothing further. **inquiet** is a borrowing from Latin *inquiētus*, "restless" (EtymDB 2.1; Lewis & Short): *in-*, "not", and *quiētus*, "quiet".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *D'abord, j'étais nerveux. Ensuite, j'étais content.*
- the pairs — *content, contente* — *inquiet, inquiète*
- *J'étais content du voyage.*
- a feeling of yours, last week, with its reason — *J'étais … parce que …*

Before you move on

Why is *j'étais content* the usual choice in a story? (A feeling has **no edge**: it is scene.) What does *j'ai été content* make of it? (A **reaction**, an event.) Say "I was pleased with the trip". (***J'étais content du voyage.***) Which Latin verb hides in *content*? (***Tenēre***, "to hold".)

264.2 j'espère revenir — saying what you are reaching for

Say "to hope". (*Espérer.*) Then "I was pleased". (*J'étais content.*)

An experience has a past and a future. Last lesson was how it felt; this one is what you want next.

You'll want to know: j'espère + an infinitive

j'espère + infinitive — "I hope to".

> **J'espère revenir** à Paris. — I hope to come back to Paris.
> **J'espère parler** français un jour. — I hope to speak French one day.

espérer is an *-er* verb whose *é* opens to *è* where the ending goes quiet: *j'espère*, *tu espères*, but *nous espérons*. An infinitive straight after it, with nothing in between, makes the hope your own. Italian puts a small *di* there; French puts nothing.

When someone else is the one who will do it, the frame is **j'espère que...**, and the verb after it stays plain: *J'espère que tu vas bien.* — I hope you're well.

Grammar Lens: mon rêve, c'est de...

An ambition is bigger than a hope, and it has its own frame:

> **Mon rêve, c'est de** vivre près de la mer. — My dream is to live by the sea.

You have **le rêve**, "the dream", and **rêver**, "to dream", which takes the same *de*: *je rêve de partir*, I dream of leaving.

Three strengths, then, for the future: ***je voudrais*** *partir*, I'd like to; ***j'espère*** *partir*, I hope to; ***mon rêve, c'est de*** *partir*, it is my dream. Only the last needs a *de*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

espérer is inherited from Latin *spērāre*, "to hope, to expect" (EtymDB 2.1; Lewis & Short, under *spero*), with an *e-* that French grew in front of *sp-*, as it grew an *é-* in front of the *sc-* of *écrire*. English **desperate** is the same verb with *dē-* in front: hope taken away. **rêver** goes back to Old French *resver*, "to be delirious" (EtymDB 2.1), and further than that the sources do not reach.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *J'espère revenir à Paris.*
- someone else — *J'espère que tu vas bien.*
- *Mon rêve, c'est de vivre près de la mer.*
- the three strengths — *je voudrais*, *j'espère*, *mon rêve, c'est de* — with one verb of your own

Before you move on

What goes between *j'espère* and the infinitive? (**Nothing.**) Which of the three strengths needs a *de*? (***Mon rêve, c'est de.***) Which English word is *spērāre* with *dē-* in front? (**Desperate.**)

264.3 Review — how it felt, and what comes next

Say "my mother was worried". (*Ma mère était inquiète.*) Then "I hope to come back". (*J'espère revenir.*)

What you've built

Two lessons, and an experience has a shape: what happened, how it felt, and what you want next. The feeling is scene, in the imparfait:

j'étais content, *j'étais nerveux*. What it was about takes *de*: *content du voyage*. And the future comes in three strengths: *je voudrais*, *j'espère*, *mon rêve, c'est de*.
Here is a journey told with all three:

> *D'abord, j'étais nerveux, parce que je ne connaissais pas la ville. Mais ensuite, j'étais content du voyage. J'espère revenir la semaine prochaine.*

Je ne connaissais pas is *connaître* in the imparfait, on the *nous connaissons* stem: a not-knowing that went on, so it is scene.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *D'abord, j'étais nerveux.*
- *Mais ensuite, j'étais content du voyage.*
- *J'espère revenir la semaine prochaine.*
- a feeling with an arrow — *J'étais fatigué, donc je suis rentré.*
- one journey of yours — how it felt at first, how it felt at the end, and one hope

Before you move on

Is *j'étais nerveux* scene or event? (**Scene.**) What goes between *j'espère* and *revenir*? (**Nothing.**) Say "my dream is to live by the sea". (***Mon rêve, c'est de vivre près de la mer.***)

Chapter 265

More Than, and for How Long — plus ... que, depuis, pendant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can compare two things, and say how long something has been going on or lasted.
>
> *Complete FR-C265-revision-experience: compare two ways to travel, and say how long you have lived somewhere and how long you lived somewhere else.*

265.1 plus ... que — more than

> Say "fast". (*Rapide.*) Say "expensive". (*Cher.*)
>
> An experience is easier to describe beside another one. This lesson sets two things side by side.

You'll want to know: plus ... que, moins ... que

To compare two things, put **plus**, "more", in front of the adjective and **que**, "than", in front of the second thing:

> Le train est **plus** rapide **que** la voiture. — The train is faster than the car. L'avion est **plus** cher **que** le train. — The plane is dearer than the train. Tu es **plus** jeune **que** moi. — You are younger than me.

English often builds the comparison into the adjective, *faster*, *younger*; French builds it with *plus*. After *que* a person takes the strong form you know: *que moi*, *que toi*, *que lui*.

Its opposite is **moins**, "less": *Le vélo est **moins** cher **que** la voiture.* And for "as … as", **aussi ... que**: *Le train est **aussi** cher **que** l'avion.*

Grammar Lens: le plus, and the one that refuses

For the most of all, give *plus* the article as well:

> *le train **le plus** rapide* — the fastest train *la voiture **la plus** chère* — the dearest car

These adjectives stay after the noun, as in *le vin rouge*, and the adjective takes its own article: *le train le plus rapide*, the article twice. One of the commonest adjectives refuses *plus*. **Bon** becomes **meilleur**, "better": *Le café est **meilleur** que le thé.* Its adverb, *bien*, becomes **mieux**: *Tu parles **mieux** que moi.* — You speak better than me.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plus is inherited from Latin *plūs*, "more" (EtymDB 2.1), which English kept whole as **plus**. **moins** is inherited, through Old French *meins*, from Latin *minus*, "less" (EtymDB 2.1), English **minus**. **meilleur** is inherited, through Old French *meillor*, from Latin *melior*, "better" (EtymDB 2.1), which English kept in **ameliorate**, "to make better"; and **mieux** goes back to its neighbour *melius*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Le train est plus rapide que la voiture.*
- the other way round — *La voiture est moins rapide que le train.*
- *le train le plus rapide*
- a view with a comparison — *Je pense que le vélo est meilleur que la voiture.*

Before you move on

Say "the plane is dearer than the train". (***L'avion est plus cher que le train.***) How do you say "the fastest train"? (***Le train le plus rapide.***) What does *bon* become? (***Meilleur.***)

265.2 depuis, pendant — how long, and still going

Say "the train is faster than the car". (*Le train est plus rapide que la voiture.*) Then "I live in Paris". (*J'habite à Paris.*)

An experience has a length, and French asks whether it is over.

You'll want to know: depuis, and the present

J'habite ici **depuis** trois ans. — I have been living here for three years. **J'habite** ici **depuis** janvier. — I have lived here since January.

Listen to the verb. English says *have been living*; French says **j'habite**, the plain **present**, because the living is still going on. **Depuis** takes a length, "for three years", or a starting point, "since January", with the same present. The question is *depuis quand*, since when, or *depuis combien de temps*, for how long.

Everyday speech everywhere has a second way to say it, with the length in front: ***Ça fait trois ans que*** *j'habite ici.*

Grammar Lens: pendant, and il y a

When the stretch has **ended**, the verb goes into the passé composé and the length takes **pendant**, "for, during":

J'ai habité à Paris **pendant** deux ans. — I lived in Paris for two years. *(and then I left)*

One English word, *for*, splits in two. *Depuis* with the present: still going on. *Pendant* with the passé composé: over.
And the **il y a** you know as "there is" also means "ago", with an event:

Je suis arrivé ici ***il y a*** *trois ans.* — I arrived here three years ago.

So one life can carry all three: *Je suis arrivé il y a trois ans. J'habite ici depuis trois ans. Avant, j'ai habité à Paris pendant deux ans.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

depuis is *de*, "from", plus **puis**, "then" (EtymDB 2.1): "from then on". *Puis* goes back to a spoken Latin *postius*, built on *post*, "after". **pendant** is the participle of **pendre**, "to hang", from Latin *pendēre* (EtymDB 2.1): *pendant deux ans* is, at root, "two years hanging", the stretch while the matter hung open.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *J'habite ici depuis trois ans.*
- *Ça fait trois ans que j'habite ici.*
- the stretch that is over — *J'ai habité à Paris pendant deux ans.*
- "ago" — *Je suis arrivé il y a trois mois.*

Before you move on

Which tense goes with *depuis*, when it is still going on? (The **present**.) Which word takes over when the stretch is finished, and with which tense? (***Pendant***, with the **passé composé**.) What does *il y a* mean with an event? (**Ago.**)

265.3 Review — describing an experience

Say "the coffee is better than the tea". (*Le café est meilleur que le thé.*) Then "I have been living here for three years". (*J'habite ici depuis trois ans.*)

What you've built

Two chapters, and an experience can be told whole: how it felt, what you hope next, how it compares, and how long it lasted. *Plus … que*, *moins … que*, *aussi … que*, with *meilleur* for the one adjective that

refuses. *Depuis* with the present for what is still going on, *pendant* with the passé composé for what is over, and *il y a* for "ago". Here is a life in four lines:

> *J'ai habité à Paris pendant deux ans. C'était une ville plus chère que Lyon, mais j'étais content. J'habite à Lyon depuis janvier. J'espère rester ici.*

Rester, "to stay", is one of the standing verb's children, Latin *re-stāre*: to stay back.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *J'ai habité à Paris pendant deux ans.*
- *C'était une ville plus chère que Lyon.*
- *J'habite à Lyon depuis janvier.*
- and the dream beyond it — *Mon rêve, c'est de vivre près de la mer.*
- your own — where you live, since when, and one place you lived before, with *pendant*

Before you move on

In *j'habite à Lyon depuis janvier*, why the present? (The living is **still going on**.) Say "less expensive than the car". (***Moins cher que la voiture.***) And which word says "ago"? (***Il y a.***)

Chapter 266

If — si, s'il pleut, ça dépend

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can state a real condition with si and the present, and say that something depends, naming on what.
>
> *Complete FR-C266-revision-conditions: a plan with a branch in it: a real condition with si, and an answer that depends.*

266.1 si — if

Say "I don't know". (*Je ne sais pas.*) Then "I have been living here for three years". (*J'habite ici depuis trois ans.*)

Most sentences so far have said what is, or what was. This chapter says what follows **if** something else is true, and it begins with two letters.

Grammar Lens: si opens a condition

si — "if".

> **Si** tu as faim, mange. — If you're hungry, eat. **Si** tu as froid, ferme la fenêtre. — If you're cold, shut the window.

Whatever follows *si* is the **condition**; the rest of the sentence is what follows from it. The condition can come first, with a comma, or second, without one: *Ferme la fenêtre* ***si*** *tu as froid.* Notice that French **has** hunger and cold, *tu as faim*, *tu as froid*, where English **is** hungry and cold.

Grammar Lens: s'il, and si for "whether"

Before **il** and **ils**, *si* drops its vowel: **s'il**, **s'ils**. Before *elle* it keeps it: *si elle*. You have said *s'il* since the chapter on please, because *s'il vous plaît* is "if it pleases you".
After a verb of knowing or asking, *si* also means "whether", and your *je ne sais pas* comes in useful:

> ***Je ne sais pas si*** *c'est loin.* — I don't know whether it's far.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

You have met **si** before, as the "yes" that contradicts a negative: *Tu ne viens pas ? — Si !* That one goes back to Latin *sīc*, "so, thus". The *si* of this lesson is inherited from Latin *sī*, "if", the Latin word that opened a condition (Lewis & Short, under *si*). EtymDB 2.1 lists both Latin words behind the French spelling. Two words, worn into one shape.
The ear tells them apart by their place. The "yes" *si* stands alone, as an answer. The "if" *si* opens a whole clause.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Si tu as faim, mange.*
- the same, condition second — *Mange, si tu as faim.*
- *Si tu as froid, ferme la fenêtre.*
- *Je ne sais pas si c'est loin.*

Before you move on

Which half of *si tu as faim, mange* is the condition? (***Si tu as faim.***) What does *si* become before *il*? (***S'il.***) What does *si* mean after *je ne sais pas*? (**Whether**.) Which Latin words are behind the two kinds of *si*? (***sī***, "if", and ***sīc***, "so".)

266.2 s'il pleut, je reste — the condition that really happens

Say "if". (*Si.*) Say "it was raining". (*Il pleuvait.*) Now the present: "it's raining". (*Il pleut.*)

Grammar Lens: both halves in the present

> **S'il pleut, je reste** à la maison. — If it rains, I stay at home. **Si le train est cher, je prends** la voiture. — If the train is expensive, I take the car.

This is a **real** condition, true now or whenever it happens. Both halves take the plain present, as in English: nothing new to build.
The result half can also be advice, with the *tu devrais* of chapter two hundred and sixty-one, or a command:

> *Si tu es malade,* ***tu devrais*** *dormir.* — If you're ill, you should sleep. *Si tu es fatigué,* ***dors !*** — If you're tired, sleep!

Why it's said this way

A real condition is a plan with a branch in it. Someone who takes the train to work every day lives by two of them:

> *Si je rate le train, je prends le métro. Si je rate le métro, je reste à la maison.*

Compare *donc. Il pleut, donc je reste* says it **is** raining. *S'il pleut, je reste* says it **might**, and here is what happens if so. Same consequence; the second has not decided whether the cause is true.

Grammar Lens: tomorrow, still in the present

For one particular occasion still to come, the result can move into the future, with the *aller* + infinitive you know. The *si* half does not move:

> *S'il pleut* ***demain****, je* ***vais rester*** *à la maison.* — If it rains tomorrow, I'm going to stay at home.

Il pleut, the present, even about tomorrow. English does the same, "if

it rains tomorrow", so here the ear is on your side.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rester goes back to Latin *restāre* (EtymDB 2.1), "to stay behind, to hold still" (Lewis & Short, under *resto*): *re-*, "back", plus *stāre*, "to stand", the standing verb behind *j'étais*. To stay is to stand still while the others go on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *S'il pleut, je reste à la maison.*
- the branch — *Si je rate le train, je prends le métro.*
- advice in the result — *Si tu es malade, tu devrais dormir.*
- tomorrow — *S'il pleut demain, je vais rester à la maison.*

Before you move on

Which tense goes in the *si* half of a real condition? (The **present**, even for tomorrow.) What is the difference between *il pleut, donc je reste* and *s'il pleut, je reste*? (The first says it **is** raining; the second has **not decided**.) What is *rester*, taken apart? (***Re-*** and ***stāre***: to stand back.)

266.3 ça dépend — the condition you do not have to finish

Say "if it rains, I stay at home". (*S'il pleut, je reste à la maison.*)

That sentence names its condition. Sometimes you want the condition without saying what it is.

You'll want to know: ça dépend

ça dépend — "it depends".

> — *Tu vas au cinéma demain ?* — ***Ça dépend.*** — Going to the cinema tomorrow? It depends.

You have **dépendre**, "to depend". *Ça dépend* is its "it" form, and on its own it is a complete answer: it says a condition exists and declines to say which.

Ça is the everyday "it, that", and ***tout dépend*** is "it all depends".

Grammar Lens: ça dépend de

Add **de** and you can name the condition after all:

> ***Ça dépend du*** *temps.* — It depends on the weather. ***Ça dépend de*** *toi.* — It depends on you. ***Ça dépend de l'****heure.* — It depends on the time.

De and *le* weld into **du**, as in *content du voyage*. English says *depend* ***on***; French says *dépend* ***de***, "hangs **from**", which is the older picture. Or name it with a whole *si*: *Ça dépend. S'il pleut, je reste à la maison.* The *ça dépend* announces a condition; the *si* sentence states it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépendre has no parent in EtymDB 2.1; it is usually traced to Latin *dēpendēre*, "to hang down from something" (Lewis & Short, under *dependeo*): *dē*, "down from", and *pendēre*, "to hang". To depend on something is to **hang from** it, and the answer swings until the condition settles. The same *pendēre* is inside *pendant*, which you met with *pendant que*. Its close relative *pendere*, "to make hang, to weigh on the scales" (Lewis & Short, under *pendo*), is the one behind *penser*. English **pendant** and **pending** belong to the family too.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- answer *Tu vas au cinéma demain ? — Ça dépend.*
- name it — *Ça dépend du temps.*
- name it with a whole condition — *Ça dépend. S'il pleut, je reste à la maison.*

- hand it back — *Ça dépend de toi. Qu'est-ce que tu en penses ?*

Before you move on

What does *ça dépend* say, and what does it not say? (That there **is** a condition — not **which**.) What do you add to name it? (***De***: *ça dépend de toi.*) What is hanging, in *dēpendēre*? (**The answer**, from the condition.)

266.4 Review — if, and it depends

Say "if he is tired", with the vowel *si* loses. (*S'il est fatigué.*) Then "it depends". (*Ça dépend.*)

What you've built

Three lessons, and a way of talking about what has not happened yet. The condition, opened by *si*: *s'il pleut.* The result, in the present, the future with *aller*, or a piece of advice. And the condition not yet named: *ça dépend*, or named after all: *ça dépend du temps.*

> *— Tu vas à la plage demain ? — Ça dépend du temps. S'il fait beau, je vais à la plage. S'il pleut, je vais rester à la maison.*

Two branches, one for each kind of weather, and the *si* half in the present both times, although both are about tomorrow.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Ça dépend du temps.*
- the first branch — *S'il fait beau, je vais à la plage.*
- the second — *S'il pleut, je vais rester à la maison.*
- advice in a branch — *Si tu es fatigué, tu devrais dormir.*
- your own plan for tomorrow, with *ça dépend* and two branches

Before you move on

In *s'il fait beau demain*, which tense is *fait*? (The **present**.) What does *si* become before *il*? (***S'il.***) And what does *ça dépend* leave unsaid? (**Which** condition.)

Chapter 267

Would — the conditionnel, and Six Lines

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what would happen with the conditionnel, and write six connected lines about a journey that end looking forward.
>
> *Complete FR-W267-six-lignes: six lines to one reader: the scene in the imparfait, events in order, a reason, and a last line with j'espère, ce serait or si.*

267.1 je pourrais, j'aimerais — the would of French

Ask a stranger for a coffee. (*Je voudrais un café.*) Then say "I should sleep". (*Je devrais dormir.*)

Two forms of one tense. This lesson gives it its name and its recipe.

Grammar Lens: the infinitive, plus the imparfait's endings

This is the **conditionnel**, French's "would". Keep the **whole** infinitive and add the endings of the imparfait, **-ais** for "I":

> parler, **je parlerais** — I would speak finir, **je finirais** — I would finish prendre, **je prendrais** — I would take

A verb in *-re* lets its final *e* go first: *prendr-*, *prendrais*. The other

persons change only the ending: **je parlerais**, **tu parlerais**, **il parlerait**, **nous parlerions**, **vous parleriez**, **ils parleraient**. Beside the imparfait: *je parlais*, I was speaking; *je parlerais*, I would speak. The infinitive inside it is the whole difference.
A few common verbs squeeze their stem first. You have met two of them, *vouloir* in **je voudrais** and *devoir* in **je devrais**; a third is *pouvoir*, **je pourrais**. *Aimer* follows the plain recipe: **j'aimerais**. Three jobs, all softening. A **polite request**: *Vous pourriez m'aider ?* — Could you help me? A **wish**: *J'aimerais partir en vacances.* — I'd like to go on holiday. And **advice**: *À ta place, je dormirais.* — In your place, I'd sleep.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Latin had no would-tense. Spoken Latin made one by gluing a past of *habēre*, "to have", onto the infinitive: roughly "I had to speak", which slid into "I would speak". French chose the **imperfect** of that verb, the same *habēbat* that became *avait*; worn down on the end of a verb, it is the **-ait** of *parlerait*. Italian glued on a different past, which is why its endings do not match. Neither EtymDB nor Lewis & Short covers a change this late; this is the usual explanation in histories of Romance, given as that. The name **conditionnel** comes from Medieval Latin *conditiōnālis*, built on *conditiō*, "a condition" (EtymDB 2.1).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *je parlerais, tu parlerais, il parlerait*
- the imparfait, then the conditionnel — *je parlais*, then *je parlerais*
- a polite request, after a problem — *Excusez-moi, j'ai un problème. Vous pourriez m'aider ?*
- a wish — *J'aimerais partir en vacances.*
- an answer that depends — *Ça dépend. J'aimerais venir, mais je ne peux pas.*

Before you move on

Build "I would finish". (***Je finirais*** — the whole infinitive, plus *-ais*.) What are the three jobs of the conditionnel? (A **polite request**, a **wish**, **advice**.) Which Latin past hides in its endings? (***Habēbat***, "he had", the same one inside ***avait***.)

267.2 ce serait — it would be

Build "I would speak". (*Je parlerais.*) Then "it's good", now. (*C'est bien.*)

You'll want to know: ce serait

ce serait — "it would be", "that would be".

être refused the imparfait's recipe and gave you *c'était*. Its conditionnel has a stem of its own too, **ser-**, with the same endings: *je serais*, *tu serais*, *il serait*. *C'est* is now, *c'était* was, and ***ce serait*** is the judgement on something that has not happened:

> ***Ce serait*** *bien.* — That would be good. ***Ce serait*** *plus rapide en train.* — It would be quicker by train.

En train, "by train", and *en voiture*, "by car", are how French says the way you travel.

Grammar Lens: si, the imparfait, and the would

Now the condition that is **not** true. Put the *si* half in the **imparfait**, and the result in the **conditionnel**:

> ***Si j'avais*** *le temps,* ***je partirais*** *en vacances.* — If I had the time, I'd go on holiday. ***Si c'était*** *moins cher,* ***je prendrais*** *le train.* — If it were cheaper, I'd take the train.

Set it beside last chapter's real condition. *S'il pleut, je reste*: it might rain, and here is the plan. *S'il pleuvait, je resterais*: it is not raining, and I am imagining. The conditionnel goes in the result, and the *si* half takes the imparfait.

In relaxed speech, in Québec and in France alike, you may hear *si j'aurais* for "if I had"; standard French keeps the imparfait after *si*, and so should a letter or an exam.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

être is inherited, through Old French *estre*, from Latin *esse*, "to be" (EtymDB 2.1). The stem **ser-** is usually traced to a spoken Latin infinitive *essere*, reshaped from *esse*, with the worn *habēbat* of the last lesson on its end: something like "had to be". Neither source records forms this late, so that step is the usual explanation rather than a cited one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *je serais, tu serais, il serait*
- *Ce serait plus rapide en train.*
- *Si j'avais le temps, je partirais en vacances.*
- real, then imagined — *S'il pleut, je reste.* then *S'il pleuvait, je resterais.*
- a judgement with *mieux* — *Ce serait mieux en train.*

Before you move on

What stem does *être* use in the conditionnel? (***Ser-.***) Say "it would be quicker by train". (***Ce serait plus rapide en train.***) In *si j'avais le temps, je partirais*, which half takes the conditionnel? (The **result**, *je partirais.*)

267.3 Review — if this, then that would

Say "that would be good". (*Ce serait bien.*) Then "I could". (*Je pourrais.*)

What you've built

Two chapters, and a whole way of talking about what has not happened yet. A real branch: *s'il pleut, je reste.* A branch not yet named: *ça dépend*, or *ça dépend de toi.* The softened result, in the conditionnel: *je pourrais*, *j'aimerais*, *je devrais*, *ce serait.* And the

condition that is not true now: *si j'avais le temps, je partirais.*

> *— On va au parc demain ? — Ça dépend. Ce serait bien, mais s'il pleut, on pourrait aller au musée.*

On pourrait is "we could", the *on* form of *je pourrais*: a soft suggestion, which is why it fits after *s'il pleut*. The *si* half stays in the present, because rain tomorrow is a real possibility.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *Ce serait bien d'aller au parc demain.*
- *S'il pleut, on pourrait aller au musée.*
- advice inside a branch — *Si tu es fatigué, tu devrais dormir.*
- a hope and a judgement — *J'espère partir en vacances. Ce serait bien.*
- the imagined one — *Si j'avais le temps, je partirais en vacances.*

Before you move on

In *s'il pleut, on pourrait aller au musée*, which half is the conditionnel? (***On pourrait aller.***) Which tense does the *si* half take when the condition is not true now? (The **imparfait**.) What would "we would be" be, from *serait*? (***Nous serions.***) And which Latin verb hides in the *devoir* of *je devrais*? (***Dēbēre***, to owe.)

267.4 Six lines about a journey

Chapter forty-eight asked for four lines that held together, with *parce que*. This one asks for six, and they tell a story.

Pick one person who will read it: *un ami*, *une amie*, someone in your family.

What to know first

A told story is not a list of events. It has a **scene**, in the imparfait: *c'était*, *il y avait*, *il faisait froid*, *j'étais content*. It has **events**, in the passé composé, put in order with *d'abord*, *ensuite* and *enfin*. It has at least one **reason**, pointing back with *parce que* or forward with *donc*, and perhaps a turn with *mais*.

And a good one ends by looking forward: *j'espère …*, or *ce serait …*, or a condition with *si*.

The DELF B1 writing paper asks for a connected text of at least 160 words. Six lines is the first step towards it, not the whole of it.

Writing — connected composition

On paper, write **six lines** to your reader about a journey, real or invented, one line for each of these:

1. the scene: when it was, and the weather;
2. where you were, who was with you, and how long you stayed, with *pendant*;
3. the first thing that happened, with *d'abord*;
4. the next thing, with *ensuite*, and a reason, with *parce que* or *donc*;
5. how it ended and how you felt, with *enfin* and *j'étais*;
6. one line forward, with *j'espère*, *ce serait* or *si*.

Use only words you already write. The exercise is choosing the right past for each line.

Before you move on

Now go through your lines as you went through the journey in chapter two hundred and fifty-nine. Mark every verb **S** for scene or **E** for event. Line one should be all **S**; two mostly **S**, though its *pendant* verb is an **E**; three and four mostly **E**; five has one of each. A line about the weather marked **E** is the commonest slip: change *il a plu* back to *il pleuvait*.
Then two spelling checks. The participle of an *-er* verb ends in **-é**: *j'ai parlé*, *je suis arrivé*, and with *être* it agrees with a woman

writing about herself: *je suis arrivée*. And the imparfait's endings are silent but spelled: *-ais*, *-ait*, *-aient*.
Last, read line six on its own. If it has a *si* about something real, is the verb after it in the plain present? If it has *ce serait*, is it your judgement on something that has not happened yet? Then it looks forward, and the story is finished.

Chapter 268

Tout d'abord

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can put the steps of a story in order: first of all, in the first place, afterwards, lastly and to finish.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 268: I can put the steps of a story in order: first of all, in the first place, afterwards, lastly and to finish.*

268.1 tout d'abord — first of all, to begin with

> Before the new one: say the French for a team, then the French for a birthday.

You'll want to know: tout d'abord

tout d'abord — "first of all, to begin with".

> Tout d'abord, nous avons pris un café.
>
> *First of all, we had a coffee.*

A little stronger than *d'abord* alone; it opens a list or a story.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tout d'abord joins *tout* "all", inherited from Latin *tōtus* "whole" (Lewis & Short), and *d'abord* "at first", which is built on *abord* "approach", from *aborder* "to come alongside", itself built on *bord* "edge, side of a ship".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tout d'abord*
- *Say it: tout d'abord*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tout d'abord*
- *Recall:* say the French for a team, then the French for a birthday, then say *tout d'abord* again

Before you move on

What does tout d'abord mean? ("First of all, to begin with".) Say it once more.

268.2 en premier lieu — in the first place, firstly

Before the new one: say the French for a birthday, then the French for first of all.

You'll want to know: en premier lieu

en premier lieu — "in the first place, firstly".

En premier lieu, il a parlé de sa famille.

In the first place, he talked about his family.

Formal; it orders the points of a speech or a report, often followed by *en second lieu*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lieu is inherited from Latin *locus* "place", and *premier* comes from Latin *prīmārius* "of the first rank", built on *prīmus* "first" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: en premier lieu*
- *Say it: en premier lieu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *en premier lieu*
- *Recall:* say the French for a birthday, then the French for first of all, then say *en premier lieu* again

Before you move on

What does en premier lieu mean? ("In the first place, firstly".) Say it once more.

268.3 par la suite — afterwards, later on

Before the new one: say the French for first of all, then the French for in the first place.

You'll want to know: par la suite

par la suite — "afterwards, later on".

Par la suite, ils sont devenus amis.

Afterwards, they became friends.

It looks back from a later point in the story: what came next.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

suite is inherited from Vulgar Latin *sequita* "a following" (EtymDB), built on Latin *sequī* "to follow".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: par la suite*
- *Say it: par la suite*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *par la suite*
- *Recall:* say the French for first of all, then the French for in the first place, then say *par la suite* again

Before you move on

What does par la suite mean? ("Afterwards, later on".) Say it once more.

268.4 en dernier lieu — lastly, last of all

Before the new one: say the French for in the first place, then the French for afterwards.

You'll want to know: en dernier lieu

en dernier lieu — "lastly, last of all".

En dernier lieu, elle a fermé la porte à clé.

Last of all, she locked the door.

The partner of *en premier lieu*; careful, written French.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dernier comes from Old French *derrenier*, usually traced to Latin *dē retrō* "from behind" (Lewis & Short); *lieu* is inherited from Latin *locus* "place".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: en dernier lieu*
- *Say it: en dernier lieu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *en dernier lieu*
- *Recall:* say the French for in the first place, then the French for afterwards, then say *en dernier lieu* again

Before you move on

What does en dernier lieu mean? ("Lastly, last of all".) Say it once more.

268.5 pour finir — to finish, to end with

Before the new one: say the French for afterwards, then the French for lastly.

You'll want to know: pour finir

pour finir — "to finish, to end with".

Pour finir, nous avons chanté tous ensemble.

To finish, we all sang together.

Common at the end of a story or a meal: *pour finir, un petit café.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

finir is inherited from Latin *fīnīre* "to bound, to bring to an end" (EtymDB), built on *fīnis* "boundary, end" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: pour finir*
- *Say it: pour finir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *pour finir*
- *Recall:* say the French for afterwards, then the French for lastly, then say *pour finir* again

Before you move on

What does pour finir mean? (“To finish, to end with”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 269

Au moment où

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can link two events in time: when, as soon as, at the moment when, at once and while.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 269: I can link two events in time: when, as soon as, at the moment when, at once and while.*

269.1 lorsque — when (careful style)

> Before the new one: say the French for lastly, then the French for to finish.

You'll want to know: lorsque

lorsque — "when (careful style)".

> Lorsque je suis arrivé, la fête avait déjà commencé.
>
> *When I arrived, the party had already started.*

It means *quand* in a time clause, a little more written. Before a vowel it becomes *lorsqu'*: *lorsqu'il pleut.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lorsque joins *lors* "then" and *que* "that". *Lors* is traced to Latin *illā hōrā* "at that hour" (EtymDB), from *hōra* "hour".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: lorsque*
- *Say it: lorsque*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *lorsque*
- *Recall:* say the French for lastly, then the French for to finish, then say *lorsque* again

Before you move on

What does lorsque mean? ("When (careful style)".) Say it once more.

269.2 dès que — as soon as

Before the new one: say the French for to finish, then the French for when.

You'll want to know: dès que

dès que — "as soon as".

Dès que le film a fini, nous sommes partis.

As soon as the film ended, we left.

For an event still to come, the future follows: *dès qu'il arrivera, on mangera.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dès is usually traced to Late Latin *dē ex* "from out of", the prepositions *dē* "from" and *ex* "out of" (Lewis & Short) run together; EtymDB lists no parent.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dès que*
- *Say it: dès que*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dès que*
- *Recall:* say the French for to finish, then the French for when, then say *dès que* again

Before you move on

What does dès que mean? ("As soon as".) Say it once more.

269.3 au moment où — at the moment when, right as

Before the new one: say the French for when, then the French for as soon as.

You'll want to know: au moment où

au moment où — "at the moment when, right as".

Au moment où je sortais, le téléphone a sonné.

Right as I was going out, the phone rang.

After *moment*, French says *où*, not *quand*: *au moment où il est entré.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moment comes from Latin *mōmentum* (EtymDB), taken over as a learned word; Lewis & Short gloss it "movement, motion", built on *movēre* "to move".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: au moment où*
- *Say it: au moment où*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *au moment où*
- *Recall:* say the French for when, then the French for as soon as, then say *au moment où* again

Before you move on

What does au moment où mean? ("At the moment when, right as".) Say it once more.

269.4 aussitôt — at once, immediately

Before the new one: say the French for as soon as, then the French for at the moment when.

You'll want to know: aussitôt

aussitôt — "at once, immediately".

Il a vu la lettre et il l'a aussitôt ouverte.

He saw the letter and opened it at once.

Aussitôt que means the same as *dès que*: as soon as.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aussitôt joins *aussi* "so" and *tôt* "early"; *tôt* is usually traced to Latin *tostum* "scorched, burnt", from *torrēre* "to roast" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: aussitôt*
- *Say it: aussitôt*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *aussitôt*
- *Recall:* say the French for as soon as, then the French for at the moment when, then say *aussitôt* again

Before you move on

What does aussitôt mean? ("At once, immediately".) Say it once more.

269.5 tandis que — while, whereas

Before the new one: say the French for at the moment when, then the French for at once.

You'll want to know: tandis que

tandis que — "while, whereas".

Il lisait tandis que sa sœur jouait du piano.

He was reading while his sister was playing the piano.

Two uses: time, 'while', and contrast, 'whereas': *il aime la mer, tandis que je préfère la montagne.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tandis is inherited from Latin *tam diū* "for so long" (EtymDB), from *tam* "so" and *diū* "for a long time" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tandis que*
- *Say it: tandis que*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tandis que*
- *Recall:* say the French for at the moment when, then the French for at once, then say *tandis que* again

Before you move on

What does tandis que mean? ("While, whereas".) Say it once more.

Chapter 270

Tout à coup

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that something happened all of a sudden, without warning, abruptly, on the spot or straight after.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 270: I can say that something happened all of a sudden, without warning, abruptly, on the spot or straight after.*

270.1 tout à coup — all of a sudden

> Before the new one: say the French for at once, then the French for while.

You'll want to know: tout à coup

tout à coup — "all of a sudden".

> Tout à coup, il a commencé à pleuvoir.
>
> *All of a sudden, it started to rain.*

Close to *soudain*; storytellers love it. *Tout d'un coup* also means 'all at once'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coup is inherited from Late Latin *colpus* "a blow", from Latin *colaphus* "a punch" (EtymDB), itself borrowed from Greek.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tout à coup*
- *Say it: tout à coup*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tout à coup*
- *Recall:* say the French for at once, then the French for while, then say *tout à coup* again

Before you move on

What does tout à coup mean? ("All of a sudden".) Say it once more.

270.2 subitement — suddenly, without warning

Before the new one: say the French for while, then the French for all of a sudden.

You'll want to know: subitement

subitement — "suddenly, without warning".

Le vent a subitement changé.

The wind suddenly changed.

Built on *subit*, 'sudden': *une mort subite*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

subitement is built on *subit* "sudden", a learned borrowing from Latin *subitus* "sudden", from *subīre* "to come up, to steal upon" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: subitement*
- *Say it: subitement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *subitement*
- *Recall:* say the French for while, then the French for all of a sudden, then say *subitement* again

Before you move on

What does subitement mean? ("Suddenly, without warning".) Say it once more.

270.3 brusquement — abruptly, sharply

Before the new one: say the French for all of a sudden, then the French for suddenly.

You'll want to know: brusquement

brusquement — "abruptly, sharply".

La voiture s'est arrêtée brusquement.

The car stopped abruptly.

Brusque also describes a manner: *un ton brusque*, a curt tone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brusquement is built on *brusque*, which was borrowed from Italian *brusco* "rough, sharp, sour" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *brusquement*
- *Say it:* *brusquement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *brusquement*
- *Recall:* say the French for all of a sudden, then the French for suddenly, then say *brusquement* again

Before you move on

What does brusquement mean? ("Abruptly, sharply".) Say it once more.

270.4 sur le coup — at the time, on the spot

Before the new one: say the French for suddenly, then the French for abruptly.

You'll want to know: sur le coup

sur le coup — "at the time, on the spot".

Sur le coup, je n'ai rien compris.

At the time, I did not understand anything.

The feeling of the very moment; later you see things differently.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coup is inherited from Late Latin *colpus* "a blow", from Latin *colaphus* "a punch" (EtymDB): at the moment of the blow.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sur le coup*
- *Say it: sur le coup*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sur le coup*
- *Recall:* say the French for suddenly, then the French for abruptly, then say *sur le coup* again

Before you move on

What does sur le coup mean? ("At the time, on the spot".) Say it once more.

270.5 dans la foulée — straight after, in the same stride

Before the new one: say the French for abruptly, then the French for at the time.

You'll want to know: dans la foulée

dans la foulée — "straight after, in the same stride".

Il a quitté l'école et il a trouvé un travail dans la foulée.

He left school and found a job straight after.

Neutral and frequent in the press. *La foulée* is a runner's stride.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

foulée is built on *fouler* "to tread, to press", which is inherited through Old French *foler* from a verb built on Latin *fullō* "a fuller, a cloth-treader" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dans la foulée*
- *Say it: dans la foulée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dans la foulée*
- *Recall:* say the French for abruptly, then the French for at the time, then say *dans la foulée* again

Before you move on

What does dans la foulée mean? (“Straight after, in the same stride”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 271

Peu à peu

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that something changed little by little, gradually, as things went along, in the long run, or sooner or later.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 271: I can say that something changed little by little, gradually, as things went along, in the long run, or sooner or later.*

271.1 peu à peu — little by little

> Before the new one: say the French for at the time, then the French for straight after.

You'll want to know: peu à peu

peu à peu — "little by little".

> Peu à peu, la ville s'est réveillée.
>
> *Little by little, the town woke up.*

The same as *petit à petit*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peu is inherited from Latin *paucum* "a little", the neuter of *paucus* "few" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: peu à peu*
- *Say it: peu à peu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *peu à peu*
- *Recall:* say the French for at the time, then the French for straight after, then say *peu à peu* again

Before you move on

What does peu à peu mean? ("Little by little".) Say it once more.

271.2 progressivement — gradually, progressively

Before the new one: say the French for straight after, then the French for little by little.

You'll want to know: progressivement

progressivement — "gradually, progressively".

Il fait progressivement plus chaud.

It is gradually getting warmer.

Built on *progressif*; a neutral word, common in reports.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

progressivement is built on *progressif*, a learned borrowing from Latin *prōgressīvus* (EtymDB), built on *prōgressus* "a going forward", from *prōgredī* "to step forward" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: progressivement*
- *Say it: progressivement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *progressivement*
- *Recall:* say the French for straight after, then the French for little by little, then say *progressivement* again

Before you move on

What does progressivement mean? ("Gradually, progressively".) Say it once more.

271.3 au fur et à mesure — as one goes along, bit by bit

Before the new one: say the French for little by little, then the French for gradually.

You'll want to know: au fur et à mesure

au fur et à mesure — "as one goes along, bit by bit".

Il apprend la langue au fur et à mesure.

He learns the language as he goes along.

With a verb: *au fur et à mesure que*: *au fur et à mesure qu'on avance.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mesure is inherited from Latin *mēnsūra* "a measuring" (EtymDB). *Fur* is an old word for "rate, price", which EtymDB traces to Latin *forum* "market place".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: au fur et à mesure*
- *Say it: au fur et à mesure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *au fur et à mesure*
- *Recall:* say the French for little by little, then the French for gradually, then say *au fur et à mesure* again

Before you move on

What does au fur et à mesure mean? ("As one goes along, bit by bit".) Say it once more.

271.4 à la longue — in the long run, eventually

Before the new one: say the French for gradually, then the French for as one goes along.

You'll want to know: à la longue

à la longue — "in the long run, eventually".

> À la longue, on s'habitue au bruit.
>
> *In the long run, you get used to the noise.*

Here *la longue* is a noun: a long stretch of time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

longue is the feminine of *long*, inherited from Latin *longus* "long" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: à la longue*
- *Say it: à la longue*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *à la longue*
- *Recall:* say the French for gradually, then the French for as one goes along, then say *à la longue* again

Before you move on

What does à la longue mean? ("In the long run, eventually".) Say it once more.

271.5 tôt ou tard — sooner or later

Before the new one: say the French for as one goes along, then the French for in the long run.

You'll want to know: tôt ou tard

tôt ou tard — "sooner or later".

Tôt ou tard, il va comprendre.

Sooner or later, he is going to understand.

The order is fixed: *tôt* first.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tard is inherited from Latin *tardē* "slowly, late" (Lewis & Short), from *tardus* "slow" (EtymDB); *tôt* is usually traced to Latin *tostum* "scorched".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tôt ou tard*
- *Say it: tôt ou tard*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tôt ou tard*
- *Recall:* say the French for as one goes along, then the French for in the long run, then say *tôt ou tard* again

Before you move on

What does tôt ou tard mean? ("Sooner or later".) Say it once more.

Chapter 272

Jadis et naguère

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about long ago and not so long ago: in olden days, formerly, before, until then and since then.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 272: I can talk about long ago and not so long ago: in olden days, formerly, before, until then and since then.*

272.1 jadis — long ago, in olden days

Before the new one: say the French for in the long run, then the French for sooner or later.

You'll want to know: jadis

jadis — "long ago, in olden days".

> Jadis, cette rue était un marché.
>
> *Long ago, this street was a market.*

Literary and a little old-fashioned; fairy tales like it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jadis comes from Old French *ja a dis* "it is days already" (EtymDB), with *ja* from Latin *iam* "already" and *dis* from Latin *diēs* "day".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: jadis*
- *Say it: jadis*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *jadis*
- *Recall:* say the French for in the long run, then the French for sooner or later, then say *jadis* again

Before you move on

What does jadis mean? ("Long ago, in olden days".) Say it once more.

272.2 naguère — not long ago; formerly (literary)

Before the new one: say the French for sooner or later, then the French for long ago.

You'll want to know: naguère

naguère — "not long ago; formerly (literary)".

Naguère, ce village était très calme.

Not long ago, this village was very quiet.

From *n'a guère*: it is hardly (long) ago. Many writers now use it for 'formerly'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

naguère comes from *n'a guère* "it is hardly (long)". *Guère* is usually traced to a Frankish word meaning "much"; the origin is not fully settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: naguère*
- *Say it: naguère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *naguère*
- *Recall:* say the French for sooner or later, then the French for long ago, then say *naguère* again

Before you move on

What does naguère mean? ("Not long ago; formerly (literary)".) Say it once more.

272.3 auparavant — before, previously

Before the new one: say the French for long ago, then the French for not long ago.

You'll want to know: auparavant

auparavant — "before, previously".

Elle est médecin; auparavant, elle était professeur.

She is a doctor; before that, she was a teacher.

An adverb that stands alone. Before a noun, French uses *avant*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

auparavant is built from *au*, *par* and *avant*; *avant* is inherited from Late Latin *abante*, built on Latin *ante* "before" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *auparavant*
- *Say it:* *auparavant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *auparavant*
- *Recall:* say the French for long ago, then the French for not long ago, then say *auparavant* again

Before you move on

What does auparavant mean? (“Before, previously”.) Say it once more.

272.4 jusqu’alors — until then, up to then

Before the new one: say the French for not long ago, then the French for before.

You’ll want to know: jusqu’alors

jusqu’alors — “until then, up to then”.

Jusqu’alors, personne ne connaissait son secret.

Until then, nobody knew his secret.

Looks back to a moment in the past; from today, say *jusqu’à maintenant*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jusque is built on Latin *ūsque* “all the way” (Lewis & Short) with *inde* (EtymDB) or, in another view, *dē*; *alors* joins *à* and *lors*, which EtymDB traces to Latin *illā hōrā* “at that hour”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: jusqu'alors*
- *Say it: jusqu'alors*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *jusqu'alors*
- *Recall:* say the French for not long ago, then the French for before, then say *jusqu'alors* again

Before you move on

What does jusqu'alors mean? ("Until then, up to then".) Say it once more.

272.5 depuis lors — since then, ever since

Before the new one: say the French for before, then the French for until then.

You'll want to know: depuis lors

depuis lors — "since then, ever since".

> Il est parti en 2010; depuis lors, il n'écrit plus.
>
> *He left in 2010; since then, he no longer writes.*

Formal; in speech, *depuis* or *depuis ce moment-là*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

depuis joins *de* and *puis* "then" (EtymDB); *lors* is traced in EtymDB to Latin *illā hōrā* "at that hour".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: depuis lors*
- *Say it: depuis lors*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *depuis lors*
- *Recall:* say the French for before, then the French for until then, then say *depuis lors* again

Before you move on

What does depuis lors mean? ("Since then, ever since".) Say it once more.

Chapter 273

La veille et le lendemain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can place an event the day before or the day after another, two days later, and say lately or soon.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 273: I can place an event the day before or the day after another, two days later, and say lately or soon.*

273.1 la veille — the day before, the eve

> Before the new one: say the French for until then, then the French for since then.

You'll want to know: la veille

la veille — "the day before, the eve".

> La veille de son examen, elle n'a pas dormi.
>
> *The day before her exam, she did not sleep.*

La veille au soir — the evening before. The verb *veiller* means to stay up.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

veille is inherited from Latin *vigilia* "wakefulness, a night watch" (EtymDB), built on *vigil* "awake": the night of waiting before a feast.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la veille*
- *Say it: la veille*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la veille*
- *Recall:* say the French for until then, then the French for since then, then say *la veille* again

Before you move on

What does la veille mean? ("The day before, the eve".) Say it once more.

273.2 le lendemain — the next day, the day after

Before the new one: say the French for since then, then the French for the day before.

You'll want to know: le lendemain

le lendemain — "the next day, the day after".

Le lendemain, il a téléphoné pour s'excuser.

The next day, he phoned to apologise.

It looks forward from a day in the past; from today, say *demain*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lendemain grew out of *l'endemain*, built on *demain*, which is inherited from Latin *dē mānе* "from the morning" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lendemain*
- *Say it: le lendemain*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le lendemain*
- *Recall:* say the French for since then, then the French for the day before, then say *le lendemain* again

Before you move on

What does le lendemain mean? ("The next day, the day after".) Say it once more.

273.3 le surlendemain — two days later, the day after next

Before the new one: say the French for the day before, then the French for the next day.

You'll want to know: le surlendemain

le surlendemain — "two days later, the day after next".

Il est arrivé le lundi et il est reparti le surlendemain.

He arrived on the Monday and left again two days later.

Sur + *lendemain*: one day beyond the next day.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

surlendemain is built on *lendemain* with *sur* "over, beyond"; *demain* is inherited from Latin *dē māne* "from the morning" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le surlendemain*
- *Say it: le surlendemain*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le surlendemain*
- *Recall:* say the French for the day before, then the French for the next day, then say *le surlendemain* again

Before you move on

What does le surlendemain mean? ("Two days later, the day after next".) Say it once more.

273.4 dernièrement — lately, recently

Before the new one: say the French for the next day, then the French for two days later.

You'll want to know: dernièrement

dernièrement — "lately, recently".

Dernièrement, je dors mal.

Lately, I have been sleeping badly.

Close to *récemment*; it goes with the present or the passé composé.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dernièrement is built on *dernier* "last", from Old French *derrenier*, usually traced to Latin *dē retrō* "from behind" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dernièrement*
- *Say it: dernièrement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dernièrement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the next day, then the French for two days later, then say *dernièrement* again

Before you move on

What does dernièrement mean? ("Lately, recently".) Say it once more.

273.5 prochainement — soon, shortly

Before the new one: say the French for two days later, then the French for lately.

You'll want to know: prochainement

prochainement — "soon, shortly".

Le magasin va ouvrir prochainement.

The shop is going to open soon.

A word of announcements and posters: *prochainement au cinéma.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prochainement is built on *prochain* "next", inherited from Vulgar Latin *propeānus*, built on Latin *prope* "near" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: prochainement*
- *Say it: prochainement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *prochainement*
- *Recall:* say the French for two days later, then the French for lately, then say *prochainement* again

Before you move on

What does prochainement mean? (“Soon, shortly”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 274

Ce qui est arrivé

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that something occurred, unfolded, took place, came before something else or lasted.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 274: I can say that something occurred, unfolded, took place, came before something else or lasted.*

274.1 survenir — to occur, to arise unexpectedly

> Before the new one: say the French for lately, then the French for soon.

You'll want to know: survenir

survenir — "to occur, to arise unexpectedly".

> Un problème est survenu pendant le voyage.
>
> *A problem arose during the trip.*

Conjugated like *venir*, with *être*: *il est survenu*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

survenir comes from Latin *supervenīre* "to come upon, to arrive unexpectedly", from *super* "over" and *venīre* "to come" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: survenir*
- *Say it: survenir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *survenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for lately, then the French for soon, then say *survenir* again

Before you move on

What does survenir mean? ("To occur, to arise unexpectedly".) Say it once more.

274.2 dérouler — to unfold, to take place (as se dérouler); to unroll

Before the new one: say the French for soon, then the French for to occur.

You'll want to know: dérouler

dérouler — "to unfold, to take place (as se dérouler); to unroll".

Le concert s'est déroulé dans le parc.

The concert took place in the park.

Mostly reflexive in this sense: *se dérouler*. Without *se*, it means to unroll a carpet or a map.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dérouler is built on *rouler* "to roll", which comes from Old French *roeler*, built on Latin *rota* "wheel" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dérouler*
- *Say it: dérouler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dérouler*
- *Recall:* say the French for soon, then the French for to occur, then say *dérouler* again

Before you move on

What does dérouler mean? ("To unfold, to take place (as se dérouler); to unroll".) Say it once more.

274.3 avoir lieu — to take place, to be held

Before the new one: say the French for to occur, then the French for to unfold.

You'll want to know: avoir lieu

avoir lieu — "to take place, to be held".

La réunion a eu lieu hier.

The meeting took place yesterday.

For planned events: *la fête aura lieu samedi.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lieu is inherited from Latin *locus* "place", and *avoir* from Latin *habēre* "to have, to hold" (Lewis & Short): to have a place.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: avoir lieu*
- *Say it: avoir lieu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *avoir lieu*
- *Recall:* say the French for to occur, then the French for to unfold, then say *avoir lieu* again

Before you move on

What does avoir lieu mean? ("To take place, to be held".) Say it once more.

274.4 précéder — to precede, to come before

Before the new one: say the French for to unfold, then the French for to take place.

You'll want to know: précéder

précéder — "to precede, to come before".

Un grand silence a précédé la réponse.

A long silence came before the answer.

Le jour précédent — the day before, in a story.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

précéder is a learned borrowing from Latin *praecēdere* "to go before", from *prae* "before" and *cēdere* "to go" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: précéder*
- *Say it: précéder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *précéder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to unfold, then the French for to take place, then say *précéder* again

Before you move on

What does précéder mean? ("To precede, to come before".) Say it once more.

274.5 durer — to last

Before the new one: say the French for to take place, then the French for to precede.

You'll want to know: durer

durer — "to last".

Le voyage a duré trois heures.

The journey lasted three hours.

Ça n'a pas duré — it did not last.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

durer is inherited from Latin *dūrāre* "to harden, to hold out, to last" (EtymDB), built on *dūrus* "hard".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *durer*
- *Say it:* *durer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *durer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to take place, then the French for to precede, then say *durer* again

Before you move on

What does durer mean? ("To last".) Say it once more.

Chapter 275

Le temps passe

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that time went by, that something was put off or came to a result, and name a hitch and a deadline.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 275: I can say that time went by, that something was put off or came to a result, and name a hitch and a deadline.*

275.1 écouler — to go by (as s'écouler, of time); to sell off (goods)

> Before the new one: say the French for to precede, then the French for to last.

You'll want to know: écouler

écouler — "to go by (as s'écouler, of time); to sell off (goods)".

> Trois ans se sont écoulés depuis son départ.
>
> *Three years have gone by since he left.*

Mostly used as *s'écouler*: time goes by, and water flows out (*l'eau s'écoule*). Without *se*, it means to sell off goods: *écouler un stock*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écouler is built on *couler* "to flow", which is inherited from Latin *cōlāre* "to strain, to filter" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *écouler*
- *Say it:* *écouler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *écouler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to precede, then the French for to last, then say *écouler* again

Before you move on

What does écouler mean? ("To go by (as s'écouler, of time); to sell off (goods)".) Say it once more.

275.2 ajourner — to postpone, to adjourn

Before the new one: say the French for to last, then the French for to go by.

You'll want to know: ajourner

ajourner — "to postpone, to adjourn".

Le match a été ajourné parce qu'il pleuvait.

The match was postponed because it was raining.

Formal; in everyday speech, *remettre à plus tard*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ajourner comes from Old French *ajorner* (EtymDB), built on *jor* "day", from Latin *diurnum* "daily, a day's portion": to put to another day.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: ajourner*
- *Say it: ajourner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *ajourner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to last, then the French for to go by, then say *ajourner* again

Before you move on

What does ajourner mean? ("To postpone, to adjourn".) Say it once more.

275.3 aboutir — to succeed, to come to a result; to lead to

Before the new one: say the French for to go by, then the French for to postpone.

You'll want to know: aboutir

aboutir — "to succeed, to come to a result; to lead to".

Le projet a enfin abouti.

The project finally succeeded.

Aboutir à — to lead to: *la rue aboutit à la place.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aboutir is built on *à* and *bout* "end": to reach the end. *Bout* comes from *bouter* "to push", which is usually traced to a Frankish verb; the origin is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: aboutir*
- *Say it: aboutir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *aboutir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go by, then the French for to postpone, then say *aboutir* again

Before you move on

What does aboutir mean? ("To succeed, to come to a result; to lead to".) Say it once more.

275.4 le contretemps — the hitch, the mishap

Before the new one: say the French for to postpone, then the French for to succeed.

You'll want to know: le contretemps

le contretemps — "the hitch, the mishap".

Un petit contretemps nous a mis en retard.

A small hitch made us late.

À contretemps — at the wrong moment, out of step.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contretemps joins *contre* "against", from Latin *contrā*, and *temps* "time", from Latin *tempus* (Lewis & Short): something that goes against the timing.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le contretemps*
- *Say it: le contretemps*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le contretemps*
- *Recall:* say the French for to postpone, then the French for to succeed, then say *le contretemps* again

Before you move on

What does le contretemps mean? ("The hitch, the mishap".) Say it once more.

275.5 l'échéance — the deadline, the due date

Before the new one: say the French for to succeed, then the French for the hitch.

You'll want to know: l'échéance

l'échéance — "the deadline, the due date".

L'échéance approche et le travail n'est pas fini.

The deadline is getting close and the work is not finished.

À brève échéance — in the short term.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échéance is built on *échoir* "to fall due", which is inherited from a Latin compound of *ex* "out" and *cadere* "to fall" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'échéance*
- *Say it: l'échéance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'échéance*
- *Recall:* say the French for to succeed, then the French for the hitch, then say *l'échéance* again

Before you move on

What does l'échéance mean? ("The deadline, the due date".) Say it once more.

275.6 Retour sur les faits

Say the French for first of all and in the first place.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- first of all, in the first place, afterwards, lastly, to finish
- when, as soon as, at the moment when, at once, while
- all of a sudden, suddenly, abruptly, at the time, straight after
- little by little, gradually, as one goes along, in the long run, sooner or later
- long ago, not long ago, before, until then, since then

- the day before, the next day, two days later, lately, soon
- to occur, to unfold, to take place, to precede, to last
- to go by, to postpone, to succeed, the hitch, the deadline

Before you move on

First of all? (**tout d'abord**.) In the first place? (**en premier lieu**.) Afterwards? (**par la suite**.) Lastly? (**en dernier lieu**.) To finish? (**pour finir**.) When? (**lorsque**.) As soon as? (**dès que**.) At the moment when? (**au moment où**.) At once? (**aussitôt**.) While? (**tandis que**.) All of a sudden? (**tout à coup**.) Suddenly? (**subitement**.) Abruptly? (**brusquement**.) At the time? (**sur le coup**.) Straight after? (**dans la foulée**.) Little by little? (**peu à peu**.) Gradually? (**progressivement**.) As one goes along? (**au fur et à mesure**.) In the long run? (**à la longue**.) Sooner or later? (**tôt ou tard**.) Long ago? (**jadis**.) Not long ago? (**naguère**.) Before? (**auparavant**.) Until then? (**jusqu'alors**.) Since then? (**depuis lors**.) The day before? (**la veille**.) The next day? (**le lendemain**.) Two days later? (**le surlendemain**.) Lately? (**dernièrement**.) Soon? (**prochainement**.) To occur? (**survenir**.) To unfold? (**dérouler**.) To take place? (**avoir lieu**.) To precede? (**précéder**.) To last? (**durer**.) To go by? (**écouler**.) To postpone? (**ajourner**.) To succeed? (**aboutir**.) The hitch? (**le contretemps**.) The deadline? (**l'échéance**.)

Chapter 276

Les époques

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about stretches of time: an era, a decade, a millennium, an age and a duration.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 276: I can talk about stretches of time: an era, a decade, a millennium, an age and a duration.*

276.1 l'époque — the time, the era, the period

> Before the new one: say the French for the hitch, then the French for the deadline.

You'll want to know: l'époque

l'époque — "the time, the era, the period".

> À l'époque, on n'avait pas de téléphone portable.
>
> *Back then, people did not have mobile phones.*

À l'époque — back then; *à cette époque-là* — at that time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

époque is a learned borrowing from Greek *epokhḗ* "a halt, a fixed point in time", which reached French through Medieval Latin (EtymDB lists the French word without a parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'époque*
- *Say it: l'époque*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'époque*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hitch, then the French for the deadline, then say *l'époque* again

Before you move on

What does l'époque mean? ("The time, the era, the period".) Say it once more.

276.2 la décennie — the decade

Before the new one: say the French for the deadline, then the French for the time.

You'll want to know: la décennie

la décennie — "the decade".

La ville a beaucoup changé en une décennie.

The town changed a lot in a decade.

Ten years. *La décade* is also heard in this sense, though strictly it means ten days.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décennie is a learned borrowing from Latin *decennium* "a period of ten years" (EtymDB), from *decem* "ten" and *annus* "year".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la décennie*
- *Say it: la décennie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la décennie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the deadline, then the French for the time, then say *la décennie* again

Before you move on

What does la décennie mean? ("The decade".) Say it once more.

276.3 le millénaire — the millennium

Before the new one: say the French for the time, then the French for the decade.

You'll want to know: le millénaire

le millénaire — "the millennium".

Cette église a presque un millénaire.

This church is almost a thousand years old.

Le troisième millénaire — the third millennium.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

millénaire is a learned borrowing from Latin *millēnārius* "containing a thousand" (EtymDB), built on *mīlle* "thousand".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le millénaire*
- *Say it: le millénaire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le millénaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the time, then the French for the decade, then say *le millénaire* again

Before you move on

What does le millénaire mean? ("The millennium".) Say it once more.

276.4 l'ère — the era, the age

Before the new one: say the French for the decade, then the French for the millennium.

You'll want to know: l'ère

l'ère — "the era, the age".

Nous vivons dans l'ère d'internet.

We live in the internet age.

Feminine: *une nouvelle ère*, a new era.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ère was borrowed from Late Latin *aera* "a counted number, an era" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ère*
- *Say it: l'ère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'ère*
- *Recall:* say the French for the decade, then the French for the millennium, then say *l'ère* again

Before you move on

What does l'ère mean? ("The era, the age".) Say it once more.

276.5 la durée — the length, the duration

Before the new one: say the French for the millennium, then the French for the era.

You'll want to know: la durée

la durée — "the length, the duration".

La durée du film est de deux heures.

The film is two hours long.

Pour une durée de six mois — for a period of six months.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

durée is built on *durer* "to last", which is inherited from Latin *dūrāre* "to hold out, to last" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la durée*
- *Say it: la durée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la durée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the millennium, then the French for the era, then say *la durée* again

Before you move on

What does la durée mean? ("The length, the duration".) Say it once more.

Chapter 277

Étape par étape

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the stages of an event: a step, a phase, the order of events, an instant, and what came at the end.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 277: I can describe the stages of an event: a step, a phase, the order of events, an instant, and what came at the end.*

277.1 l'étape — the step, the leg; a stop on a journey

> Before the new one: say the French for the era, then the French for the length.

You'll want to know: l'étape

l'étape — "the step, the leg; a stop on a journey".

> La première étape du voyage était la plus longue.
>
> *The first leg of the journey was the longest.*

Also a stop on a trip: *faire étape* — to stop over.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étape comes from Old French *estaple* “a market, a place to unload goods”, which was borrowed from Middle Dutch *stapel* “a pile, a depot” (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’étape*
- *Say it: l’étape*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l’étape*
- *Recall:* say the French for the era, then the French for the length, then say *l’étape* again

Before you move on

What does l’étape mean? (“The step, the leg; a stop on a journey”.) Say it once more.

277.2 la phase — the phase

Before the new one: say the French for the length, then the French for the step.

You’ll want to know: la phase

la phase — “the phase”.

Le projet entre dans sa dernière phase.

The project is entering its last phase.

Also the phases of the moon: *les phases de la lune*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

phase is a learned borrowing from Greek *phásis* "appearance", said first of the moon (EtymDB lists the French word without a parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la phase*
- *Say it: la phase*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la phase*
- *Recall:* say the French for the length, then the French for the step, then say *la phase* again

Before you move on

What does la phase mean? ("The phase".) Say it once more.

277.3 la chronologie — the chronology, the order of events

Before the new one: say the French for the step, then the French for the phase.

You'll want to know: la chronologie

la chronologie — "the chronology, the order of events".

Le policier a refait la chronologie de la soirée.

The police officer went back over the order of events that evening.

Par ordre chronologique — in order of time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chronologie is a learned word built from Greek *khrónos* "time" and *-logía* "account, study" (EtymDB lists the French word without a parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chronologie*
- *Say it: la chronologie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la chronologie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the step, then the French for the phase, then say *la chronologie* again

Before you move on

What does la chronologie mean? ("The chronology, the order of events".) Say it once more.

277.4 l'instant — the instant, the moment

Before the new one: say the French for the phase, then the French for the chronology.

You'll want to know: l'instant

l'instant — "the instant, the moment".

Pendant un instant, personne n'a parlé.

For a moment, nobody spoke.

Pour l'instant — for now; *à l'instant* — a moment ago.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

instant is a learned borrowing from Latin *īnstāns* "present, pressing" (EtymDB), from *īnstāre* "to stand near, to press on" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'instant*
- *Say it: l'instant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'instant*
- *Recall:* say the French for the phase, then the French for the chronology, then say *l'instant* again

Before you move on

What does l'instant mean? ("The instant, the moment".) Say it once more.

277.5 à l'issue de — at the end of, following

Before the new one: say the French for the chronology, then the French for the instant.

You'll want to know: à l'issue de

à l'issue de — "at the end of, following".

> À l'issue du match, les joueurs ont salué le public.
>
> *At the end of the match, the players waved to the crowd.*

Formal and frequent in news reports. *L'issue* alone is the way out, or the outcome.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

issue is the old past participle of Old French *issir* "to go out", which is inherited from Latin *exīre* "to go out" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *à l'issue de*
- *Say it:* *à l'issue de*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *à l'issue de*
- *Recall:* say the French for the chronology, then the French for the instant, then say *à l'issue de* again

Before you move on

What does à l'issue de mean? ("At the end of, following".) Say it once more.

Chapter 278

La presse

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the news and the papers: current events, the press, daily and weekly papers, and their subscribers.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 278: I can talk about the news and the papers: current events, the press, daily and weekly papers, and their subscribers.*

278.1 l'actualité — the news, current events

> Before the new one: say the French for the instant, then the French for at the end of.

You'll want to know: l'actualité

l'actualité — "the news, current events".

> Mon père suit l'actualité tous les matins.
>
> *My father follows the news every morning.*

Les actualités — the news on TV or radio, a little old-fashioned. *D'actualité* — topical.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

actualité is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *āctuālitās* (EtymDB), built on *āctuālis* "active, real", from *agere* "to do" (Lewis & Short): what is happening now.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'actualité*
- *Say it: l'actualité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'actualité*
- *Recall:* say the French for the instant, then the French for at the end of, then say *l'actualité* again

Before you move on

What does l'actualité mean? ("The news, current events".) Say it once more.

278.2 la presse — the press, the newspapers

Before the new one: say the French for at the end of, then the French for the news.

You'll want to know: la presse

la presse — "the press, the newspapers".

La presse a beaucoup parlé de cette histoire.

The press talked a lot about this story.

La presse écrite — the print press. It also names a machine that presses.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

presse is built on *presser* "to press", which is inherited from Latin *pressāre*, built on *premere* "to press" (Lewis & Short): first the printing press, then the papers it printed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la presse*
- *Say it: la presse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la presse*
- *Recall:* say the French for at the end of, then the French for the news, then say *la presse* again

Before you move on

What does la presse mean? ("The press, the newspapers".) Say it once more.

278.3 le quotidien — the daily paper; daily life

Before the new one: say the French for the news, then the French for the press.

You'll want to know: le quotidien

le quotidien — "the daily paper; daily life".

Il achète un quotidien tous les matins.

He buys a daily paper every morning.

As an adjective, *quotidien* means daily: *la vie quotidienne.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quotidien is a learned borrowing from Latin *quotīdiānus*, *cottīdiānus* "daily" (EtymDB), from *cottīdiē* "every day", built on *diēs* "day" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le quotidien*
- *Say it: le quotidien*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le quotidien*
- *Recall:* say the French for the news, then the French for the press, then say *le quotidien* again

Before you move on

What does le quotidien mean? ("The daily paper; daily life".) Say it once more.

278.4 l'hebdomadaire — the weekly (paper or magazine)

Before the new one: say the French for the press, then the French for the daily paper.

You'll want to know: l'hebdomadaire

l'hebdomadaire — "the weekly (paper or magazine)".

Ma grand-mère lit un hebdomadaire sur la cuisine.

My grandmother reads a weekly about cooking.

Often *un hebdo* in speech. As an adjective: *une réunion hebdomadaire.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hebdomadaire is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *hebdomadārius* (EtymDB), built on Greek *hebdomás* "a group of seven, a week".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'hebdomadaire*
- *Say it: l'hebdomadaire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'hebdomadaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the press, then the French for the daily paper, then say *l'hebdomadaire* again

Before you move on

What does l'hebdomadaire mean? ("The weekly (paper or magazine)".) Say it once more.

278.5 l'abonné — the subscriber

Before the new one: say the French for the daily paper, then the French for the weekly.

You'll want to know: l'abonné

l'abonné — "the subscriber".

Les abonnés reçoivent le journal à la maison.

Subscribers get the paper at home.

Être abonné à un journal — to take a paper. Feminine: *l'abonnée*. Online: *les abonnés* are followers.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

abonné is the past participle of *abonner* "to subscribe" (EtymDB), built on Old French *bonne*, *borne* "a boundary", which is usually traced to a Gaulish word: a price fixed within limits.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'abonné*
- *Say it: l'abonné*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'abonné*
- *Recall:* say the French for the daily paper, then the French for the weekly, then say *l'abonné* again

Before you move on

What does l'abonné mean? ("The subscriber".) Say it once more.

Chapter 279

Écrire pour le journal

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that someone wrote up, printed and brought out a text, and talk about the newsroom and the date it came out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 279: I can say that someone wrote up, printed and brought out a text, and talk about the newsroom and the date it came out.*

279.1 rédiger — to write, to draft (a text)

> Before the new one: say the French for the weekly, then the French for the subscriber.

You'll want to know: rédiger

rédiger — "to write, to draft (a text)".

> Le journaliste a rédigé son article en une heure.
>
> *The journalist wrote his article in an hour.*

For a text with a purpose: *rédiger une lettre, un rapport.* In daily speech, *écrire.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rédiger is a learned borrowing from Latin *redigere* "to bring back, to reduce to order" (EtymDB), from *red-* "back" and *agere* "to drive" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rédiger*
- *Say it: rédiger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rédiger*
- *Recall:* say the French for the weekly, then the French for the subscriber, then say *rédiger* again

Before you move on

What does rédiger mean? ("To write, to draft (a text)".) Say it once more.

279.2 la rédaction — the newsroom, the editorial staff; a school essay

Before the new one: say the French for the subscriber, then the French for to write.

You'll want to know: la rédaction

la rédaction — "the newsroom, the editorial staff; a school essay".

Toute la rédaction a travaillé tard ce soir-là.

The whole newsroom worked late that evening.

At school, *une rédaction* is an essay.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rédaction is a learned borrowing from Latin *redāctiō* (EtymDB), from *redigere* "to put in order": first the writing of a text, then the people who write it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rédaction*
- *Say it: la rédaction*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rédaction*
- *Recall:* say the French for the subscriber, then the French for to write, then say *la rédaction* again

Before you move on

What does la rédaction mean? ("The newsroom, the editorial staff; a school essay".) Say it once more.

279.3 imprimer — to print

Before the new one: say the French for to write, then the French for the newsroom.

You'll want to know: imprimer

imprimer — "to print".

Le journal est imprimé pendant la nuit.

The paper is printed during the night.

At home too: *imprimer un billet de train.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

imprimer is a learned borrowing from Latin *imprimere* "to press into" (EtymDB), from *in* and *premere* "to press" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: imprimer*
- *Say it: imprimer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *imprimer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to write, then the French for the newsroom, then say *imprimer* again

Before you move on

What does imprimer mean? ("To print".) Say it once more.

279.4 paraître — to come out, to be published; to seem

Before the new one: say the French for the newsroom, then the French for to print.

You'll want to know: paraître

paraître — "to come out, to be published; to seem".

Le magazine paraît tous les jeudis.

The magazine comes out every Thursday.

Two senses: to be published, and *il paraît que* — it seems, people say. The current spelling also allows *paraitre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

paraître is inherited from Late Latin *pārēscere*, built on Latin *pārēre* "to appear, to come in sight" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: paraître*
- *Say it: paraître*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *paraître*
- *Recall:* say the French for the newsroom, then the French for to print, then say *paraître* again

Before you move on

What does paraître mean? ("To come out, to be published; to seem".) Say it once more.

279.5 la parution — the publication, the release (of a book or paper)

Before the new one: say the French for to print, then the French for to come out.

You'll want to know: la parution

la parution — "the publication, the release (of a book or paper)".

Le livre a eu du succès dès sa parution.

The book was a success as soon as it came out.

La date de parution — the publication date.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parution is built on *paru*, the past participle of *paraître*, which comes from Latin *pārērre* "to appear" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la parution*
- *Say it: la parution*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la parution*
- *Recall:* say the French for to print, then the French for to come out, then say *la parution* again

Before you move on

What does la parution mean? ("The publication, the release (of a book or paper)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 280

Le journal télévisé

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the news on television and radio: the TV news, the presenter, the viewers, the listeners and the microphone.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 280: I can talk about the news on television and radio: the TV news, the presenter, the viewers, the listeners and the microphone.*

280.1 le journal télévisé — the television news

> Before the new one: say the French for to come out, then the French for the publication.

You'll want to know: le journal télévisé

le journal télévisé — "the television news".

> Nous regardons le journal télévisé à vingt heures.
>
> *We watch the television news at eight in the evening.*

Often *le JT* in speech, or *le journal de vingt heures*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

journal is inherited from Latin *diurnālis* "daily" (EtymDB); *télévisé* is built on *télévision*, from Greek *tēle* "far" and Latin *vīsiō* "sight", from

vidēre “to see”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le journal télévisé*
- *Say it: le journal télévisé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le journal télévisé*
- *Recall:* say the French for to come out, then the French for the publication, then say *le journal télévisé* again

Before you move on

What does le journal télévisé mean? (“The television news”.) Say it once more.

280.2 le présentateur — the presenter, the newsreader

Before the new one: say the French for the publication, then the French for the television news.

You’ll want to know: le présentateur

le présentateur — “the presenter, the newsreader”.

Le présentateur a annoncé une bonne nouvelle.

The presenter announced some good news.

Feminine: *la présentatrice.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

présentateur is built on *présenter* “to present”, from Latin *praesentāre* “to show”, built on *praesēns* “present, at hand” (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le présentateur*
- *Say it: le présentateur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le présentateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the publication, then the French for the television news, then say *le présentateur* again

Before you move on

What does le présentateur mean? ("The presenter, the newsreader".) Say it once more.

280.3 le téléspectateur — the viewer (of television)

Before the new one: say the French for the television news, then the French for the presenter.

You'll want to know: le téléspectateur

le téléspectateur — "the viewer (of television)".

Des millions de téléspectateurs ont vu le match.

Millions of viewers watched the match.

Feminine: *la téléspectatrice.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

téléspectateur joins Greek *tēle* "far" and *spectateur*, a learned borrowing from Latin *spectātor* "onlooker", from *spectāre* "to watch" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le téléspectateur*
- *Say it: le téléspectateur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le téléspectateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the television news, then the French for the presenter, then say *le téléspectateur* again

Before you move on

What does le téléspectateur mean? ("The viewer (of television)".) Say it once more.

280.4 l'auditeur — the listener

Before the new one: say the French for the presenter, then the French for the viewer.

You'll want to know: l'auditeur

l'auditeur — "the listener".

Les auditeurs peuvent appeler la radio.

Listeners can phone in to the radio.

Feminine: *l'auditrice*. In a firm, *un auditeur* also checks the accounts.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

auditeur is a learned borrowing from Latin *audītor* "hearer" (EtymDB), from *audīre* "to hear".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'auditeur*
- *Say it: l'auditeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'auditeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the presenter, then the French for the viewer, then say *l'auditeur* again

Before you move on

What does l'auditeur mean? ("The listener".) Say it once more.

280.5 le micro — the microphone, the mic

Before the new one: say the French for the viewer, then the French for the listener.

You'll want to know: le micro

le micro — "the microphone, the mic".

Le chanteur a pris le micro.

The singer took the mic.

Short for *le microphone*. *Au micro* — speaking on air.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

micro is short for *microphone*, a learned word built from Greek *mīkrós* "small" and *phōnḗ* "voice, sound" (EtymDB lists the short form without a parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le micro*
- *Say it:* *le micro*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le micro*
- *Recall:* say the French for the viewer, then the French for the listener, then say *le micro* again

Before you move on

What does le micro mean? (“The microphone, the mic”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 281

Le reportage

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about reporting from the field: a report, a special correspondent, a correspondent, a wire story and a news agency.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 281: I can talk about reporting from the field: a report, a special correspondent, a correspondent, a wire story and a news agency.*

281.1 le reportage — the report, the feature (on TV, radio or in a paper)

> Before the new one: say the French for the listener, then the French for the microphone.

You'll want to know: le reportage

le reportage — "the report, the feature (on TV, radio or in a paper)".

> J'ai vu un reportage sur la vie à la montagne.
>
> *I watched a feature about life in the mountains.*

Faire un reportage — to report on something, on location.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reportage is built with the suffix *-age* on the verb meaning "to carry back, to report" (EtymDB), which comes from Latin *reportāre* "to carry back", built on *portāre* "to carry" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le reportage*
- *Say it: le reportage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le reportage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the listener, then the French for the microphone, then say *le reportage* again

Before you move on

What does le reportage mean? ("The report, the feature (on TV, radio or in a paper)".) Say it once more.

281.2 l'envoyé spécial — the special correspondent

Before the new one: say the French for the microphone, then the French for the report.

You'll want to know: l'envoyé spécial

l'envoyé spécial — "the special correspondent".

Notre envoyé spécial est arrivé sur place ce matin.

Our special correspondent arrived on the spot this morning.

Envoyé is the past participle of *envoyer*: someone sent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

envoyé comes from *envoyer*, inherited from Late Latin *inviāre* "to put on the way", built on *via* "way" (Lewis & Short); *spécial* is a learned borrowing from Latin *speciālis* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'envoyé spécial*
- *Say it: l'envoyé spécial*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'envoyé spécial*
- *Recall:* say the French for the microphone, then the French for the report, then say *l'envoyé spécial* again

Before you move on

What does l'envoyé spécial mean? ("The special correspondent".) Say it once more.

281.3 le correspondant — the correspondent; a pen friend

Before the new one: say the French for the report, then the French for the special correspondent.

You'll want to know: le correspondant

le correspondant — "the correspondent; a pen friend".

Le correspondant du journal vit à l'étranger depuis dix ans.

The paper's correspondent has lived abroad for ten years.

At school, *un correspondant* is an exchange partner or a pen friend.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

correspondant is built on *correspondre*, a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *correspondēre* "to answer together", from *con-* and *respondēre* "to answer" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le correspondant*
- *Say it: le correspondant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le correspondant*
- *Recall:* say the French for the report, then the French for the special correspondent, then say *le correspondant* again

Before you move on

What does le correspondant mean? ("The correspondent; a pen friend".) Say it once more.

281.4 la dépêche — the dispatch, the wire story

Before the new one: say the French for the special correspondent, then the French for the correspondent.

You'll want to know: la dépêche

la dépêche — "the dispatch, the wire story".

Une dépêche est arrivée à midi.

A wire story came in at noon.

A short news item sent by an agency to the papers.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépêche is built on *dépêcher* “to send off quickly”, which comes from Old French *despeechier* “to set free”, formed as the opposite of *empêcher* “to hinder”; the root is usually traced to Latin *pedica* “a fetter” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dépêche*
- *Say it: la dépêche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la dépêche*
- *Recall:* say the French for the special correspondent, then the French for the correspondent, then say *la dépêche* again

Before you move on

What does la dépêche mean? (“The dispatch, the wire story”.) Say it once more.

281.5 l’agence de presse — the news agency

Before the new one: say the French for the correspondent, then the French for the dispatch.

You’ll want to know: l’agence de presse

l’agence de presse — “the news agency”.

L’agence de presse envoie des dépêches toute la journée.

The news agency sends out wire stories all day long.

Other agencies: *une agence de voyages*, *une agence immobilière*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agence is usually traced to Italian *agenzia* (EtymDB lists no parent), which goes back to Latin *agere* "to do, to act" (Lewis & Short); *presse* is built on *presser*, from Latin *premere* "to press".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'agence de presse*
- *Say it: l'agence de presse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'agence de presse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the correspondent, then the French for the dispatch, then say *l'agence de presse* again

Before you move on

What does l'agence de presse mean? ("The news agency".) Say it once more.

Chapter 282

Les gros titres

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the front page: headlines, banner headlines, sections, editorials and short news items.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 282: I can talk about the front page: headlines, banner headlines, sections, editorials and short news items.*

282.1 le gros titre — the headline

> Before the new one: say the French for the dispatch, then the French for the news agency.

You'll want to know: le gros titre

le gros titre — "the headline".

> Le gros titre du jour parle du prix du pain.
>
> *Today's headline is about the price of bread.*

Faire les gros titres — to make the headlines. *À la une* — on the front page.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

titre is inherited from Latin *titulus* "inscription, label" (EtymDB), and *gros* from Late Latin *grossus* "thick" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gros titre*
- *Say it: le gros titre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le gros titre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the dispatch, then the French for the news agency, then say *le gros titre* again

Before you move on

What does le gros titre mean? ("The headline".) Say it once more.

282.2 la manchette — the banner headline; a shirt cuff

Before the new one: say the French for the news agency, then the French for the headline.

You'll want to know: la manchette

la manchette — "the banner headline; a shirt cuff".

La manchette annonçait la victoire de l'équipe.

The banner headline announced the team's victory.

On a shirt, *les manchettes* are the cuffs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manchette is a diminutive of *manche* "sleeve" (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *manica* "a long sleeve", built on *manus* "hand" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la manchette*
- *Say it: la manchette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la manchette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the news agency, then the French for the headline, then say *la manchette* again

Before you move on

What does la manchette mean? ("The banner headline; a shirt cuff".) Say it once more.

282.3 la rubrique — the section, the regular feature (in a paper)

Before the new one: say the French for the headline, then the French for the banner headline.

You'll want to know: la rubrique

la rubrique — "the section, the regular feature (in a paper)".

Il écrit dans la rubrique sport.

He writes in the sports section.

La rubrique nécrologique — the death notices.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rubrique is a learned borrowing from Latin *rubrīca* "red earth, a heading written in red", from *ruber* "red" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rubrique*
- *Say it: la rubrique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rubrique*
- *Recall:* say the French for the headline, then the French for the banner headline, then say *la rubrique* again

Before you move on

What does la rubrique mean? ("The section, the regular feature (in a paper)".) Say it once more.

282.4 l'éditorial — the editorial, the leading article

Before the new one: say the French for the banner headline, then the French for the section.

You'll want to know: l'éditorial

l'éditorial — "the editorial, the leading article".

Le directeur du journal écrit l'éditorial.

The editor of the paper writes the editorial.

Plural *les éditoriaux*. Its writer is *l'éditorialiste*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éditorial is usually traced to English *editorial* (EtymDB lists no parent), built on *editor*, which comes from Latin *ēditor* "one who brings out", from *ēdere* "to give out" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éditorial*
- *Say it: l'éditorial*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'éditorial*
- *Recall:* say the French for the banner headline, then the French for the section, then say *l'éditorial* again

Before you move on

What does l'éditorial mean? ("The editorial, the leading article".) Say it once more.

282.5 les faits divers — short news items, minor news stories

Before the new one: say the French for the section, then the French for the editorial.

You'll want to know: les faits divers

les faits divers — "short news items, minor news stories".

Il aime lire les faits divers.

He likes reading the short news items.

Small stories: thefts, odd events, accidents. Singular: *un fait divers*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fait is inherited from Latin *factum* "a deed" (Lewis & Short), and *divers* is a learned borrowing from Latin *dīversus* "turned different ways" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les faits divers*
- *Say it: les faits divers*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les faits divers*
- *Recall:* say the French for the section, then the French for the editorial, then say *les faits divers* again

Before you move on

What does les faits divers mean? ("Short news items, minor news stories".) Say it once more.

Chapter 283

À l'antenne

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that something was broadcast, filmed or interviewed, and that someone spoke on air.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 283: I can say that something was broadcast, filmed or interviewed, and that someone spoke on air.*

283.1 diffuser — to broadcast; to spread

> Before the new one: say the French for the editorial, then the French for short news items.

You'll want to know: diffuser

diffuser — "to broadcast; to spread".

> La télé a diffusé le match en direct.
>
> *The TV broadcast the match live.*

Also to spread news or a smell: *diffuser une information.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

diffuser is built on *diffus* "spread out" (EtymDB), a learned borrowing from Latin *diffūsus*, the past participle of *diffundere* "to pour out" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: diffuser*
- *Say it: diffuser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *diffuser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the editorial, then the French for short news items, then say *diffuser* again

Before you move on

What does diffuser mean? ("To broadcast; to spread".) Say it once more.

283.2 la diffusion — the broadcasting, the showing; the spread

Before the new one: say the French for short news items, then the French for to broadcast.

You'll want to know: la diffusion

la diffusion — "the broadcasting, the showing; the spread".

La diffusion du match commence à vingt heures.

The broadcast of the match starts at eight in the evening.

En diffusion — being shown, on air.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

diffusion is a learned borrowing from Latin *diffūsiō* "a spreading out" (EtymDB), from *diffundere* "to pour out".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la diffusion*
- *Say it: la diffusion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la diffusion*
- *Recall:* say the French for short news items, then the French for to broadcast, then say *la diffusion* again

Before you move on

What does la diffusion mean? ("The broadcasting, the showing; the spread".) Say it once more.

283.3 filmer — to film

Before the new one: say the French for to broadcast, then the French for the broadcasting.

You'll want to know: filmer

filmer — "to film".

Un homme a tout filmé avec son téléphone.

A man filmed everything with his phone.

Se faire filmer — to get filmed.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

filmer is built on *film*, which was borrowed from English *film* "a thin skin, a coating" (EtymDB lists the verb without a parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: filmer*
- *Say it: filmer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *filmer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to broadcast, then the French for the broadcasting, then say *filmer* again

Before you move on

What does filmer mean? ("To film".) Say it once more.

283.4 interviewer — to interview

Before the new one: say the French for the broadcasting, then the French for to film.

You'll want to know: interviewer

interviewer — "to interview".

La journaliste a interviewé le maire.

The journalist interviewed the mayor.

It ends in the French *-er* sound of *parler*. The noun is *l'interview*, feminine; in Québec, *l'entrevue*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interviewer was borrowed from English *interview*, which itself comes from French *entrevue* "a meeting face to face" (EtymDB), built on *voir*, from Latin *vidēre*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: interviewer*
- *Say it: interviewer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *interviewer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the broadcasting, then the French for to film, then say *interviewer* again

Before you move on

What does interviewer mean? ("To interview".) Say it once more.

283.5 l'antenne — the aerial, the antenna; being on air

Before the new one: say the French for to film, then the French for to interview.

You'll want to know: l'antenne

l'antenne — "the aerial, the antenna; being on air".

Le chanteur a parlé pendant dix minutes à l'antenne.

The singer spoke on air for ten minutes.

Être à l'antenne — to be on air. Also an insect's feeler.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

antenne is a learned borrowing from Latin *antemna* "a sail yard" (EtymDB), first said of an insect's feelers, then of a radio mast.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'antenne*
- *Say it: l'antenne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'antenne*
- *Recall:* say the French for to film, then the French for to interview, then say *l'antenne* again

Before you move on

What does l'antenne mean? ("The aerial, the antenna; being on air".) Say it once more.

283.6 Retour sur les chapitres 276–283

Say the French for the time and the decade.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the time, the decade, the millennium, the era, the length
- the step, the phase, the chronology, the instant, at the end of
- the news, the press, the daily paper, the weekly, the subscriber
- to write, the newsroom, to print, to come out, the publication
- the television news, the presenter, the viewer, the listener, the microphone
- the report, the special correspondent, the correspondent, the dispatch, the news agency
- the headline, the banner headline, the section, the editorial, short news items
- to broadcast, the broadcasting, to film, to interview, the aerial

Before you move on

The time? (**l'époque**.) The decade? (**la décennie**.) The millennium? (**le millénaire**.) The era? (**l'ère**.) The length? (**la durée**.) The step? (**l'étape**.) The phase? (**la phase**.) The chronology? (**la chronologie**.) The instant? (**l'instant**.) At the end of? (**à l'issue de**.) The news? (**l'actualité**.) The press? (**la presse**.) The daily paper? (**le quotidien**.) The weekly? (**l'hebdomadaire**.) The subscriber? (**l'abonné**.) To write? (**rédiger**.) The newsroom? (**la rédaction**.) To print? (**imprimer**.) To come out? (**paraître**.) The publication? (**la parution**.) The television news? (**le journal télévisé**.) The presenter? (**le présentateur**.) The viewer? (**le téléspectateur**.) The listener? (**l'auditeur**.) The microphone? (**le micro**.) The report? (**le reportage**.) The special correspondent? (**l'envoyé spécial**.) The correspondent? (**le correspondant**.) The dispatch? (**la dépêche**.) The news agency? (**l'agence de presse**.) The headline? (**le gros titre**.) The banner headline? (**la manchette**.) The section? (**la rubrique**.) The editorial? (**l'éditorial**.) Short news items? (**les faits divers**.) To broadcast? (**diffuser**.) The broadcasting? (**la diffusion**.) To film? (**filmer**.) To interview? (**interviewer**.) The aerial? (**l'antenne**.)

Chapter 284

Ce que disent les journaux

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can report what people said and found out: revealing, reporting, denying, recounting and commenting.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 284: I can report what people said and found out: revealing, reporting, denying, recounting and commenting.*

284.1 révéler — to reveal, to disclose

> Before the new one: say the French for to interview, then the French for the aerial.

You'll want to know: révéler

révéler — "to reveal, to disclose".

> Le journal a révélé le secret du chanteur.
>
> *The paper revealed the singer's secret.*

Se révéler — to turn out: *il s'est révélé très utile.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

révéler is a learned borrowing from Latin *revēlāre* "to unveil" (EtymDB), from *re-* "back" and *vēlum* "a veil".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: révéler*
- *Say it: révéler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *révéler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to interview, then the French for the aerial, then say *révéler* again

Before you move on

What does révéler mean? ("To reveal, to disclose".) Say it once more.

284.2 rapporter — to report, to relate; to bring back

Before the new one: say the French for the aerial, then the French for to reveal.

You'll want to know: rapporter

rapporter — "to report, to relate; to bring back".

Le journaliste a rapporté ce qu'il avait vu.

The journalist reported what he had seen.

Also to bring back: *rapporter des souvenirs de vacances.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rapporter is built on *apporter* "to bring", which comes from Latin *apportāre* (EtymDB), from *ad* and *portāre* "to carry" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rapporter*
- *Say it: rapporter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rapporter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the aerial, then the French for to reveal, then say *rapporter* again

Before you move on

What does rapporter mean? ("To report, to relate; to bring back".) Say it once more.

284.3 démentir — to deny, to refute (officially)

Before the new one: say the French for to reveal, then the French for to report.

You'll want to know: démentir

démentir — "to deny, to refute (officially)".

Le chanteur a démenti la nouvelle.

The singer denied the news.

Conjugated like *sortir*: *il dément, ils démentent.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

démentir is built on *dé-* and the verb for "to lie" (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *mentīrī* "to lie" (Lewis & Short): to show that something is false.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: démentir*
- *Say it: démentir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *démentir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reveal, then the French for to report, then say *démentir* again

Before you move on

What does démentir mean? ("To deny, to refute (officially)".) Say it once more.

284.4 relater — to recount, to relate

Before the new one: say the French for to report, then the French for to deny.

You'll want to know: relater

relater — "to recount, to relate".

Le livre relate la vie d'une famille pendant la guerre.

The book recounts the life of a family during the war.

Formal and written; in speech, *raconter*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

relater is built on Latin *relātus* (EtymDB), the past participle of *referre* "to carry back, to report" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: relater*
- *Say it: relater*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *relater*
- *Recall:* say the French for to report, then the French for to deny, then say *relater* again

Before you move on

What does relater mean? (“To recount, to relate”.) Say it once more.

284.5 commenter — to comment on

Before the new one: say the French for to deny, then the French for to recount.

You’ll want to know: commenter

commenter — “to comment on”.

Il commente les matchs à la radio.

He commentates on matches on the radio.

No *sur* after it: *commenter un match*; with the noun, *faire un commentaire sur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

commenter is a learned borrowing from Latin *commentārī* “to think over, to write notes on” (Lewis & Short), which is linked to the root of *mēns* “mind”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *commenter*
- *Say it:* *commenter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *commenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deny, then the French for to recount, then say *commenter* again

Before you move on

What does commenter mean? ("To comment on".) Say it once more.

Chapter 285

On dit que...

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about what goes round: a rumour, a scoop, false information, censorship and a controversy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 285: I can talk about what goes round: a rumour, a scoop, false information, censorship and a controversy.*

285.1 la rumeur — the rumour

> Before the new one: say the French for to recount, then the French for to comment on.

You'll want to know: la rumeur

la rumeur — "the rumour".

> Une rumeur court dans le village.
>
> *A rumour is going round the village.*

La rumeur court — the rumour is going round. Also a low noise: *la rumeur de la ville.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rumeur is inherited from Latin *rūmor* "common talk, hearsay" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rumeur*
- *Say it: la rumeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rumeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to recount, then the French for to comment on, then say *la rumeur* again

Before you move on

What does la rumeur mean? ("The rumour".) Say it once more.

285.2 le scoop — the scoop, the exclusive story

Before the new one: say the French for to comment on, then the French for the rumour.

You'll want to know: le scoop

le scoop — "the scoop, the exclusive story".

Ce journal a eu le scoop avant tout le monde.

This paper got the scoop before everyone else.

Borrowed from English; official French proposes *l'exclusivité*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

scoop was borrowed from English *scoop* "a ladle; a story got ahead of rivals" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le scoop*
- *Say it: le scoop*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le scoop*
- *Recall:* say the French for to comment on, then the French for the rumour, then say *le scoop* again

Before you move on

What does le scoop mean? (“The scoop, the exclusive story”.) Say it once more.

285.3 la désinformation — disinformation, false information

Before the new one: say the French for the rumour, then the French for the scoop.

You’ll want to know: la désinformation

la désinformation — “disinformation, false information”.

Il y a beaucoup de désinformation sur internet.

There is a lot of false information on the internet.

People also say *les fausses nouvelles*, or *les fake news* in speech.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désinformation is built on *information*, a learned borrowing from Latin *īnfōrmātiō* “an outline, an idea”, built on *fōrma* “shape” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la désinformation*
- *Say it: la désinformation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la désinformation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rumour, then the French for the scoop, then say *la désinformation* again

Before you move on

What does la désinformation mean? ("Disinformation, false information".) Say it once more.

285.4 la censure — censorship

Before the new one: say the French for the scoop, then the French for disinformation.

You'll want to know: la censure

la censure — "censorship".

Le film a été interdit par la censure.

The film was banned by the censors.

The verb is *censurer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

censure is a learned borrowing from Latin *cēnsūra* "the office of the censor", from *cēnsēre* "to assess, to judge" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la censure*
- *Say it: la censure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la censure*
- *Recall:* say the French for the scoop, then the French for disinformation, then say *la censure* again

Before you move on

What does la censure mean? ("Censorship".) Say it once more.

285.5 la polémique — the controversy, the row

Before the new one: say the French for disinformation, then the French for censorship.

You'll want to know: la polémique

la polémique — "the controversy, the row".

Ses paroles ont créé une polémique.

His words caused a row.

As an adjective: *un ton polémique*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

polémique comes from Greek *polemikós* "warlike" (EtymDB), built on *pólemos* "war": a war of words.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la polémique*
- *Say it: la polémique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la polémique*
- *Recall:* say the French for disinformation, then the French for censorship, then say *la polémique* again

Before you move on

What does la polémique mean? ("The controversy, the row".) Say it once more.

Chapter 286

Les chiffres

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can report figures: a poll, a final count, a rise, a fall and a statistic.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 286: I can report figures: a poll, a final count, a rise, a fall and a statistic.*

286.1 le sondage — the poll, the survey

> Before the new one: say the French for censorship, then the French for the controversy.

You'll want to know: le sondage

le sondage — "the poll, the survey".

> Un sondage montre que les jeunes lisent moins.
>
> *A poll shows that young people read less.*

Un sondage d'opinion — an opinion poll.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sondage is built on *sonder* "to sound, to probe", from *sonde* "a sounding line", which is usually traced to Old English *sund* "water, sea"; the origin is not fully settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sondage*
- *Say it: le sondage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sondage*
- *Recall:* say the French for censorship, then the French for the controversy, then say *le sondage* again

Before you move on

What does le sondage mean? ("The poll, the survey".) Say it once more.

286.2 le bilan — the final count, the outcome; the review

Before the new one: say the French for the controversy, then the French for the poll.

You'll want to know: le bilan

le bilan — "the final count, the outcome; the review".

Le bilan de l'année est très positif.

The outcome of the year is very positive.

After a disaster, *le bilan* is the number of dead and injured. *Faire le bilan* — to take stock.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bilan was borrowed from Italian *bilancio* "balance" (EtymDB), built on Late Latin *bilanx* "with two scales" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bilan*
- *Say it: le bilan*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bilan*
- *Recall:* say the French for the controversy, then the French for the poll, then say *le bilan* again

Before you move on

What does le bilan mean? ("The final count, the outcome; the review".) Say it once more.

286.3 la hausse — the rise, the increase

Before the new one: say the French for the poll, then the French for the final count.

You'll want to know: la hausse

la hausse — "the rise, the increase".

Les prix sont en hausse.

Prices are going up.

En hausse — going up.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hausse is built on *hausser* "to raise" (EtymDB), which is inherited from Vulgar Latin *altiāre*, built on Latin *altus* "high".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la hausse*
- *Say it: la hausse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la hausse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the poll, then the French for the final count, then say *la hausse* again

Before you move on

What does la hausse mean? ("The rise, the increase".) Say it once more.

286.4 la baisse — the drop, the fall

Before the new one: say the French for the final count, then the French for the rise.

You'll want to know: la baisse

la baisse — "the drop, the fall".

Le nombre de touristes est en baisse.

The number of tourists is falling.

En baisse — going down; the verb is *baisser*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

baisse is built on *baisser* "to lower", inherited from Vulgar Latin *bassiāre*, built on Late Latin *bassus* "low" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la baisse*
- *Say it: la baisse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la baisse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the final count, then the French for the rise, then say *la baisse* again

Before you move on

What does la baisse mean? (“The drop, the fall”.) Say it once more.

286.5 la statistique — the statistic; statistics

Before the new one: say the French for the rise, then the French for the drop.

You’ll want to know: la statistique

la statistique — “the statistic; statistics”.

Les statistiques montrent une baisse des accidents.

The statistics show a fall in accidents.

Plural in the sense of figures; *la statistique* is also the field of study.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

statistique was borrowed from German *Statistik* (EtymDB), built on Latin *status* “state”, from *stāre* “to stand”: first the science of the state.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la statistique*
- *Say it: la statistique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la statistique*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rise, then the French for the drop, then say *la statistique* again

Before you move on

What does la statistique mean? (“The statistic; statistics”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 287

Le cambriolage

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell the story of a burglary: breaking in, the burglar, the burglary, the forced entry and the loot.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 287: I can tell the story of a burglary: breaking in, the burglar, the burglary, the forced entry and the loot.*

287.1 cambrioler — to burgle, to break into

> Before the new one: say the French for the drop, then the French for the statistic.

You'll want to know: cambrioler

cambrioler — "to burgle, to break into".

> Quelqu'un a cambriolé la maison pendant les vacances.
>
> *Someone burgled the house during the holidays.*

Said of a place, not a person: *cambrioler un appartement.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cambrioler is built on the old slang word *cambriole* "a small room", usually traced to Provençal *cambro* "room", which goes back to Latin *camera* "a vault" (Lewis & Short); EtymDB lists the verb without a

parent.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: cambrioler*
- *Say it: cambrioler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *cambrioler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the drop, then the French for the statistic, then say *cambrioler* again

Before you move on

What does cambrioler mean? ("To burgle, to break into".) Say it once more.

287.2 le cambrioleur — the burglar

Before the new one: say the French for the statistic, then the French for to burgle.

You'll want to know: le cambrioleur

le cambrioleur — "the burglar".

Le cambrioleur est entré par la fenêtre.

The burglar got in through the window.

Feminine: *la cambrioleuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cambrioleur is built on *cambrioler* "to burgle" with the agent suffix *-eur* (EtymDB); the verb goes back to slang *cambriole* "a small room".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cambrioleur*
- *Say it: le cambrioleur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cambrioleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the statistic, then the French for to burgle, then say *le cambrioleur* again

Before you move on

What does le cambrioleur mean? ("The burglar".) Say it once more.

287.3 le cambriolage — the burglary, the break-in

Before the new one: say the French for to burgle, then the French for the burglar.

You'll want to know: le cambriolage

le cambriolage — "the burglary, the break-in".

> Le cambriolage a eu lieu pendant la nuit.
>
> *The burglary took place during the night.*

Said of a home, a shop or an office.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cambriolage is built on *cambrioler* "to burgle" with the noun suffix *-age* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cambriolage*
- *Say it: le cambriolage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cambriolage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to burgle, then the French for the burglar, then say *le cambriolage* again

Before you move on

What does le cambriolage mean? ("The burglary, the break-in".) Say it once more.

287.4 l'effraction — the forced entry, breaking in

Before the new one: say the French for the burglar, then the French for the burglary.

You'll want to know: l'effraction

l'effraction — "the forced entry, breaking in".

La police n'a trouvé aucune trace d'effraction.

The police found no sign of a forced entry.

Entrer par effraction — to break in.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

effraction is a learned word built on Latin *effractus*, the past participle of *effringere* "to break open", from *ex* and *frangere* "to break" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'effraction*
- *Say it: l'effraction*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'effraction*
- *Recall:* say the French for the burglar, then the French for the burglary, then say *l'effraction* again

Before you move on

What does l'effraction mean? ("The forced entry, breaking in".) Say it once more.

287.5 le butin — the loot, the haul

Before the new one: say the French for the burglary, then the French for the forced entry.

You'll want to know: le butin

le butin — "the loot, the haul".

Le butin était caché dans une valise.

The loot was hidden in a suitcase.

Also the haul of a happy day: *le butin des soldes*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

butin comes from Old French *butin* "booty" (EtymDB), which is usually traced to Middle Low German *būte* "exchange, a share of booty".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le butin*
- *Say it: le butin*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le butin*
- *Recall:* say the French for the burglary, then the French for the forced entry, then say *le butin* again

Before you move on

What does le butin mean? (“The loot, the haul”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 288

Attention aux escrocs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about thieves and tricksters: pickpockets, scams, con artists, swindling and fraud.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 288: I can talk about thieves and tricksters: pickpockets, scams, con artists, swindling and fraud.*

288.1 le pickpocket — the pickpocket

> Before the new one: say the French for the forced entry, then the French for the loot.

You'll want to know: le pickpocket

le pickpocket — "the pickpocket".

> Un pickpocket m'a pris mon téléphone dans le métro.
>
> *A pickpocket took my phone on the underground.*

Borrowed from English. Signs warn: *attention aux pickpockets*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pickpocket was borrowed from English *pickpocket* (EtymDB), one who picks pockets.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pickpocket*
- *Say it: le pickpocket*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pickpocket*
- *Recall:* say the French for the forced entry, then the French for the loot, then say *le pickpocket* again

Before you move on

What does le pickpocket mean? ("The pickpocket".) Say it once more.

288.2 l'arnaque — the scam, the rip-off (informal)

Before the new one: say the French for the loot, then the French for the pickpocket.

You'll want to know: l'arnaque

l'arnaque — "the scam, the rip-off (informal)".

Ce restaurant est une vraie arnaque.

This restaurant is a real rip-off.

Informal. The verb is *arnaquer*, to rip off.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arnaque is built on the slang verb *arnaquer* "to rip off" (EtymDB); the origin of the verb is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arnaque*
- *Say it: l'arnaque*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'arnaque*
- *Recall:* say the French for the loot, then the French for the pickpocket, then say *l'arnaque* again

Before you move on

What does l'arnaque mean? ("The scam, the rip-off (informal)".) Say it once more.

288.3 l'escroc — the swindler, the con artist

Before the new one: say the French for the pickpocket, then the French for the scam.

You'll want to know: l'escroc

l'escroc — "the swindler, the con artist".

L'escroc se faisait passer pour un policier.

The con artist was passing himself off as a police officer.

The final *c* is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

escroc was borrowed from Italian *scrocco* "sponging, living at others' cost" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'escroc*
- *Say it: l'escroc*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'escroc*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pickpocket, then the French for the scam, then say *l'escroc* again

Before you move on

What does l'escroc mean? ("The swindler, the con artist".) Say it once more.

288.4 escroquer — to swindle, to con

Before the new one: say the French for the scam, then the French for the swindler.

You'll want to know: escroquer

escroquer — "to swindle, to con".

Il a escroqué des personnes âgées.

He swindled elderly people.

Escroquer quelqu'un de cent euros — to con someone out of a hundred euros.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

escroquer was borrowed from Italian *scroccare* "to sponge, to get by trickery" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *escroquer*
- *Say it:* *escroquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *escroquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the scam, then the French for the swindler, then say *escroquer* again

Before you move on

What does escroquer mean? (“To swindle, to con”.) Say it once more.

288.5 l’escroquerie — the fraud, the swindle

Before the new one: say the French for the swindler, then the French for to swindle.

You’ll want to know: l’escroquerie

l’escroquerie — “the fraud, the swindle”.

Il a été arrêté pour escroquerie.

He was arrested for fraud.

The formal and legal word; *l’arnaque* is the everyday one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

escroquerie is built on *escroquer* “to swindle” (EtymDB), which was borrowed from Italian *scroccare*.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'escroquerie*
- *Say it: l'escroquerie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'escroquerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the swindler, then the French for to swindle, then say *l'escroquerie* again

Before you move on

What does l'escroquerie mean? ("The fraud, the swindle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 289

Une agression

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can report an attack: the assault, attacking, the attacker, threatening and a threat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 289: I can report an attack: the assault, attacking, the attacker, threatening and a threat.*

289.1 l'agression — the attack, the assault

> Before the new one: say the French for to swindle, then the French for the fraud.

You'll want to know: l'agression

l'agression — "the attack, the assault".

> Une agression a eu lieu près du marché.
>
> *An assault took place near the market.*

An attack on a person. A hostile mood is *l'agressivité*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agression is a learned borrowing from Latin *aggressiō* "a going towards", from *aggredī* "to approach, to attack", built on *gradī* "to step" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'agression*
- *Say it: l'agression*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'agression*
- *Recall:* say the French for to swindle, then the French for the fraud, then say *l'agression* again

Before you move on

What does l'agression mean? ("The attack, the assault".) Say it once more.

289.2 agresser — to attack, to assault

Before the new one: say the French for the fraud, then the French for the attack.

You'll want to know: agresser

agresser — "to attack, to assault".

Deux hommes ont agressé un jeune homme dans la rue.

Two men attacked a young man in the street.

Also figuratively: *ce bruit m'agresse* — this noise gets to me.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agresser is formed on the stem of *agression*, a learned borrowing from Latin *aggressiō*, from *aggredī* "to attack" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: agresser*
- *Say it: agresser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *agresser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fraud, then the French for the attack, then say *agresser* again

Before you move on

What does agresser mean? ("To attack, to assault".) Say it once more.

289.3 l'agresseur — the attacker, the assailant

Before the new one: say the French for the attack, then the French for to attack.

You'll want to know: l'agresseur

l'agresseur — "the attacker, the assailant".

L'agresseur est parti en courant.

The attacker ran off.

In news reports the attacker is often unnamed: *un agresseur inconnu*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agresseur is a learned borrowing from Latin *aggressor* "an attacker", from *aggredī* "to attack" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'agresseur*
- *Say it: l'agresseur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'agresseur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the attack, then the French for to attack, then say *l'agresseur* again

Before you move on

What does l'agresseur mean? ("The attacker, the assailant".) Say it once more.

289.4 menacer — to threaten

Before the new one: say the French for to attack, then the French for the attacker.

You'll want to know: menacer

menacer — "to threaten".

Il a menacé le vendeur avec un couteau.

He threatened the shop assistant with a knife.

Menacer de + infinitive: *il a menacé de partir.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

menacer is inherited from Vulgar Latin *mināciāre* "to threaten" (EtymDB), built on Latin *mināx* "threatening".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: menacer*
- *Say it: menacer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *menacer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to attack, then the French for the attacker, then say *menacer* again

Before you move on

What does menacer mean? (“To threaten”.) Say it once more.

289.5 la menace — the threat

Before the new one: say the French for the attacker, then the French for to threaten.

You’ll want to know: la menace

la menace — “the threat”.

Elle a reçu des menaces au téléphone.

She got threats over the phone.

Une menace de mort — a death threat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

menace is inherited from Vulgar Latin *minācia* “a threat” (EtymDB), built on Latin *mināx* “threatening”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la menace*
- *Say it:* *la menace*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la menace*
- *Recall:* say the French for the attacker, then the French for to threaten, then say *la menace* again

Before you move on

What does la menace mean? (“The threat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 290

Le crime

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about serious crime: a crime, a criminal, a murder, a young offender and crime in general.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 290: I can talk about serious crime: a crime, a criminal, a murder, a young offender and crime in general.*

290.1 le crime — the crime; the murder

> Before the new one: say the French for to threaten, then the French for the threat.

You'll want to know: le crime

le crime — "the crime; the murder".

> Ce crime a choqué toute la ville.
>
> *This crime shocked the whole town.*

In French, *un crime* is a serious offence, often a murder.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crime is inherited from Latin *crīmen* "a charge, a crime" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le crime*
- *Say it: le crime*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le crime*
- *Recall:* say the French for to threaten, then the French for the threat, then say *le crime* again

Before you move on

What does le crime mean? ("The crime; the murder".) Say it once more.

290.2 le criminel — the criminal

Before the new one: say the French for the threat, then the French for the crime.

You'll want to know: le criminel

le criminel — "the criminal".

Le criminel a été arrêté deux jours plus tard.

The criminal was arrested two days later.

Also an adjective: *un acte criminel*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

criminel is a learned borrowing from Latin *crīminālis* (EtymDB), built on *crīmen* "a charge, a crime".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le criminel*
- *Say it: le criminel*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le criminel*
- *Recall:* say the French for the threat, then the French for the crime, then say *le criminel* again

Before you move on

What does le criminel mean? ("The criminal".) Say it once more.

290.3 le meurtre — the murder

Before the new one: say the French for the crime, then the French for the criminal.

You'll want to know: le meurtre

le meurtre — "the murder".

Le roman raconte l'histoire d'un meurtre.

The novel tells the story of a murder.

The killer is *le meurtrier*, *la meurtrière*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

meurtre is built on Old French *murtrir* "to murder", which is usually traced to a Frankish verb related to English *murder* (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le meurtre*
- *Say it: le meurtre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le meurtre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the crime, then the French for the criminal, then say *le meurtre* again

Before you move on

What does le meurtre mean? ("The murder".) Say it once more.

290.4 le délinquant — the offender, the delinquent

Before the new one: say the French for the criminal, then the French for the murder.

You'll want to know: le délinquant

le délinquant — "the offender, the delinquent".

Le juge a parlé avec le jeune délinquant.

The judge spoke with the young offender.

Un délinquant mineur — a young offender.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

délinquant is a learned word from Latin *dēlinquēns*, the present participle of *dēlinquere* "to fail, to do wrong" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le délinquant*
- *Say it: le délinquant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le délinquant*
- *Recall:* say the French for the criminal, then the French for the murder, then say *le délinquant* again

Before you move on

What does le délinquant mean? ("The offender, the delinquent".) Say it once more.

290.5 la délinquance — crime, delinquency

Before the new one: say the French for the murder, then the French for the offender.

You'll want to know: la délinquance

la délinquance — "crime, delinquency".

La délinquance a baissé dans le quartier.

Crime has gone down in the neighbourhood.

Crime in general, as a problem of society.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

délinquance is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *dēlinquentia* (EtymDB), from *dēlinquere* "to do wrong".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la délinquance*
- *Say it: la délinquance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la délinquance*
- *Recall:* say the French for the murder, then the French for the offender, then say *la délinquance* again

Before you move on

What does la délinquance mean? ("Crime, delinquency".) Say it once more.

Chapter 291

Les gendarmes

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the police on patrol: the gendarme, the gendarmerie, patrolling, a patrol and a squad.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 291: I can talk about the police on patrol: the gendarme, the gendarmerie, patrolling, a patrol and a squad.*

291.1 le gendarme — the gendarme

> Before the new one: say the French for the offender, then the French for crime.

You'll want to know: le gendarme

le gendarme — "the gendarme".

> Les gendarmes ont arrêté la voiture sur la route.
>
> *The gendarmes stopped the car on the road.*

In France, *les gendarmes* are soldiers who do police work, mostly outside big towns; *les policiers* work in the cities.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gendarme comes from *gens d'armes* "men of arms" (EtymDB lists the word without a parent): *gens* goes back to Latin *gēns* "a people, a

clan" and *armes* to Latin *arma* "weapons" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gendarme*
- *Say it: le gendarme*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le gendarme*
- *Recall:* say the French for the offender, then the French for crime, then say *le gendarme* again

Before you move on

What does le gendarme mean? ("The gendarme".) Say it once more.

291.2 la gendarmerie — the gendarmerie; its offices

Before the new one: say the French for crime, then the French for the gendarme.

You'll want to know: la gendarmerie

la gendarmerie — "the gendarmerie; its offices".

Elle a perdu son sac et elle a appelé la gendarmerie.

She lost her bag and called the gendarmerie.

Both the force and the building.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gendarmerie is built on *gendarme* (EtymDB), from *gens d'armes* "men of arms".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gendarmerie*
- *Say it: la gendarmerie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la gendarmerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for crime, then the French for the gendarme, then say *la gendarmerie* again

Before you move on

What does la gendarmerie mean? ("The gendarmerie; its offices".) Say it once more.

291.3 patrouiller — to patrol

Before the new one: say the French for the gendarme, then the French for the gendarmerie.

You'll want to know: patrouiller

patrouiller — "to patrol".

Des policiers patrouillent dans le parc la nuit.

Police officers patrol the park at night.

Patrouiller dans un quartier — to patrol a neighbourhood.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

patrouiller comes from Old French *patrouiller* "to paddle about, to tramp in mud" (EtymDB), built on *patte* "paw", whose origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: patrouiller*
- *Say it: patrouiller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *patrouiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for the gendarme, then the French for the gendarmerie, then say *patrouiller* again

Before you move on

What does patrouiller mean? ("To patrol".) Say it once more.

291.4 la patrouille — the patrol

Before the new one: say the French for the gendarmerie, then the French for to patrol.

You'll want to know: la patrouille

la patrouille — "the patrol".

Une patrouille passe dans la rue toutes les heures.

A patrol goes down the street every hour.

En patrouille — on patrol.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

patrouille comes from Old French *patrouille* (EtymDB), built on *patrouiller* "to tramp about".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la patrouille*
- *Say it: la patrouille*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la patrouille*
- *Recall:* say the French for the gendarmerie, then the French for to patrol, then say *la patrouille* again

Before you move on

What does la patrouille mean? ("The patrol".) Say it once more.

291.5 la brigade — the squad, the brigade

Before the new one: say the French for to patrol, then the French for the patrol.

You'll want to know: la brigade

la brigade — "the squad, the brigade".

Une brigade de police est arrivée en dix minutes.

A police squad arrived in ten minutes.

La brigade des stupéfiants — the drug squad.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brigade was borrowed from Italian *brigata* "a troop, a company" (EtymDB), built on *briga* "strife, trouble".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la brigade*
- *Say it: la brigade*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la brigade*
- *Recall:* say the French for to patrol, then the French for the patrol, then say *la brigade* again

Before you move on

What does la brigade mean? ("The squad, the brigade".) Say it once more.

291.6 Retour sur les chapitres 284–291

Say the French for to reveal and to report.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to reveal, to report, to deny, to recount, to comment on
- the rumour, the scoop, disinformation, censorship, the controversy
- the poll, the final count, the rise, the drop, the statistic
- to burgle, the burglar, the burglary, the forced entry, the loot
- the pickpocket, the scam, the swindler, to swindle, the fraud
- the attack, to attack, the attacker, to threaten, the threat
- the crime, the criminal, the murder, the offender, crime
- the gendarme, the gendarmerie, to patrol, the patrol, the squad

Before you move on

To reveal? (**révéler**.) To report? (**rapporter**.) To deny? (**démentir**.) To recount? (**relater**.) To comment on?

(**commenter**.) The rumour? (**la rumeur**.) The scoop? (**le scoop**.) Disinformation? (**la désinformation**.) Censorship? (**la censure**.) The controversy? (**la polémique**.) The poll? (**le sondage**.) The final count? (**le bilan**.) The rise? (**la hausse**.) The drop? (**la baisse**.) The statistic? (**la statistique**.) To burgle? (**cambrioler**.) The burglar? (**le cambrioleur**.) The burglary? (**le cambriolage**.) The forced entry? (**l'effraction**.) The loot? (**le butin**.) The pickpocket? (**le pickpocket**.) The scam? (**l'arnaque**.) The swindler? (**l'escroc**.) To swindle? (**escroquer**.) The fraud? (**l'escroquerie**.) The attack? (**l'agression**.) To attack? (**agresser**.) The attacker? (**l'agresseur**.) To threaten? (**menacer**.) The threat? (**la menace**.) The crime? (**le crime**.) The criminal? (**le criminel**.) The murder? (**le meurtre**.) The offender? (**le délinquant**.) Crime? (**la délinquance**.) The gendarme? (**le gendarme**.) The gendarmerie? (**la gendarmerie**.) To patrol? (**patrouiller**.) The patrol? (**la patrouille**.) The squad? (**la brigade**.)

Chapter 292

Les enquêteurs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the people who look into a crime and what they find: the investigator, the inspector, the detective, a clue and a print.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 292: I can talk about the people who look into a crime and what they find: the investigator, the inspector, the detective, a clue and a print.*

292.1 l'enquêteur — the investigator

> Before the new one: say the French for the patrol, then the French for the squad.

You'll want to know: l'enquêteur

l'enquêteur — "the investigator".

> Les enquêteurs ont parlé avec les voisins.
>
> *The investigators talked to the neighbours.*

Feminine: *l'enquêtrice*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enquêteur is built on the noun for "an inquiry", which is inherited from Latin *inquīsīta* "things sought", from *inquīrere* "to seek into", built on

quaerere “to seek” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’enquêteur*
- *Say it: l’enquêteur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l’enquêteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the patrol, then the French for the squad, then say *l’enquêteur* again

Before you move on

What does l’enquêteur mean? (“The investigator”.) Say it once more.

292.2 l’inspecteur — the inspector, the police inspector

Before the new one: say the French for the squad, then the French for the investigator.

You’ll want to know: l’inspecteur

l’inspecteur — “the inspector, the police inspector”.

L’inspecteur a posé beaucoup de questions.

The inspector asked a lot of questions.

Also at school or at work: *un inspecteur des impôts* — a tax inspector.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inspecteur is a learned borrowing from Latin *īnspector* “examiner”, from *īnspicere* “to look into” (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'inspecteur*
- *Say it: l'inspecteur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'inspecteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the squad, then the French for the investigator, then say *l'inspecteur* again

Before you move on

What does l'inspecteur mean? ("The inspector, the police inspector".) Say it once more.

292.3 le détective — the private detective

Before the new one: say the French for the investigator, then the French for the inspector.

You'll want to know: le détective

le détective — "the private detective".

Il lit des romans de détectives.

He reads detective novels.

Un détective privé works for clients; police officers are *inspecteurs* or *enquêteurs*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

détective is usually traced to English *detective* (EtymDB lists no parent), which is built on Latin *dētēctus*, from *dētegere* "to uncover" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le détective*
- *Say it: le détective*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le détective*
- *Recall:* say the French for the investigator, then the French for the inspector, then say *le détective* again

Before you move on

What does le détective mean? ("The private detective".) Say it once more.

292.4 l'indice — the clue; the index, the rating

Before the new one: say the French for the inspector, then the French for the private detective.

You'll want to know: l'indice

l'indice — "the clue; the index, the rating".

Le détective a trouvé un indice important.

The detective found an important clue.

Also a number on a scale: *l'indice des prix*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

indice is a learned borrowing from Latin *indicium* "a sign, a proof" (EtymDB), built on *index* "pointer, sign".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'indice*
- *Say it: l'indice*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'indice*
- *Recall:* say the French for the inspector, then the French for the private detective, then say *l'indice* again

Before you move on

What does l'indice mean? ("The clue; the index, the rating".) Say it once more.

292.5 l'empreinte — the print, the fingerprint

Before the new one: say the French for the private detective, then the French for the clue.

You'll want to know: l'empreinte

l'empreinte — "the print, the fingerprint".

Il y avait des empreintes sur le verre.

There were prints on the glass.

Les empreintes digitales — fingerprints; *l'empreinte carbone* — the carbon footprint.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

empreinte is the past participle of Old French *empreindre* "to press in", which is inherited from Latin *imprimere* "to press into" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'empreinte*
- *Say it: l'empreinte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'empreinte*
- *Recall:* say the French for the private detective, then the French for the clue, then say *l'empreinte* again

Before you move on

What does l'empreinte mean? ("The print, the fingerprint".) Say it once more.

Chapter 293

Un mystère

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about solving a case: a mystery, clearing it up, proving something, an alibi and a suspicion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 293: I can talk about solving a case: a mystery, clearing it up, proving something, an alibi and a suspicion.*

293.1 le mystère — the mystery

> Before the new one: say the French for the clue, then the French for the print.

You'll want to know: le mystère

le mystère — "the mystery".

> Personne ne sait où est le tableau: c'est un mystère.
>
> *Nobody knows where the painting is: it is a mystery.*

The adjective is *mystérieux*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mystère is a learned borrowing from Latin *mystērium*, from Greek *mustḗrion* "a secret rite" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mystère*
- *Say it: le mystère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le mystère*
- *Recall:* say the French for the clue, then the French for the print, then say *le mystère* again

Before you move on

What does le mystère mean? ("The mystery".) Say it once more.

293.2 élucider — to solve, to clear up

Before the new one: say the French for the print, then the French for the mystery.

You'll want to know: élucider

élucider — "to solve, to clear up".

La police n'a jamais élucidé ce crime.

The police never solved this crime.

Formal; in speech, *résoudre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

élucider is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *ēlūcidāre* "to make clear" (EtymDB), built on *lūx* "light".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *élucider*
- *Say it:* *élucider*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *élucider*
- *Recall:* say the French for the print, then the French for the mystery, then say *élucider* again

Before you move on

What does élucider mean? (“To solve, to clear up”.) Say it once more.

293.3 prouver — to prove

Before the new one: say the French for the mystery, then the French for to solve.

You’ll want to know: prouver

prouver — “to prove”.

Il ne peut pas prouver qu’il était chez lui.

He cannot prove that he was at home.

Prouver que + indicative.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prouver is inherited from Latin *probāre* “to test, to prove, to approve” (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: prouver*
- *Say it: prouver*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *prouver*
- *Recall:* say the French for the mystery, then the French for to solve, then say *prouver* again

Before you move on

What does prouver mean? ("To prove".) Say it once more.

293.4 l'alibi — the alibi

Before the new one: say the French for to solve, then the French for to prove.

You'll want to know: l'alibi

l'alibi — "the alibi".

Son alibi est solide: il était au cinéma.

His alibi is solid: he was at the cinema.

Also an excuse: *un bon alibi pour ne pas venir.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

alibi was borrowed from Latin *alibī* "elsewhere" (EtymDB), built on *alius* "other".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'alibi*
- *Say it: l'alibi*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'alibi*
- *Recall:* say the French for to solve, then the French for to prove, then say *l'alibi* again

Before you move on

What does l'alibi mean? ("The alibi".) Say it once more.

293.5 le soupçon — the suspicion; a hint

Before the new one: say the French for to prove, then the French for the alibi.

You'll want to know: le soupçon

le soupçon — "the suspicion; a hint".

La police a des soupçons sur le voisin.

The police have suspicions about the neighbour.

Un soupçon de sel — a hint of salt.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soupçon is inherited from Late Latin *suspectiō* "suspicion" (EtymDB), from *suspicere* "to look up at, to suspect".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le soupçon*
- *Say it: le soupçon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le soupçon*
- *Recall:* say the French for to prove, then the French for the alibi, then say *le soupçon* again

Before you move on

What does le soupçon mean? (“The suspicion; a hint”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 294

L'arrestation

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe an arrest: stopping someone, the arrest, handcuffs, police custody and questioning.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 294: I can describe an arrest: stopping someone, the arrest, handcuffs, police custody and questioning.*

294.1 interpeller — to stop and question (police); to call out to

> Before the new one: say the French for the alibi, then the French for the suspicion.

You'll want to know: interpeller

interpeller — "to stop and question (police); to call out to".

> La police a interpellé deux jeunes hommes.
>
> *The police stopped two young men for questioning.*

In the news, *interpeller* means the police took someone in. In the street, it means to call out to someone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interpeller is a learned borrowing from Latin *interpellāre* "to interrupt, to address" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: interpeller*
- *Say it: interpeller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *interpeller*
- *Recall:* say the French for the alibi, then the French for the suspicion, then say *interpeller* again

Before you move on

What does interpeller mean? ("To stop and question (police); to call out to".) Say it once more.

294.2 l'arrestation — the arrest

Before the new one: say the French for the suspicion, then the French for to stop and question.

You'll want to know: l'arrestation

l'arrestation — "the arrest".

L'arrestation a eu lieu tôt le matin.

The arrest took place early in the morning.

The verb is *arrêter*: *il a été arrêté.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrestation comes from Medieval Latin *arrestātiō* (EtymDB), built on *arrestāre* "to stop", from *ad* and *restāre* "to stay back" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arrestation*
- *Say it: l'arrestation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'arrestation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the suspicion, then the French for to stop and question, then say *l'arrestation* again

Before you move on

What does l'arrestation mean? ("The arrest".) Say it once more.

294.3 les menottes — the handcuffs

Before the new one: say the French for to stop and question, then the French for the arrest.

You'll want to know: les menottes

les menottes — "the handcuffs".

Le policier lui a mis les menottes.

The police officer put the handcuffs on him.

Literally 'little hands', from *main*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

menottes is a diminutive of *main* "hand", which is inherited from Latin *manus* "hand" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les menottes*
- *Say it: les menottes*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les menottes*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stop and question, then the French for the arrest, then say *les menottes* again

Before you move on

What does les menottes mean? ("The handcuffs".) Say it once more.

294.4 la garde à vue — police custody

Before the new one: say the French for the arrest, then the French for the handcuffs.

You'll want to know: la garde à vue

la garde à vue — "police custody".

Le jeune homme a passé la nuit en garde à vue.

The young man spent the night in police custody.

Être placé en garde à vue — to be held for questioning.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

garde comes from *garder* "to keep, to watch", from a Frankish verb *wardōn* (EtymDB); *vue* is built on *voir*, from Latin *vidēre* "to see": kept in sight.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la garde à vue*
- *Say it: la garde à vue*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la garde à vue*
- *Recall:* say the French for the arrest, then the French for the handcuffs, then say *la garde à vue* again

Before you move on

What does la garde à vue mean? ("Police custody".) Say it once more.

294.5 interroger — to question, to interrogate

Before the new one: say the French for the handcuffs, then the French for police custody.

You'll want to know: interroger

interroger — "to question, to interrogate".

Les policiers l'ont interrogé pendant trois heures.

The police questioned him for three hours.

At school, *interroger un élève* — to test a pupil orally.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interroger is a learned borrowing from Latin *interrogāre* "to ask, to question" (EtymDB), built on *rogāre* "to ask".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *interroger*
- *Say it:* *interroger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *interroger*
- *Recall:* say the French for the handcuffs, then the French for police custody, then say *interroger* again

Before you move on

What does interroger mean? ("To question, to interrogate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 295

Les aveux

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that someone confessed, had an accomplice, was acquitted or was let go.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 295: I can say that someone confessed, had an accomplice, was acquitted or was let go.*

295.1 avouer — to confess, to admit

> Before the new one: say the French for police custody, then the French for to question.

You'll want to know: avouer

avouer — "to confess, to admit".

> Il a fini par avouer.
>
> *In the end he confessed.*

Je dois avouer que… — I must admit that…

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avouer is inherited through Old French *avoer* from Latin *advocāre* "to call to, to call upon" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: avouer*
- *Say it: avouer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *avouer*
- *Recall:* say the French for police custody, then the French for to question, then say *avouer* again

Before you move on

What does avouer mean? ("To confess, to admit".) Say it once more.

295.2 l'aveu — the confession, the avowal

Before the new one: say the French for to question, then the French for to confess.

You'll want to know: l'aveu

l'aveu — "the confession, the avowal".

Ses aveux ont surpris tout le monde.

His confession surprised everyone.

Often plural: *passer aux aveux* — to confess.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aveu is built on *avouer* "to confess", which is inherited from Latin *advocāre* "to call to" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aveu*
- *Say it: l'aveu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'aveu*
- *Recall:* say the French for to question, then the French for to confess, then say *l'aveu* again

Before you move on

What does l'aveu mean? ("The confession, the avowal".) Say it once more.

295.3 le complice — the accomplice

Before the new one: say the French for to confess, then the French for the confession.

You'll want to know: le complice

le complice — "the accomplice".

Il avait un complice qui l'attendait dans la voiture.

He had an accomplice who was waiting for him in the car.

Also an adjective: *un sourire complice* — a knowing smile.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

complice is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *complex*, *complicem* "partner, one folded in with" (EtymDB), built on *plicāre* "to fold".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le complice*
- *Say it: le complice*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le complice*
- *Recall:* say the French for to confess, then the French for the confession, then say *le complice* again

Before you move on

What does le complice mean? ("The accomplice".) Say it once more.

295.4 acquitter — to acquit; to pay off

Before the new one: say the French for the confession, then the French for the accomplice.

You'll want to know: acquitter

acquitter — "to acquit; to pay off".

Le tribunal a acquitté le jeune homme.

The court acquitted the young man.

Also to pay a debt: *s'acquitter d'une dette.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

acquitter is built on *quitte* "free of debt", which comes from Medieval Latin *quitus*, from Latin *quiētus* "at rest" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: acquitter*
- *Say it: acquitter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *acquitter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the confession, then the French for the accomplice, then say *acquitter* again

Before you move on

What does acquitter mean? ("To acquit; to pay off".) Say it once more.

295.5 relâcher — to release, to let go; to loosen

Before the new one: say the French for the accomplice, then the French for to acquit.

You'll want to know: relâcher

relâcher — "to release, to let go; to loosen".

La police l'a relâché le lendemain.

The police let him go the next day.

Relâcher ses efforts — to slacken off.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

relâcher is inherited through Old French *relaschier* (EtymDB) from Latin *relaxāre* "to loosen" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *relâcher*
- *Say it:* *relâcher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *relâcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the accomplice, then the French for to acquit, then say *relâcher* again

Before you move on

What does relâcher mean? (“To release, to let go; to loosen”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 296

Le braquage

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell the story of a hold-up: the armed robbery, the robbers, a hostage, a ransom and an escape.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 296: I can tell the story of a hold-up: the armed robbery, the robbers, a hostage, a ransom and an escape.*

296.1 le braquage — the armed robbery, the hold-up

> Before the new one: say the French for to acquit, then the French for to release.

You'll want to know: le braquage

le braquage — "the armed robbery, the hold-up".

> Le braquage de la banque a duré dix minutes.
>
> *The bank robbery lasted ten minutes.*

Informal but frequent in the news.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

braquage is built with *-age* on the verb meaning "to aim, to point (a gun)"; the origin of that verb is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le braquage*
- *Say it: le braquage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le braquage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to acquit, then the French for to release, then say *le braquage* again

Before you move on

What does le braquage mean? ("The armed robbery, the hold-up".) Say it once more.

296.2 le braqueur — the armed robber

Before the new one: say the French for to release, then the French for the armed robbery.

You'll want to know: le braqueur

le braqueur — "the armed robber".

Les braqueurs sont partis avec l'argent.

The robbers left with the money.

Feminine: *la braqueuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

braqueur is built with the agent suffix *-eur* on the verb meaning "to aim a gun"; the origin is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le braqueur*
- *Say it: le braqueur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le braqueur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to release, then the French for the armed robbery, then say *le braqueur* again

Before you move on

What does le braqueur mean? ("The armed robber".) Say it once more.

296.3 l'otage — the hostage

Before the new one: say the French for the armed robbery, then the French for the armed robber.

You'll want to know: l'otage

l'otage — "the hostage".

Les braqueurs ont pris trois otages.

The robbers took three hostages.

Masculine even when the hostage is a woman: *un otage*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

otage comes from Old French *ostage*, usually traced to *oste* "guest, host", from Latin *hospes* (Lewis & Short): a guest held as a pledge. EtymDB lists no parent.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'otage*
- *Say it: l'otage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'otage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the armed robbery, then the French for the armed robber, then say *l'otage* again

Before you move on

What does l'otage mean? ("The hostage".) Say it once more.

296.4 la rançon — the ransom

Before the new one: say the French for the armed robber, then the French for the hostage.

You'll want to know: la rançon

la rançon — "the ransom".

La famille a payé une rançon.

The family paid a ransom.

La rançon du succès — the price of success.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rançon comes from Old French *rençon* (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *redēmptiō* "a buying back", from *redimere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rançon*
- *Say it: la rançon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rançon*
- *Recall:* say the French for the armed robber, then the French for the hostage, then say *la rançon* again

Before you move on

What does la rançon mean? ("The ransom".) Say it once more.

296.5 échapper — to escape; to slip from (one's hands)

Before the new one: say the French for the hostage, then the French for the ransom.

You'll want to know: échapper

échapper — "to escape; to slip from (one's hands)".

Un des braqueurs s'est échappé par le toit.

One of the robbers escaped over the roof.

Used both ways. With *se* for breaking out: *s'échapper de prison.* Without *se*, with *à*: *échapper à un danger* — to escape a danger.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échapper comes from Old French *eschaper* (EtymDB), usually traced to Vulgar Latin *excappāre* "to slip out of one's cloak", built on *cappa* "a cloak".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *échapper*
- *Say it:* *échapper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *échapper*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hostage, then the French for the ransom, then say *échapper* again

Before you move on

What does échapper mean? ("To escape; to slip from (one's hands)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 297

Accident de la route

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a road accident: a pile-up, a reckless driver, speeding, the accident report and a skid.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 297: I can describe a road accident: a pile-up, a reckless driver, speeding, the accident report and a skid.*

297.1 le carambolage — the pile-up, the multiple crash

Before the new one: say the French for the ransom, then the French for to escape.

You'll want to know: le carambolage

le carambolage — "the pile-up, the multiple crash".

> Il y a eu un carambolage sur l'autoroute ce matin.
>
> *There was a pile-up on the motorway this morning.*

A billiards word first: *caramboler* is to hit two balls in one shot.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carambolage is built on *caramboler* "to hit two balls at once", from *carambole*, the red ball in billiards, which was borrowed from Spanish *carambola* (EtymDB lists the noun without a parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le carambolage*
- *Say it: le carambolage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le carambolage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the ransom, then the French for to escape, then say *le carambolage* again

Before you move on

What does le carambolage mean? ("The pile-up, the multiple crash".) Say it once more.

297.2 le chauffard — the reckless driver, the road hog

Before the new one: say the French for to escape, then the French for the pile-up.

You'll want to know: le chauffard

le chauffard — "the reckless driver, the road hog".

Un chauffard a grillé le feu rouge.

A reckless driver went through the red light.

The suffix *-ard* adds a scornful sense. *Griller un feu* — to run a red light.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chauffard is built on *chauffeur* "driver" with the scornful suffix *-ard*; *chauffer* "to heat" is inherited from Latin *calefacere* "to make warm" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chauffard*
- *Say it: le chauffard*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chauffard*
- *Recall:* say the French for to escape, then the French for the pile-up, then say *le chauffard* again

Before you move on

What does le chauffard mean? ("The reckless driver, the road hog".) Say it once more.

297.3 l'excès de vitesse — speeding

Before the new one: say the French for the pile-up, then the French for the reckless driver.

You'll want to know: l'excès de vitesse

l'excès de vitesse — "speeding".

Il a payé une amende pour excès de vitesse.

He paid a fine for speeding.

Un excès de vitesse — a speeding offence.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

excès is a learned borrowing from Latin *excessus* "a going out, a going beyond", from *excēdere* (Lewis & Short); *vitesse* is built on *vite* "fast", whose origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'excès de vitesse*
- *Say it: l'excès de vitesse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'excès de vitesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pile-up, then the French for the reckless driver, then say *l'excès de vitesse* again

Before you move on

What does l'excès de vitesse mean? ("Speeding".) Say it once more.

297.4 le constat — the accident report (for insurance); a finding

Before the new one: say the French for the reckless driver, then the French for speeding.

You'll want to know: le constat

le constat — "the accident report (for insurance); a finding".

Les deux conducteurs ont rempli un constat.

The two drivers filled in an accident report.

Le constat amiable — the joint report that drivers fill in together.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

constat was borrowed from Latin *cōnstat* "it is established, it is agreed" (EtymDB), from *cōnstāre* "to stand firm".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le constat*
- *Say it: le constat*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le constat*
- *Recall:* say the French for the reckless driver, then the French for speeding, then say *le constat* again

Before you move on

What does le constat mean? ("The accident report (for insurance); a finding".) Say it once more.

297.5 le dérapage — the skid; a slip-up

Before the new one: say the French for speeding, then the French for the accident report.

You'll want to know: le dérapage

le dérapage — "the skid; a slip-up".

Sur la route mouillée, le camion a fait un dérapage.

On the wet road, the lorry went into a skid.

Also in politics: *un dérapage verbal* — an unfortunate remark.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dérapage is built on the verb meaning "to skid", which is usually traced to Provençal and to a Germanic root meaning "to snatch"; EtymDB lists no parent.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le dérapage*
- *Say it:* *le dérapage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le dérapage*
- *Recall:* say the French for speeding, then the French for the accident report, then say *le dérapage* again

Before you move on

What does le dérapage mean? ("The skid; a slip-up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 298

Le choc

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a crash: knocking someone over, an injured person, the shock, the airbag and a dent.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 298: I can describe a crash: knocking someone over, an injured person, the shock, the airbag and a dent.*

298.1 renverser — to knock over, to run over; to spill

Before the new one: say the French for the accident report, then the French for the skid.

You'll want to know: renverser

renverser — "to knock over, to run over; to spill".

> Une voiture a renversé un enfant à vélo.
>
> *A car knocked over a child on a bike.*

Also to spill: *renverser du café.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

renverser is built on Old French *enverser* "to turn upside down", from *envers* "reverse", which is inherited from Latin *inversus*, from *vertere* "to turn" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: renverser*
- *Say it: renverser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *renverser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the accident report, then the French for the skid, then say *renverser* again

Before you move on

What does renverser mean? ("To knock over, to run over; to spill".) Say it once more.

298.2 le blessé — the injured person, the casualty

Before the new one: say the French for the skid, then the French for to knock over.

You'll want to know: le blessé

le blessé — "the injured person, the casualty".

Les blessés ont été emmenés à l'hôpital.

The injured were taken to hospital.

Un blessé grave, *un blessé léger* — a seriously, a slightly injured person.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

blessé is the past participle of the verb meaning "to wound", which is usually traced to a Frankish word for "to bruise"; the origin is not fully settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le blessé*
- *Say it: le blessé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le blessé*
- *Recall:* say the French for the skid, then the French for to knock over, then say *le blessé* again

Before you move on

What does le blessé mean? ("The injured person, the casualty".) Say it once more.

298.3 le choc — the shock, the crash

Before the new one: say the French for to knock over, then the French for the injured person.

You'll want to know: le choc

le choc — "the shock, the crash".

Le choc a été très violent.

The crash was very violent.

Être en état de choc — to be in shock.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

choc is built on *choquer* "to strike against", which is usually traced to Middle Dutch *schokken* "to jolt" (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le choc*
- *Say it: le choc*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le choc*
- *Recall:* say the French for to knock over, then the French for the injured person, then say *le choc* again

Before you move on

What does le choc mean? ("The shock, the crash".) Say it once more.

298.4 l'airbag — the airbag

Before the new one: say the French for the injured person, then the French for the shock.

You'll want to know: l'airbag

l'airbag — "the airbag".

L'airbag s'est ouvert pendant le choc.

The airbag opened in the crash.

Official French says *le coussin gonflable*, the usual word in Québec.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

airbag was borrowed from English *airbag* (EtymDB), a bag filled with air.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'airbag*
- *Say it: l'airbag*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'airbag*
- *Recall:* say the French for the injured person, then the French for the shock, then say *l'airbag* again

Before you move on

What does l'airbag mean? ("The airbag".) Say it once more.

298.5 cabosser — to dent

Before the new one: say the French for the shock, then the French for the airbag.

You'll want to know: cabosser

cabosser — "to dent".

Le choc a cabossé la voiture.

The crash dented the car.

Une voiture toute cabossée — a car full of dents.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cabosser is usually linked to *bosse* "a bump"; the origin is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: cabosser*
- *Say it: cabosser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *cabosser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the shock, then the French for the airbag, then say *cabosser* again

Before you move on

What does cabosser mean? ("To dent".) Say it once more.

Chapter 299

Une mauvaise chute

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a fall and what it does: a fall, spraining something, a bruise, a large bruise and a wound.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 299: I can describe a fall and what it does: a fall, spraining something, a bruise, a large bruise and a wound.*

299.1 la chute — the fall; the drop

> Before the new one: say the French for the airbag, then the French for to dent.

You'll want to know: la chute

la chute — "the fall; the drop".

> Ma grand-mère a fait une chute dans l'escalier.
>
> *My grandmother had a fall on the stairs.*

Les chutes de neige — snowfalls; *une chute d'eau* — a waterfall.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chute is built on *chu*, the old past participle of *choir* "to fall" (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *cadere* "to fall" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chute*
- *Say it: la chute*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la chute*
- *Recall:* say the French for the airbag, then the French for to dent, then say *la chute* again

Before you move on

What does la chute mean? ("The fall; the drop".) Say it once more.

299.2 fouler — to sprain (as se fouler); to tread on

Before the new one: say the French for to dent, then the French for the fall.

You'll want to know: fouler

fouler — "to sprain (as se fouler); to tread on".

Il s'est foulé la cheville en courant.

He sprained his ankle while running.

In this sense mostly reflexive, with a body part: *se fouler le poignet.* Without *se*, it means to tread on or to press: *fouler le sol.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fouler is inherited through Old French *foler* "to crush, to trample" from a verb built on Latin *fullō* "a fuller", who trod cloth (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: fouler*
- *Say it: fouler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *fouler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dent, then the French for the fall, then say *fouler* again

Before you move on

What does fouler mean? ("To sprain (as se fouler); to tread on".) Say it once more.

299.3 la contusion — the bruise, the contusion

Before the new one: say the French for the fall, then the French for to sprain.

You'll want to know: la contusion

la contusion — "the bruise, the contusion".

Il a seulement quelques contusions.

He only has a few bruises.

Medical; in everyday French, *un bleu*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contusion is a learned borrowing from Latin *contūsiō* "a bruising" (EtymDB), from *contundere* "to beat, to bruise".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la contusion*
- *Say it: la contusion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la contusion*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fall, then the French for to sprain, then say *la contusion* again

Before you move on

What does la contusion mean? ("The bruise, the contusion".) Say it once more.

299.4 l'hématome — the haematoma, the large bruise

Before the new one: say the French for to sprain, then the French for the bruise.

You'll want to know: l'hématome

l'hématome — "the haematoma, the large bruise".

Elle a un gros hématome sur la jambe.

She has a big bruise on her leg.

Masculine: *un hématome*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hématome is a learned medical word built on Greek *haîma* "blood" with the suffix *-ōma* (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'hématome*
- *Say it: l'hématome*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'hématome*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sprain, then the French for the bruise, then say *l'hématome* again

Before you move on

What does l'hématome mean? ("The haematoma, the large bruise".) Say it once more.

299.5 la plaie — the wound, the cut

Before the new one: say the French for the bruise, then the French for the haematoma.

You'll want to know: la plaie

la plaie — "the wound, the cut".

L'infirmière a nettoyé la plaie.

The nurse cleaned the wound.

Informal: *quelle plaie !* — what a pain!

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plaie is inherited from Latin *plāga* "a blow, a wound" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plaie*
- *Say it: la plaie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la plaie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bruise, then the French for the haematoma, then say *la plaie* again

Before you move on

What does la plaie mean? (“The wound, the cut”.) Say it once more.

299.6 Retour sur les chapitres 292–299

Say the French for the investigator and the inspector.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the investigator, the inspector, the private detective, the clue, the print
- the mystery, to solve, to prove, the alibi, the suspicion
- to stop and question, the arrest, the handcuffs, police custody, to question
- to confess, the confession, the accomplice, to acquit, to release
- the armed robbery, the armed robber, the hostage, the ransom, to escape
- the pile-up, the reckless driver, speeding, the accident report, the skid
- to knock over, the injured person, the shock, the airbag, to dent
- the fall, to sprain, the bruise, the haematoma, the wound

Before you move on

The investigator? (**l'enquêteur**.) The inspector? (**l'inspecteur**.) The private detective? (**le détective**.) The clue? (**l'indice**.) The print? (**l'empreinte**.) The mystery? (**le mystère**.) To solve? (**élucider**.) To prove? (**prouver**.) The alibi? (**l'alibi**.) The suspicion? (**le soupçon**.) To stop and question? (**interpeller**.) The arrest? (**l'arrestation**.) The handcuffs? (**les menottes**.) Police custody? (**la garde à vue**.) To question? (**interroger**.) To confess? (**avouer**.) The confession? (**l'aveu**.) The accomplice? (**le complice**.) To acquit? (**acquitter**.) To release? (**relâcher**.) The armed robbery? (**le braquage**.) The armed robber? (**le braqueur**.) The hostage? (**l'otage**.) The ransom? (**la rançon**.) To escape? (**échapper**.) The pile-up? (**le carambolage**.) The reckless driver? (**le chauffard**.) Speeding? (**l'excès de vitesse**.) The accident report? (**le constat**.) The skid? (**le dérapage**.) To knock over? (**renverser**.) The injured person? (**le blessé**.) The shock? (**le choc**.) The airbag? (**l'airbag**.) To dent? (**cabosser**.) The fall? (**la chute**.) To sprain? (**fouler**.) The bruise? (**la contusion**.) The haematoma? (**l'hématome**.) The wound? (**la plaie**.)

Chapter 300

Les secours

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a rescue: the emergency services, coming to help, reviving someone, a tourniquet and a stretcher.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 300: I can describe a rescue: the emergency services, coming to help, reviving someone, a tourniquet and a stretcher.*

300.1 les secours — the emergency services, help

> Before the new one: say the French for the haematoma, then the French for the wound.

You'll want to know: les secours

les secours — "the emergency services, help".

> Les secours sont arrivés en dix minutes.
>
> *The emergency services arrived in ten minutes.*

Au secours ! — help! *Les premiers secours* — first aid.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

secours is inherited from Latin *succursus* "help" (EtymDB), from *succurrere* "to run to help".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les secours*
- *Say it: les secours*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les secours*
- *Recall:* say the French for the haematoma, then the French for the wound, then say *les secours* again

Before you move on

What does les secours mean? ("The emergency services, help".) Say it once more.

300.2 secourir — to rescue, to help

Before the new one: say the French for the wound, then the French for the emergency services.

You'll want to know: secourir

secourir — "to rescue, to help".

Des voisins ont secouru la vieille dame.

Neighbours helped the old lady.

Conjugated like *courir*: *il a secouru.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

secourir is inherited from Latin *succurrere* "to run to help", from *sub* and *currere* "to run" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: secourir*
- *Say it: secourir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *secourir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the wound, then the French for the emergency services, then say *secourir* again

Before you move on

What does secourir mean? ("To rescue, to help".) Say it once more.

300.3 réanimer — to resuscitate, to revive

Before the new one: say the French for the emergency services, then the French for to rescue.

You'll want to know: réanimer

réanimer — "to resuscitate, to revive".

Les pompiers ont réanimé l'homme.

The firefighters revived the man.

Le service de réanimation — intensive care.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réanimer is built on *animer*, a learned borrowing from Latin *animāre* "to give life", from *anima* "breath, life" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: réanimer*
- *Say it: réanimer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *réanimer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the emergency services, then the French for to rescue, then say *réanimer* again

Before you move on

What does réanimer mean? ("To resuscitate, to revive".) Say it once more.

300.4 le garrot — the tourniquet

Before the new one: say the French for to rescue, then the French for to resuscitate.

You'll want to know: le garrot

le garrot — "the tourniquet".

Un médecin a posé un garrot sur sa jambe.

A doctor put a tourniquet on his leg.

Also the withers of a horse.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *garrot* is not settled; it is sometimes linked to Provençal *garra* "leg" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le garrot*
- *Say it: le garrot*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le garrot*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rescue, then the French for to resuscitate, then say *le garrot* again

Before you move on

What does le garrot mean? (“The tourniquet”.) Say it once more.

300.5 la civière — the stretcher

Before the new one: say the French for to resuscitate, then the French for the tourniquet.

You’ll want to know: la civière

la civière — “the stretcher”.

Ils l’ont transporté sur une civière.

They carried him on a stretcher.

Carried by two people.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *civière* is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la civière*
- *Say it: la civière*, once more

- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la civière*
- *Recall:* say the French for to resuscitate, then the French for the tourniquet, then say *la civière* again

Before you move on

What does la civière mean? (“The stretcher”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 301

L'alerte

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe raising the alarm: an alert, alerting people, a defibrillator, an emergency exit and clearing a building.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 301: I can describe raising the alarm: an alert, alerting people, a defibrillator, an emergency exit and clearing a building.*

301.1 l'alerte — the alert, the alarm

> Before the new one: say the French for the tourniquet, then the French for the stretcher.

You'll want to know: l'alerte

l'alerte — "the alert, the alarm".

> L'alerte a été donnée à trois heures du matin.
>
> *The alarm was raised at three in the morning.*

Donner l'alerte — to raise the alarm; *une alerte à la bombe* — a bomb scare.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

alerte is usually traced to Italian *all'erta* "on the lookout, on the height" (EtymDB lists the French word without a parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'alerte*
- *Say it: l'alerte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'alerte*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tourniquet, then the French for the stretcher, then say *l'alerte* again

Before you move on

What does l'alerte mean? ("The alert, the alarm".) Say it once more.

301.2 alerter — to alert, to warn

Before the new one: say the French for the stretcher, then the French for the alert.

You'll want to know: alerter

alerter — "to alert, to warn".

Un voisin a alerté les pompiers.

A neighbour alerted the fire brigade.

Alerter la police — to call the police.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

alerter is built on *alerte* “alert” (EtymDB), which is usually traced to Italian *all’erta* “on the lookout”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: alerter*
- *Say it: alerter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *alerter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stretcher, then the French for the alert, then say *alerter* again

Before you move on

What does alerter mean? (“To alert, to warn”.) Say it once more.

301.3 le défibrillateur — the defibrillator

Before the new one: say the French for the alert, then the French for to alert.

You’ll want to know: le défibrillateur

le défibrillateur — “the defibrillator”.

Il y a un défibrillateur à l’entrée de la mairie.

There is a defibrillator at the entrance of the town hall.

Often in public places, in a box on the wall.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défibrillateur is a learned medical word built on *fibrillation*, from Latin *fibrilla* “a small fibre”, from *fibra* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le défibrillateur*
- *Say it: le défibrillateur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le défibrillateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the alert, then the French for to alert, then say *le défibrillateur* again

Before you move on

What does le défibrillateur mean? ("The defibrillator".) Say it once more.

301.4 la sortie de secours — the emergency exit

Before the new one: say the French for to alert, then the French for the defibrillator.

You'll want to know: la sortie de secours

la sortie de secours — "the emergency exit".

Les gens sont sortis par la sortie de secours.

People went out through the emergency exit.

Signs also say *issue de secours*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sortie is built on *sortir* "to go out", which is usually traced to Latin *sortīrī* "to draw lots" (Lewis & Short; EtymDB lists no parent); *secours* is inherited from Latin *succursus* "help".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sortie de secours*
- *Say it: la sortie de secours*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la sortie de secours*
- *Recall:* say the French for to alert, then the French for the defibrillator, then say *la sortie de secours* again

Before you move on

What does la sortie de secours mean? ("The emergency exit".) Say it once more.

301.5 évacuer — to evacuate, to clear

Before the new one: say the French for the defibrillator, then the French for the emergency exit.

You'll want to know: évacuer

évacuer — "to evacuate, to clear".

La police a évacué le bâtiment.

The police evacuated the building.

Also of water: *évacuer l'eau de pluie* — to drain away rainwater.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

évacuer is a learned borrowing from Latin *ēvacuāre* "to empty out" (EtymDB), built on *vacuus* "empty".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *évacuer*
- *Say it:* *évacuer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *évacuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the defibrillator, then the French for the emergency exit, then say *évacuer* again

Before you move on

What does évacuer mean? ("To evacuate, to clear".) Say it once more.

Chapter 302

Au feu !

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a fire and a blast: the blaze, the extinguisher, an explosion, blowing up and a spark.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 302: I can describe a fire and a blast: the blaze, the extinguisher, an explosion, blowing up and a spark.*

302.1 l'incendie — the fire, the blaze

> Before the new one: say the French for the emergency exit, then the French for to evacuate.

You'll want to know: l'incendie

l'incendie — "the fire, the blaze".

> Un incendie a brûlé trois maisons.
>
> *A fire burnt down three houses.*

A fire out of control is *un incendie*; a fire in a fireplace is *un feu*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

incendie is a learned borrowing from Latin *incendium* "a burning, a fire", from *incendere* "to set on fire" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'incendie*
- *Say it: l'incendie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'incendie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the emergency exit, then the French for to evacuate, then say *l'incendie* again

Before you move on

What does l'incendie mean? ("The fire, the blaze".) Say it once more.

302.2 l'extincteur — the fire extinguisher

Before the new one: say the French for to evacuate, then the French for the fire.

You'll want to know: l'extincteur

l'extincteur — "the fire extinguisher".

Le cuisinier a utilisé l'extincteur.

The cook used the fire extinguisher.

Masculine: *un extincteur.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

extincteur is a learned borrowing from Latin *exstinctor* "one who puts out" (EtymDB), from *exstinguere* "to put out".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'extincteur*
- *Say it: l'extincteur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'extincteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to evacuate, then the French for the fire, then say *l'extincteur* again

Before you move on

What does l'extincteur mean? ("The fire extinguisher".) Say it once more.

302.3 l'explosion — the explosion, the blast

Before the new one: say the French for the fire, then the French for the fire extinguisher.

You'll want to know: l'explosion

l'explosion — "the explosion, the blast".

On a entendu l'explosion à deux kilomètres.

People heard the blast two kilometres away.

Figurative: *une explosion de joie* — an outburst of joy.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

explosion is a learned borrowing from Latin *explōsiō* (EtymDB), from *explōdere* "to drive off by clapping", built on *plaudere* "to clap".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'explosion*
- *Say it: l'explosion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'explosion*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fire, then the French for the fire extinguisher, then say *l'explosion* again

Before you move on

What does l'explosion mean? ("The explosion, the blast".) Say it once more.

302.4 exploser — to explode, to blow up

Before the new one: say the French for the fire extinguisher, then the French for the explosion.

You'll want to know: exploser

exploser — "to explode, to blow up".

Une bouteille de gaz a explosé.

A gas bottle exploded.

Informal: *exploser de rire* — to burst out laughing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exploser is built on *explosion*, a learned borrowing from Latin *explōsiō*, from *explōdere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: exploser*
- *Say it: exploser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *exploser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fire extinguisher, then the French for the explosion, then say *exploser* again

Before you move on

What does exploser mean? ("To explode, to blow up".) Say it once more.

302.5 l'étincelle — the spark

Before the new one: say the French for the explosion, then the French for to explode.

You'll want to know: l'étincelle

l'étincelle — "the spark".

Une petite étincelle a suffi.

One small spark was enough.

Figurative too: *l'étincelle d'une idée.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étincelle is inherited from Vulgar Latin *stincilla* "spark" (EtymDB), an altered form of Latin *scintilla.*

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étincelle*
- *Say it: l'étincelle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'étincelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for the explosion, then the French for to explode, then say *l'étincelle* again

Before you move on

What does l'étincelle mean? ("The spark".) Say it once more.

Chapter 303

Quand la terre tremble

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about natural disasters: an earthquake, an avalanche, a rockfall, things caving in and the rubble.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 303: I can talk about natural disasters: an earthquake, an avalanche, a rockfall, things caving in and the rubble.*

303.1 le tremblement de terre — the earthquake

> Before the new one: say the French for to explode, then the French for the spark.

You'll want to know: le tremblement de terre

le tremblement de terre — "the earthquake".

> Le tremblement de terre a duré trente secondes.
>
> *The earthquake lasted thirty seconds.*

News reports also say *le séisme*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tremblement is built on *trembler*, inherited from Vulgar Latin *tremulāre*, built on Latin *tremulus* "trembling" (Lewis & Short); *terre* is inherited from Latin *terra* "earth" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tremblement de terre*
- *Say it: le tremblement de terre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le tremblement de terre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to explode, then the French for the spark, then say *le tremblement de terre* again

Before you move on

What does le tremblement de terre mean? ("The earthquake".) Say it once more.

303.2 l'avalanche — the avalanche

Before the new one: say the French for the spark, then the French for the earthquake.

You'll want to know: l'avalanche

l'avalanche — "the avalanche".

Une avalanche a fermé la route.

An avalanche closed the road.

Figurative: *une avalanche de lettres.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avalanche was borrowed from Franco-Provençal *avalançhe* (EtymDB), an Alpine word, shaped by *avaler* "to go down".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avalanche*
- *Say it: l'avalanche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'avalanche*
- *Recall:* say the French for the spark, then the French for the earthquake, then say *l'avalanche* again

Before you move on

What does l'avalanche mean? ("The avalanche".) Say it once more.

303.3 l'éboulement — the rockfall, the landslide

Before the new one: say the French for the earthquake, then the French for the avalanche.

You'll want to know: l'éboulement

l'éboulement — "the rockfall, the landslide".

Un éboulement a coupé la route de la montagne.

A rockfall cut off the mountain road.

Signs in the mountains warn: *chute de pierres.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éboulement is built on *ébouler* "to crumble down"; the origin of that verb is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éboulement*
- *Say it: l'éboulement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'éboulement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the earthquake, then the French for the avalanche, then say *l'éboulement* again

Before you move on

What does l'éboulement mean? ("The rockfall, the landslide".) Say it once more.

303.4 effondrer — to collapse, to cave in (as s'effondrer)

Before the new one: say the French for the avalanche, then the French for the rockfall.

You'll want to know: effondrer

effondrer — "to collapse, to cave in (as s'effondrer)".

Le vieux pont s'est effondré.

The old bridge collapsed.

Mostly reflexive. Also of a person: *elle s'est effondrée en larmes* — she broke down in tears.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

effondrer comes from Old French *esfondrer* (EtymDB), built on *fond* "bottom", from Latin *fundus* "bottom, ground" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: effondrer*
- *Say it: effondrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *effondrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the avalanche, then the French for the rockfall, then say *effondrer* again

Before you move on

What does effondrer mean? ("To collapse, to cave in (as s'effondrer)".) Say it once more.

303.5 les décombres — the rubble, the debris

Before the new one: say the French for the rockfall, then the French for to collapse.

You'll want to know: les décombres

les décombres — "the rubble, the debris".

Les secours cherchent dans les décombres.

The rescue teams are searching in the rubble.

Plural only.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décombres is built on Old French *descombrer* "to clear away", the opposite of *encombrer* "to block"; the root is usually traced to a Gaulish word for a blockage, and the origin is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les décombres*
- *Say it: les décombres*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les décombres*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rockfall, then the French for to collapse, then say *les décombres* again

Before you move on

What does les décombres mean? (“The rubble, the debris”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 304

Au bord de l'eau

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about danger in the water: drowning, a rescuer, a lifebuoy and a lifeguard.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 304: I can talk about danger in the water: drowning, a rescuer, a lifebuoy and a lifeguard.*

304.1 la noyade — drowning, a drowning

> Before the new one: say the French for to collapse, then the French for the rubble.

You'll want to know: la noyade

la noyade — "drowning, a drowning".

> Il y a beaucoup de noyades en été.
>
> *There are a lot of drownings in summer.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

noyade is built on *noyer* "to drown" (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *necāre* "to kill".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la noyade*
- *Say it: la noyade*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la noyade*
- *Recall:* say the French for to collapse, then the French for the rubble, then say *la noyade* again

Before you move on

What does la noyade mean? ("Drowning, a drowning".) Say it once more.

304.2 noyer — to drown (as se noyer); to flood

Before the new one: say the French for the rubble, then the French for drowning.

You'll want to know: noyer

noyer — "to drown (as se noyer); to flood".

Il s'est presque noyé dans le lac.

He nearly drowned in the lake.

Reflexive for a person who drowns: *il s'est noyé*. Without *se*, to drown someone or to flood: *noyer le moteur*. The noun *le noyer* is a walnut tree.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

noyer is inherited from Latin *necāre* "to kill" (EtymDB), which in Late Latin narrowed to killing by water (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: noyer*
- *Say it: noyer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *noyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rubble, then the French for drowning, then say *noyer* again

Before you move on

What does noyer mean? ("To drown (as se noyer); to flood".) Say it once more.

304.3 le sauveteur — the rescuer

Before the new one: say the French for drowning, then the French for to drown.

You'll want to know: le sauveteur

le sauveteur — "the rescuer".

Les sauveteurs ont travaillé toute la nuit.

The rescuers worked all night.

Feminine: *la sauveteuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauveteur is built on *sauver* "to save", which is inherited from Late Latin *salvāre*, built on *salvus* "safe" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sauveteur*
- *Say it: le sauveteur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sauveteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for drowning, then the French for to drown, then say *le sauveteur* again

Before you move on

What does le sauveteur mean? ("The rescuer".) Say it once more.

304.4 la bouée — the buoy; the rubber ring

Before the new one: say the French for to drown, then the French for the rescuer.

You'll want to know: la bouée

la bouée — "the buoy; the rubber ring".

On a lancé une bouée à l'homme dans l'eau.

Someone threw a lifebuoy to the man in the water.

La bouée de sauvetage — the lifebuoy; for children, *une bouée* is a swim ring.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouée is usually traced to Middle Dutch *boeie* "buoy"; the origin is not fully settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bouée*
- *Say it: la bouée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bouée*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drown, then the French for the rescuer, then say *la bouée* again

Before you move on

What does la bouée mean? ("The buoy; the rubber ring".) Say it once more.

304.5 le maître-nageur — the lifeguard, the swimming instructor

Before the new one: say the French for the rescuer, then the French for the buoy.

You'll want to know: le maître-nageur

le maître-nageur — "the lifeguard, the swimming instructor".

Le maître-nageur surveille la piscine.

The lifeguard watches over the pool.

Feminine: *la maître-nageuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maître is inherited from Latin *magister* "master", and *nageur* is built on *nager* "to swim", which comes from Latin *nāvigāre* "to sail" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le maître-nageur*
- *Say it: le maître-nageur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le maître-nageur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rescuer, then the French for the buoy, then say *le maître-nageur* again

Before you move on

What does le maître-nageur mean? ("The lifeguard, the swimming instructor".) Say it once more.

Chapter 305

Les rescapés

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell the story of a disaster at sea or in the air: a shipwreck, a crash, survivors, surviving and a catastrophe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 305: I can tell the story of a disaster at sea or in the air: a shipwreck, a crash, survivors, surviving and a catastrophe.*

305.1 le naufrage — the shipwreck

> Before the new one: say the French for the buoy, then the French for the lifeguard.

You'll want to know: le naufrage

le naufrage — "the shipwreck".

> Le naufrage a eu lieu près de la côte.
>
> *The shipwreck happened near the coast.*

Faire naufrage — to be shipwrecked.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

naufrage is a learned borrowing from Latin *naufragium* "a shipwreck" (EtymDB), from *nāvis* "ship" and *frangere* "to break".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le naufrage*
- *Say it: le naufrage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le naufrage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the buoy, then the French for the lifeguard, then say *le naufrage* again

Before you move on

What does le naufrage mean? ("The shipwreck".) Say it once more.

305.2 écraser — to crash (as s'écraser); to crush

Before the new one: say the French for the lifeguard, then the French for the shipwreck.

You'll want to know: écraser

écraser — "to crash (as s'écraser); to crush".

Un petit avion s'est écrasé dans la forêt.

A small plane crashed in the forest.

Reflexive for a plane that crashes: *s'écraser*. Without *se* it is common too, to crush or to mash: *écraser des pommes de terre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écraser comes from Middle French *escraser* "to squash" (EtymDB), usually traced to a Scandinavian word, Old Norse *krasa* "to shatter".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *écraser*
- *Say it:* *écraser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *écraser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the lifeguard, then the French for the shipwreck, then say *écraser* again

Before you move on

What does écraser mean? ("To crash (as s'écraser); to crush".) Say it once more.

305.3 le rescapé — the survivor (of a disaster)

Before the new one: say the French for the shipwreck, then the French for to crash.

You'll want to know: le rescapé

le rescapé — "the survivor (of a disaster)".

Les rescapés ont raconté leur nuit en mer.

The survivors told the story of their night at sea.

Someone saved from a disaster: *les rescapés du naufrage.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rescapé is usually explained as a northern dialect form of *réchappé* "escaped", built on *échapper* "to escape", which comes from Old French *eschaper* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rescapé*
- *Say it: le rescapé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le rescapé*
- *Recall:* say the French for the shipwreck, then the French for to crash, then say *le rescapé* again

Before you move on

What does le rescapé mean? ("The survivor (of a disaster)".) Say it once more.

305.4 survivre — to survive

Before the new one: say the French for to crash, then the French for the survivor.

You'll want to know: survivre

survivre — "to survive".

Tous les passagers ont survécu.

All the passengers survived.

Survivre à — to survive something: *survivre à un accident.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

survivre is inherited from Late Latin *supervīvere* "to outlive" (EtymDB), from *super* "over" and *vīvere* "to live".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: survivre*
- *Say it: survivre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *survivre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to crash, then the French for the survivor, then say *survivre* again

Before you move on

What does survivre mean? ("To survive".) Say it once more.

305.5 la catastrophe — the catastrophe, the disaster

Before the new one: say the French for the survivor, then the French for to survive.

You'll want to know: la catastrophe

la catastrophe — "the catastrophe, the disaster".

Le tremblement de terre a été une catastrophe.

The earthquake was a catastrophe.

Informal: *c'est la catastrophe !* — it is a disaster!

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

catastrophe was borrowed from Latin *catastropha*, from Greek *katastrophḗ* "an overturning, a sudden end" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la catastrophe*
- *Say it: la catastrophe*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la catastrophe*
- *Recall:* say the French for the survivor, then the French for to survive, then say *la catastrophe* again

Before you move on

What does la catastrophe mean? ("The catastrophe, the disaster".) Say it once more.

Chapter 306

Petits accidents

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe small accidents: choking, food poisoning, a sting, a bite and biting.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 306: I can describe small accidents: choking, food poisoning, a sting, a bite and biting.*

306.1 étouffer — to choke (as s'étouffer); to suffocate, to stifle

> Before the new one: say the French for to survive, then the French for the catastrophe.

You'll want to know: étouffer

étouffer — "to choke (as s'étouffer); to suffocate, to stifle".

> Il s'est étouffé avec un bonbon.
>
> *He choked on a sweet.*

For choking on food, the reflexive *s'étouffer*. Without *se*, to smother or to stifle: *on étouffe ici !* — it is stifling in here.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étouffer comes from Old French *estouffer* (EtymDB); the origin of the root is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: étouffer*
- *Say it: étouffer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *étouffer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to survive, then the French for the catastrophe, then say *étouffer* again

Before you move on

What does étouffer mean? ("To choke (as s'étouffer); to suffocate, to stifle".) Say it once more.

306.2 l'intoxication — the poisoning

Before the new one: say the French for the catastrophe, then the French for to choke.

You'll want to know: l'intoxication

l'intoxication — "the poisoning".

Toute la famille a eu une intoxication alimentaire.

The whole family had food poisoning.

Une intoxication alimentaire — food poisoning. It does not mean being drunk.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

intoxication is built on *intoxiquer*, from Medieval Latin *intoxicāre* (EtymDB), built on *toxicum* "poison", a borrowing from Greek *toxikón* "poison for arrows".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'intoxication*
- *Say it: l'intoxication*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'intoxication*
- *Recall:* say the French for the catastrophe, then the French for to choke, then say *l'intoxication* again

Before you move on

What does l'intoxication mean? ("The poisoning".) Say it once more.

306.3 piquer — to sting, to bite (of insects); to prick

Before the new one: say the French for to choke, then the French for the poisoning.

You'll want to know: piquer

piquer — "to sting, to bite (of insects); to prick".

Un insecte l'a piqué au bras.

An insect stung him on the arm.

Informal: *piquer* also means to pinch, to steal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

piquer is inherited from Vulgar Latin *piccāre* "to prick, to sting" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: piquer*
- *Say it: piquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *piquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to choke, then the French for the poisoning, then say *piquer* again

Before you move on

What does piquer mean? ("To sting, to bite (of insects); to prick".) Say it once more.

306.4 mordre — to bite

Before the new one: say the French for the poisoning, then the French for to sting.

You'll want to know: mordre

mordre — "to bite".

Le chien du voisin a mordu le facteur.

The neighbour's dog bit the postman.

Se faire mordre — to get bitten.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mordre is inherited from Latin *mordēre* "to bite" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: mordre*
- *Say it: mordre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *mordre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the poisoning, then the French for to sting, then say *mordre* again

Before you move on

What does mordre mean? ("To bite".) Say it once more.

306.5 la morsure — the bite (a wound)

Before the new one: say the French for to sting, then the French for to bite.

You'll want to know: la morsure

la morsure — "the bite (a wound)".

La morsure du chien n'était pas grave.

The dog bite was not serious.

For insects, French uses the verb *piquer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

morsure is built on *mors*, the old past participle of *mordre* "to bite", from Latin *morsus* "a bite" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la morsure*
- *Say it:* *la morsure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la morsure*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sting, then the French for to bite, then say *la morsure* again

Before you move on

What does la morsure mean? ("The bite (a wound)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 307

Les dégâts

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about damage after an accident: the damage, damaging, insurance, the people hit by a disaster and a scratch.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 307: I can talk about damage after an accident: the damage, damaging, insurance, the people hit by a disaster and a scratch.*

307.1 le dégât — the damage

> Before the new one: say the French for to bite, then the French for the bite.

You'll want to know: le dégât

le dégât — "the damage".

> L'orage a fait beaucoup de dégâts.
>
> *The storm did a lot of damage.*

Usually plural: *les dégâts*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dégât is built on Old French *degaster* "to lay waste", usually traced to Latin *dēvastāre* (EtymDB lists no parent), built on *vastus* "empty,

waste" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dégât*
- *Say it: le dégât*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le dégât*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bite, then the French for the bite, then say *le dégât* again

Before you move on

What does le dégât mean? ("The damage".) Say it once more.

307.2 endommager — to damage

Before the new one: say the French for the bite, then the French for the damage.

You'll want to know: endommager

endommager — "to damage".

L'eau a endommagé la cuisine.

The water damaged the kitchen.

For things, not people.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

endommager is built on *dommage* "harm", from Old French *damage*, which goes back to Latin *damnum* "loss" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: endommager*
- *Say it: endommager*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *endommager*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bite, then the French for the damage, then say *endommager* again

Before you move on

What does endommager mean? ("To damage".) Say it once more.

307.3 l'assurance — the insurance; self-confidence

Before the new one: say the French for the damage, then the French for to damage.

You'll want to know: l'assurance

l'assurance — "the insurance; self-confidence".

L'assurance va tout payer.

The insurance is going to pay for everything.

Avoir de l'assurance — to be self-assured.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

assurance is built on *assurer* "to make safe", which is inherited from Vulgar Latin *assēcūrāre*, built on Latin *sēcūrus* "safe, free from care" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'assurance*
- *Say it: l'assurance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'assurance*
- *Recall:* say the French for the damage, then the French for to damage, then say *l'assurance* again

Before you move on

What does l'assurance mean? ("The insurance; self-confidence".) Say it once more.

307.4 le sinistré — the disaster victim

Before the new one: say the French for to damage, then the French for the insurance.

You'll want to know: le sinistré

le sinistré — "the disaster victim".

Les sinistrés ont dormi dans une école.

The people hit by the disaster slept in a school.

Also an adjective: *une région sinistrée.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sinistré is built on *sinistre* "a disaster", from Latin *sinister* "left, unlucky" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sinistré*
- *Say it: le sinistré*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sinistré*
- *Recall:* say the French for to damage, then the French for the insurance, then say *le sinistré* again

Before you move on

What does le sinistré mean? ("The disaster victim".) Say it once more.

307.5 la rayure — the scratch; a stripe

Before the new one: say the French for the insurance, then the French for the disaster victim.

You'll want to know: la rayure

la rayure — "the scratch; a stripe".

Il y a une longue rayure sur la voiture.

There is a long scratch on the car.

Also a stripe: *une chemise à rayures.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rayure is built on *rayer* "to scratch, to stripe", from *raie* "a line", which EtymDB traces through Old French *roie* to Gaulish *rica* "a furrow"; the details are not fully settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rayure*
- *Say it: la rayure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rayure*
- *Recall:* say the French for the insurance, then the French for the disaster victim, then say *la rayure* again

Before you move on

What does la rayure mean? (“The scratch; a stripe”.) Say it once more.

307.6 Retour sur les chapitres 300–307

Say the French for the emergency services and to rescue.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the emergency services, to rescue, to resuscitate, the tourniquet, the stretcher
- the alert, to alert, the defibrillator, the emergency exit, to evacuate
- the fire, the fire extinguisher, the explosion, to explode, the spark
- the earthquake, the avalanche, the rockfall, to collapse, the rubble
- drowning, to drown, the rescuer, the buoy, the lifeguard
- the shipwreck, to crash, the survivor, to survive, the catastrophe
- to choke, the poisoning, to sting, to bite, the bite
- the damage, to damage, the insurance, the disaster victim, the scratch

Before you move on

The emergency services? (**les secours**.) To rescue? (**secourir**.) To resuscitate? (**réanimer**.) The tourniquet? (**le garrot**.) The stretcher? (**la civière**.) The alert? (**l'alerte**.) To alert? (**alerter**.) The defibrillator? (**le défibrillateur**.) The emergency exit? (**la sortie de secours**.) To evacuate? (**évacuer**.) The fire? (**l'incendie**.) The fire extinguisher? (**l'extincteur**.) The explosion? (**l'explosion**.) To explode? (**exploser**.) The spark? (**l'étincelle**.) The earthquake? (**le tremblement de terre**.) The avalanche? (**l'avalanche**.) The rockfall? (**l'éboulement**.) To collapse? (**effondrer**.) The rubble? (**les décombres**.) Drowning? (**la noyade**.) To drown? (**noyer**.) The rescuer? (**le sauveteur**.) The buoy? (**la bouée**.) The lifeguard? (**le maître-nageur**.) The shipwreck? (**le naufrage**.) To crash? (**écraser**.) The survivor? (**le rescapé**.) To survive? (**survivre**.) The catastrophe? (**la catastrophe**.) To choke? (**étouffer**.) The poisoning? (**l'intoxication**.) To sting? (**piquer**.) To bite? (**mordre**.) The bite? (**la morsure**.) The damage? (**le dégât**.) To damage? (**endommager**.) The insurance? (**l'assurance**.) The disaster victim? (**le sinistré**.) The scratch? (**la rayure**.)

Chapter 308

Une naissance

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a birth: the birth, being pregnant, the delivery, breastfeeding and the cradle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 308: I can talk about a birth: the birth, being pregnant, the delivery, breastfeeding and the cradle.*

308.1 la naissance — the birth

> Before the new one: say the French for the disaster victim, then the French for the scratch.

You'll want to know: la naissance

la naissance — "the birth".

> Nous avons fêté la naissance de notre fille.
>
> *We celebrated the birth of our daughter.*

La date de naissance — date of birth; *de naissance* — from birth.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

naissance is built on the stem of *naître* "to be born", which is inherited from Vulgar Latin *nāscere*, from Latin *nāscī* "to be born" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la naissance*
- *Say it: la naissance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la naissance*
- *Recall:* say the French for the disaster victim, then the French for the scratch, then say *la naissance* again

Before you move on

What does la naissance mean? ("The birth".) Say it once more.

308.2 enceinte — pregnant

Before the new one: say the French for the scratch, then the French for the birth.

You'll want to know: enceinte

enceinte — "pregnant".

Ma sœur est enceinte de six mois.

My sister is six months pregnant.

Enceinte de six mois — six months pregnant. As a noun, *une enceinte* is a loudspeaker or a city wall.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enceinte is inherited from Late Latin *incincta* (EtymDB), usually read as "without a belt", from *cingere* "to gird" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: enceinte*
- *Say it: enceinte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *enceinte*
- *Recall:* say the French for the scratch, then the French for the birth, then say *enceinte* again

Before you move on

What does enceinte mean? ("Pregnant".) Say it once more.

308.3 l'accouchement — the delivery, giving birth

Before the new one: say the French for the birth, then the French for pregnant.

You'll want to know: l'accouchement

l'accouchement — "the delivery, giving birth".

L'accouchement s'est bien passé.

The delivery went well.

Un accouchement à domicile — a home birth.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accouchement is built on a verb from Old French *acouchier* "to lie down", itself built on *coucher*, which is inherited from Latin *collocāre* "to place, to lay" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'accouchement*
- *Say it: l'accouchement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'accouchement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the birth, then the French for pregnant, then say *l'accouchement* again

Before you move on

What does l'accouchement mean? ("The delivery, giving birth".) Say it once more.

308.4 allaiter — to breastfeed

Before the new one: say the French for pregnant, then the French for the delivery.

You'll want to know: allaiter

allaiter — "to breastfeed".

Elle a allaité son bébé pendant six mois.

She breastfed her baby for six months.

Built on *lait*, milk.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

allaiter is usually traced to Late Latin *allactāre* "to suckle", built on *lac*, *lactis* "milk" (Lewis & Short); EtymDB lists its Catalan and Italian cousins.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: allaiter*
- *Say it: allaiter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *allaiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for pregnant, then the French for the delivery, then say *allaiter* again

Before you move on

What does allaiter mean? (“To breastfeed”.) Say it once more.

308.5 le berceau — the cradle

Before the new one: say the French for the delivery, then the French for to breastfeed.

You’ll want to know: le berceau

le berceau — “the cradle”.

Le bébé dort dans son berceau.

The baby is sleeping in its cradle.

Figurative: *le berceau d’une civilisation.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

berceau comes from Old French *berçuel*, inherited from Vulgar Latin *berciolum* “cradle” (EtymDB), which is usually traced to Gaulish.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le berceau*
- *Say it:* *le berceau*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le berceau*
- *Recall:* say the French for the delivery, then the French for to breastfeed, then say *le berceau* again

Before you move on

What does le berceau mean? (“The cradle”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 309

Les premières années

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about early childhood: the maternity ward, a christening, christening a child, a pushchair and childhood.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 309: I can talk about early childhood: the maternity ward, a christening, christening a child, a pushchair and childhood.*

309.1 la maternité — the maternity hospital; motherhood

> Before the new one: say the French for to breastfeed, then the French for the cradle.

You'll want to know: la maternité

la maternité — "the maternity hospital; motherhood".

> Le bébé est né à la maternité de la ville.
>
> *The baby was born at the town's maternity hospital.*

Le congé de maternité — maternity leave.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maternité is a learned borrowing from Latin *māternitās* "motherhood" (EtymDB), built on *māter* "mother".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la maternité*
- *Say it: la maternité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la maternité*
- *Recall:* say the French for to breastfeed, then the French for the cradle, then say *la maternité* again

Before you move on

What does la maternité mean? ("The maternity hospital; motherhood".) Say it once more.

309.2 le baptême — the christening, the baptism

Before the new one: say the French for the cradle, then the French for the maternity hospital.

You'll want to know: le baptême

le baptême — "the christening, the baptism".

Toute la famille est venue au baptême.

The whole family came to the christening.

The *p* is silent. *Le baptême de l'air* — a first flight.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

baptême comes through Old French *batesme* (EtymDB) from Church Latin *baptisma*, a borrowing from Greek *báptisma* “a dipping”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le baptême*
- *Say it: le baptême*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le baptême*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cradle, then the French for the maternity hospital, then say *le baptême* again

Before you move on

What does le baptême mean? (“The christening, the baptism”.) Say it once more.

309.3 baptiser — to christen, to baptise; to name

Before the new one: say the French for the maternity hospital, then the French for the christening.

You’ll want to know: baptiser

baptiser — “to christen, to baptise; to name”.

Le prêtre a baptisé l’enfant dimanche.

The priest christened the child on Sunday.

Also to give a name: *ils ont baptisé leur bateau.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

baptiser comes through Old French *baptisier* (EtymDB) from Church Latin *baptizāre*, a borrowing from Greek *baptízein* “to dip”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: baptiser*
- *Say it: baptiser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *baptiser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the maternity hospital, then the French for the christening, then say *baptiser* again

Before you move on

What does baptiser mean? (“To christen, to baptise; to name”.) Say it once more.

309.4 la poussette — the pushchair, the stroller

Before the new one: say the French for the christening, then the French for to christen.

You’ll want to know: la poussette

la poussette — “the pushchair, the stroller”.

Elle se promène au parc avec la poussette.

She walks in the park with the pushchair.

Built on *pousser*, to push.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poussette is built on *pousser* “to push”, which is inherited from Latin *pulsāre* “to beat, to push” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poussette*
- *Say it: la poussette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la poussette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the christening, then the French for to christen, then say *la poussette* again

Before you move on

What does la poussette mean? (“The pushchair, the stroller”.) Say it once more.

309.5 l’enfance — childhood

Before the new one: say the French for to christen, then the French for the pushchair.

You’ll want to know: l’enfance

l’enfance — “childhood”.

Il a passé son enfance à la campagne.

He spent his childhood in the countryside.

Un ami d’enfance — a childhood friend.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enfance comes from Old French *enfance*, from Latin *īnfantia* "childhood" (EtymDB), built on *īnfāns* "unable to speak".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'enfance*
- *Say it: l'enfance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'enfance*
- *Recall:* say the French for to christen, then the French for the pushchair, then say *l'enfance* again

Before you move on

What does l'enfance mean? ("Childhood".) Say it once more.

Chapter 310

La jeunesse

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about growing up: adolescence, teenagers, youth, the start of the school year and coming of age.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 310: I can talk about growing up: adolescence, teenagers, youth, the start of the school year and coming of age.*

310.1 l'adolescence — adolescence, the teenage years

> Before the new one: say the French for the pushchair, then the French for childhood.

You'll want to know: l'adolescence

l'adolescence — "adolescence, the teenage years".

> Son adolescence a été difficile.
>
> *His teenage years were difficult.*

Feminine: *une adolescence heureuse.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adolescence is a learned borrowing from Latin *adulēscentia* “youth” (EtymDB), from *adolēscere* “to grow up”, built on *alere* “to nourish” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’adolescence*
- *Say it: l’adolescence*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l’adolescence*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pushchair, then the French for childhood, then say *l’adolescence* again

Before you move on

What does l’adolescence mean? (“Adolescence, the teenage years”.) Say it once more.

310.2 l’adolescent — the teenager, the adolescent

Before the new one: say the French for childhood, then the French for adolescence.

You’ll want to know: l’adolescent

l’adolescent — “the teenager, the adolescent”.

Les adolescents passent des heures sur leur téléphone.

Teenagers spend hours on their phones.

Often *un ado*, *une ado* in speech.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adolescent is a learned borrowing from Latin *adolēscēns* "growing up" (EtymDB), the present participle of *adolēscere*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'adolescent*
- *Say it: l'adolescent*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'adolescent*
- *Recall:* say the French for childhood, then the French for adolescence, then say *l'adolescent* again

Before you move on

What does l'adolescent mean? ("The teenager, the adolescent".) Say it once more.

310.3 la jeunesse — youth, young people

Before the new one: say the French for adolescence, then the French for the teenager.

You'll want to know: la jeunesse

la jeunesse — "youth, young people".

Dans sa jeunesse, il jouait au rugby.

In his youth, he played rugby.

Also young people as a group: *la jeunesse d'aujourd'hui*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jeunesse is built on *jeune* "young", which is inherited from Latin *iuvenis* "young" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la jeunesse*
- *Say it: la jeunesse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la jeunesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for adolescence, then the French for the teenager, then say *la jeunesse* again

Before you move on

What does la jeunesse mean? ("Youth, young people".) Say it once more.

310.4 la rentrée — the start of the school year; the return

Before the new one: say the French for the teenager, then the French for youth.

You'll want to know: la rentrée

la rentrée — "the start of the school year; the return".

La rentrée a lieu en septembre.

The school year starts in September.

A very French notion: after the summer, everyone goes back to school and to work.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rentrée is built on *rentrer* "to go back in", from *re-* and *entrer*, which is inherited from Latin *intrāre* "to go in" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rentrée*
- *Say it: la rentrée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rentrée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the teenager, then the French for youth, then say *la rentrée* again

Before you move on

What does la rentrée mean? ("The start of the school year; the return".) Say it once more.

310.5 majeur — of age, adult; major

Before the new one: say the French for youth, then the French for the start of the school year.

You'll want to know: majeur

majeur — "of age, adult; major".

Il est majeur depuis hier: il a dix-huit ans.

He came of age yesterday: he is eighteen.

In France you are *majeur* at eighteen. *La majeure partie* — most of.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

majeur is a learned borrowing from Latin *māior* “greater” (EtymDB), the comparative of *magnus* “great”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *majeur*
- *Say it:* *majeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *majeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for youth, then the French for the start of the school year, then say *majeur* again

Before you move on

What does majeur mean? (“Of age, adult; major”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 311

Un grand jour

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about getting engaged and married: getting engaged, the proposal, getting married, the wedding cake and sugared almonds.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 311: I can talk about getting engaged and married: getting engaged, the proposal, getting married, the wedding cake and sugared almonds.*

311.1 fiancer — to get engaged (as se fiancer)

> Before the new one: say the French for the start of the school year, then the French for of age.

You'll want to know: fiancer

fiancer — "to get engaged (as se fiancer)".

> Ils se sont fiancés l'été dernier.
>
> *They got engaged last summer.*

Mostly reflexive: *se fiancer avec quelqu'un.* The person is *le fiancé*, *la fiancée.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fiancer is built on Old French *fiance* "trust, a promise", from *fier* "to trust", which goes back to Latin *fīdus* "faithful" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: fiancer*
- *Say it: fiancer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *fiancer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the start of the school year, then the French for of age, then say *fiancer* again

Before you move on

What does fiancer mean? ("To get engaged (as se fiancer)".) Say it once more.

311.2 la demande en mariage — the marriage proposal

Before the new one: say the French for of age, then the French for to get engaged.

You'll want to know: la demande en mariage

la demande en mariage — "the marriage proposal".

Il a fait sa demande en mariage au restaurant.

He proposed at the restaurant.

Demander quelqu'un en mariage — to propose to someone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mariage is built on *marier*, inherited from Latin *marītāre* "to wed" (EtymDB); *demande* is built on *demander*, from Latin *dēmandāre* "to entrust" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la demande en mariage*
- *Say it: la demande en mariage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la demande en mariage*
- *Recall:* say the French for of age, then the French for to get engaged, then say *la demande en mariage* again

Before you move on

What does la demande en mariage mean? ("The marriage proposal".) Say it once more.

311.3 marier — to get married (as se marier); to marry (a couple), to marry off

Before the new one: say the French for to get engaged, then the French for the marriage proposal.

You'll want to know: marier

marier — "to get married (as se marier); to marry (a couple), to marry off".

Ils se sont mariés à la mairie.

They got married at the town hall.

Reflexive for the couple: *ils se marient en juin.* Without *se*, the mayor marries them: *le maire les a mariés.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marier is inherited from Latin *marītāre* "to wed" (EtymDB), built on *marītus* "husband".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: marier*
- *Say it: marier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *marier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get engaged, then the French for the marriage proposal, then say *marier* again

Before you move on

What does marier mean? ("To get married (as se marier); to marry (a couple), to marry off".) Say it once more.

311.4 la pièce montée — the tiered wedding cake

Before the new one: say the French for the marriage proposal, then the French for to get married.

You'll want to know: la pièce montée

la pièce montée — "the tiered wedding cake".

À la fin du repas, on a servi la pièce montée.

At the end of the meal, the wedding cake was served.

A tower of small cream puffs, a classic of French weddings.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pièce is inherited from Late Latin *pettia* "a piece", of Gaulish origin (EtymDB); *montée* is built on *monter* "to go up", from Latin *mōns* "mountain" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pièce montée*
- *Say it: la pièce montée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la pièce montée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the marriage proposal, then the French for to get married, then say *la pièce montée* again

Before you move on

What does la pièce montée mean? ("The tiered wedding cake".) Say it once more.

311.5 la dragée — the sugared almond

Before the new one: say the French for to get married, then the French for the tiered wedding cake.

You'll want to know: la dragée

la dragée — "the sugared almond".

Les invités ont reçu des dragées.

The guests were given sugared almonds.

Given at weddings and christenings in France and Belgium.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dragée comes from Old French *dragie* (EtymDB), usually traced to Latin *tragēmata* “sweets, dessert”, a borrowing from Greek.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dragée*
- *Say it: la dragée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la dragée*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get married, then the French for the tiered wedding cake, then say *la dragée* again

Before you move on

What does la dragée mean? (“The sugared almond”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 312

Une nouvelle maison

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about moving: the move, moving in, the house-warming, the tenant and the lease.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 312: I can talk about moving: the move, moving in, the house-warming, the tenant and the lease.*

312.1 le déménagement — the move, the house move

> Before the new one: say the French for the tiered wedding cake, then the French for the sugared almond.

You'll want to know: le déménagement

le déménagement — "the move, the house move".

> Le déménagement a pris toute la journée.
>
> *The move took the whole day.*

The verb is *déménager*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déménagement is built on *ménage* "household", which goes back to Vulgar Latin *mansiōnāticum*, built on Latin *mānsiō* "a dwelling", from

manēre “to stay” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le déménagement*
- *Say it: le déménagement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le déménagement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tiered wedding cake, then the French for the sugared almond, then say *le déménagement* again

Before you move on

What does le déménagement mean? (“The move, the house move”.) Say it once more.

312.2 emménager — to move in

Before the new one: say the French for the sugared almond, then the French for the move.

You’ll want to know: emménager

emménager — “to move in”.

Nous avons emménagé dans un nouvel appartement.

We moved into a new flat.

The opposite of *déménager*, to move out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

emménager is built on *en-* and *ménage* “household”, which goes back to Latin *mānsiō* “a dwelling” (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *emménager*
- *Say it:* *emménager*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *emménager*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sugared almond, then the French for the move, then say *emménager* again

Before you move on

What does emménager mean? ("To move in".) Say it once more.

312.3 la crémaillère — the house-warming; a pot-hook

Before the new one: say the French for the move, then the French for to move in.

You'll want to know: la crémaillère

la crémaillère — "the house-warming; a pot-hook".

Ils ont pendu la crémaillère samedi soir.

They had their house-warming on Saturday night.

Pendre la crémaillère — to throw a house-warming party; once, hanging the pot-hook over the fire was the last step of moving in.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crémaillère is usually traced to Late Latin *cremaculus* "a pot-hook", from Greek *kremastḗr* "a hanger"; the details are not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la crémaillère*
- *Say it: la crémaillère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la crémaillère*
- *Recall:* say the French for the move, then the French for to move in, then say *la crémaillère* again

Before you move on

What does la crémaillère mean? ("The house-warming; a pot-hook".) Say it once more.

312.4 le locataire — the tenant

Before the new one: say the French for to move in, then the French for the house-warming.

You'll want to know: le locataire

le locataire — "the tenant".

Le nouveau locataire est arrivé lundi.

The new tenant arrived on Monday.

The owner is *le propriétaire*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

locataire is a learned word built on Latin *locātus*, from *locāre* "to place, to let out" (Lewis & Short); EtymDB lists Italian *locatario* beside it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le locataire*
- *Say it: le locataire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le locataire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move in, then the French for the house-warming, then say *le locataire* again

Before you move on

What does le locataire mean? (“The tenant”.) Say it once more.

312.5 le bail — the lease

Before the new one: say the French for the house-warming, then the French for the tenant.

You’ll want to know: le bail

le bail — “the lease”.

Ils ont signé un bail de trois ans.

They signed a three-year lease.

Plural *les baux*. Informal: *ça fait un bail !* — it has been ages!

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bail is built on *bailler* “to hand over” (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *bāiulāre* “to carry a load” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bail*
- *Say it: le bail*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bail*
- *Recall:* say the French for the house-warming, then the French for the tenant, then say *le bail* again

Before you move on

What does le bail mean? (“The lease”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 313

La retraite

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about later life: retirement, retired people, old age, going into hospital and a death.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 313: I can talk about later life: retirement, retired people, old age, going into hospital and a death.*

313.1 la retraite — retirement; the pension

> Before the new one: say the French for the tenant, then the French for the lease.

You'll want to know: la retraite

la retraite — "retirement; the pension".

> Mon père a pris sa retraite l'année dernière.
>
> *My father retired last year.*

Prendre sa retraite — to retire; *être à la retraite* — to be retired.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retraite is the old past participle of Old French *retraire* "to withdraw", which is inherited from Latin *retrahere* "to draw back" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la retraite*
- *Say it: la retraite*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la retraite*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tenant, then the French for the lease, then say *la retraite* again

Before you move on

What does la retraite mean? ("Retirement; the pension".) Say it once more.

313.2 le retraité — the retired person, the pensioner

Before the new one: say the French for the lease, then the French for retirement.

You'll want to know: le retraité

le retraité — "the retired person, the pensioner".

Les retraités se retrouvent au café le matin.

The pensioners meet at the café in the morning.

Feminine: *la retraitée*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retraité is built on *retraite* "retirement", from Old French *retraire*, inherited from Latin *retrahere* "to draw back" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le retraité*
- *Say it: le retraité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le retraité*
- *Recall:* say the French for the lease, then the French for retirement, then say *le retraité* again

Before you move on

What does le retraité mean? ("The retired person, the pensioner".) Say it once more.

313.3 la vieillesse — old age

Before the new one: say the French for retirement, then the French for the retired person.

You'll want to know: la vieillesse

la vieillesse — "old age".

Il a eu une vieillesse heureuse.

He had a happy old age.

The opposite of *la jeunesse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vieillesse is built on *vieil*, *vieux* "old", inherited from Late Latin *veclus*, from Latin *vetulus* "little old" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vieillesse*
- *Say it: la vieillesse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la vieillesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for retirement, then the French for the retired person, then say *la vieillesse* again

Before you move on

What does la vieillesse mean? ("Old age".) Say it once more.

313.4 hospitaliser — to take into hospital, to hospitalise

Before the new one: say the French for the retired person, then the French for old age.

You'll want to know: hospitaliser

hospitaliser — "to take into hospital, to hospitalise".

Ma grand-mère a été hospitalisée pendant une semaine.

My grandmother was in hospital for a week.

Mostly in the passive: *il a été hospitalisé.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hospitaliser is built on *hospital*, the old form of *hôpital*, from Latin *hospitālis* "of a guest", built on *hospes* "guest, host" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: hospitaliser*
- *Say it: hospitaliser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *hospitaliser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the retired person, then the French for old age, then say *hospitaliser* again

Before you move on

What does hospitaliser mean? ("To take into hospital, to hospitalise".) Say it once more.

313.5 le décès — the death (formal)

Before the new one: say the French for old age, then the French for to take into hospital.

You'll want to know: le décès

le décès — "the death (formal)".

> Le décès a eu lieu à l'hôpital.
>
> *The death took place at the hospital.*

The formal and official word; in daily speech, *la mort*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décès is inherited from Latin *dēcessus* "a going away, a death" (EtymDB), from *dēcēdere* "to go away".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le décès*
- *Say it: le décès*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le décès*
- *Recall:* say the French for old age, then the French for to take into hospital, then say *le décès* again

Before you move on

What does le décès mean? ("The death (formal)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 314

Les funérailles

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a death and a funeral: passing away, burying, the burial, the funeral and the cemetery.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 314: I can talk about a death and a funeral: passing away, burying, the burial, the funeral and the cemetery.*

314.1 décéder — to pass away, to die (formal)

> Before the new one: say the French for to take into hospital, then the French for the death.

You'll want to know: décéder

décéder — "to pass away, to die (formal)".

> Il est décédé à l'âge de quatre-vingts ans.
>
> *He passed away at the age of eighty.*

Takes *être*. Official language; *mourir* in everyday speech.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décéder is a learned borrowing from Latin *dēcēdere* "to go away, to die" (EtymDB), from *dē* and *cēdere* "to go".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: décéder*
- *Say it: décéder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *décéder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to take into hospital, then the French for the death, then say *décéder* again

Before you move on

What does décéder mean? ("To pass away, to die (formal)".) Say it once more.

314.2 enterrer — to bury

Before the new one: say the French for the death, then the French for to pass away.

You'll want to know: enterrer

enterrer — "to bury".

Ils ont enterré leur grand-père près de l'église.

They buried their grandfather near the church.

Figurative: *enterrer un projet* — to drop a plan.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enterrer is inherited from Vulgar Latin *interrāre* "to put in the earth" (EtymDB), built on Latin *terra* "earth".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: enterrer*
- *Say it: enterrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *enterrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the death, then the French for to pass away, then say *enterrer* again

Before you move on

What does enterrer mean? (“To bury”.) Say it once more.

314.3 l’enterrement — the burial, the funeral

Before the new one: say the French for to pass away, then the French for to bury.

You’ll want to know: l’enterrement

l’enterrement — “the burial, the funeral”.

Beaucoup de gens sont venus à l’enterrement.

Many people came to the funeral.

The everyday word for a funeral.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enterrement is built on *enterrer* “to bury”, which is inherited from Vulgar Latin *interrāre*, built on *terra* “earth” (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'enterrement*
- *Say it: l'enterrement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'enterrement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pass away, then the French for to bury, then say *l'enterrement* again

Before you move on

What does l'enterrement mean? ("The burial, the funeral".) Say it once more.

314.4 les funérailles — the funeral (formal)

Before the new one: say the French for to bury, then the French for the burial.

You'll want to know: les funérailles

les funérailles — "the funeral (formal)".

Les funérailles du chanteur ont eu lieu dans son village.

The singer's funeral was held in his village.

Formal and plural only; the everyday word is *l'enterrement*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

funérailles comes from Medieval Latin *fūnerālia* (EtymDB), built on *fūnus* "a funeral" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les funérailles*
- *Say it: les funérailles*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les funérailles*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bury, then the French for the burial, then say *les funérailles* again

Before you move on

What does les funérailles mean? ("The funeral (formal)".) Say it once more.

314.5 le cimetière — the cemetery, the graveyard

Before the new one: say the French for the burial, then the French for the funeral.

You'll want to know: le cimetière

le cimetière — "the cemetery, the graveyard".

Le cimetière est derrière l'église.

The cemetery is behind the church.

Masculine: *le cimetière.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cimetière comes from Church Latin *coemētērium*, a borrowing from Greek *koimētérion* "a sleeping place" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cimetière*
- *Say it: le cimetière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cimetière*
- *Recall:* say the French for the burial, then the French for the funeral, then say *le cimetière* again

Before you move on

What does le cimetière mean? ("The cemetery, the graveyard".) Say it once more.

Chapter 315

Le deuil

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about mourning and what people leave behind: the grave, mourning, the will, inheriting and an inheritance.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 315: I can talk about mourning and what people leave behind: the grave, mourning, the will, inheriting and an inheritance.*

315.1 la tombe — the grave, the tomb

> Before the new one: say the French for the funeral, then the French for the cemetery.

You'll want to know: la tombe

la tombe — "the grave, the tomb".

> Elle met des fleurs sur la tombe de sa mère.
>
> *She puts flowers on her mother's grave.*

Not to be confused with *il tombe*, he falls.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tombe comes from Late Latin *tumba* "a tomb" (EtymDB), a borrowing from Greek *týmbos* "a burial mound".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tombe*
- *Say it: la tombe*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la tombe*
- *Recall:* say the French for the funeral, then the French for the cemetery, then say *la tombe* again

Before you move on

What does la tombe mean? ("The grave, the tomb".) Say it once more.

315.2 le deuil — mourning, grief

Before the new one: say the French for the cemetery, then the French for the grave.

You'll want to know: le deuil

le deuil — "mourning, grief".

Toute la famille est en deuil.

The whole family is in mourning.

Porter le deuil — to wear mourning; *faire son deuil* — to come to terms with a loss.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

deuil is usually traced to a Late Latin noun *dolus* "grief", built on *dolēre* "to suffer, to grieve" (Lewis & Short); it is not classical *dolus* "trickery", and EtymDB lists no parent.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le deuil*
- *Say it: le deuil*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le deuil*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cemetery, then the French for the grave, then say *le deuil* again

Before you move on

What does le deuil mean? ("Mourning, grief".) Say it once more.

315.3 le testament — the will (legal)

Before the new one: say the French for the grave, then the French for mourning.

You'll want to know: le testament

le testament — "the will (legal)".

Il a laissé sa maison à ses enfants dans son testament.

He left his house to his children in his will.

Faire son testament — to make one's will.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

testament is a learned borrowing from Latin *testāmentum* "a will", from *testārī* "to bear witness", built on *testis* "witness" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le testament*
- *Say it: le testament*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le testament*
- *Recall:* say the French for the grave, then the French for mourning, then say *le testament* again

Before you move on

What does le testament mean? ("The will (legal)".) Say it once more.

315.4 hériter — to inherit

Before the new one: say the French for mourning, then the French for the will.

You'll want to know: hériter

hériter — "to inherit".

Elle a hérité de la maison de sa tante.

She inherited her aunt's house.

Hériter de quelque chose — with *de*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hériter comes from Old French *eriter* (EtymDB), from Late Latin *hērēditāre* "to inherit", built on *hērēs* "heir" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: hériter*
- *Say it: hériter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *hériter*
- *Recall:* say the French for mourning, then the French for the will, then say *hériter* again

Before you move on

What does hériter mean? ("To inherit".) Say it once more.

315.5 l'héritage — the inheritance; the heritage

Before the new one: say the French for the will, then the French for to inherit.

You'll want to know: l'héritage

l'héritage — "the inheritance; the heritage".

Il a reçu un petit héritage.

He received a small inheritance.

Also a cultural legacy: *l'héritage des anciens*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

héritage is built on *hériter* "to inherit" (EtymDB), from Late Latin *hērēditāre*, built on *hērēs* "heir".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'héritage*
- *Say it: l'héritage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'héritage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the will, then the French for to inherit, then say *l'héritage* again

Before you move on

What does l'héritage mean? ("The inheritance; the heritage".) Say it once more.

315.6 Retour sur les chapitres 308–315

Say the French for the birth and pregnant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the birth, pregnant, the delivery, to breastfeed, the cradle
- the maternity hospital, the christening, to christen, the pushchair, childhood
- adolescence, the teenager, youth, the start of the school year, of age
- to get engaged, the marriage proposal, to get married, the tiered wedding cake, the sugared almond
- the move, to move in, the house-warming, the tenant, the lease
- retirement, the retired person, old age, to take into hospital, the death
- to pass away, to bury, the burial, the funeral, the cemetery
- the grave, mourning, the will, to inherit, the inheritance

Before you move on

The birth? (**la naissance**.) Pregnant? (**enceinte**.) The delivery? (**l'accouchement**.) To breastfeed? (**allaiter**.) The cradle? (**le berceau**.) The maternity hospital? (**la maternité**.) The christening? (**le baptême**.) To christen? (**baptiser**.) The pushchair? (**la poussette**.) Childhood? (**l'enfance**.) Adolescence? (**l'adolescence**.) The teenager? (**l'adolescent**.) Youth? (**la jeunesse**.) The start of the school year? (**la rentrée**.) Of age? (**majeur**.) To get engaged? (**fiancer**.) The marriage proposal? (**la demande en mariage**.) To get married? (**marier**.) The tiered wedding cake? (**la pièce montée**.) The sugared almond? (**la dragée**.) The move? (**le déménagement**.) To move in? (**emménager**.) The house-warming? (**la crémaillère**.) The tenant? (**le locataire**.) The lease? (**le bail**.) Retirement? (**la retraite**.) The retired person? (**le retraité**.) Old age? (**la vieillesse**.) To take into hospital? (**hospitaliser**.) The death? (**le décès**.) To pass away? (**décéder**.) To bury? (**enterrer**.) The burial? (**l'enterrement**.) The funeral? (**les funérailles**.) The cemetery? (**le cimetière**.) The grave? (**la tombe**.) Mourning? (**le deuil**.) The will? (**le testament**.) To inherit? (**hériter**.) The inheritance? (**l'héritage**.)

Chapter 316

Célébrer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a public celebration: celebrating, the celebration, a procession, a brass band and a public holiday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 316: I can describe a public celebration: celebrating, the celebration, a procession, a brass band and a public holiday.*

316.1 célébrer — to celebrate

> Before the new one: say the French for to inherit, then the French for the inheritance.

You'll want to know: célébrer

célébrer — "to celebrate".

> La ville a célébré la fin de la guerre.
>
> *The town celebrated the end of the war.*

More formal than *fêter*; also for a mass or a wedding: *célébrer un mariage*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

célébrer is a learned borrowing from Latin *celebrāre* "to frequent, to celebrate, to honour" (EtymDB), built on *celeber* "crowded, famous".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: célébrer*
- *Say it: célébrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *célébrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to inherit, then the French for the inheritance, then say *célébrer* again

Before you move on

What does célébrer mean? ("To celebrate".) Say it once more.

316.2 la célébration — the celebration

Before the new one: say the French for the inheritance, then the French for to celebrate.

You'll want to know: la célébration

la célébration — "the celebration".

La célébration a duré toute la nuit.

The celebration went on all night.

Often for a religious or official event.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

célébration is a learned borrowing from Latin *celebrātiō* "a crowd, a festival", from *celebrāre* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la célébration*
- *Say it: la célébration*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la célébration*
- *Recall:* say the French for the inheritance, then the French for to celebrate, then say *la célébration* again

Before you move on

What does la célébration mean? ("The celebration".) Say it once more.

316.3 le cortège — the procession

Before the new one: say the French for to celebrate, then the French for the celebration.

You'll want to know: le cortège

le cortège — "the procession".

Le cortège a traversé le centre-ville.

The procession went through the town centre.

A wedding, funeral or protest procession.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cortège was borrowed from Italian *corteggio* "a retinue" (EtymDB), built on *corte* "court", from Latin *cohors* "an enclosure, a company" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cortège*
- *Say it: le cortège*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cortège*
- *Recall:* say the French for to celebrate, then the French for the celebration, then say *le cortège* again

Before you move on

What does le cortège mean? ("The procession".) Say it once more.

316.4 la fanfare — the brass band; a fanfare

Before the new one: say the French for the celebration, then the French for the procession.

You'll want to know: la fanfare

la fanfare — "the brass band; a fanfare".

La fanfare jouait devant la mairie.

The brass band was playing in front of the town hall.

En fanfare — with a lot of noise.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fanfare is usually explained as imitating the sound of trumpets; the origin is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fanfare*
- *Say it: la fanfare*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fanfare*
- *Recall:* say the French for the celebration, then the French for the procession, then say *la fanfare* again

Before you move on

What does la fanfare mean? ("The brass band; a fanfare".) Say it once more.

316.5 le jour férié — the public holiday, the bank holiday

Before the new one: say the French for the procession, then the French for the brass band.

You'll want to know: le jour férié

le jour férié — "the public holiday, the bank holiday".

Le premier mai est un jour férié.

The first of May is a public holiday.

Faire le pont — to take the day off between a holiday and the weekend.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

férié is a learned borrowing from Latin *fēriātus* "on holiday", from *fēriae* "days of rest, holidays" (Lewis & Short); *jour* comes from Latin *diurnum*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jour férié*
- *Say it: le jour férié*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le jour férié*
- *Recall:* say the French for the procession, then the French for the brass band, then say *le jour férié* again

Before you move on

What does le jour férié mean? ("The public holiday, the bank holiday".) Say it once more.

Chapter 317

Le carnaval

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a carnival: the parade, marching past, the carnival, a float and dressing up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 317: I can describe a carnival: the parade, marching past, the carnival, a float and dressing up.*

317.1 le défilé — the parade; a fashion show

> Before the new one: say the French for the brass band, then the French for the public holiday.

You'll want to know: le défilé

le défilé — "the parade; a fashion show".

> Les enfants regardent le défilé du 14 juillet.
>
> *The children are watching the 14 July parade.*

Un défilé de mode — a fashion show.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défilé is the past participle of *défiler* "to march past" used as a noun (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le défilé*
- *Say it: le défilé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le défilé*
- *Recall:* say the French for the brass band, then the French for the public holiday, then say *le défilé* again

Before you move on

What does le défilé mean? ("The parade; a fashion show".) Say it once more.

317.2 défiler — to march past, to parade; to scroll

Before the new one: say the French for the public holiday, then the French for the parade.

You'll want to know: défiler

défiler — "to march past, to parade; to scroll".

Les soldats ont défilé dans la rue.

The soldiers marched down the street.

On a screen: *faire défiler une page* — to scroll.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défiler is built on *file* "a row, a line" (EtymDB), which comes from *fil* "thread", from Latin *fīlum* "a thread" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: défiler*
- *Say it: défiler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *défiler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the public holiday, then the French for the parade, then say *défiler* again

Before you move on

What does défiler mean? ("To march past, to parade; to scroll".) Say it once more.

317.3 le carnaval — the carnival

Before the new one: say the French for the parade, then the French for to march past.

You'll want to know: le carnaval

le carnaval — "the carnival".

Le carnaval a lieu en février.

The carnival takes place in February.

Plural *les carnavals*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carnaval was borrowed from Italian *carnevale* (EtymDB), from Medieval Latin *carnelevāre* "putting away meat", from *carō* "flesh" and *levāre* "to lift".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le carnaval*
- *Say it: le carnaval*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le carnaval*
- *Recall:* say the French for the parade, then the French for to march past, then say *le carnaval* again

Before you move on

What does le carnaval mean? ("The carnival".) Say it once more.

317.4 le char — the float (in a parade); the tank

Before the new one: say the French for to march past, then the French for the carnival.

You'll want to know: le char

le char — "the float (in a parade); the tank".

Les chars du carnaval sont pleins de fleurs.

The carnival floats are full of flowers.

In Québec, *le char* is also the everyday word for a car.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

char is inherited from Latin *carrus* "a wagon" (EtymDB), a word of Gaulish origin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le char*
- *Say it: le char*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le char*
- *Recall:* say the French for to march past, then the French for the carnival, then say *le char* again

Before you move on

What does le char mean? ("The float (in a parade); the tank".) Say it once more.

317.5 déguiser — to dress up (as se déguiser); to disguise

Before the new one: say the French for the carnival, then the French for the float.

You'll want to know: déguiser

déguiser — "to dress up (as se déguiser); to disguise".

Les enfants se sont déguisés en animaux.

The children dressed up as animals.

Mostly reflexive in this sense: *se déguiser en* — to dress up as. Without *se*, to disguise: *déguiser sa voix.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déguiser comes from Old French *desguiser* (EtymDB), built on *guise* "manner, way", which is usually traced to a Frankish word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *déguiser*
- *Say it:* *déguiser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déguiser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the carnival, then the French for the float, then say *déguiser* again

Before you move on

What does déguiser mean? ("To dress up (as se déguiser); to disguise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 318

Le feu d'artifice

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a night of celebration: fireworks, firecrackers, the dance, garlands and decorating.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 318: I can describe a night of celebration: fireworks, firecrackers, the dance, garlands and decorating.*

318.1 le feu d'artifice — the fireworks (display)

> Before the new one: say the French for the float, then the French for to dress up.

You'll want to know: le feu d'artifice

le feu d'artifice — "the fireworks (display)".

> Le feu d'artifice a commencé à vingt-trois heures.
>
> *The fireworks started at eleven at night.*

Plural: *les feux d'artifice*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feu is inherited from Latin *focus* "hearth" (EtymDB), and *artifice* is a learned borrowing from Latin *artificium* "craft, skill", from *ars* and *facere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le feu d'artifice*
- *Say it: le feu d'artifice*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le feu d'artifice*
- *Recall:* say the French for the float, then the French for to dress up, then say *le feu d'artifice* again

Before you move on

What does le feu d'artifice mean? ("The fireworks (display)".) Say it once more.

318.2 le pétard — the firecracker, the banger

Before the new one: say the French for to dress up, then the French for the fireworks.

You'll want to know: le pétard

le pétard — "the firecracker, the banger".

Les enfants ont lancé des pétards dans la rue.

The children set off bangers in the street.

Informal: *être en pétard* — to be furious.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pétard is built on *péter* "to go bang, to break wind" with the suffix *-ard* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pétard*
- *Say it: le pétard*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pétard*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dress up, then the French for the fireworks, then say *le pétard* again

Before you move on

What does le pétard mean? (“The firecracker, the banger”.) Say it once more.

318.3 le bal — the dance, the ball

Before the new one: say the French for the fireworks, then the French for the firecracker.

You’ll want to know: le bal

le bal — “the dance, the ball”.

Les jeunes dansent au bal du village.

The young people dance at the village dance.

Le bal populaire — the open-air public dance, a summer tradition.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bal is built on Old French *baller* “to dance”, which is inherited from Late Latin *ballāre* (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bal*
- *Say it: le bal*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bal*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fireworks, then the French for the firecracker, then say *le bal* again

Before you move on

What does le bal mean? ("The dance, the ball".) Say it once more.

318.4 la guirlande — the garland, the string of lights

Before the new one: say the French for the firecracker, then the French for the dance.

You'll want to know: la guirlande

la guirlande — "the garland, the string of lights".

Il y a des guirlandes dans toutes les rues.

There are strings of lights in every street.

Une guirlande électrique — fairy lights.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guirlande was borrowed from Italian *ghirlanda* "garland" (EtymDB); the origin of the Italian word is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la guirlande*
- *Say it: la guirlande*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la guirlande*
- *Recall:* say the French for the firecracker, then the French for the dance, then say *la guirlande* again

Before you move on

What does la guirlande mean? ("The garland, the string of lights".) Say it once more.

318.5 décorer — to decorate

Before the new one: say the French for the dance, then the French for the garland.

You'll want to know: décorer

décorer — "to decorate".

Les enfants ont décoré la salle avec des ballons.

The children decorated the room with balloons.

Also to award a medal: *il a été décoré*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décorer is a learned borrowing from Latin *decorāre* "to adorn", from *decus* "ornament, honour" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *décorer*
- *Say it:* *décorer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *décorer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the dance, then the French for the garland, then say *décorer* again

Before you move on

What does décorer mean? (“To decorate”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 319

Le réveillon

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the winter holidays: the late-night feast, celebrating it, the Christmas tree, the yule log and the king cake.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 319: I can describe the winter holidays: the late-night feast, celebrating it, the Christmas tree, the yule log and the king cake.*

319.1 le réveillon — the festive late-night dinner (24 or 31 December)

> Before the new one: say the French for the garland, then the French for to decorate.

You'll want to know: le réveillon

le réveillon — "the festive late-night dinner (24 or 31 December)".

> Toute la famille passe le réveillon chez ma tante.
>
> *The whole family spends the festive dinner at my aunt's.*

It falls on the evenings of 24 and 31 December.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réveillon is built on *réveiller* "to wake up", from *veiller* "to stay awake", which is inherited from Latin *vigilāre* "to keep watch" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le réveillon*
- *Say it: le réveillon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le réveillon*
- *Recall:* say the French for the garland, then the French for to decorate, then say *le réveillon* again

Before you move on

What does le réveillon mean? ("The festive late-night dinner (24 or 31 December)".) Say it once more.

319.2 réveillonner — to have the festive late-night dinner

Before the new one: say the French for to decorate, then the French for the festive late-night dinner.

You'll want to know: réveillonner

réveillonner — "to have the festive late-night dinner".

Nous avons réveillonné jusqu'à trois heures du matin.

We had our festive dinner until three in the morning.

On 24 December or 31 December.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réveillonner is built on *réveillon*, from *réveiller* "to wake up", which goes back to Latin *vigilāre* "to keep watch" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: réveillonner*
- *Say it: réveillonner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *réveillonner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to decorate, then the French for the festive late-night dinner, then say *réveillonner* again

Before you move on

What does réveillonner mean? ("To have the festive late-night dinner".) Say it once more.

319.3 le sapin — the fir tree; the Christmas tree

Before the new one: say the French for the festive late-night dinner, then the French for to have the festive late-night dinner.

You'll want to know: le sapin

le sapin — "the fir tree; the Christmas tree".

Les enfants décorent le sapin.

The children decorate the Christmas tree.

Decorated in December, often with *des guirlandes*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sapin is inherited from Latin *sappīnus* "a fir tree" (EtymDB), probably of Gaulish origin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sapin*
- *Say it: le sapin*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sapin*
- *Recall:* say the French for the festive late-night dinner, then the French for to have the festive late-night dinner, then say *le sapin* again

Before you move on

What does le sapin mean? ("The fir tree; the Christmas tree".) Say it once more.

319.4 la bûche — the log; the yule log cake

Before the new one: say the French for to have the festive late-night dinner, then the French for the fir tree.

You'll want to know: la bûche

la bûche — "the log; the yule log cake".

Pour le dessert, nous avons mangé une bûche au chocolat.

For dessert, we ate a chocolate yule log.

A rolled cake shaped like a log, eaten in December.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bûche comes from Old French *busche*, inherited from Vulgar Latin *busca* "firewood" (EtymDB), usually traced to a Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bûche*
- *Say it: la bûche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bûche*
- *Recall:* say the French for to have the festive late-night dinner, then the French for the fir tree, then say *la bûche* again

Before you move on

What does la bûche mean? ("The log; the yule log cake".) Say it once more.

319.5 la galette — the king cake; a flat round cake

Before the new one: say the French for the fir tree, then the French for the log.

You'll want to know: la galette

la galette — "the king cake; a flat round cake".

En janvier, on mange la galette des rois.

In January, people eat the king cake.

La galette des rois hides a small figure; whoever finds it wears the paper crown.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

galette is built on *galet* “a flat pebble”, a diminutive of an old word that is usually traced to Gaulish (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la galette*
- *Say it: la galette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la galette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fir tree, then the French for the log, then say *la galette* again

Before you move on

What does la galette mean? (“The king cake; a flat round cake”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 320

À votre santé !

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can raise a glass and make wishes: clinking glasses, a toast, wishing, candles and a wish.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 320: I can raise a glass and make wishes: clinking glasses, a toast, wishing, candles and a wish.*

320.1 trinquer — to clink glasses, to drink to

> Before the new one: say the French for the log, then the French for the king cake.

You'll want to know: trinquer

trinquer — "to clink glasses, to drink to".

> Nous avons trinqué aux mariés.
>
> *We clinked glasses to the bride and groom.*

Informal: *c'est moi qui ai trinqué* — I paid the price.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trinquer was borrowed from German *trinken* "to drink" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: trinquer*
- *Say it: trinquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *trinquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the log, then the French for the king cake, then say *trinquer* again

Before you move on

What does trinquer mean? ("To clink glasses, to drink to".) Say it once more.

320.2 le toast — the toast (with a drink); toasted bread

Before the new one: say the French for the king cake, then the French for to clink glasses.

You'll want to know: le toast

le toast — "the toast (with a drink); toasted bread".

Le père de la mariée a porté un toast.

The bride's father proposed a toast.

Porter un toast à quelqu'un — to drink to someone. Also a slice of toasted bread.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

toast is usually traced to English *toast* (EtymDB lists no parent), which comes from Old French *toster* "to grill", built on Latin *tostus* "roasted", from *torrēre* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le toast*
- *Say it: le toast*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le toast*
- *Recall:* say the French for the king cake, then the French for to clink glasses, then say *le toast* again

Before you move on

What does le toast mean? ("The toast (with a drink); toasted bread".) Say it once more.

320.3 souhaiter — to wish

Before the new one: say the French for to clink glasses, then the French for the toast.

You'll want to know: souhaiter

souhaiter — "to wish".

Je te souhaite un joyeux anniversaire.

I wish you a happy birthday.

Souhaiter que + subjunctive: *je souhaite qu'il vienne.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souhaiter comes from Old French *sohaidier* (EtymDB), built with *sub-* on a Germanic verb meaning "to promise, to command".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: souhaiter*
- *Say it: souhaiter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *souhaiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clink glasses, then the French for the toast, then say *souhaiter* again

Before you move on

What does souhaiter mean? ("To wish".) Say it once more.

320.4 la bougie — the candle; the spark plug

Before the new one: say the French for the toast, then the French for to wish.

You'll want to know: la bougie

la bougie — "the candle; the spark plug".

Elle a soufflé les trente bougies de son gâteau.

She blew out the thirty candles on her cake.

In an engine, *une bougie* is a spark plug.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bougie comes from the name of a North African port town that sold candle wax to Europe in the Middle Ages (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bougie*
- *Say it: la bougie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bougie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the toast, then the French for to wish, then say *la bougie* again

Before you move on

What does la bougie mean? ("The candle; the spark plug".) Say it once more.

320.5 le vœu — the wish; the vow

Before the new one: say the French for to wish, then the French for the candle.

You'll want to know: le vœu

le vœu — "the wish; the vow".

Elle a fait un vœu avant de souffler les bougies.

She made a wish before blowing out the candles.

Meilleurs vœux ! — best wishes for the new year.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vœu comes from Old French *vou* (EtymDB), inherited from Latin *vōtum* "a vow, a wish", from *vovēre* "to vow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le vœu*
- *Say it:* *le vœu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le vœu*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wish, then the French for the candle, then say *le vœu* again

Before you move on

What does le vœu mean? (“The wish; the vow”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 321

Il était une fois

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can start a fairy tale and name who lives in it: once upon a time, a fairy, a witch, a dragon, and a fable.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 321: I can start a fairy tale and name who lives in it: once upon a time, a fairy, a witch, a dragon, and a fable.*

321.1 il était une fois — once upon a time

> Before the new one: say the French for the candle, then the French for the wish.

You'll want to know: il était une fois

il était une fois — "once upon a time".

> Il était une fois une petite fille qui vivait dans la forêt.
>
> *Once upon a time there was a little girl who lived in the forest.*

The opening of most fairy tales. Literally 'there was one time'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fois is inherited from Latin *vicēs* "turns, times" (Lewis & Short); *était* is a form of *être*, whose imperfect is inherited from Latin *stāre* "to stand" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: il était une fois*
- *Say it: il était une fois*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *il était une fois*
- *Recall:* say the French for the candle, then the French for the wish, then say *il était une fois* again

Before you move on

What does il était une fois mean? ("Once upon a time".) Say it once more.

321.2 la fée — the fairy

Before the new one: say the French for the wish, then the French for once upon a time.

You'll want to know: la fée

la fée — "the fairy".

La bonne fée a aidé la jeune fille.

The good fairy helped the girl.

Une bonne fée — a fairy godmother.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fée is inherited from Vulgar Latin *Fāta* "goddess of fate" (EtymDB), built on Latin *fātum* "destiny".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fée*
- *Say it: la fée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the wish, then the French for once upon a time, then say *la fée* again

Before you move on

What does la fée mean? (“The fairy”.) Say it once more.

321.3 la sorcière — the witch

Before the new one: say the French for once upon a time, then the French for the fairy.

You’ll want to know: la sorcière

la sorcière — “the witch”.

La sorcière vivait seule dans une maison noire.

The witch lived alone in a black house.

The masculine *le sorcier* is a wizard.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sorcière is the feminine of *sorcier*, inherited from Vulgar Latin *sortiārius* “one who casts lots”, built on *sors* “a lot, fate” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sorcière*
- *Say it: la sorcière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la sorcière*
- *Recall:* say the French for once upon a time, then the French for the fairy, then say *la sorcière* again

Before you move on

What does la sorcière mean? (“The witch”.) Say it once more.

321.4 le dragon — the dragon

Before the new one: say the French for the fairy, then the French for the witch.

You’ll want to know: le dragon

le dragon — “the dragon”.

Le dragon dormait sur une montagne d’or.

The dragon was sleeping on a mountain of gold.

In old armies, *un dragon* was also a horse soldier.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dragon is inherited from Latin *dracō*, *dracōnem* (EtymDB), a borrowing from Greek *drákōn* “serpent”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dragon*
- *Say it: le dragon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le dragon*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fairy, then the French for the witch, then say *le dragon* again

Before you move on

What does le dragon mean? (“The dragon”.) Say it once more.

321.5 la fable — the fable

Before the new one: say the French for the witch, then the French for the dragon.

You’ll want to know: la fable

la fable — “the fable”.

Les enfants apprennent des fables à l’école.

Children learn fables at school.

French children learn fables by heart, with animals that talk.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fable comes from Old French *fable*, a learned borrowing from Latin *fābula* “a story” (EtymDB), built on *fārī* “to speak”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la fable*
- *Say it:* *la fable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fable*
- *Recall:* say the French for the witch, then the French for the dragon, then say *la fable* again

Before you move on

What does la fable mean? (“The fable”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 322

Le récit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about stories: an account, narrating, a legend, a myth and the moral.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 322: I can talk about stories: an account, narrating, a legend, a myth and the moral.*

322.1 le récit — the account, the story

> Before the new one: say the French for the dragon, then the French for the fable.

You'll want to know: le récit

le récit — "the account, the story".

> Son récit de voyage était très drôle.
>
> *His account of the trip was very funny.*

Un récit de voyage — a travel story.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

récit is built on *réciter* "to recite" (EtymDB), a learned borrowing from Latin *recitāre* "to read aloud".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le récit*
- *Say it: le récit*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le récit*
- *Recall:* say the French for the dragon, then the French for the fable, then say *le récit* again

Before you move on

What does le récit mean? ("The account, the story".) Say it once more.

322.2 narrer — to narrate, to tell

Before the new one: say the French for the fable, then the French for the account.

You'll want to know: narrer

narrer — "to narrate, to tell".

Le grand-père narrait des histoires de guerre.

The grandfather used to tell war stories.

Literary; in speech, *raconter*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

narrer is a learned borrowing from Latin *narrāre* "to tell, to relate" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: narrer*
- *Say it: narrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *narrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fable, then the French for the account, then say *narrer* again

Before you move on

What does narrer mean? (“To narrate, to tell”.) Say it once more.

322.3 la légende — the legend; the caption

Before the new one: say the French for the account, then the French for to narrate.

You’ll want to know: la légende

la légende — “the legend; the caption”.

Dans la légende, un dragon vivait dans ce lac.

In the legend, a dragon lived in this lake.

Under a photo or a map, *la légende* is the caption or the key.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

légende is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *legenda* “things to be read”, from *legere* “to read” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la légende*
- *Say it: la légende*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la légende*
- *Recall:* say the French for the account, then the French for to narrate, then say *la légende* again

Before you move on

What does la légende mean? ("The legend; the caption".) Say it once more.

322.4 le mythe — the myth

Before the new one: say the French for to narrate, then the French for the legend.

You'll want to know: le mythe

le mythe — "the myth".

Les mythes grecs parlent de dieux et de monstres.

Greek myths talk about gods and monsters.

Also a false belief: *c'est un mythe.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mythe comes from Late Latin *mythos*, a borrowing from Greek *mûthos* "word, story" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mythe*
- *Say it: le mythe*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le mythe*
- *Recall:* say the French for to narrate, then the French for the legend, then say *le mythe* again

Before you move on

What does le mythe mean? (“The myth”.) Say it once more.

322.5 la morale — the moral (of a story); morals

Before the new one: say the French for the legend, then the French for the myth.

You’ll want to know: la morale

la morale — “the moral (of a story); morals”.

La morale de cette histoire est simple.

The moral of this story is simple.

Faire la morale à quelqu’un — to lecture someone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

morale is a learned borrowing from Latin *mōrālis* “of manners”, built on *mōs* “custom, habit” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la morale*
- *Say it:* *la morale*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la morale*
- *Recall:* say the French for the legend, then the French for the myth, then say *la morale* again

Before you move on

What does la morale mean? (“The moral (of a story); morals”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 323

Le règne

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell the story of a king or queen: reigning, the reign, the throne, the crown and crowning.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 323: I can tell the story of a king or queen: reigning, the reign, the throne, the crown and crowning.*

323.1 régner — to reign, to rule

Before the new one: say the French for the myth, then the French for the moral.

You'll want to know: régner

régner — "to reign, to rule".

> Ce roi a régné pendant quarante ans.
>
> *This king reigned for forty years.*

Figurative: *le silence régnait* — silence reigned.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

régner comes from Old French *reignier*, from Latin *rēgnāre* "to rule" (EtymDB), built on *rēgnum* "kingship", from *rēx* "king" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: régner*
- *Say it: régner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *régner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the myth, then the French for the moral, then say *régner* again

Before you move on

What does régner mean? ("To reign, to rule".) Say it once more.

323.2 le règne — the reign

Before the new one: say the French for the moral, then the French for to reign.

You'll want to know: le règne

le règne — "the reign".

Pendant son règne, le pays a connu la paix.

During his reign, the country knew peace.

Also a kingdom in nature: *le règne animal*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

règne comes from Old French *regne*, from Latin *rēgnum* "kingship, authority" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le règne*
- *Say it: le règne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le règne*
- *Recall:* say the French for the moral, then the French for to reign, then say *le règne* again

Before you move on

What does le règne mean? (“The reign”.) Say it once more.

323.3 le trône — the throne

Before the new one: say the French for to reign, then the French for the reign.

You’ll want to know: le trône

le trône — “the throne”.

Le fils du roi est monté sur le trône.

The king’s son came to the throne.

Monter sur le trône — to come to the throne.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trône comes from Old French *trone*, from Latin *thronus* “throne” (EtymDB), a borrowing from Greek *thrónos* “a seat”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le trône*
- *Say it: le trône*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le trône*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reign, then the French for the reign, then say *le trône* again

Before you move on

What does le trône mean? ("The throne".) Say it once more.

323.4 la couronne — the crown; the wreath

Before the new one: say the French for the reign, then the French for the throne.

You'll want to know: la couronne

la couronne — "the crown; the wreath".

Le roi portait une couronne d'or.

The king wore a gold crown.

Also a ring of flowers or of bread: *une couronne de fleurs*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couronne is inherited from Latin *corōna* "a wreath, a crown" (EtymDB), itself a borrowing from Greek.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la couronne*
- *Say it: la couronne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la couronne*
- *Recall:* say the French for the reign, then the French for the throne, then say *la couronne* again

Before you move on

What does la couronne mean? ("The crown; the wreath".) Say it once more.

323.5 couronner — to crown

Before the new one: say the French for the throne, then the French for the crown.

You'll want to know: couronner

couronner — "to crown".

Le nouveau roi a été couronné dans la grande église.

The new king was crowned in the great church.

Figurative: *couronner une carrière* — to crown a career.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couronner is inherited from Latin *corōnāre* "to crown" (EtymDB), built on *corōna*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: couronner*
- *Say it: couronner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *couronner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the throne, then the French for the crown, then say *couronner* again

Before you move on

What does couronner mean? (“To crown”.) Say it once more.

323.6 Retour sur les chapitres 316–323

Say the French for to celebrate and the celebration.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to celebrate, the celebration, the procession, the brass band, the public holiday
- the parade, to march past, the carnival, the float, to dress up
- the fireworks, the firecracker, the dance, the garland, to decorate
- the festive late-night dinner, to have the festive late-night dinner, the fir tree, the log, the king cake
- to clink glasses, the toast, to wish, the candle, the wish
- once upon a time, the fairy, the witch, the dragon, the fable
- the account, to narrate, the legend, the myth, the moral
- to reign, the reign, the throne, the crown, to crown

Before you move on

To celebrate? (**célébrer**.) The celebration? (**la célébration**.) The procession? (**le cortège**.) The brass band? (**la fanfare**.) The public holiday? (**le jour férié**.) The parade? (**le défilé**.) To march past? (**défiler**.) The carnival? (**le carnaval**.) The float? (**le char**.) To dress up? (**déguiser**.) The fireworks? (**le feu d'artifice**.) The firecracker? (**le pétard**.) The dance? (**le bal**.) The garland? (**la guirlande**.) To decorate? (**décorer**.) The festive late-night dinner? (**le réveillon**.) To have the festive late-night dinner? (**réveillonner**.) The fir tree? (**le sapin**.) The log? (**la bûche**.) The king cake? (**la galette**.) To clink glasses? (**trinquer**.) The toast? (**le toast**.) To wish? (**souhaiter**.) The candle? (**la bougie**.) The wish? (**le vœu**.) Once upon a time? (**il était une fois**.) The fairy? (**la fée**.) The witch? (**la sorcière**.) The dragon? (**le dragon**.) The fable? (**la fable**.) The account? (**le récit**.) To narrate? (**narrer**.) The legend? (**la légende**.) The myth? (**le mythe**.) The moral? (**la morale**.) To reign? (**régner**.) The reign? (**le règne**.) The throne? (**le trône**.) The crown? (**la couronne**.) To crown? (**couronner**.)

Chapter 324

La conquête

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about wars of long ago: invading, an invasion, conquering, a conquest and defeating an enemy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 324: I can talk about wars of long ago: invading, an invasion, conquering, a conquest and defeating an enemy.*

324.1 envahir — to invade; to overrun

> Before the new one: say the French for the crown, then the French for to crown.

You'll want to know: envahir

envahir — "to invade; to overrun".

> L'armée a envahi le pays voisin.
>
> *The army invaded the neighbouring country.*

Figurative: *les touristes envahissent la plage.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

envahir is inherited from Vulgar Latin *invādīre*, from Latin *invādere* "to go into, to attack" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: envahir*
- *Say it: envahir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *envahir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the crown, then the French for to crown, then say *envahir* again

Before you move on

What does envahir mean? ("To invade; to overrun".) Say it once more.

324.2 l'invasion — the invasion

Before the new one: say the French for to crown, then the French for to invade.

You'll want to know: l'invasion

l'invasion — "the invasion".

L'invasion a commencé au printemps.

The invasion began in the spring.

Figurative: *une invasion de moustiques.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

invasion is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *invāsiō* (EtymDB), from *invādere* "to go into".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'invasion*
- *Say it: l'invasion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'invasion*
- *Recall:* say the French for to crown, then the French for to invade, then say *l'invasion* again

Before you move on

What does l'invasion mean? ("The invasion".) Say it once more.

324.3 conquérir — to conquer; to win over

Before the new one: say the French for to invade, then the French for the invasion.

You'll want to know: conquérir

conquérir — "to conquer; to win over".

Ils ont conquis toute la région en un an.

They conquered the whole region in a year.

Past participle *conquis*. Also *conquérir le public* — to win the audience over.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conquérir comes from Old French *conquerre*, from Vulgar Latin *conquaerere* "to seek to gain" (EtymDB), built on *quaerere* "to seek".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: conquérir*
- *Say it: conquérir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *conquérir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to invade, then the French for the invasion, then say *conquérir* again

Before you move on

What does conquérir mean? ("To conquer; to win over".) Say it once more.

324.4 la conquête — the conquest

Before the new one: say the French for the invasion, then the French for to conquer.

You'll want to know: la conquête

la conquête — "the conquest".

La conquête de l'espace a commencé en 1957.

The conquest of space began in 1957.

Informal: *sa dernière conquête* — his latest girlfriend or boyfriend.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conquête comes from Old French *conqueste*, usually traced to Vulgar Latin *conquaesita* "things sought and won", built on *quaerere* "to seek" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la conquête*
- *Say it: la conquête*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la conquête*
- *Recall:* say the French for the invasion, then the French for to conquer, then say *la conquête* again

Before you move on

What does la conquête mean? ("The conquest".) Say it once more.

324.5 vaincre — to defeat, to overcome

Before the new one: say the French for to conquer, then the French for the conquest.

You'll want to know: vaincre

vaincre — "to defeat, to overcome".

L'armée a vaincu l'ennemi en trois jours.

The army defeated the enemy in three days.

Irregular: *il a vaincu*, *nous vainquons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vaincre comes from Old French *veintre* (EtymDB), inherited from Latin *vincere* "to conquer" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vaincre*
- *Say it:* *vaincre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *vaincre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to conquer, then the French for the conquest, then say *vaincre* again

Before you move on

What does vaincre mean? (“To defeat, to overcome”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 325

Les traces du passé

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about people who study the past and what they find: the historian, ancestors, heritage, the archaeologist and a dig.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 325: I can talk about people who study the past and what they find: the historian, ancestors, heritage, the archaeologist and a dig.*

325.1 l'historien — the historian

> Before the new one: say the French for the conquest, then the French for to defeat.

You'll want to know: l'historien

l'historien — "the historian".

> Les historiens ne sont pas d'accord sur cette date.
>
> *Historians do not agree on this date.*

Feminine: *l'historienne*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

historien is built on *histoire*, from Latin *historia*, a borrowing from Greek *historía* "inquiry, knowledge" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'historien*
- *Say it: l'historien*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'historien*
- *Recall:* say the French for the conquest, then the French for to defeat, then say *l'historien* again

Before you move on

What does l'historien mean? ("The historian".) Say it once more.

325.2 l'ancêtre — the ancestor

Before the new one: say the French for to defeat, then the French for the historian.

You'll want to know: l'ancêtre

l'ancêtre — "the ancestor".

Mes ancêtres vivaient dans ce village.

My ancestors lived in this village.

Also a forerunner: *l'ancêtre du vélo.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ancêtre comes from Old French *ancestre* (EtymDB), inherited from Latin *antecessor* "one who goes before", from *ante* and *cēdere*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ancêtre*
- *Say it: l'ancêtre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'ancêtre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to defeat, then the French for the historian, then say *l'ancêtre* again

Before you move on

What does l'ancêtre mean? ("The ancestor".) Say it once more.

325.3 le patrimoine — heritage; an estate

Before the new one: say the French for the historian, then the French for the ancestor.

You'll want to know: le patrimoine

le patrimoine — "heritage; an estate".

Ce château fait partie du patrimoine du pays.

This castle is part of the country's heritage.

Le patrimoine culturel — cultural heritage.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

patrimoine is a learned borrowing from Latin *patrimōnium* "an inheritance from a father" (EtymDB), built on *pater* "father".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le patrimoine*
- *Say it: le patrimoine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le patrimoine*
- *Recall:* say the French for the historian, then the French for the ancestor, then say *le patrimoine* again

Before you move on

What does le patrimoine mean? ("Heritage; an estate".) Say it once more.

325.4 l'archéologue — the archaeologist

Before the new one: say the French for the ancestor, then the French for heritage.

You'll want to know: l'archéologue

l'archéologue — "the archaeologist".

Les archéologues ont trouvé des pièces très anciennes.

The archaeologists found some very old coins.

The science is *l'archéologie*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

archéologue is a learned word built from Greek *arkhaîos* "ancient" and *-logos* "one who studies" (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'archéologue*
- *Say it: l'archéologue*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'archéologue*
- *Recall:* say the French for the ancestor, then the French for heritage, then say *l'archéologue* again

Before you move on

What does l'archéologue mean? ("The archaeologist".) Say it once more.

325.5 la fouille — the dig, the excavation; a search

Before the new one: say the French for heritage, then the French for the archaeologist.

You'll want to know: la fouille

la fouille — "the dig, the excavation; a search".

Les fouilles ont duré trois ans.

The dig went on for three years.

Also a search, by the police or at an airport.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fouille is built on *fouiller* "to dig, to search", usually traced to Vulgar Latin *fodiculāre* (EtymDB lists no parent), built on Latin *fodere* "to dig" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fouille*
- *Say it: la fouille*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fouille*
- *Recall:* say the French for heritage, then the French for the archaeologist, then say *la fouille* again

Before you move on

What does la fouille mean? (“The dig, the excavation; a search”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 326

La libération

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about freedom and remembrance: freeing, liberation, resisting, the resistance and commemorating.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 326: I can talk about freedom and remembrance: freeing, liberation, resisting, the resistance and commemorating.*

326.1 libérer — to free, to set free

> Before the new one: say the French for the archaeologist, then the French for the dig.

You'll want to know: libérer

libérer — "to free, to set free".

> Les soldats ont libéré la ville.
>
> *The soldiers freed the town.*

Also of a room: *libérer la chambre* — to check out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

libérer is a learned borrowing from Latin *līberāre* "to set free" (EtymDB), built on *līber* "free".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: libérer*
- *Say it: libérer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *libérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the archaeologist, then the French for the dig, then say *libérer* again

Before you move on

What does libérer mean? ("To free, to set free".) Say it once more.

326.2 la libération — the liberation, the release

Before the new one: say the French for the dig, then the French for to free.

You'll want to know: la libération

la libération — "the liberation, the release".

La libération de la ville a été une grande fête.

The liberation of the town was a great celebration.

La libération d'un otage — the release of a hostage.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

libération is a learned borrowing from Latin *līberātiō* "a setting free, a release" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la libération*
- *Say it: la libération*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la libération*
- *Recall:* say the French for the dig, then the French for to free, then say *la libération* again

Before you move on

What does la libération mean? ("The liberation, the release".) Say it once more.

326.3 résister — to resist, to hold out

Before the new one: say the French for to free, then the French for the liberation.

You'll want to know: résister

résister — "to resist, to hold out".

Le petit village a résisté pendant des mois.

The little village held out for months.

Résister à — to resist: *résister à l'ennemi.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

résister is a learned borrowing from Latin *resistere* "to stand back, to withstand" (EtymDB), built on *sistere*, from *stāre* "to stand".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: résister*
- *Say it: résister*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *résister*
- *Recall:* say the French for to free, then the French for the liberation, then say *résister* again

Before you move on

What does résister mean? ("To resist, to hold out".) Say it once more.

326.4 la résistance — the resistance; stamina

Before the new one: say the French for the liberation, then the French for to resist.

You'll want to know: la résistance

la résistance — "the resistance; stamina".

Ses grands-parents ont fait partie de la Résistance.

His grandparents were part of the Resistance.

Also stamina: *avoir de la résistance.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

résistance is built on *résister*, a learned borrowing from Latin *resistere* "to withstand" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la résistance*
- *Say it: la résistance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la résistance*
- *Recall:* say the French for the liberation, then the French for to resist, then say *la résistance* again

Before you move on

What does la résistance mean? ("The resistance; stamina".) Say it once more.

326.5 commémorer — to commemorate

Before the new one: say the French for to resist, then the French for the resistance.

You'll want to know: commémorer

commémorer — "to commemorate".

Chaque année, la ville commémore la fin de la guerre.

Every year, the town commemorates the end of the war.

The noun is *la commémoration*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

commémorer is a learned borrowing from Latin *commemorāre* "to call to mind" (EtymDB), from *con-* and *memor* "mindful".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *commémorer*
- *Say it:* *commémorer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *commémorer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to resist, then the French for the resistance, then say *commémorer* again

Before you move on

What does commémorer mean? ("To commemorate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 327

La recette

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a recipe: the recipe, the ingredients, a pinch, a spoonful and preheating the oven.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 327: I can talk about a recipe: the recipe, the ingredients, a pinch, a spoonful and preheating the oven.*

327.1 la recette — the recipe; the takings

> Before the new one: say the French for the resistance, then the French for to commemorate.

You'll want to know: la recette

la recette — "the recipe; the takings".

> Ma grand-mère m'a donné sa recette de tarte.
>
> *My grandmother gave me her tart recipe.*

In a shop, *la recette* is the day's takings.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recette comes from Old French *recete*, from Latin *recepta* "things received" (EtymDB), from *recipere* "to take back, to receive".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la recette*
- *Say it: la recette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la recette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the resistance, then the French for to commemorate, then say *la recette* again

Before you move on

What does la recette mean? ("The recipe; the takings".) Say it once more.

327.2 l'ingrédient — the ingredient

Before the new one: say the French for to commemorate, then the French for the recipe.

You'll want to know: l'ingrédient

l'ingrédient — "the ingredient".

Elle a acheté tous les ingrédients au marché.

She bought all the ingredients at the market.

Masculine: *un ingrédient.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ingrédient is a learned borrowing from Latin *ingrediēns* "going in" (EtymDB), from *ingredī* "to enter", built on *gradī* "to step".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ingrédient*
- *Say it: l'ingrédient*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'ingrédient*
- *Recall:* say the French for to commemorate, then the French for the recipe, then say *l'ingrédient* again

Before you move on

What does l'ingrédient mean? ("The ingredient".) Say it once more.

327.3 la pincée — the pinch (of salt, of pepper)

Before the new one: say the French for the recipe, then the French for the ingredient.

You'll want to know: la pincée

la pincée — "the pinch (of salt, of pepper)".

Il ajoute une pincée de sel.

He adds a pinch of salt.

As much as you hold between two fingers.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pincée is built on *pincer* "to pinch", whose origin is not settled (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pincée*
- *Say it: la pincée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la pincée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the recipe, then the French for the ingredient, then say *la pincée* again

Before you move on

What does la pincée mean? ("The pinch (of salt, of pepper)".) Say it once more.

327.4 la cuillerée — the spoonful

Before the new one: say the French for the ingredient, then the French for the pinch.

You'll want to know: la cuillerée

la cuillerée — "the spoonful".

Elle met deux cuillerées de sucre dans son café.

She puts two spoonfuls of sugar in her coffee.

Also spelt *cuillérée*. *Une cuillerée à soupe* — a tablespoonful.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuillerée is built on *cuiller* "spoon" (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *cochlear* "a spoon" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cuillerée*
- *Say it: la cuillerée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la cuillerée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the ingredient, then the French for the pinch, then say *la cuillerée* again

Before you move on

What does la cuillerée mean? ("The spoonful".) Say it once more.

327.5 préchauffer — to preheat

Before the new one: say the French for the pinch, then the French for the spoonful.

You'll want to know: préchauffer

préchauffer — "to preheat".

Il préchauffe le four à 180 degrés.

He preheats the oven to 180 degrees.

Préchauffer le four is the first line of many recipes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préchauffer is built on *pré-* "before" and *chauffer* "to heat", which is inherited from Latin *calefacere* "to make warm" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *préchauffer*
- *Say it:* *préchauffer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *préchauffer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pinch, then the French for the spoonful, then say *préchauffer* again

Before you move on

What does préchauffer mean? (“To preheat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 328

Couper les légumes

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe getting vegetables ready: the chopping board, peeling, chopping, slicing thinly and grating.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 328: I can describe getting vegetables ready: the chopping board, peeling, chopping, slicing thinly and grating.*

328.1 la planche à découper — the chopping board

Before the new one: say the French for the spoonful, then the French for to preheat.

You'll want to know: la planche à découper

la planche à découper — "the chopping board".

> Les légumes sont sur la planche à découper.
>
> *The vegetables are on the chopping board.*

Une planche alone is a plank or a board.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

planche is inherited from Late Latin *planca* "a board" (EtymDB); *découper* is built on *couper* "to cut", from *coup* "a blow".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la planche à découper*
- *Say it: la planche à découper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la planche à découper*
- *Recall:* say the French for the spoonful, then the French for to preheat, then say *la planche à découper* again

Before you move on

What does la planche à découper mean? ("The chopping board".) Say it once more.

328.2 éplucher — to peel

Before the new one: say the French for to preheat, then the French for the chopping board.

You'll want to know: éplucher

éplucher — "to peel".

Mon père épluche les pommes de terre.

My father is peeling the potatoes.

Figurative: *éplucher un texte* — to go through it in detail.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éplucher is built on Old French *peluchier* "to pick at", from Vulgar Latin *piluccāre* (EtymDB), a verb usually traced to *pilus* "a hair" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: éplucher*
- *Say it: éplucher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *éplucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to preheat, then the French for the chopping board, then say *éplucher* again

Before you move on

What does éplucher mean? ("To peel".) Say it once more.

328.3 hacher — to chop, to mince

Before the new one: say the French for the chopping board, then the French for to peel.

You'll want to know: hacher

hacher — "to chop, to mince".

Elle hache les oignons très fin.

She chops the onions very finely.

La viande hachée — minced meat; *un steak haché* — a burger patty.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hacher is built on *hache* “axe”, which comes from a Frankish word *hapja* (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: hacher*
- *Say it: hacher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *hacher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the chopping board, then the French for to peel, then say *hacher* again

Before you move on

What does hacher mean? (“To chop, to mince”.) Say it once more.

328.4 émincer — to slice thinly

Before the new one: say the French for to peel, then the French for to chop.

You’ll want to know: émincer

émincer — “to slice thinly”.

Le cuisinier émince les poivrons.

The cook slices the peppers thinly.

A cooking word; *couper en fines tranches* says the same.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

émincer is built on *mince* "thin", from Old French *mincier* "to cut fine", usually traced to Vulgar Latin *minūtiāre*, built on *minūtus* "small" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: émincer*
- *Say it: émincer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *émincer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to peel, then the French for to chop, then say *émincer* again

Before you move on

What does émincer mean? ("To slice thinly".) Say it once more.

328.5 râper — to grate

Before the new one: say the French for to chop, then the French for to slice thinly.

You'll want to know: râper

râper — "to grate".

Il râpe du fromage sur les pâtes.

He grates cheese over the pasta.

Le fromage râpé — grated cheese; the tool is *la râpe*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

râper comes from a Germanic verb meaning "to scrape together" (EtymDB lists Old High German *raspōn* beside it).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: râper*
- *Say it: râper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *râper*
- *Recall:* say the French for to chop, then the French for to slice thinly, then say *râper* again

Before you move on

What does râper mean? ("To grate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 329

Battre les œufs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe mixing: the mixing bowl, pouring, beating, the whisk and whisking.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 329: I can describe mixing: the mixing bowl, pouring, beating, the whisk and whisking.*

329.1 le saladier — the salad bowl, the mixing bowl

Before the new one: say the French for to slice thinly, then the French for to grate.

You'll want to know: le saladier

le saladier — "the salad bowl, the mixing bowl".

> Elle met la farine dans un grand saladier.
>
> *She puts the flour in a big bowl.*

Built on *salade*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

saladier is built on *salade*, which EtymDB traces to Italian *salata* "something salted" (Provençal *salada* is also proposed), built on Latin

sal “salt” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le saladier*
- *Say it: le saladier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le saladier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to slice thinly, then the French for to grate, then say *le saladier* again

Before you move on

What does le saladier mean? (“The salad bowl, the mixing bowl”.) Say it once more.

329.2 verser — to pour; to pay in

Before the new one: say the French for to grate, then the French for the salad bowl.

You’ll want to know: verser

verser — “to pour; to pay in”.

Il verse le lait dans le saladier.

He pours the milk into the bowl.

Also to pay money in: *verser un salaire*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verser is inherited from Latin *versāre* “to turn often” (EtymDB), built on *vertere* “to turn”.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *verser*
- *Say it:* *verser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *verser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to grate, then the French for the salad bowl, then say *verser* again

Before you move on

What does verser mean? ("To pour; to pay in".) Say it once more.

329.3 battre — to beat

Before the new one: say the French for the salad bowl, then the French for to pour.

You'll want to know: battre

battre — "to beat".

Elle bat les œufs avec une fourchette.

She beats the eggs with a fork.

Battre les blancs en neige — to beat egg whites until stiff. Also to beat someone at a game.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

battre is inherited from Late Latin *battere* "to beat" (EtymDB), from Latin *battuere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *battre*
- *Say it:* *battre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *battre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the salad bowl, then the French for to pour, then say *battre* again

Before you move on

What does battre mean? (“To beat”.) Say it once more.

329.4 le fouet — the whisk; the whip

Before the new one: say the French for to pour, then the French for to beat.

You’ll want to know: le fouet

le fouet — “the whisk; the whip”.

Il mélange la crème avec un fouet.

He mixes the cream with a whisk.

Un coup de fouet — a boost.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fouet is usually explained as a diminutive of Old French *fou* “beech”, from Latin *fāgus* “beech” (Lewis & Short): first a beech switch.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fouet*
- *Say it: le fouet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le fouet*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pour, then the French for to beat, then say *le fouet* again

Before you move on

What does le fouet mean? (“The whisk; the whip”.) Say it once more.

329.5 fouetter — to whisk, to whip

Before the new one: say the French for to beat, then the French for the whisk.

You’ll want to know: fouetter

fouetter — “to whisk, to whip”.

Elle fouette la crème pendant cinq minutes.

She whips the cream for five minutes.

La crème fouettée — whipped cream.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fouetter is built on *fouet* “whip, whisk” (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: fouetter*
- *Say it: fouetter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *fouetter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to beat, then the French for the whisk, then say *fouetter* again

Before you move on

What does fouetter mean? ("To whisk, to whip".) Say it once more.

Chapter 330

Sur le feu

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe cooking on the hob: boiling, the boil, a big pot, simmering and the cast-iron pot.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 330: I can describe cooking on the hob: boiling, the boil, a big pot, simmering and the cast-iron pot.*

330.1 bouillir — to boil

> Before the new one: say the French for the whisk, then the French for to whisk.

You'll want to know: bouillir

bouillir — "to boil".

> L'eau bout depuis cinq minutes.
>
> *The water has been boiling for five minutes.*

Irregular: *l'eau bout*, *elle a bouilli*. *Faire bouillir* — to bring to the boil.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouillir is inherited through Old French *boillir* from Latin *bullīre* "to bubble, to boil" (EtymDB), built on *bulla* "a bubble".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: bouillir*
- *Say it: bouillir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bouillir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the whisk, then the French for to whisk, then say *bouillir* again

Before you move on

What does bouillir mean? ("To boil".) Say it once more.

330.2 l'ébullition — boiling, the boiling point

Before the new one: say the French for to whisk, then the French for to boil.

You'll want to know: l'ébullition

l'ébullition — "boiling, the boiling point".

Il met les pâtes quand l'eau arrive à ébullition.

He puts the pasta in when the water comes to the boil.

Porter à ébullition — to bring to the boil.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ébullition is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *ēbullītiō* "a bubbling up" (EtymDB), built on *bulla* "a bubble".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ébullition*
- *Say it: l'ébullition*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'ébullition*
- *Recall:* say the French for to whisk, then the French for to boil, then say *l'ébullition* again

Before you move on

What does l'ébullition mean? ("Boiling, the boiling point".) Say it once more.

330.3 la marmite — the cooking pot, the stockpot

Before the new one: say the French for to boil, then the French for boiling.

You'll want to know: la marmite

la marmite — "the cooking pot, the stockpot".

La soupe cuit dans une grande marmite.

The soup is cooking in a big pot.

A large pot with a lid and two handles.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *marmite* is not settled; an Old French adjective *marmite* "hypocritical" is listed beside it (EtymDB), perhaps a pot that hides what it holds.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la marmite*
- *Say it: la marmite*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la marmite*
- *Recall:* say the French for to boil, then the French for boiling, then say *la marmite* again

Before you move on

What does la marmite mean? ("The cooking pot, the stockpot".) Say it once more.

330.4 mijoter — to simmer; to cook up (a plan)

Before the new one: say the French for boiling, then the French for the cooking pot.

You'll want to know: mijoter

mijoter — "to simmer; to cook up (a plan)".

La soupe mijote doucement.

The soup is simmering gently.

Informal: *qu'est-ce que tu mijotes ?* — what are you up to?

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *mijoter* is not settled; it is usually linked to an old dialect word for a place where fruit ripens (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: mijoter*
- *Say it: mijoter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *mijoter*
- *Recall:* say the French for boiling, then the French for the cooking pot, then say *mijoter* again

Before you move on

What does mijoter mean? ("To simmer; to cook up (a plan)".) Say it once more.

330.5 la cocotte — the casserole dish, the cast-iron pot

Before the new one: say the French for the cooking pot, then the French for to simmer.

You'll want to know: la cocotte

la cocotte — "the casserole dish, the cast-iron pot".

Elle fait cuire le poulet dans une cocotte.

She cooks the chicken in a casserole dish.

La cocotte-minute — the pressure cooker. In baby talk, *une cocotte* is a hen.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *cocotte* is not settled: one sense is a child's word for a hen, the other an older word for a pot (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la cocotte*
- *Say it:* *la cocotte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la cocotte*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cooking pot, then the French for to simmer, then say *la cocotte* again

Before you move on

What does la cocotte mean? (“The casserole dish, the cast-iron pot”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 331

Au four

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe baking: the tin, putting a dish in the oven, the cooking time, turning golden and browning on top.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 331: I can describe baking: the tin, putting a dish in the oven, the cooking time, turning golden and browning on top.*

331.1 le moule — the baking tin, the mould

> Before the new one: say the French for to simmer, then the French for the casserole dish.

You'll want to know: le moule

le moule — "the baking tin, the mould".

> Elle verse la pâte dans le moule.
>
> *She pours the mixture into the tin.*

Masculine; *la moule* is a mussel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moule comes from Old French *modle*, inherited from Latin *modulus* "a small measure" (EtymDB), built on *modus* "measure".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le moule*
- *Say it: le moule*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le moule*
- *Recall:* say the French for to simmer, then the French for the casserole dish, then say *le moule* again

Before you move on

What does le moule mean? ("The baking tin, the mould".) Say it once more.

331.2 enfourner — to put in the oven

Before the new one: say the French for the casserole dish, then the French for the baking tin.

You'll want to know: enfourner

enfourner — "to put in the oven".

Il enfourne le gâteau pour quarante minutes.

He puts the cake in the oven for forty minutes.

Informal: to gobble up food.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enfourner is built on *en-* and *four* "oven", which is inherited from Latin *furnus* "an oven" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: enfourner*
- *Say it: enfourner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *enfourner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the casserole dish, then the French for the baking tin, then say *enfourner* again

Before you move on

What does enfourner mean? ("To put in the oven".) Say it once more.

331.3 la cuisson — the cooking, the cooking time

Before the new one: say the French for the baking tin, then the French for to put in the oven.

You'll want to know: la cuisson

la cuisson — "the cooking, the cooking time".

La cuisson du gâteau dure quarante minutes.

The cake takes forty minutes to cook.

For meat: *quelle cuisson ?* — how would you like it cooked?

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cuisson is usually traced to Latin *coctiō* "a cooking", from *coquere* "to cook" (Lewis & Short), reshaped after *cuire*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cuisson*
- *Say it: la cuisson*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la cuisson*
- *Recall:* say the French for the baking tin, then the French for to put in the oven, then say *la cuisson* again

Before you move on

What does la cuisson mean? ("The cooking, the cooking time".) Say it once more.

331.4 dorer — to turn golden, to brown; to gild

Before the new one: say the French for to put in the oven, then the French for the cooking.

You'll want to know: dorer

dorer — "to turn golden, to brown; to gild".

Le poulet dore lentement au four.

The chicken is slowly turning golden in the oven.

Faire dorer les oignons — to brown the onions.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dorer is inherited through Old French *dorer* (EtymDB) from Latin *deaurāre* "to gild", built on *aurum* "gold" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dorer*
- *Say it: dorer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dorer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put in the oven, then the French for the cooking, then say *dorer* again

Before you move on

What does dorer mean? ("To turn golden, to brown; to gild".) Say it once more.

331.5 gratiner — to brown on top, to cook with a crust

Before the new one: say the French for the cooking, then the French for to turn golden.

You'll want to know: gratiner

gratiner — "to brown on top, to cook with a crust".

Elle fait gratiner les pâtes avec du fromage.

She browns the pasta with cheese on top.

Un gratin — a dish browned in the oven, often with cheese.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gratiner is built on *gratin*, the crust scraped from the dish, from the verb meaning "to scrape", which is usually traced to a Frankish word (EtymDB lists no parent).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: gratiner*
- *Say it: gratiner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *gratiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cooking, then the French for to turn golden, then say *gratiner* again

Before you move on

What does gratiner mean? (“To brown on top, to cook with a crust”.) Say it once more.

331.6 Retour sur les chapitres 324–331

Say the French for to invade and the invasion.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to invade, the invasion, to conquer, the conquest, to defeat
- the historian, the ancestor, heritage, the archaeologist, the dig
- to free, the liberation, to resist, the resistance, to commemorate
- the recipe, the ingredient, the pinch, the spoonful, to preheat
- the chopping board, to peel, to chop, to slice thinly, to grate
- the salad bowl, to pour, to beat, the whisk, to whisk
- to boil, boiling, the cooking pot, to simmer, the casserole dish
- the baking tin, to put in the oven, the cooking, to turn golden, to brown on top

Before you move on

To invade? (**envahir**.) The invasion? (**l'invasion**.) To conquer? (**conquérir**.) The conquest? (**la conquête**.) To defeat? (**vaincre**.) The historian? (**l'historien**.) The ancestor? (**l'ancêtre**.) Heritage? (**le patrimoine**.) The archaeologist? (**l'archéologue**.) The dig? (**la fouille**.) To free? (**libérer**.) The liberation? (**la libération**.) To resist? (**résister**.) The resistance? (**la résistance**.) To commemorate? (**commémorer**.) The recipe? (**la recette**.) The ingredient? (**l'ingrédient**.) The pinch? (**la pincée**.) The spoonful? (**la cuillerée**.) To preheat? (**préchauffer**.) The chopping board? (**la planche à découper**.) To peel? (**éplucher**.) To chop? (**hacher**.) To slice thinly? (**émincer**.) To grate? (**râper**.) The salad bowl? (**le saladier**.) To pour? (**verser**.) To beat? (**battre**.) The whisk? (**le fouet**.) To whisk? (**fouetter**.) To boil? (**bouillir**.) Boiling? (**l'ébullition**.) The cooking pot? (**la marmite**.) To simmer? (**mijoter**.) The casserole dish? (**la cocotte**.) The baking tin? (**le moule**.) To put in the oven? (**enfourner**.) The cooking? (**la cuisson**.) To turn golden? (**dorer**.) To brown on top? (**gratiner**.)

Chapter 332

Assaisonner

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe finishing a dish: the colander, draining, sprinkling, seasoning and tasting.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 332: I can describe finishing a dish: the colander, draining, sprinkling, seasoning and tasting.*

332.1 la passoire — the colander, the sieve

> Before the new one: say the French for to turn golden, then the French for to brown on top.

You'll want to know: la passoire

la passoire — "the colander, the sieve".

> Il met les pâtes dans la passoire.
>
> *He puts the pasta in the colander.*

Informal: *une mémoire comme une passoire* — a memory like a sieve.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

passoire is built on *passer* "to pass", which is inherited from Vulgar Latin *passāre*, built on Latin *passus* "a step" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la passoire*
- *Say it: la passoire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la passoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to turn golden, then the French for to brown on top, then say *la passoire* again

Before you move on

What does la passoire mean? ("The colander, the sieve".) Say it once more.

332.2 égoutter — to drain

Before the new one: say the French for to brown on top, then the French for the colander.

You'll want to know: égoutter

égoutter — "to drain".

Elle égoutte les pâtes.

She drains the pasta.

Laisser égoutter — to leave to drain.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

égoutter is built on *goutte* "a drop", which is inherited from Latin *gutta* "a drop" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *égoutter*
- *Say it:* *égoutter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *égoutter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to brown on top, then the French for the colander, then say *égoutter* again

Before you move on

What does égoutter mean? (“To drain”.) Say it once more.

332.3 saupoudrer — to sprinkle, to dust

Before the new one: say the French for the colander, then the French for to drain.

You’ll want to know: saupoudrer

saupoudrer — “to sprinkle, to dust”.

Il saupoudre le gâteau de sucre.

He dusts the cake with sugar.

Saupoudrer de — to dust with.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

saupoudrer is built from *sel* “salt” and *poudrer* “to powder” (EtymDB); *poudre* goes back to Latin *pulvis* “dust”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: saupoudrer*
- *Say it: saupoudrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *saupoudrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the colander, then the French for to drain, then say *saupoudrer* again

Before you move on

What does saupoudrer mean? ("To sprinkle, to dust".) Say it once more.

332.4 assaisonner — to season

Before the new one: say the French for to drain, then the French for to sprinkle.

You'll want to know: assaisonner

assaisonner — "to season".

Elle assaisonne la salade avec de l'huile et du vinaigre.

She dresses the salad with oil and vinegar.

L'assaisonnement — the seasoning, the dressing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

assaisonner is built on *saison* "season, the right time", usually traced to Latin *satiō* "a sowing" (Lewis & Short): to bring food to the right point.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: assaisonner*
- *Say it: assaisonner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *assaisonner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drain, then the French for to sprinkle, then say *assaisonner* again

Before you move on

What does assaisonner mean? (“To season”.) Say it once more.

332.5 déguster — to taste, to savour

Before the new one: say the French for to sprinkle, then the French for to season.

You’ll want to know: déguster

déguster — “to taste, to savour”.

Nous avons dégusté les fromages de la région.

We tasted the cheeses of the region.

To eat or drink slowly, with pleasure. Informal: *il a dégusté* — he really suffered.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déguster is a learned borrowing from Latin *dēgustāre* “to taste” (EtymDB), built on *gustus* “taste”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *déguster*
- *Say it:* *déguster*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déguster*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sprinkle, then the French for to season, then say *déguster* again

Before you move on

What does déguster mean? (“To taste, to savour”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 333

Faire du pain

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe making dough: yeast, kneading, the rolling pin, rolling out and turning out a cake.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 333: I can describe making dough: yeast, kneading, the rolling pin, rolling out and turning out a cake.*

333.1 la levure — the yeast; baking powder

> Before the new one: say the French for to season, then the French for to taste.

You'll want to know: la levure

la levure — "the yeast; baking powder".

> Le boulanger met de la levure dans la pâte.
>
> *The baker puts yeast in the dough.*

La levure chimique — baking powder.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

levure is built on *lever* "to raise", which is inherited from Latin *levāre* "to lift" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la levure*
- *Say it: la levure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la levure*
- *Recall:* say the French for to season, then the French for to taste, then say *la levure* again

Before you move on

What does la levure mean? ("The yeast; baking powder".) Say it once more.

333.2 pétrir — to knead

Before the new one: say the French for to taste, then the French for the yeast.

You'll want to know: pétrir

pétrir — "to knead".

Le boulanger pétrit la pâte pendant dix minutes.

The baker kneads the dough for ten minutes.

Regular, like *finir*: *il pétrit*, *nous pétrissons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pétrir is usually traced to Late Latin *pistrīre* "to knead", built on *pistor* "a miller, a baker" (Lewis & Short); EtymDB lists no parent.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: pétrir*
- *Say it: pétrir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *pétrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to taste, then the French for the yeast, then say *pétrir* again

Before you move on

What does pétrir mean? ("To knead".) Say it once more.

333.3 le rouleau à pâtisserie — the rolling pin

Before the new one: say the French for the yeast, then the French for to knead.

You'll want to know: le rouleau à pâtisserie

le rouleau à pâtisserie — "the rolling pin".

Le rouleau à pâtisserie est dans le tiroir.

The rolling pin is in the drawer.

Un rouleau alone is a roll: *un rouleau de papier.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rouleau is built on *rôle* "a roll", from Latin *rotulus* "a little wheel", built on *rota* (Lewis & Short); *pâtisserie* is built on *pâte.*

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rouleau à pâtisserie*
- *Say it: le rouleau à pâtisserie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le rouleau à pâtisserie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the yeast, then the French for to knead, then say *le rouleau à pâtisserie* again

Before you move on

What does le rouleau à pâtisserie mean? ("The rolling pin".) Say it once more.

333.4 étaler — to roll out, to spread

Before the new one: say the French for to knead, then the French for the rolling pin.

You'll want to know: étaler

étaler — "to roll out, to spread".

Il étale la pâte avec le rouleau à pâtisserie.

He rolls out the dough with the rolling pin.

Also to spread butter: *étaler du beurre sur le pain.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étaler is built on Old French *estal* "a place, a stall", which is usually traced to a Frankish word (EtymDB lists no parent): to lay out on a stall.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: étaler*
- *Say it: étaler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *étaler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to knead, then the French for the rolling pin, then say *étaler* again

Before you move on

What does étaler mean? ("To roll out, to spread".) Say it once more.

333.5 démouler — to turn out (of a tin)

Before the new one: say the French for the rolling pin, then the French for to roll out.

You'll want to know: démouler

démouler — "to turn out (of a tin)".

Elle démoule le gâteau quand il est froid.

She turns out the cake when it is cold.

The opposite of putting into *le moule*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

démouler is built on *dé-* and *moule* "mould", which comes from Latin *modulus* "a small measure" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: démouler*
- *Say it: démouler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *démouler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rolling pin, then the French for to roll out, then say *démouler* again

Before you move on

What does démouler mean? ("To turn out (of a tin)".) Say it once more.

333.6 Pas à pas, encore une fois

Say the French for the colander and to drain.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the colander, to drain, to sprinkle, to season, to taste
- the yeast, to knead, the rolling pin, to roll out, to turn out

Before you move on

The colander? (**la passoire**.) To drain? (**égoutter**.) To sprinkle? (**saupoudrer**.) To season? (**assaisonner**.) To taste? (**déguster**.) The yeast? (**la levure**.) To knead? (**pétrir**.) The rolling pin? (**le rouleau à pâtisserie**.) To roll out? (**étaler**.) To turn out? (**démouler**.)

333.7 Faire du pain — once more

Say the French for the yeast and to knead.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the yeast, to knead, the rolling pin, to roll out, to turn out

Before you move on

The yeast? (**la levure**.) To knead? (**pétrir**.) The rolling pin? (**le rouleau à pâtisserie**.) To roll out? (**étaler**.) To turn out? (**démouler**.)

Chapter 334

Mon point de vue

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give my point of view, maintain or claim something, state it firmly and say whether an answer is convincing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 334: I can give my point of view, maintain or claim something, state it firmly and say whether an answer is convincing.*

334.1 le point de vue — the point of view

> Before the new one: say the French for a team, then the French for a birthday.

You'll want to know: le point de vue

le point de vue — "the point of view".

> De mon point de vue, c'est une bonne idée.
>
> *From my point of view, it is a good idea.*

The plural is *les points de vue*. *À mon avis* says much the same thing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

point is inherited from Latin *punctum* "a prick, a point" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), and *vue* is the noun made from *voir* "to see", inherited

from Latin *vidēre*: the spot you look from.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le point de vue*
- *Say it: le point de vue*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le point de vue*
- *Recall:* say the French for a team, then the French for a birthday, then say *le point de vue* again

Before you move on

What does le point de vue mean? ("The point of view".) Say it once more.

334.2 soutenir — to maintain, to claim; to support

Before the new one: say the French for a birthday, then the French for the point of view.

You'll want to know: soutenir

soutenir — "to maintain, to claim; to support".

Il soutient que le train est plus confortable que l'avion.

He maintains that the train is more comfortable than the plane.

Conjugated like *tenir*: *je soutiens, nous soutenons*; past participle *soutenu*. It also means to support a person: *soutenir un ami*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soutenir is inherited from Latin *sustinēre* "to hold up, to bear" (Lewis & Short), through Old French *sustenir* (EtymDB). The Latin is built from *sub* "under" and *tenēre* "to hold": you hold an idea up so it does not fall.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: soutenir*
- *Say it: soutenir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *soutenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for a birthday, then the French for the point of view, then say *soutenir* again

Before you move on

What does soutenir mean? ("To maintain, to claim; to support".) Say it once more.

334.3 prétendre — to claim (with a hint of doubt)

Before the new one: say the French for the point of view, then the French for to maintain.

You'll want to know: prétendre

prétendre — "to claim (with a hint of doubt)".

Il prétend qu'il n'a pas reçu mon message.

He claims he did not get my message.

A false friend: *prétendre* is to claim, and the speaker often doubts the claim. Conjugated like *rendre*: *il prétend.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prétendre comes from Latin *praetendere* "to stretch forth, to hold out in front" (Lewis & Short), taken into Old French as a learned word (EtymDB). You hold a claim out in front of you.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: prétendre*
- *Say it: prétendre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *prétendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the point of view, then the French for to maintain, then say *prétendre* again

Before you move on

What does prétendre mean? ("To claim (with a hint of doubt)".) Say it once more.

334.4 affirmer — to state firmly, to assert

Before the new one: say the French for to maintain, then the French for to claim.

You'll want to know: affirmer

affirmer — "to state firmly, to assert".

Elle affirme qu'elle était à la maison ce soir-là.

She states that she was at home that evening.

Stronger than *dire*: you say it as a fact.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

affirmer is a learned borrowing from Latin *affirmāre* "to assert, to declare" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *firmus* "firm": you make your words firm.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: affirmer*
- *Say it: affirmer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *affirmer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to maintain, then the French for to claim, then say *affirmer* again

Before you move on

What does affirmer mean? ("To state firmly, to assert".) Say it once more.

334.5 convaincant — convincing

Before the new one: say the French for to claim, then the French for to state firmly.

You'll want to know: convaincant

convaincant — "convincing".

Sa réponse n'était pas très convaincante.

His answer was not very convincing.

It agrees: *un ton convaincant, une réponse convaincante.* It comes from *convaincre*, to convince.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

convaincant is the present participle of *convaincre*, which comes from Latin *convincere* "to overcome, to prove wrong" (Lewis & Short), built on *vincere* "to conquer".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *convaincant*
- *Say it:* *convaincant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *convaincant*
- *Recall:* say the French for to claim, then the French for to state firmly, then say *convaincant* again

Before you move on

What does convaincant mean? ("Convincing".) Say it once more.

Chapter 335

Le débat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can take part in a debate: debate a question, state a thesis, build a line of argument and try to persuade someone.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 335: I can take part in a debate: debate a question, state a thesis, build a line of argument and try to persuade someone.*

335.1 le débat — the debate

> Before the new one: say the French for to state firmly, then the French for convincing.

You'll want to know: le débat

le débat — "the debate".

> Ce soir, il y a un débat à la télévision sur l'école.
>
> *Tonight there is a debate on television about schools.*

Un débat animé — a lively debate.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

débat is formed from the verb *débattre*, built on *battre* "to beat", which is inherited from Latin *battuere* "to beat, to strike" (EtymDB; Lewis &

Short). Ideas are knocked back and forth.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le débat*
- *Say it: le débat*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le débat*
- *Recall:* say the French for to state firmly, then the French for convincing, then say *le débat* again

Before you move on

What does le débat mean? ("The debate".) Say it once more.

335.2 débattre — to debate, to discuss

Before the new one: say the French for convincing, then the French for the debate.

You'll want to know: débattre

débattre — "to debate, to discuss".

Nous avons débattu de ce problème pendant deux heures.

We debated this problem for two hours.

Débattre de quelque chose. Conjugated like *battre*: *je débats, nous débattons.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

débattre is inherited from Old French *debatre* "to fight, to contend" (EtymDB), built from *dé-* and *battre*, which comes from Latin *battuere* "to beat" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: débattre*
- *Say it: débattre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *débattre*
- *Recall:* say the French for convincing, then the French for the debate, then say *débattre* again

Before you move on

What does débattre mean? ("To debate, to discuss".) Say it once more.

335.3 la thèse — the thesis, the position argued for

Before the new one: say the French for the debate, then the French for to debate.

You'll want to know: la thèse

la thèse — "the thesis, the position argued for".

Sa thèse est simple : nous travaillons trop.

His thesis is simple: we work too much.

At university, *une thèse* is a doctoral thesis.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

thèse is a learned borrowing from Latin *thesis* "a proposition" (Lewis & Short), which came from Greek *thésis* "a setting down, a statement" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la thèse*
- *Say it: la thèse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la thèse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the debate, then the French for to debate, then say *la thèse* again

Before you move on

What does la thèse mean? ("The thesis, the position argued for".) Say it once more.

335.4 l'argumentation — the line of argument

Before the new one: say the French for to debate, then the French for the thesis.

You'll want to know: l'argumentation

l'argumentation — "the line of argument".

Ton argumentation est claire, mais je ne suis pas d'accord.

Your line of argument is clear, but I do not agree.

The whole chain of reasons; one single reason is *un argument*. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

argumentation is a learned borrowing from Latin *argūmentātiō* "the bringing of proof" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *argūmentum* "proof", built on *arguere* "to make clear".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'argumentation*
- *Say it: l'argumentation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'argumentation*
- *Recall:* say the French for to debate, then the French for the thesis, then say *l'argumentation* again

Before you move on

What does l'argumentation mean? ("The line of argument".) Say it once more.

335.5 persuader — to persuade

Before the new one: say the French for the thesis, then the French for the line of argument.

You'll want to know: persuader

persuader — "to persuade".

J'ai essayé de persuader mon père d'acheter une nouvelle voiture.

I tried to persuade my father to buy a new car.

Persuader quelqu'un de faire quelque chose. Close to *convaincre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

persuader comes from Latin *persuādēre* "to bring over by talking, to convince" (Lewis & Short), through Middle French (EtymDB). It is built from *per-* and *suādēre* "to advise".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: persuader*
- *Say it: persuader*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *persuader*
- *Recall:* say the French for the thesis, then the French for the line of argument, then say *persuader* again

Before you move on

What does persuader mean? ("To persuade".) Say it once more.

Chapter 336

Pas d'accord

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can disagree politely: say we disagree, raise an objection, retort and contradict what someone said.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 336: I can disagree politely: say we disagree, raise an objection, retort and contradict what someone said.*

336.1 le désaccord — the disagreement

> Before the new one: say the French for the line of argument, then the French for to persuade.

You'll want to know: le désaccord

le désaccord — "the disagreement".

> Nous sommes en désaccord sur presque tout.
>
> *We disagree about almost everything.*

Être en désaccord — to disagree. The opposite is *être d'accord*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désaccord is built from *dés-* "not" and *accord* "agreement", which comes from the Old French verb *acorder* (EtymDB). That verb is usually traced to a Latin formation on *cor, cordis* "heart".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le désaccord*
- *Say it: le désaccord*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le désaccord*
- *Recall:* say the French for the line of argument, then the French for to persuade, then say *le désaccord* again

Before you move on

What does le désaccord mean? ("The disagreement".) Say it once more.

336.2 objecter — to object, to say in reply

Before the new one: say the French for to persuade, then the French for the disagreement.

You'll want to know: objecter

objecter — "to object, to say in reply".

Elle a objecté que c'était trop cher.

She objected that it was too expensive.

Objecter que… — to object that… Formal; in speech many people say *je ne suis pas d'accord*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

objecter is a learned borrowing from Latin *obiectāre* "to throw against, to set before" (Lewis & Short), formed on *obicere* "to throw before", from *ob* and *iacere* "to throw".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: objecter*
- *Say it: objecter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *objecter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to persuade, then the French for the disagreement, then say *objecter* again

Before you move on

What does objecter mean? ("To object, to say in reply".) Say it once more.

336.3 l'objection — the objection

Before the new one: say the French for the disagreement, then the French for to object.

You'll want to know: l'objection

l'objection — "the objection".

Pas d'objection ? Alors nous commençons.

No objection? Then we start.

Faire une objection — to raise an objection. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

objection is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *obiectiō* "a throwing against, an objection", from *obicere* "to throw before" (Lewis & Short), built on *iacere* "to throw".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'objection*
- *Say it: l'objection*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'objection*
- *Recall:* say the French for the disagreement, then the French for to object, then say *l'objection* again

Before you move on

What does l'objection mean? ("The objection".) Say it once more.

336.4 rétorquer — to retort

Before the new one: say the French for to object, then the French for the objection.

You'll want to know: rétorquer

rétorquer — "to retort".

Il a rétorqué que ce n'était pas vrai.

He retorted that it was not true.

Literally to twist back: you turn the words back on the speaker.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rétorquer is a learned borrowing from Latin *retorquēre* "to twist or bend back" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *torquēre* "to twist".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rétorquer*
- *Say it: rétorquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rétorquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to object, then the French for the objection, then say *rétorquer* again

Before you move on

What does rétorquer mean? ("To retort".) Say it once more.

336.5 contredire — to contradict

Before the new one: say the French for the objection, then the French for to retort.

You'll want to know: contredire

contredire — "to contradict".

Je n'aime pas quand tu me contredis devant tout le monde.

I do not like it when you contradict me in front of everyone.

Like *dire*, but *vous contredisez*. *Se contredire* — to contradict yourself.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contredire comes through Old French from Latin *contrādīcere* "to speak against" (EtymDB), built from *contrā* "against" and *dīcere* "to say" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *contredire*
- *Say it:* *contredire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *contredire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the objection, then the French for to retort, then say *contredire* again

Before you move on

What does contredire mean? ("To contradict".) Say it once more.

Chapter 337

Trouver un accord

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can admit someone is right, give way, concede a point and reach a consensus or a compromise.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 337: I can admit someone is right, give way, concede a point and reach a consensus or a compromise.*

337.1 admettre — to admit

> Before the new one: say the French for to retort, then the French for to contradict.

You'll want to know: admettre

admettre — "to admit".

> Je dois admettre que ton idée était meilleure.
>
> *I have to admit that your idea was better.*

Conjugated like *mettre*; past participle *admis*. It also means to let in: *être admis à l'université*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

admettre comes through Old French *admettre* from Latin *admittere* "to let in, to allow" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built from *ad* "to" and *mittere* "to send": you let a fact in.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: admettre*
- *Say it: admettre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *admettre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to retort, then the French for to contradict, then say *admettre* again

Before you move on

What does admettre mean? ("To admit".) Say it once more.

337.2 le consensus — the consensus, broad agreement

Before the new one: say the French for to contradict, then the French for to admit.

You'll want to know: le consensus

le consensus — "the consensus, broad agreement".

Après deux heures, nous avons trouvé un consensus.

After two hours, we reached a consensus.

The final *s* is said: *consensuss*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

consensus was borrowed whole from Latin *cōnsēnsus* "agreement, accord" (EtymDB), from *cōnsentīre* "to agree", built on *sentīre* "to feel" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le consensus*
- *Say it: le consensus*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le consensus*
- *Recall:* say the French for to contradict, then the French for to admit, then say *le consensus* again

Before you move on

What does le consensus mean? ("The consensus, broad agreement".) Say it once more.

337.3 le compromis — the compromise

Before the new one: say the French for to admit, then the French for the consensus.

You'll want to know: le compromis

le compromis — "the compromise".

> Finalement, nous avons trouvé un compromis : un film, puis une pizza.
>
> *In the end we found a compromise: a film, then a pizza.*

Trouver un compromis — to reach a compromise. The same form in the plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compromis comes from Latin *compromissum* "a mutual promise to abide by an arbiter's award" (Lewis & Short; EtymDB), built on *prōmittere* "to promise".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le compromis*
- *Say it: le compromis*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le compromis*
- *Recall:* say the French for to admit, then the French for the consensus, then say *le compromis* again

Before you move on

What does le compromis mean? ("The compromise".) Say it once more.

337.4 céder — to give in, to give way; to hand over

Before the new one: say the French for the consensus, then the French for the compromise.

You'll want to know: céder

céder — "to give in, to give way; to hand over".

Il a insisté, et j'ai fini par céder.

He insisted, and I ended up giving in.

Céder à quelqu'un — to give in to someone. *Je cède*, with *è* before a silent ending.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

céder is a learned borrowing from Latin *cēdere* "to go, to withdraw, to yield" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: céder*
- *Say it: céder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *céder*
- *Recall:* say the French for the consensus, then the French for the compromise, then say *céder* again

Before you move on

What does céder mean? ("To give in, to give way; to hand over".) Say it once more.

337.5 concéder — to concede, to grant

Before the new one: say the French for the compromise, then the French for to give in.

You'll want to know: concéder

concéder — "to concede, to grant".

Je te concède ce point : tu avais raison.

I grant you that point: you were right.

Je concède, like *céder*. Formal; in speech, *je reconnais que* is common.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

concéder comes from Latin *concēdere* "to withdraw, to grant" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), a strengthened form of *cēdere* "to go, to yield".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *concéder*
- *Say it:* *concéder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *concéder*
- *Recall:* say the French for the compromise, then the French for to give in, then say *concéder* again

Before you move on

What does concéder mean? ("To concede, to grant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 338

Je n'y crois pas

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I doubt something, that I am sceptical, deny a claim and say an idea is absurd or debatable.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 338: I can say I doubt something, that I am sceptical, deny a claim and say an idea is absurd or debatable.*

338.1 douter — to doubt

> Before the new one: say the French for to give in, then the French for to concede.

You'll want to know: douter

douter — "to doubt".

> Je doute qu'il vienne demain.
>
> *I doubt that he will come tomorrow.*

Douter que takes the subjunctive: *je doute qu'il vienne. Se douter de* means the opposite: to suspect.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douter is inherited, through Old French, from Latin *dubitāre* "to waver, to be uncertain" (Lewis & Short). Lewis & Short link the Latin verb

to *duo* "two": a mind going two ways.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: douter*
- *Say it: douter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *douter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give in, then the French for to concede, then say *douter* again

Before you move on

What does douter mean? ("To doubt".) Say it once more.

338.2 sceptique — sceptical

Before the new one: say the French for to concede, then the French for to doubt.

You'll want to know: sceptique

sceptique — "sceptical".

Mon frère reste sceptique : il ne croit pas les journaux.

My brother remains sceptical: he does not believe the newspapers.

One form for both genders. The *c* is silent: say *septique*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sceptique is a learned word, usually traced through Latin *Sceptici* "the Sceptics" (Lewis & Short) to Greek *skeptikós* "inquiring, thoughtful", which is built on *sképtesthai* "to look about, to consider".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sceptique*
- *Say it: sceptique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sceptique*
- *Recall:* say the French for to concede, then the French for to doubt, then say *sceptique* again

Before you move on

What does sceptique mean? ("Sceptical".) Say it once more.

338.3 nier — to deny

Before the new one: say the French for to doubt, then the French for sceptical.

You'll want to know: nier

nier — "to deny".

Il nie avoir pris l'argent.

He denies taking the money.

Nier + infinitive, or *nier que. Je nie, nous nions.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nier is inherited from Latin *negāre* "to say no, to deny" (Lewis & Short), through Old French *noier* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: nier*
- *Say it: nier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *nier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to doubt, then the French for sceptical, then say *nier* again

Before you move on

What does nier mean? ("To deny".) Say it once more.

338.4 absurde — absurd

Before the new one: say the French for sceptical, then the French for to deny.

You'll want to know: absurde

absurde — "absurd".

C'est absurde de payer deux fois pour le même billet.

It is absurd to pay twice for the same ticket.

One form for both genders: *une idée absurde*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

absurde is a learned borrowing from Latin *absurdus* "out of tune, harsh; senseless" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *surdus* "deaf, dull-sounding".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: absurde*
- *Say it: absurde*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *absurde*
- *Recall:* say the French for sceptical, then the French for to deny, then say *absurde* again

Before you move on

What does absurde mean? ("Absurd".) Say it once more.

338.5 discutable — debatable, questionable

Before the new one: say the French for to deny, then the French for absurd.

You'll want to know: discutable

discutable — "debatable, questionable".

Ta décision est discutable, mais c'est ton choix.

Your decision is debatable, but it is your choice.

From *discuter* + *-able*: it can be argued about. *C'est discutable* is a polite way to disagree.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

discutable is built from *discuter* and the suffix *-able* (EtymDB). *discuter* comes from Latin *discutere* "to strike apart, to shatter" (Lewis & Short), built on *quatere* "to shake".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: discutable*
- *Say it: discutable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *discutable*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deny, then the French for absurd, then say *discutable* again

Before you move on

What does discutable mean? ("Debatable, questionable".) Say it once more.

Chapter 339

Les preuves

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about proof: say something is obvious, plain to see, indisputable or clear.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 339: I can talk about proof: say something is obvious, plain to see, indisputable or clear.*

339.1 la preuve — the proof, the evidence

> Before the new one: say the French for absurd, then the French for debatable.

You'll want to know: la preuve

la preuve — "the proof, the evidence".

> Tu dis que c'est lui, mais tu n'as aucune preuve.
>
> *You say it was him, but you have no proof.*

Faire preuve de — to show a quality: *faire preuve de courage*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

preuve is usually traced to Old French *prueve*, a noun formed on *prouver* "to prove", which is inherited from Latin *probāre* "to test, to examine" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la preuve*
- *Say it: la preuve*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la preuve*
- *Recall:* say the French for absurd, then the French for debatable, then say *la preuve* again

Before you move on

What does la preuve mean? ("The proof, the evidence".) Say it once more.

339.2 évident — obvious, evident

Before the new one: say the French for debatable, then the French for the proof.

You'll want to know: évident

évident — "obvious, evident".

C'est évident : il est fatigué.

It is obvious: he is tired.

Ce n'est pas évident also means it is not easy.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

évident is a learned borrowing from Latin *ēvidēns* "apparent, visible, clear" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built from *ē* "out" and *vidēre* "to see".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: évident*
- *Say it: évident*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *évident*
- *Recall:* say the French for debatable, then the French for the proof, then say *évident* again

Before you move on

What does évident mean? ("Obvious, evident".) Say it once more.

339.3 l'évidence — the obvious, what is plain to see

Before the new one: say the French for the proof, then the French for obvious.

You'll want to know: l'évidence

l'évidence — "the obvious, what is plain to see".

Il faut se rendre à l'évidence : nous sommes perdus.

We have to face the facts: we are lost.

A false friend: *l'évidence* is what is plain to see; evidence in court is *la preuve*. *Se rendre à l'évidence* — to face the facts.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

évidence is a learned borrowing from Latin *ēvidentia* "clearness, distinctness" (Lewis & Short), from *ēvidēns* "clear", built on *vidēre* "to see".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'évidence*
- *Say it: l'évidence*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'évidence*
- *Recall:* say the French for the proof, then the French for obvious, then say *l'évidence* again

Before you move on

What does l'évidence mean? ("The obvious, what is plain to see".) Say it once more.

339.4 incontestable — indisputable, unquestionable

Before the new one: say the French for obvious, then the French for the obvious.

You'll want to know: incontestable

incontestable — "indisputable, unquestionable".

Son talent est incontestable.

Her talent is indisputable.

Literally that no one can contest. One form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

incontestable is built from *in-* "not", *contester* and *-able*. *contester* comes from Latin *contestārī* "to call to witness" (Lewis & Short), built on *testis* "witness".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: incontestable*
- *Say it: incontestable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *incontestable*
- *Recall:* say the French for obvious, then the French for the obvious, then say *incontestable* again

Before you move on

What does incontestable mean? ("Indisputable, unquestionable".) Say it once more.

339.5 manifeste — clear, obvious, manifest

Before the new one: say the French for the obvious, then the French for indisputable.

You'll want to know: manifeste

manifeste — "clear, obvious, manifest".

Il y a une erreur manifeste dans la facture.

There is a clear mistake in the bill.

Formal. As a noun, *un manifeste* is a manifesto.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manifeste is a learned borrowing from Latin *manifestus* "palpable, plain, evident" (Lewis & Short), which the dictionary links to *manus* "hand": so clear you could touch it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: manifeste*
- *Say it: manifeste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *manifeste*
- *Recall:* say the French for the obvious, then the French for indisputable, then say *manifeste* again

Before you move on

What does manifeste mean? ("Clear, obvious, manifest".) Say it once more.

Chapter 340

Croire ou pas

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say whether a person or a story is reliable, believable, dubious, likely or hard to believe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 340: I can say whether a person or a story is reliable, believable, dubious, likely or hard to believe.*

340.1 fiable — reliable

Before the new one: say the French for indisputable, then the French for clear.

You'll want to know: fiable

fiable — "reliable".

Cette voiture est vieille, mais très fiable.

This car is old, but very reliable.

For people and things: *une source fiable.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fiable is built on *se fier* "to trust" (EtymDB), which is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin *fīdāre*, formed on Latin *fīdere* "to trust" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: fiable*
- *Say it: fiable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *fiable*
- *Recall:* say the French for indisputable, then the French for clear, then say *fiable* again

Before you move on

What does fiable mean? ("Reliable".) Say it once more.

340.2 crédible — believable, credible

Before the new one: say the French for clear, then the French for reliable.

You'll want to know: crédible

crédible — "believable, credible".

Son histoire n'est pas très crédible.

His story is not very believable.

One form for both genders. Close to *croyable*, but more formal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crédible is a learned borrowing from Latin *crēdibilis* "worthy of belief" (Lewis & Short), from *crēdere* "to believe".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: crédible*
- *Say it: crédible*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *crédible*
- *Recall:* say the French for clear, then the French for reliable, then say *crédible* again

Before you move on

What does crédible mean? ("Believable, credible".) Say it once more.

340.3 douteux — doubtful, dubious

Before the new one: say the French for reliable, then the French for believable.

You'll want to know: douteux

douteux — "doubtful, dubious".

Ce restaurant a l'air douteux : il n'y a personne.

This restaurant looks dubious: there is nobody there.

Feminine *douteuse*. *Il est douteux que* takes the subjunctive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douteux is built from *doute* "doubt" and the suffix *-eux* (EtymDB). *doute* comes from *douter*, inherited from Latin *dubitāre* "to waver, to doubt" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *douteux*
- *Say it:* *douteux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *douteux*
- *Recall:* say the French for reliable, then the French for believable, then say *douteux* again

Before you move on

What does douteux mean? ("Doubtful, dubious".) Say it once more.

340.4 vraisemblable — likely, believable

Before the new one: say the French for believable, then the French for doubtful.

You'll want to know: vraisemblable

vraisemblable — "likely, believable".

C'est une explication vraisemblable.

It is a likely explanation.

Literally like the truth: *vrai* + *semblable*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vraisemblable is built from *vrai* "true" and *semblable* "like", on the model of Latin *vērī similis* "like the truth" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: vraisemblable*
- *Say it: vraisemblable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *vraisemblable*
- *Recall:* say the French for believable, then the French for doubtful, then say *vraisemblable* again

Before you move on

What does vraisemblable mean? ("Likely, believable".) Say it once more.

340.5 invraisemblable — unlikely, hard to believe

Before the new one: say the French for doubtful, then the French for likely.

You'll want to know: invraisemblable

invraisemblable — "unlikely, hard to believe".

Il m'a raconté une histoire invraisemblable.

He told me a story that was hard to believe.

With *in-*, the opposite of *vraisemblable*: so odd it is hard to believe.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

invraisemblable is built from *in-* "not" and *vraisemblable*, which is formed from *vrai* "true" and *semblable* "like", on the model of Latin *vērī similis* "like the truth" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: invraisemblable*
- *Say it: invraisemblable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *invraisemblable*
- *Recall:* say the French for doubtful, then the French for likely, then say *invraisemblable* again

Before you move on

What does invraisemblable mean? ("Unlikely, hard to believe".) Say it once more.

Chapter 341

Je m'explique

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can clear up a misunderstanding: clarify, specify, give more details and clear a question up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 341: I can clear up a misunderstanding: clarify, specify, give more details and clear a question up.*

341.1 le malentendu — the misunderstanding

> Before the new one: say the French for likely, then the French for unlikely.

You'll want to know: le malentendu

le malentendu — "the misunderstanding".

> Excuse-moi, c'est un malentendu : je parlais de l'autre réunion.
>
> *Sorry, it is a misunderstanding: I was talking about the other meeting.*

From *mal* + *entendu*: badly heard.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

malentendu is built from *mal* "badly" and *entendu*, the past participle of *entendre*, which comes from Latin *intendere* "to stretch toward, to

turn the mind to" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le malentendu*
- *Say it: le malentendu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le malentendu*
- *Recall:* say the French for likely, then the French for unlikely, then say *le malentendu* again

Before you move on

What does le malentendu mean? ("The misunderstanding".) Say it once more.

341.2 clarifier — to clarify

Before the new one: say the French for unlikely, then the French for the misunderstanding.

You'll want to know: clarifier

clarifier — "to clarify".

Je voudrais clarifier un point avant de commencer.

I would like to clarify one point before starting.

Clarifier la situation — to make things clear.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clarifier is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *clārificāre* (EtymDB), which Lewis & Short gloss "to make illustrious, to make famous"; it is built on *clārus* "clear, bright", and French took it in the sense to make

clear.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: clarifier*
- *Say it: clarifier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *clarifier*
- *Recall:* say the French for unlikely, then the French for the misunderstanding, then say *clarifier* again

Before you move on

What does clarifier mean? ("To clarify".) Say it once more.

341.3 préciser — to specify, to make precise

Before the new one: say the French for the misunderstanding, then the French for to clarify.

You'll want to know: préciser

préciser — "to specify, to make precise".

Il a précisé l'heure de la réunion dans son message.

He specified the time of the meeting in his message.

Préciser que — to point out exactly. From *précis*, precise.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préciser is built on *précis* "precise" (EtymDB), from Latin *praecīsus* "cut off, abridged", the participle of *praecīdere* "to cut off in front" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: préciser*
- *Say it: préciser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *préciser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the misunderstanding, then the French for to clarify, then say *préciser* again

Before you move on

What does préciser mean? ("To specify, to make precise".) Say it once more.

341.4 la précision — the precision; an extra detail

Before the new one: say the French for to clarify, then the French for to specify.

You'll want to know: la précision

la précision — "the precision; an extra detail".

Merci pour ces précisions.

Thanks for these extra details.

In the plural, *des précisions* are extra details: *donner des précisions.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

précision is a learned borrowing from Latin *praecīsiō* "a cutting off" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *praecīdere* "to cut off in front".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la précision*
- *Say it: la précision*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la précision*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clarify, then the French for to specify, then say *la précision* again

Before you move on

What does la précision mean? ("The precision; an extra detail".) Say it once more.

341.5 éclaircir — to clear up, to make clearer

Before the new one: say the French for to specify, then the French for the precision.

You'll want to know: éclaircir

éclaircir — "to clear up, to make clearer".

Nous devons éclaircir ce problème avant lundi.

We need to clear up this problem before Monday.

A *-ir* verb like *finir*. Of the sky too: *le ciel s'éclaircit.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éclaircir is built from *é-* and *clair* "clear", which is inherited from Latin *clārus* "clear, bright" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: éclaircir*
- *Say it: éclaircir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *éclaircir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to specify, then the French for the precision, then say *éclaircir* again

Before you move on

What does éclaircir mean? ("To clear up, to make clearer".) Say it once more.

341.6 Raisons et opinions

Say the French for the point of view and to maintain.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the point of view, to maintain, to claim, to state firmly, convincing
- the debate, to debate, the thesis, the line of argument, to persuade
- the disagreement, to object, the objection, to retort, to contradict
- to admit, the consensus, the compromise, to give in, to concede
- to doubt, sceptical, to deny, absurd, debatable
- the proof, obvious, the obvious, indisputable, clear
- reliable, believable, doubtful, likely, unlikely
- the misunderstanding, to clarify, to specify, the precision, to clear up

Before you move on

The point of view? (**le point de vue**.) To maintain? (**soutenir**.) To claim? (**prétendre**.) To state firmly? (**affirmer**.) Convincing?

(**convaincant**.) The debate? (**le débat**.) To debate? (**débattre**.) The thesis? (**la thèse**.) The line of argument? (**l'argumentation**.) To persuade? (**persuader**.) The disagreement? (**le désaccord**.) To object? (**objecter**.) The objection? (**l'objection**.) To retort? (**rétorquer**.) To contradict? (**contredire**.) To admit? (**admettre**.) The consensus? (**le consensus**.) The compromise? (**le compromis**.) To give in? (**céder**.) To concede? (**concéder**.) To doubt? (**douter**.) Sceptical? (**sceptique**.) To deny? (**nier**.) Absurd? (**absurde**.) Debatable? (**discutable**.) The proof? (**la preuve**.) Obvious? (**évident**.) The obvious? (**l'évidence**.) Indisputable? (**incontestable**.) Clear? (**manifeste**.) Reliable? (**fiable**.) Believable? (**crédible**.) Doubtful? (**douteux**.) Likely? (**vraisemblable**.) Unlikely? (**invraisemblable**.) The misunderstanding? (**le malentendu**.) To clarify? (**clarifier**.) To specify? (**préciser**.) The precision? (**la précision**.) To clear up? (**éclaircir**.)

Chapter 342

Évaluer et juger

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can evaluate something, judge it, give a judgement and say whether a view is subjective or impartial.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 342: I can evaluate something, judge it, give a judgement and say whether a view is subjective or impartial.*

342.1 évaluer — to evaluate, to assess

> Before the new one: say the French for the precision, then the French for to clear up.

You'll want to know: évaluer

évaluer — "to evaluate, to assess".

> Le professeur évalue notre travail chaque mois.
>
> *The teacher assesses our work every month.*

Évaluer le prix d'une maison — to estimate it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

évaluer is usually explained as a French formation from *é-* and Old French *value* "worth", the old participle of *valoir*, which is inherited from Latin *valēre* "to be strong, to be worth" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *évaluer*
- *Say it:* *évaluer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *évaluer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the precision, then the French for to clear up, then say *évaluer* again

Before you move on

What does évaluer mean? ("To evaluate, to assess".) Say it once more.

342.2 juger — to judge

Before the new one: say the French for to clear up, then the French for to evaluate.

You'll want to know: juger

juger — "to judge".

Il ne faut pas juger les gens sur leurs vêtements.

You should not judge people by their clothes.

Nous jugeons, with an *e* to keep the *g* soft.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

juger is inherited from Latin *iūdicāre* "to pass judgement" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *iūdex* "judge", itself built from *iūs* "law" and *dīcere* "to say".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: juger*
- *Say it: juger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *juger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clear up, then the French for to evaluate, then say *juger* again

Before you move on

What does juger mean? ("To judge".) Say it once more.

342.3 le jugement — the judgement

Before the new one: say the French for to evaluate, then the French for to judge.

You'll want to know: le jugement

le jugement — "the judgement".

J'ai confiance en ton jugement.

I trust your judgement.

In court, *un jugement* is a ruling.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jugement is inherited through Old French *jugement* from Late Latin *iūdicāmentum* (EtymDB), built on *iūdicāre* "to judge" and *iūdex* "judge" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jugement*
- *Say it: le jugement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le jugement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to evaluate, then the French for to judge, then say *le jugement* again

Before you move on

What does le jugement mean? ("The judgement".) Say it once more.

342.4 subjectif — subjective

Before the new one: say the French for to judge, then the French for the judgement.

You'll want to know: subjectif

subjectif — "subjective".

C'est un avis très subjectif.

It is a very subjective view.

Feminine *subjective*: *une impression subjective.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

subjectif comes from Latin *subiectīvus* (EtymDB), formed on *subiectus*, the participle of *subicere* "to throw under, to place under" (Lewis & Short), built on *iacere* "to throw".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: subjectif*
- *Say it: subjectif*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *subjectif*
- *Recall:* say the French for to judge, then the French for the judgement, then say *subjectif* again

Before you move on

What does subjectif mean? (“Subjective”.) Say it once more.

342.5 impartial — impartial, fair

Before the new one: say the French for the judgement, then the French for subjective.

You’ll want to know: impartial

impartial — “impartial, fair”.

Un juge doit rester impartial.

A judge must stay impartial.

Feminine *impartiale*, plural *impartiaux*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

impartial is built from *in-* “not” and *partial* “taking sides”, a learned formation on Latin *pars, partis* “part, side” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: impartial*
- *Say it: impartial*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *impartial*
- *Recall:* say the French for the judgement, then the French for subjective, then say *impartial* again

Before you move on

What does impartial mean? ("Impartial, fair".) Say it once more.

Chapter 343

Le pour et le contre

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can weigh up pros and cons: name an advantage, a drawback and an aspect, voice a criticism and stress a point.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 343: I can weigh up pros and cons: name an advantage, a drawback and an aspect, voice a criticism and stress a point.*

343.1 l'avantage — the advantage

> Before the new one: say the French for subjective, then the French for impartial.

You'll want to know: l'avantage

l'avantage — "the advantage".

> Le grand avantage de ce quartier, c'est le calme.
>
> *The big advantage of this neighbourhood is the quiet.*

Masculine: *un avantage*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avantage is built from *avant* "before, ahead" and the suffix *-age*: being ahead. *avant* is usually traced to Late Latin *abante* "in front", from *ab*

and *ante* “before” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’avantage*
- *Say it: l’avantage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l’avantage*
- *Recall:* say the French for subjective, then the French for impartial, then say *l’avantage* again

Before you move on

What does l’avantage mean? (“The advantage”.) Say it once more.

343.2 l’inconvénient — the drawback, the disadvantage

Before the new one: say the French for impartial, then the French for the advantage.

You’ll want to know: l’inconvénient

l’inconvénient — “the drawback, the disadvantage”.

Le seul inconvénient, c’est le prix.

The only drawback is the price.

Je n’y vois pas d’inconvénient — I have no objection. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inconvénient comes from Latin *inconveniēns* “unsuitable” (Lewis & Short), built from *in-* “not” and *convenīre* “to come together, to suit”, on *venīre* “to come”.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'inconvénient*
- *Say it: l'inconvénient*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'inconvénient*
- *Recall:* say the French for impartial, then the French for the advantage, then say *l'inconvénient* again

Before you move on

What does l'inconvénient mean? ("The drawback, the disadvantage".) Say it once more.

343.3 l'aspect — the aspect, the side (of a question)

Before the new one: say the French for the advantage, then the French for the drawback.

You'll want to know: l'aspect

l'aspect — "the aspect, the side (of a question)".

Il faut regarder tous les aspects du problème.

We have to consider every aspect of the problem.

The final *ct* is usually silent. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aspect is a learned borrowing from Latin *aspectus* "a seeing, a look, an appearance" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *aspicere* "to behold", built on *specere* "to look".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aspect*
- *Say it: l'aspect*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'aspect*
- *Recall:* say the French for the advantage, then the French for the drawback, then say *l'aspect* again

Before you move on

What does l'aspect mean? ("The aspect, the side (of a question)".) Say it once more.

343.4 la critique — the criticism; the review

Before the new one: say the French for the drawback, then the French for the aspect.

You'll want to know: la critique

la critique — "the criticism; the review".

Elle n'aime pas les critiques.

She does not like criticism.

Une critique is a criticism or a review; *un critique* is a critic. The verb is *critiquer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

critique comes from Latin *criticus*, which came from Greek *kritikós* "able to judge" (EtymDB), built on *krínein* "to separate, to judge".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la critique*
- *Say it: la critique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la critique*
- *Recall:* say the French for the drawback, then the French for the aspect, then say *la critique* again

Before you move on

What does la critique mean? ("The criticism; the review".) Say it once more.

343.5 souligner — to stress, to point out; to underline

Before the new one: say the French for the aspect, then the French for the criticism.

You'll want to know: souligner

souligner — "to stress, to point out; to underline".

Il a souligné deux erreurs dans mon texte.

He pointed out two mistakes in my text.

Literally to draw a line under: *souligner un mot.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souligner is built from *sous* "under" and *ligne* "line", which comes from Latin *līnea* "a linen thread, a line" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: souligner*
- *Say it: souligner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *souligner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the aspect, then the French for the criticism, then say *souligner* again

Before you move on

What does souligner mean? ("To stress, to point out; to underline".) Say it once more.

Chapter 344

Raisonner

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can reason, follow a line of reasoning, draw a conclusion and qualify what I said with a nuance.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 344: I can reason, follow a line of reasoning, draw a conclusion and qualify what I said with a nuance.*

344.1 raisonner — to reason, to think logically

> Before the new one: say the French for the criticism, then the French for to stress.

You'll want to know: raisonner

raisonner — "to reason, to think logically".

> Il raisonne bien, mais il parle trop vite.
>
> *He reasons well, but he speaks too fast.*

From *raison*. Not to be mixed up with *résonner*, to resound.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raisonner is built on *raison* "reason", which is inherited from Latin *ratiō, ratiōnis* "a reckoning, reason" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: raisonner*
- *Say it: raisonner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *raisonner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the criticism, then the French for to stress, then say *raisonner* again

Before you move on

What does raisonner mean? ("To reason, to think logically".) Say it once more.

344.2 le raisonnement — the reasoning

Before the new one: say the French for to stress, then the French for to reason.

You'll want to know: le raisonnement

le raisonnement — "the reasoning".

Ton raisonnement est juste.

Your reasoning is sound.

Un raisonnement is one chain of thought. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raisonnement is built from *raisonner* and the suffix *-ment* (EtymDB). The verb rests on *raison*, from Latin *ratiō* "a reckoning, reason" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le raisonnement*
- *Say it: le raisonnement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le raisonnement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stress, then the French for to reason, then say *le raisonnement* again

Before you move on

What does le raisonnement mean? ("The reasoning".) Say it once more.

344.3 conclure — to conclude

Before the new one: say the French for to reason, then the French for the reasoning.

You'll want to know: conclure

conclure — "to conclude".

Après la réunion, nous avons conclu qu'il fallait attendre.

After the meeting, we concluded that we had to wait.

Past participle *conclu*. *Conclure un accord* — to close a deal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conclure came into Old French as *conclure*, a borrowing from Latin *conclūdere* "to shut up, to bring to an end" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *claudere* "to shut".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: conclure*
- *Say it: conclure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *conclure*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reason, then the French for the reasoning, then say *conclure* again

Before you move on

What does conclure mean? ("To conclude".) Say it once more.

344.4 la nuance — the subtle difference, the shade

Before the new one: say the French for the reasoning, then the French for to conclude.

You'll want to know: la nuance

la nuance — "the subtle difference, the shade".

Il y a une petite nuance entre ces deux mots.

There is a slight difference between these two words.

Of colours too: *une nuance de bleu.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *nuance* is usually traced to Old French *nuer* "to shade, like clouds", from *nue* "cloud", inherited from Latin *nūbēs* "cloud" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nuance*
- *Say it: la nuance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la nuance*
- *Recall:* say the French for the reasoning, then the French for to conclude, then say *la nuance* again

Before you move on

What does la nuance mean? ("The subtle difference, the shade".) Say it once more.

344.5 nuancer — to qualify, to tone down (a view)

Before the new one: say the French for to conclude, then the French for the subtle difference.

You'll want to know: nuancer

nuancer — "to qualify, to tone down (a view)".

Je voudrais nuancer ce que j'ai dit hier.

I would like to qualify what I said yesterday.

Nous nuançons, with *ç* before *o*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nuancer is built on *nuance* "shade", whose origin is usually traced to Old French *nue* "cloud", inherited from Latin *nūbēs* "cloud" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: nuancer*
- *Say it: nuancer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *nuancer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to conclude, then the French for the subtle difference, then say *nuancer* again

Before you move on

What does nuancer mean? ("To qualify, to tone down (a view)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 345

Pour ou contre

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who is for or against an idea: approve or disapprove, name a supporter and an opponent, and argue a case.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 345: I can say who is for or against an idea: approve or disapprove, name a supporter and an opponent, and argue a case.*

345.1 approuver — to approve (of)

> Before the new one: say the French for the subtle difference, then the French for to qualify.

You'll want to know: approuver

approuver — "to approve (of)".

> Mes parents n'approuvent pas mon choix.
>
> *My parents do not approve of my choice.*

Approuver une décision — to approve of a decision.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

approuver comes from Latin *approbāre* "to approve, to assent to" (EtymDB), built from *ad* and *probāre* "to test, to find good" (Lewis &

Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: approuver*
- *Say it: approuver*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *approuver*
- *Recall:* say the French for the subtle difference, then the French for to qualify, then say *approuver* again

Before you move on

What does approuver mean? ("To approve (of)".) Say it once more.

345.2 désapprouver — to disapprove (of)

Before the new one: say the French for to qualify, then the French for to approve.

You'll want to know: désapprouver

désapprouver — "to disapprove (of)".

Le maire désapprouve ce projet.

The mayor disapproves of this project.

Dés- + *approuver*: the opposite.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désapprouver is built from *dés-* "not" and *approuver*, which comes from Latin *approbāre* "to approve", on *probāre* "to test" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: désapprouver*
- *Say it: désapprouver*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *désapprouver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to qualify, then the French for to approve, then say *désapprouver* again

Before you move on

What does désapprouver mean? ("To disapprove (of)".) Say it once more.

345.3 le partisan — the supporter (of an idea)

Before the new one: say the French for to approve, then the French for to disapprove.

You'll want to know: le partisan

le partisan — "the supporter (of an idea)".

Les partisans du projet sont contents.

The supporters of the project are happy.

Être partisan de — to be in favour of. Feminine *partisane*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

partisan was borrowed from Italian *partigiano* "a supporter of a side" (EtymDB), built on *parte* "part, side", from Latin *pars, partis* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le partisan*
- *Say it: le partisan*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le partisan*
- *Recall:* say the French for to approve, then the French for to disapprove, then say *le partisan* again

Before you move on

What does le partisan mean? ("The supporter (of an idea)".) Say it once more.

345.4 l'adversaire — the opponent

Before the new one: say the French for to disapprove, then the French for the supporter.

You'll want to know: l'adversaire

l'adversaire — "the opponent".

Son adversaire a gagné le débat.

His opponent won the debate.

Masculine or feminine: *un* or *une adversaire*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adversaire comes from Latin *adversārius* "an opponent" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *adversus* "turned toward, facing", built on *vertere* "to turn".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'adversaire*
- *Say it: l'adversaire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'adversaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to disapprove, then the French for the supporter, then say *l'adversaire* again

Before you move on

What does l'adversaire mean? ("The opponent".) Say it once more.

345.5 argumenter — to argue a case, to give reasons

Before the new one: say the French for the supporter, then the French for the opponent.

You'll want to know: argumenter

argumenter — "to argue a case, to give reasons".

Elle argumente avec calme.

She argues her case calmly.

Not quarrelling: *argumenter* is to back a view with reasons; to quarrel is *se disputer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

argumenter is a learned borrowing from Latin *argūmentārī* "to bring forward proof" (Lewis & Short), from *argūmentum* "proof", built on *arguere* "to make clear".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *argumenter*
- *Say it:* *argumenter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *argumenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the supporter, then the French for the opponent, then say *argumenter* again

Before you move on

What does argumenter mean? ("To argue a case, to give reasons".) Say it once more.

Chapter 346

Causes et conséquences

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what caused or provoked something, name a consequence, and say what it leads to or follows from.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 346: I can say what caused or provoked something, name a consequence, and say what it leads to or follows from.*

346.1 causer — to cause

> Before the new one: say the French for the opponent, then the French for to argue a case.

You'll want to know: causer

causer — "to cause".

> Le brouillard a causé un accident sur l'autoroute.
>
> *The fog caused an accident on the motorway.*

Another *causer*, informal, means to chat: *causer avec un ami*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

causer is built on *cause*, which comes from Latin *causa* "cause, reason, lawsuit" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: causer*
- *Say it: causer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *causer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the opponent, then the French for to argue a case, then say *causer* again

Before you move on

What does causer mean? ("To cause".) Say it once more.

346.2 provoquer — to bring about, to cause; to provoke

Before the new one: say the French for to argue a case, then the French for to cause.

You'll want to know: provoquer

provoquer — "to bring about, to cause; to provoke".

Ce médicament peut provoquer de la fatigue.

This medicine can cause tiredness.

To cause, often something bad; also to provoke a person.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

provoquer comes from Latin *prōvocāre* "to call forth, to challenge" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *vocāre* "to call".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: provoquer*
- *Say it: provoquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *provoquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to argue a case, then the French for to cause, then say *provoquer* again

Before you move on

What does provoquer mean? ("To bring about, to cause; to provoke".) Say it once more.

346.3 la conséquence — the consequence

Before the new one: say the French for to cause, then the French for to bring about.

You'll want to know: la conséquence

la conséquence — "the consequence".

Cette décision aura des conséquences pour tout le monde.

This decision will have consequences for everyone.

En conséquence — accordingly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conséquence is a learned borrowing from Latin *cōnsequentia* (EtymDB), from *cōnsequī* "to follow after", built on *sequī* "to follow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la conséquence*
- *Say it: la conséquence*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la conséquence*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cause, then the French for to bring about, then say *la conséquence* again

Before you move on

What does la conséquence mean? ("The consequence".) Say it once more.

346.4 entraîner — to lead to, to bring about; to train

Before the new one: say the French for to bring about, then the French for the consequence.

You'll want to know: entraîner

entraîner — "to lead to, to bring about; to train".

Le froid entraîne souvent des rhumes.

The cold often leads to colds.

In sport, *s'entraîner* is to train; the coach is *l'entraîneur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entraîner is built from *en-* and *traîner* "to drag", which is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin *tragīnāre*, based on Latin *trahere* "to pull, to draw" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *entraîner*
- *Say it:* *entraîner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *entraîner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bring about, then the French for the consequence, then say *entraîner* again

Before you move on

What does entraîner mean? ("To lead to, to bring about; to train".) Say it once more.

346.5 découler — to follow (from), to result from

Before the new one: say the French for the consequence, then the French for to lead to.

You'll want to know: découler

découler — "to follow (from), to result from".

Tous nos problèmes découlent de cette erreur.

All our problems follow from this mistake.

Découler de — to flow from. Formal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

découler is built from *dé-* "from" and *couler* "to flow", which is inherited from Latin *cōlāre* "to filter, to strain" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *découler*
- *Say it:* *découler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *découler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the consequence, then the French for to lead to, then say *découler* again

Before you move on

What does découler mean? ("To follow (from), to result from".) Say it once more.

Chapter 347

Puisque et vu que

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give a known reason with since, given that and seeing that, and draw a result with consequently and that is why.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 347: I can give a known reason with since, given that and seeing that, and draw a result with consequently and that is why.*

347.1 puisque — since, as (a known reason)

> Before the new one: say the French for to lead to, then the French for to follow.

You'll want to know: puisque

puisque — "since, as (a known reason)".

> Puisque tu es là, tu peux m'aider.
>
> *Since you are here, you can help me.*

Takes the indicative: *puisque tu es là*. The reason is one both people already know. Before *il* or *elle*: *puisqu'il*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

puisque is built from *puis* "then, afterwards" and *que*. *puis* is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin form of *post* "after" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: puisque*
- *Say it: puisque*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *puisque*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lead to, then the French for to follow, then say *puisque* again

Before you move on

What does puisque mean? ("Since, as (a known reason)".) Say it once more.

347.2 étant donné que — given that

Before the new one: say the French for to follow, then the French for since.

You'll want to know: étant donné que

étant donné que — "given that".

Étant donné que le magasin est fermé, nous rentrons.

Given that the shop is closed, we are going home.

Takes the indicative: *étant donné que le magasin est fermé*. Careful style, frequent in writing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étant donné que is built from *étant*, the present participle of *être*, and *donné* "given". *donner* is inherited from Latin *dōnāre* "to give as a present" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: étant donné que*
- *Say it: étant donné que*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *étant donné que*
- *Recall:* say the French for to follow, then the French for since, then say *étant donné que* again

Before you move on

What does étant donné que mean? ("Given that".) Say it once more.

347.3 vu que — seeing that

Before the new one: say the French for since, then the French for given that.

You'll want to know: vu que

vu que — "seeing that".

Vu qu'il pleut, nous restons à la maison.

Seeing that it is raining, we are staying at home.

Takes the indicative: *vu qu'il pleut.* A little more relaxed than *étant donné que.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vu que is built from *vu*, the past participle of *voir* "to see", which is inherited from Latin *vidēre* "to see" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vu que*
- *Say it:* *vu que*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *vu que*
- *Recall:* say the French for since, then the French for given that, then say *vu que* again

Before you move on

What does vu que mean? ("Seeing that".) Say it once more.

347.4 par conséquent — consequently, therefore

Before the new one: say the French for given that, then the French for seeing that.

You'll want to know: par conséquent

par conséquent — "consequently, therefore".

Il est malade ; par conséquent, il ne vient pas.

He is ill; consequently, he is not coming.

Written style; in speech, *donc* or *alors*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

conséquent is a learned borrowing from Latin *cōnsequēns* "following, consistent" (EtymDB), the participle of *cōnsequī* "to follow after", built on *sequī* "to follow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: par conséquent*
- *Say it: par conséquent*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *par conséquent*
- *Recall:* say the French for given that, then the French for seeing that, then say *par conséquent* again

Before you move on

What does par conséquent mean? ("Consequently, therefore".) Say it once more.

347.5 c'est pourquoi — that is why

Before the new one: say the French for seeing that, then the French for consequently.

You'll want to know: c'est pourquoi

c'est pourquoi — "that is why".

Je n'ai pas d'argent ; c'est pourquoi je reste ici.

I have no money; that is why I am staying here.

It brings in the result, after the cause.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pourquoi is built from *pour* "for", from Latin *prō*, and *quoi* "what", from Latin *quid* (Lewis & Short): for what.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: c'est pourquoi*
- *Say it: c'est pourquoi*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *c'est pourquoi*
- *Recall:* say the French for seeing that, then the French for consequently, then say *c'est pourquoi* again

Before you move on

What does c'est pourquoi mean? ("That is why".) Say it once more.

Chapter 348

Grâce à toi

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what something is due to: because of and thanks to, indeed and from then on, and name its origin.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 348: I can say what something is due to: because of and thanks to, indeed and from then on, and name its origin.*

348.1 à cause de — because of

> Before the new one: say the French for consequently, then the French for that is why.

You'll want to know: à cause de

à cause de — "because of".

> Nous sommes restés à la maison à cause de la neige.
>
> *We stayed at home because of the snow.*

Followed by a noun; with a verb, use *parce que*. *À cause du*, *à cause des*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

à cause de is built on *cause*, which comes from Latin *causa* "cause, reason, lawsuit" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: à cause de*
- *Say it: à cause de*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *à cause de*
- *Recall:* say the French for consequently, then the French for that is why, then say *à cause de* again

Before you move on

What does à cause de mean? ("Because of".) Say it once more.

348.2 grâce à — thanks to

Before the new one: say the French for that is why, then the French for because of.

You'll want to know: grâce à

grâce à — "thanks to".

Grâce à toi, j'ai trouvé un travail.

Thanks to you, I found a job.

For good results; for bad ones, *à cause de*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grâce comes through Old French *grace* from Latin *grātia* "favour, thanks" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *grātus* "pleasing".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: grâce à*
- *Say it: grâce à*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *grâce à*
- *Recall:* say the French for that is why, then the French for because of, then say *grâce à* again

Before you move on

What does grâce à mean? ("Thanks to".) Say it once more.

348.3 en effet — indeed; and that is because

Before the new one: say the French for because of, then the French for thanks to.

You'll want to know: en effet

en effet — "indeed; and that is because".

Il est fatigué ; en effet, il a travaillé toute la nuit.

He is tired; indeed, he worked all night.

It confirms or explains what came before; it does not mean *in effect*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

effet comes through Old French *effet* from Latin *effectus* "an effect, a result" (EtymDB), from *efficere* "to bring about", built on *facere* "to do, to make" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: en effet*
- *Say it: en effet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *en effet*
- *Recall:* say the French for because of, then the French for thanks to, then say *en effet* again

Before you move on

What does en effet mean? ("Indeed; and that is because".) Say it once more.

348.4 dès lors — from then on; consequently

Before the new one: say the French for thanks to, then the French for indeed.

You'll want to know: dès lors

dès lors — "from then on; consequently".

Il a perdu son travail ; dès lors, tout a changé.

He lost his job; from then on, everything changed.

Two senses: from that moment on, and so. *Dès lors que* means given that.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lors goes back through Old French to Vulgar Latin *illā hōrā* "at that hour" (EtymDB). *dès* "from" is usually traced to Latin *dē ex* "from out of".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dès lors*
- *Say it: dès lors*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dès lors*
- *Recall:* say the French for thanks to, then the French for indeed, then say *dès lors* again

Before you move on

What does dès lors mean? (“From then on; consequently”.) Say it once more.

348.5 l’origine — the origin

Before the new one: say the French for indeed, then the French for from then on.

You’ll want to know: l’origine

l’origine — “the origin”.

Quelle est l’origine de ce problème ?

What is the origin of this problem?

À l’origine — originally. Feminine: *une origine*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

origine is a learned borrowing from Latin *orīgō* “beginning, source, origin” (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *orīrī* “to rise”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'origine*
- *Say it: l'origine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'origine*
- *Recall:* say the French for indeed, then the French for from then on, then say *l'origine* again

Before you move on

What does l'origine mean? ("The origin".) Say it once more.

Chapter 349

D'où ça vient

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say where something comes from, what it results from, what influences it and what it gives rise to.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 349: I can say where something comes from, what it results from, what influences it and what it gives rise to.*

349.1 provenir — to come from, to originate in

> Before the new one: say the French for from then on, then the French for the origin.

You'll want to know: provenir

provenir — "to come from, to originate in".

> Ce bruit provient de la cuisine.
>
> *This noise is coming from the kitchen.*

Conjugated like *venir*, with *être*. *En provenance de* — arriving from.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

provenir comes from Latin *prōvenīre* "to come forth, to arise" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *venīre* "to come".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: provenir*
- *Say it: provenir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *provenir*
- *Recall:* say the French for from then on, then the French for the origin, then say *provenir* again

Before you move on

What does provenir mean? ("To come from, to originate in".) Say it once more.

349.2 résulter — to result (from)

Before the new one: say the French for the origin, then the French for to come from.

You'll want to know: résulter

résulter — "to result (from)".

Cet accident résulte d'une erreur humaine.

This accident results from human error.

Il en résulte que — the result is that. Mostly in the third person.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

résulter is a learned borrowing from Latin *resultāre* "to spring back, to rebound" (Lewis & Short), built on *saltāre* "to leap".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: résulter*
- *Say it: résulter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *résulter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the origin, then the French for to come from, then say *résulter* again

Before you move on

What does résulter mean? ("To result (from)".) Say it once more.

349.3 l'influence — the influence

Before the new one: say the French for to come from, then the French for to result.

You'll want to know: l'influence

l'influence — "the influence".

Ses amis ont une mauvaise influence sur lui.

His friends are a bad influence on him.

Sous l'influence de — under the influence of. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

influence is usually traced to Medieval Latin *influentia* "a flowing in", built on Latin *influere* "to flow into" (Lewis & Short), from *fluere* "to flow".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'influence*
- *Say it: l'influence*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'influence*
- *Recall:* say the French for to come from, then the French for to result, then say *l'influence* again

Before you move on

What does l'influence mean? ("The influence".) Say it once more.

349.4 influencer — to influence

Before the new one: say the French for to result, then the French for the influence.

You'll want to know: influencer

influencer — "to influence".

La publicité influence nos choix.

Advertising influences our choices.

Nous influençons, with *ç*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

influencer is built on *influence*, from Medieval Latin *influentia* "a flowing in", on Latin *influere* "to flow into", from *fluere* "to flow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: influencer*
- *Say it: influencer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *influencer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to result, then the French for the influence, then say *influencer* again

Before you move on

What does influencer mean? ("To influence".) Say it once more.

349.5 engendrer — to generate, to give rise to

Before the new one: say the French for the influence, then the French for to influence.

You'll want to know: engendrer

engendrer — "to generate, to give rise to".

Le bruit engendre la fatigue.

Noise brings on tiredness.

Formal. The older sense is to father a child.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

engendrer is inherited from Latin *ingenerāre* "to implant, to produce" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *generāre* "to beget", from *genus* "birth, kind".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *engendrer*
- *Say it:* *engendrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *engendrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the influence, then the French for to influence, then say *engendrer* again

Before you move on

What does engendrer mean? (“To generate, to give rise to”.) Say it once more.

349.6 Retour sur les chapitres 342–349

Say the French for to evaluate and to judge.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to evaluate, to judge, the judgement, subjective, impartial
- the advantage, the drawback, the aspect, the criticism, to stress
- to reason, the reasoning, to conclude, the subtle difference, to qualify
- to approve, to disapprove, the supporter, the opponent, to argue a case
- to cause, to bring about, the consequence, to lead to, to follow
- since, given that, seeing that, consequently, that is why
- because of, thanks to, indeed, from then on, the origin
- to come from, to result, the influence, to influence, to generate

Before you move on

To evaluate? (**évaluer**.) To judge? (**juger**.) The judgement? (**le jugement**.) Subjective? (**subjectif**.) Impartial? (**impartial**.) The advantage? (**l'avantage**.) The drawback? (**l'inconvénient**.) The aspect? (**l'aspect**.) The criticism? (**la critique**.) To stress? (**souligner**.) To reason? (**raisonner**.) The reasoning? (**le raisonnement**.) To conclude? (**conclure**.) The subtle difference? (**la nuance**.) To qualify? (**nuancer**.) To approve? (**approuver**.) To disapprove? (**désapprouver**.) The supporter? (**le partisan**.) The opponent? (**l'adversaire**.) To argue a case? (**argumenter**.) To cause? (**causer**.) To bring about? (**provoquer**.) The consequence? (**la conséquence**.) To lead to? (**entraîner**.) To follow? (**découler**.) Since? (**puisque**.) Given that? (**étant donné que**.) Seeing that? (**vu que**.) Consequently? (**par conséquent**.) That is why? (**c'est pourquoi**.) Because of? (**à cause de**.) Thanks to? (**grâce à**.) Indeed? (**en effet**.) From then on? (**dès lors**.) The origin? (**l'origine**.) To come from? (**provenir**.) To result? (**résulter**.) The influence? (**l'influence**.) To influence? (**influencer**.) To generate? (**engendrer**.)

Chapter 350

Les répercussions

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the impact of an event, its knock-on effects, what set it off, what it aroused and the motive behind it.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 350: I can describe the impact of an event, its knock-on effects, what set it off, what it aroused and the motive behind it.*

350.1 l'impact — the impact

> Before the new one: say the French for to influence, then the French for to generate.

You'll want to know: l'impact

l'impact — "the impact".

> Ce projet a un impact sur tout le quartier.
>
> *This project has an impact on the whole neighbourhood.*

Avoir un impact sur — to have an effect on. The final *ct* is said. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

impact comes from Latin *impāctus*, the participle of *impingere* "to dash against, to strike" (Lewis & Short), built on *pangere* "to fix, to drive in".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'impact*
- *Say it: l'impact*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'impact*
- *Recall:* say the French for to influence, then the French for to generate, then say *l'impact* again

Before you move on

What does l'impact mean? ("The impact".) Say it once more.

350.2 la répercussion — the repercussion, the knock-on effect

Before the new one: say the French for to generate, then the French for the impact.

You'll want to know: la répercussion

la répercussion — "the repercussion, the knock-on effect".

Cette décision aura des répercussions sur les prix.

This decision will have repercussions on prices.

Mostly in the plural: *des répercussions*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

répercussion is a learned borrowing from Latin *repercussiō* "a rebounding" (Lewis & Short), from *repercutere* "to strike back", built on *quatere* "to shake, to strike".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la répercussion*
- *Say it: la répercussion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la répercussion*
- *Recall:* say the French for to generate, then the French for the impact, then say *la répercussion* again

Before you move on

What does la répercussion mean? ("The repercussion, the knock-on effect".) Say it once more.

350.3 déclencher — to set off, to trigger

Before the new one: say the French for the impact, then the French for the repercussion.

You'll want to know: déclencher

déclencher — "to set off, to trigger".

Une petite remarque a déclenché la colère de mon père.

A small remark set off my father's anger.

Of alarms too: *l'alarme s'est déclenchée.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déclencher is built from *dé-* and *clenche* "latch", which comes from a Frankish *klinka* "latch" (EtymDB): you lift the latch and things start moving.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: déclencher*
- *Say it: déclencher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déclencher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the impact, then the French for the repercussion, then say *déclencher* again

Before you move on

What does déclencher mean? ("To set off, to trigger".) Say it once more.

350.4 susciter — to arouse, to give rise to

Before the new one: say the French for the repercussion, then the French for to set off.

You'll want to know: susciter

susciter — "to arouse, to give rise to".

Sa décision a suscité beaucoup de questions.

Her decision raised a lot of questions.

Formal: *susciter la curiosité* — to arouse curiosity.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

susciter is a learned borrowing from Latin *suscitāre* "to lift up, to rouse" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *citāre* "to set in motion".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: susciter*
- *Say it: susciter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *susciter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the repercussion, then the French for to set off, then say *susciter* again

Before you move on

What does susciter mean? ("To arouse, to give rise to".) Say it once more.

350.5 le motif — the motive, the reason; the pattern

Before the new one: say the French for to set off, then the French for to arouse.

You'll want to know: le motif

le motif — "the motive, the reason; the pattern".

Quel est le motif de votre visite ?

What is the reason for your visit?

Also a pattern on cloth: *un motif à fleurs*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

motif comes from Late Latin *mōtīvus* "serving to move" (EtymDB), from *movēre* "to move" (Lewis & Short): what moves you to act.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le motif*
- *Say it: le motif*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le motif*
- *Recall:* say the French for to set off, then the French for to arouse, then say *le motif* again

Before you move on

What does le motif mean? ("The motive, the reason; the pattern".) Say it once more.

Chapter 351

Comment réagir

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe how someone reacted, tell a real reason from a pretext, and justify a decision.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 351: I can describe how someone reacted, tell a real reason from a pretext, and justify a decision.*

351.1 réagir — to react

Before the new one: say the French for to arouse, then the French for the motive.

You'll want to know: réagir

réagir — "to react".

> Comment as-tu réagi quand tu as appris la nouvelle ?
>
> *How did you react when you heard the news?*

Réagir à quelque chose. A *-ir* verb like *finir*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réagir is built from *ré-* "back" and *agir* "to act", which comes from Latin *agere* "to do, to drive" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: réagir*
- *Say it: réagir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *réagir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to arouse, then the French for the motive, then say *réagir* again

Before you move on

What does réagir mean? ("To react".) Say it once more.

351.2 la réaction — the reaction

Before the new one: say the French for the motive, then the French for to react.

You'll want to know: la réaction

la réaction — "the reaction".

Sa réaction m'a surpris.

Her reaction surprised me.

Feminine: *une réaction.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réaction comes from Medieval Latin *reactiō* (EtymDB), built from *re-* "back" and *āctiō* "a doing", from *agere* "to do" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réaction*
- *Say it: la réaction*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la réaction*
- *Recall:* say the French for the motive, then the French for to react, then say *la réaction* again

Before you move on

What does la réaction mean? ("The reaction".) Say it once more.

351.3 le prétexte — the pretext

Before the new one: say the French for to react, then the French for the reaction.

You'll want to know: le prétexte

le prétexte — "the pretext".

Il a trouvé un prétexte pour partir plus tôt.

He found a pretext to leave earlier.

Sous prétexte que — on the pretext that.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prétexte is a learned borrowing from Latin *praetextus* "an outward show, a pretext" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *praetexere* "to weave in front, to cover", built on *texere* "to weave".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le prétexte*
- *Say it: le prétexte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le prétexte*
- *Recall:* say the French for to react, then the French for the reaction, then say *le prétexte* again

Before you move on

What does le prétexte mean? ("The pretext".) Say it once more.

351.4 justifier — to justify

Before the new one: say the French for the reaction, then the French for the pretext.

You'll want to know: justifier

justifier — "to justify".

Elle a justifié sa décision devant l'équipe.

She justified her decision in front of the team.

Se justifier — to explain yourself.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

justifier comes from Late Latin *iūstificāre* "to justify" (EtymDB), built on *iūstus* "right, fair" (Lewis & Short) and *-ficāre* "to make".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: justifier*
- *Say it: justifier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *justifier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the reaction, then the French for the pretext, then say *justifier* again

Before you move on

What does justifier mean? ("To justify".) Say it once more.

351.5 la justification — the justification

Before the new one: say the French for the pretext, then the French for to justify.

You'll want to know: la justification

la justification — "the justification".

Il n'y a aucune justification pour ce prix.

There is no justification for this price.

Feminine: *une justification.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

justification is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *iūstificātiō* (EtymDB), from *iūstificāre* "to justify", built on *iūstus* "right, fair" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la justification*
- *Say it: la justification*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la justification*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pretext, then the French for to justify, then say *la justification* again

Before you move on

What does la justification mean? ("The justification".) Say it once more.

Chapter 352

Freins et atouts

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what stands in the way of a plan, what prevents or hinders it, and what favours it or works as an asset.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 352: I can say what stands in the way of a plan, what prevents or hinders it, and what favours it or works as an asset.*

352.1 empêcher — to prevent, to stop (from)

> Before the new one: say the French for to justify, then the French for the justification.

You'll want to know: empêcher

empêcher — "to prevent, to stop (from)".

> Le bruit m'empêche de dormir.
>
> *The noise stops me from sleeping.*

Empêcher quelqu'un de faire quelque chose. Il n'empêche que — all the same.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

empêcher is inherited through Old French *empeechier* from Late Latin *impedicāre* "to fetter, to hinder" (EtymDB), built on *pedica* "a fetter for the foot" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: empêcher*
- *Say it: empêcher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *empêcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to justify, then the French for the justification, then say *empêcher* again

Before you move on

What does empêcher mean? ("To prevent, to stop (from)".) Say it once more.

352.2 entraver — to hinder, to hamper

Before the new one: say the French for the justification, then the French for to prevent.

You'll want to know: entraver

entraver — "to hinder, to hamper".

La neige entrave le travail des pompiers.

The snow is hampering the firefighters.

Formal. *Une entrave* was a chain on an animal's legs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

entraver is usually explained as built from *en-* and Old French *tref* "beam", from Latin *trabs* "a beam" (Lewis & Short): a piece of wood tied to the legs. The details are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: entraver*
- *Say it: entraver*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *entraver*
- *Recall:* say the French for the justification, then the French for to prevent, then say *entraver* again

Before you move on

What does entraver mean? ("To hinder, to hamper".) Say it once more.

352.3 favoriser — to favour, to encourage

Before the new one: say the French for to prevent, then the French for to hinder.

You'll want to know: favoriser

favoriser — "to favour, to encourage".

Le sport favorise un bon sommeil.

Exercise encourages good sleep.

To help something happen; also to treat someone better than others.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

favoriser is built on *faveur* "favour", from Latin *favor* "goodwill, favour" (Lewis & Short), from *favēre* "to be well disposed".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: favoriser*
- *Say it: favoriser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *favoriser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to prevent, then the French for to hinder, then say *favoriser* again

Before you move on

What does favoriser mean? ("To favour, to encourage".) Say it once more.

352.4 l'atout — the asset, the strong point; the trump card

Before the new one: say the French for to hinder, then the French for to favour.

You'll want to know: l'atout

l'atout — "the asset, the strong point; the trump card".

Parler trois langues est un vrai atout.

Speaking three languages is a real asset.

In card games, *l'atout* is the trump suit. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

atout is built from *à* and *tout* "all": a card that beats all the others. *tout* is inherited from Latin *tōtus* "whole" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'atout*
- *Say it: l'atout*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'atout*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hinder, then the French for to favour, then say *l'atout* again

Before you move on

What does l'atout mean? ("The asset, the strong point; the trump card".) Say it once more.

352.5 le frein — the brake; the obstacle

Before the new one: say the French for to favour, then the French for the asset.

You'll want to know: le frein

le frein — "the brake; the obstacle".

Le prix est un frein pour beaucoup de familles.

The price is an obstacle for many families.

On a car or a bike, *les freins* are the brakes; the verb is *freiner*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frein is inherited from Latin *frēnum* "a bridle, a bit" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short): what holds a horse back.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le frein*
- *Say it:* *le frein*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le frein*
- *Recall:* say the French for to favour, then the French for the asset, then say *le frein* again

Before you move on

What does le frein mean? ("The brake; the obstacle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 353

Trouver un remède

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how to fix a situation: find a remedy, put it right, soften it or make up for it, or say it got worse.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 353: I can say how to fix a situation: find a remedy, put it right, soften it or make up for it, or say it got worse.*

353.1 le remède — the remedy, the cure

> Before the new one: say the French for the asset, then the French for the brake.

You'll want to know: le remède

le remède — "the remedy, the cure".

> Le meilleur remède contre la fatigue, c'est le sommeil.
>
> *The best remedy for tiredness is sleep.*

Un remède de grand-mère — a home remedy.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remède comes from Latin *remedium* "a cure, a remedy" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built from *re-* and *medērī* "to heal".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le remède*
- *Say it: le remède*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le remède*
- *Recall:* say the French for the asset, then the French for the brake, then say *le remède* again

Before you move on

What does le remède mean? ("The remedy, the cure".) Say it once more.

353.2 remédier — to remedy, to put right

Before the new one: say the French for the brake, then the French for the remedy.

You'll want to know: remédier

remédier — "to remedy, to put right".

Il faut remédier à ce problème rapidement.

This problem has to be put right quickly.

Remédier à quelque chose, with *à*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remédier is a learned borrowing from Latin *remediāre* "to cure" (EtymDB), from *remedium* "a cure", built on *medērī* "to heal" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: remédier*
- *Say it: remédier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *remédier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the brake, then the French for the remedy, then say *remédier* again

Before you move on

What does remédier mean? ("To remedy, to put right".) Say it once more.

353.3 aggraver — to make worse, to aggravate

Before the new one: say the French for the remedy, then the French for to remedy.

You'll want to know: aggraver

aggraver — "to make worse, to aggravate".

Le froid a aggravé sa toux.

The cold made his cough worse.

S'aggraver — to get worse: *la situation s'aggrave.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aggraver is a learned borrowing from Latin *aggravāre* "to make heavier" (EtymDB), built on *gravis* "heavy" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aggraver*
- *Say it:* *aggraver*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *aggraver*
- *Recall:* say the French for the remedy, then the French for to remedy, then say *aggraver* again

Before you move on

What does aggraver mean? ("To make worse, to aggravate".) Say it once more.

353.4 atténuer — to lessen, to soften

Before the new one: say the French for to remedy, then the French for to make worse.

You'll want to know: atténuer

atténuer — "to lessen, to soften".

Ce médicament atténue la douleur.

This medicine eases the pain.

S'atténuer — to fade, to ease.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

atténuer is a learned borrowing from Latin *attenuāre* "to make thin, to weaken" (Lewis & Short), built on *tenuis* "thin".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: atténuer*
- *Say it: atténuer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *atténuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to remedy, then the French for to make worse, then say *atténuer* again

Before you move on

What does atténuer mean? ("To lessen, to soften".) Say it once more.

353.5 compenser — to make up for, to compensate

Before the new one: say the French for to make worse, then the French for to lessen.

You'll want to know: compenser

compenser — "to make up for, to compensate".

Il travaille le samedi pour compenser.

He works on Saturdays to make up for it.

Compenser le temps perdu — to make up for lost time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compenser is a learned borrowing from Latin *compēnsāre* "to weigh one thing against another" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *pēnsāre* "to weigh".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *compenser*
- *Say it:* *compenser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *compenser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to make worse, then the French for to lessen, then say *compenser* again

Before you move on

What does compenser mean? ("To make up for, to compensate".) Say it once more.

Chapter 354

Je cherche du travail

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apply for a job: send my CV and my application, say who the candidates are and talk about being taken on.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 354: I can apply for a job: send my CV and my application, say who the candidates are and talk about being taken on.*

354.1 le CV — the CV, the résumé

> Before the new one: say the French for to lessen, then the French for to make up for.

You'll want to know: le CV

le CV — "the CV, the résumé".

> J'ai envoyé mon CV à dix entreprises.
>
> *I sent my CV to ten companies.*

Said *cé-vé*: short for Latin *curriculum vitae*. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

CV is short for *curriculum vitae*, Latin for "a running of life": *curriculum* "a running, a course", from *currere* "to run", and *vīta* "life"

(Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le CV*
- *Say it: le CV*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le CV*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lessen, then the French for to make up for, then say *le CV* again

Before you move on

What does le CV mean? ("The CV, the résumé".) Say it once more.

354.2 le candidat — the candidate, the applicant

Before the new one: say the French for to make up for, then the French for the CV.

You'll want to know: le candidat

le candidat — "the candidate, the applicant".

Il y a vingt candidats pour ce poste.

There are twenty applicants for this job.

Feminine *candidate*. Also in elections.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

candidat comes from Latin *candidātus* "clothed in white" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *candidus* "dazzling white": in Rome, people seeking office wore a whitened toga.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le candidat*
- *Say it: le candidat*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le candidat*
- *Recall:* say the French for to make up for, then the French for the CV, then say *le candidat* again

Before you move on

What does le candidat mean? ("The candidate, the applicant".) Say it once more.

354.3 la candidature — the application (for a job)

Before the new one: say the French for the CV, then the French for the candidate.

You'll want to know: la candidature

la candidature — "the application (for a job)".

J'ai envoyé ma candidature hier soir.

I sent my application last night.

Poser sa candidature — to apply.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

candidature is built from *candidat* and the suffix *-ure*. *candidat* comes from Latin *candidātus* "clothed in white", from *candidus* "white" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la candidature*
- *Say it: la candidature*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la candidature*
- *Recall:* say the French for the CV, then the French for the candidate, then say *la candidature* again

Before you move on

What does la candidature mean? ("The application (for a job)".) Say it once more.

354.4 postuler — to apply (for a job)

Before the new one: say the French for the candidate, then the French for the application.

You'll want to know: postuler

postuler — "to apply (for a job)".

Elle a postulé à un poste de vendeuse.

She applied for a job as a shop assistant.

Postuler à or *pour un poste.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

postuler is a learned borrowing from Latin *postulāre* "to ask, to demand" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: postuler*
- *Say it: postuler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *postuler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the candidate, then the French for the application, then say *postuler* again

Before you move on

What does postuler mean? ("To apply (for a job)".) Say it once more.

354.5 l'embauche — the hiring, being taken on

Before the new one: say the French for the application, then the French for to apply.

You'll want to know: l'embauche

l'embauche — "the hiring, being taken on".

Après l'entretien, il a eu une promesse d'embauche.

After the interview, he got a written job offer.

Une promesse d'embauche — a written job offer. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

embauche is formed from the verb meaning to take on a worker (EtymDB), built on an old word *bauche* "workshop". The origin of *bauche* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'embauche*
- *Say it: l'embauche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'embauche*
- *Recall:* say the French for the application, then the French for to apply, then say *l'embauche* again

Before you move on

What does l'embauche mean? ("The hiring, being taken on".) Say it once more.

Chapter 355

Quitter son travail

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about leaving a job: being laid off, a dismissal, resigning, a resignation and the notice period.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 355: I can talk about leaving a job: being laid off, a dismissal, resigning, a resignation and the notice period.*

355.1 licencier — to dismiss, to lay off

> Before the new one: say the French for to apply, then the French for the hiring.

You'll want to know: licencier

licencier — "to dismiss, to lay off".

> L'usine a licencié cinquante ouvriers.
>
> *The factory laid off fifty workers.*

Formal; in speech people also say *renvoyer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

licencier is built on *licence* "leave, permission", from Latin *licentia* "freedom, licence" (Lewis & Short), from *licēre* "to be allowed": first, to give someone leave to go.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: licencier*
- *Say it: licencier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *licencier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to apply, then the French for the hiring, then say *licencier* again

Before you move on

What does licencier mean? ("To dismiss, to lay off".) Say it once more.

355.2 le licenciement — the dismissal, the layoff

Before the new one: say the French for the hiring, then the French for to dismiss.

You'll want to know: le licenciement

le licenciement — "the dismissal, the layoff".

Il a reçu sa lettre de licenciement.

He received his letter of dismissal.

Un licenciement économique — a layoff for economic reasons.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

licenciement is built from *licencier* and the suffix *-ment*. The verb rests on *licence*, from Latin *licentia* "freedom, licence", from *licēre* "to be allowed" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le licenciement*
- *Say it: le licenciement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le licenciement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hiring, then the French for to dismiss, then say *le licenciement* again

Before you move on

What does le licenciement mean? ("The dismissal, the layoff".) Say it once more.

355.3 la démission — the resignation

Before the new one: say the French for to dismiss, then the French for the dismissal.

You'll want to know: la démission

la démission — "the resignation".

Il a donné sa démission lundi.

He handed in his resignation on Monday.

Donner sa démission — to resign.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

démission is a learned borrowing from Latin *dēmissiō* "a letting down, a lowering" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *dēmittere* "to send down", built on *mittere* "to send".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la démission*
- *Say it: la démission*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la démission*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dismiss, then the French for the dismissal, then say *la démission* again

Before you move on

What does la démission mean? ("The resignation".) Say it once more.

355.4 démissionner — to resign, to quit (a job)

Before the new one: say the French for the dismissal, then the French for the resignation.

You'll want to know: démissionner

démissionner — "to resign, to quit (a job)".

Elle a démissionné parce qu'elle n'était pas heureuse.

She resigned because she was not happy.

Démissionner de son poste.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

démissionner is built on *démission*, from Latin *dēmissiō* "a letting down", from *dēmittere* "to send down", built on *mittere* "to send" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: démissionner*
- *Say it: démissionner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *démissionner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the dismissal, then the French for the resignation, then say *démissionner* again

Before you move on

What does démissionner mean? ("To resign, to quit (a job)".) Say it once more.

355.5 le préavis — the notice (period)

Before the new one: say the French for the resignation, then the French for to resign.

You'll want to know: le préavis

le préavis — "the notice (period)".

Je dois faire un mois de préavis avant de partir.

I have to work a month of notice before leaving.

Sans préavis — without notice.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préavis is built from *pré-* "before" and *avis* "opinion, notice". *avis* comes from Old French *avis*, built on *vis* "sight, view" (EtymDB), from Latin *vīsus* "a look, a sight", from *vidēre* "to see" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le préavis*
- *Say it: le préavis*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le préavis*
- *Recall:* say the French for the resignation, then the French for to resign, then say *le préavis* again

Before you move on

What does le préavis mean? ("The notice (period)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 356

Sans emploi

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about looking for a job: unemployment, being out of work, and companies that hire and recruit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 356: I can talk about looking for a job: unemployment, being out of work, and companies that hire and recruit.*

356.1 l'emploi — the job, employment; the use

> Before the new one: say the French for to resign, then the French for the notice.

You'll want to know: l'emploi

l'emploi — "the job, employment; the use".

> Mon frère cherche un emploi dans une banque.
>
> *My brother is looking for a job in a bank.*

Un emploi du temps — a timetable. *Le mode d'emploi* — the instructions. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

emploi is formed from *employer* (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *implicāre* "to enfold, to involve" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'emploi*
- *Say it: l'emploi*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'emploi*
- *Recall:* say the French for to resign, then the French for the notice, then say *l'emploi* again

Before you move on

What does l'emploi mean? ("The job, employment; the use".) Say it once more.

356.2 le chômage — the unemployment

Before the new one: say the French for the notice, then the French for the job.

You'll want to know: le chômage

le chômage — "the unemployment".

Il est au chômage depuis trois mois.

He has been out of work for three months.

Être au chômage — to be out of work. *Toucher le chômage* — to get unemployment benefit; in Québec the benefit is *l'assurance-emploi*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chômage is built on *chômer* "to stop work". The verb is usually traced to Late Latin *caumāre* "to rest during the heat", from Greek *kaûma* "burning heat".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chômage*
- *Say it: le chômage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chômage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the notice, then the French for the job, then say *le chômage* again

Before you move on

What does le chômage mean? ("The unemployment".) Say it once more.

356.3 le chômeur — the unemployed person

Before the new one: say the French for the job, then the French for the unemployment.

You'll want to know: le chômeur

le chômeur — "the unemployed person".

Ce chômeur cherche du travail tous les jours.

This unemployed man looks for work every day.

Feminine *chômeuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chômeur is built from *chômer* "to stop work" and *-eur*. The verb is usually traced to Late Latin *caumāre* "to rest during the heat", from Greek *kaûma* "burning heat".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chômeur*
- *Say it: le chômeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chômeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the job, then the French for the unemployment, then say *le chômeur* again

Before you move on

What does le chômeur mean? ("The unemployed person".) Say it once more.

356.4 embaucher — to hire, to take on

Before the new one: say the French for the unemployment, then the French for the unemployed person.

You'll want to know: embaucher

embaucher — "to hire, to take on".

Le restaurant embauche des serveurs pour l'été.

The restaurant is taking on waiters for the summer.

Le restaurant embauche — the restaurant is hiring.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

embaucher is usually explained as built from *en-* and an old word *bauche* "workshop": to bring someone into the workshop. The origin of *bauche* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *embaucher*
- *Say it:* *embaucher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *embaucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the unemployment, then the French for the unemployed person, then say *embaucher* again

Before you move on

What does embaucher mean? ("To hire, to take on".) Say it once more.

356.5 recruter — to recruit

Before the new one: say the French for the unemployed person, then the French for to hire.

You'll want to know: recruter

recruter — "to recruit".

L'entreprise recrute des ingénieurs.

The company is recruiting engineers.

The person recruited is *une recrue*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recruter is built on *recrue* "a recruit" (EtymDB), the old participle of *recroître* "to grow again": new growth for a group. *croître* is inherited from Latin *crēscere* "to grow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *recruter*
- *Say it:* *recruter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *recruter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the unemployed person, then the French for to hire, then say *recruter* again

Before you move on

What does recruter mean? ("To recruit".) Say it once more.

Chapter 357

Le premier poste

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a first job: an internship, an intern, an apprentice, an apprenticeship and the employer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 357: I can talk about a first job: an internship, an intern, an apprentice, an apprenticeship and the employer.*

357.1 le stage — the internship, the work placement; a training course

> Before the new one: say the French for to hire, then the French for to recruit.

You'll want to know: le stage

le stage — "the internship, the work placement; a training course".

> Cet été, je fais un stage dans un hôtel.
>
> *This summer, I am doing an internship in a hotel.*

A false friend: not a theatre stage. *Un stage de cuisine* — a cooking course.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stage comes from Medieval Latin *stagium* "a period of residence" (EtymDB), usually linked to Latin *stāre* "to stand" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le stage*
- *Say it: le stage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le stage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hire, then the French for to recruit, then say *le stage* again

Before you move on

What does le stage mean? ("The internship, the work placement; a training course".) Say it once more.

357.2 le stagiaire — the intern, the trainee

Before the new one: say the French for to recruit, then the French for the internship.

You'll want to know: le stagiaire

le stagiaire — "the intern, the trainee".

Le stagiaire travaille avec moi depuis lundi.

The intern has been working with me since Monday.

The same form for a man or a woman: *une stagiaire*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stagiaire is built from *stage* and *-aire*. *stage* comes from Medieval Latin *stagium* "a period of residence" (EtymDB), usually linked to Latin *stāre* "to stand".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le stagiaire*
- *Say it: le stagiaire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le stagiaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to recruit, then the French for the internship, then say *le stagiaire* again

Before you move on

What does le stagiaire mean? ("The intern, the trainee".) Say it once more.

357.3 l'apprenti — the apprentice

Before the new one: say the French for the internship, then the French for the intern.

You'll want to know: l'apprenti

l'apprenti — "the apprentice".

Le boulanger a un apprenti de seize ans.

The baker has a sixteen-year-old apprentice.

Feminine *apprentie*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

apprenti comes from Middle French *apprentis* (EtymDB), built on *apprendre* "to learn", which comes from Latin *apprehendere* "to seize, to grasp" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'apprenti*
- *Say it: l'apprenti*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'apprenti*
- *Recall:* say the French for the internship, then the French for the intern, then say *l'apprenti* again

Before you move on

What does l'apprenti mean? ("The apprentice".) Say it once more.

357.4 l'apprentissage — the apprenticeship; learning

Before the new one: say the French for the intern, then the French for the apprentice.

You'll want to know: l'apprentissage

l'apprentissage — "the apprenticeship; learning".

L'apprentissage d'une langue prend du temps.

Learning a language takes time.

Être en apprentissage — to be an apprentice. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

apprentissage is built from *apprenti* and *-age*. *apprenti* rests on *apprendre*, from Latin *apprehendere* "to seize, to grasp" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'apprentissage*
- *Say it: l'apprentissage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'apprentissage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the intern, then the French for the apprentice, then say *l'apprentissage* again

Before you move on

What does l'apprentissage mean? ("The apprenticeship; learning".) Say it once more.

357.5 l'employeur — the employer

Before the new one: say the French for the apprentice, then the French for the apprenticeship.

You'll want to know: l'employeur

l'employeur — "the employer".

Mon employeur me paie à la fin du mois.

My employer pays me at the end of the month.

The feminine *employeuse* is rare.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

employeur is built from *employer* and *-eur*. *employer* is inherited from Latin *implicāre* "to enfold, to involve" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'employeur*
- *Say it: l'employeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'employeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the apprentice, then the French for the apprenticeship, then say *l'employeur* again

Before you move on

What does l'employeur mean? ("The employer".) Say it once more.

357.6 Retour sur les chapitres 350–357

Say the French for the impact and the repercussion.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the impact, the repercussion, to set off, to arouse, the motive
- to react, the reaction, the pretext, to justify, the justification
- to prevent, to hinder, to favour, the asset, the brake
- the remedy, to remedy, to make worse, to lessen, to make up for
- the CV, the candidate, the application, to apply, the hiring
- to dismiss, the dismissal, the resignation, to resign, the notice

- the job, the unemployment, the unemployed person, to hire, to recruit
- the internship, the intern, the apprentice, the apprenticeship, the employer

Before you move on

The impact? (**l'impact**.) The repercussion? (**la répercussion**.) To set off? (**déclencher**.) To arouse? (**susciter**.) The motive? (**le motif**.) To react? (**réagir**.) The reaction? (**la réaction**.) The pretext? (**le prétexte**.) To justify? (**justifier**.) The justification? (**la justification**.) To prevent? (**empêcher**.) To hinder? (**entraver**.) To favour? (**favoriser**.) The asset? (**l'atout**.) The brake? (**le frein**.) The remedy? (**le remède**.) To remedy? (**remédier**.) To make worse? (**aggraver**.) To lessen? (**atténuer**.) To make up for? (**compenser**.) The CV? (**le CV**.) The candidate? (**le candidat**.) The application? (**la candidature**.) To apply? (**postuler**.) The hiring? (**l'embauche**.) To dismiss? (**licencier**.) The dismissal? (**le licenciement**.) The resignation? (**la démission**.) To resign? (**démissionner**.) The notice? (**le préavis**.) The job? (**l'emploi**.) The unemployment? (**le chômage**.) The unemployed person? (**le chômeur**.) To hire? (**embaucher**.) To recruit? (**recruter**.) The internship? (**le stage**.) The intern? (**le stagiaire**.) The apprentice? (**l'apprenti**.) The apprenticeship? (**l'apprentissage**.) The employer? (**l'employeur**.)

Chapter 358

La grève

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about workers' rights: the union, a strike, strikers, employees and overtime.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 358: I can talk about workers' rights: the union, a strike, strikers, employees and overtime.*

358.1 le syndicat — the trade union

> Before the new one: say the French for the apprenticeship, then the French for the employer.

You'll want to know: le syndicat

le syndicat — "the trade union".

> Mon père travaille pour un syndicat.
>
> *My father works for a trade union.*

Le syndicat d'initiative is an old name for a tourist office.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

syndicat is built from *syndic* "representative" and *-at* (EtymDB). *syndic* comes from Late Latin *syndicus* "delegate of a body", from Greek *sýndikos* "advocate".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le syndicat*
- *Say it: le syndicat*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le syndicat*
- *Recall:* say the French for the apprenticeship, then the French for the employer, then say *le syndicat* again

Before you move on

What does le syndicat mean? ("The trade union".) Say it once more.

358.2 la grève — the strike

Before the new one: say the French for the employer, then the French for the trade union.

You'll want to know: la grève

la grève — "the strike".

Les trains ne roulent pas : il y a une grève.

The trains are not running: there is a strike.

Faire grève, *être en grève* — to be on strike. *La grève* is also a sandy shore.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grève "strike" is built on *grève* "sandy shore": the usual explanation is a riverside square of that name where people looking for work gathered. The origin of *grève* "shore" is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grève*
- *Say it: la grève*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la grève*
- *Recall:* say the French for the employer, then the French for the trade union, then say *la grève* again

Before you move on

What does la grève mean? ("The strike".) Say it once more.

358.3 le gréviste — the striker

Before the new one: say the French for the trade union, then the French for the strike.

You'll want to know: le gréviste

le gréviste — "the striker".

Les grévistes demandent de meilleurs salaires.

The strikers are asking for better wages.

The same form for a man or a woman.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gréviste is built from *grève* "strike" and *-iste*. *grève* first meant a sandy shore; its origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gréviste*
- *Say it: le gréviste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le gréviste*
- *Recall:* say the French for the trade union, then the French for the strike, then say *le gréviste* again

Before you move on

What does le gréviste mean? ("The striker".) Say it once more.

358.4 le salarié — the employee, the wage earner

Before the new one: say the French for the strike, then the French for the striker.

You'll want to know: le salarié

le salarié — "the employee, the wage earner".

Cette entreprise a deux cents salariés.

This company has two hundred employees.

From *salaire*. Feminine *salariée*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

salarié is built on *salaire* "wages", from Latin *salārium* "salt money, an allowance" (Lewis & Short), from *sāl* "salt".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le salarié*
- *Say it: le salarié*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le salarié*
- *Recall:* say the French for the strike, then the French for the striker, then say *le salarié* again

Before you move on

What does le salarié mean? ("The employee, the wage earner".) Say it once more.

358.5 les heures supplémentaires — the overtime

Before the new one: say the French for the striker, then the French for the employee.

You'll want to know: les heures supplémentaires

les heures supplémentaires — "the overtime".

Ce mois-ci, j'ai fait vingt heures supplémentaires.

This month, I did twenty hours of overtime.

Often shortened to *les heures sup*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

supplémentaire is built on *supplément*, from Latin *supplēmentum* "a filling up, a supply" (Lewis & Short); *heure* is inherited from Latin *hōra* "hour".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les heures supplémentaires*
- *Say it: les heures supplémentaires*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les heures supplémentaires*
- *Recall:* say the French for the striker, then the French for the employee, then say *les heures supplémentaires* again

Before you move on

What does les heures supplémentaires mean? ("The overtime".) Say it once more.

Chapter 359

Au bureau

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe my place at work: an executive, my tasks, a deadline, an extension and a delivery.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 359: I can describe my place at work: an executive, my tasks, a deadline, an extension and a delivery.*

359.1 le cadre — the executive, the manager; the frame

> Before the new one: say the French for the employee, then the French for the overtime.

You'll want to know: le cadre

le cadre — "the executive, the manager; the frame".

> Mon oncle est cadre dans une grande entreprise.
>
> *My uncle is an executive in a big company.*

Un cadre is a salaried manager; *le cadre* is also a frame, or a setting.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cadre was borrowed from Italian *quadro* "a square, a frame" (EtymDB), from Latin *quadrum* "a square" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cadre*
- *Say it: le cadre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cadre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the employee, then the French for the overtime, then say *le cadre* again

Before you move on

What does le cadre mean? ("The executive, the manager; the frame".) Say it once more.

359.2 la tâche — the task, the duty

Before the new one: say the French for the overtime, then the French for the executive.

You'll want to know: la tâche

la tâche — "the task, the duty".

Chaque matin, je fais la liste de mes tâches.

Every morning, I make a list of my tasks.

Feminine: *une tâche difficile.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tâche is usually traced to Medieval Latin *taxa* "an assessed amount, set work", from Latin *taxāre* "to appraise" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tâche*
- *Say it: la tâche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la tâche*
- *Recall:* say the French for the overtime, then the French for the executive, then say *la tâche* again

Before you move on

What does la tâche mean? ("The task, the duty".) Say it once more.

359.3 le délai — the deadline, the time allowed

Before the new one: say the French for the executive, then the French for the task.

You'll want to know: le délai

le délai — "the deadline, the time allowed".

Nous avons un délai de deux semaines pour finir.

We have two weeks to finish.

A false friend: *un délai* is the time you have, not a delay.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

délai comes from Old French *delai* (EtymDB), a noun formed on *delaier* "to put off". The further origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le délai*
- *Say it: le délai*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le délai*
- *Recall:* say the French for the executive, then the French for the task, then say *le délai* again

Before you move on

What does le délai mean? ("The deadline, the time allowed".) Say it once more.

359.4 la prolongation — the extension

Before the new one: say the French for the task, then the French for the deadline.

You'll want to know: la prolongation

la prolongation — "the extension".

J'ai demandé une prolongation de mon contrat.

I asked for an extension of my contract.

In football, *les prolongations* — extra time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prolongation comes from Late Latin *prōlongātiō* (EtymDB), from *prōlongāre* "to lengthen", built on *longus* "long" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la prolongation*
- *Say it: la prolongation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la prolongation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the task, then the French for the deadline, then say *la prolongation* again

Before you move on

What does la prolongation mean? ("The extension".) Say it once more.

359.5 la livraison — the delivery

Before the new one: say the French for the deadline, then the French for the extension.

You'll want to know: la livraison

la livraison — "the delivery".

La livraison est gratuite le samedi.

Delivery is free on Saturdays.

From *livrer*. *Livraison à domicile* — home delivery.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

livraison is built from *livrer* and *-aison* (EtymDB). *livrer* is inherited from Latin *līberāre* "to set free" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la livraison*
- *Say it: la livraison*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la livraison*
- *Recall:* say the French for the deadline, then the French for the extension, then say *la livraison* again

Before you move on

What does la livraison mean? (“The delivery”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 360

Faire carrière

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about getting on at work: a pay rise, a promotion, qualifications, skills and training.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 360: I can talk about getting on at work: a pay rise, a promotion, qualifications, skills and training.*

360.1 l'augmentation — the pay rise, the increase

> Before the new one: say the French for the extension, then the French for the delivery.

You'll want to know: l'augmentation

l'augmentation — "the pay rise, the increase".

> J'ai demandé une augmentation à mon patron.
>
> *I asked my boss for a pay rise.*

From *augmenter*. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

augmentation comes from Late Latin *augmentātiō* "an increase" (EtymDB), from *augēre* "to increase" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'augmentation*
- *Say it: l'augmentation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'augmentation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the extension, then the French for the delivery, then say *l'augmentation* again

Before you move on

What does l'augmentation mean? ("The pay rise, the increase".) Say it once more.

360.2 la promotion — the promotion; the special offer

Before the new one: say the French for the delivery, then the French for the pay rise.

You'll want to know: la promotion

la promotion — "the promotion; the special offer".

Elle a eu une promotion : elle dirige maintenant l'équipe.

She got a promotion: she now runs the team.

In shops, *en promotion* — on special offer.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

promotion is a learned borrowing from Latin *prōmōtiō* "advancement" (EtymDB), from *prōmovēre* "to move forward", built on *movēre* "to move" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la promotion*
- *Say it: la promotion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la promotion*
- *Recall:* say the French for the delivery, then the French for the pay rise, then say *la promotion* again

Before you move on

What does la promotion mean? ("The promotion; the special offer".) Say it once more.

360.3 la qualification — the qualification

Before the new one: say the French for the pay rise, then the French for the promotion.

You'll want to know: la qualification

la qualification — "the qualification".

Ce travail ne demande pas de qualification.

This job does not require any qualification.

In sport, *la qualification* is qualifying for the next round.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

qualification comes from Medieval Latin *quālificātiō*, built on Latin *quālis* "of what kind" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la qualification*
- *Say it: la qualification*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la qualification*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pay rise, then the French for the promotion, then say *la qualification* again

Before you move on

What does la qualification mean? ("The qualification".) Say it once more.

360.4 la compétence — the skill, the competence

Before the new one: say the French for the promotion, then the French for the qualification.

You'll want to know: la compétence

la compétence — "the skill, the competence".

Il a de bonnes compétences en langues.

He has good language skills.

Mostly in the plural for skills: *des compétences*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

compétence comes from Late Latin *competentia* (EtymDB), from *competere* "to come together, to be suitable", built on *petere* "to seek" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la compétence*
- *Say it: la compétence*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la compétence*
- *Recall:* say the French for the promotion, then the French for the qualification, then say *la compétence* again

Before you move on

What does la compétence mean? (“The skill, the competence”.) Say it once more.

360.5 la formation — the training, the education

Before the new one: say the French for the qualification, then the French for the skill.

You’ll want to know: la formation

la formation — “the training, the education”.

L’entreprise paie ma formation.

The company is paying for my training.

La formation continue — training for adults in work.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

formation comes through Old French *formacion* from Latin *fōrmātiō* “a shaping” (EtymDB), from *fōrmāre* “to shape”, built on *fōrma* “shape” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la formation*
- *Say it: la formation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la formation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the qualification, then the French for the skill, then say *la formation* again

Before you move on

What does la formation mean? (“The training, the education”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 361

Trop de travail

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am stressed or worn out and talk about being effective, efficiency and productivity.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 361: I can say I am stressed or worn out and talk about being effective, efficiency and productivity.*

361.1 stressé — stressed

> Before the new one: say the French for the skill, then the French for the training.

You'll want to know: stressé

stressé — "stressed".

> Je suis stressé à cause du travail.
>
> *I am stressed because of work.*

Feminine *stressée*. Built on English *stress*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stressé is built on *stress*, which was borrowed from English *stress* "strain, pressure" (EtymDB). The English word goes back to Middle English *destresse* "distress".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: stressé*
- *Say it: stressé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *stressé*
- *Recall:* say the French for the skill, then the French for the training, then say *stressé* again

Before you move on

What does stressé mean? ("Stressed".) Say it once more.

361.2 épuisé — exhausted, worn out; sold out

Before the new one: say the French for the training, then the French for stressed.

You'll want to know: épuisé

épuisé — "exhausted, worn out; sold out".

Après ce voyage, je suis épuisé.

After that trip, I am exhausted.

Of a book or a product: sold out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épuisé is the participle of *épuiser* "to drain dry", built on *puits* "a well", which comes from Latin *puteus* "a well" (Lewis & Short): drained like a well.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: épuisé*
- *Say it: épuisé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *épuisé*
- *Recall:* say the French for the training, then the French for stressed, then say *épuisé* again

Before you move on

What does épuisé mean? ("Exhausted, worn out; sold out".) Say it once more.

361.3 efficace — effective, efficient

Before the new one: say the French for stressed, then the French for exhausted.

You'll want to know: efficace

efficace — "effective, efficient".

Ce médicament est très efficace.

This medicine is very effective.

One form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

efficace comes from Latin *efficāx* "effective" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *efficere* "to bring about", built on *facere* "to do, to make".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *efficace*
- *Say it:* *efficace*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *efficace*
- *Recall:* say the French for stressed, then the French for exhausted, then say *efficace* again

Before you move on

What does efficace mean? ("Effective, efficient".) Say it once more.

361.4 l'efficacité — the efficiency, effectiveness

Before the new one: say the French for exhausted, then the French for effective.

You'll want to know: l'efficacité

l'efficacité — "the efficiency, effectiveness".

Il travaille avec beaucoup d'efficacité.

He works very efficiently.

Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

efficacité is a learned borrowing from Latin *efficācitās* "efficacy" (Lewis & Short), from *efficāx* "effective", built on *facere* "to do".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'efficacité*
- *Say it: l'efficacité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'efficacité*
- *Recall:* say the French for exhausted, then the French for effective, then say *l'efficacité* again

Before you move on

What does l'efficacité mean? ("The efficiency, effectiveness".) Say it once more.

361.5 la productivité — the productivity

Before the new one: say the French for effective, then the French for the efficiency.

You'll want to know: la productivité

la productivité — "the productivity".

La productivité de l'usine a augmenté.

The factory's productivity has gone up.

From *productif*, productive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

productivité is built from *productif* and *-ité*. The family goes back to Latin *prōdūcere* "to lead forth, to bring out", built on *dūcere* "to lead" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la productivité*
- *Say it: la productivité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la productivité*
- *Recall:* say the French for effective, then the French for the efficiency, then say *la productivité* again

Before you move on

What does la productivité mean? ("The productivity".) Say it once more.

Chapter 362

Citoyens

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about citizens, citizenship, nationality, freedom and equality.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 362: I can talk about citizens, citizenship, nationality, freedom and equality.*

362.1 le citoyen — the citizen

> Before the new one: say the French for the efficiency, then the French for the productivity.

You'll want to know: le citoyen

le citoyen — "the citizen".

> Chaque citoyen a le droit de voter.
>
> *Every citizen has the right to vote.*

Feminine *citoyenne*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

citoyen is inherited from Old French *citoien* (EtymDB), built on *cité* "city", from Latin *cīvitās* "citizenship, a state", from *cīvis* "citizen" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le citoyen*
- *Say it: le citoyen*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le citoyen*
- *Recall:* say the French for the efficiency, then the French for the productivity, then say *le citoyen* again

Before you move on

What does le citoyen mean? ("The citizen".) Say it once more.

362.2 la citoyenneté — the citizenship

Before the new one: say the French for the productivity, then the French for the citizen.

You'll want to know: la citoyenneté

la citoyenneté — "the citizenship".

Il a demandé la citoyenneté de son nouveau pays.

He applied for citizenship of his new country.

From *citoyen* + *-eté*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

citoyenneté is built from *citoyen* "citizen" and *-eté*. *citoyen* goes back to Latin *cīvitās* "citizenship", from *cīvis* "citizen" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la citoyenneté*
- *Say it: la citoyenneté*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la citoyenneté*
- *Recall:* say the French for the productivity, then the French for the citizen, then say *la citoyenneté* again

Before you move on

What does la citoyenneté mean? ("The citizenship".) Say it once more.

362.3 la nationalité — the nationality

Before the new one: say the French for the citizen, then the French for the citizenship.

You'll want to know: la nationalité

la nationalité — "the nationality".

Elle a la double nationalité, française et canadienne.

She has dual nationality, French and Canadian.

De nationalité française — of French nationality.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nationalité is built from *nation* and *-ité*. *nation* comes from Latin *nātiō* "birth, a people" (Lewis & Short), from *nāscī* "to be born".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nationalité*
- *Say it: la nationalité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la nationalité*
- *Recall:* say the French for the citizen, then the French for the citizenship, then say *la nationalité* again

Before you move on

What does la nationalité mean? ("The nationality".) Say it once more.

362.4 la liberté — the freedom, liberty

Before the new one: say the French for the citizenship, then the French for the nationality.

You'll want to know: la liberté

la liberté — "the freedom, liberty".

Ces gens se battent pour leur liberté.

These people are fighting for their freedom.

En liberté — free, at large.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

liberté comes through Old French *liberté* from Latin *lībertās* "freedom" (EtymDB), from *līber* "free" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la liberté*
- *Say it: la liberté*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la liberté*
- *Recall:* say the French for the citizenship, then the French for the nationality, then say *la liberté* again

Before you move on

What does la liberté mean? ("The freedom, liberty".) Say it once more.

362.5 l'égalité — the equality

Before the new one: say the French for the nationality, then the French for the freedom.

You'll want to know: l'égalité

l'égalité — "the equality".

Ils demandent l'égalité entre les hommes et les femmes.

They are asking for equality between men and women.

In sport, *à égalité* — level, a draw. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

égalité is built from *égal* "equal" and *-ité* (EtymDB). *égal* comes from Latin *aequālis* "equal", from *aequus* "level, even" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'égalité*
- *Say it: l'égalité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'égalité*
- *Recall:* say the French for the nationality, then the French for the freedom, then say *l'égalité* again

Before you move on

What does l'égalité mean? ("The equality".) Say it once more.

Chapter 363

Dans la rue

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a protest: a demonstration, demonstrators, a banner, and people who demonstrate and protest.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 363: I can describe a protest: a demonstration, demonstrators, a banner, and people who demonstrate and protest.*

363.1 la manifestation — the demonstration, the protest march; the event

> Before the new one: say the French for the freedom, then the French for the equality.

You'll want to know: la manifestation

la manifestation — "the demonstration, the protest march; the event".

> Il y a une manifestation dans le centre-ville samedi.
>
> *There is a demonstration in the town centre on Saturday.*

Often shortened to *la manif*. Also any public event: *une manifestation sportive*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manifestation comes from Late Latin *manifēstātiō* "a making plain" (EtymDB), from *manifestus* "clear, plain" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la manifestation*
- *Say it: la manifestation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la manifestation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the freedom, then the French for the equality, then say *la manifestation* again

Before you move on

What does la manifestation mean? ("The demonstration, the protest march; the event".) Say it once more.

363.2 manifester — to demonstrate (in the street); to show

Before the new one: say the French for the equality, then the French for the demonstration.

You'll want to know: manifester

manifester — "to demonstrate (in the street); to show".

Les étudiants manifestent contre la nouvelle loi.

The students are demonstrating against the new law.

Manifester sa joie — to show your joy.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manifester is a learned borrowing from Latin *manifēstāre* "to make plain, to show" (Lewis & Short), from *manifestus* "clear, plain".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: manifester*
- *Say it: manifester*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *manifester*
- *Recall:* say the French for the equality, then the French for the demonstration, then say *manifester* again

Before you move on

What does manifester mean? ("To demonstrate (in the street); to show".) Say it once more.

363.3 le manifestant — the demonstrator, the marcher

Before the new one: say the French for the demonstration, then the French for to demonstrate.

You'll want to know: le manifestant

le manifestant — "the demonstrator, the marcher".

Les manifestants marchent vers la mairie.

The demonstrators are marching towards the town hall.

Feminine *manifestante*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manifestant is the present participle of *manifester* used as a noun. The verb comes from Latin *manifēstāre* "to make plain", from *manifestus* "clear" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le manifestant*
- *Say it: le manifestant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le manifestant*
- *Recall:* say the French for the demonstration, then the French for to demonstrate, then say *le manifestant* again

Before you move on

What does le manifestant mean? ("The demonstrator, the marcher".) Say it once more.

363.4 la banderole — the banner

Before the new one: say the French for to demonstrate, then the French for the demonstrator.

You'll want to know: la banderole

la banderole — "the banner".

Les manifestants portent une grande banderole.

The demonstrators are carrying a big banner.

A long strip of cloth with words on it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banderole was borrowed from Italian *banderuola* “a little flag” (EtymDB), a small form of *bandiera* “flag”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la banderole*
- *Say it: la banderole*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la banderole*
- *Recall:* say the French for to demonstrate, then the French for the demonstrator, then say *la banderole* again

Before you move on

What does la banderole mean? (“The banner”.) Say it once more.

363.5 protester — to protest

Before the new one: say the French for the demonstrator, then the French for the banner.

You’ll want to know: protester

protester — “to protest”.

Les voisins protestent contre le bruit.

The neighbours are protesting about the noise.

Protester contre quelque chose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

protester comes from Latin *prōtestārī* “to declare publicly, to bear witness” (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *testis* “witness”.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: protester*
- *Say it: protester*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *protester*
- *Recall:* say the French for the demonstrator, then the French for the banner, then say *protester* again

Before you move on

What does protester mean? ("To protest".) Say it once more.

Chapter 364

Juste et injuste

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about justice and injustice, say what is unfair, and name prejudice and stereotypes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 364: I can talk about justice and injustice, say what is unfair, and name prejudice and stereotypes.*

364.1 la justice — the justice; the courts

> Before the new one: say the French for the banner, then the French for to protest.

You'll want to know: la justice

la justice — "the justice; the courts".

> La famille demande justice.
>
> *The family is asking for justice.*

La justice is also the legal system: *aller en justice*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

justice comes through Old French from Latin *iūstitia* "fairness, justice" (EtymDB), from *iūstus* "right, fair" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la justice*
- *Say it: la justice*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la justice*
- *Recall:* say the French for the banner, then the French for to protest, then say *la justice* again

Before you move on

What does la justice mean? ("The justice; the courts".) Say it once more.

364.2 injuste — unfair, unjust

Before the new one: say the French for to protest, then the French for the justice.

You'll want to know: injuste

injuste — "unfair, unjust".

C'est injuste : il a eu la même note que moi sans travailler.

It is unfair: he got the same mark as me without working.

One form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

injuste is a learned borrowing from Latin *iniūstus* "unjust" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built from *in-* "not" and *iūstus* "right, fair".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: injuste*
- *Say it: injuste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *injuste*
- *Recall:* say the French for to protest, then the French for the justice, then say *injuste* again

Before you move on

What does injuste mean? (“Unfair, unjust”.) Say it once more.

364.3 l’injustice — the injustice

Before the new one: say the French for the justice, then the French for unfair.

You’ll want to know: l’injustice

l’injustice — “the injustice”.

L’injustice la met en colère.

Injustice makes her angry.

Feminine: *une injustice*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

injustice is a learned borrowing from Latin *iniūstitia* “injustice” (Lewis & Short), from *iniūstus* “unjust”, built on *iūstus* “right, fair”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'injustice*
- *Say it: l'injustice*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'injustice*
- *Recall:* say the French for the justice, then the French for unfair, then say *l'injustice* again

Before you move on

What does l'injustice mean? ("The injustice".) Say it once more.

364.4 le préjugé — the prejudice

Before the new one: say the French for unfair, then the French for the injustice.

You'll want to know: le préjugé

le préjugé — "the prejudice".

Elle a beaucoup de préjugés sur les jeunes.

She has a lot of prejudices about young people.

Literally judged in advance: *pré-* + *jugé*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préjugé is built from *pré-* "before" and *jugé* "judged", after Latin *praeiūdicium* "a judgement made beforehand" (Lewis & Short), built on *iūdex* "judge".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le préjugé*
- *Say it: le préjugé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le préjugé*
- *Recall:* say the French for unfair, then the French for the injustice, then say *le préjugé* again

Before you move on

What does le préjugé mean? ("The prejudice".) Say it once more.

364.5 le stéréotype — the stereotype

Before the new one: say the French for the injustice, then the French for the prejudice.

You'll want to know: le stéréotype

le stéréotype — "the stereotype".

Ce film est plein de stéréotypes.

This film is full of stereotypes.

First a word from printing: a solid metal plate that copies a page.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stéréotype is usually explained as a French formation from Greek *stereós* "solid" and *týpos* "mark, impression": first a printing plate, then a fixed idea that is copied without thought.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le stéréotype*
- *Say it: le stéréotype*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le stéréotype*
- *Recall:* say the French for the injustice, then the French for the prejudice, then say *le stéréotype* again

Before you move on

What does le stéréotype mean? ("The stereotype".) Say it once more.

Chapter 365

Les problèmes sociaux

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about social problems: poverty, inequality, discrimination and immigration.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 365: I can talk about social problems: poverty, inequality, discrimination and immigration.*

365.1 la pauvreté — the poverty

> Before the new one: say the French for the prejudice, then the French for the stereotype.

You'll want to know: la pauvreté

la pauvreté — "the poverty".

> Beaucoup de familles vivent dans la pauvreté.
>
> *Many families live in poverty.*

From *pauvre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pauvreté is inherited through Old French *poverté* from Latin *paupertās* "poverty" (EtymDB), from *pauper* "poor" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pauvreté*
- *Say it: la pauvreté*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la pauvreté*
- *Recall:* say the French for the prejudice, then the French for the stereotype, then say *la pauvreté* again

Before you move on

What does la pauvreté mean? ("The poverty".) Say it once more.

365.2 l'inégalité — the inequality

Before the new one: say the French for the stereotype, then the French for the poverty.

You'll want to know: l'inégalité

l'inégalité — "the inequality".

Les inégalités entre riches et pauvres augmentent.

Inequalities between rich and poor are growing.

Often plural: *les inégalités*. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inégalité is built from *in-* "not" and *égalité* "equality", which rests on *égal*, from Latin *aequālis* "equal" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'inégalité*
- *Say it: l'inégalité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'inégalité*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stereotype, then the French for the poverty, then say *l'inégalité* again

Before you move on

What does l'inégalité mean? ("The inequality".) Say it once more.

365.3 la discrimination — the discrimination

Before the new one: say the French for the poverty, then the French for the inequality.

You'll want to know: la discrimination

la discrimination — "the discrimination".

La loi interdit la discrimination à l'embauche.

The law forbids discrimination in hiring.

Lutter contre la discrimination — to fight discrimination.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

discrimination is a learned borrowing from Latin *discrīminātiō* "a distinguishing" (EtymDB), from *discrīmen* "a dividing line", built on *cernere* "to separate" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la discrimination*
- *Say it: la discrimination*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la discrimination*
- *Recall:* say the French for the poverty, then the French for the inequality, then say *la discrimination* again

Before you move on

What does la discrimination mean? ("The discrimination".) Say it once more.

365.4 discriminer — to discriminate (against)

Before the new one: say the French for the inequality, then the French for the discrimination.

You'll want to know: discriminer

discriminer — "to discriminate (against)".

Cette entreprise discrimine les femmes.

This company discriminates against women.

Être discriminé — to be discriminated against.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

discriminer is a learned borrowing from Latin *discrīmināre* "to divide, to separate" (Lewis & Short), from *discrīmen* "a dividing line", built on *cernere* "to separate".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: discriminer*
- *Say it: discriminer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *discriminer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the inequality, then the French for the discrimination, then say *discriminer* again

Before you move on

What does discriminer mean? ("To discriminate (against)".) Say it once more.

365.5 l'immigration — the immigration

Before the new one: say the French for the discrimination, then the French for to discriminate.

You'll want to know: l'immigration

l'immigration — "the immigration".

L'immigration est un sujet de débat dans beaucoup de pays.

Immigration is a subject of debate in many countries.

Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

immigration is built on Latin *immigrāre* "to move into" and *migrātiō* "a moving from one place to another", from *migrāre* "to move, to wander" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'immigration*
- *Say it: l'immigration*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'immigration*
- *Recall:* say the French for the discrimination, then the French for to discriminate, then say *l'immigration* again

Before you move on

What does l'immigration mean? ("The immigration".) Say it once more.

365.6 Retour sur les chapitres 358–365

Say the French for the trade union and the strike.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the trade union, the strike, the striker, the employee, the overtime
- the executive, the task, the deadline, the extension, the delivery
- the pay rise, the promotion, the qualification, the skill, the training
- stressed, exhausted, effective, the efficiency, the productivity
- the citizen, the citizenship, the nationality, the freedom, the equality
- the demonstration, to demonstrate, the demonstrator, the banner, to protest
- the justice, unfair, the injustice, the prejudice, the stereotype
- the poverty, the inequality, the discrimination, to discriminate, the immigration

Before you move on

The trade union? (**le syndicat**.) The strike? (**la grève**.) The striker? (**le gréviste**.) The employee? (**le salarié**.) The overtime? (**les heures supplémentaires**.) The executive? (**le cadre**.) The task? (**la tâche**.) The deadline? (**le délai**.) The extension? (**la prolongation**.) The delivery? (**la livraison**.) The pay rise? (**l'augmentation**.) The promotion? (**la promotion**.) The qualification? (**la qualification**.) The skill? (**la compétence**.) The training? (**la formation**.) Stressed? (**stressé**.) Exhausted? (**épuisé**.) Effective? (**efficace**.) The efficiency? (**l'efficacité**.) The productivity? (**la productivité**.) The citizen? (**le citoyen**.) The citizenship? (**la citoyenneté**.) The nationality? (**la nationalité**.) The freedom? (**la liberté**.) The equality? (**l'égalité**.) The demonstration? (**la manifestation**.) To demonstrate? (**manifester**.) The demonstrator? (**le manifestant**.) The banner? (**la banderole**.) To protest? (**protester**.) The justice? (**la justice**.) Unfair? (**injuste**.) The injustice? (**l'injustice**.) The prejudice? (**le préjugé**.) The stereotype? (**le stéréotype**.) The poverty? (**la pauvreté**.) The inequality? (**l'inégalité**.) The discrimination? (**la discrimination**.) To discriminate? (**discriminer**.) The immigration? (**l'immigration**.)

Chapter 366

Donner un coup de main

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about helping others: volunteering, a volunteer, an association, solidarity and the community.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 366: I can talk about helping others: volunteering, a volunteer, an association, solidarity and the community.*

366.1 le bénévole — the volunteer; unpaid, voluntary

> Before the new one: say the French for to discriminate, then the French for the immigration.

You'll want to know: le bénévole

le bénévole — "the volunteer; unpaid, voluntary".

> Les bénévoles servent des repas aux personnes âgées.
>
> *The volunteers serve meals to elderly people.*

The same form for a man or a woman. As an adjective: *un travail bénévole.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bénévole is a learned borrowing from Latin *benevolus* "well-wishing, kind" (Lewis & Short), built from *bene* "well" and *velle* "to want".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bénévole*
- *Say it: le bénévole*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bénévole*
- *Recall:* say the French for to discriminate, then the French for the immigration, then say *le bénévole* again

Before you move on

What does le bénévole mean? ("The volunteer; unpaid, voluntary".) Say it once more.

366.2 le bénévolat — the volunteering, unpaid work

Before the new one: say the French for the immigration, then the French for the volunteer.

You'll want to know: le bénévolat

le bénévolat — "the volunteering, unpaid work".

Le bénévolat prend tous ses samedis.

Volunteering takes up all her Saturdays.

Faire du bénévolat — to do voluntary work.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bénévolat is built from *bénévole* and *-at*. *bénévole* comes from Latin *benevolus* "well-wishing", from *bene* "well" and *velle* "to want" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bénévolat*
- *Say it: le bénévolat*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bénévolat*
- *Recall:* say the French for the immigration, then the French for the volunteer, then say *le bénévolat* again

Before you move on

What does le bénévolat mean? ("The volunteering, unpaid work".) Say it once more.

366.3 l'association — the association, the club, the charity

Before the new one: say the French for the volunteer, then the French for the volunteering.

You'll want to know: l'association

l'association — "the association, the club, the charity".

Je travaille dans une association qui aide les personnes âgées.

I work for an association that helps elderly people.

In France, *une association* is a non-profit group of any kind. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

association is built on *associer* (EtymDB), from Latin *associāre* "to join to", built on *socius* "companion" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'association*
- *Say it: l'association*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'association*
- *Recall:* say the French for the volunteer, then the French for the volunteering, then say *l'association* again

Before you move on

What does l'association mean? ("The association, the club, the charity".) Say it once more.

366.4 la solidarité — the solidarity

Before the new one: say the French for the volunteering, then the French for the association.

You'll want to know: la solidarité

la solidarité — "the solidarity".

Après l'incendie, il y a eu beaucoup de solidarité dans le village.

After the fire, there was a lot of solidarity in the village.

From *solidaire*, standing together.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

solidarité is built on *solidaire* (EtymDB), from the Latin legal phrase *in solidum* "for the whole sum", from *solidus* "solid, whole" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la solidarité*
- *Say it: la solidarité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la solidarité*
- *Recall:* say the French for the volunteering, then the French for the association, then say *la solidarité* again

Before you move on

What does la solidarité mean? ("The solidarity".) Say it once more.

366.5 la communauté — the community

Before the new one: say the French for the association, then the French for the solidarity.

You'll want to know: la communauté

la communauté — "the community".

Toute la communauté a aidé cette famille.

The whole community helped this family.

La vie en communauté — living together in a group.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

communauté is usually explained as built on *commun* “common”, which is inherited from Latin *commūnis* “shared, common” (EtymDB), after Latin *commūnitās* “fellowship” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la communauté*
- *Say it: la communauté*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la communauté*
- *Recall:* say the French for the association, then the French for the solidarity, then say *la communauté* again

Before you move on

What does la communauté mean? (“The community”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 367

Supposons

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can make a hypothesis: suppose or presume something, and say an explanation is plausible.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 367: I can make a hypothesis: suppose or presume something, and say an explanation is plausible.*

367.1 supposer — to suppose, to assume

> Before the new one: say the French for the solidarity, then the French for the community.

You'll want to know: supposer

supposer — "to suppose, to assume".

> Je suppose que tu es fatigué après ce voyage.
>
> *I suppose you are tired after that trip.*

Supposer que + indicative. *À supposer que* takes the subjunctive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

supposer comes through Middle French (EtymDB) from Latin *suppōnere* "to put under, to put in place of" (Lewis & Short), which took the sense "to assume" in Medieval Latin; it is built on *pōnere* "to put".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: supposer*
- *Say it: supposer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *supposer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the solidarity, then the French for the community, then say *supposer* again

Before you move on

What does supposer mean? ("To suppose, to assume".) Say it once more.

367.2 l'hypothèse — the hypothesis

Before the new one: say the French for the community, then the French for to suppose.

You'll want to know: l'hypothèse

l'hypothèse — "the hypothesis".

Dans cette hypothèse, nous partirions plus tôt.

On that hypothesis, we would leave earlier.

Dans l'hypothèse où takes the conditional. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hypothèse is a learned borrowing from Latin *hypothesis* (EtymDB), from Greek *hupóthesis* "a foundation, a supposition", built from *hupó* "under" and *thésis* "a placing".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'hypothèse*
- *Say it: l'hypothèse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'hypothèse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the community, then the French for to suppose, then say *l'hypothèse* again

Before you move on

What does l'hypothèse mean? ("The hypothesis".) Say it once more.

367.3 présumer — to presume

Before the new one: say the French for to suppose, then the French for the hypothesis.

You'll want to know: présumer

présumer — "to presume".

Je présume que le magasin est fermé le dimanche.

I presume the shop is closed on Sundays.

Formal: *je présume que oui* — I presume so.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

présumer is a learned borrowing from Latin *praesūmere* "to take beforehand, to suppose" (Lewis & Short), built on *sūmere* "to take".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: présumer*
- *Say it: présumer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *présumer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to suppose, then the French for the hypothesis, then say *présumer* again

Before you move on

What does présumer mean? (“To presume”.) Say it once more.

367.4 plausible — plausible

Before the new one: say the French for the hypothesis, then the French for to presume.

You’ll want to know: plausible

plausible — “plausible”.

Son explication est plausible.

His explanation is plausible.

One form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plausible is a learned borrowing from Latin *plausibilis* “deserving applause, acceptable” (Lewis & Short), from *plaudere* “to clap”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: plausible*
- *Say it: plausible*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *plausible*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hypothesis, then the French for to presume, then say *plausible* again

Before you move on

What does plausible mean? ("Plausible".) Say it once more.

367.5 la supposition — the supposition, the assumption

Before the new one: say the French for to presume, then the French for plausible.

You'll want to know: la supposition

la supposition — "the supposition, the assumption".

Ce n'est qu'une supposition : je n'en suis pas sûr.

It is only an assumption: I am not sure of it.

Faire une supposition — to make an assumption.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

supposition is a learned borrowing from Latin *suppositiō* "a putting under, a substitution" (Lewis & Short), from *suppōnere*, built on *pōnere* "to put".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la supposition*
- *Say it: la supposition*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la supposition*
- *Recall:* say the French for to presume, then the French for plausible, then say *la supposition* again

Before you move on

What does la supposition mean? ("The supposition, the assumption".) Say it once more.

Chapter 368

À une condition

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can set a condition: provided that, as long as, unless, in case, or else — with the right mood after each.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 368: I can set a condition: provided that, as long as, unless, in case, or else — with the right mood after each.*

368.1 à condition que — provided that, on condition that

> Before the new one: say the French for plausible, then the French for the supposition.

You'll want to know: à condition que

à condition que — "provided that, on condition that".

> Tu peux sortir, à condition que tu sois à la maison avant minuit.
>
> *You can go out, on condition that you are home before midnight.*

Takes the subjunctive: *que tu sois*. With the same subject, *à condition de* + infinitive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

condition comes through Old French from Latin *condiciō* "an agreement, terms, a condition" (EtymDB), from *condīcere* "to talk over, to agree on", built on *dīcere* "to say" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: à condition que*
- *Say it: à condition que*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *à condition que*
- *Recall:* say the French for plausible, then the French for the supposition, then say *à condition que* again

Before you move on

What does à condition que mean? ("Provided that, on condition that".) Say it once more.

368.2 pourvu que — as long as, provided that; let us hope that

Before the new one: say the French for the supposition, then the French for provided that.

You'll want to know: pourvu que

pourvu que — "as long as, provided that; let us hope that".

Nous irons à la plage, pourvu qu'il fasse beau.

We will go to the beach, as long as the weather is nice.

Takes the subjunctive: *qu'il fasse*. At the start of a sentence it is a wish: *Pourvu qu'il vienne !* — let us hope he comes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pourvu is the past participle of *pourvoir* "to provide", which comes from Latin *prōvidēre* "to foresee, to provide for" (Lewis & Short), built on *vidēre* "to see".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: pourvu que*
- *Say it: pourvu que*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *pourvu que*
- *Recall:* say the French for the supposition, then the French for provided that, then say *pourvu que* again

Before you move on

What does pourvu que mean? ("As long as, provided that; let us hope that".) Say it once more.

368.3 à moins que — unless

Before the new one: say the French for provided that, then the French for as long as.

You'll want to know: à moins que

à moins que — "unless".

Je viendrai à pied, à moins qu'il ne pleuve.

I will come on foot, unless it rains.

Takes the subjunctive, often with a *ne* that is not a negative: *à moins qu'il ne pleuve*. With the same subject, *à moins de* + infinitive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moins is inherited through Old French *meins* from Latin *minus* "less" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short): at less than this.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *à moins que*
- *Say it:* *à moins que*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *à moins que*
- *Recall:* say the French for provided that, then the French for as long as, then say *à moins que* again

Before you move on

What does à moins que mean? ("Unless".) Say it once more.

368.4 au cas où — in case

Before the new one: say the French for as long as, then the French for unless.

You'll want to know: au cas où

au cas où — "in case".

Je prends un parapluie, au cas où il pleuvrait.

I am taking an umbrella in case it rains.

Takes the conditional, not the subjunctive: *au cas où il pleuvrait.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cas comes through Old French *cas* from Latin *cāsus* "a falling, a chance event" (EtymDB), from *cadere* "to fall" (Lewis & Short): what may befall.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: au cas où*
- *Say it: au cas où*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *au cas où*
- *Recall:* say the French for as long as, then the French for unless, then say *au cas où* again

Before you move on

What does au cas où mean? ("In case".) Say it once more.

368.5 sinon — otherwise, or else

Before the new one: say the French for unless, then the French for in case.

You'll want to know: sinon

sinon — "otherwise, or else".

Dépêche-toi, sinon nous allons manquer le train.

Hurry up, or else we will miss the train.

It can also mean if not, apart from: *personne, sinon lui.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sinon is built from *si* “if” and *non* “not”, which are inherited from Latin *sī* “if” and *nōn* “not” (Lewis & Short): if not.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sinon*
- *Say it: sinon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sinon*
- *Recall:* say the French for unless, then the French for in case, then say *sinon* again

Before you move on

What does sinon mean? (“Otherwise, or else”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 369

Selon les cas

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that a plan depends on things: according to, a possible extra, possibly, an eventuality and for lack of.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 369: I can say that a plan depends on things: according to, a possible extra, possibly, an eventuality and for lack of.*

369.1 selon — according to; depending on

> Before the new one: say the French for in case, then the French for otherwise.

You'll want to know: selon

selon — "according to; depending on".

> Selon le journal, il va neiger demain.
>
> *According to the newspaper, it is going to snow tomorrow.*

Selon moi — in my view. *C'est selon* — it depends.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

selon comes from Old French *selonc*, *selunc* (EtymDB), usually traced to a Vulgar Latin *sublongum* "along", built on *longus* "long" (Lewis &

Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: selon*
- *Say it: selon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *selon*
- *Recall:* say the French for in case, then the French for otherwise, then say *selon* again

Before you move on

What does selon mean? ("According to; depending on".) Say it once more.

369.2 éventuel — possible (if it happens)

Before the new one: say the French for otherwise, then the French for according to.

You'll want to know: éventuel

éventuel — "possible (if it happens)".

Nous avons gardé de l'argent pour les frais éventuels.

We kept some money for any possible costs.

A false friend: *éventuel* means possible, not final. Feminine *éventuelle*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éventuel is a learned formation on Latin *ēventus* "an outcome, an event" (Lewis & Short), from *ēvenīre* "to come out, to happen", built on *venīre* "to come".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: éventuel*
- *Say it: éventuel*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *éventuel*
- *Recall:* say the French for otherwise, then the French for according to, then say *éventuel* again

Before you move on

What does éventuel mean? ("Possible (if it happens)".) Say it once more.

369.3 éventuellement — possibly, if need be

Before the new one: say the French for according to, then the French for possible.

You'll want to know: éventuellement

éventuellement — "possibly, if need be".

Je peux éventuellement venir samedi.

I can possibly come on Saturday.

A false friend: not eventually, which is *finalement*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éventuellement is built from *éventuel* and *-ment*. *éventuel* rests on Latin *ēventus* "an outcome", from *ēvenīre* "to happen" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: éventuellement*
- *Say it: éventuellement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *éventuellement*
- *Recall:* say the French for according to, then the French for possible, then say *éventuellement* again

Before you move on

What does éventuellement mean? ("Possibly, if need be".) Say it once more.

369.4 l'éventualité — the possibility, the eventuality

Before the new one: say the French for possible, then the French for possibly.

You'll want to know: l'éventualité

l'éventualité — "the possibility, the eventuality".

Il faut prévoir toutes les éventualités.

We have to plan for every possibility.

Dans l'éventualité où takes the conditional. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éventualité is built from *éventuel* and *-ité*. *éventuel* rests on Latin *ēventus* "an outcome", from *ēvenīre* "to happen" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éventualité*
- *Say it: l'éventualité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'éventualité*
- *Recall:* say the French for possible, then the French for possibly, then say *l'éventualité* again

Before you move on

What does l'éventualité mean? ("The possibility, the eventuality".) Say it once more.

369.5 faute de — for lack of

Before the new one: say the French for possibly, then the French for the possibility.

You'll want to know: faute de

faute de — "for lack of".

Faute de temps, nous n'avons pas visité le musée.

For lack of time, we did not visit the museum.

Faute de mieux — for want of anything better.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faute is inherited through Old French from a Vulgar Latin *fallita* "a shortcoming" (EtymDB), from Latin *fallere* "to deceive, to fail" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: faute de*
- *Say it: faute de*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *faute de*
- *Recall:* say the French for possibly, then the French for the possibility, then say *faute de* again

Before you move on

What does faute de mean? ("For lack of".) Say it once more.

Chapter 370

Les imprévus

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the unexpected: a hitch, what is foreseeable or not, adapting to it and being easygoing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 370: I can talk about the unexpected: a hitch, what is foreseeable or not, adapting to it and being easygoing.*

370.1 l'imprévu — the hitch, the unexpected event

Before the new one: say the French for the possibility, then the French for for lack of.

You'll want to know: l'imprévu

l'imprévu — "the hitch, the unexpected event".

> J'ai un imprévu, je ne peux pas venir ce soir.
>
> *Something has come up, I cannot come tonight.*

Also an adjective: *une visite imprévue*. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

imprévu is built from *in-* "not" and *prévu*, the participle of *prévoir* "to foresee" (EtymDB), from Latin *praevidēre* "to foresee", built on *vidēre* "to see" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'imprévu*
- *Say it: l'imprévu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'imprévu*
- *Recall:* say the French for the possibility, then the French for for lack of, then say *l'imprévu* again

Before you move on

What does l'imprévu mean? ("The hitch, the unexpected event".) Say it once more.

370.2 prévisible — foreseeable, predictable

Before the new one: say the French for for lack of, then the French for the hitch.

You'll want to know: prévisible

prévisible — "foreseeable, predictable".

Ce retard était prévisible avec cette neige.

This delay was predictable with this snow.

One form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prévisible is built on *prévoir* "to foresee" and the suffix *-ible*. *prévoir* comes from Latin *praevidēre* "to foresee", built on *vidēre* "to see" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: prévisible*
- *Say it: prévisible*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *prévisible*
- *Recall:* say the French for for lack of, then the French for the hitch, then say *prévisible* again

Before you move on

What does prévisible mean? ("Foreseeable, predictable".) Say it once more.

370.3 imprévisible — unpredictable

Before the new one: say the French for the hitch, then the French for foreseeable.

You'll want to know: imprévisible

imprévisible — "unpredictable".

Le temps à la montagne est imprévisible.

The weather in the mountains is unpredictable.

With *in-*, the opposite of *prévisible*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

imprévisible is built from *in-* "not" and *prévisible*, which rests on *prévoir*, from Latin *praevidēre* "to foresee" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: imprévisible*
- *Say it: imprévisible*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *imprévisible*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hitch, then the French for foreseeable, then say *imprévisible* again

Before you move on

What does imprévisible mean? ("Unpredictable".) Say it once more.

370.4 adapter — to adapt (mostly reflexive, s'adapter)

Before the new one: say the French for foreseeable, then the French for unpredictable.

You'll want to know: adapter

adapter — "to adapt (mostly reflexive, s'adapter)".

Les enfants s'adaptent vite à une nouvelle école.

Children adapt quickly to a new school.

Mostly reflexive: *s'adapter à* — to adapt to. *Adapter un livre* — to adapt a book for the screen.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adapter is a learned borrowing from Latin *adaptāre* “to fit to” (EtymDB), built from *ad* “to” and *aptāre* “to fit”, from *aptus* “fitted” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: adapter*
- *Say it: adapter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *adapter*
- *Recall:* say the French for foreseeable, then the French for unpredictable, then say *adapter* again

Before you move on

What does adapter mean? (“To adapt (mostly reflexive, s’adapter)”.) Say it once more.

370.5 souple — supple; easygoing, adaptable

Before the new one: say the French for unpredictable, then the French for to adapt.

You’ll want to know: souple

souple — “supple; easygoing, adaptable”.

Mes horaires sont souples : je peux venir plus tard.

My hours are adaptable: I can come later.

Of the body: supple. Of a person or a rule: easygoing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

souple is inherited from Latin *supplex* "bending the knee, humble" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *plicāre* "to fold".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: souple*
- *Say it: souple*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *souple*
- *Recall:* say the French for unpredictable, then the French for to adapt, then say *souple* again

Before you move on

What does souple mean? ("Supple; easygoing, adaptable".) Say it once more.

Chapter 371

Changement de programme

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can change a plan: cancel it, put it off, say it is temporary or final, and schedule something new.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 371: I can change a plan: cancel it, put it off, say it is temporary or final, and schedule something new.*

371.1 annuler — to cancel

Before the new one: say the French for to adapt, then the French for supple.

You'll want to know: annuler

annuler — "to cancel".

> Le concert est annulé à cause de la pluie.
>
> *The concert is cancelled because of the rain.*

Annuler une réservation — to cancel a booking.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

annuler comes from Late Latin *annūllāre* "to bring to nothing" (EtymDB), built on *nūllus* "none" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: annuler*
- *Say it: annuler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *annuler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to adapt, then the French for supple, then say *annuler* again

Before you move on

What does annuler mean? ("To cancel".) Say it once more.

371.2 reporter — to postpone, to put off

Before the new one: say the French for supple, then the French for to cancel.

You'll want to know: reporter

reporter — "to postpone, to put off".

Nous avons reporté la réunion à jeudi.

We postponed the meeting to Thursday.

Reporter à plus tard — to put off till later. The noun *un reporter* is a news reporter.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

reporter is built from *re-* "back" and *porter* "to carry", after Latin *reportāre* "to carry back" (Lewis & Short), on *portāre* "to carry": you carry the date further on.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: reporter*
- *Say it: reporter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *reporter*
- *Recall:* say the French for supple, then the French for to cancel, then say *reporter* again

Before you move on

What does reporter mean? ("To postpone, to put off".) Say it once more.

371.3 provisoire — temporary, provisional

Before the new one: say the French for to cancel, then the French for to postpone.

You'll want to know: provisoire

provisoire — "temporary, provisional".

C'est une solution provisoire, en attendant mieux.

It is a temporary solution, until something better comes.

One form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

provisoire comes from Medieval Latin *prōvīsōrius*, built on Latin *prōvīsus*, the participle of *prōvidēre* "to foresee, to provide for" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: provisoire*
- *Say it: provisoire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *provisoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cancel, then the French for to postpone, then say *provisoire* again

Before you move on

What does provisoire mean? ("Temporary, provisional".) Say it once more.

371.4 définitif — final, definitive

Before the new one: say the French for to postpone, then the French for temporary.

You'll want to know: définitif

définitif — "final, definitive".

Sa décision est définitive.

Her decision is final.

Feminine *définitive*. *En définitive* — in the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

définitif is a learned borrowing from Latin *dēfīnītīvus* (EtymDB), from *dēfīnīre* "to set limits, to define", built on *fīnis* "end, boundary" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: définitif*
- *Say it: définitif*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *définitif*
- *Recall:* say the French for to postpone, then the French for temporary, then say *définitif* again

Before you move on

What does définitif mean? ("Final, definitive".) Say it once more.

371.5 programmer — to schedule, to plan; to program

Before the new one: say the French for temporary, then the French for final.

You'll want to know: programmer

programmer — "to schedule, to plan; to program".

Nous avons programmé la fête pour samedi.

We scheduled the party for Saturday.

Also to program a machine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

programmer is built on *programme*, from Late Latin *programma* "a proclamation, an edict" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from Greek *prógramma* "a written public notice", built from *pró* "before" and *gráphein* "to write".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: programmer*
- *Say it: programmer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *programmer*
- *Recall:* say the French for temporary, then the French for final, then say *programmer* again

Before you move on

What does programmer mean? ("To schedule, to plan; to program".) Say it once more.

Chapter 372

Prendre un risque

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can weigh a risk: say something is chancy or unlikely, talk about the probability, and accept a cost.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 372: I can weigh a risk: say something is chancy or unlikely, talk about the probability, and accept a cost.*

372.1 le risque — the risk

Before the new one: say the French for final, then the French for to schedule.

You'll want to know: le risque

le risque — "the risk".

Il y a un risque de pluie demain.

There is a chance of rain tomorrow.

Prendre un risque — to take a risk; the verb is *risquer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

risque comes from Old Italian *risco* "danger" (EtymDB). The further origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le risque*
- *Say it: le risque*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le risque*
- *Recall:* say the French for final, then the French for to schedule, then say *le risque* again

Before you move on

What does le risque mean? ("The risk".) Say it once more.

372.2 hasardeux — risky, chancy

Before the new one: say the French for to schedule, then the French for the risk.

You'll want to know: hasardeux

hasardeux — "risky, chancy".

C'est un projet hasardeux, mais il veut essayer.

It is a risky project, but he wants to try.

Feminine *hasardeuse*. Formal; in speech, *risqué*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hasardeux is built from an old French word for chance and the suffix *-eux*. That word is usually traced, through Spanish, to Arabic *az-zahr* "the die"; the details are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: hasardeux*
- *Say it: hasardeux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *hasardeux*
- *Recall:* say the French for to schedule, then the French for the risk, then say *hasardeux* again

Before you move on

What does hasardeux mean? (“Risky, chancy”.) Say it once more.

372.3 improbable — improbable, unlikely

Before the new one: say the French for the risk, then the French for risky.

You’ll want to know: improbable

improbable — “improbable, unlikely”.

Il est improbable qu’il vienne ce soir.

It is unlikely that he will come tonight.

Il est improbable que takes the subjunctive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

improbable is a learned borrowing from Latin *improbābilis* “not to be approved” (Lewis & Short), built from *in-* “not” and *probābilis*, from *probāre* “to test”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: improbable*
- *Say it: improbable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *improbable*
- *Recall:* say the French for the risk, then the French for risky, then say *improbable* again

Before you move on

What does improbable mean? ("Improbable, unlikely".) Say it once more.

372.4 la probabilité — the probability, the likelihood

Before the new one: say the French for risky, then the French for improbable.

You'll want to know: la probabilité

la probabilité — "the probability, the likelihood".

La probabilité de gagner est très faible.

The probability of winning is very low.

Selon toute probabilité — in all likelihood.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

probabilité is a learned borrowing from Latin *probābilitās* "likelihood" (Lewis & Short), from *probābilis* "likely", built on *probāre* "to test".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la probabilité*
- *Say it: la probabilité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la probabilité*
- *Recall:* say the French for risky, then the French for improbable, then say *la probabilité* again

Before you move on

What does la probabilité mean? ("The probability, the likelihood".) Say it once more.

372.5 quitte à — even if it means

Before the new one: say the French for improbable, then the French for the probability.

You'll want to know: quitte à

quitte à — "even if it means".

Je pars tôt, quitte à attendre une heure sur le quai.

I am leaving early, even if it means waiting an hour on the platform.

+ infinitive: you accept the cost. *Être quitte* — to be even, owe nothing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quitte comes from Old French *quitte* "free, released", taken from Latin *quiētus* "at rest" (EtymDB), from *quiēs* "rest" (Lewis & Short); a Medieval Latin form *quittus* is usually placed in between.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *quitte à*
- *Say it:* *quitte à*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *quitte à*
- *Recall:* say the French for improbable, then the French for the probability, then say *quitte à* again

Before you move on

What does quitte à mean? (“Even if it means”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 373

Si j'ai le temps

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say whether I am free, commit to something, say I am flexible, and say what I am considering.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 373: I can say whether I am free, commit to something, say I am flexible, and say what I am considering.*

373.1 disponible — available, free

> Before the new one: say the French for the probability, then the French for even if it means.

You'll want to know: disponible

disponible — "available, free".

> Je suis disponible mardi après-midi.
>
> *I am free on Tuesday afternoon.*

Of people and things: *ce modèle n'est plus disponible.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

disponible is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *dispōnibilis* (EtymDB), from Latin *dispōnere* "to set in order, to arrange", built on *pōnere* "to put" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: disponible*
- *Say it: disponible*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *disponible*
- *Recall:* say the French for the probability, then the French for even if it means, then say *disponible* again

Before you move on

What does disponible mean? ("Available, free".) Say it once more.

373.2 engager — to commit (mostly reflexive, s'engager); to hire

Before the new one: say the French for even if it means, then the French for available.

You'll want to know: engager

engager — "to commit (mostly reflexive, s'engager); to hire".

Il s'est engagé à finir le travail avant vendredi.

He committed to finishing the work before Friday.

S'engager à + infinitive — to commit to doing. *Engager quelqu'un* — to hire someone. *Nous engageons.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

engager is built from *en-* and *gage* "a pledge". *gage* is usually traced to a Frankish word for a pledge (EtymDB lists Germanic relatives such as Gothic *wadi*).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: engager*
- *Say it: engager*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *engager*
- *Recall:* say the French for even if it means, then the French for available, then say *engager* again

Before you move on

What does engager mean? ("To commit (mostly reflexive, s'engager); to hire".) Say it once more.

373.3 l'engagement — the commitment

Before the new one: say the French for available, then the French for to commit.

You'll want to know: l'engagement

l'engagement — "the commitment".

C'est un engagement important : je ne peux pas dire non.

It is an important commitment: I cannot say no.

Prendre un engagement — to make a commitment. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

engagement is built from *engager* and *-ment* (EtymDB). *engager* rests on *gage* "a pledge", usually traced to a Frankish word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'engagement*
- *Say it: l'engagement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'engagement*
- *Recall:* say the French for available, then the French for to commit, then say *l'engagement* again

Before you move on

What does l'engagement mean? ("The commitment".) Say it once more.

373.4 flexible — flexible

Before the new one: say the French for to commit, then the French for the commitment.

You'll want to know: flexible

flexible — "flexible".

Mon patron est assez flexible sur les horaires.

My boss is quite flexible about hours.

One form for both genders. Close to *souple*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flexible is a learned borrowing from Latin *flexibilis* "easily bent" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *flectere* "to bend".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: flexible*
- *Say it: flexible*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *flexible*
- *Recall:* say the French for to commit, then the French for the commitment, then say *flexible* again

Before you move on

What does flexible mean? ("Flexible".) Say it once more.

373.5 envisager — to consider, to plan on

Before the new one: say the French for the commitment, then the French for flexible.

You'll want to know: envisager

envisager — "to consider, to plan on".

Nous envisageons de déménager l'année prochaine.

We are considering moving next year.

Envisager de + infinitive. *Nous envisageons.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

envisager is built from *en-* and *visage* "face": to look something in the face. *visage* rests on Latin *vīsus* "sight", from *vidēre* "to see" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: envisager*
- *Say it: envisager*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *envisager*
- *Recall:* say the French for the commitment, then the French for flexible, then say *envisager* again

Before you move on

What does envisager mean? (“To consider, to plan on”.) Say it once more.

373.6 Retour sur les chapitres 366–373

Say the French for the volunteer and the volunteering.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the volunteer, the volunteering, the association, the solidarity, the community
- to suppose, the hypothesis, to presume, plausible, the supposition
- provided that, as long as, unless, in case, otherwise
- according to, possible, possibly, the possibility, for lack of
- the hitch, foreseeable, unpredictable, to adapt, supple
- to cancel, to postpone, temporary, final, to schedule
- the risk, risky, improbable, the probability, even if it means
- available, to commit, the commitment, flexible, to consider

Before you move on

The volunteer? (**le bénévole**.) The volunteering? (**le bénévolat**.) The association? (**l'association**.) The solidarity? (**la solidarité**.) The community? (**la communauté**.) To suppose? (**supposer**.) The hypothesis? (**l'hypothèse**.) To presume? (**présumer**.) Plausible? (**plausible**.) The supposition? (**la supposition**.) Provided that? (**à condition que**.) As long as? (**pourvu que**.) Unless? (**à moins que**.) In case? (**au cas où**.) Otherwise? (**sinon**.) According to? (**selon**.) Possible? (**éventuel**.) Possibly? (**éventuellement**.) The possibility? (**l'éventualité**.) For lack of? (**faute de**.) The hitch? (**l'imprévu**.) Foreseeable? (**prévisible**.) Unpredictable? (**imprévisible**.) To adapt? (**adapter**.) Supple? (**souple**.) To cancel? (**annuler**.) To postpone? (**reporter**.) Temporary? (**provisoire**.) Final? (**définitif**.) To schedule? (**programmer**.) The risk? (**le risque**.) Risky? (**hasardeux**.) Improbable? (**improbable**.) The probability? (**la probabilité**.) Even if it means? (**quitte à**.) Available? (**disponible**.) To commit? (**engager**.) The commitment? (**l'engagement**.) Flexible? (**flexible**.) To consider? (**envisager**.)

Chapter 374

Mes objectifs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I aim to do: my goal, my intention, an objective, a resolution and what I am aiming at.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 374: I can say what I aim to do: my goal, my intention, an objective, a resolution and what I am aiming at.*

374.1 le but — the aim, the goal

> Before the new one: say the French for flexible, then the French for to consider.

You'll want to know: le but

le but — "the aim, the goal".

> Mon but, c'est de trouver un travail à l'étranger.
>
> *My aim is to find a job abroad.*

In football, *un but* is a goal. The final *t* is often said.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

but comes from Old French *but* "end, aim" (EtymDB), linked to *butte* "a mound used as a target"; it is usually traced to a Frankish word for a stump or a log.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le but*
- *Say it: le but*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le but*
- *Recall:* say the French for flexible, then the French for to consider, then say *le but* again

Before you move on

What does le but mean? ("The aim, the goal".) Say it once more.

374.2 l'intention — the intention

Before the new one: say the French for to consider, then the French for the aim.

You'll want to know: l'intention

l'intention — "the intention".

Je n'ai pas l'intention de partir.

I have no intention of leaving.

Avoir l'intention de + infinitive. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

intention comes through Old French from Latin *intentiō* "a stretching, an aim" (EtymDB), from *intendere* "to stretch toward", built on *tendere* "to stretch" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'intention*
- *Say it: l'intention*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'intention*
- *Recall:* say the French for to consider, then the French for the aim, then say *l'intention* again

Before you move on

What does l'intention mean? ("The intention".) Say it once more.

374.3 l'objectif — the objective, the target; the lens

Before the new one: say the French for the aim, then the French for the intention.

You'll want to know: l'objectif

l'objectif — "the objective, the target; the lens".

Notre objectif est de finir avant juin.

Our objective is to finish before June.

On a camera, *l'objectif* is the lens. As an adjective, *objectif* means objective. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

objectif comes from Medieval Latin *obiectīvus* (EtymDB), from *obicere* "to throw before, to put before" (Lewis & Short), built on *iacere* "to throw".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'objectif*
- *Say it: l'objectif*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'objectif*
- *Recall:* say the French for the aim, then the French for the intention, then say *l'objectif* again

Before you move on

What does l'objectif mean? ("The objective, the target; the lens".) Say it once more.

374.4 la résolution — the resolution, the firm decision

Before the new one: say the French for the intention, then the French for the objective.

You'll want to know: la résolution

la résolution — "the resolution, the firm decision".

Ma bonne résolution pour cette année : faire du sport.

My resolution for this year: to do some sport.

Les bonnes résolutions — New Year resolutions.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

résolution is a learned borrowing from Latin *resolūtiō* "a loosening, a solution" (EtymDB), from *resolvere* "to loosen", built on *solvere* "to loosen" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la résolution*
- *Say it: la résolution*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la résolution*
- *Recall:* say the French for the intention, then the French for the objective, then say *la résolution* again

Before you move on

What does la résolution mean? ("The resolution, the firm decision".) Say it once more.

374.5 viser — to aim (at)

Before the new one: say the French for the objective, then the French for the resolution.

You'll want to know: viser

viser — "to aim (at)".

Elle vise la première place.

She is aiming for first place.

Viser à + infinitive — to aim to.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

viser is inherited through Old French from a Vulgar Latin *vīsāre* (EtymDB), from Latin *vīsere* "to view closely" (Lewis & Short), built on *vidēre* "to see".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *viser*
- *Say it:* *viser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *viser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the objective, then the French for the resolution, then say *viser* again

Before you move on

What does viser mean? (“To aim (at)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 375

Au lycée

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about secondary school: the lycée, its pupils, attending it, the school report and the head.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 375: I can talk about secondary school: the lycée, its pupils, attending it, the school report and the head.*

375.1 le lycée — the secondary school (ages fifteen to eighteen)

Before the new one: say the French for the resolution, then the French for to aim.

You'll want to know: le lycée

le lycée — "the secondary school (ages fifteen to eighteen)".

> Ma sœur entre au lycée en septembre.
>
> *My sister starts secondary school in September.*

Belgium: *l'athénée* or *l'école secondaire*; Québec: *l'école secondaire*, then *le cégep*; Switzerland: *le gymnase*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lycée comes from Latin *lycēum* (EtymDB), from Greek *Lúkeion*, the name of a gymnasium where a famous philosopher taught.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lycée*
- *Say it: le lycée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le lycée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the resolution, then the French for to aim, then say *le lycée* again

Before you move on

What does le lycée mean? ("The secondary school (ages fifteen to eighteen)".) Say it once more.

375.2 le lycéen — the secondary-school pupil

Before the new one: say the French for to aim, then the French for the secondary school.

You'll want to know: le lycéen

le lycéen — "the secondary-school pupil".

Les lycéens ont des cours jusqu'à six heures.

The pupils have lessons until six o'clock.

Feminine *lycéenne*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lycéen is built from *lycée* and *-en*. *lycée* comes from Latin *lycēum*, from Greek *Lúkeion* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lycéen*
- *Say it: le lycéen*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le lycéen*
- *Recall:* say the French for to aim, then the French for the secondary school, then say *le lycéen* again

Before you move on

What does le lycéen mean? ("The secondary-school pupil".) Say it once more.

375.3 fréquenter — to attend, to go regularly to; to spend time with

Before the new one: say the French for the secondary school, then the French for the secondary-school pupil.

You'll want to know: fréquenter

fréquenter — "to attend, to go regularly to; to spend time with".

Il fréquente un lycée près de chez lui.

He attends a secondary school near his home.

Fréquenter quelqu'un — to see a lot of someone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fréquenter is a learned borrowing from Latin *frequentāre* "to visit often, to crowd" (Lewis & Short), from *frequēns* "crowded, frequent".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: fréquenter*
- *Say it: fréquenter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *fréquenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the secondary school, then the French for the secondary-school pupil, then say *fréquenter* again

Before you move on

What does fréquenter mean? ("To attend, to go regularly to; to spend time with".) Say it once more.

375.4 le bulletin — the school report; the bulletin

Before the new one: say the French for the secondary-school pupil, then the French for to attend.

You'll want to know: le bulletin

le bulletin — "the school report; the bulletin".

Cette année, mon bulletin est meilleur.

This year, my school report is better.

Un bulletin de vote — a ballot paper.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bulletin was borrowed from Italian *bullettino* "a small note, a ticket" (EtymDB), built on Latin *bulla* "a bubble, a seal" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bulletin*
- *Say it: le bulletin*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bulletin*
- *Recall:* say the French for the secondary-school pupil, then the French for to attend, then say *le bulletin* again

Before you move on

What does le bulletin mean? ("The school report; the bulletin".) Say it once more.

375.5 le proviseur — the head teacher (of a lycée)

Before the new one: say the French for to attend, then the French for the school report.

You'll want to know: le proviseur

le proviseur — "the head teacher (of a lycée)".

Le proviseur a parlé aux parents hier soir.

The head teacher spoke to the parents last night.

In a *collège*, the head is *le principal*. Belgium: *le préfet*; Québec: *le directeur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

proviseur is a learned borrowing from Latin *prōvīsor* "one who foresees, a provider" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *prōvidēre* "to foresee, to provide for".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le proviseur*
- *Say it: le proviseur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le proviseur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to attend, then the French for the school report, then say *le proviseur* again

Before you move on

What does le proviseur mean? ("The head teacher (of a lycée)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 376

À l'université

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about starting university: the faculty, enrolling, enrolment, the semester and the lecture hall.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 376: I can talk about starting university: the faculty, enrolling, enrolment, the semester and the lecture hall.*

376.1 la faculté — the faculty, the university; the ability

> Before the new one: say the French for the school report, then the French for the head teacher.

You'll want to know: la faculté

la faculté — "the faculty, the university; the ability".

> Elle étudie à la faculté de médecine.
>
> *She studies at the faculty of medicine.*

In speech, *la fac*: *aller à la fac.* It can also mean an ability.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faculté is a learned borrowing from Latin *facultās* "ability, power" (Lewis & Short), from *facilis* "easy, doable".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la faculté*
- *Say it: la faculté*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la faculté*
- *Recall:* say the French for the school report, then the French for the head teacher, then say *la faculté* again

Before you move on

What does la faculté mean? ("The faculty, the university; the ability".) Say it once more.

376.2 inscrire — to enrol, to register (mostly reflexive, s'inscrire); to write down

Before the new one: say the French for the head teacher, then the French for the faculty.

You'll want to know: inscrire

inscrire — "to enrol, to register (mostly reflexive, s'inscrire); to write down".

Je me suis inscrit à un cours d'anglais.

I enrolled in an English course.

S'inscrire à — to sign up for. Conjugated like *écrire*: *je m'inscris*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inscrire is a learned borrowing from Latin *īnscrībere* "to write on, to inscribe" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), reshaped on *écrire*; it is built on *scrībere* "to write".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: inscrire*
- *Say it: inscrire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *inscrire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the head teacher, then the French for the faculty, then say *inscrire* again

Before you move on

What does inscrire mean? ("To enrol, to register (mostly reflexive, s'inscrire); to write down".) Say it once more.

376.3 l'inscription — the registration, the enrolment

Before the new one: say the French for the faculty, then the French for to enrol.

You'll want to know: l'inscription

l'inscription — "the registration, the enrolment".

Les inscriptions ferment le trente septembre.

Registration closes on the thirtieth of September.

Also words carved in stone. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inscription is a learned borrowing from Latin *īnscrīptiō* "a writing on, an inscription" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *īnscrībere* "to write on".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'inscription*
- *Say it: l'inscription*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'inscription*
- *Recall:* say the French for the faculty, then the French for to enrol, then say *l'inscription* again

Before you move on

What does l'inscription mean? ("The registration, the enrolment".) Say it once more.

376.4 le semestre — the semester, the half-year

Before the new one: say the French for to enrol, then the French for the registration.

You'll want to know: le semestre

le semestre — "the semester, the half-year".

Le premier semestre commence en septembre.

The first semester starts in September.

Six months; three months is *un trimestre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

semestre comes from Latin *sēmēstris* "of six months" (EtymDB), built from *sex* "six" and *mēnsis* "month" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le semestre*
- *Say it: le semestre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le semestre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to enrol, then the French for the registration, then say *le semestre* again

Before you move on

What does le semestre mean? ("The semester, the half-year".) Say it once more.

376.5 l'amphithéâtre — the lecture hall

Before the new one: say the French for the registration, then the French for the semester.

You'll want to know: l'amphithéâtre

l'amphithéâtre — "the lecture hall".

Le cours a lieu dans le grand amphithéâtre.

The lecture takes place in the big lecture hall.

Shortened to *l'amphi*. Also an ancient arena. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amphithéâtre comes from Latin *amphitheātrum* (EtymDB), from Greek *amphithéatron*, built from *amphí* "around" and *théatron* "a place for seeing".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'amphithéâtre*
- *Say it: l'amphithéâtre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'amphithéâtre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the registration, then the French for the semester, then say *l'amphithéâtre* again

Before you move on

What does l'amphithéâtre mean? ("The lecture hall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 377

Avant l'examen

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about getting ready for an exam: revising, revision, memorising, learning by heart and the textbook.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 377: I can talk about getting ready for an exam: revising, revision, memorising, learning by heart and the textbook.*

377.1 réviser — to revise, to study for (an exam); to service (a car)

> Before the new one: say the French for the semester, then the French for the lecture hall.

You'll want to know: réviser

réviser — "to revise, to study for (an exam); to service (a car)".

> Je révise mes cours tous les soirs.
>
> *I revise my notes every evening.*

Belgium and Québec: *étudier*. *Faire réviser sa voiture* — to have the car serviced.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réviser is a learned borrowing from Latin *revīsere* "to view again, to revisit" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *vīsere*, from *vidēre* "to see".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: réviser*
- *Say it: réviser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *réviser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the semester, then the French for the lecture hall, then say *réviser* again

Before you move on

What does réviser mean? ("To revise, to study for (an exam); to service (a car)".) Say it once more.

377.2 la révision — the revision; the service (of a car)

Before the new one: say the French for the lecture hall, then the French for to revise.

You'll want to know: la révision

la révision — "the revision; the service (of a car)".

Pendant les révisions, je ne sors pas.

During revision, I do not go out.

In the plural for exam revision: *les révisions*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

révision is a learned borrowing from Latin *revīsiō* "a seeing again" (EtymDB), from *revidēre* "to go to see again", built on *vidēre* "to see" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la révision*
- *Say it: la révision*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la révision*
- *Recall:* say the French for the lecture hall, then the French for to revise, then say *la révision* again

Before you move on

What does la révision mean? ("The revision; the service (of a car)".) Say it once more.

377.3 mémoriser — to memorise

Before the new one: say the French for to revise, then the French for the revision.

You'll want to know: mémoriser

mémoriser — "to memorise".

J'ai mémorisé tous les verbes.

I memorised all the verbs.

From *mémoire*, memory.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mémoriser is built on *mémoire* "memory", from Latin *memoria* "memory", from *memor* "mindful" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: mémoriser*
- *Say it: mémoriser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *mémoriser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to revise, then the French for the revision, then say *mémoriser* again

Before you move on

What does mémoriser mean? ("To memorise".) Say it once more.

377.4 par cœur — by heart

Before the new one: say the French for the revision, then the French for to memorise.

You'll want to know: par cœur

par cœur — "by heart".

Il apprend le poème par cœur.

He is learning the poem by heart.

Connaître par cœur — to know by heart.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cœur is inherited from Latin *cor* "heart" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), once thought to be the seat of memory.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: par cœur*
- *Say it: par cœur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *par cœur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the revision, then the French for to memorise, then say *par cœur* again

Before you move on

What does par cœur mean? ("By heart".) Say it once more.

377.5 le manuel — the textbook, the manual

Before the new one: say the French for to memorise, then the French for by heart.

You'll want to know: le manuel

le manuel — "the textbook, the manual".

Le manuel de maths coûte cher.

The maths textbook is expensive.

As an adjective: done by hand, *un travail manuel*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

manuel comes from Late Latin *manuāle* "a handbook" (EtymDB), from *manuālis* "of the hand", built on *manus* "hand" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le manuel*
- *Say it:* *le manuel*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le manuel*
- *Recall:* say the French for to memorise, then the French for by heart, then say *le manuel* again

Before you move on

What does le manuel mean? (“The textbook, the manual”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 378

Examens et résultats

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about passing or failing: failing an exam, repeating a year, a competitive exam, the average mark and a resit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 378: I can talk about passing or failing: failing an exam, repeating a year, a competitive exam, the average mark and a resit.*

378.1 échouer — to fail (an exam); to run aground

> Before the new one: say the French for by heart, then the French for the textbook.

You'll want to know: échouer

échouer — "to fail (an exam); to run aground".

> Il a échoué à l'examen du permis de conduire.
>
> *He failed his driving test.*

Échouer à un examen; the noun is *un échec*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échouer first meant to run a ship aground. The origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: échouer*
- *Say it: échouer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *échouer*
- *Recall:* say the French for by heart, then the French for the textbook, then say *échouer* again

Before you move on

What does échouer mean? ("To fail (an exam); to run aground".) Say it once more.

378.2 redoubler — to repeat a year (at school); to increase

Before the new one: say the French for the textbook, then the French for to fail.

You'll want to know: redoubler

redoubler — "to repeat a year (at school); to increase".

Elle a redoublé sa première année.

She repeated her first year.

Belgium, Switzerland and Québec use the verb without *re-*. *Redoubler d'efforts* — to try twice as hard.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

redoubler is built from *re-* and *doubler* "to double", inherited from Late Latin *duplāre* (EtymDB), from Latin *duplus* "double" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: redoubler*
- *Say it: redoubler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *redoubler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the textbook, then the French for to fail, then say *redoubler* again

Before you move on

What does redoubler mean? ("To repeat a year (at school); to increase".) Say it once more.

378.3 le concours — the competitive exam; the competition

Before the new one: say the French for to fail, then the French for to repeat a year.

You'll want to know: le concours

le concours — "the competitive exam; the competition".

Il prépare le concours pour devenir professeur.

He is preparing for the competitive exam to become a teacher.

Only a set number pass. The same form in the plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

concours comes from Latin *concursus* "a running together" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *concurrere* "to run together", built on *currere* "to run".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le concours*
- *Say it: le concours*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le concours*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fail, then the French for to repeat a year, then say *le concours* again

Before you move on

What does le concours mean? ("The competitive exam; the competition".) Say it once more.

378.4 la moyenne — the average; the pass mark

Before the new one: say the French for to repeat a year, then the French for the competitive exam.

You'll want to know: la moyenne

la moyenne — "the average; the pass mark".

J'ai eu la moyenne en maths : dix sur vingt.

I got the pass mark in maths: ten out of twenty.

In France, marks are out of twenty; *avoir la moyenne* is to get ten.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moyenne is the feminine of *moyen* "middle, average", inherited through Old French *moien* (EtymDB) from Latin *mediānus* "in the middle", from *medius* "middle" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la moyenne*
- *Say it: la moyenne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la moyenne*
- *Recall:* say the French for to repeat a year, then the French for the competitive exam, then say *la moyenne* again

Before you move on

What does la moyenne mean? ("The average; the pass mark".) Say it once more.

378.5 le rattrapage — the resit (exam); catching up

Before the new one: say the French for the competitive exam, then the French for the average.

You'll want to know: le rattrapage

le rattrapage — "the resit (exam); catching up".

Il a échoué à l'examen, mais il y a un rattrapage en juillet.

He failed the exam, but there is a resit in July.

Belgium: *la seconde session*. From *rattraper*, to catch up.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rattrapage is built from *rattraper* "to catch again, to catch up" and *-age* (EtymDB). *rattraper* is *re-* + *attraper* "to catch", which rests on *trappe* "a trap", usually traced to a Frankish word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rattrapage*
- *Say it: le rattrapage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le rattrapage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the competitive exam, then the French for the average, then say *le rattrapage* again

Before you move on

What does le rattrapage mean? ("The resit (exam); catching up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 379

Le diplôme

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about qualifications: a diploma, an exam paper, a grade with honours, a doctorate and a grant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 379: I can talk about qualifications: a diploma, an exam paper, a grade with honours, a doctorate and a grant.*

379.1 le diplôme — the diploma, the degree

> Before the new one: say the French for the average, then the French for the resit.

You'll want to know: le diplôme

le diplôme — "the diploma, the degree".

> Il a enfin son diplôme d'infirmier.
>
> *He finally has his nursing diploma.*

Passer un diplôme — to take a qualification.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

diplôme comes from Latin *diplōma* "a letter folded double, a state letter of recommendation" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from Greek

díplōma “a folded paper”, built on *diplóos* “double”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le diplôme*
- *Say it: le diplôme*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le diplôme*
- *Recall:* say the French for the average, then the French for the resit, then say *le diplôme* again

Before you move on

What does le diplôme mean? (“The diploma, the degree”.) Say it once more.

379.2 l’épreuve — the test, the exam paper; the ordeal

Before the new one: say the French for the resit, then the French for the diploma.

You’ll want to know: l’épreuve

l’épreuve — “the test, the exam paper; the ordeal”.

La première épreuve de l’examen dure trois heures.

The first paper of the exam lasts three hours.

Une épreuve écrite, *une épreuve orale*. In sport, an event. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épreuve is formed on *éprouver* “to test, to feel” (EtymDB), built from *é-* and *prouver*, which is inherited from Latin *probāre* “to test, to

examine" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'épreuve*
- *Say it: l'épreuve*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'épreuve*
- *Recall:* say the French for the resit, then the French for the diploma, then say *l'épreuve* again

Before you move on

What does l'épreuve mean? ("The test, the exam paper; the ordeal".) Say it once more.

379.3 la mention — the distinction, the honours (on an exam); the mention

Before the new one: say the French for the diploma, then the French for the test.

You'll want to know: la mention

la mention — "the distinction, the honours (on an exam); the mention".

> Elle a eu son diplôme avec mention.
>
> *She got her diploma with honours.*

Mention bien, *mention très bien* — with honours, with high honours.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mention is a learned borrowing from Latin *mentiō* "a calling to mind, a mention" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), related to *mēns* "mind".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mention*
- *Say it: la mention*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la mention*
- *Recall:* say the French for the diploma, then the French for the test, then say *la mention* again

Before you move on

What does la mention mean? ("The distinction, the honours (on an exam); the mention".) Say it once more.

379.4 le doctorat — the doctorate, the PhD

Before the new one: say the French for the test, then the French for the distinction.

You'll want to know: le doctorat

le doctorat — "the doctorate, the PhD".

Mon cousin fait un doctorat en chimie.

My cousin is doing a PhD in chemistry.

The holder is *un docteur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

doctorat comes from Medieval Latin *doctōrātus*, built on *doctor* "teacher", from *docēre* "to teach" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le doctorat*
- *Say it: le doctorat*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le doctorat*
- *Recall:* say the French for the test, then the French for the distinction, then say *le doctorat* again

Before you move on

What does le doctorat mean? ("The doctorate, the PhD".) Say it once more.

379.5 la bourse — the grant, the scholarship; the stock exchange

Before the new one: say the French for the distinction, then the French for the doctorate.

You'll want to know: la bourse

la bourse — "the grant, the scholarship; the stock exchange".

Elle a reçu une bourse pour étudier à l'étranger.

She got a grant to study abroad.

La Bourse is the stock exchange. Once a purse.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bourse is inherited through Old French *borse* “purse” (EtymDB) from Late Latin *bursa* “a leather bag”, from Greek *búrsa* “a hide”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bourse*
- *Say it: la bourse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bourse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the distinction, then the French for the doctorate, then say *la bourse* again

Before you move on

What does la bourse mean? (“The grant, the scholarship; the stock exchange”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 380

Les règles

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about rules: a standard, the regulations, what is compulsory or optional, and an obligation.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 380: I can talk about rules: a standard, the regulations, what is compulsory or optional, and an obligation.*

380.1 la norme — the norm, the standard

> Before the new one: say the French for the doctorate, then the French for the grant.

You'll want to know: la norme

la norme — "the norm, the standard".

> Ce casque est aux normes.
>
> *This helmet meets the standards.*

Être aux normes — to meet the standards.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

norme is a learned borrowing from Latin *nōrma* "a carpenter's square, a rule, a pattern" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la norme*
- *Say it: la norme*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la norme*
- *Recall:* say the French for the doctorate, then the French for the grant, then say *la norme* again

Before you move on

What does la norme mean? ("The norm, the standard".) Say it once more.

380.2 le règlement — the regulations, the rules; the payment

Before the new one: say the French for the grant, then the French for the norm.

You'll want to know: le règlement

le règlement — "the regulations, the rules; the payment".

Le règlement de l'école interdit les téléphones en classe.

The school rules forbid phones in class.

It also means payment: *règlement par carte*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

règlement is built from *régler* "to regulate, to settle" and *-ment*. The verb rests on *règle* "rule", from Latin *rēgula* "a ruler, a rule", built on *regere* "to guide" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le règlement*
- *Say it: le règlement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le règlement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the grant, then the French for the norm, then say *le règlement* again

Before you move on

What does le règlement mean? ("The regulations, the rules; the payment".) Say it once more.

380.3 obligatoire — compulsory, mandatory

Before the new one: say the French for the norm, then the French for the regulations.

You'll want to know: obligatoire

obligatoire — "compulsory, mandatory".

Le port du casque est obligatoire sur le chantier.

Wearing a helmet is compulsory on the building site.

One form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

obligatoire is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *obligātōrius* "binding" (EtymDB), from *obligāre* "to bind", built on *ligāre* "to tie" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: obligatoire*
- *Say it: obligatoire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *obligatoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the norm, then the French for the regulations, then say *obligatoire* again

Before you move on

What does obligatoire mean? ("Compulsory, mandatory".) Say it once more.

380.4 facultatif — optional

Before the new one: say the French for the regulations, then the French for compulsory.

You'll want to know: facultatif

facultatif — "optional".

Le cours de musique est facultatif.

The music class is optional.

Feminine *facultative*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

facultatif is built on *faculté* "power, option", from Latin *facultās* "ability, power" (Lewis & Short), from *facilis* "easy, doable": you may do it if you choose.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: facultatif*
- *Say it: facultatif*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *facultatif*
- *Recall:* say the French for the regulations, then the French for compulsory, then say *facultatif* again

Before you move on

What does facultatif mean? ("Optional".) Say it once more.

380.5 l'obligation — the obligation, the duty

Before the new one: say the French for compulsory, then the French for optional.

You'll want to know: l'obligation

l'obligation — "the obligation, the duty".

Tu n'as aucune obligation de venir.

You are under no obligation to come.

Feminine: *une obligation.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

obligation is a learned borrowing from Latin *obligātiō* "a binding, an engagement" (EtymDB), from *obligāre* "to bind", built on *ligāre* "to tie" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'obligation*
- *Say it: l'obligation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'obligation*
- *Recall:* say the French for compulsory, then the French for optional, then say *l'obligation* again

Before you move on

What does l'obligation mean? ("The obligation, the duty".) Say it once more.

Chapter 381

Permis ou non

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what is authorised or tolerated, talk about permission and tolerance, and say what someone demands.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 381: I can say what is authorised or tolerated, talk about permission and tolerance, and say what someone demands.*

381.1 autoriser — to authorise, to allow

> Before the new one: say the French for optional, then the French for the obligation.

You'll want to know: autoriser

autoriser — "to authorise, to allow".

> Les chiens ne sont pas autorisés dans le magasin.
>
> *Dogs are not allowed in the shop.*

Autoriser quelqu'un à + infinitive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

autoriser comes from Old French *auctorisier* (EtymDB), from Medieval Latin *auctōrizāre*, built on *auctor* "author, guarantor", from

augēre “to increase” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: autoriser*
- *Say it: autoriser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *autoriser*
- *Recall:* say the French for optional, then the French for the obligation, then say *autoriser* again

Before you move on

What does autoriser mean? (“To authorise, to allow”.) Say it once more.

381.2 l’autorisation — the authorisation, the permission

Before the new one: say the French for the obligation, then the French for to authorise.

You’ll want to know: l’autorisation

l’autorisation — “the authorisation, the permission”.

Il faut une autorisation pour filmer ici.

You need permission to film here.

Feminine. Close to *la permission*, but more official.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

autorisation is built from *autoriser* and *-ation*. The verb rests on Latin *auctor* “author, guarantor”, from *augēre* “to increase” (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'autorisation*
- *Say it: l'autorisation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'autorisation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the obligation, then the French for to authorise, then say *l'autorisation* again

Before you move on

What does l'autorisation mean? ("The authorisation, the permission".) Say it once more.

381.3 tolérer — to tolerate, to put up with

Before the new one: say the French for to authorise, then the French for the authorisation.

You'll want to know: tolérer

tolérer — "to tolerate, to put up with".

Le professeur ne tolère pas les retards.

The teacher does not tolerate lateness.

Je tolère, with *è* before a silent ending.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tolérer is a learned borrowing from Latin *tolerāre* "to bear, to endure" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tolérer*
- *Say it: tolérer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tolérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to authorise, then the French for the authorisation, then say *tolérer* again

Before you move on

What does tolérer mean? ("To tolerate, to put up with".) Say it once more.

381.4 la tolérance — the tolerance

Before the new one: say the French for the authorisation, then the French for to tolerate.

You'll want to know: la tolérance

la tolérance — "the tolerance".

Il faut un peu de tolérance pour vivre ensemble.

Living together takes a bit of tolerance.

Tolérance zéro — zero tolerance.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tolérance is a learned borrowing from Latin *tolerantia* "endurance, bearing" (Lewis & Short), from *tolerāre* "to bear".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tolérance*
- *Say it: la tolérance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la tolérance*
- *Recall:* say the French for the authorisation, then the French for to tolerate, then say *la tolérance* again

Before you move on

What does la tolérance mean? ("The tolerance".) Say it once more.

381.5 exiger — to demand, to require

Before the new one: say the French for to tolerate, then the French for the tolerance.

You'll want to know: exiger

exiger — "to demand, to require".

Le patron exige beaucoup de ses salariés.

The boss demands a lot of his employees.

Exiger que takes the subjunctive. *Nous exigeons.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exiger is a learned borrowing from Latin *exigere* "to drive out, to demand" (Lewis & Short), built from *ex* "out" and *agere* "to drive".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *exiger*
- *Say it:* *exiger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *exiger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tolerate, then the French for the tolerance, then say *exiger* again

Before you move on

What does exiger mean? (“To demand, to require”.) Say it once more.

381.6 Retour sur les chapitres 374–381

Say the French for the aim and the intention.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the aim, the intention, the objective, the resolution, to aim
- the secondary school, the secondary-school pupil, to attend, the school report, the head teacher
- the faculty, to enrol, the registration, the semester, the lecture hall
- to revise, the revision, to memorise, by heart, the textbook
- to fail, to repeat a year, the competitive exam, the average, the resit
- the diploma, the test, the distinction, the doctorate, the grant
- the norm, the regulations, compulsory, optional, the obligation
- to authorise, the authorisation, to tolerate, the tolerance, to demand

Before you move on

The aim? (**le but**.) The intention? (**l'intention**.) The objective? (**l'objectif**.) The resolution? (**la résolution**.) To aim? (**viser**.) The secondary school? (**le lycée**.) The secondary-school pupil? (**le lycéen**.) To attend? (**fréquenter**.) The school report? (**le bulletin**.) The head teacher? (**le proviseur**.) The faculty? (**la faculté**.) To enrol? (**inscrire**.) The registration? (**l'inscription**.) The semester? (**le semestre**.) The lecture hall? (**l'amphithéâtre**.) To revise? (**réviser**.) The revision? (**la révision**.) To memorise? (**mémoriser**.) By heart? (**par cœur**.) The textbook? (**le manuel**.) To fail? (**échouer**.) To repeat a year? (**redoubler**.) The competitive exam? (**le concours**.) The average? (**la moyenne**.) The resit? (**le rattrapage**.) The diploma? (**le diplôme**.) The test? (**l'épreuve**.) The distinction? (**la mention**.) The doctorate? (**le doctorat**.) The grant? (**la bourse**.) The norm? (**la norme**.) The regulations? (**le règlement**.) Compulsory? (**obligatoire**.) Optional? (**facultatif**.) The obligation? (**l'obligation**.) To authorise? (**autoriser**.) The authorisation? (**l'autorisation**.) To tolerate? (**tolérer**.) The tolerance? (**la tolérance**.) To demand? (**exiger**.)

Chapter 382

Enfreindre les règles

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that someone broke a rule: breaking the law, an offence, transgressing, a penalty and penalising someone.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 382: I can say that someone broke a rule: breaking the law, an offence, transgressing, a penalty and penalising someone.*

382.1 enfreindre — to break (a rule, the law)

> Before the new one: say the French for the tolerance, then the French for to demand.

You'll want to know: enfreindre

enfreindre — "to break (a rule, the law)".

> Il a enfreint le code de la route.
>
> *He broke the highway code.*

Conjugated like *peindre*: *il enfreint*, *ils enfreignent*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enfreindre is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin *infrangere* "to break into", reshaped from Latin *infringere* "to break" (Lewis & Short), built

on *frangere* “to break”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: enfreindre*
- *Say it: enfreindre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *enfreindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tolerance, then the French for to demand, then say *enfreindre* again

Before you move on

What does enfreindre mean? (“To break (a rule, the law)”.) Say it once more.

382.2 l’infraction — the offence, the violation

Before the new one: say the French for to demand, then the French for to break.

You’ll want to know: l’infraction

l’infraction — “the offence, the violation”.

Conduire sans permis est une infraction grave.

Driving without a licence is a serious offence.

Feminine: *une infraction au code de la route.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

infraction is a learned borrowing from Latin *infractiō* “a breaking” (EtymDB), built on *frangere* “to break” (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'infraction*
- *Say it: l'infraction*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'infraction*
- *Recall:* say the French for to demand, then the French for to break, then say *l'infraction* again

Before you move on

What does l'infraction mean? ("The offence, the violation".) Say it once more.

382.3 transgresser — to transgress, to break (a rule)

Before the new one: say the French for to break, then the French for the offence.

You'll want to know: transgresser

transgresser — "to transgress, to break (a rule)".

Les adolescents aiment transgresser les règles.

Teenagers like to break the rules.

Formal, a little literary.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

transgresser is built on Latin *trānsgressus*, from *trānsgredī* "to step across" (Lewis & Short), built on *gradī* "to step".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: transgresser*
- *Say it: transgresser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *transgresser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to break, then the French for the offence, then say *transgresser* again

Before you move on

What does transgresser mean? ("To transgress, to break (a rule)".) Say it once more.

382.4 la sanction — the penalty, the sanction

Before the new one: say the French for the offence, then the French for to transgress.

You'll want to know: la sanction

la sanction — "the penalty, the sanction".

> Les sanctions sont lourdes pour ce genre d'infraction.
>
> *The penalties are heavy for this kind of offence.*

It can also mean approval, but mostly it is a penalty.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sanction is a learned borrowing from Latin *sānctiō* "a decree, a penalty clause" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *sancīre* "to make sacred, to decree".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sanction*
- *Say it: la sanction*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la sanction*
- *Recall:* say the French for the offence, then the French for to transgress, then say *la sanction* again

Before you move on

What does la sanction mean? ("The penalty, the sanction".) Say it once more.

382.5 sanctionner — to penalise, to sanction

Before the new one: say the French for to transgress, then the French for the penalty.

You'll want to know: sanctionner

sanctionner — "to penalise, to sanction".

L'école a sanctionné les élèves qui fumaient dans les toilettes.

The school penalised the pupils who were smoking in the toilets.

Être sanctionné — to be penalised.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sanctionner is built on *sanction*, from Latin *sānctiō* "a decree, a penalty clause", from *sancīre* "to make sacred, to decree" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sanctionner*
- *Say it: sanctionner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sanctionner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to transgress, then the French for the penalty, then say *sanctionner* again

Before you move on

What does sanctionner mean? ("To penalise, to sanction".) Say it once more.

Chapter 383

Qui peut participer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who can take part: the requirements and criteria, being eligible, admission, and being left out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 383: I can say who can take part: the requirements and criteria, being eligible, admission, and being left out.*

383.1 l'exigence — the requirement, the demand

> Before the new one: say the French for the penalty, then the French for to penalise.

You'll want to know: l'exigence

l'exigence — "the requirement, the demand".

> Ce poste a beaucoup d'exigences.
>
> *This job has a lot of requirements.*

Feminine. *Être exigeant* — to be demanding.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exigence is usually traced to Late Latin *exigentia* "urgency, need", from *exigere* "to drive out, to demand" (Lewis & Short), built on *agere* "to

drive".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'exigence*
- *Say it: l'exigence*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'exigence*
- *Recall:* say the French for the penalty, then the French for to penalise, then say *l'exigence* again

Before you move on

What does l'exigence mean? ("The requirement, the demand".) Say it once more.

383.2 le critère — the criterion

Before the new one: say the French for to penalise, then the French for the requirement.

You'll want to know: le critère

le critère — "the criterion".

Le prix est mon premier critère.

Price is my first criterion.

The plural is *les critères*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

critère is usually traced, as a learned word, to Late Latin *critērium*, from Greek *kritḗrion* "a means of judging", built on *krínein* "to judge".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le critère*
- *Say it: le critère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le critère*
- *Recall:* say the French for to penalise, then the French for the requirement, then say *le critère* again

Before you move on

What does le critère mean? ("The criterion".) Say it once more.

383.3 éligible — eligible

Before the new one: say the French for the requirement, then the French for the criterion.

You'll want to know: éligible

éligible — "eligible".

À dix-huit ans, on est éligible au conseil municipal.

At eighteen, you are eligible for the town council.

One form for both genders. *Éligible à une aide* — eligible for aid.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éligible is usually traced to Late Latin *ēligibilis* "that may be chosen", from *ēligere* "to pick out", built on *legere* "to choose, to gather" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *éligible*
- *Say it:* *éligible*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *éligible*
- *Recall:* say the French for the requirement, then the French for the criterion, then say *éligible* again

Before you move on

What does éligible mean? ("Eligible".) Say it once more.

383.4 l'admission — the admission, the entry

Before the new one: say the French for the criterion, then the French for eligible.

You'll want to know: l'admission

l'admission — "the admission, the entry".

Les résultats d'admission arrivent en juin.

The admission results come out in June.

Feminine. From *admettre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

admission is a learned borrowing from Latin *admissiō* "a letting in" (EtymDB), from *admittere* "to let in", built on *mittere* "to send" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'admission*
- *Say it: l'admission*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'admission*
- *Recall:* say the French for the criterion, then the French for eligible, then say *l'admission* again

Before you move on

What does l'admission mean? ("The admission, the entry".) Say it once more.

383.5 exclure — to exclude, to rule out

Before the new one: say the French for eligible, then the French for the admission.

You'll want to know: exclure

exclure — "to exclude, to rule out".

On ne peut pas exclure un retard.

A delay cannot be ruled out.

Like *conclure*: past participle *exclu*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

exclure is a learned borrowing from Latin *exclūdere* "to shut out" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built from *ex* "out" and *claudere* "to shut".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *exclure*
- *Say it:* *exclure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *exclure*
- *Recall:* say the French for eligible, then the French for the admission, then say *exclure* again

Before you move on

What does exclure mean? (“To exclude, to rule out”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 384

Des papiers en règle

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can keep my papers in order: say when something expires, whether it is still valid, and renew it.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 384: I can keep my papers in order: say when something expires, whether it is still valid, and renew it.*

384.1 expirer — to expire; to breathe out

> Before the new one: say the French for the admission, then the French for to exclude.

You'll want to know: expirer

expirer — "to expire; to breathe out".

> Mon passeport expire au mois de mai.
>
> *My passport expires in May.*

Of breathing: *inspirer*, then *expirer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

expirer is a learned borrowing from Latin *exspīrāre* "to breathe out, to die away" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *spīrāre* "to breathe".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: expirer*
- *Say it: expirer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *expirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the admission, then the French for to exclude, then say *expirer* again

Before you move on

What does expirer mean? ("To expire; to breathe out".) Say it once more.

384.2 valable — acceptable, valid; worthwhile

Before the new one: say the French for to exclude, then the French for to expire.

You'll want to know: valable

valable — "acceptable, valid; worthwhile".

Ce billet est valable une semaine.

This ticket is valid for a week.

Une excuse valable — a good excuse. One form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

valable is built from *valoir* "to be worth" and *-able* (EtymDB). *valoir* is inherited from Latin *valēre* "to be strong, to be worth" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: valable*
- *Say it: valable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *valable*
- *Recall:* say the French for to exclude, then the French for to expire, then say *valable* again

Before you move on

What does valable mean? ("Acceptable, valid; worthwhile".) Say it once more.

384.3 valide — valid; fit, able-bodied

Before the new one: say the French for to expire, then the French for acceptable.

You'll want to know: valide

valide — "valid; fit, able-bodied".

Il faut une pièce d'identité valide.

A valid identity document is needed.

Of a person: fit, able-bodied.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

valide is a learned borrowing from Latin *validus* "strong, powerful" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *valēre* "to be strong".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: valide*
- *Say it: valide*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *valide*
- *Recall:* say the French for to expire, then the French for acceptable, then say *valide* again

Before you move on

What does valide mean? ("Valid; fit, able-bodied".) Say it once more.

384.4 renouveler — to renew

Before the new one: say the French for acceptable, then the French for valid.

You'll want to know: renouveler

renouveler — "to renew".

Je dois renouveler ma carte d'identité.

I have to renew my identity card.

Je renouvelle, with *ll* before a silent ending.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

renouveler is built from *re-* and Old French *noveler* "to make new", from Latin *novellus* "young, new", a small form of *novus* "new" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: renouveler*
- *Say it: renouveler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *renouveler*
- *Recall:* say the French for acceptable, then the French for valid, then say *renouveler* again

Before you move on

What does renouveler mean? ("To renew".) Say it once more.

384.5 le renouvellement — the renewal

Before the new one: say the French for valid, then the French for to renew.

You'll want to know: le renouvellement

le renouvellement — "the renewal".

Le renouvellement du passeport prend un mois.

Renewing a passport takes a month.

Spelled with *ll*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

renouvellement is built from *renouveler* and *-ment* (EtymDB). The verb rests on Latin *novellus* "new", from *novus* "new" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le renouvellement*
- *Say it: le renouvellement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le renouvellement*
- *Recall:* say the French for valid, then the French for to renew, then say *le renouvellement* again

Before you move on

What does le renouvellement mean? ("The renewal".) Say it once more.

Chapter 385

La paperasse

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can deal with red tape: bureaucracy, the steps to take, a procedure, a certificate and an official statement.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 385: I can deal with red tape: bureaucracy, the steps to take, a procedure, a certificate and an official statement.*

385.1 la bureaucratie — the bureaucracy, the red tape

> Before the new one: say the French for to renew, then the French for the renewal.

You'll want to know: la bureaucratie

la bureaucratie — "the bureaucracy, the red tape".

> Il y a trop de bureaucratie dans ce pays.
>
> *There is too much red tape in this country.*

The *t* is said like *s*: *bureaucrassie*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bureaucratie is a French formation from *bureau* "office" and *-cratie* "rule" (EtymDB), from Greek *krátos* "power": rule by offices.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bureaucratie*
- *Say it: la bureaucratie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bureaucratie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to renew, then the French for the renewal, then say *la bureaucratie* again

Before you move on

What does la bureaucratie mean? ("The bureaucracy, the red tape".) Say it once more.

385.2 la démarche — the step (to get something done); the gait

Before the new one: say the French for the renewal, then the French for the bureaucracy.

You'll want to know: la démarche

la démarche — "the step (to get something done); the gait".

J'ai fait toutes les démarches pour obtenir mon visa.

I took all the steps to get my visa.

Faire des démarches — to take the necessary steps. Also the way someone walks.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

démarche is formed on an old verb *démarcher* (EtymDB), built from *dé-* and *marcher* "to walk"; *marcher* is usually traced to a Frankish word for treading.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la démarche*
- *Say it: la démarche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la démarche*
- *Recall:* say the French for the renewal, then the French for the bureaucracy, then say *la démarche* again

Before you move on

What does la démarche mean? ("The step (to get something done); the gait".) Say it once more.

385.3 la procédure — the procedure

Before the new one: say the French for the bureaucracy, then the French for the step.

You'll want to know: la procédure

la procédure — "the procedure".

La procédure est longue, mais simple.

The procedure is long, but simple.

In law, a court case: *une procédure judiciaire.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

procédure is built on *procéder* "to proceed", from Latin *prōcēdere* "to go forward" (Lewis & Short), built on *cēdere* "to go".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la procédure*
- *Say it: la procédure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la procédure*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bureaucracy, then the French for the step, then say *la procédure* again

Before you move on

What does la procédure mean? ("The procedure".) Say it once more.

385.4 le certificat — the certificate

Before the new one: say the French for the step, then the French for the procedure.

You'll want to know: le certificat

le certificat — "the certificate".

Le médecin m'a donné un certificat pour l'école.

The doctor gave me a certificate for school.

Un certificat médical — a doctor's note.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

certificat comes from Medieval Latin *certificātum* (EtymDB), built on Latin *certus* "sure" and *facere* "to make" (Lewis & Short): a paper that makes a fact sure.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le certificat*
- *Say it: le certificat*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le certificat*
- *Recall:* say the French for the step, then the French for the procedure, then say *le certificat* again

Before you move on

What does le certificat mean? ("The certificate".) Say it once more.

385.5 l'attestation — the official statement, the attestation

Before the new one: say the French for the procedure, then the French for the certificate.

You'll want to know: l'attestation

l'attestation — "the official statement, the attestation".

La banque demande une attestation de domicile.

The bank is asking for proof of address.

A signed paper that confirms a fact. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

attestation is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *attestātiō* (EtymDB), from *attestārī* "to bear witness to" (Lewis & Short), built on *testis* "witness".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'attestation*
- *Say it: l'attestation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'attestation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the procedure, then the French for the certificate, then say *l'attestation* again

Before you move on

What does l'attestation mean? ("The official statement, the attestation".) Say it once more.

Chapter 386

Les accusations

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who is accused of what: an accusation, a thief, a formal complaint and a minor offence.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 386: I can say who is accused of what: an accusation, a thief, a formal complaint and a minor offence.*

386.1 accuser — to accuse

Before the new one: say the French for the certificate, then the French for the official statement.

You'll want to know: accuser

accuser — "to accuse".

Ils l'accusent d'avoir volé un vélo.

They accuse him of stealing a bike.

Accuser quelqu'un de quelque chose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accuser comes through Old French *acuser* (EtymDB) from Latin *accūsāre* "to call to account, to accuse", built from *ad* and *causa* "cause, lawsuit" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: accuser*
- *Say it: accuser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *accuser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the certificate, then the French for the official statement, then say *accuser* again

Before you move on

What does accuser mean? ("To accuse".) Say it once more.

386.2 l'accusation — the accusation, the charge

Before the new one: say the French for the official statement, then the French for to accuse.

You'll want to know: l'accusation

l'accusation — "the accusation, the charge".

C'est une accusation très grave.

It is a very serious accusation.

Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accusation is a learned borrowing from Latin *accūsātiō* "an accusation, an indictment" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *accūsāre* "to accuse".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'accusation*
- *Say it: l'accusation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'accusation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the official statement, then the French for to accuse, then say *l'accusation* again

Before you move on

What does l'accusation mean? ("The accusation, the charge".) Say it once more.

386.3 le voleur — the thief

Before the new one: say the French for to accuse, then the French for the accusation.

You'll want to know: le voleur

le voleur — "the thief".

Le voleur est entré par la fenêtre.

The thief came in through the window.

Feminine *voleuse*. *Au voleur !* — stop thief!

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voleur is built from *voler* "to steal" and *-eur*. *voler* "to steal" is the same word as *voler* "to fly", from Latin *volāre* "to fly" (Lewis & Short): the falcon that flies off with its prey.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le voleur*
- *Say it: le voleur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le voleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to accuse, then the French for the accusation, then say *le voleur* again

Before you move on

What does le voleur mean? ("The thief".) Say it once more.

386.4 la plainte — the complaint (to the police); the moan

Before the new one: say the French for the accusation, then the French for the thief.

You'll want to know: la plainte

la plainte — "the complaint (to the police); the moan".

Elle a porté plainte à la police.

She filed a complaint with the police.

Porter plainte — to file a complaint. From *se plaindre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plainte comes from Old French *plainte* "lament, complaint" (EtymDB), formed on *plaindre*, from Latin *plangere* "to beat the breast, to lament" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plainte*
- *Say it: la plainte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la plainte*
- *Recall:* say the French for the accusation, then the French for the thief, then say *la plainte* again

Before you move on

What does la plainte mean? ("The complaint (to the police); the moan".) Say it once more.

386.5 le délit — the misdemeanour, the offence

Before the new one: say the French for the thief, then the French for the complaint.

You'll want to know: le délit

le délit — "the misdemeanour, the offence".

Voler dans un magasin est un délit.

Shoplifting is an offence.

Less serious than *un crime*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

délit comes through Old French *delit* (EtymDB) from Latin *dēlictum* "a fault, an offence", from *dēlinquere* "to fail, to do wrong" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le délit*
- *Say it: le délit*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le délit*
- *Recall:* say the French for the thief, then the French for the complaint, then say *le délit* again

Before you move on

What does le délit mean? (“The misdemeanour, the offence”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 387

Au tribunal

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a trial: the defence, the verdict, and whether someone is guilty or innocent.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 387: I can describe a trial: the defence, the verdict, and whether someone is guilty or innocent.*

387.1 le procès — the trial

Before the new one: say the French for the complaint, then the French for the misdemeanour.

You'll want to know: le procès

le procès — "the trial".

Le procès commence la semaine prochaine.

The trial starts next week.

Faire un procès à quelqu'un — to sue someone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

procès comes from Latin *prōcessus* "a going forward, progress" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *prōcēdere* "to go forward", built on *cēdere* "to go".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le procès*
- *Say it: le procès*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le procès*
- *Recall:* say the French for the complaint, then the French for the misdemeanour, then say *le procès* again

Before you move on

What does le procès mean? ("The trial".) Say it once more.

387.2 la défense — the defence

Before the new one: say the French for the misdemeanour, then the French for the trial.

You'll want to know: la défense

la défense — "the defence".

L'avocat de la défense a parlé pendant une heure.

The defence lawyer spoke for an hour.

Défense de fumer — no smoking.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défense comes from Late Latin *dēfēnsa* "protection" (EtymDB), from *dēfendere* "to ward off, to defend" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la défense*
- *Say it: la défense*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la défense*
- *Recall:* say the French for the misdemeanour, then the French for the trial, then say *la défense* again

Before you move on

What does la défense mean? ("The defence".) Say it once more.

387.3 le verdict — the verdict

Before the new one: say the French for the trial, then the French for the defence.

You'll want to know: le verdict

le verdict — "the verdict".

Le verdict tombe demain.

The verdict comes tomorrow.

The final *ct* is said.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verdict was borrowed from English *verdict*, from Medieval Latin *vērēdictum* "a thing truly said", built from *vērē* "truly" and *dictum* "said" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le verdict*
- *Say it: le verdict*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le verdict*
- *Recall:* say the French for the trial, then the French for the defence, then say *le verdict* again

Before you move on

What does le verdict mean? ("The verdict".) Say it once more.

387.4 coupable — guilty

Before the new one: say the French for the defence, then the French for the verdict.

You'll want to know: coupable

coupable — "guilty".

Pour le juge, il est coupable.

For the judge, he is guilty.

Also a noun: *le coupable* — the culprit.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coupable is inherited from Latin *culpābilis* "blameworthy" (EtymDB), from *culpa* "fault, blame" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *coupable*
- *Say it:* *coupable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *coupable*
- *Recall:* say the French for the defence, then the French for the verdict, then say *coupable* again

Before you move on

What does coupable mean? (“Guilty”.) Say it once more.

387.5 innocent — innocent

Before the new one: say the French for the verdict, then the French for guilty.

You’ll want to know: innocent

innocent — “innocent”.

Il dit qu’il est innocent.

He says he is innocent.

Feminine *innocente*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

innocent is a learned borrowing from Latin *innocēns* “harmless, blameless” (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built from *in-* “not” and *nocēre* “to harm”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *innocent*
- *Say it:* *innocent*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *innocent*
- *Recall:* say the French for the verdict, then the French for guilty, then say *innocent* again

Before you move on

What does innocent mean? (“Innocent”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 388

La peine

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about punishment: a sentence, condemning someone, a conviction, a prisoner and punishing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 388: I can talk about punishment: a sentence, condemning someone, a conviction, a prisoner and punishing.*

388.1 la peine — the sentence, the penalty; sorrow

> Before the new one: say the French for guilty, then the French for innocent.

You'll want to know: la peine

la peine — "the sentence, the penalty; sorrow".

> Il a eu une peine de deux ans de prison.
>
> *He got a two-year prison sentence.*

Avoir de la peine — to be sad. *Ce n'est pas la peine* — it is not worth it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peine is inherited through Old French from Latin *poena* "a penalty, punishment" (Lewis & Short), itself from Greek *poinḗ* "a fine".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la peine*
- *Say it: la peine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la peine*
- *Recall:* say the French for guilty, then the French for innocent, then say *la peine* again

Before you move on

What does la peine mean? ("The sentence, the penalty; sorrow".) Say it once more.

388.2 condamner — to sentence, to condemn

Before the new one: say the French for innocent, then the French for the sentence.

You'll want to know: condamner

condamner — "to sentence, to condemn".

Le tribunal l'a condamné à une amende.

The court sentenced him to a fine.

The *m* is silent: *condaner*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

condamner is inherited through Old French (EtymDB) from Latin *condemnāre* “to sentence, to condemn” (Lewis & Short), built on *damnāre* “to condemn”, from *damnum* “loss, harm”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: condamner*
- *Say it: condamner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *condamner*
- *Recall:* say the French for innocent, then the French for the sentence, then say *condamner* again

Before you move on

What does condamner mean? (“To sentence, to condemn”.) Say it once more.

388.3 la condamnation — the conviction, the sentence; the condemnation

Before the new one: say the French for the sentence, then the French for to sentence.

You’ll want to know: la condamnation

la condamnation — “the conviction, the sentence; the condemnation”.

Après sa condamnation, il a perdu son emploi.

After his conviction, he lost his job.

The *m* is silent here too.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

condamnation is a learned borrowing from Latin *condemnātiō* "a condemnation" (Lewis & Short), from *condemnāre* "to sentence", built on *damnum* "loss, harm".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la condamnation*
- *Say it: la condamnation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la condamnation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sentence, then the French for to sentence, then say *la condamnation* again

Before you move on

What does la condamnation mean? ("The conviction, the sentence; the condemnation".) Say it once more.

388.4 le détenu — the prisoner, the inmate

Before the new one: say the French for to sentence, then the French for the conviction.

You'll want to know: le détenu

le détenu — "the prisoner, the inmate".

Les détenus peuvent recevoir des visites le samedi.

The inmates can have visitors on Saturdays.

Feminine *détenue*. From *détenir*, to hold.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

détenu is the past participle of *détenir* "to hold, to detain", from Latin *dētinēre* "to hold back" (Lewis & Short), built on *tenēre* "to hold".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le détenu*
- *Say it: le détenu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le détenu*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sentence, then the French for the conviction, then say *le détenu* again

Before you move on

What does le détenu mean? ("The prisoner, the inmate".) Say it once more.

388.5 punir — to punish

Before the new one: say the French for the conviction, then the French for the prisoner.

You'll want to know: punir

punir — "to punish".

Ses parents l'ont puni parce qu'il a cassé la fenêtre.

His parents punished him because he broke the window.

A *-ir* verb like *finir*: *ils punissent.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

punir comes through Old French *punir* (EtymDB) from Latin *pūnīre* "to inflict a penalty on" (Lewis & Short), from *poena* "penalty".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: punir*
- *Say it: punir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *punir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the conviction, then the French for the prisoner, then say *punir* again

Before you move on

What does punir mean? ("To punish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 389

L'enquête

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about an investigation: investigating, a witness, giving evidence and the victim.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 389: I can talk about an investigation: investigating, a witness, giving evidence and the victim.*

389.1 l'enquête — the investigation, the inquiry; the survey

> Before the new one: say the French for the prisoner, then the French for to punish.

You'll want to know: l'enquête

l'enquête — "the investigation, the inquiry; the survey".

> La police a ouvert une enquête.
>
> *The police have opened an investigation.*

Also a survey: *une enquête sur les jeunes*. Feminine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enquête comes from Old French *enqueste* (EtymDB), from Latin *inquīsīta* "things searched for", from *inquīrere* "to search into", built

on *quaerere* “to seek” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l’enquête*
- *Say it: l’enquête*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l’enquête*
- *Recall:* say the French for the prisoner, then the French for to punish, then say *l’enquête* again

Before you move on

What does l’enquête mean? (“The investigation, the inquiry; the survey”.) Say it once more.

389.2 enquêter — to investigate

Before the new one: say the French for to punish, then the French for the investigation.

You’ll want to know: enquêter

enquêter — “to investigate”.

Deux policiers enquêtent sur l’accident.

Two police officers are investigating the accident.

Enquêter sur quelque chose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enquêter is built on *enquête* “inquiry”, from Old French *enqueste*, from Latin *inquīrere* “to search into” (Lewis & Short), built on *quaerere* “to seek”.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: enquêter*
- *Say it: enquêter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *enquêter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to punish, then the French for the investigation, then say *enquêter* again

Before you move on

What does enquêter mean? ("To investigate".) Say it once more.

389.3 le témoin — the witness

Before the new one: say the French for the investigation, then the French for to investigate.

You'll want to know: le témoin

le témoin — "the witness".

Un témoin a tout vu depuis sa fenêtre.

A witness saw everything from his window.

At a wedding, *le témoin* is the best man or a witness.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

témoin comes from Old French *tesmoing* (EtymDB), from Latin *testimōnium* "evidence, testimony", built on *testis* "witness" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le témoin*
- *Say it: le témoin*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le témoin*
- *Recall:* say the French for the investigation, then the French for to investigate, then say *le témoin* again

Before you move on

What does le témoin mean? ("The witness".) Say it once more.

389.4 témoigner — to testify, to give evidence

Before the new one: say the French for to investigate, then the French for the witness.

You'll want to know: témoigner

témoigner — "to testify, to give evidence".

Elle a accepté de témoigner au procès.

She agreed to testify at the trial.

Témoigner de — to show, to bear witness to.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

témoigner comes from Old French *tesmoignier* (EtymDB), formed on *tesmoing* "witness", from Latin *testimōnium* "testimony", built on *testis* "witness" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: témoigner*
- *Say it: témoigner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *témoigner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to investigate, then the French for the witness, then say *témoigner* again

Before you move on

What does témoigner mean? ("To testify, to give evidence".) Say it once more.

389.5 la victime — the victim

Before the new one: say the French for the witness, then the French for to testify.

You'll want to know: la victime

la victime — "the victim".

La victime est encore à l'hôpital.

The victim is still in hospital.

Always feminine in grammar, even for a man: *il est la victime.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

victime is a learned borrowing from Latin *victima* "an animal offered in sacrifice" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la victime*
- *Say it: la victime*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la victime*
- *Recall:* say the French for the witness, then the French for to testify, then say *la victime* again

Before you move on

What does la victime mean? (“The victim”.) Say it once more.

389.6 Retour sur les chapitres 382–389

Say the French for to break and the offence.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to break, the offence, to transgress, the penalty, to penalise
- the requirement, the criterion, eligible, the admission, to exclude
- to expire, acceptable, valid, to renew, the renewal
- the bureaucracy, the step, the procedure, the certificate, the official statement
- to accuse, the accusation, the thief, the complaint, the misdemeanour
- the trial, the defence, the verdict, guilty, innocent
- the sentence, to sentence, the conviction, the prisoner, to punish
- the investigation, to investigate, the witness, to testify, the victim

Before you move on

To break? (**enfreindre**.) The offence? (**l'infraction**.) To transgress? (**transgresser**.) The penalty? (**la sanction**.) To penalise? (**sanctionner**.) The requirement? (**l'exigence**.) The criterion? (**le critère**.) Eligible? (**éligible**.) The admission? (**l'admission**.) To exclude? (**exclure**.) To expire? (**expirer**.) Acceptable? (**valable**.) Valid? (**valide**.) To renew? (**renouveler**.) The renewal? (**le renouvellement**.) The bureaucracy? (**la bureaucratie**.) The step? (**la démarche**.) The procedure? (**la procédure**.) The certificate? (**le certificat**.) The official statement? (**l'attestation**.) To accuse? (**accuser**.) The accusation? (**l'accusation**.) The thief? (**le voleur**.) The complaint? (**la plainte**.) The misdemeanour? (**le délit**.) The trial? (**le procès**.) The defence? (**la défense**.) The verdict? (**le verdict**.) Guilty? (**coupable**.) Innocent? (**innocent**.) The sentence? (**la peine**.) To sentence? (**condamner**.) The conviction? (**la condamnation**.) The prisoner? (**le détenu**.) To punish? (**punir**.) The investigation? (**l'enquête**.) To investigate? (**enquêter**.) The witness? (**le témoin**.) To testify? (**témoigner**.) The victim? (**la victime**.)

Chapter 390

Les comptes de la maison

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about household money: the budget, income, a subscription, spending and a membership fee.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 390: I can talk about household money: the budget, income, a subscription, spending and a membership fee.*

390.1 le budget — the budget

> Before the new one: say the French for to testify, then the French for the victim.

You'll want to know: le budget

le budget — "the budget".

> Notre budget pour les vacances est de mille euros.
>
> *Our holiday budget is a thousand euros.*

The final *t* is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

budget was borrowed from English *budget* (EtymDB), which came from Old French *bougette* "a little leather bag", a small form of *bouge* "bag". *bouge* goes back to Late Latin *bulga* "a leather bag", a Gaulish word

(EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le budget*
- *Say it: le budget*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le budget*
- *Recall:* say the French for to testify, then the French for the victim, then say *le budget* again

Before you move on

What does le budget mean? ("The budget".) Say it once more.

390.2 le revenu — the income

Before the new one: say the French for the victim, then the French for the budget.

You'll want to know: le revenu

le revenu — "the income".

Leur revenu a baissé cette année.

Their income went down this year.

Often plural: *les revenus*. From *revenir*: what comes back to you.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

revenu is the past participle of *revenir* "to come back" used as a noun: what comes back to you. *revenir* comes from Latin *revenīre*, built on *venīre* "to come" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le revenu*
- *Say it: le revenu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le revenu*
- *Recall:* say the French for the victim, then the French for the budget, then say *le revenu* again

Before you move on

What does le revenu mean? ("The income".) Say it once more.

390.3 l'abonnement — the subscription; the season ticket

Before the new one: say the French for the budget, then the French for the income.

You'll want to know: l'abonnement

l'abonnement — "the subscription; the season ticket".

J'ai un abonnement de bus pour l'année.

I have a bus pass for the year.

S'abonner à — to subscribe to. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

abonnement is built on *abonner* "to subscribe" (EtymDB), usually traced to Old French *bonne* "a boundary, a limit"; first, fixing a set sum in advance.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'abonnement*
- *Say it: l'abonnement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'abonnement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the budget, then the French for the income, then say *l'abonnement* again

Before you move on

What does l'abonnement mean? ("The subscription; the season ticket".) Say it once more.

390.4 la dépense — the expense, the spending

Before the new one: say the French for the income, then the French for the subscription.

You'll want to know: la dépense

la dépense — "the expense, the spending".

Le loyer est notre plus grosse dépense.

Rent is our biggest expense.

From *dépenser*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépense comes through Middle French *despense* (EtymDB) from Late Latin *dispēnsa*, from *dispendere* "to weigh out, to pay out", built on *pendere* "to weigh" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dépense*
- *Say it: la dépense*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la dépense*
- *Recall:* say the French for the income, then the French for the subscription, then say *la dépense* again

Before you move on

What does la dépense mean? ("The expense, the spending".) Say it once more.

390.5 la cotisation — the contribution, the membership fee

Before the new one: say the French for the subscription, then the French for the expense.

You'll want to know: la cotisation

la cotisation — "the contribution, the membership fee".

La cotisation au club de tennis est de cent euros.

The tennis club fee is a hundred euros.

On a payslip, *les cotisations* are social security contributions.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cotisation is built on *cotiser* "to pay one's share" (EtymDB), from *cote* "a share", from Medieval Latin *quota* "how great a part", from *quotus* "how many" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cotisation*
- *Say it: la cotisation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la cotisation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the subscription, then the French for the expense, then say *la cotisation* again

Before you move on

What does la cotisation mean? ("The contribution, the membership fee".) Say it once more.

Chapter 391

Mettre de côté

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about saving and investing: savings, saving money, investing, an investment and the interest rate.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 391: I can talk about saving and investing: savings, saving money, investing, an investment and the interest rate.*

391.1 l'épargne — the savings, saving

> Before the new one: say the French for the expense, then the French for the contribution.

You'll want to know: l'épargne

l'épargne — "the savings, saving".

> Ils ont mis leur épargne sur un compte à la banque.
>
> *They put their savings in a bank account.*

Feminine. Formal; in speech, *les économies*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épargne is formed from *épargner*, inherited through Old French *espargnier* from a Frankish *sparanjan* "to spare" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'épargne*
- *Say it: l'épargne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'épargne*
- *Recall:* say the French for the expense, then the French for the contribution, then say *l'épargne* again

Before you move on

What does l'épargne mean? ("The savings, saving".) Say it once more.

391.2 épargner — to save up (money); to spare

Before the new one: say the French for the contribution, then the French for the savings.

You'll want to know: épargner

épargner — "to save up (money); to spare".

Elle épargne un peu chaque mois.

She saves a little every month.

Also to spare someone: *épargner quelqu'un.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épargner is inherited from Old French *espargnier* (EtymDB), from a Frankish *sparanjan* "to spare".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *épargner*
- *Say it:* *épargner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *épargner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the contribution, then the French for the savings, then say *épargner* again

Before you move on

What does épargner mean? ("To save up (money); to spare".) Say it once more.

391.3 investir — to invest

Before the new one: say the French for the savings, then the French for to save up.

You'll want to know: investir

investir — "to invest".

Il a investi son argent dans un appartement.

He invested his money in a flat.

A *-ir* verb like *finir*: *nous investissons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

investir is a learned borrowing from Latin *investīre* "to clothe, to cover" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *vestis* "clothing"; the money sense came later, probably through Italian.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: investir*
- *Say it: investir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *investir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the savings, then the French for to save up, then say *investir* again

Before you move on

What does investir mean? ("To invest".) Say it once more.

391.4 l'investissement — the investment

Before the new one: say the French for to save up, then the French for to invest.

You'll want to know: l'investissement

l'investissement — "the investment".

Une bonne formation est un bon investissement.

Good training is a good investment.

Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

investissement is built from *investir* and *-ment*. *investir* comes from Latin *investīre* "to clothe", built on *vestis* "clothing" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'investissement*
- *Say it: l'investissement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'investissement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to save up, then the French for to invest, then say *l'investissement* again

Before you move on

What does l'investissement mean? ("The investment".) Say it once more.

391.5 le taux — the rate

Before the new one: say the French for to invest, then the French for the investment.

You'll want to know: le taux

le taux — "the rate".

Le taux d'intérêt est de trois pour cent.

The interest rate is three per cent.

The same form in the plural. *Le taux de chômage* — the unemployment rate.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

taux comes from Old French *tauxer* "to fix a price" (EtymDB), from Latin *taxāre* "to appraise, to value" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le taux*
- *Say it:* *le taux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le taux*
- *Recall:* say the French for to invest, then the French for the investment, then say *le taux* again

Before you move on

What does le taux mean? (“The rate”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 392

À la banque

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can handle money at the bank: cash, a cheque, a chequebook, a transfer and taking money out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 392: I can handle money at the bank: cash, a cheque, a chequebook, a transfer and taking money out.*

392.1 les espèces — the cash

> Before the new one: say the French for the investment, then the French for the rate.

You'll want to know: les espèces

les espèces — "the cash".

> Ce petit café n'accepte que les espèces.
>
> *This small café only takes cash.*

Payer en espèces — to pay cash. Québec: *payer comptant*. In the singular, *une espèce* is a species or a kind.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

espèces is the plural of *espèce* "kind", from Latin *speciēs* "appearance, kind" (Lewis & Short), from *specere* "to look": money in a visible form.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les espèces*
- *Say it: les espèces*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les espèces*
- *Recall:* say the French for the investment, then the French for the rate, then say *les espèces* again

Before you move on

What does les espèces mean? ("The cash".) Say it once more.

392.2 le chèque — the cheque

Before the new one: say the French for the rate, then the French for the cash.

You'll want to know: le chèque

le chèque — "the cheque".

Elle a payé le plombier par chèque.

She paid the plumber by cheque.

Un chèque sans provision — a bounced cheque.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chèque is usually traced to English *cheque*, *check*, itself linked to *check* "a control": a paper that guards against forgery.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chèque*
- *Say it: le chèque*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chèque*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rate, then the French for the cash, then say *le chèque* again

Before you move on

What does le chèque mean? ("The cheque".) Say it once more.

392.3 le chéquier — the chequebook

Before the new one: say the French for the cash, then the French for the cheque.

You'll want to know: le chéquier

le chéquier — "the chequebook".

La banque m'a envoyé un nouveau chéquier.

The bank sent me a new chequebook.

From *chèque*. Fewer and fewer people use one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chéquier is built from *chèque* and the suffix *-ier*. *chèque* is usually traced to English *cheque*, *check*, linked to *check* "a control".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chéquier*
- *Say it: le chéquier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chéquier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cash, then the French for the cheque, then say *le chéquier* again

Before you move on

What does le chéquier mean? ("The chequebook".) Say it once more.

392.4 le virement — the bank transfer

Before the new one: say the French for the cheque, then the French for the chequebook.

You'll want to know: le virement

le virement — "the bank transfer".

J'ai fait un virement pour payer le loyer.

I made a transfer to pay the rent.

Un virement bancaire — a bank transfer.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

virement is built from *virer* "to turn, to transfer" and *-ment* (EtymDB). The origin of *virer* is usually traced to a Latin form linked to *vibrāre* "to shake"; it is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le virement*
- *Say it: le virement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le virement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cheque, then the French for the chequebook, then say *le virement* again

Before you move on

What does le virement mean? ("The bank transfer".) Say it once more.

392.5 retirer — to take out, to withdraw

Before the new one: say the French for the chequebook, then the French for the bank transfer.

You'll want to know: retirer

retirer — "to take out, to withdraw".

J'ai retiré cinquante euros au distributeur.

I took fifty euros out of the cash machine.

Also to take off: *retirer son manteau.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retirer is built from *re-* "back" and *tirer* "to pull" (EtymDB). The origin of *tirer* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: retirer*
- *Say it: retirer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *retirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the chequebook, then the French for the bank transfer, then say *retirer* again

Before you move on

What does retirer mean? (“To take out, to withdraw”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 393

Garanties et devis

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can deal with what I buy: a guarantee, guaranteeing something, a quote, and whether it pays or is good value.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 393: I can deal with what I buy: a guarantee, guaranteeing something, a quote, and whether it pays or is good value.*

393.1 la garantie — the guarantee, the warranty

> Before the new one: say the French for the bank transfer, then the French for to take out.

You'll want to know: la garantie

la garantie — "the guarantee, the warranty".

> Le frigo est encore sous garantie.
>
> *The fridge is still under warranty.*

Sous garantie — under warranty.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

garantie is formed on *garantir* (EtymDB), from Old French *garant* "protector, warrant", usually traced to a Frankish word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la garantie*
- *Say it: la garantie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la garantie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bank transfer, then the French for to take out, then say *la garantie* again

Before you move on

What does la garantie mean? ("The guarantee, the warranty".) Say it once more.

393.2 garantir — to guarantee

Before the new one: say the French for to take out, then the French for the guarantee.

You'll want to know: garantir

garantir — "to guarantee".

Le vendeur garantit la réparation pendant un an.

The seller guarantees the repair for a year.

A *-ir* verb like *finir*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

garantir is inherited from Old French *garantir* "to protect, to vouch for" (EtymDB), from *garant* "protector", usually traced to a Frankish word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: garantir*
- *Say it: garantir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *garantir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to take out, then the French for the guarantee, then say *garantir* again

Before you move on

What does garantir mean? ("To guarantee".) Say it once more.

393.3 le devis — the quote, the estimate

Before the new one: say the French for the guarantee, then the French for to guarantee.

You'll want to know: le devis

le devis — "the quote, the estimate".

Le plombier m'a envoyé un devis.

The plumber sent me a quote.

The *s* is silent. *Demander un devis* — to ask for a quote.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

devis is formed on *deviser* "to divide, to arrange" (EtymDB), from a Vulgar Latin form of *dīvidere* "to divide" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le devis*
- *Say it: le devis*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le devis*
- *Recall:* say the French for the guarantee, then the French for to guarantee, then say *le devis* again

Before you move on

What does le devis mean? ("The quote, the estimate".) Say it once more.

393.4 rentable — profitable, worth it

Before the new one: say the French for to guarantee, then the French for the quote.

You'll want to know: rentable

rentable — "profitable, worth it".

Ce magasin n'est plus rentable.

This shop is no longer profitable.

From *rente*, income.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rentable is built from *rente* "income" and *-able*. *rente* comes from a Vulgar Latin *rendita*, from the verb behind *rendre* "to give back", Latin *reddere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rentable*
- *Say it: rentable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rentable*
- *Recall:* say the French for to guarantee, then the French for the quote, then say *rentable* again

Before you move on

What does rentable mean? (“Profitable, worth it”.) Say it once more.

393.5 avantageux — good value, favourable

Before the new one: say the French for the quote, then the French for profitable.

You’ll want to know: avantageux

avantageux — “good value, favourable”.

Cet abonnement est très avantageux.

This subscription is very good value.

Feminine *avantageuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avantageux is inherited from Old French *avantageus* (EtymDB), built on *avantage* “advantage”, from *avant* “ahead”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *avantageux*
- *Say it:* *avantageux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *avantageux*
- *Recall:* say the French for the quote, then the French for profitable, then say *avantageux* again

Before you move on

What does avantageux mean? (“Good value, favourable”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 394

Gagner et perdre

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about business money: profit, a loss, going bankrupt, paying back and a loan.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 394: I can talk about business money: profit, a loss, going bankrupt, paying back and a loan.*

394.1 le bénéfice — the profit; the benefit

> Before the new one: say the French for profitable, then the French for good value.

You'll want to know: le bénéfice

le bénéfice — "the profit; the benefit".

> L'entreprise a fait un bénéfice cette année.
>
> *The company made a profit this year.*

Au bénéfice de — for the benefit of.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bénéfice is a learned borrowing from Latin *beneficium* "a kindness, a favour" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built from *bene* "well" and *facere* "to do".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bénéfice*
- *Say it: le bénéfice*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bénéfice*
- *Recall:* say the French for profitable, then the French for good value, then say *le bénéfice* again

Before you move on

What does le bénéfice mean? ("The profit; the benefit".) Say it once more.

394.2 la perte — the loss

Before the new one: say the French for good value, then the French for the profit.

You'll want to know: la perte

la perte — "the loss".

Ce voyage est une perte de temps.

This trip is a waste of time.

Une perte de temps — a waste of time.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

perte is inherited from Vulgar Latin *perdita* "a thing lost" (EtymDB), from *perdere* "to lose" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la perte*
- *Say it: la perte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la perte*
- *Recall:* say the French for good value, then the French for the profit, then say *la perte* again

Before you move on

What does la perte mean? ("The loss".) Say it once more.

394.3 la faillite — the bankruptcy

Before the new one: say the French for the profit, then the French for the loss.

You'll want to know: la faillite

la faillite — "the bankruptcy".

Le restaurant a fait faillite après deux ans.

The restaurant went bankrupt after two years.

Faire faillite — to go bankrupt.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faillite was borrowed from Italian *fallita* "failure" (EtymDB), from Latin *fallere* "to deceive, to fail" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la faillite*
- *Say it: la faillite*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la faillite*
- *Recall:* say the French for the profit, then the French for the loss, then say *la faillite* again

Before you move on

What does la faillite mean? ("The bankruptcy".) Say it once more.

394.4 rembourser — to pay back, to refund

Before the new one: say the French for the loss, then the French for the bankruptcy.

You'll want to know: rembourser

rembourser — "to pay back, to refund".

Je te rembourse demain, promis.

I will pay you back tomorrow, I promise.

Se faire rembourser — to get a refund.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rembourser is built from *re-*, *en-* and *bourse* "purse": to put back into the purse. *bourse* comes from Late Latin *bursa* "a hide, a leather bag" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rembourser*
- *Say it: rembourser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rembourser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the loss, then the French for the bankruptcy, then say *rembourser* again

Before you move on

What does rembourser mean? ("To pay back, to refund".) Say it once more.

394.5 l'emprunt — the loan (that you take out)

Before the new one: say the French for the bankruptcy, then the French for to pay back.

You'll want to know: l'emprunt

l'emprunt — "the loan (that you take out)".

Ils ont fait un emprunt pour acheter la maison.

They took out a loan to buy the house.

From *emprunter*, to borrow. Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

emprunt is formed on *emprunter* "to borrow", usually traced to a Vulgar Latin *imprūmūtāre*, built on Latin *mūtuum* "a loan" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'emprunt*
- *Say it: l'emprunt*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'emprunt*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bankruptcy, then the French for to pay back, then say *l'emprunt* again

Before you move on

What does l'emprunt mean? ("The loan (that you take out)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 395

Mon compte en ligne

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can manage an online account: the user, the password, the username, logging in and getting access.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 395: I can manage an online account: the user, the password, the username, logging in and getting access.*

395.1 l'utilisateur — the user

> Before the new one: say the French for to pay back, then the French for the loan.

You'll want to know: l'utilisateur

l'utilisateur — "the user".

> Chaque utilisateur a son propre profil.
>
> *Each user has their own profile.*

Feminine *utilisatrice*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

utilisateur is built on *utiliser* "to use", from *utile* "useful", which comes from Latin *ūtilis* "useful", from *ūtī* "to use" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'utilisateur*
- *Say it: l'utilisateur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'utilisateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pay back, then the French for the loan, then say *l'utilisateur* again

Before you move on

What does l'utilisateur mean? ("The user".) Say it once more.

395.2 le mot de passe — the password

Before the new one: say the French for the loan, then the French for the user.

You'll want to know: le mot de passe

le mot de passe — "the password".

J'ai encore oublié mon mot de passe.

I forgot my password again.

The plural is *les mots de passe*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mot de passe is a word that lets you pass. *mot* comes from Late Latin *muttum* "a mutter, a grunt" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), and *passer* from Vulgar Latin *passāre*, built on *passus* "a step" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mot de passe*
- *Say it: le mot de passe*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le mot de passe*
- *Recall:* say the French for the loan, then the French for the user, then say *le mot de passe* again

Before you move on

What does le mot de passe mean? ("The password".) Say it once more.

395.3 l'identifiant — the username, the login

Before the new one: say the French for the user, then the French for the password.

You'll want to know: l'identifiant

l'identifiant — "the username, the login".

Chaque employé a un identifiant et un mot de passe.

Each employee has a username and a password.

Masculine. From *identifier*, to identify.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

identifiant is the present participle of *identifier* used as a noun. The verb comes from Medieval Latin *identificāre*, built on Latin *īdem* "the same" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'identifiant*
- *Say it: l'identifiant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'identifiant*
- *Recall:* say the French for the user, then the French for the password, then say *l'identifiant* again

Before you move on

What does l'identifiant mean? ("The username, the login".) Say it once more.

395.4 connecter — to connect; to log in (reflexive, se connecter)

Before the new one: say the French for the password, then the French for the username.

You'll want to know: connecter

connecter — "to connect; to log in (reflexive, se connecter)".

Je me connecte à mon compte tous les matins.

I log in to my account every morning.

Se connecter — to log in; *se déconnecter* — to log out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

connecter is built on Latin *cōnectere* "to bind together" (Lewis & Short), from *nectere* "to tie", partly through English *connect*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: connecter*
- *Say it: connecter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *connecter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the password, then the French for the username, then say *connecter* again

Before you move on

What does connecter mean? ("To connect; to log in (reflexive, se connecter)".) Say it once more.

395.5 accéder — to access, to reach

Before the new one: say the French for the username, then the French for to connect.

You'll want to know: accéder

accéder — "to access, to reach".

Sans mot de passe, on ne peut pas accéder au site.

Without a password, you cannot get into the website.

Accéder à, with *à*. *J'accède.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accéder is a learned borrowing from Latin *accēdere* "to go toward, to approach" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *cēdere* "to go".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *accéder*
- *Say it:* *accéder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *accéder*
- *Recall:* say the French for the username, then the French for to connect, then say *accéder* again

Before you move on

What does accéder mean? (“To access, to reach”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 396

Installer un logiciel

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can install and remove software, talk about the device it runs on and about updates.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 396: I can install and remove software, talk about the device it runs on and about updates.*

396.1 installer — to install; to set up

Before the new one: say the French for to connect, then the French for to access.

You'll want to know: installer

installer — "to install; to set up".

> J'ai installé une nouvelle application sur mon téléphone.
>
> *I installed a new app on my phone.*

S'installer — to settle in, to move in.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

installer is usually traced to Medieval Latin *installāre* "to put into a stall, to install in office", built on a Germanic word for a stall; EtymDB lists relatives such as Old English *steall* "a standing place".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: installer*
- *Say it: installer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *installer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to connect, then the French for to access, then say *installer* again

Before you move on

What does installer mean? ("To install; to set up".) Say it once more.

396.2 désinstaller — to uninstall

Before the new one: say the French for to access, then the French for to install.

You'll want to know: désinstaller

désinstaller — "to uninstall".

J'ai désinstallé ce jeu : il prenait trop de place.

I uninstalled that game: it took up too much space.

Dés- + *installer*: the opposite.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désinstaller is built from *dés-* and *installer*, which is usually traced to Medieval Latin *installāre* "to put into a stall", built on a Germanic word for a stall.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: désinstaller*
- *Say it: désinstaller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *désinstaller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to access, then the French for to install, then say *désinstaller* again

Before you move on

What does désinstaller mean? ("To uninstall".) Say it once more.

396.3 l'appareil — the device, the appliance

Before the new one: say the French for to install, then the French for to uninstall.

You'll want to know: l'appareil

l'appareil — "the device, the appliance".

Cet appareil ne marche plus.

This device does not work any more.

Un appareil photo — a camera. On the phone, *qui est à l'appareil ?* — who is speaking? Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

appareil is formed on *appareiller* "to prepare, to fit out" (EtymDB), from a Vulgar Latin *appariculāre*, built on Latin *parāre* "to prepare" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'appareil*
- *Say it: l'appareil*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'appareil*
- *Recall:* say the French for to install, then the French for to uninstall, then say *l'appareil* again

Before you move on

What does l'appareil mean? ("The device, the appliance".) Say it once more.

396.4 le logiciel — the software, the program

Before the new one: say the French for to uninstall, then the French for the device.

You'll want to know: le logiciel

le logiciel — "the software, the program".

Ce logiciel est gratuit.

This software is free.

Québec also says *le programme*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

logiciel is usually described as a French coinage of the twentieth century from *logique* "logic" and *-iel*, made to replace English *software*. *logique* comes from Greek *logikḗ* "the art of reasoning".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le logiciel*
- *Say it: le logiciel*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le logiciel*
- *Recall:* say the French for to uninstall, then the French for the device, then say *le logiciel* again

Before you move on

What does le logiciel mean? ("The software, the program".) Say it once more.

396.5 la mise à jour — the update

Before the new one: say the French for the device, then the French for the software.

You'll want to know: la mise à jour

la mise à jour — "the update".

Mon téléphone fait une mise à jour cette nuit.

My phone is doing an update tonight.

Mettre à jour — to update. Plural *les mises à jour*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mise à jour is a putting up to date. *mise* is the participle of *mettre*, from Latin *mittere* "to send, to put", and *jour* is inherited from Latin *diurnum* "daily" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mise à jour*
- *Say it: la mise à jour*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la mise à jour*
- *Recall:* say the French for the device, then the French for the software, then say *la mise à jour* again

Before you move on

What does la mise à jour mean? ("The update".) Say it once more.

Chapter 397

Les fichiers

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can work with files: delete, copy and paste them, and save my work.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 397: I can work with files: delete, copy and paste them, and save my work.*

397.1 le fichier — the file (on a computer)

> Before the new one: say the French for the software, then the French for the update.

You'll want to know: le fichier

le fichier — "the file (on a computer)".

> Je t'ai envoyé le fichier par courriel.
>
> *I sent you the file by email.*

A paper file is *un dossier*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fichier is built on *fiche* "an index card", from *ficher* "to fasten, to fix in" (EtymDB), usually traced to a Vulgar Latin *fīgicāre*, from *fīgere* "to fix" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fichier*
- *Say it: le fichier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le fichier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the software, then the French for the update, then say *le fichier* again

Before you move on

What does le fichier mean? ("The file (on a computer)".) Say it once more.

397.2 supprimer — to delete; to remove

Before the new one: say the French for the update, then the French for the file.

You'll want to know: supprimer

supprimer — "to delete; to remove".

J'ai supprimé toutes les vieilles photos.

I deleted all the old photos.

Also to abolish: *supprimer une loi*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

supprimer is a learned borrowing from Latin *supprimere* "to press under, to hold back" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *premere* "to press".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: supprimer*
- *Say it: supprimer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *supprimer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the update, then the French for the file, then say *supprimer* again

Before you move on

What does supprimer mean? ("To delete; to remove".) Say it once more.

397.3 copier — to copy

Before the new one: say the French for the file, then the French for to delete.

You'll want to know: copier

copier — "to copy".

Il a copié le texte dans un nouveau document.

He copied the text into a new document.

At school, *copier* also means to cheat by copying.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

copier comes from Medieval Latin *copiāre* "to transcribe" (EtymDB), from *cōpia* "plenty, abundance" (Lewis & Short): to make more of a text.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: copier*
- *Say it: copier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *copier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the file, then the French for to delete, then say *copier* again

Before you move on

What does copier mean? ("To copy".) Say it once more.

397.4 coller — to paste; to stick

Before the new one: say the French for to delete, then the French for to copy.

You'll want to know: coller

coller — "to paste; to stick".

Elle a collé le texte dans son message.

She pasted the text into her message.

Copier-coller — copy and paste. Informal: *être collé à un examen* — to fail it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coller is built on *colle* "glue", which comes through Vulgar Latin from Greek *kólla* "glue" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: coller*
- *Say it: coller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *coller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to delete, then the French for to copy, then say *coller* again

Before you move on

What does coller mean? ("To paste; to stick".) Say it once more.

397.5 sauvegarder — to save (a file); to safeguard

Before the new one: say the French for to copy, then the French for to paste.

You'll want to know: sauvegarder

sauvegarder — "to save (a file); to safeguard".

Il a oublié de sauvegarder son travail.

He forgot to save his work.

Une sauvegarde — a backup.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sauvegarder is built from *sauve* "safe", from Latin *salvus* "safe" (Lewis & Short), and *garder* "to keep", usually traced to a Frankish word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sauvegarder*
- *Say it: sauvegarder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sauvegarder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to copy, then the French for to paste, then say *sauvegarder* again

Before you move on

What does sauvegarder mean? ("To save (a file); to safeguard".) Say it once more.

397.6 Retour sur les chapitres 390–397

Say the French for the budget and the income.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the budget, the income, the subscription, the expense, the contribution
- the savings, to save up, to invest, the investment, the rate
- the cash, the cheque, the chequebook, the bank transfer, to take out
- the guarantee, to guarantee, the quote, profitable, good value
- the profit, the loss, the bankruptcy, to pay back, the loan
- the user, the password, the username, to connect, to access
- to install, to uninstall, the device, the software, the update
- the file, to delete, to copy, to paste, to save

Before you move on

The budget? (**le budget**.) The income? (**le revenu**.) The subscription? (**l'abonnement**.) The expense? (**la dépense**.) The contribution? (**la cotisation**.) The savings? (**l'épargne**.) To save up? (**épargner**.) To invest? (**investir**.) The investment? (**l'investissement**.) The rate? (**le taux**.) The cash? (**les espèces**.) The cheque? (**le chèque**.) The chequebook? (**le chéquier**.) The bank transfer? (**le virement**.) To take out? (**retirer**.) The guarantee? (**la garantie**.) To guarantee? (**garantir**.) The quote? (**le devis**.) Profitable? (**rentable**.) Good value? (**avantageux**.) The profit? (**le bénéfice**.) The loss? (**la perte**.) The bankruptcy? (**la faillite**.) To pay back? (**rembourser**.) The loan? (**l'emprunt**.) The user? (**l'utilisateur**.) The password? (**le mot de passe**.) The username? (**l'identifiant**.) To connect? (**connecter**.) To access? (**accéder**.) To install? (**installer**.) To uninstall? (**désinstaller**.) The device? (**l'appareil**.) The software? (**le logiciel**.) The update? (**la mise à jour**.) The file? (**le fichier**.) To delete? (**supprimer**.) To copy? (**copier**.) To paste? (**coller**.) To save? (**sauvegarder**.)

Chapter 398

Sur internet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about being online: the network, the connection, browsing, a link and posting something.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 398: I can talk about being online: the network, the connection, browsing, a link and posting something.*

398.1 le réseau — the network

> Before the new one: say the French for to paste, then the French for to save.

You'll want to know: le réseau

le réseau — "the network".

> Il n'y a pas de réseau en montagne.
>
> *There is no signal in the mountains.*

Les réseaux sociaux — social media.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réseau is usually traced to Old French *reseuil*, a small form of *rets* "net" (EtymDB has *rets* from Old French *reiz*), which goes back to Latin *rēte* "a net" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le réseau*
- *Say it: le réseau*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le réseau*
- *Recall:* say the French for to paste, then the French for to save, then say *le réseau* again

Before you move on

What does le réseau mean? ("The network".) Say it once more.

398.2 la connexion — the connection

Before the new one: say the French for to save, then the French for the network.

You'll want to know: la connexion

la connexion — "the connection".

La connexion est très lente ce soir.

The connection is very slow tonight.

Spelled with *x*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

connexion is a learned borrowing from Latin *cōnexiō* "a joining, a connection" (EtymDB), from *cōnectere* "to bind together", built on *nectere* "to tie" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la connexion*
- *Say it: la connexion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la connexion*
- *Recall:* say the French for to save, then the French for the network, then say *la connexion* again

Before you move on

What does la connexion mean? ("The connection".) Say it once more.

398.3 naviguer — to browse; to sail

Before the new one: say the French for the network, then the French for the connection.

You'll want to know: naviguer

naviguer — "to browse; to sail".

Il navigue sur internet pendant des heures.

He browses the internet for hours.

First of ships: *naviguer sur la mer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

naviguer is a learned borrowing from Latin *nāvigāre* "to sail" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), built on *nāvis* "ship".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naviguer*
- *Say it:* *naviguer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *naviguer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the network, then the French for the connection, then say *naviguer* again

Before you move on

What does naviguer mean? (“To browse; to sail”.) Say it once more.

398.4 le lien — the link; the bond

Before the new one: say the French for the connection, then the French for to browse.

You’ll want to know: le lien

le lien — “the link; the bond”.

Je t’envoie le lien vers la vidéo.

I am sending you the link to the video.

Between people too: *un lien d’amitié*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lien is inherited from Latin *ligāmen* “a bond, a band” (EtymDB), from *ligāre* “to tie” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lien*
- *Say it: le lien*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le lien*
- *Recall:* say the French for the connection, then the French for to browse, then say *le lien* again

Before you move on

What does le lien mean? (“The link; the bond”.) Say it once more.

398.5 publier — to post, to publish

Before the new one: say the French for to browse, then the French for the link.

You’ll want to know: publier

publier — “to post, to publish”.

Elle a publié une photo de son chat.

She posted a photo of her cat.

Of books too: *publier un roman.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

publier is inherited from Latin *pūblicāre* “to make public” (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *pūblicus* “of the people”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: publier*
- *Say it: publier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *publier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to browse, then the French for the link, then say *publier* again

Before you move on

What does publier mean? (“To post, to publish”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 399

Ça ne marche pas

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what is wrong with a device: it has broken down, crashed or frozen, needs restarting or has a virus.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 399: I can say what is wrong with a device: it has broken down, crashed or frozen, needs restarting or has a virus.*

399.1 la panne — the breakdown, the failure

> Before the new one: say the French for the link, then the French for to post.

You'll want to know: la panne

la panne — "the breakdown, the failure".

> Ma voiture est en panne.
>
> *My car has broken down.*

Tomber en panne — to break down. *Une panne de courant* — a power cut.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

panne was first a sailing word, *mettre en panne*, for stopping a ship by turning its sails. The origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la panne*
- *Say it: la panne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la panne*
- *Recall:* say the French for the link, then the French for to post, then say *la panne* again

Before you move on

What does la panne mean? ("The breakdown, the failure".) Say it once more.

399.2 planter — to crash (of a computer, informal); to plant

Before the new one: say the French for to post, then the French for the breakdown.

You'll want to know: planter

planter — "to crash (of a computer, informal); to plant".

Mon ordinateur a planté pendant la réunion.

My computer crashed during the meeting.

Informal in this sense. First, to plant: *planter un arbre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

planter is inherited from Latin *plantāre* "to plant" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from *planta* "a sprout, a cutting".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: planter*
- *Say it: planter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *planter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to post, then the French for the breakdown, then say *planter* again

Before you move on

What does planter mean? ("To crash (of a computer, informal); to plant".) Say it once more.

399.3 bloquer — to block; to freeze (reflexive, se bloquer)

Before the new one: say the French for the breakdown, then the French for to crash.

You'll want to know: bloquer

bloquer — "to block; to freeze (reflexive, se bloquer)".

L'écran s'est bloqué : rien ne bouge.

The screen froze: nothing moves.

In Belgium, *bloquer* also means to cram for exams.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bloquer is built on *bloc* "a block", which came through Old French from Middle Dutch *blok* "a tree trunk, a log" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: bloquer*
- *Say it: bloquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bloquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the breakdown, then the French for to crash, then say *bloquer* again

Before you move on

What does bloquer mean? ("To block; to freeze (reflexive, se bloquer)".) Say it once more.

399.4 redémarrer — to restart, to reboot

Before the new one: say the French for to crash, then the French for to block.

You'll want to know: redémarrer

redémarrer — "to restart, to reboot".

Si ça ne marche pas, il faut redémarrer l'ordinateur.

If it does not work, you have to restart the computer.

Re- means again: to start again.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

redémarrer is built from *re-* and *démarrer* "to start", first a sailing word for casting off a moored boat, from *dé-* and *amarrer* "to moor", a word borrowed from Dutch (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: redémarrer*
- *Say it: redémarrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *redémarrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to crash, then the French for to block, then say *redémarrer* again

Before you move on

What does redémarrer mean? ("To restart, to reboot".) Say it once more.

399.5 le virus — the virus

Before the new one: say the French for to block, then the French for to restart.

You'll want to know: le virus

le virus — "the virus".

Si tu ouvres ce fichier, tu risques d'attraper un virus.

If you open that file, you risk getting a virus.

For computers and for illness. The *s* is said.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

virus was taken whole from Latin *vīrus* "slime, poison" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short); the computer sense came from English.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le virus*
- *Say it: le virus*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le virus*
- *Recall:* say the French for to block, then the French for to restart, then say *le virus* again

Before you move on

What does le virus mean? (“The virus”.) Say it once more.

399.6 Conditions et règles

Say the French for the network and the connection.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the network, the connection, to browse, the link, to post
- the breakdown, to crash, to block, to restart, the virus

Before you move on

The network? (**le réseau**.) The connection? (**la connexion**.) To browse? (**naviguer**.) The link? (**le lien**.) To post? (**publier**.) The breakdown? (**la panne**.) To crash? (**planter**.) To block? (**bloquer**.) To restart? (**redémarrer**.) The virus? (**le virus**.)

399.7 Ça ne marche pas — once more

Say the French for the breakdown and to crash.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the breakdown, to crash, to block, to restart, the virus

Before you move on

The breakdown? (**la panne**.) To crash? (**planter**.) To block? (**bloquer**.) To restart? (**redémarrer**.) The virus? (**le virus**.)

Chapter 400

Autour de la ville en voiture

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the big roads round a town: the ring road, the outskirts, the interchange, the slip road and turning off.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 400: I can talk about the big roads round a town: the ring road, the outskirts, the interchange, the slip road and turning off.*

400.1 le périphérique — the ring road (round a city)

> Before the new one: say the French for a team, then the French for a birthday.

You'll want to know: le périphérique

le périphérique — "the ring road (round a city)".

> Le soir, il y a beaucoup de voitures sur le périphérique.
>
> *In the evening there are a lot of cars on the ring road.*

In everyday speech people often say *le périph*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

périphérique is built on *périphérie* 'outer edge', a learned word that is usually traced through Late Latin *peripheria* to Greek *periphéreia* 'circumference', from *peri* 'around' and *phérein* 'to carry'. EtymDB has no reliable source line for it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le périphérique*
- *Say it: le périphérique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le périphérique*
- *Recall:* say the French for a team, then the French for a birthday, then say *le périphérique* again

Before you move on

What does le périphérique mean? ("The ring road (round a city)".) Say it once more.

400.2 la périphérie — the outskirts, the edge (of a town)

Before the new one: say the French for a birthday, then the French for the ring road.

You'll want to know: la périphérie

la périphérie — "the outskirts, the edge (of a town)".

Mes cousins habitent à la périphérie de la ville.

My cousins live on the outskirts of the town.

En périphérie — on the edge of town, away from the centre.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

périphérie is usually traced to Late Latin *peripheria*, a learned borrowing from Greek *periphéreia* 'circumference', built from *peri* 'around' and *phérein* 'to carry'. EtymDB does not list the word, so the line is hedged.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la périphérie*
- *Say it: la périphérie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la périphérie*
- *Recall:* say the French for a birthday, then the French for the ring road, then say *la périphérie* again

Before you move on

What does la périphérie mean? ("The outskirts, the edge (of a town)".) Say it once more.

400.3 l'échangeur — the interchange (between motorways)

Before the new one: say the French for the ring road, then the French for the outskirts.

You'll want to know: l'échangeur

l'échangeur — "the interchange (between motorways)".

Après l'échangeur, nous avons pris l'autoroute du sud.

After the interchange we took the southbound motorway.

A masculine noun: *un échangeur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échangeur is built on *échanger* 'to exchange' with the ending *-eur*. *Échanger* comes from Old French *eschangier*, which is inherited from Vulgar Latin *excambiāre* (EtymDB): the place where cars exchange one road for another.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'échangeur*
- *Say it: l'échangeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'échangeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the ring road, then the French for the outskirts, then say *l'échangeur* again

Before you move on

What does l'échangeur mean? ("The interchange (between motorways)".) Say it once more.

400.4 la bretelle — the slip road; the strap

Before the new one: say the French for the outskirts, then the French for the interchange.

You'll want to know: la bretelle

la bretelle — "the slip road; the strap".

Le camion a pris la bretelle pour quitter l'autoroute.

The lorry took the slip road to leave the motorway.

Les bretelles are also braces that hold up trousers.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bretelle was borrowed from Old High German *brittil* 'rein, strap' (EtymDB). A strap ties two things together, and so does a short road between two big ones.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bretelle*
- *Say it: la bretelle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bretelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for the outskirts, then the French for the interchange, then say *la bretelle* again

Before you move on

What does la bretelle mean? ("The slip road; the strap".) Say it once more.

400.5 bifurquer — to turn off, to fork

Before the new one: say the French for the interchange, then the French for the slip road.

You'll want to know: bifurquer

bifurquer — "to turn off, to fork".

Au village, la route bifurque vers la montagne.

At the village the road forks towards the mountains.

La bifurcation — the fork in the road.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bifurquer is a learned formation on Latin *bifurcus* 'with two prongs', from *bi-* 'two' and *furca* 'fork' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bifurquer*
- *Say it:* *bifurquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bifurquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the interchange, then the French for the slip road, then say *bifurquer* again

Before you move on

What does bifurquer mean? ("To turn off, to fork".) Say it once more.

Chapter 401

Au volant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe how someone drives: speeding up, turning the wheel, skidding, stalling and the pedals.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 401: I can describe how someone drives: speeding up, turning the wheel, skidding, stalling and the pedals.*

401.1 accélérer — to speed up, to accelerate

> Before the new one: say the French for the slip road, then the French for to turn off.

You'll want to know: accélérer

accélérer — "to speed up, to accelerate".

> Sur l'autoroute, mon père accélère un peu trop.
>
> *On the motorway my father speeds up a little too much.*

L'accélérateur is the accelerator pedal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accélérer is a learned borrowing from Latin *accelerāre* 'to hasten', built on *celer* 'swift' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: accélérer*
- *Say it: accélérer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *accélérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the slip road, then the French for to turn off, then say *accélérer* again

Before you move on

What does accélérer mean? ("To speed up, to accelerate".) Say it once more.

401.2 braquer — to turn the wheel (hard); to aim

Before the new one: say the French for to turn off, then the French for to speed up.

You'll want to know: braquer

braquer — "to turn the wheel (hard); to aim".

Elle a braqué à gauche pour éviter le chat.

She turned the wheel hard to the left to avoid the cat.

Braquer une banque is slang for to hold up a bank.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *braquer* is not fully settled. It is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin verb built on Latin *bracchium* 'arm' (Lewis & Short): first to point or turn something with the arm.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *braquer*
- *Say it:* *braquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *braquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to turn off, then the French for to speed up, then say *braquer* again

Before you move on

What does braquer mean? ("To turn the wheel (hard); to aim".) Say it once more.

401.3 déraper — to skid

Before the new one: say the French for to speed up, then the French for to turn the wheel.

You'll want to know: déraper

déraper — "to skid".

Avec la pluie, la voiture a dérapé dans la descente.

Because of the rain the car skidded on the way down.

Also figurative: *la conversation a dérapé* — the talk got out of hand.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déraper is usually traced to Provençal *derapar*, first said of an anchor pulled loose from the sea bed, built on a Germanic verb for seizing. EtymDB links it with Germanic cousins such as Old Norse *hreppa* 'to grasp' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: déraper*
- *Say it: déraper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déraper*
- *Recall:* say the French for to speed up, then the French for to turn the wheel, then say *déraper* again

Before you move on

What does déraper mean? ("To skid".) Say it once more.

401.4 caler — to stall (an engine); to wedge

Before the new one: say the French for to turn the wheel, then the French for to skid.

You'll want to know: caler

caler — "to stall (an engine); to wedge".

Au feu rouge, j'ai calé deux fois.

At the red light I stalled twice.

Je cale also means I give up, I cannot eat any more.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caler in the sense 'to stall' was borrowed from Provençal *calar* 'to lower a sail', which goes back to Greek *khalân* 'to slacken' (EtymDB). A boat that lowers its sail stops, and so does an engine.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: caler*
- *Say it: caler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *caler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to turn the wheel, then the French for to skid, then say *caler* again

Before you move on

What does caler mean? (“To stall (an engine); to wedge”.) Say it once more.

401.5 la pédale — the pedal

Before the new one: say the French for to skid, then the French for to stall.

You’ll want to know: la pédale

la pédale — “the pedal”.

Le pied droit reste près de la pédale.

The right foot stays near the pedal.

Pédaler — to pedal, on a bike.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pédale was borrowed from Italian *pedale*, which is inherited from Latin *pedālis* ’of the foot’, from *pēs* ’foot’ (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la pédale*
- *Say it:* *la pédale*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la pédale*
- *Recall:* say the French for to skid, then the French for to stall, then say *la pédale* again

Before you move on

What does la pédale mean? (“The pedal”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 402

Bien voir la route

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about seeing clearly from a car: the windscreen, the rear-view mirror, the horn, honking and windows that mist up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 402: I can talk about seeing clearly from a car: the windscreen, the rear-view mirror, the horn, honking and windows that mist up.*

402.1 le pare-brise — the windscreen

> Before the new one: say the French for to stall, then the French for the pedal.

You'll want to know: le pare-brise

le pare-brise — "the windscreen".

> Un caillou a cassé le pare-brise.
>
> *A stone broke the windscreen.*

The plural does not change: *des pare-brise*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pare-brise is built from *parer* 'to ward off' and *brise* 'breeze' (EtymDB): the glass that keeps the wind out. *Parer* goes back to

Latin *parāre* 'to prepare' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pare-brise*
- *Say it: le pare-brise*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pare-brise*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stall, then the French for the pedal, then say *le pare-brise* again

Before you move on

What does le pare-brise mean? ("The windscreen".) Say it once more.

402.2 le rétroviseur — the rear-view mirror; the wing mirror

Before the new one: say the French for the pedal, then the French for the windscreen.

You'll want to know: le rétroviseur

le rétroviseur — "the rear-view mirror; the wing mirror".

Avant de tourner, il regarde dans le rétroviseur.

Before turning, he checks the mirror.

In speech, often *le rétro*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rétroviseur is built from *rétro-*, from Latin *retrō* 'backwards', and *viseur* 'sight', from *viser* 'to aim', which goes back to Latin *vidēre* 'to see' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rétroviseur*
- *Say it: le rétroviseur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le rétroviseur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pedal, then the French for the windscreen, then say *le rétroviseur* again

Before you move on

What does le rétroviseur mean? ("The rear-view mirror; the wing mirror".) Say it once more.

402.3 le klaxon — the horn (of a car)

Before the new one: say the French for the windscreen, then the French for the rear-view mirror.

You'll want to know: le klaxon

le klaxon — "the horn (of a car)".

Dans les rues étroites, on entend souvent le klaxon des taxis.

In the narrow streets you often hear the taxis' horns.

First a trade name; now an ordinary noun.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

klaxon was borrowed from English *klaxon* (EtymDB), first the trade name of an electric car horn.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le klaxon*
- *Say it: le klaxon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le klaxon*
- *Recall:* say the French for the windscreen, then the French for the rear-view mirror, then say *le klaxon* again

Before you move on

What does le klaxon mean? ("The horn (of a car)".) Say it once more.

402.4 klaxonner — to honk, to sound the horn

Before the new one: say the French for the rear-view mirror, then the French for the horn.

You'll want to know: klaxonner

klaxonner — "to honk, to sound the horn".

Le chauffeur a klaxonné devant la maison.

The driver honked outside the house.

Regular *-er* verb: *je klaxonne*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

klaxonner is built on *klaxon* 'car horn' (EtymDB), which was borrowed from English *klaxon*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: klaxonner*
- *Say it: klaxonner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *klaxonner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rear-view mirror, then the French for the horn, then say *klaxonner* again

Before you move on

What does klaxonner mean? ("To honk, to sound the horn".) Say it once more.

402.5 embuer — to mist up (mostly reflexive: s'embuer)

Before the new one: say the French for the horn, then the French for to honk.

You'll want to know: embuer

embuer — "to mist up (mostly reflexive: s'embuer)".

Quand il fait froid, les vitres s'embuent.

When it is cold, the windows mist up.

Mostly reflexive: *les vitres s'embuent. Embué* — misty.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

embuer is built on *buée* 'mist, condensation'. *Buée* is usually traced to an old verb *buer* 'to do the washing', of Germanic origin: the steam that rose from the washing tubs. EtymDB does not list the word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: embuer*
- *Say it: embuer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *embuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the horn, then the French for to honk, then say *embuer* again

Before you move on

What does embuer mean? ("To mist up (mostly reflexive: s'embuer)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 403

À la pompe

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can fill up a car: the pump, diesel, fuel, the tank and starting off again.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 403: I can fill up a car: the pump, diesel, fuel, the tank and starting off again.*

403.1 la pompe — the pump

> Before the new one: say the French for to honk, then the French for to mist up.

You'll want to know: la pompe

la pompe — "the pump".

> La pompe numéro trois ne marche pas.
>
> *Pump number three is not working.*

La pompe à essence is the petrol pump; *une pompe à vélo* is a bicycle pump.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *pompe* is not settled. It is usually linked to Middle Low German *pumpe* 'pump' (EtymDB) and may imitate the sound of the pump.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pompe*
- *Say it: la pompe*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la pompe*
- *Recall:* say the French for to honk, then the French for to mist up, then say *la pompe* again

Before you move on

What does la pompe mean? ("The pump".) Say it once more.

403.2 le gazole — the diesel (fuel)

Before the new one: say the French for to mist up, then the French for the pump.

You'll want to know: le gazole

le gazole — "the diesel (fuel)".

Ma voiture roule au gazole.

My car runs on diesel.

Also spelled *le gasoil*; many people say *le diesel*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gazole is usually explained as a French spelling of English *gas oil*; EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gazole*
- *Say it: le gazole*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le gazole*
- *Recall:* say the French for to mist up, then the French for the pump, then say *le gazole* again

Before you move on

What does le gazole mean? ("The diesel (fuel)".) Say it once more.

403.3 le carburant — the fuel

Before the new one: say the French for the pump, then the French for the diesel.

You'll want to know: le carburant

le carburant — "the fuel".

Le prix du carburant augmente encore.

The price of fuel is going up again.

The general word: petrol and diesel are both *carburant*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carburant is built on *carburer* 'to mix fuel with air', from *carbure* 'carbide', a learned formation on Latin *carbō* 'charcoal' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le carburant*
- *Say it: le carburant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le carburant*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pump, then the French for the diesel, then say *le carburant* again

Before you move on

What does le carburant mean? ("The fuel".) Say it once more.

403.4 le réservoir — the tank (for fuel); the reservoir

Before the new one: say the French for the diesel, then the French for the fuel.

You'll want to know: le réservoir

le réservoir — "the tank (for fuel); the reservoir".

Le réservoir est presque vide.

The tank is almost empty.

Faire le plein — to fill the tank.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réservoir is built on *réserver* 'to keep aside', a learned borrowing from Latin *reservāre*, from *servāre* 'to keep safe' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le réservoir*
- *Say it: le réservoir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le réservoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the diesel, then the French for the fuel, then say *le réservoir* again

Before you move on

What does le réservoir mean? ("The tank (for fuel); the reservoir".) Say it once more.

403.5 démarrer — to start up (a car, an engine); to get going

Before the new one: say the French for the fuel, then the French for the tank.

You'll want to know: démarrer

démarrer — "to start up (a car, an engine); to get going".

Ce matin, la vieille voiture ne démarre pas.

This morning the old car will not start.

Also for projects: *le travail démarre lundi.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

démarrer is built from *dé-* and *amarrer* 'to moor', which is usually traced to Middle Dutch *aenmarren* 'to tie up': to start was first to untie a boat. EtymDB lists the verb without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *démarrer*
- *Say it:* *démarrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *démarrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fuel, then the French for the tank, then say *démarrer* again

Before you move on

What does démarrer mean? ("To start up (a car, an engine); to get going".) Say it once more.

Chapter 404

Un pneu à plat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can deal with a flat tyre: the puncture, getting one, the tyre, the jack and pumping it up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 404: I can deal with a flat tyre: the puncture, getting one, the tyre, the jack and pumping it up.*

404.1 la crevaison — the puncture, the flat tyre

Before the new one: say the French for the tank, then the French for to start up.

You'll want to know: la crevaison

la crevaison — "the puncture, the flat tyre".

> Nous avons eu une crevaison sur la petite route.
>
> *We had a puncture on the little road.*

Réparer une crevaison — to mend a puncture.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crevaison is built on *crever* 'to burst' with the ending *-aison* (EtymDB). *Crever* is inherited from Latin *crepāre* 'to crack, to burst'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la crevaison*
- *Say it: la crevaison*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la crevaison*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tank, then the French for to start up, then say *la crevaison* again

Before you move on

What does la crevaison mean? ("The puncture, the flat tyre".) Say it once more.

404.2 crever — to get a flat tyre; to burst

Before the new one: say the French for to start up, then the French for the puncture.

You'll want to know: crever

crever — "to get a flat tyre; to burst".

J'ai crevé à dix kilomètres de la maison.

I got a flat tyre ten kilometres from home.

Informal: *je suis crevé* — I am worn out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crever is inherited through Old French *crever* from Latin *crepāre* 'to crack, to burst' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *crever*
- *Say it:* *crever*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *crever*
- *Recall:* say the French for to start up, then the French for the puncture, then say *crever* again

Before you move on

What does crever mean? (“To get a flat tyre; to burst”.) Say it once more.

404.3 le pneu — the tyre

Before the new one: say the French for the puncture, then the French for to get a flat tyre.

You’ll want to know: le pneu

le pneu — “the tyre”.

Le pneu avant est à plat.

The front tyre is flat.

Plural *les pneus*. *Un pneu neige* — a winter tyre.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pneu is short for *pneumatique* ’filled with air’, a learned word from Latin *pneumaticus*, from Greek *pneûma* ’breath, air’ (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pneu*
- *Say it: le pneu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pneu*
- *Recall:* say the French for the puncture, then the French for to get a flat tyre, then say *le pneu* again

Before you move on

What does le pneu mean? ("The tyre".) Say it once more.

404.4 le cric — the jack (for lifting a car)

Before the new one: say the French for to get a flat tyre, then the French for the tyre.

You'll want to know: le cric

le cric — "the jack (for lifting a car)".

Le cric est sous le tapis, à l'arrière de la voiture.

The jack is under the mat at the back of the car.

The final *c* is pronounced.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *cric* is not settled. It is usually traced to Middle High German *kriec* 'winch'; EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cric*
- *Say it: le cric*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cric*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get a flat tyre, then the French for the tyre, then say *le cric* again

Before you move on

What does le cric mean? ("The jack (for lifting a car)".) Say it once more.

404.5 gonfler — to pump up, to inflate; to swell

Before the new one: say the French for the tyre, then the French for the jack.

You'll want to know: gonfler

gonfler — "to pump up, to inflate; to swell".

Au garage, il gonfle les pneus.

At the garage he pumps up the tyres.

Informal: *ça me gonfle* — that gets on my nerves.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gonfler goes back to Latin *conflāre* 'to blow together', from *flāre* 'to blow' (EtymDB), probably through a southern dialect.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gonfler*
- *Say it:* *gonfler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *gonfler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tyre, then the French for the jack, then say *gonfler* again

Before you move on

What does gonfler mean? (“To pump up, to inflate; to swell”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 405

La dépanneuse arrive

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can get help after a breakdown: the tow truck, the mechanic who comes, fixing the car on the spot, towing and the garage owner.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 405: I can get help after a breakdown: the tow truck, the mechanic who comes, fixing the car on the spot, towing and the garage owner.*

405.1 dépanner — to get going again (after a breakdown); to help out

> Before the new one: say the French for the jack, then the French for to pump up.

You'll want to know: dépanner

dépanner — "to get going again (after a breakdown); to help out".

> Un voisin nous a dépannés avec ses câbles.
>
> *A neighbour got us going again with his cables.*

Also: *tu peux me dépanner de dix euros ?* — can you lend me ten euros?

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépanner is built from *dé-* 'un-' and *panne* 'breakdown' (EtymDB). *Panne* is usually traced to a sailing phrase, *mettre en panne*, for a ship held still with its sails turned against the wind.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dépanner*
- *Say it: dépanner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dépanner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the jack, then the French for to pump up, then say *dépanner* again

Before you move on

What does dépanner mean? ("To get going again (after a breakdown); to help out".) Say it once more.

405.2 la dépanneuse — the tow truck, the breakdown lorry

Before the new one: say the French for to pump up, then the French for to get going again.

You'll want to know: la dépanneuse

la dépanneuse — "the tow truck, the breakdown lorry".

La dépanneuse est arrivée après une heure.

The tow truck arrived after an hour.

Built on *dépanner* with the ending *-euse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépanneuse is built on *dépanner* 'to get going again' with the ending *-euse*. *Dépanner* is built from *dé-* and *panne* 'breakdown' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dépanneuse*
- *Say it: la dépanneuse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la dépanneuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pump up, then the French for to get going again, then say *la dépanneuse* again

Before you move on

What does la dépanneuse mean? ("The tow truck, the breakdown lorry".) Say it once more.

405.3 le dépanneur — the breakdown mechanic

Before the new one: say the French for to get going again, then the French for the tow truck.

You'll want to know: le dépanneur

le dépanneur — "the breakdown mechanic".

Le dépanneur a changé la batterie au bord de la route.

The breakdown mechanic changed the battery by the side of the road.

In Québec, *un dépanneur* is also a corner shop that stays open late.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dépanneur is built on *dépanner* with the ending *-eur*: the person who gets you out of a *panne*. *Dépanner* is built from *dé-* and *panne* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dépanneur*
- *Say it: le dépanneur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le dépanneur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get going again, then the French for the tow truck, then say *le dépanneur* again

Before you move on

What does le dépanneur mean? ("The breakdown mechanic".) Say it once more.

405.4 remorquer — to tow

Before the new one: say the French for the tow truck, then the French for the breakdown mechanic.

You'll want to know: remorquer

remorquer — "to tow".

Ils ont remorqué la voiture jusqu'au garage.

They towed the car to the garage.

Une remorque — a trailer.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remorquer was borrowed from Italian *rimorchiare* 'to tow' (EtymDB), which is usually traced through Late Latin to a Greek word for towing with a rope.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: remorquer*
- *Say it: remorquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *remorquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tow truck, then the French for the breakdown mechanic, then say *remorquer* again

Before you move on

What does remorquer mean? ("To tow".) Say it once more.

405.5 le garagiste — the garage owner, the car mechanic

Before the new one: say the French for the breakdown mechanic, then the French for to tow.

You'll want to know: le garagiste

le garagiste — "the garage owner, the car mechanic".

Le garagiste a trouvé le problème tout de suite.

The mechanic found the problem straight away.

Le garagiste runs the garage; *le mécanicien* does the repairs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

garagiste is built on *garage* with *-iste*. *Garage* comes from *garer* 'to put in a safe place', which is usually traced to a Germanic verb meaning 'to watch over'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le garagiste*
- *Say it: le garagiste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le garagiste*
- *Recall:* say the French for the breakdown mechanic, then the French for to tow, then say *le garagiste* again

Before you move on

What does le garagiste mean? ("The garage owner, the car mechanic".) Say it once more.

Chapter 406

La voiture de près

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the outside and inside of a car: the bodywork, the bonnet, the car door, the boot and the back seat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 406: I can name the outside and inside of a car: the bodywork, the bonnet, the car door, the boot and the back seat.*

406.1 la carrosserie — the bodywork (of a car)

> Before the new one: say the French for to tow, then the French for the garage owner.

You'll want to know: la carrosserie

la carrosserie — "the bodywork (of a car)".

> La carrosserie est rayée sur le côté.
>
> *The bodywork is scratched on the side.*

Un carrossier repairs bodywork.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carrosserie is built on *carrosse* 'coach', which was borrowed from Italian *carrozza*, from *carro* and so from Latin *carrus* 'wagon'

(EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la carrosserie*
- *Say it: la carrosserie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la carrosserie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tow, then the French for the garage owner, then say *la carrosserie* again

Before you move on

What does la carrosserie mean? ("The bodywork (of a car)".) Say it once more.

406.2 le capot — the bonnet (of a car)

Before the new one: say the French for the garage owner, then the French for the bodywork.

You'll want to know: le capot

le capot — "the bonnet (of a car)".

Le mécanicien ouvre le capot.

The mechanic opens the bonnet.

In American English: the hood.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

capot is usually traced to *cape* 'cloak with a hood', from Late Latin *cappa*: the engine wears a hood. EtymDB has no source line for this sense.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le capot*
- *Say it: le capot*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le capot*
- *Recall:* say the French for the garage owner, then the French for the bodywork, then say *le capot* again

Before you move on

What does le capot mean? ("The bonnet (of a car)".) Say it once more.

406.3 la portière — the car door

Before the new one: say the French for the bodywork, then the French for the bonnet.

You'll want to know: la portière

la portière — "the car door".

Il a fermé la portière trop fort.

He shut the car door too hard.

La porte for a house, *la portière* for a car or a train.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

portière is built on *porte* 'door', which is inherited from Latin *porta* 'gate' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la portière*
- *Say it: la portière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la portière*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bodywork, then the French for the bonnet, then say *la portière* again

Before you move on

What does la portière mean? (“The car door”.) Say it once more.

406.4 le coffre — the boot (of a car); the chest

Before the new one: say the French for the bonnet, then the French for the car door.

You’ll want to know: le coffre

le coffre — “the boot (of a car); the chest”.

Les valises sont dans le coffre.

The suitcases are in the boot.

Un coffre is also a big wooden box.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coffre is inherited from Latin *cophinus* ’basket’, which came from Greek *kóphinos* (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coffre*
- *Say it: le coffre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le coffre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bonnet, then the French for the car door, then say *le coffre* again

Before you move on

What does le coffre mean? (“The boot (of a car); the chest”.) Say it once more.

406.5 la banquette — the back seat; the bench seat

Before the new one: say the French for the car door, then the French for the boot.

You’ll want to know: la banquette

la banquette — “the back seat; the bench seat”.

Les enfants dorment sur la banquette arrière.

The children are asleep on the back seat.

La banquette arrière — the back seat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banquette is a small *banc* ’bench’, probably borrowed from Occitan *banqueta*. *Banc* comes from a Germanic word for ’bench’ (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la banquette*
- *Say it: la banquette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la banquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the car door, then the French for the boot, then say *la banquette* again

Before you move on

What does la banquette mean? (“The back seat; the bench seat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 407

Se garer en ville

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about parking in town: parking, stopping, the ticket machine, a tight parking space and the pound.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 407: I can talk about parking in town: parking, stopping, the ticket machine, a tight parking space and the pound.*

407.1 le stationnement — parking

> Before the new one: say the French for the boot, then the French for the back seat.

You'll want to know: le stationnement

le stationnement — "parking".

> Le stationnement est interdit devant l'école.
>
> *Parking is not allowed in front of the school.*

Stationnement payant — pay parking.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stationnement is built on *stationner* 'to park' with *-ment*. *Stationner* comes from *station*, a learned borrowing from Latin *statiō* 'a standing',

from *stāre* 'to stand' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le stationnement*
- *Say it: le stationnement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le stationnement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the boot, then the French for the back seat, then say *le stationnement* again

Before you move on

What does le stationnement mean? ("Parking".) Say it once more.

407.2 stationner — to park, to be parked

Before the new one: say the French for the back seat, then the French for parking.

You'll want to know: stationner

stationner — "to park, to be parked".

Les camions ne peuvent pas stationner ici.

Lorries cannot park here.

More formal than *se garer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

stationner is built on *station*, a learned borrowing from Latin *statiō* 'a standing', from *stāre* 'to stand' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: stationner*
- *Say it: stationner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *stationner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the back seat, then the French for parking, then say *stationner* again

Before you move on

What does stationner mean? ("To park, to be parked".) Say it once more.

407.3 l'horodateur — the parking ticket machine

Before the new one: say the French for parking, then the French for to park.

You'll want to know: l'horodateur

l'horodateur — "the parking ticket machine".

Elle paie à l'horodateur avec sa carte.

She pays at the ticket machine with her card.

A masculine noun. Older single meters were *parcmètres*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

horodateur is built from *horo-*, from Greek *hṓra* 'hour', and *dateur* 'something that dates', from *date*: it prints the time on the ticket. EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'horodateur*
- *Say it: l'horodateur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'horodateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for parking, then the French for to park, then say *l'horodateur* again

Before you move on

What does l'horodateur mean? ("The parking ticket machine".) Say it once more.

407.4 le créneau — the parallel parking space; the time slot

Before the new one: say the French for to park, then the French for the parking ticket machine.

You'll want to know: le créneau

le créneau — "the parallel parking space; the time slot".

Mon frère fait très bien les créneaux.

My brother is very good at parallel parking.

Faire un créneau — to parallel park. Also a time slot: *un créneau libre.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

créneau comes from Old French *crenel*, a small *cren* 'notch': first the gap at the top of a castle wall. The origin of *cren* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le créneau*
- *Say it: le créneau*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le créneau*
- *Recall:* say the French for to park, then the French for the parking ticket machine, then say *le créneau* again

Before you move on

What does le créneau mean? ("The parallel parking space; the time slot".) Say it once more.

407.5 la fourrière — the car pound

Before the new one: say the French for the parking ticket machine, then the French for the parallel parking space.

You'll want to know: la fourrière

la fourrière — "the car pound".

Sa voiture était mal garée et elle est partie à la fourrière.

Her car was badly parked and it was taken to the pound.

Also the pound for stray dogs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fourrière is usually traced to Old French *feurre* 'fodder', of Germanic origin: first the place where seized animals were kept and fed. EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fourrière*
- *Say it: la fourrière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fourrière*
- *Recall:* say the French for the parking ticket machine, then the French for the parallel parking space, then say *la fourrière* again

Before you move on

What does la fourrière mean? ("The car pound".) Say it once more.

407.6 Routes, gares et hôtels

Say the French for the ring road and the outskirts.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the ring road, the outskirts, the interchange, the slip road, to turn off
- to speed up, to turn the wheel, to skid, to stall, the pedal
- the windscreen, the rear-view mirror, the horn, to honk, to mist up
- the pump, the diesel, the fuel, the tank, to start up
- the puncture, to get a flat tyre, the tyre, the jack, to pump up
- to get going again, the tow truck, the breakdown mechanic, to tow, the garage owner
- the bodywork, the bonnet, the car door, the boot, the back seat
- parking, to park, the parking ticket machine, the parallel parking space, the car pound

Before you move on

The ring road? (**le périphérique**.) The outskirts? (**la périphérie**.) The interchange? (**l'échangeur**.) The slip road? (**la bretelle**.) To turn off? (**bifurquer**.) To speed up? (**accélérer**.) To turn the wheel? (**braquer**.) To skid? (**déraper**.) To stall? (**caler**.) The pedal? (**la pédale**.) The windscreen? (**le pare-brise**.) The rear-view mirror? (**le rétroviseur**.) The horn? (**le klaxon**.) To honk? (**klaxonner**.) To mist up? (**embuer**.) The pump? (**la pompe**.) The diesel? (**le gazole**.) The fuel? (**le carburant**.) The tank? (**le réservoir**.) To start up? (**démarrer**.) The puncture? (**la crevaison**.) To get a flat tyre? (**crever**.) The tyre? (**le pneu**.) The jack? (**le cric**.) To pump up? (**gonfler**.) To get going again? (**dépanner**.) The tow truck? (**la dépanneuse**.) The breakdown mechanic? (**le dépanneur**.) To tow? (**remorquer**.) The garage owner? (**le garagiste**.) The bodywork? (**la carrosserie**.) The bonnet? (**le capot**.) The car door? (**la portière**.) The boot? (**le coffre**.) The back seat? (**la banquette**.) Parking? (**le stationnement**.) To park? (**stationner**.) The parking ticket machine? (**l'horodateur**.) The parallel parking space? (**le créneau**.) The car pound? (**la fourrière**.)

Chapter 408

Contrôles sur la route

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about road checks and fines: the fine, the speed camera, getting caught, writing someone up and checking.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 408: I can talk about road checks and fines: the fine, the speed camera, getting caught, writing someone up and checking.*

408.1 la contravention — the fine (for a driving offence), the ticket

> Before the new one: say the French for the parallel parking space, then the French for the car pound.

You'll want to know: la contravention

la contravention — "the fine (for a driving offence), the ticket".

> Il a reçu une contravention pour excès de vitesse.
>
> *He got a ticket for speeding.*

Informally *un PV*, short for *procès-verbal*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contravention is a learned formation on Late Latin *contrāvenīre* 'to oppose, to go against', from *contrā* 'against' and *venīre* 'to come' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la contravention*
- *Say it: la contravention*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la contravention*
- *Recall:* say the French for the parallel parking space, then the French for the car pound, then say *la contravention* again

Before you move on

What does la contravention mean? ("The fine (for a driving offence), the ticket".) Say it once more.

408.2 le radar — the speed camera; the radar

Before the new one: say the French for the car pound, then the French for the fine.

You'll want to know: le radar

le radar — "the speed camera; the radar".

Il y a un radar à l'entrée du village.

There is a speed camera at the edge of the village.

Un radar fixe stays in one place; *un radar mobile* moves.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

radar was borrowed from English *radar*, made from the first letters of *radio detection and ranging*. EtymDB lists the word without a source line.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le radar*
- *Say it: le radar*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le radar*
- *Recall:* say the French for the car pound, then the French for the fine, then say *le radar* again

Before you move on

What does le radar mean? ("The speed camera; the radar".) Say it once more.

408.3 flasher — to flash (of a speed camera), to catch speeding

Before the new one: say the French for the fine, then the French for the speed camera.

You'll want to know: flasher

flasher — "to flash (of a speed camera), to catch speeding".

> Je me suis fait flasher à quatre-vingt-dix.
>
> *I got caught by a speed camera at ninety.*

Informal; mostly *se faire flasher*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flasher is built on *flash*, which was borrowed from English *flash* (EtymDB): the camera flashes when you go too fast.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: flasher*
- *Say it: flasher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *flasher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fine, then the French for the speed camera, then say *flasher* again

Before you move on

What does flasher mean? ("To flash (of a speed camera), to catch speeding".) Say it once more.

408.4 verbaliser — to fine, to write up (a driver)

Before the new one: say the French for the speed camera, then the French for to flash.

You'll want to know: verbaliser

verbaliser — "to fine, to write up (a driver)".

Le policier a verbalisé le conducteur.

The police officer fined the driver.

Formal and official.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verbaliser is built on *verbal*, as in *procès-verbal* 'official written report', a learned word from Late Latin *verbālis*, from *verbum* 'word' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: verbaliser*
- *Say it: verbaliser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *verbaliser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the speed camera, then the French for to flash, then say *verbaliser* again

Before you move on

What does verbaliser mean? ("To fine, to write up (a driver)".) Say it once more.

408.5 contrôler — to inspect, to check; to control

Before the new one: say the French for to flash, then the French for to fine.

You'll want to know: contrôler

contrôler — "to inspect, to check; to control".

La police contrôle les papiers des automobilistes.

The police check the drivers' papers.

Un contrôle — a check.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contrôler comes from Old French *contrerole* 'a second register kept to check the first', from Medieval Latin *contrārotulum* (EtymDB), built on *rotulus* 'roll', a small *rota* 'wheel'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: contrôler*
- *Say it: contrôler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *contrôler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to flash, then the French for to fine, then say *contrôler* again

Before you move on

What does contrôler mean? ("To inspect, to check; to control".) Say it once more.

Chapter 409

Dans les virages

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the road surface and signalling: the indicator, the headlights, the bend, the carriageway and turning aside.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 409: I can talk about the road surface and signalling: the indicator, the headlights, the bend, the carriageway and turning aside.*

409.1 le clignotant — the indicator, the turn signal

> Before the new one: say the French for to fine, then the French for to inspect.

You'll want to know: le clignotant

le clignotant — "the indicator, the turn signal".

> Il tourne sans mettre son clignotant.
>
> *He turns without using his indicator.*

Built on *clignoter* 'to blink on and off'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clignotant is built on *clignoter* 'to flash on and off', from *cligner* 'to blink'. The origin of *cligner* is not settled, and EtymDB does not list the word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le clignotant*
- *Say it: le clignotant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le clignotant*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fine, then the French for to inspect, then say *le clignotant* again

Before you move on

What does le clignotant mean? ("The indicator, the turn signal".) Say it once more.

409.2 le phare — the headlight; the lighthouse

Before the new one: say the French for to inspect, then the French for the indicator.

You'll want to know: le phare

le phare — "the headlight; the lighthouse".

La nuit, les phares éclairent la route.

At night the headlights light up the road.

Un phare is also a lighthouse.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

phare comes from Latin *pharus* 'lighthouse', from Greek *pháros*, first the name of an island whose lighthouse was one of the wonders of the ancient world (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le phare*
- *Say it: le phare*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le phare*
- *Recall:* say the French for to inspect, then the French for the indicator, then say *le phare* again

Before you move on

What does le phare mean? ("The headlight; the lighthouse".) Say it once more.

409.3 le virage — the bend, the curve (in a road)

Before the new one: say the French for the indicator, then the French for the headlight.

You'll want to know: le virage

le virage — "the bend, the curve (in a road)".

Le bus ralentit dans le virage.

The bus slows down on the bend.

Un virage dangereux — a dangerous bend.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

virage is built on *virer* 'to turn' with *-age*. The origin of *virer* is not settled; it is often linked to Latin *gyrare* 'to turn round'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le virage*
- *Say it: le virage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le virage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the indicator, then the French for the headlight, then say *le virage* again

Before you move on

What does le virage mean? ("The bend, the curve (in a road)".) Say it once more.

409.4 la chaussée — the road surface, the carriageway

Before the new one: say the French for the headlight, then the French for the bend.

You'll want to know: la chaussée

la chaussée — "the road surface, the carriageway".

La chaussée est glissante après la pluie.

The road surface is slippery after the rain.

The part of the street for cars, not the pavement.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chaussée is inherited from Late Latin *calciāta* 'paved with lime', from *calx* 'lime' (EtymDB). English *causeway* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chaussée*
- *Say it: la chaussée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la chaussée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the headlight, then the French for the bend, then say *la chaussée* again

Before you move on

What does la chaussée mean? ("The road surface, the carriageway".) Say it once more.

409.5 dévier — to turn aside, to divert

Before the new one: say the French for the bend, then the French for the road surface.

You'll want to know: dévier

dévier — "to turn aside, to divert".

La voiture a dévié de sa route sur le pont.

The car swerved off course on the bridge.

Also *dévier la circulation* — to divert the traffic.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dévier is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *dēviāre* 'to leave the road', from *via* 'way' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dévier*
- *Say it:* *dévier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dévier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bend, then the French for the road surface, then say *dévier* again

Before you move on

What does dévier mean? ("To turn aside, to divert".) Say it once more.

Chapter 410

Bouchons sur l'autoroute

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about heavy traffic: the jam, the gridlock, the diversion, the rest area and overtaking.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 410: I can talk about heavy traffic: the jam, the gridlock, the diversion, the rest area and overtaking.*

410.1 le bouchon — the traffic jam; the cork

> Before the new one: say the French for the road surface, then the French for to turn aside.

You'll want to know: le bouchon

le bouchon — "the traffic jam; the cork".

> Il y a dix kilomètres de bouchon avant le tunnel.
>
> *There is a ten-kilometre jam before the tunnel.*

Un bouchon is also a cork for a bottle.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouchon is built on Middle French *bousche* 'handful of straw' (EtymDB): first a twist of straw that stopped up a bottle, now a cork and a road blocked by cars.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bouchon*
- *Say it: le bouchon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bouchon*
- *Recall:* say the French for the road surface, then the French for to turn aside, then say *le bouchon* again

Before you move on

What does le bouchon mean? ("The traffic jam; the cork".) Say it once more.

410.2 l'embouteillage — the gridlock, the traffic jam

Before the new one: say the French for to turn aside, then the French for the traffic jam.

You'll want to know: l'embouteillage

l'embouteillage — "the gridlock, the traffic jam".

Le vendredi soir, les embouteillages sont terribles.

On Friday evenings the traffic jams are terrible.

A masculine noun; close to *bouchon*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

embouteillage is built on *embouteiller* 'to put in bottles', from *bouteille* 'bottle', which goes back to Late Latin *butticula*, a small *buttis* 'cask' (EtymDB): cars stuck as in the neck of a bottle.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'embouteillage*
- *Say it: l'embouteillage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'embouteillage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to turn aside, then the French for the traffic jam, then say *l'embouteillage* again

Before you move on

What does l'embouteillage mean? ("The gridlock, the traffic jam".) Say it once more.

410.3 la déviation — the diversion, the detour (for traffic)

Before the new one: say the French for the traffic jam, then the French for the gridlock.

You'll want to know: la déviation

la déviation — "the diversion, the detour (for traffic)".

À cause des travaux, il y a une déviation par le village.

Because of the roadworks there is a diversion through the village.

Signs say *Déviation* with an arrow.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déviation is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *dēviātiō*, from *dēviāre* 'to leave the road', built on *via* 'way' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la déviation*
- *Say it: la déviation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la déviation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the traffic jam, then the French for the gridlock, then say *la déviation* again

Before you move on

What does la déviation mean? ("The diversion, the detour (for traffic)".) Say it once more.

410.4 l'aire — the rest area (on a motorway); the area

Before the new one: say the French for the gridlock, then the French for the diversion.

You'll want to know: l'aire

l'aire — "the rest area (on a motorway); the area".

Nous mangeons sur une aire de repos.

We eat at a motorway rest area.

A feminine noun: *une aire de repos*, *une aire de jeux*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aire is inherited from Latin *ārea* 'open space, threshing floor' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aire*
- *Say it: l'aire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'aire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the gridlock, then the French for the diversion, then say *l'aire* again

Before you move on

What does l'aire mean? ("The rest area (on a motorway); the area".) Say it once more.

410.5 doubler — to overtake; to double

Before the new one: say the French for the diversion, then the French for the rest area.

You'll want to know: doubler

doubler — "to overtake; to double".

Il est dangereux de doubler dans un tunnel.

It is dangerous to overtake in a tunnel.

Dépasser also means to overtake.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

doubler is inherited through Old French *dobler* from Late Latin *dūplāre* 'to double', from *duplus* 'double' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *doubler*
- *Say it:* *doubler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *doubler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the diversion, then the French for the rest area, then say *doubler* again

Before you move on

What does doubler mean? (“To overtake; to double”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 411

Un petit accident

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a small road accident: hitting something, bumping into it, the pedestrian, the cyclist and writing up what happened.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 411: I can describe a small road accident: hitting something, bumping into it, the pedestrian, the cyclist and writing up what happened.*

411.1 percuter — to crash into, to hit

> Before the new one: say the French for the rest area, then the French for to overtake.

You'll want to know: percuter

percuter — "to crash into, to hit".

> Une moto a percuté l'arrière du bus.
>
> *A motorbike crashed into the back of the bus.*

A hard, violent hit.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

percuter is a learned borrowing from Latin *percutere* 'to strike hard' (EtymDB), from *per-* and *quatere* 'to shake'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: percuter*
- *Say it: percuter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *percuter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rest area, then the French for to overtake, then say *percuter* again

Before you move on

What does percuter mean? ("To crash into, to hit".) Say it once more.

411.2 heurter — to bump into, to knock against; to offend

Before the new one: say the French for to overtake, then the French for to crash into.

You'll want to know: heurter

heurter — "to bump into, to knock against; to offend".

En reculant, il a heurté un poteau.

While reversing he bumped into a post.

Also figurative: *heurter quelqu'un* — to hurt someone's feelings.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

heurter comes from Old French *hurter* 'to ram', which is built on Frankish *hūrt* 'battering ram' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: heurter*
- *Say it: heurter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *heurter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to overtake, then the French for to crash into, then say *heurter* again

Before you move on

What does heurter mean? ("To bump into, to knock against; to offend".) Say it once more.

411.3 le piéton — the pedestrian

Before the new one: say the French for to crash into, then the French for to bump into.

You'll want to know: le piéton

le piéton — "the pedestrian".

Les voitures s'arrêtent pour laisser passer les piétons.

The cars stop to let the pedestrians cross.

Une rue piétonne — a pedestrian street.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

piéton is built on *pied* 'foot' (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *pēs* 'foot'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le piéton*
- *Say it: le piéton*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le piéton*
- *Recall:* say the French for to crash into, then the French for to bump into, then say *le piéton* again

Before you move on

What does le piéton mean? ("The pedestrian".) Say it once more.

411.4 le cycliste — the cyclist

Before the new one: say the French for to bump into, then the French for the pedestrian.

You'll want to know: le cycliste

le cycliste — "the cyclist".

Le cycliste roulait sur la droite.

The cyclist was riding on the right.

Same form for a woman: *une cycliste*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cycliste is built on *cycle* 'bicycle', a learned word from Latin *cyclus*, from Greek *kýklos* 'circle, wheel' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cycliste*
- *Say it: le cycliste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cycliste*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bump into, then the French for the pedestrian, then say *le cycliste* again

Before you move on

What does le cycliste mean? ("The cyclist".) Say it once more.

411.5 constater — to note, to record (what happened)

Before the new one: say the French for the pedestrian, then the French for the cyclist.

You'll want to know: constater

constater — "to note, to record (what happened)".

Les deux conducteurs ont constaté les dégâts ensemble.

The two drivers noted the damage together.

Le constat amiable is the form drivers fill in together after an accident.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

constater is built on Latin *constat* 'it is certain', from *constāre* 'to stand firm', from *con-* and *stāre* 'to stand' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *constater*
- *Say it:* *constater*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *constater*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pedestrian, then the French for the cyclist, then say *constater* again

Before you move on

What does constater mean? (“To note, to record (what happened)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 412

Au guichet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can buy a ticket at the counter: the ticket office, the price list, the journey, the flat-rate pass and validating the ticket.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 412: I can buy a ticket at the counter: the ticket office, the price list, the journey, the flat-rate pass and validating the ticket.*

412.1 le guichet — the ticket office, the counter window

> Before the new one: say the French for the cyclist, then the French for to note.

You'll want to know: le guichet

le guichet — "the ticket office, the counter window".

> Il y a beaucoup de monde au guichet.
>
> *There are a lot of people at the ticket office.*

Le guichet automatique is a cash machine in some places.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guichet comes from Old French *guischet* 'small door in a big one'. It is usually traced to a Norse or Germanic word, but the origin is not settled; English *wicket* is a cousin (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le guichet*
- *Say it: le guichet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le guichet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cyclist, then the French for to note, then say *le guichet* again

Before you move on

What does le guichet mean? ("The ticket office, the counter window".) Say it once more.

412.2 le tarif — the fare, the price (list)

Before the new one: say the French for to note, then the French for the ticket office.

You'll want to know: le tarif

le tarif — "the fare, the price (list)".

Les étudiants paient un tarif réduit.

Students pay a reduced fare.

Plein tarif — full price.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tarif was borrowed from Italian *tariffa*, which came from Arabic *ta^{c}rīfa* 'notice, list of rates' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tarif*
- *Say it: le tarif*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le tarif*
- *Recall:* say the French for to note, then the French for the ticket office, then say *le tarif* again

Before you move on

What does le tarif mean? ("The fare, the price (list)".) Say it once more.

412.3 le trajet — the ride, the journey (from A to B)

Before the new one: say the French for the ticket office, then the French for the fare.

You'll want to know: le trajet

le trajet — "the ride, the journey (from A to B)".

Le trajet en train dure deux heures.

The train journey takes two hours.

Le trajet is the trip itself; *le voyage* is the whole travel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trajet was borrowed from Italian *tragetto* 'crossing', which goes back to Latin *trāiectus* 'a crossing over', from *trāicere* 'to throw across', built on *iacere* 'to throw' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le trajet*
- *Say it: le trajet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le trajet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the ticket office, then the French for the fare, then say *le trajet* again

Before you move on

What does le trajet mean? ("The ride, the journey (from A to B)".) Say it once more.

412.4 le forfait — the flat-rate pass, the package

Before the new one: say the French for the fare, then the French for the ride.

You'll want to know: le forfait

le forfait — "the flat-rate pass, the package".

Elle a acheté un forfait pour la semaine.

She bought a pass for the week.

Un forfait de ski — a ski pass; *un forfait mobile* — a phone plan.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *forfait* in this sense is not settled. It is usually explained as an old *fur fait* 'done at the agreed rate', reshaped after the older *forfait* 'misdeed'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le forfait*
- *Say it: le forfait*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le forfait*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fare, then the French for the ride, then say *le forfait* again

Before you move on

What does le forfait mean? ("The flat-rate pass, the package".) Say it once more.

412.5 valider — to validate (a ticket); to approve

Before the new one: say the French for the ride, then the French for the flat-rate pass.

You'll want to know: valider

valider — "to validate (a ticket); to approve".

Dans le bus, les passagers valident leur billet.

On the bus the passengers validate their tickets.

A ticket that is not validated can mean a fine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

valider is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *validāre* 'to make valid', from *validus* 'strong', built on *valēre* 'to be strong' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: valider*
- *Say it: valider*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *valider*
- *Recall:* say the French for the ride, then the French for the flat-rate pass, then say *valider* again

Before you move on

What does valider mean? ("To validate (a ticket); to approve".) Say it once more.

Chapter 413

Sur le quai

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find my train: the track, stamping a ticket, the ticket inspector, the carriage and the places a train serves.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 413: I can find my train: the track, stamping a ticket, the ticket inspector, the carriage and the places a train serves.*

413.1 la voie — the track, the platform number; the way

> Before the new one: say the French for the flat-rate pass, then the French for to validate.

You'll want to know: la voie

la voie — "the track, the platform number; the way".

> Le train de sept heures part de la voie six.
>
> *The seven o'clock train leaves from platform six.*

La voie is the track with its number; *le quai* is where you stand.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

voie is inherited through Old French *voie* from Latin *via* 'road, way' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la voie*
- *Say it: la voie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la voie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the flat-rate pass, then the French for to validate, then say *la voie* again

Before you move on

What does la voie mean? ("The track, the platform number; the way".) Say it once more.

413.2 composter — to stamp (a ticket)

Before the new one: say the French for to validate, then the French for the track.

You'll want to know: composter

composter — "to stamp (a ticket)".

Avant de monter, il a composté son billet.

Before getting on, he stamped his ticket.

Paper tickets were stamped in a small machine on the platform; in Switzerland, *oblitérer* is also heard.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

composter is built on *composteur*, a stamping machine, which is usually traced to Italian *compositore* 'typesetter', from Latin *compōnere* 'to put together'. EtymDB lists the verb without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: composter*
- *Say it: composter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *composter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to validate, then the French for the track, then say *composter* again

Before you move on

What does composter mean? ("To stamp (a ticket)".) Say it once more.

413.3 le contrôleur — the ticket inspector

Before the new one: say the French for the track, then the French for to stamp.

You'll want to know: le contrôleur

le contrôleur — "the ticket inspector".

Le contrôleur passe dans le train et vérifie les billets.

The inspector goes through the train and checks the tickets.

Feminine: *la contrôleuse.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contrôleur comes from Old French *contrerollour* (EtymDB), built on *contrerole* 'a second register for checking', from Medieval Latin *contrārotulum*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le contrôleur*
- *Say it: le contrôleur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le contrôleur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the track, then the French for to stamp, then say *le contrôleur* again

Before you move on

What does le contrôleur mean? ("The ticket inspector".) Say it once more.

413.4 le wagon — the carriage (of a train)

Before the new one: say the French for to stamp, then the French for the ticket inspector.

You'll want to know: le wagon

le wagon — "the carriage (of a train)".

Notre place est dans le wagon numéro douze.

Our seat is in carriage number twelve.

Rail staff often say *la voiture*; most people say *le wagon*. *Le wagon-restaurant* — the dining car.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

wagon was borrowed from English *wagon*, which came from Dutch *wagen* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le wagon*
- *Say it: le wagon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le wagon*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stamp, then the French for the ticket inspector, then say *le wagon* again

Before you move on

What does le wagon mean? ("The carriage (of a train)".) Say it once more.

413.5 desservir — to stop at, to serve (a place); to clear away (after a meal)

Before the new one: say the French for the ticket inspector, then the French for the carriage.

You'll want to know: desservir

desservir — "to stop at, to serve (a place); to clear away (after a meal)".

Ce train dessert tous les villages de la vallée.

This train serves all the villages in the valley.

Also *desservir* after a meal — to clear away the dishes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

desservir is built from *des-* and *servir* 'to serve', which is inherited from Latin *servīre* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *desservir*
- *Say it:* *desservir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *desservir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the ticket inspector, then the French for the carriage, then say *desservir* again

Before you move on

What does desservir mean? ("To stop at, to serve (a place); to clear away (after a meal)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 414

Le train de nuit

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can travel on a night train: the berth, the end of the line, the left-luggage office, the luggage trolley and the shuttle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 414: I can travel on a night train: the berth, the end of the line, the left-luggage office, the luggage trolley and the shuttle.*

414.1 la couchette — the berth, the couchette

> Before the new one: say the French for the carriage, then the French for to stop at.

You'll want to know: la couchette

la couchette — "the berth, the couchette".

> Dans le train de nuit, j'ai dormi sur la couchette du haut.
>
> *On the night train I slept on the top berth.*

A small *couche* 'bed'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

couchette is a small *couche* 'bed', from *coucher* 'to lay down', which is inherited from Latin *collocāre* 'to put in place', built on *locus* 'place'

(Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la couchette*
- *Say it: la couchette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la couchette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the carriage, then the French for to stop at, then say *la couchette* again

Before you move on

What does la couchette mean? ("The berth, the couchette".) Say it once more.

414.2 le terminus — the end of the line, the terminus

Before the new one: say the French for to stop at, then the French for the berth.

You'll want to know: le terminus

le terminus — "the end of the line, the terminus".

Le bus s'arrête au terminus et tout le monde descend.

The bus stops at the end of the line and everyone gets off.

The final *s* is pronounced.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

terminus was borrowed from English *terminus*, a learned word from Latin *terminus* 'boundary, end' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le terminus*
- *Say it: le terminus*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le terminus*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stop at, then the French for the berth, then say *le terminus* again

Before you move on

What does le terminus mean? ("The end of the line, the terminus".) Say it once more.

414.3 la consigne — the left-luggage office; the instruction

Before the new one: say the French for the berth, then the French for the end of the line.

You'll want to know: la consigne

la consigne — "the left-luggage office; the instruction".

Nous avons laissé nos sacs à la consigne.

We left our bags at the left-luggage office.

Les consignes de sécurité — the safety instructions.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

consigne is built on *consigner* 'to put in safe keeping', a learned borrowing from Latin *consignāre* 'to seal', from *signum* 'mark' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la consigne*
- *Say it: la consigne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la consigne*
- *Recall:* say the French for the berth, then the French for the end of the line, then say *la consigne* again

Before you move on

What does la consigne mean? ("The left-luggage office; the instruction".) Say it once more.

414.4 le chariot — the trolley (for luggage or shopping)

Before the new one: say the French for the end of the line, then the French for the left-luggage office.

You'll want to know: le chariot

le chariot — "the trolley (for luggage or shopping)".

Il pousse un chariot plein de valises.

He is pushing a trolley full of suitcases.

In a supermarket, *le chariot* is the shopping trolley.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chariot is built on Old French *char* 'cart', which is inherited from Latin *carrus* 'wagon' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chariot*
- *Say it: le chariot*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chariot*
- *Recall:* say the French for the end of the line, then the French for the left-luggage office, then say *le chariot* again

Before you move on

What does le chariot mean? ("The trolley (for luggage or shopping)".) Say it once more.

414.5 la navette — the shuttle (bus or train)

Before the new one: say the French for the left-luggage office, then the French for the trolley.

You'll want to know: la navette

la navette — "the shuttle (bus or train)".

Une navette relie le centre-ville à l'aéroport.

A shuttle links the town centre with the airport.

Faire la navette — to go back and forth.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

navette is a small *nef* 'ship', from Latin *nāvis* 'ship' (Lewis & Short): first the boat-shaped shuttle of a loom that runs back and forth.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la navette*
- *Say it: la navette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la navette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the left-luggage office, then the French for the trolley, then say *la navette* again

Before you move on

What does la navette mean? (“The shuttle (bus or train)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 415

En ville sans voiture

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can get around town without a car: the stop, the train set on a line, the book of tickets, the tram and the scooter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 415: I can get around town without a car: the stop, the train set on a line, the book of tickets, the tram and the scooter.*

415.1 la station — the metro station, the stop; the taxi rank; the resort

> Before the new one: say the French for the trolley, then the French for the shuttle.

You'll want to know: la station

la station — "the metro station, the stop; the taxi rank; the resort".

> Je descends à la prochaine station de métro.
>
> *I get off at the next metro stop.*

For trains, *la gare*; for the metro, *la station*. *Une station de ski* — a ski resort.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

station comes from Old French *estation*, a learned borrowing from Latin *statiō* 'a standing, a post', from *stāre* 'to stand' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la station*
- *Say it: la station*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la station*
- *Recall:* say the French for the trolley, then the French for the shuttle, then say *la station* again

Before you move on

What does la station mean? ("The metro station, the stop; the taxi rank; the resort".) Say it once more.

415.2 la rame — the metro train, the set of carriages

Before the new one: say the French for the shuttle, then the French for the metro station.

You'll want to know: la rame

la rame — "the metro train, the set of carriages".

La rame de métro est pleine à huit heures.

The metro train is full at eight o'clock.

La rame is also an oar; that is a different word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rame in this sense comes from *rame* 'ream, stack', borrowed through Catalan *raima* (EtymDB) from Arabic *rizma* 'bundle': a row of carriages, like a stack of sheets.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rame*
- *Say it: la rame*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rame*
- *Recall:* say the French for the shuttle, then the French for the metro station, then say *la rame* again

Before you move on

What does la rame mean? ("The metro train, the set of carriages".) Say it once more.

415.3 le carnet — the book of tickets; the notebook

Before the new one: say the French for the metro station, then the French for the metro train.

You'll want to know: le carnet

le carnet — "the book of tickets; the notebook".

Elle achète un carnet de dix tickets.

She buys a book of ten tickets.

Un carnet is also a small notebook.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carnet comes from Middle French *quernet* 'quire of four sheets' (EtymDB), from Latin *quaternī* 'four each'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le carnet*
- *Say it: le carnet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le carnet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the metro station, then the French for the metro train, then say *le carnet* again

Before you move on

What does le carnet mean? ("The book of tickets; the notebook".) Say it once more.

415.4 le tramway — the tram

Before the new one: say the French for the metro train, then the French for the book of tickets.

You'll want to know: le tramway

le tramway — "the tram".

Le tramway passe toutes les cinq minutes.

The tram comes every five minutes.

In speech, *le tram*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tramway was borrowed from English *tramway* (EtymDB). English *tram* 'rail' comes from Middle Dutch *trame* 'beam'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tramway*
- *Say it: le tramway*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le tramway*
- *Recall:* say the French for the metro train, then the French for the book of tickets, then say *le tramway* again

Before you move on

What does le tramway mean? ("The tram".) Say it once more.

415.5 la trottinette — the scooter (kick or electric)

Before the new one: say the French for the book of tickets, then the French for the tram.

You'll want to know: la trottinette

la trottinette — "the scooter (kick or electric)".

Mon voisin va au bureau en trottinette électrique.

My neighbour goes to the office on an electric scooter.

Une trottinette électrique — an e-scooter.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trottinette is built on *trottiner* 'to trot along' with *-ette* (EtymDB). *Trotter* 'to trot' is usually traced to a Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la trottinette*
- *Say it: la trottinette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la trottinette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the book of tickets, then the French for the tram, then say *la trottinette* again

Before you move on

What does la trottinette mean? ("The scooter (kick or electric)".) Say it once more.

415.6 Retour sur les chapitres 408–415

Say the French for the fine and the speed camera.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the fine, the speed camera, to flash, to fine, to inspect
- the indicator, the headlight, the bend, the road surface, to turn aside
- the traffic jam, the gridlock, the diversion, the rest area, to overtake
- to crash into, to bump into, the pedestrian, the cyclist, to note
- the ticket office, the fare, the ride, the flat-rate pass, to validate
- the track, to stamp, the ticket inspector, the carriage, to stop at

- the berth, the end of the line, the left-luggage office, the trolley, the shuttle
- the metro station, the metro train, the book of tickets, the tram, the scooter

Before you move on

The fine? (**la contravention**.) The speed camera? (**le radar**.) To flash? (**flasher**.) To fine? (**verbaliser**.) To inspect? (**contrôler**.) The indicator? (**le clignotant**.) The headlight? (**le phare**.) The bend? (**le virage**.) The road surface? (**la chaussée**.) To turn aside? (**dévier**.) The traffic jam? (**le bouchon**.) The gridlock? (**l'embouteillage**.) The diversion? (**la déviation**.) The rest area? (**l'aire**.) To overtake? (**doubler**.) To crash into? (**percuter**.) To bump into? (**heurter**.) The pedestrian? (**le piéton**.) The cyclist? (**le cycliste**.) To note? (**constater**.) The ticket office? (**le guichet**.) The fare? (**le tarif**.) The ride? (**le trajet**.) The flat-rate pass? (**le forfait**.) To validate? (**valider**.) The track? (**la voie**.) To stamp? (**composter**.) The ticket inspector? (**le contrôleur**.) The carriage? (**le wagon**.) To stop at? (**desservir**.) The berth? (**la couchette**.) The end of the line? (**le terminus**.) The left-luggage office? (**la consigne**.) The trolley? (**le chariot**.) The shuttle? (**la navette**.) The metro station? (**la station**.) The metro train? (**la rame**.) The book of tickets? (**le carnet**.) The tram? (**le tramway**.) The scooter? (**la trottinette**.)

Chapter 416

À l'aérogare

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can check in for a flight: the flight, the airport building, check-in, the hold and boarding.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 416: I can check in for a flight: the flight, the airport building, check-in, the hold and boarding.*

416.1 le vol — the flight

> Before the new one: say the French for the tram, then the French for the scooter.

You'll want to know: le vol

le vol — "the flight".

> Notre vol part à sept heures du matin.
>
> *Our flight leaves at seven in the morning.*

Le vol is also a theft; that sense comes from *voler* 'to steal'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vol is built on *voler* 'to fly' (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *volāre*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vol*
- *Say it: le vol*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le vol*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tram, then the French for the scooter, then say *le vol* again

Before you move on

What does le vol mean? ("The flight".) Say it once more.

416.2 l'aérogare — the airport building (for passengers)

Before the new one: say the French for the scooter, then the French for the flight.

You'll want to know: l'aérogare

l'aérogare — "the airport building (for passengers)".

La navette va de la gare jusqu'à l'aérogare.

The shuttle runs from the railway station to the airport building.

A feminine noun: *une aérogare*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

aérogare is built from *aéro-*, from Greek *aḗr* 'air', and *gare*, the building for trains: a *gare* for planes. EtymDB lists the word without a source line.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aérogare*
- *Say it: l'aérogare*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'aérogare*
- *Recall:* say the French for the scooter, then the French for the flight, then say *l'aérogare* again

Before you move on

What does l'aérogare mean? ("The airport building (for passengers)".) Say it once more.

416.3 l'enregistrement — the check-in; the recording

Before the new one: say the French for the flight, then the French for the airport building.

You'll want to know: l'enregistrement

l'enregistrement — "the check-in; the recording".

L'enregistrement ferme une heure avant le départ.

Check-in closes an hour before departure.

A masculine noun. Also a recording of music.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enregistrement is built on *enregistrer* with *-ment* (EtymDB). *Enregistrer* comes from *registre* 'register', from Medieval Latin *registrum*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'enregistrement*
- *Say it: l'enregistrement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'enregistrement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the flight, then the French for the airport building, then say *l'enregistrement* again

Before you move on

What does l'enregistrement mean? ("The check-in; the recording".) Say it once more.

416.4 la soute — the hold (of a plane or ship)

Before the new one: say the French for the airport building, then the French for the check-in.

You'll want to know: la soute

la soute — "the hold (of a plane or ship)".

Sa grande valise voyage dans la soute.

Her big suitcase travels in the hold.

Un bagage en soute — a checked bag.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soute was borrowed from Provençal *sota* (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *subtus* 'underneath': the space below deck.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la soute*
- *Say it: la soute*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la soute*
- *Recall:* say the French for the airport building, then the French for the check-in, then say *la soute* again

Before you move on

What does la soute mean? ("The hold (of a plane or ship)".) Say it once more.

416.5 l'embarquement — the boarding

Before the new one: say the French for the check-in, then the French for the hold.

You'll want to know: l'embarquement

l'embarquement — "the boarding".

L'embarquement commence à la porte douze.

Boarding begins at gate twelve.

A masculine noun. *La carte d'embarquement* — the boarding pass.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

embarquement is built on *embarquer* 'to board' (EtymDB lists it), from *en-* and *barque* 'boat', which goes back to Latin *barca* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'embarquement*
- *Say it: l'embarquement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'embarquement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the check-in, then the French for the hold, then say *l'embarquement* again

Before you move on

What does l'embarquement mean? ("The boarding".) Say it once more.

Chapter 417

À la douane

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can go through security and customs: the customs officer, declaring goods, the scanner gate, searching bags and changing planes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 417: I can go through security and customs: the customs officer, declaring goods, the scanner gate, searching bags and changing planes.*

417.1 le douanier — the customs officer

> Before the new one: say the French for the hold, then the French for the boarding.

You'll want to know: le douanier

le douanier — "the customs officer".

> Le douanier a demandé ce qu'il y avait dans la boîte.
>
> *The customs officer asked what was in the box.*

Built on *la douane* 'customs'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

douanier is built on *douane* 'customs', which is usually traced through Old Italian *doana* to Arabic *dīwān* 'register, office'. EtymDB does not

list the word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le douanier*
- *Say it: le douanier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le douanier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hold, then the French for the boarding, then say *le douanier* again

Before you move on

What does le douanier mean? ("The customs officer".) Say it once more.

417.2 déclarer — to declare

Before the new one: say the French for the boarding, then the French for the customs officer.

You'll want to know: déclarer

déclarer — "to declare".

Elle n'a rien à déclarer.

She has nothing to declare.

Also *déclarer ses revenus* — to file a tax return.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déclarer is a learned borrowing from Latin *dēclārāre* 'to make clear', from *clārus* 'clear' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: déclarer*
- *Say it: déclarer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déclarer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the boarding, then the French for the customs officer, then say *déclarer* again

Before you move on

What does déclarer mean? ("To declare".) Say it once more.

417.3 le portique — the scanner gate (at security); the portico

Before the new one: say the French for the customs officer, then the French for to declare.

You'll want to know: le portique

le portique — "the scanner gate (at security); the portico".

Au contrôle, le portique a sonné à cause de sa ceinture.

At security the gate beeped because of his belt.

Un portique de sécurité — a walk-through scanner.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

portique is a learned borrowing from Latin *porticus* 'colonnade', built on *porta* 'gate' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le portique*
- *Say it: le portique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le portique*
- *Recall:* say the French for the customs officer, then the French for to declare, then say *le portique* again

Before you move on

What does le portique mean? ("The scanner gate (at security); the portico".) Say it once more.

417.4 fouiller — to search (a bag, a person)

Before the new one: say the French for to declare, then the French for the scanner gate.

You'll want to know: fouiller

fouiller — "to search (a bag, a person)".

Un agent a fouillé mon sac à dos.

An officer searched my rucksack.

La fouille — the search.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fouiller goes back to Vulgar Latin *fodiculāre*, from Latin *fodere* 'to dig' (Lewis & Short); EtymDB links it with *fouir* 'to dig'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: fouiller*
- *Say it: fouiller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *fouiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to declare, then the French for the scanner gate, then say *fouiller* again

Before you move on

What does fouiller mean? (“To search (a bag, a person)”.) Say it once more.

417.5 transiter — to change planes, to pass through

Before the new one: say the French for the scanner gate, then the French for to search.

You’ll want to know: transiter

transiter — “to change planes, to pass through”.

Ce vol est moins cher, mais il transite par deux aéroports.

This flight is cheaper, but it goes through two airports.

Le transit — transit.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

transiter is built on *transit*, a learned borrowing from Latin *trānsitus* ’a passing across’, from *trānsīre*, built on *īre* ’to go’ (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *transiter*
- *Say it:* *transiter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *transiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the scanner gate, then the French for to search, then say *transiter* again

Before you move on

What does transiter mean? (“To change planes, to pass through”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 418

À bord

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about life on board: boarding, the flight attendants, the window and the aisle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 418: I can talk about life on board: boarding, the flight attendants, the window and the aisle.*

418.1 embarquer — to board; to take along

> Before the new one: say the French for to search, then the French for to change planes.

You'll want to know: embarquer

embarquer — "to board; to take along".

> Les passagers embarquent par l'avant de l'avion.
>
> *The passengers board at the front of the plane.*

Informal: *embarquer quelqu'un* — to take someone along.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

embarquer is built from *en-* and *barque* 'small boat', which came through Italian or Provençal from Latin *barca* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB lists the verb without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *embarquer*
- *Say it:* *embarquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *embarquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to search, then the French for to change planes, then say *embarquer* again

Before you move on

What does embarquer mean? ("To board; to take along".) Say it once more.

418.2 l'hôtesse — the flight attendant (a woman); the hostess

Before the new one: say the French for to change planes, then the French for to board.

You'll want to know: l'hôtesse

l'hôtesse — "the flight attendant (a woman); the hostess".

L'hôtesse sert des boissons pendant le vol.

The flight attendant serves drinks during the flight.

Une hôtesse de l'air; today also *un ou une agent de bord*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hôtesse is the feminine of *hôte* 'host', which goes back to Latin *hospes* 'host, guest' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the feminine.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'hôtesse*
- *Say it: l'hôtesse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'hôtesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for to change planes, then the French for to board, then say *l'hôtesse* again

Before you move on

What does l'hôtesse mean? ("The flight attendant (a woman); the hostess".) Say it once more.

418.3 le steward — the steward (on a plane)

Before the new one: say the French for to board, then the French for the flight attendant.

You'll want to know: le steward

le steward — "the steward (on a plane)".

Le steward aide une dame avec son sac.

The steward helps a lady with her bag.

Pronounced more or less as in English.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

steward was borrowed from English *steward* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le steward*
- *Say it: le steward*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le steward*
- *Recall:* say the French for to board, then the French for the flight attendant, then say *le steward* again

Before you move on

What does le steward mean? ("The steward (on a plane)".) Say it once more.

418.4 le hublot — the porthole, the window (of a plane or ship)

Before the new one: say the French for the flight attendant, then the French for the steward.

You'll want to know: le hublot

le hublot — "the porthole, the window (of a plane or ship)".

Ma fille veut toujours une place côté hublot.

My daughter always wants a window seat.

Côté hublot — window seat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *hublot* is not settled, and EtymDB does not list it. It was first a sailors' word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le hublot*
- *Say it: le hublot*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le hublot*
- *Recall:* say the French for the flight attendant, then the French for the steward, then say *le hublot* again

Before you move on

What does le hublot mean? ("The porthole, the window (of a plane or ship)".) Say it once more.

418.5 l'allée — the aisle; the path, the drive

Before the new one: say the French for the steward, then the French for the porthole.

You'll want to know: l'allée

l'allée — "the aisle; the path, the drive".

Il préfère une place côté allée.

He prefers an aisle seat.

A feminine noun. In a park, *une allée* is a path lined with trees.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

allée is built on *aller* 'to go' (EtymDB): a place where you walk.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *l'allée*
- *Say it:* *l'allée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'allée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the steward, then the French for the porthole, then say *l'allée* again

Before you move on

What does l'allée mean? ("The aisle; the path, the drive".) Say it once more.

Chapter 419

Décollage et atterrissage

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about take-off and landing, and flying over places.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 419: I can talk about take-off and landing, and flying over places.*

419.1 décoller — to take off; to unstick

Before the new one: say the French for the porthole, then the French for the aisle.

You'll want to know: décoller

décoller — "to take off; to unstick".

L'avion a décollé avec une heure de retard.

The plane took off an hour late.

Also *décoller une étiquette* — to peel off a label.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décoller is built from *dé-* 'un-' and *coller* 'to stick', from *colle* 'glue', which goes back to Greek *kólla* (EtymDB): the plane comes unstuck from the ground.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: décoller*
- *Say it: décoller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *décoller*
- *Recall:* say the French for the porthole, then the French for the aisle, then say *décoller* again

Before you move on

What does décoller mean? ("To take off; to unstick".) Say it once more.

419.2 le décollage — the take-off

Before the new one: say the French for the aisle, then the French for to take off.

You'll want to know: le décollage

le décollage — "the take-off".

Au décollage, les enfants regardent par la fenêtre.

At take-off the children look out of the window.

Built on *décoller* with *-age*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décollage is built on *décoller* with *-age*. *Décoller* is *dé-* 'un-' plus *coller* 'to stick', from *colle* 'glue', from Greek *kólla* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le décollage*
- *Say it: le décollage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le décollage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the aisle, then the French for to take off, then say *le décollage* again

Before you move on

What does le décollage mean? ("The take-off".) Say it once more.

419.3 l'atterrissage — the landing (of a plane)

Before the new one: say the French for to take off, then the French for the take-off.

You'll want to know: l'atterrissage

l'atterrissage — "the landing (of a plane)".

L'atterrissage a été un peu brusque.

The landing was a bit rough.

A masculine noun.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

atterrissage is built on *atterrir* 'to land' with *-age*; *atterrir* comes from *terre* 'land', from Latin *terra* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the noun.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'atterrissage*
- *Say it: l'atterrissage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'atterrissage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to take off, then the French for the take-off, then say *l'atterrissage* again

Before you move on

What does l'atterrissage mean? ("The landing (of a plane)".) Say it once more.

419.4 atterrir — to land

Before the new one: say the French for the take-off, then the French for the landing.

You'll want to know: atterrir

atterrir — "to land".

Nous avons atterri sous la pluie.

We landed in the rain.

Conjugated like *finir*: *nous atterrissons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

atterrir is built from *à* and *terre* 'land', which is inherited from Latin *terra* (Lewis & Short); EtymDB lists the verb without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: atterrir*
- *Say it: atterrir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *atterrir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the take-off, then the French for the landing, then say *atterrir* again

Before you move on

What does atterrir mean? ("To land".) Say it once more.

419.5 survoler — to fly over

Before the new one: say the French for the landing, then the French for to land.

You'll want to know: survoler

survoler — "to fly over".

Pendant le vol, nous avons survolé les montagnes.

During the flight we flew over the mountains.

Figurative: *survoler un texte* — to skim a text.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

survoler is built from *sur* 'over' and *voler* 'to fly', which is inherited from Latin *volāre* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the compound.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *survoler*
- *Say it:* *survoler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *survoler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the landing, then the French for to land, then say *survoler* again

Before you move on

What does survoler mean? (“To fly over”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 420

Escale et retard

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about bumpy flights and changed times: turbulence, the stopover, jet lag, moving a time and delaying.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 420: I can talk about bumpy flights and changed times: turbulence, the stopover, jet lag, moving a time and delaying.*

420.1 la turbulence — the turbulence

> Before the new one: say the French for to land, then the French for to fly over.

You'll want to know: la turbulence

la turbulence — "the turbulence".

> Pendant les turbulences, tout le monde reste assis.
>
> *During the turbulence everyone stays seated.*

Often plural: *des turbulences*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

turbulence is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *turbulentia*, from *turba* 'disorder, crowd' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la turbulence*
- *Say it: la turbulence*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la turbulence*
- *Recall:* say the French for to land, then the French for to fly over, then say *la turbulence* again

Before you move on

What does la turbulence mean? ("The turbulence".) Say it once more.

420.2 l'escale — the stopover, the port of call

Before the new one: say the French for to fly over, then the French for the turbulence.

You'll want to know: l'escale

l'escale — "the stopover, the port of call".

Nous avons fait une escale de trois heures.

We had a three-hour stopover.

A feminine noun. *Un vol sans escale* — a non-stop flight.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

escale was borrowed from Italian *scala* 'landing stage', from Latin *scāla* 'ladder, steps' (EtymDB): the steps where a ship let people off.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'escale*
- *Say it: l'escale*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'escale*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fly over, then the French for the turbulence, then say *l'escale* again

Before you move on

What does l'escale mean? ("The stopover, the port of call".) Say it once more.

420.3 décaler — to shift, to move (a time)

Before the new one: say the French for the turbulence, then the French for the stopover.

You'll want to know: décaler

décaler — "to shift, to move (a time)".

La compagnie a décalé le départ d'une heure.

The airline moved the departure by an hour.

Décaler un rendez-vous — to move an appointment.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décaler is built from *dé-* and *caler* 'to wedge': to take out the wedge and move something along. The origin of *cale* 'wedge' is usually traced to German *Keil*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: décaler*
- *Say it: décaler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *décaler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the turbulence, then the French for the stopover, then say *décaler* again

Before you move on

What does décaler mean? ("To shift, to move (a time)".) Say it once more.

420.4 le décalage — the gap, the shift; jet lag

Before the new one: say the French for the stopover, then the French for to shift.

You'll want to know: le décalage

le décalage — "the gap, the shift; jet lag".

Avec le décalage horaire, il dort mal pendant trois jours.

With jet lag he sleeps badly for three days.

Le décalage horaire — jet lag, the time difference.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décalage is built on *décaler* 'to shift' with *-age* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le décalage*
- *Say it: le décalage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le décalage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stopover, then the French for to shift, then say *le décalage* again

Before you move on

What does le décalage mean? (“The gap, the shift; jet lag”.) Say it once more.

420.5 retarder — to delay, to hold up

Before the new one: say the French for to shift, then the French for the gap.

You’ll want to know: retarder

retarder — “to delay, to hold up”.

La neige a retardé tous les vols.

The snow delayed all the flights.

Ma montre retarde — my watch is slow.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retarder is a learned borrowing from Latin *retardāre* ’to hold back’, from *tardus* ’slow’ (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *retarder*
- *Say it:* *retarder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *retarder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to shift, then the French for the gap, then say *retarder* again

Before you move on

What does retarder mean? (“To delay, to hold up”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 421

Vol annulé

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can deal with a cancelled flight: the cancellation, the refund, confirming, calling off a booking and overbooking.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 421: I can deal with a cancelled flight: the cancellation, the refund, confirming, calling off a booking and overbooking.*

421.1 l'annulation — the cancellation

> Before the new one: say the French for the gap, then the French for to delay.

You'll want to know: l'annulation

l'annulation — "the cancellation".

> Après l'annulation, la compagnie nous a donné une chambre.
>
> *After the cancellation the airline gave us a room.*

A feminine noun.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

annulation is built on *annuler* 'to cancel', a learned borrowing from Late Latin *annullāre* 'to make nothing', from *nullus* 'none' (Lewis &

Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'annulation*
- *Say it: l'annulation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'annulation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the gap, then the French for to delay, then say *l'annulation* again

Before you move on

What does l'annulation mean? ("The cancellation".) Say it once more.

421.2 le remboursement — the refund

Before the new one: say the French for to delay, then the French for the cancellation.

You'll want to know: le remboursement

le remboursement — "the refund".

Elle attend le remboursement de son billet.

She is waiting for the refund on her ticket.

Built on *rembourser*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remboursement is built on *rembourser* 'to pay back', from *bourse* 'purse', which comes from Old French *borse* (EtymDB) and is usually traced to Late Latin *bursa*, from Greek *býrsa* 'hide'. EtymDB does not

list the noun.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le remboursement*
- *Say it: le remboursement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le remboursement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to delay, then the French for the cancellation, then say *le remboursement* again

Before you move on

What does le remboursement mean? ("The refund".) Say it once more.

421.3 confirmer — to confirm

Before the new one: say the French for the cancellation, then the French for the refund.

You'll want to know: confirmer

confirmer — "to confirm".

L'agence a confirmé notre vol par courriel.

The agency confirmed our flight by email.

La confirmation — the confirmation.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

confirmer is a learned borrowing from Latin *cōnfirmāre* 'to make firm', from *firmus* 'firm' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: confirmer*
- *Say it: confirmer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *confirmer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cancellation, then the French for the refund, then say *confirmer* again

Before you move on

What does confirmer mean? ("To confirm".) Say it once more.

421.4 décommander — to cancel (a booking, an order)

Before the new one: say the French for the refund, then the French for to confirm.

You'll want to know: décommander

décommander — "to cancel (a booking, an order)".

Après l'annulation du vol, nous avons décommandé le taxi.

After the flight was cancelled, we cancelled the taxi.

Se décommander — to cry off, to cancel at the last minute.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décommander is built from *dé-* and *commander* 'to order', which goes back through Vulgar Latin to Latin *commendāre* 'to entrust', built on *mandāre* (EtymDB lists *commander*).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: décommander*
- *Say it: décommander*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *décommander*
- *Recall:* say the French for the refund, then the French for to confirm, then say *décommander* again

Before you move on

What does décommander mean? ("To cancel (a booking, an order)".) Say it once more.

421.5 la surréservation — the overbooking

Before the new one: say the French for to confirm, then the French for to cancel.

You'll want to know: la surréservation

la surréservation — "the overbooking".

> À cause de la surréservation, deux passagers n'ont pas pu partir.
>
> *Because of the overbooking, two passengers could not leave.*

Many people say *le surbooking*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

surréservation is built from *sur-* 'over' and *réservation*, from *réserver* 'to keep aside', a learned borrowing from Latin *reservāre* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la surréservation*
- *Say it: la surréservation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la surréservation*
- *Recall:* say the French for to confirm, then the French for to cancel, then say *la surréservation* again

Before you move on

What does la surréservation mean? ("The overbooking".) Say it once more.

Chapter 422

La traversée

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can take a ferry: the ferry, the crossing, the cabin, the life jacket and getting off.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 422: I can take a ferry: the ferry, the crossing, the cabin, the life jacket and getting off.*

422.1 le ferry — the ferry

> Before the new one: say the French for to cancel, then the French for the overbooking.

You'll want to know: le ferry

le ferry — "the ferry".

> Nous prenons le ferry pour aller sur l'île.
>
> *We take the ferry to go over to the island.*

In Québec: *le traversier*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ferry was borrowed from English *ferry* (EtymDB), from a verb meaning 'to carry over water'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le ferry*
- *Say it: le ferry*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le ferry*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cancel, then the French for the overbooking, then say *le ferry* again

Before you move on

What does le ferry mean? ("The ferry".) Say it once more.

422.2 la traversée — the crossing (by sea)

Before the new one: say the French for the overbooking, then the French for the ferry.

You'll want to know: la traversée

la traversée — "the crossing (by sea)".

La traversée dure quatre heures.

The crossing takes four hours.

Built on *traverser* 'to cross'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

traversée is built on *traverser* 'to cross', which goes back to Latin *trānsversus* 'lying across', from *vertere* 'to turn' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the noun.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la traversée*
- *Say it: la traversée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la traversée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the overbooking, then the French for the ferry, then say *la traversée* again

Before you move on

What does la traversée mean? ("The crossing (by sea)".) Say it once more.

422.3 la cabine — the cabin

Before the new one: say the French for the ferry, then the French for the crossing.

You'll want to know: la cabine

la cabine — "the cabin".

Pour la nuit, ils ont pris une cabine avec deux lits.

For the night they took a cabin with two beds.

Une cabine d'essayage — a fitting room.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *cabine* is not settled; it is usually linked to a northern dialect word and to English *cabin*. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cabine*
- *Say it: la cabine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la cabine*
- *Recall:* say the French for the ferry, then the French for the crossing, then say *la cabine* again

Before you move on

What does la cabine mean? ("The cabin".) Say it once more.

422.4 le gilet — the waistcoat; the cardigan; the life jacket (gilet de sauvetage)

Before the new one: say the French for the crossing, then the French for the cabin.

You'll want to know: le gilet

le gilet — "the waistcoat; the cardigan; the life jacket (gilet de sauvetage)".

Sous chaque siège, il y a un gilet de sauvetage.

Under every seat there is a life jacket.

Le gilet de sauvetage — the life jacket. *Un gilet* can also be a cardigan.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gilet goes back to Turkish *yelek* 'waistcoat', which reached French through Arabic (EtymDB), probably by way of Spanish.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gilet*
- *Say it: le gilet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le gilet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the crossing, then the French for the cabin, then say *le gilet* again

Before you move on

What does le gilet mean? ("The waistcoat; the cardigan; the life jacket (gilet de sauvetage)".) Say it once more.

422.5 débarquer — to get off (a boat or plane), to land

Before the new one: say the French for the cabin, then the French for the waistcoat.

You'll want to know: débarquer

débarquer — "to get off (a boat or plane), to land".

Les passagers débarquent sur le quai.

The passengers get off onto the quay.

Informal: *il débarque* — he turns up out of the blue.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

débarquer is built from *dé-* and *barque* 'boat' (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *barca* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *débarquer*
- *Say it:* *débarquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *débarquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cabin, then the French for the waistcoat, then say *débarquer* again

Before you move on

What does débarquer mean? ("To get off (a boat or plane), to land".) Say it once more.

Chapter 423

En croisière

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a cruise: the cruise, coming alongside, pitching, capsizing and drifting.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 423: I can talk about a cruise: the cruise, coming alongside, pitching, capsizing and drifting.*

423.1 la croisière — the cruise

> Before the new one: say the French for the waistcoat, then the French for to get off.

You'll want to know: la croisière

la croisière — "the cruise".

> Mes grands-parents ont fait une croisière sur le fleuve.
>
> *My grandparents went on a river cruise.*

Une vitesse de croisière — cruising speed.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

croisière is built on *croiser* 'to cross, to sail to and fro', from *croix* 'cross', which is inherited from Latin *crux* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la croisière*
- *Say it: la croisière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la croisière*
- *Recall:* say the French for the waistcoat, then the French for to get off, then say *la croisière* again

Before you move on

What does la croisière mean? ("The cruise".) Say it once more.

423.2 accoster — to come alongside, to dock; to approach (someone)

Before the new one: say the French for to get off, then the French for the cruise.

You'll want to know: accoster

accoster — "to come alongside, to dock; to approach (someone)".

Le bateau accoste au port vers midi.

The boat docks in the harbour around noon.

Accoster quelqu'un — to go up to someone in the street.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accoster is built on *coste*, the old form of *côte* 'side, coast', which is inherited from Latin *costa* 'rib, side' (Lewis & Short): to bring the ship's side to the shore.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *accoster*
- *Say it:* *accoster*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *accoster*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get off, then the French for the cruise, then say *accoster* again

Before you move on

What does accoster mean? ("To come alongside, to dock; to approach (someone)".) Say it once more.

423.3 tanguer — to pitch (of a boat); to sway

Before the new one: say the French for the cruise, then the French for to come alongside.

You'll want to know: tanguer

tanguer — "to pitch (of a boat); to sway".

Avec le vent, le bateau tangue beaucoup.

In the wind the boat pitches a lot.

Tanguer is front to back; *rouler* is side to side.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *tanguer* is not settled. It is a sailors' word, and EtymDB gives no reliable source for it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tanguer*
- *Say it: tanguer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tanguer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cruise, then the French for to come alongside, then say *tanguer* again

Before you move on

What does tanguer mean? ("To pitch (of a boat); to sway".) Say it once more.

423.4 chavirer — to capsize; to tip over

Before the new one: say the French for to come alongside, then the French for to pitch.

You'll want to know: chavirer

chavirer — "to capsize; to tip over".

La petite barque a chaviré près des rochers.

The little boat capsized near the rocks.

Figurative: *son cœur chavire* — her heart turns over.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chavirer was borrowed from Provençal *capvirar* 'to turn upside down' (EtymDB), from *cap* 'head', from Latin *caput*, and *virar* 'to turn'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: chavirer*
- *Say it: chavirer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *chavirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to come alongside, then the French for to pitch, then say *chavirer* again

Before you move on

What does chavirer mean? ("To capsize; to tip over".) Say it once more.

423.5 dériver — to drift; to derive

Before the new one: say the French for to pitch, then the French for to capsize.

You'll want to know: dériver

dériver — "to drift; to derive".

Sans moteur, le canot a dérivé toute la nuit.

Without an engine the dinghy drifted all night.

À la dérive — adrift.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dériver 'to drift' is usually linked to English *drive*, reshaped after the older *dériver* 'to divert a stream', from Latin *dērīvāre* (Lewis & Short). The details are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dériver*
- *Say it: dériver*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dériver*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pitch, then the French for to capsize, then say *dériver* again

Before you move on

What does dériver mean? (“To drift; to derive”.) Say it once more.

423.6 Retour sur les chapitres 416–423

Say the French for the flight and the airport building.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the flight, the airport building, the check-in, the hold, the boarding
- the customs officer, to declare, the scanner gate, to search, to change planes
- to board, the flight attendant, the steward, the porthole, the aisle
- to take off, the take-off, the landing, to land, to fly over
- the turbulence, the stopover, to shift, the gap, to delay
- the cancellation, the refund, to confirm, to cancel, the overbooking
- the ferry, the crossing, the cabin, the waistcoat, to get off
- the cruise, to come alongside, to pitch, to capsize, to drift

Before you move on

The flight? (**le vol**.) The airport building? (**l'aérogare**.) The check-in? (**l'enregistrement**.) The hold? (**la soute**.) The boarding? (**l'embarquement**.) The customs officer? (**le douanier**.) To declare? (**déclarer**.) The scanner gate? (**le portique**.) To search? (**fouiller**.) To change planes? (**transiter**.) To board? (**embarquer**.) The flight attendant? (**l'hôtesse**.) The steward? (**le steward**.) The porthole? (**le hublot**.) The aisle? (**l'allée**.) To take off? (**décoller**.) The take-off? (**le décollage**.) The landing? (**l'atterrissage**.) To land? (**atterrir**.) To fly over? (**survoler**.) The turbulence? (**la turbulence**.) The stopover? (**l'escale**.) To shift? (**décaler**.) The gap? (**le décalage**.) To delay? (**retarder**.) The cancellation? (**l'annulation**.) The refund? (**le remboursement**.) To confirm? (**confirmer**.) To cancel? (**décommander**.) The overbooking? (**la surréservation**.) The ferry? (**le ferry**.) The crossing? (**la traversée**.) The cabin? (**la cabine**.) The waistcoat? (**le gilet**.) To get off? (**débarquer**.) The cruise? (**la croisière**.) To come alongside? (**accoster**.) To pitch? (**tanguer**.) To capsize? (**chavirer**.) To drift? (**dériver**.)

Chapter 424

Où dormir ?

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about places to stay: the inn, the holiday cottage, a night, staying somewhere and spending time there.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 424: I can talk about places to stay: the inn, the holiday cottage, a night, staying somewhere and spending time there.*

424.1 l'auberge — the inn; the hostel

> Before the new one: say the French for to capsize, then the French for to drift.

You'll want to know: l'auberge

l'auberge — "the inn; the hostel".

> Nous avons dormi dans une petite auberge de campagne.
>
> *We slept in a little country inn.*

A feminine noun. *Une auberge de jeunesse* — a youth hostel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

auberge was borrowed from Provençal *alberga*, which is usually traced to a Germanic word meaning 'shelter for an army'. EtymDB lists it

without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'auberge*
- *Say it: l'auberge*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'auberge*
- *Recall:* say the French for to capsize, then the French for to drift, then say *l'auberge* again

Before you move on

What does l'auberge mean? ("The inn; the hostel".) Say it once more.

424.2 le gîte — the holiday cottage; the shelter

Before the new one: say the French for to drift, then the French for the inn.

You'll want to know: le gîte

le gîte — "the holiday cottage; the shelter".

Cet été, ils louent un gîte à la campagne.

This summer they are renting a holiday cottage in the country.

Un gîte rural — a holiday cottage in the country.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gîte comes from Old French *giste* (EtymDB), built on *gésir* 'to lie down', which is inherited from Latin *iacēre* 'to lie' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gîte*
- *Say it: le gîte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le gîte*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drift, then the French for the inn, then say *le gîte* again

Before you move on

What does le gîte mean? ("The holiday cottage; the shelter".) Say it once more.

424.3 la nuitée — the overnight stay (paid for at a hotel)

Before the new one: say the French for the inn, then the French for the holiday cottage.

You'll want to know: la nuitée

la nuitée — "the overnight stay (paid for at a hotel)".

La nuitée coûte quatre-vingts euros avec le petit-déjeuner.

A night costs eighty euros with breakfast.

A word from hotel bills and prices.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nuitée is built on *nuit* 'night' (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *nox, noctis* 'night'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nuitée*
- *Say it: la nuitée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la nuitée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the inn, then the French for the holiday cottage, then say *la nuitée* again

Before you move on

What does la nuitée mean? ("The overnight stay (paid for at a hotel)".) Say it once more.

424.4 loger — to lodge, to stay; to put up

Before the new one: say the French for the holiday cottage, then the French for the overnight stay.

You'll want to know: loger

loger — "to lodge, to stay; to put up".

Pendant le festival, nous logeons chez des amis.

During the festival we are staying with friends.

Le logement — housing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

loger comes from Old French *logier* (EtymDB), built on *loge* 'hut', which is usually traced to a Frankish word for a shelter of leaves.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: loger*
- *Say it: loger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *loger*
- *Recall:* say the French for the holiday cottage, then the French for the overnight stay, then say *loger* again

Before you move on

What does loger mean? ("To lodge, to stay; to put up".) Say it once more.

424.5 séjourner — to stay for a while, to spend time (somewhere)

Before the new one: say the French for the overnight stay, then the French for to lodge.

You'll want to know: séjourner

séjourner — "to stay for a while, to spend time (somewhere)".

Ils ont séjourné une semaine au bord du lac.

They stayed a week by the lake.

More formal than *rester*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

séjourner goes back to Vulgar Latin *subdiurnāre* 'to spend the day', built on Latin *diurnus* 'of the day', from *diēs* 'day' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *séjourner*
- *Say it:* *séjourner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *séjourner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the overnight stay, then the French for to lodge, then say *séjourner* again

Before you move on

What does séjourner mean? ("To stay for a while, to spend time (somewhere)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 425

Au camping

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about camping: the campsite, the tent, the sleeping bag, camping and sleeping out in the open.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 425: I can talk about camping: the campsite, the tent, the sleeping bag, camping and sleeping out in the open.*

425.1 le camping — the campsite; camping

> Before the new one: say the French for to lodge, then the French for to stay for a while.

You'll want to know: le camping

le camping — "the campsite; camping".

> Le camping est à cinq minutes de la plage.
>
> *The campsite is five minutes from the beach.*

In French, *le camping* is also the place.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

camping was borrowed from English *camping* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le camping*
- *Say it: le camping*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le camping*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lodge, then the French for to stay for a while, then say *le camping* again

Before you move on

What does le camping mean? ("The campsite; camping".) Say it once more.

425.2 la tente — the tent

Before the new one: say the French for to stay for a while, then the French for the campsite.

You'll want to know: la tente

la tente — "the tent".

Les enfants ont monté la tente tout seuls.

The children put up the tent on their own.

Monter la tente — to pitch the tent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tente goes back to Vulgar Latin *tenta* 'something stretched', from Latin *tendere* 'to stretch' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tente*
- *Say it: la tente*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la tente*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stay for a while, then the French for the campsite, then say *la tente* again

Before you move on

What does la tente mean? (“The tent”.) Say it once more.

425.3 le sac de couchage — the sleeping bag

Before the new one: say the French for the campsite, then the French for the tent.

You’ll want to know: le sac de couchage

le sac de couchage — “the sleeping bag”.

Il fait froid la nuit, alors je dors dans mon sac de couchage.

It is cold at night, so I sleep in my sleeping bag.

In speech, often *le duvet*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sac is inherited from Latin *saccus*, from Greek *sákkos* ’bag’ (EtymDB); *couchage* is built on *coucher* ’to lie down’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sac de couchage*
- *Say it: le sac de couchage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sac de couchage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the campsite, then the French for the tent, then say *le sac de couchage* again

Before you move on

What does le sac de couchage mean? ("The sleeping bag".) Say it once more.

425.4 camper — to camp

Before the new one: say the French for the tent, then the French for the sleeping bag.

You'll want to know: camper

camper — "to camp".

L'été dernier, nous avons campé près d'une rivière.

Last summer we camped near a river.

Le campeur — the camper.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

camper is built on *camp* (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *campus* 'field, open plain'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: camper*
- *Say it: camper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *camper*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tent, then the French for the sleeping bag, then say *camper* again

Before you move on

What does camper mean? ("To camp".) Say it once more.

425.5 bivouaquer — to bivouac, to sleep out in the open

Before the new one: say the French for the sleeping bag, then the French for to camp.

You'll want to know: bivouaquer

bivouaquer — "to bivouac, to sleep out in the open".

En montagne, ils ont bivouaqué sous les étoiles.

In the mountains they slept out under the stars.

Un bivouac is one night in the open, often in the mountains.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bivouaquer is built on *bivouac*, which is usually traced to Swiss or Alsatian German *Biwacht* 'extra night watch'. EtymDB lists the verb without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bivouaquer*
- *Say it:* *bivouaquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bivouaquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sleeping bag, then the French for to camp, then say *bivouaquer* again

Before you move on

What does bivouaquer mean? ("To bivouac, to sleep out in the open".) Say it once more.

Chapter 426

À la réception

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can check in at a hotel: the front desk, the receptionist, the floor, the stay and unpacking.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 426: I can check in at a hotel: the front desk, the receptionist, the floor, the stay and unpacking.*

426.1 la réception — the reception desk; the reception (party)

> Before the new one: say the French for to camp, then the French for to bivouac.

You'll want to know: la réception

la réception — "the reception desk; the reception (party)".

> Nous laissons la clé à la réception.
>
> *We leave the key at reception.*

Une réception is also a formal party.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réception is a learned borrowing from Latin *receptiō* 'a receiving', from *recipere* 'to receive', built on *capere* 'to take' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réception*
- *Say it: la réception*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la réception*
- *Recall:* say the French for to camp, then the French for to bivouac, then say *la réception* again

Before you move on

What does la réception mean? ("The reception desk; the reception (party)".) Say it once more.

426.2 le réceptionniste — the receptionist

Before the new one: say the French for to bivouac, then the French for the reception desk.

You'll want to know: le réceptionniste

le réceptionniste — "the receptionist".

Le réceptionniste nous a donné un plan du quartier.

The receptionist gave us a map of the area.

Same form with *la* for a woman.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réceptionniste is built on *réception* with *-iste* (EtymDB lists it); *réception* goes back to Latin *receptiō*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le réceptionniste*
- *Say it: le réceptionniste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le réceptionniste*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bivouac, then the French for the reception desk, then say *le réceptionniste* again

Before you move on

What does le réceptionniste mean? ("The receptionist".) Say it once more.

426.3 l'étage — the storey, the floor (of a building)

Before the new one: say the French for the reception desk, then the French for the receptionist.

You'll want to know: l'étage

l'étage — "the storey, the floor (of a building)".

Notre chambre est au troisième étage.

Our room is on the third floor.

A masculine noun. *Le rez-de-chaussée* is the ground floor; the *premier étage* is one floor up.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étage comes from Old French *estage* 'dwelling, level', which is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin word built on *stāre* 'to stand'. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étage*
- *Say it: l'étage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'étage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the reception desk, then the French for the receptionist, then say *l'étage* again

Before you move on

What does l'étage mean? ("The storey, the floor (of a building)".) Say it once more.

426.4 le séjour — the stay; the living room

Before the new one: say the French for the receptionist, then the French for the storey.

You'll want to know: le séjour

le séjour — "the stay; the living room".

Le patron de l'hôtel nous a souhaité un bon séjour.

The hotel owner wished us a pleasant stay.

La salle de séjour or *le séjour* — the living room.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

séjour is built on *séjourner* 'to stay', which goes back to Vulgar Latin *subdiurnāre*, built on *diēs* 'day' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le séjour*
- *Say it: le séjour*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le séjour*
- *Recall:* say the French for the receptionist, then the French for the storey, then say *le séjour* again

Before you move on

What does le séjour mean? ("The stay; the living room".) Say it once more.

426.5 déballer — to unpack

Before the new one: say the French for the storey, then the French for the stay.

You'll want to know: déballer

déballer — "to unpack".

Il a déballé ses affaires et rangé ses chemises.

He unpacked his things and put his shirts away.

Figurative: *déballer tout* — to come out with everything.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déballer is built from *dé-* and *balle* 'bale, bundle', which is usually traced to a Frankish word meaning 'ball'. EtymDB does not list the verb.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *déballer*
- *Say it:* *déballer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déballer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the storey, then the French for the stay, then say *déballer* again

Before you move on

What does déballer mean? (“To unpack”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 427

Le confort de la chambre

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about comfort in a hotel room: the air conditioning, the heating, the radiator, the pillowcase and the bathrobe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 427: I can talk about comfort in a hotel room: the air conditioning, the heating, the radiator, the pillowcase and the bathrobe.*

427.1 la climatisation — the air conditioning

> Before the new one: say the French for the stay, then the French for to unpack.

You'll want to know: la climatisation

la climatisation — "the air conditioning".

> La climatisation fait trop de bruit la nuit.
>
> *The air conditioning makes too much noise at night.*

In speech, *la clim*. *Climatisé* — air-conditioned.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

climatisation is built on *climat* 'climate', from Latin *clima*, a learned word from Greek *klíma* 'slope, region' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB lists

it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la climatisation*
- *Say it: la climatisation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la climatisation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stay, then the French for to unpack, then say *la climatisation* again

Before you move on

What does la climatisation mean? ("The air conditioning".) Say it once more.

427.2 le chauffage — the heating

Before the new one: say the French for to unpack, then the French for the air conditioning.

You'll want to know: le chauffage

le chauffage — "the heating".

En hiver, le chauffage marche toute la journée.

In winter the heating runs all day.

Le chauffage central — central heating.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chauffage is built on *chauffer* 'to heat' with *-age*. *Chauffer* is inherited from Latin *calefacere* 'to make warm', from *calēre* 'to be warm' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chauffage*
- *Say it: le chauffage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chauffage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to unpack, then the French for the air conditioning, then say *le chauffage* again

Before you move on

What does le chauffage mean? ("The heating".) Say it once more.

427.3 le radiateur — the radiator

Before the new one: say the French for the air conditioning, then the French for the heating.

You'll want to know: le radiateur

le radiateur — "the radiator".

Elle a mis ses chaussettes sur le radiateur.

She put her socks on the radiator.

Also the radiator of a car.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

radiateur is a learned formation on Latin *radiāre* 'to send out rays', from *radius* 'ray' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le radiateur*
- *Say it: le radiateur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le radiateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the air conditioning, then the French for the heating, then say *le radiateur* again

Before you move on

What does le radiateur mean? ("The radiator".) Say it once more.

427.4 la taie — the pillowcase

Before the new one: say the French for the heating, then the French for the radiator.

You'll want to know: la taie

la taie — "the pillowcase".

La taie d'oreiller sent la lessive.

The pillowcase smells of washing powder.

In full: *la taie d'oreiller*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

taie comes from Old French *teie* (EtymDB), from Latin *thēca* 'case, cover', which came from Greek *thḗkē* 'box' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la taie*
- *Say it: la taie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la taie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the heating, then the French for the radiator, then say *la taie* again

Before you move on

What does la taie mean? ("The pillowcase".) Say it once more.

427.5 le peignoir — the bathrobe, the dressing gown

Before the new one: say the French for the radiator, then the French for the pillowcase.

You'll want to know: le peignoir

le peignoir — "the bathrobe, the dressing gown".

Après la douche, il met le peignoir de l'hôtel.

After the shower he puts on the hotel bathrobe.

Un peignoir de bain — a bathrobe.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

peignoir is built on *peigner* 'to comb', from Latin *pectināre*, from *pecten* 'comb' (Lewis & Short): first the gown worn while your hair was combed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le peignoir*
- *Say it: le peignoir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le peignoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the radiator, then the French for the pillowcase, then say *le peignoir* again

Before you move on

What does le peignoir mean? ("The bathrobe, the dressing gown".) Say it once more.

Chapter 428

Une fuite dans la salle de bains

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can report a bathroom problem: the leak, the tap, the washbasin, dripping and unblocking.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 428: I can report a bathroom problem: the leak, the tap, the washbasin, dripping and unblocking.*

428.1 la fuite — the leak; the escape

> Before the new one: say the French for the pillowcase, then the French for the bathrobe.

You'll want to know: la fuite

la fuite — "the leak; the escape".

> Il y a une fuite sous la douche.
>
> *There is a leak under the shower.*

Une fuite d'eau — a water leak; *prendre la fuite* — to run away.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fuite goes back to Vulgar Latin *fugita* 'a fleeing', from Latin *fugere* 'to flee' (Lewis & Short): the water escapes.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fuite*
- *Say it: la fuite*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fuite*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pillowcase, then the French for the bathrobe, then say *la fuite* again

Before you move on

What does la fuite mean? ("The leak; the escape".) Say it once more.

428.2 le robinet — the tap, the faucet

Before the new one: say the French for the bathrobe, then the French for the leak.

You'll want to know: le robinet

le robinet — "the tap, the faucet".

Le robinet d'eau chaude ne ferme plus.

The hot tap will not turn off any more.

Ouvrir le robinet — to turn on the tap.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

robinet is usually traced to an old pet name for a sheep: early taps were often shaped like a sheep's head. EtymDB lists the word without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le robinet*
- *Say it: le robinet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le robinet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bathrobe, then the French for the leak, then say *le robinet* again

Before you move on

What does le robinet mean? ("The tap, the faucet".) Say it once more.

428.3 le lavabo — the washbasin

Before the new one: say the French for the leak, then the French for the tap.

You'll want to know: le lavabo

le lavabo — "the washbasin".

Il se lave les mains au lavabo.

He washes his hands at the basin.

Le lavabo is the basin in the bathroom.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lavabo is a learned borrowing from Latin *lavābō* 'I will wash', from *lavāre* 'to wash' (EtymDB), first a word in a church prayer.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lavabo*
- *Say it: le lavabo*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le lavabo*
- *Recall:* say the French for the leak, then the French for the tap, then say *le lavabo* again

Before you move on

What does le lavabo mean? ("The washbasin".) Say it once more.

428.4 goutter — to drip

Before the new one: say the French for the tap, then the French for the washbasin.

You'll want to know: goutter

goutter — "to drip".

Le robinet goutte toute la nuit.

The tap drips all night.

Une goutte — a drop.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

goutter is built on *goutte* 'drop', which is inherited from Latin *gutta* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the verb.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: goutter*
- *Say it: goutter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *goutter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tap, then the French for the washbasin, then say *goutter* again

Before you move on

What does goutter mean? ("To drip".) Say it once more.

428.5 déboucher — to unblock; to uncork; to come out (onto)

Before the new one: say the French for the washbasin, then the French for to drip.

You'll want to know: déboucher

déboucher — "to unblock; to uncork; to come out (onto)".

Le plombier a débouché la douche en dix minutes.

The plumber unblocked the shower in ten minutes.

Déboucher une bouteille — to open a bottle; *la rue débouche sur la place* — the street comes out onto the square.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déboucher is built from *dé-* and *boucher* 'to stop up' (EtymDB), which comes from Middle French *bousche* 'bundle of straw', the old way to plug a hole.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *déboucher*
- *Say it:* *déboucher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déboucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the washbasin, then the French for to drip, then say *déboucher* again

Before you move on

What does déboucher mean? (“To unblock; to uncork; to come out (onto)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 429

Petits soucis dans la chambre

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe small problems in a room: the light bulb, the socket, the minibar, the carpet and a stain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 429: I can describe small problems in a room: the light bulb, the socket, the minibar, the carpet and a stain.*

429.1 l'ampoule — the light bulb; the blister

> Before the new one: say the French for to drip, then the French for to unblock.

You'll want to know: l'ampoule

l'ampoule — "the light bulb; the blister".

> L'ampoule de la lampe ne marche plus.
>
> *The bulb in the lamp has gone.*

A feminine noun. After a long walk, *une ampoule* is a blister.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ampoule is inherited from Latin *ampulla* 'small flask', built on *amphora* (EtymDB): a bulb looks like a little glass flask.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ampoule*
- *Say it: l'ampoule*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'ampoule*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drip, then the French for to unblock, then say *l'ampoule* again

Before you move on

What does l'ampoule mean? ("The light bulb; the blister".) Say it once more.

429.2 la prise — the socket (for electricity), the plug; the hold

Before the new one: say the French for to unblock, then the French for the light bulb.

You'll want to know: la prise

la prise — "the socket (for electricity), the plug; the hold".

Il n'y a pas de prise près du lit.

There is no socket near the bed.

Une prise de courant — a socket; *une prise* also a grip or hold.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prise is the feminine past participle of *prendre* 'to take', used as a noun (EtymDB); *prendre* is inherited from Latin *prehendere* 'to grasp'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la prise*
- *Say it: la prise*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la prise*
- *Recall:* say the French for to unblock, then the French for the light bulb, then say *la prise* again

Before you move on

What does la prise mean? ("The socket (for electricity), the plug; the hold".) Say it once more.

429.3 le minibar — the minibar

Before the new one: say the French for the light bulb, then the French for the socket.

You'll want to know: le minibar

le minibar — "the minibar".

Les boissons du minibar sont très chères.

The drinks in the minibar are very dear.

Plural *les minibars*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

minibar is built from *mini-* 'small' and *bar*, which was borrowed from English *bar*. EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le minibar*
- *Say it: le minibar*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le minibar*
- *Recall:* say the French for the light bulb, then the French for the socket, then say *le minibar* again

Before you move on

What does le minibar mean? ("The minibar".) Say it once more.

429.4 la moquette — the fitted carpet

Before the new one: say the French for the socket, then the French for the minibar.

You'll want to know: la moquette

la moquette — "the fitted carpet".

La moquette de la chambre est un peu sale.

The carpet in the room is a bit dirty.

Un tapis is a rug; *la moquette* covers the whole floor. In Belgium also *le tapis plain*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *moquette* is not settled; it was first a kind of thick cloth. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la moquette*
- *Say it: la moquette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la moquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for the socket, then the French for the minibar, then say *la moquette* again

Before you move on

What does la moquette mean? (“The fitted carpet”.) Say it once more.

429.5 la tache — the stain, the spot

Before the new one: say the French for the minibar, then the French for the fitted carpet.

You’ll want to know: la tache

la tache — “the stain, the spot”.

Il y a une tache de café sur le drap.

There is a coffee stain on the sheet.

No accent: *une tache* is a stain; *une tâche* is a task.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tache comes from Old French *tache* (EtymDB), which is usually traced to a Germanic word meaning ’sign, mark’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la tache*
- *Say it:* *la tache*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la tache*
- *Recall:* say the French for the minibar, then the French for the fitted carpet, then say *la tache* again

Before you move on

What does la tache mean? ("The stain, the spot".) Say it once more.

Chapter 430

Bestioles et volets

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can complain about bugs and light in a room: the bedbug, the cockroach, the mosquito net, the shutter and the blind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 430: I can complain about bugs and light in a room: the bedbug, the cockroach, the mosquito net, the shutter and the blind.*

430.1 la punaise — the bedbug; the drawing pin

> Before the new one: say the French for the fitted carpet, then the French for the stain.

You'll want to know: la punaise

la punaise — "the bedbug; the drawing pin".

> Elle a trouvé des punaises dans le matelas.
>
> *She found bedbugs in the mattress.*

Une punaise de lit — a bedbug; in an office, *une punaise* is a drawing pin.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

punaise is built on the old adjective *punais* 'stinking' (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *putēre* 'to stink'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la punaise*
- *Say it: la punaise*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la punaise*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fitted carpet, then the French for the stain, then say *la punaise* again

Before you move on

What does la punaise mean? ("The bedbug; the drawing pin".) Say it once more.

430.2 le cafard — the cockroach; the blues

Before the new one: say the French for the stain, then the French for the bedbug.

You'll want to know: le cafard

le cafard — "the cockroach; the blues".

Il y avait un cafard dans la salle de bains.

There was a cockroach in the bathroom.

Avoir le cafard — to feel low.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cafard is usually traced to Arabic *kāfir* 'unbeliever', first an insult for a two-faced person; the path to the insect is not settled. EtymDB lists the word without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cafard*
- *Say it: le cafard*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cafard*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stain, then the French for the bedbug, then say *le cafard* again

Before you move on

What does le cafard mean? ("The cockroach; the blues".) Say it once more.

430.3 la moustiquaire — the mosquito net; the fly screen

Before the new one: say the French for the bedbug, then the French for the cockroach.

You'll want to know: la moustiquaire

la moustiquaire — "the mosquito net; the fly screen".

La fenêtre a une moustiquaire, alors nous dormons bien.

The window has a fly screen, so we sleep well.

Built on *le moustique*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moustiquaire is built on *moustique* 'mosquito', from Spanish *mosquito* 'little fly', which goes back to Latin *musca* 'fly' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la moustiquaire*
- *Say it: la moustiquaire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la moustiquaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bedbug, then the French for the cockroach, then say *la moustiquaire* again

Before you move on

What does la moustiquaire mean? ("The mosquito net; the fly screen".) Say it once more.

430.4 le volet — the shutter

Before the new one: say the French for the cockroach, then the French for the mosquito net.

You'll want to know: le volet

le volet — "the shutter".

Le matin, elle ouvre les volets de la chambre.

In the morning she opens the bedroom shutters.

Fermer les volets — to close the shutters.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

volet is built on *voler* 'to fly' (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *volāre*: a panel that swings open like a wing.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le volet*
- *Say it: le volet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le volet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cockroach, then the French for the mosquito net, then say *le volet* again

Before you move on

What does le volet mean? ("The shutter".) Say it once more.

430.5 le store — the blind (on a window)

Before the new one: say the French for the mosquito net, then the French for the shutter.

You'll want to know: le store

le store — "the blind (on a window)".

Le store est cassé, il ne descend plus.

The blind is broken; it will not come down any more.

Baisser le store — to pull down the blind.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

store is usually traced to Italian *stora*; behind it is Latin *storea* 'mat of rushes' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le store*
- *Say it: le store*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le store*
- *Recall:* say the French for the mosquito net, then the French for the shutter, then say *le store* again

Before you move on

What does le store mean? ("The blind (on a window)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 431

On n’est pas content

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can complain: the complaint, demanding, grumbling, disturbing someone and being unhappy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 431: I can complain: the complaint, demanding, grumbling, disturbing someone and being unhappy.*

431.1 la réclamation — the complaint, the claim

> Before the new one: say the French for the shutter, then the French for the blind.

You’ll want to know: la réclamation

la réclamation — “the complaint, the claim”.

> Nous avons fait une réclamation à la direction de l’hôtel.
>
> *We made a complaint to the hotel management.*

Formal; *le service des réclamations* — the complaints department.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réclamation is a learned borrowing from Latin *reclāmātiō* ’a crying out against’ (EtymDB), from *clāmāre* ’to shout’.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réclamation*
- *Say it: la réclamation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la réclamation*
- *Recall:* say the French for the shutter, then the French for the blind, then say *la réclamation* again

Before you move on

What does la réclamation mean? ("The complaint, the claim".) Say it once more.

431.2 réclamer — to ask for, to demand; to claim

Before the new one: say the French for the blind, then the French for the complaint.

You'll want to know: réclamer

réclamer — "to ask for, to demand; to claim".

Il a réclamé une autre chambre, plus calme.

He asked for another, quieter room.

Réclamer son argent — to demand one's money back.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réclamer comes from Old French *reclamer*, from Latin *reclāmāre* 'to cry out against', built on *clāmāre* 'to shout' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: réclamer*
- *Say it: réclamer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *réclamer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the blind, then the French for the complaint, then say *réclamer* again

Before you move on

What does réclamer mean? (“To ask for, to demand; to claim”.) Say it once more.

431.3 rouspéter — to grumble, to moan

Before the new one: say the French for the complaint, then the French for to ask for.

You’ll want to know: rouspéter

rouspéter — “to grumble, to moan”.

Mon oncle rouspète toujours contre le service.

My uncle is forever grumbling about the service.

Informal. *Il rouspète* — he moans.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *rouspéter* is not settled; it is an old slang word. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rouspéter*
- *Say it: rouspéter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rouspéter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the complaint, then the French for to ask for, then say *rouspéter* again

Before you move on

What does rouspéter mean? ("To grumble, to moan".) Say it once more.

431.4 déranger — to disturb, to bother

Before the new one: say the French for to ask for, then the French for to grumble.

You'll want to know: déranger

déranger — "to disturb, to bother".

La musique des voisins nous a dérangés toute la nuit.

The neighbours' music disturbed us all night.

Ne pas déranger — do not disturb, on a hotel door.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déranger comes from Old French *desrengier* 'to throw out of line', from *des-* and *rengier* 'to put in a row', built on *reng* 'row' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: déranger*
- *Say it: déranger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déranger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to ask for, then the French for to grumble, then say *déranger* again

Before you move on

What does déranger mean? (“To disturb, to bother”.) Say it once more.

431.5 mécontent — unhappy, dissatisfied

Before the new one: say the French for to grumble, then the French for to disturb.

You’ll want to know: mécontent

mécontent — “unhappy, dissatisfied”.

Les clients sont mécontents du petit-déjeuner.

The guests are unhappy with the breakfast.

Mécontent de — unhappy with; *le mécontentement* — discontent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mécontent is built from *mé-* ’badly, not’ and *content* ’glad’, from Latin *contentus* ’satisfied’, from *continēre*, built on *tenēre* ’to hold’ (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: mécontent*
- *Say it: mécontent*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *mécontent*
- *Recall:* say the French for to grumble, then the French for to disturb, then say *mécontent* again

Before you move on

What does mécontent mean? (“Unhappy, dissatisfied”.) Say it once more.

431.6 Retour sur les chapitres 424–431

Say the French for the inn and the holiday cottage.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the inn, the holiday cottage, the overnight stay, to lodge, to stay for a while
- the campsite, the tent, the sleeping bag, to camp, to bivouac
- the reception desk, the receptionist, the storey, the stay, to unpack
- the air conditioning, the heating, the radiator, the pillowcase, the bathrobe
- the leak, the tap, the washbasin, to drip, to unblock
- the light bulb, the socket, the minibar, the fitted carpet, the stain
- the bedbug, the cockroach, the mosquito net, the shutter, the blind
- the complaint, to ask for, to grumble, to disturb, unhappy

Before you move on

The inn? (**l'auberge**.) The holiday cottage? (**le gîte**.) The overnight stay? (**la nuitée**.) To lodge? (**loger**.) To stay for a while? (**séjourner**.) The campsite? (**le camping**.) The tent? (**la tente**.) The sleeping bag? (**le sac de couchage**.) To camp? (**camper**.) To bivouac? (**bivouaquer**.) The reception desk? (**la réception**.) The receptionist? (**le réceptionniste**.) The storey? (**l'étage**.) The stay? (**le séjour**.) To unpack? (**déballer**.) The air conditioning? (**la climatisation**.) The heating? (**le chauffage**.) The radiator? (**le radiateur**.) The pillowcase? (**la taie**.) The bathrobe? (**le peignoir**.) The leak? (**la fuite**.) The tap? (**le robinet**.) The washbasin? (**le lavabo**.) To drip? (**goutter**.) To unblock? (**déboucher**.) The light bulb? (**l'ampoule**.) The socket? (**la prise**.) The minibar? (**le minibar**.) The fitted carpet? (**la moquette**.) The stain? (**la tache**.) The bedbug? (**la punaise**.) The cockroach? (**le cafard**.) The mosquito net? (**la moustiquaire**.) The shutter? (**le volet**.) The blind? (**le store**.) The complaint? (**la réclamation**.) To ask for? (**réclamer**.) To grumble? (**rouspéter**.) To disturb? (**déranger**.) Unhappy? (**mécontent**.)

Chapter 432

Parler au gérant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can take a problem to the manager: the manager, the inconvenience, reporting a problem, the cleaning and something faulty.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 432: I can take a problem to the manager: the manager, the inconvenience, reporting a problem, the cleaning and something faulty.*

432.1 le gérant — the manager

> Before the new one: say the French for to disturb, then the French for unhappy.

You'll want to know: le gérant

le gérant — "the manager".

> Le gérant de l'hôtel est venu voir la chambre.
>
> *The hotel manager came to check the room.*

Feminine *la gérante*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gérant is built on *gérer* 'to manage', a learned borrowing from Latin *gerere* 'to carry on, to run' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB lists it without a

source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le gérant*
- *Say it: le gérant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le gérant*
- *Recall:* say the French for to disturb, then the French for unhappy, then say *le gérant* again

Before you move on

What does le gérant mean? ("The manager".) Say it once more.

432.2 le désagrément — the inconvenience, the nuisance

Before the new one: say the French for unhappy, then the French for the manager.

You'll want to know: le désagrément

le désagrément — "the inconvenience, the nuisance".

Nous sommes désolés pour ce désagrément.

We are sorry for the inconvenience.

A polite word in apologies.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désagrément is built from *dés-* and *agrément* 'pleasure', from *agréer* 'to please', from *gré* 'liking', which goes back to Latin *grātum* 'something pleasing' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le désagrément*
- *Say it: le désagrément*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le désagrément*
- *Recall:* say the French for unhappy, then the French for the manager, then say *le désagrément* again

Before you move on

What does le désagrément mean? ("The inconvenience, the nuisance".) Say it once more.

432.3 signaler — to report, to point out

Before the new one: say the French for the manager, then the French for the inconvenience.

You'll want to know: signaler

signaler — "to report, to point out".

J'ai signalé la fuite à la réception.

I reported the leak to reception.

Signaler un problème — to report a problem.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

signaler is built on *signal*, from Late Latin *signāle*, from *signum* 'mark, sign' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: signaler*
- *Say it: signaler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *signaler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the manager, then the French for the inconvenience, then say *signaler* again

Before you move on

What does signaler mean? ("To report, to point out".) Say it once more.

432.4 le ménage — the cleaning, the housework; the household

Before the new one: say the French for the inconvenience, then the French for to report.

You'll want to know: le ménage

le ménage — "the cleaning, the housework; the household".

Le ménage n'a pas été fait dans notre chambre.

Our room has not been cleaned.

Faire le ménage — to do the cleaning.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ménage comes from Old French *manage* 'dwelling, household' (EtymDB), usually traced to a word built on Latin *manēre* 'to stay'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le ménage*
- *Say it: le ménage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le ménage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the inconvenience, then the French for to report, then say *le ménage* again

Before you move on

What does le ménage mean? ("The cleaning, the housework; the household".) Say it once more.

432.5 défectueux — faulty, defective

Before the new one: say the French for to report, then the French for the cleaning.

You'll want to know: défectueux

défectueux — "faulty, defective".

La télévision est défectueuse depuis notre arrivée.

The television has been faulty since we arrived.

Feminine *défectueuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

défectueux is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *dēfectuōsus*, from *dēfectus* 'lack', from *dēficere* 'to fail', built on *facere* 'to do' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *défectueux*
- *Say it:* *défectueux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *défectueux*
- *Recall:* say the French for to report, then the French for the cleaning, then say *défectueux* again

Before you move on

What does défectueux mean? ("Faulty, defective".) Say it once more.

Chapter 433

Être dédommagé

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about deposits and compensation: the down payment, the deposit, compensation, compensating someone and paying damages.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 433: I can talk about deposits and compensation: the down payment, the deposit, compensation, compensating someone and paying damages.*

433.1 l'acompte — the down payment, the part payment

> Before the new one: say the French for the cleaning, then the French for faulty.

You'll want to know: l'acompte

l'acompte — "the down payment, the part payment".

> Pour le gîte, nous avons versé un acompte de cent euros.
>
> *For the cottage we paid a hundred euros up front.*

A masculine noun. *Verser un acompte* — to pay a part in advance.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

acompte comes from *à compte* 'on account', from *compte*, built on *compter* 'to count', which goes back to Latin *computāre* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'acompte*
- *Say it: l'acompte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'acompte*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cleaning, then the French for faulty, then say *l'acompte* again

Before you move on

What does l'acompte mean? ("The down payment, the part payment".) Say it once more.

433.2 les arrhes — the deposit (that is not refunded)

Before the new one: say the French for faulty, then the French for the down payment.

You'll want to know: les arrhes

les arrhes — "the deposit (that is not refunded)".

Si vous annulez, vous perdez les arrhes.

If you cancel, you lose the deposit.

Feminine plural: *des arrhes*. The *h* is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrhes is a learned borrowing from Latin *arrha* 'pledge' (EtymDB), which came from Greek *arrhabṓn*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les arrhes*
- *Say it: les arrhes*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les arrhes*
- *Recall:* say the French for faulty, then the French for the down payment, then say *les arrhes* again

Before you move on

What does les arrhes mean? ("The deposit (that is not refunded)".) Say it once more.

433.3 dédommager — to compensate

Before the new one: say the French for the down payment, then the French for the deposit.

You'll want to know: dédommager

dédommager — "to compensate".

La compagnie a dédommagé les passagers du vol annulé.

The airline compensated the passengers of the cancelled flight.

Dédommager quelqu'un de quelque chose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dédommager is built from *dé-* 'un-' and *dommage* 'harm', which goes back to Latin *damnum* 'loss' (Lewis & Short); EtymDB lists the verb.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dédommager*
- *Say it: dédommager*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dédommager*
- *Recall:* say the French for the down payment, then the French for the deposit, then say *dédommager* again

Before you move on

What does dédommager mean? ("To compensate".) Say it once more.

433.4 le dédommagement — the compensation

Before the new one: say the French for the deposit, then the French for to compensate.

You'll want to know: le dédommagement

le dédommagement — "the compensation".

L'hôtel nous a offert un repas en dédommagement.

The hotel offered us a meal by way of compensation.

En dédommagement — as compensation.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dédommagement is built on *dédommager* with *-ment* (EtymDB). *Dédommager* comes from *dommage* 'harm', from Latin *damnum* 'loss' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dédommagement*
- *Say it: le dédommagement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le dédommagement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the deposit, then the French for to compensate, then say *le dédommagement* again

Before you move on

What does le dédommagement mean? ("The compensation".) Say it once more.

433.5 indemniser — to pay damages to, to indemnify

Before the new one: say the French for to compensate, then the French for the compensation.

You'll want to know: indemniser

indemniser — "to pay damages to, to indemnify".

L'assurance va nous indemniser pour la valise perdue.

The insurance is going to pay us for the lost suitcase.

Formal, used by insurers: *l'indemnisation*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

indemniser is built on *indemne* 'unharmed', a learned borrowing from Latin *indemnis*, from *in-* 'not' and *damnum* 'loss' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: indemniser*
- *Say it: indemniser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *indemniser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to compensate, then the French for the compensation, then say *indemniser* again

Before you move on

What does indemniser mean? ("To pay damages to, to indemnify".) Say it once more.

Chapter 434

Trouver son chemin

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find my bearings: getting oriented, the compass, spotting a landmark, the landmark itself and getting lost.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 434: I can find my bearings: getting oriented, the compass, spotting a landmark, the landmark itself and getting lost.*

434.1 orienter — to get one's bearings (mostly reflexive: s'orienter); to guide

> Before the new one: say the French for the compensation, then the French for to pay damages to.

You'll want to know: orienter

orienter — "to get one's bearings (mostly reflexive: s'orienter); to guide".

> Dans la vieille ville, je m'oriente mal.
>
> *In the old town I find it hard to get my bearings.*

Mostly reflexive: *s'orienter*. *Le sens de l'orientation* — a sense of direction.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

orienter is built on *orient* 'east', from Latin *oriēns* 'rising', said of the sun, from *orīrī* 'to rise' (Lewis & Short): first to turn towards the east.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: orienter*
- *Say it: orienter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *orienter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the compensation, then the French for to pay damages to, then say *orienter* again

Before you move on

What does orienter mean? ("To get one's bearings (mostly reflexive: s'orienter); to guide".) Say it once more.

434.2 la boussole — the compass

Before the new one: say the French for to pay damages to, then the French for to get one's bearings.

You'll want to know: la boussole

la boussole — "the compass".

En forêt, il garde toujours sa boussole sur lui.

In the woods he keeps his compass on him the whole time.

Perdre la boussole — to lose one's head.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boussole was borrowed from Italian *bussola* 'compass' (EtymDB), from Late Latin *buxula* 'small box', built on *buxus* 'box tree'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la boussole*
- *Say it: la boussole*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la boussole*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pay damages to, then the French for to get one's bearings, then say *la boussole* again

Before you move on

What does la boussole mean? ("The compass".) Say it once more.

434.3 repérer — to spot; to find one's way (se repérer)

Before the new one: say the French for to get one's bearings, then the French for the compass.

You'll want to know: repérer

repérer — "to spot; to find one's way (se repérer)".

Elle a repéré un petit café près de la gare.

She spotted a little café near the station.

Se repérer — to find your way around.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

repérer is built on *repère* 'mark, landmark' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: repérer*
- *Say it: repérer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *repérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to get one's bearings, then the French for the compass, then say *repérer* again

Before you move on

What does repérer mean? ("To spot; to find one's way (se repérer)".) Say it once more.

434.4 le repère — the landmark, the reference point

Before the new one: say the French for the compass, then the French for to spot.

You'll want to know: le repère

le repère — "the landmark, the reference point".

L'église est un bon repère pour retrouver l'hôtel.

The church is a good landmark for finding the hotel again.

Un point de repère — a landmark.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

repère is usually explained as a spelling of *repaire* 'den, resting place' reshaped after Latin *reperīre* 'to find' (Lewis & Short); the details are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le repère*
- *Say it: le repère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le repère*
- *Recall:* say the French for the compass, then the French for to spot, then say *le repère* again

Before you move on

What does le repère mean? ("The landmark, the reference point".) Say it once more.

434.5 égarer — to mislay; to get lost (s'égarer)

Before the new one: say the French for to spot, then the French for the landmark.

You'll want to know: égarer

égarer — "to mislay; to get lost (s'égarer)".

Sans carte, ils se sont égarés dans les petites rues.

Without a map they got lost in the little streets.

S'égarer — to lose your way; *égarer ses clés* — to mislay your keys.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

égarer comes from Old French *esgarer* (EtymDB), which is usually traced to a Frankish verb meaning 'to watch over', with *es-* 'away'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *égarer*
- *Say it:* *égarer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *égarer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to spot, then the French for the landmark, then say *égarer* again

Before you move on

What does égarer mean? ("To mislay; to get lost (s'égarer)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 435

Les panneaux

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can follow signs: the sign, the arrow, the crossroads, the marker post and the corner.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 435: I can follow signs: the sign, the arrow, the crossroads, the marker post and the corner.*

435.1 le panneau — the road sign; the panel

> Before the new one: say the French for the landmark, then the French for to mislay.

You'll want to know: le panneau

le panneau — "the road sign; the panel".

> Le panneau indique le centre-ville à deux kilomètres.
>
> *The sign shows the town centre two kilometres away.*

Plural *les panneaux*. *Tomber dans le panneau* — to fall for it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

panneau comes from Old French *panel* (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *pannellus*, a small *pannus* 'piece of cloth'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le panneau*
- *Say it: le panneau*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le panneau*
- *Recall:* say the French for the landmark, then the French for to mislay, then say *le panneau* again

Before you move on

What does le panneau mean? ("The road sign; the panel".) Say it once more.

435.2 la flèche — the arrow

Before the new one: say the French for to mislay, then the French for the road sign.

You'll want to know: la flèche

la flèche — "the arrow".

Il suit les flèches jusqu'au parking.

He follows the arrows to the car park.

Partir en flèche — to shoot off.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flèche comes from Old French *fleche*, which goes back to a Frankish word for 'arrow' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la flèche*
- *Say it: la flèche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la flèche*
- *Recall:* say the French for to mislay, then the French for the road sign, then say *la flèche* again

Before you move on

What does la flèche mean? ("The arrow".) Say it once more.

435.3 le croisement — the crossroads, the junction

Before the new one: say the French for the road sign, then the French for the arrow.

You'll want to know: le croisement

le croisement — "the crossroads, the junction".

> Au croisement, nous tournons à droite.
>
> *At the crossroads we turn right.*

Close to *le carrefour*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

croisement is built on *croiser* 'to cross' with *-ment*; *croiser* comes from *croix*, inherited from Latin *crux* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the noun.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le croisement*
- *Say it: le croisement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le croisement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the road sign, then the French for the arrow, then say *le croisement* again

Before you move on

What does le croisement mean? (“The crossroads, the junction”.) Say it once more.

435.4 la borne — the marker post, the boundary stone; the charging point

Before the new one: say the French for the arrow, then the French for the crossroads.

You’ll want to know: la borne

la borne — “the marker post, the boundary stone; the charging point”.

Une vieille borne au bord de la route indique le village.

An old marker stone by the road points to the village.

Une borne kilométrique — a kilometre stone; *une borne de recharge* — a charging point.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

borne comes from an Old French word found as *bodne* and *bontie* (EtymDB gives *bontie*), which is usually traced to a Gaulish word for a boundary mark; the origin is not fully settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la borne*
- *Say it: la borne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la borne*
- *Recall:* say the French for the arrow, then the French for the crossroads, then say *la borne* again

Before you move on

What does la borne mean? ("The marker post, the boundary stone; the charging point".) Say it once more.

435.5 l'angle — the corner; the angle

Before the new one: say the French for the crossroads, then the French for the marker post.

You'll want to know: l'angle

l'angle — "the corner; the angle".

La pharmacie est à l'angle de la rue.

The chemist's is on the corner of the street.

A masculine noun. *À l'angle de* — on the corner of.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

angle came through Old French from Latin *angulus* 'corner, angle' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'angle*
- *Say it: l'angle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'angle*
- *Recall:* say the French for the crossroads, then the French for the marker post, then say *l'angle* again

Before you move on

What does l'angle mean? ("The corner; the angle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 436

Raccourcis et détours

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about routes: the shortcut, the detour, the route plan, going round something and turning back.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 436: I can talk about routes: the shortcut, the detour, the route plan, going round something and turning back.*

436.1 le raccourci — the shortcut

> Before the new one: say the French for the marker post, then the French for the corner.

You'll want to know: le raccourci

le raccourci — "the shortcut".

> Il connaît un raccourci par le parc.
>
> *He knows a shortcut through the park.*

Built on *raccourcir* 'to shorten'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raccourci is the past participle of *raccourcir* 'to shorten', used as a noun (EtymDB); the verb is built on *court* 'short', from Latin *curtus* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le raccourci*
- *Say it: le raccourci*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le raccourci*
- *Recall:* say the French for the marker post, then the French for the corner, then say *le raccourci* again

Before you move on

What does le raccourci mean? ("The shortcut".) Say it once more.

436.2 le détour — the detour, the roundabout way

Before the new one: say the French for the corner, then the French for the shortcut.

You'll want to know: le détour

le détour — "the detour, the roundabout way".

Nous avons fait un détour pour voir le château.

We made a detour to visit the castle.

Sans détour — straight out, frankly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

détour comes from Old French *destour*, built on *détourner* 'to turn away' (EtymDB), from *tourner*, which goes back to Latin *tornāre* 'to turn on a lathe'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le détour*
- *Say it: le détour*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le détour*
- *Recall:* say the French for the corner, then the French for the shortcut, then say *le détour* again

Before you move on

What does le détour mean? ("The detour, the roundabout way".) Say it once more.

436.3 l'itinéraire — the route, the itinerary

Before the new one: say the French for the shortcut, then the French for the detour.

You'll want to know: l'itinéraire

l'itinéraire — "the route, the itinerary".

Avant de partir, elle prépare son itinéraire.

Before leaving, she plans her route.

A masculine noun. *Un itinéraire bis* — an alternative route.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

itinéraire is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *itinerārium* 'travel guide' (EtymDB), from *iter, itineris* 'journey'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'itinéraire*
- *Say it: l'itinéraire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'itinéraire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the shortcut, then the French for the detour, then say *l'itinéraire* again

Before you move on

What does l'itinéraire mean? ("The route, the itinerary".) Say it once more.

436.4 contourner — to go round, to bypass

Before the new one: say the French for the detour, then the French for the route.

You'll want to know: contourner

contourner — "to go round, to bypass".

La route contourne la ville par le nord.

The road goes round the town to the north.

Figurative: *contourner un problème* — to get round a problem.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

contourner goes back to Vulgar Latin *contornāre* (EtymDB), from Latin *tornāre* 'to turn'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: contourner*
- *Say it: contourner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *contourner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the detour, then the French for the route, then say *contourner* again

Before you move on

What does contourner mean? ("To go round, to bypass".) Say it once more.

436.5 rebrousser — to turn back (rebrousser chemin)

Before the new one: say the French for the route, then the French for to go round.

You'll want to know: rebrousser

rebrousser — "to turn back (rebrousser chemin)".

La route était fermée, alors nous avons rebroussé chemin.

The road was closed, so we turned back.

Almost always in *rebrousser chemin* — to retrace one's steps.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rebrousser is usually traced to *rebours* 'against the grain', from Late Latin *reburrus* 'with hair standing up'; the details are not settled, and EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rebrousser*
- *Say it:* *rebrousser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rebrousser*
- *Recall:* say the French for the route, then the French for to go round, then say *rebrousser* again

Before you move on

What does rebrousser mean? (“To turn back (rebrousser chemin)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 437

Petites rues et grandes avenues

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe streets: the dead end, the alley, the avenue, the boulevard and the passer-by.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 437: I can describe streets: the dead end, the alley, the avenue, the boulevard and the passer-by.*

437.1 l'impasse — the dead end; the deadlock

> Before the new one: say the French for to go round, then the French for to turn back.

You'll want to know: l'impasse

l'impasse — "the dead end; the deadlock".

> L'hôtel est au fond d'une impasse calme.
>
> *The hotel is at the end of a quiet dead end.*

A feminine noun. Figurative: *être dans l'impasse* — to be at a deadlock.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

impasse is built from *in-* 'not' and *passe*, from *passer* 'to pass' (EtymDB), which goes back to Vulgar Latin *passāre*, from *passus* 'a step'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'impasse*
- *Say it: l'impasse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'impasse*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go round, then the French for to turn back, then say *l'impasse* again

Before you move on

What does l'impasse mean? ("The dead end; the deadlock".) Say it once more.

437.2 la ruelle — the alley, the lane

Before the new one: say the French for to turn back, then the French for the dead end.

You'll want to know: la ruelle

la ruelle — "the alley, the lane".

Nous nous promenons dans les ruelles du vieux quartier.

We stroll through the alleys of the old quarter.

A small *rue*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ruelle is a small *rue* 'street', which is inherited from Latin *rūga* 'wrinkle, fold' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la ruelle*
- *Say it: la ruelle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la ruelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for to turn back, then the French for the dead end, then say *la ruelle* again

Before you move on

What does la ruelle mean? (“The alley, the lane”.) Say it once more.

437.3 l’avenue — the avenue

Before the new one: say the French for the dead end, then the French for the alley.

You’ll want to know: l’avenue

l’avenue — “the avenue”.

Les grands magasins sont sur l’avenue principale.

The big shops are on the main avenue.

A feminine noun.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avenue is the old feminine past participle of *avenir* ’to come to’ (EtymDB), from Latin *advenīre*, built on *venīre* ’to come’: the way that leads up to a place.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'avenue*
- *Say it: l'avenue*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'avenue*
- *Recall:* say the French for the dead end, then the French for the alley, then say *l'avenue* again

Before you move on

What does l'avenue mean? ("The avenue".) Say it once more.

437.4 le boulevard — the boulevard

Before the new one: say the French for the alley, then the French for the avenue.

You'll want to know: le boulevard

le boulevard — "the boulevard".

Le bus passe par le boulevard qui fait le tour du centre.

The bus goes along the boulevard that runs round the centre.

Often lined with trees.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

boulevard was borrowed from Middle Dutch *bolwerc* 'bulwark' (EtymDB): first the top of a town wall, later the wide road built where the wall had been.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le boulevard*
- *Say it: le boulevard*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le boulevard*
- *Recall:* say the French for the alley, then the French for the avenue, then say *le boulevard* again

Before you move on

What does le boulevard mean? ("The boulevard".) Say it once more.

437.5 le passant — the passer-by

Before the new one: say the French for the avenue, then the French for the boulevard.

You'll want to know: le passant

le passant — "the passer-by".

J'ai demandé mon chemin à un passant.

I asked a passer-by for directions.

Feminine *la passante*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

passant is the present participle of *passer* 'to pass', used as a noun (EtymDB); *passer* goes back to Vulgar Latin *passāre*, from *passus* 'a step'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le passant*
- *Say it:* *le passant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le passant*
- *Recall:* say the French for the avenue, then the French for the boulevard, then say *le passant* again

Before you move on

What does le passant mean? (“The passer-by”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 438

Flâner en ville

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about wandering round a town: strolling, going for a walk, walking about, wandering and pacing the streets.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 438: I can talk about wandering round a town: strolling, going for a walk, walking about, wandering and pacing the streets.*

438.1 flâner — to stroll, to wander about

> Before the new one: say the French for the boulevard, then the French for the passer-by.

You'll want to know: flâner

flâner — "to stroll, to wander about".

> Le dimanche, j'aime flâner au marché.
>
> *On Sundays I like strolling round the market.*

Un flâneur — someone who strolls with no aim.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flâner came into French from a Norman dialect word, which is usually traced to Old Norse *flana* 'to rush about'. EtymDB lists the verb

without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: flâner*
- *Say it: flâner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *flâner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the boulevard, then the French for the passer-by, then say *flâner* again

Before you move on

What does flâner mean? ("To stroll, to wander about".) Say it once more.

438.2 balader — to go for a walk (mostly reflexive: se balader); to take round

Before the new one: say the French for the passer-by, then the French for to stroll.

You'll want to know: balader

balader — "to go for a walk (mostly reflexive: se balader); to take round".

Après le dîner, nous nous baladons au bord de la rivière.

After dinner we go for a walk by the river.

Mostly reflexive and informal: *se balader*. *Une balade* — a walk.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

balader is built on *balade* 'walk, outing', from *ballade* 'dancing song', which goes back to Late Latin *ballāre* 'to dance' (Lewis & Short).

EtymDB lists the verb without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: balader*
- *Say it: balader*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *balader*
- *Recall:* say the French for the passer-by, then the French for to stroll, then say *balader* again

Before you move on

What does balader mean? ("To go for a walk (mostly reflexive: se balader); to take round".) Say it once more.

438.3 déambuler — to walk about, to wander

Before the new one: say the French for to stroll, then the French for to go for a walk.

You'll want to know: déambuler

déambuler — "to walk about, to wander".

Les touristes déambulent entre les boutiques.

The tourists wander about between the shops.

A bit literary.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déambuler is a learned borrowing from Latin *deambulāre* 'to walk about', from *dē-* and *ambulāre* 'to walk' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: déambuler*
- *Say it: déambuler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déambuler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stroll, then the French for to go for a walk, then say *déambuler* again

Before you move on

What does déambuler mean? ("To walk about, to wander".) Say it once more.

438.4 errer — to wander, to roam

Before the new one: say the French for to go for a walk, then the French for to walk about.

You'll want to know: errer

errer — "to wander, to roam".

Le chien errait seul dans la rue.

The dog was wandering alone in the street.

Stronger than *flâner*: no aim at all, sometimes lost.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

errer is inherited through Old French *errer* from Latin *errāre* 'to wander, to go astray' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: errer*
- *Say it: errer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *errer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to go for a walk, then the French for to walk about, then say *errer* again

Before you move on

What does errer mean? ("To wander, to roam".) Say it once more.

438.5 arpenter — to pace up and down; to stride along

Before the new one: say the French for to walk about, then the French for to wander.

You'll want to know: arpenter

arpenter — "to pace up and down; to stride along".

> Pendant deux jours, nous avons arpenté la ville à pied.
>
> *For two days we walked the town from end to end.*

Also *arpenter le couloir* — to pace up and down the corridor.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arpenter is built on *arpent*, an old measure of land (EtymDB), from Latin *arepennis* 'half an acre', a word Latin took from Gaulish (Lewis & Short): first to measure a field by walking it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *arpenter*
- *Say it:* *arpenter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *arpenter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to walk about, then the French for to wander, then say *arpenter* again

Before you move on

What does arpenter mean? ("To pace up and down; to stride along".) Say it once more.

Chapter 439

Clochers et remparts

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the old buildings of a town: the cathedral, the basilica, the bell tower, the belfry and the town walls.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 439: I can talk about the old buildings of a town: the cathedral, the basilica, the bell tower, the belfry and the town walls.*

439.1 la cathédrale — the cathedral

> Before the new one: say the French for to wander, then the French for to pace up and down.

You'll want to know: la cathédrale

la cathédrale — "the cathedral".

> La cathédrale est au centre de la vieille ville.
>
> *The cathedral is in the middle of the old town.*

The bishop's church.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cathédrale is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *(ecclēsia) cathedrālis* 'church with a bishop's chair', from *cathedra* 'chair', from

Greek *kathédra* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cathédrale*
- *Say it: la cathédrale*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la cathédrale*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wander, then the French for to pace up and down, then say *la cathédrale* again

Before you move on

What does la cathédrale mean? ("The cathedral".) Say it once more.

439.2 la basilique — the basilica

Before the new one: say the French for to pace up and down, then the French for the cathedral.

You'll want to know: la basilique

la basilique — "the basilica".

On monte à la basilique par un long escalier.

You go up to the basilica by a long flight of steps.

A large and important church.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

basilique is a learned borrowing from Latin *basilica*, from Greek *basilikḗ (stoá)* 'royal hall' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la basilique*
- *Say it: la basilique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la basilique*
- *Recall:* say the French for to pace up and down, then the French for the cathedral, then say *la basilique* again

Before you move on

What does la basilique mean? ("The basilica".) Say it once more.

439.3 le clocher — the bell tower, the steeple

Before the new one: say the French for the cathedral, then the French for the basilica.

You'll want to know: le clocher

le clocher — "the bell tower, the steeple".

On voit le clocher du village de très loin.

The village steeple is visible from far away.

L'esprit de clocher — small-town thinking.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clocher is built on *cloche* 'bell', which goes back to Late Latin *clocca*, usually traced to a Celtic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le clocher*
- *Say it: le clocher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le clocher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cathedral, then the French for the basilica, then say *le clocher* again

Before you move on

What does le clocher mean? ("The bell tower, the steeple".) Say it once more.

439.4 le beffroi — the belfry (town bell tower)

Before the new one: say the French for the basilica, then the French for the bell tower.

You'll want to know: le beffroi

le beffroi — "the belfry (town bell tower)".

Du haut du beffroi, la vue sur la ville est superbe.

From the top of the belfry the view over the town is superb.

Many towns in the north of France and in Belgium have a *beffroi*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

beffroi is usually traced to Middle High German *bercfrit* 'tower that protects'; EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le beffroi*
- *Say it: le beffroi*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le beffroi*
- *Recall:* say the French for the basilica, then the French for the bell tower, then say *le beffroi* again

Before you move on

What does le beffroi mean? (“The belfry (town bell tower)”.) Say it once more.

439.5 les remparts — the town walls, the ramparts

Before the new one: say the French for the bell tower, then the French for the belfry.

You’ll want to know: les remparts

les remparts — “the town walls, the ramparts”.

Le soir, nous faisons le tour des remparts.

In the evening we walk round the town walls.

Mostly plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rempart is built on *remparer* ’to fortify again’, from *re-* and *emparer*, which is usually traced to Provençal *amparar* ’to protect’, from Latin *ante* and *parāre* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les remparts*
- *Say it: les remparts*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les remparts*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bell tower, then the French for the belfry, then say *les remparts* again

Before you move on

What does les remparts mean? ("The town walls, the ramparts".) Say it once more.

439.6 Retour sur les chapitres 432–439

Say the French for the manager and the inconvenience.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the manager, the inconvenience, to report, the cleaning, faulty
- the down payment, the deposit, to compensate, the compensation, to pay damages to
- to get one's bearings, the compass, to spot, the landmark, to mislay
- the road sign, the arrow, the crossroads, the marker post, the corner
- the shortcut, the detour, the route, to go round, to turn back
- the dead end, the alley, the avenue, the boulevard, the passer-by
- to stroll, to go for a walk, to walk about, to wander, to pace up and down
- the cathedral, the basilica, the bell tower, the belfry, the town walls

Before you move on

The manager? (**le gérant**.) The inconvenience? (**le désagrément**.) To report? (**signaler**.) The cleaning? (**le ménage**.) Faulty? (**défectueux**.) The down payment? (**l'acompte**.) The deposit? (**les arrhes**.) To compensate? (**dédommager**.) The compensation? (**le dédommagement**.) To pay damages to? (**indemniser**.) To get one's bearings? (**orienter**.) The compass? (**la boussole**.) To spot? (**repérer**.) The landmark? (**le repère**.) To mislay? (**égarer**.) The road sign? (**le panneau**.) The arrow? (**la flèche**.) The crossroads? (**le croisement**.) The marker post? (**la borne**.) The corner? (**l'angle**.) The shortcut? (**le raccourci**.) The detour? (**le détour**.) The route? (**l'itinéraire**.) To go round? (**contourner**.) To turn back? (**rebrousser**.) The dead end? (**l'impasse**.) The alley? (**la ruelle**.) The avenue? (**l'avenue**.) The boulevard? (**le boulevard**.) The passer-by? (**le passant**.) To stroll? (**flâner**.) To go for a walk? (**balader**.) To walk about? (**déambuler**.) To wander? (**errer**.) To pace up and down? (**arpenter**.) The cathedral? (**la cathédrale**.) The basilica? (**la basilique**.) The bell tower? (**le clocher**.) The belfry? (**le beffroi**.) The town walls? (**les remparts**.)

Chapter 440

Les quartiers

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about parts of a town and official buildings: the old suburb, the district, the prefecture, the police station and the barracks.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 440: I can talk about parts of a town and official buildings: the old suburb, the district, the prefecture, the police station and the barracks.*

440.1 le faubourg — the old suburb, the outer district

> Before the new one: say the French for the belfry, then the French for the town walls.

You'll want to know: le faubourg

le faubourg — "the old suburb, the outer district".

> Ils habitent dans un faubourg tranquille.
>
> *They live in a quiet old suburb.*

First the part of a town outside its walls.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

faubourg comes from Old French *fors bourg* 'settlement outside the town' (EtymDB), from *fors* 'outside', from Latin *forīs*, and *bourg* 'town'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le faubourg*
- *Say it: le faubourg*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le faubourg*
- *Recall:* say the French for the belfry, then the French for the town walls, then say *le faubourg* again

Before you move on

What does le faubourg mean? ("The old suburb, the outer district".) Say it once more.

440.2 l'arrondissement — the district (of a large city)

Before the new one: say the French for the town walls, then the French for the old suburb.

You'll want to know: l'arrondissement

l'arrondissement — "the district (of a large city)".

Elle travaille dans le cinquième arrondissement.

She works in the fifth district.

A masculine noun. Some large cities are divided into numbered *arrondissements*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arrondissement is built on *arrondir* 'to round off', from *rond* 'round', which goes back to Latin *rotundus*, from *rota* 'wheel' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arrondissement*
- *Say it: l'arrondissement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'arrondissement*
- *Recall:* say the French for the town walls, then the French for the old suburb, then say *l'arrondissement* again

Before you move on

What does l'arrondissement mean? ("The district (of a large city)".) Say it once more.

440.3 la préfecture — the prefecture (regional state office)

Before the new one: say the French for the old suburb, then the French for the district.

You'll want to know: la préfecture

la préfecture — "the prefecture (regional state office)".

Pour son titre de séjour, il va à la préfecture.

For his residence permit he goes to the prefecture.

Where the State's office for a *département* is.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

préfecture is a learned borrowing from Latin *praefectūra* 'office of a prefect', from *praeficere* 'to put in charge', built on *facere* 'to do, to make' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la préfecture*
- *Say it: la préfecture*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la préfecture*
- *Recall:* say the French for the old suburb, then the French for the district, then say *la préfecture* again

Before you move on

What does la préfecture mean? ("The prefecture (regional state office)".) Say it once more.

440.4 le commissariat — the police station

Before the new one: say the French for the district, then the French for the prefecture.

You'll want to know: le commissariat

le commissariat — "the police station".

Après le vol de son sac, elle est allée au commissariat.

After her bag was stolen, she went to the police station.

In full: *le commissariat de police.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

commissariat is built on *commissaire* 'commissioner', from Medieval Latin *commissārius*, from *committere* 'to entrust', built on *mittere* 'to send' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le commissariat*
- *Say it: le commissariat*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le commissariat*
- *Recall:* say the French for the district, then the French for the prefecture, then say *le commissariat* again

Before you move on

What does le commissariat mean? ("The police station".) Say it once more.

440.5 la caserne — the barracks; the fire station

Before the new one: say the French for the prefecture, then the French for the police station.

You'll want to know: la caserne

la caserne — "the barracks; the fire station".

La caserne des pompiers est à côté de l'école.

The fire station is next to the school.

La caserne des pompiers — the fire station.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caserne was borrowed from Provençal *cazerna* 'small hut for four soldiers', which goes back to Latin *quaterna* 'group of four' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la caserne*
- *Say it:* *la caserne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la caserne*
- *Recall:* say the French for the prefecture, then the French for the police station, then say *la caserne* again

Before you move on

What does la caserne mean? ("The barracks; the fire station".) Say it once more.

Chapter 441

Dans la rue

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe things in a street: the bench, the street lamp, the old lamp post, the kiosk and the cobblestones.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 441: I can describe things in a street: the bench, the street lamp, the old lamp post, the kiosk and the cobblestones.*

441.1 le banc — the bench

> Before the new one: say the French for the police station, then the French for the barracks.

You'll want to know: le banc

le banc — "the bench".

> Deux vieux messieurs lisent sur un banc.
>
> *Two old men are reading on a bench.*

Un banc de poissons — a shoal of fish.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

banc comes from a Germanic word for 'bench' (EtymDB), and English *bench* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le banc*
- *Say it: le banc*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le banc*
- *Recall:* say the French for the police station, then the French for the barracks, then say *le banc* again

Before you move on

What does le banc mean? ("The bench".) Say it once more.

441.2 le lampadaire — the street lamp; the floor lamp

Before the new one: say the French for the barracks, then the French for the bench.

You'll want to know: le lampadaire

le lampadaire — "the street lamp; the floor lamp".

Les lampadaires s'allument à six heures.

The street lamps come on at six o'clock.

At home, *un lampadaire* is a standing lamp.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lampadaire is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *lampadārium* 'candlestick', from *lampas*, from Greek *lampás* 'torch' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lampadaire*
- *Say it: le lampadaire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le lampadaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for the barracks, then the French for the bench, then say *le lampadaire* again

Before you move on

What does le lampadaire mean? ("The street lamp; the floor lamp".) Say it once more.

441.3 le réverbère — the lamp post (old-style)

Before the new one: say the French for the bench, then the French for the street lamp.

You'll want to know: le réverbère

le réverbère — "the lamp post (old-style)".

Dans la vieille rue, il reste quelques réverbères.

In the old street a few old lamp posts are still standing.

Older word, often for old-fashioned lamps.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réverbère is built on *réverbérer* 'to reflect', a learned borrowing from Latin *reverberāre* 'to beat back', from *verber* 'whip' (Lewis & Short): the old lamps had a mirror that threw back the light.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le réverbère*
- *Say it: le réverbère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le réverbère*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bench, then the French for the street lamp, then say *le réverbère* again

Before you move on

What does le réverbère mean? ("The lamp post (old-style)".) Say it once more.

441.4 le kiosque — the kiosk, the newsstand

Before the new one: say the French for the street lamp, then the French for the lamp post.

You'll want to know: le kiosque

le kiosque — "the kiosk, the newsstand".

Il achète le journal au kiosque du coin.

He buys the paper at the kiosk on the corner.

Un kiosque à musique — a bandstand.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

kiosque was borrowed from Turkish *köşk* 'pavilion', which came from Persian *kušk* 'palace, portico' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le kiosque*
- *Say it: le kiosque*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le kiosque*
- *Recall:* say the French for the street lamp, then the French for the lamp post, then say *le kiosque* again

Before you move on

What does le kiosque mean? (“The kiosk, the newsstand”.) Say it once more.

441.5 le pavé — the cobblestone; the paving

Before the new one: say the French for the lamp post, then the French for the kiosk.

You’ll want to know: le pavé

le pavé — “the cobblestone; the paving”.

Les vélos roulent mal sur les pavés.

Bikes do not ride well on the cobbles.

Un pavé is also a very thick book or a thick steak.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pavé is the past participle of *paver* ’to pave’ (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *pavīre* ’to beat the earth flat’ (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le pavé*
- *Say it:* *le pavé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pavé*
- *Recall:* say the French for the lamp post, then the French for the kiosk, then say *le pavé* again

Before you move on

What does le pavé mean? (“The cobblestone; the paving”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 442

Façades et vitrines

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the front of buildings: the façade, the shop window, the shop sign, the gutter and the covered market.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 442: I can describe the front of buildings: the façade, the shop window, the shop sign, the gutter and the covered market.*

442.1 la façade — the façade, the front (of a building)

Before the new one: say the French for the kiosk, then the French for the cobblestone.

You'll want to know: la façade

la façade — "the façade, the front (of a building)".

La façade de la mairie est toute blanche.

The front of the town hall is all white.

Figurative: *c'est de la façade* — it is all for show.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

façade was borrowed from Italian *facciata* (EtymDB), built on *faccia* 'face', which goes back to Latin *faciēs*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la façade*
- *Say it: la façade*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la façade*
- *Recall:* say the French for the kiosk, then the French for the cobblestone, then say *la façade* again

Before you move on

What does la façade mean? ("The façade, the front (of a building)".) Say it once more.

442.2 la vitrine — the shop window; the display case

Before the new one: say the French for the cobblestone, then the French for the façade.

You'll want to know: la vitrine

la vitrine — "the shop window; the display case".

Elle regarde les chaussures dans la vitrine.

She looks at the shoes in the shop window.

Faire du lèche-vitrines — to go window-shopping.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vitrine is built on *vitre* 'pane of glass' (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *vitrum* 'glass'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vitrine*
- *Say it: la vitrine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la vitrine*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cobblestone, then the French for the façade, then say *la vitrine* again

Before you move on

What does la vitrine mean? ("The shop window; the display case".) Say it once more.

442.3 l'enseigne — the shop sign; the brand

Before the new one: say the French for the façade, then the French for the shop window.

You'll want to know: l'enseigne

l'enseigne — "the shop sign; the brand".

L'enseigne du café est en bois.

The café's sign is made of wood.

A feminine noun. *Une grande enseigne* — a big chain of shops.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enseigne is inherited from Latin *īnsignia* 'marks, badges', from *signum* 'mark' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'enseigne*
- *Say it: l'enseigne*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'enseigne*
- *Recall:* say the French for the façade, then the French for the shop window, then say *l'enseigne* again

Before you move on

What does l'enseigne mean? ("The shop sign; the brand".) Say it once more.

442.4 la gouttière — the roof gutter, the rain gutter

Before the new one: say the French for the shop window, then the French for the shop sign.

You'll want to know: la gouttière

la gouttière — "the roof gutter, the rain gutter".

L'eau de pluie coule dans la gouttière.

The rainwater runs into the gutter.

On the roof; the gutter in the street has another name.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gouttière is built on *goutte* 'drop', which is inherited from Latin *gutta* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gouttière*
- *Say it: la gouttière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la gouttière*
- *Recall:* say the French for the shop window, then the French for the shop sign, then say *la gouttière* again

Before you move on

What does la gouttière mean? ("The roof gutter, the rain gutter".) Say it once more.

442.5 la halle — the covered market (hall)

Before the new one: say the French for the shop sign, then the French for the roof gutter.

You'll want to know: la halle

la halle — "the covered market (hall)".

Le samedi, les paysans vendent leurs légumes sous la halle.

On Saturdays the farmers sell their vegetables in the covered market.

Les halles — the covered market of a town.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

halle comes from Old French *hale*, from Frankish *halla* 'large room, hall' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la halle*
- *Say it: la halle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la halle*
- *Recall:* say the French for the shop sign, then the French for the roof gutter, then say *la halle* again

Before you move on

What does la halle mean? ("The covered market (hall)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 443

L'hiver en ville

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a town in winter: the sewer, the gutter in the street, clearing the snow, salting the roads and snow-ploughing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 443: I can talk about a town in winter: the sewer, the gutter in the street, clearing the snow, salting the roads and snow-ploughing.*

443.1 l'égout — the sewer, the drain

> Before the new one: say the French for the roof gutter, then the French for the covered market.

You'll want to know: l'égout

l'égout — "the sewer, the drain".

> Après l'orage, les égouts sont pleins.
>
> *After the storm the sewers are full.*

A masculine noun.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

égout is built on *égoutter* 'to let drip, to drain' (EtymDB), from *goutte* 'drop', which goes back to Latin *gutta*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'égout*
- *Say it: l'égout*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'égout*
- *Recall:* say the French for the roof gutter, then the French for the covered market, then say *l'égout* again

Before you move on

What does l'égout mean? ("The sewer, the drain".) Say it once more.

443.2 le caniveau — the gutter (in the street)

Before the new one: say the French for the covered market, then the French for the sewer.

You'll want to know: le caniveau

le caniveau — "the gutter (in the street)".

La neige fond et coule dans le caniveau.

The snow melts and runs into the gutter.

At the edge of the road, beside the pavement.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *caniveau* is not settled, and EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le caniveau*
- *Say it: le caniveau*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le caniveau*
- *Recall:* say the French for the covered market, then the French for the sewer, then say *le caniveau* again

Before you move on

What does le caniveau mean? (“The gutter (in the street)”.) Say it once more.

443.3 déblayer — to clear away (snow, rubble)

Before the new one: say the French for the sewer, then the French for the gutter.

You’ll want to know: déblayer

déblayer — “to clear away (snow, rubble)”.

Les voisins ont déblayé la neige devant l’immeuble.

The neighbours cleared the snow in front of the building.

Le déblaiement — the clearing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déblayer comes from Old French *desbleer* ’to clear a field of its corn’, usually traced to *blé* ’corn’; EtymDB lists the verb without a source.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: déblayer*
- *Say it: déblayer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déblayer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the sewer, then the French for the gutter, then say *déblayer* again

Before you move on

What does déblayer mean? ("To clear away (snow, rubble)".) Say it once more.

443.4 saler — to salt (food, roads)

Before the new one: say the French for the gutter, then the French for to clear away.

You'll want to know: saler

saler — "to salt (food, roads)".

La ville sale les routes quand il gèle.

The town puts salt on the roads when it freezes.

C'est salé ! — that is pricey (informal).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

saler goes back to Vulgar Latin *salāre*, from Latin *sal* 'salt' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: saler*
- *Say it: saler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *saler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the gutter, then the French for to clear away, then say *saler* again

Before you move on

What does saler mean? ("To salt (food, roads)".) Say it once more.

443.5 déneiger — to clear of snow, to plough

Before the new one: say the French for to clear away, then the French for to salt.

You'll want to know: déneiger

déneiger — "to clear of snow, to plough".

Le matin, les camions déneigent les grandes rues.

In the morning the lorries clear the snow from the main streets.

Very common in Québec and in the mountains: *le déneigement*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déneiger is built from *dé-* and *neige* 'snow', which goes back to Latin *nix, nivis* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *déneiger*
- *Say it:* *déneiger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déneiger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clear away, then the French for to salt, then say *déneiger* again

Before you move on

What does déneiger mean? ("To clear of snow, to plough".) Say it once more.

Chapter 444

Les commerces de bouche

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can shop for food in small shops: the delicatessen, the fishmonger, the caterer, the grocer and the greengrocer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 444: I can shop for food in small shops: the delicatessen, the fishmonger, the caterer, the grocer and the greengrocer.*

444.1 la charcuterie — the pork butcher, the delicatessen; cold meats

> Before the new one: say the French for to salt, then the French for to clear of snow.

You'll want to know: la charcuterie

la charcuterie — "the pork butcher, the delicatessen; cold meats".

> À la charcuterie, nous achetons du jambon et du pâté.
>
> *At the pork butcher's we buy ham and pâté.*

De la charcuterie also means the cold meats themselves.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

charcuterie is built on *charcutier*, from *chair cuite* 'cooked meat'; *chair* goes back to Latin *carō* 'flesh' and *cuite* to *coquere* 'to cook' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la charcuterie*
- *Say it: la charcuterie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la charcuterie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to salt, then the French for to clear of snow, then say *la charcuterie* again

Before you move on

What does la charcuterie mean? ("The pork butcher, the delicatessen; cold meats".) Say it once more.

444.2 la poissonnerie — the fishmonger's, the fish shop

Before the new one: say the French for to clear of snow, then the French for the pork butcher.

You'll want to know: la poissonnerie

la poissonnerie — "the fishmonger's, the fish shop".

Le vendredi, il y a la queue devant la poissonnerie.

On Fridays there is a queue outside the fish shop.

Le poissonnier — the fishmonger.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

poissonnerie is built on *poisson* 'fish', which goes back to Latin *piscis* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the shop name.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poissonnerie*
- *Say it: la poissonnerie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la poissonnerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clear of snow, then the French for the pork butcher, then say *la poissonnerie* again

Before you move on

What does la poissonnerie mean? ("The fishmonger's, the fish shop".) Say it once more.

444.3 le traiteur — the caterer; the deli (with ready meals)

Before the new one: say the French for the pork butcher, then the French for the fishmonger's.

You'll want to know: le traiteur

le traiteur — "the caterer; the deli (with ready meals)".

Pour la fête, nous avons commandé des plats chez le traiteur.

For the party we ordered dishes from the caterer.

A shop that sells ready-made dishes and caters for parties.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

traiteur is built on *traiter* 'to deal with, to serve food to', which is inherited from Latin *tractāre* 'to handle', from *trahere* 'to draw' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le traiteur*
- *Say it: le traiteur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le traiteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pork butcher, then the French for the fishmonger's, then say *le traiteur* again

Before you move on

What does le traiteur mean? ("The caterer; the deli (with ready meals)".) Say it once more.

444.4 l'épicier — the grocer

Before the new one: say the French for the fishmonger's, then the French for the caterer.

You'll want to know: l'épicier

l'épicier — "the grocer".

L'épicier du quartier ferme à neuf heures.

The local grocer closes at nine.

L'épicerie — the grocer's shop.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épicier is built on *épice* 'spice', which is inherited from Latin *speciēs* 'kind', later 'goods, spices' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'épicier*
- *Say it: l'épicier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'épicier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fishmonger's, then the French for the caterer, then say *l'épicier* again

Before you move on

What does l'épicier mean? ("The grocer".) Say it once more.

444.5 le primeur — the greengrocer; early produce

Before the new one: say the French for the caterer, then the French for the grocer.

You'll want to know: le primeur

le primeur — "the greengrocer; early produce".

Chez le primeur, les fraises sont déjà arrivées.

At the greengrocer's the strawberries are already in.

Les primeurs are the first fruit and vegetables of the year.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

primeur is built on the old adjective *prime* 'first', from Latin *prīmus* (Lewis & Short): the first produce of the year. EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le primeur*
- *Say it:* *le primeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le primeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the caterer, then the French for the grocer, then say *le primeur* again

Before you move on

What does le primeur mean? ("The greengrocer; early produce".) Say it once more.

Chapter 445

Petites boutiques

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find small specialist shops: the hardware shop, the household shop, the stationer, the haberdasher and the wine merchant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 445: I can find small specialist shops: the hardware shop, the household shop, the stationer, the haberdasher and the wine merchant.*

445.1 la quincaillerie — the hardware shop, the ironmonger's

> Before the new one: say the French for the grocer, then the French for the greengrocer.

You'll want to know: la quincaillerie

la quincaillerie — "the hardware shop, the ironmonger's".

> Il achète des clous à la quincaillerie.
>
> *He buys nails at the hardware shop.*

Le quincaillier runs it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

quincaillerie is built on *quincaille* 'small metal goods', which is usually traced to an old word that imitates the clink of metal. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la quincaillerie*
- *Say it: la quincaillerie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la quincaillerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the grocer, then the French for the greengrocer, then say *la quincaillerie* again

Before you move on

What does la quincaillerie mean? ("The hardware shop, the ironmonger's".) Say it once more.

445.2 la droguerie — the household goods shop

Before the new one: say the French for the greengrocer, then the French for the hardware shop.

You'll want to know: la droguerie

la droguerie — "the household goods shop".

À la droguerie, elle trouve des produits pour le ménage.

At the household shop she finds cleaning products.

Not a chemist's: it sells paint, soap and cleaning products.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

droguerie is built on *drogue*, first 'dried goods, spices'. The origin of *drogue* is not settled; it is sometimes linked to Dutch *droog* 'dry'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la droguerie*
- *Say it: la droguerie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la droguerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the greengrocer, then the French for the hardware shop, then say *la droguerie* again

Before you move on

What does la droguerie mean? ("The household goods shop".) Say it once more.

445.3 la papeterie — the stationer's

Before the new one: say the French for the hardware shop, then the French for the household goods shop.

You'll want to know: la papeterie

la papeterie — "the stationer's".

Avant la rentrée, la papeterie est pleine d'enfants.

Before school starts again, the stationer's is full of children.

Pronounced *pa-pè-tri*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

papeterie is built on *papier* 'paper' (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *papyrus*, from Greek *pápyros*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la papeterie*
- *Say it: la papeterie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la papeterie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hardware shop, then the French for the household goods shop, then say *la papeterie* again

Before you move on

What does la papeterie mean? ("The stationer's".) Say it once more.

445.4 la mercerie — the haberdasher's, the sewing shop

Before the new one: say the French for the household goods shop, then the French for the stationer's.

You'll want to know: la mercerie

la mercerie — "the haberdasher's, the sewing shop".

Ma grand-mère achète ses boutons à la mercerie.

My grandmother buys her buttons at the haberdasher's.

Buttons, thread, ribbons.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mercerie is built on *mercier* 'dealer in small goods' (EtymDB lists *mercerie*), which goes back to Latin *merx, mercis* 'goods'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mercerie*
- *Say it: la mercerie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la mercerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for the household goods shop, then the French for the stationer's, then say *la mercerie* again

Before you move on

What does la mercerie mean? ("The haberdasher's, the sewing shop".) Say it once more.

445.5 le caviste — the wine merchant

Before the new one: say the French for the stationer's, then the French for the haberdasher's.

You'll want to know: le caviste

le caviste — "the wine merchant".

Le caviste nous a conseillé un vin de la région.

The wine merchant recommended a local wine.

Built on *la cave* 'cellar'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caviste is built on *cave* 'cellar' with *-iste* (EtymDB); *cave* goes back to Latin *cavus* 'hollow'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le caviste*
- *Say it: le caviste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le caviste*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stationer's, then the French for the haberdasher's, then say *le caviste* again

Before you move on

What does le caviste mean? ("The wine merchant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 446

Chez le cordonnier

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can get things mended: the cobbler, resoling, polishing, the locksmith and sewing back.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 446: I can get things mended: the cobbler, resoling, polishing, the locksmith and sewing back.*

446.1 le cordonnier — the cobbler, the shoe mender

> Before the new one: say the French for the haberdasher's, then the French for the wine merchant.

You'll want to know: le cordonnier

le cordonnier — "the cobbler, the shoe mender".

> Le cordonnier a réparé mes bottes en une journée.
>
> *The cobbler mended my boots in a day.*

Les cordonniers sont toujours les plus mal chaussés — the cobbler's children go barefoot.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cordonnier is an altered form of an older word for a worker in fine leather, named after a city famous for it. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cordonnier*
- *Say it: le cordonnier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cordonnier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the haberdasher's, then the French for the wine merchant, then say *le cordonnier* again

Before you move on

What does le cordonnier mean? ("The cobbler, the shoe mender".) Say it once more.

446.2 ressemeler — to resole

Before the new one: say the French for the wine merchant, then the French for the cobbler.

You'll want to know: ressemeler

ressemeler — "to resole".

Il fait ressemeler ses chaussures chaque hiver.

He has his shoes resoled every winter.

La semelle — the sole.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ressemeler is built from *re-* 'again' and *semelle* 'sole' (EtymDB lists the verb). The origin of *semelle* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: ressemeler*
- *Say it: ressemeler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *ressemeler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the wine merchant, then the French for the cobbler, then say *ressemeler* again

Before you move on

What does ressemeler mean? ("To resole".) Say it once more.

446.3 cirer — to polish, to wax

Before the new one: say the French for the cobbler, then the French for to resole.

You'll want to know: cirer

cirer — "to polish, to wax".

Le dimanche, mon père cire ses chaussures.

On Sundays my father polishes his shoes.

La cire — wax; *le cirage* — shoe polish.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cirer is built on *cire* 'wax', which is inherited from Latin *cēra* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: cirer*
- *Say it: cirer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *cirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cobbler, then the French for to resole, then say *cirer* again

Before you move on

What does cirer mean? ("To polish, to wax".) Say it once more.

446.4 le serrurier — the locksmith

Before the new one: say the French for to resole, then the French for to polish.

You'll want to know: le serrurier

le serrurier — "the locksmith".

Elle a perdu ses clés et elle a appelé un serrurier.

She lost her keys and called a locksmith.

La serrure — the lock.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serrurier is built on *serrure* 'lock', from *serrer* 'to close tight', which goes back to Vulgar Latin *serrāre*, built on Latin *sera* 'bar for a door' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le serrurier*
- *Say it: le serrurier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le serrurier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to resole, then the French for to polish, then say *le serrurier* again

Before you move on

What does le serrurier mean? (“The locksmith”.) Say it once more.

446.5 recoudre — to sew back on, to stitch up

Before the new one: say the French for to polish, then the French for the locksmith.

You’ll want to know: recoudre

recoudre — “to sew back on, to stitch up”.

La dame a recousu le bouton de ma veste.

The lady sewed the button back on my jacket.

Irregular: *je recouds, il a recousu.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recoudre is built from *re-* ’again’ and *coudre* ’to sew’, which goes back to Latin *consuere*, from *suere* ’to sew’ (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: recoudre*
- *Say it: recoudre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *recoudre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to polish, then the French for the locksmith, then say *recoudre* again

Before you move on

What does recoudre mean? (“To sew back on, to stitch up”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 447

Au pressing

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can get clothes cleaned and altered: the dry cleaner, the launderette, removing stains, dyeing and altering.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 447: I can get clothes cleaned and altered: the dry cleaner, the launderette, removing stains, dyeing and altering.*

447.1 le pressing — the dry cleaner's

> Before the new one: say the French for the locksmith, then the French for to sew back on.

You'll want to know: le pressing

le pressing — "the dry cleaner's".

> Il dépose sa veste au pressing le lundi.
>
> *He drops his jacket off at the dry cleaner's on Mondays.*

Le nettoyage à sec — dry cleaning.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pressing was borrowed from English *pressing* 'ironing', a sense English does not use for a shop. EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pressing*
- *Say it: le pressing*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pressing*
- *Recall:* say the French for the locksmith, then the French for to sew back on, then say *le pressing* again

Before you move on

What does le pressing mean? ("The dry cleaner's".) Say it once more.

447.2 la laverie — the launderette

Before the new one: say the French for to sew back on, then the French for the dry cleaner's.

You'll want to know: la laverie

la laverie — "the launderette".

Les étudiants lavent leur linge à la laverie.

The students wash their clothes at the launderette.

Une laverie automatique; in Québec, *une buanderie.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

laverie is built on *laver* 'to wash', which is inherited from Latin *lavāre* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la laverie*
- *Say it: la laverie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la laverie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sew back on, then the French for the dry cleaner's, then say *la laverie* again

Before you move on

What does la laverie mean? ("The launderette".) Say it once more.

447.3 détacher — to remove a stain from; to untie

Before the new one: say the French for the dry cleaner's, then the French for the launderette.

You'll want to know: détacher

détacher — "to remove a stain from; to untie".

Le pressing a bien détaché ma chemise blanche.

The dry cleaner got the stain out of my white shirt.

Two senses: from *tache* 'stain', and from *attacher* — *détacher sa ceinture*, to undo one's belt.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

détacher in the sense 'to untie' comes from Old French *destachier* (EtymDB), the opposite of *attacher*; in the sense 'to remove a stain' it is built on *tache* 'stain'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: détacher*
- *Say it: détacher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *détacher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the dry cleaner's, then the French for the launderette, then say *détacher* again

Before you move on

What does détacher mean? ("To remove a stain from; to untie".) Say it once more.

447.4 teindre — to dye

Before the new one: say the French for the launderette, then the French for to remove a stain from.

You'll want to know: teindre

teindre — "to dye".

Elle a teint son vieux pull en bleu.

She dyed her old jumper blue.

Irregular: *je teins, j'ai teint. La teinturerie* — another word for the dry cleaner's.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

teindre is inherited through Old French *taindre* from Latin *tingere* 'to dye, to wet' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: teindre*
- *Say it: teindre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *teindre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the launderette, then the French for to remove a stain from, then say *teindre* again

Before you move on

What does teindre mean? ("To dye".) Say it once more.

447.5 retoucher — to alter (a garment); to touch up

Before the new one: say the French for to remove a stain from, then the French for to dye.

You'll want to know: retoucher

retoucher — "to alter (a garment); to touch up".

Le tailleur a retouché le bas du pantalon.

The tailor altered the bottom of the trousers.

Une retouche — an alteration; also on photos.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retoucher is built from *re-* 'again' and *toucher* 'to touch' (EtymDB lists the verb), which is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin verb that imitates a knock.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: retoucher*
- *Say it: retoucher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *retoucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to remove a stain from, then the French for to dye, then say *retoucher* again

Before you move on

What does retoucher mean? (“To alter (a garment); to touch up”.) Say it once more.

447.6 Retour sur les chapitres 440–447

Say the French for the old suburb and the district.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the old suburb, the district, the prefecture, the police station, the barracks
- the bench, the street lamp, the lamp post, the kiosk, the cobblestone
- the façade, the shop window, the shop sign, the roof gutter, the covered market
- the sewer, the gutter, to clear away, to salt, to clear of snow
- the pork butcher, the fishmonger’s, the caterer, the grocer, the greengrocer
- the hardware shop, the household goods shop, the stationer’s, the haberdasher’s, the wine merchant
- the cobbler, to resole, to polish, the locksmith, to sew back on
- the dry cleaner’s, the launderette, to remove a stain from, to dye, to alter

Before you move on

The old suburb? (**le faubourg**.) The district? (**l'arrondissement**.) The prefecture? (**la préfecture**.) The police station? (**le commissariat**.) The barracks? (**la caserne**.) The bench? (**le banc**.) The street lamp? (**le lampadaire**.) The lamp post? (**le réverbère**.) The kiosk? (**le kiosque**.) The cobblestone? (**le pavé**.) The façade? (**la façade**.) The shop window? (**la vitrine**.) The shop sign? (**l'enseigne**.) The roof gutter? (**la gouttière**.) The covered market? (**la halle**.) The sewer? (**l'égout**.) The gutter? (**le caniveau**.) To clear away? (**déblayer**.) To salt? (**saler**.) To clear of snow? (**déneiger**.) The pork butcher? (**la charcuterie**.) The fishmonger's? (**la poissonnerie**.) The caterer? (**le traiteur**.) The grocer? (**l'épicier**.) The greengrocer? (**le primeur**.) The hardware shop? (**la quincaillerie**.) The household goods shop? (**la droguerie**.) The stationer's? (**la papeterie**.) The haberdasher's? (**la mercerie**.) The wine merchant? (**le caviste**.) The cobbler? (**le cordonnier**.) To resole? (**ressemeler**.) To polish? (**cirer**.) The locksmith? (**le serrurier**.) To sew back on? (**recoudre**.) The dry cleaner's? (**le pressing**.) The launderette? (**la laverie**.) To remove a stain from? (**détacher**.) To dye? (**teindre**.) To alter? (**retoucher**.)

Chapter 448

Coiffeur et opticien

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use personal services: the hairdresser, shaving, the optician, the watchmaker and the jeweller.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 448: I can use personal services: the hairdresser, shaving, the optician, the watchmaker and the jeweller.*

448.1 le coiffeur — the hairdresser, the barber

> Before the new one: say the French for to dye, then the French for to alter.

You'll want to know: le coiffeur

le coiffeur — "the hairdresser, the barber".

> Je vais chez le coiffeur une fois par mois.
>
> *I go to the hairdresser's once a month.*

Feminine *la coiffeuse*. *Aller chez le coiffeur.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coiffeur is built on *coiffer* 'to do someone's hair' (EtymDB), from *coiffe* 'cap', which is usually traced to Late Latin *cofia*, of Germanic origin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coiffeur*
- *Say it: le coiffeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le coiffeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dye, then the French for to alter, then say *le coiffeur* again

Before you move on

What does le coiffeur mean? ("The hairdresser, the barber".) Say it once more.

448.2 raser — to shave (often se raser); to raze

Before the new one: say the French for to alter, then the French for the hairdresser.

You'll want to know: raser

raser — "to shave (often se raser); to raze".

Le coiffeur lui a rasé la barbe.

The barber shaved off his beard.

Se raser — to shave; informal *ça me rase* — that bores me.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

raser is inherited from Vulgar Latin *rāsāre*, from Latin *rāsus* 'scraped', the past participle of *rādere* 'to scrape' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: raser*
- *Say it: raser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *raser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to alter, then the French for the hairdresser, then say *raser* again

Before you move on

What does raser mean? ("To shave (often se raser); to raze".) Say it once more.

448.3 l'opticien — the optician

Before the new one: say the French for the hairdresser, then the French for to shave.

You'll want to know: l'opticien

l'opticien — "the optician".

L'opticien a réparé mes lunettes tout de suite.

The optician fixed my glasses straight away.

A masculine noun; feminine *l'opticienne*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

opticien is built on *optique* 'optics', a learned word from Latin *opticus*, from Greek *optikós* 'of seeing' (EtymDB). EtymDB lists *opticien* itself without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'opticien*
- *Say it: l'opticien*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'opticien*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hairdresser, then the French for to shave, then say *l'opticien* again

Before you move on

What does l'opticien mean? ("The optician".) Say it once more.

448.4 l'horloger — the watchmaker, the clockmaker

Before the new one: say the French for to shave, then the French for the optician.

You'll want to know: l'horloger

l'horloger — "the watchmaker, the clockmaker".

L'horloger a changé la pile de ma montre.

The watchmaker changed the battery in my watch.

A masculine noun. *L'horlogerie* — the watchmaker's shop.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

horloger is built on *horloge* 'clock', which comes from Latin *hōrologium*, from Greek *hōrológion* 'thing that tells the hour' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'horloger*
- *Say it: l'horloger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'horloger*
- *Recall:* say the French for to shave, then the French for the optician, then say *l'horloger* again

Before you move on

What does l'horloger mean? ("The watchmaker, the clockmaker".) Say it once more.

448.5 le bijoutier — the jeweller

Before the new one: say the French for the optician, then the French for the watchmaker.

You'll want to know: le bijoutier

le bijoutier — "the jeweller".

Il a acheté une bague chez le bijoutier.

He bought a ring at the jeweller's.

La bijouterie — the jeweller's shop.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bijoutier is built on *bijou* 'jewel' (EtymDB lists it), which was borrowed from Breton *bizou* 'ring', from *biz* 'finger'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bijoutier*
- *Say it: le bijoutier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bijoutier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the optician, then the French for the watchmaker, then say *le bijoutier* again

Before you move on

What does le bijoutier mean? ("The jeweller".) Say it once more.

Chapter 449

Fleurs, tabac et colis

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use local shops and send things: the florist, the tobacconist, putting a stamp on, sending off and tying up a parcel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 449: I can use local shops and send things: the florist, the tobacconist, putting a stamp on, sending off and tying up a parcel.*

449.1 le fleuriste — the florist

> Before the new one: say the French for the watchmaker, then the French for the jeweller.

You'll want to know: le fleuriste

le fleuriste — "the florist".

> Le fleuriste a fait un joli bouquet pour ma mère.
>
> *The florist made a pretty bunch of flowers for my mother.*

Same form for a woman: *la fleuriste*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fleuriste is built on *fleur* 'flower' with *-iste*; *fleur* is inherited from Latin *flōs, flōris* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fleuriste*
- *Say it: le fleuriste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le fleuriste*
- *Recall:* say the French for the watchmaker, then the French for the jeweller, then say *le fleuriste* again

Before you move on

What does le fleuriste mean? ("The florist".) Say it once more.

449.2 le buraliste — the tobacconist

Before the new one: say the French for the jeweller, then the French for the florist.

You'll want to know: le buraliste

le buraliste — "the tobacconist".

Le buraliste vend aussi des timbres et des journaux.

The tobacconist also sells stamps and newspapers.

He runs *le bureau de tabac*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

buraliste is built on *bureau* 'office, desk' with *-iste* (EtymDB). *Bureau* first meant a coarse woollen cloth that covered a desk.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le buraliste*
- *Say it: le buraliste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le buraliste*
- *Recall:* say the French for the jeweller, then the French for the florist, then say *le buraliste* again

Before you move on

What does le buraliste mean? ("The tobacconist".) Say it once more.

449.3 affranchir — to put a stamp on, to frank; to free

Before the new one: say the French for the florist, then the French for the tobacconist.

You'll want to know: affranchir

affranchir — "to put a stamp on, to frank; to free".

Elle a affranchi la lettre au tarif normal.

She put a normal-rate stamp on the letter.

L'affranchissement — the postage. First 'to set free'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

affranchir is built from *a-* and *franc* 'free', the word behind *franchir* (EtymDB links the two); *franc* comes from the name of the Franks: a letter with its stamp travels free.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: affranchir*
- *Say it: affranchir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *affranchir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the florist, then the French for the tobacconist, then say *affranchir* again

Before you move on

What does affranchir mean? ("To put a stamp on, to frank; to free".) Say it once more.

449.4 expédier — to send off, to ship

Before the new one: say the French for the tobacconist, then the French for to put a stamp on.

You'll want to know: expédier

expédier — "to send off, to ship".

Nous avons expédié le colis mardi.

We sent the parcel off on Tuesday.

L'expéditeur — the sender.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

expédier is built on *expédient*, from Latin *expedīre* 'to free the feet, to get things ready', from *pēs* 'foot' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *expédier*
- *Say it:* *expédier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *expédier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tobacconist, then the French for to put a stamp on, then say *expédier* again

Before you move on

What does expédier mean? (“To send off, to ship”.) Say it once more.

449.5 ficeler — to tie up (with string)

Before the new one: say the French for to put a stamp on, then the French for to send off.

You’ll want to know: ficeler

ficeler — “to tie up (with string)”.

Le vendeur a ficelé le paquet avec soin.

The shop assistant tied up the parcel carefully.

La ficelle — string; also a thin baguette.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ficeler is built on *ficelle* ’string’ (EtymDB lists the verb), which is usually traced to Vulgar Latin *fūnicella*, a small *fūnis* ’rope’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: ficeler*
- *Say it: ficeler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *ficeler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put a stamp on, then the French for to send off, then say *ficeler* again

Before you move on

What does ficeler mean? (“To tie up (with string)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 450

À la caisse

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can pay at the till: the cashier, taking money, charging a card, the card machine and cash.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 450: I can pay at the till: the cashier, taking money, charging a card, the card machine and cash.*

450.1 le caissier — the cashier

> Before the new one: say the French for to send off, then the French for to tie up.

You'll want to know: le caissier

le caissier — "the cashier".

> Le caissier m'a rendu la monnaie.
>
> *The cashier gave me my change.*

Feminine *la caissière*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caissier is built on *caisse* 'till, box' (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *capsa* 'box', probably through Provençal.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le caissier*
- *Say it: le caissier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le caissier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to send off, then the French for to tie up, then say *le caissier* again

Before you move on

What does le caissier mean? ("The cashier".) Say it once more.

450.2 encaisser — to cash in, to take (money); to take (a blow)

Before the new one: say the French for to tie up, then the French for the cashier.

You'll want to know: encaisser

encaisser — "to cash in, to take (money); to take (a blow)".

Le commerçant encaisse le paiement.

The shopkeeper takes the payment.

Informal: *je ne peux pas l'encaisser* — I cannot stand him.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

encaisser is built from *en-* and *caisse* 'box, till', which goes back to Latin *capsa* (Lewis & Short): to put the money in the till.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *encaisser*
- *Say it:* *encaisser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *encaisser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tie up, then the French for the cashier, then say *encaisser* again

Before you move on

What does encaisser mean? ("To cash in, to take (money); to take (a blow)".) Say it once more.

450.3 débiter — to charge (an account); to cut up

Before the new one: say the French for the cashier, then the French for to cash in.

You'll want to know: débiter

débiter — "to charge (an account); to cut up".

Le magasin a débité ma carte deux fois.

The shop charged my card twice.

Le débit — the debit; also the flow of a river.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

débiter is built on *débit* (EtymDB), from Latin *dēbitum* 'what is owed', from *dēbēre* 'to owe'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: débiter*
- *Say it: débiter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *débiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cashier, then the French for to cash in, then say *débiter* again

Before you move on

What does débiter mean? ("To charge (an account); to cut up".) Say it once more.

450.4 le terminal — the card machine; the terminal

Before the new one: say the French for to cash in, then the French for to charge.

You'll want to know: le terminal

le terminal — "the card machine; the terminal".

Elle pose sa carte sur le terminal.

She taps her card on the card machine.

Le terminal de paiement; also an airport terminal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

terminal is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *terminālis* 'of a boundary' (EtymDB), from *terminus* 'end, limit'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le terminal*
- *Say it: le terminal*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le terminal*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cash in, then the French for to charge, then say *le terminal* again

Before you move on

What does le terminal mean? (“The card machine; the terminal”.) Say it once more.

450.5 le liquide — cash; the liquid

Before the new one: say the French for to charge, then the French for the card machine.

You’ll want to know: le liquide

le liquide — “cash; the liquid”.

Le petit café accepte seulement le liquide.

The little café only takes cash.

Payer en liquide — to pay cash.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

liquide is a learned borrowing from Latin *liquidus* ’fluid’ (EtymDB), from *liquēre* ’to be fluid’: money that flows freely.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le liquide*
- *Say it: le liquide*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le liquide*
- *Recall:* say the French for to charge, then the French for the card machine, then say *le liquide* again

Before you move on

What does le liquide mean? (“Cash; the liquid”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 451

À la banque

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can deal with a bank account: the withdrawal, paying money in, settling a bill, the overdraft and the statement.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 451: I can deal with a bank account: the withdrawal, paying money in, settling a bill, the overdraft and the statement.*

451.1 le retrait — the withdrawal

> Before the new one: say the French for the card machine, then the French for cash.

You'll want to know: le retrait

le retrait — "the withdrawal".

> Il a fait un retrait de cinquante euros.
>
> *He took out fifty euros.*

Un retrait d'argent — a cash withdrawal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

retrait is the old past participle of *retraire* 'to draw back', from Latin *retrahere*, built on *trahere* 'to draw' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does

not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le retrait*
- *Say it: le retrait*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le retrait*
- *Recall:* say the French for the card machine, then the French for cash, then say *le retrait* again

Before you move on

What does le retrait mean? ("The withdrawal".) Say it once more.

451.2 créditer — to credit, to pay into

Before the new one: say the French for cash, then the French for the withdrawal.

You'll want to know: créditer

créditer — "to credit, to pay into".

La banque a crédité mon compte ce matin.

The bank paid the money into my account this morning.

The opposite of *débiter*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

créditer is built on *crédit*, from Latin *crēditum* 'a loan', from *crēdere* 'to trust' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *créditer*
- *Say it:* *créditer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *créditer*
- *Recall:* say the French for cash, then the French for the withdrawal, then say *créditer* again

Before you move on

What does créditer mean? ("To credit, to pay into".) Say it once more.

451.3 régler — to settle (a bill), to pay; to adjust

Before the new one: say the French for the withdrawal, then the French for to credit.

You'll want to know: régler

régler — "to settle (a bill), to pay; to adjust".

Nous avons réglé la note de l'hôtel par carte.

We paid the hotel bill by card.

Régler un problème — to sort out a problem; *régler la radio* — to tune the radio.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

régler is built on *règle* 'rule, ruler', which goes back to Latin *rēgula* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: régler*
- *Say it: régler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *régler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the withdrawal, then the French for to credit, then say *régler* again

Before you move on

What does régler mean? ("To settle (a bill), to pay; to adjust".) Say it once more.

451.4 le découvert — the overdraft

Before the new one: say the French for to credit, then the French for to settle.

You'll want to know: le découvert

le découvert — "the overdraft".

À la fin du mois, il est souvent à découvert.

At the end of the month he is often overdrawn.

Être à découvert — to be overdrawn.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

découvert is the past participle of *découvrir* 'to uncover' (EtymDB), from Late Latin *discooperīre*: an account left uncovered by money.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le découvert*
- *Say it: le découvert*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le découvert*
- *Recall:* say the French for to credit, then the French for to settle, then say *le découvert* again

Before you move on

What does le découvert mean? ("The overdraft".) Say it once more.

451.5 le relevé — the statement (from a bank); the reading

Before the new one: say the French for to settle, then the French for the overdraft.

You'll want to know: le relevé

le relevé — "the statement (from a bank); the reading".

Elle vérifie son relevé de compte chaque mois.

She checks her bank statement every month.

Un relevé de compte; *le relevé du compteur* — the meter reading.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

relevé is the past participle of *relever* 'to lift; to note down' (EtymDB lists it), from Latin *relevāre*, built on *levāre* 'to raise'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le relevé*
- *Say it:* *le relevé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le relevé*
- *Recall:* say the French for to settle, then the French for the overdraft, then say *le relevé* again

Before you move on

What does le relevé mean? (“The statement (from a bank); the reading”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 452

Les bonnes affaires

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can find a bargain: the discount, the price cut, haggling, selling off and the street sale.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 452: I can find a bargain: the discount, the price cut, haggling, selling off and the street sale.*

452.1 la remise — the discount; the shed

> Before the new one: say the French for the overdraft, then the French for the statement.

You'll want to know: la remise

la remise — "the discount; the shed".

> Le vendeur m'a fait une remise de dix pour cent.
>
> *The salesman gave me ten per cent off.*

Une remise is also a garden shed.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

remise is the feminine past participle of *remettre* (EtymDB), from Latin *remittere* 'to send back', built on *mittere* 'to send'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la remise*
- *Say it: la remise*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la remise*
- *Recall:* say the French for the overdraft, then the French for the statement, then say *la remise* again

Before you move on

What does la remise mean? ("The discount; the shed".) Say it once more.

452.2 le rabais — the reduction, the price cut

Before the new one: say the French for the statement, then the French for the discount.

You'll want to know: le rabais

le rabais — "the reduction, the price cut".

Ces chaussures sont vendues au rabais.

These shoes are being sold at a reduced price.

Au rabais — cut-price, sometimes cheap and poor.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rabais is built on *rabaisser* 'to bring down', from *baisser* 'to lower', which goes back to Vulgar Latin *bassiāre*, from Late Latin *bassus* 'low'. EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rabais*
- *Say it: le rabais*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le rabais*
- *Recall:* say the French for the statement, then the French for the discount, then say *le rabais* again

Before you move on

What does le rabais mean? ("The reduction, the price cut".) Say it once more.

452.3 marchander — to haggle, to bargain

Before the new one: say the French for the discount, then the French for the reduction.

You'll want to know: marchander

marchander — "to haggle, to bargain".

Au marché aux puces, tout le monde marchande.

At the flea market everyone haggles.

Le marchandage — haggling.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marchander is built on *marchand* 'trader' (EtymDB), which goes back to a Vulgar Latin form of *mercārī* 'to trade', from *merx* 'goods'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *marchander*
- *Say it:* *marchander*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *marchander*
- *Recall:* say the French for the discount, then the French for the reduction, then say *marchander* again

Before you move on

What does marchander mean? ("To haggle, to bargain".) Say it once more.

452.4 brader — to sell off cheap

Before the new one: say the French for the reduction, then the French for to haggle.

You'll want to know: brader

brader — "to sell off cheap".

En janvier, les boutiques bradent leurs vêtements d'hiver.

In January the shops sell off their winter clothes cheap.

Also figurative: *brader son talent* — to throw it away.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brader is usually traced to Dutch *braden* 'to roast', from the meat roasted at old street markets; EtymDB lists it without a source, and the details are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: brader*
- *Say it: brader*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *brader*
- *Recall:* say the French for the reduction, then the French for to haggle, then say *brader* again

Before you move on

What does brader mean? (“To sell off cheap”.) Say it once more.

452.5 la braderie — the street sale, the clearance market

Before the new one: say the French for to haggle, then the French for to sell off cheap.

You’ll want to know: la braderie

la braderie — “the street sale, the clearance market”.

Chaque septembre, la ville organise une grande braderie.

Every September the town holds a big street sale.

Very popular in the north of France and in Belgium.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

braderie is built on *brader* ’to sell off cheap’ (EtymDB), which is usually traced to Dutch *braden* ’to roast’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la braderie*
- *Say it: la braderie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la braderie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to haggle, then the French for to sell off cheap, then say *la braderie* again

Before you move on

What does la braderie mean? ("The street sale, the clearance market".) Say it once more.

Chapter 453

Emballer et envoyer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can send things: the packaging, wrapping, the delivery man, the cardboard box and registered post.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 453: I can send things: the packaging, wrapping, the delivery man, the cardboard box and registered post.*

453.1 l'emballage — the packaging, the wrapping

Before the new one: say the French for to sell off cheap, then the French for the street sale.

You'll want to know: l'emballage

l'emballage — "the packaging, the wrapping".

Il y a trop d'emballage autour de ce petit objet.

There is too much packaging round this small object.

A masculine noun. *Un emballage cadeau* — gift wrap.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

emballage is built on *emballer* 'to wrap up' with *-age* (EtymDB lists it). *Emballer* comes from *balle* 'bale', usually traced to a Frankish word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'emballage*
- *Say it: l'emballage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'emballage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sell off cheap, then the French for the street sale, then say *l'emballage* again

Before you move on

What does l'emballage mean? ("The packaging, the wrapping".) Say it once more.

453.2 emballer — to wrap (up), to pack; to thrill (informal)

Before the new one: say the French for the street sale, then the French for the packaging.

You'll want to know: emballer

emballer — "to wrap (up), to pack; to thrill (informal)".

La vendeuse emballe le cadeau dans du papier rouge.

The shop assistant wraps the present in red paper.

Informal: *ça m'emballe* — I love the idea; *s'emballer* — to get carried away.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

emballer is built from *en-* and *balle* 'bale, bundle' (EtymDB lists the verb), and *balle* is usually traced to a Frankish word meaning 'ball'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *emballer*
- *Say it:* *emballer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *emballer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the street sale, then the French for the packaging, then say *emballer* again

Before you move on

What does emballer mean? ("To wrap (up), to pack; to thrill (informal)".) Say it once more.

453.3 le livreur — the delivery man, the courier

Before the new one: say the French for the packaging, then the French for to wrap.

You'll want to know: le livreur

le livreur — "the delivery man, the courier".

Le livreur a laissé le paquet chez la voisine.

The delivery man left the parcel with the neighbour.

Feminine *la livreuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

livreur is built on *livrer* 'to deliver' with *-eur* (EtymDB); *livrer* is inherited from Latin *līberāre* 'to set free', from *līber* 'free'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le livreur*
- *Say it: le livreur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le livreur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the packaging, then the French for to wrap, then say *le livreur* again

Before you move on

What does le livreur mean? (“The delivery man, the courier”.) Say it once more.

453.4 le carton — the cardboard box; cardboard

Before the new one: say the French for to wrap, then the French for the delivery man.

You’ll want to know: le carton

le carton — “the cardboard box; cardboard”.

Nous avons mis les livres dans des cartons.

We put the books in cardboard boxes.

Un carton jaune — a yellow card, in sport.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

carton was borrowed from Italian *cartone* ’thick paper’ (EtymDB), from *carta*, which goes back to Latin *charta* ’sheet of papyrus’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le carton*
- *Say it: le carton*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le carton*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wrap, then the French for the delivery man, then say *le carton* again

Before you move on

What does le carton mean? ("The cardboard box; cardboard".) Say it once more.

453.5 le recommandé — the registered letter, registered post

Before the new one: say the French for the delivery man, then the French for the cardboard box.

You'll want to know: le recommandé

le recommandé — "the registered letter, registered post".

La banque m'a envoyé un recommandé.

The bank sent me a registered letter.

En recommandé — by registered post; *une lettre recommandée*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recommandé is the past participle of *recommander* 'to entrust', from *re-* and *commander*, which goes back to Latin *mandāre* 'to entrust' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the noun.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le recommandé*
- *Say it: le recommandé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le recommandé*
- *Recall:* say the French for the delivery man, then the French for the cardboard box, then say *le recommandé* again

Before you move on

What does le recommandé mean? ("The registered letter, registered post".) Say it once more.

Chapter 454

Le relief

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe high ground: the cliff, the plateau, the summit, the mountain pass and the side of a mountain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 454: I can describe high ground: the cliff, the plateau, the summit, the mountain pass and the side of a mountain.*

454.1 la falaise — the cliff

> Before the new one: say the French for the cardboard box, then the French for the registered letter.

You'll want to know: la falaise

la falaise — "the cliff".

> Du haut de la falaise, on voit toute la baie.
>
> *From the top of the cliff the whole bay is in view.*

Usually over the sea.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

falaise comes from Old French *faleise*, from Frankish *falisa* 'rock, cliff' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la falaise*
- *Say it: la falaise*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la falaise*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cardboard box, then the French for the registered letter, then say *la falaise* again

Before you move on

What does la falaise mean? ("The cliff".) Say it once more.

454.2 le plateau — the plateau, the high plain; the tray

Before the new one: say the French for the registered letter, then the French for the cliff.

You'll want to know: le plateau

le plateau — "the plateau, the high plain; the tray".

Le village est sur un plateau, au-dessus de la vallée.

The village is on a plateau above the valley.

Plural *les plateaux*. *Un plateau* is also a tray, and a TV set.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plateau is built on *plat* 'flat', which goes back to Vulgar Latin *plattus*, from Greek *platýs* 'broad' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plateau*
- *Say it: le plateau*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le plateau*
- *Recall:* say the French for the registered letter, then the French for the cliff, then say *le plateau* again

Before you move on

What does le plateau mean? ("The plateau, the high plain; the tray".) Say it once more.

454.3 le sommet — the summit, the top; the summit meeting

Before the new one: say the French for the cliff, then the French for the plateau.

You'll want to know: le sommet

le sommet — "the summit, the top; the summit meeting".

Nous sommes arrivés au sommet à midi.

We reached the summit at noon.

Un sommet européen — a European summit.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sommet comes from Old French *somet* (EtymDB), a small *som* 'top', from Latin *summum* 'highest point', from *summus* 'highest'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sommet*
- *Say it: le sommet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sommet*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cliff, then the French for the plateau, then say *le sommet* again

Before you move on

What does le sommet mean? ("The summit, the top; the summit meeting".) Say it once more.

454.4 le col — the mountain pass; the collar

Before the new one: say the French for the plateau, then the French for the summit.

You'll want to know: le col

le col — "the mountain pass; the collar".

La route du col est fermée en hiver.

The road over the pass is closed in winter.

Le col de la chemise — the shirt collar.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

col is inherited through Old French *col* 'neck' from Latin *collum* 'neck' (EtymDB): a low point between two mountains, like a neck.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le col*
- *Say it: le col*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le col*
- *Recall:* say the French for the plateau, then the French for the summit, then say *le col* again

Before you move on

What does le col mean? ("The mountain pass; the collar".) Say it once more.

454.5 le versant — the mountainside, the slope

Before the new one: say the French for the summit, then the French for the mountain pass.

You'll want to know: le versant

le versant — "the mountainside, the slope".

Les vignes poussent sur le versant sud.

The vines grow on the south-facing side.

Le versant nord — the north face.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

versant is the present participle of *verser* 'to pour, to tip', used as a noun (EtymDB lists it); *verser* goes back to Latin *versāre*, from *vertere* 'to turn' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le versant*
- *Say it:* *le versant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le versant*
- *Recall:* say the French for the summit, then the French for the mountain pass, then say *le versant* again

Before you move on

What does le versant mean? (“The mountainside, the slope”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 455

En randonnée

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a hike: the hike, the hiker, the slope, climbing up and stumbling.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 455: I can talk about a hike: the hike, the hiker, the slope, climbing up and stumbling.*

455.1 la randonnée — the hike, the long walk

> Before the new one: say the French for the mountain pass, then the French for the mountainside.

You'll want to know: la randonnée

la randonnée — "the hike, the long walk".

> Le dimanche, nous faisons une randonnée en montagne.
>
> *On Sundays we go for a hike in the mountains.*

In speech, *la rando*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

randonnée is built on *randonner* 'to walk a long way' (EtymDB), from Old French *randonner* 'to run headlong', usually traced to a Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la randonnée*
- *Say it: la randonnée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la randonnée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the mountain pass, then the French for the mountainside, then say *la randonnée* again

Before you move on

What does la randonnée mean? ("The hike, the long walk".) Say it once more.

455.2 le randonneur — the hiker

Before the new one: say the French for the mountainside, then the French for the hike.

You'll want to know: le randonneur

le randonneur — "the hiker".

Les randonneurs se reposent près du lac.

The hikers are resting by the lake.

Feminine *la randonneuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

randonneur is built on *randonner* 'to hike' with *-eur* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le randonneur*
- *Say it: le randonneur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le randonneur*
- *Recall:* say the French for the mountainside, then the French for the hike, then say *le randonneur* again

Before you move on

What does le randonneur mean? (“The hiker”.) Say it once more.

455.3 la pente — the slope, the incline

Before the new one: say the French for the hike, then the French for the hiker.

You’ll want to know: la pente

la pente — “the slope, the incline”.

La pente est raide, alors nous montons doucement.

The slope is steep, so we go up slowly.

En pente — sloping.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pente goes back to Vulgar Latin *pendita*, from Latin *pendēre* ’to hang’ (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la pente*
- *Say it:* *la pente*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la pente*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hike, then the French for the hiker, then say *la pente* again

Before you move on

What does la pente mean? ("The slope, the incline".) Say it once more.

455.4 gravir — to climb (up)

Before the new one: say the French for the hiker, then the French for the slope.

You'll want to know: gravir

gravir — "to climb (up)".

Ils ont gravi la colline en une heure.

They climbed the hill in an hour.

Conjugated like *finir*. A bit formal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *gravir* is not settled, and EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: gravir*
- *Say it: gravir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *gravir*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hiker, then the French for the slope, then say *gravir* again

Before you move on

What does gravir mean? ("To climb (up)".) Say it once more.

455.5 trébucher — to stumble, to trip

Before the new one: say the French for the slope, then the French for to climb.

You'll want to know: trébucher

trébucher — "to stumble, to trip".

Sur le sentier, elle a trébuché sur une pierre.

On the path she tripped over a stone.

Trébucher sur un mot — to stumble over a word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trébucher comes from Old French *trebuchier* 'to topple' (EtymDB), from *tres-*, from Latin *trāns* 'across', and a Frankish word for 'trunk, body'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: trébucher*
- *Say it: trébucher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *trébucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for the slope, then the French for to climb, then say *trébucher* again

Before you move on

What does trébucher mean? ("To stumble, to trip".) Say it once more.

455.6 Retour sur les chapitres 448–455

Say the French for the hairdresser and to shave.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the hairdresser, to shave, the optician, the watchmaker, the jeweller
- the florist, the tobacconist, to put a stamp on, to send off, to tie up
- the cashier, to cash in, to charge, the card machine, cash
- the withdrawal, to credit, to settle, the overdraft, the statement
- the discount, the reduction, to haggle, to sell off cheap, the street sale
- the packaging, to wrap, the delivery man, the cardboard box, the registered letter
- the cliff, the plateau, the summit, the mountain pass, the mountainside
- the hike, the hiker, the slope, to climb, to stumble

Before you move on

The hairdresser? (**le coiffeur**.) To shave? (**raser**.) The optician? (**l'opticien**.) The watchmaker? (**l'horloger**.) The jeweller? (**le bijoutier**.) The florist? (**le fleuriste**.) The tobacconist? (**le buraliste**.) To put a stamp on? (**affranchir**.) To send off? (**expédier**.) To tie up? (**ficeler**.) The cashier? (**le caissier**.) To cash in? (**encaisser**.) To charge? (**débiter**.) The card machine? (**le terminal**.) Cash? (**le liquide**.) The withdrawal? (**le retrait**.) To credit? (**créditer**.) To settle? (**régler**.) The overdraft? (**le découvert**.) The statement? (**le relevé**.) The discount? (**la remise**.) The reduction? (**le rabais**.) To haggle? (**marchander**.) To sell off cheap? (**brader**.) The street sale? (**la braderie**.) The packaging? (**l'emballage**.) To wrap? (**emballer**.) The delivery man? (**le livreur**.) The cardboard box? (**le carton**.) The registered letter? (**le recommandé**.) The cliff? (**la falaise**.) The plateau? (**le plateau**.) The summit? (**le sommet**.) The mountain pass? (**le col**.) The mountainside? (**le versant**.) The hike? (**la randonnée**.) The hiker? (**le randonneur**.) The slope? (**la pente**.) To climb? (**gravir**.) To stumble? (**trébucher**.)

Chapter 456

Ruisseaux et marais

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe wet places: the stream, the pond, the marsh, splashing about and water running down.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 456: I can describe wet places: the stream, the pond, the marsh, splashing about and water running down.*

456.1 le ruisseau — the stream, the brook

> Before the new one: say the French for to climb, then the French for to stumble.

You'll want to know: le ruisseau

le ruisseau — "the stream, the brook".

> Un petit ruisseau traverse le jardin.
>
> *A little stream runs across the garden.*

Plural *les ruisseaux*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ruisseau goes back to Vulgar Latin *rīvuscellus* (EtymDB), a small *rīvus* 'stream'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le ruisseau*
- *Say it: le ruisseau*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le ruisseau*
- *Recall:* say the French for to climb, then the French for to stumble, then say *le ruisseau* again

Before you move on

What does le ruisseau mean? ("The stream, the brook".) Say it once more.

456.2 l'étang — the pond

Before the new one: say the French for to stumble, then the French for the stream.

You'll want to know: l'étang

l'étang — "the pond".

Des canards nagent sur l'étang.

Some ducks are swimming on the pond.

A masculine noun. Bigger than a *mare*, smaller than a *lac*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étang comes from Old French *estanc* (EtymDB lists it), built on *estanchier* 'to stop the flow of water', which is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin verb; the details are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'étang*
- *Say it: l'étang*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'étang*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stumble, then the French for the stream, then say *l'étang* again

Before you move on

What does l'étang mean? ("The pond".) Say it once more.

456.3 le marais — the marsh, the swamp

Before the new one: say the French for the stream, then the French for the pond.

You'll want to know: le marais

le marais — "the marsh, the swamp".

Beaucoup d'oiseaux vivent dans le marais.

Many birds live in the marsh.

Les marais salants — salt marshes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marais comes from Old French *mareis*, from Frankish *marisk* 'marsh' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le marais*
- *Say it: le marais*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le marais*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stream, then the French for the pond, then say *le marais* again

Before you move on

What does le marais mean? ("The marsh, the swamp".) Say it once more.

456.4 patauger — to splash about, to wade; to flounder

Before the new one: say the French for the pond, then the French for the marsh.

You'll want to know: patauger

patauger — "to splash about, to wade; to flounder".

Les enfants pataugent dans le ruisseau.

The children are splashing about in the stream.

Figurative: *je patauge* — I am getting nowhere.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

patauger is usually linked to *patte* 'paw, foot', but the origin is not settled. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: patauger*
- *Say it: patauger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *patauger*
- *Recall:* say the French for the pond, then the French for the marsh, then say *patauger* again

Before you move on

What does patauger mean? ("To splash about, to wade; to flounder".) Say it once more.

456.5 ruisseler — to stream, to run down (of water)

Before the new one: say the French for the marsh, then the French for to splash about.

You'll want to know: ruisseler

ruisseler — "to stream, to run down (of water)".

La pluie ruisselle sur les vitres.

The rain is streaming down the windows.

Le ruissellement — run-off water.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ruisseler is built on *ruissel*, an old form of *ruisseau* 'stream' (EtymDB lists it), from Latin *rīvus*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ruisseler*
- *Say it:* *ruisseler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *ruisseler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the marsh, then the French for to splash about, then say *ruisseler* again

Before you move on

What does ruisseler mean? ("To stream, to run down (of water)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 457

Au fond des bois

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a wood: the clearing, the bush, the fern, the moss and the bark.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 457: I can describe a wood: the clearing, the bush, the fern, the moss and the bark.*

457.1 la clairière — the clearing (in a wood)

Before the new one: say the French for to splash about, then the French for to stream.

You'll want to know: la clairière

la clairière — "the clearing (in a wood)".

> Au milieu de la forêt, nous avons pique-niqué dans une clairière.
>
> *In the middle of the forest we had a picnic in a clearing.*

Built on *clair* 'light'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

clairière is built on *clair* 'clear, light', which is inherited from Latin *clārus* (Lewis & Short): the light place among the trees. EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la clairière*
- *Say it: la clairière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la clairière*
- *Recall:* say the French for to splash about, then the French for to stream, then say *la clairière* again

Before you move on

What does la clairière mean? ("The clearing (in a wood)".) Say it once more.

457.2 le buisson — the bush

Before the new one: say the French for to stream, then the French for the clearing.

You'll want to know: le buisson

le buisson — "the bush".

Un lapin se cache dans le buisson.

A rabbit is hiding in the bush.

Tourner autour du pot means to beat about the bush.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

buisson is built on *bois* 'wood', which is usually traced to a Germanic word for 'bush' (EtymDB lists Germanic cousins).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le buisson*
- *Say it: le buisson*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le buisson*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stream, then the French for the clearing, then say *le buisson* again

Before you move on

What does le buisson mean? (“The bush”.) Say it once more.

457.3 la fougère — the fern, the bracken

Before the new one: say the French for the clearing, then the French for the bush.

You’ll want to know: la fougère

la fougère — “the fern, the bracken”.

Les fougères poussent sous les arbres.

The ferns grow under the trees.

Often in the plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fougère comes from Old French *fulgiere*, from Vulgar Latin *filicāria* ’place full of ferns’, from Latin *filix* ’fern’ (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fougère*
- *Say it: la fougère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fougère*
- *Recall:* say the French for the clearing, then the French for the bush, then say *la fougère* again

Before you move on

What does la fougère mean? ("The fern, the bracken".) Say it once more.

457.4 la mousse — the moss; the foam

Before the new one: say the French for the bush, then the French for the fern.

You'll want to know: la mousse

la mousse — "the moss; the foam".

Les pierres du chemin sont couvertes de mousse.

The stones on the path are covered in moss.

La mousse is also foam, as on beer; that is probably a different word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mousse 'moss' comes from Old French *mosse*, from Frankish *mosa* 'moss' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mousse*
- *Say it: la mousse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la mousse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bush, then the French for the fern, then say *la mousse* again

Before you move on

What does la mousse mean? ("The moss; the foam".) Say it once more.

457.5 l'écorce — the bark (of a tree); the peel

Before the new one: say the French for the fern, then the French for the moss.

You'll want to know: l'écorce

l'écorce — "the bark (of a tree); the peel".

L'écorce de ce vieil arbre est très épaisse.

The bark of this old tree is very thick.

A feminine noun. *L'écorce d'orange* — orange peel.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écorce is inherited from Latin *scortea* 'leather garment', from *scortum* 'hide, skin' (EtymDB): the tree's skin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *l'écorce*
- *Say it:* *l'écorce*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'écorce*
- *Recall:* say the French for the fern, then the French for the moss, then say *l'écorce* again

Before you move on

What does l'écorce mean? ("The bark (of a tree); the peel".) Say it once more.

Chapter 458

Au bord de la mer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the coast: the dune, the tide, the cove, the reef and the seashell.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 458: I can describe the coast: the dune, the tide, the cove, the reef and the seashell.*

458.1 la dune — the dune

Before the new one: say the French for the moss, then the French for the bark.

You'll want to know: la dune

la dune — "the dune".

Derrière la plage, il y a de hautes dunes.

Behind the beach there are high dunes.

Une dune de sable — a sand dune.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dune was borrowed from Middle Dutch *dūne* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dune*
- *Say it: la dune*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la dune*
- *Recall:* say the French for the moss, then the French for the bark, then say *la dune* again

Before you move on

What does la dune mean? ("The dune".) Say it once more.

458.2 la marée — the tide

Before the new one: say the French for the bark, then the French for the dune.

You'll want to know: la marée

la marée — "the tide".

À marée basse, on peut marcher jusqu'à l'île.

At low tide you can walk to the island.

Marée haute — high tide; *une marée noire* — an oil spill.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marée is built on *mer* 'sea' (EtymDB), which is inherited from Latin *mare*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la marée*
- *Say it: la marée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la marée*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bark, then the French for the dune, then say *la marée* again

Before you move on

What does la marée mean? (“The tide”.) Say it once more.

458.3 la crique — the cove, the creek

Before the new one: say the French for the dune, then the French for the tide.

You’ll want to know: la crique

la crique — “the cove, the creek”.

Nous avons trouvé une petite crique sans personne.

We found a little cove with nobody in it.

A small, sheltered beach between rocks.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

crique was borrowed from Old Norse *kriki* ’bend, nook’ (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la crique*
- *Say it: la crique*, once more

- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la crique*
- *Recall:* say the French for the dune, then the French for the tide, then say *la crique* again

Before you move on

What does la crique mean? (“The cove, the creek”.) Say it once more.

458.4 le récif — the reef

Before the new one: say the French for the tide, then the French for the cove.

You’ll want to know: le récif

le récif — “the reef”.

Les bateaux évitent le récif près du port.

The boats steer clear of the reef near the harbour.

Un récif de corail — a coral reef.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

récif was borrowed from Spanish *arrecife*, which is usually traced to Arabic *ar-raṣīf* ’causeway, raised way’. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le récif*
- *Say it: le récif*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le récif*
- *Recall:* say the French for the tide, then the French for the cove, then say *le récif* again

Before you move on

What does le récif mean? ("The reef".) Say it once more.

458.5 le coquillage — the seashell; the shellfish

Before the new one: say the French for the cove, then the French for the reef.

You'll want to know: le coquillage

le coquillage — "the seashell; the shellfish".

La petite fille ramasse des coquillages sur la plage.

The little girl collects shells on the beach.

Les coquillages are also shellfish to eat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coquillage is built on *coquille* 'shell' (EtymDB lists it), which goes back to Vulgar Latin *conchilia*, from Latin *concha* 'shellfish, shell'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coquillage*
- *Say it: le coquillage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le coquillage*
- *Recall:* say the French for the cove, then the French for the reef, then say *le coquillage* again

Before you move on

What does le coquillage mean? ("The seashell; the shellfish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 459

Les animaux des bois

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name animals of the woods: the squirrel, the hedgehog, the wild boar, the stag and the doe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 459: I can name animals of the woods: the squirrel, the hedgehog, the wild boar, the stag and the doe.*

459.1 l'écureuil — the squirrel

> Before the new one: say the French for the reef, then the French for the seashell.

You'll want to know: l'écureuil

l'écureuil — "the squirrel".

> Un écureuil monte dans l'arbre avec une noisette.
>
> *A squirrel runs up the tree with a hazelnut.*

A masculine noun. The ending sounds like *euil*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

écureuil comes from Middle French *escureul* (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *scūriolus*, a small Latin *sciūrus*, from Greek *skíouros* 'shadow-tail'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'écureuil*
- *Say it: l'écureuil*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'écureuil*
- *Recall:* say the French for the reef, then the French for the seashell, then say *l'écureuil* again

Before you move on

What does l'écureuil mean? ("The squirrel".) Say it once more.

459.2 le hérisson — the hedgehog

Before the new one: say the French for the seashell, then the French for the squirrel.

You'll want to know: le hérisson

le hérisson — "the hedgehog".

La nuit, un hérisson traverse le jardin.

At night a hedgehog crosses the garden.

The *h* is aspirate: *le hérisson*, not *l'hérisson*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

hérisson comes from Old French *heriçun* (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *ēricius* 'hedgehog'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le hérisson*
- *Say it: le hérisson*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le hérisson*
- *Recall:* say the French for the seashell, then the French for the squirrel, then say *le hérisson* again

Before you move on

What does le hérisson mean? ("The hedgehog".) Say it once more.

459.3 le sanglier — the wild boar

Before the new one: say the French for the squirrel, then the French for the hedgehog.

You'll want to know: le sanglier

le sanglier — "the wild boar".

Les sangliers sortent du bois le soir.

The wild boar come out of the wood in the evening.

La laie is the female.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sanglier goes back to Latin *singulāris* 'solitary', as in *singulāris porcus* 'the pig that lives alone', from *singulus* 'single' (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sanglier*
- *Say it: le sanglier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sanglier*
- *Recall:* say the French for the squirrel, then the French for the hedgehog, then say *le sanglier* again

Before you move on

What does le sanglier mean? ("The wild boar".) Say it once more.

459.4 le cerf — the stag, the deer

Before the new one: say the French for the hedgehog, then the French for the wild boar.

You'll want to know: le cerf

le cerf — "the stag, the deer".

Au lever du jour, nous avons vu un cerf dans la clairière.

At daybreak we saw a stag in the clearing.

The *f* is silent: *le cerf* rhymes with *serre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cerf is inherited through Old French from Latin *cervus* 'deer' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cerf*
- *Say it: le cerf*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cerf*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hedgehog, then the French for the wild boar, then say *le cerf* again

Before you move on

What does le cerf mean? (“The stag, the deer”.) Say it once more.

459.5 la biche — the doe, the hind

Before the new one: say the French for the wild boar, then the French for the stag.

You’ll want to know: la biche

la biche — “the doe, the hind”.

La biche et son petit boivent à l’étang.

The doe and her fawn are drinking at the pond.

Affectionate: *ma biche* — my darling.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

biche comes from Middle French *biche* (EtymDB), which is usually traced through a northern dialect to Latin *bestia* ’animal’; the details are not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la biche*
- *Say it: la biche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la biche*
- *Recall:* say the French for the wild boar, then the French for the stag, then say *la biche* again

Before you move on

What does la biche mean? (“The doe, the hind”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 460

Le bulletin météo

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can follow a weather report: the weather forecast, the outlook, cloudy, sunny and the thermometer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 460: I can follow a weather report: the weather forecast, the outlook, cloudy, sunny and the thermometer.*

460.1 la météo — the weather forecast; the weather

> Before the new one: say the French for the stag, then the French for the doe.

You'll want to know: la météo

la météo — "the weather forecast; the weather".

> Selon la météo, il va faire beau demain.
>
> *According to the forecast it is going to be nice tomorrow.*

Short for *la météorologie*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

météo is short for *météorologie*, a learned borrowing from Greek *meteōrología*, from *metéōros* 'high in the air' (EtymDB lists the short

form).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la météo*
- *Say it: la météo*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la météo*
- *Recall:* say the French for the stag, then the French for the doe, then say *la météo* again

Before you move on

What does la météo mean? ("The weather forecast; the weather".) Say it once more.

460.2 les prévisions — the forecast, the outlook

Before the new one: say the French for the doe, then the French for the weather forecast.

You'll want to know: les prévisions

les prévisions — "the forecast, the outlook".

Les prévisions pour le week-end ne sont pas bonnes.

The forecast for the weekend is not good.

Mostly plural: *les prévisions météo*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

prévision is built on *prévoir* 'to foresee', from Latin *praevidēre*, built on *vidēre* 'to see' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list the noun.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les prévisions*
- *Say it: les prévisions*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les prévisions*
- *Recall:* say the French for the doe, then the French for the weather forecast, then say *les prévisions* again

Before you move on

What does les prévisions mean? ("The forecast, the outlook".) Say it once more.

460.3 nuageux — cloudy

Before the new one: say the French for the weather forecast, then the French for the forecast.

You'll want to know: nuageux

nuageux — "cloudy".

Le ciel est nuageux, mais il ne pleut pas.

The sky is cloudy, but it is not raining.

Feminine *nuageuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

nuageux is built on *nuage* 'cloud' (EtymDB lists it), from the old word *nue* 'cloud', which goes back to Latin *nūbēs*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nuageux*
- *Say it:* *nuageux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *nuageux*
- *Recall:* say the French for the weather forecast, then the French for the forecast, then say *nuageux* again

Before you move on

What does nuageux mean? ("Cloudy".) Say it once more.

460.4 ensoleillé — sunny

Before the new one: say the French for the forecast, then the French for cloudy.

You'll want to know: ensoleillé

ensoleillé — "sunny".

La terrasse est ensoleillée l'après-midi.

The terrace is sunny in the afternoon.

Une journée ensoleillée — a sunny day.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ensoleillé is built on *soleil* 'sun', which goes back to Vulgar Latin *sōliculus*, a small *sōl* 'sun' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: ensoleillé*
- *Say it: ensoleillé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *ensoleillé*
- *Recall:* say the French for the forecast, then the French for cloudy, then say *ensoleillé* again

Before you move on

What does ensoleillé mean? ("Sunny".) Say it once more.

460.5 le thermomètre — the thermometer

Before the new one: say the French for cloudy, then the French for sunny.

You'll want to know: le thermomètre

le thermomètre — "the thermometer".

Ce matin, le thermomètre indique moins cinq.

This morning the thermometer reads minus five.

Also for a fever.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

thermomètre is a learned formation from Greek *thermós* 'hot' and *métron* 'measure' (EtymDB lists the word).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le thermomètre*
- *Say it: le thermomètre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le thermomètre*
- *Recall:* say the French for cloudy, then the French for sunny, then say *le thermomètre* again

Before you move on

What does le thermomètre mean? ("The thermometer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 461

Bruine et averses

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about showers: drizzle, drizzling, the shower, the bright spell and the sky clearing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 461: I can talk about showers: drizzle, drizzling, the shower, the bright spell and the sky clearing.*

461.1 la bruine — the drizzle

> Before the new one: say the French for sunny, then the French for the thermometer.

You'll want to know: la bruine

la bruine — "the drizzle".

> Une bruine fine tombe depuis ce matin.
>
> *A fine drizzle has been falling since this morning.*

Very light rain.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bruine is usually traced to Latin *pruīna* 'hoarfrost' (Lewis & Short), but the path is not settled, and EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bruine*
- *Say it: la bruine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bruine*
- *Recall:* say the French for sunny, then the French for the thermometer, then say *la bruine* again

Before you move on

What does la bruine mean? ("The drizzle".) Say it once more.

461.2 bruiner — to drizzle

Before the new one: say the French for the thermometer, then the French for the drizzle.

You'll want to know: bruiner

bruiner — "to drizzle".

Il bruine, mais nous sortons quand même.

It is drizzling, but we are going out anyway.

Only with *il*: *il bruine*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bruiner is built on *bruine* 'drizzle' (EtymDB lists the verb).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: bruiner*
- *Say it: bruiner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bruiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for the thermometer, then the French for the drizzle, then say *bruiner* again

Before you move on

What does bruiner mean? ("To drizzle".) Say it once more.

461.3 l'averse — the rain shower, the downpour

Before the new one: say the French for the drizzle, then the French for to drizzle.

You'll want to know: l'averse

l'averse — "the rain shower, the downpour".

Nous avons attendu la fin de l'averse sous un arbre.

We waited for the shower to end under a tree.

A feminine noun. Short and heavy.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

averse comes from *à verse* 'pouring down', from *verser* 'to pour', which goes back to Latin *versāre*, from *vertere* 'to turn' (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'averse*
- *Say it: l'averse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'averse*
- *Recall:* say the French for the drizzle, then the French for to drizzle, then say *l'averse* again

Before you move on

What does l'averse mean? ("The rain shower, the downpour".) Say it once more.

461.4 l'éclaircie — the bright spell, the sunny interval

Before the new one: say the French for to drizzle, then the French for the rain shower.

You'll want to know: l'éclaircie

l'éclaircie — "the bright spell, the sunny interval".

Après la pluie, il y a eu une belle éclaircie.

After the rain there was a lovely bright spell.

A feminine noun. *Des averses et des éclaircies* — sunshine and showers.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éclaircie is built on *éclaircir* 'to brighten, to clear up', from *clair* 'clear', which is inherited from Latin *clārus* (Lewis & Short). EtymDB does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éclaircie*
- *Say it: l'éclaircie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'éclaircie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to drizzle, then the French for the rain shower, then say *l'éclaircie* again

Before you move on

What does l'éclaircie mean? ("The bright spell, the sunny interval".) Say it once more.

461.5 dégager — to clear (of the sky); to free

Before the new one: say the French for the rain shower, then the French for the bright spell.

You'll want to know: dégager

dégager — "to clear (of the sky); to free".

Vers midi, le ciel s'est dégagé.

Around midday the sky cleared.

Le ciel se dégage — the sky is clearing; *dégager le passage* — to clear the way.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dégager is built from *dé-* and *gage* 'pledge' (EtymDB lists the verb), which comes from a Frankish word: first to take back what was pledged, then to set free.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dégager*
- *Say it:* *dégager*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dégager*
- *Recall:* say the French for the rain shower, then the French for the bright spell, then say *dégager* again

Before you move on

What does dégager mean? ("To clear (of the sky); to free".) Say it once more.

Chapter 462

L'orage gronde

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a storm: stormy weather, lightning, hail, rumbling and a gust of wind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 462: I can describe a storm: stormy weather, lightning, hail, rumbling and a gust of wind.*

462.1 orageux — stormy, thundery

Before the new one: say the French for the bright spell, then the French for to clear.

You'll want to know: orageux

orageux — "stormy, thundery".

> Le temps est orageux depuis ce matin.
>
> *The weather has been thundery since this morning.*

Feminine *orageuse*. Figurative: *une discussion orageuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

orageux is built on *orage* 'storm' (EtymDB lists it), from Old French *ore* 'wind', which goes back to Latin *aura* 'breeze'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: orageux*
- *Say it: orageux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *orageux*
- *Recall:* say the French for the bright spell, then the French for to clear, then say *orageux* again

Before you move on

What does orageux mean? ("Stormy, thundery".) Say it once more.

462.2 la foudre — the lightning (that strikes)

Before the new one: say the French for to clear, then the French for stormy.

You'll want to know: la foudre

la foudre — "the lightning (that strikes)".

La foudre est tombée sur un arbre du parc.

Lightning struck a tree in the park.

La foudre strikes; *un éclair* is the flash you see.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

foudre is inherited from Latin *fulgur* 'lightning' (Lewis & Short); EtymDB lists the word without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la foudre*
- *Say it: la foudre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la foudre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clear, then the French for stormy, then say *la foudre* again

Before you move on

What does la foudre mean? (“The lightning (that strikes)”.) Say it once more.

462.3 la grêle — the hail

Before the new one: say the French for stormy, then the French for the lightning.

You’ll want to know: la grêle

la grêle — “the hail”.

La grêle a abîmé les voitures dans la rue.

The hail damaged the cars in the street.

Il grêle — it is hailing; *un grêlon* — a hailstone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grêle ’hail’ is built on *grêler* ’to hail’, which is usually traced to a Frankish verb; the origin is not settled. It is not the same word as the adjective *grêle* ’thin’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grêle*
- *Say it: la grêle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la grêle*
- *Recall:* say the French for stormy, then the French for the lightning, then say *la grêle* again

Before you move on

What does la grêle mean? ("The hail".) Say it once more.

462.4 gronder — to rumble; to scold

Before the new one: say the French for the lightning, then the French for the hail.

You'll want to know: gronder

gronder — "to rumble; to scold".

Le tonnerre gronde au loin.

Thunder is rumbling in the distance.

Gronder un enfant — to tell a child off.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gronder is inherited from Latin *grundīre* 'to grunt' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: gronder*
- *Say it: gronder*, once more

- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *gronder*
- *Recall:* say the French for the lightning, then the French for the hail, then say *gronder* again

Before you move on

What does gronder mean? (“To rumble; to scold”.) Say it once more.

462.5 la rafale — the gust (of wind); the burst

Before the new one: say the French for the hail, then the French for to rumble.

You’ll want to know: la rafale

la rafale — “the gust (of wind); the burst”.

Une rafale de vent a emporté son chapeau.

A gust of wind blew his hat away.

Des rafales à cent kilomètres-heure.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *rafale* is not settled. It is usually linked to Italian *raffica* ’gust’; EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rafale*
- *Say it: la rafale*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rafale*
- *Recall:* say the French for the hail, then the French for to rumble, then say *la rafale* again

Before you move on

What does la rafale mean? ("The gust (of wind); the burst".) Say it once more.

Chapter 463

Le grand froid

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about freezing weather: black ice, frost, freezing, thawing and shivering.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 463: I can talk about freezing weather: black ice, frost, freezing, thawing and shivering.*

463.1 le verglas — the black ice

> Before the new one: say the French for to rumble, then the French for the gust.

You'll want to know: le verglas

le verglas — "the black ice".

> Avec le verglas, les voitures roulent très lentement.
>
> *Because of the black ice, cars are going very slowly.*

Une route verglacée — an icy road.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

verglas is built from *verre* 'glass', from Latin *vitrum*, and *glace* 'ice', from Latin *glaciēs* (EtymDB): ice as smooth as glass.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le verglas*
- *Say it: le verglas*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le verglas*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rumble, then the French for the gust, then say *le verglas* again

Before you move on

What does le verglas mean? ("The black ice".) Say it once more.

463.2 le givre — the frost (on surfaces), the hoarfrost

Before the new one: say the French for the gust, then the French for the black ice.

You'll want to know: le givre

le givre — "the frost (on surfaces), the hoarfrost".

Le matin, il y a du givre sur le pare-brise.

In the morning there is frost on the windscreen.

White frost on windows and grass.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *givre* is not settled; it may come from a language spoken in the region before Latin. EtymDB lists it without a source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le givre*
- *Say it: le givre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le givre*
- *Recall:* say the French for the gust, then the French for the black ice, then say *le givre* again

Before you move on

What does le givre mean? ("The frost (on surfaces), the hoarfrost".) Say it once more.

463.3 geler — to freeze

Before the new one: say the French for the black ice, then the French for the frost.

You'll want to know: geler

geler — "to freeze".

Cette nuit, il a gelé et le lac est blanc.

Last night it froze and the lake is white.

Il gèle — it is freezing; *je suis gelé* — I am frozen.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

geler is inherited through Old French from Latin *gelāre* 'to freeze', from *gelū* 'frost' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *geler*
- *Say it:* *geler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *geler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the black ice, then the French for the frost, then say *geler* again

Before you move on

What does geler mean? ("To freeze".) Say it once more.

463.4 dégeler — to thaw

Before the new one: say the French for the frost, then the French for to freeze.

You'll want to know: dégeler

dégeler — "to thaw".

Au printemps, la rivière dégèle.

In spring the river thaws.

Le dégel — the thaw.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dégeler is built from *dé-* and *geler* 'to freeze' (EtymDB lists it), which is inherited from Latin *gelāre*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dégeler*
- *Say it: dégeler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dégeler*
- *Recall:* say the French for the frost, then the French for to freeze, then say *dégeler* again

Before you move on

What does dégeler mean? (“To thaw”.) Say it once more.

463.5 grelotter — to shiver (with cold)

Before the new one: say the French for to freeze, then the French for to thaw.

You’ll want to know: grelotter

grelotter — “to shiver (with cold)”.

Sans manteau, le garçon grelotte à l’arrêt de bus.

Without a coat the boy is shivering at the bus stop.

Only from cold.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grelotter is built on *grelot* ’small round bell’ (EtymDB), usually explained by an old phrase about teeth that rattle like a little bell.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: grelotter*
- *Say it: grelotter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *grelotter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to freeze, then the French for to thaw, then say *grelotter* again

Before you move on

What does grelotter mean? ("To shiver (with cold)".) Say it once more.

463.6 Retour sur les chapitres 456–463

Say the French for the stream and the pond.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the stream, the pond, the marsh, to splash about, to stream
- the clearing, the bush, the fern, the moss, the bark
- the dune, the tide, the cove, the reef, the seashell
- the squirrel, the hedgehog, the wild boar, the stag, the doe
- the weather forecast, the forecast, cloudy, sunny, the thermometer
- the drizzle, to drizzle, the rain shower, the bright spell, to clear
- stormy, the lightning, the hail, to rumble, the gust
- the black ice, the frost, to freeze, to thaw, to shiver

Before you move on

The stream? (**le ruisseau**.) The pond? (**l'étang**.) The marsh? (**le marais**.) To splash about? (**patauger**.) To stream? (**ruisseler**.)

The clearing? (**la clairière**.) The bush? (**le buisson**.) The fern? (**la fougère**.) The moss? (**la mousse**.) The bark? (**l'écorce**.) The dune? (**la dune**.) The tide? (**la marée**.) The cove? (**la crique**.) The reef? (**le récif**.) The seashell? (**le coquillage**.) The squirrel? (**l'écureuil**.) The hedgehog? (**le hérisson**.) The wild boar? (**le sanglier**.) The stag? (**le cerf**.) The doe? (**la biche**.) The weather forecast? (**la météo**.) The forecast? (**les prévisions**.) Cloudy? (**nuageux**.) Sunny? (**ensoleillé**.) The thermometer? (**le thermomètre**.) The drizzle? (**la bruine**.) To drizzle? (**bruiner**.) The rain shower? (**l'averse**.) The bright spell? (**l'éclaircie**.) To clear? (**dégager**.) Stormy? (**orageux**.) The lightning? (**la foudre**.) The hail? (**la grêle**.) To rumble? (**gronder**.) The gust? (**la rafale**.) The black ice? (**le verglas**.) The frost? (**le givre**.) To freeze? (**geler**.) To thaw? (**dégeler**.) To shiver? (**grelotter**.)

Chapter 464

La canicule

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a heatwave: the heatwave, the drought, the humidity, clammy air and sweating.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 464: I can talk about a heatwave: the heatwave, the drought, the humidity, clammy air and sweating.*

464.1 la canicule — the heatwave

Before the new one: say the French for to thaw, then the French for to shiver.

You'll want to know: la canicule

la canicule — "the heatwave".

Pendant la canicule, les gens restent chez eux l'après-midi.

During the heatwave people stay at home in the afternoon.

In Québec also *la vague de chaleur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

canicule is a learned borrowing from Latin *canīcula* 'little dog', the name of the Dog Star, which rises in the hottest days of summer (EtymDB); it is built on *canis* 'dog'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la canicule*
- *Say it: la canicule*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la canicule*
- *Recall:* say the French for to thaw, then the French for to shiver, then say *la canicule* again

Before you move on

What does la canicule mean? ("The heatwave".) Say it once more.

464.2 la sécheresse — the drought

Before the new one: say the French for to shiver, then the French for the heatwave.

You'll want to know: la sécheresse

la sécheresse — "the drought".

À cause de la sécheresse, les rivières sont presque vides.

Because of the drought the rivers are almost empty.

Built on *sec* 'dry'.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sécheresse is built on *sec, sèche* 'dry' (EtymDB lists it), which is inherited from Latin *siccus*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sécheresse*
- *Say it: la sécheresse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la sécheresse*
- *Recall:* say the French for to shiver, then the French for the heatwave, then say *la sécheresse* again

Before you move on

What does la sécheresse mean? (“The drought”.) Say it once more.

464.3 l’humidité — the humidity, the damp

Before the new one: say the French for the heatwave, then the French for the drought.

You’ll want to know: l’humidité

l’humidité — “the humidity, the damp”.

Avec l’humidité, mes cheveux frisent.

With the humidity my hair goes frizzy.

A feminine noun.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

humidité is a learned borrowing from Latin *hūmiditās* (EtymDB), from *hūmidus* ’damp’.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'humidité*
- *Say it: l'humidité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'humidité*
- *Recall:* say the French for the heatwave, then the French for the drought, then say *l'humidité* again

Before you move on

What does l'humidité mean? ("The humidity, the damp".) Say it once more.

464.4 moite — clammy, sticky (with damp heat)

Before the new one: say the French for the drought, then the French for the humidity.

You'll want to know: moite

moite — "clammy, sticky (with damp heat)".

Dans le métro, l'air est chaud et moite.

In the metro the air is hot and clammy.

Les mains moites — sweaty hands. Same form for both genders.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

moite comes from Old French *moiste* (EtymDB), which is usually traced to Latin *mūcidus* 'mouldy, slimy' (Lewis & Short); the details are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: moite*
- *Say it: moite*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *moite*
- *Recall:* say the French for the drought, then the French for the humidity, then say *moite* again

Before you move on

What does moite mean? ("Clammy, sticky (with damp heat)".) Say it once more.

464.5 transpirer — to sweat, to perspire

Before the new one: say the French for the humidity, then the French for clammy.

You'll want to know: transpirer

transpirer — "to sweat, to perspire".

Il transpire beaucoup quand il fait chaud.

He sweats a lot when it is hot.

A little more polite than *suer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

transpirer is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *transpīrāre* 'to breathe through' (EtymDB), from *trāns* and *spīrāre* 'to breathe'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: transpirer*
- *Say it: transpirer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *transpirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for the humidity, then the French for clammy, then say *transpirer* again

Before you move on

What does transpirer mean? ("To sweat, to perspire".) Say it once more.

Chapter 465

Tempête et inondations

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about storms and floods: the storm, the flood, flooding, overflowing and the puddle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 465: I can talk about storms and floods: the storm, the flood, flooding, overflowing and the puddle.*

465.1 la tempête — the storm, the gale

> Before the new one: say the French for clammy, then the French for to sweat.

You'll want to know: la tempête

la tempête — "the storm, the gale".

> La tempête a fait tomber des arbres sur la route.
>
> *The storm brought trees down onto the road.*

Stronger than an *orage*: a lot of wind.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tempête comes from Old French *tempeste*, from Vulgar Latin *tempesta*, from Latin *tempestās* 'weather, storm', built on *tempus* 'time' (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tempête*
- *Say it: la tempête*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la tempête*
- *Recall:* say the French for clammy, then the French for to sweat, then say *la tempête* again

Before you move on

What does la tempête mean? ("The storm, the gale".) Say it once more.

465.2 l'inondation — the flood

Before the new one: say the French for to sweat, then the French for the storm.

You'll want to know: l'inondation

l'inondation — "the flood".

Après l'inondation, la cave était pleine d'eau.

After the flood the cellar was full of water.

A feminine noun.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inondation is a learned borrowing from Latin *inundātiō* (EtymDB), from *inundāre* 'to overflow', built on *unda* 'wave'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'inondation*
- *Say it: l'inondation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'inondation*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sweat, then the French for the storm, then say *l'inondation* again

Before you move on

What does l'inondation mean? ("The flood".) Say it once more.

465.3 inonder — to flood

Before the new one: say the French for the storm, then the French for the flood.

You'll want to know: inonder

inonder — "to flood".

La rivière a inondé les champs.

The river flooded the fields.

Figurative: *inonder de messages* — to flood with messages.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

inonder is a learned borrowing from Latin *inundāre* 'to overflow' (EtymDB), from *unda* 'wave'.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: inonder*
- *Say it: inonder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *inonder*
- *Recall:* say the French for the storm, then the French for the flood, then say *inonder* again

Before you move on

What does inonder mean? ("To flood".) Say it once more.

465.4 déborder — to overflow; to go beyond

Before the new one: say the French for the flood, then the French for to flood.

You'll want to know: déborder

déborder — "to overflow; to go beyond".

Après trois jours de pluie, le ruisseau déborde.

After three days of rain the stream is overflowing.

Être débordé — to be swamped with work.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

déborder is built from *dé-* and *bord* 'edge, side' (EtymDB lists it), which comes from a Frankish word for the side of a ship.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: déborder*
- *Say it: déborder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *déborder*
- *Recall:* say the French for the flood, then the French for to flood, then say *déborder* again

Before you move on

What does déborder mean? (“To overflow; to go beyond”.) Say it once more.

465.5 la flaque — the puddle

Before the new one: say the French for to flood, then the French for to overflow.

You’ll want to know: la flaque

la flaque — “the puddle”.

Le bus est passé dans une flaque et m’a mouillé.

The bus went through a puddle and got me wet.

Une flaque d’eau.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flaque came into French from Picard *flaque* (EtymDB), a northern dialect word usually linked to *flache* ’hollow, soft ground’; the deeper origin is not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la flaque*
- *Say it: la flaque*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la flaque*
- *Recall:* say the French for to flood, then the French for to overflow, then say *la flaque* again

Before you move on

What does la flaque mean? (“The puddle”.) Say it once more.

465.6 Ville, commerces, nature et météo

Say the French for the heatwave and the drought.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the heatwave, the drought, the humidity, clammy, to sweat
- the storm, the flood, to flood, to overflow, the puddle

Before you move on

The heatwave? (**la canicule**.) The drought? (**la sécheresse**.) The humidity? (**l’humidité**.) Clammy? (**moite**.) To sweat? (**transpirer**.) The storm? (**la tempête**.) The flood? (**l’inondation**.) To flood? (**inonder**.) To overflow? (**déborder**.) The puddle? (**la flaque**.)

465.7 Tempête et inondations — once more

Say the French for the storm and the flood.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the storm, the flood, to flood, to overflow, the puddle

Before you move on

The storm? (**la tempête**.) The flood? (**l'inondation**.) To flood? (**inonder**.) To overflow? (**déborder**.) The puddle? (**la flaque**.)

Chapter 466

Timides et sociables

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe how shy or outgoing someone is.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 466: I can describe how shy or outgoing someone is.*

466.1 la timidité — shyness

> Before the new one: say the French for a team, then the French for a birthday.

You'll want to know: la timidité

la timidité — "shyness".

> Avec le temps, il a perdu sa timidité.
>
> *With time, he lost his shyness.*

The adjective *timide* "shy" is the everyday word; *la timidité* names the quality.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la timidité is a learned borrowing from Latin *timiditās* "fearfulness" (EtymDB), built on *timidus* "fearful", from *timēre* "to fear" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la timidité*
- *Say it: la timidité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la timidité*
- *Recall:* say the French for a team, then the French for a birthday, then say *la timidité* again

Before you move on

What does la timidité mean? ("Shyness".) Say it once more.

466.2 sociable — sociable, outgoing

Before the new one: say the French for a birthday, then the French for shyness.

You'll want to know: sociable

sociable — "sociable, outgoing".

Ma cousine est très sociable : elle parle à tout le monde.

My cousin is very sociable: she talks to everyone.

The same form for a man and a woman. The opposite is *peu sociable*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sociable is a learned borrowing from Latin *sociābilis* "that can be joined together", built on *socius* "a companion, a partner" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sociable*
- *Say it: sociable*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sociable*
- *Recall:* say the French for a birthday, then the French for shyness, then say *sociable* again

Before you move on

What does sociable mean? ("Sociable, outgoing".) Say it once more.

466.3 réservé — reserved, quiet (of a person); booked

Before the new one: say the French for shyness, then the French for sociable.

You'll want to know: réservé

réservé — "reserved, quiet (of a person); booked".

Mon frère est un garçon réservé ; il parle peu de lui.

My brother is a reserved boy; he says little about himself.

Of a table or a seat it means booked: *une table réservée*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réservé is the past participle of *réserver* "to keep back", which comes from Latin *reservāre* (Lewis & Short), built on *servāre* "to keep, to watch over".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: réservé*
- *Say it: réservé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *réservé*
- *Recall:* say the French for shyness, then the French for sociable, then say *réservé* again

Before you move on

What does réservé mean? ("Reserved, quiet (of a person); booked".) Say it once more.

466.4 bouder — to sulk

Before the new one: say the French for sociable, then the French for reserved.

You'll want to know: bouder

bouder — "to sulk".

Le petit garçon boude parce qu'il ne peut pas sortir.

The little boy is sulking because he cannot go out.

Bouder quelqu'un means to give someone the cold shoulder.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *bouder* is not settled. It is usually traced to an expressive root *bod-* for something swollen, the picture being pushed-out lips.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: bouder*
- *Say it: bouder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bouder*
- *Recall:* say the French for sociable, then the French for reserved, then say *bouder* again

Before you move on

What does bouder mean? ("To sulk".) Say it once more.

466.5 taquiner — to tease (playfully)

Before the new one: say the French for reserved, then the French for to sulk.

You'll want to know: taquiner

taquiner — "to tease (playfully)".

Mon oncle aime taquiner les enfants pendant le dîner.

My uncle likes teasing the children at dinner.

Gentle, friendly teasing; stronger mockery is *se moquer de*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

taquiner is built on the adjective *taquin*, which first meant "stingy" and later "fond of teasing". The origin of *taquin* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *taquiner*
- *Say it:* *taquiner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *taquiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for reserved, then the French for to sulk, then say *taquiner* again

Before you move on

What does taquiner mean? (“To tease (playfully)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 467

Qualités et défauts

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the weak sides of someone's character.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 467: I can describe the weak sides of someone's character.*

467.1 têtu — stubborn

> Before the new one: say the French for to sulk, then the French for to tease.

You'll want to know: têtu

têtu — "stubborn".

> Mon grand-père est têtu : il ne change jamais d'avis.
>
> *My grandfather is stubborn: he never changes his mind.*

Built on *la tête*: someone with a hard head. Feminine *têtue*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

têtu is built on Old French *teste* "head" (EtymDB), now *tête*, which is inherited from Latin *testa* "an earthen pot, a shell" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: têtu*
- *Say it: têtu*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *têtu*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sulk, then the French for to tease, then say *têtu* again

Before you move on

What does têtu mean? ("Stubborn".) Say it once more.

467.2 la paresse — laziness

Before the new one: say the French for to tease, then the French for stubborn.

You'll want to know: la paresse

la paresse — "laziness".

Le dimanche, je me laisse aller à la paresse.

On Sundays I give in to laziness.

The noun of *paresseux* "lazy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la paresse is inherited, through Old French *peresce*, from Latin *pigritia* "sluggishness" (EtymDB), built on *piger* "reluctant, slow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la paresse*
- *Say it: la paresse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la paresse*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tease, then the French for stubborn, then say *la paresse* again

Before you move on

What does la paresse mean? (“Laziness”.) Say it once more.

467.3 avare — stingy, mean with money; miser

Before the new one: say the French for stubborn, then the French for laziness.

You’ll want to know: avare

avare — “stingy, mean with money; miser”.

Il n’est pas avare, mais il compte chaque euro.

He is not stingy, but he counts every euro.

Also a noun: *un avare* — a miser.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

avare is a learned borrowing from Latin *avārus* “greedy”, related to *avēre* “to long for, to crave” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: avare*
- *Say it: avare*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *avare*
- *Recall:* say the French for stubborn, then the French for laziness, then say *avare* again

Before you move on

What does avare mean? ("Stingy, mean with money; miser".) Say it once more.

467.4 maladroit — clumsy

Before the new one: say the French for laziness, then the French for stingy.

You'll want to know: maladroit

maladroit — "clumsy".

Je suis maladroit : j'ai encore cassé un verre.

I am clumsy: I broke another glass.

The opposite is *adroit* "skilful". *Une maladresse* is a clumsy act.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

maladroit is built from *mal* "badly" and *adroit* "skilful" (EtymDB). *Adroit* comes from *à droit* "rightly", and *droit* is inherited from Latin *dīrēctus* "straight".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: maladroit*
- *Say it: maladroit*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *maladroit*
- *Recall:* say the French for laziness, then the French for stingy, then say *maladroit* again

Before you move on

What does maladroit mean? (“Clumsy”.) Say it once more.

467.5 étourdi — scatterbrained, absent-minded

Before the new one: say the French for stingy, then the French for clumsy.

You’ll want to know: étourdi

étourdi — “scatterbrained, absent-minded”.

Ma sœur est un peu étourdie ; elle oublie souvent ses clés.

My sister is a bit scatterbrained; she often forgets her keys.

Also *dazed*, after a blow: *il est encore étourdi.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étourdi is the participle of *étourdir* “to daze”. It is usually traced to a Vulgar Latin *exturdīre*, built on *turdus* “a thrush”, a bird once thought to be easily dazed; the origin is not fully settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *étourdi*
- *Say it:* *étourdi*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *étourdi*
- *Recall:* say the French for stingy, then the French for clumsy, then say *étourdi* again

Before you move on

What does étourdi mean? ("Scatterbrained, absent-minded".) Say it once more.

Chapter 468

Sincères et menteurs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say whether someone is honest, naive or cunning.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 468: I can say whether someone is honest, naive or cunning.*

468.1 sincère — sincere, honest

> Before the new one: say the French for clumsy, then the French for scatterbrained.

You'll want to know: sincère

sincère — "sincere, honest".

> Elle est toujours sincère avec ses amis.
>
> *She is always honest with her friends.*

The noun is *la sincérité*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sincère is a learned borrowing from Latin *sincērus* "pure, clean, whole" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sincère*
- *Say it: sincère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sincère*
- *Recall:* say the French for clumsy, then the French for scatterbrained, then say *sincère* again

Before you move on

What does sincère mean? ("Sincere, honest".) Say it once more.

468.2 le menteur — liar; lying

Before the new one: say the French for scatterbrained, then the French for sincere.

You'll want to know: le menteur

le menteur — "liar; lying".

Ne le crois pas, c'est un menteur.

Do not believe him, he is a liar.

A woman is *la menteuse*. A lie is *un mensonge*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le menteur is inherited from Old French *menteor* (EtymDB), built on *mentir* "to lie", from Latin *mentīrī* "to lie" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le menteur*
- *Say it: le menteur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le menteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for scatterbrained, then the French for sincere, then say *le menteur* again

Before you move on

What does le menteur mean? ("Liar; lying".) Say it once more.

468.3 naïf — naive

Before the new one: say the French for sincere, then the French for liar.

You'll want to know: naïf

naïf — "naive".

J'étais si naïf que je croyais tout.

I was so naive that I believed everything.

Feminine *naïve*. The noun is *la naïveté*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

naïf is inherited from Latin *nātīvus* "inborn, natural" (EtymDB), from *nāscī* "to be born" (Lewis & Short); the sense moved from "natural" to "unspoiled" and then to "naive".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: naïf*
- *Say it: naïf*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *naïf*
- *Recall:* say the French for sincere, then the French for liar, then say *naïf* again

Before you move on

What does naïf mean? ("Naive".) Say it once more.

468.4 rusé — cunning, crafty

Before the new one: say the French for liar, then the French for naive.

You'll want to know: rusé

rusé — "cunning, crafty".

Le renard est rusé : il trouve toujours une sortie.

The fox is cunning: it always finds a way out.

The noun *une ruse* is a trick.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rusé comes from *ruser*, first said of a hunted animal that doubles back. *Ruser* is inherited from Latin *recūsāre* "to refuse, to draw back" (Lewis & Short), itself built on *causa*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rusé*
- *Say it: rusé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rusé*
- *Recall:* say the French for liar, then the French for naive, then say *rusé* again

Before you move on

What does rusé mean? ("Cunning, crafty".) Say it once more.

468.5 mentir — to lie, to tell lies

Before the new one: say the French for naive, then the French for cunning.

You'll want to know: mentir

mentir — "to lie, to tell lies".

Il a menti à ses parents sur ses notes.

He lied to his parents about his marks.

Present: *je mens, il ment, nous mentons.* Past: *j'ai menti.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

mentir is inherited, through Old French, from Vulgar Latin *mentīre*, a form of Latin *mentīrī* "to lie" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mentir*
- *Say it:* *mentir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *mentir*
- *Recall:* say the French for naive, then the French for cunning, then say *mentir* again

Before you move on

What does mentir mean? ("To lie, to tell lies".) Say it once more.

Chapter 469

De quelle humeur ?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe moods: calm, moody or irritated.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 469: I can describe moods: calm, moody or irritated.*

469.1 l'humeur — mood

> Before the new one: say the French for cunning, then the French for to lie.

You'll want to know: l'humeur

l'humeur — "mood".

> Ce matin, je suis de bonne humeur.
>
> *This morning I am in a good mood.*

De bonne humeur — in a good mood; *de mauvaise humeur* — in a bad mood. It is feminine: *une humeur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'humeur is inherited from Latin *ūmor* "moisture, fluid" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short): old medicine linked a person's mood to the fluids of the body.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'humeur*
- *Say it: l'humeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'humeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for cunning, then the French for to lie, then say *l'humeur* again

Before you move on

What does l'humeur mean? ("Mood".) Say it once more.

469.2 serein — calm, serene

Before the new one: say the French for to lie, then the French for mood.

You'll want to know: serein

serein — "calm, serene".

Après les vacances, je me sens plus serein.

After the holidays I feel calmer.

Feminine *sereine*. It describes a calm mind, not loud or worried.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

serein is inherited from Latin *serēnus* "clear, bright, calm" (Lewis & Short), said first of the sky. Old French also had a noun *serein* "evening", from Latin *sērum* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: serein*
- *Say it: serein*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *serein*
- *Recall:* say the French for to lie, then the French for mood, then say *serein* again

Before you move on

What does serein mean? (“Calm, serene”.) Say it once more.

469.3 lunatique — moody

Before the new one: say the French for mood, then the French for calm.

You’ll want to know: lunatique

lunatique — “moody”.

Mon frère est lunatique : un jour il rit, un jour il boude.

My brother is moody: one day he laughs, the next he sulks.

Not like English *lunatic*: it means moody, full of ups and downs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

lunatique is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *lūnāticus* “moonstruck” (Lewis & Short), built on *lūna* “the moon”: moods were thought to follow its phases.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: lunatique*
- *Say it: lunatique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *lunatique*
- *Recall:* say the French for mood, then the French for calm, then say *lunatique* again

Before you move on

What does lunatique mean? ("Moody".) Say it once more.

469.4 énerver — to annoy, to get on someone's nerves; (s'énerver) to get worked up

Before the new one: say the French for calm, then the French for moody.

You'll want to know: énerver

énerver — "to annoy, to get on someone's nerves; (s'énerver) to get worked up".

Je m'énerve quand le train est en retard.

I get worked up when the train is late.

Often reflexive: *s'énerver*, past *je me suis énervé*. *Ça m'énerve* — that gets on my nerves.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

énerver is a learned borrowing from Latin *ēnervāre* "to cut the sinews, to weaken" (EtymDB), built on *nervus* "a sinew" (Lewis & Short). French later gave it the sense "to set the nerves on edge".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *énerver*
- *Say it:* *énerver*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *énerver*
- *Recall:* say the French for calm, then the French for moody, then say *énerver* again

Before you move on

What does énerver mean? ("To annoy, to get on someone's nerves; (s'énerver) to get worked up".) Say it once more.

469.5 agacer — to irritate, to get on someone's nerves

Before the new one: say the French for moody, then the French for to annoy.

You'll want to know: agacer

agacer — "to irritate, to get on someone's nerves".

Le bruit de la rue agace mon voisin.

The noise from the street irritates my neighbour.

Spelling: *nous agaçons*, with *ç* before *o*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

agacer goes back to Old French *agacier*. The origin is not settled: a link with *agace*, an old word for the magpie, is often suggested.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *agacer*
- *Say it:* *agacer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *agacer*
- *Recall:* say the French for moody, then the French for to annoy, then say *agacer* again

Before you move on

What does agacer mean? ("To irritate, to get on someone's nerves".) Say it once more.

Chapter 470

Quelle frayeur !

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a fright and the relief afterwards.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 470: I can talk about a fright and the relief afterwards.*

470.1 la frayeur — fright, scare

> Before the new one: say the French for to annoy, then the French for to irritate.

You'll want to know: la frayeur

la frayeur — "fright, scare".

> Quelle frayeur ! J'ai cru que j'avais perdu mon passeport.
>
> *What a fright! I thought I had lost my passport.*

Stronger than *la peur*, and over quickly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la frayeur is inherited from Old French *freor* (EtymDB), from Latin *fragor* "a crash, a din", built on *frangere* "to break" (Lewis & Short); its form was later drawn towards *effrayer*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la frayeur*
- *Say it: la frayeur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la frayeur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to annoy, then the French for to irritate, then say *la frayeur* again

Before you move on

What does la frayeur mean? ("Fright, scare".) Say it once more.

470.2 effrayer — to frighten, to scare

Before the new one: say the French for to irritate, then the French for fright.

You'll want to know: effrayer

effrayer — "to frighten, to scare".

L'orage a effrayé le chien toute la nuit.

The storm frightened the dog all night.

Être effrayé — to be frightened. *Effrayant* — frightening.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

effrayer comes from Old French *esfreer* "to disturb, to take the peace away" (EtymDB), built on *es-* "out" and *freer* "to make peace", which is usually traced to Frankish *fridu* "peace".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: effrayer*
- *Say it: effrayer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *effrayer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to irritate, then the French for fright, then say *effrayer* again

Before you move on

What does effrayer mean? ("To frighten, to scare".) Say it once more.

470.3 sursauter — to jump, to start (with surprise)

Before the new one: say the French for fright, then the French for to frighten.

You'll want to know: sursauter

sursauter — "to jump, to start (with surprise)".

J'ai sursauté quand la porte a claqué.

I jumped when the door slammed.

A sudden jump of the body, from surprise or fear.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sursauter is built from *sur* and *sauter* "to jump", which is inherited from Latin *saltāre* "to dance, to leap" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sursauter*
- *Say it: sursauter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sursauter*
- *Recall:* say the French for fright, then the French for to frighten, then say *sursauter* again

Before you move on

What does sursauter mean? ("To jump, to start (with surprise)".) Say it once more.

470.4 le soulagement — relief

Before the new one: say the French for to frighten, then the French for to jump.

You'll want to know: le soulagement

le soulagement — "relief".

Quel soulagement ! Ma fille est bien arrivée.

What a relief! My daughter has arrived safely.

The verb is *soulager* "to relieve"; *je suis soulagé* — I am relieved.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le soulagement is built on *soulager* "to relieve", which comes from Latin *sublevāre* "to lift up, to lighten" (Lewis & Short), from *levāre* "to raise".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le soulagement*
- *Say it: le soulagement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le soulagement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to frighten, then the French for to jump, then say *le soulagement* again

Before you move on

What does le soulagement mean? ("Relief".) Say it once more.

470.5 rassurer — to reassure

Before the new one: say the French for to jump, then the French for relief.

You'll want to know: rassurer

rassurer — "to reassure".

Le médecin a rassuré mes parents.

The doctor reassured my parents.

Je suis rassuré — I feel reassured.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rassurer comes from Old French *rasseürer* (EtymDB), built from *re-* and *asseürer* "to make safe", which goes back to Latin *sēcūrus* "free from care" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rassurer*
- *Say it: rassurer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rassurer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to jump, then the French for relief, then say *rassurer* again

Before you move on

What does rassurer mean? (“To reassure”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 471

Une grande déception

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about disappointment and sadness.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 471: I can talk about disappointment and sadness.*

471.1 la déception — disappointment

> Before the new one: say the French for relief, then the French for to reassure.

You'll want to know: la déception

la déception — "disappointment".

> Le film a été une vraie déception.
>
> *The film was a real disappointment.*

A false friend: it does not mean *deception* in English, which is *la tromperie*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la déception is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *dēceptiō* "deceit", from *dēcipere* "to catch, to deceive", built on *capere* "to take" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la déception*
- *Say it: la déception*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la déception*
- *Recall:* say the French for relief, then the French for to reassure, then say *la déception* again

Before you move on

What does la déception mean? ("Disappointment".) Say it once more.

471.2 décevoir — to disappoint

Before the new one: say the French for to reassure, then the French for disappointment.

You'll want to know: décevoir

décevoir — "to disappoint".

Le concert m'a beaucoup déçu.

The concert disappointed me a lot.

Like *recevoir*: *je déçois*, *j'ai été déçu*. It does not mean to deceive.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

décevoir is inherited, through Old French *deceveir*, from Latin *dēcipere* "to deceive" (EtymDB), built on *capere* "to take" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: décevoir*
- *Say it: décevoir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *décevoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reassure, then the French for disappointment, then say *décevoir* again

Before you move on

What does décevoir mean? (“To disappoint”.) Say it once more.

471.3 le chagrin — sorrow, grief

Before the new one: say the French for disappointment, then the French for to disappoint.

You’ll want to know: le chagrin

le chagrin — “sorrow, grief”.

Elle a eu beaucoup de chagrin quand son chat est mort.

She felt great sorrow when her cat died.

Avoir du chagrin — to be sad. *Un chagrin d’amour* — heartbreak.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *le chagrin* “sorrow” is not settled. A link with *chagrin*, a grainy leather named from Turkish *sağrı* (EtymDB), is sometimes proposed.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chagrin*
- *Say it: le chagrin*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chagrin*
- *Recall:* say the French for disappointment, then the French for to disappoint, then say *le chagrin* again

Before you move on

What does le chagrin mean? ("Sorrow, grief".) Say it once more.

471.4 sangloter — to sob

Before the new one: say the French for to disappoint, then the French for sorrow.

You'll want to know: sangloter

sangloter — "to sob".

L'enfant sanglotait dans les bras de sa mère.

The child was sobbing in his mother's arms.

Un sanglot — a sob.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sangloter is inherited from Latin *singultāre* "to hiccup, to sob" (EtymDB), from *singultus* "a hiccup, a sob" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sangloter*
- *Say it: sangloter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sangloter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to disappoint, then the French for sorrow, then say *sangloter* again

Before you move on

What does sangloter mean? ("To sob".) Say it once more.

471.5 consoler — to comfort, to console

Before the new one: say the French for sorrow, then the French for to sob.

You'll want to know: consoler

consoler — "to comfort, to console".

Mon ami m'a consolé après mon échec.

My friend comforted me after my failure.

Se consoler — to get over something sad.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

consoler is a learned borrowing from Latin *cōnsōlārī* "to comfort" (EtymDB), built on *sōlārī* "to soothe" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *consoler*
- *Say it:* *consoler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *consoler*
- *Recall:* say the French for sorrow, then the French for to sob, then say *consoler* again

Before you move on

What does consoler mean? (“To comfort, to console”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 472

Souvenirs et regrets

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can talk about memories, regrets and being moved.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 472: I can talk about memories, regrets and being moved.

472.1 la nostalgie — nostalgia, longing for the past

Before the new one: say the French for to sob, then the French for to comfort.

You'll want to know: la nostalgie

la nostalgie — "nostalgia, longing for the past".

Je pense à mon enfance avec nostalgie.

I think of my childhood with nostalgia.

Avoir la nostalgie de — to miss, to long for.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la nostalgie comes from New Latin *nostalgia* (EtymDB), coined from Greek *nóstos* "return home" and *álgos* "pain": it first named homesickness.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nostalgie*
- *Say it: la nostalgie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la nostalgie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sob, then the French for to comfort, then say *la nostalgie* again

Before you move on

What does la nostalgie mean? ("Nostalgia, longing for the past".) Say it once more.

472.2 regretter — to regret; to miss

Before the new one: say the French for to comfort, then the French for nostalgia.

You'll want to know: regretter

regretter — "to regret; to miss".

Je regrette mon ancien quartier.

I miss my old neighbourhood.

Je regrette also means I am sorry: *je regrette, c'est complet.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

regretter comes from Old French *regreter* "to lament the dead" (EtymDB), built from *re-* and an old verb for weeping, probably of Germanic origin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: regretter*
- *Say it: regretter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *regretter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to comfort, then the French for nostalgia, then say *regretter* again

Before you move on

What does regretter mean? ("To regret; to miss".) Say it once more.

472.3 la mélancolie — melancholy, gloom

Before the new one: say the French for nostalgia, then the French for to regret.

You'll want to know: la mélancolie

la mélancolie — "melancholy, gloom".

L'automne me donne toujours un peu de mélancolie.

Autumn always makes me a little melancholy.

The adjective is *mélancolique*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la mélancolie comes through Latin *melancholia* from Greek *melankholía* (EtymDB), built on *mélas* "black" and *kholḗ* "bile": old medicine blamed sadness on black bile.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la mélancolie*
- *Say it: la mélancolie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la mélancolie*
- *Recall:* say the French for nostalgia, then the French for to regret, then say *la mélancolie* again

Before you move on

What does la mélancolie mean? ("Melancholy, gloom".) Say it once more.

472.4 émouvoir — to move, to touch (emotionally)

Before the new one: say the French for to regret, then the French for melancholy.

You'll want to know: émouvoir

émouvoir — "to move, to touch (emotionally)".

Sa lettre m'a beaucoup ému.

Her letter moved me a lot.

Past participle *ému*: *j'étais ému* — I was moved.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

émouvoir comes from Latin *ēmovēre* "to move out, to stir", built on *movēre* "to move" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: émouvoir*
- *Say it: émouvoir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *émouvoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to regret, then the French for melancholy, then say *émouvoir* again

Before you move on

What does émouvoir mean? ("To move, to touch (emotionally)".) Say it once more.

472.5 bouleverser — to deeply upset, to overwhelm; to turn upside down

Before the new one: say the French for melancholy, then the French for to move.

You'll want to know: bouleverser

bouleverser — "to deeply upset, to overwhelm; to turn upside down".

Cette nouvelle a bouleversé toute la famille.

This news deeply upset the whole family.

Also of plans or a room: *il a bouleversé nos projets.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bouleverser is built from *boule* "ball", from Latin *bulla* "a bubble", and *verser* "to tip over", from Latin *versāre* "to turn", built on *vertere* (Lewis & Short): to send rolling like a ball.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bouleverser*
- *Say it:* *bouleverser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bouleverser*
- *Recall:* say the French for melancholy, then the French for to move, then say *bouleverser* again

Before you move on

What does bouleverser mean? ("To deeply upset, to overwhelm; to turn upside down".) Say it once more.

Chapter 473

Fierté et modestie

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about pride, vanity and modesty.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 473: I can talk about pride, vanity and modesty.*

473.1 la fierté — pride

> Before the new one: say the French for to move, then the French for to deeply upset.

You'll want to know: la fierté

la fierté — "pride".

> Mon père parle de mon travail avec fierté.
>
> *My father speaks about my work with pride.*

Built on *fier* "proud"; a good kind of pride.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la fierté is built on *fier* "proud" with *-té* (EtymDB). *Fier* is inherited from Latin *ferus* "wild, untamed" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fierté*
- *Say it: la fierté*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fierté*
- *Recall:* say the French for to move, then the French for to deeply upset, then say *la fierté* again

Before you move on

What does la fierté mean? ("Pride".) Say it once more.

473.2 l'orgueil — arrogance, excessive pride

Before the new one: say the French for to deeply upset, then the French for pride.

You'll want to know: l'orgueil

l'orgueil — "arrogance, excessive pride".

Par orgueil, il n'a pas demandé d'aide.

Out of pride, he did not ask for help.

Masculine: *un orgueil*. Stronger and more negative than *la fierté*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'orgueil comes from Frankish *urgōli* "pride", a Germanic word related to Old English *orgel* "pride" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'orgueil*
- *Say it: l'orgueil*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'orgueil*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deeply upset, then the French for pride, then say *l'orgueil* again

Before you move on

What does l'orgueil mean? ("Arrogance, excessive pride".) Say it once more.

473.3 vaniteux — vain, conceited

Before the new one: say the French for pride, then the French for arrogance.

You'll want to know: vaniteux

vaniteux — "vain, conceited".

Il est vaniteux et parle toujours de lui.

He is vain and always talks about himself.

Feminine *vaniteuse*. The noun is *la vanité*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vaniteux is built on *vanité*, a learned borrowing from Latin *vānitās* "emptiness, vanity", from *vānus* "empty" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaniteux*
- *Say it: vaniteux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *vaniteux*
- *Recall:* say the French for pride, then the French for arrogance, then say *vaniteux* again

Before you move on

What does vaniteux mean? ("Vain, conceited".) Say it once more.

473.4 modeste — modest

Before the new one: say the French for arrogance, then the French for vain.

You'll want to know: modeste

modeste — "modest".

Elle a gagné le prix, mais elle reste modeste.

She won the prize, but she remains modest.

Also simple, small: *un salaire modeste*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

modeste is a learned borrowing from Latin *modestus* "keeping within measure", from *modus* "measure" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: modeste*
- *Say it: modeste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *modeste*
- *Recall:* say the French for arrogance, then the French for vain, then say *modeste* again

Before you move on

What does modeste mean? (“Modest”.) Say it once more.

473.5 vanter — to praise; (se vanter) to boast

Before the new one: say the French for vain, then the French for modest.

You’ll want to know: vanter

vanter — “to praise; (se vanter) to boast”.

Mon collègue se vante de sa nouvelle voiture.

My colleague is boasting about his new car.

Mostly reflexive: *se vanter de quelque chose*. *Vanter un produit* — to praise a product.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vanter is inherited from Old French *vanter* (EtymDB), usually traced to a Late Latin *vānitāre* “to speak emptily”, built on Latin *vānus* “empty, vain” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: vanter*
- *Say it: vanter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *vanter*
- *Recall:* say the French for vain, then the French for modest, then say *vanter* again

Before you move on

What does vanter mean? ("To praise; (se vanter) to boast".) Say it once more.

473.6 Sentiments et santé

Say the French for shyness and sociable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- shyness, sociable, reserved, to sulk, to tease
- stubborn, laziness, stingy, clumsy, scatterbrained
- sincere, liar, naive, cunning, to lie
- mood, calm, moody, to annoy, to irritate
- fright, to frighten, to jump, relief, to reassure
- disappointment, to disappoint, sorrow, to sob, to comfort
- nostalgia, to regret, melancholy, to move, to deeply upset
- pride, arrogance, vain, modest, to praise

Before you move on

Shyness? (**la timidité**.) Sociable? (**sociable**.) Reserved? (**réservé**.) To sulk? (**bouder**.) To tease? (**taquiner**.) Stubborn?

(**têtu**.) Laziness? (**la paresse**.) Stingy? (**avare**.) Clumsy? (**maladroit**.) Scatterbrained? (**étourdi**.) Sincere? (**sincère**.) Liar? (**le menteur**.) Naive? (**naïf**.) Cunning? (**rusé**.) To lie? (**mentir**.) Mood? (**l'humeur**.) Calm? (**serein**.) Moody? (**lunatique**.) To annoy? (**énerver**.) To irritate? (**agacer**.) Fright? (**la frayeur**.) To frighten? (**effrayer**.) To jump? (**sursauter**.) Relief? (**le soulagement**.) To reassure? (**rassurer**.) Disappointment? (**la déception**.) To disappoint? (**décevoir**.) Sorrow? (**le chagrin**.) To sob? (**sangloter**.) To comfort? (**consoler**.) Nostalgia? (**la nostalgie**.) To regret? (**regretter**.) Melancholy? (**la mélancolie**.) To move? (**émouvoir**.) To deeply upset? (**bouleverser**.) Pride? (**la fierté**.) Arrogance? (**l'orgueil**.) Vain? (**vaniteux**.) Modest? (**modeste**.) To praise? (**vanter**.)

Chapter 474

Rire aux éclats

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about fun, laughter and good spirits.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 474: I can talk about fun, laughter and good spirits.*

474.1 la gaieté — cheerfulness

> Before the new one: say the French for modest, then the French for to praise.

You'll want to know: la gaieté

la gaieté — "cheerfulness".

> Sa gaieté met tout le monde de bonne humeur.
>
> *Her cheerfulness puts everyone in a good mood.*

Also spelt *la gaîté*. Built on *gai* "cheerful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la gaieté is built on *gai* "cheerful" (EtymDB), which came into French from Old Occitan *gai*; it is usually traced further back to a Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gaieté*
- *Say it: la gaieté*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la gaieté*
- *Recall:* say the French for modest, then the French for to praise, then say *la gaieté* again

Before you move on

What does la gaieté mean? ("Cheerfulness".) Say it once more.

474.2 rigoler — to laugh, to have fun (informal)

Before the new one: say the French for to praise, then the French for cheerfulness.

You'll want to know: rigoler

rigoler — "to laugh, to have fun (informal)".

On a bien rigolé pendant la soirée.

We had a good laugh at the party.

Informal. *Tu rigoles !* — you are joking!

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rigoler goes back to Old French *rigoler* "to amuse oneself". The origin is not settled; a link with *rire* is often suggested.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rigoler*
- *Say it: rigoler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rigoler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to praise, then the French for cheerfulness, then say *rigoler* again

Before you move on

What does rigoler mean? ("To laugh, to have fun (informal)".) Say it once more.

474.3 le fou rire — fit of the giggles

Before the new one: say the French for cheerfulness, then the French for to laugh.

You'll want to know: le fou rire

le fou rire — "fit of the giggles".

Pendant le cours, nous avons eu un fou rire.

During the lesson we got the giggles.

Avoir le fou rire — to be unable to stop laughing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le fou rire is "mad laughter": *fou* is inherited from Latin *follis* "bellows, a bag of wind", and *rire* from Latin *rīdēre* "to laugh" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fou rire*
- *Say it: le fou rire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le fou rire*
- *Recall:* say the French for cheerfulness, then the French for to laugh, then say *le fou rire* again

Before you move on

What does le fou rire mean? ("Fit of the giggles".) Say it once more.

474.4 marrant — funny (informal)

Before the new one: say the French for to laugh, then the French for fit of the giggles.

You'll want to know: marrant

marrant — "funny (informal)".

Ton frère est vraiment marrant.

Your brother is really funny.

Informal, like *drôle*. *Se marrer* — to laugh.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marrant is the present participle of *se marrer* "to laugh", a word of familiar French. The origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: marrant*
- *Say it: marrant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *marrant*
- *Recall:* say the French for to laugh, then the French for fit of the giggles, then say *marrant* again

Before you move on

What does marrant mean? ("Funny (informal)".) Say it once more.

474.5 chatouiller — to tickle

Before the new one: say the French for fit of the giggles, then the French for funny.

You'll want to know: chatouiller

chatouiller — "to tickle".

Le grand-père chatouille le bébé, qui rit.

The grandfather tickles the baby, who laughs.

Être chatouilleux — to be ticklish.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *chatouiller* is not settled. It is probably an expressive word; Germanic words for tickling, like Old English *citelian*, look similar (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *chatouiller*
- *Say it:* *chatouiller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *chatouiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for fit of the giggles, then the French for funny, then say *chatouiller* again

Before you move on

What does chatouiller mean? (“To tickle”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 475

Jalousie et rancune

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about jealousy, grudges and making up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 475: I can talk about jealousy, grudges and making up.*

475.1 la jalousie — jealousy

> Before the new one: say the French for funny, then the French for to tickle.

You'll want to know: la jalousie

la jalousie — "jealousy".

> La jalousie a gâché leur amitié.
>
> *Jealousy spoilt their friendship.*

Built on *jaloux*. Also a slatted blind on a window.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la jalousie is built on *jaloux* (EtymDB), which goes back to Late Latin *zēlōsus* "full of zeal", from *zēlus*, a borrowing from Greek *zêlos* "zeal, rivalry".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la jalousie*
- *Say it: la jalousie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la jalousie*
- *Recall:* say the French for funny, then the French for to tickle, then say *la jalousie* again

Before you move on

What does la jalousie mean? ("Jealousy".) Say it once more.

475.2 envier — to envy

Before the new one: say the French for to tickle, then the French for jealousy.

You'll want to know: envier

envier — "to envy".

J'envie mon frère : il voyage beaucoup.

I envy my brother: he travels a lot.

Envier quelque chose à quelqu'un — to envy someone something.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

envier is built on *envie* (EtymDB), inherited from Latin *invidia* "envy", from *invidēre* "to look askance at", built on *vidēre* "to see" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *envier*
- *Say it:* *envier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *envier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tickle, then the French for jealousy, then say *envier* again

Before you move on

What does envier mean? ("To envy".) Say it once more.

475.3 la rancune — grudge, resentment

Before the new one: say the French for jealousy, then the French for to envy.

You'll want to know: la rancune

la rancune — "grudge, resentment".

Je ne garde pas de rancune contre lui.

I do not bear him a grudge.

Sans rancune ! — no hard feelings!

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la rancune comes from Old French *rancure*, which goes back to Latin *rancor* "a rancid smell, a grudge" (Lewis & Short); its ending was later reshaped.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la rancune*
- *Say it: la rancune*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rancune*
- *Recall:* say the French for jealousy, then the French for to envy, then say *la rancune* again

Before you move on

What does la rancune mean? ("Grudge, resentment".) Say it once more.

475.4 rancunier — resentful, unforgiving

Before the new one: say the French for to envy, then the French for grudge.

You'll want to know: rancunier

rancunier — "resentful, unforgiving".

Ma voisine est rancunière : elle n'oublie rien.

My neighbour is resentful: she forgets nothing.

Feminine *rancunière*. Someone who keeps grudges.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rancunier is built on *rancune* "grudge", which goes back to Latin *rancor* "a rancid smell, a grudge" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rancunier*
- *Say it: rancunier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rancunier*
- *Recall:* say the French for to envy, then the French for grudge, then say *rancunier* again

Before you move on

What does rancunier mean? ("Resentful, unforgiving".) Say it once more.

475.5 réconcilier — to reconcile; (se réconcilier) to make up

Before the new one: say the French for grudge, then the French for resentful.

You'll want to know: réconcilier

réconcilier — "to reconcile; (se réconcilier) to make up".

Après des mois de silence, ils se sont réconciliés.

After months of silence, they made up.

Mostly reflexive: *se réconcilier avec quelqu'un.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

réconcilier is a learned borrowing from Latin *reconciliāre* "to bring together again", built on *concilium* "a gathering" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: réconcilier*
- *Say it: réconcilier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *réconcilier*
- *Recall:* say the French for grudge, then the French for resentful, then say *réconcilier* again

Before you move on

What does réconcilier mean? ("To reconcile; (se réconcilier) to make up".) Say it once more.

Chapter 476

Optimistes et inquiets

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say whether someone worries or looks on the bright side.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 476: I can say whether someone worries or looks on the bright side.

476.1 l'inquiétude — worry, anxiety

Before the new one: say the French for resentful, then the French for to reconcile.

You'll want to know: l'inquiétude

l'inquiétude — "worry, anxiety".

Elle attend le résultat avec inquiétude.

She is waiting for the result with worry.

Built on *inquiet* "worried". Feminine: *une inquiétude*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'inquiétude is a learned borrowing from Latin *inquiētūdō* "restlessness" (EtymDB), built on *quiēs* "rest" with the negative *in-* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'inquiétude*
- *Say it: l'inquiétude*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'inquiétude*
- *Recall:* say the French for resentful, then the French for to reconcile, then say *l'inquiétude* again

Before you move on

What does l'inquiétude mean? ("Worry, anxiety".) Say it once more.

476.2 anxieux — anxious

Before the new one: say the French for to reconcile, then the French for worry.

You'll want to know: anxieux

anxieux — "anxious".

Avant un examen, je suis toujours anxieux.

Before an exam I am always anxious.

Feminine *anxieuse*. Stronger than *inquiet*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

anxieux is a learned borrowing from Latin *anxius* "troubled" (EtymDB), from *angere* "to squeeze, to distress" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: anxieux*
- *Say it: anxieux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *anxieux*
- *Recall:* say the French for to reconcile, then the French for worry, then say *anxieux* again

Before you move on

What does anxieux mean? ("Anxious".) Say it once more.

476.3 méfier — to be wary, to distrust (se méfier)

Before the new one: say the French for worry, then the French for anxious.

You'll want to know: méfier

méfier — "to be wary, to distrust (se méfier)".

Je me méfie des gens trop gentils.

I am wary of people who are too nice.

Always reflexive in use: *se méfier de*. The adjective is *méfiant*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

se méfier is built from *mé-* "badly" and *se fier* "to trust", which goes back to Vulgar Latin *fīdāre*, from Latin *fīdere* "to trust" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: méfier*
- *Say it: méfier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *méfier*
- *Recall:* say the French for worry, then the French for anxious, then say *méfier* again

Before you move on

What does méfier mean? ("To be wary, to distrust (se méfier)".) Say it once more.

476.4 optimiste — optimistic; optimist

Before the new one: say the French for anxious, then the French for to be wary.

You'll want to know: optimiste

optimiste — "optimistic; optimist".

Malgré la pluie, elle reste optimiste.

In spite of the rain, she stays optimistic.

The same form for a man and a woman.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

optimiste is built on *optimisme*, a modern learned word made from Latin *optimus* "best" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: optimiste*
- *Say it: optimiste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *optimiste*
- *Recall:* say the French for anxious, then the French for to be wary, then say *optimiste* again

Before you move on

What does optimiste mean? ("Optimistic; optimist".) Say it once more.

476.5 pessimiste — pessimistic; pessimist

Before the new one: say the French for to be wary, then the French for optimistic.

You'll want to know: pessimiste

pessimiste — "pessimistic; pessimist".

Mon oncle est pessimiste : il pense que tout va mal finir.

My uncle is pessimistic: he thinks everything will end badly.

The same form for a man and a woman.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pessimiste is built on *pessimisme*, a modern learned word made from Latin *pessimus* "worst" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: pessimiste*
- *Say it: pessimiste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *pessimiste*
- *Recall:* say the French for to be wary, then the French for optimistic, then say *pessimiste* again

Before you move on

What does pessimiste mean? ("Pessimistic; pessimist".) Say it once more.

Chapter 477

De la hanche au talon

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the parts of the leg and foot.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 477: I can name the parts of the leg and foot.*

477.1 la cuisse — thigh

> Before the new one: say the French for optimistic, then the French for pessimistic.

You'll want to know: la cuisse

la cuisse — "thigh".

> Après la course, j'ai mal aux cuisses.
>
> *After the run my thighs hurt.*

Also a leg of chicken: *une cuisse de poulet.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la cuisse is inherited, through Old French, from Latin *coxa* "hip" (Lewis & Short); the word slid down from the hip to the thigh.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cuisse*
- *Say it: la cuisse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la cuisse*
- *Recall:* say the French for optimistic, then the French for pessimistic, then say *la cuisse* again

Before you move on

What does la cuisse mean? ("Thigh".) Say it once more.

477.2 le mollet — calf (of the leg)

Before the new one: say the French for pessimistic, then the French for thigh.

You'll want to know: le mollet

le mollet — "calf (of the leg)".

Le cycliste a des mollets très forts.

The cyclist has very strong calves.

The soft back part of the lower leg.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le mollet is built on *mol*, the old form of *mou* "soft", with the small ending *-et* (EtymDB); *mou* is inherited from Latin *mollis* "soft" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le mollet*
- *Say it: le mollet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le mollet*
- *Recall:* say the French for pessimistic, then the French for thigh, then say *le mollet* again

Before you move on

What does le mollet mean? ("Calf (of the leg)".) Say it once more.

477.3 le talon — heel

Before the new one: say the French for thigh, then the French for calf.

You'll want to know: le talon

le talon — "heel".

Ces chaussures me font mal au talon.

These shoes hurt my heel.

Also the heel of a shoe: *des talons hauts* — high heels.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le talon is inherited from Vulgar Latin *tālo* (EtymDB), from Latin *tālus* "the ankle, the anklebone" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le talon*
- *Say it: le talon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le talon*
- *Recall:* say the French for thigh, then the French for calf, then say *le talon* again

Before you move on

What does le talon mean? ("Heel".) Say it once more.

477.4 l'orteil — toe

Before the new one: say the French for calf, then the French for heel.

You'll want to know: l'orteil

l'orteil — "toe".

Je me suis cogné l'orteil contre un pied de table.

I stubbed my toe on the leg of a table.

Masculine. *Le gros orteil* — the big toe. Fingers are *les doigts*; toes can also be *les doigts de pied*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'orteil comes from Old French *arteil*, from Latin *articulus* "a small joint, a limb" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short); its first vowel was later changed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'orteil*
- *Say it: l'orteil*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'orteil*
- *Recall:* say the French for calf, then the French for heel, then say *l'orteil* again

Before you move on

What does l'orteil mean? ("Toe".) Say it once more.

477.5 la hanche — hip

Before the new one: say the French for heel, then the French for toe.

You'll want to know: la hanche

la hanche — "hip".

Elle porte son bébé sur la hanche.

She carries her baby on her hip.

The *h* is aspirated: *la hanche*, not *l'hanche*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la hanche comes from a Germanic word for the haunch. English *haunch* is the same word, taken from Old French (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la hanche*
- *Say it:* *la hanche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la hanche*
- *Recall:* say the French for heel, then the French for toe, then say *la hanche* again

Before you move on

What does la hanche mean? (“Hip”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 478

Le visage de près

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the small parts of the face.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 478: I can name the small parts of the face.*

478.1 le sourcil — eyebrow

> Before the new one: say the French for toe, then the French for hip.

You'll want to know: le sourcil

le sourcil — "eyebrow".

> Il lève les sourcils quand il est surpris.
>
> *He raises his eyebrows when he is surprised.*

Froncer les sourcils — to frown.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le sourcil is inherited from Latin *supercilium* "eyebrow" (EtymDB), built from *super* "above" and *cilium* "eyelid" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sourcil*
- *Say it: le sourcil*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sourcil*
- *Recall:* say the French for toe, then the French for hip, then say *le sourcil* again

Before you move on

What does le sourcil mean? ("Eyebrow".) Say it once more.

478.2 la paupière — eyelid

Before the new one: say the French for hip, then the French for eyebrow.

You'll want to know: la paupière

la paupière — "eyelid".

Le soir, mes paupières deviennent lourdes.

In the evening my eyelids get heavy.

Fermer les paupières — to close one's eyes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la paupière is inherited from Latin *palpebra* "eyelid" (Lewis & Short), with a reshaped ending.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la paupière*
- *Say it: la paupière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la paupière*
- *Recall:* say the French for hip, then the French for eyebrow, then say *la paupière* again

Before you move on

What does la paupière mean? ("Eyelid".) Say it once more.

478.3 le cil — eyelash

Before the new one: say the French for eyebrow, then the French for eyelid.

You'll want to know: le cil

le cil — "eyelash".

Le bébé a de longs cils noirs.

The baby has long black eyelashes.

Mostly plural: *les cils*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le cil is inherited from Latin *cilium* "eyelid" (Lewis & Short); in French it came to name the hairs on the eyelid.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cil*
- *Say it: le cil*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cil*
- *Recall:* say the French for eyebrow, then the French for eyelid, then say *le cil* again

Before you move on

What does le cil mean? (“Eyelash”.) Say it once more.

478.4 la narine — nostril

Before the new one: say the French for eyelid, then the French for eyelash.

You’ll want to know: la narine

la narine — “nostril”.

Le cheval souffle par les narines.

The horse is snorting through its nostrils.

Usually plural: *les narines*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la narine is inherited from Vulgar Latin *nārīna* (EtymDB), built on Latin *nāris* “nostril” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la narine*
- *Say it: la narine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la narine*
- *Recall:* say the French for eyelid, then the French for eyelash, then say *la narine* again

Before you move on

What does la narine mean? ("Nostril".) Say it once more.

478.5 la tempe — temple (side of the head)

Before the new one: say the French for eyelash, then the French for nostril.

You'll want to know: la tempe

la tempe — "temple (side of the head)".

Quand je suis fatigué, j'ai mal aux tempes.

When I am tired, my temples ache.

A temple for worship is *un temple*, a different word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la tempe is inherited from Vulgar Latin *tempula* (EtymDB), from Latin *tempora* "the temples of the head" (Lewis & Short), a different word from *tempus* "time".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tempe*
- *Say it: la tempe*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la tempe*
- *Recall:* say the French for eyelash, then the French for nostril, then say *la tempe* again

Before you move on

What does la tempe mean? (“Temple (side of the head)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 479

Petits accidents

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about small injuries at home.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 479: I can talk about small injuries at home.*

479.1 blesser — to injure, to hurt; (se blesser) to hurt oneself

> Before the new one: say the French for nostril, then the French for temple.

You'll want to know: blesser

blesser — "to injure, to hurt; (se blesser) to hurt oneself".

> Il s'est blessé au pied en jouant au foot.
>
> *He hurt his foot playing football.*

Often reflexive: *se blesser à la main.* Also to hurt feelings: *ses mots m'ont blessé.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

blesser comes from Old French *blecier* “to injure” (EtymDB), from Frankish *blētjan* “to bruise”, a Germanic word.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: blesser*
- *Say it: blesser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *blesser*
- *Recall:* say the French for nostril, then the French for temple, then say *blesser* again

Before you move on

What does blesser mean? (“To injure, to hurt; (se blesser) to hurt oneself”.) Say it once more.

479.2 la coupure — cut

Before the new one: say the French for temple, then the French for to injure.

You’ll want to know: la coupure

la coupure — “cut”.

J’ai une petite coupure au doigt.

I have a small cut on my finger.

Also a break in a supply: *une coupure de courant* — a power cut.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la coupure is built on *couper* “to cut” with *-ure* (EtymDB); *couper* comes from *coup* “blow”, from Latin *colaphus* “a punch”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la coupure*
- *Say it: la coupure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la coupure*
- *Recall:* say the French for temple, then the French for to injure, then say *la coupure* again

Before you move on

What does la coupure mean? (“Cut”.) Say it once more.

479.3 l’égratignure — scratch, graze

Before the new one: say the French for to injure, then the French for cut.

You’ll want to know: l’égratignure

l’égratignure — “scratch, graze”.

Le chat m’a fait une égratignure sur le bras.

The cat gave me a scratch on my arm.

Feminine. Lighter than *une coupure*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l’égratignure is built on *égratigner* “to scratch”, itself built on *gratter* “to scratch”, which comes from a Germanic word, Frankish *krattōn*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'égratignure*
- *Say it: l'égratignure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'égratignure*
- *Recall:* say the French for to injure, then the French for cut, then say *l'égratignure* again

Before you move on

What does l'égratignure mean? ("Scratch, graze".) Say it once more.

479.4 la brûlure — burn

Before the new one: say the French for cut, then the French for scratch.

You'll want to know: la brûlure

la brûlure — "burn".

Elle s'est fait une brûlure en sortant le gâteau du four.

She burnt herself taking the cake out of the oven.

Built on *brûler* "to burn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la brûlure is built on *brûler* "to burn" with *-ure*. The origin of *brûler* is not settled: Latin *ustulāre* "to scorch" and a Germanic verb for burning have both been proposed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la brûlure*
- *Say it: la brûlure*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la brûlure*
- *Recall:* say the French for cut, then the French for scratch, then say *la brûlure* again

Before you move on

What does la brûlure mean? ("Burn".) Say it once more.

479.5 la bosse — bump, lump

Before the new one: say the French for scratch, then the French for burn.

You'll want to know: la bosse

la bosse — "bump, lump".

Après sa chute, l'enfant a une bosse sur le front.

After his fall, the child has a bump on his forehead.

Also a camel's hump: *la bosse du chameau*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la bosse goes back to Old French *boce* (EtymDB). Its earlier origin is not settled; a Vulgar Latin *bottia* "swelling" is sometimes proposed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la bosse*
- *Say it:* *la bosse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bosse*
- *Recall:* say the French for scratch, then the French for burn, then say *la bosse* again

Before you move on

What does la bosse mean? (“Bump, lump”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 480

Une jambe dans le plâtre

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a broken bone and getting about.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 480: I can talk about a broken bone and getting about.*

480.1 la fracture — fracture, break (of a bone)

> Before the new one: say the French for burn, then the French for bump.

You'll want to know: la fracture

la fracture — "fracture, break (of a bone)".

> La radio montre une fracture du poignet.
>
> *The X-ray shows a broken wrist.*

The everyday verb is *se casser*: *il s'est cassé la jambe.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la fracture is a learned borrowing from Latin *frāctūra* "a break", from *frangere* "to break" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fracture*
- *Say it: la fracture*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fracture*
- *Recall:* say the French for burn, then the French for bump, then say *la fracture* again

Before you move on

What does la fracture mean? ("Fracture, break (of a bone)".) Say it once more.

480.2 le plâtre — plaster cast; plaster

Before the new one: say the French for bump, then the French for fracture.

You'll want to know: le plâtre

le plâtre — "plaster cast; plaster".

Mon fils a eu la jambe dans le plâtre pendant six semaines.

My son had his leg in a cast for six weeks.

Être dans le plâtre — to be in a cast. Also building plaster.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le plâtre comes from Old French *plastre*, which goes back to Latin *emplastrum* "a plaster for a wound", a borrowing from Greek *émplastron*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plâtre*
- *Say it: le plâtre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le plâtre*
- *Recall:* say the French for bump, then the French for fracture, then say *le plâtre* again

Before you move on

What does le plâtre mean? ("Plaster cast; plaster".) Say it once more.

480.3 la béquille — crutch

Before the new one: say the French for fracture, then the French for plaster cast.

You'll want to know: la béquille

la béquille — "crutch".

Elle marche avec des béquilles depuis son accident.

She has been walking on crutches since her accident.

Also the kickstand of a bike or scooter.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la béquille is usually traced to *bec* "beak", for the curved handle; the origin is not fully settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la béquille*
- *Say it: la béquille*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la béquille*
- *Recall:* say the French for fracture, then the French for plaster cast, then say *la béquille* again

Before you move on

What does la béquille mean? ("Crutch".) Say it once more.

480.4 boiter — to limp

Before the new one: say the French for plaster cast, then the French for crutch.

You'll want to know: boiter

boiter — "to limp".

Depuis sa chute, mon chien boite un peu.

Since his fall, my dog limps a little.

The adjective *boiteux* means limping, and also shaky: *une excuse boiteuse.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *boiter* is not settled. A link with *boîte*, once the socket of a joint, has been proposed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: boiter*
- *Say it: boiter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *boiter*
- *Recall:* say the French for plaster cast, then the French for crutch, then say *boiter* again

Before you move on

What does boiter mean? ("To limp".) Say it once more.

480.5 l'os — bone

Before the new one: say the French for crutch, then the French for to limp.

You'll want to know: l'os

l'os — "bone".

Le chien ronge un os dans le jardin.

The dog is gnawing a bone in the garden.

Masculine. Singular *un os* with a sounded *s*; plural *des os*, where the *s* is usually silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'os is inherited from Latin *os*, *ossis* "bone" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'os*
- *Say it: l'os*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'os*
- *Recall:* say the French for crutch, then the French for to limp, then say *l'os* again

Before you move on

What does l'os mean? ("Bone".) Say it once more.

Chapter 481

Une mauvaise entorse

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a sprain and how it heals.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 481: I can talk about a sprain and how it heals.*

481.1 l'entorse — sprain

Before the new one: say the French for to limp, then the French for bone.

You'll want to know: l'entorse

l'entorse — "sprain".

Il s'est fait une entorse à la cheville au tennis.

He sprained his ankle playing tennis.

Feminine. *Une entorse au règlement* — a breach of the rules.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'entorse comes from the old verb *entordre* "to twist", built from *en-* and *tordre*, which is inherited from Latin *torquēre* "to twist" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'entorse*
- *Say it: l'entorse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'entorse*
- *Recall:* say the French for to limp, then the French for bone, then say *l'entorse* again

Before you move on

What does l'entorse mean? ("Sprain".) Say it once more.

481.2 tordre — to twist, to wring; (se tordre) to twist (a joint)

Before the new one: say the French for bone, then the French for sprain.

You'll want to know: tordre

tordre — "to twist, to wring; (se tordre) to twist (a joint)".

Je me suis tordu le pied dans l'escalier.

I twisted my foot on the stairs.

For a joint it is reflexive: *se tordre la cheville*. Present *je tords, il tord*; past *j'ai tordu*. *Se tordre de rire* — to double up laughing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tordre is inherited from Vulgar Latin *torcere*, a form of Latin *torquēre* "to twist" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tordre*
- *Say it: tordre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tordre*
- *Recall:* say the French for bone, then the French for sprain, then say *tordre* again

Before you move on

What does tordre mean? ("To twist, to wring; (se tordre) to twist (a joint)".) Say it once more.

481.3 enfler — to swell

Before the new one: say the French for sprain, then the French for to twist.

You'll want to know: enfler

enfler — "to swell".

Sa cheville a enflé pendant la nuit.

Her ankle swelled during the night.

Enflé — swollen. The everyday word is often *gonfler*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

enfler is inherited from Latin *īnflāre* "to blow into, to puff up" (EtymDB), built on *flāre* "to blow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *enfler*
- *Say it:* *enfler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *enfler*
- *Recall:* say the French for sprain, then the French for to twist, then say *enfler* again

Before you move on

What does enfler mean? ("To swell".) Say it once more.

481.4 l'attelle — splint

Before the new one: say the French for to twist, then the French for to swell.

You'll want to know: l'attelle

l'attelle — "splint".

Le médecin lui a mis une attelle au doigt.

The doctor put a splint on his finger.

Feminine. Lighter than *un plâtre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'attelle is inherited from Vulgar Latin *astella* (EtymDB), from Latin *astula* "a splinter, a chip of wood" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'attelle*
- *Say it: l'attelle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'attelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for to twist, then the French for to swell, then say *l'attelle* again

Before you move on

What does l'attelle mean? ("Splint".) Say it once more.

481.5 le kiné — physiotherapist (informal)

Before the new one: say the French for to swell, then the French for splint.

You'll want to know: le kiné

le kiné — "physiotherapist (informal)".

Je vais chez le kiné deux fois par semaine.

I go to the physio twice a week.

Short for *le kinésithérapeute*. A woman is *la kiné*. In Belgium also *le kiné*; in Québec *le physiothérapeute*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le kiné is short for *kinésithérapeute*, a learned word built from Greek *kínēsis* "movement" and *therapeutḗs* "one who treats".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le kiné*
- *Say it: le kiné*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le kiné*
- *Recall:* say the French for to swell, then the French for splint, then say *le kiné* again

Before you move on

What does le kiné mean? ("Physiotherapist (informal)".) Say it once more.

481.6 Retour sur les chapitres 474–481

Say the French for cheerfulness and to laugh.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- cheerfulness, to laugh, fit of the giggles, funny, to tickle
- jealousy, to envy, grudge, resentful, to reconcile
- worry, anxious, to be wary, optimistic, pessimistic
- thigh, calf, heel, toe, hip
- eyebrow, eyelid, eyelash, nostril, temple
- to injure, cut, scratch, burn, bump
- fracture, plaster cast, crutch, to limp, bone
- sprain, to twist, to swell, splint, physiotherapist

Before you move on

Cheerfulness? (**la gaieté**.) To laugh? (**rigoler**.) Fit of the giggles? (**le fou rire**.) Funny? (**marrant**.) To tickle? (**chatouiller**.)

Jealousy? (**la jalousie**.) To envy? (**envier**.) Grudge? (**la rancune**.) Resentful? (**rancunier**.) To reconcile? (**réconcilier**.) Worry? (**l'inquiétude**.) Anxious? (**anxieux**.) To be wary? (**méfier**.) Optimistic? (**optimiste**.) Pessimistic? (**pessimiste**.) Thigh? (**la cuisse**.) Calf? (**le mollet**.) Heel? (**le talon**.) Toe? (**l'orteil**.) Hip? (**la hanche**.) Eyebrow? (**le sourcil**.) Eyelid? (**la paupière**.) Eyelash? (**le cil**.) Nostril? (**la narine**.) Temple? (**la tempe**.) To injure? (**blesser**.) Cut? (**la coupure**.) Scratch? (**l'égratignure**.) Burn? (**la brûlure**.) Bump? (**la bosse**.) Fracture? (**la fracture**.) Plaster cast? (**le plâtre**.) Crutch? (**la béquille**.) To limp? (**boiter**.) Bone? (**l'os**.) Sprain? (**l'entorse**.) To twist? (**tordre**.) To swell? (**enfler**.) Splint? (**l'attelle**.) Physiotherapist? (**le kiné**.)

Chapter 482

Éternuements et allergies

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about allergies, sneezing and itching.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 482: I can talk about allergies, sneezing and itching.*

482.1 éternuer — to sneeze

> Before the new one: say the French for splint, then the French for physiotherapist.

You'll want to know: éternuer

éternuer — "to sneeze".

> Au printemps, j'éternue tout le temps.
>
> *In spring I sneeze all the time.*

À vos souhaits ! — bless you! (said after a sneeze).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éternuer is inherited, through Old French *esternuer*, from Latin *sternūtāre* "to sneeze" (EtymDB), built on *sternuere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: éternuer*
- *Say it: éternuer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *éternuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for splint, then the French for physiotherapist, then say *éternuer* again

Before you move on

What does éternuer mean? ("To sneeze".) Say it once more.

482.2 l'allergie — allergy

Before the new one: say the French for physiotherapist, then the French for to sneeze.

You'll want to know: l'allergie

l'allergie — "allergy".

Mon fils a une allergie aux chats.

My son has an allergy to cats.

Feminine. *Être allergique à* — to be allergic to.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'allergie was borrowed from German *Allergie*, a modern learned word built from Greek *állos* "other" and *érgon* "work, action".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'allergie*
- *Say it: l'allergie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'allergie*
- *Recall:* say the French for physiotherapist, then the French for to sneeze, then say *l'allergie* again

Before you move on

What does l'allergie mean? ("Allergy".) Say it once more.

482.3 le pollen — pollen

Before the new one: say the French for to sneeze, then the French for allergy.

You'll want to know: le pollen

le pollen — "pollen".

En mai, il y a beaucoup de pollen dans l'air.

In May there is a lot of pollen in the air.

The final *n* is sounded: *pol-lène*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le pollen is a learned borrowing from Latin *pollen* "fine flour, powder" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pollen*
- *Say it: le pollen*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pollen*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sneeze, then the French for allergy, then say *le pollen* again

Before you move on

What does le pollen mean? ("Pollen".) Say it once more.

482.4 la démangeaison — itch, itching

Before the new one: say the French for allergy, then the French for pollen.

You'll want to know: la démangeaison

la démangeaison — "itch, itching".

Cette crème calme les démangeaisons.

This cream soothes the itching.

The verb is *démanger*: *ça me démange* — it itches.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la démangeaison is built on *démanger* "to itch" with *-aison* (EtymDB); *démanger* is *manger* "to eat", from Latin *mandūcāre* "to chew", with *dé-*: the skin feels eaten.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la démangeaison*
- *Say it: la démangeaison*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la démangeaison*
- *Recall:* say the French for allergy, then the French for pollen, then say *la démangeaison* again

Before you move on

What does la démangeaison mean? ("Itch, itching".) Say it once more.

482.5 gratter — to scratch; to itch

Before the new one: say the French for pollen, then the French for itch.

You'll want to know: gratter

gratter — "to scratch; to itch".

Le chien se gratte derrière l'oreille.

The dog is scratching behind its ear.

Se gratter — to scratch oneself. *Ce pull gratte* — this jumper is itchy.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gratter comes from Frankish *krattōn* "to scratch", a Germanic word related to German *kratzen* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gratter*
- *Say it:* *gratter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *gratter*
- *Recall:* say the French for pollen, then the French for itch, then say *gratter* again

Before you move on

What does gratter mean? (“To scratch; to itch”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 483

Mal au cœur

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe feeling sick, dizzy or having a headache.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 483: I can describe feeling sick, dizzy or having a headache.*

483.1 la nausée — nausea

> Before the new one: say the French for itch, then the French for to scratch.

You'll want to know: la nausée

la nausée — "nausea".

> En bateau, j'ai souvent la nausée.
>
> *On a boat I often feel sick.*

Avoir la nausée or, more informally, *avoir mal au cœur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la nausée is a learned borrowing from Latin *nausea* "seasickness" (EtymDB), from Greek *nausía*, built on *naûs* "ship".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nausée*
- *Say it: la nausée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la nausée*
- *Recall:* say the French for itch, then the French for to scratch, then say *la nausée* again

Before you move on

What does la nausée mean? ("Nausea".) Say it once more.

483.2 vomir — to vomit, to be sick

Before the new one: say the French for to scratch, then the French for nausea.

You'll want to know: vomir

vomir — "to vomit, to be sick".

Le petit a vomi dans la voiture.

The little one was sick in the car.

A regular *-ir* verb: *nous vomissons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

vomir is inherited from Vulgar Latin *vomīre*, a form of Latin *vomere* "to vomit" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: vomir*
- *Say it: vomir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *vomir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to scratch, then the French for nausea, then say *vomir* again

Before you move on

What does vomir mean? ("To vomit, to be sick".) Say it once more.

483.3 la migraine — migraine, bad headache

Before the new one: say the French for nausea, then the French for to vomit.

You'll want to know: la migraine

la migraine — "migraine, bad headache".

Quand j'ai la migraine, je reste dans le noir.

When I have a migraine, I stay in the dark.

In speech, also any bad headache.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la migraine comes from Late Latin *hēmicrānia* (EtymDB), from Greek *hēmikranía*, built on *hēmi-* "half" and *kraníon* "skull": a pain on one side of the head.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la migraine*
- *Say it: la migraine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la migraine*
- *Recall:* say the French for nausea, then the French for to vomit, then say *la migraine* again

Before you move on

What does la migraine mean? ("Migraine, bad headache".) Say it once more.

483.4 le vertige — dizziness; fear of heights

Before the new one: say the French for to vomit, then the French for migraine.

You'll want to know: le vertige

le vertige — "dizziness; fear of heights".

En haut de la tour, j'ai eu le vertige.

At the top of the tower, I felt dizzy.

Avoir le vertige — to feel dizzy, or to be afraid of heights.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le vertige is a learned borrowing from Latin *vertīgō* "a turning round, dizziness", from *vertere* "to turn" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vertige*
- *Say it: le vertige*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le vertige*
- *Recall:* say the French for to vomit, then the French for migraine, then say *le vertige* again

Before you move on

What does le vertige mean? (“Dizziness; fear of heights”.) Say it once more.

483.5 digérer — to digest

Before the new one: say the French for migraine, then the French for dizziness.

You’ll want to know: digérer

digérer — “to digest”.

Je ne digère pas bien le lait.

I do not digest milk well.

Also to take in bad news: *il n’a pas digéré la défaite.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

digérer is a learned borrowing from Latin *dīgerere* “to divide, to arrange, to digest”, built on *gerere* “to carry” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *digérer*
- *Say it:* *digérer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *digérer*
- *Recall:* say the French for migraine, then the French for dizziness, then say *digérer* again

Before you move on

What does digérer mean? (“To digest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 484

Aux urgences

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about emergency care.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 484: I can talk about emergency care.*

484.1 l'ambulance — ambulance

> Before the new one: say the French for dizziness, then the French for to digest.

You'll want to know: l'ambulance

l'ambulance — "ambulance".

> L'ambulance est arrivée en dix minutes.
>
> *The ambulance arrived in ten minutes.*

Feminine: *une ambulance*. *Appeler une ambulance* — to call an ambulance.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'ambulance is built on *ambulant* "moving about" (EtymDB), from Latin *ambulāre* "to walk" (Lewis & Short): first a field hospital that moved with an army.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'ambulance*
- *Say it: l'ambulance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'ambulance*
- *Recall:* say the French for dizziness, then the French for to digest, then say *l'ambulance* again

Before you move on

What does l'ambulance mean? ("Ambulance".) Say it once more.

484.2 le secouriste — first-aider, rescue worker

Before the new one: say the French for to digest, then the French for ambulance.

You'll want to know: le secouriste

le secouriste — "first-aider, rescue worker".

Un secouriste s'est occupé du blessé.

A first-aider took care of the injured man.

A woman is *la secouriste*. *Les premiers secours* — first aid.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le secouriste is built on *secours* "help", which goes back to Latin *succursus*, from *succurrere* "to run to help", built on *currere* "to run" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le secouriste*
- *Say it: le secouriste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le secouriste*
- *Recall:* say the French for to digest, then the French for ambulance, then say *le secouriste* again

Before you move on

What does le secouriste mean? ("First-aider, rescue worker".) Say it once more.

484.3 le brancard — stretcher

Before the new one: say the French for ambulance, then the French for first-aider.

You'll want to know: le brancard

le brancard — "stretcher".

Ils ont porté le joueur sur un brancard.

They carried the player on a stretcher.

Also called *une civière*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le brancard is built on a northern dialect form of *branche* "branch" with *-ard*: first two poles for carrying. *Branche* comes from Late Latin *branca* "paw".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le brancard*
- *Say it: le brancard*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le brancard*
- *Recall:* say the French for ambulance, then the French for first-aider, then say *le brancard* again

Before you move on

What does le brancard mean? ("Stretcher".) Say it once more.

484.4 la piqûre — injection; sting, bite

Before the new one: say the French for first-aider, then the French for stretcher.

You'll want to know: la piqûre

la piqûre — "injection; sting, bite".

L'infirmière m'a fait une piqûre au bras.

The nurse gave me an injection in the arm.

Also an insect bite: *une piqûre de moustique*. Also spelt *piqure*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la piqûre is built on *piquer* "to prick" with *-ure*. *Piquer* goes back to a Vulgar Latin *piccāre*, probably an expressive word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la piqûre*
- *Say it: la piqûre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la piqûre*
- *Recall:* say the French for first-aider, then the French for stretcher, then say *la piqûre* again

Before you move on

What does la piqûre mean? ("Injection; sting, bite".) Say it once more.

484.5 la salle d'attente — waiting room

Before the new one: say the French for stretcher, then the French for injection.

You'll want to know: la salle d'attente

la salle d'attente — "waiting room".

Nous avons passé deux heures dans la salle d'attente.

We spent two hours in the waiting room.

At a doctor's, a station or a hospital.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la salle d'attente joins *salle* "room", from Frankish *sal* "a hall", and *attente* "waiting", built on *attendre*, inherited from Latin *attendere* "to stretch towards", from *tendere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la salle d'attente*
- *Say it: la salle d'attente*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la salle d'attente*
- *Recall:* say the French for stretcher, then the French for injection, then say *la salle d'attente* again

Before you move on

What does la salle d'attente mean? ("Waiting room".) Say it once more.

Chapter 485

Tomber malade et guérir

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about getting better after an illness.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 485: I can talk about getting better after an illness.*

485.1 guérir — to heal, to cure; to get better

Before the new one: say the French for injection, then the French for waiting room.

You'll want to know: guérir

guérir — "to heal, to cure; to get better".

> Ma grand-mère a guéri de sa grippe en une semaine.
>
> *My grandmother got over her flu in a week.*

Guérir de — to recover from. A regular *-ir* verb: *nous guérissons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

guérir comes from Frankish *warjan* "to protect, to defend" (EtymDB), a Germanic word; the sense moved from "protect" to "heal".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: guérir*
- *Say it: guérir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *guérir*
- *Recall:* say the French for injection, then the French for waiting room, then say *guérir* again

Before you move on

What does guérir mean? ("To heal, to cure; to get better".) Say it once more.

485.2 la guérison — recovery, cure

Before the new one: say the French for waiting room, then the French for to heal.

You'll want to know: la guérison

la guérison — "recovery, cure".

Les médecins sont contents de sa guérison.

The doctors are pleased with his recovery.

Built on *guérir*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la guérison is built on *guérir* "to heal", which comes from Frankish *warjan* "to protect" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la guérison*
- *Say it: la guérison*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la guérison*
- *Recall:* say the French for waiting room, then the French for to heal, then say *la guérison* again

Before you move on

What does la guérison mean? (“Recovery, cure”.) Say it once more.

485.3 rétablir — to restore; (se rétablir) to recover

Before the new one: say the French for to heal, then the French for recovery.

You’ll want to know: rétablir

rétablir — “to restore; (se rétablir) to recover”.

Après l’opération, elle s’est vite rétablie.

After the operation, she recovered quickly.

Mostly reflexive for health: *se rétablir*. *Rétablir le courant* — to restore the power.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rétablir is built from *re-* and *établir* “to set up”, inherited from Latin *stabilīre* “to make firm”, from *stabilis*, built on *stāre* “to stand” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rétablir*
- *Say it: rétablir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rétablir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to heal, then the French for recovery, then say *rétablir* again

Before you move on

What does rétablir mean? ("To restore; (se rétablir) to recover".) Say it once more.

485.4 la convalescence — convalescence, recovery period

Before the new one: say the French for recovery, then the French for to restore.

You'll want to know: la convalescence

la convalescence — "convalescence, recovery period".

Pendant sa convalescence, il a lu beaucoup de livres.

During his recovery he read a lot of books.

Être en convalescence — to be convalescing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la convalescence is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *convalēscentia* "regaining of health" (EtymDB), from *convalēscere* "to grow strong", built on *valēre* "to be strong" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la convalescence*
- *Say it: la convalescence*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la convalescence*
- *Recall:* say the French for recovery, then the French for to restore, then say *la convalescence* again

Before you move on

What does la convalescence mean? ("Convalescence, recovery period".) Say it once more.

485.5 soigner — to look after, to treat, to nurse

Before the new one: say the French for to restore, then the French for convalescence.

You'll want to know: soigner

soigner — "to look after, to treat, to nurse".

Le vétérinaire a bien soigné notre chat.

The vet treated our cat well.

Se soigner — to look after oneself. *Soigné* — neat, well-groomed.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

soigner is built on *soin* "care", usually traced to a Frankish word *sunnija* "care, concern" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *soigner*
- *Say it:* *soigner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *soigner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to restore, then the French for convalescence, then say *soigner* again

Before you move on

What does soigner mean? (“To look after, to treat, to nurse”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 486

Nuits agitées

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a bad night: sleeplessness, snoring and nightmares.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 486: I can describe a bad night: sleeplessness, snoring and nightmares.*

486.1 l'insomnie — insomnia, sleeplessness

> Before the new one: say the French for convalescence, then the French for to look after.

You'll want to know: l'insomnie

l'insomnie — "insomnia, sleeplessness".

> Quand je suis stressé, je souffre d'insomnie.
>
> *When I am stressed, I suffer from insomnia.*

Feminine. Often plural: *avoir des insomnies.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'insomnie is a learned borrowing from Latin *insomnia* "sleeplessness" (EtymDB), built on *somnus* "sleep" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'insomnie*
- *Say it: l'insomnie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'insomnie*
- *Recall:* say the French for convalescence, then the French for to look after, then say *l'insomnie* again

Before you move on

What does l'insomnie mean? ("Insomnia, sleeplessness".) Say it once more.

486.2 ronfler — to snore

Before the new one: say the French for to look after, then the French for insomnia.

You'll want to know: ronfler

ronfler — "to snore".

Mon colocataire ronfle très fort.

My flatmate snores very loudly.

Also of an engine: *le moteur ronfle.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ronfler goes back to Old French *ronfler* (EtymDB); it is usually taken to imitate the sound, perhaps with help from *souffler* "to blow".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: ronfler*
- *Say it: ronfler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *ronfler*
- *Recall:* say the French for to look after, then the French for insomnia, then say *ronfler* again

Before you move on

What does ronfler mean? ("To snore".) Say it once more.

486.3 le cauchemar — nightmare

Before the new one: say the French for insomnia, then the French for to snore.

You'll want to know: le cauchemar

le cauchemar — "nightmare".

Cette nuit, j'ai fait un cauchemar terrible.

Last night I had a terrible nightmare.

Faire un cauchemar — to have a nightmare.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le cauchemar comes from Old French *cauquemare* (EtymDB), built from *caucher* "to press", from Latin *calcāre* "to tread", and Middle Dutch *mare* "a night ghost", a Germanic word for a spirit that sits on the sleeper.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le cauchemar*
- *Say it:* *le cauchemar*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cauchemar*
- *Recall:* say the French for insomnia, then the French for to snore, then say *le cauchemar* again

Before you move on

What does le cauchemar mean? (“Nightmare”.) Say it once more.

486.4 bâiller — to yawn

Before the new one: say the French for to snore, then the French for nightmare.

You’ll want to know: bâiller

bâiller — “to yawn”.

Les élèves bâillent pendant le cours de l’après-midi.

The pupils yawn during the afternoon lesson.

Do not mix it up with *bailler*, an old word for giving.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bâiller is inherited from Old French *baaillier*, from Vulgar Latin *bataclāre* (EtymDB), built on *batāre* “to gape”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: bâiller*
- *Say it: bâiller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bâiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for to snore, then the French for nightmare, then say *bâiller* again

Before you move on

What does bâiller mean? (“To yawn”.) Say it once more.

486.5 la sieste — nap, siesta

Before the new one: say the French for nightmare, then the French for to yawn.

You’ll want to know: la sieste

la sieste — “nap, siesta”.

Après le déjeuner, mon grand-père fait la sieste.

After lunch, my grandfather has a nap.

Faire la sieste — to have a nap.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la sieste was borrowed from Spanish *siesta* (EtymDB), from Latin *sexta* (*hōra*) “the sixth hour”, that is noon.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la sieste*
- *Say it:* *la sieste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la sieste*
- *Recall:* say the French for nightmare, then the French for to yawn, then say *la sieste* again

Before you move on

What does la sieste mean? (“Nap, siesta”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 487

Amoureux

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about falling in love.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 487: I can talk about falling in love.*

487.1 amoureux — in love; lover

> Before the new one: say the French for to yawn, then the French for nap.

You'll want to know: amoureux

amoureux — "in love; lover".

> Ils sont amoureux depuis le lycée.
>
> *They have been in love since secondary school.*

Feminine *amoureuse*. *Tomber amoureux de quelqu'un* — to fall in love with someone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

amoureux is inherited from Old French *amoros* (EtymDB), built on *amour*, from Latin *amor* "love" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *amoureux*
- *Say it:* *amoureux*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *amoureux*
- *Recall:* say the French for to yawn, then the French for nap, then say *amoureux* again

Before you move on

What does amoureux mean? ("In love; lover".) Say it once more.

487.2 le coup de foudre — love at first sight

Before the new one: say the French for nap, then the French for in love.

You'll want to know: le coup de foudre

le coup de foudre — "love at first sight".

Quand ils se sont rencontrés, ça a été le coup de foudre.

When they met, it was love at first sight.

Literally a lightning strike. *Avoir un coup de foudre pour* also works for places or objects.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le coup de foudre is "a stroke of lightning": *coup* comes from Latin *colaphus* "a punch", and *foudre* is inherited from Latin *fulgur* "lightning" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coup de foudre*
- *Say it: le coup de foudre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le coup de foudre*
- *Recall:* say the French for nap, then the French for in love, then say *le coup de foudre* again

Before you move on

What does le coup de foudre mean? ("Love at first sight".) Say it once more.

487.3 draguer — to chat up, to flirt with (informal); to dredge

Before the new one: say the French for in love, then the French for love at first sight.

You'll want to know: draguer

draguer — "to chat up, to flirt with (informal); to dredge".

Au café, un garçon a essayé de la draguer.

At the café a boy tried to chat her up.

Informal. In Québec people say *cruiser*. The first sense is to dredge a river.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

draguer is built on *drague* "a dredge", which was borrowed from English *drag*. The sense "to chat up", like sweeping the streets, is recent and informal.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *draguer*
- *Say it:* *draguer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *draguer*
- *Recall:* say the French for in love, then the French for love at first sight, then say *draguer* again

Before you move on

What does draguer mean? ("To chat up, to flirt with (informal); to dredge".) Say it once more.

487.4 la tendresse — tenderness, affection

Before the new one: say the French for love at first sight, then the French for to chat up.

You'll want to know: la tendresse

la tendresse — "tenderness, affection".

Elle regarde son fils avec tendresse.

She looks at her son with tenderness.

Built on *tendre* "tender, soft".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la tendresse is built on *tendre* "tender" with *-esse* (EtymDB); *tendre* is inherited from Latin *tener* "soft, delicate" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la tendresse*
- *Say it: la tendresse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la tendresse*
- *Recall:* say the French for love at first sight, then the French for to chat up, then say *la tendresse* again

Before you move on

What does la tendresse mean? ("Tenderness, affection".) Say it once more.

487.5 caresser — to stroke, to caress

Before the new one: say the French for to chat up, then the French for tenderness.

You'll want to know: caresser

caresser — "to stroke, to caress".

Le garçon caresse doucement le chat.

The boy gently strokes the cat.

Une caresse — a caress, a stroke.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caresser was borrowed from Italian *carezzare* (EtymDB), built on *carezza* "a caress", from *caro* "dear", inherited from Latin *cārus* "dear" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *caresser*
- *Say it:* *caresser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *caresser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to chat up, then the French for tenderness, then say *caresser* again

Before you move on

What does caresser mean? (“To stroke, to caress”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 488

Câlins et confidences

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about closeness and sharing secrets.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 488: I can talk about closeness and sharing secrets.*

488.1 le câlin — cuddle, hug

> Before the new one: say the French for tenderness, then the French for to stroke.

You'll want to know: le câlin

le câlin — "cuddle, hug".

> Avant de dormir, la petite veut un câlin.
>
> *Before sleeping, the little girl wants a cuddle.*

Faire un câlin à quelqu'un — to give someone a cuddle. In Québec also *un colleux*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le câlin is built on *câliner*. This is usually traced to a western dialect verb for resting in the shade or the warmth, which goes back to Latin *calēre* "to be warm" (Lewis & Short); the origin is not fully settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le câlin*
- *Say it: le câlin*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le câlin*
- *Recall:* say the French for tenderness, then the French for to stroke, then say *le câlin* again

Before you move on

What does le câlin mean? ("Cuddle, hug".) Say it once more.

488.2 câliner — to cuddle

Before the new one: say the French for to stroke, then the French for cuddle.

You'll want to know: câliner

câliner — "to cuddle".

Le père câline son bébé sur le canapé.

The father cuddles his baby on the sofa.

Câlin as an adjective means affectionate: *un chat câlin.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

câliner is usually traced to a western dialect verb for resting in the shade or the warmth, which goes back to Latin *calēre* "to be warm" (Lewis & Short); the origin is not fully settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: câliner*
- *Say it: câliner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *câliner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stroke, then the French for cuddle, then say *câliner* again

Before you move on

What does câliner mean? (“To cuddle”.) Say it once more.

488.3 la complicité — closeness, bond; complicity

Before the new one: say the French for cuddle, then the French for to cuddle.

You’ll want to know: la complicité

la complicité — “closeness, bond; complicity”.

Il y a une grande complicité entre les deux sœurs.

There is a strong bond between the two sisters.

Usually warm: a close understanding. In law, complicity in a crime.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la complicité is built on *complice* “partner, accomplice” (EtymDB), from Late Latin *complex*, *complicis* “closely joined”, built on *plicāre* “to fold” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la complicité*
- *Say it: la complicité*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la complicité*
- *Recall:* say the French for cuddle, then the French for to cuddle, then say *la complicité* again

Before you move on

What does la complicité mean? ("Closeness, bond; complicity".) Say it once more.

488.4 chuchoter — to whisper

Before the new one: say the French for to cuddle, then the French for closeness.

You'll want to know: chuchoter

chuchoter — "to whisper".

Les deux amies chuchotent au fond de la classe.

The two friends are whispering at the back of the classroom.

Un chuchotement — a whisper. *Murmurer* is close.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chuchoter is usually described as an imitative word: it copies the soft sound of whispering, and the origin is not settled beyond that.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuchoter*
- *Say it: chuchoter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *chuchoter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cuddle, then the French for closeness, then say *chuchoter* again

Before you move on

What does chuchoter mean? ("To whisper".) Say it once more.

488.5 confier — to entrust; (se confier) to confide

Before the new one: say the French for closeness, then the French for to whisper.

You'll want to know: confier

confier — "to entrust; (se confier) to confide".

Je me confie toujours à ma meilleure amie.

I always confide in my best friend.

Confier un secret à quelqu'un; *se confier à quelqu'un.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

confier goes back to Latin *cōnfīdere* "to trust fully", reshaped after *fier*; both are built on *fīdere* "to trust" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *confier*
- *Say it:* *confier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *confier*
- *Recall:* say the French for closeness, then the French for to whisper, then say *confier* again

Before you move on

What does confier mean? ("To entrust; (se confier) to confide".) Say it once more.

Chapter 489

Fiançailles et noces

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about engagements and weddings.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 489: I can talk about engagements and weddings.*

489.1 les fiançailles — engagement (to marry)

Before the new one: say the French for to whisper, then the French for to entrust.

You'll want to know: les fiançailles

les fiançailles — "engagement (to marry)".

Ils ont fêté leurs fiançailles avec toute la famille.

They celebrated their engagement with the whole family.

Always plural and feminine: *des fiançailles*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

les fiançailles is built on *fiancer* "to promise in marriage", from old *fiance* "trust, promise", which goes back to Vulgar Latin *fīdāre*, from Latin *fīdere* "to trust" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les fiançailles*
- *Say it: les fiançailles*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les fiançailles*
- *Recall:* say the French for to whisper, then the French for to entrust, then say *les fiançailles* again

Before you move on

What does les fiançailles mean? ("Engagement (to marry)".) Say it once more.

489.2 l'alliance — wedding ring; alliance

Before the new one: say the French for to entrust, then the French for engagement.

You'll want to know: l'alliance

l'alliance — "wedding ring; alliance".

Il porte son alliance à la main gauche.

He wears his wedding ring on his left hand.

Feminine. *Une bague de fiançailles* — an engagement ring.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'alliance is built on *allier* "to unite", inherited from Latin *alligāre* "to bind to", built on *ligāre* "to tie" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'alliance*
- *Say it: l'alliance*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'alliance*
- *Recall:* say the French for to entrust, then the French for engagement, then say *l'alliance* again

Before you move on

What does l'alliance mean? ("Wedding ring; alliance".) Say it once more.

489.3 les noces — wedding (celebration)

Before the new one: say the French for engagement, then the French for wedding ring.

You'll want to know: les noces

les noces — "wedding (celebration)".

Mes grands-parents ont fêté leurs noces d'or.

My grandparents celebrated their golden wedding anniversary.

Usually plural. *Le voyage de noces* — the honeymoon trip.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

les noces is inherited from Vulgar Latin *noptiae*, a form of Latin *nūptiae* "a wedding", from *nūbere* "to marry" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les noces*
- *Say it: les noces*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les noces*
- *Recall:* say the French for engagement, then the French for wedding ring, then say *les noces* again

Before you move on

What does les noces mean? ("Wedding (celebration)".) Say it once more.

489.4 la lune de miel — honeymoon

Before the new one: say the French for wedding ring, then the French for wedding.

You'll want to know: la lune de miel

la lune de miel — "honeymoon".

Pour leur lune de miel, ils sont partis au bord de la mer.

For their honeymoon they went to the seaside.

Built on the same picture as English *honeymoon*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la lune de miel translates English *honeymoon* word for word: *lune* is inherited from Latin *lūna* "moon" and *miel* from Latin *mel* "honey" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lune de miel*
- *Say it: la lune de miel*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la lune de miel*
- *Recall:* say the French for wedding ring, then the French for wedding, then say *la lune de miel* again

Before you move on

What does la lune de miel mean? ("Honeymoon".) Say it once more.

489.5 la cérémonie — ceremony

Before the new one: say the French for wedding, then the French for honeymoon.

You'll want to know: la cérémonie

la cérémonie — "ceremony".

La cérémonie a eu lieu dans un petit jardin.

The ceremony took place in a small garden.

Sans cérémonie — informally.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la cérémonie is a learned borrowing from Latin *caerimōnia* "a sacred rite, reverence" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la cérémonie*
- *Say it: la cérémonie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la cérémonie*
- *Recall:* say the French for wedding, then the French for honeymoon, then say *la cérémonie* again

Before you move on

What does la cérémonie mean? ("Ceremony".) Say it once more.

489.6 Retour sur les chapitres 482–489

Say the French for to sneeze and allergy.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to sneeze, allergy, pollen, itch, to scratch
- nausea, to vomit, migraine, dizziness, to digest
- ambulance, first-aider, stretcher, injection, waiting room
- to heal, recovery, to restore, convalescence, to look after
- insomnia, to snore, nightmare, to yawn, nap
- in love, love at first sight, to chat up, tenderness, to stroke
- cuddle, to cuddle, closeness, to whisper, to entrust
- engagement, wedding ring, wedding, honeymoon, ceremony

Before you move on

To sneeze? (**éternuer**.) Allergy? (**l'allergie**.) Pollen? (**le pollen**.) Itch? (**la démangeaison**.) To scratch? (**gratter**.) Nausea? (**la nausée**.) To vomit? (**vomir**.) Migraine? (**la migraine**.)

Dizziness? (**le vertige**.) To digest? (**digérer**.) Ambulance? (**l'ambulance**.) First-aider? (**le secouriste**.) Stretcher? (**le brancard**.) Injection? (**la piqûre**.) Waiting room? (**la salle d'attente**.) To heal? (**guérir**.) Recovery? (**la guérison**.) To restore? (**rétablir**.) Convalescence? (**la convalescence**.) To look after? (**soigner**.) Insomnia? (**l'insomnie**.) To snore? (**ronfler**.) Nightmare? (**le cauchemar**.) To yawn? (**bâiller**.) Nap? (**la sieste**.) In love? (**amoureux**.) Love at first sight? (**le coup de foudre**.) To chat up? (**draguer**.) Tenderness? (**la tendresse**.) To stroke? (**caresser**.) Cuddle? (**le câlin**.) To cuddle? (**câliner**.) Closeness? (**la complicité**.) To whisper? (**chuchoter**.) To entrust? (**confier**.) Engagement? (**les fiançailles**.) Wedding ring? (**l'alliance**.) Wedding? (**les noces**.) Honeymoon? (**la lune de miel**.) Ceremony? (**la cérémonie**.)

Chapter 490

La famille au sens large

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about godparents and older and younger siblings.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 490: I can talk about godparents and older and younger siblings.*

490.1 le parrain — godfather; sponsor

> Before the new one: say the French for honeymoon, then the French for ceremony.

You'll want to know: le parrain

le parrain — "godfather; sponsor".

> Mon parrain m'offre toujours un livre pour mon anniversaire.
>
> *My godfather always gives me a book for my birthday.*

Also someone who sponsors a newcomer: *le parrain d'un projet*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le parrain is inherited, through Old French *parain*, from Vulgar Latin *patrīnus* (EtymDB), built on *pater* "father" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le parrain*
- *Say it: le parrain*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le parrain*
- *Recall:* say the French for honeymoon, then the French for ceremony, then say *le parrain* again

Before you move on

What does le parrain mean? ("Godfather; sponsor".) Say it once more.

490.2 la marraine — godmother

Before the new one: say the French for ceremony, then the French for godfather.

You'll want to know: la marraine

la marraine — "godmother".

Ma marraine habite à la campagne.

My godmother lives in the country.

Also a sponsor: *la marraine d'une association.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la marraine is inherited, through Old French *marrene*, from Vulgar Latin *mātrīna* (EtymDB), built on *māter* "mother" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la marraine*
- *Say it: la marraine*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la marraine*
- *Recall:* say the French for ceremony, then the French for godfather, then say *la marraine* again

Before you move on

What does la marraine mean? (“Godmother”.) Say it once more.

490.3 le filleul — godson, godchild

Before the new one: say the French for godfather, then the French for godmother.

You’ll want to know: le filleul

le filleul — “godson, godchild”.

Elle emmène son filleul au zoo.

She takes her godson to the zoo.

A goddaughter is *la filleule*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le filleul is inherited, through Old French *fillol*, from Latin *fīliolus* “little son” (EtymDB), from *fīlius* “son” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le filleul*
- *Say it: le filleul*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le filleul*
- *Recall:* say the French for godfather, then the French for godmother, then say *le filleul* again

Before you move on

What does le filleul mean? ("Godson, godchild".) Say it once more.

490.4 l'aîné — eldest, older (sibling)

Before the new one: say the French for godmother, then the French for godson.

You'll want to know: l'aîné

l'aîné — "eldest, older (sibling)".

L'aîné de la famille a vingt ans.

The eldest child in the family is twenty.

A woman is *l'aînée*. *Mon frère aîné* — my older brother.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'aîné comes from Old French *ainsné* (EtymDB), "born before": *ains* "before" goes back to Latin *ante*, and *né* to Latin *nātus*, from *nāscī* "to be born" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aîné*
- *Say it: l'aîné*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'aîné*
- *Recall:* say the French for godmother, then the French for godson, then say *l'aîné* again

Before you move on

What does l'aîné mean? ("Eldest, older (sibling)".) Say it once more.

490.5 le cadet — younger (sibling); youngest

Before the new one: say the French for godson, then the French for eldest.

You'll want to know: le cadet

le cadet — "younger (sibling); youngest".

Mon frère cadet a trois ans de moins que moi.

My younger brother is three years younger than me.

A woman is *la cadette*. *C'est le cadet de mes soucis* — that is the least of my worries.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le cadet was borrowed from Gascon *capdet* "little chief", a title for younger sons serving as officers; it goes back to Latin *capitellum*, from *caput* "head" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cadet*
- *Say it: le cadet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cadet*
- *Recall:* say the French for godson, then the French for eldest, then say *le cadet* again

Before you move on

What does le cadet mean? ("Younger (sibling); youngest".) Say it once more.

Chapter 491

Quand ça se termine

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about breaking up and separating.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 491: I can talk about breaking up and separating.*

491.1 le conjoint — spouse, partner

> Before the new one: say the French for eldest, then the French for younger.

You'll want to know: le conjoint

le conjoint — "spouse, partner".

> Les conjoints sont invités à la fête de l'entreprise.
>
> *Spouses are invited to the company party.*

A woman is *la conjointe*. Formal: married or living together. In Québec, *le conjoint* is very common in speech.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le conjoint is the participle of *conjoindre* "to join together", from Latin *coniungere*, so *coniūnctus* "joined", built on *iungere* "to join" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le conjoint*
- *Say it: le conjoint*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le conjoint*
- *Recall:* say the French for eldest, then the French for younger, then say *le conjoint* again

Before you move on

What does le conjoint mean? ("Spouse, partner".) Say it once more.

491.2 séparer — to separate; (se séparer) to split up

Before the new one: say the French for younger, then the French for spouse.

You'll want to know: séparer

séparer — "to separate; (se séparer) to split up".

Après dix ans de vie commune, ils se sont séparés.

After ten years together, they split up.

Reflexive for couples: *se séparer*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

séparer is a learned borrowing from Latin *sēparāre* "to part, to separate" (EtymDB), built from *sē-* "apart" and a verb *parāre*; which *parāre* is meant is not settled (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: séparer*
- *Say it: séparer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *séparer*
- *Recall:* say the French for younger, then the French for spouse, then say *séparer* again

Before you move on

What does séparer mean? ("To separate; (se séparer) to split up".) Say it once more.

491.3 la séparation — separation, parting

Before the new one: say the French for spouse, then the French for to separate.

You'll want to know: la séparation

la séparation — "separation, parting".

La séparation a été difficile pour les enfants.

The separation was hard for the children.

Also a parting: *une séparation à la gare.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la séparation is a learned borrowing from Latin *sēparātiō* "a separation" (EtymDB), from *sēparāre* "to part, to separate" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la séparation*
- *Say it: la séparation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la séparation*
- *Recall:* say the French for spouse, then the French for to separate, then say *la séparation* again

Before you move on

What does la séparation mean? ("Separation, parting".) Say it once more.

491.4 rompre — to break up; to break

Before the new one: say the French for to separate, then the French for separation.

You'll want to know: rompre

rompre — "to break up; to break".

Il a rompu avec sa copine au mois de mai.

He broke up with his girlfriend in May.

Rompre avec quelqu'un — to break up with someone. Present *il rompt.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rompre is inherited from Latin *rumpere* "to break, to burst" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rompre*
- *Say it: rompre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rompre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to separate, then the French for separation, then say *rompre* again

Before you move on

What does rompre mean? (“To break up; to break”.) Say it once more.

491.5 la rupture — break-up; breaking

Before the new one: say the French for separation, then the French for to break up.

You’ll want to know: la rupture

la rupture — “break-up; breaking”.

Après la rupture, elle est partie vivre à la campagne.

After the break-up, she went to live in the country.

Être en rupture de stock — to be out of stock.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la rupture is a learned borrowing from Late Latin *ruptūra* “a break”, from *rumpere* “to break” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la rupture*
- *Say it:* *la rupture*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la rupture*
- *Recall:* say the French for separation, then the French for to break up, then say *la rupture* again

Before you move on

What does la rupture mean? (“Break-up; breaking”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 492

Familles d'aujourd'hui

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe different kinds of families.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 492: I can describe different kinds of families.*

492.1 recomposé — blended (of a family)

> Before the new one: say the French for to break up, then the French for break-up.

You'll want to know: recomposé

recomposé — "blended (of a family)".

> Nous sommes une famille recomposée avec cinq enfants.
>
> *We are a blended family with five children.*

Une famille recomposée — parents and children from earlier unions living together.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

recomposé is built from *re-* and *composé*, from *composer* "to put together", which goes back to Latin *compōnere*, reshaped after *poser*; both rest on *pōnere* "to put" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: recomposé*
- *Say it: recomposé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *recomposé*
- *Recall:* say the French for to break up, then the French for break-up, then say *recomposé* again

Before you move on

What does recomposé mean? ("Blended (of a family)".) Say it once more.

492.2 adopter — to adopt

Before the new one: say the French for break-up, then the French for blended.

You'll want to know: adopter

adopter — "to adopt".

Mes voisins ont adopté une petite fille.

My neighbours have adopted a little girl.

Also of an idea or a pet: *adopter un chien.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

adopter is a learned borrowing from Latin *adoptāre* "to choose, to adopt" (EtymDB), built on *optāre* "to choose, to wish" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: adopter*
- *Say it: adopter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *adopter*
- *Recall:* say the French for break-up, then the French for blended, then say *adopter* again

Before you move on

What does adopter mean? ("To adopt".) Say it once more.

492.3 l'adoption — adoption

Before the new one: say the French for blended, then the French for to adopt.

You'll want to know: l'adoption

l'adoption — "adoption".

L'adoption a pris trois ans.

The adoption took three years.

Feminine. *Un enfant adopté* — an adopted child.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'adoption is a learned borrowing from Latin *adoptiō* "adoption", from *adoptāre*, built on *optāre* "to choose" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'adoption*
- *Say it: l'adoption*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'adoption*
- *Recall:* say the French for blended, then the French for to adopt, then say *l'adoption* again

Before you move on

What does l'adoption mean? ("Adoption".) Say it once more.

492.4 la fratrie — siblings (as a group)

Before the new one: say the French for to adopt, then the French for adoption.

You'll want to know: la fratrie

la fratrie — "siblings (as a group)".

Dans ma fratrie, nous sommes quatre.

There are four of us siblings.

A useful word with no plain everyday English match: all the brothers and sisters of one family.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la fratrie is a modern learned word built on Latin *frāter* "brother" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la fratrie*
- *Say it: la fratrie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la fratrie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to adopt, then the French for adoption, then say *la fratrie* again

Before you move on

What does la fratrie mean? (“Siblings (as a group)”.) Say it once more.

492.5 la famille nombreuse — large family

Before the new one: say the French for adoption, then the French for siblings.

You’ll want to know: la famille nombreuse

la famille nombreuse — “large family”.

Elle vient d’une famille nombreuse de sept enfants.

She comes from a large family of seven children.

In France, from three children on; such families get some discounts.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la famille nombreuse joins *famille*, a learned borrowing from Latin *familia* “household”, and *nombreux* “numerous”, from Latin *numerōsus*, built on *numerus* “number” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la famille nombreuse*
- *Say it: la famille nombreuse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la famille nombreuse*
- *Recall:* say the French for adoption, then the French for siblings, then say *la famille nombreuse* again

Before you move on

What does la famille nombreuse mean? ("Large family".) Say it once more.

Chapter 493

La première année

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about pregnancy and a baby's first months.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 493: I can talk about pregnancy and a baby's first months.*

493.1 la grossesse — pregnancy

Before the new one: say the French for siblings, then the French for large family.

You'll want to know: la grossesse

la grossesse — "pregnancy".

> Pendant sa grossesse, elle a continué à travailler.
>
> *During her pregnancy she kept on working.*

Être enceinte — to be pregnant.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la grossesse is built on *gros* "big" with *-esse*; *gros* is inherited from Late Latin *grossus* "thick".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la grossesse*
- *Say it: la grossesse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la grossesse*
- *Recall:* say the French for siblings, then the French for large family, then say *la grossesse* again

Before you move on

What does la grossesse mean? ("Pregnancy".) Say it once more.

493.2 accoucher — to give birth

Before the new one: say the French for large family, then the French for pregnancy.

You'll want to know: accoucher

accoucher — "to give birth".

Ma sœur a accouché d'un garçon ce matin.

My sister gave birth to a boy this morning.

Accoucher de — to give birth to. *L'accouchement* — the birth.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accoucher comes from Old French *acouchier* "to lay down, to take to one's bed" (EtymDB), built on *coucher*, from Latin *collocāre* "to place", itself built on *locus* "place" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: accoucher*
- *Say it: accoucher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *accoucher*
- *Recall:* say the French for large family, then the French for pregnancy, then say *accoucher* again

Before you move on

What does accoucher mean? ("To give birth".) Say it once more.

493.3 le nourrisson — infant, small baby

Before the new one: say the French for pregnancy, then the French for to give birth.

You'll want to know: le nourrisson

le nourrisson — "infant, small baby".

Le nourrisson dort presque toute la journée.

The infant sleeps almost all day.

Formal: a baby of a few months.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le nourrisson comes from Late Latin *nūtrītiō* "feeding, nursing", built on *nūtrīre* "to feed" (Lewis & Short), the source of *nourrir*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le nourrisson*
- *Say it: le nourrisson*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le nourrisson*
- *Recall:* say the French for pregnancy, then the French for to give birth, then say *le nourrisson* again

Before you move on

What does le nourrisson mean? ("Infant, small baby".) Say it once more.

493.4 le biberon — baby's bottle

Before the new one: say the French for to give birth, then the French for infant.

You'll want to know: le biberon

le biberon — "baby's bottle".

Le père donne le biberon au bébé.

The father gives the baby its bottle.

Donner le biberon — to bottle-feed.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le biberon is built on Latin *bibere* "to drink" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), with the ending *-on*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le biberon*
- *Say it: le biberon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le biberon*
- *Recall:* say the French for to give birth, then the French for infant, then say *le biberon* again

Before you move on

What does le biberon mean? (“Baby’s bottle”.) Say it once more.

493.5 bercer — to rock (a baby)

Before the new one: say the French for infant, then the French for baby’s bottle.

You’ll want to know: bercer

bercer — “to rock (a baby)”.

Elle berce le bébé pour l’endormir.

She rocks the baby to get it to sleep.

Spelling: *nous berçons*. *Une berceuse* — a lullaby.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bercer comes from Old French *bercier* “to rock” (EtymDB), built on *bers* “cradle”, which is usually traced to a Gaulish word.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bercer*
- *Say it:* *bercer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bercer*
- *Recall:* say the French for infant, then the French for baby's bottle, then say *bercer* again

Before you move on

What does bercer mean? ("To rock (a baby)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 494

Élever des enfants

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about bringing up children.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 494: I can talk about bringing up children.*

494.1 élever — to bring up, to raise

> Before the new one: say the French for baby's bottle, then the French for to rock.

You'll want to know: élever

élever — "to bring up, to raise".

> Ses grands-parents l'ont élevé à la campagne.
>
> *His grandparents brought him up in the country.*

Accent change: *j'élève*, *nous élevons*. Also to raise animals: *élever des moutons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

élever is built from *é-* and *lever* "to raise", which is inherited from Latin *levāre* "to lift" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *élever*
- *Say it:* *élever*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *élever*
- *Recall:* say the French for baby's bottle, then the French for to rock, then say *élever* again

Before you move on

What does élever mean? ("To bring up, to raise".) Say it once more.

494.2 gâter — to spoil (a child); to ruin

Before the new one: say the French for to rock, then the French for to bring up.

You'll want to know: gâter

gâter — "to spoil (a child); to ruin".

Mon oncle gâte beaucoup ses neveux.

My uncle really spoils his nephews.

Un enfant gâté — a spoilt child. *Il fait un temps gâté* — the weather has turned bad.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

gâter is inherited from Latin *vastāre* "to lay waste" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short); its first sound was reshaped under a related Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: gâter*
- *Say it: gâter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *gâter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rock, then the French for to bring up, then say *gâter* again

Before you move on

What does gâter mean? ("To spoil (a child); to ruin".) Say it once more.

494.3 la punition — punishment

Before the new one: say the French for to bring up, then the French for to spoil.

You'll want to know: la punition

la punition — "punishment".

Comme punition, il n'a pas eu de dessert.

As a punishment, he did not get any pudding.

The verb is *punir* "to punish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la punition is a learned borrowing from Latin *pūnītiō* "punishment" (EtymDB), from *pūnīre* "to punish", built on *poena* "penalty" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la punition*
- *Say it: la punition*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la punition*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bring up, then the French for to spoil, then say *la punition* again

Before you move on

What does la punition mean? ("Punishment".) Say it once more.

494.4 désobéir — to disobey

Before the new one: say the French for to spoil, then the French for punishment.

You'll want to know: désobéir

désobéir — "to disobey".

Le chien désobéit quand il voit un chat.

The dog disobeys when it sees a cat.

Désobéir à quelqu'un. A regular *-ir* verb: *ils désobéissent.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

désobéir is built from *dés-* and *obéir* "to obey", which goes back to Latin *oboedīre* "to listen to, to obey", built on *audīre* "to hear" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: désobéir*
- *Say it: désobéir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *désobéir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to spoil, then the French for punishment, then say *désobéir* again

Before you move on

What does désobéir mean? ("To disobey".) Say it once more.

494.5 la crèche — day nursery, crèche; nativity scene

Before the new one: say the French for punishment, then the French for to disobey.

You'll want to know: la crèche

la crèche — "day nursery, crèche; nativity scene".

Le matin, je dépose ma fille à la crèche.

In the morning I drop my daughter off at the nursery.

For children under three. In Belgium also *la crèche*; in Québec *la garderie*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la crèche comes from Frankish *krippija* "a manger, a crib" (EtymDB), a Germanic word related to English *crib*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la crèche*
- *Say it: la crèche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la crèche*
- *Recall:* say the French for punishment, then the French for to disobey, then say *la crèche* again

Before you move on

What does la crèche mean? ("Day nursery, crèche; nativity scene".) Say it once more.

Chapter 495

Disputes et trahisons

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about quarrels, betrayal and falling out.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 495: I can talk about quarrels, betrayal and falling out.*

495.1 la dispute — quarrel, argument

> Before the new one: say the French for to disobey, then the French for day nursery.

You'll want to know: la dispute

la dispute — "quarrel, argument".

> Ils ont eu une dispute à propos de l'argent.
>
> *They had an argument about money.*

A real row, not a debate.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la dispute is built on the verb *disputer*, from Latin *disputāre* "to discuss, to argue" (EtymDB), built from *dis-* "apart" and *putāre* "to reckon" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dispute*
- *Say it: la dispute*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la dispute*
- *Recall:* say the French for to disobey, then the French for day nursery, then say *la dispute* again

Before you move on

What does la dispute mean? ("Quarrel, argument".) Say it once more.

495.2 brouiller — to mix up, to blur; (se brouiller) to fall out

Before the new one: say the French for day nursery, then the French for quarrel.

You'll want to know: brouiller

brouiller — "to mix up, to blur; (se brouiller) to fall out".

Les deux frères se sont brouillés à cause d'une maison.

The two brothers fell out over a house.

Se brouiller avec quelqu'un — to fall out with someone. *Des œufs brouillés* — scrambled eggs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

brouiller goes back to Old French *brouiller*, from Vulgar Latin *brodiculāre* "to jumble together" (EtymDB), which is usually traced to a Germanic word for broth.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: brouiller*
- *Say it: brouiller*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *brouiller*
- *Recall:* say the French for day nursery, then the French for quarrel, then say *brouiller* again

Before you move on

What does brouiller mean? ("To mix up, to blur; (se brouiller) to fall out".) Say it once more.

495.3 tromper — to deceive; to be unfaithful to

Before the new one: say the French for quarrel, then the French for to mix up.

You'll want to know: tromper

tromper — "to deceive; to be unfaithful to".

Elle a appris que son compagnon la trompait.

She found out that her partner was cheating on her.

Se tromper — to make a mistake, a very common sense.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tromper goes back to Old French *tromper* (EtymDB). The origin is not settled; a link with *trompe* "horn" is often proposed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tromper*
- *Say it:* *tromper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tromper*
- *Recall:* say the French for quarrel, then the French for to mix up, then say *tromper* again

Before you move on

What does tromper mean? ("To deceive; to be unfaithful to".) Say it once more.

495.4 trahir — to betray

Before the new one: say the French for to mix up, then the French for to deceive.

You'll want to know: trahir

trahir — "to betray".

Elle a trahi le secret de son amie.

She betrayed her friend's secret.

A regular *-ir* verb: *nous trahissons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

trahir is inherited from Latin *trādere* "to hand over" (Lewis & Short), built from *trāns* and *dare* "to give".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: trahir*
- *Say it: trahir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *trahir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to mix up, then the French for to deceive, then say *trahir* again

Before you move on

What does trahir mean? (“To betray”.) Say it once more.

495.5 la trahison — betrayal; treason

Before the new one: say the French for to deceive, then the French for to betray.

You’ll want to know: la trahison

la trahison — “betrayal; treason”.

Pour lui, ce mensonge est une trahison.

For him, this lie is a betrayal.

Built on *trahir*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la trahison comes from Old French *traison* (EtymDB), built on *trair* “to betray”, from Latin *trādere* “to hand over”, built on *dare* (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la trahison*
- *Say it: la trahison*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la trahison*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deceive, then the French for to betray, then say *la trahison* again

Before you move on

What does la trahison mean? (“Betrayal; treason”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 496

Fil et aiguille

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about sewing, knitting and embroidery.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 496: I can talk about sewing, knitting and embroidery.*

496.1 coudre — to sew

> Before the new one: say the French for to betray, then the French for betrayal.

You'll want to know: coudre

coudre — "to sew".

> Ma grand-mère m'a appris à coudre.
>
> *My grandmother taught me to sew.*

Irregular: *je couds, nous cousons*; past *j'ai cousu*. *Coudre un bouton* — to sew on a button.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

coudre is inherited from Vulgar Latin *cōsere* (EtymDB), a form of Latin *cōnsuere* "to sew together", built on *suere* "to sew" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: coudre*
- *Say it: coudre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *coudre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to betray, then the French for betrayal, then say *coudre* again

Before you move on

What does coudre mean? ("To sew".) Say it once more.

496.2 tricoter — to knit

Before the new one: say the French for betrayal, then the French for to sew.

You'll want to know: tricoter

tricoter — "to knit".

Mon père tricote une écharpe pour l'hiver.

My father is knitting a scarf for the winter.

Le tricot — knitting; also a knitted jumper.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tricoter goes back to Old French *tricoter* (EtymDB), which once meant "to beat with sticks". Its origin is not settled; a Germanic source has been proposed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tricoter*
- *Say it: tricoter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tricoter*
- *Recall:* say the French for betrayal, then the French for to sew, then say *tricoter* again

Before you move on

What does tricoter mean? ("To knit".) Say it once more.

496.3 la pelote — ball (of wool or string)

Before the new one: say the French for to sew, then the French for to knit.

You'll want to know: la pelote

la pelote — "ball (of wool or string)".

Le chat joue avec une pelote de laine.

The cat is playing with a ball of wool.

Une pelote de laine — a ball of wool. *La pelote basque* is a ball game.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la pelote is inherited from Vulgar Latin *pilotta* "a small ball" (EtymDB), built on Latin *pila* "a ball" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pelote*
- *Say it: la pelote*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la pelote*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sew, then the French for to knit, then say *la pelote* again

Before you move on

What does la pelote mean? (“Ball (of wool or string)”.) Say it once more.

496.4 broder — to embroider

Before the new one: say the French for to knit, then the French for ball.

You’ll want to know: broder

broder — “to embroider”.

Elle a brodé des fleurs sur un coussin.

She embroidered flowers on a cushion.

La broderie — embroidery. Informally, to embellish a story.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

broder goes back to Old French *brosder*, a word of Germanic origin; its form was later drawn towards *bord* “edge”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: broder*
- *Say it: broder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *broder*
- *Recall:* say the French for to knit, then the French for ball, then say *broder* again

Before you move on

What does broder mean? ("To embroider".) Say it once more.

496.5 la couture — sewing; fashion design

Before the new one: say the French for ball, then the French for to embroider.

You'll want to know: la couture

la couture — "sewing; fashion design".

Je fais de la couture le samedi.

I do sewing on Saturdays.

La haute couture — high fashion. *Une couture* is also a seam.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la couture is inherited, through Old French *cousture*, from Vulgar Latin *cōnsūtūra* "a seam" (EtymDB), built on *cōnsuere* "to sew together", from *suere* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la couture*
- *Say it:* *la couture*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la couture*
- *Recall:* say the French for ball, then the French for to embroider, then say *la couture* again

Before you move on

What does la couture mean? (“Sewing; fashion design”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 497

Une journée de pêche

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a day out fishing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 497: I can talk about a day out fishing.*

497.1 la canne à pêche — fishing rod

> Before the new one: say the French for to embroider, then the French for sewing.

You'll want to know: la canne à pêche

la canne à pêche — "fishing rod".

> Mon oncle m'a offert une canne à pêche.
>
> *My uncle gave me a fishing rod.*

La canne alone is a walking stick.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la canne à pêche joins *canne* "cane, rod", from Latin *canna* "a reed", and *pêche* "fishing", built on *pêcher*, from Latin *piscārī* "to fish" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la canne à pêche*
- *Say it: la canne à pêche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la canne à pêche*
- *Recall:* say the French for to embroider, then the French for sewing, then say *la canne à pêche* again

Before you move on

What does la canne à pêche mean? ("Fishing rod".) Say it once more.

497.2 l'hameçon — fish hook

Before the new one: say the French for sewing, then the French for fishing rod.

You'll want to know: l'hameçon

l'hameçon — "fish hook".

Le poisson a mordu à l'hameçon.

The fish took the hook.

Masculine. *Mordre à l'hameçon* is also to fall for a trick.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'hameçon comes from Old French *ameçon*, built on a Vulgar Latin form of Latin *hāmus* "a hook" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'hameçon*
- *Say it: l'hameçon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'hameçon*
- *Recall:* say the French for sewing, then the French for fishing rod, then say *l'hameçon* again

Before you move on

What does l'hameçon mean? ("Fish hook".) Say it once more.

497.3 l'appât — bait

Before the new one: say the French for fishing rod, then the French for fish hook.

You'll want to know: l'appât

l'appât — "bait".

Il utilise des vers comme appât.

He uses worms as bait.

Masculine. The verb is *appâter* "to lure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'appât is built on *appâter* (EtymDB), from *à* and Old French *past* "food", which goes back to Latin *pāstus* "feeding", from *pāscere* "to feed" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'appât*
- *Say it: l'appât*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'appât*
- *Recall:* say the French for fishing rod, then the French for fish hook, then say *l'appât* again

Before you move on

What does l'appât mean? ("Bait".) Say it once more.

497.4 pêcher — to fish; to catch (fish)

Before the new one: say the French for fish hook, then the French for bait.

You'll want to know: pêcher

pêcher — "to fish; to catch (fish)".

Le dimanche, nous allons pêcher au bord du lac.

On Sundays we go fishing by the lake.

Do not mix it up with *pécher* "to sin" or *le pêcher*, the peach tree.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

pêcher is inherited, through Old French *peschier*, from Vulgar Latin *piscāre* (EtymDB), a form of Latin *piscārī* "to fish", from *piscis* "fish" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: pêcher*
- *Say it: pêcher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *pêcher*
- *Recall:* say the French for fish hook, then the French for bait, then say *pêcher* again

Before you move on

What does pêcher mean? (“To fish; to catch (fish)”.) Say it once more.

497.5 le pêcheur — fisherman, angler

Before the new one: say the French for bait, then the French for to fish.

You’ll want to know: le pêcheur

le pêcheur — “fisherman, angler”.

Le pêcheur attend depuis le lever du soleil.

The angler has been waiting since sunrise.

A woman is *la pêcheuse*. Do not mix it up with *le pécheur* “sinner”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le pêcheur is inherited from Latin *piscātor* “a fisherman”, from *piscārī* “to fish”, from *piscis* “fish” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pêcheur*
- *Say it: le pêcheur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pêcheur*
- *Recall:* say the French for bait, then the French for to fish, then say *le pêcheur* again

Before you move on

What does le pêcheur mean? ("Fisherman, angler".) Say it once more.

497.6 Retour sur les chapitres 490–497

Say the French for godfather and godmother.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- godfather, godmother, godson, eldest, younger
- spouse, to separate, separation, to break up, break-up
- blended, to adopt, adoption, siblings, large family
- pregnancy, to give birth, infant, baby's bottle, to rock
- to bring up, to spoil, punishment, to disobey, day nursery
- quarrel, to mix up, to deceive, to betray, betrayal
- to sew, to knit, ball, to embroider, sewing
- fishing rod, fish hook, bait, to fish, fisherman

Before you move on

Godfather? (**le parrain**.) Godmother? (**la marraine**.) Godson? (**le filleul**.) Eldest? (**l'aîné**.) Younger? (**le cadet**.) Spouse? (**le**

conjoint.) To separate? (**séparer**.) Separation? (**la séparation**.) To break up? (**rompre**.) Break-up? (**la rupture**.) Blended? (**recomposé**.) To adopt? (**adopter**.) Adoption? (**l'adoption**.) Siblings? (**la fratrie**.) Large family? (**la famille nombreuse**.) Pregnancy? (**la grossesse**.) To give birth? (**accoucher**.) Infant? (**le nourrisson**.) Baby's bottle? (**le biberon**.) To rock? (**bercer**.) To bring up? (**élever**.) To spoil? (**gâter**.) Punishment? (**la punition**.) To disobey? (**désobéir**.) Day nursery? (**la crèche**.) Quarrel? (**la dispute**.) To mix up? (**brouiller**.) To deceive? (**tromper**.) To betray? (**trahir**.) Betrayal? (**la trahison**.) To sew? (**coudre**.) To knit? (**tricoter**.) Ball? (**la pelote**.) To embroider? (**broder**.) Sewing? (**la couture**.) Fishing rod? (**la canne à pêche**.) Fish hook? (**l'hameçon**.) Bait? (**l'appât**.) To fish? (**pêcher**.) Fisherman? (**le pêcheur**.)

Chapter 498

En plein air

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about climbing and evenings outdoors.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 498: I can talk about climbing and evenings outdoors.*

498.1 l'escalade — climbing

> Before the new one: say the French for to fish, then the French for fisherman.

You'll want to know: l'escalade

l'escalade — "climbing".

> Je fais de l'escalade en salle le mercredi.
>
> *I go indoor climbing on Wednesdays.*

Feminine. *Faire de l'escalade* — to climb (as a sport).

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'escalade was borrowed from Italian *scalata* (EtymDB), from *scalare* "to climb", built on *scala* "ladder", inherited from Latin *scāla* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'escalade*
- *Say it: l'escalade*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'escalade*
- *Recall:* say the French for to fish, then the French for fisherman, then say *l'escalade* again

Before you move on

What does l'escalade mean? ("Climbing".) Say it once more.

498.2 grimper — to climb

Before the new one: say the French for fisherman, then the French for climbing.

You'll want to know: grimper

grimper — "to climb".

Les enfants grimpent dans l'arbre.

The children are climbing the tree.

Grimper à un arbre or *dans un arbre.* Also of prices: *les prix grimpent.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

grimper is usually traced to *gripper* "to grab", a verb of Germanic origin, with an added nasal sound; the origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: grimper*
- *Say it: grimper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *grimper*
- *Recall:* say the French for fisherman, then the French for climbing, then say *grimper* again

Before you move on

What does grimper mean? ("To climb".) Say it once more.

498.3 la gourde — water bottle, flask

Before the new one: say the French for climbing, then the French for to climb.

You'll want to know: la gourde

la gourde — "water bottle, flask".

Avant de partir, il a rempli sa gourde.

Before leaving, he filled his water bottle.

First a dried gourd. Informally, *une gourde* is also a dimwit.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la gourde goes back to Old French *coorde* (EtymDB), from Latin *cucurbita* "a gourd" (Lewis & Short): dried gourds once served as flasks.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la gourde*
- *Say it: la gourde*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la gourde*
- *Recall:* say the French for climbing, then the French for to climb, then say *la gourde* again

Before you move on

What does la gourde mean? ("Water bottle, flask".) Say it once more.

498.4 la lampe de poche — torch, flashlight

Before the new one: say the French for to climb, then the French for water bottle.

You'll want to know: la lampe de poche

la lampe de poche — "torch, flashlight".

Il cherche ses clés avec une lampe de poche.

He is looking for his keys with a torch.

Also *une lampe torche*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la lampe de poche is "a pocket lamp": *lampe* comes from Latin *lampas* "a torch", a borrowing from Greek, and *poche* "pocket" is of Frankish origin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la lampe de poche*
- *Say it: la lampe de poche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la lampe de poche*
- *Recall:* say the French for to climb, then the French for water bottle, then say *la lampe de poche* again

Before you move on

What does la lampe de poche mean? (“Torch, flashlight”.) Say it once more.

498.5 le feu de camp — campfire

Before the new one: say the French for water bottle, then the French for torch.

You’ll want to know: le feu de camp

le feu de camp — “campfire”.

Le soir, nous chantions autour du feu de camp.

In the evening we used to sing round the campfire.

Faire un feu de camp — to make a campfire.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le feu de camp joins *feu*, inherited from Latin *focus* “hearth”, and *camp*, from Latin *campus* “a field” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le feu de camp*
- *Say it: le feu de camp*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le feu de camp*
- *Recall:* say the French for water bottle, then the French for torch, then say *le feu de camp* again

Before you move on

What does le feu de camp mean? (“Campfire”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 499

Jeux de société

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about board games.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 499: I can talk about board games.*

499.1 le jeu de société — board game

> Before the new one: say the French for torch, then the French for campfire.

You'll want to know: le jeu de société

le jeu de société — "board game".

> Le soir, nous jouons à un jeu de société.
>
> *In the evening we play a board game.*

Plural *des jeux de société*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le jeu de société is "a game for company": *jeu* is inherited from Latin *iocus* "a joke, play", and *société* from Latin *societās*, built on *socius* "companion" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jeu de société*
- *Say it: le jeu de société*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le jeu de société*
- *Recall:* say the French for torch, then the French for campfire, then say *le jeu de société* again

Before you move on

What does le jeu de société mean? ("Board game".) Say it once more.

499.2 le dé — dice, die

Before the new one: say the French for campfire, then the French for board game.

You'll want to know: le dé

le dé — "dice, die".

C'est à toi de lancer le dé.

It is your turn to throw the dice.

Plural *les dés*. *Un dé à coudre* — a thimble.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le dé is usually traced to Latin *datum* "what is given", from *dare* "to give" (Lewis & Short), but the origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dé*
- *Say it: le dé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le dé*
- *Recall:* say the French for campfire, then the French for board game, then say *le dé* again

Before you move on

What does le dé mean? (“Dice, die”.) Say it once more.

499.3 le pion — pawn, counter (in a game)

Before the new one: say the French for board game, then the French for dice.

You’ll want to know: le pion

le pion — “pawn, counter (in a game)”.

Elle avance son pion de trois cases.

She moves her counter forward three squares.

In school slang, *le pion* is also a supervisor.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le pion is inherited from Late Latin *pedō* “a foot soldier” (EtymDB), built on *pēs* “foot” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pion*
- *Say it: le pion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pion*
- *Recall:* say the French for board game, then the French for dice, then say *le pion* again

Before you move on

What does le pion mean? (“Pawn, counter (in a game)”.) Say it once more.

499.4 l’échiquier — chessboard

Before the new one: say the French for dice, then the French for pawn.

You’ll want to know: l’échiquier

l’échiquier — “chessboard”.

Ils ont posé l’échiquier sur une petite table.

They put the chessboard on a little table.

Masculine. Chess is *les échecs*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l’échiquier comes from Old French *eschequier*, built on *eschec* “check”, which goes back through Arabic to Persian *šāh* “king”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'échiquier*
- *Say it: l'échiquier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'échiquier*
- *Recall:* say the French for dice, then the French for pawn, then say *l'échiquier* again

Before you move on

What does l'échiquier mean? ("Chessboard".) Say it once more.

499.5 tricher — to cheat

Before the new one: say the French for pawn, then the French for chessboard.

You'll want to know: tricher

tricher — "to cheat".

Mon petit frère triche toujours aux cartes.

My little brother always cheats at cards.

Un tricheur — a cheat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tricher is inherited from Old French *trichier* (EtymDB), usually traced to Vulgar Latin *triccāre*, from Latin *trīcārī* "to make difficulties, to trifle" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tricher*
- *Say it: tricher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tricher*
- *Recall:* say the French for pawn, then the French for chessboard, then say *tricher* again

Before you move on

What does tricher mean? (“To cheat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 500

Cartes et paris

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about card games and betting.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 500: I can talk about card games and betting.*

500.1 la belote — belote (a card game)

> Before the new one: say the French for chessboard, then the French for to cheat.

You'll want to know: la belote

la belote — "belote (a card game)".

> Le dimanche, mes oncles jouent à la belote.
>
> *On Sundays my uncles play belote.*

A very popular card game in France, played in pairs with 32 cards.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *la belote* is not settled; the game took its name in France in the early twentieth century.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la belote*
- *Say it: la belote*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la belote*
- *Recall:* say the French for chessboard, then the French for to cheat, then say *la belote* again

Before you move on

What does la belote mean? ("Belote (a card game)".) Say it once more.

500.2 distribuer — to deal (cards); to hand out

Before the new one: say the French for to cheat, then the French for belote.

You'll want to know: distribuer

distribuer — "to deal (cards); to hand out".

C'est à ton tour de distribuer les cartes.

It is your turn to deal the cards.

Also to hand out: *distribuer des tracts.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

distribuer is a learned borrowing from Latin *distribuere* "to divide out", built on *tribuere* "to assign" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: distribuer*
- *Say it: distribuer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *distribuer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to cheat, then the French for belote, then say *distribuer* again

Before you move on

What does distribuer mean? (“To deal (cards); to hand out”.) Say it once more.

500.3 parier — to bet

Before the new one: say the French for belote, then the French for to deal.

You’ll want to know: parier

parier — “to bet”.

Il a parié dix euros sur son équipe.

He bet ten euros on his team.

Je parie que… — I bet that…

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

parier comes from Late Latin *pariāre* “to make equal, to match”, built on *pār* “equal” (Lewis & Short): two sides put up equal stakes.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: parier*
- *Say it: parier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *parier*
- *Recall:* say the French for belote, then the French for to deal, then say *parier* again

Before you move on

What does parier mean? ("To bet".) Say it once more.

500.4 le pari — bet

Before the new one: say the French for to deal, then the French for to bet.

You'll want to know: le pari

le pari — "bet".

J'ai perdu mon pari avec mon frère.

I lost my bet with my brother.

Faire un pari — to make a bet.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le pari is built on *parier* "to bet" (EtymDB), which comes from Late Latin *pariāre* "to make equal", from *pār* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pari*
- *Say it: le pari*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pari*
- *Recall:* say the French for to deal, then the French for to bet, then say *le pari* again

Before you move on

What does le pari mean? (“Bet”.) Say it once more.

500.5 le hasard — chance, luck

Before the new one: say the French for to bet, then the French for bet.

You’ll want to know: le hasard

le hasard — “chance, luck”.

Les jeux de hasard sont interdits aux mineurs.

Games of chance are forbidden to minors.

Par hasard — by chance. The *h* is aspirated: *le hasard*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le hasard comes from Arabic *az-zahr* “the die”, through Spanish *azar* (EtymDB): first a game of dice, then chance itself.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le hasard*
- *Say it:* *le hasard*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le hasard*
- *Recall:* say the French for to bet, then the French for bet, then say *le hasard* again

Before you move on

What does le hasard mean? (“Chance, luck”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 501

Collectionneurs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about collecting and building models.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 501: I can talk about collecting and building models.*

501.1 collectionner — to collect

Before the new one: say the French for bet, then the French for chance.

You'll want to know: collectionner

collectionner — "to collect".

> Mon voisin collectionne les vieilles cartes postales.
>
> *My neighbour collects old postcards.*

As a hobby. To pick up someone is *aller chercher*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

collectionner is built on *collection* (EtymDB), a learned borrowing from Latin *collēctiō* "a gathering", from *colligere* "to gather", built on *legere* "to gather, to read" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: collectionner*
- *Say it: collectionner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *collectionner*
- *Recall:* say the French for bet, then the French for chance, then say *collectionner* again

Before you move on

What does collectionner mean? ("To collect".) Say it once more.

501.2 le collectionneur — collector

Before the new one: say the French for chance, then the French for to collect.

You'll want to know: le collectionneur

le collectionneur — "collector".

Ce collectionneur possède deux mille timbres.

This collector owns two thousand stamps.

A woman is *la collectionneuse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le collectionneur is built on *collectionner* "to collect", from *collection*, a learned borrowing from Latin *collēctiō*, built on *legere* "to gather" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le collectionneur*
- *Say it: le collectionneur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le collectionneur*
- *Recall:* say the French for chance, then the French for to collect, then say *le collectionneur* again

Before you move on

What does le collectionneur mean? (“Collector”.) Say it once more.

501.3 la maquette — scale model; mock-up

Before the new one: say the French for to collect, then the French for collector.

You’ll want to know: la maquette

la maquette — “scale model; mock-up”.

Il a construit une maquette de bateau.

He built a model boat.

Also a designer’s mock-up of a page or a building.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la maquette was borrowed from Italian *macchietta* “a little sketch” (EtymDB), from *macchia* “a spot”, inherited from Latin *macula* “a spot” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la maquette*
- *Say it: la maquette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la maquette*
- *Recall:* say the French for to collect, then the French for collector, then say *la maquette* again

Before you move on

What does la maquette mean? ("Scale model; mock-up".) Say it once more.

501.4 le modélisme — model-making

Before the new one: say the French for collector, then the French for scale model.

You'll want to know: le modélisme

le modélisme — "model-making".

Mon père fait du modélisme : il construit des petits trains.

My father does model-making: he builds little trains.

Un modéliste — a model-maker.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le modélisme is built on *modèle* "model" with *-isme*; *modèle* was borrowed from Italian *modello*, which goes back to Latin *modulus* "a small measure", from *modus* "measure" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le modélisme*
- *Say it: le modélisme*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le modélisme*
- *Recall:* say the French for collector, then the French for scale model, then say *le modélisme* again

Before you move on

What does le modélisme mean? ("Model-making".) Say it once more.

501.5 assembler — to put together, to assemble

Before the new one: say the French for scale model, then the French for model-making.

You'll want to know: assembler

assembler — "to put together, to assemble".

Il a assemblé l'armoire en deux heures.

He put the wardrobe together in two hours.

S'assembler — to gather.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

assembler is inherited from Latin *assimulāre* (EtymDB), which in Classical Latin meant "to make like"; the sense "to bring together" is usually traced to *simul* "together" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *assembler*
- *Say it:* *assembler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *assembler*
- *Recall:* say the French for scale model, then the French for model-making, then say *assembler* again

Before you move on

What does assembler mean? ("To put together, to assemble".) Say it once more.

Chapter 502

Prendre des photos

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about taking good photos.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 502: I can talk about taking good photos.*

502.1 flou — blurred, out of focus; vague

> Before the new one: say the French for model-making, then the French for to put together.

You'll want to know: flou

flou — "blurred, out of focus; vague".

> Toutes mes photos de la fête sont floues.
>
> *All my photos from the party are blurred.*

Feminine *floue*. Also vague: *des idées floues*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

flou goes back to Old French *flou* "faded, weak, soft" (EtymDB). Its earlier origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: flou*
- *Say it: flou*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *flou*
- *Recall:* say the French for model-making, then the French for to put together, then say *flou* again

Before you move on

What does flou mean? ("Blurred, out of focus; vague".) Say it once more.

502.2 net — sharp, in focus; clean, clear

Before the new one: say the French for to put together, then the French for blurred.

You'll want to know: net

net — "sharp, in focus; clean, clear".

Sur cette photo, le visage est bien net.

In this photo the face is nice and sharp.

Feminine *nette*. Also net (of money): *un salaire net*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

net is inherited from Latin *nitidus* "shining, clean" (EtymDB), from *nitēre* "to shine" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: net*
- *Say it: net*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *net*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put together, then the French for blurred, then say *net* again

Before you move on

What does net mean? (“Sharp, in focus; clean, clear”.) Say it once more.

502.3 le cliché — snapshot, photo; cliché

Before the new one: say the French for blurred, then the French for sharp.

You’ll want to know: le cliché

le cliché — “snapshot, photo; cliché”.

Le photographe a pris de beaux clichés du port.

The photographer took some lovely shots of the harbour.

Also a worn-out idea, as in English.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le cliché is the participle of *clicher* “to make a printing plate” (EtymDB), a word probably imitating the sound of the die striking the metal.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le cliché*
- *Say it: le cliché*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cliché*
- *Recall:* say the French for blurred, then the French for sharp, then say *le cliché* again

Before you move on

What does le cliché mean? ("Snapshot, photo; cliché".) Say it once more.

502.4 cadrer — to frame (a picture)

Before the new one: say the French for sharp, then the French for snapshot.

You'll want to know: cadrer

cadrer — "to frame (a picture)".

Elle a mal cadré la photo : la tour est coupée.

She framed the photo badly: the tower is cut off.

Also to fit: *ça ne cadre pas avec ses idées.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

cadrer is built on *cadre* "frame", borrowed from Italian *quadro*, from Latin *quadrum* "a square" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: cadrer*
- *Say it: cadrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *cadrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for sharp, then the French for snapshot, then say *cadrer* again

Before you move on

What does cadrer mean? ("To frame (a picture)".) Say it once more.

502.5 le trépied — tripod

Before the new one: say the French for snapshot, then the French for to frame.

You'll want to know: le trépied

le trépied — "tripod".

Pour les photos de nuit, il utilise un trépied.

For night photos he uses a tripod.

Three feet: *tré-* "three" and *pied* "foot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le trépied comes from Latin *tripēs* "three-footed" (EtymDB), built from *trēs* "three" and *pēs* "foot" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le trépied*
- *Say it: le trépied*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le trépied*
- *Recall:* say the French for snapshot, then the French for to frame, then say *le trépied* again

Before you move on

What does le trépied mean? (“Tripod”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 503

Le jardinage

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about gardening.
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 503: I can talk about gardening.*

503.1 le jardinage — gardening

Before the new one: say the French for to frame, then the French for tripod.

You'll want to know: le jardinage

le jardinage — "gardening".

Le jardinage me détend après le travail.

Gardening relaxes me after work.

Faire du jardinage — to do some gardening.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le jardinage is built on *jardin* "garden" with *-age*; *jardin* goes back to Frankish *gardo* "an enclosure", a Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le jardinage*
- *Say it: le jardinage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le jardinage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to frame, then the French for tripod, then say *le jardinage* again

Before you move on

What does le jardinage mean? ("Gardening".) Say it once more.

503.2 jardiner — to garden

Before the new one: say the French for tripod, then the French for gardening.

You'll want to know: jardiner

jardiner — "to garden".

Ma mère jardine tous les samedis.

My mother gardens every Saturday.

A regular *-er* verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

jardiner is built on *jardin* "garden", which goes back to Frankish *gardo* "an enclosure".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: jardiner*
- *Say it: jardiner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *jardiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for tripod, then the French for gardening, then say *jardiner* again

Before you move on

What does jardiner mean? ("To garden".) Say it once more.

503.3 semer — to sow

Before the new one: say the French for gardening, then the French for to garden.

You'll want to know: semer

semer — "to sow".

En avril, nous semons des carottes.

In April we sow carrots.

Je sème, *nous semons*. Informally, to lose someone: *il nous a semés*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

semer is inherited from Latin *sēmināre* "to sow" (EtymDB), from *sēmen* "seed" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *semer*
- *Say it:* *semer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *semer*
- *Recall:* say the French for gardening, then the French for to garden, then say *semer* again

Before you move on

What does semer mean? (“To sow”.) Say it once more.

503.4 arroser — to water (plants)

Before the new one: say the French for to garden, then the French for to sow.

You’ll want to know: arroser

arroser — “to water (plants)”.

Pendant les vacances, le voisin arrose nos plantes.

During the holidays the neighbour waters our plants.

Informally, to celebrate with a drink: *on va arroser ça.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

arroser comes from Late Latin *arrōsāre* “to bedew”, built on Latin *rōs* “dew” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: arroser*
- *Say it: arroser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *arroser*
- *Recall:* say the French for to garden, then the French for to sow, then say *arroser* again

Before you move on

What does arroser mean? ("To water (plants)".) Say it once more.

503.5 l'arrosoir — watering can

Before the new one: say the French for to sow, then the French for to water.

You'll want to know: l'arrosoir

l'arrosoir — "watering can".

L'enfant remplit l'arrosoir au robinet.

The child fills the watering can at the tap.

Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'arrosoir is built on *arroser* "to water" with *-oir*, the ending for a tool; *arroser* goes back to Latin *rōs* "dew" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arrosoir*
- *Say it: l'arrosoir*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'arrosoir*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sow, then the French for to water, then say *l'arrosoir* again

Before you move on

What does l'arrosoir mean? ("Watering can".) Say it once more.

Chapter 504

À la salle

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about working out at the gym.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 504: I can talk about working out at the gym.*

504.1 la musculation — weight training, bodybuilding

> Before the new one: say the French for to water, then the French for watering can.

You'll want to know: la musculation

la musculation — "weight training, bodybuilding".

> Je fais de la musculation deux fois par semaine.
>
> *I do weight training twice a week.*

Informally *la muscu*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la musculation is built on *muscle*, a learned borrowing from Latin *musculus* "a little mouse, a muscle", from *mūs* "mouse" (Lewis &

Short): a moving muscle looked like a mouse under the skin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la musculation*
- *Say it: la musculation*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la musculation*
- *Recall:* say the French for to water, then the French for watering can, then say *la musculation* again

Before you move on

What does la musculation mean? ("Weight training, bodybuilding".) Say it once more.

504.2 l'haltère — dumbbell, weight

Before the new one: say the French for watering can, then the French for weight training.

You'll want to know: l'haltère

l'haltère — "dumbbell, weight".

Il soulève des haltères devant le miroir.

He lifts dumbbells in front of the mirror.

Masculine: *un haltère*. The *h* is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'haltère comes, through Latin, from Greek *haltēres*, weights that athletes held while jumping, built on *hállesthai* "to jump".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'haltère*
- *Say it: l'haltère*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'haltère*
- *Recall:* say the French for watering can, then the French for weight training, then say *l'haltère* again

Before you move on

What does l'haltère mean? ("Dumbbell, weight".) Say it once more.

504.3 étirer — to stretch; (s'étirer) to stretch (oneself)

Before the new one: say the French for weight training, then the French for dumbbell.

You'll want to know: étirer

étirer — "to stretch; (s'étirer) to stretch (oneself)".

Après le sport, je m'étire pendant dix minutes.

After sport I stretch for ten minutes.

Mostly reflexive for the body: *s'étirer*. *Un étirement* — a stretch.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étirer is built from *é-* and *tirer* "to pull". The origin of *tirer* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *étirer*
- *Say it:* *étirer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *étirer*
- *Recall:* say the French for weight training, then the French for dumbbell, then say *étirer* again

Before you move on

What does étirer mean? ("To stretch; (s'étirer) to stretch (oneself)".) Say it once more.

504.4 la sueur — sweat

Before the new one: say the French for dumbbell, then the French for to stretch.

You'll want to know: la sueur

la sueur — "sweat".

Après une heure de course, il était tout en sueur.

After an hour's running he was dripping with sweat.

En sueur — sweating.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la sueur is inherited, through Old French *suor*, from Latin *sūdor* "sweat" (EtymDB), related to *sūdāre* "to sweat" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sueur*
- *Say it: la sueur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la sueur*
- *Recall:* say the French for dumbbell, then the French for to stretch, then say *la sueur* again

Before you move on

What does la sueur mean? (“Sweat”.) Say it once more.

504.5 échauffer — to warm up; (s’échauffer) to warm up (before sport)

Before the new one: say the French for to stretch, then the French for sweat.

You’ll want to know: échauffer

échauffer — “to warm up; (s’échauffer) to warm up (before sport)”.

Les joueurs s’échauffent avant le match.

The players warm up before the match.

Mostly reflexive in sport: *s’échauffer*. *L’échauffement* — the warm-up.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

échauffer is inherited from Old French *eschaufer* (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *excalefāre*, a form of Latin *calefacere* “to make warm”, built on *calēre* “to be warm” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *échauffer*
- *Say it:* *échauffer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *échauffer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to stretch, then the French for sweat, then say *échauffer* again

Before you move on

What does échauffer mean? ("To warm up; (s'échauffer) to warm up (before sport)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 505

Sur le terrain

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about what happens during a match.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 505: I can talk about what happens during a match.*

505.1 l'arbitre — referee, umpire

> Before the new one: say the French for sweat, then the French for to warm up.

You'll want to know: l'arbitre

l'arbitre — "referee, umpire".

> L'arbitre a donné un carton rouge.
>
> *The referee gave a red card.*

The same form for a man and a woman: *un arbitre*, *une arbitre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'arbitre is a learned borrowing from Latin *arbiter* "a witness, a judge" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'arbitre*
- *Say it: l'arbitre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'arbitre*
- *Recall:* say the French for sweat, then the French for to warm up, then say *l'arbitre* again

Before you move on

What does l'arbitre mean? ("Referee, umpire".) Say it once more.

505.2 le sifflet — whistle

Before the new one: say the French for to warm up, then the French for referee.

You'll want to know: le sifflet

le sifflet — "whistle".

Au coup de sifflet, les joueurs sont sortis.

At the whistle, the players went off.

Le coup de sifflet final — the final whistle.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le sifflet is built on *siffler* "to whistle", which goes back to Late Latin *sīfilāre*, a form of Latin *sībilāre* "to hiss, to whistle" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sifflet*
- *Say it: le sifflet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sifflet*
- *Recall:* say the French for to warm up, then the French for referee, then say *le sifflet* again

Before you move on

What does le sifflet mean? (“Whistle”.) Say it once more.

505.3 siffler — to whistle; to boo

Before the new one: say the French for referee, then the French for whistle.

You’ll want to know: siffler

siffler — “to whistle; to boo”.

Le public a sifflé l’équipe après la défaite.

The crowd booed the team after the defeat.

In France, a crowd that whistles is booing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

siffler is inherited from Late Latin *sīfilāre*, a form of Latin *sībilāre* “to hiss, to whistle” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: siffler*
- *Say it: siffler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *siffler*
- *Recall:* say the French for referee, then the French for whistle, then say *siffler* again

Before you move on

What does siffler mean? ("To whistle; to boo".) Say it once more.

505.4 le terrain — pitch, ground; plot of land

Before the new one: say the French for whistle, then the French for to whistle.

You'll want to know: le terrain

le terrain — "pitch, ground; plot of land".

Les joueurs entrent sur le terrain.

The players come onto the pitch.

Un terrain de foot — a football pitch. Also a plot: *acheter un terrain.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le terrain is inherited from Latin *terrēnum* "land, ground" (EtymDB), from *terra* "earth" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le terrain*
- *Say it: le terrain*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le terrain*
- *Recall:* say the French for whistle, then the French for to whistle, then say *le terrain* again

Before you move on

What does le terrain mean? ("Pitch, ground; plot of land".) Say it once more.

505.5 marquer — to score; to mark

Before the new one: say the French for to whistle, then the French for pitch.

You'll want to know: marquer

marquer — "to score; to mark".

Elle a marqué deux buts dans le match.

She scored two goals in the match.

Marquer un but — to score a goal. Also to note down: *marquer une adresse.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

marquer is built on *marque* "a mark, a sign", a word of Germanic origin related to English *mark*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: marquer*
- *Say it: marquer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *marquer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to whistle, then the French for pitch, then say *marquer* again

Before you move on

What does marquer mean? ("To score; to mark".) Say it once more.

505.6 Retour sur les chapitres 498–505

Say the French for climbing and to climb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- climbing, to climb, water bottle, torch, campfire
- board game, dice, pawn, chessboard, to cheat
- belote, to deal, to bet, bet, chance
- to collect, collector, scale model, model-making, to put together
- blurred, sharp, snapshot, to frame, tripod
- gardening, to garden, to sow, to water, watering can
- weight training, dumbbell, to stretch, sweat, to warm up
- referee, whistle, to whistle, pitch, to score

Before you move on

Climbing? (**l'escalade**.) To climb? (**grimper**.) Water bottle? (**la gourde**.) Torch? (**la lampe de poche**.) Campfire? (**le feu de camp**.) Board game? (**le jeu de société**.) Dice? (**le dé**.) Pawn?

(**le pion**.) Chessboard? (**l'échiquier**.) To cheat? (**tricher**.) Belote? (**la belote**.) To deal? (**distribuer**.) To bet? (**parier**.) Bet? (**le pari**.) Chance? (**le hasard**.) To collect? (**collectionner**.) Collector? (**le collectionneur**.) Scale model? (**la maquette**.) Model-making? (**le modélisme**.) To put together? (**assembler**.) Blurred? (**flou**.) Sharp? (**net**.) Snapshot? (**le cliché**.) To frame? (**cadrer**.) Tripod? (**le trépied**.) Gardening? (**le jardinage**.) To garden? (**jardiner**.) To sow? (**semer**.) To water? (**arroser**.) Watering can? (**l'arrosoir**.) Weight training? (**la musculation**.) Dumbbell? (**l'haltère**.) To stretch? (**étirer**.) Sweat? (**la sueur**.) To warm up? (**échauffer**.) Referee? (**l'arbitre**.) Whistle? (**le sifflet**.) To whistle? (**siffler**.) Pitch? (**le terrain**.) To score? (**marquer**.)

Chapter 506

Le résultat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about results and rankings.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 506: I can talk about results and rankings.*

506.1 le match nul — draw, tie (in sport)

> Before the new one: say the French for pitch, then the French for to score.

You'll want to know: le match nul

le match nul — "draw, tie (in sport)".

> Les deux équipes ont fait match nul.
>
> *The two teams drew.*

Faire match nul — to draw.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le match nul joins *match*, borrowed from English, and *nul* "null, none", from Latin *nūllus* "not any" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le match nul*
- *Say it: le match nul*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le match nul*
- *Recall:* say the French for pitch, then the French for to score, then say *le match nul* again

Before you move on

What does le match nul mean? ("Draw, tie (in sport)".) Say it once more.

506.2 le classement — ranking, league table

Before the new one: say the French for to score, then the French for draw.

You'll want to know: le classement

le classement — "ranking, league table".

Notre équipe est troisième au classement.

Our team is third in the league.

Built on *classer* "to sort, to rank".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le classement is built on *classer* "to rank", from *classe*, a learned borrowing from Latin *classis* "a class, a division" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le classement*
- *Say it: le classement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le classement*
- *Recall:* say the French for to score, then the French for draw, then say *le classement* again

Before you move on

What does le classement mean? (“Ranking, league table”.) Say it once more.

506.3 éliminer — to knock out, to eliminate

Before the new one: say the French for draw, then the French for ranking.

You’ll want to know: éliminer

éliminer — “to knock out, to eliminate”.

Notre équipe a été éliminée en demi-finale.

Our team was knocked out in the semi-final.

Passive in sport: *être éliminé*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

éliminer is a learned borrowing from Latin *ēlīmināre* “to turn out of doors” (EtymDB), built on *līmen* “threshold” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *éliminer*
- *Say it:* *éliminer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *éliminer*
- *Recall:* say the French for draw, then the French for ranking, then say *éliminer* again

Before you move on

What does éliminer mean? ("To knock out, to eliminate".) Say it once more.

506.4 qualifier — (se qualifier) to qualify; to describe as

Before the new one: say the French for ranking, then the French for to knock out.

You'll want to know: qualifier

qualifier — "(se qualifier) to qualify; to describe as".

L'équipe s'est qualifiée pour la finale.

The team qualified for the final.

Reflexive in sport: *se qualifier pour*. Also to describe: *qualifier quelqu'un de menteur*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

qualifier is a learned borrowing from Medieval Latin *quālificāre*, built from *quālis* "of what kind" and *facere* "to make" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: qualifier*
- *Say it: qualifier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *qualifier*
- *Recall:* say the French for ranking, then the French for to knock out, then say *qualifier* again

Before you move on

What does qualifier mean? ("(se qualifier) to qualify; to describe as".) Say it once more.

506.5 le vainqueur — winner, victor

Before the new one: say the French for to knock out, then the French for (se qualifier) to qualify.

You'll want to know: le vainqueur

le vainqueur — "winner, victor".

Le vainqueur du match jouera la finale.

The winner of the match will play in the final.

Traditionally the same form for a woman: *elle est sortie vainqueur*; *la vainqueure* is also found today, especially in Québec.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le vainqueur is built on *vaincre* "to defeat", which is inherited from Latin *vincere* "to conquer" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le vainqueur*
- *Say it:* *le vainqueur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le vainqueur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to knock out, then the French for (se qualifier) to qualify, then say *le vainqueur* again

Before you move on

What does le vainqueur mean? (“Winner, victor”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 507

Le tournoi

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about tournaments and winners.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 507: I can talk about tournaments and winners.*

507.1 le tournoi — tournament

Before the new one: say the French for (se qualifier) to qualify, then the French for winner.

You'll want to know: le tournoi

le tournoi — "tournament".

Notre école organise un tournoi de basket.

Our school is organising a basketball tournament.

In the Middle Ages, a contest between knights.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le tournoi is built on *tournoyer* "to wheel about", from *tourner* "to turn", which comes from Latin *tornāre* "to turn on a lathe" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tournoi*
- *Say it: le tournoi*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le tournoi*
- *Recall:* say the French for (se qualifier) to qualify, then the French for winner, then say *le tournoi* again

Before you move on

What does le tournoi mean? ("Tournament".) Say it once more.

507.2 la médaille — medal

Before the new one: say the French for winner, then the French for tournament.

You'll want to know: la médaille

la médaille — "medal".

Elle a gagné une médaille d'argent.

She won a silver medal.

Le revers de la médaille — the other side of the coin.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la médaille was borrowed from Italian *medaglia* (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *metallum* "metal, a mine", from Greek *métallon*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la médaille*
- *Say it: la médaille*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la médaille*
- *Recall:* say the French for winner, then the French for tournament, then say *la médaille* again

Before you move on

What does la médaille mean? (“Medal”.) Say it once more.

507.3 le podium — podium

Before the new one: say the French for tournament, then the French for medal.

You’ll want to know: le podium

le podium — “podium”.

Trois athlètes français sont montés sur le podium.

Three French athletes went up on the podium.

Said *po-dyom*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le podium is a learned borrowing from Latin *podium* “a raised platform” (EtymDB), from Greek *pódion* “a little foot, a base”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le podium*
- *Say it: le podium*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le podium*
- *Recall:* say the French for tournament, then the French for medal, then say *le podium* again

Before you move on

What does le podium mean? ("Podium".) Say it once more.

507.4 le champion — champion

Before the new one: say the French for medal, then the French for podium.

You'll want to know: le champion

le champion — "champion".

Il est champion de natation de sa région.

He is the swimming champion of his region.

A woman is *la championne*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le champion is inherited from Medieval Latin *campiō* "a fighter in a duel" (EtymDB), a Germanic word built on the word for a battlefield, related to Latin *campus* "field".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le champion*
- *Say it: le champion*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le champion*
- *Recall:* say the French for medal, then the French for podium, then say *le champion* again

Before you move on

What does le champion mean? ("Champion".) Say it once more.

507.5 affronter — to face, to take on

Before the new one: say the French for podium, then the French for champion.

You'll want to know: affronter

affronter — "to face, to take on".

Demain, notre équipe affronte les champions.

Tomorrow our team takes on the champions.

S'affronter — to face each other.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

affronter comes from Old French *afronter* "to face" (EtymDB), built on *front* "forehead", from Latin *frōns* (Lewis & Short): to stand forehead to forehead.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *affronter*
- *Say it:* *affronter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *affronter*
- *Recall:* say the French for podium, then the French for champion, then say *affronter* again

Before you move on

What does affronter mean? (“To face, to take on”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 508

La course

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about races and runners.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 508: I can talk about races and runners.*

508.1 le coureur — runner; rider (in a race)

> Before the new one: say the French for champion, then the French for to face.

You'll want to know: le coureur

le coureur — "runner; rider (in a race)".

> Le coureur a battu son propre record.
>
> *The runner beat his own record.*

A woman is *la coureuse*. Also a cyclist in a race: *un coureur cycliste*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le coureur is built on *courir* "to run", inherited from Latin *currere* "to run" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le coureur*
- *Say it: le coureur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le coureur*
- *Recall:* say the French for champion, then the French for to face, then say *le coureur* again

Before you move on

What does le coureur mean? ("Runner; rider (in a race)".) Say it once more.

508.2 la ligne d'arrivée — finishing line

Before the new one: say the French for to face, then the French for runner.

You'll want to know: la ligne d'arrivée

la ligne d'arrivée — "finishing line".

Elle a franchi la ligne d'arrivée en premier.

She crossed the finishing line first.

The start is *la ligne de départ*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la ligne d'arrivée joins *ligne*, from Latin *līnea* "a line", and *arrivée*, built on *arriver*, from Vulgar Latin *arrīpāre* "to come to the shore", built on *rīpa* "bank" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la ligne d'arrivée*
- *Say it: la ligne d'arrivée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la ligne d'arrivée*
- *Recall:* say the French for to face, then the French for runner, then say *la ligne d'arrivée* again

Before you move on

What does la ligne d'arrivée mean? ("Finishing line".) Say it once more.

508.3 le marathon — marathon

Before the new one: say the French for runner, then the French for finishing line.

You'll want to know: le marathon

le marathon — "marathon".

Mon père a couru son premier marathon à cinquante ans.

My father ran his first marathon at fifty.

Also a long, tiring task: *un marathon de réunions.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le marathon takes its name from a Greek town (EtymDB), whose own name comes from Greek *márathon* "fennel"; the race recalls a runner's long journey from there.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le marathon*
- *Say it: le marathon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le marathon*
- *Recall:* say the French for runner, then the French for finishing line, then say *le marathon* again

Before you move on

What does le marathon mean? ("Marathon".) Say it once more.

508.4 le relais — relay; relay race

Before the new one: say the French for finishing line, then the French for marathon.

You'll want to know: le relais

le relais — "relay; relay race".

Notre équipe a gagné le relais quatre fois cent mètres.

Our team won the four by one hundred metres relay.

Prendre le relais — to take over.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le relais comes from Old French *relaier* "to leave behind" (EtymDB), built from *re-* and *laier* "to leave": fresh horses were left waiting along the road.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le relais*
- *Say it: le relais*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le relais*
- *Recall:* say the French for finishing line, then the French for marathon, then say *le relais* again

Before you move on

What does le relais mean? ("Relay; relay race".) Say it once more.

508.5 chronométrer — to time (with a stopwatch)

Before the new one: say the French for marathon, then the French for relay.

You'll want to know: chronométrer

chronométrer — "to time (with a stopwatch)".

L'entraîneur chronomètre chaque coureur.

The coach times each runner.

Un chronomètre, informally *un chrono* — a stopwatch.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

chronométrer is built on *chronomètre* "stopwatch", a learned word made from Greek *khrónos* "time" and *métron* "measure".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *chronométrer*
- *Say it:* *chronométrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *chronométrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for marathon, then the French for relay, then say *chronométrer* again

Before you move on

What does chronométrer mean? ("To time (with a stopwatch)".)
Say it once more.

Chapter 509

Dans l'eau

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about swimming, diving and rowing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 509: I can talk about swimming, diving and rowing.*

509.1 plonger — to dive

> Before the new one: say the French for relay, then the French for to time.

You'll want to know: plonger

plonger — "to dive".

> Les enfants plongent du haut du rocher.
>
> *The children dive off the top of the rock.*

Spelling: *nous plongeons*. *La plongée* — scuba diving.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

plonger is inherited from Old French *plongier* (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *plumbicāre* "to sink like lead", built on *plumbum* "lead" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: plonger*
- *Say it: plonger*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *plonger*
- *Recall:* say the French for relay, then the French for to time, then say *plonger* again

Before you move on

What does plonger mean? ("To dive".) Say it once more.

509.2 le plongeon — dive

Before the new one: say the French for to time, then the French for to dive.

You'll want to know: le plongeon

le plongeon — "dive".

Il a fait un beau plongeon dans la piscine.

He did a nice dive into the pool.

Faire un plongeon — to dive in.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le plongeon is built on *plonger* "to dive" (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *plumbicāre* "to sink like lead", built on *plumbum* "lead" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le plongeon*
- *Say it: le plongeon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le plongeon*
- *Recall:* say the French for to time, then the French for to dive, then say *le plongeon* again

Before you move on

What does le plongeon mean? (“Dive”.) Say it once more.

509.3 le maillot de bain — swimsuit, swimming trunks

Before the new one: say the French for to dive, then the French for dive.

You’ll want to know: le maillot de bain

le maillot de bain — “swimsuit, swimming trunks”.

J’ai oublié mon maillot de bain à l’hôtel.

I left my swimsuit at the hotel.

Often *le maillot* alone.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le maillot de bain joins *maillot*, built on *maille* “a stitch, a mesh”, from Latin *macula* “a spot, a mesh”, and *bain* “bath”, from Latin *balneum* (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le maillot de bain*
- *Say it: le maillot de bain*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le maillot de bain*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dive, then the French for dive, then say *le maillot de bain* again

Before you move on

What does le maillot de bain mean? ("Swimsuit, swimming trunks".) Say it once more.

509.4 la brasse — breaststroke

Before the new one: say the French for dive, then the French for swimsuit.

You'll want to know: la brasse

la brasse — "breaststroke".

Ma grand-mère nage la brasse tous les matins.

My grandmother swims breaststroke every morning.

Front crawl is *le crawl*; backstroke is *le dos crawlé*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la brasse is inherited from Latin *bracchia* "arms" (EtymDB), the plural of *bracchium* "arm" (Lewis & Short): first the span of two outstretched arms.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la brasse*
- *Say it: la brasse*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la brasse*
- *Recall:* say the French for dive, then the French for swimsuit, then say *la brasse* again

Before you move on

What does la brasse mean? (“Breaststroke”.) Say it once more.

509.5 ramer — to row

Before the new one: say the French for swimsuit, then the French for breaststroke.

You’ll want to know: ramer

ramer — “to row”.

Nous avons ramé jusqu’à l’île.

We rowed to the island.

Informally, to struggle: *j’ai ramé pour trouver un appartement.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ramer is linked to *rame* “oar”. EtymDB traces it to Old French *raim* “branch”, from Latin *rāmus* “a branch”; Latin *rēmus* “an oar” (Lewis & Short) probably shaped the sense, and the origin is not fully settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ramer*
- *Say it:* *ramer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *ramer*
- *Recall:* say the French for swimsuit, then the French for breaststroke, then say *ramer* again

Before you move on

What does ramer mean? (“To row”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 510

Glace et neige

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about skating and sledging.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 510: I can talk about skating and sledging.*

510.1 le patin — skate

> Before the new one: say the French for breaststroke, then the French for to row.

You'll want to know: le patin

le patin — "skate".

> J'ai reçu des patins pour mon anniversaire.
>
> *I got skates for my birthday.*

Le patin à glace — ice skating; *le patin à roulettes* — roller skating.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le patin is built on *patte* "paw, foot" with *-in* (EtymDB); the origin of *patte* is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le patin*
- *Say it: le patin*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le patin*
- *Recall:* say the French for breaststroke, then the French for to row, then say *le patin* again

Before you move on

What does le patin mean? ("Skate".) Say it once more.

510.2 patiner — to skate

Before the new one: say the French for to row, then the French for skate.

You'll want to know: patiner

patiner — "to skate".

L'hiver, nous patinons sur le lac gelé.

In winter we skate on the frozen lake.

Of wheels: to spin: *la voiture patine.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

patiner is built on *patin* "skate", from *patte* "paw", whose origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: patiner*
- *Say it: patiner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *patiner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to row, then the French for skate, then say *patiner* again

Before you move on

What does patiner mean? ("To skate".) Say it once more.

510.3 la luge — sledge, sled

Before the new one: say the French for skate, then the French for to skate.

You'll want to know: la luge

la luge — "sledge, sled".

Les enfants font de la luge sur la colline.

The children are sledging on the hill.

Faire de la luge — to go sledging. In Québec *la traîne sauvage*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la luge came into French from the dialects of the Alps. It is usually traced to a Gaulish word; the origin is not fully settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la luge*
- *Say it: la luge*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la luge*
- *Recall:* say the French for skate, then the French for to skate, then say *la luge* again

Before you move on

What does la luge mean? ("Sledge, sled".) Say it once more.

510.4 la patinoire — ice rink

Before the new one: say the French for to skate, then the French for sledge.

You'll want to know: la patinoire

la patinoire — "ice rink".

Le samedi, la patinoire est pleine de monde.

On Saturdays the ice rink is crowded.

Informally, a very icy road: *la route est une patinoire.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la patinoire is built on *patiner* "to skate" with *-oire*, the ending for a place.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la patinoire*
- *Say it: la patinoire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la patinoire*
- *Recall:* say the French for to skate, then the French for sledge, then say *la patinoire* again

Before you move on

What does la patinoire mean? ("Ice rink".) Say it once more.

510.5 la piste — slope, run; track

Before the new one: say the French for sledge, then the French for ice rink.

You'll want to know: la piste

la piste — "slope, run; track".

Cette piste noire est trop difficile pour moi.

This black run is too difficult for me.

Also a running track, a dance floor, or a clue: *une bonne piste*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la piste was borrowed from Italian *pista* "a beaten track" (EtymDB), built on *pistare* "to pound", which goes back to Latin *pinsere* "to pound" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la piste*
- *Say it:* *la piste*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la piste*
- *Recall:* say the French for sledge, then the French for ice rink, then say *la piste* again

Before you move on

What does la piste mean? (“Slope, run; track”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 511

Instruments de musique

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about the instrument I play.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 511: I can talk about the instrument I play.*

511.1 la flûte — flute; recorder

> Before the new one: say the French for ice rink, then the French for slope.

You'll want to know: la flûte

la flûte — "flute; recorder".

> Au collège, tous les élèves apprennent la flûte.
>
> *At secondary school all the pupils learn the recorder.*

La flûte à bec — the recorder; *la flûte traversière* — the flute. Also a tall champagne glass.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la flûte goes back to Old French *flaüte* or *fleute*, probably from Old Occitan *flaüt* (EtymDB). The origin is not settled; it may imitate the sound.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la flûte*
- *Say it: la flûte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la flûte*
- *Recall:* say the French for ice rink, then the French for slope, then say *la flûte* again

Before you move on

What does la flûte mean? ("Flute; recorder".) Say it once more.

511.2 le violoncelle — cello

Before the new one: say the French for slope, then the French for flute.

You'll want to know: le violoncelle

le violoncelle — "cello".

Ma sœur joue du violoncelle depuis l'âge de huit ans.

My sister has played the cello since she was eight.

Jouer du violoncelle. The player is *le* or *la violoncelliste.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le violoncelle was borrowed from Italian *violoncello*, a small form of *violone* "a large viol", itself built on *viola.*

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le violoncelle*
- *Say it: le violoncelle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le violoncelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for slope, then the French for flute, then say *le violoncelle* again

Before you move on

What does le violoncelle mean? ("Cello".) Say it once more.

511.3 la trompette — trumpet

Before the new one: say the French for flute, then the French for cello.

You'll want to know: la trompette

la trompette — "trumpet".

Mon voisin joue de la trompette le dimanche matin.

My neighbour plays the trumpet on Sunday mornings.

Le or *la trompettiste* — the trumpeter.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la trompette is built on *trompe* "horn" with the small ending *-ette*; *trompe* comes from a Frankish word *trumpa*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la trompette*
- *Say it: la trompette*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la trompette*
- *Recall:* say the French for flute, then the French for cello, then say *la trompette* again

Before you move on

What does la trompette mean? (“Trumpet”.) Say it once more.

511.4 l’accordéon — accordion

Before the new one: say the French for cello, then the French for trumpet.

You’ll want to know: l’accordéon

l’accordéon — “accordion”.

Au bal du village, un vieil homme jouait de l’accordéon.

At the village dance an old man was playing the accordion.

Masculine. A typical sound of the French *bal musette*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l’accordéon was borrowed from German *Akkordion* (EtymDB), built on *Akkord* “chord”, which itself was borrowed from French *accord*; *accord* goes back to Latin *cor* “heart” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'accordéon*
- *Say it: l'accordéon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'accordéon*
- *Recall:* say the French for cello, then the French for trumpet, then say *l'accordéon* again

Before you move on

What does l'accordéon mean? ("Accordion".) Say it once more.

511.5 accorder — to tune (an instrument); to grant

Before the new one: say the French for trumpet, then the French for accordion.

You'll want to know: accorder

accorder — "to tune (an instrument); to grant".

Avant le concert, le guitariste accorde sa guitare.

Before the concert the guitarist tunes his guitar.

Also to grant: *accorder une pause*. *S'accorder* — to agree.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accorder is inherited from Vulgar Latin *accordāre* "to bring into agreement" (EtymDB), built on Latin *cor* "heart" (Lewis & Short): to make hearts agree.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *accorder*
- *Say it:* *accorder*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *accorder*
- *Recall:* say the French for trumpet, then the French for accordion, then say *accorder* again

Before you move on

What does accorder mean? (“To tune (an instrument); to grant”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 512

Chanter juste

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about singing and tunes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 512: I can talk about singing and tunes.*

512.1 la chorale — choir

> Before the new one: say the French for accordion, then the French for to tune.

You'll want to know: la chorale

la chorale — "choir".

> Je chante dans une chorale depuis trois ans.
>
> *I have been singing in a choir for three years.*

An amateur choir; *le chœur* is a choir too, also in a church.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la chorale comes from *choral*, built on Medieval Latin *chorālis*, from Latin *chorus* "a dance, a choir", a borrowing from Greek *khorós*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la chorale*
- *Say it: la chorale*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la chorale*
- *Recall:* say the French for accordion, then the French for to tune, then say *la chorale* again

Before you move on

What does la chorale mean? ("Choir".) Say it once more.

512.2 fredonner — to hum

Before the new one: say the French for to tune, then the French for choir.

You'll want to know: fredonner

fredonner — "to hum".

Elle fredonne une chanson en faisant la cuisine.

She hums a song while she cooks.

Humming with the lips closed or almost closed.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

fredonner is built on old *fredon* "a trill" (EtymDB), which is usually traced to Latin *fritinnīre* "to twitter" (Lewis & Short); the origin is not fully settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: fredonner*
- *Say it: fredonner*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *fredonner*
- *Recall:* say the French for to tune, then the French for choir, then say *fredonner* again

Before you move on

What does fredonner mean? ("To hum".) Say it once more.

512.3 siffloter — to whistle softly (a tune)

Before the new one: say the French for choir, then the French for to hum.

You'll want to know: siffloter

siffloter — "to whistle softly (a tune)".

Mon grand-père sifflote en marchant.

My grandfather whistles softly as he walks.

Built on *siffler* with *-oter*, which makes the action light and repeated.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

siffloter is built on *siffler* "to whistle" with *-oter*; *siffler* goes back to Latin *sībilāre* "to hiss, to whistle" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: siffloter*
- *Say it: siffloter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *siffloter*
- *Recall:* say the French for choir, then the French for to hum, then say *siffloter* again

Before you move on

What does siffloter mean? ("To whistle softly (a tune)".) Say it once more.

512.4 le refrain — chorus, refrain

Before the new one: say the French for to hum, then the French for to whistle softly.

You'll want to know: le refrain

le refrain — "chorus, refrain".

Tout le monde chante le refrain avec lui.

Everyone sings the chorus with him.

The verses are *les couplets*. *C'est toujours le même refrain* — it is always the same old story.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le refrain comes from Old French *refraindre* "to break off, to repeat" (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *refrangere*, built on *frangere* "to break" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le refrain*
- *Say it: le refrain*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le refrain*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hum, then the French for to whistle softly, then say *le refrain* again

Before you move on

What does le refrain mean? (“Chorus, refrain”.) Say it once more.

512.5 la mélodie — melody, tune

Before the new one: say the French for to whistle softly, then the French for chorus.

You’ll want to know: la mélodie

la mélodie — “melody, tune”.

Cette mélodie me rappelle mon enfance.

This tune reminds me of my childhood.

The adjective is *mélodieux* “tuneful”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la mélodie comes from Late Latin *melōdia*, a borrowing from Greek *melōidía* “singing”, built on *mélos* “song” and *ōidḗ* “ode”.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *la mélodie*
- *Say it:* *la mélodie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la mélodie*
- *Recall:* say the French for to whistle softly, then the French for chorus, then say *la mélodie* again

Before you move on

What does la mélodie mean? (“Melody, tune”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 513

L'orchestre

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about playing in an orchestra.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 513: I can talk about playing in an orchestra.*

513.1 l'orchestre — orchestra; stalls (in a theatre)

Before the new one: say the French for chorus, then the French for melody.

You'll want to know: l'orchestre

l'orchestre — "orchestra; stalls (in a theatre)".

> L'orchestre joue ce soir au théâtre.
>
> *The orchestra is playing at the theatre tonight.*

Masculine. In a theatre, *l'orchestre* is also the stalls.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'orchestre comes from Latin *orchēstra*, a borrowing from Greek *orkhḗstra* "the space where the chorus danced" (EtymDB), built on *orkheîsthai* "to dance".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'orchestre*
- *Say it: l'orchestre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'orchestre*
- *Recall:* say the French for chorus, then the French for melody, then say *l'orchestre* again

Before you move on

What does l'orchestre mean? ("Orchestra; stalls (in a theatre)".) Say it once more.

513.2 le chef d'orchestre — conductor (of an orchestra)

Before the new one: say the French for melody, then the French for orchestra.

You'll want to know: le chef d'orchestre

le chef d'orchestre — "conductor (of an orchestra)".

Le chef d'orchestre lève sa baguette.

The conductor raises his baton.

A woman is often *la cheffe d'orchestre* or *la chef d'orchestre*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le chef d'orchestre is "the head of the orchestra": *chef* is inherited from Latin *caput* "head" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chef d'orchestre*
- *Say it: le chef d'orchestre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chef d'orchestre*
- *Recall:* say the French for melody, then the French for orchestra, then say *le chef d'orchestre* again

Before you move on

What does le chef d'orchestre mean? ("Conductor (of an orchestra)".) Say it once more.

513.3 la partition — (musical) score, sheet music

Before the new one: say the French for orchestra, then the French for conductor.

You'll want to know: la partition

la partition — "(musical) score, sheet music".

Le pianiste a oublié sa partition à la maison.

The pianist left his sheet music at home.

Also a division, as in English *partition*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la partition is a learned borrowing from Latin *partītiō* "a division" (EtymDB), from *partīrī* "to divide", built on *pars* "part" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la partition*
- *Say it: la partition*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la partition*
- *Recall:* say the French for orchestra, then the French for conductor, then say *la partition* again

Before you move on

What does la partition mean? ("(musical) score, sheet music".) Say it once more.

513.4 la répétition — rehearsal; repetition

Before the new one: say the French for conductor, then the French for (musical) score.

You'll want to know: la répétition

la répétition — "rehearsal; repetition".

La répétition commence à vingt heures.

The rehearsal starts at eight o'clock.

Une répétition générale — a dress rehearsal.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la répétition is a learned borrowing from Latin *repetītiō* "a repeating" (EtymDB), from *repetere* "to go back to", built on *petere* "to seek" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la répétition*
- *Say it: la répétition*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la répétition*
- *Recall:* say the French for conductor, then the French for (musical) score, then say *la répétition* again

Before you move on

What does la répétition mean? ("Rehearsal; repetition".) Say it once more.

513.5 improviser — to improvise

Before the new one: say the French for (musical) score, then the French for rehearsal.

You'll want to know: improviser

improviser — "to improvise".

Les musiciens de jazz improvisent beaucoup.

Jazz musicians improvise a lot.

Also outside music: *on a improvisé un repas.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

improviser was borrowed from Italian *improvvisare* (EtymDB), from *improvviso*, from Latin *imprōvīsus* "unforeseen", built on *vidēre* "to see" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: improviser*
- *Say it: improviser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *improviser*
- *Recall:* say the French for (musical) score, then the French for rehearsal, then say *improviser* again

Before you move on

What does improviser mean? ("To improvise".) Say it once more.

513.6 Retour sur les chapitres 506–513

Say the French for draw and ranking.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- draw, ranking, to knock out, (se qualifier) to qualify, winner
- tournament, medal, podium, champion, to face
- runner, finishing line, marathon, relay, to time
- to dive, dive, swimsuit, breaststroke, to row
- skate, to skate, sledge, ice rink, slope
- flute, cello, trumpet, accordion, to tune
- choir, to hum, to whistle softly, chorus, melody
- orchestra, conductor, (musical) score, rehearsal, to improvise

Before you move on

Draw? (**le match nul**.) Ranking? (**le classement**.) To knock out? (**éliminer**.) (se qualifier) to qualify? (**qualifier**.) Winner? (**le vainqueur**.) Tournament? (**le tournoi**.) Medal? (**la médaille**.) Podium? (**le podium**.) Champion? (**le champion**.) To face? (**affronter**.) Runner? (**le coureur**.) Finishing line? (**la ligne d'arrivée**.) Marathon? (**le marathon**.) Relay? (**le relais**.) To time? (**chronométrer**.) To dive? (**plonger**.) Dive? (**le plongeon**.) Swimsuit? (**le maillot de bain**.) Breaststroke? (**la brasse**.) To row? (**ramer**.) Skate? (**le patin**.) To skate? (**patiner**.) Sledge? (**la luge**.) Ice rink? (**la patinoire**.) Slope? (**la piste**.) Flute? (**la flûte**.) Cello? (**le violoncelle**.) Trumpet? (**la trompette**.) Accordion? (**l'accordéon**.) To tune? (**accorder**.) Choir? (**la chorale**.) To hum? (**fredonner**.) To whistle softly? (**siffloter**.) Chorus? (**le refrain**.) Melody? (**la mélodie**.) Orchestra? (**l'orchestre**.) Conductor? (**le chef d'orchestre**.) (musical) score? (**la partition**.) Rehearsal? (**la répétition**.) To improvise? (**improviser**.)

Chapter 514

Au théâtre

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a theatre company and a show.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 514: I can talk about a theatre company and a show.*

514.1 la troupe — (theatre) company, troupe; troop

Before the new one: say the French for rehearsal, then the French for to improvise.

You'll want to know: la troupe

la troupe — "(theatre) company, troupe; troop".

> La troupe joue la même pièce depuis deux ans.
>
> *The company has been playing the same play for two years.*

Also a group of soldiers or animals.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la troupe is usually traced to Frankish *thorp* "a gathering, a village" (EtymDB), a Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la troupe*
- *Say it: la troupe*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la troupe*
- *Recall:* say the French for rehearsal, then the French for to improvise, then say *la troupe* again

Before you move on

What does la troupe mean? ("(theatre) company, troupe; troop".) Say it once more.

514.2 les coulisses — wings, backstage

Before the new one: say the French for to improvise, then the French for (theatre) company.

You'll want to know: les coulisses

les coulisses — "wings, backstage".

Avant le spectacle, les acteurs attendent dans les coulisses.

Before the show the actors wait in the wings.

Mostly plural. *Dans les coulisses* — behind the scenes.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

les coulisses comes from *coulisse* "a groove that something slides in", built on *couler* "to flow, to slide", from Latin *cōlāre* "to strain" (Lewis & Short): the sets slid in grooves at the side of the stage.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les coulisses*
- *Say it: les coulisses*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les coulisses*
- *Recall:* say the French for to improvise, then the French for (theatre) company, then say *les coulisses* again

Before you move on

What does les coulisses mean? ("Wings, backstage".) Say it once more.

514.3 le décor — set, scenery; decor

Before the new one: say the French for (theatre) company, then the French for wings.

You'll want to know: le décor

le décor — "set, scenery; decor".

Le décor représente une petite cuisine.

The set shows a small kitchen.

In a theatre, often plural: *les décors*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le décor is built on *décorer*, a learned borrowing from Latin *decorāre* "to adorn", from *decus* "ornament, honour" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le décor*
- *Say it: le décor*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le décor*
- *Recall:* say the French for (theatre) company, then the French for wings, then say *le décor* again

Before you move on

What does le décor mean? ("Set, scenery; decor".) Say it once more.

514.4 le costume — costume; suit

Before the new one: say the French for wings, then the French for set.

You'll want to know: le costume

le costume — "costume; suit".

Les costumes de la pièce sont magnifiques.

The costumes in the play are magnificent.

Also a man's suit: *un costume gris*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le costume was borrowed from Italian *costume* "custom, way of dressing" (EtymDB), which goes back to Latin *cōnsuētūdō* "habit", from *cōnsuēscere* "to get used to" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le costume*
- *Say it: le costume*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le costume*
- *Recall:* say the French for wings, then the French for set, then say *le costume* again

Before you move on

What does le costume mean? (“Costume; suit”.) Say it once more.

514.5 l’entracte — interval, intermission

Before the new one: say the French for set, then the French for costume.

You’ll want to know: l’entracte

l’entracte — “interval, intermission”.

Pendant l’entracte, nous avons bu un café.

During the interval we had a coffee.

Masculine. Literally between the acts.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l’entracte is built from *entre* “between”, from Latin *inter*, and *acte* “act”, a learned borrowing from Latin *āctus*, from *agere* “to do, to drive” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *l'entracte*
- *Say it:* *l'entracte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'entracte*
- *Recall:* say the French for set, then the French for costume, then say *l'entracte* again

Before you move on

What does l'entracte mean? ("Interval, intermission".) Say it once more.

Chapter 515

Sur scène

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about acting on stage.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 515: I can talk about acting on stage.*

515.1 le trac — stage fright, nerves

Before the new one: say the French for costume, then the French for interval.

You'll want to know: le trac

le trac — "stage fright, nerves".

Avant chaque concert, elle a le trac.

Before every concert she gets stage fright.

Avoir le trac — to have nerves, also before an exam.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

The origin of *le trac* is not settled; it appeared in French in the nineteenth century.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le trac*
- *Say it: le trac*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le trac*
- *Recall:* say the French for costume, then the French for interval, then say *le trac* again

Before you move on

What does le trac mean? ("Stage fright, nerves".) Say it once more.

515.2 la réplique — line (in a play); reply

Before the new one: say the French for interval, then the French for stage fright.

You'll want to know: la réplique

la réplique — "line (in a play); reply".

L'acteur a oublié sa réplique.

The actor forgot his line.

Also a copy: *une réplique de la statue.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la réplique is built on *répliquer* "to reply", from Latin *replicāre* "to fold back, to reply", built on *plicāre* "to fold" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la réplique*
- *Say it: la réplique*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la réplique*
- *Recall:* say the French for interval, then the French for stage fright, then say *la réplique* again

Before you move on

What does la réplique mean? ("Line (in a play); reply".) Say it once more.

515.3 interpréter — to perform, to play (a role); to interpret

Before the new one: say the French for stage fright, then the French for line.

You'll want to know: interpréter

interpréter — "to perform, to play (a role); to interpret".

Elle interprète le rôle de la mère.

She plays the role of the mother.

Also to interpret a dream or a text. An interpreter between languages is *un interprète*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

interpréter is a learned borrowing from Latin *interpretārī* "to explain, to translate" (EtymDB), from *interpres* "a go-between, an interpreter" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: interpréter*
- *Say it: interpréter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *interpréter*
- *Recall:* say the French for stage fright, then the French for line, then say *interpréter* again

Before you move on

What does interpréter mean? ("To perform, to play (a role); to interpret".) Say it once more.

515.4 le comédien — actor (especially on stage)

Before the new one: say the French for line, then the French for to perform.

You'll want to know: le comédien

le comédien — "actor (especially on stage)".

Ce comédien joue au théâtre et au cinéma.

This actor works in the theatre and in film.

A woman is *la comédienne*. Not only comic actors: any actor.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le comédien is built on *comédie* (EtymDB), from Latin *cōmoedia*, a borrowing from Greek *kōmōidía* "comedy".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le comédien*
- *Say it: le comédien*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le comédien*
- *Recall:* say the French for line, then the French for to perform, then say *le comédien* again

Before you move on

What does le comédien mean? (“Actor (especially on stage)”.) Say it once more.

515.5 les applaudissements — applause

Before the new one: say the French for to perform, then the French for actor.

You’ll want to know: les applaudissements

les applaudissements — “applause”.

> À la fin, il y a eu de longs applaudissements.
>
> *At the end there was long applause.*

Usually plural. The verb is *applaudir* “to clap”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

les applaudissements is built on *applaudir* “to clap”, a learned borrowing from Latin *applaudere* “to clap at”, built on *plaudere* “to clap” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: les applaudissements*
- *Say it: les applaudissements*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *les applaudissements*
- *Recall:* say the French for to perform, then the French for actor, then say *les applaudissements* again

Before you move on

What does les applaudissements mean? ("Applause".) Say it once more.

Chapter 516

Pinceaux et couleurs

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about painting and drawing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 516: I can talk about painting and drawing.*

516.1 le pinceau — paintbrush

> Before the new one: say the French for actor, then the French for applause.

You'll want to know: le pinceau

le pinceau — "paintbrush".

> L'artiste nettoie ses pinceaux après le travail.
>
> *The artist cleans her brushes after work.*

Plural *les pinceaux*. For walls, a bigger brush is *une brosse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le pinceau comes from Old French *pincel* (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *pēnicellus*, a form of Latin *pēniculus* "a brush" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le pinceau*
- *Say it: le pinceau*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le pinceau*
- *Recall:* say the French for actor, then the French for applause, then say *le pinceau* again

Before you move on

What does le pinceau mean? ("Paintbrush".) Say it once more.

516.2 la toile — canvas; cloth; web

Before the new one: say the French for applause, then the French for paintbrush.

You'll want to know: la toile

la toile — "canvas; cloth; web".

Le peintre a vendu sa plus grande toile.

The painter sold his biggest canvas.

Une toile d'araignée — a spider's web. *La Toile* — the Web.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la toile is inherited from Latin *tēla* "a web, a cloth on the loom" (EtymDB), related to *texere* "to weave" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la toile*
- *Say it: la toile*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la toile*
- *Recall:* say the French for applause, then the French for paintbrush, then say *la toile* again

Before you move on

What does la toile mean? (“Canvas; cloth; web”.) Say it once more.

516.3 l’aquarelle — watercolour

Before the new one: say the French for paintbrush, then the French for canvas.

You’ll want to know: l’aquarelle

l’aquarelle — “watercolour”.

Elle peint des paysages à l’aquarelle.

She paints landscapes in watercolour.

Feminine. Both the technique and a painting.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l’aquarelle was borrowed from Italian *acquarella*, built on *acqua* “water”, inherited from Latin *aqua* (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'aquarelle*
- *Say it: l'aquarelle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'aquarelle*
- *Recall:* say the French for paintbrush, then the French for canvas, then say *l'aquarelle* again

Before you move on

What does l'aquarelle mean? ("Watercolour".) Say it once more.

516.4 le chevalet — easel

Before the new one: say the French for canvas, then the French for watercolour.

You'll want to know: le chevalet

le chevalet — "easel".

Le peintre installe son chevalet au bord de la rivière.

The painter sets up his easel by the river.

Literally a little horse.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le chevalet is built on *cheval* "horse" with the small ending *-et* (EtymDB); *cheval* is inherited from Latin *caballus* "a horse" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le chevalet*
- *Say it: le chevalet*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le chevalet*
- *Recall:* say the French for canvas, then the French for watercolour, then say *le chevalet* again

Before you move on

What does le chevalet mean? ("Easel".) Say it once more.

516.5 esquisser — to sketch, to outline

Before the new one: say the French for watercolour, then the French for easel.

You'll want to know: esquisser

esquisser — "to sketch, to outline".

L'architecte a esquissé la maison en quelques minutes.

The architect sketched the house in a few minutes.

Une esquisse — a sketch. *Esquisser un sourire* — to give a faint smile.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

esquisser is built on *esquisse* "a sketch", borrowed from Italian *schizzo* (EtymDB), whose origin is usually traced to a Latin word for a sudden improvised poem.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *esquisser*
- *Say it:* *esquisser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *esquisser*
- *Recall:* say the French for watercolour, then the French for easel, then say *esquisser* again

Before you move on

What does esquisser mean? (“To sketch, to outline”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 517

Marbre et argile

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about sculpture.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 517: I can talk about sculpture.*

517.1 la sculpture — sculpture

> Before the new one: say the French for easel, then the French for to sketch.

You'll want to know: la sculpture

la sculpture — "sculpture".

> Le musée présente des sculptures modernes.
>
> *The museum is showing modern sculptures.*

The *p* is silent: *scul-ture*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la sculpture is a learned borrowing from Latin *sculptūra* (EtymDB), from *sculpere* "to carve in stone" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la sculpture*
- *Say it: la sculpture*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la sculpture*
- *Recall:* say the French for easel, then the French for to sketch, then say *la sculpture* again

Before you move on

What does la sculpture mean? ("Sculpture".) Say it once more.

517.2 sculpter — to sculpt, to carve

Before the new one: say the French for to sketch, then the French for sculpture.

You'll want to know: sculpter

sculpter — "to sculpt, to carve".

Il sculpte des animaux dans le bois.

He carves animals out of wood.

The *p* is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

sculpter was made in French from *sculpture* and *sculpteur*, which go back to Latin *sculpere* "to carve" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: sculpter*
- *Say it: sculpter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *sculpter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sketch, then the French for sculpture, then say *sculpter* again

Before you move on

What does sculpter mean? ("To sculpt, to carve".) Say it once more.

517.3 l'argile — clay

Before the new one: say the French for sculpture, then the French for to sculpt.

You'll want to know: l'argile

l'argile — "clay".

Les enfants font des petits pots en argile.

The children are making little pots out of clay.

Feminine. *La terre glaise* is a close word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'argile comes from Latin *argilla* (EtymDB), a borrowing from Greek *árgillos* "white clay", related to *argós* "white".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'argile*
- *Say it: l'argile*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'argile*
- *Recall:* say the French for sculpture, then the French for to sculpt, then say *l'argile* again

Before you move on

What does l'argile mean? ("Clay".) Say it once more.

517.4 le marbre — marble

Before the new one: say the French for to sculpt, then the French for clay.

You'll want to know: le marbre

le marbre — "marble".

Dans le hall, il y a un escalier en marbre.

In the hall there is a marble staircase.

Rester de marbre — to remain unmoved.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le marbre is inherited from Latin *marmor* "marble" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), from Greek *mármaros*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le marbre*
- *Say it: le marbre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le marbre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sculpt, then the French for clay, then say *le marbre* again

Before you move on

What does le marbre mean? (“Marble”.) Say it once more.

517.5 le sculpteur — sculptor

Before the new one: say the French for clay, then the French for marble.

You’ll want to know: le sculpteur

le sculpteur — “sculptor”.

Le sculpteur travaille dans un vieil atelier.

The sculptor works in an old workshop.

A woman is *la sculptrice* or *la sculpteure*. The *p* is silent.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le sculpteur is a learned borrowing from Latin *sculptor* “a carver” (EtymDB), from *sculpere* “to carve” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le sculpteur*
- *Say it: le sculpteur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le sculpteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for clay, then the French for marble, then say *le sculpteur* again

Before you move on

What does le sculpteur mean? (“Sculptor”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 518

Une exposition

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about going to an exhibition.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 518: I can talk about going to an exhibition.*

518.1 l'exposition — exhibition

Before the new one: say the French for marble, then the French for sculptor.

You'll want to know: l'exposition

l'exposition — "exhibition".

> Nous avons vu une exposition de photos.
>
> *We saw an exhibition of photos.*

Feminine. Informally *une expo*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'exposition is a learned borrowing from Latin *expositiō* "a setting out" (EtymDB), from *expōnere* "to put out", built on *pōnere* "to put" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'exposition*
- *Say it: l'exposition*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'exposition*
- *Recall:* say the French for marble, then the French for sculptor, then say *l'exposition* again

Before you move on

What does l'exposition mean? ("Exhibition".) Say it once more.

518.2 le vernissage — private view, opening (of an exhibition)

Before the new one: say the French for sculptor, then the French for exhibition.

You'll want to know: le vernissage

le vernissage — "private view, opening (of an exhibition)".

Elle nous a invités au vernissage de son exposition.

She invited us to the opening of her exhibition.

First the last coat of varnish, put on the day before the show.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le vernissage is built on *vernir* "to varnish" with *-age* (EtymDB): painters once varnished their works on the eve of the show. The origin of *vernis* is usually traced to Medieval Latin *veronix*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le vernissage*
- *Say it: le vernissage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le vernissage*
- *Recall:* say the French for sculptor, then the French for exhibition, then say *le vernissage* again

Before you move on

What does le vernissage mean? ("Private view, opening (of an exhibition)".) Say it once more.

518.3 la galerie — gallery; arcade

Before the new one: say the French for exhibition, then the French for private view.

You'll want to know: la galerie

la galerie — "gallery; arcade".

Cette galerie vend les tableaux de jeunes artistes.

This gallery sells paintings by young artists.

Une galerie marchande — a shopping arcade.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la galerie was borrowed from Italian *galleria*, from Medieval Latin *galeria*. The earlier origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la galerie*
- *Say it: la galerie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la galerie*
- *Recall:* say the French for exhibition, then the French for private view, then say *la galerie* again

Before you move on

What does la galerie mean? ("Gallery; arcade".) Say it once more.

518.4 l'œuvre — work (of art)

Before the new one: say the French for private view, then the French for gallery.

You'll want to know: l'œuvre

l'œuvre — "work (of art)".

Le musée garde les œuvres d'un grand peintre.

The museum holds the works of a great painter.

Feminine for a single work: *une œuvre d'art*. *Un chef-d'œuvre* — a masterpiece.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'œuvre is inherited from Latin *opera* "work, effort" (EtymDB), related to *opus* "a work" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'œuvre*
- *Say it: l'œuvre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'œuvre*
- *Recall:* say the French for private view, then the French for gallery, then say *l'œuvre* again

Before you move on

What does l'œuvre mean? ("Work (of art)".) Say it once more.

518.5 encadrer — to put in a frame; to supervise

Before the new one: say the French for gallery, then the French for work.

You'll want to know: encadrer

encadrer — "to put in a frame; to supervise".

J'ai fait encadrer une vieille photo de mes parents.

I had an old photo of my parents framed.

Also to supervise: *encadrer une équipe*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

encadrer is built from *en-* and *cadre* "frame", borrowed from Italian *quadro*, from Latin *quadrum* "a square" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *encadrer*
- *Say it:* *encadrer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *encadrer*
- *Recall:* say the French for gallery, then the French for work, then say *encadrer* again

Before you move on

What does encadrer mean? ("To put in a frame; to supervise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 519

Un bon roman

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe the plot of a novel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 519: I can describe the plot of a novel.*

519.1 le romancier — novelist

Before the new one: say the French for work, then the French for to put in a frame.

You'll want to know: le romancier

le romancier — "novelist".

Ce romancier écrit un livre par an.

This novelist writes a book a year.

A woman is *la romancière*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le romancier is built on *roman* "novel", from Old French *romanz*, a story told in the common Romance tongue rather than in Latin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le romancier*
- *Say it: le romancier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le romancier*
- *Recall:* say the French for work, then the French for to put in a frame, then say *le romancier* again

Before you move on

What does le romancier mean? ("Novelist".) Say it once more.

519.2 l'intrigue — plot (of a story); intrigue

Before the new one: say the French for to put in a frame, then the French for novelist.

You'll want to know: l'intrigue

l'intrigue — "plot (of a story); intrigue".

L'intrigue du livre se passe dans un petit village.

The plot of the book takes place in a small village.

Feminine. Also a secret scheme.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'intrigue was borrowed from Italian *intrigo* (EtymDB), from *intrigare*, from Latin *intrīcāre* "to entangle, to perplex" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'intrigue*
- *Say it: l'intrigue*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'intrigue*
- *Recall:* say the French for to put in a frame, then the French for novelist, then say *l'intrigue* again

Before you move on

What does l'intrigue mean? ("Plot (of a story); intrigue".) Say it once more.

519.3 le dénouement — ending, outcome (of a story)

Before the new one: say the French for novelist, then the French for plot.

You'll want to know: le dénouement

le dénouement — "ending, outcome (of a story)".

Je n'ai pas aimé le dénouement du film.

I did not like the ending of the film.

Literally the untying of the knot.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le dénouement is built on *dénouer* "to untie", from *dé-* and *nouer* "to tie", inherited from Latin *nōdāre*, from *nōdus* "a knot" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le dénouement*
- *Say it: le dénouement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le dénouement*
- *Recall:* say the French for novelist, then the French for plot, then say *le dénouement* again

Before you move on

What does le dénouement mean? ("Ending, outcome (of a story)".) Say it once more.

519.4 le rebondissement — twist, new development

Before the new one: say the French for plot, then the French for ending.

You'll want to know: le rebondissement

le rebondissement — "twist, new development".

Le roman est plein de rebondissements.

The novel is full of twists.

Built on *rebondir* "to bounce back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le rebondissement is built on *rebondir* "to bounce back", from *bondir* "to leap", which first meant "to resound" and goes back to Vulgar Latin *bombitīre*, from Latin *bombus* "a booming sound".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rebondissement*
- *Say it: le rebondissement*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le rebondissement*
- *Recall:* say the French for plot, then the French for ending, then say *le rebondissement* again

Before you move on

What does le rebondissement mean? (“Twist, new development”.) Say it once more.

519.5 captivant — gripping, captivating

Before the new one: say the French for ending, then the French for twist.

You’ll want to know: captivant

captivant — “gripping, captivating”.

J’ai lu un livre captivant pendant les vacances.

I read a gripping book during the holidays.

Built on *captiver* “to captivate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

captivant is the present participle of *captiver* “to captivate”, from Late Latin *captīvāre* “to take prisoner”, built on *captīvus* “a captive”, from *capere* “to take” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *captivant*
- *Say it:* *captivant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *captivant*
- *Recall:* say the French for ending, then the French for twist, then say *captivant* again

Before you move on

What does captivant mean? (“Gripping, captivating”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 520

Chez le libraire

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about browsing in a bookshop.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 520: I can talk about browsing in a bookshop.*

520.1 le libraire — bookseller

> Before the new one: say the French for twist, then the French for gripping.

You'll want to know: le libraire

le libraire — "bookseller".

> Le libraire m'a conseillé un bon roman.
>
> *The bookseller recommended a good novel to me.*

A woman is *la libraire*. A library is *une bibliothèque*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le libraire is a learned borrowing from Latin *librārius* "a copyist, a bookseller" (EtymDB), from *liber* "book" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le libraire*
- *Say it: le libraire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le libraire*
- *Recall:* say the French for twist, then the French for gripping, then say *le libraire* again

Before you move on

What does le libraire mean? ("Bookseller".) Say it once more.

520.2 le rayon — section (of a shop); shelf; ray

Before the new one: say the French for gripping, then the French for bookseller.

You'll want to know: le rayon

le rayon — "section (of a shop); shelf; ray".

Les livres pour enfants sont au rayon du fond.

The children's books are in the section at the back.

Also a ray: *un rayon de soleil.* That is a different word with the same form.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

This *rayon*, a shelf or a section, comes from Old French *ree* "honeycomb", a word of Germanic origin. *Rayon* "a ray" is a different word, from Latin *radius*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le rayon*
- *Say it: le rayon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le rayon*
- *Recall:* say the French for gripping, then the French for bookseller, then say *le rayon* again

Before you move on

What does le rayon mean? ("Section (of a shop); shelf; ray".) Say it once more.

520.3 feuilleter — to leaf through

Before the new one: say the French for bookseller, then the French for section.

You'll want to know: feuilleter

feuilleter — "to leaf through".

Elle feuillette un magazine dans la salle d'attente.

She leafs through a magazine in the waiting room.

Spelling: *je feuillette*, *nous feuilletons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

feuilleter is built on *feuille* "leaf, page" (EtymDB), inherited from Latin *folia*, the plural of *folium* "a leaf" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: feuilleter*
- *Say it: feuilleter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *feuilleter*
- *Recall:* say the French for bookseller, then the French for section, then say *feuilleter* again

Before you move on

What does feuilleter mean? ("To leaf through".) Say it once more.

520.4 le livre de poche — paperback

Before the new one: say the French for section, then the French for to leaf through.

You'll want to know: le livre de poche

le livre de poche — "paperback".

J'achète surtout des livres de poche : c'est moins cher.

I mostly buy paperbacks: they are cheaper.

En poche — in paperback.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le livre de poche is "a pocket book": *livre* is inherited from Latin *liber* "book" (Lewis & Short), and *poche* "pocket" is of Frankish origin.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le livre de poche*
- *Say it: le livre de poche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le livre de poche*
- *Recall:* say the French for section, then the French for to leaf through, then say *le livre de poche* again

Before you move on

What does le livre de poche mean? ("Paperback".) Say it once more.

520.5 dévorer — to devour

Before the new one: say the French for to leaf through, then the French for paperback.

You'll want to know: dévorer

dévorer — "to devour".

Ma fille dévore tous les romans de cette série.

My daughter devours every novel in this series.

Of food or books: *dévorer un livre* — to read it eagerly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dévorer is a learned borrowing from Latin *dēvorāre* "to swallow down", built on *vorāre* "to swallow" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dévorer*
- *Say it:* *dévorer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dévorer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to leaf through, then the French for paperback, then say *dévorer* again

Before you move on

What does dévorer mean? ("To devour".) Say it once more.

Chapter 521

Auteurs et lecteurs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about readers, heroes and signed books.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 521: I can talk about readers, heroes and signed books.*

521.1 le lecteur — reader; player (for discs)

> Before the new one: say the French for paperback, then the French for to devour.

You'll want to know: le lecteur

le lecteur — "reader; player (for discs)".

> Ce journal a beaucoup de lecteurs jeunes.
>
> *This newspaper has a lot of young readers.*

A woman is *la lectrice*. *Un lecteur de DVD* — a DVD player.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le lecteur is a learned borrowing from Latin *lēctor* "a reader" (EtymDB), from *legere* "to gather, to read" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le lecteur*
- *Say it: le lecteur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le lecteur*
- *Recall:* say the French for paperback, then the French for to devour, then say *le lecteur* again

Before you move on

What does le lecteur mean? ("Reader; player (for discs)".) Say it once more.

521.2 le narrateur — narrator

Before the new one: say the French for to devour, then the French for reader.

You'll want to know: le narrateur

le narrateur — "narrator".

Dans ce roman, le narrateur est un enfant.

In this novel the narrator is a child.

A woman is *la narratrice*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le narrateur is a learned borrowing from Latin *narrātor* "a storyteller" (EtymDB), from *narrāre* "to tell" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le narrateur*
- *Say it: le narrateur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le narrateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to devour, then the French for reader, then say *le narrateur* again

Before you move on

What does le narrateur mean? (“Narrator”.) Say it once more.

521.3 le héros — hero; main character

Before the new one: say the French for reader, then the French for narrator.

You’ll want to know: le héros

le héros — “hero; main character”.

Le héros du livre est un vieux marin.

The hero of the book is an old sailor.

The *h* is aspirated: *le héros*, *les héros* with no liaison.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le héros comes from Latin *hērōs*, a borrowing from Greek *hḗrōs* “a demigod, a hero” (EtymDB).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le héros*
- *Say it: le héros*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le héros*
- *Recall:* say the French for reader, then the French for narrator, then say *le héros* again

Before you move on

What does le héros mean? ("Hero; main character".) Say it once more.

521.4 la dédicace — signed message, inscription (in a book); dedication

Before the new one: say the French for narrator, then the French for hero.

You'll want to know: la dédicace

la dédicace — "signed message, inscription (in a book); dedication".

L'auteur a écrit une dédicace dans mon livre.

The author wrote an inscription in my book.

Une séance de dédicaces — a book signing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la dédicace is a learned borrowing from Latin *dēdicātiō* "a consecration", from *dēdicāre* "to dedicate" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la dédicace*
- *Say it: la dédicace*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la dédicace*
- *Recall:* say the French for narrator, then the French for hero, then say *la dédicace* again

Before you move on

What does la dédicace mean? ("Signed message, inscription (in a book); dedication".) Say it once more.

521.5 dédicacer — to sign (a book for someone)

Before the new one: say the French for hero, then the French for signed message.

You'll want to know: dédicacer

dédicacer — "to sign (a book for someone)".

L'écrivain dédicace ses livres à la librairie samedi.

The writer is signing his books at the bookshop on Saturday.

Spelling: *nous dédicaçons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

dédicacer is built on *dédicace*, a learned borrowing from Latin *dēdicātiō*, from *dēdicāre* "to dedicate" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: dédicacer*
- *Say it: dédicacer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *dédicacer*
- *Recall:* say the French for hero, then the French for signed message, then say *dédicacer* again

Before you move on

What does dédicacer mean? ("To sign (a book for someone)".) Say it once more.

521.6 Retour sur les chapitres 514–521

Say the French for (theatre) company and wings.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- (theatre) company, wings, set, costume, interval
- stage fright, line, to perform, actor, applause
- paintbrush, canvas, watercolour, easel, to sketch
- sculpture, to sculpt, clay, marble, sculptor
- exhibition, private view, gallery, work, to put in a frame
- novelist, plot, ending, twist, gripping
- bookseller, section, to leaf through, paperback, to devour
- reader, narrator, hero, signed message, to sign

Before you move on

(theatre) company? (**la troupe**.) Wings? (**les coulisses**.) Set? (**le décor**.) Costume? (**le costume**.) Interval? (**l'entracte**.) Stage

fright? (**le trac**.) Line? (**la réplique**.) To perform? (**interpréter**.) Actor? (**le comédien**.) Applause? (**les applaudissements**.) Paintbrush? (**le pinceau**.) Canvas? (**la toile**.) Watercolour? (**l'aquarelle**.) Easel? (**le chevalet**.) To sketch? (**esquisser**.) Sculpture? (**la sculpture**.) To sculpt? (**sculpter**.) Clay? (**l'argile**.) Marble? (**le marbre**.) Sculptor? (**le sculpteur**.) Exhibition? (**l'exposition**.) Private view? (**le vernissage**.) Gallery? (**la galerie**.) Work? (**l'œuvre**.) To put in a frame? (**encadrer**.) Novelist? (**le romancier**.) Plot? (**l'intrigue**.) Ending? (**le dénouement**.) Twist? (**le rebondissement**.) Gripping? (**captivant**.) Bookseller? (**le libraire**.) Section? (**le rayon**.) To leaf through? (**feuilleter**.) Paperback? (**le livre de poche**.) To devour? (**dévorer**.) Reader? (**le lecteur**.) Narrator? (**le narrateur**.) Hero? (**le héros**.) Signed message? (**la dédicace**.) To sign? (**dédicacer**.)

Chapter 522

Quel genre de livres ?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what kinds of books I like.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 522: I can say what kinds of books I like.*

522.1 la poésie — poetry

> Before the new one: say the French for signed message, then the French for to sign.

You'll want to know: la poésie

la poésie — "poetry".

> Mon père lit de la poésie le soir.
>
> *My father reads poetry in the evening.*

Un poème is a single poem.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la poésie comes from Latin *poēsis* (EtymDB), a borrowing from Greek *poíēsis* "a making, a poem".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la poésie*
- *Say it: la poésie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la poésie*
- *Recall:* say the French for signed message, then the French for to sign, then say *la poésie* again

Before you move on

What does la poésie mean? ("Poetry".) Say it once more.

522.2 la bande dessinée — comic book, comic strip

Before the new one: say the French for to sign, then the French for poetry.

You'll want to know: la bande dessinée

la bande dessinée — "comic book, comic strip".

Les adultes aussi lisent des bandes dessinées.

Adults read comics too.

Informally *la BD*. A big art form in France and Belgium.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la bande dessinée is "a drawn strip": *bande* is of Germanic origin, and *dessiner* comes from Italian *disegnare*, from Latin *dēsignāre* "to mark out", built on *signum* "a sign" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la bande dessinée*
- *Say it: la bande dessinée*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la bande dessinée*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sign, then the French for poetry, then say *la bande dessinée* again

Before you move on

What does la bande dessinée mean? ("Comic book, comic strip".) Say it once more.

522.3 le polar — crime novel, detective story (informal)

Before the new one: say the French for poetry, then the French for comic book.

You'll want to know: le polar

le polar — "crime novel, detective story (informal)".

En été, je lis surtout des polars.

In summer I mostly read crime novels.

Informal for *le roman policier*. Also a crime film.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le polar is a slang shortening of *(roman) policier* "detective (novel)" with the familiar ending *-ar* (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le polar*
- *Say it: le polar*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le polar*
- *Recall:* say the French for poetry, then the French for comic book, then say *le polar* again

Before you move on

What does le polar mean? ("Crime novel, detective story (informal)".) Say it once more.

522.4 la biographie — biography

Before the new one: say the French for comic book, then the French for crime novel.

You'll want to know: la biographie

la biographie — "biography".

Je lis la biographie d'un grand musicien.

I am reading the biography of a great musician.

Une autobiographie — an autobiography.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la biographie is a learned word built from Greek *bíos* "life" and *gráphein* "to write", by way of Medieval Greek *biographía*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la biographie*
- *Say it: la biographie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la biographie*
- *Recall:* say the French for comic book, then the French for crime novel, then say *la biographie* again

Before you move on

What does la biographie mean? ("Biography".) Say it once more.

522.5 le conte — tale, story

Before the new one: say the French for crime novel, then the French for biography.

You'll want to know: le conte

le conte — "tale, story".

Le soir, la mère lit un conte à ses enfants.

In the evening the mother reads her children a story.

Un conte de fées — a fairy tale.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le conte is built on *conter* "to tell", inherited from Latin *computāre* "to count, to reckon", built on *putāre* (Lewis & Short): to recount.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le conte*
- *Say it:* *le conte*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le conte*
- *Recall:* say the French for crime novel, then the French for biography, then say *le conte* again

Before you move on

What does le conte mean? (“Tale, story”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 523

Une série à suivre

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a series I am watching.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 523: I can talk about a series I am watching.*

523.1 l'épisode — episode

Before the new one: say the French for biography, then the French for tale.

You'll want to know: l'épisode

l'épisode — "episode".

> J'ai regardé trois épisodes hier soir.
>
> *I watched three episodes last night.*

Masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'épisode comes from Greek *epeisódion* "an added part" (EtymDB), built on *epí* "upon" and *eísodos* "an entrance".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'épisode*
- *Say it: l'épisode*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'épisode*
- *Recall:* say the French for biography, then the French for tale, then say *l'épisode* again

Before you move on

What does l'épisode mean? ("Episode".) Say it once more.

523.2 la saison — season

Before the new one: say the French for tale, then the French for episode.

You'll want to know: la saison

la saison — "season".

La deuxième saison de la série sort en mars.

The second season of the series comes out in March.

Also the seasons of the year, and *la haute saison* for tourism.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la saison is inherited from Latin *satiō*, *satiōnem* "a sowing" (EtymDB), from *serere* "to sow" (Lewis & Short): first the time for sowing.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la saison*
- *Say it: la saison*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la saison*
- *Recall:* say the French for tale, then the French for episode, then say *la saison* again

Before you move on

What does la saison mean? (“Season”.) Say it once more.

523.3 le suspense — suspense

Before the new one: say the French for episode, then the French for season.

You’ll want to know: le suspense

le suspense — “suspense”.

Ce film garde le suspense jusqu’à la fin.

This film keeps up the suspense to the end.

Said the English way or *sus-pense*. A different word from *en suspens* “pending”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le suspense was borrowed from English *suspense*, which goes back to Latin *suspendere* “to hang up”, built on *pendere* “to hang” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le suspense*
- *Say it: le suspense*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le suspense*
- *Recall:* say the French for episode, then the French for season, then say *le suspense* again

Before you move on

What does le suspense mean? ("Suspense".) Say it once more.

523.4 la plateforme — (streaming) platform; platform

Before the new one: say the French for season, then the French for suspense.

You'll want to know: la plateforme

la plateforme — "(streaming) platform; platform".

Cette série est disponible sur une plateforme.

This series is available on a streaming platform.

Also a station platform in some contexts, but that is usually *le quai*. Older spelling *plate-forme*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la plateforme is built from *plat* "flat" and *forme* "shape", from Latin *forma* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la plateforme*
- *Say it: la plateforme*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la plateforme*
- *Recall:* say the French for season, then the French for suspense, then say *la plateforme* again

Before you move on

What does la plateforme mean? ("(streaming) platform; platform".) Say it once more.

523.5 palpitant — thrilling, exciting

Before the new one: say the French for suspense, then the French for (streaming) platform.

You'll want to know: palpitant

palpitant — "thrilling, exciting".

Le dernier épisode était palpitant.

The last episode was thrilling.

Built on *palpiter* "to throb".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

palpitant is the present participle of *palpiter* "to throb", a learned borrowing from Latin *palpitāre* "to flutter, to throb", from *palpāre* "to touch softly" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: palpitant*
- *Say it: palpitant*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *palpitant*
- *Recall:* say the French for suspense, then the French for (streaming) platform, then say *palpitant* again

Before you move on

What does palpitant mean? (“Thrilling, exciting”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 524

En version originale

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about how a film is made and shown.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 524: I can talk about how a film is made and shown.*

524.1 la version originale — original-language version

> Before the new one: say the French for (streaming) platform, then the French for thrilling.

You'll want to know: la version originale

la version originale — "original-language version".

> Je préfère voir les films en version originale.
>
> *I prefer to watch films in the original language.*

Often *la VO*; *la VOST* has subtitles; *la VF* is the French dub.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la version originale joins *version*, from Medieval Latin *versiō* "a turning", from *vertere* "to turn", and *originale*, from Latin *orīgō*

"beginning", from *orīrī* "to rise" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la version originale*
- *Say it: la version originale*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la version originale*
- *Recall:* say the French for (streaming) platform, then the French for thrilling, then say *la version originale* again

Before you move on

What does la version originale mean? ("Original-language version".) Say it once more.

524.2 projeter — to screen (a film); to plan; to project

Before the new one: say the French for thrilling, then the French for original-language version.

You'll want to know: projeter

projeter — "to screen (a film); to plan; to project".

Le cinéma du quartier projette des films en version originale.

The local cinema screens films in the original language.

Spelling: *je projette*, *nous projetons*. Also to plan: *projeter un voyage*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

projeter comes from Old French *porjeter* "to throw forward", built on *jeter* "to throw", which goes back to Latin *iactāre*, from *iacere* "to throw" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: projeter*
- *Say it: projeter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *projeter*
- *Recall:* say the French for thrilling, then the French for original-language version, then say *projeter* again

Before you move on

What does projeter mean? ("To screen (a film); to plan; to project".) Say it once more.

524.3 le doublage — dubbing

Before the new one: say the French for original-language version, then the French for to screen.

You'll want to know: le doublage

le doublage — "dubbing".

Le doublage de ce dessin animé est très réussi.

The dubbing of this cartoon is very good.

Built on *doubler* "to dub".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le doublage is built on *doubler* with *-age*; *doubler* comes from *double*, from Latin *duplus* "twofold", built on *duo* "two" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le doublage*
- *Say it: le doublage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le doublage*
- *Recall:* say the French for original-language version, then the French for to screen, then say *le doublage* again

Before you move on

What does le doublage mean? ("Dubbing".) Say it once more.

524.4 le réalisateur — (film) director

Before the new one: say the French for to screen, then the French for dubbing.

You'll want to know: le réalisateur

le réalisateur — "(film) director".

Le réalisateur a présenté son film au public.

The director presented his film to the audience.

A woman is *la réalisatrice*. In a theatre, *le metteur en scène*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le réalisateur is built on *réaliser* "to make real", from *réel*, from Late Latin *reālis*, built on *rēs* "a thing" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le réalisateur*
- *Say it: le réalisateur*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le réalisateur*
- *Recall:* say the French for to screen, then the French for dubbing, then say *le réalisateur* again

Before you move on

What does le réalisateur mean? ("(film) director".) Say it once more.

524.5 le tournage — shooting, filming (of a film)

Before the new one: say the French for dubbing, then the French for (film) director.

You'll want to know: le tournage

le tournage — "shooting, filming (of a film)".

Le tournage a duré trois mois.

The filming lasted three months.

Tourner un film — to shoot a film.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le tournage is built on *tourner* with *-age* (EtymDB); *tourner* comes from Latin *tornāre* "to turn on a lathe" (Lewis & Short), and early cameras were cranked by hand.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tournage*
- *Say it: le tournage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le tournage*
- *Recall:* say the French for dubbing, then the French for (film) director, then say *le tournage* again

Before you move on

What does le tournage mean? ("Shooting, filming (of a film)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 525

Devant l'écran

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about watching television.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 525: I can talk about watching television.*

525.1 zapper — to channel-hop; to skip

> Before the new one: say the French for (film) director, then the French for shooting.

You'll want to know: zapper

zapper — "to channel-hop; to skip".

> Le soir, il zappe d'une chaîne à l'autre.
>
> *In the evening he flicks from one channel to another.*

Informally, to forget or skip: *j'ai zappé le rendez-vous.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

zapper was borrowed from English *zap* (EtymDB), an imitative word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: zapper*
- *Say it: zapper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *zapper*
- *Recall:* say the French for (film) director, then the French for shooting, then say *zapper* again

Before you move on

What does zapper mean? ("To channel-hop; to skip".) Say it once more.

525.2 la télécommande — remote control

Before the new one: say the French for shooting, then the French for to channel-hop.

You'll want to know: la télécommande

la télécommande — "remote control".

Personne ne trouve la télécommande.

Nobody can find the remote control.

Informally also *la zapette*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la télécommande is built from Greek *tēle* "far" and *commande* "command", which goes back, through *commander*, to Latin *commendāre* "to entrust", built on *mandāre* "to entrust, to order" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la télécommande*
- *Say it: la télécommande*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la télécommande*
- *Recall:* say the French for shooting, then the French for to channel-hop, then say *la télécommande* again

Before you move on

What does la télécommande mean? ("Remote control".) Say it once more.

525.3 l'émission — (television or radio) programme; emission

Before the new one: say the French for to channel-hop, then the French for remote control.

You'll want to know: l'émission

l'émission — "(television or radio) programme; emission".

Cette émission de cuisine passe tous les jeudis.

This cooking programme is on every Thursday.

Feminine. Also emissions: *les émissions de CO2*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'émission is a learned borrowing from Latin *ēmissiō* "a sending out" (EtymDB), from *ēmittere*, built on *mittere* "to send" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'émission*
- *Say it: l'émission*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'émission*
- *Recall:* say the French for to channel-hop, then the French for remote control, then say *l'émission* again

Before you move on

What does l'émission mean? ("(television or radio) programme; emission".) Say it once more.

525.4 le documentaire — documentary

Before the new one: say the French for remote control, then the French for (television or radio) programme.

You'll want to know: le documentaire

le documentaire — "documentary".

Hier, nous avons vu un documentaire sur les baleines.

Yesterday we watched a documentary about whales.

Also an adjective: *un film documentaire*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le documentaire is built on *document* (EtymDB), a learned borrowing from Latin *documentum* "a lesson, a proof", from *docēre* "to teach" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le documentaire*
- *Say it: le documentaire*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le documentaire*
- *Recall:* say the French for remote control, then the French for (television or radio) programme, then say *le documentaire* again

Before you move on

What does le documentaire mean? ("Documentary".) Say it once more.

525.5 rediffuser — to repeat, to rebroadcast

Before the new one: say the French for (television or radio) programme, then the French for documentary.

You'll want to know: rediffuser

rediffuser — "to repeat, to rebroadcast".

La chaîne rediffuse ce vieux film chaque été.

The channel repeats this old film every summer.

Une rediffusion — a repeat.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rediffuser is built from *re-* and *diffuser* "to broadcast", from Latin *diffundere* "to pour out, to spread", built on *fundere* "to pour" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rediffuser*
- *Say it: rediffuser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rediffuser*
- *Recall:* say the French for (television or radio) programme, then the French for documentary, then say *rediffuser* again

Before you move on

What does rediffuser mean? (“To repeat, to rebroadcast”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 526

Laver le linge

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about doing the washing.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 526: I can talk about doing the washing.*

526.1 la machine à laver — washing machine

> Before the new one: say the French for documentary, then the French for to repeat.

You'll want to know: la machine à laver

la machine à laver — "washing machine".

> La machine à laver tourne depuis une heure.
>
> *The washing machine has been running for an hour.*

Also *le lave-linge*. *Faire une machine* — to do a load of washing.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la machine à laver joins *machine*, a learned borrowing from Latin *māchina* "a device", and *laver* "to wash", inherited from Latin *lavāre* (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la machine à laver*
- *Say it: la machine à laver*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la machine à laver*
- *Recall:* say the French for documentary, then the French for to repeat, then say *la machine à laver* again

Before you move on

What does la machine à laver mean? ("Washing machine".) Say it once more.

526.2 essorer — to spin (dry), to wring

Before the new one: say the French for to repeat, then the French for washing machine.

You'll want to know: essorer

essorer — "to spin (dry), to wring".

La machine essore le linge à la fin du programme.

The machine spins the washing at the end of the cycle.

L'essorage — the spin cycle.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

essorer comes from Old French *essorer* (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *exaurāre*, built on Latin *aura* "a breeze" (Lewis & Short): to dry washing was first to put it out in the air.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: essorer*
- *Say it: essorer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *essorer*
- *Recall:* say the French for to repeat, then the French for washing machine, then say *essorer* again

Before you move on

What does essorer mean? ("To spin (dry), to wring".) Say it once more.

526.3 étendre — to hang out (washing); to spread out

Before the new one: say the French for washing machine, then the French for to spin.

You'll want to know: étendre

étendre — "to hang out (washing); to spread out".

Elle étend le linge sur le balcon.

She hangs the washing out on the balcony.

S'étendre — to lie down, to stretch out.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

étendre is inherited, through Old French *estendre*, from Latin *extendere* "to stretch out" (EtymDB), built on *tendere* "to stretch" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: étendre*
- *Say it: étendre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *étendre*
- *Recall:* say the French for washing machine, then the French for to spin, then say *étendre* again

Before you move on

What does étendre mean? ("To hang out (washing); to spread out".) Say it once more.

526.4 la pince à linge — clothes peg

Before the new one: say the French for to spin, then the French for to hang out.

You'll want to know: la pince à linge

la pince à linge — "clothes peg".

Il me faut encore des pinces à linge.

I still need some clothes pegs.

Une pince alone is pliers or tongs.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la pince à linge joins *pince*, built on *pincer* "to pinch", an expressive word, and *linge*, from Latin *līneus* "made of linen", from *līnum* "flax" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la pince à linge*
- *Say it: la pince à linge*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la pince à linge*
- *Recall:* say the French for to spin, then the French for to hang out, then say *la pince à linge* again

Before you move on

What does la pince à linge mean? ("Clothes peg".) Say it once more.

526.5 le cintre — coat hanger

Before the new one: say the French for to hang out, then the French for clothes peg.

You'll want to know: le cintre

le cintre — "coat hanger".

Je mets ma chemise sur un cintre.

I put my shirt on a hanger.

In Québec *le support*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le cintre is built on *cintrer* "to curve" (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *cinctūrāre*, from Latin *cinctūra* "a girdle", from *cingere* "to gird" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le cintre*
- *Say it:* *le cintre*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le cintre*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hang out, then the French for clothes peg, then say *le cintre* again

Before you move on

What does le cintre mean? (“Coat hanger”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 527

Repasser et ranger

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about ironing and putting clothes away.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 527: I can talk about ironing and putting clothes away.*

527.1 le fer à repasser — iron (for clothes)

> Before the new one: say the French for clothes peg, then the French for coat hanger.

You'll want to know: le fer à repasser

le fer à repasser — "iron (for clothes)".

> Le fer à repasser est encore chaud.
>
> *The iron is still hot.*

Often *le fer* alone. *La planche à repasser* — the ironing board.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le fer à repasser is "an iron for pressing": *fer* is inherited from Latin *ferrum* "iron" (Lewis & Short), and *repasser* is built on *passer*.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le fer à repasser*
- *Say it: le fer à repasser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le fer à repasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for clothes peg, then the French for coat hanger, then say *le fer à repasser* again

Before you move on

What does le fer à repasser mean? ("Iron (for clothes)".) Say it once more.

527.2 froissé — creased, crumpled; offended

Before the new one: say the French for coat hanger, then the French for iron.

You'll want to know: froissé

froissé — "creased, crumpled; offended".

Ta chemise est toute froissée.

Your shirt is all creased.

Also hurt, offended: *il est froissé par ta remarque.*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

froissé is the participle of *froisser* "to crumple" (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *frustiāre* "to break into bits", from Latin *frustum* "a crumb, a bit" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: froissé*
- *Say it: froissé*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *froissé*
- *Recall:* say the French for coat hanger, then the French for iron, then say *froissé* again

Before you move on

What does froissé mean? ("Creased, crumpled; offended".) Say it once more.

527.3 tremper — to soak; to dip

Before the new one: say the French for iron, then the French for creased.

You'll want to know: tremper

tremper — "to soak; to dip".

Je fais tremper le pantalon taché dans l'eau froide.

I am soaking the stained trousers in cold water.

Faire tremper — to leave to soak. *Être trempé* — to be soaked.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

tremper is inherited from Latin *temperāre* "to mix in due proportion" (Lewis & Short), with its letters later shifted; the sense moved to mixing with water.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: tremper*
- *Say it: tremper*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *tremper*
- *Recall:* say the French for iron, then the French for creased, then say *tremper* again

Before you move on

What does tremper mean? ("To soak; to dip".) Say it once more.

527.4 la penderie — wardrobe (for hanging clothes)

Before the new one: say the French for creased, then the French for to soak.

You'll want to know: la penderie

la penderie — "wardrobe (for hanging clothes)".

Les manteaux sont dans la penderie de l'entrée.

The coats are in the hall wardrobe.

A cupboard with a rail for hanging; *l'armoire* has shelves too.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la penderie is built on *pendre* "to hang" with *-erie*; *pendre* is inherited from Latin *pendēre* "to hang" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la penderie*
- *Say it: la penderie*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la penderie*
- *Recall:* say the French for creased, then the French for to soak, then say *la penderie* again

Before you move on

What does la penderie mean? ("Wardrobe (for hanging clothes)".) Say it once more.

527.5 accrocher — to hang (up), to hook

Before the new one: say the French for to soak, then the French for wardrobe.

You'll want to know: accrocher

accrocher — "to hang (up), to hook".

Il accroche sa veste derrière la porte.

He hangs his jacket behind the door.

Accrocher un tableau — to hang a picture. *S'accrocher* — to hold on.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

accrocher is built on *croc* "a hook" (EtymDB), which comes from Frankish *krōk*, a Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *accrocher*
- *Say it:* *accrocher*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *accrocher*
- *Recall:* say the French for to soak, then the French for wardrobe, then say *accrocher* again

Before you move on

What does accrocher mean? ("To hang (up), to hook".) Say it once more.

Chapter 528

Faire le ménage

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about cleaning the house.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 528: I can talk about cleaning the house.*

528.1 balayer — to sweep

> Before the new one: say the French for wardrobe, then the French for to hang.

You'll want to know: balayer

balayer — "to sweep".

> Tous les soirs, il balaie la cuisine.
>
> *Every evening he sweeps the kitchen.*

Je balaie or *je balaye*; both are correct.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

balayer is built on *balai* "broom" (EtymDB), a word of Celtic origin, first the name of the broom plant.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: balayer*
- *Say it: balayer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *balayer*
- *Recall:* say the French for wardrobe, then the French for to hang, then say *balayer* again

Before you move on

What does balayer mean? ("To sweep".) Say it once more.

528.2 épousseter — to dust

Before the new one: say the French for to hang, then the French for to sweep.

You'll want to know: épousseter

épousseter — "to dust".

Elle époussette les meubles du salon.

She dusts the furniture in the living room.

Spelling: *j'époussette*. Built on *la poussière*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

épousseter is built on an old word *pousse* "dust", which goes back to Latin *pulvis* "dust" (Lewis & Short); *la poussière* has the same source.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: épousseter*
- *Say it: épousseter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *épousseter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to hang, then the French for to sweep, then say *épousseter* again

Before you move on

What does épousseter mean? ("To dust".) Say it once more.

528.3 frotter — to rub, to scrub

Before the new one: say the French for to sweep, then the French for to dust.

You'll want to know: frotter

frotter — "to rub, to scrub".

J'ai frotté la tache, mais elle est encore là.

I scrubbed the stain, but it is still there.

Se frotter les mains — to rub one's hands.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

frotter goes back to Old French *froter*. The origin is not settled; a link with Latin *fricāre* "to rub" is often proposed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: frotter*
- *Say it: frotter*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *frotter*
- *Recall:* say the French for to sweep, then the French for to dust, then say *frotter* again

Before you move on

What does frotter mean? ("To rub, to scrub".) Say it once more.

528.4 l'éponge — sponge

Before the new one: say the French for to dust, then the French for to rub.

You'll want to know: l'éponge

l'éponge — "sponge".

Il nettoie la table de la cuisine avec une éponge.

He wipes down the kitchen table with a sponge.

Feminine. *Passer l'éponge* — to let bygones be bygones.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'éponge is inherited, through Old French *esponge*, from Latin *spongia* (EtymDB), a borrowing from Greek *spongiá* "a sponge".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'éponge*
- *Say it: l'éponge*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'éponge*
- *Recall:* say the French for to dust, then the French for to rub, then say *l'éponge* again

Before you move on

What does l'éponge mean? ("Sponge".) Say it once more.

528.5 la serpillière — floor cloth, mop

Before the new one: say the French for to rub, then the French for sponge.

You'll want to know: la serpillière

la serpillière — "floor cloth, mop".

Après le repas, je passe la serpillière.

After the meal I mop the floor.

Passer la serpillière — to mop. In the north of France and in Belgium also *la wassingue*; in Québec *la moppe*. Also spelt *serpillère*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la serpillière goes back to Old French *sarpilliere* "a coarse cloth". The origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la serpillière*
- *Say it: la serpillière*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la serpillière*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rub, then the French for sponge, then say *la serpillière* again

Before you move on

What does la serpillière mean? (“Floor cloth, mop”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 529

À table

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about laying and clearing up after a meal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 529: I can talk about laying and clearing up after a meal.*

529.1 la nappe — tablecloth

> Before the new one: say the French for sponge, then the French for floor cloth.

You'll want to know: la nappe

la nappe — "tablecloth".

> Pour la fête, ma mère sort la belle nappe blanche.
>
> *For the party my mother gets out the nice white tablecloth.*

Also a sheet of water or fog: *une nappe de brouillard*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la nappe is inherited from Latin *mappa* "a napkin, a cloth" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short), with its first sound changed.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la nappe*
- *Say it: la nappe*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la nappe*
- *Recall:* say the French for sponge, then the French for floor cloth, then say *la nappe* again

Before you move on

What does la nappe mean? ("Tablecloth".) Say it once more.

529.2 le couvert — place setting; cutlery

Before the new one: say the French for floor cloth, then the French for tablecloth.

You'll want to know: le couvert

le couvert — "place setting; cutlery".

Les enfants mettent le couvert avant le dîner.

The children set out the plates and cutlery before dinner.

Mettre le couvert — to set out plates and cutlery for a meal. *Les couverts* — the cutlery.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le couvert is the participle of *couvrir* "to cover" (EtymDB), inherited from Latin *cooperīre* "to cover completely" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le couvert*
- *Say it: le couvert*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le couvert*
- *Recall:* say the French for floor cloth, then the French for tablecloth, then say *le couvert* again

Before you move on

What does le couvert mean? (“Place setting; cutlery”.) Say it once more.

529.3 débarrasser — to clear away (after a meal); to get rid of

Before the new one: say the French for tablecloth, then the French for place setting.

You’ll want to know: débarrasser

débarrasser — “to clear away (after a meal); to get rid of”.

Après le repas, mon père débarrasse la table.

After the meal my father clears the dinner table.

Se débarrasser de — to get rid of.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

débarrasser is the opposite of *embarrasser* “to hinder”. The origin of this root is not settled; a link with *barre* “bar” is often proposed.

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: débarrasser*
- *Say it: débarrasser*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *débarrasser*
- *Recall:* say the French for tablecloth, then the French for place setting, then say *débarrasser* again

Before you move on

What does débarrasser mean? ("To clear away (after a meal); to get rid of".) Say it once more.

529.4 la louche — ladle

Before the new one: say the French for place setting, then the French for to clear away.

You'll want to know: la louche

la louche — "ladle".

Elle sert la soupe avec une louche.

She serves the soup with a ladle.

As an adjective, *louche* means shady: *une affaire louche.* That is a different word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

This *louche* "a ladle" is usually traced to Frankish *lōtja*, a Germanic word. The adjective *louche* "shady" is a different word, from Latin *luscus* "one-eyed" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la louche*
- *Say it: la louche*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la louche*
- *Recall:* say the French for place setting, then the French for to clear away, then say *la louche* again

Before you move on

What does la louche mean? (“Ladle”.) Say it once more.

529.5 le couvercle — lid

Before the new one: say the French for to clear away, then the French for ladle.

You’ll want to know: le couvercle

le couvercle — “lid”.

Avec le couvercle sur la casserole, ça cuit plus vite.

With the lid on the pan, it cooks faster.

Built on *couvrir* “to cover”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le couvercle is inherited from Latin *cooperculum* “a lid”, from *cooperīre* “to cover completely” (Lewis & Short).

What you’ve built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le couvercle*
- *Say it: le couvercle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le couvercle*
- *Recall:* say the French for to clear away, then the French for ladle, then say *le couvercle* again

Before you move on

What does le couvercle mean? (“Lid”.) Say it once more.

529.6 Retour sur les chapitres 522–529

Say the French for poetry and comic book.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- poetry, comic book, crime novel, biography, tale
- episode, season, suspense, (streaming) platform, thrilling
- original-language version, to screen, dubbing, (film) director, shooting
- to channel-hop, remote control, (television or radio) programme, documentary, to repeat
- washing machine, to spin, to hang out, clothes peg, coat hanger
- iron, creased, to soak, wardrobe, to hang
- to sweep, to dust, to rub, sponge, floor cloth
- tablecloth, place setting, to clear away, ladle, lid

Before you move on

Poetry? (**la poésie**.) Comic book? (**la bande dessinée**.) Crime novel? (**le polar**.) Biography? (**la biographie**.) Tale? (**le conte**.) Episode? (**l'épisode**.) Season? (**la saison**.) Suspense? (**le suspense**.) (streaming) platform? (**la plateforme**.) Thrilling? (**palpitant**.) Original-language version? (**la version originale**.) To screen? (**projeter**.) Dubbing? (**le doublage**.) (film) director? (**le réalisateur**.) Shooting? (**le tournage**.) To channel-hop? (**zapper**.) Remote control? (**la télécommande**.) (television or radio) programme? (**l'émission**.) Documentary? (**le documentaire**.) To repeat? (**rediffuser**.) Washing machine? (**la machine à laver**.) To spin? (**essorer**.) To hang out? (**étendre**.) Clothes peg? (**la pince à linge**.) Coat hanger? (**le cintre**.) Iron? (**le fer à repasser**.) Creased? (**froissé**.) To soak? (**tremper**.) Wardrobe? (**la penderie**.) To hang? (**accrocher**.) To sweep? (**balayer**.) To dust? (**épousseter**.) To rub? (**frotter**.) Sponge? (**l'éponge**.) Floor cloth? (**la serpillière**.) Tablecloth? (**la nappe**.) Place setting? (**le couvert**.) To clear away? (**débarrasser**.) Ladle? (**la louche**.) Lid? (**le couvercle**.)

Chapter 530

Faire la vaisselle

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about doing the dishes.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 530: I can talk about doing the dishes.*

530.1 la vaisselle — dishes, crockery

> Before the new one: say the French for ladle, then the French for lid.

You'll want to know: la vaisselle

la vaisselle — "dishes, crockery".

> Ce soir, c'est mon frère qui fait la vaisselle.
>
> *Tonight it is my brother who does the dishes.*

Faire la vaisselle — to do the washing-up. In Switzerland also *relaver*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la vaisselle is inherited, through Old French *vaissele*, from Vulgar Latin *vascella* (EtymDB), from Latin *vāsculum* "a small vessel", built on *vās* "a vessel" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vaisselle*
- *Say it: la vaisselle*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la vaisselle*
- *Recall:* say the French for ladle, then the French for lid, then say *la vaisselle* again

Before you move on

What does la vaisselle mean? ("Dishes, crockery".) Say it once more.

530.2 l'évier — (kitchen) sink

Before the new one: say the French for lid, then the French for dishes.

You'll want to know: l'évier

l'évier — "(kitchen) sink".

Les assiettes sales sont dans l'évier.

The dirty plates are in the sink.

Masculine. A bathroom basin is *le lavabo*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

l'évier is inherited from Latin *aquārium* "a place for water" (EtymDB), built on *aqua* "water" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: l'évier*
- *Say it: l'évier*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *l'évier*
- *Recall:* say the French for lid, then the French for dishes, then say *l'évier* again

Before you move on

What does l'évier mean? ("(kitchen) sink".) Say it once more.

530.3 rincer — to rinse

Before the new one: say the French for dishes, then the French for (kitchen) sink.

You'll want to know: rincer

rincer — "to rinse".

Je rince les verres à l'eau chaude.

I rinse the glasses in hot water.

Spelling: *nous rinçons*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

rincer goes back to Old French *reïncier*. The origin is not settled: a Vulgar Latin *recentiāre* "to refresh", from *recēns* "fresh" (Lewis & Short), is often proposed, and EtymDB compares Old Norse *hreinsa* "to cleanse".

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: rincer*
- *Say it: rincer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *rincer*
- *Recall:* say the French for dishes, then the French for (kitchen) sink, then say *rincer* again

Before you move on

What does rincer mean? ("To rinse".) Say it once more.

530.4 essuyer — to wipe, to dry

Before the new one: say the French for (kitchen) sink, then the French for to rinse.

You'll want to know: essuyer

essuyer — "to wipe, to dry".

Il essuie les assiettes après le repas.

He dries the plates after the meal.

J'essuie, *nous essuyons*. *S'essuyer les mains* — to dry one's hands.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

essuyer is inherited from Latin *exsūcāre* "to squeeze the juice out", built on *sūcus* "juice" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: essuyer*
- *Say it: essuyer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *essuyer*
- *Recall:* say the French for (kitchen) sink, then the French for to rinse, then say *essuyer* again

Before you move on

What does essuyer mean? ("To wipe, to dry".) Say it once more.

530.5 le torchon — tea towel, dishcloth

Before the new one: say the French for to rinse, then the French for to wipe.

You'll want to know: le torchon

le torchon — "tea towel, dishcloth".

Le torchon est accroché près de l'évier.

The tea towel is hanging by the sink.

In Belgium *l'essuie*. *Le torchon brûle* — there is trouble between them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le torchon is built on *torche* "a twist of straw", which goes back to Vulgar Latin *torca*, from Latin *torquēre* "to twist" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *le torchon*
- *Say it:* *le torchon*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le torchon*
- *Recall:* say the French for to rinse, then the French for to wipe, then say *le torchon* again

Before you move on

What does le torchon mean? (“Tea towel, dishcloth”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 531

Le bricolage

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about small repair jobs at home.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 531: I can talk about small repair jobs at home.*

531.1 le bricolage — DIY, odd jobs

Before the new one: say the French for to wipe, then the French for tea towel.

You'll want to know: le bricolage

le bricolage — "DIY, odd jobs".

> Le week-end, mon oncle fait du bricolage.
>
> *At the weekend my uncle does DIY.*

Un magasin de bricolage — a DIY shop.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le bricolage is built on *bricoler*, from Old French *bricole* (EtymDB), once a catapult and later a small job. The earlier origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le bricolage*
- *Say it: le bricolage*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le bricolage*
- *Recall:* say the French for to wipe, then the French for tea towel, then say *le bricolage* again

Before you move on

What does le bricolage mean? ("DIY, odd jobs".) Say it once more.

531.2 bricoler — to do DIY, to tinker

Before the new one: say the French for tea towel, then the French for DIY.

You'll want to know: bricoler

bricoler — "to do DIY, to tinker".

Ma tante aime bricoler dans son garage.

My aunt likes tinkering in her garage.

Un bricoleur, *une bricoleuse* — a handy person.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

bricoler is built on *bricole*, once a catapult and later a small job. The earlier origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: bricoler*
- *Say it: bricoler*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *bricoler*
- *Recall:* say the French for tea towel, then the French for DIY, then say *bricoler* again

Before you move on

What does bricoler mean? ("To do DIY, to tinker".) Say it once more.

531.3 la vis — screw

Before the new one: say the French for DIY, then the French for to do DIY.

You'll want to know: la vis

la vis — "screw".

Il manque une vis à cette chaise.

This chair is missing a screw.

The *s* is sounded: *vis* rhymes with *fils*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

la vis is inherited from Latin *vītis* "a vine" (EtymDB; Lewis & Short): the screw is probably named for the spiral of the vine's tendrils.

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: la vis*
- *Say it: la vis*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *la vis*
- *Recall:* say the French for DIY, then the French for to do DIY, then say *la vis* again

Before you move on

What does la vis mean? ("Screw".) Say it once more.

531.4 le tournevis — screwdriver

Before the new one: say the French for to do DIY, then the French for screw.

You'll want to know: le tournevis

le tournevis — "screwdriver".

Pour ouvrir la radio, il a pris un petit tournevis.

To open the radio, he took a small screwdriver.

Literally turn-screw. The *s* is sounded.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

le tournevis is built from *tourner* "to turn", from Latin *tornāre*, and *vis* "screw", inherited from Latin *vītis* "a vine" (EtymDB).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: le tournevis*
- *Say it: le tournevis*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *le tournevis*
- *Recall:* say the French for to do DIY, then the French for screw, then say *le tournevis* again

Before you move on

What does le tournevis mean? ("Screwdriver".) Say it once more.

531.5 percer — to drill, to pierce

Before the new one: say the French for screw, then the French for screwdriver.

You'll want to know: percer

percer — "to drill, to pierce".

Mon voisin perce un trou dans le mur.

My neighbour is drilling a hole in the wall.

Spelling: *nous perçons*. *Une perceuse* — a drill.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

percer is inherited from Old French *percier* (EtymDB), from Vulgar Latin *pertūsiāre*, built on Latin *pertundere* "to bore through" (Lewis & Short).

What you've built

One more word for telling, explaining and describing at B1.

Your turn

- *Say it: percer*
- *Say it: percer*, once more
- *Say it:* a sentence of your own with *percer*
- *Recall:* say the French for screw, then the French for screwdriver, then say *percer* again

Before you move on

What does percer mean? ("To drill, to pierce".) Say it once more.

531.6 Loisirs et maison

Say the French for dishes and (kitchen) sink.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- dishes, (kitchen) sink, to rinse, to wipe, tea towel
- DIY, to do DIY, screw, screwdriver, to drill

Before you move on

Dishes? (**la vaisselle**.) (kitchen) sink? (**l'évier**.) To rinse? (**rincer**.) To wipe? (**essuyer**.) Tea towel? (**le torchon**.) DIY? (**le bricolage**.) To do DIY? (**bricoler**.) Screw? (**la vis**.) Screwdriver? (**le tournevis**.) To drill? (**percer**.)

531.7 Le bricolage — once more

Say the French for DIY and to do DIY.

Your turn

- *Say it:* DIY, to do DIY, screw, screwdriver, to drill

Before you move on

DIY? (**le bricolage**.) To do DIY? (**bricoler**.) Screw? (**la vis**.) Screwdriver? (**le tournevis**.) To drill? (**percer**.)

Pronunciation — a reference, not a chapter

A **reference**, not a chapter. Each lesson tells you the sounds you need for its word and links here for more. French spelling hides more sound than Spanish does — silent letters, nasal vowels, liaison — so this page is worth dipping into, but never a gate to pass before Lesson 1.

Ids (e.g. `silent-final`) are cited in each lesson's frontmatter `sounds:` field.

The big three habits (unlearn Spanish/English here)

- `silent-final` — **most final consonants are silent.** *salut* → *sa-LU* (no *t*); *vous* → *voo* and *les* → *lay* (no *s*). Common exceptions kept: final *c, r, f, l* (the word "CaReFuL"). *bonjour*'s *r* is pronounced.
- `liaison` — a normally-silent final consonant **reconnects** onto a following vowel: *vous* + *avez* → *vou-zavez*. Comes later; just know it exists.
- `nasal` — some vowels are **nasal**: air through the nose, and the *n*/*m* itself goes silent. *bon* is not "bon" but a nasal *bõ*; *bien* is a nasal *byẽ*. See below.

Vowels

- `vowel-ou` — **ou** = *oo* as in *food*: *jour* (*zhoor*), *vous*, *bonjour*.

- `vowel-u` — **u** = a front-rounded *ee* with rounded lips (say *ee*, then purse your lips): *salut*, *tu*. No English equivalent; not *oo*.
- `vowel-oi` — **oi** = *wa*: *soir* (*swahr*), *bonsoir*, *moi* (*mwah*).
- `vowel-e-acute` — **é** = a crisp *ay* (no glide): *enchanté*.
- `vowel-e-grave` — **è / ê** = an open *eh* as in *bed*: *très*.

Nasal vowels

- `nasal-on` — **on / om** = nasal *õ* (like *song* without the *g*): *bon*, *bonjour*, *bonsoir*, *nom*.
- `nasal-in` — **in / ain / ien** = nasal *ẽ*: *bien* (*byẽ*), *matin*, *bientôt*.
- `nasal-an` — **an / en** = nasal *ã*: *enchanté* (*ã-shã-TAY*), *comment*.
- `double-n-blocks-nasal` — a doubled *nn*/*mm* **cancels** the nasal and the vowel goes back through the mouth: *bon* (*bõ*) vs. *bonne* (*bun*).

Consonants that differ

- `j-zh` — **j** = the soft *zh* of *measure*: *jour* (*zhoor*), *je* (*zhuh*).
- `soft-g` — **g** before *e*/*i* = the same *zh*: *âge*.
- `r-uvular` — **r** = a soft guttural sound at the back of the throat, not the Spanish tap/trill nor the English *r*. *bonjour*, *soir*.
- `h-silent` — **h** is always silent (as in Spanish): *heure* → *euhr*.
- `ch-sh` — **ch** = English *sh*: *enchanté* (*ã-**sh**ã-tay*).
- `gn` — **gn** = the *ny* of *canyon* (= Spanish *ñ*): *signe*.

Accents & spelling marks

- `accent-marks` — French accents mostly change **vowel quality**, not stress: *é* (closed *ay*), *è*/*ê* (open *eh*), *à*/*ù* (distinguish words), *ç* (soft *s*). Unlike Spanish, they do **not** mark which syllable is stressed — French stresses the **last** syllable of a group, lightly and evenly.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

(s')appeler
to call / to call oneself
Introduced in Chapter 2.

à
to, at — one letter, Latin ad, and the accent that keeps it apart from the verb a
Introduced in Chapter 39.

à bientôt
see you soon (literally "to well-soon")
Introduced in Chapter 4.

à cause de
because of
Introduced in Chapter 348.

à condition que
provided that, on condition that
Introduced in Chapter 368.

à côté
beside
Introduced in Chapter 157.

à demain
see you tomorrow (literally "to tomorrow")
Introduced in Chapter 4.

à droite
on the right
Introduced in Chapter 188.

à gauche
on the left
Introduced in Chapter 188.

à l'issue de
at the end of, following
Introduced in Chapter 277.

à la longue
in the long run, eventually
Introduced in Chapter 271.

à moins que
unless
Introduced in Chapter 368.

à plus tard
see you later (literally "to more late")
Introduced in Chapter 4.

aboutir
to succeed, to come to a result; to lead to
Introduced in Chapter 275.

absurde
absurd
Introduced in Chapter 338.

accéder
to access, to reach
Introduced in Chapter 395.

accélérer
to speed up, to accelerate
Introduced in Chapter 401.

accompagner
to go with
Introduced in Chapter 178.

accorder
to tune (an instrument); to grant
Introduced in Chapter 511.

accoster
to come alongside, to dock; to approach (someone)
Introduced in Chapter 423.

accoucher
to give birth
Introduced in Chapter 493.

accrocher
to hang (up), to hook
Introduced in Chapter 527.

accueillir
to welcome
Introduced in Chapter 241.

accuser
to accuse
Introduced in Chapter 386.

acheter
to buy
Introduced in Chapter 64.

acquitter
to acquit; to pay off
Introduced in Chapter 295.

adapter
to adapt (mostly reflexive, s'adapter)
Introduced in Chapter 370.

admettre
to admit
Introduced in Chapter 337.

admirer
to admire
Introduced in Chapter 152.

adopter
to adopt
Introduced in Chapter 492.

affirmer
to state firmly, to assert
Introduced in Chapter 334.

affranchir
to put a stamp on, to frank; to free
Introduced in Chapter 449.

affronter
to face, to take on
Introduced in Chapter 507.

agacer
to irritate, to get on someone's nerves
Introduced in Chapter 469.

aggraver
to make worse, to aggravate
Introduced in Chapter 353.

agir
to act
Introduced in Chapter 152.

agresser
to attack, to assault
Introduced in Chapter 289.

aider
to help — English aid arriving by the Latin road, while English help came by the Germanic one; the two words are unrelated
Introduced in Chapter 28.

ailleurs
elsewhere
Introduced in Chapter 216.

aimable
friendly
Introduced in Chapter 220.

aimer
to like AND to love — one French verb where English keeps two, so the strength comes from what follows it, and adding bien makes it WEAKER
Introduced in Chapter 28.

ajourner
to postpone, to adjourn
Introduced in Chapter 275.

ajouter
to add
Introduced in Chapter 178.

alerter
to alert, to warn
Introduced in Chapter 301.

allaiter
to breastfeed
Introduced in Chapter 308.

aller
to go (and, oddly, “to be” in “how are you?”)
Introduced in Chapter 3.

allumer
to switch on, to light
Introduced in Chapter 143.

alors
in that case, so
Introduced in Chapter 187.

améliorer
to improve
Introduced in Chapter 237.

amer
bitter
Introduced in Chapter 94.

amoureux
in love; lover
Introduced in Chapter 487.

amusant / amusante
fun, amusing
Introduced in Chapter 219.

ancien / ancienne
former, ancient
Introduced in Chapter 161.

annoncer
to announce
Introduced in Chapter 178.

annuler
to cancel
Introduced in Chapter 371.

anxieux
anxious
Introduced in Chapter 476.

août
August — the month renamed for the emperor Augustus
Introduced in Chapter 10.

apparaître
to appear
Introduced in Chapter 178.

applaudir
to applaud
Introduced in Chapter 208.

apprendre
to learn
Introduced in Chapter 60.

approuver
to approve (of)
Introduced in Chapter 345.

argumenter
to argue a case, to give reasons
Introduced in Chapter 345.

arpenter
to pace up and down; to stride along
Introduced in Chapter 438.

arrêter
to stop
Introduced in Chapter 176.

arroser
to water (plants)
Introduced in Chapter 503.

assaisonner
to season
Introduced in Chapter 332.

assembler
to put together, to assemble
Introduced in Chapter 501.

assez
enough, and rather — one word doing both jobs, and it takes de before a noun and nothing before an adjective
Introduced in Chapter 44.

attacher
to tie, to fasten
Introduced in Chapter 240.

atteindre
to reach
Introduced in Chapter 210.

attendre
to wait for
Introduced in Chapter 64.

atténuer
to lessen, to soften
Introduced in Chapter 353.

atterrir
to land
Introduced in Chapter 419.

au cas où
in case
Introduced in Chapter 368.

au contraire
on the contrary
Introduced in Chapter 158.

au fond
at the bottom, at the back
Introduced in Chapter 188.

au fur et à mesure
as one goes along, bit by bit
Introduced in Chapter 271.

au moment où
at the moment when, right as
Introduced in Chapter 269.

au revoir
goodbye (literally "until the seeing-again")
Introduced in Chapter 4.

au-dessous
below
Introduced in Chapter 157.

au-dessus
above
Introduced in Chapter 157.

aucun / aucune
none, not a single
Introduced in Chapter 139.

augmenter
to increase
Introduced in Chapter 208.

aujourd'hui
today
Introduced in Chapter 97.

auparavant
before, previously
Introduced in Chapter 272.

aussitôt
at once, immediately
Introduced in Chapter 269.

autoriser
to authorise, to allow
Introduced in Chapter 381.

autour
around
Introduced in Chapter 216.

autrefois
formerly, in the old days
Introduced in Chapter 140.

avancer
to move forward
Introduced in Chapter 152.

avant-hier
the day before yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 140.

avantageux
good value, favourable
Introduced in Chapter 393.

avare
stingy, mean with money; miser
Introduced in Chapter 467.

avoir lieu
to take place, to be held
Introduced in Chapter 274.

avouer
to confess, to admit
Introduced in Chapter 295.

avril
April — perhaps the opening month
Introduced in Chapter 9.

bâiller
to yawn
Introduced in Chapter 486.

baisser
to lower
Introduced in Chapter 152.

balader
to go for a walk (mostly reflexive: se balader); to take round
Introduced in Chapter 438.

balayer
to sweep
Introduced in Chapter 528.

baptiser
to christen, to baptise; to name
Introduced in Chapter 309.

bas / basse
low
Introduced in Chapter 160.

battre
to beat
Introduced in Chapter 329.

bavard / bavarde
talkative
Introduced in Chapter 246.

bavarder
to chat
Introduced in Chapter 150.

beaucoup
a lot — a beautiful blow, two words fused, and the p that never sounds
Introduced in Chapter 44.

bercer
to rock (a baby)
Introduced in Chapter 493.

bien
well / good / fine
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bien que
although
Introduced in Chapter 158.

bifurquer
to turn off, to fork
Introduced in Chapter 400.

bivouaquer
to bivouac, to sleep out in the open
Introduced in Chapter 425.

blanc
white — a Germanic word in a Latin language, running against the traffic
Introduced in Chapter 16.

blesser
to injure, to hurt; (se blesser) to hurt oneself
Introduced in Chapter 479.

bleu
blue — a Germanic word that went to France, changed clothes, and came back
Introduced in Chapter 16.

bleu, blanc, rouge
the flag, in order — and two of its three colours are loanwords
Introduced in Chapter 16.

bloquer
to block; to freeze (reflexive, se bloquer)
Introduced in Chapter 399.

boire
to drink
Introduced in Chapter 61.

boiter
to limp
Introduced in Chapter 480.

bon / bonne
good (adjective)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bonjour
hello / good day
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bonne nuit
good night (going to bed)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bonsoir
good evening
Introduced in Chapter 1.

bouder
to sulk
Introduced in Chapter 466.

bouger
to stir, to move
Introduced in Chapter 184.

bouillir
to boil
Introduced in Chapter 330.

bouleverser
to deeply upset, to overwhelm; to turn upside down
Introduced in Chapter 472.

brader
to sell off cheap
Introduced in Chapter 452.

brancher
to plug in
Introduced in Chapter 150.

braquer
to turn the wheel (hard); to aim
Introduced in Chapter 401.

bricoler
to do DIY, to tinker
Introduced in Chapter 531.

broder
to embroider
Introduced in Chapter 496.

brouiller
to mix up, to blur; (se brouiller) to fall out
Introduced in Chapter 495.

bruiner
to drizzle
Introduced in Chapter 461.

brûler
to burn
Introduced in Chapter 236.

brun
brown (of hair, skin)
Introduced in Chapter 130.

brusquement
abruptly, sharply
Introduced in Chapter 270.

bruyant
noisy
Introduced in Chapter 132.

c'est
this is, that is — ce plus est, with the elision you have been hearing since l'eau
Introduced in Chapter 38.

c'est pourquoi
that is why
Introduced in Chapter 347.

c'était, il y avait
it was, there was — être's own imparfait stem, and the two openers a French scene is built from
Introduced in Chapter 258.

ça dépend
it depends — the condition you do not have to name, and how to name it when you want to
Introduced in Chapter 266.

cabosser
to dent
Introduced in Chapter 298.

cacher
to hide
Introduced in Chapter 66.

cadrer
to frame (a picture)
Introduced in Chapter 502.

calculer
to calculate
Introduced in Chapter 236.

caler
to stall (an engine); to wedge
Introduced in Chapter 401.

câliner
to cuddle
Introduced in Chapter 488.

calme
calm, quiet
Introduced in Chapter 131.

cambrioler
to burgle, to break into
Introduced in Chapter 287.

camper
to camp
Introduced in Chapter 425.

captivant
gripping, captivating
Introduced in Chapter 519.

caresser
to stroke, to caress
Introduced in Chapter 487.

carré
square
Introduced in Chapter 94.

casser
to break
Introduced in Chapter 206.

causer
to cause
Introduced in Chapter 346.

ce serait
it would be — a judgement on something that has not happened, and the if that is not true now
Introduced in Chapter 267.

ce soir
this evening
Introduced in Chapter 141.

céder
to give in, to give way; to hand over
Introduced in Chapter 337.

célèbre
famous
Introduced in Chapter 132.

célébrer
to celebrate
Introduced in Chapter 316.

célibataire
single
Introduced in Chapter 162.

cent
a hundred
Introduced in Chapter 105.

cependant
nevertheless, however
Introduced in Chapter 217.

certainement
certainly
Introduced in Chapter 189.

changer
to change
Introduced in Chapter 176.

chatouiller
to tickle
Introduced in Chapter 474.

chauffer
to heat
Introduced in Chapter 206.

chavirer
to capsize; to tip over
Introduced in Chapter 423.

cher
dear; expensive
Introduced in Chapter 90.

chercher
to look for
Introduced in Chapter 63.

chien, chat
dog and cat — chien is the REGULAR, expected descendant of canis (unlike Spanish's mysterious perro); chat continues cattus, the same Egypt-to-Rome story as Spanish's gato
Introduced in Chapter 26.

chronométrer
to time (with a stopwatch)
Introduced in Chapter 508.

chuchoter
to whisper
Introduced in Chapter 488.

cinq
five
Introduced in Chapter 6.

cinquante
fifty
Introduced in Chapter 105.

cirer
to polish, to wax
Introduced in Chapter 446.

clair / claire
clear, light (of a colour)
Introduced in Chapter 192.

clarifier
to clarify
Introduced in Chapter 341.

collectionner
to collect
Introduced in Chapter 501.

coller
to paste; to stick
Introduced in Chapter 397.

combien
how much and how many — one word where English needs two
Introduced in Chapter 36.

commander
to order
Introduced in Chapter 205.

comme ci, comme ça
so-so (literally “like this, like that”)
Introduced in Chapter 3.

commémorer
to commemorate
Introduced in Chapter 326.

commencer
to begin
Introduced in Chapter 137.

comment
how
Introduced in Chapter 2.

comment
how — a word you have been using since your first lesson
Introduced in Chapter 36.

comment ça va ?
how are you? — the neutral everyday question
Introduced in Chapter 3.

comment vous appelez-vous?
what's your name? (literally "how do you call yourself?")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

commenter
to comment on
Introduced in Chapter 284.

comparer
to compare
Introduced in Chapter 147.

compenser
to make up for, to compensate
Introduced in Chapter 353.

compliqué / compliquée
complicated
Introduced in Chapter 191.

composter
to stamp (a ticket)
Introduced in Chapter 413.

comprendre
to understand — literally com- + prendre, "to take together," so in French understanding IS grasping, and the verb conjugates exactly like the one it is built from
Introduced in Chapter 29.

compter
to count
Introduced in Chapter 66.

concéder
to concede, to grant
Introduced in Chapter 337.

conclure
to conclude
Introduced in Chapter 344.

condamner
to sentence, to condemn
Introduced in Chapter 388.

conduire
to drive
Introduced in Chapter 138.

confier
to entrust; (se confier) to confide
Introduced in Chapter 488.

confirmer
to confirm
Introduced in Chapter 421.

confortable
comfortable
Introduced in Chapter 159.

connaître
to know (a person, a place)
Introduced in Chapter 138.

connecter
to connect; to log in (reflexive, se connecter)
Introduced in Chapter 395.

conquérir
to conquer; to win over
Introduced in Chapter 324.

conseiller
to advise
Introduced in Chapter 147.

consoler
to comfort, to console
Introduced in Chapter 471.

constater
to note, to record (what happened)
Introduced in Chapter 411.

construire
to build
Introduced in Chapter 233.

content
pleased, glad
Introduced in Chapter 56.

continuer
to continue
Introduced in Chapter 144.

contourner
to go round, to bypass
Introduced in Chapter 436.

contredire
to contradict
Introduced in Chapter 336.

contrôler
to inspect, to check; to control
Introduced in Chapter 408.

convaincant
convincing
Introduced in Chapter 334.

convaincre
to convince
Introduced in Chapter 147.

copier
to copy
Introduced in Chapter 397.

corriger
to correct
Introduced in Chapter 182.

coudre
to sew
Introduced in Chapter 496.

coupable
guilty
Introduced in Chapter 387.

couper
to cut
Introduced in Chapter 63.

courageux / courageuse
brave
Introduced in Chapter 190.

courir
to run — Latin currere, the root under current, course, courier and curriculum, and the verb that shows why chien palatalized its c and courir did not
Introduced in Chapter 30.

couronner
to crown
Introduced in Chapter 323.

craindre
to fear
Introduced in Chapter 211.

crédible
believable, credible
Introduced in Chapter 340.

créditer
to credit, to pay into
Introduced in Chapter 451.

crever
to get a flat tyre; to burst
Introduced in Chapter 404.

crier
to shout
Introduced in Chapter 143.

critiquer
to criticise
Introduced in Chapter 147.

croire
to believe
Introduced in Chapter 137.

cru / crue
raw
Introduced in Chapter 161.

cueillir
to pick (flowers, fruit)
Introduced in Chapter 184.

cuisiner
to cook
Introduced in Chapter 60.

cuit / cuite
cooked
Introduced in Chapter 192.

curieux / curieuse
curious
Introduced in Chapter 218.

d'abord
first, at first — the word that opens a story told in order
Introduced in Chapter 259.

dangereux / dangereuse
dangerous
Introduced in Chapter 160.

dans la foulée
straight after, in the same stride
Introduced in Chapter 270.

de
of, from — the word already inside du, and the one that does what English does with an apostrophe
Introduced in Chapter 39.

de rien
you're welcome (literally "of nothing")
Introduced in Chapter 3.

de toute façon
anyway
Introduced in Chapter 158.

déambuler
to walk about, to wander
Introduced in Chapter 438.

déballer
to unpack
Introduced in Chapter 426.

débarquer
to get off (a boat or plane), to land
Introduced in Chapter 422.

débarrasser
to clear away (after a meal); to get rid of
Introduced in Chapter 529.

débattre
to debate, to discuss
Introduced in Chapter 335.

débiter
to charge (an account); to cut up
Introduced in Chapter 450.

déblayer
to clear away (snow, rubble)
Introduced in Chapter 443.

déborder
to overflow; to go beyond
Introduced in Chapter 465.

déboucher
to unblock; to uncork; to come out (onto)
Introduced in Chapter 428.

décaler
to shift, to move (a time)
Introduced in Chapter 420.

décéder
to pass away, to die (formal)
Introduced in Chapter 314.

décembre
December — the month that still says “ten”
Introduced in Chapter 10.

décevoir
to disappoint
Introduced in Chapter 471.

décider
to decide
Introduced in Chapter 144.

déclarer
to declare
Introduced in Chapter 417.

déclencher
to set off, to trigger
Introduced in Chapter 350.

décoller
to take off; to unstick
Introduced in Chapter 419.

décommander
to cancel (a booking, an order)
Introduced in Chapter 421.

décorer
to decorate
Introduced in Chapter 318.

découler
to follow (from), to result from
Introduced in Chapter 346.

découvrir
to discover
Introduced in Chapter 149.

dedans
inside
Introduced in Chapter 97.

dédicacer
to sign (a book for someone)
Introduced in Chapter 521.

dédommager
to compensate
Introduced in Chapter 433.

défectueux
faulty, defective
Introduced in Chapter 432.

défendre
to defend
Introduced in Chapter 184.

défiler
to march past, to parade; to scroll
Introduced in Chapter 317.

définitif
final, definitive
Introduced in Chapter 371.

dégager
to clear (of the sky); to free
Introduced in Chapter 461.

dégeler
to thaw
Introduced in Chapter 463.

déguiser
to dress up (as se déguiser); to disguise
Introduced in Chapter 317.

déguster
to taste, to savour
Introduced in Chapter 332.

dehors
outside
Introduced in Chapter 97.

déjà
already
Introduced in Chapter 140.

demander
to ask — an ordinary, polite, everyday word, and one of the sharpest false friends French holds for an English speaker
Introduced in Chapter 28.

démarrer
to start up (a car, an engine); to get going
Introduced in Chapter 403.

déménager
to move house
Introduced in Chapter 235.

démentir
to deny, to refute (officially)
Introduced in Chapter 284.

démissionner
to resign, to quit (a job)
Introduced in Chapter 355.

démontrer
to prove
Introduced in Chapter 147.

démouler
to turn out (of a tin)
Introduced in Chapter 333.

déneiger
to clear of snow, to plough
Introduced in Chapter 443.

dépanner
to get going again (after a breakdown); to help out
Introduced in Chapter 405.

dépasser
to overtake
Introduced in Chapter 181.

dépendre
to depend
Introduced in Chapter 179.

dépenser
to spend (money)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

déplacer
to move (something)
Introduced in Chapter 176.

depuis
since, for
Introduced in Chapter 187.

depuis lors
since then, ever since
Introduced in Chapter 272.

déranger
to disturb, to bother
Introduced in Chapter 431.

déraper
to skid
Introduced in Chapter 401.

dériver
to drift; to derive
Introduced in Chapter 423.

dernier
last
Introduced in Chapter 132.

dernièrement
lately, recently
Introduced in Chapter 273.

dérouler
to unfold, to take place (as se dérouler); to unroll
Introduced in Chapter 274.

derrière
behind
Introduced in Chapter 157.

dès lors
from then on; consequently
Introduced in Chapter 348.

dès que
as soon as
Introduced in Chapter 269.

désagréable
unpleasant
Introduced in Chapter 159.

désapprouver
to disapprove (of)
Introduced in Chapter 345.

désinstaller
to uninstall
Introduced in Chapter 396.

désobéir
to disobey
Introduced in Chapter 494.

désormais
from now on
Introduced in Chapter 156.

desservir
to stop at, to serve (a place); to clear away (after a meal)
Introduced in Chapter 413.

dessiner
to draw
Introduced in Chapter 66.

dessous
underneath
Introduced in Chapter 97.

dessus
on top
Introduced in Chapter 97.

détacher
to remove a stain from; to untie
Introduced in Chapter 447.

détruire
to destroy
Introduced in Chapter 182.

deux
two
Introduced in Chapter 6.

devant
in front
Introduced in Chapter 157.

dévier
to turn aside, to divert
Introduced in Chapter 409.

devoir
must — the third of the set, and the one with a debt inside it
Introduced in Chapter 37.

dévorer
to devour
Introduced in Chapter 520.

différent / différente
different
Introduced in Chapter 219.

difficile
difficult
Introduced in Chapter 90.

diffuser
to broadcast; to spread
Introduced in Chapter 283.

digérer
to digest
Introduced in Chapter 483.

dimanche
Sunday — the Lord's day
Introduced in Chapter 7.

diminuer
to decrease
Introduced in Chapter 208.

diriger
to direct
Introduced in Chapter 182.

discriminer
to discriminate (against)
Introduced in Chapter 365.

discutable
debatable, questionable
Introduced in Chapter 338.

discuter
to discuss
Introduced in Chapter 145.

disparaître
to disappear
Introduced in Chapter 184.

disponible
available, free
Introduced in Chapter 373.

distribuer
to deal (cards); to hand out
Introduced in Chapter 500.

divorcé / divorcée
divorced
Introduced in Chapter 162.

divorcer
to divorce
Introduced in Chapter 207.

dix
ten
Introduced in Chapter 6.

dix-huit
eighteen — free, once you have the rule
Introduced in Chapter 15.

dix-neuf
nineteen — the last number before the system changes again
Introduced in Chapter 15.

dix-sept
seventeen — the number where French stops inheriting and starts building
Introduced in Chapter 15.

donc
so, therefore
Introduced in Chapter 158.

donner
to give
Introduced in Chapter 61.

dorer
to turn golden, to brown; to gild
Introduced in Chapter 331.

dormir
to sleep — Latin dormīre, unchanged in French, and the source of dormitory and dormant, though not of the dormouse
Introduced in Chapter 30.

doubler
to overtake; to double
Introduced in Chapter 410.

douter
to doubt
Introduced in Chapter 338.

douteux
doubtful, dubious
Introduced in Chapter 340.

doux
soft; mild; sweet
Introduced in Chapter 92.

douze
twelve — the second welded teen, and the one that shows the pattern
Introduced in Chapter 14.

draguer
to chat up, to flirt with (informal); to dredge
Introduced in Chapter 487.

drôle
funny
Introduced in Chapter 132.

dur / dure
hard
Introduced in Chapter 244.

durer
to last
Introduced in Chapter 274.

échanger
to exchange
Introduced in Chapter 183.

échapper
to escape; to slip from (one's hands)
Introduced in Chapter 296.

échauffer
to warm up; (s'échauffer) to warm up (before sport)
Introduced in Chapter 504.

échouer
to fail (an exam); to run aground
Introduced in Chapter 378.

éclaircir
to clear up, to make clearer
Introduced in Chapter 341.

économiser
to save (money)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

écouler
to go by (as s'écouler, of time); to sell off (goods)
Introduced in Chapter 275.

écouter
to listen to
Introduced in Chapter 64.

écraser
to crash (as s'écraser); to crush
Introduced in Chapter 305.

écrire
to write — Latin scrībere, "to scratch," with a propped-up é- that French added in front of every borrowed sc-, sp- and st- word
Introduced in Chapter 29.

efficace
effective, efficient
Introduced in Chapter 361.

effondrer
to collapse, to cave in (as s'effondrer)
Introduced in Chapter 303.

effrayer
to frighten, to scare
Introduced in Chapter 470.

égarer
to mislay; to get lost (s'égarer)
Introduced in Chapter 434.

égoutter
to drain
Introduced in Chapter 332.

élever
to bring up, to raise
Introduced in Chapter 494.

éligible
eligible
Introduced in Chapter 383.

éliminer
to knock out, to eliminate
Introduced in Chapter 506.

élucider
to solve, to clear up
Introduced in Chapter 293.

emballer
to wrap (up), to pack; to thrill (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 453.

embarquer
to board; to take along
Introduced in Chapter 418.

embaucher
to hire, to take on
Introduced in Chapter 356.

embrasser
to kiss
Introduced in Chapter 175.

embuer
to mist up (mostly reflexive: s'embuer)
Introduced in Chapter 402.

émincer
to slice thinly
Introduced in Chapter 328.

emménager
to move in
Introduced in Chapter 312.

émouvoir
to move, to touch (emotionally)
Introduced in Chapter 472.

empêcher
to prevent, to stop (from)
Introduced in Chapter 352.

empirer
to get worse
Introduced in Chapter 237.

emprunter
to borrow
Introduced in Chapter 184.

en dernier lieu
lastly, last of all
Introduced in Chapter 268.

en effet
indeed; and that is because
Introduced in Chapter 348.

en premier lieu
in the first place, firstly
Introduced in Chapter 268.

encadrer
to put in a frame; to supervise
Introduced in Chapter 518.

encaisser
to cash in, to take (money); to take (a blow)
Introduced in Chapter 450.

enceinte
pregnant
Introduced in Chapter 308.

enchanté(e)
pleased to meet you (literally "enchanted")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

encore
still, again
Introduced in Chapter 156.

endommager
to damage
Introduced in Chapter 307.

énerver
to annoy, to get on someone's nerves; (s'énerver) to get worked up
Introduced in Chapter 469.

enfin
finally
Introduced in Chapter 156.

enfler
to swell
Introduced in Chapter 481.

enfourner
to put in the oven
Introduced in Chapter 331.

enfreindre
to break (a rule, the law)
Introduced in Chapter 382.

engager
to commit (mostly reflexive, s'engager); to hire
Introduced in Chapter 373.

engendrer
to generate, to give rise to
Introduced in Chapter 349.

enlever
to take off, to remove
Introduced in Chapter 176.

ennuyeux / ennuyeuse
boring
Introduced in Chapter 219.

enquêter
to investigate
Introduced in Chapter 389.

enregistrer
to record
Introduced in Chapter 214.

enrhumé / enrhumée
with a cold
Introduced in Chapter 162.

enseigner
to teach
Introduced in Chapter 61.

ensemble
together
Introduced in Chapter 217.

ensoleillé
sunny
Introduced in Chapter 460.

ensuite
afterwards, next
Introduced in Chapter 156.

entendre
to hear — from a Latin verb meaning "to stretch toward," so English's intend is its closest surviving cousin, and French still keeps the older sense in entendu and s'entendre
Introduced in Chapter 30.

enterrer
to bury
Introduced in Chapter 314.

entraîner
to lead to, to bring about; to train
Introduced in Chapter 346.

entraver
to hinder, to hamper
Introduced in Chapter 352.

entretenir
to maintain
Introduced in Chapter 214.

envahir
to invade; to overrun
Introduced in Chapter 324.

envier
to envy
Introduced in Chapter 475.

environ
about, approximately
Introduced in Chapter 217.

envisager
to consider, to plan on
Introduced in Chapter 373.

envoyer
to send
Introduced in Chapter 65.

épargner
to save up (money); to spare
Introduced in Chapter 391.

épicé / épicée
spicy
Introduced in Chapter 161.

éplucher
to peel
Introduced in Chapter 328.

épouser
to marry
Introduced in Chapter 207.

épousseter
to dust
Introduced in Chapter 528.

épuisé
exhausted, worn out; sold out
Introduced in Chapter 361.

errer
to wander, to roam
Introduced in Chapter 438.

escroquer
to swindle, to con
Introduced in Chapter 288.

espérer
to hope
Introduced in Chapter 138.

esquisser
to sketch, to outline
Introduced in Chapter 516.

essayer
to try
Introduced in Chapter 144.

essorer
to spin (dry), to wring
Introduced in Chapter 526.

essuyer
to wipe, to dry
Introduced in Chapter 530.

et
and — Latin et unchanged, and a t that never joins to the next word
Introduced in Chapter 40.

et demie
half past — literally “and a half”
Introduced in Chapter 8.

et quart
quarter past — literally “and a quarter”
Introduced in Chapter 8.

étaler
to roll out, to spread
Introduced in Chapter 333.

étant donné que
given that
Introduced in Chapter 347.

éteindre
to switch off, to put out
Introduced in Chapter 143.

étendre
to hang out (washing); to spread out
Introduced in Chapter 526.

éternuer
to sneeze
Introduced in Chapter 482.

étirer
to stretch; (s’étirer) to stretch (oneself)
Introduced in Chapter 504.

étouffer
to choke (as s’étouffer); to suffocate, to stifle
Introduced in Chapter 306.

étourdi
scatterbrained, absent-minded
Introduced in Chapter 467.

étrange
strange
Introduced in Chapter 219.

étranger / étrangère
foreign
Introduced in Chapter 220.

être / ser · estar
the same two Latin verbs, and the opposite solution — Spanish kept them apart
Introduced in Chapter 19.

étroit
narrow
Introduced in Chapter 92.

étudier
to study
Introduced in Chapter 62.

évacuer
to evacuate, to clear
Introduced in Chapter 301.

évaluer
to evaluate, to assess
Introduced in Chapter 342.

éventuel
possible (if it happens)
Introduced in Chapter 369.

éventuellement
possibly, if need be
Introduced in Chapter 369.

évident
obvious, evident
Introduced in Chapter 339.

éviter
to avoid
Introduced in Chapter 179.

exagérer
to exaggerate
Introduced in Chapter 182.

exclure
to exclude, to rule out
Introduced in Chapter 383.

exiger
to demand, to require
Introduced in Chapter 381.

exister
to exist
Introduced in Chapter 214.

expédier
to send off, to ship
Introduced in Chapter 449.

expirer
to expire; to breathe out
Introduced in Chapter 384.

expliquer
to explain
Introduced in Chapter 144.

exploser
to explode, to blow up
Introduced in Chapter 302.

exprimer
to express
Introduced in Chapter 214.

fâché / fâchée
angry
Introduced in Chapter 246.

facile
easy
Introduced in Chapter 89.

facultatif
optional
Introduced in Chapter 380.

faible
weak
Introduced in Chapter 91.

faute de
for lack of
Introduced in Chapter 369.

faux / fausse
false, wrong
Introduced in Chapter 245.

favoriser
to favour, to encourage
Introduced in Chapter 352.

fermé
closed
Introduced in Chapter 131.

fermer
to close — from Latin firmāre, "to make firm," so a French door is not shut but made fast; the same verb gave Italian "to stop" and Spanish "to sign"
Introduced in Chapter 31.

fêter
to celebrate
Introduced in Chapter 182.

feuilleter
to leaf through
Introduced in Chapter 520.

février
February — the month of the purification festival
Introduced in Chapter 9.

fiable
reliable
Introduced in Chapter 340.

fiancer
to get engaged (as se fiancer)
Introduced in Chapter 311.

ficeler
to tie up (with string)
Introduced in Chapter 449.

fier / fière
proud
Introduced in Chapter 218.

filmer
to film
Introduced in Chapter 283.

finir
to finish — and the second regular family, which grows an extra syllable in the plural
Introduced in Chapter 41.

fixer
to fix, to stare at
Introduced in Chapter 212.

flâner
to stroll, to wander about
Introduced in Chapter 438.

flasher
to flash (of a speed camera), to catch speeding
Introduced in Chapter 408.

flexible
flexible
Introduced in Chapter 373.

flotter
to float
Introduced in Chapter 212.

flou
blurred, out of focus; vague
Introduced in Chapter 502.

fonctionner
to function, to work
Introduced in Chapter 212.

fort
strong
Introduced in Chapter 91.

fouetter
to whisk, to whip
Introduced in Chapter 329.

fouiller
to search (a bag, a person)
Introduced in Chapter 417.

fouler
to sprain (as se fouler); to tread on
Introduced in Chapter 299.

frais / fraîche
fresh, cool
Introduced in Chapter 161.

frapper
to hit, to knock
Introduced in Chapter 236.

fredonner
to hum
Introduced in Chapter 512.

freiner
to brake
Introduced in Chapter 212.

fréquenter
to attend, to go regularly to; to spend time with
Introduced in Chapter 375.

froissé
creased, crumpled; offended
Introduced in Chapter 527.

frotter
to rub, to scrub
Introduced in Chapter 528.

fumer
to smoke
Introduced in Chapter 146.

gagner
to win; to earn
Introduced in Chapter 66.

garantir
to guarantee
Introduced in Chapter 393.

garer
to park
Introduced in Chapter 175.

gaspiller
to waste
Introduced in Chapter 181.

gâter
to spoil (a child); to ruin
Introduced in Chapter 494.

geler
to freeze
Introduced in Chapter 463.

généreux / généreuse
generous
Introduced in Chapter 246.

gentil
kind, nice
Introduced in Chapter 92.

glisser
to slip
Introduced in Chapter 183.

gonfler
to pump up, to inflate; to swell
Introduced in Chapter 404.

goûter
to taste
Introduced in Chapter 206.

goutter
to drip
Introduced in Chapter 428.

grâce à
thanks to
Introduced in Chapter 348.

gratiner
to brown on top, to cook with a crust
Introduced in Chapter 331.

gratter
to scratch; to itch
Introduced in Chapter 482.

gratuit / gratuite
free of charge
Introduced in Chapter 245.

gravir
to climb (up)
Introduced in Chapter 455.

grelotter
to shiver (with cold)
Introduced in Chapter 463.

grimper
to climb
Introduced in Chapter 498.

gris
grey
Introduced in Chapter 91.

gronder
to rumble; to scold
Introduced in Chapter 462.

gros
big, fat
Introduced in Chapter 93.

grossir
to put on weight
Introduced in Chapter 214.

guérir
to heal, to cure; to get better
Introduced in Chapter 485.

habiter
to live / to dwell (a second -er verb — same pattern)
Introduced in Chapter 5.

hacher
to chop, to mince
Introduced in Chapter 328.

hasardeux
risky, chancy
Introduced in Chapter 372.

haut
high, tall
Introduced in Chapter 90.

héberger
to put up (a guest)
Introduced in Chapter 151.

hériter
to inherit
Introduced in Chapter 315.

heure
hour (feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 8.

heureusement
luckily
Introduced in Chapter 189.

heureux
happy
Introduced in Chapter 55.

heurter
to bump into, to knock against; to offend
Introduced in Chapter 411.

hier
yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 98.

honnête
honest
Introduced in Chapter 220.

hospitaliser
to take into hospital, to hospitalise
Introduced in Chapter 313.

huit
eight
Introduced in Chapter 6.

hurler
to scream
Introduced in Chapter 241.

ici, là, là-bas
here, there, over there — three distances, and the same ci and la already frozen inside voici and voila
Introduced in Chapter 38.

il a, elle a
he has, she has — the verb worn down to a single letter
Introduced in Chapter 17.

il est, ... heures
"it is … o'clock" — the frame that tells the time
Introduced in Chapter 8.

il est, elle est
he is, she is — the most frequently said word in the language
Introduced in Chapter 19.

il était une fois
once upon a time
Introduced in Chapter 321.

il faisait froid, il faisait chaud
it was cold, it was hot — the weather, made in the past
Introduced in Chapter 258.

il y a
there is, there are — literally it has there, and the y is a Latin word for there that survives nowhere else
Introduced in Chapter 38.

ils ont, elles ont
they have — the form that refuses to look like the rest
Introduced in Chapter 17.

ils sont, elles sont
they are — the hiss against ils ont's buzz
Introduced in Chapter 19.

imaginer
to imagine
Introduced in Chapter 209.

impartial
impartial, fair
Introduced in Chapter 342.

impoli / impolie
rude
Introduced in Chapter 159.

imprévisible
unpredictable
Introduced in Chapter 370.

imprimer
to print
Introduced in Chapter 279.

improbable
improbable, unlikely
Introduced in Chapter 372.

improviser
to improvise
Introduced in Chapter 513.

inconfortable
uncomfortable
Introduced in Chapter 159.

inconnu / inconnue
unknown
Introduced in Chapter 160.

incontestable
indisputable, unquestionable
Introduced in Chapter 339.

indemniser
to pay damages to, to indemnify
Introduced in Chapter 433.

indiquer
to point out
Introduced in Chapter 209.

influencer
to influence
Introduced in Chapter 349.

informer
to inform
Introduced in Chapter 209.

injuste
unfair, unjust
Introduced in Chapter 364.

innocent
innocent
Introduced in Chapter 387.

inonder
to flood
Introduced in Chapter 465.

inquiet / inquiète
worried
Introduced in Chapter 162.

inscrire
to enrol, to register (mostly reflexive, s'inscrire); to write down
Introduced in Chapter 376.

insister
to insist
Introduced in Chapter 240.

installer
to install; to set up
Introduced in Chapter 396.

interdire
to forbid
Introduced in Chapter 177.

interpeller
to stop and question (police); to call out to
Introduced in Chapter 294.

interpréter
to perform, to play (a role); to interpret
Introduced in Chapter 515.

interroger
to question, to interrogate
Introduced in Chapter 294.

interrompre
to interrupt
Introduced in Chapter 240.

interviewer
to interview
Introduced in Chapter 283.

inutile
useless
Introduced in Chapter 191.

investir
to invest
Introduced in Chapter 391.

inviter
to invite
Introduced in Chapter 175.

invraisemblable
unlikely, hard to believe
Introduced in Chapter 340.

j'ai
I have — one syllable, one vowel, and all that is left of Latin habeō
Introduced in Chapter 17.

j'ai raté le train
I've missed the train — and the three parts of reporting a problem to a stranger
Introduced in Chapter 263.

j'ai vingt ans / I am twenty
a clean split down Europe — Romance HAS its years, Germanic IS its years
Introduced in Chapter 17.

jadis
long ago, in olden days
Introduced in Chapter 272.

jaloux / jalouse
jealous
Introduced in Chapter 218.

jamais
never; ever
Introduced in Chapter 96.

janvier
January — the month of Janus, god of doorways
Introduced in Chapter 9.

jardiner
to garden
Introduced in Chapter 503.

je
I
Introduced in Chapter 2.

je devrais
I should — devoir softened into advice, with the same ending as je voudrais
Introduced in Chapter 261.

je m'appelle...
my name is… (literally "I call myself")
Introduced in Chapter 2.

Je parle français
"I speak French" — your first full sentence (français = French)
Introduced in Chapter 5.

je suis
I am — from Latin sum, and one of the oldest word-shapes in Europe
Introduced in Chapter 19.

je suis désolé(e)
I'm sorry (literally "I am desolate")
Introduced in Chapter 24.

jeter
to throw away
Introduced in Chapter 236.

jeudi
Thursday — the day of Jupiter
Introduced in Chapter 7.

jeune
young
Introduced in Chapter 92.

joli
pretty
Introduced in Chapter 130.

jouer
to play
Introduced in Chapter 60.

jour
day (le jour — masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

joyeux / joyeuse
cheerful
Introduced in Chapter 190.

juger
to judge
Introduced in Chapter 342.

juillet
July — the month renamed for Julius Caesar
Introduced in Chapter 10.

juin
June — the month of Juno, queen of the gods
Introduced in Chapter 9.

jusqu'à
until
Introduced in Chapter 187.

jusqu'alors
until then, up to then
Introduced in Chapter 272.

juste
fair, right
Introduced in Chapter 245.

justifier
to justify
Introduced in Chapter 351.

klaxonner
to honk, to sound the horn
Introduced in Chapter 402.

l'abeille
a bee
Introduced in Chapter 87.

l'abonné
the subscriber
Introduced in Chapter 278.

l'abonnement
the subscription; the season ticket
Introduced in Chapter 390.

l'accordéon
accordion
Introduced in Chapter 511.

l'accouchement
the delivery, giving birth
Introduced in Chapter 308.

l'accusation
the accusation, the charge
Introduced in Chapter 386.

l'acompte
the down payment, the part payment
Introduced in Chapter 433.

l'acteur
an actor
Introduced in Chapter 249.

l'actrice
an actress
Introduced in Chapter 249.

l'actualité
the news, current events
Introduced in Chapter 278.

l'addition
the bill
Introduced in Chapter 247.

l'admission
the admission, the entry
Introduced in Chapter 383.

l'adolescence
adolescence, the teenage years
Introduced in Chapter 310.

l'adolescent
the teenager, the adolescent
Introduced in Chapter 310.

l'adoption
adoption
Introduced in Chapter 492.

l'adresse
an address
Introduced in Chapter 134.

l'adulte
an adult
Introduced in Chapter 250.

l'adversaire
the opponent
Introduced in Chapter 345.

l'aérogare
the airport building (for passengers)
Introduced in Chapter 416.

l'aéroport
an airport
Introduced in Chapter 103.

l'agence de presse
the news agency
Introduced in Chapter 281.

l'agresseur
the attacker, the assailant
Introduced in Chapter 289.

l'agression
the attack, the assault
Introduced in Chapter 289.

l'agriculteur
a farmer
Introduced in Chapter 123.

l'aiguille
a needle
Introduced in Chapter 230.

l'ail
garlic
Introduced in Chapter 120.

l'aîné
eldest, older (sibling)
Introduced in Chapter 490.

l'airbag
the airbag
Introduced in Chapter 298.

l'aire
the rest area (on a motorway); the area
Introduced in Chapter 410.

l'alerte
the alert, the alarm
Introduced in Chapter 301.

l'alibi
the alibi
Introduced in Chapter 293.

l'allée
the aisle; the path, the drive
Introduced in Chapter 418.

l'allergie
allergy
Introduced in Chapter 482.

l'alliance
wedding ring; alliance
Introduced in Chapter 489.

l'ambulance
ambulance
Introduced in Chapter 484.

l'amende
a fine
Introduced in Chapter 227.

l'ami, l'amie
friend — masculine or feminine by a regular swap, and the reason le/la elides to l' before a vowel
Introduced in Chapter 33.

l'amitié
friendship
Introduced in Chapter 186.

l'amour
love
Introduced in Chapter 155.

l'amphithéâtre
the lecture hall
Introduced in Chapter 376.

l'ampoule
the light bulb; the blister
Introduced in Chapter 429.

l'ancêtre
the ancestor
Introduced in Chapter 325.

l'angle
the corner; the angle
Introduced in Chapter 435.

l'angoisse
anxiety
Introduced in Chapter 155.

l'anniversaire
a birthday
Introduced in Chapter 257.

l'annonce
an advert, an announcement
Introduced in Chapter 142.

l'annulation
the cancellation
Introduced in Chapter 421.

l'antenne
the aerial, the antenna; being on air
Introduced in Chapter 283.

l'appareil
the device, the appliance
Introduced in Chapter 396.

l'appartement
a flat
Introduced in Chapter 163.

l'appât
bait
Introduced in Chapter 497.

l'apprenti
the apprentice
Introduced in Chapter 357.

l'apprentissage
the apprenticeship; learning
Introduced in Chapter 357.

l'aquarelle
watercolour
Introduced in Chapter 516.

l'arbitre
referee, umpire
Introduced in Chapter 505.

l'arbre
a tree
Introduced in Chapter 81.

l'archéologue
the archaeologist
Introduced in Chapter 325.

l'architecte
an architect
Introduced in Chapter 166.

l'argent
money; silver
Introduced in Chapter 79.

l'argile
clay
Introduced in Chapter 517.

l'argumentation
the line of argument
Introduced in Chapter 335.

l'armée
an army
Introduced in Chapter 165.

l'armoire
a wardrobe
Introduced in Chapter 112.

l'arnaque
the scam, the rip-off (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 288.

l'arrestation
the arrest
Introduced in Chapter 294.

l'arrêt
a stop
Introduced in Chapter 247.

l'arrivée
arrival
Introduced in Chapter 231.

l'arrondissement
the district (of a large city)
Introduced in Chapter 440.

l'arrosoir
watering can
Introduced in Chapter 503.

l'art
art
Introduced in Chapter 257.

l'ascenseur
a lift, an elevator
Introduced in Chapter 106.

l'aspect
the aspect, the side (of a question)
Introduced in Chapter 343.

l'aspirateur
a vacuum cleaner
Introduced in Chapter 115.

l'assiette
a plate
Introduced in Chapter 76.

l'association
the association, the club, the charity
Introduced in Chapter 366.

l'assurance
the insurance; self-confidence
Introduced in Chapter 307.

l'atout
the asset, the strong point; the trump card
Introduced in Chapter 352.

l'attelle
splint
Introduced in Chapter 481.

l'atterrissage
the landing (of a plane)
Introduced in Chapter 419.

l'attestation
the official statement, the attestation
Introduced in Chapter 385.

l'auberge
the inn; the hostel
Introduced in Chapter 424.

l'auditeur
the listener
Introduced in Chapter 280.

l'augmentation
the pay rise, the increase
Introduced in Chapter 360.

l'automne
autumn — the season English borrowed whole
Introduced in Chapter 11.

l'autorisation
the authorisation, the permission
Introduced in Chapter 381.

l'autoroute
a motorway
Introduced in Chapter 227.

l'avalanche
the avalanche
Introduced in Chapter 303.

l'avantage
the advantage
Introduced in Chapter 343.

l'avenir
the future
Introduced in Chapter 141.

l'avenue
the avenue
Introduced in Chapter 437.

l'averse
the rain shower, the downpour
Introduced in Chapter 461.

l'aveu
the confession, the avowal
Introduced in Chapter 295.

l'avion
an aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 99.

l'avis
a notice, an opinion
Introduced in Chapter 142.

l'avocat
a lawyer; an avocado
Introduced in Chapter 124.

l'eau
water — the most worn-down word French ever took from Latin
Introduced in Chapter 13.

l'éboulement
the rockfall, the landslide
Introduced in Chapter 303.

l'ébullition
boiling, the boiling point
Introduced in Chapter 330.

l'échangeur
the interchange (between motorways)
Introduced in Chapter 400.

l'écharpe
a scarf
Introduced in Chapter 116.

l'échéance
the deadline, the due date
Introduced in Chapter 275.

l'échec
failure
Introduced in Chapter 197.

l'échelle
a ladder
Introduced in Chapter 230.

l'échiquier
chessboard
Introduced in Chapter 499.

l'éclair
lightning
Introduced in Chapter 229.

l'éclaircie
the bright spell, the sunny interval
Introduced in Chapter 461.

l'école
a school
Introduced in Chapter 99.

l'économie
the economy
Introduced in Chapter 248.

l'écorce
the bark (of a tree); the peel
Introduced in Chapter 457.

l'écran
a screen
Introduced in Chapter 195.

l'écrivain
a writer
Introduced in Chapter 249.

l'écureuil
the squirrel
Introduced in Chapter 459.

l'éditorial
the editorial, the leading article
Introduced in Chapter 282.

l'efficacité
the efficiency, effectiveness
Introduced in Chapter 361.

l'effraction
the forced entry, breaking in
Introduced in Chapter 287.

l'égalité
the equality
Introduced in Chapter 362.

l'église
a church
Introduced in Chapter 100.

l'égout
the sewer, the drain
Introduced in Chapter 443.

l'égratignure
scratch, graze
Introduced in Chapter 479.

l'électricien
an electrician
Introduced in Chapter 196.

l'électricité
electricity
Introduced in Chapter 255.

l'éléphant
an elephant
Introduced in Chapter 88.

l'élève
a pupil
Introduced in Chapter 59.

l'emballage
the packaging, the wrapping
Introduced in Chapter 453.

l'embarquement
the boarding
Introduced in Chapter 416.

l'embauche
the hiring, being taken on
Introduced in Chapter 354.

l'embouteillage
the gridlock, the traffic jam
Introduced in Chapter 410.

l'émission
(television or radio) programme; emission
Introduced in Chapter 525.

l'emploi
the job, employment; the use
Introduced in Chapter 356.

l'employé
an employee
Introduced in Chapter 224.

l'employeur
the employer
Introduced in Chapter 357.

l'empreinte
the print, the fingerprint
Introduced in Chapter 292.

l'emprunt
the loan (that you take out)
Introduced in Chapter 394.

l'énergie
energy
Introduced in Chapter 255.

l'enfance
childhood
Introduced in Chapter 309.

l'enfant
child — one spelling for both genders, the article alone showing which; literally "not yet speaking"
Introduced in Chapter 33.

l'engagement
the commitment
Introduced in Chapter 373.

l'enquête
the investigation, the inquiry; the survey
Introduced in Chapter 389.

l'enquêteur
the investigator
Introduced in Chapter 292.

l'enregistrement
the check-in; the recording
Introduced in Chapter 416.

l'enseigne
the shop sign; the brand
Introduced in Chapter 442.

l'enterrement
the burial, the funeral
Introduced in Chapter 314.

l'entorse
sprain
Introduced in Chapter 481.

l'entracte
interval, intermission
Introduced in Chapter 514.

l'entraîneur
a coach
Introduced in Chapter 203.

l'entrée
an entrance
Introduced in Chapter 199.

l'entreprise
a company
Introduced in Chapter 174.

l'entretien
an interview
Introduced in Chapter 204.

l'enveloppe
an envelope
Introduced in Chapter 252.

l'environnement
the environment
Introduced in Chapter 229.

l'envoyé spécial
the special correspondent
Introduced in Chapter 281.

l'épargne
the savings, saving
Introduced in Chapter 391.

l'épaule
a shoulder
Introduced in Chapter 50.

l'épicerie
a grocer's shop
Introduced in Chapter 107.

l'épicier
the grocer
Introduced in Chapter 444.

l'épine
a thorn
Introduced in Chapter 254.

l'épisode
episode
Introduced in Chapter 523.

l'éponge
sponge
Introduced in Chapter 528.

l'époque
the time, the era, the period
Introduced in Chapter 276.

l'épreuve
the test, the exam paper; the ordeal
Introduced in Chapter 379.

l'équipe
a team
Introduced in Chapter 257.

l'ère
the era, the age
Introduced in Chapter 276.

l'erreur
a mistake
Introduced in Chapter 232.

l'escalade
climbing
Introduced in Chapter 498.

l'escale
the stopover, the port of call
Introduced in Chapter 420.

l'escalier
the stairs
Introduced in Chapter 75.

l'escroc
the swindler, the con artist
Introduced in Chapter 288.

l'escroquerie
the fraud, the swindle
Introduced in Chapter 288.

l'espoir
hope
Introduced in Chapter 186.

l'estomac
the stomach
Introduced in Chapter 52.

l'étage
the storey, the floor (of a building)
Introduced in Chapter 426.

l'étagère
a shelf
Introduced in Chapter 112.

l'étang
the pond
Introduced in Chapter 456.

l'étape
the step, the leg; a stop on a journey
Introduced in Chapter 277.

l'été
summer — literally "the heat"
Introduced in Chapter 11.

l'étincelle
the spark
Introduced in Chapter 302.

l'étiquette
a label
Introduced in Chapter 169.

l'étoile
a star
Introduced in Chapter 83.

l'étranger
a foreigner
Introduced in Chapter 250.

l'étudiant
a student
Introduced in Chapter 124.

l'éventualité
the possibility, the eventuality
Introduced in Chapter 369.

l'évidence
the obvious, what is plain to see
Introduced in Chapter 339.

l'évier
(kitchen) sink
Introduced in Chapter 530.

l'examen
an exam
Introduced in Chapter 126.

l'excès de vitesse
speeding
Introduced in Chapter 297.

l'exemple
an example
Introduced in Chapter 251.

l'exigence
the requirement, the demand
Introduced in Chapter 383.

l'expérience
experience
Introduced in Chapter 225.

l'explosion
the explosion, the blast
Introduced in Chapter 302.

l'exposition
exhibition
Introduced in Chapter 518.

l'extincteur
the fire extinguisher
Introduced in Chapter 302.

l'haltère
dumbbell, weight
Introduced in Chapter 504.

l'hameçon
fish hook
Introduced in Chapter 497.

l'hebdomadaire
the weekly (paper or magazine)
Introduced in Chapter 278.

l'hématome
the haematoma, the large bruise
Introduced in Chapter 299.

l'herbe
grass
Introduced in Chapter 134.

l'héritage
the inheritance; the heritage
Introduced in Chapter 315.

l'histoire
history, a story
Introduced in Chapter 232.

l'historien
the historian
Introduced in Chapter 325.

l'hiver
winter — literally "the wintry season"
Introduced in Chapter 11.

l'hôpital
a hospital
Introduced in Chapter 54.

l'horaire
opening hours, a timetable
Introduced in Chapter 142.

l'horloger
the watchmaker, the clockmaker
Introduced in Chapter 448.

l'horodateur
the parking ticket machine
Introduced in Chapter 407.

l'hôtel
a hotel
Introduced in Chapter 101.

l'hôtesse
the flight attendant (a woman); the hostess
Introduced in Chapter 418.

l'huile
oil
Introduced in Chapter 69.

l'humeur
mood
Introduced in Chapter 469.

l'humidité
the humidity, the damp
Introduced in Chapter 464.

l'hypothèse
the hypothesis
Introduced in Chapter 367.

l'idée
an idea
Introduced in Chapter 127.

l'identifiant
the username, the login
Introduced in Chapter 395.

l'île
an island
Introduced in Chapter 82.

l'immeuble
a block of flats
Introduced in Chapter 253.

l'immigration
the immigration
Introduced in Chapter 365.

l'impact
the impact
Introduced in Chapter 350.

l'impasse
the dead end; the deadlock
Introduced in Chapter 437.

l'impôt
a tax
Introduced in Chapter 252.

l'imprévu
the hitch, the unexpected event
Introduced in Chapter 370.

l'imprimante
a printer
Introduced in Chapter 204.

l'incendie
the fire, the blaze
Introduced in Chapter 302.

l'inconvénient
the drawback, the disadvantage
Introduced in Chapter 343.

l'indice
the clue; the index, the rating
Introduced in Chapter 292.

l'inégalité
the inequality
Introduced in Chapter 365.

l'infirmière
a nurse
Introduced in Chapter 123.

l'influence
the influence
Introduced in Chapter 349.

l'infraction
the offence, the violation
Introduced in Chapter 382.

l'ingénieur
an engineer
Introduced in Chapter 124.

l'ingrédient
the ingredient
Introduced in Chapter 327.

l'injustice
the injustice
Introduced in Chapter 364.

l'inondation
the flood
Introduced in Chapter 465.

l'inquiétude
worry, anxiety
Introduced in Chapter 476.

l'inscription
the registration, the enrolment
Introduced in Chapter 376.

l'insomnie
insomnia, sleeplessness
Introduced in Chapter 486.

l'inspecteur
the inspector, the police inspector
Introduced in Chapter 292.

l'instant
the instant, the moment
Introduced in Chapter 277.

l'intention
the intention
Introduced in Chapter 374.

l'interdiction
a ban
Introduced in Chapter 168.

l'intoxication
the poisoning
Introduced in Chapter 306.

l'intrigue
plot (of a story); intrigue
Introduced in Chapter 519.

l'invasion
the invasion
Introduced in Chapter 324.

l'investissement
the investment
Introduced in Chapter 391.

l'invité
a guest
Introduced in Chapter 58.

l'itinéraire
the route, the itinerary
Introduced in Chapter 436.

l'objectif
the objective, the target; the lens
Introduced in Chapter 374.

l'objection
the objection
Introduced in Chapter 336.

l'obligation
the obligation, the duty
Introduced in Chapter 380.

l'oignon
an onion
Introduced in Chapter 68.

l'oiseau
a bird
Introduced in Chapter 85.

l'oncle
an uncle
Introduced in Chapter 57.

l'ongle
a nail (finger or toe)
Introduced in Chapter 51.

l'opticien
the optician
Introduced in Chapter 448.

l'orage
a storm
Introduced in Chapter 133.

l'orange
an orange
Introduced in Chapter 68.

l'orchestre
orchestra; stalls (in a theatre)
Introduced in Chapter 513.

l'ordinateur
a computer
Introduced in Chapter 111.

l'ordonnance
a prescription
Introduced in Chapter 215.

l'oreille
an ear
Introduced in Chapter 134.

l'oreiller
a pillow
Introduced in Chapter 113.

l'orgueil
arrogance, excessive pride
Introduced in Chapter 473.

l'origine
the origin
Introduced in Chapter 348.

l'orteil
toe
Introduced in Chapter 477.

l'os
bone
Introduced in Chapter 480.

l'otage
the hostage
Introduced in Chapter 296.

l'ouest
the west
Introduced in Chapter 109.

l'ours
a bear
Introduced in Chapter 86.

l'outil
a tool
Introduced in Chapter 256.

l'ouvrier
a worker
Introduced in Chapter 196.

l'université
a university
Introduced in Chapter 232.

l'urgence
an emergency
Introduced in Chapter 243.

l'usine
a factory
Introduced in Chapter 108.

l'utilisateur
the user
Introduced in Chapter 395.

l'œil, les yeux
eye — masculine, with a plural that looks irregular but is the REGULAR outcome of Latin oculos; œil's own singular is the piece that changed
Introduced in Chapter 35.

l'œuf, les œufs
egg — masculine, a genuine cousin of English egg, and the one French noun whose final consonant vanishes only in the plural
Introduced in Chapter 34.

l'œuvre
work (of art)
Introduced in Chapter 518.

la bague
a ring
Introduced in Chapter 118.

la baignoire
a bathtub
Introduced in Chapter 112.

la baisse
the drop, the fall
Introduced in Chapter 286.

la banane
a banana
Introduced in Chapter 68.

la bande dessinée
comic book, comic strip
Introduced in Chapter 522.

la banderole
the banner
Introduced in Chapter 363.

la banlieue
the suburbs
Introduced in Chapter 216.

la banque
a bank
Introduced in Chapter 99.

la banquette
the back seat; the bench seat
Introduced in Chapter 406.

la basilique
the basilica
Introduced in Chapter 439.

la batterie
a battery
Introduced in Chapter 223.

la belle-fille
a daughter-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 167.

la belle-mère
a mother-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 167.

la belote
belote (a card game)
Introduced in Chapter 500.

la béquille
crutch
Introduced in Chapter 480.

la bibliothèque
a library
Introduced in Chapter 102.

la biche
the doe, the hind
Introduced in Chapter 459.

la bière
beer
Introduced in Chapter 121.

la biographie
biography
Introduced in Chapter 522.

la blessure
a wound
Introduced in Chapter 185.

la boîte
a box
Introduced in Chapter 80.

la boîte aux lettres
a letterbox, a postbox
Introduced in Chapter 109.

la borne
the marker post, the boundary stone; the charging point
Introduced in Chapter 435.

la bosse
bump, lump
Introduced in Chapter 479.

la bouche
mouth — feminine, and originally the Latin word for cheek, not mouth at all
Introduced in Chapter 35.

la boucherie
a butcher's
Introduced in Chapter 164.

la boue
mud
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la bouée
the buoy; the rubber ring
Introduced in Chapter 304.

la bougie
the candle; the spark plug
Introduced in Chapter 320.

la boulangerie
a bakery
Introduced in Chapter 102.

la bourse
the grant, the scholarship; the stock exchange
Introduced in Chapter 379.

la boussole
the compass
Introduced in Chapter 434.

la bouteille
a bottle
Introduced in Chapter 77.

la braderie
the street sale, the clearance market
Introduced in Chapter 452.

la branche
a branch
Introduced in Chapter 228.

la brasse
breaststroke
Introduced in Chapter 509.

la bretelle
the slip road; the strap
Introduced in Chapter 400.

la brigade
the squad, the brigade
Introduced in Chapter 291.

la brique
a brick
Introduced in Chapter 202.

la brosse à dents
a toothbrush
Introduced in Chapter 113.

la bruine
the drizzle
Introduced in Chapter 461.

la brûlure
burn
Introduced in Chapter 479.

la bûche
the log; the yule log cake
Introduced in Chapter 319.

la bureaucratie
the bureaucracy, the red tape
Introduced in Chapter 385.

la cabine
the cabin
Introduced in Chapter 422.

la caisse
a till, a checkout
Introduced in Chapter 125.

la candidature
the application (for a job)
Introduced in Chapter 354.

la canicule
the heatwave
Introduced in Chapter 464.

la canne à pêche
fishing rod
Introduced in Chapter 497.

la carotte
a carrot
Introduced in Chapter 69.

la carrière
a career
Introduced in Chapter 204.

la carrosserie
the bodywork (of a car)
Introduced in Chapter 406.

la carte
a map; a card
Introduced in Chapter 80.

la carte bancaire
a bank card
Introduced in Chapter 226.

la carte postale
a postcard
Introduced in Chapter 169.

la cascade
a waterfall
Introduced in Chapter 171.

la caserne
the barracks; the fire station
Introduced in Chapter 440.

la casquette
a cap
Introduced in Chapter 117.

la casserole
a saucepan
Introduced in Chapter 193.

la catastrophe
the catastrophe, the disaster
Introduced in Chapter 305.

la cathédrale
the cathedral
Introduced in Chapter 439.

la cave
a cellar
Introduced in Chapter 200.

la ceinture
a belt
Introduced in Chapter 116.

la célébration
the celebration
Introduced in Chapter 316.

la censure
censorship
Introduced in Chapter 285.

la cérémonie
ceremony
Introduced in Chapter 489.

la cerise
a cherry
Introduced in Chapter 120.

la chaise
a chair
Introduced in Chapter 73.

la chaleur
heat
Introduced in Chapter 133.

la chambre
a bedroom
Introduced in Chapter 74.

la chanson
a song
Introduced in Chapter 128.

la charcuterie
the pork butcher, the delicatessen; cold meats
Introduced in Chapter 444.

la chaussée
the road surface, the carriageway
Introduced in Chapter 409.

la chemise
a shirt
Introduced in Chapter 103.

la cheville
an ankle
Introduced in Chapter 52.

la chèvre
a goat
Introduced in Chapter 87.

la chorale
choir
Introduced in Chapter 512.

la chronologie
the chronology, the order of events
Introduced in Chapter 277.

la chute
the fall; the drop
Introduced in Chapter 299.

la cicatrice
a scar
Introduced in Chapter 185.

la citoyenneté
the citizenship
Introduced in Chapter 362.

la civière
the stretcher
Introduced in Chapter 300.

la clairière
the clearing (in a wood)
Introduced in Chapter 457.

la classe
a class; a classroom
Introduced in Chapter 126.

la clé
a key
Introduced in Chapter 73.

la climatisation
the air conditioning
Introduced in Chapter 427.

la clôture
a fence
Introduced in Chapter 200.

la cocotte
the casserole dish, the cast-iron pot
Introduced in Chapter 330.

la colère
anger
Introduced in Chapter 55.

la colline
a hill
Introduced in Chapter 84.

la communauté
the community
Introduced in Chapter 366.

la compétence
the skill, the competence
Introduced in Chapter 360.

la complicité
closeness, bond; complicity
Introduced in Chapter 488.

la condamnation
the conviction, the sentence; the condemnation
Introduced in Chapter 388.

la confiance
trust
Introduced in Chapter 186.

la confiture
jam
Introduced in Chapter 71.

la connexion
the connection
Introduced in Chapter 398.

la conquête
the conquest
Introduced in Chapter 324.

la conséquence
the consequence
Introduced in Chapter 346.

la consigne
the left-luggage office; the instruction
Introduced in Chapter 414.

la consultation
a medical appointment
Introduced in Chapter 243.

la contravention
the fine (for a driving offence), the ticket
Introduced in Chapter 408.

la contusion
the bruise, the contusion
Introduced in Chapter 299.

la convalescence
convalescence, recovery period
Introduced in Chapter 485.

la corde
a rope
Introduced in Chapter 202.

la correspondance
a connection
Introduced in Chapter 203.

la cotisation
the contribution, the membership fee
Introduced in Chapter 390.

la couchette
the berth, the couchette
Introduced in Chapter 414.

la couleur
a colour
Introduced in Chapter 129.

la coupure
cut
Introduced in Chapter 479.

la couronne
the crown; the wreath
Introduced in Chapter 323.

la cousine
a cousin (female)
Introduced in Chapter 57.

la couture
sewing; fashion design
Introduced in Chapter 496.

la couverture
a blanket
Introduced in Chapter 113.

la cravate
a tie
Introduced in Chapter 116.

la crèche
day nursery, crèche; nativity scene
Introduced in Chapter 494.

la crémaillère
the house-warming; a pot-hook
Introduced in Chapter 312.

la crème
cream
Introduced in Chapter 72.

la crevaison
the puncture, the flat tyre
Introduced in Chapter 404.

la crique
the cove, the creek
Introduced in Chapter 458.

la critique
the criticism; the review
Introduced in Chapter 343.

la croisière
the cruise
Introduced in Chapter 423.

la cuillère
a spoon
Introduced in Chapter 77.

la cuillerée
the spoonful
Introduced in Chapter 327.

la cuisine
a kitchen; cooking
Introduced in Chapter 73.

la cuisse
thigh
Introduced in Chapter 477.

la cuisson
the cooking, the cooking time
Introduced in Chapter 331.

la date
a date
Introduced in Chapter 135.

la décennie
the decade
Introduced in Chapter 276.

la déception
disappointment
Introduced in Chapter 471.

la décision
a decision
Introduced in Chapter 225.

la dédicace
signed message, inscription (in a book); dedication
Introduced in Chapter 521.

la défaite
a defeat
Introduced in Chapter 203.

la défense
the defence
Introduced in Chapter 387.

la délinquance
crime, delinquency
Introduced in Chapter 290.

la demande en mariage
the marriage proposal
Introduced in Chapter 311.

la démangeaison
itch, itching
Introduced in Chapter 482.

la démarche
the step (to get something done); the gait
Introduced in Chapter 385.

la démission
the resignation
Introduced in Chapter 355.

la dent
a tooth
Introduced in Chapter 49.

la dépanneuse
the tow truck, the breakdown lorry
Introduced in Chapter 405.

la dépêche
the dispatch, the wire story
Introduced in Chapter 281.

la dépense
the expense, the spending
Introduced in Chapter 390.

la désinformation
disinformation, false information
Introduced in Chapter 285.

la destination
a destination
Introduced in Chapter 231.

la dette
a debt
Introduced in Chapter 226.

la déviation
the diversion, the detour (for traffic)
Introduced in Chapter 410.

la différence
a difference
Introduced in Chapter 251.

la diffusion
the broadcasting, the showing; the spread
Introduced in Chapter 283.

la discrimination
the discrimination
Introduced in Chapter 365.

la dispute
quarrel, argument
Introduced in Chapter 495.

la douane
customs
Introduced in Chapter 164.

la douche
a shower
Introduced in Chapter 112.

la douleur
pain
Introduced in Chapter 53.

la dragée
the sugared almond
Introduced in Chapter 311.

la droguerie
the household goods shop
Introduced in Chapter 445.

la droite
the right
Introduced in Chapter 110.

la dune
the dune
Introduced in Chapter 458.

la durée
the length, the duration
Introduced in Chapter 276.

la fable
the fable
Introduced in Chapter 321.

la façade
the façade, the front (of a building)
Introduced in Chapter 442.

la facture
a bill, an invoice
Introduced in Chapter 142.

la faculté
the faculty, the university; the ability
Introduced in Chapter 376.

la faillite
the bankruptcy
Introduced in Chapter 394.

la falaise
the cliff
Introduced in Chapter 454.

la famille
family — feminine and fixed, whoever is in it, and once meant the household's servants
Introduced in Chapter 33.

la famille nombreuse
large family
Introduced in Chapter 492.

la fanfare
the brass band; a fanfare
Introduced in Chapter 316.

la farine
flour
Introduced in Chapter 120.

la fatigue
tiredness
Introduced in Chapter 54.

la fée
the fairy
Introduced in Chapter 321.

la femme
a woman; a wife
Introduced in Chapter 57.

la fenêtre
a window
Introduced in Chapter 73.

la feuille
a leaf; a sheet of paper
Introduced in Chapter 81.

la feuille de papier
a sheet of paper
Introduced in Chapter 204.

la fiancée
a fiancée
Introduced in Chapter 167.

la fiche de paie
a pay slip
Introduced in Chapter 169.

la fierté
pride
Introduced in Chapter 473.

la fièvre
a fever
Introduced in Chapter 53.

la fille
a daughter; a girl
Introduced in Chapter 56.

la flamme
a flame
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la flaque
the puddle
Introduced in Chapter 465.

la flèche
the arrow
Introduced in Chapter 435.

la fleur
a flower
Introduced in Chapter 81.

la flûte
flute; recorder
Introduced in Chapter 511.

la fois
a time, an occasion
Introduced in Chapter 129.

la fontaine
a fountain
Introduced in Chapter 170.

la formation
the training, the education
Introduced in Chapter 360.

la foudre
the lightning (that strikes)
Introduced in Chapter 462.

la fougère
the fern, the bracken
Introduced in Chapter 457.

la fouille
the dig, the excavation; a search
Introduced in Chapter 325.

la fourchette
a fork
Introduced in Chapter 77.

la fourmi
an ant
Introduced in Chapter 88.

la fourrière
the car pound
Introduced in Chapter 407.

la fracture
fracture, break (of a bone)
Introduced in Chapter 480.

la fraise
a strawberry
Introduced in Chapter 120.

la fratrie
siblings (as a group)
Introduced in Chapter 492.

la frayeur
fright, scare
Introduced in Chapter 470.

la frontière
a border
Introduced in Chapter 109.

la fuite
the leak; the escape
Introduced in Chapter 428.

la fumée
smoke
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la gaieté
cheerfulness
Introduced in Chapter 474.

la galerie
gallery; arcade
Introduced in Chapter 518.

la galette
the king cake; a flat round cake
Introduced in Chapter 319.

la garantie
the guarantee, the warranty
Introduced in Chapter 393.

la garde à vue
police custody
Introduced in Chapter 294.

la gauche
the left
Introduced in Chapter 110.

la gendarmerie
the gendarmerie; its offices
Introduced in Chapter 291.

la géographie
geography
Introduced in Chapter 257.

la glace
ice cream; ice; a mirror
Introduced in Chapter 121.

la gomme
a rubber, an eraser
Introduced in Chapter 127.

la gorge
the throat
Introduced in Chapter 51.

la gourde
water bottle, flask
Introduced in Chapter 498.

la gouttière
the roof gutter, the rain gutter
Introduced in Chapter 442.

la graine
a seed
Introduced in Chapter 228.

la grand-mère
a grandmother
Introduced in Chapter 56.

la grêle
the hail
Introduced in Chapter 462.

la grenouille
a frog
Introduced in Chapter 88.

la grève
the strike
Introduced in Chapter 358.

la grippe
flu
Introduced in Chapter 215.

la grossesse
pregnancy
Introduced in Chapter 493.

la grotte
a cave
Introduced in Chapter 254.

la guérison
recovery, cure
Introduced in Chapter 485.

la guerre
war
Introduced in Chapter 165.

la guirlande
the garland, the string of lights
Introduced in Chapter 318.

la guitare
a guitar
Introduced in Chapter 256.

la halle
the covered market (hall)
Introduced in Chapter 442.

la hanche
hip
Introduced in Chapter 477.

la hausse
the rise, the increase
Introduced in Chapter 286.

la honte
shame
Introduced in Chapter 186.

la jalousie
jealousy
Introduced in Chapter 475.

la jambe
a leg
Introduced in Chapter 49.

la jeunesse
youth, young people
Introduced in Chapter 310.

la joie
joy
Introduced in Chapter 55.

la joue
a cheek
Introduced in Chapter 51.

la jupe
a skirt
Introduced in Chapter 104.

la justice
the justice; the courts
Introduced in Chapter 364.

la justification
the justification
Introduced in Chapter 351.

la laine
wool
Introduced in Chapter 172.

la lampe
a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 74.

la lampe de poche
torch, flashlight
Introduced in Chapter 498.

la laverie
the launderette
Introduced in Chapter 447.

la leçon
a lesson
Introduced in Chapter 126.

la légende
the legend; the caption
Introduced in Chapter 322.

la lessive
washing powder; the washing
Introduced in Chapter 115.

la lettre
a letter
Introduced in Chapter 118.

la lèvre
a lip
Introduced in Chapter 134.

la levure
the yeast; baking powder
Introduced in Chapter 333.

la libération
the liberation, the release
Introduced in Chapter 326.

la liberté
the freedom, liberty
Introduced in Chapter 362.

la ligne d'arrivée
finishing line
Introduced in Chapter 508.

la livraison
the delivery
Introduced in Chapter 359.

la loi
a law
Introduced in Chapter 222.

la louche
ladle
Introduced in Chapter 529.

la luge
sledge, sled
Introduced in Chapter 510.

la lune
the Moon (feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 7.

la lune de miel
honeymoon
Introduced in Chapter 489.

la machine à laver
washing machine
Introduced in Chapter 526.

la main
the hand — feminine despite ending in a consonant, and the root of half the words you know
Introduced in Chapter 21.

la mairie
the town hall
Introduced in Chapter 102.

la maladie
an illness
Introduced in Chapter 54.

la manchette
the banner headline; a shirt cuff
Introduced in Chapter 282.

la manifestation
the demonstration, the protest march; the event
Introduced in Chapter 363.

la maquette
scale model; mock-up
Introduced in Chapter 501.

la marée
the tide
Introduced in Chapter 458.

la mariée
a bride
Introduced in Chapter 197.

la marmite
the cooking pot, the stockpot
Introduced in Chapter 330.

la marraine
godmother
Introduced in Chapter 490.

la maternité
the maternity hospital; motherhood
Introduced in Chapter 309.

la médaille
medal
Introduced in Chapter 507.

la mélancolie
melancholy, gloom
Introduced in Chapter 472.

la mélodie
melody, tune
Introduced in Chapter 512.

la menace
the threat
Introduced in Chapter 289.

la mention
the distinction, the honours (on an exam); the mention
Introduced in Chapter 379.

la mer
the sea
Introduced in Chapter 82.

la mercerie
the haberdasher's, the sewing shop
Introduced in Chapter 445.

la mère
mother — and the reason English calls physical stuff "matter"
Introduced in Chapter 12.

la météo
the weather forecast; the weather
Introduced in Chapter 460.

la migraine
migraine, bad headache
Introduced in Chapter 483.

la mise à jour
the update
Introduced in Chapter 396.

la monnaie
change (coins); currency
Introduced in Chapter 135.

la montagne
a mountain
Introduced in Chapter 81.

la montre
a watch
Introduced in Chapter 221.

la moquette
the fitted carpet
Introduced in Chapter 429.

la morale
the moral (of a story); morals
Introduced in Chapter 322.

la morsure
the bite (a wound)
Introduced in Chapter 306.

la moto
a motorbike
Introduced in Chapter 247.

la mouche
a fly
Introduced in Chapter 194.

la mousse
the moss; the foam
Introduced in Chapter 457.

la moustiquaire
the mosquito net; the fly screen
Introduced in Chapter 430.

la moyenne
the average; the pass mark
Introduced in Chapter 378.

la musculation
weight training, bodybuilding
Introduced in Chapter 504.

la musique
music
Introduced in Chapter 128.

la naissance
the birth
Introduced in Chapter 308.

la nappe
tablecloth
Introduced in Chapter 529.

la narine
nostril
Introduced in Chapter 478.

la natation
swimming
Introduced in Chapter 173.

la nationalité
the nationality
Introduced in Chapter 362.

la nausée
nausea
Introduced in Chapter 483.

la navette
the shuttle (bus or train)
Introduced in Chapter 414.

la neige
snow
Introduced in Chapter 83.

la nièce
a niece
Introduced in Chapter 59.

la noix
a walnut, a nut
Introduced in Chapter 72.

la norme
the norm, the standard
Introduced in Chapter 380.

la nostalgie
nostalgia, longing for the past
Introduced in Chapter 472.

la nouvelle
a piece of news
Introduced in Chapter 195.

la noyade
drowning, a drowning
Introduced in Chapter 304.

la nuance
the subtle difference, the shade
Introduced in Chapter 344.

la nuitée
the overnight stay (paid for at a hotel)
Introduced in Chapter 424.

la paix
peace
Introduced in Chapter 165.

la panne
the breakdown, the failure
Introduced in Chapter 399.

la papeterie
the stationer's
Introduced in Chapter 445.

la paresse
laziness
Introduced in Chapter 467.

la partition
(musical) score, sheet music
Introduced in Chapter 513.

la parution
the publication, the release (of a book or paper)
Introduced in Chapter 279.

la passoire
the colander, the sieve
Introduced in Chapter 332.

la patinoire
ice rink
Introduced in Chapter 510.

la patrouille
the patrol
Introduced in Chapter 291.

la paupière
eyelid
Introduced in Chapter 478.

la pauvreté
the poverty
Introduced in Chapter 365.

la peau
skin
Introduced in Chapter 51.

la pêche
a peach
Introduced in Chapter 221.

la pédale
the pedal
Introduced in Chapter 401.

la peine
the sentence, the penalty; sorrow
Introduced in Chapter 388.

la pelote
ball (of wool or string)
Introduced in Chapter 496.

la pelouse
a lawn
Introduced in Chapter 254.

la penderie
wardrobe (for hanging clothes)
Introduced in Chapter 527.

la pente
the slope, the incline
Introduced in Chapter 455.

la périphérie
the outskirts, the edge (of a town)
Introduced in Chapter 400.

la permission
permission
Introduced in Chapter 168.

la personne
person — feminine no matter who is meant, even a man, and secretly "nobody" when it stands next to ne
Introduced in Chapter 33.

la personne âgée
an elderly person
Introduced in Chapter 250.

la perte
the loss
Introduced in Chapter 394.

la petite-fille
a granddaughter
Introduced in Chapter 58.

la peur
fear
Introduced in Chapter 55.

la pharmacie
a pharmacy
Introduced in Chapter 101.

la phase
the phase
Introduced in Chapter 277.

la photo
a photo
Introduced in Chapter 80.

la pièce
a coin, a room
Introduced in Chapter 198.

la pièce montée
the tiered wedding cake
Introduced in Chapter 311.

la pierre
a stone
Introduced in Chapter 82.

la pince à linge
clothes peg
Introduced in Chapter 526.

la pincée
the pinch (of salt, of pepper)
Introduced in Chapter 327.

la piqûre
injection; sting, bite
Introduced in Chapter 484.

la piscine
a swimming pool
Introduced in Chapter 107.

la piste
slope, run; track
Introduced in Chapter 510.

la plage
a beach
Introduced in Chapter 82.

la plaie
the wound, the cut
Introduced in Chapter 299.

la plaine
a plain
Introduced in Chapter 171.

la plainte
the complaint (to the police); the moan
Introduced in Chapter 386.

la planche à découper
the chopping board
Introduced in Chapter 328.

la plante
a plant
Introduced in Chapter 228.

la plateforme
(streaming) platform; platform
Introduced in Chapter 523.

la pluie
rain
Introduced in Chapter 83.

la poche
a pocket
Introduced in Chapter 115.

la poêle
a frying pan
Introduced in Chapter 193.

la poésie
poetry
Introduced in Chapter 522.

la poire
a pear
Introduced in Chapter 70.

la poissonnerie
the fishmonger's, the fish shop
Introduced in Chapter 444.

la poitrine
the chest
Introduced in Chapter 52.

la polémique
the controversy, the row
Introduced in Chapter 285.

la police
the police
Introduced in Chapter 102.

la politique
politics
Introduced in Chapter 248.

la pollution
pollution
Introduced in Chapter 229.

la pommade
an ointment
Introduced in Chapter 215.

la pomme
an apple
Introduced in Chapter 67.

la pomme de terre
a potato
Introduced in Chapter 68.

la pompe
the pump
Introduced in Chapter 403.

la portière
the car door
Introduced in Chapter 406.

la possibilité
a possibility
Introduced in Chapter 225.

la poste
the post office
Introduced in Chapter 101.

la poubelle
a bin
Introduced in Chapter 114.

la poule
a hen
Introduced in Chapter 86.

la poussette
the pushchair, the stroller
Introduced in Chapter 309.

la poussière
dust
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la précision
the precision; an extra detail
Introduced in Chapter 341.

la préfecture
the prefecture (regional state office)
Introduced in Chapter 440.

la presse
the press, the newspapers
Introduced in Chapter 278.

la preuve
the proof, the evidence
Introduced in Chapter 339.

la prise
the socket (for electricity), the plug; the hold
Introduced in Chapter 429.

la probabilité
the probability, the likelihood
Introduced in Chapter 372.

la procédure
the procedure
Introduced in Chapter 385.

la productivité
the productivity
Introduced in Chapter 361.

la prolongation
the extension
Introduced in Chapter 359.

la promesse
a promise
Introduced in Chapter 198.

la promotion
the promotion; the special offer
Introduced in Chapter 360.

la publicité
advertising
Introduced in Chapter 195.

la punaise
the bedbug; the drawing pin
Introduced in Chapter 430.

la punition
punishment
Introduced in Chapter 494.

la qualification
the qualification
Introduced in Chapter 360.

la quincaillerie
the hardware shop, the ironmonger's
Introduced in Chapter 445.

la racine
a root
Introduced in Chapter 228.

la radio
a radio
Introduced in Chapter 111.

la rafale
the gust (of wind); the burst
Introduced in Chapter 462.

la raison
a reason
Introduced in Chapter 225.

la rame
the metro train, the set of carriages
Introduced in Chapter 415.

la rançon
the ransom
Introduced in Chapter 296.

la rancune
grudge, resentment
Introduced in Chapter 475.

la randonnée
the hike, the long walk
Introduced in Chapter 455.

la raquette
a racket
Introduced in Chapter 173.

la rayure
the scratch; a stripe
Introduced in Chapter 307.

la réaction
the reaction
Introduced in Chapter 351.

la réception
the reception desk; the reception (party)
Introduced in Chapter 426.

la recette
the recipe; the takings
Introduced in Chapter 327.

la réclamation
the complaint, the claim
Introduced in Chapter 431.

la rédaction
the newsroom, the editorial staff; a school essay
Introduced in Chapter 279.

la réduction
a discount
Introduced in Chapter 198.

la règle
a rule
Introduced in Chapter 168.

la remise
the discount; the shed
Introduced in Chapter 452.

la rentrée
the start of the school year; the return
Introduced in Chapter 310.

la répercussion
the repercussion, the knock-on effect
Introduced in Chapter 350.

la répétition
rehearsal; repetition
Introduced in Chapter 513.

la réplique
line (in a play); reply
Introduced in Chapter 515.

la réponse
an answer
Introduced in Chapter 127.

la réservation
a booking
Introduced in Chapter 164.

la résistance
the resistance; stamina
Introduced in Chapter 326.

la résolution
the resolution, the firm decision
Introduced in Chapter 374.

la retraite
retirement; the pension
Introduced in Chapter 313.

la réunion
a meeting
Introduced in Chapter 174.

la révision
the revision; the service (of a car)
Introduced in Chapter 377.

la rivière
a river
Introduced in Chapter 81.

la robe
a dress
Introduced in Chapter 103.

la roue
a wheel
Introduced in Chapter 227.

la rubrique
the section, the regular feature (in a paper)
Introduced in Chapter 282.

la rue
a street
Introduced in Chapter 98.

la ruelle
the alley, the lane
Introduced in Chapter 437.

la rumeur
the rumour
Introduced in Chapter 285.

la rupture
break-up; breaking
Introduced in Chapter 491.

la saison
season
Introduced in Chapter 523.

la salade
a salad; lettuce
Introduced in Chapter 72.

la salle à manger
a dining room
Introduced in Chapter 163.

la salle d'attente
waiting room
Introduced in Chapter 484.

la salle de bain
a bathroom
Introduced in Chapter 74.

la salle de sport
a gym
Introduced in Chapter 173.

la sanction
the penalty, the sanction
Introduced in Chapter 382.

la santé
health
Introduced in Chapter 154.

la sauce
a sauce
Introduced in Chapter 122.

la sculpture
sculpture
Introduced in Chapter 517.

la sécheresse
the drought
Introduced in Chapter 464.

la seconde
a second
Introduced in Chapter 135.

la sécurité
safety
Introduced in Chapter 168.

la semaine
a week
Introduced in Chapter 95.

la séparation
separation, parting
Introduced in Chapter 491.

la serpillière
floor cloth, mop
Introduced in Chapter 528.

la serrure
a lock
Introduced in Chapter 163.

la serviette
a towel; a napkin
Introduced in Chapter 113.

la sieste
nap, siesta
Introduced in Chapter 486.

la société
society
Introduced in Chapter 222.

la soie
silk
Introduced in Chapter 172.

la soif
thirst
Introduced in Chapter 54.

la solidarité
the solidarity
Introduced in Chapter 366.

la sonnette
a doorbell
Introduced in Chapter 163.

la sorcière
the witch
Introduced in Chapter 321.

la sortie
an exit
Introduced in Chapter 199.

la sortie de secours
the emergency exit
Introduced in Chapter 301.

la soupe
a soup
Introduced in Chapter 69.

la souris
a mouse
Introduced in Chapter 85.

la soute
the hold (of a plane or ship)
Introduced in Chapter 416.

la station
the metro station, the stop; the taxi rank; the resort
Introduced in Chapter 415.

la statistique
the statistic; statistics
Introduced in Chapter 286.

la statue
a statue
Introduced in Chapter 170.

la sueur
sweat
Introduced in Chapter 504.

la supposition
the supposition, the assumption
Introduced in Chapter 367.

la surréservation
the overbooking
Introduced in Chapter 421.

la sœur
sister — the one family word that broke the pattern
Introduced in Chapter 12.

la tache
the stain, the spot
Introduced in Chapter 429.

la tâche
the task, the duty
Introduced in Chapter 359.

la taie
the pillowcase
Introduced in Chapter 427.

la taille
size; the waist
Introduced in Chapter 117.

la tante
an aunt
Introduced in Chapter 57.

la tasse
a cup
Introduced in Chapter 77.

la télécommande
remote control
Introduced in Chapter 525.

la télévision
a television
Introduced in Chapter 111.

la tempe
temple (side of the head)
Introduced in Chapter 478.

la température
temperature
Introduced in Chapter 194.

la tempête
the storm, the gale
Introduced in Chapter 465.

la tendresse
tenderness, affection
Introduced in Chapter 487.

la tente
the tent
Introduced in Chapter 425.

la terre
earth, land
Introduced in Chapter 201.

la tête
the head — from Latin for a clay pot
Introduced in Chapter 21.

la thèse
the thesis, the position argued for
Introduced in Chapter 335.

la timidité
shyness
Introduced in Chapter 466.

la toile
canvas; cloth; web
Introduced in Chapter 516.

la tolérance
the tolerance
Introduced in Chapter 381.

la tomate
a tomato
Introduced in Chapter 68.

la tombe
the grave, the tomb
Introduced in Chapter 315.

la tortue
a tortoise
Introduced in Chapter 89.

la tour
a tower
Introduced in Chapter 170.

la toux
a cough
Introduced in Chapter 53.

la tradition
a tradition
Introduced in Chapter 165.

la trahison
betrayal; treason
Introduced in Chapter 495.

la traversée
the crossing (by sea)
Introduced in Chapter 422.

la tristesse
sadness
Introduced in Chapter 55.

la trompette
trumpet
Introduced in Chapter 511.

la trottinette
the scooter (kick or electric)
Introduced in Chapter 415.

la troupe
(theatre) company, troupe; troop
Introduced in Chapter 514.

la turbulence
the turbulence
Introduced in Chapter 420.

la vache
a cow
Introduced in Chapter 85.

la vague
a wave
Introduced in Chapter 84.

la vaisselle
dishes, crockery
Introduced in Chapter 530.

la valise
a suitcase
Introduced in Chapter 80.

la vallée
a valley
Introduced in Chapter 194.

la veille
the day before, the eve
Introduced in Chapter 273.

la vérité
the truth
Introduced in Chapter 251.

la version originale
original-language version
Introduced in Chapter 524.

la veste
a jacket
Introduced in Chapter 116.

la victime
the victim
Introduced in Chapter 389.

la victoire
a victory
Introduced in Chapter 173.

la vie
life
Introduced in Chapter 129.

la vieillesse
old age
Introduced in Chapter 313.

la ville
a town, a city
Introduced in Chapter 98.

la vis
screw
Introduced in Chapter 531.

la vitrine
the shop window; the display case
Introduced in Chapter 442.

la voie
the track, the platform number; the way
Introduced in Chapter 413.

la voiture
a car
Introduced in Chapter 100.

là-haut
up there
Introduced in Chapter 216.

laisser
to leave (something); to let
Introduced in Chapter 65.

lancer
to throw
Introduced in Chapter 179.

laver
to wash
Introduced in Chapter 60.

le / la / les
the (masculine / feminine / plural)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

le bail
the lease
Introduced in Chapter 312.

le bal
the dance, the ball
Introduced in Chapter 318.

le balai
a broom
Introduced in Chapter 114.

le balcon
a balcony
Introduced in Chapter 163.

le ballon
a ball
Introduced in Chapter 173.

le banc
the bench
Introduced in Chapter 441.

le baptême
the christening, the baptism
Introduced in Chapter 309.

le bébé
a baby
Introduced in Chapter 58.

le beffroi
the belfry (town bell tower)
Introduced in Chapter 439.

le bénéfice
the profit; the benefit
Introduced in Chapter 394.

le bénévolat
the volunteering, unpaid work
Introduced in Chapter 366.

le bénévole
the volunteer; unpaid, voluntary
Introduced in Chapter 366.

le berceau
the cradle
Introduced in Chapter 308.

le beurre
butter — masculine, and the same borrowed word as English butter, not two separate coinages
Introduced in Chapter 34.

le biberon
baby's bottle
Introduced in Chapter 493.

le bijou
a jewel, a piece of jewellery
Introduced in Chapter 118.

le bijoutier
the jeweller
Introduced in Chapter 448.

le bilan
the final count, the outcome; the review
Introduced in Chapter 286.

le billet
a ticket; a banknote
Introduced in Chapter 80.

le billet de banque
a banknote
Introduced in Chapter 198.

le biscuit
a biscuit
Introduced in Chapter 121.

le blessé
the injured person, the casualty
Introduced in Chapter 298.

le boucher
a butcher
Introduced in Chapter 196.

le bouchon
the traffic jam; the cork
Introduced in Chapter 410.

le boulanger
a baker
Introduced in Chapter 124.

le boulevard
the boulevard
Introduced in Chapter 437.

le bouton
a button
Introduced in Chapter 221.

le brancard
stretcher
Introduced in Chapter 484.

le braquage
the armed robbery, the hold-up
Introduced in Chapter 296.

le braqueur
the armed robber
Introduced in Chapter 296.

le bras
an arm
Introduced in Chapter 49.

le bricolage
DIY, odd jobs
Introduced in Chapter 531.

le brouillard
fog
Introduced in Chapter 133.

le budget
the budget
Introduced in Chapter 390.

le buisson
the bush
Introduced in Chapter 457.

le bulletin
the school report; the bulletin
Introduced in Chapter 375.

le buraliste
the tobacconist
Introduced in Chapter 449.

le bureau
an office; a desk
Introduced in Chapter 108.

le but
the aim, the goal
Introduced in Chapter 374.

le butin
the loot, the haul
Introduced in Chapter 287.

le bœuf
beef; an ox
Introduced in Chapter 119.

le cadeau
a present, a gift
Introduced in Chapter 79.

le cadet
younger (sibling); youngest
Introduced in Chapter 490.

le cadre
the executive, the manager; the frame
Introduced in Chapter 359.

le cafard
the cockroach; the blues
Introduced in Chapter 430.

le café
coffee — masculine, and the one drink-word nearly all of Europe borrowed along the same single road
Introduced in Chapter 32.

le cahier
a notebook
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le caillou
a pebble
Introduced in Chapter 171.

le caissier
the cashier
Introduced in Chapter 450.

le câlin
cuddle, hug
Introduced in Chapter 488.

le cambriolage
the burglary, the break-in
Introduced in Chapter 287.

le cambrioleur
the burglar
Introduced in Chapter 287.

le camping
the campsite; camping
Introduced in Chapter 425.

le canapé
a sofa
Introduced in Chapter 75.

le canard
a duck
Introduced in Chapter 86.

le candidat
the candidate, the applicant
Introduced in Chapter 354.

le caniveau
the gutter (in the street)
Introduced in Chapter 443.

le caoutchouc
natural rubber
Introduced in Chapter 202.

le capot
the bonnet (of a car)
Introduced in Chapter 406.

le carambolage
the pile-up, the multiple crash
Introduced in Chapter 297.

le carburant
the fuel
Introduced in Chapter 403.

le carnaval
the carnival
Introduced in Chapter 317.

le carnet
the book of tickets; the notebook
Introduced in Chapter 415.

le carrefour
a crossroads
Introduced in Chapter 108.

le carton
the cardboard box; cardboard
Introduced in Chapter 453.

le casque
a helmet
Introduced in Chapter 253.

le cauchemar
nightmare
Introduced in Chapter 486.

le caviste
the wine merchant
Introduced in Chapter 445.

le cerf
the stag, the deer
Introduced in Chapter 459.

le certificat
the certificate
Introduced in Chapter 385.

le cerveau
the brain
Introduced in Chapter 154.

le chagrin
sorrow, grief
Introduced in Chapter 471.

le champignon
a mushroom
Introduced in Chapter 119.

le champion
champion
Introduced in Chapter 507.

le championnat
a championship
Introduced in Chapter 203.

le chanteur
a singer
Introduced in Chapter 223.

le chantier
a building site
Introduced in Chapter 253.

le chapeau
a hat
Introduced in Chapter 104.

le char
the float (in a parade); the tank
Introduced in Chapter 317.

le chargeur
a charger
Introduced in Chapter 223.

le chariot
the trolley (for luggage or shopping)
Introduced in Chapter 414.

le château
a castle
Introduced in Chapter 170.

le chauffage
the heating
Introduced in Chapter 427.

le chauffard
the reckless driver, the road hog
Introduced in Chapter 297.

le chauffeur
a driver
Introduced in Chapter 124.

le chef d'orchestre
conductor (of an orchestra)
Introduced in Chapter 513.

le chèque
the cheque
Introduced in Chapter 392.

le chéquier
the chequebook
Introduced in Chapter 392.

le chercheur
a researcher
Introduced in Chapter 224.

le chevalet
easel
Introduced in Chapter 516.

le choc
the shock, the crash
Introduced in Chapter 298.

le chocolat
chocolate
Introduced in Chapter 121.

le choix
a choice
Introduced in Chapter 225.

le chômage
the unemployment
Introduced in Chapter 356.

le chômeur
the unemployed person
Introduced in Chapter 356.

le cil
eyelash
Introduced in Chapter 478.

le cimetière
the cemetery, the graveyard
Introduced in Chapter 314.

le cinéma
a cinema
Introduced in Chapter 107.

le cintre
coat hanger
Introduced in Chapter 526.

le citoyen
the citizen
Introduced in Chapter 362.

le citron
a lemon
Introduced in Chapter 71.

le classement
ranking, league table
Introduced in Chapter 506.

le clavier
a keyboard
Introduced in Chapter 195.

le cliché
snapshot, photo; cliché
Introduced in Chapter 502.

le client
a customer
Introduced in Chapter 125.

le clignotant
the indicator, the turn signal
Introduced in Chapter 409.

le climat
the climate
Introduced in Chapter 229.

le clocher
the bell tower, the steeple
Introduced in Chapter 439.

le clou
a nail for hammering
Introduced in Chapter 230.

le cochon
a pig
Introduced in Chapter 85.

le coffre
the boot (of a car); the chest
Introduced in Chapter 406.

le coiffeur
the hairdresser, the barber
Introduced in Chapter 448.

le col
the mountain pass; the collar
Introduced in Chapter 454.

le colis
a parcel
Introduced in Chapter 252.

le collectionneur
collector
Introduced in Chapter 501.

le collègue
a colleague
Introduced in Chapter 174.

le collier
a necklace
Introduced in Chapter 118.

le comédien
actor (especially on stage)
Introduced in Chapter 515.

le commissariat
the police station
Introduced in Chapter 440.

le complice
the accomplice
Introduced in Chapter 295.

le comprimé
a tablet (medicine)
Introduced in Chapter 215.

le compromis
the compromise
Introduced in Chapter 337.

le comptable
an accountant
Introduced in Chapter 224.

le compte bancaire
a bank account
Introduced in Chapter 226.

le concert
a concert
Introduced in Chapter 223.

le concombre
a cucumber
Introduced in Chapter 119.

le concours
the competitive exam; the competition
Introduced in Chapter 378.

le conjoint
spouse, partner
Introduced in Chapter 491.

le conseil
advice
Introduced in Chapter 168.

le consensus
the consensus, broad agreement
Introduced in Chapter 337.

le constat
the accident report (for insurance); a finding
Introduced in Chapter 297.

le conte
tale, story
Introduced in Chapter 522.

le contrat
a contract
Introduced in Chapter 174.

le contretemps
the hitch, the mishap
Introduced in Chapter 275.

le contrôleur
the ticket inspector
Introduced in Chapter 413.

le coquillage
the seashell; the shellfish
Introduced in Chapter 458.

le cordonnier
the cobbler, the shoe mender
Introduced in Chapter 446.

le correspondant
the correspondent; a pen friend
Introduced in Chapter 281.

le cortège
the procession
Introduced in Chapter 316.

le costume
costume; suit
Introduced in Chapter 514.

le coton
cotton
Introduced in Chapter 172.

le cou
the neck
Introduced in Chapter 50.

le coude
an elbow
Introduced in Chapter 52.

le couloir
a corridor
Introduced in Chapter 76.

le coup de foudre
love at first sight
Introduced in Chapter 487.

le courage
courage
Introduced in Chapter 186.

le coureur
runner; rider (in a race)
Introduced in Chapter 508.

le courriel
an email
Introduced in Chapter 135.

le couteau
a knife
Introduced in Chapter 77.

le couvercle
lid
Introduced in Chapter 529.

le couvert
place setting; cutlery
Introduced in Chapter 529.

le crayon
a pencil
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le créneau
the parallel parking space; the time slot
Introduced in Chapter 407.

le cric
the jack (for lifting a car)
Introduced in Chapter 404.

le crime
the crime; the murder
Introduced in Chapter 290.

le criminel
the criminal
Introduced in Chapter 290.

le critère
the criterion
Introduced in Chapter 383.

le croisement
the crossroads, the junction
Introduced in Chapter 435.

le cuir
leather
Introduced in Chapter 172.

le cuisinier
a cook
Introduced in Chapter 123.

le CV
the CV, the résumé
Introduced in Chapter 354.

le cycliste
the cyclist
Introduced in Chapter 411.

le dé
dice, die
Introduced in Chapter 499.

le débat
the debate
Introduced in Chapter 335.

le décalage
the gap, the shift; jet lag
Introduced in Chapter 420.

le décès
the death (formal)
Introduced in Chapter 313.

le décollage
the take-off
Introduced in Chapter 419.

le décor
set, scenery; decor
Introduced in Chapter 514.

le découvert
the overdraft
Introduced in Chapter 451.

le dédommagement
the compensation
Introduced in Chapter 433.

le défibrillateur
the defibrillator
Introduced in Chapter 301.

le défilé
the parade; a fashion show
Introduced in Chapter 317.

le dégât
the damage
Introduced in Chapter 307.

le déjeuner
lunch
Introduced in Chapter 70.

le délai
the deadline, the time allowed
Introduced in Chapter 359.

le délinquant
the offender, the delinquent
Introduced in Chapter 290.

le délit
the misdemeanour, the offence
Introduced in Chapter 386.

le déménagement
the move, the house move
Introduced in Chapter 312.

le dénouement
ending, outcome (of a story)
Introduced in Chapter 519.

le dentifrice
toothpaste
Introduced in Chapter 114.

le dentiste
a dentist
Introduced in Chapter 166.

le dépanneur
the breakdown mechanic
Introduced in Chapter 405.

le départ
departure
Introduced in Chapter 231.

le dérapage
the skid; a slip-up
Introduced in Chapter 297.

le désaccord
the disagreement
Introduced in Chapter 336.

le désagrément
the inconvenience, the nuisance
Introduced in Chapter 432.

le désert
a desert
Introduced in Chapter 84.

le dessert
a dessert
Introduced in Chapter 122.

le dessin
a drawing
Introduced in Chapter 129.

le détective
the private detective
Introduced in Chapter 292.

le détenu
the prisoner, the inmate
Introduced in Chapter 388.

le détour
the detour, the roundabout way
Introduced in Chapter 436.

le deuil
mourning, grief
Introduced in Chapter 315.

le devis
the quote, the estimate
Introduced in Chapter 393.

le dialecte
a dialect
Introduced in Chapter 195.

le dictionnaire
a dictionary
Introduced in Chapter 232.

le dîner
dinner
Introduced in Chapter 70.

le diplôme
the diploma, the degree
Introduced in Chapter 379.

le distributeur
a cash machine
Introduced in Chapter 226.

le doctorat
the doctorate, the PhD
Introduced in Chapter 379.

le documentaire
documentary
Introduced in Chapter 525.

le doigt
a finger
Introduced in Chapter 49.

le dossier
a folder, a file
Introduced in Chapter 169.

le douanier
the customs officer
Introduced in Chapter 417.

le doublage
dubbing
Introduced in Chapter 524.

le dragon
the dragon
Introduced in Chapter 321.

le drap
a sheet
Introduced in Chapter 193.

le facteur
a postman, a postwoman
Introduced in Chapter 125.

le faubourg
the old suburb, the outer district
Introduced in Chapter 440.

le fauteuil
an armchair
Introduced in Chapter 193.

le fer
iron; an iron (for clothes)
Introduced in Chapter 115.

le fer à repasser
iron (for clothes)
Introduced in Chapter 527.

le ferry
the ferry
Introduced in Chapter 422.

le feu
fire
Introduced in Chapter 84.

le feu d'artifice
the fireworks (display)
Introduced in Chapter 318.

le feu de camp
campfire
Introduced in Chapter 498.

le feu rouge
a red light
Introduced in Chapter 108.

le fiancé
a fiancé
Introduced in Chapter 167.

le fichier
the file (on a computer)
Introduced in Chapter 397.

le fil
a thread, a wire
Introduced in Chapter 230.

le filleul
godson, godchild
Introduced in Chapter 490.

le film
a film
Introduced in Chapter 128.

le fleuriste
the florist
Introduced in Chapter 449.

le fleuve
a large river
Introduced in Chapter 164.

le foie
the liver
Introduced in Chapter 154.

le forfait
the flat-rate pass, the package
Introduced in Chapter 412.

le formulaire
a form
Introduced in Chapter 252.

le fou rire
fit of the giggles
Introduced in Chapter 474.

le fouet
the whisk; the whip
Introduced in Chapter 329.

le frein
the brake; the obstacle
Introduced in Chapter 352.

le frère
brother — and the friar who is one
Introduced in Chapter 12.

le fromage
cheese — masculine, and named for its MOULD rather than for the milk it's made from
Introduced in Chapter 34.

le fruit
a fruit
Introduced in Chapter 67.

le garagiste
the garage owner, the car mechanic
Introduced in Chapter 405.

le garrot
the tourniquet
Introduced in Chapter 300.

le gâteau
a cake
Introduced in Chapter 69.

le gaz
gas
Introduced in Chapter 255.

le gazole
the diesel (fuel)
Introduced in Chapter 403.

le gendarme
the gendarme
Introduced in Chapter 291.

le gendre
a son-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 167.

le genou
a knee
Introduced in Chapter 50.

le gérant
the manager
Introduced in Chapter 432.

le gilet
the waistcoat; the cardigan; the life jacket (gilet de sauvetage)
Introduced in Chapter 422.

le gîte
the holiday cottage; the shelter
Introduced in Chapter 424.

le givre
the frost (on surfaces), the hoarfrost
Introduced in Chapter 463.

le gouvernement
the government
Introduced in Chapter 222.

le grand-père
a grandfather
Introduced in Chapter 56.

le grenier
an attic
Introduced in Chapter 200.

le gréviste
the striker
Introduced in Chapter 358.

le gros titre
the headline
Introduced in Chapter 282.

le guichet
the ticket office, the counter window
Introduced in Chapter 412.

le guide
a guide, a guidebook
Introduced in Chapter 169.

le hasard
chance, luck
Introduced in Chapter 500.

le hérisson
the hedgehog
Introduced in Chapter 459.

le héros
hero; main character
Introduced in Chapter 521.

le hublot
the porthole, the window (of a plane or ship)
Introduced in Chapter 418.

le jambon
ham
Introduced in Chapter 71.

le jardin
a garden
Introduced in Chapter 74.

le jardinage
gardening
Introduced in Chapter 503.

le jeu
a game
Introduced in Chapter 128.

le jeu de société
board game
Introduced in Chapter 499.

le joueur
a player
Introduced in Chapter 203.

le jour férié
the public holiday, the bank holiday
Introduced in Chapter 316.

le journal télévisé
the television news
Introduced in Chapter 280.

le journaliste
a journalist
Introduced in Chapter 166.

le juge
a judge
Introduced in Chapter 222.

le jugement
the judgement
Introduced in Chapter 342.

le jumeau
a twin
Introduced in Chapter 250.

le jus
juice
Introduced in Chapter 121.

le kiné
physiotherapist (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 481.

le kiosque
the kiosk, the newsstand
Introduced in Chapter 441.

le klaxon
the horn (of a car)
Introduced in Chapter 402.

le lait
milk — masculine, and the one drink in this chapter French did not have to borrow
Introduced in Chapter 32.

le lampadaire
the street lamp; the floor lamp
Introduced in Chapter 441.

le lapin
a rabbit
Introduced in Chapter 88.

le lavabo
the washbasin
Introduced in Chapter 428.

le lecteur
reader; player (for discs)
Introduced in Chapter 521.

le lendemain
the next day, the day after
Introduced in Chapter 273.

le libraire
bookseller
Introduced in Chapter 520.

le licenciement
the dismissal, the layoff
Introduced in Chapter 355.

le lien
the link; the bond
Introduced in Chapter 398.

le linge
laundry, linen
Introduced in Chapter 115.

le lion
a lion
Introduced in Chapter 87.

le liquide
cash; the liquid
Introduced in Chapter 450.

le livre de poche
paperback
Introduced in Chapter 520.

le livreur
the delivery man, the courier
Introduced in Chapter 453.

le locataire
the tenant
Introduced in Chapter 312.

le logiciel
the software, the program
Introduced in Chapter 396.

le loup
a wolf
Introduced in Chapter 85.

le loyer
the rent
Introduced in Chapter 142.

le lycée
the secondary school (ages fifteen to eighteen)
Introduced in Chapter 375.

le lycéen
the secondary-school pupil
Introduced in Chapter 375.

le magasin
a shop
Introduced in Chapter 99.

le magazine
a magazine
Introduced in Chapter 232.

le maillot
a swimsuit; a sports shirt
Introduced in Chapter 117.

le maillot de bain
swimsuit, swimming trunks
Introduced in Chapter 509.

le maire
a mayor
Introduced in Chapter 248.

le maître-nageur
the lifeguard, the swimming instructor
Introduced in Chapter 304.

le malentendu
the misunderstanding
Introduced in Chapter 341.

le manifestant
the demonstrator, the marcher
Introduced in Chapter 363.

le manteau
a coat
Introduced in Chapter 104.

le manuel
the textbook, the manual
Introduced in Chapter 377.

le marais
the marsh, the swamp
Introduced in Chapter 456.

le marathon
marathon
Introduced in Chapter 508.

le marbre
marble
Introduced in Chapter 517.

le mari
a husband
Introduced in Chapter 57.

le marié
a bridegroom
Introduced in Chapter 197.

le marteau
a hammer
Introduced in Chapter 230.

le match nul
draw, tie (in sport)
Introduced in Chapter 506.

le matin
the morning
Introduced in Chapter 95.

le mécanicien
a mechanic
Introduced in Chapter 196.

le médecin
a doctor
Introduced in Chapter 53.

le médicament
a medicine
Introduced in Chapter 53.

le melon
a melon
Introduced in Chapter 120.

le ménage
the cleaning, the housework; the household
Introduced in Chapter 432.

le mensonge
a lie
Introduced in Chapter 251.

le menteur
liar; lying
Introduced in Chapter 468.

le menton
the chin
Introduced in Chapter 51.

le métal
metal
Introduced in Chapter 202.

le métro
the underground, the metro
Introduced in Chapter 106.

le meurtre
the murder
Introduced in Chapter 290.

le micro
the microphone, the mic
Introduced in Chapter 280.

le miel
honey
Introduced in Chapter 69.

le millénaire
the millennium
Introduced in Chapter 276.

le minibar
the minibar
Introduced in Chapter 429.

le miroir
a mirror
Introduced in Chapter 75.

le modélisme
model-making
Introduced in Chapter 501.

le mois
a month
Introduced in Chapter 95.

le mollet
calf (of the leg)
Introduced in Chapter 477.

le monde
the world
Introduced in Chapter 110.

le monument
a monument
Introduced in Chapter 170.

le mot
a word
Introduced in Chapter 126.

le mot de passe
the password
Introduced in Chapter 395.

le moteur
an engine
Introduced in Chapter 227.

le motif
the motive, the reason; the pattern
Introduced in Chapter 350.

le moule
the baking tin, the mould
Introduced in Chapter 331.

le moustique
a mosquito
Introduced in Chapter 194.

le mouton
a sheep
Introduced in Chapter 87.

le mur
a wall
Introduced in Chapter 73.

le muscle
a muscle
Introduced in Chapter 185.

le musée
a museum
Introduced in Chapter 100.

le mystère
the mystery
Introduced in Chapter 293.

le mythe
the myth
Introduced in Chapter 322.

le narrateur
narrator
Introduced in Chapter 521.

le naufrage
the shipwreck
Introduced in Chapter 305.

le neveu
a nephew
Introduced in Chapter 59.

le nez
nose — masculine, a silent final z, and another genuine cousin of its English counterpart
Introduced in Chapter 35.

le nord
the north
Introduced in Chapter 109.

le nourrisson
infant, small baby
Introduced in Chapter 493.

le nuage
a cloud
Introduced in Chapter 83.

le numéro
a number (on a door, a phone)
Introduced in Chapter 134.

le pain
bread — and the companion who is, literally, someone you share it with
Introduced in Chapter 13.

le panneau
the road sign; the panel
Introduced in Chapter 435.

le pansement
a plaster, a dressing
Introduced in Chapter 243.

le pantalon
trousers
Introduced in Chapter 104.

le papier
paper
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le papillon
a butterfly
Introduced in Chapter 194.

le parapluie
an umbrella
Introduced in Chapter 79.

le parc
a park
Introduced in Chapter 100.

le pare-brise
the windscreen
Introduced in Chapter 402.

le parfum
perfume
Introduced in Chapter 118.

le pari
bet
Introduced in Chapter 500.

le parking
a car park
Introduced in Chapter 106.

le parrain
godfather; sponsor
Introduced in Chapter 490.

le partisan
the supporter (of an idea)
Introduced in Chapter 345.

le passant
the passer-by
Introduced in Chapter 437.

le passeport
a passport
Introduced in Chapter 164.

le patin
skate
Introduced in Chapter 510.

le patrimoine
heritage; an estate
Introduced in Chapter 325.

le pavé
the cobblestone; the paving
Introduced in Chapter 441.

le paysage
a landscape
Introduced in Chapter 231.

le péage
a toll
Introduced in Chapter 227.

le pêcheur
fisherman, angler
Introduced in Chapter 497.

le peigne
a comb
Introduced in Chapter 114.

le peignoir
the bathrobe, the dressing gown
Introduced in Chapter 427.

le peintre
a painter
Introduced in Chapter 249.

le père
father — one of the oldest words anyone can reconstruct
Introduced in Chapter 12.

le périphérique
the ring road (round a city)
Introduced in Chapter 400.

le permis de conduire
a driving licence
Introduced in Chapter 253.

le pétard
the firecracker, the banger
Introduced in Chapter 318.

le petit-déjeuner
breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 70.

le petit-fils
a grandson
Introduced in Chapter 58.

le phare
the headlight; the lighthouse
Introduced in Chapter 409.

le pharmacien
a pharmacist
Introduced in Chapter 166.

le photographe
a photographer
Introduced in Chapter 166.

le piano
a piano
Introduced in Chapter 256.

le pickpocket
the pickpocket
Introduced in Chapter 288.

le pied
a foot
Introduced in Chapter 49.

le piéton
the pedestrian
Introduced in Chapter 411.

le pilote
a pilot
Introduced in Chapter 224.

le pinceau
paintbrush
Introduced in Chapter 516.

le pion
pawn, counter (in a game)
Introduced in Chapter 499.

le placard
a cupboard
Introduced in Chapter 76.

le plafond
a ceiling
Introduced in Chapter 76.

le plastique
plastic
Introduced in Chapter 172.

le plateau
the plateau, the high plain; the tray
Introduced in Chapter 454.

le plâtre
plaster cast; plaster
Introduced in Chapter 480.

le plombier
a plumber
Introduced in Chapter 196.

le plongeon
dive
Introduced in Chapter 509.

le pneu
the tyre
Introduced in Chapter 404.

le podium
podium
Introduced in Chapter 507.

le poème
a poem
Introduced in Chapter 249.

le poignet
a wrist
Introduced in Chapter 52.

le point de vue
the point of view
Introduced in Chapter 334.

le poisson
fish
Introduced in Chapter 67.

le poivre
pepper
Introduced in Chapter 72.

le polar
crime novel, detective story (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 522.

le policier
a police officer
Introduced in Chapter 123.

le pollen
pollen
Introduced in Chapter 482.

le pompier
a firefighter
Introduced in Chapter 125.

le pont
a bridge
Introduced in Chapter 100.

le portail
a gate
Introduced in Chapter 200.

le portefeuille
a wallet
Introduced in Chapter 117.

le portique
the scanner gate (at security); the portico
Introduced in Chapter 417.

le potager
a vegetable garden
Introduced in Chapter 200.

le pouce
a thumb
Introduced in Chapter 185.

le poulet
chicken
Introduced in Chapter 67.

le poumon
a lung
Introduced in Chapter 154.

le pourboire
a tip
Introduced in Chapter 247.

le préavis
the notice (period)
Introduced in Chapter 355.

le préjugé
the prejudice
Introduced in Chapter 364.

le présentateur
the presenter, the newsreader
Introduced in Chapter 280.

le pressing
the dry cleaner's
Introduced in Chapter 447.

le prêt
a loan
Introduced in Chapter 226.

le prétexte
the pretext
Introduced in Chapter 351.

le primeur
the greengrocer; early produce
Introduced in Chapter 444.

le printemps
spring — literally "the first time"
Introduced in Chapter 11.

le prix
a price; a prize
Introduced in Chapter 129.

le problème
a problem
Introduced in Chapter 127.

le procès
the trial
Introduced in Chapter 387.

le professeur
a teacher
Introduced in Chapter 59.

le projet
a plan, a project
Introduced in Chapter 141.

le proviseur
the head teacher (of a lycée)
Introduced in Chapter 375.

le pyjama
pyjamas
Introduced in Chapter 221.

le quai
a platform
Introduced in Chapter 247.

le quartier
a district, a neighbourhood
Introduced in Chapter 103.

le quotidien
the daily paper; daily life
Introduced in Chapter 278.

le rabais
the reduction, the price cut
Introduced in Chapter 452.

le raccourci
the shortcut
Introduced in Chapter 436.

le radar
the speed camera; the radar
Introduced in Chapter 408.

le radiateur
the radiator
Introduced in Chapter 427.

le raisin
grapes
Introduced in Chapter 71.

le raisonnement
the reasoning
Introduced in Chapter 344.

le randonneur
the hiker
Introduced in Chapter 455.

le rattrapage
the resit (exam); catching up
Introduced in Chapter 378.

le rayon
section (of a shop); shelf; ray
Introduced in Chapter 520.

le réalisateur
(film) director
Introduced in Chapter 524.

le rebondissement
twist, new development
Introduced in Chapter 519.

le réceptionniste
the receptionist
Introduced in Chapter 426.

le récif
the reef
Introduced in Chapter 458.

le récit
the account, the story
Introduced in Chapter 322.

le recommandé
the registered letter, registered post
Introduced in Chapter 453.

le recyclage
recycling
Introduced in Chapter 255.

le refrain
chorus, refrain
Introduced in Chapter 512.

le réfrigérateur
a fridge
Introduced in Chapter 111.

le régime
a diet
Introduced in Chapter 243.

le règlement
the regulations, the rules; the payment
Introduced in Chapter 380.

le règne
the reign
Introduced in Chapter 323.

le rein
a kidney
Introduced in Chapter 154.

le relais
relay; relay race
Introduced in Chapter 508.

le relevé
the statement (from a bank); the reading
Introduced in Chapter 451.

le remboursement
the refund
Introduced in Chapter 421.

le remède
the remedy, the cure
Introduced in Chapter 353.

le renard
a fox
Introduced in Chapter 86.

le renouvellement
the renewal
Introduced in Chapter 384.

le repas
a meal
Introduced in Chapter 122.

le repère
the landmark, the reference point
Introduced in Chapter 434.

le reportage
the report, the feature (on TV, radio or in a paper)
Introduced in Chapter 281.

le repos
rest
Introduced in Chapter 155.

le rescapé
the survivor (of a disaster)
Introduced in Chapter 305.

le réseau
the network
Introduced in Chapter 398.

le réservoir
the tank (for fuel); the reservoir
Introduced in Chapter 403.

le restaurant
a restaurant
Introduced in Chapter 101.

le résultat
a result
Introduced in Chapter 251.

le retour
the return
Introduced in Chapter 231.

le retrait
the withdrawal
Introduced in Chapter 451.

le retraité
the retired person, the pensioner
Introduced in Chapter 313.

le rétroviseur
the rear-view mirror; the wing mirror
Introduced in Chapter 402.

le rêve
a dream
Introduced in Chapter 155.

le réveillon
the festive late-night dinner (24 or 31 December)
Introduced in Chapter 319.

le revenu
the income
Introduced in Chapter 390.

le réverbère
the lamp post (old-style)
Introduced in Chapter 441.

le rhume
a cold
Introduced in Chapter 185.

le rideau
a curtain
Introduced in Chapter 112.

le risque
the risk
Introduced in Chapter 372.

le riz
rice
Introduced in Chapter 70.

le robinet
the tap, the faucet
Introduced in Chapter 428.

le rocher
a rock
Introduced in Chapter 171.

le romancier
novelist
Introduced in Chapter 519.

le rouleau à pâtisserie
the rolling pin
Introduced in Chapter 333.

le ruisseau
the stream, the brook
Introduced in Chapter 456.

le sable
sand
Introduced in Chapter 82.

le sac
a bag
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le sac de couchage
the sleeping bag
Introduced in Chapter 425.

le sachet
a small bag
Introduced in Chapter 202.

le saladier
the salad bowl, the mixing bowl
Introduced in Chapter 329.

le salaire
a salary
Introduced in Chapter 174.

le salarié
the employee, the wage earner
Introduced in Chapter 358.

le salon
a living room
Introduced in Chapter 75.

le sandwich
a sandwich
Introduced in Chapter 122.

le sang
blood
Introduced in Chapter 50.

le sanglier
the wild boar
Introduced in Chapter 459.

le sapin
the fir tree; the Christmas tree
Introduced in Chapter 319.

le sauveteur
the rescuer
Introduced in Chapter 304.

le savon
soap
Introduced in Chapter 113.

le scientifique
a scientist
Introduced in Chapter 224.

le scoop
the scoop, the exclusive story
Introduced in Chapter 285.

le sculpteur
sculptor
Introduced in Chapter 517.

le secouriste
first-aider, rescue worker
Introduced in Chapter 484.

le séjour
the stay; the living room
Introduced in Chapter 426.

le sel
salt — masculine, cousin of English salt by common descent, and the source of a salary story no ancient writer actually tells
Introduced in Chapter 34.

le semestre
the semester, the half-year
Introduced in Chapter 376.

le sentier
a path
Introduced in Chapter 254.

le serpent
a snake
Introduced in Chapter 86.

le serrurier
the locksmith
Introduced in Chapter 446.

le serveur
a waiter
Introduced in Chapter 125.

le shampooing
shampoo
Introduced in Chapter 114.

le siècle
a century
Introduced in Chapter 135.

le siège
a seat
Introduced in Chapter 199.

le sifflet
whistle
Introduced in Chapter 505.

le singe
a monkey
Introduced in Chapter 87.

le sinistré
the disaster victim
Introduced in Chapter 307.

le sirop
a syrup
Introduced in Chapter 215.

le sol
the floor, the ground
Introduced in Chapter 75.

le soldat
a soldier
Introduced in Chapter 165.

le soleil
the sun
Introduced in Chapter 83.

le sommeil
sleep
Introduced in Chapter 155.

le sommet
the summit, the top; the summit meeting
Introduced in Chapter 454.

le sondage
the poll, the survey
Introduced in Chapter 286.

le soulagement
relief
Introduced in Chapter 470.

le soupçon
the suspicion; a hint
Introduced in Chapter 293.

le sourcil
eyebrow
Introduced in Chapter 478.

le spectacle
a show
Introduced in Chapter 223.

le sport
sport
Introduced in Chapter 128.

le stade
a stadium
Introduced in Chapter 107.

le stage
the internship, the work placement; a training course
Introduced in Chapter 357.

le stagiaire
the intern, the trainee
Introduced in Chapter 357.

le stationnement
parking
Introduced in Chapter 407.

le stéréotype
the stereotype
Introduced in Chapter 364.

le steward
the steward (on a plane)
Introduced in Chapter 418.

le store
the blind (on a window)
Introduced in Chapter 430.

le stylo
a pen
Introduced in Chapter 78.

le succès
success
Introduced in Chapter 197.

le sucre
sugar — masculine, closing a chapter where every drink-word is; the fourth and longest road of the four
Introduced in Chapter 32.

le sud
the south
Introduced in Chapter 109.

le supermarché
a supermarket
Introduced in Chapter 107.

le surlendemain
two days later, the day after next
Introduced in Chapter 273.

le suspense
suspense
Introduced in Chapter 523.

le syndicat
the trade union
Introduced in Chapter 358.

le tableau
a board; a painting
Introduced in Chapter 126.

le talon
heel
Introduced in Chapter 477.

le tambour
a drum
Introduced in Chapter 256.

le tapis
a rug, a carpet
Introduced in Chapter 111.

le tarif
the fare, the price (list)
Introduced in Chapter 412.

le taux
the rate
Introduced in Chapter 391.

le taxi
a taxi
Introduced in Chapter 106.

le téléphone
a phone
Introduced in Chapter 79.

le téléphone portable
a mobile phone
Introduced in Chapter 204.

le téléspectateur
the viewer (of television)
Introduced in Chapter 280.

le témoin
the witness
Introduced in Chapter 389.

le temps, il pleut
weather — le temps means BOTH "time" and "weather," the SAME Latin tempus polysemy as Spanish's tiempo; il pleut keeps Latin's pl- UNCHANGED, unlike Spanish's llueve
Introduced in Chapter 25.

le terminal
the card machine; the terminal
Introduced in Chapter 450.

le terminus
the end of the line, the terminus
Introduced in Chapter 414.

le terrain
pitch, ground; plot of land
Introduced in Chapter 505.

le testament
the will (legal)
Introduced in Chapter 315.

le thé
tea — masculine, and the drink whose name split in two depending which Chinese port a trader dealt with
Introduced in Chapter 32.

le théâtre
a theatre
Introduced in Chapter 102.

le thermomètre
the thermometer
Introduced in Chapter 460.

le tigre
a tiger
Introduced in Chapter 88.

le timbre
a stamp
Introduced in Chapter 252.

le tiroir
a drawer
Introduced in Chapter 193.

le toast
the toast (with a drink); toasted bread
Introduced in Chapter 320.

le toit
a roof
Introduced in Chapter 74.

le tonnerre
thunder
Introduced in Chapter 229.

le torchon
tea towel, dishcloth
Introduced in Chapter 530.

le touriste
a tourist
Introduced in Chapter 250.

le tournage
shooting, filming (of a film)
Introduced in Chapter 524.

le tournevis
screwdriver
Introduced in Chapter 531.

le tournoi
tournament
Introduced in Chapter 507.

le trac
stage fright, nerves
Introduced in Chapter 515.

le train
a train
Introduced in Chapter 99.

le traiteur
the caterer; the deli (with ready meals)
Introduced in Chapter 444.

le trajet
the ride, the journey (from A to B)
Introduced in Chapter 412.

le tramway
the tram
Introduced in Chapter 415.

le tremblement de terre
the earthquake
Introduced in Chapter 303.

le trépied
tripod
Introduced in Chapter 502.

le tribunal
a court
Introduced in Chapter 222.

le tronc
a trunk
Introduced in Chapter 254.

le trône
the throne
Introduced in Chapter 323.

le trottoir
a pavement
Introduced in Chapter 108.

le tunnel
a tunnel
Introduced in Chapter 253.

le vainqueur
winner, victor
Introduced in Chapter 506.

le vase
a vase
Introduced in Chapter 228.

le vélo
a bicycle
Introduced in Chapter 106.

le vendeur
a shop assistant
Introduced in Chapter 123.

le vent
the wind
Introduced in Chapter 84.

le ventre
stomach — masculine, nasal like la main but through a different vowel, and the word that closes four chapters of everyday nouns
Introduced in Chapter 35.

le verdict
the verdict
Introduced in Chapter 387.

le verglas
the black ice
Introduced in Chapter 463.

le vernissage
private view, opening (of an exhibition)
Introduced in Chapter 518.

le verre
a glass
Introduced in Chapter 76.

le versant
the mountainside, the slope
Introduced in Chapter 454.

le vertige
dizziness; fear of heights
Introduced in Chapter 483.

le veuf
a widower
Introduced in Chapter 197.

le village
a village
Introduced in Chapter 101.

le vin
wine — the word that refused to wear down, in any language
Introduced in Chapter 13.

le vinaigre
vinegar
Introduced in Chapter 122.

le violon
a violin
Introduced in Chapter 256.

le violoncelle
cello
Introduced in Chapter 511.

le virage
the bend, the curve (in a road)
Introduced in Chapter 409.

le virement
the bank transfer
Introduced in Chapter 392.

le virus
the virus
Introduced in Chapter 399.

le visage
the face
Introduced in Chapter 50.

le voisin
a neighbour
Introduced in Chapter 58.

le vol
the flight
Introduced in Chapter 416.

le volant
a steering wheel
Introduced in Chapter 199.

le volcan
a volcano
Introduced in Chapter 171.

le volet
the shutter
Introduced in Chapter 430.

le voleur
the thief
Introduced in Chapter 386.

le vote
a vote
Introduced in Chapter 248.

le voyage
a journey, a trip
Introduced in Chapter 110.

le vœu
the wish; the vow
Introduced in Chapter 320.

le wagon
the carriage (of a train)
Introduced in Chapter 413.

le yaourt
a yoghurt
Introduced in Chapter 71.

léger
light (not heavy)
Introduced in Chapter 93.

lequel / laquelle
which one
Introduced in Chapter 139.

les applaudissements
applause
Introduced in Chapter 515.

les arrhes
the deposit (that is not refunded)
Introduced in Chapter 433.

les bagages
luggage
Introduced in Chapter 199.

les bottes
boots
Introduced in Chapter 117.

les chaussettes
socks
Introduced in Chapter 105.

les chaussures
shoes
Introduced in Chapter 104.

les ciseaux
scissors
Introduced in Chapter 221.

les coulisses
wings, backstage
Introduced in Chapter 514.

les déchets
rubbish
Introduced in Chapter 255.

les décombres
the rubble, the debris
Introduced in Chapter 303.

les devoirs
homework
Introduced in Chapter 127.

les élections
elections
Introduced in Chapter 248.

les espèces
the cash
Introduced in Chapter 392.

les faits divers
short news items, minor news stories
Introduced in Chapter 282.

les fiançailles
engagement (to marry)
Introduced in Chapter 489.

les funérailles
the funeral (formal)
Introduced in Chapter 314.

les gants
gloves
Introduced in Chapter 116.

les haricots
beans
Introduced in Chapter 119.

les heures supplémentaires
the overtime
Introduced in Chapter 358.

les légumes
vegetables
Introduced in Chapter 119.

les lunettes
glasses
Introduced in Chapter 79.

les mathématiques
mathematics
Introduced in Chapter 257.

les menottes
the handcuffs
Introduced in Chapter 294.

les noces
wedding (celebration)
Introduced in Chapter 489.

les pâtes
pasta
Introduced in Chapter 72.

les prévisions
the forecast, the outlook
Introduced in Chapter 460.

les remparts
the town walls, the ramparts
Introduced in Chapter 439.

les secours
the emergency services, help
Introduced in Chapter 300.

les soldes
the sales
Introduced in Chapter 198.

les urgences
the emergency department
Introduced in Chapter 243.

les vacances
holidays
Introduced in Chapter 110.

les vêtements
clothes
Introduced in Chapter 103.

libérer
to free, to set free
Introduced in Chapter 326.

libre
free
Introduced in Chapter 131.

licencier
to dismiss, to lay off
Introduced in Chapter 355.

lire
to read — from a Latin verb that first meant “to gather,” which is why reading, electing, collecting and being elegant all turn out to be the same act
Introduced in Chapter 29.

lisse
smooth
Introduced in Chapter 244.

livrer
to deliver
Introduced in Chapter 150.

loger
to lodge, to stay; to put up
Introduced in Chapter 424.

loin
far
Introduced in Chapter 96.

loin de
far from
Introduced in Chapter 188.

lointain / lointaine
distant
Introduced in Chapter 192.

lorsque
when (careful style)
Introduced in Chapter 269.

louer
to rent
Introduced in Chapter 235.

lourd
heavy
Introduced in Chapter 93.

lui et elle
him and her, standing alone — where elle is the same word twice and lui is not
Introduced in Chapter 43.

lunatique
moody
Introduced in Chapter 469.

lundi
Monday — the Moon’s day
Introduced in Chapter 7.

mai
May — the month of Maia, goddess of growth
Introduced in Chapter 9.

maigrir
to lose weight
Introduced in Chapter 242.

maintenant
now
Introduced in Chapter 96.

mais
but — Latin magis, more, which stayed more in Spanish and became but only here
Introduced in Chapter 40.

majeur
of age, adult; major
Introduced in Chapter 310.

malade
ill, sick
Introduced in Chapter 54.

maladroit
clumsy
Introduced in Chapter 467.

malgré
despite
Introduced in Chapter 189.

malheureusement
unfortunately
Introduced in Chapter 189.

manger
to eat
Introduced in Chapter 61.

manifeste
clear, obvious, manifest
Introduced in Chapter 339.

manifester
to demonstrate (in the street); to show
Introduced in Chapter 363.

manquer
to miss, to be missing
Introduced in Chapter 237.

marchander
to haggle, to bargain
Introduced in Chapter 452.

marcher
to walk — and also to work, so ça marche is the most useful two words in the chapter; its own origin is genuinely unsettled between a Frankish verb and a Latin hammer
Introduced in Chapter 30.

mardi
Tuesday — the day of Mars
Introduced in Chapter 7.

marié / mariée
married
Introduced in Chapter 162.

marier
to get married (as se marier); to marry (a couple), to marry off
Introduced in Chapter 311.

marquer
to score; to mark
Introduced in Chapter 505.

marrant
funny (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 474.

marron
brown (chestnut)
Introduced in Chapter 130.

mars
March — the war-god's month, and the old start of the year
Introduced in Chapter 9.

me
me / myself (reflexive and object pronoun)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

méchant
nasty, mean
Introduced in Chapter 133.

mécontent
unhappy, dissatisfied
Introduced in Chapter 431.

méfier
to be wary, to distrust (se méfier)
Introduced in Chapter 476.

mélanger
to mix
Introduced in Chapter 240.

mémoriser
to memorise
Introduced in Chapter 377.

menacer
to threaten
Introduced in Chapter 289.

mentir
to lie, to tell lies
Introduced in Chapter 468.

merci
thank you
Introduced in Chapter 3.

mercredi
Wednesday — the day of Mercury
Introduced in Chapter 7.

mériter
to deserve
Introduced in Chapter 237.

mesurer
to measure
Introduced in Chapter 234.

mettre
to put; to put on
Introduced in Chapter 137.

midi
noon — literally "the day's middle"
Introduced in Chapter 8.

mijoter
to simmer; to cook up (a plan)
Introduced in Chapter 330.

mille
a thousand
Introduced in Chapter 136.

mince
thin, slim
Introduced in Chapter 93.

minuit
midnight — literally "the night's middle"
Introduced in Chapter 8.

moderne
modern
Introduced in Chapter 161.

modeste
modest
Introduced in Chapter 473.

moi et toi
me and you, standing alone — the heavy twins of je and tu, split by stress exactly as quoi split from que
Introduced in Chapter 43.

moins le quart
quarter to — literally “minus the quarter”
Introduced in Chapter 8.

moite
clammy, sticky (with damp heat)
Introduced in Chapter 464.

Monsieur, Madame
sir and madam — my lord and my lady, worn down, and the two words French uses where English uses a surname
Introduced in Chapter 44.

montrer
to show
Introduced in Chapter 62.

mordre
to bite
Introduced in Chapter 306.

mouillé
wet
Introduced in Chapter 95.

mourir
to die
Introduced in Chapter 207.

mûr / mûre
ripe
Introduced in Chapter 192.

n’importe quoi
anything at all
Introduced in Chapter 139.

naguère
not long ago; formerly (literary)
Introduced in Chapter 272.

naïf
naive
Introduced in Chapter 468.

naître
to be born
Introduced in Chapter 207.

narrer
to narrate, to tell
Introduced in Chapter 322.

naviguer
to browse; to sail
Introduced in Chapter 398.

nécessaire
necessary
Introduced in Chapter 191.

neiger
to snow
Introduced in Chapter 178.

nerveux / nerveuse
nervous
Introduced in Chapter 218.

net
sharp, in focus; clean, clear
Introduced in Chapter 502.

nettoyer
to clean
Introduced in Chapter 63.

neuf
nine
Introduced in Chapter 6.

nier
to deny
Introduced in Chapter 338.

noir
black — the straightforward one, straight down from Latin
Introduced in Chapter 16.

non
no / not
Introduced in Chapter 22.

non plus
neither, not either
Introduced in Chapter 139.

nourrir
to feed
Introduced in Chapter 242.

nous avons
we have — and the ending is finally something you can hear
Introduced in Chapter 17.

nous sommes
we are — and the only plural that keeps the regular ending
Introduced in Chapter 19.

nouveau
new
Introduced in Chapter 89.

novembre
November — the month that still says “nine”
Introduced in Chapter 10.

noyer
to drown (as se noyer); to flood
Introduced in Chapter 304.

nuageux
cloudy
Introduced in Chapter 460.

nuancer
to qualify, to tone down (a view)
Introduced in Chapter 344.

nuit
night (la nuit — feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

obéir
to obey
Introduced in Chapter 240.

objecter
to object, to say in reply
Introduced in Chapter 336.

obligatoire
compulsory, mandatory
Introduced in Chapter 380.

observer
to observe
Introduced in Chapter 148.

occupé
busy
Introduced in Chapter 131.

octobre
October — the month that still says “eight”
Introduced in Chapter 10.

offrir
to offer
Introduced in Chapter 237.

offrir un cadeau
to give a present
Introduced in Chapter 210.

on
one, people, and in practice we — a noun for man that turned into a pronoun
Introduced in Chapter 41.

onze
eleven — and not “ten-one”, which is the whole surprise
Introduced in Chapter 14.

optimiste
optimistic; optimist
Introduced in Chapter 476.

orageux
stormy, thundery
Introduced in Chapter 462.

organiser
to organise
Introduced in Chapter 141.

orienter
to get one’s bearings (mostly reflexive: s’orienter); to guide
Introduced in Chapter 434.

ou
or — the same three letters as the question word for where, kept apart by one accent
Introduced in Chapter 40.

où
where — and the accent that separates it from a completely different word
Introduced in Chapter 36.

oublier
to forget
Introduced in Chapter 63.

oui
yes
Introduced in Chapter 22.

ouvert
open
Introduced in Chapter 131.

ouvrir
to open — an -ir verb that takes -er endings, from a Latin verb reshaped to look like its own opposite, and the source of English overt and overture
Introduced in Chapter 31.

palpitant
thrilling, exciting
Introduced in Chapter 523.

par conséquent
consequently, therefore
Introduced in Chapter 347.

par cœur
by heart
Introduced in Chapter 377.

par la suite
afterwards, later on
Introduced in Chapter 268.

paraître
to come out, to be published; to seem
Introduced in Chapter 279.

parce que
because — three words fused into two, par ce que, 'by this that'
Introduced in Chapter 40.

pareil / pareille
the same
Introduced in Chapter 219.

paresseux / paresseuse
lazy
Introduced in Chapter 246.

parfois
sometimes
Introduced in Chapter 98.

parier
to bet
Introduced in Chapter 500.

parler
to speak / to talk (your first regular -er verb)
Introduced in Chapter 5.

partager
to share
Introduced in Chapter 179.

participer
to take part
Introduced in Chapter 148.

partir en vacances
to go on holiday
Introduced in Chapter 242.

partout
everywhere
Introduced in Chapter 216.

passé simple · Präteritum · passato remoto
three languages, one retreat — and it spread by contact, not coincidence
Introduced in Chapter 18.

patauger
to splash about, to wade; to flounder
Introduced in Chapter 456.

patient / patiente
patient
Introduced in Chapter 220.

patiner
to skate
Introduced in Chapter 510.

patrouiller
to patrol
Introduced in Chapter 291.

pauvre
poor
Introduced in Chapter 91.

payer
to pay
Introduced in Chapter 62.

pêcher
to fish; to catch (fish)
Introduced in Chapter 497.

peindre
to paint
Introduced in Chapter 66.

penser
to think — from a Latin verb meaning "to weigh," which is why English pensive, ponder, compensate, expense and even the flower pansy all sit in one family
Introduced in Chapter 29.

percer
to drill, to pierce
Introduced in Chapter 531.

percuter
to crash into, to hit
Introduced in Chapter 411.

perdre
to lose
Introduced in Chapter 63.

permettre
to allow
Introduced in Chapter 177.

persuader
to persuade
Introduced in Chapter 335.

peser
to weigh
Introduced in Chapter 234.

pessimiste
pessimistic; pessimist
Introduced in Chapter 476.

pétrir
to knead
Introduced in Chapter 333.

peu à peu
little by little
Introduced in Chapter 271.

peureux / peureuse
fearful
Introduced in Chapter 190.

photographier
to photograph
Introduced in Chapter 233.

piquer
to sting, to bite (of insects); to prick
Introduced in Chapter 306.

plaisanter
to joke
Introduced in Chapter 242.

planter
to crash (of a computer, informal); to plant
Introduced in Chapter 399.

plausible
plausible
Introduced in Chapter 367.

plein
full
Introduced in Chapter 90.

pleurer
to cry
Introduced in Chapter 60.

plier
to fold
Introduced in Chapter 148.

plonger
to dive
Introduced in Chapter 509.

poli / polie
polite
Introduced in Chapter 159.

ponctuel / ponctuelle
punctual
Introduced in Chapter 220.

porter
to carry; to wear
Introduced in Chapter 65.

posséder
to own
Introduced in Chapter 148.

postuler
to apply (for a job)
Introduced in Chapter 354.

pour finir
to finish, to end with
Introduced in Chapter 268.

pourquoi
why — and the answer word that is built to match it
Introduced in Chapter 36.

poursuivre
to chase
Introduced in Chapter 212.

pourtant
however, yet
Introduced in Chapter 158.

pourvu que
as long as, provided that; let us hope that
Introduced in Chapter 368.

pousser
to push
Introduced in Chapter 181.

pouvoir
can — the verb that turns a demand into a request
Introduced in Chapter 37.

précéder
to precede, to come before
Introduced in Chapter 274.

préchauffer
to preheat
Introduced in Chapter 327.

préciser
to specify, to make precise
Introduced in Chapter 341.

préférer
to prefer
Introduced in Chapter 138.

prendre
to take — the grasping verb English borrowed a dozen times over, from prehensile
to prison to surprise
Introduced in Chapter 28.

préparer
to prepare
Introduced in Chapter 180.

près
near
Introduced in Chapter 96.

près de
near to
Introduced in Chapter 188.

présenter
to introduce
Introduced in Chapter 180.

presque
almost
Introduced in Chapter 217.

présumer
to presume
Introduced in Chapter 367.

prêt / prête
ready
Introduced in Chapter 245.

prétendre
to claim (with a hint of doubt)
Introduced in Chapter 334.

prêter
to lend
Introduced in Chapter 180.

prévenir
to warn
Introduced in Chapter 208.

prévisible
foreseeable, predictable
Introduced in Chapter 370.

prévoir
to foresee, to plan for
Introduced in Chapter 141.

prier
to pray
Introduced in Chapter 151.

prochain
next
Introduced in Chapter 132.

prochainement
soon, shortly
Introduced in Chapter 273.

profiter
to enjoy, to make the most of
Introduced in Chapter 209.

profond / profonde
deep
Introduced in Chapter 160.

programmer
to schedule, to plan; to program
Introduced in Chapter 371.

progressivement
gradually, progressively
Introduced in Chapter 271.

projeter
to screen (a film); to plan; to project
Introduced in Chapter 524.

promettre
to promise
Introduced in Chapter 177.

proposer
to propose
Introduced in Chapter 180.

propre
clean
Introduced in Chapter 244.

protéger
to protect
Introduced in Chapter 177.

protester
to protest
Introduced in Chapter 363.

prouver
to prove
Introduced in Chapter 293.

provenir
to come from, to originate in
Introduced in Chapter 349.

provisoire
temporary, provisional
Introduced in Chapter 371.

provoquer
to bring about, to cause; to provoke
Introduced in Chapter 346.

publier
to post, to publish
Introduced in Chapter 398.

puis
then
Introduced in Chapter 96.

puisque
since, as (a known reason)
Introduced in Chapter 347.

punir
to punish
Introduced in Chapter 388.

qualifier
(se qualifier) to qualify; to describe as
Introduced in Chapter 506.

quand
when — and a silent d that comes back to life
Introduced in Chapter 36.

quarante
forty
Introduced in Chapter 105.

quatorze
fourteen — the longest of the welded teens, and the least worn
Introduced in Chapter 14.

quatre
four
Introduced in Chapter 6.

quatre-vingt-dix
ninety
Introduced in Chapter 136.

que
what — the partner of qui, and the one that always elides
Introduced in Chapter 43.

Quel âge as-tu ?
asking someone's age — a fixed phrase you can use whole
Introduced in Chapter 17.

qui
who — Latin quis, unchanged in twenty centuries, and the shortest question in French
Introduced in Chapter 43.

quinze
fifteen — and the fortnight the French count in
Introduced in Chapter 14.

quitte à
even if it means
Introduced in Chapter 372.

quoi
what, standing on its own — the stressed twin of que, and the one that survives after a preposition
Introduced in Chapter 43.

raconter
to tell (a story) — and the backbone of a told story: the scene, the events in order, and the turn
Introduced in Chapter 259.

raisonner
to reason, to think logically
Introduced in Chapter 344.

ralentir
to slow down
Introduced in Chapter 151.

ramasser
to pick up
Introduced in Chapter 180.

ramer
to row
Introduced in Chapter 509.

rancunier
resentful, unforgiving
Introduced in Chapter 475.

ranger
to tidy up
Introduced in Chapter 242.

râper
to grate
Introduced in Chapter 328.

rapide
fast
Introduced in Chapter 89.

rapporter
to report, to relate; to bring back
Introduced in Chapter 284.

rarement
rarely
Introduced in Chapter 156.

raser
to shave (often se raser); to raze
Introduced in Chapter 448.

rassurer
to reassure
Introduced in Chapter 470.

réagir
to react
Introduced in Chapter 351.

réaliser
to achieve
Introduced in Chapter 210.

réanimer
to resuscitate, to revive
Introduced in Chapter 300.

rebrousser
to turn back (rebrousser chemin)
Introduced in Chapter 436.

récemment
recently
Introduced in Chapter 140.

recevoir
to receive
Introduced in Chapter 65.

réclamer
to ask for, to demand; to claim
Introduced in Chapter 431.

recommander
to recommend
Introduced in Chapter 151.

recomposé
blended (of a family)
Introduced in Chapter 492.

réconcilier
to reconcile; (se réconcilier) to make up
Introduced in Chapter 475.

reconnaître
to recognise
Introduced in Chapter 210.

recoudre
to sew back on, to stitch up
Introduced in Chapter 446.

recruter
to recruit
Introduced in Chapter 356.

reculer
to move back
Introduced in Chapter 152.

redémarrer
to restart, to reboot
Introduced in Chapter 399.

rediffuser
to repeat, to rebroadcast
Introduced in Chapter 525.

rédiger
to write, to draft (a text)
Introduced in Chapter 279.

redoubler
to repeat a year (at school); to increase
Introduced in Chapter 378.

réduire
to reduce
Introduced in Chapter 238.

refroidir
to cool down
Introduced in Chapter 206.

refuser
to refuse
Introduced in Chapter 238.

regarder
to look at, to watch
Introduced in Chapter 64.

régler
to settle (a bill), to pay; to adjust
Introduced in Chapter 451.

régner
to reign, to rule
Introduced in Chapter 323.

regretter
to regret; to miss
Introduced in Chapter 472.

relâcher
to release, to let go; to loosen
Introduced in Chapter 295.

relater
to recount, to relate
Introduced in Chapter 284.

remarquer
to notice
Introduced in Chapter 153.

rembourser
to pay back, to refund
Introduced in Chapter 394.

remédier
to remedy, to put right
Introduced in Chapter 353.

remercier
to thank
Introduced in Chapter 175.

remorquer
to tow
Introduced in Chapter 405.

remplacer
to replace
Introduced in Chapter 153.

remplir
to fill
Introduced in Chapter 234.

remplir un formulaire
to fill in a form
Introduced in Chapter 145.

rencontrer
to meet
Introduced in Chapter 153.

rendre
to give back
Introduced in Chapter 210.

renoncer
to give up
Introduced in Chapter 183.

renouveler
to renew
Introduced in Chapter 384.

rentable
profitable, worth it
Introduced in Chapter 393.

renverser
to knock over, to run over; to spill
Introduced in Chapter 298.

réparer
to repair
Introduced in Chapter 233.

repasser
to iron
Introduced in Chapter 233.

repérer
to spot; to find one's way (se repérer)
Introduced in Chapter 434.

répéter
to repeat
Introduced in Chapter 233.

répondre
to answer
Introduced in Chapter 137.

reporter
to postpone, to put off
Introduced in Chapter 371.

réservé
reserved, quiet (of a person); booked
Introduced in Chapter 466.

réserver
to book
Introduced in Chapter 205.

résister
to resist, to hold out
Introduced in Chapter 326.

résoudre
to solve
Introduced in Chapter 238.

respirer
to breathe
Introduced in Chapter 151.

ressembler
to look like
Introduced in Chapter 181.

ressemeler
to resole
Introduced in Chapter 446.

résulter
to result (from)
Introduced in Chapter 349.

rétablir
to restore; (se rétablir) to recover
Introduced in Chapter 485.

retarder
to delay, to hold up
Introduced in Chapter 420.

retirer
to take out, to withdraw
Introduced in Chapter 392.

rétorquer
to retort
Introduced in Chapter 336.

retoucher
to alter (a garment); to touch up
Introduced in Chapter 447.

réveillonner
to have the festive late-night dinner
Introduced in Chapter 319.

révéler
to reveal, to disclose
Introduced in Chapter 284.

revenir
to come back
Introduced in Chapter 62.

rêver
to dream
Introduced in Chapter 149.

réviser
to revise, to study for (an exam); to service (a car)
Introduced in Chapter 377.

riche
rich
Introduced in Chapter 91.

rien
nothing
Introduced in Chapter 139.

rigoler
to laugh, to have fun (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 474.

rincer
to rinse
Introduced in Chapter 530.

rire
to laugh
Introduced in Chapter 59.

risquer
to risk
Introduced in Chapter 238.

rompre
to break up; to break
Introduced in Chapter 491.

rond
round
Introduced in Chapter 94.

ronfler
to snore
Introduced in Chapter 486.

rose
pink
Introduced in Chapter 130.

rouge
red — and English red is not a lookalike but an actual cousin
Introduced in Chapter 16.

rougir
to blush
Introduced in Chapter 153.

rouspéter
to grumble, to moan
Introduced in Chapter 431.

rugueux / rugueuse
rough
Introduced in Chapter 244.

ruisseler
to stream, to run down (of water)
Introduced in Chapter 456.

rusé
cunning, crafty
Introduced in Chapter 468.

s'amuser
to have fun
Introduced in Chapter 146.

s'approcher
to come near
Introduced in Chapter 150.

s'asseoir
to sit down — a verb you do to yourself, from Latin sedēre, and the one French verb that ships with two accepted sets of forms
Introduced in Chapter 31.

s'éloigner
to move away
Introduced in Chapter 150.

s'ennuyer
to be bored
Introduced in Chapter 146.

s'habiller
to get dressed
Introduced in Chapter 138.

s'habituer
to get used to
Introduced in Chapter 239.

s'il vous plaît
please (literally "if it pleases you")
Introduced in Chapter 23.

s'inquiéter
to worry
Introduced in Chapter 146.

saigner
to bleed
Introduced in Chapter 153.

sale
dirty
Introduced in Chapter 92.

salé
salty
Introduced in Chapter 94.

saler
to salt (food, roads)
Introduced in Chapter 443.

saluer
to greet
Introduced in Chapter 175.

salut
hi / bye (informal)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

samedi
Saturday — the Sabbath day
Introduced in Chapter 7.

sanctionner
to penalise, to sanction
Introduced in Chapter 382.

sangloter
to sob
Introduced in Chapter 471.

saupoudrer
to sprinkle, to dust
Introduced in Chapter 332.

sauter
to jump
Introduced in Chapter 143.

sauvegarder
to save (a file); to safeguard
Introduced in Chapter 397.

sauver
to rescue
Introduced in Chapter 177.

savoir
to know (a fact)
Introduced in Chapter 64.

sceptique
sceptical
Introduced in Chapter 338.

sculpter
to sculpt, to carve
Introduced in Chapter 517.

se coiffer
to do one's hair
Introduced in Chapter 235.

se dépêcher
to hurry
Introduced in Chapter 239.

se disputer
to quarrel
Introduced in Chapter 145.

se fâcher
to get angry
Introduced in Chapter 146.

se lever, debout
to stand — French has no single verb for it, so the movement is se lever ("to lighten yourself") and the state is être debout, literally "on end"
Introduced in Chapter 31.

se plaindre
to complain
Introduced in Chapter 209.

se produire
to happen, to occur
Introduced in Chapter 140.

se promener
to go for a walk
Introduced in Chapter 148.

se rendre compte
to realise
Introduced in Chapter 239.

se reposer
to rest
Introduced in Chapter 235.

se réveiller
to wake up
Introduced in Chapter 235.

se taire
to be silent
Introduced in Chapter 211.

sec
dry
Introduced in Chapter 94.

sécher
to dry
Introduced in Chapter 205.

secourir
to rescue, to help
Introduced in Chapter 300.

seize
sixteen — the last word French inherited already welded
Introduced in Chapter 14.

séjourner
to stay for a while, to spend time (somewhere)
Introduced in Chapter 424.

selon
according to; depending on
Introduced in Chapter 369.

semblable
similar
Introduced in Chapter 245.

sembler
to seem
Introduced in Chapter 149.

semer
to sow
Introduced in Chapter 503.

sentir
to feel; to smell
Introduced in Chapter 65.

séparer
to separate; (se séparer) to split up
Introduced in Chapter 491.

sept
seven
Introduced in Chapter 6.

septembre
September — the month that still says “seven”
Introduced in Chapter 10.

serein
calm, serene
Introduced in Chapter 469.

sérieux / sérieuse
serious
Introduced in Chapter 190.

serrer
to squeeze
Introduced in Chapter 213.

servir
to serve
Introduced in Chapter 149.

seulement
only
Introduced in Chapter 217.

siffler
to whistle; to boo
Introduced in Chapter 505.

siffloter
to whistle softly (a tune)
Introduced in Chapter 512.

signaler
to report, to point out
Introduced in Chapter 432.

signer
to sign
Introduced in Chapter 145.

silencieux / silencieuse
silent
Introduced in Chapter 244.

simple
simple
Introduced in Chapter 191.

sincère
sincere, honest
Introduced in Chapter 468.

sinon
otherwise, or else
Introduced in Chapter 368.

six
six
Introduced in Chapter 6.

skier
to ski
Introduced in Chapter 183.

sociable
sociable, outgoing
Introduced in Chapter 466.

soigner
to look after, to treat, to nurse
Introduced in Chapter 485.

soir
evening (le soir — masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

soixante
sixty
Introduced in Chapter 136.

soixante-dix
seventy
Introduced in Chapter 136.

sombre
dark
Introduced in Chapter 192.

soudain
suddenly
Introduced in Chapter 187.

souffrir
to suffer
Introduced in Chapter 149.

souhaiter
to wish
Introduced in Chapter 320.

soulever
to lift
Introduced in Chapter 213.

souligner
to stress, to point out; to underline
Introduced in Chapter 343.

soupçonner
to suspect
Introduced in Chapter 213.

souple
supple; easygoing, adaptable
Introduced in Chapter 370.

sourire
to smile
Introduced in Chapter 143.

soutenir
to maintain, to claim; to support
Introduced in Chapter 334.

souvent
often
Introduced in Chapter 98.

stationner
to park, to be parked
Introduced in Chapter 407.

stressé
stressed
Introduced in Chapter 361.

subitement
suddenly, without warning
Introduced in Chapter 270.

subjectif
subjective
Introduced in Chapter 342.

sucré
sweet (with sugar)
Introduced in Chapter 93.

suffire
to be enough
Introduced in Chapter 236.

suggérer
to suggest
Introduced in Chapter 213.

supposer
to suppose, to assume
Introduced in Chapter 367.

supprimer
to delete; to remove
Introduced in Chapter 397.

sûr / sûre
safe, sure
Introduced in Chapter 160.

sur le coup
at the time, on the spot
Introduced in Chapter 270.

surprendre
to surprise
Introduced in Chapter 213.

sursauter
to jump, to start (with surprise)
Introduced in Chapter 470.

survenir
to occur, to arise unexpectedly
Introduced in Chapter 274.

survivre
to survive
Introduced in Chapter 305.

survoler
to fly over
Introduced in Chapter 419.

susciter
to arouse, to give rise to
Introduced in Chapter 350.

sympathique
nice, friendly
Introduced in Chapter 133.

tandis que
while, whereas
Introduced in Chapter 269.

tanguer
to pitch (of a boat); to sway
Introduced in Chapter 423.

taquiner
to tease (playfully)
Introduced in Chapter 466.

tard
late
Introduced in Chapter 187.

teindre
to dye
Introduced in Chapter 447.

télécharger
to download
Introduced in Chapter 183.

téléphoner
to phone
Introduced in Chapter 145.

témoigner
to testify, to give evidence
Introduced in Chapter 389.

tenir
to hold
Introduced in Chapter 176.

tenter
to attempt
Introduced in Chapter 211.

têtu
stubborn
Introduced in Chapter 467.

timide
shy
Introduced in Chapter 190.

tirer
to pull
Introduced in Chapter 181.

tolérer
to tolerate, to put up with
Introduced in Chapter 381.

tordre
to twist, to wring; (se tordre) to twist (a joint)
Introduced in Chapter 481.

tôt ou tard
sooner or later
Introduced in Chapter 271.

toucher
to touch
Introduced in Chapter 206.

toujours
always; still
Introduced in Chapter 95.

tourner
to turn
Introduced in Chapter 179.

tousser
to cough
Introduced in Chapter 241.

tout à coup
all of a sudden
Introduced in Chapter 270.

tout d'abord
first of all, to begin with
Introduced in Chapter 268.

tout droit
straight on — and the directions that follow it: left, right, keep going, cross
Introduced in Chapter 262.

traduire
to translate
Introduced in Chapter 144.

trahir
to betray
Introduced in Chapter 495.

tranquille
quiet, peaceful
Introduced in Chapter 218.

transgresser
to transgress, to break (a rule)
Introduced in Chapter 382.

transiter
to change planes, to pass through
Introduced in Chapter 417.

transpirer
to sweat, to perspire
Introduced in Chapter 464.

transporter
to transport
Introduced in Chapter 211.

travailler
to work (a third -er verb — and the origin of "travel")
Introduced in Chapter 5.

travailleur / travailleuse
hard-working
Introduced in Chapter 246.

traverser
to cross
Introduced in Chapter 208.

trébucher
to stumble, to trip
Introduced in Chapter 455.

treize
thirteen — three-ten, with both halves now legible
Introduced in Chapter 14.

trembler
to tremble
Introduced in Chapter 241.

tremper
to soak; to dip
Introduced in Chapter 527.

trente
thirty
Introduced in Chapter 105.

très
very — Latin trans, 'across', which crossed over into an intensifier and takes no de at all
Introduced in Chapter 44.

tricher
to cheat
Introduced in Chapter 499.

tricoter
to knit
Introduced in Chapter 496.

trinquer
to clink glasses, to drink to
Introduced in Chapter 320.

triste
sad
Introduced in Chapter 56.

trois
three
Introduced in Chapter 6.

tromper
to deceive; to be unfaithful to
Introduced in Chapter 495.

trouver
to find
Introduced in Chapter 67.

tu / vous
you (familiar / formal)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

tu as
you have — the informal one, and it sounds exactly like the last one
Introduced in Chapter 17.

tu es
you are — two letters, and it sounds like a single vowel
Introduced in Chapter 19.

tuer
to kill
Introduced in Chapter 211.

un
one — and, at the same time, "a/an"
Introduced in Chapter 6.

un aller-retour, un aller simple
a return ticket, a one-way ticket — and how to ask for one, and when and where the train leaves
Introduced in Chapter 263.

un an, des ans
a year — and the annual, the anniversary and the annals inside it
Introduced in Chapter 17.

un peu
a little — the opposite end of the same scale, and the same bare de after it
Introduced in Chapter 44.

unir
to unite
Introduced in Chapter 239.

utile
useful
Introduced in Chapter 191.

utiliser
to use
Introduced in Chapter 62.

vaincre
to defeat, to overcome
Introduced in Chapter 324.

valable
acceptable, valid; worthwhile
Introduced in Chapter 384.

valide
valid; fit, able-bodied
Introduced in Chapter 384.

valider
to validate (a ticket); to approve
Introduced in Chapter 412.

valoir
to be worth
Introduced in Chapter 239.

vaniteux
vain, conceited
Introduced in Chapter 473.

vanter
to praise; (se vanter) to boast
Introduced in Chapter 473.

vendredi
Friday — the day of Venus
Introduced in Chapter 7.

verbaliser
to fine, to write up (a driver)
Introduced in Chapter 408.

vérifier
to check
Introduced in Chapter 234.

verser
to pour; to pay in
Introduced in Chapter 329.

vert, jaune
green and yellow — vert is the standard, expected Latin viridis descendant shared by nearly every Romance language; jaune comes from a Latin word that literally meant "yellow-GREEN," and is usually said to share its ultimate PIE root with German's gelb, though that particular link is less secure than it first appears
Introduced in Chapter 27.

vide
empty
Introduced in Chapter 90.

vider
to empty
Introduced in Chapter 234.

vieillir
to grow old
Introduced in Chapter 207.

vieux
old
Introduced in Chapter 89.

vingt
twenty — a single inherited word again, and the base French will later count in
Introduced in Chapter 15.

violet
purple
Introduced in Chapter 130.

viser
to aim (at)
Introduced in Chapter 374.

visiter
to visit (a place)
Introduced in Chapter 137.

vivre
to live
Introduced in Chapter 61.

voici
here is — a frozen command, see here, and the word that lets you introduce somebody who is not you
Introduced in Chapter 38.

voler
to fly, to steal
Introduced in Chapter 238.

vomir
to vomit, to be sick
Introduced in Chapter 483.

voter
to vote
Introduced in Chapter 241.

vouloir
to want — and why je voudrais is the form you will actually use
Introduced in Chapter 37.

vous avez
you have — plural, and polite to one person
Introduced in Chapter 17.

vous êtes
you are — and the circumflex marks the s that used to be there
Introduced in Chapter 19.

vraiment
really
Introduced in Chapter 189.

vraisemblable
likely, believable
Introduced in Chapter 340.

vu que
seeing that
Introduced in Chapter 347.

zapper
to channel-hop; to skip
Introduced in Chapter 525.

zéro
zero
Introduced in Chapter 136.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 salut — *let your eye and hand meet one known word*
Which written letter stays silent at the end of salut?

1.2 salut — *one supported copy*
Copy the visible word salut once, then report how many letters you wrote.

1.3 salut — *look, hide, write, compare*
After hiding the model for five seconds, write the casual greeting and then compare it.

1.4 *One heard greeting — write what you know*
From the heard cue sa-LU alone, write the known casual greeting.

Chapter 22

22.1 *(oui, continued) — The other "yes," si*
French has two words for yes. Which one contradicts a negative?

Chapter 45

45.1 *(reading) — six things you would be told*
Which line tells you to listen?

45.2 *(reading) — six lines off a form*
How old is she?

45.3 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Where does she live?

Chapter 259

259.1 *(reading) — a journey, told in both pasts*
How many events in the passé composé are in the passage?

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 salut — *let your eye and hand meet one known word*
Answer: t
Also accepted: the final t; final t

1.2 salut — *one supported copy*
Answer: salut — five letters
Also accepted: salut; 5; five

1.3 salut — *look, hide, write, compare*
Answer: salut

1.4 *One heard greeting — write what you know*
Answer: salut

Chapter 22

22.1 *(oui, continued) — The other "yes," si*
Answer: si
Also accepted: si!

Chapter 45

45.1 *(reading) — six things you would be told*
Answer: ecoute
Also accepted: Écoute; Écoute !; listen

45.2 *(reading) — six lines off a form*
Answer: twenty
Also accepted: vingt; vingt ans; 20

45.3 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Answer: paris
Also accepted: à Paris

Chapter 259

259.1 *(reading) — a journey, told in both pasts*
Answer: seven
Also accepted: 7; sept

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

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a ball *le ballon*
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À la salle
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a label *l'étiquette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1167

a ladder *l'échelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1533
a lamp *la lampe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 583
a landscape *le paysage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1539
a large river *le fleuve*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1137
a law *la loi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1485
a lawn *la pelouse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1677
a lawyer; an avocado *l'avocat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 889
a leaf; a sheet of paper *la feuille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 627
a leg *la jambe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 433
a lemon *le citron*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
a lesson *la leçon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 901
a letter *la lettre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 853
a letterbox, a postbox *la boîte aux lettres*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 797
a library *la bibliothèque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753
a lie *le mensonge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1659
a lift, an elevator *l'ascenseur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 779
a lion *le lion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 663
a lip *la lèvre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
a little — the opposite end of the same scale, and the same bare de after it *un peu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 415
a living room *le salon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 589
a loan *le prêt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1509
a lock *la serrure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1131

a lot — a beautiful blow, two words fused, and the p that never sounds *beaucoup*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 415
a lung *le poumon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1075
a magazine *le magazine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1545
a map; a card *la carte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 621
a mayor *le maire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1641
a meal *le repas*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 877
a mechanic *le mécanicien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1329
a medical appointment *la consultation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1611
a medicine *le médicament*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 457
a meeting *la réunion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1197
a melon *le melon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 865
a mirror *le miroir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 589
a mistake *l'erreur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1545
a mobile phone *le téléphone portable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1377
a monkey *le singe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 663
a month *le mois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711
a monument *le monument*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1173
a mosquito *le moustique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1317
a mother-in-law *la belle-mère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1155
a motorbike *la moto*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1635
a motorway *l'autoroute*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1515
a mountain *la montagne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 627

a mouse *la souris*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651
a muscle *le muscle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1263
a museum *le musée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 741
a mushroom *le champignon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 859
a nail (finger or toe) *l'ongle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 445
a nail for hammering *le clou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1533
a necklace *le collier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 853
a needle *l'aiguille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1533
a neighbour *le voisin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 487
a nephew *le neveu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
a niece *la nièce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
a notebook *le cahier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 609
a notice, an opinion *l'avis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1001
a number (on a door, a phone) *le numéro*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
a nurse *l'infirmière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 883
a painter *le peintre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1647
a parcel *le colis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1665
a park *le parc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 741
a passport *le passeport*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1137
a path *le sentier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1677
a pavement *le trottoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 791
a pay slip *la fiche de paie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1167

a peach *la pêche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1479
a pear *la poire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
a pebble *le caillou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1179
a pen *le stylo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 609
a pencil *le crayon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 609
a pharmacist *le pharmacien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1149
a pharmacy *la pharmacie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 747
a phone *le téléphone*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615
a photo *la photo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 621
a photographer *le photographe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1149
a piano *le piano*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1689
a piece of news *la nouvelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1323
a pig *le cochon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651
a pillow *l'oreiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 821
a pilot *le pilote*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1497
a plain *la plaine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1179
a plan, a project *le projet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
a plant *la plante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1521
a plaster, a dressing *le pansement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1611
a plate *l'assiette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 595
a platform *le quai*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1635
a player *le joueur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1371

a plumber *le plombier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1329
a pocket *la poche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
a poem *le poème*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1647
a police officer *le policier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 883
a possibility *la possibilité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1503
a postcard *la carte postale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1167
a postman, a postwoman *le facteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 895
a potato *la pomme de terre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 547
a prescription *l'ordonnance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1443
a present, a gift *le cadeau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615
a price; a prize *le prix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 921
a printer *l'imprimante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1377
a problem *le problème*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
a promise *la promesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1341
a pupil *l'élève*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
a rabbit *le lapin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 669
a racket *la raquette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1191
a radio *la radio*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 809
a reason *la raison*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1503
a red light *le feu rouge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 791
a researcher *le chercheur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1497
a restaurant *le restaurant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 747

a result *le résultat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1659
a return ticket, a one-way ticket — and how to ask for one, and when and where the train leaves *un aller-retour, un aller simple*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1737
a ring *la bague*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 853
a river *la rivière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 627
a rock *le rocher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1179
a roof *le toit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 583
a root *la racine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1521
a rope *la corde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1365
a rubber, an eraser *la gomme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
a rug, a carpet *le tapis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 809
a rule *la règle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1161
a salad; lettuce *la salade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
a salary *le salaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1197
a sandwich *le sandwich*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 877
a sauce *la sauce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 877
a saucepan *la casserole*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1311
a scar *la cicatrice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1263
a scarf *l'écharpe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 839
a school *l'école*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 735
a scientist *le scientifique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1497
a screen *l'écran*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1323
a seat *le siège*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1347

a second *la seconde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 957
a seed *la graine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1521
a sheep *le mouton*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 663
a sheet *le drap*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1311
a sheet of paper *la feuille de papier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1377
a shelf *l'étagère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 815
a shirt *la chemise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 759
a shop *le magasin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 735
a shop assistant *le vendeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 883
a shoulder *l'épaule*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 439
a show *le spectacle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1491
a shower *la douche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 815
a singer *le chanteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1491
a skirt *la jupe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 765
a small bag *le sachet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1365
a snake *le serpent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 657
a sofa *le canapé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 589
a soldier *le soldat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1143
a son-in-law *le gendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1155
a song *la chanson*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 915
a soup *la soupe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 553
a spoon *la cuillère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 601

a stadium *le stade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 785
a stamp *le timbre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1665
a star *l'étoile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 639
a statue *la statue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1173
a steering wheel *le volant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1347
a stone *la pierre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 633
a stop *l'arrêt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1635
a storm *l'orage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
a strawberry *la fraise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 865
a street *la rue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729
a student *l'étudiant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 889
a suitcase *la valise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 621
a supermarket *le supermarché*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 785
a swimming pool *la piscine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 785
a swimsuit; a sports shirt *le maillot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 847
a syrup *le sirop*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1443
À table
chapter topic; Chapter 529, p. 3405
a tablet (medicine) *le comprimé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1443
a tax *l'impôt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1665
a taxi *le taxi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 779
a teacher *le professeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
a team *l'équipe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1695

a television *la télévision*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 809
a theatre *le théâtre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753
a thorn *l'épine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1677
a thousand *mille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
a thread, a wire *le fil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1533
a thumb *le pouce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1263
a ticket; a banknote *le billet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 621
a tie *la cravate*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 839
a tiger *le tigre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 669
a till, a checkout *la caisse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 895
a time, an occasion *la fois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 921
a tip *le pourboire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1635
a toll *le péage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1515
a tomato *la tomate*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 547
a tool *l'outil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1689
a tooth *la dent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 433
a toothbrush *la brosse à dents*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 821
a tortoise *la tortue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
a tourist *le touriste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1653
a towel; a napkin *la serviette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 821
a tower *la tour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1173
a town, a city *la ville*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729

a tradition *la tradition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1143
a train *le train*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 735
a tree *l'arbre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 627
a trunk *le tronc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1677
a tunnel *le tunnel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1671
a twin *le jumeau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1653
À une condition
chapter topic; Chapter 368, p. 2397
a university *l'université*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1545
a vacuum cleaner *l'aspirateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
a valley *la vallée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1317
a vase *le vase*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1521
a vegetable garden *le potager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1353
a victory *la victoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1191
a village *le village*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 747
a violin *le violon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1689
a volcano *le volcan*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1179
a vote *le vote*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1641
À votre santé !
chapter topic; Chapter 320, p. 2095
a waiter *le serveur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 895
a wall *le mur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 577
a wallet *le portefeuille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 847
a walnut, a nut *la noix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571

a wardrobe *l'armoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 815
a watch *la montre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1479
a waterfall *la cascade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1179
a wave *la vague*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 645
a week *la semaine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711
a wheel *la roue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1515
a widower *le veuf*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1335
a window *la fenêtre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 577
a wolf *le loup*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651
a woman; a wife *la femme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 481
a word *le mot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 901
a worker *l'ouvrier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1329
a wound *la blessure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1263
a wrist *le poignet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451
a writer *l'écrivain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1647
a year — and the annual, the anniversary and the annals inside it *un an, des ans*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
a yoghurt *le yaourt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
about, approximately *environ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1455
above *au-dessus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
Above, Below, In front, Behind, Beside
chapter topic; Chapter 157, p. 1093
abruptly, sharply *brusquement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1783
absurd *absurde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2209

acceptable, valid; worthwhile *valable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2497
Accident de la route
chapter topic; Chapter 297, p. 1951
according to; depending on *selon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2403
accordion *l'accordéon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3293
Actor, Actress, Poem, Writer, Painter
chapter topic; Chapter 249, p. 1647
actor (especially on stage) *le comédien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3319
adolescence, the teenage years *l'adolescence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2033
adoption *l'adoption*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3175
advertising *la publicité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1323
advice *le conseil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1161
afterwards, later on *par la suite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1771
afterwards, next *ensuite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
ai · as · a — three spellings, one ear
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 17, p. 195
all of a sudden *tout à coup*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1783
aller · venir · naître · mourir — the shape of the list
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
allergy *l'allergie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3113
almost *presque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1455
Almost, About, Only, Together, Nevertheless
chapter topic; Chapter 217, p. 1455
already *déjà*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
Already, Recently, the Day before Yesterday, Formerly, To Happen
chapter topic; Chapter 140, p. 989
although *bien que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
always; still *toujours*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711

ambulance *l'ambulance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3125
Amoureux
chapter topic; Chapter 487, p. 3143
an accountant *le comptable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1497
an actor *l'acteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1647
an actress *l'actrice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1647
an address *l'adresse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
an adult *l'adulte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1653
an advert, an announcement *l'annonce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1001
an aeroplane *l'avion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 735
an airport *l'aéroport*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 759
an ankle *la cheville*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451
an answer *la réponse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
an ant *la fourmi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 669
an apple *la pomme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 541
an architect *l'architecte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1149
an arm *le bras*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 433
an armchair *le fauteuil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1311
an army *l'armée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1143
an attic *le grenier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1353
an aunt *la tante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 481
an ear *l'oreille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
an elbow *le coude*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451

an elderly person *la personne âgée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1653
an electrician *l'électricien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1329
an elephant *l'éléphant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 669
an email *le courriel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 957
an emergency *l'urgence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1611
an employee *l'employé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1497
an engine *le moteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1515
an engineer *l'ingénieur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 889
an entrance *l'entrée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1347
an envelope *l'enveloppe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1665
an exam *l'examen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 901
an example *l'exemple*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1659
an exit *la sortie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1347
an idea *l'idée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
an illness *la maladie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 463
an interview *l'entretien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1377
an island *l'île*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 633
an office; a desk *le bureau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 791
an ointment *la pommade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1443
an onion *l'oignon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 547
an orange *l'orange*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 547
an umbrella *le parapluie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615

an uncle *l'oncle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 481
and — Latin et unchanged, and a t that never joins to the next word *et*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
anger *la colère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
angry *fâché / fâchée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1629
Ant, Elephant, Rabbit, Frog, Tiger
chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 669
anxiety *l'angoisse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1081
anxious *anxieux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3075
anything at all *n'importe quoi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
anyway *de toute façon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
applause *les applaudissements*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3319
April — perhaps the opening month *avril*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 113
Arm, Leg, Foot, Finger, Tooth
chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 433
around *autour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1449
Around, Everywhere, Elsewhere, Up there, Suburbs
chapter topic; Chapter 216, p. 1449
arrival *l'arrivée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1539
arrogance, excessive pride *l'orgueil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3055
art *l'art*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1695
as long as, provided that; let us hope that *pourvu que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2397
as one goes along, bit by bit *au fur et à mesure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1789
as soon as *dès que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1777
Asking a Question — Three Ways, and Which One to Use
chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 349

asking someone's age — a fixed phrase you can use whole *Quel âge as-tu ?*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 17, p. 195
Assaisonner
chapter topic; Chapter 332, p. 2171
at once, immediately *aussitôt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1777
at the bottom, at the back *au fond*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1281
at the end of, following *à l'issue de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1827
at the moment when, right as *au moment où*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1777
At the Station — un aller-retour, j'ai raté le train
chapter topic; Chapter 263, p. 1737
at the time, on the spot *sur le coup*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1783
Attention aux escrocs
chapter topic; Chapter 288, p. 1895
-ātum · -ītum · -ūtum — where the endings came from
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 213
au, aux — where *à* and *le* melt together
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
Au bord de l'eau
chapter topic; Chapter 304, p. 1995
Au bord de la mer
chapter topic; Chapter 458, p. 2961
Au bureau
chapter topic; Chapter 359, p. 2341
Au camping
chapter topic; Chapter 425, p. 2755
Au feu !
chapter topic; Chapter 302, p. 1983
Au fond des bois
chapter topic; Chapter 457, p. 2955
Au four
chapter topic; Chapter 331, p. 2163
Au guichet
chapter topic; Chapter 412, p. 2673
Au lycée
chapter topic; Chapter 375, p. 2441
Au moment où
chapter topic; Chapter 269, p. 1777
Au pressing
chapter topic; Chapter 447, p. 2891

au printemps, en été — saying you are *in* a season
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 11, p. 133
Au théâtre
chapter topic; Chapter 514, p. 3313
Au tribunal
chapter topic; Chapter 387, p. 2515
Au volant
chapter topic; Chapter 401, p. 2605
August — the month renamed for the emperor Augustus *août*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 123
Auteurs et lecteurs
chapter topic; Chapter 521, p. 3355
Autour de la ville en voiture
chapter topic; Chapter 400, p. 2599
autumn — the season English borrowed whole *l'automne*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 133
Aux urgences
chapter topic; Chapter 484, p. 3125
available, free *disponible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2427
Avant l'examen
chapter topic; Chapter 377, p. 2453

B

baby's bottle *le biberon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3181
bait *l'appât*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3205
Baker, Student, Driver, Lawyer, Engineer
chapter topic; Chapter 124, p. 889
ball (of wool or string) *la pelote*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3199
Ball, Racket, Gym, Swimming, Victory
chapter topic; Chapter 173, p. 1191
Banana, Orange, Potato, Tomato, Onion
chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 547
Bank card, Cash machine, Bank account, Loan, Debt
chapter topic; Chapter 226, p. 1509
Battery, Charger, Singer, Concert, Show
chapter topic; Chapter 223, p. 1491
Battre les œufs
chapter topic; Chapter 329, p. 2151

beans *les haricots*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 859
Bear, Fox, Snake, Hen, Duck
chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 657
because of *à cause de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2271
because — three words fused into two, par ce que, 'by this that' *parce que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
beef; an ox *le bœuf*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 859
Beef, Vegetables, Mushroom, Beans, Cucumber
chapter topic; Chapter 119, p. 859
beer *la bière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 871
Beer, Juice, Ice cream, Chocolate, Biscuit
chapter topic; Chapter 121, p. 871
before, previously *auparavant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1795
behind *derrière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
believable, credible *crédible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2221
belote (a card game) *la belote*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3225
below *au-dessous*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
beside *à côté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
Bestioles et volets
chapter topic; Chapter 430, p. 2785
bet *le pari*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3225
betrayal; treason *la trahison*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3193
Bicycle, Underground, Taxi, Car park, Lift
chapter topic; Chapter 106, p. 779
Bien voir la route
chapter topic; Chapter 402, p. 2611
big, fat *gros*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
Bill, Tip, Stop, Motorbike, Platform
chapter topic; Chapter 247, p. 1635
biography *la biographie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3363

bitter *amer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
black — the straightforward one, straight down from Latin *noir*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
blended (of a family) *recomposé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3175
blood *le sang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 439
blue — a Germanic word that went to France, changed clothes, and came back *bleu*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
blurred, out of focus; vague *flou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3237
board game *le jeu de société*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3219
boiling, the boiling point *l'ébullition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2157
bone *l'os*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3099
bookseller *le libraire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3349
boots *les bottes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 847
Boots, Cap, Swimsuit, Size, Wallet
chapter topic; Chapter 117, p. 847
Border, North, South, West, Letterbox
chapter topic; Chapter 109, p. 797
boring *ennuyeux / ennuyeuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1467
Boring, Fun, Strange, Different, Same
chapter topic; Chapter 219, p. 1467
Bouchons sur l'autoroute
chapter topic; Chapter 410, p. 2661
Box, Suitcase, Ticket, Map, Photo
chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 621
brave *courageux / courageuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1293
bread — and the companion who is, literally, someone you share it with *le pain*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 13, p. 153
Bread, Water, Wine
chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 153
break-up; breaking *la rupture*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3169

breakfast *le petit-déjeuner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
breaststroke *la brasse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3281
Bridegroom, Bride, Widower, Success, Failure
chapter topic; Chapter 197, p. 1335
brother — and the friar who is one *le frère*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141
brown (chestnut) *marron*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
brown (of hair, skin) *brun*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
Bruine et averses
chapter topic; Chapter 461, p. 2979
bump, lump *la bosse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3093
burn *la brûlure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3093
busy *occupé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933
Busy, Free, Open, Closed, Calm
chapter topic; Chapter 131, p. 933
but — Latin magis, more, which stayed more in Spanish and became but only here *mais*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
Butcher, Mechanic, Electrician, Plumber, Worker
chapter topic; Chapter 196, p. 1329
butter — masculine, and the same borrowed word as English butter, not two separate coinages *le beurre*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 34, p. 335
by heart *par cœur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2453

C

ç — the little tail that softens *c*
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 45
Ça ne marche pas
chapter topic; Chapter 399, p. 2591
calf (of the leg) *le mollet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3081
Câlins et confidences
chapter topic; Chapter 488, p. 3149

calm, quiet *calme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933
calm, serene *serein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3031
campfire *le feu de camp*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3213
can — the verb that turns a demand into a request *pouvoir*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 37, p. 359
canvas; cloth; web *la toile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3325
Car, Bridge, Park, Church, Museum
chapter topic; Chapter 100, p. 741
Carrot, Cake, Soup, Honey, Oil
chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 553
Cartes et paris
chapter topic; Chapter 500, p. 3225
cash; the liquid *le liquide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 2911
Castle, Tower, Monument, Statue, Fountain
chapter topic; Chapter 170, p. 1173
Causes et conséquences
chapter topic; Chapter 346, p. 2259
ce, cet, cette, ces — pointing at a noun
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
Ce que disent les journaux
chapter topic; Chapter 284, p. 1871
Ce qui est arrivé
chapter topic; Chapter 274, p. 1807
Célébrer
chapter topic; Chapter 316, p. 2071
cello *le violoncelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3293
censorship *la censure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 1877
ceremony *la cérémonie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3155
certainly *certainement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1287
champion *le champion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3269
chance, luck *le hasard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3225
change (coins); currency *la monnaie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 957

Changement de programme
chapter topic; Chapter 371, p. 2415
Chanter juste
chapter topic; Chapter 512, p. 3299
cheerful *joyeux / joyeuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1293
Cheerful, Serious, Shy, Brave, Fearful
chapter topic; Chapter 190, p. 1293
cheerfulness *la gaieté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3063
Cheese, Butter, Salt, Egg
chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 335
cheese — masculine, and named for its MOULD rather than for the milk it's made from *le fromage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 335
chessboard *l'échiquier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3219
Chest, Stomach, Ankle, Elbow, Wrist
chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 451
Chez le cordonnier
chapter topic; Chapter 446, p. 2885
Chez le libraire
chapter topic; Chapter 520, p. 3349
chicken *le poulet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 541
(chien, chat, continued) — chat
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 26, p. 279
child — one spelling for both genders, the article alone showing which; literally "not yet speaking" *l'enfant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 329
childhood *l'enfance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2027
chocolate *le chocolat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 871
choir *la chorale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3299
chorus, refrain *le refrain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3299
Citoyens
chapter topic; Chapter 362, p. 2359
clammy, sticky (with damp heat) *moite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 2999
Class, Lesson, Exam, Word, Board
chapter topic; Chapter 126, p. 901

clay *l'argile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3331
clean *propre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1617
Clean, Cut, Forget, Look for, Lose
chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 517
clear, light (of a colour) *clair / claire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1305
clear, obvious, manifest *manifeste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2215
climbing *l'escalade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3213
Clochers et remparts
chapter topic; Chapter 439, p. 2841
closed *fermé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933
closeness, bond; complicity *la complicité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3149
clothes *les vêtements*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 759
clothes peg *la pince à linge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 3387
cloudy *nuageux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 2973
clumsy *maladroit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3019
coat hanger *le cintre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 3387
coffee — masculine, and the one drink-word nearly all of Europe borrowed along the same single road *le café*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 323
Coffee, Tea, Milk, Sugar
chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 323
Coiffeur et opticien
chapter topic; Chapter 448, p. 2899
Collectionneurs
chapter topic; Chapter 501, p. 3231
collector *le collectionneur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3231
Colours
chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 183
Come back, Study, Pay, Use, Show
chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 511
comfortable *confortable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105

Comfortable, Uncomfortable, Polite, Rude, Unpleasant
chapter topic; Chapter 159, p. 1105
comic book, comic strip *la bande dessinée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3363
Comment réagir
chapter topic; Chapter 351, p. 2291
Comment vas-tu ? / Comment allez-vous ?
grammar topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 3, p. 33
Company, Colleague, Salary, Meeting, Contract
chapter topic; Chapter 174, p. 1197
complicated *compliqué / compliquée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1299
compulsory, mandatory *obligatoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2471
conductor (of an orchestra) *le chef d'orchestre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3305
consequently, therefore *par conséquent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2265
Contrôles sur la route
chapter topic; Chapter 408, p. 2649
convalescence, recovery period *la convalescence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3131
convincing *convaincant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2185
cooked *cuit / cuite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1305
Cooked, Ripe, Dark, Clear, Distant
chapter topic; Chapter 192, p. 1305
costume; suit *le costume*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3313
cotton *le coton*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1185
Couper les légumes
chapter topic; Chapter 328, p. 2145
courage *le courage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1269
Cow, Pig, Bird, Mouse, Wolf
chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 651
cream *la crème*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
creased, crumpled; offended *froissé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 3393
crime, delinquency *la délinquance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 1907

crime novel, detective story (informal) *le polar*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3363
Croire ou pas
chapter topic; Chapter 340, p. 2221
crutch *la béquille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3099
Cry, Wash, Cook, Play, Learn
chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 499
cuddle, hug *le câlin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3149
cunning, crafty *rusé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3025
Cupboard, Ceiling, Corridor, Glass, Plate
chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 595
curious *curieux / curieuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1461
Curious, Jealous, Proud, Nervous, Quiet
chapter topic; Chapter 218, p. 1461
customs *la douane*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1137
cut *la coupure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3093

D

D'abord, Ensuite, Enfin — A Story Told in Order
chapter topic; Chapter 259, p. 1711
D'où ça vient
chapter topic; Chapter 349, p. 2277
dangerous *dangereux / dangereuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
Dans l'eau
chapter topic; Chapter 509, p. 3281
Dans la rue
chapter topic; Chapter 363, p. 2855; Chapter 441, p. 2855
Dans les virages
chapter topic; Chapter 409, p. 2655
dark *sombre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1305
day (le jour — masculine) *jour*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
day nursery, crèche; nativity scene *la crèche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3187

De la hanche au talon
chapter topic; Chapter 477, p. 3081
de la — the half of the partitive that was missing
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
De quelle humeur ?
chapter topic; Chapter 469, p. 3031
dear; expensive *cher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
debatable, questionable *discutable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2209
December — the month that still says "ten" *décembre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123
Décollage et atterrissage
chapter topic; Chapter 419, p. 2717
deep *profond / profonde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
Deep, Low, Unknown, Dangerous, Safe
chapter topic; Chapter 160, p. 1111
Defeat, Championship, Player, Coach, Connection
chapter topic; Chapter 203, p. 1371
departure *le départ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1539
depuis, pendant — how long, and still going
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1749
Des papiers en règle
chapter topic; Chapter 384, p. 2497
des — the plural of *un*, and the last shape of *some*
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
despite *malgré*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1287
Despite, Unfortunately, Luckily, Certainly, Really
chapter topic; Chapter 189, p. 1287
Devant l'écran
chapter topic; Chapter 525, p. 3381
Dialect, Piece of news, Advertising, Screen, Keyboard
chapter topic; Chapter 195, p. 1323
dice, die *le dé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3219
different *différent / différente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1467
difficult *difficile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
Difficult, Dear, High, Full, Empty
chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 681

dinner *le dîner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
dirty *sale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
disappointment *la déception*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3043
dishes, crockery *la vaisselle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 3413
disinformation, false information *la désinformation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 1877
Disputes et trahisons
chapter topic; Chapter 495, p. 3193
distant *lointain / lointaine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1305
District, Airport, Clothes, Shirt, Dress
chapter topic; Chapter 103, p. 759
dive *le plongeon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3281
divorced *divorcé / divorcée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1125
DIY, odd jobs *le bricolage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 3419
dizziness; fear of heights *le vertige*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3119
documentary *le documentaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 3381
Dog and Cat
chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 279
dog and cat — chien is the REGULAR, expected descendant of canis (unlike Spanish's mysterious perro); chat continues cattus, the same Egypt-to-Rome story as Spanish's gato *chien, chat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 26, p. 279
donc, alors — the arrow that points forward
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1719
Donner un coup de main
chapter topic; Chapter 366, p. 2385
doubtful, dubious *douteux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2221
Draw, Paint, Count, Win, Hide
chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 535
draw, tie (in sport) *le match nul*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3263
Drawing, Life, Time, Colour, Price
chapter topic; Chapter 129, p. 921

Driving licence, Helmet, Tunnel, Building site, Block of flats
chapter topic; Chapter 253, p. 1671
drowning, a drowning *la noyade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 1995
dry *sec*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
du pain, de l'eau — asking for *some*
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 13, p. 153
dubbing *le doublage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3375
dumbbell, weight *l'haltère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3249
dust *la poussière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1359

E

é è ê — the three hats on *e*, and the one that hides an *s*
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 45
earth, land *la terre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1359
Earth, Mud, Dust, Smoke, Flame
chapter topic; Chapter 201, p. 1359
easel *le chevalet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3325
easy *facile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
Écrire pour le journal
chapter topic; Chapter 279, p. 1839
effective, efficient *efficace*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2353
egg — masculine, a genuine cousin of English egg, and the one French noun whose final consonant vanishes only in the plural *l'œuf, les œufs*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 335
eight *huit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
eighteen — free, once you have the rule *dix-huit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
eldest, older (sibling) *l'aîné*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3163
elections *les élections*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1641

electricity *l'électricité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1683
eleven — and not "ten-one", which is the whole surprise *onze*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
Élever des enfants
chapter topic; Chapter 494, p. 3187
eligible *éligible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2491
elle est allée — the participle agrees
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
elle s'est lavée — the auxiliary lies about the rule
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
elles se sont souvenues — the verbs with no other form
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
elsewhere *ailleurs*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1449
Emballer et envoyer
chapter topic; Chapter 453, p. 2929
Employee, Pilot, Accountant, Scientist, Researcher
chapter topic; Chapter 224, p. 1497
empty *vide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
En croisière
chapter topic; Chapter 423, p. 2741
En plein air
chapter topic; Chapter 498, p. 3213
En randonnée
chapter topic; Chapter 455, p. 2941
En version originale
chapter topic; Chapter 524, p. 3375
En ville sans voiture
chapter topic; Chapter 415, p. 2691
ending, outcome (of a story) *le dénouement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3343
energy *l'énergie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1683
Enfreindre les règles
chapter topic; Chapter 382, p. 2485
engagement (to marry) *les fiançailles*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3155
enough, and rather — one word doing both jobs, and it takes de before a noun and nothing before an adjective *assez*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 415
Entrance, Exit, Luggage, Seat, Steering wheel
chapter topic; Chapter 199, p. 1347

episode *l'épisode*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3369
Escale et retard
chapter topic; Chapter 420, p. 2723
esse — the first stem
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
est-ce que — the phrase that announces a question before it starts
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
Étape par étape
chapter topic; Chapter 277, p. 1827
été — the third stem
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
Éternuements et allergies
chapter topic; Chapter 482, p. 3113
Être dédommagé
chapter topic; Chapter 433, p. 2805
Évaluer et juger
chapter topic; Chapter 342, p. 2235
even if it means *quitte à*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2421
evening (le soir — masculine) *soir*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
everywhere *partout*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1449
Examens et résultats
chapter topic; Chapter 378, p. 2459
excusez-moi — the question that finds the way
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1731
exhausted, worn out; sold out *épuisé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2353
exhibition *l'exposition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3337
experience *l'expérience*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1503
Experience, Choice, Decision, Possibility, Reason
chapter topic; Chapter 225, p. 1503
expliquer pourquoi — to unfold
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1725
eye — masculine, with a plural that looks irregular but is the REGULAR outcome of Latin oculos; œil's own singular is the piece that changed *l'œil, les yeux*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 35, p. 341

eyebrow *le sourcil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3087
eyelash *le cil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3087
eyelid *la paupière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3087
Eyes, Nose, Mouth, Stomach
chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 341

F

Façades et vitrines
chapter topic; Chapter 442, p. 2861
failure *l'échec*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1335
fair, right *juste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1623
Faire carrière
chapter topic; Chapter 360, p. 2347
Faire du pain
chapter topic; Chapter 333, p. 2177
Faire la vaisselle
chapter topic; Chapter 530, p. 3413
Faire le ménage
chapter topic; Chapter 528, p. 3399
false, wrong *faux / fausse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1623
Familles d'aujourd'hui
chapter topic; Chapter 492, p. 3175
Family, and the Oldest Words We Have
chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 141
family — feminine and fixed, whoever is in it, and once meant the household's servants *la famille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 329
famous *célèbre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939
far *loin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
far from *loin de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1281
Farewells
chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 45
fast *rapide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675

father — one of the oldest words anyone can reconstruct *le père*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141
faulty, defective *défectueux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 2799
fear *la peur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
fearful *peureux / peureuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1293
February — the month of the purification festival *février*
explicit focus: pronunciation, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 113
Fiançailles et noces
chapter topic; Chapter 489, p. 3155
Fierté et modestie
chapter topic; Chapter 473, p. 3055
fifteen — and the fortnight the French count in *quinze*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
fifty *cinquante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 771
Fil et aiguille
chapter topic; Chapter 496, p. 3199
(film) director *le réalisateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3375
final, definitive *définitif*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2415
finally *enfin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
Find, Fish, Chicken, Fruit, Apple
chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 541
Finding the Way — excusez-moi, tout droit
chapter topic; Chapter 262, p. 1731
fini · vendu — the other two classes
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
finishing line *la ligne d'arrivée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3275
fire *le feu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 645
Firefighter, Postman, Waiter, Customer, Till
chapter topic; Chapter 125, p. 895
first-aider, rescue worker *le secouriste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3125
first, at first — the word that opens a story told in order *d'abord*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1711
first of all, to begin with *tout d'abord*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1771

fish *le poisson*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 541
fish hook *l'hameçon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3205
fisherman, angler *le pêcheur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3205
fishing rod *la canne à pêche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3205
fit of the giggles *le fou rire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3063
five *cinq*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
Five Ways to Point
chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 367
Flâner en ville
chapter topic; Chapter 438, p. 2835
Flat, Dining room, Balcony, Lock, Doorbell
chapter topic; Chapter 163, p. 1131
Fleurs, tabac et colis
chapter topic; Chapter 449, p. 2905
flexible *flexible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2427
floor cloth, mop *la serpillière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 3399
Floor, Stairs, Mirror, Living room, Sofa
chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 589
flour *la farine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 865
flu *la grippe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1443
Flu, Prescription, Tablet, Syrup, Ointment
chapter topic; Chapter 215, p. 1443
flute; recorder *la flûte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3293
fog *le brouillard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
for lack of *faute de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2403
foreign *étranger / étrangère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1473
Foreigner, Tourist, Adult, Elderly person, Twin
chapter topic; Chapter 250, p. 1653
foreseeable, predictable *prévisible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2409

former, ancient *ancien / ancienne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1119
formerly, in the old days *autrefois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
forty *quarante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 771
four *quatre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
Four lines, and the joiner that moves nothing
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 48, p. 431
fourteen — the longest of the welded teens, and the least worn *quatorze*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
fracture, break (of a bone) *la fracture*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3099
free *libre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933
free of charge *gratuit / gratuite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1623
Freins et atouts
chapter topic; Chapter 352, p. 2297
fresh, cool *frais / fraîche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1119
Friday — the day of Venus *vendredi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
friend — masculine or feminine by a regular swap, and the reason le/la elides to l' before a vowel *l'ami, l'amie*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 329
friendly *aimable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1473
friendship *l'amitié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1269
Friendship, Hope, Trust, Courage, Shame
chapter topic; Chapter 186, p. 1269
fright, scare *la frayeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3037
from now on *désormais*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
from then on; consequently *dès lors*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2271
full *plein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
fun, amusing *amusant / amusante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1467

funny *drôle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939
funny (informal) *marrant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3063

G

Gagner et perdre
chapter topic; Chapter 394, p. 2559
gallery; arcade *la galerie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3337
Garanties et devis
chapter topic; Chapter 393, p. 2553
gardening *le jardinage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3243
garlic *l'ail*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 865
gas *le gaz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1683
Gate, Fence, Cellar, Attic, Vegetable garden
chapter topic; Chapter 200, p. 1353
generous *généreux / généreuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1629
Generous, Lazy, Hard-working, Talkative, Angry
chapter topic; Chapter 246, p. 1629
geography *la géographie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1695
Geography, Mathematics, Art, Team, Birthday
chapter topic; Chapter 257, p. 1695
given that *étant donné que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2265
Glace et neige
chapter topic; Chapter 510, p. 3287
glasses *les lunettes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615
gloves *les gants*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 839
godfather; sponsor *le parrain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3163
godmother *la marraine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3163
godson, godchild *le filleul*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3163

good (adjective) *bon / bonne*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
good evening *bonsoir*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
good night (going to bed) *bonne nuit*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
good value, favourable *avantageux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 2553
goodbye (literally "until the seeing-again") *au revoir*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 45
Grâce à toi
chapter topic; Chapter 348, p. 2271
gradually, progressively *progressivement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1789
grapes *le raisin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
grass *l'herbe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 951
Grass, Ear, Lip, Number (on a door, Address
chapter topic; Chapter 134, p. 951
Green and Yellow
chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 283
green and yellow — vert is the standard, expected Latin viridis descendant shared by nearly every Romance language; jaune comes from a Latin word that literally meant "yellow-GREEN," and is usually said to share its ultimate PIE root with German's gelb, though that particular link is less secure than it first appears *vert, jaune*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 283
Greetings
chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1
grey *gris*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
gripping, captivating *captivant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3343
grudge, resentment *la rancune*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3069
guilty *coupable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2515

H

habeō litterās scriptās — the buried possessive
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213

habēre — the root you already met
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
half past — literally "and a half" *et demie*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
ham *le jambon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
happy *heureux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
hard *dur / dure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1617
hard-working *travailleur / travailleuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1629
he has, she has — the verb worn down to a single letter *il a, elle a*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
he is, she is — the most frequently said word in the language *il est, elle est*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
Head and Hand
chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 259
health *la santé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1075
Health, Brain, Lung, Liver, Kidney
chapter topic; Chapter 154, p. 1075
Hearing, Sleeping, Walking, Running
chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 303
heat *la chaleur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
heavy *lourd*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
heel *le talon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3081
hello / good day *bonjour*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
here is — a frozen command, see here, and the word that lets you introduce somebody who is not you *voici*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
here, there, over there — three distances, and the same ci and la already frozen inside voici and voila *ici, là, là-bas*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
heritage; an estate *le patrimoine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2127
hero; main character *le héros*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3355

hi / bye (informal) *salut*
explicit focus: pronunciation, writing, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
high, tall *haut*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 681
him and her, standing alone — where elle is the same word twice and lui is not *lui et elle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
hip *la hanche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3081
history, a story *l'histoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1545
holidays *les vacances*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 803
homework *les devoirs*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 907
honest *honnête*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1473
honey *le miel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 553
honeymoon *la lune de miel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3155
hope *l'espoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1269
Hospital, Illness, Thirst, Tiredness, Ill
chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 463
hour (feminine) *heure*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
how *comment*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
how — a word you have been using since your first lesson *comment*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
How Are You?
chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 33
how are you? — the neutral everyday question *comment ça va ?*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
How It Felt — j'étais content, j'espère
chapter topic; Chapter 264, p. 1743
how much and how many — one word where English needs two *combien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
How Much, and What to Call People
chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 415
however, yet *pourtant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099

Husband, Woman, Uncle, Aunt, Cousin
chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 481

I

I *je*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
I am — from Latin sum, and one of the oldest word-shapes in Europe *je suis*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
ï ë ü — the two dots that say "say me on my own"
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 4, p. 45
I have — one syllable, one vowel, and all that is left of Latin habeō *j'ai*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
I'm sorry (literally "I am desolate") *je suis désolé(e)*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 24, p. 271
I should — devoir softened into advice, with the same ending as je voudrais *je devrais*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1725
"I speak French" — your first full sentence (français = French) *Je parle français*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
I've missed the train — and the three parts of reporting a problem to a stranger *j'ai raté le train*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1737
ice cream; ice; a mirror *la glace*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 871
ice rink *la patinoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3287
If — si, s'il pleut, ça dépend
chapter topic; Chapter 266, p. 1755
Il était une fois
chapter topic; Chapter 321, p. 2101
il parla · habló · falou — the same tense, four fates
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 213
il parla — the past you read but never say
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
ill, sick *malade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 463
impartial, fair *impartial*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2235

improbable, unlikely *improbable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2421
in case *au cas où*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2397
in front *devant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1093
in love; lover *amoureux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3143
In that case, Late, Suddenly, Until, Since
chapter topic; Chapter 187, p. 1275
in that case, so *alors*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1275
in the first place, firstly *en premier lieu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1771
in the long run, eventually *à la longue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1789
indeed; and that is because *en effet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2271
indisputable, unquestionable *incontestable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2215
infant, small baby *le nourrisson*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3181
injection; sting, bite *la piqûre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3125
innocent *innocent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2515
inside *dedans*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723
insomnia, sleeplessness *l'insomnie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3137
Installer un logiciel
chapter topic; Chapter 396, p. 2571
Instruments de musique
chapter topic; Chapter 511, p. 3293
interval, intermission *l'entracte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3313
Interview, Career, Printer, Mobile phone, Sheet of paper
chapter topic; Chapter 204, p. 1377
Introducing Yourself
chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 21
iron; an iron (for clothes) *le fer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
iron (for clothes) *le fer à repasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 3393

it depends — the condition you do not have to name, and how to name it when you want to *ça dépend*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1755
"it is ... o'clock" — the frame that tells the time *il est, … heures*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
it was cold, it was hot — the weather, made in the past *il faisait froid, il faisait chaud*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1701
it was, there was — être's own imparfait stem, and the two openers a French scene is built from *c'était, il y avait*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1701
it would be — a judgement on something that has not happened, and the if that is not true now *ce serait*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1763
itch, itching *la démangeaison*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3113

J

j'ai couru — not every motion verb qualifies
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
j'ai parlé — the past built from "have"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
j'ai vingt ans — having your years
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 17, p. 195
j'espère revenir — saying what you are reaching for
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1743
j'étais content — how it felt
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1743
Jacket, Tie, Belt, Gloves, Scarf
chapter topic; Chapter 116, p. 839
Jadis et naguère
chapter topic; Chapter 272, p. 1795
Jalousie et rancune
chapter topic; Chapter 475, p. 3069
jam *la confiture*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 565
January — the month of Janus, god of doorways *janvier*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 113
Je cherche du travail
chapter topic; Chapter 354, p. 2309
je dormais / j'ai dormi — the same sleep, told two ways
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1701

je fus — the second stem
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
Je m'explique
chapter topic; Chapter 341, p. 2227
je me suis levé — the pronominal family
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
Je n'y crois pas
chapter topic; Chapter 338, p. 2209
je parlais — the past that is still running
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1701
je pense que — giving a view
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1719
je pourrais, j'aimerais — the would of French
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1763
je sais pas — the *ne* that speech leaves out
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
je suis allé — the past built from "be"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
je suis monté / j'ai monté les valises
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
je vais partir — the future made out of "go"
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
jealous *jaloux / jalouse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1461
jealousy *la jalousie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3069
Jeux de société
chapter topic; Chapter 499, p. 3219
Jewel, Ring, Necklace, Perfume, Letter
chapter topic; Chapter 118, p. 853
joy *la joie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
Joy, Fear, Anger, Sadness, Happy
chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 469
juice *le jus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 871
July — the month renamed for Julius Caesar *juillet*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123
June — the month of Juno, queen of the gods *juin*
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Juste et injuste
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K

kind, nice *gentil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
(kitchen) sink *l'évier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 3413
Kitchen, Window, Chair, Key, Wall
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ladle *la louche*
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large family *la famille nombreuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3175
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explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939
lastly, last of all *en dernier lieu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1771
late *tard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1275
lately, recently *dernièrement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1801
laundry, linen *le linge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
Laver le linge
chapter topic; Chapter 526, p. 3387
laziness *la paresse*
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Le bricolage
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Le visage de près
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leather *le cuir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1185
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Les rescapés
chapter topic; Chapter 305, p. 2001
Les secours
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Les traces du passé
chapter topic; Chapter 325, p. 2127
liar; lying *le menteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3025
lid *le couvercle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 3405
life *la vie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 921
light (not heavy) *léger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
lightning *l'éclair*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1527
Lightning, Thunder, Climate, Environment, Pollution
chapter topic; Chapter 229, p. 1527
likely, believable *vraisemblable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2221

line (in a play); reply *la réplique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3319
little by little *peu à peu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1789
long ago, in olden days *jadis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1795
Look at, Listen to, Wait for, Buy, Know
chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 523
love *l'amour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1081
love at first sight *le coup de foudre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3143
low *bas / basse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
luckily *heureusement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1287
luggage *les bagages*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1347
lunch *le déjeuner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
Lunch, Dinner, Breakfast, Rice, Pear
chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 559

M

Magazine, Dictionary, University, Mistake, History
chapter topic; Chapter 232, p. 1545
Mal au cœur
chapter topic; Chapter 483, p. 3119
marathon *le marathon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3275
marble *le marbre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3331
Marbre et argile
chapter topic; Chapter 517, p. 3331
March — the war-god's month, and the old start of the year *mars*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 113
married *marié / mariée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1125
mathematics *les mathématiques*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1695
May — the month of Maia, goddess of growth *mai*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 9, p. 113

Mayor, Elections, Vote, Politics, Economy
chapter topic; Chapter 248, p. 1641
me and you, standing alone — the heavy twins of je and tu, split by stress exactly as quoi split from que *moi et toi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
me / myself (reflexive and object pronoun) *me*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
medal *la médaille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3269
melancholy, gloom *la mélancolie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3049
melody, tune *la mélodie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3299
Mes objectifs
chapter topic; Chapter 374, p. 2435
metal *le métal*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1365
Mettre de côté
chapter topic; Chapter 391, p. 2541
midnight — literally "the night's middle" *minuit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
migraine, bad headache *la migraine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3119
milk — masculine, and the one drink in this chapter French did not have to borrow *le lait*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 323
model-making *le modélisme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3231
modern *moderne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1119
Modern, Former, Fresh, Spicy, Raw
chapter topic; Chapter 161, p. 1119
modest *modeste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3055
Mon compte en ligne
chapter topic; Chapter 395, p. 2565
Mon point de vue
chapter topic; Chapter 334, p. 2185
Monday — the Moon's day *lundi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
money; silver *l'argent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 615
mood *l'humeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3031

moody *lunatique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3031
More Than, and for How Long — plus ... que, depuis, pendant
chapter topic; Chapter 265, p. 1749
mother — and the reason English calls physical stuff "matter" *la mère*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141
Mother-in-law, Son-in-law, Daughter-in-law, Fiancé, Fiancée
chapter topic; Chapter 167, p. 1155
mourning, grief *le deuil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2063
mouth — feminine, and originally the Latin word for cheek, not mouth at all *la bouche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 341
mud *la boue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1359
Muscle, Thumb, Wound, Scar, Cold
chapter topic; Chapter 185, p. 1263
music *la musique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 915
Music, Sport, Game, Film, Song
chapter topic; Chapter 128, p. 915
(musical) score, sheet music *la partition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3305
must — the third of the set, and the one with a debt inside it *devoir*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 37, p. 359
my name is... (literally "I call myself") *je m'appelle…*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 2, p. 21

N

naive *naïf*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3025
nap, siesta *la sieste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3137
narrator *le narrateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3355
narrow *étroit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
nasty, mean *méchant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
natural rubber *le caoutchouc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1365

Natural rubber, Metal, Brick, Small bag, Rope
chapter topic; Chapter 202, p. 1365
nausea *la nausée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3119
near *près*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
near to *près de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1281
Near to, Far from, At the bottom, On the right, On the left
chapter topic; Chapter 188, p. 1281
necessary *nécessaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1299
Neck, Shoulder, Knee, Face, Blood
chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 439
Neighbour, Guest, Baby, Grandson, Granddaughter
chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 487
neither, not either *non plus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
Nephew, Niece, Pupil, Teacher, Laugh
chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 493
nervous *nerveux / nerveuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1461
never; ever *jamais*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
Never, Now, Then, Far, Near
chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 717
nevertheless, however *cependant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1455
new *nouveau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
next *prochain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939
nice, friendly *sympathique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 945
Nice, Nasty, Heat, Storm, Fog
chapter topic; Chapter 133, p. 945
night (la nuit — feminine) *nuit*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
nightmare *le cauchemar*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3137
nine *neuf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
nineteen — the last number before the system changes
again *dix-neuf*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173

ninety *quatre-vingt-dix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
no / not *non*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 22, p. 265
noisy *bruyant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 939
Noisy, Last, Next, Famous, Funny
chapter topic; Chapter 132, p. 939
none, not a single *aucun / aucune*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
noon — literally "the day's middle" *midi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 8, p. 101
nose — masculine, a silent final z, and another genuine cousin of its English counterpart *le nez*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 341
nostalgia, longing for the past *la nostalgie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3049
nostril *la narine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3087
not long ago; formerly (literary) *naguère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1795
nothing *rien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
Nothing, None, Neither, Which One, Anything at All
chapter topic; Chapter 139, p. 983
novelist *le romancier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3343
November — the month that still says "nine" *novembre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123
now *maintenant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
Nuits agitées
chapter topic; Chapter 486, p. 3137
Numbers One to Ten
chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 73
Nurse, Cook, Police officer, Shop assistant, Farmer
chapter topic; Chapter 123, p. 883

O

obvious, evident *évident*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2215
October — the month that still says "eight" *octobre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123

of age, adult; major *majeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2033
of, from — the word already inside du, and the one that does what English does with an apostrophe *de*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
Office, Factory, Pavement, Crossroads, Red light
chapter topic; Chapter 108, p. 791
often *souvent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729
oil *l'huile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 553
old *vieux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 675
old age *la vieillesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2051
On dit que...
chapter topic; Chapter 285, p. 1877
On n'est pas content
chapter topic; Chapter 431, p. 2791
on the contrary *au contraire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
on the left *à gauche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1281
on the right *à droite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1281
on top *dessus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723
On top, Underneath, Inside, Outside, Today
chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 723
once upon a time *il était une fois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2101
one — and, at the same time, "a/an" *un*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
One heard greeting — write what you know
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
one, people, and in practice we — a noun for man that turned into a pronoun *on*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
only *seulement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1455
open *ouvert*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 933
Opening Hours, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Bill
chapter topic; Chapter 142, p. 1001

opening hours, a timetable *l'horaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1001
Optimistes et inquiets
chapter topic; Chapter 476, p. 3075
optimistic; optimist *optimiste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3075
optional *facultatif*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2471
or — the same three letters as the question word for where, kept apart by one accent *ou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383
orchestra; stalls (in a theatre) *l'orchestre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3305
original-language version *la version originale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3375
otherwise, or else *sinon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2397
Où dormir ?
chapter topic; Chapter 424, p. 2749
(oui, continued) — The other "yes," si
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 265
outside *dehors*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723

P

pain *la douleur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 457
Pain, Fever, Cough, Medicine, Doctor
chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 457
paintbrush *le pinceau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3325
paper *le papier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 609
paperback *le livre de poche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3349
parking *le stationnement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 2641
Parle ! — the command, and the pronoun that goes missing
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
parlé — the past participle
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
Parler au gérant
chapter topic; Chapter 432, p. 2799

parler · parlé · parlez — one sound, three jobs
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 213
parlez-vous — the third way to ask
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
Pas d'accord
chapter topic; Chapter 336, p. 2197
pas de pain — where the partitive collapses
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 399
Passport, Customs, Booking, Butcher's, Large river
chapter topic; Chapter 164, p. 1137
pasta *les pâtes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
patient *patient / patiente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1473
pawn, counter (in a game) *le pion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3219
peace *la paix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1143
Pen, Paper, Notebook, Pencil, Bag
chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 609
pepper *le poivre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 571
père / father — one sound-law
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 12, p. 141
perfume *le parfum*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 853
Permis ou non
chapter topic; Chapter 381, p. 2477
permission *la permission*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1161
person — feminine no matter who is meant, even a man, and secretly "nobody" when it stands next to ne *la personne*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 329
pessimistic; pessimist *pessimiste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3075
petit, petite — the ending that wakes the letter before it
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 399
Petites boutiques
chapter topic; Chapter 445, p. 2879
Petites rues et grandes avenues
chapter topic; Chapter 437, p. 2829
Petits accidents
chapter topic; Chapter 306, p. 3093; Chapter 479, p. 3093
Petits soucis dans la chambre
chapter topic; Chapter 429, p. 2779

Peu à peu
chapter topic; Chapter 271, p. 1789
Phone, Umbrella, Money, Present, Glasses
chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 615
Photographer, Journalist, Architect, Dentist, Pharmacist
chapter topic; Chapter 166, p. 1149
physiotherapist (informal) *le kiné*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3105
Pillow, Blanket, Towel, Soap, Toothbrush
chapter topic; Chapter 113, p. 821
Pinceaux et couleurs
chapter topic; Chapter 516, p. 3325
pink *rose*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
Pink, Purple, Brown (chestnut), Brown (of hair, Pretty
chapter topic; Chapter 130, p. 927
pitch, ground; plot of land *le terrain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3255
place setting; cutlery *le couvert*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 3405
plaster cast; plaster *le plâtre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3099
Plaster, Emergency department, Emergency, Medical appointment, Diet
chapter topic; Chapter 243, p. 1611
plastic *le plastique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1185
Plastic, Cotton, Wool, Silk, Leather
chapter topic; Chapter 172, p. 1185
plausible *plausible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2391
Please
chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 269
please (literally "if it pleases you") *s'il vous plaît*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 23, p. 269
pleased, glad *content*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 475
pleased to meet you (literally "enchanted") *enchanté(e)*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
plot (of a story); intrigue *l'intrigue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3343
plus ... que — more than
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1749
podium *le podium*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3269

poetry *la poésie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3363
police custody *la garde à vue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 1933
Police, Theatre, Library, Bakery, Town hall
chapter topic; Chapter 102, p. 753
polite *poli / polie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105
politics *la politique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1641
pollen *le pollen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3113
pollution *la pollution*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1527
poor *pauvre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
possible (if it happens) *éventuel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2403
possibly, if need be *éventuellement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2403
Postcard, Folder, Pay slip, Label, Guide
chapter topic; Chapter 169, p. 1167
Pour ou contre
chapter topic; Chapter 345, p. 2253
pregnancy *la grossesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3181
pregnant *enceinte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2021
Prendre des photos
chapter topic; Chapter 502, p. 3237
Prendre un risque
chapter topic; Chapter 372, p. 2421
pretty *joli*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
pride *la fierté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3055
private view, opening (of an exhibition) *le vernissage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3337
profitable, worth it *rentable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 2553
Promise, Discount, Sales, Coin, Banknote
chapter topic; Chapter 198, p. 1341
proud *fier / fière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1461

provided that, on condition that *à condition que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2397
Puisque et vu que
chapter topic; Chapter 347, p. 2265
punctual *ponctuel / ponctuelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1473
Punctual, Foreign, Friendly, Honest, Patient
chapter topic; Chapter 220, p. 1473
punishment *la punition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3187
purple *violet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 927
pyjamas *le pyjama*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1479

Q

Qualités et défauts
chapter topic; Chapter 467, p. 3019
Quand ça se termine
chapter topic; Chapter 491, p. 3169
Quand la terre tremble
chapter topic; Chapter 303, p. 1989
quand, pendant que — the scene, and what cut into it
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1701
quarrel, argument *la dispute*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3193
quarter past — literally "and a quarter" *et quart*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
quarter to — literally "minus the quarter" *moins le quart*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 8, p. 101
Quel genre de livres ?
chapter topic; Chapter 522, p. 3363
quel, quelle — which
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
Quelle frayeur !
chapter topic; Chapter 470, p. 3037
Qui peut participer
chapter topic; Chapter 383, p. 2491
quiet, peaceful *tranquille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1461
Quitter son travail
chapter topic; Chapter 355, p. 2315

R

Raccourcis et détours
chapter topic; Chapter 436, p. 2823
rain *la pluie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 639
Raisonner
chapter topic; Chapter 344, p. 2247
ranking, league table *le classement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3263
rarely *rarement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
Rarely, Afterwards, Finally, From now on, Still
chapter topic; Chapter 156, p. 1087
raw *cru / crue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1119
reader; player (for discs) *le lecteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3355
Reading — Instructions, a Form, and a First Paragraph
chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 423
ready *prêt / prête*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1623
really *vraiment*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1287
recently *récemment*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
recovery, cure *la guérison*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3131
recycling *le recyclage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1683
red — and English red is not a lookalike but an actual cousin *rouge*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
referee, umpire *l'arbitre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3255
rehearsal; repetition *la répétition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3305
relay; relay race *le relais*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3275
reliable *fiable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2221
relief *le soulagement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3037
remote control *la télécommande*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 3381

Repasser et ranger
chapter topic; Chapter 527, p. 3393
resentful, unforgiving *rancunier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3069
reserved, quiet (of a person); booked *réservé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3013
rest *le repos*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1081
Rest, Sleep, Dream, Anxiety, Love
chapter topic; Chapter 155, p. 1081
Restaurant, Hotel, Pharmacy, Village, Post office
chapter topic; Chapter 101, p. 747
Result, Difference, Example, Truth, Lie
chapter topic; Chapter 251, p. 1659
retirement; the pension *la retraite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2051
Return, Arrival, Departure, Destination, Landscape
chapter topic; Chapter 231, p. 1539
rice *le riz*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 559
rich *riche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
Right, Left, World, Journey, Holidays
chapter topic; Chapter 110, p. 803
ripe *mûr / mûre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1305
Rire aux éclats
chapter topic; Chapter 474, p. 3063
risky, chancy *hasardeux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2421
Roof, Garden, Lamp, Bathroom, Bedroom
chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 583
rough *rugueux / rugueuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1617
round *rond*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
Rubber, Homework, Answer, Idea, Problem
chapter topic; Chapter 127, p. 907
rubbish *les déchets*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1683
Rubbish, Recycling, Energy, Electricity, Gas
chapter topic; Chapter 255, p. 1683
rude *impoli / impolie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105

Rug, Television, Computer, Fridge, Radio
chapter topic; Chapter 111, p. 809
Ruisseaux et marais
chapter topic; Chapter 456, p. 2949
Rule, Permission, Ban, Safety, Advice
chapter topic; Chapter 168, p. 1161
runner; rider (in a race) *le coureur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3275

S

s'il pleut, je reste — the condition that really happens
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 266, p. 1755
sad *triste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 475
Sad, Pleased, Daughter, Grandfather, Grandmother
chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 475
sadness *la tristesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 469
safe, sure *sûr / sûre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
safety *la sécurité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1161
Salad, Pasta, Cream, Pepper, Walnut
chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 571
salt — masculine, cousin of English salt by common descent, and the source of a salary story no ancient writer actually tells *le sel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 335
salty *salé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
Salty, Bitter, Round, Square, Dry
chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 705
***salut* — let your eye and hand meet one known word**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
***salut* — look, hide, write, compare**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
***salut* — one supported copy**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
sand *le sable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 633
Sandwich, Sauce, Vinegar, Dessert, Meal
chapter topic; Chapter 122, p. 877

Sans emploi
chapter topic; Chapter 356, p. 2321
Saturday — the Sabbath day *samedi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
scale model; mock-up *la maquette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3231
scatterbrained, absent-minded *étourdi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3019
sceptical *sceptique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2209
scissors *les ciseaux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1479
Scissors, Watch, Pyjamas, Button, Peach
chapter topic; Chapter 221, p. 1479
scratch, graze *l'égratignure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3093
screw *la vis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 3419
screwdriver *le tournevis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 3419
sculptor *le sculpteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3331
sculpture *la sculpture*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3331
Se garer en ville
chapter topic; Chapter 407, p. 2641
(se qualifier) to qualify; to describe as *qualifier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3263
Sea, Stone, Sand, Beach, Island
chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 633
season *la saison*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3369
Second, Change (coins), Date, Century, Email
chapter topic; Chapter 135, p. 957
section (of a shop); shelf; ray *le rayon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3349
see you later (literally "to more late") *à plus tard*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 45
see you soon (literally "to well-soon") *à bientôt*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 45
see you tomorrow (literally "to tomorrow") *à demain*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 4, p. 45
seeing that *vu que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2265

seize / dix-sept — the seam
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 15, p. 173
Selon les cas
chapter topic; Chapter 369, p. 2403
separation, parting *la séparation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3169
September — the month that still says "seven" *septembre*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 123
serious *sérieux / sérieuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1293
set, scenery; decor *le décor*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3313
seven *sept*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
seventeen — the number where French stops inheriting and starts building *dix-sept*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
seventy *soixante-dix*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
sewing; fashion design *la couture*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3199
shame *la honte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1269
shampoo *le shampooing*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 827
sharp, in focus; clean, clear *net*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3237
Sheep, Goat, Lion, Monkey, Bee
chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 663
Sheet, Drawer, Armchair, Saucepan, Frying pan
chapter topic; Chapter 193, p. 1311
shoes *les chaussures*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 765
shooting, filming (of a film) *le tournage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3375
Shop, School, Bank, Train, Aeroplane
chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 735
short news items, minor news stories *les faits divers*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 1857
Should, and Why — je devrais, expliquer
chapter topic; Chapter 261, p. 1725
Shower, Bathtub, Wardrobe, Shelf, Curtain
chapter topic; Chapter 112, p. 815
shy *timide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1293

shyness *la timidité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3013
si — if
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1755
Si j'ai le temps
chapter topic; Chapter 373, p. 2427
siblings (as a group) *la fratrie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3175
signed message, inscription (in a book); dedication *la dédicace*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3355
silent *silencieux / silencieuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1617
Silent, Clean, Hard, Smooth, Rough
chapter topic; Chapter 244, p. 1617
silk *la soie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1185
similar *semblable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1623
Similar, Fair, False, Ready, Free of charge
chapter topic; Chapter 245, p. 1623
simple *simple*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1299
Simple, Complicated, Necessary, Useful, Useless
chapter topic; Chapter 191, p. 1299
since, as (a known reason) *puisque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2265
since, for *depuis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1275
since then, ever since *depuis lors*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1795
sincere, honest *sincère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3025
Sincères et menteurs
chapter topic; Chapter 468, p. 3025
single *célibataire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1125
sir and madam — my lord and my lady, worn down, and the two words French uses where English uses a surname *Monsieur, Madame*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 415
sister — the one family word that broke the pattern *la sœur*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 141
Sitting, Standing, Opening, Closing
chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 313

six *six*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
Six lines about a journey
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 267, p. 1763
sixteen — the last word French inherited already welded *seize*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
sixty *soixante*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
size; the waist *la taille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 847
skate *le patin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3287
skin *la peau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 445
Skin, Nail, Chin, Throat, Cheek
chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 445
sledge, sled *la luge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3287
sleep *le sommeil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1081
slope, run; track *la piste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3287
smoke *la fumée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1359
smooth *lisse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1617
snapshot, photo; cliché *le cliché*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3237
snow *la neige*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 639
So, However, Anyway, On the contrary, Although
chapter topic; Chapter 158, p. 1099
so-so (literally "like this, like that") *comme ci, comme ça*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 33
so, therefore *donc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1099
soap *le savon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 821
sociable, outgoing *sociable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3013
society *la société*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1485
Society, Government, Law, Court, Judge
chapter topic; Chapter 222, p. 1485

socks *les chaussettes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 771
Socks, Thirty, Forty, Fifty, Hundred
chapter topic; Chapter 105, p. 771
Soft, Dirty, Young, Kind, Narrow
chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 693
soft; mild; sweet *doux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
sometimes *parfois*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729
soon, shortly *prochainement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1801
sooner or later *tôt ou tard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1789
sorrow, grief *le chagrin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3043
Sorry
chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 271
Souvenirs et regrets
chapter topic; Chapter 472, p. 3049
speeding *l'excès de vitesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 1951
spicy *épicé / épicée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1119
splint *l'attelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3105
sponge *l'éponge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 3399
Spoon, Knife, Fork, Bottle, Cup
chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 601
sport *le sport*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 915
spouse, partner *le conjoint*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3169
sprain *l'entorse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3105
spring — literally "the first time" *le printemps*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 133
square *carré*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 705
stage fright, nerves *le trac*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3319
Standing Alone
chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 407

still, again *encore*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1087
stingy, mean with money; miser *avare*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3019
stomach — masculine, nasal like la main but through a different vowel, and the word that closes four chapters of everyday nouns *le ventre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 341
stormy, thundery *orageux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 2985
straight after, in the same stride *dans la foulée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1783
straight on — and the directions that follow it: left, right, keep going, cross *tout droit*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1731
strange *étrange*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1467
Strawberry, Cherry, Melon, Garlic, Flour
chapter topic; Chapter 120, p. 865
(streaming) platform; platform *la plateforme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3369
stressed *stressé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2353
stretcher *le brancard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3125
strong *fort*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
Strong, Weak, Rich, Poor, Grey
chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 687
stubborn *têtu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 467, p. 3019
subjective *subjectif*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2235
success *le succès*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1335
suddenly *soudain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1275
suddenly, without warning *subitement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1783
sugar — masculine, closing a chapter where every drink-word is; the fourth and longest road of the four *le sucre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 32, p. 323
sujet, verbe, objet — the order that carries the meaning
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 383

summer — literally "the heat" *l'été*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 133
Sun, Star, Cloud, Rain, Snow
chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 639
Sunday — the Lord's day *dimanche*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
sunny *ensoleillé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 2973
Supermarket, Cinema, Stadium, Swimming pool, Grocer's shop
chapter topic; Chapter 107, p. 785
supple; easygoing, adaptable *souple*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2409
suppletion — three verbs in a trench coat
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 19, p. 229
Supposons
chapter topic; Chapter 367, p. 2391
Sur internet
chapter topic; Chapter 398, p. 2585
Sur le feu
chapter topic; Chapter 330, p. 2157
Sur le quai
chapter topic; Chapter 413, p. 2679
Sur le terrain
chapter topic; Chapter 505, p. 3255
Sur scène
chapter topic; Chapter 515, p. 3319
suspense *le suspense*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3369
sweat *la sueur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3249
sweet (with sugar) *sucré*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
swimming *la natation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1191
swimsuit, swimming trunks *le maillot de bain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3281

T

tablecloth *la nappe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 3405
Taking, Asking, Helping, Loving
chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 287

tale, story *le conte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 522, p. 3363
talkative *bavard / bavarde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1629
Tax, Form, Envelope, Stamp, Parcel
chapter topic; Chapter 252, p. 1665
tea — masculine, and the drink whose name split in two depending which Chinese port a trader dealt with *le thé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 323
tea towel, dishcloth *le torchon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 3413
Teach, Drink, Eat, Give, Live
chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 505
(television or radio) programme; emission *l'émission*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 3381
Telling the Time
chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 101
temperature *la température*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1317
Tempête et inondations
chapter topic; Chapter 465, p. 3005
temple (side of the head) *la tempe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 478, p. 3087
temporary, provisional *provisoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2415
ten *dix*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
tenderness, affection *la tendresse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3143
thank you *merci*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 33
thanks to *grâce à*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2271
that is why *c'est pourquoi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 347, p. 2265
the accident report (for insurance); a finding *le constat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 1951
the accomplice *le complice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 1939
the account, the story *le récit*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2107
the accusation, the charge *l'accusation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2509
the admission, the entry *l'admission*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2491

the advantage *l'avantage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2241
the aerial, the antenna; being on air *l'antenne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 1863
the aim, the goal *le but*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2435
the air conditioning *la climatisation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 2767
the airbag *l'airbag*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 1957
the airport building (for passengers) *l'aérogare*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 2699
the aisle; the path, the drive *l'allée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 2711
the alert, the alarm *l'alerte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 1977
the alibi *l'alibi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 1927
the alley, the lane *la ruelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 2829
the ancestor *l'ancêtre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2127
the application (for a job) *la candidature*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2309
the apprentice *l'apprenti*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2327
the apprenticeship; learning *l'apprentissage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2327
the archaeologist *l'archéologue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2127
the armed robber *le braqueur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 1945
the armed robbery, the hold-up *le braquage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 1945
the arrest *l'arrestation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 1933
the arrow *la flèche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 2817
the aspect, the side (of a question) *l'aspect*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2241
the asset, the strong point; the trump card *l'atout*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2297
the association, the club, the charity *l'association*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2385

the attack, the assault *l'agression*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 289, p. 1901
the attacker, the assailant *l'agresseur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 289, p. 1901
the authorisation, the permission *l'autorisation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2477
the avalanche *l'avalanche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 1989
the avenue *l'avenue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 2829
the average; the pass mark *la moyenne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2459
the back seat; the bench seat *la banquette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 2635
the baking tin, the mould *le moule*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2163
the bank transfer *le virement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 2917
the bankruptcy *la faillite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 2559
the banner *la banderole*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2855
the banner headline; a shirt cuff *la manchette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 1857
the bark (of a tree); the peel *l'écorce*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 2955
the barracks; the fire station *la caserne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 2849
the basilica *la basilique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 2841
the bathrobe, the dressing gown *le peignoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 2767
the bedbug; the drawing pin *la punaise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 2785
the belfry (town bell tower) *le beffroi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 2841
the bell tower, the steeple *le clocher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 2841
the bench *le banc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 2855
the bend, the curve (in a road) *le virage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 2655
the berth, the couchette *la couchette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 2685

the bill *l'addition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1635
the birth *la naissance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2021
the bite (a wound) *la morsure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 3093
the black ice *le verglas*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 2991
the blind (on a window) *le store*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 2785
the boarding *l'embarquement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 2699
the bodywork (of a car) *la carrosserie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 2635
the bonnet (of a car) *le capot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 2635
the book of tickets; the notebook *le carnet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 2691
the boot (of a car); the chest *le coffre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 2635
the boulevard *le boulevard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 2829
the brain *le cerveau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1075
the brake; the obstacle *le frein*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2297
the brass band; a fanfare *la fanfare*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2071
the breakdown mechanic *le dépanneur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 2629
the breakdown, the failure *la panne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 2591
the bright spell, the sunny interval *l'éclaircie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 2979
the broadcasting, the showing; the spread *la diffusion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 1863
the bruise, the contusion *la contusion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 1963
the budget *le budget*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 2535
the buoy; the rubber ring *la bouée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 1995
the bureaucracy, the red tape *la bureaucratie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2503

the burglar *le cambrioleur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 287, p. 1889
the burglary, the break-in *le cambriolage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 287, p. 1889
the burial, the funeral *l'enterrement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2057
the bush *le buisson*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 2955
the cabin *la cabine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 2735
the campsite; camping *le camping*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 2755
the cancellation *l'annulation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 2729
the candidate, the applicant *le candidat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2309
the candle; the spark plug *la bougie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2095
the car door *la portière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 406, p. 2635
the car pound *la fourrière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 2641
the card machine; the terminal *le terminal*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 2911
the cardboard box; cardboard *le carton*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 2929
the carnival *le carnaval*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2077
the carriage (of a train) *le wagon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 2679
the cash *les espèces*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 2917
the cashier *le caissier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 2911
the casserole dish, the cast-iron pot *la cocotte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2157
the catastrophe, the disaster *la catastrophe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2001
the caterer; the deli (with ready meals) *le traiteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 2873
the cathedral *la cathédrale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 2841
the celebration *la célébration*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2071

the cemetery, the graveyard *le cimetière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2057
the certificate *le certificat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2503
the check-in; the recording *l'enregistrement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 2699
the cheque *le chèque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 2917
the chequebook *le chéquier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 2917
the chest *la poitrine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451
the chin *le menton*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 445
the chopping board *la planche à découper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2145
the christening, the baptism *le baptême*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2027
the chronology, the order of events *la chronologie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1827
the citizen *le citoyen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2359
the citizenship *la citoyenneté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2359
the cleaning, the housework; the household *le ménage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 2799
the clearing (in a wood) *la clairière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 2955
the cliff *la falaise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 454, p. 2935
the climate *le climat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1527
the clue; the index, the rating *l'indice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 1921
the cobbler, the shoe mender *le cordonnier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 2885
the cobblestone; the paving *le pavé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 2855
the cockroach; the blues *le cafard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 2785
the colander, the sieve *la passoire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2171
the commitment *l'engagement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2427

the community *la communauté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2385
the compass *la boussole*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 2811
the compensation *le dédommagement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 2805
the competitive exam; the competition *le concours*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2459
the complaint, the claim *la réclamation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 2791
the complaint (to the police); the moan *la plainte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2509
The Compound Past
chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 213
the compromise *le compromis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2203
the confession, the avowal *l'aveu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 1939
the connection *la connexion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 2585
the conquest *la conquête*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2121
the consensus, broad agreement *le consensus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2203
the consequence *la conséquence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2259
the contribution, the membership fee *la cotisation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 2535
the controversy, the row *la polémique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 1877
the conviction, the sentence; the condemnation *la condamnation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 2521
the cooking pot, the stockpot *la marmite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2157
the cooking, the cooking time *la cuisson*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2163
the corner; the angle *l'angle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 2817
the correspondent; a pen friend *le correspondant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 281, p. 1851
the cove, the creek *la crique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 2961
the covered market (hall) *la halle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 2861

the cradle *le berceau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2021
the crime; the murder *le crime*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 1907
the criminal *le criminel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 1907
the criterion *le critère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2491
the criticism; the review *la critique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2241
the crossing (by sea) *la traversée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 2735
the crossroads, the junction *le croisement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 2817
the crown; the wreath *la couronne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2113
the cruise *la croisière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 2741
the customs officer *le douanier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 2705
the CV, the résumé *le CV*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2309
the cyclist *le cycliste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 2667
the daily paper; daily life *le quotidien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1833
the damage *le dégât*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2013
the dance, the ball *le bal*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2083
the day before, the eve *la veille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1801
the day before yesterday *avant-hier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
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the dead end; the deadlock *l'impasse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 2829
the deadline, the due date *l'échéance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1813
the deadline, the time allowed *le délai*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2341
the death (formal) *le décès*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2051

the debate *le débat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2191
the decade *la décennie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1821
the defence *la défense*
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the defibrillator *le défibrillateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 1977
the delivery *la livraison*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2341
the delivery, giving birth *l'accouchement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2021
the delivery man, the courier *le livreur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 2929
the demonstration, the protest march; the event *la manifestation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2855
the demonstrator, the marcher *le manifestant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2855
the deposit (that is not refunded) *les arrhes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 2805
the detour, the roundabout way *le détour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 2823
the device, the appliance *l'appareil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 2571
the diesel (fuel) *le gazole*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 2617
the dig, the excavation; a search *la fouille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2127
the diploma, the degree *le diplôme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2465
the disagreement *le désaccord*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2197
the disaster victim *le sinistré*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2013
the discount; the shed *la remise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 2923
the discrimination *la discrimination*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2377
the dismissal, the layoff *le licenciement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2315
the dispatch, the wire story *la dépêche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 281, p. 1851
the distinction, the honours (on an exam); the mention *la mention*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2465

the district (of a large city) *l'arrondissement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 2849
the diversion, the detour (for traffic) *la déviation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 2661
the doctorate, the PhD *le doctorat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2465
the doe, the hind *la biche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 2967
the down payment, the part payment *l'acompte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 2805
the dragon *le dragon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2101
the drawback, the disadvantage *l'inconvénient*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2241
the drizzle *la bruine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 2979
the drop, the fall *la baisse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 286, p. 1883
the drought *la sécheresse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 2999
the dry cleaner's *le pressing*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 2891
the dune *la dune*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 2961
the earthquake *le tremblement de terre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 1989
the economy *l'économie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1641
the editorial, the leading article *l'éditorial*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 1857
the efficiency, effectiveness *l'efficacité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2353
the emergency department *les urgences*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1611
the emergency exit *la sortie de secours*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 1977
the emergency services, help *les secours*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 1971
the employee, the wage earner *le salarié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2335
the employer *l'employeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2327
the end of the line, the terminus *le terminus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 2685

the environment *l'environnement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1527
the equality *l'égalité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2359
the era, the age *l'ère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1821
the executive, the manager; the frame *le cadre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2341
the expense, the spending *la dépense*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 2535
the explosion, the blast *l'explosion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 1983
the extension *la prolongation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2341
the fable *la fable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2101
the façade, the front (of a building) *la façade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 2861
the face *le visage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 439
the faculty, the university; the ability *la faculté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2447
the fairy *la fée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2101
the fall; the drop *la chute*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 1963
the fare, the price (list) *le tarif*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 2673
the fern, the bracken *la fougère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 457, p. 2955
the ferry *le ferry*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 2735
the festive late-night dinner (24 or 31 December) *le réveillon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2089
the file (on a computer) *le fichier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 2577
the final count, the outcome; the review *le bilan*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 286, p. 1883
the fine (for a driving offence), the ticket *la contravention*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 2649
the fir tree; the Christmas tree *le sapin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2089
the fire extinguisher *l'extincteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 1983

the fire, the blaze *l'incendie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 1983
the firecracker, the banger *le pétard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2083
the fireworks (display) *le feu d'artifice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2083
The First Verbs
chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 63
the fishmonger's, the fish shop *la poissonnerie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 2873
the fitted carpet *la moquette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 2779
the flag, in order — and two of its three colours are loanwords *bleu, blanc, rouge*
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 183
the flat-rate pass, the package *le forfait*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 2673
the flight *le vol*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 2699
the flight attendant (a woman); the hostess *l'hôtesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 2711
the float (in a parade); the tank *le char*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2077
the flood *l'inondation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3005
the floor, the ground *le sol*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 589
the florist *le fleuriste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 2905
the forced entry, breaking in *l'effraction*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 287, p. 1889
the forecast, the outlook *les prévisions*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 2973
The Four Seasons
chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 133
the fraud, the swindle *l'escroquerie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 288, p. 1895
the freedom, liberty *la liberté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 362, p. 2359
the frost (on surfaces), the hoarfrost *le givre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 2991
the fuel *le carburant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 2617
the funeral (formal) *les funérailles*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2057

the future *l'avenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
The Future, This Evening, a Plan, To Foresee, To Organise
chapter topic; Chapter 141, p. 995
the gap, the shift; jet lag *le décalage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 2723
the garage owner, the car mechanic *le garagiste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 2629
the garland, the string of lights *la guirlande*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2083
the gendarme *le gendarme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 1913
the gendarmerie; its offices *la gendarmerie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 1913
the government *le gouvernement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1485
the grant, the scholarship; the stock exchange *la bourse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2465
the grave, the tomb *la tombe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2063
the greengrocer; early produce *le primeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 2873
the gridlock, the traffic jam *l'embouteillage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 2661
the grocer *l'épicier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 2873
the guarantee, the warranty *la garantie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 2553
the gust (of wind); the burst *la rafale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 2985
the gutter (in the street) *le caniveau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 2867
the haberdasher's, the sewing shop *la mercerie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 2879
the haematoma, the large bruise *l'hématome*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 1963
the hail *la grêle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 2985
the hairdresser, the barber *le coiffeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 2899
the hand — feminine despite ending in a consonant, and the root of half the words you know *la main*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 259
the handcuffs *les menottes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 1933

the hardware shop, the ironmonger's *la quincaillerie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 2879
the head — from Latin for a clay pot *la tête*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 21, p. 259
the head teacher (of a lycée) *le proviseur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2441
the headlight; the lighthouse *le phare*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 2655
the headline *le gros titre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 1857
the heating *le chauffage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 2767
the heatwave *la canicule*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 2999
the hedgehog *le hérisson*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 2967
the hike, the long walk *la randonnée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 2941
the hiker *le randonneur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 2941
the hiring, being taken on *l'embauche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2309
the historian *l'historien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 325, p. 2127
the hitch, the mishap *le contretemps*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1813
the hitch, the unexpected event *l'imprévu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2409
the hold (of a plane or ship) *la soute*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 416, p. 2699
the holiday cottage; the shelter *le gîte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 2749
the horn (of a car) *le klaxon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 2611
the hostage *l'otage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 1945
the house-warming; a pot-hook *la crémaillère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2045
the household goods shop *la droguerie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 2879
the humidity, the damp *l'humidité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 2999
the hypothesis *l'hypothèse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2391

the immigration *l'immigration*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2377
the impact *l'impact*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2285
the income *le revenu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 2535
the inconvenience, the nuisance *le désagrément*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 2799
the indicator, the turn signal *le clignotant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 2655
the inequality *l'inégalité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2377
the influence *l'influence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2277
the ingredient *l'ingrédient*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2139
the inheritance; the heritage *l'héritage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2063
the injured person, the casualty *le blessé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 1957
the injustice *l'injustice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2371
the inn; the hostel *l'auberge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 2749
the inspector, the police inspector *l'inspecteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 1921
the instant, the moment *l'instant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1827
the insurance; self-confidence *l'assurance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2013
the intention *l'intention*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2435
the interchange (between motorways) *l'échangeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 2599
the intern, the trainee *le stagiaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2327
the internship, the work placement; a training course *le stage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 357, p. 2327
the invasion *l'invasion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2121
the investigation, the inquiry; the survey *l'enquête*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 2527
the investigator *l'enquêteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 1921

the investment *l'investissement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 2541
the jack (for lifting a car) *le cric*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 2623
the jeweller *le bijoutier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 2899
the job, employment; the use *l'emploi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2321
the judgement *le jugement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2235
the justice; the courts *la justice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2371
the justification *la justification*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2291
the king cake; a flat round cake *la galette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2089
the kiosk, the newsstand *le kiosque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 2855
the lamp post (old-style) *le réverbère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 2855
the landing (of a plane) *l'atterrissage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 2717
the landmark, the reference point *le repère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 2811
the launderette *la laverie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 2891
the leak; the escape *la fuite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 2773
the lease *le bail*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2045
the lecture hall *l'amphithéâtre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2447
the left *la gauche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 803
the left-luggage office; the instruction *la consigne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 2685
the legend; the caption *la légende*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2107
the length, the duration *la durée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1821
the liberation, the release *la libération*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2133
the lifeguard, the swimming instructor *le maître-nageur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 1995

the light bulb; the blister *l'ampoule*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 2779
the lightning (that strikes) *la foudre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 2985
the line of argument *l'argumentation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2191
the link; the bond *le lien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 2585
the listener *l'auditeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1845
the liver *le foie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1075
the loan (that you take out) *l'emprunt*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 2559
the locksmith *le serrurier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 2885
the log; the yule log cake *la bûche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2089
the loot, the haul *le butin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 287, p. 1889
the loss *la perte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 2559
the manager *le gérant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 2799
the marker post, the boundary stone; the charging point *la borne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 2817
the marriage proposal *la demande en mariage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2039
the marsh, the swamp *le marais*
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the (masculine / feminine / plural) *le / la / les*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
the maternity hospital; motherhood *la maternité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2027
the metro station, the stop; the taxi rank; the resort *la station*
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the metro train, the set of carriages *la rame*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 2691
the microphone, the mic *le micro*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1845
the millennium *le millénaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1821
the minibar *le minibar*
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the misdemeanour, the offence *le délit*
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the misunderstanding *le malentendu*
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the Moon (feminine) *la lune*
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the moral (of a story); morals *la morale*
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the morning *le matin*
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the mosquito net; the fly screen *la moustiquaire*
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the moss; the foam *la mousse*
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the motive, the reason; the pattern *le motif*
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the mountain pass; the collar *le col*
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the mountainside, the slope *le versant*
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the move, the house move *le déménagement*
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the murder *le meurtre*
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the mystery *le mystère*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 1927
the myth *le mythe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2107
the nationality *la nationalité*
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the neck *le cou*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 439
the network *le réseau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 2585
the news agency *l'agence de presse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 281, p. 1851
the news, current events *l'actualité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1833

the newsroom, the editorial staff; a school essay *la rédaction*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1839
the next day, the day after *le lendemain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1801
the norm, the standard *la norme*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2471
the north *le nord*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 797
the notice (period) *le préavis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2315
the objection *l'objection*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2197
the objective, the target; the lens *l'objectif*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2435
the obligation, the duty *l'obligation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2471
the obvious, what is plain to see *l'évidence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2215
the offence, the violation *l'infraction*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2485
the offender, the delinquent *le délinquant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 290, p. 1907
the official statement, the attestation *l'attestation*
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the old suburb, the outer district *le faubourg*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 2849
the opponent *l'adversaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2253
the optician *l'opticien*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 2899
the origin *l'origine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 348, p. 2271
the outskirts, the edge (of a town) *la périphérie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 2599
the overbooking *la surréservation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 2729
the overdraft *le découvert*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 2917
the overnight stay (paid for at a hotel) *la nuitée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 2749
the overtime *les heures supplémentaires*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2335
the packaging, the wrapping *l'emballage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 2929

the parade; a fashion show *le défilé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2077
the parallel parking space; the time slot *le créneau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 2641
the parking ticket machine *l'horodateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 2641
the passer-by *le passant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 437, p. 2829
the password *le mot de passe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 2565
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the patrol *la patrouille*
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the pay rise, the increase *l'augmentation*
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the pedal *la pédale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 2605
the pedestrian *le piéton*
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the penalty, the sanction *la sanction*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2485
The People You Introduce
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the phase *la phase*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1827
the pickpocket *le pickpocket*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 288, p. 1895
the pile-up, the multiple crash *le carambolage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 1951
the pillowcase *la taie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 2767
the pinch (of salt, of pepper) *la pincée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2139
the plateau, the high plain; the tray *le plateau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 454, p. 2935
the point of view *le point de vue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2185
the poisoning *l'intoxication*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 3093
the police *la police*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753
the police station *le commissariat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 2849

the poll, the survey *le sondage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 286, p. 1883
the pond *l'étang*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 2949
the pork butcher, the delicatessen; cold meats *la charcuterie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 444, p. 2873
the porthole, the window (of a plane or ship) *le hublot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 2711
the possibility, the eventuality *l'éventualité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 369, p. 2403
the post office *la poste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 747
the poverty *la pauvreté*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2377
the precision; an extra detail *la précision*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2227
the prefecture (regional state office) *la préfecture*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 440, p. 2849
the prejudice *le préjugé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2371
the presenter, the newsreader *le présentateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1845
the press, the newspapers *la presse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1833
the pretext *le prétexte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2291
the print, the fingerprint *l'empreinte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 1921
the prisoner, the inmate *le détenu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 2521
the private detective *le détective*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 292, p. 1921
the probability, the likelihood *la probabilité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2421
the procedure *la procédure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2503
the procession *le cortège*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2071
the productivity *la productivité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 361, p. 2353
the profit; the benefit *le bénéfice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 2559
the promotion; the special offer *la promotion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2347

the proof, the evidence *la preuve*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 339, p. 2215
the public holiday, the bank holiday *le jour férié*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2071
the publication, the release (of a book or paper) *la parution*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1839
the puddle *la flaque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3005
the pump *la pompe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 2617
the puncture, the flat tyre *la crevaison*
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the pushchair, the stroller *la poussette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2027
the qualification *la qualification*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2347
the quote, the estimate *le devis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 2553
the radiator *le radiateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 427, p. 2767
the rain shower, the downpour *l'averse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 2979
the ransom *la rançon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 1945
the rate *le taux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 2541
the reaction *la réaction*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2291
the rear-view mirror; the wing mirror *le rétroviseur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 2611
the reasoning *le raisonnement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2247
the reception desk; the reception (party) *la réception*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 2761
the receptionist *le réceptionniste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 2761
the recipe; the takings *la recette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2139
the reckless driver, the road hog *le chauffard*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 1951
the reduction, the price cut *le rabais*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 2923
the reef *le récif*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 2961

the refund *le remboursement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 2729
the registered letter, registered post *le recommandé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 2929
the registration, the enrolment *l'inscription*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2447
the regulations, the rules; the payment *le règlement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 380, p. 2471
the reign *le règne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2113
the remedy, the cure *le remède*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2303
the renewal *le renouvellement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2497
the rent *le loyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1001
the repercussion, the knock-on effect *la répercussion*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2285
the report, the feature (on TV, radio or in a paper) *le reportage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 281, p. 1851
the requirement, the demand *l'exigence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2491
the rescuer *le sauveteur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 1995
the resignation *la démission*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2315
the resistance; stamina *la résistance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2133
the resit (exam); catching up *le rattrapage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2459
the resolution, the firm decision *la résolution*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2435
the rest area (on a motorway); the area *l'aire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 2661
the retired person, the pensioner *le retraité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2051
the return *le retour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1539
the revision; the service (of a car) *la révision*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2453
the ride, the journey (from A to B) *le trajet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 2673
the right *la droite*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 803

the ring road (round a city) *le périphérique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 2599
the rise, the increase *la hausse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 286, p. 1883
the risk *le risque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 372, p. 2421
the road sign; the panel *le panneau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 435, p. 2817
the road surface, the carriageway *la chaussée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 2655
the rockfall, the landslide *l'éboulement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 1989
the rolling pin *le rouleau à pâtisserie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2177
the roof gutter, the rain gutter *la gouttière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 2861
the route, the itinerary *l'itinéraire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 2823
the rubble, the debris *les décombres*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 1989
the rumour *la rumeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 1877
the salad bowl, the mixing bowl *le saladier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2151
the sales *les soldes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1341
the same *pareil / pareille*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1467
the same two Latin verbs, and the opposite solution — Spanish kept them apart *être / ser · estar*
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The same writing, with a clock
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 47, p. 429
the savings, saving *l'épargne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 2541
the scam, the rip-off (informal) *l'arnaque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 288, p. 1895
the scanner gate (at security); the portico *le portique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 2705
The Scene — c'était, il y avait, il faisait froid
chapter topic; Chapter 258, p. 1701
the school report; the bulletin *le bulletin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2441
the scoop, the exclusive story *le scoop*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 285, p. 1877

the scooter (kick or electric) *la trottinette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 2691
the scratch; a stripe *la rayure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2013
the sea *la mer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 633
the seashell; the shellfish *le coquillage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 2961
the secondary school (ages fifteen to eighteen) *le lycée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2441
the secondary-school pupil *le lycéen*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2441
the section, the regular feature (in a paper) *la rubrique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 282, p. 1857
the semester, the half-year *le semestre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2447
the sentence, the penalty; sorrow *la peine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 2521
the sewer, the drain *l'égout*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 2867
the shipwreck *le naufrage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2001
the shock, the crash *le choc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 1957
the shop sign; the brand *l'enseigne*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 2861
the shop window; the display case *la vitrine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 442, p. 2861
the shortcut *le raccourci*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 2823
the shutter *le volet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 430, p. 2785
the shuttle (bus or train) *la navette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 2685
the skid; a slip-up *le dérapage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 297, p. 1951
the skill, the competence *la compétence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2347
the sleeping bag *le sac de couchage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 2755
the slip road; the strap *la bretelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 2599
the slope, the incline *la pente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 2941

the socket (for electricity), the plug; the hold *la prise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 2779
the software, the program *le logiciel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 2571
the solidarity *la solidarité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2385
the south *le sud*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 797
the spark *l'étincelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 1983
the special correspondent *l'envoyé spécial*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 281, p. 1851
the speed camera; the radar *le radar*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 2649
the spoonful *la cuillerée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2139
the squad, the brigade *la brigade*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 1913
the squirrel *l'écureuil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 2967
the stag, the deer *le cerf*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 2967
the stain, the spot *la tache*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 429, p. 2779
the stairs *l'escalier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 589
the start of the school year; the return *la rentrée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2033
the statement (from a bank); the reading *le relevé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 2917
the stationer's *la papeterie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 2879
the statistic; statistics *la statistique*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 286, p. 1883
the stay; the living room *le séjour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 2761
the step, the leg; a stop on a journey *l'étape*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1827
the step (to get something done); the gait *la démarche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 385, p. 2503
the stereotype *le stéréotype*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2371
the steward (on a plane) *le steward*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 2711

the stomach *l'estomac*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 451
the stopover, the port of call *l'escale*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 2723
the storey, the floor (of a building) *l'étage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 2761
the storm, the gale *la tempête*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3005
the stream, the brook *le ruisseau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 2949
the street lamp; the floor lamp *le lampadaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 441, p. 2855
the street sale, the clearance market *la braderie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 2923
the stretcher *la civière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 1971
the strike *la grève*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2335
the striker *le gréviste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2335
the subscriber *l'abonné*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1833
the subscription; the season ticket *l'abonnement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 390, p. 2535
the subtle difference, the shade *la nuance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2247
the suburbs *la banlieue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1449
the sugared almond *la dragée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2039
the summit, the top; the summit meeting *le sommet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 454, p. 2935
the sun *le soleil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 639
the supporter (of an idea) *le partisan*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2253
the supposition, the assumption *la supposition*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2391
the survivor (of a disaster) *le rescapé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2001
the suspicion; a hint *le soupçon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 1927
the swindler, the con artist *l'escroc*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 288, p. 1895

the take-off *le décollage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 2717
the tank (for fuel); the reservoir *le réservoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 2617
the tap, the faucet *le robinet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 2773
the task, the duty *la tâche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 359, p. 2341
the teenager, the adolescent *l'adolescent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2033
the television news *le journal télévisé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1845
the tenant *le locataire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2045
the tent *la tente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 2755
the test, the exam paper; the ordeal *l'épreuve*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 379, p. 2465
the textbook, the manual *le manuel*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2453
the thermometer *le thermomètre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 2973
the thesis, the position argued for *la thèse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2191
the thief *le voleur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2509
the threat *la menace*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 289, p. 1901
the throat *la gorge*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 445
the throne *le trône*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2113
the ticket inspector *le contrôleur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 2679
the ticket office, the counter window *le guichet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 2673
the tide *la marée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 458, p. 2961
the tiered wedding cake *la pièce montée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2039
the time, the era, the period *l'époque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1821
the toast (with a drink); toasted bread *le toast*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2095

the tobacconist *le buraliste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 2905
the tolerance *la tolérance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2477
the tourniquet *le garrot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 1971
the tow truck, the breakdown lorry *la dépanneuse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 2629
the town hall *la mairie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753
the town walls, the ramparts *les remparts*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 439, p. 2841
the track, the platform number; the way *la voie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 2679
the trade union *le syndicat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 358, p. 2335
the traffic jam; the cork *le bouchon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 2661
the training, the education *la formation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 360, p. 2347
the tram *le tramway*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 415, p. 2691
the trial *le procès*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2515
the trolley (for luggage or shopping) *le chariot*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 414, p. 2685
the truth *la vérité*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1659
the turbulence *la turbulence*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 2723
the tyre *le pneu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 2623
the underground, the metro *le métro*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 779
the unemployed person *le chômeur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2321
the unemployment *le chômage*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2321
the update *la mise à jour*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 2571
the user *l'utilisateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 2565
the username, the login *l'identifiant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 2565

the verdict *le verdict*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 387, p. 2515
the victim *la victime*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 2527
the viewer (of television) *le téléspectateur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1845
the virus *le virus*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 2591
the volunteer; unpaid, voluntary *le bénévole*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2385
the volunteering, unpaid work *le bénévolat*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 366, p. 2385
the waistcoat; the cardigan; the life jacket (gilet de sauvetage) *le gilet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 2735
the washbasin *le lavabo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 2773
the watchmaker, the clockmaker *l'horloger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 2899
the weather forecast; the weather *la météo*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 460, p. 2973
the weekly (paper or magazine) *l'hebdomadaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1833
The Welded Teens
chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 161
the west *l'ouest*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 797
the whisk; the whip *le fouet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2151
the wild boar *le sanglier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 459, p. 2967
the will (legal) *le testament*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2063
the wind *le vent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 645
the windscreen *le pare-brise*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 2611
the wine merchant *le caviste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 445, p. 2879
the wish; the vow *le vœu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2095
the witch *la sorcière*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 321, p. 2101
the withdrawal *le retrait*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 2917

the witness *le témoin*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 2527
the world *le monde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 803
the wound, the cut *la plaie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 1963
the yeast; baking powder *la levure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2177
(theatre) company, troupe; troop *la troupe*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3313
then *puis*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 717
there is, there are — literally it has there, and the y is a Latin word for there that survives nowhere else *il y a*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
they are — the hiss against ils ont's buzz *ils sont, elles sont*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
they have — the form that refuses to look like the rest *ils ont, elles ont*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
thigh *la cuisse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3081
Thin, Big, Heavy, Light, Sweet
chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 699
thin, slim *mince*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 699
thirst *la soif*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 463
thirteen — three-ten, with both halves now legible *treize*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
thirty *trente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 771
this evening *ce soir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
this is, that is — ce plus est, with the elision you have been hearing since l'eau *c'est*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 367
Thread, Needle, Nail for hammering, Hammer, Ladder
chapter topic; Chapter 230, p. 1533
three *trois*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73
three languages, one retreat — and it spread by contact, not coincidence *passé simple · Präteritum · passato remoto*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 18, p. 213

Three More Ways to Use a Verb
chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 391
thrilling, exciting *palpitant*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 523, p. 3369
thunder *le tonnerre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1527
Thursday — the day of Jupiter *jeudi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
Timides et sociables
chapter topic; Chapter 466, p. 3013
tiredness *la fatigue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 463
to access, to reach *accéder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 2565
to accuse *accuser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 386, p. 2509
to achieve *réaliser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1413
to acquit; to pay off *acquitter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 1939
to act *agir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to adapt (mostly reflexive, s'adapter) *adapter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2409
to add *ajouter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1221
to admire *admirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
To admire, To act, To move forward, To move back, To lower
chapter topic; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to admit *admettre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2203
to adopt *adopter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 492, p. 3175
to advise *conseiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to aim (at) *viser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 374, p. 2435
to alert, to warn *alerter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 1977
to allow *permettre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1215
to alter (a garment); to touch up *retoucher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 2891

to announce *annoncer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1221
to annoy, to get on someone's nerves; (s'énerver) to get worked up *énerver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3031
to answer *répondre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
to appear *apparaître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1221
to applaud *applaudir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1401
To applaud, To cross, To increase, To decrease, To warn
chapter topic; Chapter 208, p. 1401
to apply (for a job) *postuler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 354, p. 2309
to approve (of) *approuver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2253
to argue a case, to give reasons *argumenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2253
to arouse, to give rise to *susciter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2285
to ask — an ordinary, polite, everyday word, and one of the sharpest false friends French holds for an English speaker *demander*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 28, p. 287
to ask for, to demand; to claim *réclamer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 2791
to, at — one letter, Latin ad, and the accent that keeps it apart from the verb a *à*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 375
to attack, to assault *agresser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 289, p. 1901
to attempt *tenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1419
to attend, to go regularly to; to spend time with *fréquenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 375, p. 2441
to authorise, to allow *autoriser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2477
to avoid *éviter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1227
To Be, and the Three Verbs Inside It
chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 229
to be bored *s'ennuyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025

To be bored, To have fun, To get angry, To worry, To smoke
chapter topic; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to be born *naître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1395
To be born, To die, To grow old, To marry, To divorce
chapter topic; Chapter 207, p. 1395
to be enough *suffire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1569
To be enough, To burn, To throw away, To calculate, To hit
chapter topic; Chapter 236, p. 1569
to be silent *se taire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1419
To be silent, To fear, To attempt, To transport, To kill
chapter topic; Chapter 211, p. 1419
to be wary, to distrust (se méfier) *méfier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3075
to be worth *valoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1587
to beat *battre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2151
to begin *commencer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
To begin, To visit (a place), To answer, To put, To believe
chapter topic; Chapter 137, p. 969
to believe *croire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
to bet *parier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3225
to betray *trahir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3193
to bite *mordre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 3093
to bivouac, to sleep out in the open *bivouaquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 2755
to bleed *saigner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to block; to freeze (reflexive, se bloquer) *bloquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 2591
to blush *rougir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to board; to take along *embarquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 418, p. 2711
to boil *bouillir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2157

to book *réserver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1383
To book, To spend, To save, To order, To dry
chapter topic; Chapter 205, p. 1383
to borrow *emprunter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1257
to brake *freiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1425
to break *casser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1389
to break (a rule, the law) *enfreindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2485
To break, To touch, To taste, To heat, To cool down
chapter topic; Chapter 206, p. 1389
to break up; to break *rompre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3169
to breastfeed *allaiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 308, p. 2021
to breathe *respirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to bring about, to cause; to provoke *provoquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2259
to bring up, to raise *élever*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3187
to broadcast; to spread *diffuser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 1863
to brown on top, to cook with a crust *gratiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2163
to browse; to sail *naviguer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 2585
to build *construire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1551
to bump into, to knock against; to offend *heurter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 2667
to burgle, to break into *cambrioler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 287, p. 1889
to burn *brûler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1569
to bury *enterrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2057
to buy *acheter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to calculate *calculer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1569

to call / to call oneself *(s')appeler*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
to camp *camper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 425, p. 2755
to cancel *annuler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2415
to cancel (a booking, an order) *décommander*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 2729
to capsize; to tip over *chavirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 2741
to carry; to wear *porter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to cash in, to take (money); to take (a blow) *encaisser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 2911
to cause *causer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2259
to celebrate *célébrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 316, p. 2071
to celebrate *fêter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1245
to change *changer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1209
to change planes, to pass through *transiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 2705
to channel-hop; to skip *zapper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 3381
to charge (an account); to cut up *débiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 450, p. 2911
to chase *poursuivre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1425
to chat *bavarder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to chat up, to flirt with (informal); to dredge *draguer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3143
to cheat *tricher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 499, p. 3219
to check *vérifier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1557
to choke (as s'étouffer); to suffocate, to stifle *étouffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 3093
to chop, to mince *hacher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2145
to christen, to baptise; to name *baptiser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 309, p. 2027

to claim (with a hint of doubt) *prétendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2185
to clarify *clarifier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2227
to clean *nettoyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to clear away (after a meal); to get rid of *débarrasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 529, p. 3405
to clear away (snow, rubble) *déblayer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 2867
to clear of snow, to plough *déneiger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 2867
to clear (of the sky); to free *dégager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 2979
to clear up, to make clearer *éclaircir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2227
to climb *grimper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3213
to climb (up) *gravir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 2941
to clink glasses, to drink to *trinquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2095
to close — from Latin firmāre, "to make firm," so a French door is not shut but made fast; the same verb gave Italian "to stop" and Spanish "to sign" *fermer*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 313
to collapse, to cave in (as s'effondrer) *effondrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 303, p. 1989
to collect *collectionner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3231
to come alongside, to dock; to approach (someone) *accoster*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 2741
to come back *revenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to come from, to originate in *provenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2277
to come near *s'approcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to come out, to be published; to seem *paraître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1839
to comfort, to console *consoler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3043
to commemorate *commémorer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2133

to comment on *commenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 1871
to commit (mostly reflexive, s'engager); to hire *engager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2427
to compare *comparer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
To compare, To advise, To convince, To criticise, To prove
chapter topic; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to compensate *dédommager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 2805
to complain *se plaindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1407
to concede, to grant *concéder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2203
to conclude *conclure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2247
to confess, to admit *avouer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 1939
to confirm *confirmer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 421, p. 2729
to connect; to log in (reflexive, se connecter) *connecter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 395, p. 2565
to conquer; to win over *conquérir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2121
to consider, to plan on *envisager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 373, p. 2427
to continue *continuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to contradict *contredire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2197
to convince *convaincre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to cook *cuisiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to cool down *refroidir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1389
to copy *copier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 2577
to correct *corriger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1245
To correct, To direct, To destroy, To exaggerate, To celebrate
chapter topic; Chapter 182, p. 1245
to cough *tousser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1599

To cough, To tremble, To scream, To vote, To welcome
chapter topic; Chapter 241, p. 1599
to count *compter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to crash (as s'écraser); to crush *écraser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2001
to crash into, to hit *percuter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 2667
to crash (of a computer, informal); to plant *planter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 2591
to credit, to pay into *créditer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 2917
to criticise *critiquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to cross *traverser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1401
to crown *couronner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2113
to cry *pleurer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to cuddle *câliner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3149
to cut *couper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to damage *endommager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 307, p. 2013
to deal (cards); to hand out *distribuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 500, p. 3225
to debate, to discuss *débattre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2191
to deceive; to be unfaithful to *tromper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3193
to decide *décider*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to declare *déclarer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 2705
to decorate *décorer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 318, p. 2083
to decrease *diminuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1401
to deeply upset, to overwhelm; to turn upside down *bouleverser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3049
to defeat, to overcome *vaincre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2121

to defend *défendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1257
to delay, to hold up *retarder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 2723
to delete; to remove *supprimer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 2577
to deliver *livrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to demand, to require *exiger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2477
to demonstrate (in the street); to show *manifester*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2855
to dent *cabosser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 1957
to deny *nier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2209
to deny, to refute (officially) *démentir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 1871
to depend *dépendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1227
To depend, To share, To avoid, To throw, To turn
chapter topic; Chapter 179, p. 1227
to deserve *mériter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1575
to destroy *détruire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1245
to devour *dévorer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3349
to die *mourir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1395
to digest *digérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3119
to direct *diriger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1245
to disappear *disparaître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1257
to disappoint *décevoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3043
to disapprove (of) *désapprouver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 345, p. 2253
to discover *découvrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
To discover, To seem, To serve, To suffer, To dream
chapter topic; Chapter 149, p. 1043

to discriminate (against) *discriminer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 365, p. 2377
to discuss *discuter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
to dismiss, to lay off *licencier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2315
to disobey *désobéir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3187
to disturb, to bother *déranger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 2791
to dive *plonger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3281
to divorce *divorcer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1395
to do DIY, to tinker *bricoler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 3419
to do one's hair *se coiffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1563
to doubt *douter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 338, p. 2209
to download *télécharger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1251
to drain *égoutter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2171
to draw *dessiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to dream *rêver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to dress up (as se déguiser); to disguise *déguiser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2077
to drift; to derive *dériver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 2741
to drill, to pierce *percer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 531, p. 3419
to drink *boire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to drip *goutter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 2773
to drive *conduire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
to drizzle *bruiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 461, p. 2979
to drown (as se noyer); to flood *noyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 304, p. 1995

to dry *sécher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1383
to dust *épousseter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 3399
to dye *teindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 2891
to eat *manger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to embroider *broder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3199
to empty *vider*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1557
To enjoy, To imagine, To point out, To inform, To complain
chapter topic; Chapter 209, p. 1407
to enjoy, to make the most of *profiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1407
to enrol, to register (mostly reflexive, s'inscrire); to write down *inscrire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 376, p. 2447
to entrust; (se confier) to confide *confier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3149
to envy *envier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3069
to escape; to slip from (one's hands) *échapper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 296, p. 1945
to evacuate, to clear *évacuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 301, p. 1977
to evaluate, to assess *évaluer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2235
to exaggerate *exagérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1245
to exchange *échanger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1251
to exclude, to rule out *exclure*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 383, p. 2491
to exist *exister*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1437
to expire; to breathe out *expirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2497
to explain *expliquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
To explain, To translate, To decide, To try, To continue
chapter topic; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to explode, to blow up *exploser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 302, p. 1983

to express *exprimer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1437
to face, to take on *affronter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3269
to fail (an exam); to run aground *échouer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2459
to favour, to encourage *favoriser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2297
to fear *craindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1419
to feed *nourrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1605
to feel; to smell *sentir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to fill *remplir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1557
to fill in a form *remplir un formulaire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
To fill, To empty, To measure, To weigh, To check
chapter topic; Chapter 234, p. 1557
to film *filmer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 1863
to find *trouver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 541
to fine, to write up (a driver) *verbaliser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 2649
to finish — and the second regular family, which grows an extra syllable in the plural *finir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 41, p. 391
to finish, to end with *pour finir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1771
to fish; to catch (fish) *pêcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 497, p. 3205
To fix, To brake, To function, To float, To chase
chapter topic; Chapter 212, p. 1425
to fix, to stare at *fixer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1425
to flash (of a speed camera), to catch speeding *flasher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 2649
to float *flotter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1425
to flood *inonder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3005
to fly over *survoler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 2717

to fly, to steal *voler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1581
to fold *plier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to follow (from), to result from *découler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2259
to forbid *interdire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1215
to foresee, to plan for *prévoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
to forget *oublier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to frame (a picture) *cadrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3237
to free, to set free *libérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2133
to freeze *geler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 2991
to frighten, to scare *effrayer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3037
to function, to work *fonctionner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1425
to garden *jardiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3243
to generate, to give rise to *engendrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2277
to get a flat tyre; to burst *crever*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 2623
to get angry *se fâcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to get dressed *s'habiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
to get engaged (as se fiancer) *fiancer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2039
to get going again (after a breakdown); to help out *dépanner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 2629
to get married (as se marier); to marry (a couple), to marry off *marier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 311, p. 2039
to get off (a boat or plane), to land *débarquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 422, p. 2735
to get one's bearings (mostly reflexive: s'orienter); to guide *orienter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 2811

to get used to *s'habituer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1587
to get worse *empirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1575
to give *donner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to give a present *offrir un cadeau*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1413
to give back *rendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1413
to give birth *accoucher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3181
to give in, to give way; to hand over *céder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 337, p. 2203
to give up *renoncer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1251
To give up, To exchange, To download, To ski, To slip
chapter topic; Chapter 183, p. 1251
to go (and, oddly, "to be" in "how are you?") *aller*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 33
to go by (as s'écouler, of time); to sell off (goods) *écouler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1813
to go for a walk *se promener*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to go for a walk (mostly reflexive: se balader); to take round *balader*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 2835
to go on holiday *partir en vacances*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1605
to go round, to bypass *contourner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 2823
to go with *accompagner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1221
to grate *râper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2145
to greet *saluer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1203
to grow old *vieillir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1395
to grumble, to moan *rouspéter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 2791
to guarantee *garantir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 393, p. 2553
to haggle, to bargain *marchander*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 2923

to hang out (washing); to spread out *étendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 3387
to hang (up), to hook *accrocher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 3393
to happen, to occur *se produire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 989
To Have, and How Old You Are
chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 195
to have fun *s'amuser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to have the festive late-night dinner *réveillonner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 319, p. 2089
to heal, to cure; to get better *guérir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3131
to hear — from a Latin verb meaning "to stretch toward," so English's intend is its closest surviving cousin, and French still keeps the older sense in entendu and s'entendre *entendre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 303
to heat *chauffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1389
to help — English aid arriving by the Latin road, while English help came by the Germanic one; the two words are unrelated *aider*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 287
to hide *cacher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to hinder, to hamper *entraver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2297
to hire, to take on *embaucher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2321
to hit, to knock *frapper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1569
to hold *tenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1209
to honk, to sound the horn *klaxonner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 2611
to hope *espérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
to hum *fredonner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3299
to hurry *se dépêcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1587
to imagine *imaginer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1407

to improve *améliorer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1575
to improvise *improviser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 513, p. 3305
to increase *augmenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1401
to influence *influencer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2277
to inform *informer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1407
to inherit *hériter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 315, p. 2063
to injure, to hurt; (se blesser) to hurt oneself *blesser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 479, p. 3093
to insist *insister*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1593
To insist, To interrupt, To tie, To mix, To obey
chapter topic; Chapter 240, p. 1593
to inspect, to check; to control *contrôler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 408, p. 2649
to install; to set up *installer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 2571
to interrupt *interrompre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1593
to interview *interviewer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 283, p. 1863
to introduce *présenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1233
to invade; to overrun *envahir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 324, p. 2121
to invest *investir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 2541
to investigate *enquêter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 2527
to invite *inviter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1203
to iron *repasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1551
To iron, To repair, To build, To photograph, To repeat
chapter topic; Chapter 233, p. 1551
to irritate, to get on someone's nerves *agacer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 469, p. 3031
to joke *plaisanter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1605

to judge *juger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 342, p. 2235
to jump *sauter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to jump, to start (with surprise) *sursauter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3037
to justify *justifier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2291
to kill *tuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1419
to kiss *embrasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1203
To kiss, To greet, To thank, To invite, To park
chapter topic; Chapter 175, p. 1203
to knead *pétrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2177
to knit *tricoter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3199
to knock out, to eliminate *éliminer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3263
to knock over, to run over; to spill *renverser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 298, p. 1957
to know (a fact) *savoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to know (a person, a place) *connaître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
To know (a person, a place), To prefer, To hope, To drive, To get dressed
chapter topic; Chapter 138, p. 975
to land *atterrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 2717
to last *durer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1807
to laugh *rire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 493
to laugh, to have fun (informal) *rigoler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3063
to lead to, to bring about; to train *entraîner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 346, p. 2259
to leaf through *feuilleter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 520, p. 3349
to learn *apprendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to leave (something); to let *laisser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529

to lend *prêter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1233
to lessen, to soften *atténuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2303
to lie, to tell lies *mentir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 468, p. 3025
to lift *soulever*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1431
To lift, To surprise, To suspect, To squeeze, To suggest
chapter topic; Chapter 213, p. 1431
to like AND to love — one French verb where English keeps two, so the strength comes from what follows it, and adding bien makes it WEAKER *aimer*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 28, p. 287
to limp *boiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 480, p. 3099
to listen to *écouter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to live *vivre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to live / to dwell (a second -er verb — same pattern) *habiter*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
to lodge, to stay; to put up *loger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 2749
to look after, to treat, to nurse *soigner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3131
to look at, to watch *regarder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to look for *chercher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to look like *ressembler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1239
To look like, To push, To pull, To waste, To overtake
chapter topic; Chapter 181, p. 1239
to lose *perdre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 517
to lose weight *maigrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1605
To lose weight, To feed, To go on holiday, To joke, To tidy up
chapter topic; Chapter 242, p. 1605
to lower *baisser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to maintain *entretenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1437

to maintain, to claim; to support *soutenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2185
to make up for, to compensate *compenser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2303
to make worse, to aggravate *aggraver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2303
to march past, to parade; to scroll *défiler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 317, p. 2077
to marry *épouser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1395
to measure *mesurer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1557
to meet *rencontrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to memorise *mémoriser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2453
to mislay; to get lost (s'égarer) *égarer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 2811
to miss, to be missing *manquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1575
To miss, To deserve, To improve, To get worse, To offer
chapter topic; Chapter 237, p. 1575
to mist up (mostly reflexive: s'embuer) *embuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 402, p. 2611
to mix *mélanger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1593
to mix up, to blur; (se brouiller) to fall out *brouiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 495, p. 3193
to move away *s'éloigner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
To move away, To come near, To chat, To plug in, To deliver
chapter topic; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to move back *reculer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to move forward *avancer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1063
to move house *déménager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1563
To move house, To rent, To rest, To wake up, To do one's hair
chapter topic; Chapter 235, p. 1563
to move in *emménager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 312, p. 2045
to move (something) *déplacer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1209

to move, to touch (emotionally) *émouvoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3049
to narrate, to tell *narrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 322, p. 2107
to note, to record (what happened) *constater*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 411, p. 2667
to notice *remarquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
To notice, To replace, To meet, To blush, To bleed
chapter topic; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to obey *obéir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1593
to object, to say in reply *objecter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2197
to observe *observer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
To observe, To take part, To go for a walk, To fold, To own
chapter topic; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to occur, to arise unexpectedly *survenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1807
to offer *offrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1575
to open — an -ir verb that takes -er endings, from a Latin verb reshaped to look like its own opposite, and the source of English overt and overture *ouvrir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 313
to order *commander*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1383
to organise *organiser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 995
to overflow; to go beyond *déborder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 465, p. 3005
to overtake *dépasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1239
to overtake; to double *doubler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 410, p. 2661
to own *posséder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037
to pace up and down; to stride along *arpenter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 2835
to paint *peindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to park *garer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1203

to park, to be parked *stationner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 407, p. 2641
to pass away, to die (formal) *décéder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 314, p. 2057
to paste; to stick *coller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 2577
to patrol *patrouiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 291, p. 1913
to pay *payer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to pay back, to refund *rembourser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 394, p. 2559
to pay damages to, to indemnify *indemniser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 433, p. 2805
to peel *éplucher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2145
to penalise, to sanction *sanctionner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2485
to perform, to play (a role); to interpret *interpréter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 515, p. 3319
to persuade *persuader*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 335, p. 2191
to phone *téléphoner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
to photograph *photographier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1551
to pick (flowers, fruit) *cueillir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1257
to pick up *ramasser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1233
to pitch (of a boat); to sway *tanguer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 423, p. 2741
to play *jouer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to plug in *brancher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1049
to point out *indiquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1407
to polish, to wax *cirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 2885
to post, to publish *publier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 398, p. 2585
to postpone, to adjourn *ajourner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1813

to postpone, to put off *reporter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2415
to pour; to pay in *verser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2151
to praise; (se vanter) to boast *vanter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3055
to pray *prier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to precede, to come before *précéder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1807
to prefer *préférer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 975
to preheat *préchauffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 327, p. 2139
to prepare *préparer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1233
To prepare, To introduce, To lend, To propose, To pick up
chapter topic; Chapter 180, p. 1233
to presume *présumer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2391
to prevent, to stop (from) *empêcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 352, p. 2297
to print *imprimer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1839
to promise *promettre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1215
To promise, To allow, To forbid, To protect, To rescue
chapter topic; Chapter 177, p. 1215
to propose *proposer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1233
to protect *protéger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1215
to protest *protester*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 363, p. 2855
to prove *démontrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1031
to prove *prouver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 1927
to pull *tirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1239
to pump up, to inflate; to swell *gonfler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 404, p. 2623
to punish *punir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 2521

to push *pousser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1239
to put a stamp on, to frank; to free *affranchir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 2905
to put in a frame; to supervise *encadrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3337
to put in the oven *enfourner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2163
to put on weight *grossir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1437
to put; to put on *mettre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
to put together, to assemble *assembler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 501, p. 3231
to put up (a guest) *héberger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
To put up, To pray, To recommend, To slow down, To breathe
chapter topic; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to qualify, to tone down (a view) *nuancer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2247
to quarrel *se disputer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
to question, to interrogate *interroger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 1933
to reach *atteindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1413
To reach, To achieve, To give a present, To give back, To recognise
chapter topic; Chapter 210, p. 1413
to react *réagir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 351, p. 2291
to read — from a Latin verb that first meant "to gather," which is why reading, electing, collecting and being elegant all turn out to be the same act *lire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 29, p. 295
to realise *se rendre compte*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1587
to reason, to think logically *raisonner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 344, p. 2247
to reassure *rassurer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 470, p. 3037
to receive *recevoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to recognise *reconnaître*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1413

to recommend *recommander*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to reconcile; (se réconcilier) to make up *réconcilier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 475, p. 3069
to record *enregistrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1437
To record, To maintain, To exist, To express, To put on weight
chapter topic; Chapter 214, p. 1437
to recount, to relate *relater*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 1871
to recruit *recruter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 356, p. 2321
to reduce *réduire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1581
To reduce, To refuse, To risk, To solve, To fly
chapter topic; Chapter 238, p. 1581
to refuse *refuser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1581
to regret; to miss *regretter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 472, p. 3049
to reign, to rule *régner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 323, p. 2113
to release, to let go; to loosen *relâcher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 295, p. 1939
to remedy, to put right *remédier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 353, p. 2303
to remove a stain from; to untie *détacher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 447, p. 2891
to renew *renouveler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2497
to rent *louer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1563
to repair *réparer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1551
to repeat *répéter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1551
to repeat a year (at school); to increase *redoubler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 378, p. 2459
to repeat, to rebroadcast *rediffuser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 525, p. 3381
to replace *remplacer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1069
to report, to point out *signaler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 432, p. 2799

to report, to relate; to bring back *rapporter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 1871
to rescue *sauver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1215
to rescue, to help *secourir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 1971
to resign, to quit (a job) *démissionner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 355, p. 2315
to resist, to hold out *résister*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 326, p. 2133
to resole *ressemeler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 2885
to rest *se reposer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1563
to restart, to reboot *redémarrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 399, p. 2591
to restore; (se rétablir) to recover *rétablir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 485, p. 3131
to result (from) *résulter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 349, p. 2277
to resuscitate, to revive *réanimer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 300, p. 1971
to retort *rétorquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 336, p. 2197
to reveal, to disclose *révéler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 284, p. 1871
to revise, to study for (an exam); to service (a car) *réviser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 377, p. 2453
to rinse *rincer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 3413
to risk *risquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1581
to rock (a baby) *bercer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 493, p. 3181
to roll out, to spread *étaler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2177
to row *ramer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 509, p. 3281
to rub, to scrub *frotter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 3399
to rumble; to scold *gronder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 462, p. 2985

to run — Latin currere, the root under current, course, courier and curriculum, and the verb that shows why chien palatalized its c and courir did not *courir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 303
to salt (food, roads) *saler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 443, p. 2867
to save (a file); to safeguard *sauvegarder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 397, p. 2577
to save (money) *économiser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1383
to save up (money); to spare *épargner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 391, p. 2541
to schedule, to plan; to program *programmer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 371, p. 2415
to score; to mark *marquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3255
to scratch; to itch *gratter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3113
to scream *hurler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1599
to screen (a film); to plan; to project *projeter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 524, p. 3375
to sculpt, to carve *sculpter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 517, p. 3331
to search (a bag, a person) *fouiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 417, p. 2705
to season *assaisonner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2171
to seem *sembler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to sell off cheap *brader*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 452, p. 2923
to send *envoyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 529
to send off, to ship *expédier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 2905
to sentence, to condemn *condamner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 388, p. 2521
to separate; (se séparer) to split up *séparer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 491, p. 3169
to serve *servir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to set off, to trigger *déclencher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 350, p. 2285

to settle (a bill), to pay; to adjust *régler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 451, p. 2917
to sew *coudre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 496, p. 3199
to sew back on, to stitch up *recoudre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 446, p. 2885
to share *partager*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1227
to shave (often se raser); to raze *raser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 448, p. 2899
to shift, to move (a time) *décaler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 420, p. 2723
to shiver (with cold) *grelotter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 2991
to shout *crier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to show *montrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to sign *signer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1019
to sign (a book for someone) *dédicacer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 521, p. 3355
To sign, To fill in a form, To phone, To discuss, To quarrel
chapter topic; Chapter 145, p. 1019
to simmer; to cook up (a plan) *mijoter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 330, p. 2157
to sit down — a verb you do to yourself, from Latin sedēre, and the one French verb that ships with two accepted sets of forms *s'asseoir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 31, p. 313
to skate *patiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 510, p. 3287
to sketch, to outline *esquisser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3325
to ski *skier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1251
to skid *déraper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 2605
to sleep — Latin dormīre, unchanged in French, and the source of dormitory and dormant, though not of the dormouse *dormir*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 30, p. 303
to slice thinly *émincer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 328, p. 2145

to slip *glisser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1251
to slow down *ralentir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1055
to smile *sourire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to smoke *fumer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to sneeze *éternuer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 482, p. 3113
to snore *ronfler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3137
to snow *neiger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1221
To snow, To go with, To add, To announce, To appear
chapter topic; Chapter 178, p. 1221
to soak; to dip *tremper*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 3393
to sob *sangloter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 471, p. 3043
to solve *résoudre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1581
to solve, to clear up *élucider*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 293, p. 1927
to sow *semer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3243
to speak / to talk (your first regular -er verb) *parler*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
to specify, to make precise *préciser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 341, p. 2227
to speed up, to accelerate *accélérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 2605
to spend (money) *dépenser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1383
to spin (dry), to wring *essorer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 3387
to splash about, to wade; to flounder *patauger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 2949
to spoil (a child); to ruin *gâter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 494, p. 3187
to spot; to find one's way (se repérer) *repérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 434, p. 2811
to sprain (as se fouler); to tread on *fouler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 299, p. 1963

to sprinkle, to dust *saupoudrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2171
to squeeze *serrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1431
to stall (an engine); to wedge *caler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 2605
to stamp (a ticket) *composter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 2679
to stand — French has no single verb for it, so the movement is se lever ("to lighten yourself") and the state is être debout, literally "on end" *se lever, debout*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 313
to start up (a car, an engine); to get going *démarrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 403, p. 2617
to state firmly, to assert *affirmer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 334, p. 2185
to stay for a while, to spend time (somewhere) *séjourner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 424, p. 2749
to sting, to bite (of insects); to prick *piquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 306, p. 3093
to stir, to move *bouger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1257
To stir, To pick, To defend, To disappear, To borrow
chapter topic; Chapter 184, p. 1257
to stop *arrêter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1209
to stop and question (police); to call out to *interpeller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 294, p. 1933
to stop at, to serve (a place); to clear away (after a meal) *desservir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 413, p. 2679
To stop, To change, To move, To take off, To hold
chapter topic; Chapter 176, p. 1209
to stream, to run down (of water) *ruisseler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 456, p. 2949
to stress, to point out; to underline *souligner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 343, p. 2241
to stretch; (s'étirer) to stretch (oneself) *étirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3249
to stroke, to caress *caresser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 487, p. 3143
to stroll, to wander about *flâner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 2835

to study *étudier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to stumble, to trip *trébucher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 455, p. 2941
to succeed, to come to a result; to lead to *aboutir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1813
to suffer *souffrir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1043
to suggest *suggérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1431
to sulk *bouder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3013
to suppose, to assume *supposer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 367, p. 2391
to surprise *surprendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1431
to survive *survivre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 305, p. 2001
to suspect *soupçonner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1431
to sweat, to perspire *transpirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 464, p. 2999
to sweep *balayer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 528, p. 3399
to swell *enfler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3105
to swindle, to con *escroquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 288, p. 1895
to switch off, to put out *éteindre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to switch on, to light *allumer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1007
To switch on, To switch off, To jump, To smile, To shout
chapter topic; Chapter 143, p. 1007
to take into hospital, to hospitalise *hospitaliser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 313, p. 2051
to take off, to remove *enlever*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1209
to take off; to unstick *décoller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 419, p. 2717
to take out, to withdraw *retirer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 392, p. 2917
to take part *participer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1037

to take place, to be held *avoir lieu*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1807
to take — the grasping verb English borrowed a dozen times over, from prehensile to prison to surprise *prendre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 28, p. 287
to taste *goûter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1389
to taste, to savour *déguster*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 332, p. 2171
to teach *enseigner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 505
to tease (playfully) *taquiner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 466, p. 3013
to tell (a story) — and the backbone of a told story: the scene, the events in order, and the turn *raconter*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1711
to testify, to give evidence *témoigner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 389, p. 2527
to thank *remercier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1203
to thaw *dégeler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 463, p. 2991
to think — from a Latin verb meaning "to weigh," which is why English pensive, ponder, compensate, expense and even the flower pansy all sit in one family *penser*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 295
to threaten *menacer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 289, p. 1901
to throw *lancer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1227
to throw away *jeter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1569
to tickle *chatouiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 474, p. 3063
to tidy up *ranger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1605
to tie, to fasten *attacher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1593
to tie up (with string) *ficeler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 449, p. 2905
to time (with a stopwatch) *chronométrer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 508, p. 3275
to tolerate, to put up with *tolérer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 381, p. 2477

to touch *toucher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1389
to tow *remorquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 405, p. 2629
to transgress, to break (a rule) *transgresser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 382, p. 2485
to translate *traduire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to transport *transporter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1419
to tremble *trembler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1599
to try *essayer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1013
to tune (an instrument); to grant *accorder*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3293
to turn *tourner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1227
to turn aside, to divert *dévier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 409, p. 2655
to turn back (rebrousser chemin) *rebrousser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 436, p. 2823
to turn golden, to brown; to gild *dorer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 331, p. 2163
to turn off, to fork *bifurquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 400, p. 2599
to turn out (of a tin) *démouler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 333, p. 2177
to turn the wheel (hard); to aim *braquer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 401, p. 2605
to twist, to wring; (se tordre) to twist (a joint) *tordre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 481, p. 3105
to unblock; to uncork; to come out (onto) *déboucher*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 428, p. 2773
to understand — literally com- + prendre, "to take together," so in French understanding IS grasping, and the verb conjugates exactly like the one it is built from *comprendre*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 29, p. 295
to unfold, to take place (as se dérouler); to unroll *dérouler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1807
to uninstall *désinstaller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 396, p. 2571
to unite *unir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1587

To unite, To be worth, To get used to, To realise, To hurry
chapter topic; Chapter 239, p. 1587
to unpack *déballer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 426, p. 2761
to use *utiliser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 511
to validate (a ticket); to approve *valider*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 412, p. 2673
to visit (a place) *visiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 969
to vomit, to be sick *vomir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 483, p. 3119
to vote *voter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1599
to wait for *attendre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 523
to wake up *se réveiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1563
to walk about, to wander *déambuler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 2835
to walk — and also to work, so ça marche is the most useful two words in the chapter; its own origin is genuinely unsettled between a Frankish verb and a Latin hammer *marcher*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 303
to wander, to roam *errer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 438, p. 2835
to want — and why je voudrais is the form you will actually use *vouloir*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 37, p. 359
to warm up; (s'échauffer) to warm up (before sport) *échauffer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3249
to warn *prévenir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1401
to wash *laver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 499
to waste *gaspiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1239
to water (plants) *arroser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3243
to weigh *peser*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1557
to welcome *accueillir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1599

to whisk, to whip *fouetter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 329, p. 2151
to whisper *chuchoter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 488, p. 3149
to whistle softly (a tune) *siffloter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 512, p. 3299
to whistle; to boo *siffler*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3255
to win; to earn *gagner*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 535
to wipe, to dry *essuyer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 530, p. 3413
to wish *souhaiter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 320, p. 2095
to work (a third -er verb — and the origin of "travel") *travailler*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 5, p. 63
to worry *s'inquiéter*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1025
to wrap (up), to pack; to thrill (informal) *emballer*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 453, p. 2929
to write — Latin scrībere, "to scratch," with a propped-up é- that French added in front of every borrowed sc-, sp- and st- word *écrire*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 29, p. 295
to write, to draft (a text) *rédiger*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1839
to yawn *bâiller*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 486, p. 3137
today *aujourd'hui*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723
toe *l'orteil*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 477, p. 3081
together *ensemble*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1455
Tomber malade et guérir
chapter topic; Chapter 485, p. 3131
Tool, Guitar, Piano, Violin, Drum
chapter topic; Chapter 256, p. 1689
toothpaste *le dentifrice*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 827
Toothpaste, Shampoo, Comb, Bin, Broom
chapter topic; Chapter 114, p. 827
torch, flashlight *la lampe de poche*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3213

Tortoise, New, Old, Fast, Easy
chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 675
tournament *le tournoi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 507, p. 3269
Tout à coup
chapter topic; Chapter 270, p. 1783
Tout d'abord
chapter topic; Chapter 268, p. 1771
Tree, Flower, Leaf, Mountain, River
chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 627
trei-ze — which half is which
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 14, p. 161
tripod *le trépied*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 502, p. 3237
Trop de travail
chapter topic; Chapter 361, p. 2353
trousers *le pantalon*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 765
Trousers, Shoes, Hat, Coat, Skirt
chapter topic; Chapter 104, p. 765
Trouver son chemin
chapter topic; Chapter 434, p. 2811
Trouver un accord
chapter topic; Chapter 337, p. 2203
Trouver un remède
chapter topic; Chapter 353, p. 2303
trumpet *la trompette*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 511, p. 3293
Trunk, Thorn, Lawn, Path, Cave
chapter topic; Chapter 254, p. 1677
trust *la confiance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1269
Tuesday — the day of Mars *mardi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
twelve — the second welded teen, and the one that shows the pattern *douze*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
twenty — a single inherited word again, and the base French will later count in *vingt*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
twist, new development *le rebondissement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 519, p. 3343
two *deux*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 73

two days later, the day after next *le surlendemain*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1801
Two Ideas, One Sentence
chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 383

U

Un bon roman
chapter topic; Chapter 519, p. 3343
Un grand jour
chapter topic; Chapter 311, p. 2039
Un mystère
chapter topic; Chapter 293, p. 1927
Un petit accident
chapter topic; Chapter 411, p. 2667
Un pneu à plat
chapter topic; Chapter 404, p. 2623
uncomfortable *inconfortable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105
underneath *dessous*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 723
Une agression
chapter topic; Chapter 289, p. 1901
Une exposition
chapter topic; Chapter 518, p. 3337
Une fuite dans la salle de bains
chapter topic; Chapter 428, p. 2773
Une grande déception
chapter topic; Chapter 471, p. 3043
une heure — one o'clock
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 8, p. 101
Une jambe dans le plâtre
chapter topic; Chapter 480, p. 3099
Une journée de pêche
chapter topic; Chapter 497, p. 3205
Une mauvaise chute
chapter topic; Chapter 299, p. 1963
Une mauvaise entorse
chapter topic; Chapter 481, p. 3105
Une naissance
chapter topic; Chapter 308, p. 2021
Une nouvelle maison
chapter topic; Chapter 312, p. 2045

une question — the question you make with your voice alone
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
Une série à suivre
chapter topic; Chapter 523, p. 3369
une seule règle — both halves are the same fact
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 245
unfair, unjust *injuste*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 364, p. 2371
unfortunately *malheureusement*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1287
unhappy, dissatisfied *mécontent*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 431, p. 2791
unknown *inconnu / inconnue*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1111
unless *à moins que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 368, p. 2397
unlikely, hard to believe *invraisemblable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 340, p. 2221
unpleasant *désagréable*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1105
unpredictable *imprévisible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 370, p. 2409
until *jusqu'à*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1275
until then, up to then *jusqu'alors*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1795
up there *là-haut*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1449
useful *utile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1299
useless *inutile*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1299

V

Vacuum, Laundry, Washing powder, Iron, Pocket
chapter topic; Chapter 115, p. 833
vain, conceited *vaniteux*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 473, p. 3055
valid; fit, able-bodied *valide*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 384, p. 2497
Valley, Temperature, Butterfly, Fly, Mosquito
chapter topic; Chapter 194, p. 1317

Vase, Plant, Seed, Root, Branch
chapter topic; Chapter 228, p. 1521
vegetables *les légumes*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 859
Verbs of the Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 295
(vert, jaune, continued) — jaune
grammar topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 283
very — Latin trans, 'across', which crossed over into an intensifier and takes no de at all *très*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 415
vīgintī — the number French counts in
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 173
vinegar *le vinaigre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 877
Vol annulé
chapter topic; Chapter 421, p. 2729
Volcano, Plain, Waterfall, Rock, Pebble
chapter topic; Chapter 171, p. 1179

W

waiting room *la salle d'attente*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 484, p. 3125
Want, Can, Must
chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 359
war *la guerre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1143
War, Peace, Army, Soldier, Tradition
chapter topic; Chapter 165, p. 1143
wardrobe (for hanging clothes) *la penderie*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 527, p. 3393
washing machine *la machine à laver*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 526, p. 3387
washing powder; the washing *la lessive*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 833
water bottle, flask *la gourde*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 498, p. 3213
water — the most worn-down word French ever took from Latin *l'eau*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 13, p. 153
watercolour *l'aquarelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 516, p. 3325

watering can *l'arrosoir*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 503, p. 3243
we are — and the only plural that keeps the regular ending *nous sommes*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
we have — and the ending is finally something you can hear *nous avons*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
weak *faible*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 687
Weather
chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 275
weather — le temps means BOTH "time" and "weather," the SAME Latin tempus polysemy as Spanish's tiempo; il pleut keeps Latin's pl- UNCHANGED, unlike Spanish's llueve *le temps, il pleut*
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 25, p. 275
wedding (celebration) *les noces*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3155
wedding ring; alliance *l'alliance*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 489, p. 3155
Wednesday — the day of Mercury *mercredi*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 89
weight training, bodybuilding *la musculation*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 504, p. 3249
well / good / fine *bien*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
wet *mouillé*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 711
Wet, Week, Month, Morning, Always
chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 711
What I Think, and So — je pense que, donc
chapter topic; Chapter 260, p. 1719
what's your name? (literally "how do you call yourself?") *comment vous appelez-vous?*
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
what, standing on its own — the stressed twin of que, and the one that survives after a preposition *quoi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
What the Ear Cannot Hear
chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 399
what — the partner of qui, and the one that always elides *que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407

Wheel, Engine, Toll, Motorway, Fine
chapter topic; Chapter 227, p. 1515
when — and a silent d that comes back to life *quand*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
when (careful style) *lorsque*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1777
where — and the accent that separates it from a completely different word *où*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
Where French Changes Its Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 173
Where Two Words Melt Into One
chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 375
which one *lequel / laquelle*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 983
while, whereas *tandis que*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1777
whistle *le sifflet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 505, p. 3255
white — a Germanic word in a Latin language, running against the traffic *blanc*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 16, p. 183
who — Latin quis, unchanged in twenty centuries, and the shortest question in French *qui*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 407
why — and the answer word that is built to match it *pourquoi*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 349
Wind, Fire, Hill, Desert, Wave
chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 645
wine — the word that refused to wear down, in any language *le vin*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 13, p. 153
wings, backstage *les coulisses*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 514, p. 3313
winner, victor *le vainqueur*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 506, p. 3263
winter — literally "the wintry season" *l'hiver*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 133
with a cold *enrhumé / enrhumée*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1125
wool *la laine*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1185
work (of art) *l'œuvre*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 518, p. 3337

worried *inquiet / inquiète*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1125
Worried, With a cold, Single, Married, Divorced
chapter topic; Chapter 162, p. 1125
worry, anxiety *l'inquiétude*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 476, p. 3075
Would — the conditionnel, and Six Lines
chapter topic; Chapter 267, p. 1763
Writing — Four Lines, And The Joiner That Moves Nothing
chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 431
Writing — My Own Line
chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 427
Writing — With A Clock
chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 429

Y

yes *oui*
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 22, p. 265
Yes and No
chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 265
yesterday *hier*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 729
Yesterday, Often, Sometimes, Town, Street
chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 729
you are — and the circumflex marks the s that used to be there *vous êtes*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
you are — two letters, and it sounds like a single vowel *tu es*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 229
you (familiar / formal) *tu / vous*
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 21
you have — plural, and polite to one person *vous avez*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
you have — the informal one, and it sounds exactly like the last one *tu as*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 195
you're welcome (literally "of nothing") *de rien*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 3, p. 33
young *jeune*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 693
younger (sibling); youngest *le cadet*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 490, p. 3163

Your own line — the first writing with no model
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 46, p. 427
youth, young people *la jeunesse*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 310, p. 2033

Z

-ze — the ten you keep meeting
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 14, p. 161
zero *zéro*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 963
Zero, Sixty, Seventy, Ninety, Thousand
chapter topic; Chapter 136, p. 963

Other

œ — one letter, not two
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 12, p. 141